

Independent Medicare & ACA Agents — Voices by Theme

Appendix to *Health-Insurance-Agents-Research*. For every measured theme, the most engaged voices (up to 20) in full, with replies and source links. Live page: <https://vincestars-cloud.github.io/campaign-previews/health-insurance-agents/research/>

Tab 1 — Fears

Money spent on leads that don't pay back · 64 documents · 20 voices

"State Farm just rewrote 19,000 agents' contracts overnight. If you think a captive book is a retirement plan, read this If you somehow missed it: State Farm is moving all 19,000 of its agents onto a single standardized contract, ending their deferred-comp/retirement program (AIPP), and dropping health insurance for agents and spouses. Agents are reportedly looking at 30–40% less on base commissions depending on contract and book size. I can't believe State Farm disputes that number but hasn't offered its own. The core shift is from getting paid to "retain" a book to getting paid to "write new business". They also put buyout offers on the table with a Sept 30 deadline. P&C side, I know. But the lesson isn't carrier-specific and it's the thing I keep coming back to: you never actually owned that book. State Farm did. And a 20-year "trailing income" promise is only worth as much as the carrier's willingness to keep paying it which turned out to be "until it's inconvenient." The part that should get every agent's attention is the direction, not the one carrier. Comp is going performance-based across the board, trailing/renewal-style income is getting squeezed, and AI is going to absorb more of the service and retention work that used to justify those trails. The "come build a \$3–5M book and coast" pitch a lot of us were sold is quietly being retired. So I'm genuinely curious how the room sees it: Are you seeing comp pressure at your carrier/IMO too, or is this a State Farm-specific overreach? Does owning your book independently actually protect you here, or is that just trading carrier risk for lead-cost/chargeback risk? For the newer agents is anyone factoring "can they rewrite my deal in 5 years" into where they sign? Not trying to dunk on State Farm agents since a lot of them got blindsided and it's a rough spot. More interested in what this says about where the whole comp model is heading."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/

↳ MonLower (39): "Feeling good about being independent and part of multiple agent associations. While this industry is far from perfect, this is the best place to be in my estimation. I feel bad for the SF agents that are up against serious changes. State Farm is quite offended by Progressive taking their spot and is looking to get more flexible to compete. My carriers have lowered commission rates, but often times will renege due to our agencies ability to place with other carriers. Overall, comp has decreased in my 15 years but not to the point of being unsustainable. A few percentage points with most large carriers."

↳ Splodingseal (19): "It's a shit or get off the pot approach. They want agents that are hungry to write as much business as possible and to get rid of Bob and his secretary that kinda coast along only writing as much as he needs to keep the lights on."

↳ firenance (18): "Independents are more insulated as carriers tend to influence performance with contract terminations or adjusting profit share or bonus commission metrics. They don't like you, they just fire you."

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

↳ Heavy_Following_1114 (19): "You view it as a job, not a career, You have an income requirement that's initially unattainable, You're intimidated by being undercut, You don't have a solid support system, You need to be nurtured, You're not driven enough, You never learned sales and marketing, You don't forge good enough relationships with clients, You don't study enough, You don't adapt, You're not an effective communicator, You aren't familiar with the markets, You don't have enough confidence in your products, You don't have a mentor, You don't market online, You don't do enough prospecting, You don't try hard enough, You don't stay on top of trends, You don't use new technology, You don't network enough, You don't treat your role as a business, Your expectations are too big from the start, Your expectations are too small from the start, You didn't get a quality education and training, You aren't focused enough, You didn't save enough money to support yourself while you grow a book, You're using dead-end leads, You don't have the right mindset, You're not qualifying your clients, You're too emotional, You're easily intimidated, You're not hungry enough to succeed, You're selling insurance and not solutions, You don't know how to set appointments, You're not a good presenter, You're not picking the right carriers for your prospects, You're not locking down the markets, You're not offering enough value, You don't have enough practical knowledge, You're focusing on the wrong things, You have too much freedom, You're limiting yourself, You're not making good first impressions, You're not following up enough, You're following up too much and scaring clients away, The job is too stressful, You lack patience, You're not making yourself available enough for your clients, You're not being proactive, You're not participating enough in your community"

↳ ThatWideLife (12): "There's one main reason why agents leave, they are in poverty with a full time job. Insurance is great for those who live with parents and have minimal bills. I'd say for a majority of people, they don't have a year to sit back and hope they start making money."

↳ [deleted] (10): "Selling isn't for most people. Selling insurance isn't for most sales people.. selling life insurance isn't for 99% of licensed insurance agents.. I just started a few months ago and I write 5K issued AP per week on a bad week, 7K -8K on average weekly with a high of 11K weekly... this sht isn't rocket scientist like everyone makes it seem. It's ad spend, closing ratio and systems."

"Legit life insurance wfh job I recently took a job with primerica not realizing it was an mlm after the fact I'm following through and getting my licensing because they provided that but after that does anyone have any legit recommendations for an entry level wfh not mlm insurance company I don't mind them being 1099 but I don't want to have to spend a lot on leads when I'm just learning"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 42 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f816tw/legit_life_insurance_wfh_job/

↳ joeboo5150 (31): "Probably an unpopular opinion here, but WFH when you are new to the industry and have no experience is a bad idea. You need to be in the office of whoever you are working for, learning, watching other agents and staff, asking questions, soaking up everything you can. Once you know what you are doing, working from home is perfectly fine as a producer. I always tell my producers that I don't care when or where they sell, as long as they're selling. It's totally up to them. But it's going to take 5x as long for you to learn and get comfortable while working from home, in my experience. If you want to be selling and making money as quickly as possible, you don't want to start out working from home."

↳ Traditional_Bad3852 (7): "I've been doing health insurance from home for about 3 years so I was just trying to transition into it but I understand what your saying it just wouldn't be possible with my schedule I'm doing all of this when I get off of my current job because I've only found 1099 if I were to find a salary office I would gladly take it"

↳ joeboo5150 (7): "Gotcha. I assumed you were new to the industry since you are just now getting licensed."

"To form an LLC or to not form an LLC? 🤖 🤖 That is the question.... 🤖🤖 Many people get the advice to spread out their liability and form an LLC with a business. If you are forming practically any other business, I would almost always say yes, go for it. In the insurance business, however, there are costs as well as administrative and compliance considerations to consider when forming an entity that could make things unnecessarily complicated for you in the beginning. In addition, for most independent agents E&O insurance is required for carrier appointments and covers you in the case of liability for any errors or omissions that pose the highest risk of liability. Now if you're concerned that maybe you go door-to-door or do appointment setting or something along those lines and an old lady trips and falls and blames you for it, that's a whole nother story of liability and perhaps a reason that you should form an LLC. The risk of that is very low in that regard, unless tripping old ladies is something that you're accustomed to. There are three scenarios in which I tell independent agents to go ahead and form an entity. 🤖1 - you already have high Revenue Revenue can get to a certain point where you can file to be taxed as a corporation and get owner's distribution to lower overall tax burden. 🤖2 - you have high production There are certain carriers in the industry that are worth having and also require an entity in order to attain certain contract levels (compensation levels). Some carriers also require an entity if you have downlines or a certain number of downlines. 🤖3 - you have downlines (agents working for your agency) When other people's income start to get involved, other people's families, other peoples things, etc. it is always smart to have an LLC to limit your liability as a company. It's smart and it protects you from that liability of the many, many things that could potentially happen as business grows. I tend to advise not to give yourself an extra headache by forming an entity early. If you are going solo and are holding contracts independently, an entity typically does not need to be formed until these scenarios arise. A DBA is just fine until you produce, you get agents, or you get high enough revenue for a tax advantage. 🤖🤖 Please consult with a lawyer and CPA, as I am not a lawyer or a CPA, and this does not constitute official or licensed legal or financial advice."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mp3psz/to_form_an_llc_or_to_not_form_an_llc_that_is_the/

↳ noneyet1 (3): "Great points. It is also worth noting that some states make LLC's register with the Secretary of State whenever they get a nonresident agency license. That means they need to file income taxes there even if they didn't make any money in that state. it really adds an extra burden of costs because you have to pay your CPA whether you made money or not."

↳ zenbusinesscommunity (3): "This is a really solid breakdown and really covers the practical considerations well. One thing to keep in mind is that even if you start as a sole proprietor or use a DBA, having a clear plan for separating business and personal finances can save headaches down the line. Getting an EIN from the IRS early on, for example, makes it easier to open a business bank account and track income and expenses cleanly. It's also worth thinking about privacy, like using a registered agent can keep your personal address off public filings if you do eventually form an LLC."

↳ RedditInsuranceGuy (2): "I agree, organizationally, thats solid advice."

"Lead Generation New Agent, started in Jan as a W2, VERY low base salary with a commission split and no agency marketing or lead generation happening at the firm level. Everyone is on their own. I am struggling big time on getting lead generation going. Have been trying social media but have gotten virtually nothing from this. I've also been going to several leads/networking groups, have gone to about 3 meetings each. Do I door knock at this point? Looking for any tips or guidance.....feeling very defeated. I've quoted and called on the x-dates that were available and got a few from this but that's about it. I've asked for referrals on each sale I have done. Not getting any guidance from the principle."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1shk3tg/>

↳ (0): "It's tough, I've been there. u/idx-just-a-username has great info, I agree with all of that. I have a friend who drove around and walked into local businesses cold-calling, every morning from 8am-noon, for months. He would just go door to door, ask to quote their commercial insurance, ask questions & make notes if they said yes, then go on to the next one until noon. Then he'd eat his lunch, and quote all afternoon. It took a few months, but he got to where he was writing \$100k/month in new business off those. I was more focused on personal lines when I started; I met with realtors and mortgage lenders, had 5-7 coffee meetings with them every week, and if we hit it off I'd try to schedule a time to visit one of their sales meetings at their office. Hit it off with more lenders/realtors, rinse and repeat. Refer realtors to the lenders you really like, so they want to refer their clients to you. This is how I've built my business; it's a great way to go. Takes some time to get going, but once you do, you're living on referrals, not cold calls. Referrals are a MUCH higher close ratio, and way more fun to work. In the early months, when I was building that up, I spent money on leads. I put them on credit cards if I couldn't afford to pay cash. I don't recommend that, but whatever. I did it. I tried Dave Ramsey leads, Datalot (I think they have another name now?), Hometown, and a bunch of others. Ramsey & Datalot were the best, but also the most expensive. Datalot are live leads; they literally transfer them to you. There's a commercial insurance version of this too called Tivly; they're worth looking up. Any leads you buy will be expensive, but if you need to manufacture some business quick, it can work. There are also Aged leads you can buy for cheaper than hot ones. If you work up a good Aged lead script, and you're willing to be told 'No' a bunch, they can be good. I would also sponsor events, sports teams, etc. Go to the nonprofit, talk with them, say you want to do a fundraiser, and see if they'll help you market it on their socials. I'd put out there with groups that followed those charities that I was raising money for their charity; if you'd get a quote from me, I'd donate \$20 to that charity. No obligation to buy anything, just get a quote. Lots of those quotes turned into business, because lots of them had been meaning to shop their insurance anyway, and this was the excuse they needed. Use being the 'new guy' to your advantage. I used to walk into local businesses and say "Hey, I'm new, just started out at xyz insurance agency down the road. I just wanted to stop by and meet the neighbors!" See if anybody there will talk to you, make it low key, be interested in them, ask questions, etc. Honestly, activity breeds opportunity. The more you're out there, talking to people, being in the community, you're going to get opportunities to quote. If you're not winning quotes, then maybe you need a different agency, or you need to evaluate your sales process, but it sounds like right now you just need more opportunities. Good luck! The first 6 months are tough, but this is a KILLER career if you can make it."

↳ (0): "Thanks for everyone's words of encouragement and feedback. Apparently I was a day late and dollar short. Boss calls me at 4:45 Friday afternoon to let me know he is letting me go. Said I hadn't brought any business in. I asked when would he pay the commission on the 50k+ WP I brought in and he said he didn't realize I wrote it although I sent him a monthly excel sheet. SMH As much as it sucks being laid off, it's for the best. Clearly, this office was not the right fit so now I move on. Still a gut punch, was laid off at 50 and now again at 51. Never have I experienced this."

↳ (0): "I'm assuming you're selling commercial based on the networking groups. Doing what you're doing now will only help you, about 2-3 years down the road though. But you already answered your own question. Get a list of x-dates and make a lot of calls. A new agent's greatest asset is time. You have no defense to play, no book to service. You can spend that time on social media, networking, cold-calling or doing all 3. The former 2 are long term plays, the latter is immediate impact. If cold-calling makes you nervous, just remember that you could be the agent that sheds light on a coverage gap that could have ended the business's existence, or reduce a balance sheet expense enough that they can hire a new employee. That's why we're professionals. Key to calling, in my opinion, is having the xdate. If you call in that 2-3 month period prior to renewal, they're thinking about it, they'll talk (not all of them of course). You call after they renew, it's a dead horse, you're a pest. I use Insurance Xdate because they are really easy to use and seem to be the only ones that actually have Workers Comp xdates, but at this point there are a couple options for insurance specific data. PS Feeling defeated is definitely part of the business. Just wait until you pick up a deposit check on a 500k deal only to have the check canceled b/c the owner's son is golf buddies with the incumbent...then get BOR'd on the monoline Umbrella. That was over a decade ago and I still want to throat punch that sack of shit Tim."

"AMEN! i have been on a similar journey. i left my last IMO after i had a "wait a second, am i in a cult?" realization. it was led by a psychopathic narcissist, so that was the culture. like every psychopathic narcissist, there was the underlying truth and there was the surface of the mask and when in it, it can be hard to tell the difference. the surface mask was, "we are here to help people, we are here to support each other, we are so special". the underlying truth was that it was an MLM style parasitic predatory organization whose leadership was all about grabbing the money bag and draining as much blood from as many people as possible whether they were agents (through low commissions and crazy overpriced junk leads) or clients. they preyed on the vulnerable, the leader surrounded himself with women who had backgrounds in drug addiction, trauma, abusive parental and romantic relationship histories. later on i learned from women who had left that the founder/leader was sexually predatory and pressured women there to sleep with him by making them feel indebted to him for "saving" them. i was banned from my cult's group chat bc people asked me for help with better lead sources bc i was shooting up the leaderboard while everyone else was struggling so i shared some sources i was using and succeeding with. they punished and smeared me for that. so i left with 2 other top 10 leaderboard agents and started my own agency. several other top agents left to join other imo's at the same time we left. my old imo started me at 60% commission levels and 45% for GI. i start people with zero experience at 75-90%. my cult IMO charged \$27 per callback data lead that they made bank on. i offer leads that i make zero dollars on and it is pay per presentation for \$25 with a 20% min close rate promise (i'm closing double that rate and i am not an elite closer), not pay per lead who doesn't even answer the phone. cult imo was recruiting like 50 agents per week. we don't run recruiting campaigns and limit our growth according to how many leads we can provide our agents to make sure everyone is well fed. my cult IMO preached "only 8% of agents make it" but at my agency we make it our problem to solve if a full time agent is not writing at least \$15k AP per month. my cult IMO punished people for leaving, smeared them with made up lies, would call the new uplines of people who left to try and blacklist them. we have an open release policy and would always go out of our way to make any transition out as friendly and peaceful as possible. there are good IMO's and agencies out there. i can recommend some if people are looking."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1q6lb33/when_integrity_collides_with_the_insurance/hy9dvtm/

"This is one of the best videos you've put out Peter. The truth people need to hear even though they don't want to hear (clearly from the comments) There is no "lead vendor" that's going to give you the types of leads he described (multiple times) - I know it's crazy and an unimaginable thing to think of but guess what....are you ready for it?.....wait.....IN BUSINESS YOU HAVE TO ACTUALLY MARKET!!!!!! Why would you assume the product you sell is any different than anything else? Marketing is 90% of any business. If you're not getting your brand out there and marketing then you have no business. Learn how to market and sales become a lot easier. Learn how to market and you'll never run out of people to talk to. There's no way around it."

— YouTube · The Best Life Insurance Leads For 2024 | My \$500k/Yr Lead Source · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gtXNK0-8f7c&lc=Ugz11fJk41aKk9iSog94AaABAg>

↳ @davidmooney4112 (0): "Self gen is a lead source. I think what people were hoping to hear is how his business goes about self generating leads (how he runs his marketing)."

↳ @legacyfirst (0): "@davidmooney4112 he's already got videos on that"

↳ @Eternalsuav (0): "@davidmooney4112well that's what the title says"

"Not weird at all, especially when you are nervous and need to prepare for the appointment. You get a feel for your clients during door knocking and helps you better prepare for the actual appointment. As a insurance agent always act busy 😊 "

— YouTube · How This Insurance Agent Made Six-Figures Door Knocking With ZERO Leads! · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LPSZiiOXFJA&lc=UgwiqTx4gCnb32pip54AaABAg_9WFy6cpDZ779WI-S2JnjHe

"None of my prospects are answering my calls after setting an appointment I'm just asking for a bit of advice and wisdom here. About a week or more ago I made a post about having trouble cold calling in the supplementary insurance industry. After changing my approach, this week I've had people be very responsive and receptive. I've gotten about 4 or 5 enthusiastic "yes" to appointments, as well as more neutral/curious yeses for a total of about 8 appointments for people ready to listen to the product and possibly buy. However, literally none of these prospects save for one have answered the phone when I call them in the appointed time. Is this normal? What could be the cause for an enthusiastic or very curious "yes" to completely ghost? My experience with sales has mostly been with warm leads or D2D approaches, so I'm very new to converting a cold call into a sale. I'm assuming it's just a form of sales that requires a lot of follow up but I'd like to see what you guys think. Here's my current approach:

1. Open with an upbeat tone ask if I'm talking to the person. 2. Give empathic line similar to "I know you weren't expecting this call. If this is a bad time you can let me know..." something like this. This was a change I made that worked surprisingly well and has pretty much gotten 90% of my leads to stay on the line curious on what I have to say, which was something I'd been struggling with for a while. 3. If they say it's a good time, I give a quick elevator pitch to pique their interest and test the waters if they want to know about the product fully at that moment or if we should set an appointment. Most times we set appointment. 4. A few of these have even given me their free time before I even ask them so they kinda close the appointment for me. So we set the time and I put it on the agenda. Then I call them and... radio silence. I usually send a text to let them know and call a few days later but still nothing. Today I have a long list of follow ups from the ones from last week to see if they pick up today. Assuming it's on me and it's not just the nature of the cold calling in the supplemental insurance industry, my suspicion is that I'm messing up somewhere in the follow up. I haven't gotten any answer from any of my texts so maybe I'm scaring them off? I dunno. Any feedback would be greatly appreciated!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qrb80b/none_of_my_prospects_are_answering_my_calls_after/

↳ InstructionOk3766 (6): "I would strongly recommend automating reminders. Use every channel available. Email. SMS. Phone calls. Voicemails. Every missed follow up is a leak in your funnel. Plug those leaks and the same leads you already have will start producing far more revenue over time. If you are serious about growth, this massive fix you can make."

↳ theluchador19 (3): "The client should be getting automated emails and texts without you having to do it for the follow up. Also it sounds like they just are saying anything to get you off the line and are too polite to say "I'm not interested". Maybe a little more forceful? That way they can tell you, no I'm not interested"

↳ DJSimmer305 (3): "When you call someone for an appointment are you calling them from a phone number that can send text messages? If so, this is what you need to do: When you set the appointment with the person, send them a text message while you are still on the phone with them. It can be a picture of your business card, your license, or even just "hi this is u/hey2394". I recommend sending your business card because it likely has your face on it and it humanizes you to the prospect. Tell them to just reply to that message "got it" or "okay" so you can confirm they received it and have your number saved. Do not let them hang up before they reply back. The reason you need them to reply is because when you send them reminders, the will see in the conversation that they replied and it reminds them that they actually spoke to you "oh yeah, this was the guy I talked to yesterday. I liked him." Immediately after you hang up send another message: "Hi John, it's u/hey2394. We just spoke on the phone. You're all set for Wednesday at 2:30pm. I value both your time and mine, so please let me know if anything changes or you need to reschedule. Looking forward to speaking with you again." Send them reminders leading up to the appointment as well and on the day of, also ask them to reply back and confirm that 2:30 is still a good time."

"Following to hear others input. We have been struggling with quality leads as well. And I'm not talking we expect to close every deal, but we have purchased a ton of internet leads who said that they never requested a quote in the first place (InsuranceQuotes, Everquote, etc.). We understand its a numbers game at the end of the day. But we at least want a chance to win their business, and we aren't even getting that most of the time and just spending money on leads with 0 potential."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1orzwmm/leads/nnu829f/>

"Inbounds suck for a number of reasons: 1. Scam Central: most inbounds are generated in Pakistan and India. Literally the guys scamming your Grandma out of your inheritance are the ones providing inbounds to you, with entry-level scammers starting in lead generation before moving on to ripping off Americans. 2. Legal Pandora's Box: India and Pakistan will not comply to Federal TCPA rules. They will call everyone - even on the DNC - and you, and your upline, bear the legal risk. I had a good agent of mine buy one of these leads earlier this year and had to settle for five figures for just one phone call. 3. Did I Mention They're A Scam? These call centers are known to share client information, list information, and rework the leads over and over again. There are organizations that sell "pre-sold leads," which includes all major information about the client, claiming they call ahead of time to collect the information before passing it along to the agent to sell. Unbeknownst to the agent, they resell this information over and over again and you end up with huge chargebacks. I think Facebook ads are a much more durable, long-lasting, and safe lead generation solution. You own the leads, you control the ad creative, and you have a track record of the client opting in. Plus, you can scale upward to the level you're comfortable with, and can tie in pre-set appointments or call-ins for added benefit. Lastly, if you don't want to do it yourself, there are many good lead management options available that will do all of the above."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oxuubl/is_this_a_good_offer/np4s2v6/

"They are gonna say "oh yeah, we got a lot of hot internet leads and in-bound calls. We usually give the warm-leads to the juniors to cut their teeth." The fact of the matter is you're gonna be grinding cold calls for months to a couple years, you will have to show activity s until you get decent leads. Occasionally you'll get some hot transfers; then once in a blue moon a bunch of hot leads will fall in your lap because everybody got too busy, somebody quit, or you happen to call a cold lead who was just about to turn hot. Honestly, the book Fanatical Prospecting is a solid quick read to prepare you for the cold call mindset. It's pretty straight forward, practical, and easy to remember. Its so practical that it sounds like you should already know these things about prospecting LOL. It'll help you workflow your calls for the day and qualify leads so you don't burn out on dead leads. Unless you're lucky, most agents won't teach you how to prospect, they'll teach basic selling techniques, presenting the product and maybe, maybe teaching you how to effectively close. Prospecting is an important technique and skill to learn, it extends past the phone and you'll start to see everyday situations to potentially to prospect for future customers."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wl6371/i_just_became_licensed_in_pc_shortly_becoming/pawdym3/

"Aged Leads Store Question about those leads because I don't want to get on anyone's shit list. Are those leads TCPA compliant?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k24g9p/aged_leads_store/

↳ Bright_Breadfruit_30 (3): "They areyou only hear shit from people that do not understand what it means to work aged leads. They are good about communicating with clients. I have never had an issue with them. They provide you with exactly what they say they do. That being said the leads are cheap so you got to get many many many of them to work and work them hard to get results. You are better off just getting live transfers and buying real time leads from the vendor of your choice, paying the new price, and selling policies. It is so much more time/cost effective. I started with aged leads working one day a week 5 years ago. I should have just grabbed a few new instead of many aged....productivity would have been so much better all around. Good luck!"

↳ Monskiaactual (3): "You always got to look at your cost for acquisition or CPA when you buy leads and age leads might be really cheap and if they're 50 cents a piece but you have to buy a thousand to get a deal then your cost for acquisition is \$500 alternatively you can buy four or five live transfers and spend \$200 to \$250 or you can buy individual leads 10 to 30 each and spend two to \$300 besides the cost per acquisition there's the time aspect even if it costs the same amount of money it's better to use live transfers or leads because you don't have to work as art and you can close more business in the day Paige leads are great for people that are just starting out and don't have money for good leads You can pop them in a dialer or put them on automation It's not in my opinion a long-term strategy like live transfers or self generated leads are"

↳ Playful-Lab5618 (2): "Thanks for the reply. I just don't want to put my license in jeopardy by calling them. That said, they're simply meant to be for me to fall back on when I run out of new leads."

"Inbound Call Leads for Struggling Life Insurance Agency I run a small life insurance agency that generates leads through Facebook. We do 90% FEX / 10% IUL. 2025 was brutal for us on the FEX side. CPL doubled from ~\$6 to ~\$12 and our pick-up rates are so low I don't have the courage to publish them. We're still getting in touch with 60%+ of leads *eventually*, but that's after considerable effort (and morale) spent and often after they've been approached by other agents. Long story short, our cost per contacted*.*and*~*still-interested lead is high enough that it feels like it's time to jump on the inbound call / live transfer train, if it's not too late. I'd be grateful for advice / recommendations on: ~- How should I vet vendors? ~- What's "market" in terms of price, buffer, etc.? (For 50 leads/day roughly) ~- What should I look for in a contract / trial? Much appreciated."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qcyrm6/inbound_call_leads_for_struggling_life_insurance/

↳ Bright_Breadfruit_30 (3): "I noticed some of the same issues with the fex outbound leads. I have used ttc in the past for leads however for outbound dialing the results are not worth the higher cpl...25 average for fb leads from most vendors so just not worth the extra money (in my opinion anyhow). I have kept my cost at 8 per lead over the last several months but have noticed contact rate has decreased. I think some is the AI interference with answering ...perhaps. I feel like self gen is still the way to go for outbound dialing anyhow. I also am using some messenger ads and call ads...those are still in the test phase for me anyhow. Vendors for live transfers are viable in my book for 50 to 70 dollar live calls if they have a good buffer. World changes pretty fast right now. My plan is to stay consistent ...continue testing new ideas....stay real active while I grow."

↳ Monskiaactual (2): "Make sure when you select a vendor that they have something in place for DNC scrubbing TCPA liability. if you cant identify who owns the company its a bad sign. Prices are \$30-100 per call depending on vendor. though the cheaper ones are random guys overseas.. typical buffer times are 2-3 min Generally you get what you pay for, lower end conversion are 5-10% contracts should be cancelable after a week or two at most. any one who is trying to lock you in or requires a large purchase up front is selling garbage most of the time.. Good vendors have a small one time package to build trust and a allow a try before you buy"

↳ hometown_quotes (2): "FB lead costs doubling is hitting everyone right now. You're not alone in that struggle. Live transfers sound appealing but most vendors in this space are running the same garbage model as low-quality lead gen. They're buying aged data, cold calling people who filled out forms weeks ago, and claiming it's "inbound" because someone answered the phone. Real live transfers where someone actually called in asking for life insurance quotes are rare and expensive. Market rate for quality inbound calls is \$40-\$80+ per transfer depending on demographic and coverage type. Anyone promising \$15-\$20 transfers is either lying about volume or selling recycled contacts. How to vet vendors: Ask directly how they generate the calls. If they get vague about sources or say "we run campaigns," they're probably buying data and cold calling. Real inbound vendors can explain their call flow clearly. Request recorded sample calls before you commit. Listen to how prospects sound. Are they confused? Do they remember requesting information? That tells you if it's actually inbound or just someone who finally answered a cold call. Test volume claims with a small trial first. If they promise 50 transfers a day, start with 10 and see if they deliver consistent quality. Most can't scale without quality dropping hard. Watch for exclusivity clauses or mandatory minimums that lock you in. You want flexibility to walk away if quality tanks. The agents we work with who tried live transfers usually found cost per actual sale was higher than expected once you factor in no-shows, people who weren't actually interested, and transfers that were just cold calls. The math works if you're closing 30-40% but most see way lower conversion. If your current FB setup gets you to 60% contact eventually, you might be better off fixing your speed-to-lead and follow-up process instead of jumping to expensive live transfers. The difference between calling in 5 minutes vs 2 hours is massive for pickup rates."

"In regards to the recycled leads - they end up that way because everyone is too afraid to "resolve" them. Well when I knew I was on my way out, I was begging for more leads. They let me log into the accounts of agents that were no longer there, so what I did before I left was resolve around 350 leads on multiple impact accounts"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fx4zhe/i_hate_american_income_life_ail_so_bad/lqrl6m6/

"New Agent Choosing an FMO vs. Going Direct – Advice Needed! Hello everyone, I'm a newly licensed agent in Virginia, and I'm currently in the process of choosing an FMO to work with. Right now, training and support are my biggest priorities—even more than commission splits—because I know that with excellent training, the money will follow. Primarily, I want to start off offering Medicare (with the hopes to offer my clients ACA & possibly Life at a much later date, after I gain an understanding of the industry, but only as supplements to their needs). It's my understanding that I could work for multiple FMOs, as one may not entirely fulfill my needs. 😊 I've been looking at Gordon Marketing, TR King Insurance Marketing, Ritter, and Redbird, but I've seen mixed feedback. Some people say Gordon Marketing gives off MLM vibes—does anyone here have experience with them? I've also seen advice about finding an upline and then letting them be your contact because going directly to an FMO will get you lost in their hierarchy without direct support and guidance. On the flip side, I came across a comment saying that going direct with carriers (rather than using an FMO) is a better route. I'd love to hear from anyone who's done this: Did you have prior experience before going direct? Do the carriers provide strong training & support, or would I be on my own? For those in Virginia, what are the most prevalent carriers I should consider contracting with? Also, I want to run my own agency and generate my own leads. I'm not looking for an FMO that requires me to buy leads from them or forces me into a specific system. I just want solid training. If, down the line, I decide to buy leads, I'd like the option, but I don't want to be locked into it. I want to set myself up for success long-term and avoid jumping around between FMOs. Any insights or personal experiences would be greatly appreciated! Thanks in advance!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ijykig/new_agent_choosing_an_fmo_vs_going_direct_advice/

↳ NAF1138 (4): "If you want your focus to be on Medicare, I would add, in order, 1) supplemental health (Hospital plans, Cancer plans, home health plans, dental plans.) All of your Medicare clients could likely use some or all of these. 2) Final Expense Life. Easy add on if you just look to fix problems with people's existing life insurance. 3) ACA but not to go after a large ACA book. So you can sell ACA to spouses and referrals. Mostly to grab them as future Medicare clients. 4) annuities. Lots of clients will have CDs, 401ks and other amounts of money that are essentially doing nothing for them. You probably can do number 1 after six months. 2 after 2 years. 3 a year after that. And 4 after you have been in the business for about 6 years. Go slow. Work intentionally. Build a long term business."

↳ NAF1138 (3): "If you want training and support you don't want to go direct. The carriers don't care about you and mostly don't know anything about selling insurance. They are not where you want to be trained. The only exception being the captive sales forces of certain carriers. You also, want to pick ONE of those things in your list. Do not come out the gate trying to sell Medicare, ACA, Annuities and Life. You will never learn to sell any of them that way. They are all different and sometimes conflicting sales processes. They can all easily keep you busy full time. You will essentially be doing 4 jobs full time badly. Of the FMOs you mentioned, TR King is actually run by a decent human who cares about his people. Ritter is good if you know what you are doing or are working with an agent who is running an agency under them, but doing direct to Ritter is the same as going direct to the carrier. Redbird, I don't know anyone who works their but they have a reasonably good reputation. I don't know Gordon Marketing at all. That doesn't mean anything though, no one knows everyone."

↳ voidsarcastic (3): "Like commission rates? Luckily they're all pretty close carrier to carrier so sell the best plan for the client every-time, and every client is different so different plans and carriers work better for different people. Pretty sure MAPD is the same rate for every carrier (315 renewal 650 IEP) however over-rides may be different and some offer HRA bonus. Most supplements are 20-23% annual (first year advance), and dental/HI is like 45-50% annual (first year advance). Be careful some MAPD plans are non-commissionable i do avoid those, but there really aren't many. I have however done no commission part Ds, you gotta do what you gotta do. Life commissions should be between 80%-115% (9 month- 12 month advance) starting out, if you're taking a lower comp from the FMO make sure you are getting lots of support."

"The problem with Globe life is that it can be really good or really bad depending on your branch and manager. Im working with them for about a month and is ok, the leads are from unions so the people that I call they requested so is not that invasive as a cold call. the thing about push people products is kinda a sale thing no matter the field, one thing that works for me is focus on the no cost benefits and just works as I'm hooking people up, be honest to them, if they say they don't want anything do a good deed and give them whatever free benefit you have, as long as they have your contact if one day they need something they gonna call that dude that hooked them up. Also I don't think is a good type of job if you are desperate for money since in the beginning it sucks, they give you old leads since they don't want you to burn bridges with new clients but as soon as you start to book appointments the leads get better, but it take time and lots of calls. I'm not a native english speaker and although I was scared about calling people, as long as you are nice and respectful they will be nice to you. I even make sure to let the ones that dont want to be bothered to know that I will make sure to exclude them from the leads so they wont get calls again, they really appreciate. So before you look for a new company, no matter which one you go, you gotta found a good branch and team, that's gonna make a huge difference, in the end of the day they are all the same. Also, the ones that offers some salary usually sucks in the commission, at least in my case the commission from the get go is already 50% so is not that bad. try to get a normal job, save some money to be good for a couple months and then try again... not having the pressure to have to make money ASAP can makes things easier on you. Good luck."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cy9b7k/im_stuck_at_globe_life_american_income_life_and_i/mra1242/

"that's a honestly great question. I guess I have two sides to it. 1st. Do not leverage yourself past your means for leads as far as I'm concerned that's gambling and not a good idea. 2nd. while the slow grind sucks, I would do what you can to save every dollar to buy high quality leads. buy one a month two a month whatever you can afford and work events out side of that. This industry can snowball and quickly if you provide exceptional customer service. But just because you can make 100K plus commissions easily doesn't mean there isn't people out there and didn't go broke and a lot in my opinion is having bad leads. With good leads it's nearly impossible to lose money, but that's the trick finding good leads I would say for every good source there is 50 bad ones if not more. I went through 30-40 before I found the one I have now. that's just my 2 cents I'm by no way or shape an expert I'm not even with 1 year under my belt I get my story is unique and I got very lucky and swung for the fences. I only did it cause I had the income to burn and it wasn't going to leverage me in the slightest. Even knowing the future I wouldn't have put it on a credit card."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/nnantrn/

"What is insurance? Insurance is a transfer of risk. What is risk? Risk is the likelihood that something happens. Insurance was never and is still not formatted to cover known losses. That is why our "health insurance" is where it is now. We have changed "health insurance" and it is no longer insurance it is a manager of payments. Your example is ridiculous lol because that's not how either of them work."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1othjel/cold_reality_of_aca_from_an_experienced_agent/no4tbz0/

"I do life insurance too, but I do it for worksite versus individual and it's such a game changer. The company I work with actually doesn't make you pay for leads, which was the thing I was worried about the most when I started. We have a few different teams in our office and a lot of people from my team came from individual and they said it's so different so maybe that would be something to consider"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dt0fnh/why_i_left_the_life_insurance_industry/lb713fm/

"I have been in this industry for 14 years and it has become a shell of it's former self. Let me explain. In 2009 is when CMS enacted over 100 new regulations in the Medicare industry. New regulations included annual enrollment periods, government regulated commissions for Part C and D, a Scope of Appointment form that must be completed prior to an agent's presentation, annual AHIP certifications to be able to sell policies in addition to annual carrier certifications, soon after new legislation that required MA plans to have to have a network which killed PFFS plans which were the most popular MA plans at that time, laws which forbids agents to market Part C and D products, laws which govern every aspect of agents holding seminars even including not allowing agents to offer free meals for attendees, the inability to call referrals (the referral must contact you), regulations on carriers that made it illegal for carriers to offer bonuses and trips to agents for production rewards, and many more that I can't think of off the top of my head. After these draconian regulations were passed most agents left the industry. The only ones that stayed were the agents that had a solid book of business prior to these new regulations which is why the average age of a Medicare agent is 60 years old. This industry's golden age was from 1998 to 2008. Medicare Advantage was a brand new concept as well a few years later Part D was brand new as well. There were plenty of reasons why seniors needed to talk with an agent during this time and the big money was made at this time. That all changed in 2009. CMS used the excuse that since agents were getting compensated with taxpayer money (Medicare funding Dollars) that CMS had the right to regulated everything about the agent's existence in this industry. In 2020, very little has changed under the Trump administration. The only good thing to be improved upon was CMS not requiring the Scope of Appointment form to be filled out 48 hours prior to an agent's presentation and changed it to the same day as the appointment. Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as well for fear that the carrier will get in trouble with CMS and lose funding for their plans. Part D plans pay almost nothing for the sheer amount of work that needs to be done reviewing your client's drug list every year that you are almost working for free. MAPD plans pay the same commission as MA only plans. Now if you understand inflation this is another issue as well. The US Dollar loses 2%-3% of it's value every year which causes prices to increase, but you get paid renewals based upon commission rates from the first year you write the business. So while you do make renewals, those renewals become less and less every year. Now that MA plans have ironed out their networks and funding is stabilized, there is little need for seniors to switch Medicare plans every year because they already are in the best plan possible. You can go after T65 business, but that has also become problematic as well. Since Social Security has raised the full benefit retirement age from 65 to 67, most seniors are still working for an employer at 65 and have no need for Medicare coverage until they retire, especially since many spouses are not yet on Medicare and their spouse needs the group coverage. The (un)Affordable Care Act aka Obamacare is terrible and has made major medical coverage too expensive and too restrictive. After 14 years in the industry I have finally realized all that is bad and the bad FAR out weighs the good. The commissions are too small for an agent to make it especially with so few seniors actually needing a better plan plus with everything I previously mentioned you need to be insane to become a Medicare agent in 2020. If you do start off in this industry you need at LEAST 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months of marketing expenses saved or you will run out of money very quick and need to find an hourly job. You must write 100 policies every year to make it in this industry and you will max out at 400 to 500 clients because any more clients and you will have to hire help. So at \$250 commission per client earned every year you are looking at a max of \$100,000 to \$125,000 minus your marketing expenses which will cost you between \$12,000 to \$20,000 per year plus all the gas consumption and wear and tear on your vehicle driving all over town on appointments, double taxes you pay for FICA, Medicare and Social Security taxes, and lack of access yourself to affordable health insurance by not having access to group health policies. Covid-19 is a new hurdle agents must overcome and adds a dozens new challenges because of CMS regulations. The Medicare industry just isn't worth it anymore."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAg>

↳ @fleridalara888 (4): "@Seniorbenes everything he's saying is scary. I am interested in this business but I am new and don't have the capital even for leads rinow"

↳ @Seniorbenes (3): "@michaelhuebner6843 Michael Thanks for your response ,factually It is just me I am not an agency, I just did some pre-planning before getting into the business and some due diligence. I listened to the successful agents and worked my but of because I did not want to be part of the failure statistics. If you plan, execute, assess, and repeat it comes together before you know it. The secret is 12 hour days kkkkk"

↳ @michaelhuebner6843 (2): "@Seniorbenes Well you are running an agency and that is not feasible for most new agents because they lack the capitol to start on a large scale like that. Yes if you scale to the point you are doing then it can work, but your investment is huge when this industry has 90% of new agents failing in the first 2 years. My description is what an average independent agent will perform. Nick from Medicare Millionaire is an independent agent and works by himself. He is a seasoned agent and very good at selling yet he only sold 127 policies in 2018 and he does this full time and employs his own telemarketer for \$3 per hour and uses direct mail leads. I was an assistant office manager for a Medicare brokerage firm for 9 years and out of 10 agents that our office had we only had 2 top producers and they each had about 1,500 clients. They serviced all of their clients and they were extremely stressed out all the time especially during AEP when MA plans became discontinued and they needed to review plan changes every year for their large client base. The average agent had about 500 clients. You need to provide customer service for your clients if you want to keep them long term and the sheer amount of work required to service MA plans simply isn't worth it. 95% of the calls we got at our agency was people having questions about their co-pays, the network, prescription drug co-pays, Part D late enrollment penalties, prescription drug issues, and how their plan worked. You spent all your time servicing MA and Part D clients and this is why you can't have more than 500 clients on your own before you are forced to hire help. Having 2,000 clients yourself means you aren't providing service to them when they have issues or you are just selling Medigap. Sorry to say but 70% of seniors on Medicare nationwide have Medicare Advantage. You and I both know how hard it is to market Part C and D plans selling over the phone as CMS makes this almost impossible. You need a partnership with a carrier to pull that off on a large scale and be successful which makes you captive to that carrier. I am in this industry to help seniors, not to help some corporate insurance carrier gain market share. CMS doesn't allow you to market Part C or Part D on social media, you need to read your AHIP test again my dude."

"Hi David! I always appreciate your videos, so thank you for making them and sharing your knowledge so freely and often. I passed the AHIP but haven't had really any training on how to sell Medicare plans, which is frustrating because I don't want to be out that test money and not using that knowledge to help people. I do telesales for FE and plan to for Medicare but I'm nervous about all the upfront compliance stuff (like fitting in SOA over the phone for example). I have reached out to my agency about it but haven't had any assistance as of yet. Any chance you're planning on a video like this, or have a start to finish example of a Medicare call that could help put me at ease to get started?"

— YouTube · How A Career Selling Medicare Policies Works · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=d2Smzwhbqfw&lc=UgzJ1e_zsWcOx83Umxt4AaABAg

↳ @TheDIGAgency (2): "We have that for agents in my Medicare agency. Also, consider looking for an agency that will actually support and train you. Agencies have to earn their overrides if they want to survive."

↳ @reoman8179 (2): "@TheDIGAgency any recommendations on IMO/FHO's?"

"L&H broker considering transition to commercial P&C... Opinions? I currently broker Medicare plans as an independent agent. I do remote sales and do very well relative to most in the industry. I have some lead gen systems in place that I am confident can transfer to any other sales role. However, my one concern is the endless compliance regulations for selling Medicare plans to seniors. With almost every way of contacting a prospect being uncompliant, I can't help but worry that in the future one slip up could cause me to lose my business that I have gained over years of selling. I do ethical business and I will not screw someone over to make a commission, but I am looking for something else with less regulation on how I acquire a client, that also pays residuals and decent upfront commission. I am not going to go captive, I am a commission only type of person, I want to lose big and win big. I'd rather put in the work to own my book of business and get my full commission. Anyone with experience in independent commercial P&C brokering with some insight on my next steps or where to learn more? How is compliance and regulations in that sector? Is there anything better than commercial P&C as far as commission and residuals? I only mention commercial because I heard that can be big money. Let me know opinions and if there are any other commission only sales routes I should pursue for good residuals. Thank you!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dwvp5q/lh_broker_considering_transition_to_commercial_pc/

"You can make a lot of money in commercial without having to write mid market. Small commercial is any line of business under 100k to 250k A few carriers go down to 50k per line of business. If you think you can't make money on small commercial you need to learn more about small commercial. A small agency, especially a 1 or 2 person agency is not a good fit to work middle market. You will eventually lose the account to a large agency that can provide a laundry list of things a small agency can't. The first of which is doing everything insurance and bond wise for the business. This is p&C, group health, all employee benefits, retirement plans like 401(k) to owners financial planning. On top of this they offer in house loss control, risk management, and the biggest agencies have a lawyer and can offer contract reviews, etc. Risk management, OSHA compliance, loss control they a carrier is not even close to what an independent person that is employee of agency can do. We can't afford to have I house loss control, risk management so we contract with a firm that does all this. We do the same for financial planning, retirement plans and employee benefits. Large agencies love to see a small 1 to 5 person agency on mud market accounts. They will do an BOR and take the account and laugh all the way too the bank. I have lost million dollar plus accounts when I was a principal at a 13 person agency in the past. Lost a 4 million dollar a year premium account to a top 100 agency that BOR the p&c, employee benefits, bonds, and 401k. It cost the agency 300k a year in revenue. It cost me personally in commission 100k. And I took them for a 40k p&c premium to a 1.4 million dollar 1 and did 4 to 8 visits a year to their multiple plants and fixed all the gaps in coverage they had and that saved them over a million dollars in claims over 9 years I had them as a client."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lyho3b/i_started_my_own_agency_in_mid_may_been_in_the_n2xum81/

"I'm at 120%. Medicare is a diff animal. i got scared away from it when I hear the compliance horror stories has the regulators keep changing everything constantly so the agent is constantly doing more training and more paperwork and more things that make their job harder. Is that right? do you run your own ads for leads then?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nmbggg/starting_to_think_the_money_and_lifestyle_is_a/nfchvdi/

"My worst client's renewal is next week. His stuff is all on surplus lines, so he need w short apps for updating exposures etc completed annually. I actually prefill as much as I can (usually the insurance side+ limits etc) and I start sending it to him January. I send every other week until one month out, then it's weekly with a phone call too. I get his receptionist (wife) on maybe half of my calls and he's always busy and she'll take a message. She is literally always confused who I am. Typically the carrier breaks down and offers quotes based off expiring with our the apps which only reinforces his shitty behavior. This year they didn't. I was able to convince them to quite, but they are going to do an audit and inspection after renewal or cancel his ass. They also raised rates. All good imo, we kind of want this guy to go because he's such a PITA. I sent it all and with invoices Friday afternoon. We'll see how it goes lol hopefully he non complies and cancels and we can rod ourselves of it. I don't understand all of the thinking behind it, but my agency owner is worried about an E&O claim if we dont at least get renewal quotes for him, bit of he cancels for non pay or non compliance,we are good and can just tell him to go find a other broker."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sefo1v/if_insureds_could_just_open_their_mail_and_return/ofju8mq/

"Hi I know this was a year ago but there's a new young company recruiting Medicare sales agents, they say you'll get 30/40 inbound calls and work from home however they pay \$100 a sale. Although I really need to make money rn I read somewhere CMS pays 600 an enrollment t and I'm struggling with the fact that they are keeping 500 and paying us 100. Do you know if that's true?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1b3t4hx/been_out_of_the_medicare_sales_game_for_2_years/nasp1xs/

"Not only did they just crush the STM market, but they will also attempt to steal your T65 medicare clients. Oooops.....they were never your client anyways. FACT SHEET FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE June 8, 2016 Contact: CMS Media Relations (202) 690-6145 | CMS Media Inquiries Strengthening the Marketplace – Actions to Improve the Risk Pool With millions of Americans insured through the Health Insurance Marketplaces, it's clear that Marketplace coverage is a product consumers want and need and an important business for insurers, with several major issuers expanding their Marketplace presence. At the Department of Health and Human Services (HHS), we are constantly monitoring the health of the Marketplace and are always looking to make improvements that benefit both consumers and issuers. Over the past several months, HHS has taken a series of actions to strengthen the Marketplace risk pool, limit upward pressure on rates, and ensure a strong Marketplace for the long term. We believe those actions are bringing positive results. As part of our continued commitment to the long-term strength of the Marketplace, we are announcing new measures to ensure that the Marketplace continues to provide affordable coverage for millions of Americans. During the month of June, HHS will make three announcements regarding our ongoing efforts to: strengthen the risk pool by spreading the costs of care over a diverse mix of enrollees, work with issuers and state Departments of Insurance to improve coverage options, and step up Marketplace outreach, especially to young adults and uninsured families in advance of Open Enrollment 4. Today, HHS is announcing a series of actions to strengthen the Marketplace risk pool. These actions include: · Curbing abuses of short-term plans that exploit gaps in current rules to use medical underwriting to keep some of the healthiest consumers out of the Affordable Care Act's single risk pool. · Improving the risk adjustment program to more accurately reflect the cost of partial-year enrollees and to incorporate prescription drug utilization data that provide a more complete picture of enrollees' health status. These improvements will ensure that the program continues to work as intended to compensate issuers with higher-risk enrollees and thereby help issuers sustainably serve all types of consumers. · Helping consumers who turn 65 make the transition to Medicare, so that older consumers are served by the program designed for them and their health needs. · Beginning full implementation of the Special Enrollment Confirmation Process, which ensures that eligible individuals continue to have access to coverage through Special Enrollment Periods (SEPs), but prevents people from misusing the system to enroll in coverage only if they get sick. · Continuing our efforts to reduce data-matching issues (DMIs). CMS outreach, education, and operational improvements have contributed to a sharp reduction in total data matching issues generated and an almost 40 percent year-over-year increase in documents submitted to help resolve income and citizenship and immigration data matching issues. Improving the resolution of DMIs benefits the risk pool because it keeps eligible consumers, often younger and healthier consumers less motivated to overcome obstacles such as extra paperwork, from losing coverage mid-year. Risk Pool Actions Curbing Abuse of Short-Term Limited Duration Plans Short-term limited duration coverage is health care coverage issued for a short period of time. Because short-term limited duration plans are designed to fill only very short coverage gaps, this coverage is not subject to any of the key rules governing the ACA's single risk pool: they can be priced based on health status (medically underwritten), can discriminate against consumers with pre-existing conditions, and do not have to cover essential health benefits. Some issuers are now offering short-term limited duration plans to consumers as their primary form of health coverage for periods that last nearly 12 months, allowing them to target only the healthiest consumers while avoiding consumer protections. As highlighted in recent press accounts, by keeping these consumers out of the ACA single risk pool, such abuses of limited duration coverage increase costs for everyone else, and they could have a greater impact over time if allowed to become more widespread. Today, the Department of Labor, Department of Treasury, and Department of Health and Human Services (HHS) issued a proposed rule to revise the definition of short-term, limited duration coverage. Under the new rules, short-term policies may be offered only for less than three months, and coverage cannot be renewed at the end of the three month period. The proposed rule also improves transparency for consumers by requiring issuers to provide notice to consumers that the coverage is not minimum essential coverage, does not satisfy the health coverage requirement of the ACA, and will not prevent the consumer from owing a tax penalty. The proposed changes will help strengthen the risk pool by ensuring that short term limited duration plans are used only as intended, to fill truly temporary gaps in coverage. Maturing the Risk Adjustment Program By reducing incentives for issuers to try to design products that attract a disproportionately healthy risk pool, risk adjustment lets them design products that meet the needs of all consumers, protecting consumers' access to a range of robust options. Updating risk adjustment to more accurately assess every enrollee's risk makes it more effective in achieving this goal. Earlier this year, CMS made a number of changes to improve the stability, predictability, and accuracy of the risk adjustment program for issuers. These changes include better modeling of costs for preventive services, changes to the data update schedule, and earlier reporting of preliminary risk adjustment data where available. We also published a Risk Adjustment White Paper and hosted a conference on March 31, 2016 to solicit feedback from issuers, consumers, and other stakeholders on additional areas for improvement. Building off the Risk Adjustment White Paper and stakeholder feedback, today we are announcing two additional important changes to risk adjustment that we intend to propose in future rulemaking. First, we intend to propose that, beginning for the 2017 benefit year, the risk adjustment model include an adjustment factor for partial-year enrollees. By more accurately accounting for the costs of short term enrollees in ACA-compliant risk pool, this change will support the Marketplace's important role as a source of coverage for people who are between jobs, experiencing life transitions, or otherwise need coverage for part of the year. Second, we intend to propose that, beginning for the 2018 benefit year, prescription drug utilization data be incorporated in risk adjustment, as a source of information about individuals' health status and the severity of their conditions. We are also considering proposing additional changes to the model for 2018 and beyond. Transitioning Consumers to Medicare The Marketplace serves as an essential backstop for consumers as they transition between different types of coverage over their lifetime. For example, many early retirees access Marketplace coverage until they become eligible for Medicare when they turn 65. But once individuals turn 65, most people should end their Marketplace coverage and switch to Medicare. In fact, if consumers do not enroll in Medicare Part B when they turn 65, they could face financial consequences for years into the future, because they could owe higher Medicare premiums. Meanwhile, the Marketplace is intended to serve consumers who are not Medicare eligible, and continued enrollment by individuals who are eligible for Medicare can raise costs for other consumers. To make sure consumers understand the steps they need to take to move to Medicare, this summer the Marketplace will start contacting enrollees as they near their 65th birthday. This outreach will provide consumers with the information they need to enroll in Medicare if they are eligible and end their Marketplace coverage if they choose to. This builds off the changes we made to the HealthCare.gov application this year which included new pop ups with reminders for consumers who are about to turn 65 that they may be eligible for Medicare. Implementing the Special Enrollment Confirmation Process Over the last several months, the Marketplace has taken a number of steps to ensure that Special Enrollment Periods (SEPs) are there for consumers when they need them while avoiding misuse or abuse. We've strengthened our rules and clarified our processes for SEPs, so that the people who need to can still easily get coverage, while making it hard for anyone thinking about taking advantage. We also eliminated 7 SEPs, including the SEP for individuals who paid the tax p"

— Insurance-Forums.com · CMS: STM Limited to 3 Months - No Renewal Allowed · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/cms-stm-limited-to-3-months-no-renewal-allowed.82709/#post-1106530>

"Off-Market plans are OFTEN (though not always) NOT ACA compliant- meaning they don't necessarily cover every one of the 10 Essential Health Benefits (may not cover hospital stays, may not cover pharmacy, may limit the number of visits to a PCP they'll cover, may not cover maternity, may not cover mental health, may not cover preventive 100%-- All things that ACA compliant plans MUST cover to some degree). In general, you may find some comparable plans by going to a carrier directly or hiring a broker to help you research off-market plans. I would urge you not to just "google" and select a random google website and start entering your information- that's how you end up in an ENDLESS cycle of "agents" (and I use this in quotations, because I question their credentials) spam calling you because that website just sold your information to 10,000 "agents". Research reputable brokerage firms in your area- the big names in the game are Lockton, Gallagher, AON, USI, Hub International, Willis Towers Watson, Brown & Brown, etc. and they should all have a department that handles individual coverages. These big firms have LICENSED brokers. \Ask for an ACA compliant plan if you're needing everything I've listed above to be covered and/or if you have pre-existing conditions (non ACA compliant plans can deny a claim just for being pre-existing). If you're asked to fill out any personal health information besides if you're a smoker (they ask for past diagnosis, past surgeries, family history of certain things, etc. in your application) it's a Medically Underwritten plan and not an ACA compliant plan. A reputable licensed broker is connected with several carriers vs. potentially just pushing one carrier or one type of plan (for instance a MEC plan or an indemnity plan-- which are not necessarily ACA compliant but the majority of what I see these scammy agents selling), should be patient enough to walk you through your options, take your concerns into consideration (providers you really need/want to have in network, medications you're currently taking, etc.) when finding you a policy. If you feel rushed or don't like the policies they are presenting, don't be afraid to go to the next broker. However, saying this AS a broker--- the ACA Marketplace is where I instruct my friends to look first as every single one of those plans is a legitimate ACA compliant, comprehensive coverage plan, no matter what you choose. We have a pinned post on walking you through how to pick a plan here: https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1fvniop/questions_answered_which_plan_should_i_choose/ (https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1fvniop/questions_answered_which_plan_should_i_choose/) I don't know that you can pre-pay the ENTIRE year, that's a question you'll have to ask the carrier. We typically see it billed by month-- though if you're not getting a subsidy, I supposed it's possible- in theory."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1qwmyum/paying_for_aca_obamacare/o3qda14/

"CMS has seen an increase in beneficiary complaints associated with third-party marketing organizations (TPMOs) and has received feedback from beneficiary advocates and stakeholders concerned about the marketing practices of TPMOs who sell multiple MA and Part D products. In 2020, we received a total of 15,497 complaints related to marketing. In 2021, excluding December, the total was 39,617. We are unable to say that every one of the complaints is a result of TPMO marketing activities, but based on a targeted search, we do know that many are related to TPMO marketing. In addition, we have seen an increase in third party print and television ads, which appears to be corroborated by State partners. Through this final rule, we will address the concerns with TPMOs by means of the following three updates to the communications and marketing requirements under 42 CFR parts 422 and 423, subpart V: (1) We define TPMOs in the regulation at §§ 422.2260 and 423.2260 to remove any ambiguity associated with MA plans/Part D sponsors responsibilities for TPMO activities associated with the selling of MA and Part D plans; (2) we add a new disclaimer that will be required when TPMOs market MA plans/Part D products (§§ 422.2267(e) and 423.2267(e)); and (3) we update §§ 422.2274 and 423.2274 to require additional plan oversight requirements associated with TPMOs, in addition to what is already required under §§ 422.504(i) and 423.505(i) if the TPMO is a first tier, downstream or related entity (FDR). ----- Pretty mind blowing the YOY increase in complaints to Medicare. But honestly surprised there weren't more complaints"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Suprised nobody's talking about the huge MAPD marketing rules handed down by CMS · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/thread/s/suprised-nobody%E2%80%99s-talking-about-the-huge-mapd-marketing-rules-handed-down-by-cms.108507/#post-1422047>

"New Health Insurance agent selling Medicare Advantage for upcoming AEP Q's Hi, As the title says I am a new health insurance agent focusing on the upcoming AEP. My upline is telling me that his script is completely compliant. I'm concerned about the TPMO disclosure and the SOA The tpmo disclosure simply says "We do not offer every plan available in your area. Currently, we represent 0-78 organizations which offer 0-613 products in your area. Please contact \[medicare.gov\](<http://medicare.gov>) or 1-800-MEDICARE to get information on all of your options. I also just have to let you know — this call may be recorded for quality assurance or training purposes." I'm specifically concerned that it is a broad range and want to ask if that is cms compliant to say 0-78 and 0-613 or do I need to say exactly how many plans I can offer. My second question has to do with the SOA as his script does not seem compliant to me. It is as follows : In your area, we have a wide variety of Medicare plans available — including Medicare Advantage, Prescription Drug, dental, and vision. Before we go any further, I have to let you know: this conversation has no effect on your current or future health coverage unless you enroll, and talking with me does not obligate you to enroll or automatically enroll you in a plan. Ok?" As I said I am new and I haven't started selling yet and won't until October but I don't want to get in trouble and am thinking of creating my own script. Am I overthinking this or? Thanks if you read this far."

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wfh4dr/new_health_insurance_agent_selling_medicare/

↳ jroberts67 (1): "<https://blog.newhorizonsmktg.com/tpmo-disclaimer-tips-to-stay-compliant/> (<https://blog.newhorizonsmktg.com/tpmo-disclaimer-tips-to-stay-compliant/>)";

↳ Born-Nature8394 (1): "Somewhat helpful. I just wish there was a completely clear answer. I do know that 2027 rules have changed and it no longer needs to be said in the first minute. I think I will not do the range and actually tell people exactly what I can offer. That seems compliant to me."

↳ Key_Astronomer6500 (1): "Your Crm should update when you get an inbound phone call or when you dial out. At least it did with the companies I worked for. Soa sounds compliant to me as long as you get a yes. Sounds like every generic call center."

Not making enough to stay in the business · 10 documents · 10 voices

"Not many sales I work about 6-8 hrs 3-4 days a week and I suck. I have a script. I feel like I follow it pretty good. I call aged leads but I'm rarely getting a sale. Can go a few days without selling anything. Thinking of hanging it up but I don't want to give up at the same time. This is my 5th month. How long does it take to get this??"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vftpsq/>

↳ (0): "Could be the leads, the scripts or possibly just need more practice. Do you feel like you have mastered your scripts and objection handling?"

↳ (0): "No. I am terrible at objection handling"

↳ (0): "Are you getting alot of objections? Gotta master your craft if you want to close. Like the other person said 1 call close is the way to go. Most people forget about the appt and the others will just agree to be nice to get you off the phone."

"Making too little for Marketplace Insurance?? I am a college student live in FL. I enrolled health insurance through Marketplace and received premium tax credit in year 2025. Now when I'm trying to enroll for 2026, my estimated income for 2026 is lower due to job change. The Marketplace shows I have \$0 premium tax credit. I called them, they say I make too little to qualify the premium tax credit. Although they mentioned I make too much to qualify for Medicaid, I don't qualify Medicaid anyway. My question is: - My income dropped tremendously in 2025 due to job change. Is it possible that I have to pay back the Tax Credit if I made less than 2025 100%FPL? I am worried now that when I file taxes, I might owe crazy amount of money for the insurance. - how do I get cheap insurance coverage (just for serious emergency like accidents or unforeseeable disease. I normally don't go to the hospital to get checked up or for some small things like cold cuz I literally can't afford it right now) P.S.: My school don't have anything. It's a very small private school & they don't care. I'm waitressing and they do not offer insurance. I can't get on my parent's plan either."

— r/HealthInsurance · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1plaivt/>

↳ (0): "For 2026, I think what you need to do is earn the 15k. (Whatever the exact number is). Probably that means, for example, you need to not take classes over the summer and work two jobs during that time. Plus some part time work during the semesters. Also, self employment income would count. Maybe you can baby sit or clean houses in addition to working a regular job. You just have to report the income on your tax return and pay the social security taxes on it, etc (look into paying taxes separately). It still takes time and I understand it's not easy as a full time student, but Florida has you in bad situation. 😞 It's not at all supportive of college students, but that's what Florida chooses to have it be. There's a cap on what you would have to pay back in 2025, but that's going away in 2026. I don't know how that will work as where are people going to get the money, but you don't need that hanging over you!"

↳ (0): "Florida is one of the 10 states that hasn't accepted Medicaid expansion, so people who make more than 100% of FPL cannot get on Medicaid, but less than 133% of FPL and so do not have access to ACA subsidies. Does your university have access to a student healthcare group policy? I know when I attended Illinois, anyone who did not have coverage through their parents or an employer was required to get a policy by the university"

↳ (0): "Point of clarification. OP can't access Medicaid in Florida, full stop. Even at 0% FPL / no income. OP would need to be low / no income *and either* blind, disabled, pregnant, over 65, or have a dependent child under the age of 18 to remotely qualify for Medicaid. The same is true for anyone in the 9 other states that don't have expanded Medicaid programs. In order to secure subsidies through healthcare.gov, OP needs a minimum annual income of 100% FPL. This is the healthcare.gov subsidy floor in the 10 states without Medicaid expansion."

"> It's a bit funny that the only thing you didn't acknowledge in my comment was the fact that you don't just get a regular job. ACTUALLY I worked in commercial finance for years + ran 3 small businesses so there's that. I actually got fired from the finance company partly because I couldn't get any work done with my home phone ringing 50 times before lunch. >There's absolutely no way you can convince me that you're making ZERO action to receive these calls. You're not getting 100's of illegal calls by being just a random needle in the haystack, you're intentionally seeding your number(s) out there. Of course the jig is up if you'd ever confess that, but also the calls would stop too and then there goes your income. Believe what you want to believe, but I feign interest to see who buys the lead and that's that. I do not opt in anywhere. >you're intentionally seeding your number(s) out there. I do no such thing and I dare anyone to prove that I do. >Of course the jig is up if you'd ever confess that, but also the calls would stop too and then there goes your income. I don't want the money. I want the calls to stop. Since the calls won't stop, I will take the money. >We all get random calls from shady oversea call centers. Will I get 2-3 of these calls on a bad day? Yes. Do I decide to engage the call, pretend to be interested so I can sue the American receiver of the illegal transfer who is likely unaware this call was generated illegally? Absolutely not. img-wouldbealotcoolerifyoudid.jpg >You're trying to call it justice but it's just not. TCPA/DNC laws are set up to protect regular consumers, especially vulnerable ones like seniors, not to create a side hustle for bottom feeders like you. I'd be willing to bet when you find a carrier/brokerage/agent who's willing to fight you instead of just throwing you a couple of bucks to save the legal fees - you drop the suit because you don't want this going to discovery. Believe what you want to believe. I don't opt in for ANYTHING and I'm on every single marketing database known to man. Landline is 40+ years old, same address. Cell is 20+ years old same subscriber Registered voter, property owner, business owner, etc etc. The dataminers have enough out there on me that I don't need to opt in for a single goddamn thing for them to already know me Oh and I guess I'll clarify that I'm a carrier rep, my calls come from our own marketing. We don't use third parties at all. I fight and litigate EVERY single suit until summary judgement/jury verdict. Don't put words in my mouth."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8ygvfc/

"🚩 American Income Life = Scam 🚩 I spent 6 months inside American Income Life, and if you're even thinking about working here, please hear me out: it's a trap. They lure you in with promises of six-figure income, freedom, luxury trips, and "helping families." What actually happens? You're bled dry from day one. You pay for your license, exam fees, Zoom account, computer—money, money, money out of your pocket. By the time you realize what's going on, you've already invested too much to walk away easily. The first week, they make you feel like you've accomplished something huge: passing the exam, starting your "career." But then you're thrown into terrible training and endless busywork—basically just making calls for your upline. When you finally get your own "opportunity," they hand you garbage leads that have been recycled a thousand times. People scream at you to stop calling, and you're forced to keep going. It's harassment, plain and simple. The schedule is insane: 12-hour days, almost no breaks, constant check-ins and micromanagement. When you finally catch someone, you drag them onto a Zoom call and read a script full of lies that you've been drilled on. Without even realizing it, you're tricking people into buying one of the worst insurance products out there. Meanwhile, you're broke, stressed, and exhausted. They parade "success stories" in front of you—agents claiming they were once in your shoes but now they're making six figures. Fake trips, fake recognition, fake promises. It's all smoke and mirrors. 🏹 If you're considering joining, or if you're already inside and thinking "I've put too much time and money in to quit now" — wake up. That's exactly how they keep you trapped. You're not building a business. You're being used. They're scamming new agents and clients alike. This place wrecks people's finances, mental health, and self-worth. It operates like a Ponzi scheme disguised as a career opportunity. To anyone on the fence: don't fall for it. Get out while you can. To the authorities: How is this still allowed to exist?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlyhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/nggbda7/

"I would contract direct with Midland National and then call Premier or Ritter and see who will give you better contracts for whatever else you need. I will say there are good reasons to work with a decent IMO. But if you don't want marketing or sales assistance that is the way to go especially if you want to continue to work mid market. Penn Mutual does decent direct contracts too."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hmdw46/failed_mlm_insurance_agent/m3tx2fq/

"THIS! I joined maybe two weeks ago, and they are pretty good salespeople because I was definitely sold into it at first. Purchased my own training, licensing and bought my own leads which they did tell me I had to buy the lower level leads to "get a feel for it" as well. Was pressured into going to their national conference, which was VERY cultish and a lot of toxic positivity like you said and almost nobody would even speak to me because I hadn't made them any money yet. Or even look at me, not kidding they would look at me I would smile at them and they would just turn their head and walk away. First person I called when I bought the leads, the person who answered the phone told me they died 2 years ago and I was told to try to call the widow back after 6 months to see if she wants insurance for herself. what the actual fuck. Goes to show how OLD these leads are and how you're basically cold calling these people and being pushed to try to force them to buy something from you even if they don't want it. Currently trying to get out of it but I just feel so bad for my upline who is very nice but very immersed in this company, and I can tell she so badly wants the approval of these people and I was the first person she recruited who stuck around and she was just so excited and seems like she really wants me to succeed. I just feel like I didn't sign up for most of this, and was told one thing and am now being told a different thing. Like in my interview, they said I will not have to call my friends and family and are now asking me to call my friends and family. I don't want to and will not go broke doing this, or forfeit my integrity. I just feel so stupid lol"

— r/Insurance · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/Insurance/comments/1klwvqp/do_not_join_symmetry_financial_group_heres_the/n98m1gl/

"In 2027 Humana will not longer give perpetuity for new MAPD's with effective dates 2/1 and after. You will still get perpetuity on current BOB and any new enrollments up until 1/1 effective dates but any new enrollments on 2/1 and after will not longer have perpetuity. Instead we will get an increase of \$25 in commission on any new enrollments. People are upset. Is this happening across the board with all Medicare companies or is this just Humana cutting corners? I can't lie... I'm a bit worried and feel for the first time in years I need to look for a new job. Thoughts?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/two7a0u/in_2027_humana_will_not_longer_give_perpetuity/

↳ juicyfruitcake (3): "I'm a captive Humana agent and it is all MAPD's in all states and counties unfortunately."

↳ itsalfesty (2): "I got out of Medicare last year, writing has been on the wall for a while."

↳ juicyfruitcake (2): "May I ask what you transitioned to?"

"need serious suggestions I recently passed the SIE exam and got no interview calls and before giving the series 65 thought of doing the life and health insurance it will boost my resume and can get some interview calls also i do not want to be an agent or go into sales but i feel it can open some insurance client service or operational roles???"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wpcc8l/need_serious_suggestions/

↳ voidsarcastic (1): "What are you trying to do? Are you trying to be a financial advisor?"

"Can I ask where you get your leads from. That is my biggest problem, getting discouraged but don't want to give up."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hdr5qh/i_sold_two_policies_myself_today_lets_go/m3dusy3/

"Am i making a mistake with a pivot into a sales agent role? I unfortunately got laid off from my dream remote job in fitness at the start of the month and ive been in a desperate applying spree ever since. I currently work as an appointment setter with an HVAC company and honestly, its pretty ass. During my first week I got approached by an insurance sales rep in my DMs and sent me info on his agency role they are trying to fill. Its a life, accident and health insurance sales agent role. Ive never sold insurance, i was a personal trainer for 10+ years and while i did have a few years of selling memberships/training packages, this is an entirely new world to me. I did about 3 full days of research and there are some things that do stick out to me as good and bad so i wanted to get some advice on if im just coping here. The good: \- Renewals are a pretty damn interesting long term financial plan that i had never heard of and could honestly set me up for the rest of my life as i age into retirement (fitness is known for zero retirement options so this was a key one for me) \- The agency has a very strong onboarding process compared to what seems to be industry norms. 1. They give you free/back up leads for 6 months while they train you then you move into a pooled lead pile for 6 more months. This seems to be very uncommon and it can give me a large buffer to start up without being thrown to the sharks 2. 4 week bootcamp to get me up to speed and making sales pretty much right away. They have numerous people who made 1-2 sales within their training window so the options of making immediate money is there. 3. They genuinely want to keep their agency small, tactile and hitting the ground very hard so everyone makes money. They seem very specific on how many people they want on the team to avoid everyone fighting over leads 4. I can make more money than I've ever made in my life. i grew up extremely poor so this is a big driver for me. The Bad: \- Its 1099/commission only. I got a small severance with my layoff and including my savings, i only have enough to live on for \-10-12 weeks, which honestly has me worried that i wont make any early sales and end up a bit stuck with my hands in my pockets. \- I have to commit to 10-12 hour days during the first 6 months. Their words were "we give you free leads, we expect you to really take that serious and build up early so you have to be here a lot to accomplish this". I can work hard, but given that its only commission, the stress of having ZERO income coming in while im training raises my anxiety a bit. Am i being delusional stepping into this industry and this role given where i am in life?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj1b8l/>

↳ (0): "The HVAC gig being "pretty ass" is the real tell here, you're already in a grind you hate so why not take the shot at something with actual long term upside. That renewal structure is the closest thing to passive income you'll find outside of owning a business, and coming from fitness where your income caps at how many hours you can physically train people, I'd be jumping at the chance. The 10-12 week runway is tight but the bootcamp plus backed leads for 6 months is a better setup than 90% of agents get starting out. Worst case you're back to square one in 3 months with a new license and some sales experience, which beats rotting in appointment setting wondering what if."

↳ (0): "Worst case he's out of money in 3 months? WTH? Seriously?"

Being tied to an agency, upline or contract · 8 documents · 8 voices

"What Uplines Don't Want you to Know - Carrier Release Process - Explained This is a question I get a ton from new agents, and its what every upline doesn't want you to learn, so please... learn it. Treat this information like it's required for you to be in the industry to know. Review your contracts with your uplines and make sure you have protection within them as well. Heck, get a lawyer to review it. Whatever it takes, I see too many agents getting trapped in awful comp deals and abusive uplines and get "Stockholmed" into buying bad leads from them and then gaslighting them into thinking its their fault. I've been there done that. This info is for the agent that calls themselves independent:

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Demystifying Agent Contracting, Releases, and Blackout Periods I work directly with 54 carriers, 4 FMOs, multiple agencies, and nearly 1,000 independent agents. My role involves overseeing contracting, licensing, and agent/agency development. With experience spanning so many entities, I've had the chance to see the contracting process from all angles and business models. Let me break it down for anyone who's struggling to navigate this space. # Steps to Understand Contracting and Releases

1. **Contract Level (LOA vs. Broker):** * If you're directly contracted with a carrier as a truly independent broker *and* haven't signed an agreement restricting you to one entity (or an LOA contract, which assigns your commission to your upline), you should generally be free to contract with another carrier or upline without issues. 2. **Private Contracts (Non-Competes or No Non-Competes):** * If you're tied to a brokerage or agency and have a private contract (like a non-compete), get a lawyer to review your options. Some of these cannot be upheld in court, that's important for you to know. * Medicare agents may want to wait until the start of the year for a smoother transition —this avoids AEP complications. 3. **Carrier Blackout Periods:** * **New agents** can contract anytime, even during AEP, for Medicare Advantage (MA) and Medicare Supplement (Med-Supp) plans. * **Switching uplines or FMOs, however, is restricted** during AEP for MA carriers (typically September–December). * If you're contracting with a carrier for the first time, you can get a **new contract** during AEP, but you can't **switch uplines** until the blackout period ends. 4. **Release Process (To Release or Not):** * Brokers contracted directly with carriers usually retain their commissions unless restricted by a private contract (see Step 2). * You can file a self-release with an "intent to transfer". After 90–180 days, the carrier can re-contract you under a new upline while allowing you to keep producing during the interim. (you will be compensated according to your previous contract if you decide to continue producing, you wont get commission for producing if you WERE an LOA agent because your effective comp is 0%) * This safeguards agents from being stuck in unfavorable relationships. Most agents prefer waiting until the start of the year to minimize risks. The key is understanding your contract and navigating transitions safely, which is something many agents overlook. # A Brief History of the Release Process (why the heck is it this way?) The "agent-release" process emerged in the late 90s and early 2000s to manage transfers between FMOs and carriers. Unfortunately, it was often abused, with FMOs refusing to grant releases, especially during AEP, leaving agents trapped in bad contracts. To address this, carriers like UnitedHealthcare, Aetna, and Humana introduced transfer freezes during AEP to protect their investments. The "intent to transfer" process, developed in the late 2000s and early 2010s, aimed to fix these issues by providing agents a path to transfer without jeopardizing their business. # Misunderstandings About Releases If your agency/FMO/upline tells you "you can't transfer," it's likely because their training hasn't been updated to reflect the proper release procedures. This isn't usually malicious, they just want to ensure you're not left without commissions. Nobody wants to risk that. Also, the information is incredible "gate-kept", it's not a "sexy" process everyone wants to learn, until they need it... If you're looking for additional insight, this [YouTube video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NaExikyNwzo) (not affiliated with me or my company) provides a solid overview of the release process. However, it doesn't touch on the contract-level distinctions I've outlined here. Understanding these processes can help you avoid costly errors and confidently take control of your career. If you have questions or need clarification, feel free to ask!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gv923a/what_uplines_dont_want_you_to_know_carrier/

↳ Inner_Friendship5913 (2): "I just got my license in September and knew absolutely nothing about insurance. I started with Equis and had a very bad experience with my upline and felt like I was stuck with no one to teach me or train me. The top group person just blew smoke when I tried to get help so I left. I signed with Symmetry and I'm having a difficult time getting Equis to release me because they say they don't require it but Symmetry does require it. Symmetry has already started to get me started with other insurance carriers. I only had 5 with Equis. I have got no contracts with any carriers with Symmetry yet in my email but I know they started the process. BUT I was never told that I have to split my commissions 40%(me) and 60%(SME agent). I spoke to transamerica and Mutual of Omaha and they said I'd be penalized 90 days for ending the contract through Equis. So if I decide to not stay at Symmetry then that is even more insurance carriers that I'll be stuck waiting 90 days to work with again. I honestly have no idea where to go from here. I don't want to do all the work and a finalizing agent take 60% of my commissions. What company out there allows you to keep your commissions outside of the Small bit your upline gets? Or at least a fair amount?"

↳ RedditInsuranceGuy (1): "I would need to know what line of insurance you are talking about to get more specific. But basically its a standard wait of 6 months after a documented request of release from the contract for most carriers. Mutual of Omaha is pretty strict on that stuff. As far as what you do going forward is find an IMO that can fill the gaps with something competitive in the meantime while you process the releases and wait it out."

↳ Standard-Position698 (1): "I am in the process of trying to get a release/terminate contract. My up-line has refused to continue to reply and has removed me from all platforms and blocked me but will not release my contract."

"United is simply restructuring and will release new plans for AEP. Obviously they were hit hard, notice they only decommissioned the extremely affordable PPOs going forward... thats because they don't want you to sell any more of them and they cant just release plan changes mid year. And you are talking about commission cuts when we were just announced a 10% increase in MAPD renewals and Initials for 2026. There are lots of carriers dying to throw agents money.... And new carriers are still getting in the game and expanding every year, which is a good sign. I agree it is a little unstable right now, but for agents that is a good thing. Medicare and ACA aren't going anywhere. And if they do, you have an entire book to convert to the new thing."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/n56ide4/

"New Agent Choosing an FMO vs. Going Direct – Advice Needed! Hello everyone, I'm a newly licensed agent in Virginia, and I'm currently in the process of choosing an FMO to work with. Right now, training and support are my biggest priorities—even more than commission splits—because I know that with excellent training, the money will follow. Primarily, I want to start off offering Medicare (with the hopes to offer my clients ACA & possibly Life at a much later date, after I gain an understanding of the industry, but only as supplements to their needs). It's my understanding that I could work for multiple FMOs, as one may not entirely fulfill my needs. 😊 I've been looking at Gordon Marketing, TR King Insurance Marketing, Ritter, and Redbird, but I've seen mixed feedback. Some people say Gordon Marketing gives off MLM vibes—does anyone here have experience with them? I've also seen advice about finding an upline and then letting them be your contact because going directly to an FMO will get you lost in their hierarchy without direct support and guidance. On the flip side, I came across a comment saying that going direct with carriers (rather than using an FMO) is a better route. I'd love to hear from anyone who's done this: Did you have prior experience before going direct? Do the carriers provide strong training & support, or would I be on my own? For those in Virginia, what are the most prevalent carriers I should consider contracting with? Also, I want to run my own agency and generate my own leads. I'm not looking for an FMO that requires me to buy leads from them or forces me into a specific system. I just want solid training. If, down the line, I decide to buy leads, I'd like the option, but I don't want to be locked into it. I want to set myself up for success long-term and avoid jumping around between FMOs. Any insights or personal experiences would be greatly appreciated! Thanks in advance!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ijykig/new_agent_choosing_an_fmo_vs_going_direct_advice/

↳ NAF1138 (4): "If you want your focus to be on Medicare, I would add, in order, 1) supplemental health (Hospital plans, Cancer plans, home health plans, dental plans.) All of your Medicare clients could likely use some or all of these. 2) Final Expense Life. Easy add on if you just look to fix problems with people's existing life insurance. 3) ACA but not to go after a large ACA book. So you can sell ACA to spouses and referrals. Mostly to grab them as future Medicare clients. 4) annuities. Lots of clients will have CDs, 401ks and other amounts of money that are essentially doing nothing for them. You probably can do number 1 after six months. 2 after 2 years. 3 a year after that. And 4 after you have been in the business for about 6 years. Go slow. Work intentionally. Build a long term business."

↳ NAF1138 (3): "If you want training and support you don't want to go direct. The carriers don't care about you and mostly don't know anything about selling insurance. They are not where you want to be trained. The only exception being the captive sales forces of certain carriers. You also, want to pick ONE of those things in your list. Do not come out the gate trying to sell Medicare, ACA, Annuities and Life. You will never learn to sell any of them that way. They are all different and sometimes conflicting sales processes. They can all easily keep you busy full time. You will essentially be doing 4 jobs full time badly. Of the FMOs you mentioned, TR King is actually run by a decent human who cares about his people. Ritter is good if you know what you are doing or are working with an agent who is running an agency under them, but doing direct to Ritter is the same as going direct to the carrier. Redbird, I don't know anyone who works their but they have a reasonably good reputation. I don't know Gordon Marketing at all. That doesn't mean anything though, no one knows everyone."

↳ voidsarcastic (3): "Like commission rates? Luckily they're all pretty close carrier to carrier so sell the best plan for the client every-time, and every client is different so different plans and carriers work better for different people. Pretty sure MAPD is the same rate for every carrier (315 renewal 650 IEP) however over-rides may be different and some offer HRA bonus. Most supplements are 20-23% annual (first year advance), and dental/HI is like 45-50% annual (first year advance). Be careful some MAPD plans are non-commissionable i do avoid those, but there really aren't many. I have however done no commission part Ds, you gotta do what you gotta do. Life commissions should be between 80%-115% (9 month- 12 month advance) starting out, if you're taking a lower comp from the FMO make sure you are getting lots of support."

"Am i making a mistake with a pivot into a sales agent role? I unfortunately got laid off from my dream remote job in fitness at the start of the month and ive been in a desperate applying spree ever since. I currently work as an appointment setter with an HVAC company and honestly, its pretty ass. During my first week I got approached by an insurance sales rep in my DMs and sent me info on his agency role they are trying to fill. Its a life, accident and health insurance sales agent role. Ive never sold insurance, i was a personal trainer for 10+ years and while i did have a few years of selling memberships/training packages, this is an entirely new world to me. I did about 3 full days of research and there are some things that do stick out to me as good and bad so i wanted to get some advice on if im just coping here. The good: ↳ Renewals are a pretty damn interesting long term financial plan that i had never heard of and could honestly set me up for the rest of my life as i age into retirement (fitness is known for zero retirement options so this was a key one for me) ↳ The agency has a very strong onboarding process compared to what seems to be industry norms. 1. They give you free/back up leads for 6 months while they train you then you move into a pooled lead pile for 6 more months. This seems to be very uncommon and it can give me a large buffer to start up without being thrown to the sharks 2. 4 week bootcamp to get me up to speed and making sales pretty much right away. They have numerous people who made 1-2 sales within their training window so the options of making immediate money is there. 3. They genuinely want to keep their agency small, tactile and hitting the ground very hard so everyone makes money. They seem very specific on how many people they want on the team to avoid everyone fighting over leads 4. I can make more money than I've ever made in my life. i grew up extremely poor so this is a big driver for me. The Bad: ↳ Its 1099/commission only. I got a small severance with my layoff and including my savings, i only have enough to live on for ↳10-12 weeks, which honestly has me worried that i wont make any early sales and end up a bit stuck with my hands in my pockets. ↳ I have to commit to 10-12 hour days during the first 6 months. Their words were "we give you free leads, we expect you to really take that serious and build up early so you have to be here a lot to accomplish this". I can work hard, but given that its only commission, the stress of having ZERO income coming in while im training raises my anxiety a bit. Am i being delusional stepping into this industry and this role given where i am in life?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj1b8l/>

↳ (0): "The HVAC gig being "pretty ass" is the real tell here, you're already in a grind you hate so why not take the shot at something with actual long term upside. That renewal structure is the closest thing to passive income you'll find outside of owning a business, and coming from fitness where your income caps at how many hours you can physically train people, I'd be jumping at the chance. The 10-12 week runway is tight but the bootcamp plus backed leads for 6 months is a better setup than 90% of agents get starting out. Worst case you're back to square one in 3 months with a new license and some sales experience, which beats rotting in appointment setting wondering what if."

↳ (0): "Worst case he's out of money in 3 months? WTH? 🤔 Seriously?"

"Prtzl said: For starters, I'm not an insurance salesman. I'm basically looking for a way to penetrate/capitalize on the growing senior market. FE seems like a fantastic way to go about it. BUT.. the last two weeks of reviewing different companies, programs, captive vs Independent, is HIS a scam, is xyz a scam, telesales, no telesales, watch out for the MLM FE orgs, the Lead pumpers -- on and on and on.. How in the heck can anyone new wrap their head around the FE niche with any confidence? The reputation is horrid. I've listened to "Trainers" basically bash the industry so I take their route and be "saved" from all the pitfalls or be "washed out" like 95% of the newbies. I went into looking into this field with gusto to be extremely turned off by the seedy stories/Agencys. Who can I trust? One thing I am weary of is the , "come on board and make the 200K per yr" - when they spend 70K on leads and charge backs aren't accounted for. But there are people making a decent living doing this. What I'm wondering is if like a MLM/Network Marketing company -- recruit, recruit, recruit - churn n' burn.. Any advice for a newbie. I'm not a spring chicken - this would be a major change.. a risky one at that considering I don't have a lot of lazy \$\$ around to invest. Frankly, I'm not quite sure if this is for em. What a sour taste in my mouth -- sweet to sour within a week.. Click to expand... 1st, ignore any marketers that PM you, they have something to hide and can't be trusted. The reason they don't comment on the open Forum is because they know the experienced agents will call them on their BS and low contracts. If you get offers through your e-mail, run them past the Forum, that's one of the functions of the Forum. Final Expense is where the quick money's at, Medicare Supplements are where the long term money's at. If you go the Med Supp route, Final Expense is a nice tie in and allows for not only cross selling FE, but other ancillary products too. If you want to talk to somebody that'll give you an honest opinion and shoots straight, contact Ben Boman. He specializes in FE and also has Med Supps. Insurance Forums - View Profile: bboman23 Good luck and welcome to the Forum."

— Insurance-Forums.com · FE - Shady Niche? Advice.. · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/fe-shady-niche-advice.86106/#post-1152149>

"For starters, I'm not an insurance salesman. I'm basically looking for a way to penetrate/capitalize on the growing senior market. FE seems like a fantastic way to go about it. BUT.. the last two weeks of reviewing different companies, programs, captive vs independent, is HIS a scam, is xyz a scam, telesales, no telesales, watch out for the MLM FE orgs, the lead pumpers -- on and on and on.. How in the heck can anyone new wrap their head around the FE niche with any confidence? The reputation is horrid. I've listened to "Trainers" basically bash the industry so I take their route and be "saved" from all the pitfalls or be "washed out" like 95% of the newbies. I went into looking into this field with gusto to be extremely turned off by the seedy stories/Agencys. Who can I trust? One thing I am weary of is the , "come on board and make the 200K per yr" - when they spend 70K on leads and charge backs aren't accounted for - let alone their personal expenses. But there are people making a decent living doing this. I'm wondering if FE is like Network Marketing - recruit, recruit, recruit - churn n' burn.. Any advice for a newbie? I'm not a spring chicken - this would be a major change.. a risky one at that considering I don't have a lot of lazy \$\$ around to invest. Frankly, I'm not quite sure if this is for me. What a sour taste in my mouth -- sweet to sour within a week.. Thoughts for a Newbie considering a career change to FE?"

— Insurance-Forums.com · FE - Shady Niche? Advice.. · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/fe-shady-niche-advice.86106/#post-1152147>

"May I ask, what are your thoughts regarding Allstate? Are they what you call a captive agency? I'm just starting in the field. I want to gain knowledge & experience, but I don't want to be contractually tied to an agency if it doesn't work and they don't deliver on their promises. I've come across a few stories where folks said that the company refused to release them Others stated they had to sign a 2-year non-compete form (unsure if this is the proper term). Can you please give an example of an Umbrella company? Any insight that you can provide would be greatly appreciated. 😊"

— YouTube · How Do Medicare Brokers Get Paid? · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DBwUb_QfaB0&lc=UgzcO1OOgvafafZPDGN4AaABAg.9UaXkUc6WkFA--uSBCC3lo

"bro! everything you said in your spunky 6 min recruitment video was awesome, everything you said is exactly what my IMO says i should do or say door knocking and chargebacks are ruining me, i sell Fex with transamerica, RNA, Liberty Bankers, prosperity i can do upgrades policy reviews im very good at this but sadly i just lost my car due to an asshole who crashed my car while it was parked in my driveway plus like i said chargebacks are ruining me, i liked your working from home setup.... BUT!!!!!!! i skimmed towards the end and i saw your catch, its sad because you sound like whats wrong with this world, if i had \$1000 to invest in your little setup here i wouldnt be so stressed about how im not making a penny in this bussiness. im broke and thats why i need to make money but if i have to invest \$1000 i cant join because im broke hence why i would like to join so i can make money, seems more like you make more by having pepole join and by the time they notice its just like every gimmick out there you already made a grand each person that joins. maybe one day ill make money but so far i dont see that any time soon. nice try."

— YouTube · Day In The Life Of A Life Insurance Agent (Work From Home) · 5 likes · life / final-expense agent · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=D8Uca74uodA&lc=Ugzi6AUtf086V5zoqcR4AaABAg>

↳ @AdvancedAgentMarketing (2): "Well that's why we put out everything for free on youtube so people can learnt to make money selling insurance. If you don't have \$1000 to your name, I wouldn't recommend you for to start running ads. If anything, I'd recommend you to get a part time job to save up money so that you can invest in your business without being under the gun. Hope that helps."

TCPA, do-not-call and being sued for a call · 7 documents · 7 voices

"Possible complaint being filed against me. I am an independent life and health Insurance agent who may be having a complaint filed against me from a former client of mine. I have hundreds of clients enrolled in ACA plans (marketplace, Obamacare) and this person was one of them. He was enrolled in a plan and opted into automatic renewal. The plan was renewed and he called me back saying he was never aware his plan was renewed, because he was requiring a 1095 form to file his taxes. He called the marketplace and they told him to "file a complaint" against the agent. I have a recently recorded call where I told him he opted in for the automatic renewal and he didn't negate against it. I do have E&O insurance as well. I would never enroll a customer without their consent, I am just worried about what will happen next. He is losing \$1800 on his tax return due to him being enrolled in this plan, but it's not my fault. Any advice would be greatly appreciated, thank you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1c7go61/possible_complaint_being_filed_against_me/

↳ Stratosto3 (8): "Provide CMS with the info. Unfortunately they ARE cracking down, and you being independent means the heat goes to you. Explain to CMS that you have audio with explicit consent. He will then have to prove that he did not know, which you have consent to. Thats your best solution. Make sure its done by email if possible, any paper trail matters tremendously. You have no need to speak with the client in question, if you were wondering. Let CMS handle it. Sooner or later you will have this happen, mostly due to the clients being aloof during their own enrollment and not answering questions when you ask them if they have any."

↳ Stratosto3 (6): "Theres no need to. If you did the income correctly and he didnt update it, then thats on him."

↳ [deleted] (5): "Don't sweat it! You've done nothing wrong. These complaints are filed all the time and 95% of them are found to be baseless. I know it's nerve wracking and it's not a good feeling but the truth is if you do this for any length of time you will eventually get a complaint filed against you. I have been through it myself and after providing all forms of documentation and being forthright and open with the claims investigator who is just doing their job, the claim was closed and found to be baseless. Believe me when I tell you that there are actual cases of malice and this certainly isn't one. You have not done anything wrong and you have it all on record. You're going to be fine."

"Inbounds suck for a number of reasons: 1. Scam Central: most inbounds are generated in Pakistan and India. Literally the guys scamming your Grandma out of your inheritance are the ones providing inbounds to you, with entry-level scammers starting in lead generation before moving on to ripping off Americans. 2. Legal Pandora's Box: India and Pakistan will not comply to Federal TCPA rules. They will call everyone - even on the DNC - and you, and your upline, bear the legal risk. I had a good agent of mine buy one of these leads earlier this year and had to settle for five figures for just one phone call. 3. Did I Mention They're A Scam? These call centers are known to share client information, list information, and rework the leads over and over again. There are organizations that sell "pre-sold leads," which includes all major information about the client, claiming they call ahead of time to collect the information before passing it along to the agent to sell. Unbeknownst to the agent, they resell this information over and over again and you end up with huge chargebacks. I think Facebook ads are a much more durable, long-lasting, and safe lead generation solution. You own the leads, you control the ad creative, and you have a track record of the client opting in. Plus, you can scale upward to the level you're comfortable with, and can tie in pre-set appointments or call-ins for added benefit. Lastly, if you don't want to do it yourself, there are many good lead management options available that will do all of the above."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oxuubl/is_this_a_good_offer/np4s2v6/

"> in this instance would you even pursue this in court? HELL YES. Why wouldn't I? > You mentioned the complaint to the state legislator, but is this instance not something you would pursue in a lawsuit? They can run paralel. >I was under the impression that you signed up for the ACA plan? The minute the rep realized they couldn't pull off "Lindsay Smith" or whatever american name - they changed their tune. >Also aren't you afraid that someone Will steal your social security number? I'm 41 and my SSN has been lost in like 19 data breaches in the past 10 years. It's already out there, fuck it. >Or is that just the risk You're willing to accept for potentially being able to sue companies for breaking Do not call registry lists? Most of these calls are not scams, they're actual hard line attempts to sign you to an ACA plan and get a \$45 lead."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1n17wbo/another_reason_not_to_trust_lead_brokersthird/nfiv118/

"I read your other discussion you posted about the lawsuits, in this instance would you even pursue this in court? You mentioned the complaint to the state legislator, but is this instance not something you would pursue in a lawsuit? I was under the impression that you signed up for the ACA plan? Also aren't you afraid that someone Will steal your social security number? I thought when I applied for ACA I had to provide my SSN as proof of being a US citizen? Or is that just the risk You're willing to accept for potentially being able to sue companies for breaking Do not call registry lists?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1n17wbo/another_reason_not_to_trust_lead_brokersthird/nffx4hz/

"CMS has seen an increase in beneficiary complaints associated with third-party marketing organizations (TPMOs) and has received feedback from beneficiary advocates and stakeholders concerned about the marketing practices of TPMOs who sell multiple MA and Part D products. In 2020, we received a total of 15,497 complaints related to marketing. In 2021, excluding December, the total was 39,617. We are unable to say that every one of the complaints is a result of TPMO marketing activities, but based on a targeted search, we do know that many are related to TPMO marketing. In addition, we have seen an increase in third party print and television ads, which appears to be corroborated by State partners. Through this final rule, we will address the concerns with TPMOs by means of the following three updates to the communications and marketing requirements under 42 CFR parts 422 and 423, subpart V: (1) We define TPMOs in the regulation at §§ 422.2260 and 423.2260 to remove any ambiguity associated with MA plans/Part D sponsors responsibilities for TPMO activities associated with the selling of MA and Part D plans; (2) we add a new disclaimer that will be required when TPMOs market MA plans/Part D products (§§ 422.2267(e) and 423.2267(e)); and (3) we update §§ 422.2274 and 423.2274 to require additional plan oversight requirements associated with TPMOs, in addition to what is already required under §§ 422.504(i) and 423.505(i) if the TPMO is a first tier, downstream or related entity (FDR). ----- Pretty mind blowing the YOY increase in complaints to Medicare. But honestly surprised there weren't more complaints"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Suprised nobody's talking about the huge MAPD marketing rules handed down by CMS · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/thread/s/suprised-nobody%E2%80%99s-talking-about-the-huge-mapd-marketing-rules-handed-down-by-cms.108507/#post-1422047>

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— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1n17wbo/another_reason_not_to_trust_lead_brokersthird/nfiv118/

"I am curious, I recently got my license and signed with an agency, although they do not specialize in tele sales. I am looking to get into it seriously, but part time since my current job has excellent benefits. One of the thing that has me worried is the possibility of getting a lawsuit from the do not call list. Obviously I want to BOTH be compliant with the law and not accidentally do something wrong and also not get sued in the process. Anybody got any input on this? As always thanks, Peter's videos got me stoked to start selling (I havent started yet since I am a bit afraid of this)."

— YouTube · Watch Me Make A LIVE TRANSFER Insurance Sale · new or aspiring agent · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6NkrG957hww&lc=Ugy1DhEhdXGU6cQ5sQV4AaABAg>

↳ @scottmoseley5122 (0): "hi lazaro. If you are responding to leads where the prospect has given consent and is soliciting information you should have no problem! might consider changing agencies that provides free leads and you wouldn't have to worry ."

↳ @lazaroflores2314 (0): "@scottmoseley5122 so for instance calling them back when they filled out a form on a fb ad? Also considering changing agencies, they seem like a good agency but I was thinking more final expense via phone route and they seem more of the traditional in person sales deal. Thank you so much!"

AEP: the year's income riding on eight weeks · 6 documents · 6 voices

"Agency M&A Market Update Sharing some current intel on the agency M&A market. Everything here is generalities, but current trends you won't see in press releases. I also won't cite multiples, because even within these segments there is a lot of nuance and "what ifs" that have to be answered. But some general intel on if you have an agency in this category, things to consider. **Size Matters** Always has, but many capital buyers are continuing to bump up their targets. If you are sub \$750K revenue then PE buyers aren't as active. Your best bet is another local agency, and the offers won't be the same. Some PE buyers will play in this space, but the offers are super complex with low guarantees and pie in the sky earn out potentials. This has always been the case, but we're seeing less interest from larger buyers in that segment. >\$750K-\$1M, is typically where the interest remains. Majority of large buyers are open to >\$1M EBITDA, so if you are \$2.5M-\$3M+ revenue, the market is dramatically different. If you are a small agency, and want/need the best exit scenario, your primary objective is quality growth. Makes sense to increase the sale of an asset you should increase what makes it valuable, but for some reason people don't make that connection. If you are content with a handshake deal to turn over the keys with an agency across town, great, but don't expect a high sale price. **Medicare and Non-standard P&C Agencies are Super Limited** The population of buyers has dwindled tremendously over the last 12-18 months. Opinion? It's political. Any time there is looming administration change on health care or immigration, these can be volatile. Medicare agencies are constantly facing changing carriers, comp rates, etc. so on a dime a successful agency can be at risk. Just this week a client, large FMO, learned their #2 carrier was pulling out of a territory and they were at risk to lose revenue on 2,000 policies unless they find a replacement this AEP. Buyers know that, and have only been offering low cash proceeds at close and significant rolled equity or growth earn outs. So when you only have a few options, and the options aren't great, it's hard to sell for a good price. Non-standard is similar, in that there are only a handful of large buyers. Even large (>\$3M revenue) non-standard P&C agencies are not getting good offers. So unless sellers have a motivation to get out, many are holding on. Small or local non-standard, practically your only option is selling to someone local or another non-standard. **Personal Lines is Getting Slightly Less Interest Compared to Last Year** Many large buyers are changing their buy-box criteria to focus on a minimum book mix, so unless an agency has a minimum of 30%-50% CL, many of the larger buyers aren't excited. That's not saying they aren't sellable, we still get great interest for good agencies, but when the buyer pool reduces that can be reflected in the offers. This is an observation, but on average we are seeing offers for PL focused agencies around 10% less compared to last year for guaranteed proceeds. When you think about it, property rates in many states have slowed or even started to decrease, so the due diligence standards are also looking at this. Many agencies have floated on rate the last few years, and now the tide has turned. Having history of client count or PIF is more important, and if your revenue is stable but you've lost clients and policies, that's flag being discussed. **CL, or HNW, Holds Strong Interest** There are still nuances within that, but many capital buyers are focusing their efforts on agencies with 50% or more CL. Even though we still see strong interest in PL, on average we see almost double the amount of qualified inquiries for a CL focused agency. **Earn out Structures are Evolving** People know "you have to stay on for 2-3 years" to work out an earnout, but candidly recent history has proven that many sellers almost don't care about earnouts, or that's all they care about then completely check out. For truly competitive offers, buyers are focusing more on true perpetuation planning vs buying an owner out and giving them a short term retirement window. This is the rare exception, but have seen it, where some buyers are now tying earnout performance to staff retention (AMs and producers) instead of just the owner. Not everyone will adopt this, but I wouldn't be surprised if more do. So perpetuation of culture and why your agency can perform will be tied to things other than strictly financials. **EDIT Diversified Agencies are Not Always A Good Idea** Agencies that offer derivative services like real estate, tax prep, bookkeeping, payroll, HR, etc. cause problems. Back in the day there used to be buyers for these, not anymore. They will be broken up if you want to sell. Even as far as P&C PL and Medicare. As much as you feel they are complimentary, they aren't. Different markets. Even things like group benefits and HR consulting. While complimentary not everyone who does group benefits wants HR consulting. If you look at diversified larger agencies you can see one clear trend. P&C CL and group benefits can have some compliment. That's it. Focus on doing one thing, really really well, and don't get distracted with other things."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vzu98u/>

↳ (0): "Nice write up. Kind of what I am seeing/hearing as well. Have had a few calls from some older agency owners under 1,000,000 in revenue noting that they haven't received much interest from PE. I asked if they had any younger producers and they noted they did not. With the lack of younger talent and revenue under a 1,000,000 they aren't getting much traction on being acquired or able to sell to PE."

↳ (0): "Yep. Stagnant or no growth is sellable, but the true difference is a well run business, good staffing, and history of organic growth."

↳ (0): "Great write up and insights. Appreciate your expertise here, as always."

"I recently started original Medicare with a supplement plan N. If the day were to come I could no longer afford supplement premiums, I could move over to a Disadvantage plan during open enrollment without being concerned about medical underwriting. I would probably take out a reverse mortgage on my home to continue affording supplement premiums before I would do that though. I would buy a HDG supplement plan before a Disadvantage plan. I do not want a insurance company having that much control of my healthcare decisions. I don't buy my health insurance for the shiny distracting objects of vision, dental, gym memberships and such either. @johnyracercat"

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzHCpaN2Z99tywzREh4AaABAg.9y98fTJc_WH9yCV1Jiiez5

"@Seniorbenes Well you are running an agency and that is not feasible for most new agents because they lack the capitol to start on a large scale like that. Yes if you scale to the point you are doing then it can work, but your investment is huge when this industry has 90% of new agents failing in the first 2 years. My description is what an average independent agent will perform. Nick from Medicare Millionaire is an independent agent and works by himself. He is a seasoned agent and very good at selling yet he only sold 127 policies in 2018 and he does this full time and employs his own telemarketer for \$3 per hour and uses direct mail leads. I was an assistant office manager for a Medicare brokerage firm for 9 years and out of 10 agents that our office had we only had 2 top producers and they each had about 1,500 clients. They serviced all of their clients and they were extremely stressed out all the time especially during AEP when MA plans became discontinued and they needed to review plan changes every year for their large client base. The average agent had about 500 clients. You need to provide customer service for your clients if you want to keep them long term and the sheer amount of work required to service MA plans simply isn't worth it. 95% of the calls we got at our agency was people having questions about their co-pays, the network, prescription drug co-pays, Part D late enrollment penalties, prescription drug issues, and how their plan worked. You spent all your time servicing MA and Part D clients and this is why you can't have more than 500 clients on your own before you are forced to hire help. Having 2,000 clients yourself means you aren't providing service to them when they have issues or you are just selling Medigap. Sorry to say but 70% of seniors on Medicare nationwide have Medicare Advantage. You and I both know how hard it is to market Part C and D plans selling over the phone as CMS makes this almost impossible. You need a partnership with a carrier to pull that off on a large scale and be successful which makes you captive to that carrier. I am in this industry to help seniors, not to help some corporate insurance carrier gain market share. CMS doesn't allow you to market Part C or Part D on social media, you need to read your AHIP test again my dude."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfQtB4AaABAg.9FNCTGBzf7K9FPVNMvVfon>

"I wrote 84 apps but it was my first AEP I am worried about charge backs and how much it all equals out to be come Jan 1st. How many did you do in renewals?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pgvbbq/aep_apps_vs_chargebacks/nszamaq/

"Not only did they just crush the STM market, but they will also attempt to steal your T65 medicare clients. Oooops.....they were never your client anyways. FACT SHEET FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE June 8, 2016 Contact: CMS Media Relations (202) 690-6145 | CMS Media Inquiries Strengthening the Marketplace – Actions to Improve the Risk Pool With millions of Americans insured through the Health Insurance Marketplaces, it's clear that Marketplace coverage is a product consumers want and need and an important business for insurers, with several major issuers expanding their Marketplace presence. At the Department of Health and Human Services (HHS), we are constantly monitoring the health of the Marketplace and are always looking to make improvements that benefit both consumers and issuers. Over the past several months, HHS has taken a series of actions to strengthen the Marketplace risk pool, limit upward pressure on rates, and ensure a strong Marketplace for the long term. We believe those actions are bringing positive results. As part of our continued commitment to the long-term strength of the Marketplace, we are announcing new measures to ensure that the Marketplace continues to provide affordable coverage for millions of Americans. During the month of June, HHS will make three announcements regarding our ongoing efforts to: strengthen the risk pool by spreading the costs of care over a diverse mix of enrollees, work with issuers and state Departments of Insurance to improve coverage options, and step up Marketplace outreach, especially to young adults and uninsured families in advance of Open Enrollment 4. Today, HHS is announcing a series of actions to strengthen the Marketplace risk pool. These actions include: · Curbing abuses of short-term plans that exploit gaps in current rules to use medical underwriting to keep some of the healthiest consumers out of the Affordable Care Act's single risk pool. · Improving the risk adjustment program to more accurately reflect the cost of partial-year enrollees and to incorporate prescription drug utilization data that provide a more complete picture of enrollees' health status. These improvements will ensure that the program continues to work as intended to compensate issuers with higher-risk enrollees and thereby help issuers sustainably serve all types of consumers. · Helping consumers who turn 65 make the transition to Medicare, so that older consumers are served by the program designed for them and their health needs. · Beginning full implementation of the Special Enrollment Confirmation Process, which ensures that eligible individuals continue to have access to coverage through Special Enrollment Periods (SEPs), but prevents people from misusing the system to enroll in coverage only if they get sick. · Continuing our efforts to reduce data-matching issues (DMIs). CMS outreach, education, and operational improvements have contributed to a sharp reduction in total data matching issues generated and an almost 40 percent year-over-year increase in documents submitted to help resolve income and citizenship and immigration data matching issues. Improving the resolution of DMIs benefits the risk pool because it keeps eligible consumers, often younger and healthier consumers less motivated to overcome obstacles such as extra paperwork, from losing coverage mid-year. Risk Pool Actions Curbing Abuse of Short-Term Limited Duration Plans Short-term limited duration coverage is health care coverage issued for a short period of time. Because short-term limited duration plans are designed to fill only very short coverage gaps, this coverage is not subject to any of the key rules governing the ACA's single risk pool: they can be priced based on health status (medically underwritten), can discriminate against consumers with pre-existing conditions, and do not have to cover essential health benefits. Some issuers are now offering short-term limited duration plans to consumers as their primary form of health coverage for periods that last nearly 12 months, allowing them to target only the healthiest consumers while avoiding consumer protections. As highlighted in recent press accounts, by keeping these consumers out of the ACA single risk pool, such abuses of limited duration coverage increase costs for everyone else, and they could have a greater impact over time if allowed to become more widespread. Today, the Department of Labor, Department of Treasury, and Department of Health and Human Services (HHS) issued a proposed rule to revise the definition of short-term, limited duration coverage. Under the new rules, short-term policies may be offered only for less than three months, and coverage cannot be renewed at the end of the three month period. The proposed rule also improves transparency for consumers by requiring issuers to provide notice to consumers that the coverage is not minimum essential coverage, does not satisfy the health coverage requirement of the ACA, and will not prevent the consumer from owing a tax penalty. The proposed changes will help strengthen the risk pool by ensuring that short term limited duration plans are used only as intended, to fill truly temporary gaps in coverage. Maturing the Risk Adjustment Program By reducing incentives for issuers to try to design products that attract a disproportionately healthy risk pool, risk adjustment lets them design products that meet the needs of all consumers, protecting consumers' access to a range of robust options. Updating risk adjustment to more accurately assess every enrollee's risk makes it more effective in achieving this goal. Earlier this year, CMS made a number of changes to improve the stability, predictability, and accuracy of the risk adjustment program for issuers. These changes include better modeling of costs for preventive services, changes to the data update schedule, and earlier reporting of preliminary risk adjustment data where available. We also published a Risk Adjustment White Paper and hosted a conference on March 31, 2016 to solicit feedback from issuers, consumers, and other stakeholders on additional areas for improvement. Building off the Risk Adjustment White Paper and stakeholder feedback, today we are announcing two additional important changes to risk adjustment that we intend to propose in future rulemaking. First, we intend to propose that, beginning for the 2017 benefit year, the risk adjustment model include an adjustment factor for partial-year enrollees. By more accurately accounting for the costs of short term enrollees in ACA-compliant risk pool, this change will support the Marketplace's important role as a source of coverage for people who are between jobs, experiencing life transitions, or otherwise need coverage for part of the year. Second, we intend to propose that, beginning for the 2018 benefit year, prescription drug utilization data be incorporated in risk adjustment, as a source of information about individuals' health status and the severity of their conditions. We are also considering proposing additional changes to the model for 2018 and beyond. Transitioning Consumers to Medicare The Marketplace serves as an essential backstop for consumers as they transition between different types of coverage over their lifetime. For example, many early retirees access Marketplace coverage until they become eligible for Medicare when they turn 65. But once individuals turn 65, most people should end their Marketplace coverage and switch to Medicare. In fact, if consumers do not enroll in Medicare Part B when they turn 65, they could face financial consequences for years into the future, because they could owe higher Medicare premiums. Meanwhile, the Marketplace is intended to serve consumers who are not Medicare eligible, and continued enrollment by individuals who are eligible for Medicare can raise costs for other consumers. To make sure consumers understand the steps they need to take to move to Medicare, this summer the Marketplace will start contacting enrollees as they near their 65th birthday. This outreach will provide consumers with the information they need to enroll in Medicare if they are eligible and end their Marketplace coverage if they choose to. This builds off the changes we made to the HealthCare.gov application this year which included new pop ups with reminders for consumers who are about to turn 65 that they may be eligible for Medicare. Implementing the Special Enrollment Confirmation Process Over the last several months, the Marketplace has taken a number of steps to ensure that Special Enrollment Periods (SEPs) are there for consumers when they need them while avoiding misuse or abuse. We've strengthened our rules and clarified our processes for SEPs, so that the people who need to can still easily get coverage, while making it hard for anyone thinking about taking advantage. We also eliminated 7 SEPs, including the SEP for individuals who paid the tax p"

— Insurance-Forums.com · CMS: STM Limited to 3 Months - No Renewal Allowed · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/cms-stm-limited-to-3-months-no-renewal-allowed.82709/#post-1106530>

"New Health Insurance agent selling Medicare Advantage for upcoming AEP Q's Hi, As the title says I am a new health insurance agent focusing on the upcoming AEP. My upline is telling me that his script is completely compliant. I'm concerned about the TPMO disclosure and the SOA The tpmo disclosure simply says "We do not offer every plan available in your area. Currently, we represent 0-78 organizations which offer 0-613 products in your area. Please contact \[medicare.gov\](http://medicare.gov) or 1-800-MEDICARE to get information on all of your options. I also just have to let you know — this call may be recorded for quality assurance or training purposes." I'm specifically concerned that it is a broad range and want to ask if that is cms compliant to say 0-78 and 0-613 or do I need to say exactly how many plans I can offer. My second question has to do with the SOA as his script does not seem compliant to me. It is as follows : In your area, we have a wide variety of Medicare plans available — including Medicare Advantage, Prescription Drug, dental, and vision. Before we go any further, I have to let you know: this conversation has no effect on your current or future health coverage unless you enroll, and talking with me does not obligate you to enroll or automatically enroll you in a plan. Ok?" As I said I am new and I haven't started selling yet and won't until October but I don't want to get in trouble and am thinking of creating my own script. Am I overthinking this or? Thanks if you read this far."

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wfh4dr/new_health_insurance_agent_selling_medicare/

↳ jroberts67 (1): "[<https://blog.newhorizonsmktg.com/tpmo-disclaimer-tips-to-stay-compliant/>](https://blog.newhorizonsmktg.com/tpmo-disclaimer-tips-to-stay-compliant)";

↳ Born-Nature8394 (1): "Somewhat helpful. I just wish there was a completely clear answer. I do know that 2027 rules have changed and it no longer needs to be said in the first minute. I think I will not do the range and actually tell people exactly what I can offer. That seems compliant to me."

↳ Key_Astronomer6500 (1): "Your Crm should update when you get an inbound phone call or when you dial out. At least it did with the companies I worked for. Soa sounds compliant to me as long as you get a yes. Sounds like every generic call center."

Tab 2 — Hopes & Dreams

Getting licensed, certified and started · 23 documents · 20 voices

"I agree with the pro of being independent and not micromanaged. Long rant but I just quit my fairly new job where I knew NOTHING. I had no experience. They said training would be 2 months.. Unfortunately, only 3 weeks in the boss kept pulling me aside literally every day and telling me I was too slow, not doing good enough, and that I should know a lot more. Then she wanted me to study at home to "catch up" without paying me. As well as the senior staff member would make comments throughout the day like "come on. you should know this already" The problem was I knew the information. It just got very difficult to focus because of the negativity. I was sweating and so anxious all day and because of that kept making mistakes. I woke up one day and said fuck this and quit. I work best when not micromanaged. I need to take the time to learn things at my own pace. I cannot tolerate negativity. My previous job was a pharmacy technician. I did it for 5 years and I loved it and I was badass at it. It made me realize that I love talking to customers about health insurance. I hope I do well as an insurance agent :D I'm about to take the licensing exam. Yay!"

— YouTube · PROS & CONS OF BEING AN INSURANCE AGENT · 122 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UfHT3xWq4TY&lc=UgwNWyFPgvNrc06hZcd4AaABAg>

↳ @ErinNogueira (15): "Best of luck Jane! Proud of you for sticking to your guns and doing what's best for you!!"

↳ @nerd6646 (5): "how is it going? i'm about to do the same move you did lol"

↳ @dianaag28 (1): "Good for you, good luck 🍀👍"

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

↳ Legio-V-Alaudae (45): "If it was so easy and well paying, they wouldn't have to advertise the hell out of the jobs. I'm sorry you didn't have a healthy amount of skepticism when conducting due diligence."

↳ Candid_Worth_3629 (25): "Did you not ask for any advice from this subreddit or do any research prior to leaving your 9-5? Everyone would've told you to keep the main job and start out part time. It's also really important to be at a place that doesn't make you churn \$ for leads. Most are MLM schemes"

↳ jordan32025 (20): "Anyone who doesn't understand that AP written is not the same as the commission percentage shouldn't start a life insurance business. Also, going into it thinking it's a "job" is recipe for guaranteed failure. There is some financial literacy needed. This precisely why I don't recruit people who are not already actively selling consistently with a good carrier. They already know how to run a business."

"@JohnDavis-yz9nq John I am licensed agent and EITHER way can bleed ya...it is the hope of Medicare that NO ONE uses it."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 39 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgxAXzFMBaU_-X7O2GZ4AaABA9_9YRy38TRtYC9YiQyO8M_Ni

"Am I Crazy for Wanting to Leave My \$200k+ Job to Start and Independent Agency Background, I'm mid 30s, 2 kids, and I've just about had it with my extremely high stress/toxic culture job (in a healthcare/pharma marketing related field). I have a few years of savings and I'm ready to pivot my career into something more personally rewarding.....I'm seriously considering insurance! I know how to build a brand, manage CRM systems, create effective communications (the one-on-one sales aspect is new to me, but I know I can figure it out). Plus I have a solid background in many aspects of prescription drugs and healthcare (i've taken a practice licensing test without cracking a book and got a 72%, so there's more for me to learn, but a solid foundation) The idea is to start a medicare-focused agency, brand it to appeal to the communities I want to target, partner with an FMO, and begin sourcing paid and earned leads directly (this is not a challenge for me, I'm been doing it in the pharma space for years). My goal is to use the next 6 months to start up the business, get my licenses and begin lead generation. I would then quit my job in time for the end of year enrollment season, see how that goes - (pick up some light contract work throughout next year to supplement my income) and then go all-in on the business late 2026 - hoping that I can be clearing \$150k+ in 2027 and back to 200k+ earnings in 2028. Over time I'd branch out into other lines, but I want to keep a narrow focus for now so I can effectively source clients. That's the high-level plan, of course there are many more details that I'm figuring out (I'm building financial projections, comparing FMOs, analyzing the competitive landscape for local agents and the large nationals...and a lot more to make sure I'm going in with solid goals and expectations) So, am I crazy to get into this world? What are the biggest pitfalls to watch out for that will get in the way of me being successful? What is the biggest deterrents for those starting out that will make me feel burnt?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jdknqh/am_i_crazy_for_wanting_to_leave_my_200k_job_to/

↳ HamiltonSt25 (39): "I didn't read everything you wrote, but just keep in mind, it's a tough insurance climate right now (Assuming you're in the US). Doing it right now would leave you struggling to get contracts. I'm an independent and almost all of my major carriers are not giving new contracts at this time. This will drain your assets extremely fast. I'd hold out until it softens up a bit."

↳ Acceptable-Tip7886 (28): "Times are tough, if you're making 200k plus I would stay and invest. Money now is more important than money later plus you'll retire sooner"

↳ HamiltonSt25 (10): "I'm sorry, let me clarify. I'm speaking as far as P&C goes. So if you're asking about life/health, I have no idea. If you're talking P&C, then I'm speaking about direct contracts with carriers/companies."

"ALRIGHT I PASSED! So I passed finished my pre-licensing course on Saturday midnight and scheduled the state exam at 8am for that morning. I passed! I currently am getting contracted for an agency that does medicare - they have their own leads coming in and a good team it seems like. As well as training. Now that's the health side. I already did my fingerprints, got my license approved and I am waiting for the next steps. However, I have been seeing people make money in life insurance and what excites me is the 2-3 day deposits of commissions in the bank. Since I had the license I am thinking of doing this as well but don't know where to start. What are your opinions or advice you'd give to me? P.S. I got my license because I am having a baby soon and my goal is to get my wife out of work and stay at home. I was going to college and working part-time but now I am trying to ramp things up. College still is a priority for me because I promised my mom I'd finish before she passed away. But right now I believe and seen results through Life/Health to make something happen for my future family."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ju62n5/alright_i_passed/

↳ PristineAsk6192 (6): "Congrats on passing! As a life agent, it is nice to get paid quickly and with the advance pay it adds up quickly as well. However, please be cautious of chargebacks if you are on advanced pay. A safer choice is to request "as earned" especially if you're not dialed in with managing your money. Have a solid schedule, good lead flow, and just stay consistent."

↳ PristineAsk6192 (3): "I do this part-time and I've been licensed since 2021. For me chargebacks fluctuate by the product type and client age. For me, the highest chargeback product is whole life, especially for those over 60. Lowest chargeback are from Term/mortgage protection and IUL's."

↳ hawkwood76 (3): "1 of 2 ways, your upline should be providing access to training as should the carriers you represent. Also there are about a 100 different certifications you can get. Most of them are over rated, and in and of themselves will not get you more money, but some of them are valuable will teach you a lot. LUTCF is one that is quite good if you are looking to specialize in the Life/ annuity space."

"I am tired of giving these Florida call centers my residuals, I am interested in the best IMO that offers support and great systems. I want vesting from day 1, and immediate release of my license in case if anything. I'm only interested in final expense/ mapd completely telesales only. Also I think the future is Live transfers... which company can help me."

— YouTube · What Is The Best FMO or IMO For New Medicare Agents? · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XzJoCuAyo94&lc=UgyiBOS3YIikdLiMo1V4AaABAq>

↳ @savannahsmiles1797 (3): "FL and IL have the worst cluster of them"

"Just got a position at usha as a health insurance agent I'm currently getting my license I'm excited they where showing me all this crazy amount of money like 5 to 11k a week i star Monday n i just hope it's true they are currently doing 4.6 mill a week in that single office what do you think"

— YouTube · How To Make Six-Figures Selling Health Insurance! \$ \$ · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=abG7Q3fGe6o&lc=UgyYcuDkeaznGLPTi3l4AaABAq>

↳ @drichdr (4): "How's it going now man just a update?"

↳ @SA-em1lv (3): "@yago2400 i work at usha now. Its my second month. I havent made crazy money but enough to survive. But i didnt come from anything similar started from 0. I see myself getting better everyday. Its literally up to you , if you put in time and some money it will be a success and be worth it. Be coachable"

↳ @yago2400 (0): "Same here. How'd it go?"

"Medicare I am a P&C guy who owns an agency. I have two people working personal lines and I was doing commercial, which is slow at times. I wanted to get into Medicare Insurance so I went with the FMO Ritter and they have been great but...outside of my own prospect in house I am unsure how to jumpstart my book. My goal is 4 a month to start out since I do already have an income and have other daily responsibilities as an agency owner. I feel like everyone is buying leads and no one is happy with those leads so its hard to trust any lead source. Then the cost seems crazy to me for those leads. I would do live transfers but at \$45-\$60...I am not even sure I could afford enough to even try. I do have a sign coming for outside my office that basically says "We Offer Medicare Supplements!". I am hoping passing traffic will bring in some organic business. I guess what I am asking is how did some of you guys really start from scratch? Are leads pointless? For every "I like so and so leads" there's a "Really they sent me trash!". Do you really need to expand into other states? Do you need to forego the data leads and do transfers? Do your FMOs help you with leads (Ritter doesn't offer leads)?"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 4 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/15ksxo7/medicare/>

↳ Itschmit (4): "Medicare agency owner here. Been full time for 7 years. Like u/geetarman84 said, getting people is the hardest part. I'll tell you what I did, but you won't like it. I do most business in person, so I've done very little internet or phone leads. I started with and still do in person seminars. I do 20-25 a year. They don't work as well as they used to, but I still get solid leads from them. Attendees are motivated and ready to shop so they're good leads. The key is getting an insurer or FMO to co-op or better yet, fully cover the cost of marketing. I used to also do Q+A sessions, and meetings at senior centers, retirement homes, large senior apartment complexes, etc. The nice part about those was if you could convince the activities manager or building manager that you were providing a service for their people, they'd advertise it for you. When I was getting started I had a Walmart booth. Also tried CVS, but those never worked for me. Walmart was boring, and slow. Literally just waiting around for people to approach. But people did. Over a 4 hour shift I'd typically get 2-3 leads. Do 4 shifts a week, and that's a decent workload, but generally not great clients. Find people to partner with for referrals. Your clients are your best place to prospect. My dad always said the magic word is "ask". Once you have a book, if you do it right, the referrals will pour in. Beyond your clients, I've had luck with financial advisors, who want to refer their clients to someone that won't compete on the money management side. I do mailings too. They are tough way to go. I've only bought leads once, and they were not great. I'd rather spend money building up my name as the local Medicare guy."

↳ Itschmit (3): "I'm glad to help, and grateful to hear it's appreciated. For the financial advisors, I never really aggressively marketed to them. I don't think they like that anyway. For me it started as doing the right thing for a client, who turned out to be an advisor. He's referred dozens of great clients over the years. He liked knowing they were going to someone that would treat the clients right and stay in their lane (not compete). Eventually the owner of that advisory firm turned 65 so I helped him too, and it grew from there. Those good clients have referred me to brothers, sisters, friends, etc, since when someone turns 65 they probably have siblings of similar ages. When I started my agency 3ish years ago I got a suite for our offices and the owner of the building happens to be a different financial advisor. I know some have paid advisors for referrals, but I never have. The advisors I work with have said they would prefer I didn't, since that could be seen as a conflict of interest. Then again, I don't have an army of advisors sending clients to me, just 3. But making good relations with professionals is smart in general. CPA's, Senior Apartment managers, etc. You might have some perfect people already as clients of your agency."

↳ geetarman84 (3): "kiss complete brave cooperative flag instinctive adjoining repeat ancient wakeful *This post was mass deleted and anonymized with [Redact](<https://redact.dev/home/>)*":

"Started working for a company called selectquote and I was only connecting customers with Medicare part A and B with an licensed agent. I did truly enjoy bonding with the clients but I didn't like the repetitive script every phone call and decided I would love to be the licensed Medicare agent and also get my life insurance license. I've watched a few of your videos and see that this is a great line of business but before stepping in it I need to make sure it's for me. I am a peoples person and great at connecting with others. I guess my question to you would be does it get boring?"

— YouTube · Day in the Life of a Medicare Agent | Lead Generation + some helpful tips · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=n06FUKfXV0M&lc=UgzCrmqI38QJ95GBH94AaABAg>

↳ @KinkyStyles1980 (4): "Boring, no. I love helping people. Each day is different. You answer different questions and meet different people. Not boring at all."

↳ @jadaliddell8812 (1): "Thank you I'm excited about finding a class and investing in health and life insurance!!"

↳ @jadaliddell8812 (1): "What book do you recommend for life and health insurance that is great to study if I'm not in a class or anything? What book should I study to completely prepare me for the exam? All the seminars I see available are online and far away from where I stay. How should I go about getting my life and health insurances without getting them free through a company?"

"Sounds very similar to my setup, calls been really slow lately. I work with health insurance though, what kind of products are you selling? What is your commission for one sale? I sell around 7-15 ACA policies a day as well as a Medicare and STM plan every once in a while as well. Hope you have much success congratulations on the first sale."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj9u0m/had_my_first_sale_today/ov532ij/

"I love your videos! They are so helpful. I'm a licensed agent and would love to learn how to work with you."

— YouTube · How much MONEY do Medicare agents make?? · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xfL6KRRvXes&lc=UgwMwg49o4-DBSFQkbJ4AaABAg>

↳ @KinkyStyles1980 (0): "My email is in the description of this video!♥"

"Looking for: Google g2 Certified Health Insurance Agents Looking for a licensed health insurance agent to educate an online media buyer about how G2 certification works for a potential partnership. We are an online marketing agency specializing in Facebook ads for health insurance & ACA calls/leads. Would love to speak to an agent that is g2 certified to help us expand our marketing to google. We are looking for an agent licensed in the states below Texas Florida Georgia North Carolina Tennessee South Carolina Mississippi Ohio Missouri Oklahoma"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/11rwh4v/looking_for_google_g2_certified_health_insurance/

↳ FATALDREAM23 (1): "I am a CA, NV, TX licensed agent."

↳ MrCakes-here (1): "Would love to talk if you are interested. Send you a message."

"@Kenny...I'm newly licensed in PA and I really want to start making CASH IMMEDIATELY 😊 and although I want to eventually be indep. in medicare I am thinking that I could start with a health company now (before OE) and learn the ropes -- get my ahip certification for a year and earn enough to buy leads with a years experience. What do you think? I heard you on a video mention 'something' about working with a company..."

— YouTube · 6 Easy Steps To Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ck8W8FDaGYE&lc=Ugxr8hDL66lipkuJ8dh4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicareMillennials (0): "Sometimes starting with a captive agency can be a great start! Just do your research first :)"

"You will !!! just trust the process and don't give up in the first year(most people do) find a company that offer base pay and commission also leads(their out there just ask around) this will provide stability so you can focus on building your sales skills... keep an open mind and take all feedback as advice not attacks(even on the days you feel like the universe is out to get you).. take a deep breath , don't talk more than the client and reset mentally after every client... biggest lesson I learned my first year in the industry is to not take everything personally and celebrate the small win they build your confidence and add up to big checks.. Rejection is the biggest obstacle to overcome however Rejection is motivation.. and record your calls also visualize yourself performing the script not reciting it with no compassion for the clients well being to fulfill their needs.. learn to be a good listener is also important as a new agent.. also become obsessed with learning about sales and implement any tips your learn from the ones who already been through the newbie stage... find your sales personality.. and control ONLY what you control.. and lastly create more opportunities for sales by obtaining non resident line of authority in other states. The goal is to become licensed in all fifty to really maximize on growing your book of business faster than just being licensed in your resident states.. start with the states that are less than \$50 for the license. You will be surprised how cheap some starts are and some are very expensive..."

— YouTube · How much money do you make? Insurance Broker · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0Sy_Ce5T1nI&lc=UgypF-gzZViAaS_WW1V4AaABAg_9u63ArsigBXAEs9eLD3nQ9

"@GordonMarketingI'm new--very new. Still havent viewed all of your videos yet. I'd like to learn more about effective lead generation and marketing budgets needed for new independent contracting agents."

— YouTube · Where New Medicare Agents Can Get Free Training · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=A1MHluUzD-w&lc=UgwRiivclC3XXZ2NTpB4AaABAg_9SX7JcljwM19SZvNxtZoGh

"This is so inspiring I want to become licensed to sell Medicare but if I am new should I start of with a company in order to gain experience or go out on my own?"

— YouTube · Watch me Generate Leads & Network I Medicare Agent · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nfaSLw51zw&lc=UgzZVbum-gM6V2lHuF4AaABAg>

↳ @KinkyStyles1980 (2): "Start with a company if you need steady income Start Independent if you can go without steady income for at least 1 year. And can go all in"

"New agent planning to become an independent broker — looking for a remote, non-captive IMO (want to avoid mistakes). Need suggestions. I'm a college student getting licensed soon and I want to make sure I don't make the wrong choice with my first IMO. My long-term goal is to be an independent broker, not captive, so I'm looking for a fully remote, flexible, non-captive IMO that pays directly from carriers, gives day-one vested ownership, and doesn't have an MLM or sink-or-swim environment. I want structured training tied to real leads (not just videos) with a mentorship culture where I can learn through hybrid lead types (live transfers + fresh internet + aged leads). Long term, I want the freedom to stop buying IMO leads and outsource or generate my own once I can close consistently. I care about doing things right, so I want a client-first organization, not a numbers-only pressure model. I'll start with life insurance only, then expand into annuities after I build skill. Any IMO recommendations that fit this? Any industry advice is appreciated as I work toward becoming a fully independent broker, thank you! 🙏"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · new or aspiring agent · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pftb0n/>

↳ (0): "SafeLife Policy is the place where I'm at and I've built a 6-figure business very quickly. You really should be looking for strong mentorship above all else though. My agents are successful because of our team, system, and training. Good luck!"

↳ (0): "Thank you! Definitely will search for the best mentorship I can find 🙏"

↳ (0): "Ritter insurance . I have over 20 years with both!"

"Chris Donnelly said: Hi all. My name is Chris and I am a brand new agent looking to enter the business of final expense telesales. I am coming into this business from the academic world of political science (decided I was tired of going from visiting gig to visiting gig but never nailing down a tenure track job, and so I now want something radically different for myself and have decided on entering this new (for me) field. I consider myself someone who tries to do a lot of research and due diligence, however, before making any big decisions, and so I am asking for some help from you all. So in terms of where I want to call home for my first job in final expense telesales, after doing a lot of shopping around, I have narrowed my search down to what seem to me to be two excellent choices: Duford Insurance Group and Digital BGA As such, as I was wondering if any more experienced agents here could lend some insight as to the pros and cons of joining one or the other of these two companies. Just to preemptively answer some basic questions about my own plans and background that people might have: -I am 37 years old and do not have a significant other or children, and live alone -I plan to work from my apartment in the Boston area -As above suggests, I am looking to do exclusively do telesales, NOT F2F -I am fortunate enough to have accumulated some money from family, past work, and passive income and so can afford to spend a good bit of money on buying leads -I have not yet gotten licensed but hope to pass the MA state exam in a few weeks tops and to purchase transferances so that I can sell in some other states, too -I am planning on doing this full time, not part time -I'd hope to be able to earn six figures in income after a couple of years of doing this (realistic?) -Getting high quality training and mentoring is of utmost importance to me, as I do not have a background in sales or insurance Anyhow, I hope this info is helpful. I look forward to reading what people think! Click to expand... They both post here so maybe you'll get some direct responses."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Duford Insurance Group vs. Digital BGA for Final Expense Telesales · 4 reactions · new or aspiring agent · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/duford-insurance-group-vs-digital-bga-for-final-expense-telesales.110049/#post-1444479>

"Right now I am in my life and health course! I would love to get more info on where to start when I get licensed!"

— YouTube · How much MONEY do Medicare agents make?? · 2 likes · new or aspiring agent · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xfl_6KRRvXes&lc=UgzOaTozk_w8bU1dfcV4AaABAg

"May i ask where you work bc I am newly licensed and all I keep seeing are Life insurance companies and I would like to start with medicare. You can pm me if you'd like."
— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · new or aspiring agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hx3ebv/recent_lh_licensed_selling_medicare_advantage/m6jmggz/

A book of business and renewals that pay every year · 21 documents · 20 voices

"Quit \$150k W2 Sales to start an Agency. 6 Months in: Lessons learned from the "FE Trap" and pivoting to Group Health/Life. Feedback? I'm in my late 20s and recently walked away from a \$150k+ W2 sales career to build my own independent agency. I started with a \$2,000/month residual base from a previous ACA book and a small group. The Failure: I fell for the Final Expense hype. I burned several thousand dollars on my own ads, lead vendors, and a marketing firm. After 6 months, I realized the "social worker" aspect of FE isn't for me. I'm a consultant and advisor, not a hand-holder for the unbanked. The Pivot: I've officially pivoted to Group Health (U65), Individual Health, and Term Life. My daily "Machine" looks like this: • Cold Knocking: Visiting local businesses daily to prospect for Group Health. • Strategic Partners: Building a referral network (CPAs, P&C agents) for Life/Health leads. • Efficiency: Cutting all paid lead spend once current FE ads die. Reallocating that budget to BNI and local SEO. The Concern: I'm 6 months in and not profitable yet. I live in a major city and the grind is real. Thank God for my savings and residual base, but I want to make sure I'm not missing a gear. My Questions: 1. Aside from BNI and cold knocking, what high-leverage community events or "advisor-level" prospecting am I missing?"
— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rgt03f/>

↳ (0): "Insurance Sales is hard, if you don't already have a book of business. It will take a while to build the business."

↳ (0): "How long did it take you to profit?"

↳ (0): "Health biz is great, just takes years to build. Have you looked at using ICHRA to get into the door? Do some research on IHCRA if you haven't. Some other things I'd try: look for new business formations in your local newspaper and go drop in on them. Fresh meat! =) Also, how much activity are you doing? Are you cold knocking 30 businesses daily or making 100+ phone calls daily? A lack of activity is usually the cause of all sales woes. If you're looking for ways to bridge the gap with final expense, consider doing in-person seminars at local independent senior living facilities. Did those for 9 months and made around 100 sales with zero expense. Have seen dozens of other agents do well at it, too. Further, you could look at doing talks at small group church meetings, senior activity centers, about Medicare, final expenses, etc. Cost nothing and creates the best leads. Good luck. Remember it's normal that the first few years are incredibly difficult as you find your place. Stick with it and eventually you'll find your niche and begin getting traction!"

"Having done Medicare, I'd do ACA. Your odds are high that you will write the entire family versus Medicare where it's mostly one person. While you can sometimes do husband and wife enrollments it's very rare. Your goal is to build residual income. Plus, no longer dealing with pain the butt elderly people with a 2 minute attention span wanting \$5k/month in food cards who change policies multiple times per year is a bonus. I'm thankful for the experience in Medicare because it really does teach you to overcome objections and pivot pitch. Beyond that, I would never want to sell it again."
— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kmjoeg/whats_better_aca_or_medicare_sales/msbxwrl/

"For me it's, \$611 up front for MAPD and \$306 renewals in January. Med Supp Im about \$550 when you factor in PDP. My goal each year is \$100k FYC plus my renewals in Medicare. Add in annuities, FE, CHAS, etc. Being rich depends on the person."
— Insurance-Forums.com · Does anyone really get "rich" selling Medicare · 5 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/does-anyone-really-get-rich-selling-medicare.113372/#post-1494991>

"Picking apart this story, I have a few things I want to point out: 1) Do as much research as possible into whoever you're going to interview with. Glassdoor, customer reviews, news articles that may or may not feature the company, etc. If you have to pay for your own leads, but only from company approved sources, stay away. Either they let you build your book your way or they provide you leads to work. 2) Never. Ever. Trust the "can make up to \$x/mo" line. What some of these companies do is hire anyone who comes in, milk the bottom tier until they leave, and promote up people who either pull deals out of thin air OR are really good at recruiting. The recruiter can probably make \$10k/mo by bringing in people to buy leads, like they did you. If some policies get written in the process, all the better. 3) If you know it's a Pyramid scheme, why even take the job? 4) Ask important questions during the interview, such as if the job is 1099 or W2. Where do the leads come from? What am I financially responsible for? Do you have any affiliations with major carriers? If it's 1099 and you're responsible for purchasing leads, do you have the freedom to purchase from where you'd like or are you restricted to those same old "approved provider" sources? My personal favorite thing to do is whenever I'm asked about a previous work story of any kind, I try to use something shady I've witnessed to get their reaction. My go to is a guy who took \$6k from an old woman who was still receiving notices from her recently passed son's tax debts. One phone call and a faxed death certificate fixed the whole problem, and this dude was proud of fleecing the old lady. If they get excited about that sort of mentality, don't go with them. Pursue agencies that balances sales volume with professional integrity, rather than closing as many deals as possible and hoping at least 50% make it to a yearly renewal, if that. 5) You will not find one industry that doesn't have cockroaches giving a bad name to the rest. My parents don't trust flooring installers they don't know personally, because they last time they hired someone to re-floor their kitchen and dining room, \$500 of jewelry mysteriously disappeared. 6) From my own experience, if you apply and get invited to an "informational meeting where we break down what we do and how before you decide to go to the next phase of the hiring process", view it as a massive red flag. Having a "short meeting to get to know each other and see if we can do business together" is fine, if not unconventional, but informational lectures as the first stage of hiring just screams "sketchy". Best of luck in whatever direction you'd go in, but I'd recommend maintaining your license and fulfilling your state requirements to keep it. Can always come in handy, no matter what you do. I let mine lapse after a rough gig and it's been a headache to get back now that I'm my current employer."
— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dt0fnh/why_i_left_the_life_insurance_industry/lc9vldd/

"Looking for advice on starting an independent brokerage Hey everybody, Captive producer going on two years in production at SF. Licensed in P&C and L&H. Goal was always to start an agency (captive or independent) after gaining some good experience; however, due to circumstances out of my control, it looks like I'll need to make that jump sooner rather than later. I'm located in Colorado. I've averaged \$45k in premium a month with 5-7 life policies working 32 hours a week solely on internet leads (Everquote and Quote wizard, plus my captives leads that come in). Due to some personal things I've been dealing with in the past 2 years, I'd say my prospecting and overall activity has been half-assed at best. Prior to this, I worked as a finance director/Sales manager in dealerships for 13 years, so hiring, firing, training, placing loans with banks, working long hours etc. are all very familiar to me. I assume this experience should translate well to the independent world. I'm working through a business plan now and have hit a few bumps on the road. I'm planning on primarily personal lines, though I'll sell life and health incidentally and hopefully land some large commercial accounts as well 1) I'm looking at Agentero Elite and First Connect as aggregators. Does anyone know if they can be enrolled in simultaneously? Agentero has some non-standard carriers I'd like access to, but First Connect seems to be the standard as far as commissions, fees and payment. 2) I'll lean heavily on Facebook Ads for marketing, but of course plan on building a referral pipeline and supplement with paid leads to keep me busy dialing the phone. Can this be done initially around \$1500/month? Or is that spend too low? 3) Outside of setting up a commission account, PFA, obtaining my LLC, and purchasing E&O, am I missing any major components? I'm looking at different AMS platforms (First Connect provides a discount on EZlynx), but might wait 6 months or so before enrolling unless I absolutely need it immediately. 4) Goal is to end the first year with \$500,000 in premium with an average 12% commission. Hoping to average 8% on renewals and shooting for a retention around 85% before scaling and employing a CSR and an additional 1099 producer. Is this realistic? Too high or low? Hiring too fast? Thanks in advance for any answers and advice!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sav5b8/looking_for_advice_on_starting_an_independent/

↳ Torread091 (2): "Thanks for the reply! 1. I just took a look at Iron Peak and, for my state at least, it looks like they have an excellent selection of carriers. I'll put in a call to get more information, but of the 6 or so aggregators I've been talking to, they seem to have the largest variety by far. 3. I'm also calling on AMS providers as it seems the general consensus is to get that set up prior to going fully operational. Leaning towards EZlynx at the moment. Do you have any experience with their set up? Seems affordable enough and widespread enough that they must have some good things going for them. 4. I guess I should have defined the commercial account size I'd be targeting. Ideally, I'd be looking at contractors and small business owners requiring BOP, Workers comp and commercial auto totalling ~\$50k annual premium and under. I'm under the impression that over the last few years, large firms have bought out local shops in my market and their comp plan doesn't really incentivize their AM's to maintain constant contact with accounts this size. All of the commercial business I've written has been this size across a variety of industries, but the number one complaint I've heard is that the last company didn't communicate in a timely manner. That said, I really anticipate the vast majority of my prospecting to be personal line centric and gradually branch out into commercial accounts as I gain more knowledge in that area. Realistically, I'd be happy to write 4-5 accounts that size per year and increase annual production by a quarter mil in addition to the personal lines business I produce. Honestly, that's the only way I can see a pathway to meaningful scale within the first 3 years. Thanks again for the advice and the Iron Peak recommendation. Very excited to talk to them and learn more!"

↳ Torread091 (1): "That is really what my gut said. I'm not sure how these platforms all integrate and work together, so I kind of wanted to get a feel for the aggregator site/software and then find which AMS will work best for my needs. Honestly, the amount of unfamiliar software is a bit daunting, only because I'm used to living in my carriers software. But it does make sense to define and streamline process from the beginning. I guess my fear is choosing a subpar AMS, getting started and then having to navigate the transfer of info from one AMS to a better one. Although, I guess those kind of questions are probably best geared towards an AM for one of those companies. Thanks!"

↳ Torread091 (1): "That was my primary concern as well. I expect the vast majority of leads would come from Facebook Ads initially. I've got a pretty solid book that I can mine for referrals here, but I have absolutely no intention of taking customers with me, so it would specifically be people referred from my existing clients that contact me directly, a few partners I have (roofers, realtors, etc.) and I assume I'll do some cold calling on paid internet leads and in person introductions with business owners to start filling a commercial funnel. My focus would initially be non-standard home and auto; anything that needs a little extra attention, then fill in with standard home and auto from referrals and by then, I'd expect to have a funnel of commercial leads approaching their renewals. Life and health would go hand in hand with home/auto and hopefully grow quickly when commercial ramps up, ideally by setting up time to talk with their employees. At that point, I'll need to find someone that would offer an appointment for health (disability, hospital income, etc.)"

"I'm gonna say this again... There are better internet leads out there if you know where to find them. It's not gonna be a mega corp like Smart Financial... 3-5% close shows that they are recycled non exclusive bullshit. I asked a rep and she basically told me so herself. Very pushy sales tactics like your expected to just say yes... anyways. I digress. I have a lead vendor once that ran adds through radio and online click for quote, the ones that responded (75%~), my close ratio was 80%. Unfortunately, these are highly exclusive and hard to come by BUT, my point is... fuck smart financial and if you use your wits a bit and think outside the box, you can have the business come to you. I've seen it happen in a VERY beautiful way. Wish I was still at that company sometimes since I lost my book (I was pretty green about laws regarding that). But I know the blueprint 🙌"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ucbfrx/i_have_no_idea_how_internet_leads_are_profitable/ot6ab8m/

"Best strategy to start selling health insurance (Medicare + ACA) Hi everyone, I recently earned my accident & health license and I am excited to begin my journey as a health insurance agent. I am still in the early stages of learning how the sales process and industry work, so I would appreciate any advice or insights from experienced colleagues. My goal is to build residual income by focusing on health insurance (either ACA or Medicare). For ACA, I am considering using HealthSherpa for their platform and training resources. For Medicare, I am thinking of starting with 1 or 2 carriers as a captive to access knowledge. I look at this as a short-term plan (about 6 months) to build a solid foundation to then transition to a broker or agency to access multiple carriers to provide best plan and maybe better commissions. Does this sound like a good plan? Are there downsides of going captive with more than 1 carrier? I see some offer AHIP certification discount, should I take it? I would love to hear your thoughts and any suggestions you might have. Thank you so much!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1i3ms00/best_strategy_to_start_selling_health_insurance/

↳ Usual_Ad_2834 (2): "Most captive places offer a discount for ahip. Not a bad plan if it aligns with your goals honestly. Just know when your captive you wont keep your book of business and thats what you need to build residuals if you ever plan on leaving. And when you do leave if they are scummy they will force you to stay by making you wait 3-6 months with no income and cant sell that carrier. Its just the bullshit you have to deal with in the industry. So be prepared for that route. You could go independent off jump learn that way but then u have to figure out lead cost and sales in general if your new to B2C for insurance."

↳ Usual_Ad_2834 (2): "Just because you get the ahip discount does not mean you have to sign up with that company you can ghost if you want after you get it for free or reduced. Your only locked in once you get the contracts with the company. Thats the only time your locked in on only selling for the company."

↳ Usual_Ad_2834 (2): "Dm me if you have any more questions 🙌"

"Sounds like you've been there because you are spot on! I've been there and seen it first hand. Not all of them do the leads buy, but absolutely use friends and family to expand network reach to tap into a new market. There is always a pay to play aspect and very minimal trainings on sales / products because your growth isn't based on sales (some will argue this and they do but they're wrong). Literally, to increase your commission level, you must recruit. You can be the most knowledgeable sales rep and a product guru and if you don't recruit, you are considered a failure. It's all about getting you in in some emotional vulnerability and then keep moving the goal post. I swear I am going to write a book about this one day, I just feel it. It's very predatory. Psychological manipulation all in all."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p1o3ii/if_youre_an_insurance_agent_whats_the_biggest/nps4lyw/

"in California (at least) - a Medicare Agent with 150 Clients on their books is \$5400 a month or \$64,800 a year in residuals. It's very doable as "part time" if you grind to get that 150 on your book and service. for what it's worth, I started Medicare Summer of 2024 - so about 2 years doing it full time now. I currently have about 160 on my book of business. but it is a looooooong process in terms of grinding everyday. I am looking forward to Jan 2027 for the 160 book renewals. prior to that I had about 300 ACA . but have since slowed down on the ACA. Still service them - but use it more to transition my under 65 to medicare once they reach 65."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vzuzbf/is_this_really_something_you_can_do_as_a_side/p686xku/

"That is insane- I started ACA this past November. I didn't invest in leads or anything, just leaving with a small handful of clients. I'm desperately looking to build my book of business this year and I'm really looking for viable lead sources outside of open enrollment and would love to hear about the source you use during open enrollment to reach those numbers- I'm willing to invest in myself. Could you DM or reach back out on this post?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rx4i2w/enrolled_500_aca_clients_my_first_open_enrollment/ob4t2br/

"Beautiful, good for them, I'd love to reach that range or even a fraction of it one day. Even if they got a killer deal at \$1 per lead that's 700-900 per day. OMG that's a well funded mega agency that's grown well. Hope they pay you well and you get your hand in the renewals eventually. I'd be out of business if I had to pay for leads before now so it was all organic marketing and outreach."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o2ysrs/how_i_retired_my_wife_with_my_insurance_agency_ama/nixjsfb/

"HELP - P&C I'm currently working toward my P&C license in South Carolina and plan to start my own independent agency once I pass. I currently have a successful career in app design, and my wife already runs a very successful Medicare business. We're now looking to partner and build an agency together, with me focusing primarily on the P&C side. My goal is to own the book from day one and build something long term under our own name. I've been researching direct carrier appointments versus joining an agency network or aggregator. I've looked into First Connect, Smart Choice SC, Firefly and SIAA, but I'm seeing mixed opinions everywhere. For those who have actually started an independent agency from scratch, what route did you take? Would you recommend trying for direct appointments immediately, joining a network first, or using a combination of both? Any help is appreciated"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wnhsww/help_pc/

↳ Any_Lengthiness_3555 (3): "With your total lack of experience, any direct appts will be shitty ones. No question start with an aggregator."

↳ Vegetable-Being2434 (1): "When I went independent, I used First Connect to fill the access gap while I figured out which direct relationships were actually worth chasing. That worked well for me because I could start quoting pretty quickly and their support team was useful when I was still learning different carrier appetites. Since you already have a Medicare book in the household, you've got a pretty natural cross sell opportunity too."

"No, i am employed by a company so my residue and commission are no good because of my salary. However, once I get my book of business, which my goal is 200, then i go 1099. The company provides all the leads at no cost."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1h0xwxy/which_insurance_sales_is_known_for_the_best/lzcevug/

"You're honestly in a better spot than most people making this jump, you already know how to sell and you've got real production behind it, so this isn't theoretical for you. On the aggregator side, you can usually sit with both Agentero and First Connect at the same time, just be mindful of overlapping carrier access and how you're submitting business so you don't create conflicts. One thing people don't tell you early is that if you build a big book through First Connect, it can be tough to peel those relationships off later and go direct with carriers. You're basically renting access, which is fine early on, just know that's the tradeoff if you scale hard inside their system. The \$1,500 a month on Facebook ads will work to get the phone ringing, especially with your background, but it won't carry the whole operation long term. It's a good way to stay busy dialing, but the real money comes from building something that feeds itself, referrals, organic presence, and just being visible where your clients already hang out. Paid leads keep you afloat, organic builds the business. You've got most of the setup handled, the only thing I'd really stress is having a consistent process from day one. Not fancy, just repeatable. How you quote, how you follow up, how you close, and how you check back in later. That's what turns your 85 percent retention goal into something real instead of something you hope happens. The \$500k first year goal is doable based on what you're already producing, the bigger risk isn't hitting the number, it's what that book looks like on the back end. If you stay disciplined on follow up and don't let stuff fall through the cracks, you'll be fine there. I wouldn't rush into hiring. Most people bring on a CSR too early and end up paying for service work they could've handled themselves while they're still trying to stabilize revenue. Once service actually starts slowing down your ability to write new business, that's when it makes sense. At the end of the day you're not trying to prove you can sell, you've already done that. You're trying to build something that works the same way every time so you're not starting from scratch on every deal. That's the difference between being busy and actually building something that scales."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sav5b8/looking_for_advice_on_starting_an_independent/ohf1e06/

"Solo until book hits \$500k is the goal. With a \$900 policy average and 2.5 policies per household, I expect anything beyond that will require a dedicated CSR so I can focus on generating new business. Once that CSR is beginning to get overwhelmed, the plan would be to find a hybrid CSR/producer, and transition them into a full time producer after hiring another CSR. I think I might be overly optimistic, but I'd love to quote 250 households in 90 days. I average 4.87 quotes a day in my current role but only working 4 days a week (and realistically, only engaged 3-4 hours out of 8). I think 3 a day, 6 days a week is a bit optimistic depending on lead and referral flow, but ultimately manageable if I can get the leads. Closing 25% at a \$900 average with 2.5 policies per would put me at \$526k year 1 before any lapse. I would hope compounding referrals and the renewal premium would be enough to support a CSR, although doing the math, I may need to start them part time."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sav5b8/looking_for_advice_on_starting_an_independent/odz3hvr/

"Because of the set up costs / cost of lead gen is so high now, that they make up the thin margins with volume. The higher volume agencies / FMO's that use these systems have better pricing than what's advertised. You're better off going grass roots - boots on the ground. List your website everywhere you can (use citations - Whitespark offers that service to boost your Google Business Profile), list your name on all the [free Medicare broker directories](<https://mymedicarebroker.com/why-join>), make sure you inner link your website pages (use overall good SEO tactics), dominate your local town / city as much as possible. The "I just want warm, inbound calls" era is over, unless you have VERY DEEP pockets and can weather low ROI until residuals kick in."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1d5disv/turning_65_leads_medicare/p6u43y0/

"Hi Luis, Brandy Cameron. I have subscribed to your channel and love your videos, I also signed up for Shaun's course so I have your work flows. You have great content, I'm planning to get agent CRM soon but wondered if you have a slide show presentation you use with a client, or is it your smart book you use, I'm wondering how to use a presentation to help cross sell more, any thought about buying your books but wanted your opinion, if you have a presentation I would love to see it and your intake form as well. This video was so helpful and sending out that intake form may help me to. Thank you, keep up the good work. 😊"

— YouTube · 🌟 ACA Agents: This Sales Script Closes More Obamacare Clients (Copy & Paste) 📄 · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cL_RWdaqypkc&lc=UgzAExYtDIdgwh7Qx94AaABAg

↳ @InsuranceAgentTraining (1): "Here is the link to to get the ACA and/or Smartbooks: <https://simplyhealthinsurance.thinkific.com/>";

↳ @InsuranceAgentTraining (1): "thank you for watching and commenting"

↳ @InsuranceAgentTraining (1): "I am going make a video this week on cross selling. Stay tuned!! I assume this for cross selling ancillaries to ACA book?"

"This is a completely unsolicited review of ACA Express and solely my opinion: I went through the demo video last night and am enrolling in the standard package today (no set up, no monthly, \$20 per app)-this is truly a no brainer for a single producer. I give ACA Express enormous credit on this because they have figured out a great business model-they built in a supplemental benefits option (called Out of Pocket Protector) that, if only added on 10% of the apps, will more than pay the application fees in full for using the system for the first year and provide an on-going stream of income in future years (renewal commissions on the lowest level package are 20% or \$200 per year). For them, of course, as an upline, they get the overrides on all of these sales and I'm sure this will be a significant revenue stream. Just a quickie on the Out of Pocket Protector-it is a typical gap plan, the base premium for an individual is \$69 per month (\$89 for a couple) and includes about \$300 a year in 'routine benefits' for office visits and lab tests-so the actual cost is about \$45 per month Individual and \$39 per month (couple) for all of the other stuff (figure an Accident indemnity plan plus benefits for hospital stays, outpatient surgery, and \$250 for an ER visit) and not a bad deal-I wish there was a critical illness rider that could be added, that would make it even better. In addition to the Standard package they do have a Pro package that is more for call centers and agencies with multiple agents with a monthly fee and lower fee per app. On a scale of 1-10, I give ACA Express an initial 9.2 (if they could eliminate carriers on the agent facing website it would be a 9.9-nothing is a '10' except Bo Derek about 35 years ago)."

— Insurance-Forums.com · ACAexpress.com · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/acaexpress-com.69122/#post-910567>

"You will !!! just trust the process and don't give up in the first year(most people do) find a company that offer base pay and commission also leads(their out there just ask around) this will provide stability so you can focus on building your sales skills... keep an open mind and take all feedback as advice not attacks(even on the days you feel like the universe is out to get you).. take a deep breath , don't talk more than the client and reset mentally after every client... biggest lesson I learned my first year in the industry is to not take everything personally and celebrate the small win they build your confidence and add up to big checks.. Rejection is the biggest obstacle to overcome however Rejection is motivation.. and record your calls also visualize yourself performing the script not reciting it with no compassion for the clients well being to fulfill their needs.. learn to be a good listener is also important as a new agent.. also become obsessed with learning about sales and implement any tips your learn from the ones who already been through the newbie stage... find your sales personality.. and control ONLY what you control.. and lastly create more opportunities for sales by obtaining non resident line of authority in other states. The goal is to become licensed in all fifty to really maximize on growing your book of business faster than just being licensed in your resident states.. start with the states that are less than \$50 for the license. You will be surprised how cheap some starts are and some are very expensive..."

— YouTube · How much money do you make? Insurance Broker · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0Sy_Ce5T1nI&lc=UgypF-gzZViAaS_WW1V4AaABAg_9u63ArsigBXAEs9eLD3nQ9

"How do I access my insurance after going no contact with parent? I have no clue how to access anything regarding my health insurance, I have no physical card and also don't know what I need to do to get one. I know I am still insured for the time being and I would like to know, if because I changed my personal address recently if I will start receiving my own renewals or do I just file for my own plan? So confused here, anything helps! I would like to note that: I have been insured under my mother my whole life, she has always done my renewals without my knowledge, not complaining but it does make this far more confusing to work out now that I am trying to figure this out alone."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wq3bfa/how_do_i_access_my_insurance_after_going_no/

↳ theoretalking (2): "Is this it? Minnesota? <https://www.bluecrossmn.com/our-plans/medical-assistance-medicaid/minnesotacare> It looks like the website does require your member id to create an account. I suggest you call them and see if you can get your member id on the phone or have them mail you a replacement card."

↳ ExoticMarionberry965 (2): "I just got everything I needed as far as the card and making an account so thank you!! MyChart happened to have my member ID on file as well. Should I expect my renewals to be sent to my new address since it is technically federal and they should already have my address in the system since the change or do I need to notify anyone?"

↳ theoretalking (1): "Do you know where this insurance is from? An employer sponsored plan? Or Medicaid as your flair suggested?"

Six figures and the freedom that comes with it · 18 documents · 18 voices

"Are there ANY truly "good" life insurance companies to work for?? I'm in the process of getting my license, so still very new to the biz. I've read the horror stories of truly bad MLM-like companies and am staying away from those (although strangely, they seem to have their fair share of happy employees), so I did a very basic Google search of "The Best Life Insurance Companies to Work For." I got answers like Northwestern, Mutual of Omaha, New York Life, etc. So I go to Glassdoor & Indeed to read employee reviews, and those are just as all over the place as the MLMs! "Best company in the world, changed my life", "Shit leads, non-existent training, if you don't meet production goals you're fired". My question is: How do I know where the truly GOOD companies are if all the reviews are like this? I just want an entry-level role to get my feet wet, aiming for \$80k/yr in the first couple years. Nothing crazy. Thanks for any advice!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 41 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/164ik21/are_there_any_truly_good_life_insurance_companies/

↳ MrDaveyHavoc (11): "The subset of people motivated to post online reviews is always going to skew negative."

↳ amusings_ (11): "Hello 🐼 I've read about Globe Life (AIL) and it sounds like they're known for the "bait and switch" of their customers. (I.e. Using a customer's request for a Safety Kit to then try to sell them life insurance that they didn't ask for). What do you say to those claims?"

↳ amusings_ (9): "That's a good point ✅ The successful people usually don't bother to sit down and write a review about how successful they are, haha"

"What would you do if you had to start over from scratch? I'm 2.5 years into owning my agency and my book is just over \$100k. I've had some rough patches, hell, the first 2 years was a rough patch- but about 6 months ago I came to the conclusion that I'm going to put everything in me and do whatever it takes to grow my business and make up for the two years of my life that I wasted. I've gone 25 years untreated for ADHD and 2 months ago finally made myself an appointment to see what the hell is wrong with me. Fast forward 2 months later and I can finally function like a normal human being. Not only am I able to focus better, talk to people better, feel knowledgeable and handle things more professionally, but I actually care. I want to build something that will feed my family one day, pass down to my children, something that will provide us stability. I scheduled a 30 minute call with an agent I met a few years ago to see how he was doing and quite frankly, how he was doing what he was doing. I took a sneak peek at our companies production reports and this guy was selling nearly \$100k in premium a month. This meeting ended up being an hour long, but the biggest thing I took away was when he said this: "Dude... I have 5 kids", and it clicked. I have to get into survival mode, as if it wasn't just me, but those who depended on me. I think about my parents (whom I want to help retire because they are helping me financially), my girlfriend (whom wants to get married and have children with me one day), and my future kids. At this turning point in my life I am constantly asking people who are doing better than me, or are in places that I want to be, what would you do if you were in my position right now? What can I do to grow amongst these huge \$10M+ book size agents in my area? My goal is to quote over \$160k in premium a month, hopefully the quote to sell conversion ratio turns out good. These are mostly old leads, and eventually I will run out. Every Friday I am going out to 5-6 locations with realtors/brokers/lenders/title agents and handing out cookies, business cards, and a handwritten letter. Hopefully this helps me build a pipeline. I did this last week and people seemed receptive and related to the hustle. What is something I should be focusing on everyday to maximize my agencies growth?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/

↳ DonicaLewinsky69420 (16): "Ask every client and new prospect for referrals. Let them know how important it is to you. Be the business. Not the Business professional. Live it, breathe it, learn it."

↳ FuzzyDice_12 (7): "My tips: 1) Networking: I'm an introvert that comes across as an extrovert. Great for sales but I dread going to events and force myself to go. Staying connected and going to Insurance Events, opens up connections, some you may not realize for years later. Perfect example is while I'm young, I got into insurance and owning my agency at 21ish. Many of the contacts at brokerages I've made, jump ship to other brokerages. The friendship will get you an appointment where normally you couldn't have. 2) Agency Software: This one is a big one. Many of the softwares are expensive and slow. Sometimes agents, when opening their own agencies, use the software from their previous agency, with outdated tech, solely because of familiarity. I learned this lesson the hard way. Thousands a year on crappy agency software. 3) Turning 1 New Business Insured and the policy they chose to have you quote, into multiple policies and new leads. This one is big. 4) This is personal to my niche (small/medium accounts are \$100k+), and builds on 3. Offer several smaller quotes for lines of insurance applicable to your line of business the insured may not have/have been offered previously, even if you don't think the insured will be interested. "If Any" Workers Comp would be applicable for my lines of business. 5) create partnerships with other independent agencies and agents. Self explanatory I would think. 6) SOP's, and building the agency with Franchising in mind. 7) Calendar: setting up reminders to touch base on insured's. If you are coming around only at renewal time, you easily become an agent that is replaceable. 8) As an agency owner, not only having SOP's, but understanding how every moving part of your agency works. From accounting, to customer service, to certificates of insurance, and on and on. Excuse any typos (at the barber shop), but this is what I could think of off the top of my head, and while some sections are more important than others, I didn't number them in any particular order."

↳ ChrisPbacon969 (5): "Commenting to follow along. I'm about to get started on my p and c journey."

"Am I Crazy for Wanting to Leave My \$200k+ Job to Start and Independent Agency Background, I'm mid 30s, 2 kids, and I've just about had it with my extremely high stress/toxic culture job (in a healthcare/pharma marketing related field). I have a few years of savings and I'm ready to pivot my career into something more personally rewarding.....I'm seriously considering insurance! I know how to build a brand, manage CRM systems, create effective communications (the one-on-one sales aspect is new to me, but I know I can figure it out). Plus I have a solid background in many aspects of prescription drugs and healthcare (i've taken a practice licensing test without cracking a book and got a 72%, so there's more for me to learn, but a solid foundation) The idea is to start a medicare-focused agency, brand it to appeal to the communities I want to target, partner with an FMO, and begin sourcing paid and earned leads directly (this is not a challenge for me, I'm been doing it in the pharma space for years). My goal is to use the next 6 months to start up the business, get my licenses and begin lead generation. I would then quit my job in time for the end of year enrollment season, see how that goes - (pick up some light contract work throughout next year to supplement my income) and then go all-in on the business late 2026 - hoping that I can be clearing \$150k+ in 2027 and back to 200k+ earnings in 2028. Over time I'd branch out into other lines, but I want to keep a narrow focus for now so I can effectively source clients. That's the high-level plan, of course there are many more details that I'm figuring out (I'm building financial projections, comparing FMOs, analyzing the competitive landscape for local agents and the large nationals...and a lot more to make sure I'm going in with solid goals and expectations) So, am I crazy to get into this world? What are the biggest pitfalls to watch out for that will get in the way of me being successful? What is the biggest deterrents for those starting out that will my make feel burnt?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jdqnqh/am_i_crazy_for_wanting_to_leave_my_200k_job_to/

↳ HamiltonSt25 (39): "I didn't read everything you wrote, but just keep in mind, it's a tough insurance climate right now (Assuming you're in the US). Doing it right now would leave you struggling to get contracts. I'm an independent and almost all of my major carriers are not giving new contracts at this time. This will drain your assets extremely fast. I'd hold out until it softens up a bit."

↳ Acceptable-Tip7886 (28): "Times are tough, if you're making 200k plus I would stay and invest. Money now is more important than money later plus you'll retire sooner"

↳ HamiltonSt25 (10): "I'm sorry, let me clarify. I'm speaking as far as P&C goes. So if you're asking about life/health, I have no idea. If you're talking P&C, then I'm speaking about direct contracts with carriers/companies."

"I need a realistic understanding of what I can make as salary. So to break it down, I work for an agency I make \$40k salary full benefits plus a cruddy bonus structure, I'll probably end up hitting \$65k maybe \$70k with overtime and bonus during OEP I sell ACA plans thru the market place and state exchanges in 16 different states along with gap coverage and STP's. I really hate the 9-5 hours and I have an hour drive to the office. I want to go 1099 very badly but I don't have any understanding on how I would get paid or what the pay would be since my company takes care of that for me and I came into the insurance business thru them. I want to be able to profit at least \$65k, what would this take? I have about 100 clients in my book of business here, what would that translate to if I was independent? What are some numbers people are bringing in just selling ACA plans? Whats the average commission? Tips tricks? Anything would help. My company is crunching numbers and basically asking everyone to either step up and match the top 2% of agents at the company or they're getting the boot... I need a plan"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k042ke/i_need_a_realistic_understanding_of_what_i_can/

↳ Tahoptions (6): "First question: How will you get leads?"

↳ NAF1138 (6): "100 people just isn't that many. On average you would make \$25 per member per month. So your current book would get you 2500 a month give or take. Probably a little less realistically. You also have to worry about retention and attrition. None of it is going to be advanced to you either. You will need a plan to get people enrolled quickly and to keep them enrolled as other agents try to move them out from under you. It's not that it's a bad business to be in, but you want to have a plan to be able to enroll 400+ people a year, and have products to cross sell so you can eat while you build that book up. Personally, I think the Medicare market is easier to break into, but I'm biased as I run a Medicare agency."

↳ Lost-cereal- (5): "Did D2D solar for a while and was successful. Sure a lot of people don't want that, but at the same time it has its advantages. I believe building rapport and local trust in the community will help with retention. Think about it SOOO many people are getting phone calls non stop and it all comes off as scam/spam. I constantly hear "can't trust anyone anymore now days with all these scams" and I have to fight the extra mile for there trust VS showing up as a real person, with professionalism and credentials, and gaining trust in a more personal way. I'd be in and out of there home within an hour and they'll have coverage. Also I can watch them program my number in their phone and tell them DONT talk to ANYONE that calls about insurance unless you see my name pop up on your caller ID, can never be to weary about those phone scammers😂"

"Going independent...suggestions? Hello! I currently sell Medicare advantage and looking to go independent for more opportunity and flexibility (less administrative work thrown on me that has absolutely nothing to do with Medicare). For those of you that sell Medicare from home: what services and software platforms do you use? Which up line do you use? Should I invest in a CRM right away or wait? It's \$75/month for AgencyBloc. Should I get the commissions processing module for an additional \$125/month? Phone system.... RingCentral is like \$30 a month and has calling and texting so I think I might go this route. Other suggestions? Any ideas for marketing to get started? I know my up line can spend some. I would like to work entirely remote if possible. Most people just turning 65 are decent enough with technology. Thanks in advance!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/17mm0vw/going_independentsuggestions/

↳ rdbubbya (2): "I'm looking to take a jump into the insurance industry and specifically Medicare advantage. Did you make decent money as a captive agent? I want to learn and train at a captive agency before trying my hand at being an independent. Is 65-70k to keep my head above water first year attainable and realistic?"

↳ Frequent-Ad8306 (2): "Thank you for the help! I think I'm going to use an Integrity partner for FMO. I'll into intulse. They have RingCentral listed but it looks like it's through Zapier so probably an extra charge. Do you use AgencyBloc's commissions module? Is it necessary when starting out? Do you use another accounting platform like quick books to keep track of everything?"

↳ [deleted] (1): "Agency bloc's radiusbob not even up on deadline day smh"

"I actually see this sort of soulless behavior with very large commercial producers. Not all of them, not by any stretch. But I have ran commercial divisions where producers who bring in a lot of revenue are allowed to behave however they want. Practice quoting, dumping huge amounts of work on senior staff last minute in the name of hoping to get a \$500k revenue account, no screening at all, just looking at the dollars. Putting business with surplus lines simply for a shifting cost, etc. This happens quite a bit in southern CA. These brokers like to refer to themselves as cowboys, making the market work for them, etc. Don't think for a second it's not happening at the large PE backed firms. 100% is. And I'm talking about people who are millionaires at this point."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rek2rd/be_honest_how_many_of_you_lost_your_soul_in_this/o7d7aza/

"a company is offering me a 1099 position at \$200 per sale flat, selling medicare supplements following a script. he said most of his agents do 1-2 per day and some doing 3-4 per day, my goal is just to make at least \$80k per year. is this a decent enough sounding gig?"

— YouTube · How To Make \$500k A Year As A Medicare Agent In 2023! (Medicare Sales Training) · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SmppgLPuqeQ&lc=UgyD78lmlKn0yjUPmUp4AaABAg>

↳ @deerlow1851 (1): "@oddjhi I made \$3000 my first week closing and i now make on average anywhere from 1200 to 4500 every week. during OE it's on the higher side of that more often."

↳ @deerlow1851 (1): "@oddjhi Although I am apparently exceptional as I have been top of the boards every week since I started"

↳ @oddjhi (0): "How did it go. Just curious?"

"For me it's, \$611 up front for MAPD and \$306 renewals in January. Med Supp Im about \$550 when you factor in PDP. My goal each year is \$100k FYC plus my renewals in Medicare. Add in annuities, FE, CHAS, etc. Being rich depends on the person."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Does anyone really get "rich" selling Medicare · 5 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/does-anyone-really-get-rich-selling-medicare.113372/#post-1494991>

"My goal is to reach 10k a month. I know it takes some time to get there and I'm in it for the long haul. I have some side gigs I can do on the side while I grow my business. Are you referring to ACA and Medicare? I'm still learning the products, plans and enrollment periods. Hoping I can get the hang of this soon."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j31y96/how_much_money_can_you_expect_to_make_first_year/mfx13wi/

"You're honestly in a better spot than most people making this jump, you already know how to sell and you've got real production behind it, so this isn't theoretical for you. On the aggregator side, you can usually sit with both Agentero and First Connect at the same time, just be mindful of overlapping carrier access and how you're submitting business so you don't create conflicts. One thing people don't tell you early is that if you build a big book through First Connect, it can be tough to peel those relationships off later and go direct with carriers. You're basically renting access, which is fine early on, just know that's the tradeoff if you scale hard inside their system. The \$1,500 a month on Facebook ads will work to get the phone ringing, especially with your background, but it won't carry the whole operation long term. It's a good way to stay busy dialing, but the real money comes from building something that feeds itself, referrals, organic presence, and just being visible where your clients already hang out. Paid leads keep you afloat, organic builds the business. You've got most of the setup handled, the only thing I'd really stress is having a consistent process from day one. Not fancy, just repeatable. How you quote, how you follow up, how you close, and how you check back in later. That's what turns your 85 percent retention goal into something real instead of something you hope happens. The \$500k first year goal is doable based on what you're already producing, the bigger risk isn't hitting the number, it's what that book looks like on the back end. If you stay disciplined on follow up and don't let stuff fall through the cracks, you'll be fine there. I wouldn't rush into hiring. Most people bring on a CSR too early and end up paying for service work they could've handled themselves while they're still trying to stabilize revenue. Once service actually starts slowing down your ability to write new business, that's when it makes sense. At the end of the day you're not trying to prove you can sell, you've already done that. You're trying to build something that works the same way every time so you're not starting from scratch on every deal. That's the difference between being busy and actually building something that scales."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sav5b8/looking_for_advice_on_starting_an_independent/ohf1e06/

"Worked for them about 3 months... When I was first starting they said it was a hybrid role which I was looking forward to, 2 days in office and the other 3 were remote and that hours were flexible. Working on getting licensed they were constantly texting me asking how studying was going, I need to schedule my exam etc. Once I passed I started immediately got handed all kinds of their training videos and scripts. Then I was paired with a "trainer" was taught how look for prospects and to call using the scripts. If there was no appointments set, they would ask why and force you to put your next calls on speaker so they knew what was being said or use you as an example for the next training. On non-office days I was expected to be door knocking or continue calling while my trainer drove to appointments, or they door knocked which I told them I was planning on calling or running any app over the phone or zoom since it was a hybrid remote role. Fast forward, they are constantly on you even though you're 1099 and the "flexible schedule" does not exist. After leaving, a couple life policies I was split in were canceled and completely re-written, so my trainer could have the full commission. I tried to return some fact finders, but seems like most people there have blocked me, texted and called the secretary sent me to VM and left me on read. Texted the director but completely deleted me the response "who is this" after saying who it was, I got left on read, tried reaching out again but seems like I got blocked."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wn5pwj/do_not_work_for_bankers_life/pbpkn7i/

"These arrangements are so weird and sound unfair to me. As an independent broker, I get 45% new business commission and 45% renewal commission. My goal when I started was 20k a month. If I could do that, I could make it. And my yearly income would go up faster than any other job that exists anywhere, basically. Most months I land around 30-40k in written premium, but some months are lower and some higher. If I had to sit in a desk and take leads and close them for peanuts so I could make someone else richer I would shoot myself in the fucking head. I now make roughly 100k a year in my position which goes up by about 10k every year. (That's an insane raise every year). I take care of my own clients, but it's nothing..... sometimes I work for 20 minutes in the morning and have nothing left to do for the rest of the day, bonus if I am WFH that day. I get a shit ton done.... somedays its busier than hell as well, but I get through them. MOST days are slow. Takes me under a minute to do most policy changes. I have so much freedom. I am self employed. I built this from scratch, but I'd rather take the long route than have some suit breathing over my shoulder telling me I need to close 40% and do roughly 80k in premium a month. He's probably fluffing those numbers you know. Some insurance sales guys are the bottom of the barrel greaseballs who pump and dump employees. Sorry for my rant. I could never do what you are doing. Good luck."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lx17z/average_broker_closing_rate_is_this_realistic/n2lsj97/

"Love the math breakdown. I've done this in my head recently and that helped me get a clearer picture of what it takes for my production levels to look the way I need. Example: If I want to write \$40k a month in premium, I need to quote \$100k a month and have a 40% conversion ratio. My plan is to find, quote, and touch 2 new leads a day. If each lead averages \$3,000 in premium, multiply by two for each day, multiply for 31 days in a month, that's \$186,000 in quoted premium. Problem is, all the leads I have right now are old leads that didn't buy. Eventually that will run dry. Hopefully going balls to the walls with referrals pays off soon."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/oeega4z/

"Thanks for sharing your experience! Was it one major issue or a combination of things? In my research, I've noticed they seem to push a lot of additional products—CRM, website, leads, etc.— so I'm curious if that played a role in your decision. I would love to have more of a grassroots type agency, only leaning on them for access to the carriers & training. Of course, those perks would come with a premium, but I want the freedom to use or not use them. Any insights you can share would be invaluable. Thanks again!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jykgig/new_agent_choosing_an_fmo_vs_going_direct_advice/mjrxfgb/

"Am i making a mistake with a pivot into a sales agent role? I unfortunately got laid off from my dream remote job in fitness at the start of the month and ive been in a desperate applying spree ever since. I currently work as an appointment setter with an HVAC company and honestly, its pretty ass. During my first week I got approached by an insurance sales rep in my DMs and sent me info on his agency role they are trying to fill. Its a life, accident and health insurance sales agent role. Ive never sold insurance, i was a personal trainer for 10+ years and while i did have a few years of selling memberships/training packages, this is an entirely new world to me. I did about 3 full days of research and there are some things that do stick out to me as good and bad so i wanted to get some advice on if im just coping here. The good: \- Renewals are a pretty damn interesting long term financial plan that i had never heard of and could honestly set me up for the rest of my life as i age into retirement (fitness is known for zero retirement options so this was a key one for me) \- The agency has a very strong onboarding process compared to what seems to be industry norms. 1. They give you free/back up leads for 6 months while they train you then you move into a pooled lead pile for 6 more months. This seems to be very uncommon and it can give me a large buffer to start up without being thrown to the sharks 2. 4 week bootcamp to get me up to speed and making sales pretty much right away. They have numerous people who made 1-2 sales within their training window so the options of making immediate money is there. 3. They genuinely want to keep their agency small, tactile and hitting the ground very hard so everyone makes money. They seem very specific on how many people they want on the team to avoid everyone fighting over leads 4. I can make more money than I've ever made in my life. i grew up extremely poor so this is a big driver for me. The Bad: \- Its 1099/commission only. I got a small severance with my layoff and including my savings, i only have enough to live on for \-10-12 weeks, which honestly has me worried that i wont make any early sales and end up a bit stuck with my hands in my pockets. \- I have to commit to 10-12 hour days during the first 6 months. Their words were "we give you free leads, we expect you to really take that serious and build up early so you have to be here a lot to accomplish this". I can work hard, but given that its only commission, the stress of having ZERO income coming in while im training raises my anxiety a bit. Am i being delusional stepping into this industry and this role given where i am in life?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj1b8l/>

↳ (0): "The HVAC gig being "pretty ass" is the real tell here, you're already in a grind you hate so why not take the shot at something with actual long term upside. That renewal structure is the closest thing to passive income you'll find outside of owning a business, and coming from fitness where your income caps at how many hours you can physically train people, I'd be jumping at the chance. The 10-12 week runway is tight but the bootcamp plus backed leads for 6 months is a better setup than 90% of agents get starting out. Worst case you're back to square one in 3 months with a new license and some sales experience, which beats rotting in appointment setting wondering what if."

↳ (0): "Worst case he's out of money in 3 months? WTH? 🤔 Seriously?"

"New agent planning to become an independent broker — looking for a remote, non-captive IMO (want to avoid mistakes). Need suggestions. I'm a college student getting licensed soon and I want to make sure I don't make the wrong choice with my first IMO. My long-term goal is to be an independent broker, not captive, so I'm looking for a fully remote, flexible, non-captive IMO that pays directly from carriers, gives day-one vested ownership, and doesn't have an MLM or sink-or-swim environment. I want structured training tied to real leads (not just videos) with a mentorship culture where I can learn through hybrid lead types (live transfers + fresh internet + aged leads). Long term, I want the freedom to stop buying IMO leads and outsource or generate my own once I can close consistently. I care about doing things right, so I want a client-first organization, not a numbers-only pressure model. I'll start with life insurance only, then expand into annuities after I build skill. Any IMO recommendations that fit this? Any industry advice is appreciated as I work toward becoming a fully independent broker, thank you! 🙏 "

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · new or aspiring agent · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pftb0n/>

↳ (0): "SafeLife Policy is the place where I'm at and I've built a 6-figure business very quickly. You really should be looking for strong mentorship above all else though. My agents are successful because of our team, system, and training. Good luck!"

↳ (0): "Thank you! Definitely will search for the best mentorship I can find 🙏 "

↳ (0): "Ritter insurance . I have over 20 years with both!"

"Chris Donnelly said: Hi all. My name is Chris and I am a brand new agent looking to enter the business of final expense telesales. I am coming into this business from the academic world of political science (decided I was tired of going from visiting gig to visiting gig but never nailing down a tenure track job, and so I now want something radically different for myself and have decided on entering this new (for me) field. I consider myself someone who tries to do a lot of research and due diligence, however, before making any big decisions, and so I am asking for some help from you all. So in terms of where I want to call home for my first job in final expense telesales, after doing a lot of shopping around, I have narrowed my search down to what seem to me to be two excellent choices: Duford Insurance Group and Digital BGA As such, as I was wondering if any more experienced agents here could lend some insight as to the pros and cons of joining one or the other of these two companies. Just to preemptively answer some basic questions about my own plans and background that people might have: -I am 37 years old and do not have a significant other or children, and live alone -I plan to work from my apartment in the Boston area -As above suggests, I am looking to do exclusively do telesales, NOT F2F -I am fortunate enough to have accumulated some money from family, past work, and passive income and so can afford to spend a good bit of money on buying leads -I have not yet gotten licensed but hope to pass the MA state exam in a few weeks tops and to purchase transferances so that I can sell in some other states, too -I am planning on doing this full time, not part time -I'd hope to be able to earn six figures in income after a couple of years of doing this (realistic?) -Getting high quality training and mentoring is of utmost importance to me, as I do not have a background in sales or insurance Anyhow, I hope this info is helpful. I look forward to reading what people think! Click to expand... They both post here so maybe you'll get some direct responses."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Duford Insurance Group vs. Digital BGA for Final Expense Telesales · 4 reactions · new or aspiring agent · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/duford-insurance-group-vs-digital-bga-for-final-expense-telesales.110049/#post-1444479>

"Hi all. My name is Chris and I am a brand new agent looking to enter the business of final expense telesales. I am coming into this business from the academic world of political science (decided I was tired of going from visiting gig to visiting gig but never nailing down a tenure track job, and so I now want something radically different for myself and have decided on entering this new (for me) field. I consider myself someone who tries to do a lot of research and due diligence, however, before making any big decisions, and so I am asking for some help from you all. So in terms of where I want to call home for my first job in final expense telesales, after doing a lot of shopping around, I have narrowed my search down to what seem to me to be two excellent choices: Duford Insurance Group and Digital BGA As such, as I was wondering if any more experienced agents here could lend some insight as to the pros and cons of joining one or the other of these two companies. Just to preemptively answer some basic questions about my own plans and background that people might have: -I am 37 years old and do not have a significant other or children, and live alone -I plan to work from my apartment in the Boston area -As above suggests, I am looking to do exclusively do telesales, NOT F2F -I am fortunate enough to have accumulated some money from family, past work, and passive income and so can afford to spend a good bit of money on buying leads -I have not yet gotten licensed but hope to pass the MA state exam in a few weeks tops and to purchase transferances so that I can sell in some other states, too -I am planning on doing this full time, not part time -I'd hope to be able to earn six figures in income after a couple of years of doing this (realistic?) -Getting high quality training and mentoring is of utmost importance to me, as I do not have a background in sales or insurance Anyhow, I hope this info is helpful. I look forward to reading what people think!"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Duford Insurance Group vs. Digital BGA for Final Expense Telesales · new or aspiring agent · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/duford-insurance-group-vs-digital-bga-for-final-expense-telesales.110049/#post-1444478>

Going independent · 15 documents · 15 voices

"If you were starting over today with no book of business and no carrier appointments, what would you do first? Hi everyone, I officially passed my Texas Life & Health licensing exam yesterday (self studied via an online prep course), and I'm trying to be very intentional about how I build my business from Day 1. A little background: I'm 39 and transitioning from a successful corporate finance career (\$175k, annual) after being laid off in 2025. I want to use this unexpected time to invest in a career pivot to an independent producer, eventually building up to a small boutique style agency. Short-term, I plan to focus on Medicare, ACA, Life Insurance, and Supplemental Health. Longer-term, I'd like to expand into ICHRA and small employer benefits, but I don't want to spread myself too thin in the beginning. My vision is to build a referral- and relationship-based business. I'm much more interested in creating a trusted advisory practice than becoming a high-pressure salesperson. If you were in my shoes today —with no book of business, no carrier appointments, and no industry experience—but knowing what you know now: What would your first three steps be? What mistakes would you avoid? Would you join an agency/FMO first, or would you try to build independently from Day 1? Is there anything you wish someone had told you before your first year? I'm not necessarily looking for the "highest commission" straight away. Instead, I'm trying to build the strongest long-term foundation and book of business. I genuinely appreciate any advice from those who've been through it. Thanks in Advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uxw9ko/if_you_were_starting_over_today_with_no_book_of/

↳ idontknowhow2reddit (7): "I agree with all of this. Insurance is a crazy world so there's a ton of things to learn. The textbook and real world are very different so I would try to find an established company with good training to work for first. Without that, it will be hard to build a referral base or to gain that trusted advisor role. Your network and other professionals are going to need to see you in the industry a bit before they will trust you on your own."

↳ Key_Astronomer6500 (5): "Congrats! For someone who also got into insurance later in my career. 1. Pick one product and master it, then move into the second one, and so on. Medicare, ACA, Final Expense, Annuities, etc. 2. Training. Master that product and then move to the second. W 2 or Captive will give you the most training. 40 a week of training vs 1 or 2 hours a week. 3. Pick the right organization. Know the difference between recruiters selling me vs legitimate interviews. I wish someone told me about how many recruiters would try to sell me and then offer no support. I am so glad I left and went into a W2 to learn and get practice but I wish someone told me how difficult releases were! Best of luck but honestly someone with your degree of previous success should be fine. Just remember you're not gonna make as much money at first. You'll probably need to go independent to make more than 125k. However, I would suggest to build that foundation first but as long as you know what you're getting into I think you'll do great."

↳ OZKInsuranceGuy (5): "If I had to start over today, the first thing I'd do is choose my upline very carefully. The wrong agency/upline can cost you years of your career. Second, I'd pick one niche and master it before trying to sell everything. Too many new agents want to do Medicare, ACA, final expense, annuities, group benefits...and end up not getting very good at any of them. Third, I'd get in front of people every single workday. Nothing replaces activity. I'd rather have a decent script and 15 appointments than the perfect script and no one to talk to. The biggest mistakes I'd avoid are buying into recruiting hype (MLMs), signing contracts without understanding release policies, and spending time on useless activities, like tweaking logos, trying to figure out every detail of CRMs, or building websites than actually selling. I would absolutely suggest joining an agency first. I'd choose one based on transparency, track record, proven training and scripts, and upline (again, upline is very important). Make sure you're paid directly by the carriers, understand exactly how releases work (get it in writing), and ask a lot of questions before you sign anything. Once you start selling, consistency is key. Focus on activity, because your input determines your output. Work hard, follow your upline's advice and system, and don't get distracted by other opportunities or anything else."

"Looking to do final expense and Medicare sales over the phone. If you were starting out today what imo/fmo would you go with? I want to stay independent. I was going to go with Digital BGA because they promoted a reduced commission for free lead program but they've changed their structure. So I'm now open to new companies as long as I can work from home."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/skrayl/>

↳ (0): "DBA is probably the best over the phone from what I hear. Jeff is a powerhouse so I assume you'll have access to quality leads. Have you sold those (MS and FE) before or do you need training? If you need training check out my book on Amazon."

↳ (0): "I've heard nothing but good things about DBA. However, I literally quit my job to go work for them because they offered free leads with reduced commissions. Then after I got my license they no longer offered that. So I'm looking at other avenues now. I was a stockbroker for 9 years (years ago) and sold tons of insurance policies but never FE or MS. I'm all about training so if you have a book that you think I should look at either send me a DM or link it here and I'll get it. If you have recommendations for other firms let me know."

↳ (0): "That sucks, any mention why they stopped the program? Another BGA that is giving the same opportunity I remember, not to long ago is Ben Boman - saw an email of his across my desk last week about it. He's mostly FE and has a solid sales process, but I think his process prefers physical f2f sales - I may be wrong. I don't permit linking here for prospecting - so you'll have to search my name for the book."

"1099 Health & Life agent here. Im 100% commission based, and I'm associated with a brokerage which provides training, leads, and makes it very easy and simple to appoint with different carriers. I have heard lots of horror stories about how it can be, but I was very lucky to land at a place where it seems to be the dream which I'm sure there are others like it. My work life balance is what I choose. Since I am 1099/Independent- I work from where I want, however I want, for however long I want... sell the products that I choose. My brokerage provides an office space for free which you can go to 7 days a week and there are always people there willing to help or let you shadow while you learn. Pay depends on you. Last year was my first year and although it was rough (Chargebacks, customer service being the worst) I see the potential in the game especially since I have become close with some of the top producers at the brokerage. Although some decide to work 6 days a week for 10 hours or more (and make well into the 6 figures or even 7) others do what you want to do which is put their family first. I would take everything you are told with a grain of salt as it is heavily dependent on that person's experience. Mine has been great. If you are a resilient person, manage stress well, work hard on your own and don't need external motivation, this career could be good for you. It definitely has it's ups and downs (I'm a 100% commission based agent), but if you have enough money saved up to survive for a couple of months while you get started I would highly recommend a 100% commission based position if you can mentally handle it since you will get a much higher commission rate and you will own your book of business. Best of luck!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ax5nn1/what_is_it_like_being_an_insurance_agent/krlsxi6/

"Did \$30,000 last month, this month already at \$25,000.. I do group benefits and individual life. Anything is possible.. stay away from Final expense unless someone really wants it and are serious, but that can be chargeback central. Life insurance is like any other business; you got to have hustle and move on to the next. Don't even waste your time with that "overturning objections" that they teach in all these sales trainings. Next year my goal is to write \$100,000 in a month on my own pen all commission. With group I get free leads because I just open up google and search for every business in my area and call until I can't anymore. Those who are hungry will eat."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ouo21x/anybody_here_make_at_least_10k_a_month_in_life/node56/

"I'm looking to take a jump into the insurance industry and specifically Medicare advantage. Did you make decent money as a captive agent? I want to learn and train at a captive agency before trying my hand at being an independent. Is 65-70k to keep my head above water first year attainable and realistic?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/17mm0vw/going_independentsuggestions/k8d7fsd/

"With life and health, it's gonna be a few options. Now they'll be some places where you go more towards the Financial advisor side. Unfortunately, you're a couple months late for health. Everyone was hiring for the Annual enrollment period.. That's what I did for many years. I did get burned out and wanted to do more. But I did make Good money. Unfortunately, there are layoffs every year and every time I was up for promotion. There was a lay off, so I tried to go. Independent again myself. I may eventually go back to being independent one day, but I'm in the process of getting my series 7 and 66 while I get a base salary. It wasn't easy and it took four months of interviewing. After that, I plan on adding on with RICP and CFP. But that's because the company that I'm working for Will pay for it and try to grow with a W2 company. There are plenty of jobs. That will take a lot of work that pay well. I started as a W2, Medicare Agent, and made between 80 and 125,000 a year for the last six years. I wasn't doing that when I went. Independent, though, I had to spend so much money and the training, technology, Support just was so different. You gotta realize they are selling you. There's a few really good independent organizations out there, but it really depends on what you're good at and what you want. Most of them. Don't care because they get paid. Regardless. If you do nothing it doesn't matter to them. I hate MLM structure too so I stay away from those places. How have you spoken to over 50 different places and they all sound amazing, but a few actually follow through."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wlnr8v/pulling_my_hair_out/pb0iw84/

"MedicareWAA said: See link at end of my comment. Go to the 3 hour 12 minute mark. Not sure how much I'd read into his answer except that he agrees there are marketing abuses, things aren't getting better, and CMS is unlikely to give anyone a free pass. Follow the rules and turn in those who don't. And if you run a Medicare Advantage call center, know they're coming after you. I hope the independent local agents aren't shot in the crossfire. Click to expand... If you own a big call center you may have friends in high places and that is the key to success in this administration"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Dr. Oz says commission churning for MA plan is big issue · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/dr-oz-says-commission-churning-for-ma-plan-is-big-issue.115336/#post-1530471>

"billyg said: I have been focusing on studying for the last 2 weeks (reading the forum in my down time), and I will be taking my license exam before the end of the month. I have decided to start out selling FE and when my comfort level is good, I will add MedSupp. As I get started, I have two main concerns: 1) Having access to training resources to help me improve my selling skills, thereby improving my close ratio. (I plan to join ILIAA to help address this issue) 2) Having enough leads to keep me in front of people selling 6-8 hours a day, 5 days a week. For this second concern, it seems that I can choose between doing my own lead generation as an independent (maintaining a higher commission rate) or going with a company like EFES (at a lower commission). It seems that the "DIY" approach could be challenging in that there are a lot of different approaches and complexities for someone like me (no experience in lead generation). I know that there are different opinions of EFES. JDEASY seems pretty happy with them, but others don't like them. I would love to hear everyone's thoughts on pros and cons of EFES vs being independent. Click to expand... The road to success is bumpy. We don't know How many people in EFES like JDEASY who can close 40 some percent on leads. So you need to find more references to determine if you would like to join EFES. Unless you have a huge client base, you will need a lead generation methods. It costs money. Many agents failed due to lack of money to purchase the leads."

— Insurance-Forums.com · EFES Vs Independent · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/efes-vs-independent.17926/#post-225378>

"I have been focusing on studying for the last 2 weeks (reading the forum in my down time), and I will be taking my license exam before the end of the month. I have decided to start out selling FE and when my comfort level is good, I will add MedSupp. As I get started, I have two main concerns: 1) Having access to training resources to help me improve my selling skills, thereby improving my close ratio. (I plan to join ILIAA to help address this issue) 2) Having enough leads to keep me in front of people selling 6-8 hours a day, 5 days a week. For this second concern, it seems that I can choose between doing my own lead generation as an independent (maintaining a higher commission rate) or going with a company like EFES (at a lower commission). It seems that the "DIY" approach could be challenging in that there are a lot of different approaches and complexities for someone like me (no experience in lead generation). I know that there are different opinions of EFES. JDEASY seems pretty happy with them, but others don't like them. I would love to hear everyone's thoughts on pros and cons of EFES vs being independent."

— Insurance-Forums.com · EFES Vs Independent · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/efes-vs-independent.17926/#post-225359>

"Such great information. I wish all consumers understood that as agents we are paid by the insurance company when something is sold, but regardless of being an independent agent, the plan you may buy does not cost anything additional. Great information Sylvia. I try to educate my clients with things just like this because the perception is that of....well....kind of like "Needle Nose Ned - Ned Rierson".....the insurance agent in the movie "Groundhog Day" with Bill Murray. Thank you Medicare Family!!!!"

— YouTube · How Do Medicare Agents Get Paid? · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PNCKtpblji4&lc=UgxisgpOB-zuN3OQy-Z4AaABAq>

↳ @TheMedicareFamily (0): "Thanks for watching Charles!!"

"See link at end of my comment. Go to the 3 hour 12 minute mark. Not sure how much I'd read into his answer except that he agrees there are marketing abuses, things aren't getting better, and CMS is unlikely to give anyone a free pass. Follow the rules and turn in those who don't. And if you run a Medicare Advantage call center, know they're coming after you. I hope the independent local agents aren't shot in the crossfire."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Dr. Oz says commission churning for MA plan is big issue · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/dr-oz-says-commission-churning-for-ma-plan-is-big-issue.115336/#post-1530469>

"@GordonMarketingI'm new--very new. Still haven't viewed all of your videos yet. I'd like to learn more about effective lead generation and marketing budgets needed for new independent contracting agents."

— YouTube · Where New Medicare Agents Can Get Free Training · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=A1MHluUzD-w&lc=UgwRiivclC3XXZ2NTpB4AaABAq.9SX7JcljwM19SZvNxtZoGh>

"This is so inspiring I want to become licensed to sell Medicare but if I am new should I start of with a company in order to gain experience or go out on my own?"

— YouTube · Watch me Generate Leads & Network I Medicare Agent · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nnfaSLw51zw&lc=UgziZVbum-gM6V2IHuF4AaABAq>

↳ @KinkyStyles1980 (2): "Start with a company if you need steady income Start Independent if you can go without steady income for at least 1 year. And can go all in"

"New agent planning to become an independent broker — looking for a remote, non-captive IMO (want to avoid mistakes). Need suggestions. I'm a college student getting licensed soon and I want to make sure I don't make the wrong choice with my first IMO. My long-term goal is to be an independent broker, not captive, so I'm looking for a fully remote, flexible, non-captive IMO that pays directly from carriers, gives day-one vested ownership, and doesn't have an MLM or sink-or-swim environment. I want structured training tied to real leads (not just videos) with a mentorship culture where I can learn through hybrid lead types (live transfers + fresh internet + aged leads). Long term, I want the freedom to stop buying IMO leads and outsource or generate my own once I can close consistently. I care about doing things right, so I want a client-first organization, not a numbers-only pressure model. I'll start with life insurance only, then expand into annuities after I build skill. Any IMO recommendations that fit this? Any industry advice is appreciated as I work toward becoming a fully independent broker, thank you! 🙏"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · new or aspiring agent · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pftb0n/>

↳ (0): "SafeLife Policy is the place where I'm at and I've built a 6-figure business very quickly. You really should be looking for strong mentorship above all else though. My agents are successful because of our team, system, and training. Good luck!"

↳ (0): "Thank you! Definitely will search for the best mentorship I can find 🙏"

↳ (0): "Ritter insurance . I have over 20 years with both!"

"I started with symmetry as my first company as a new agent and it was going OK at first but my up line kept telling me just watch the videos just watch the videos just watch the videos and then one day she just kind of snapped on me and was telling me I just have to figure it out on my own and I Ended up just quitting because I told myself I'm not gonna work under somebody who's not willing to be there for me when I can have the simplest questions that a video can't answer as a new agent."

— YouTube · Live Dialing Insurance Leads! [Final Expense Insurance] · life / final-expense agent · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RL6Y5qig0Wg&lc=UgwGg_FVe6z7YmsJhJh4AaABAq.9YL406U_DiF9fwQ1bnjeSc

A lead source that works every month · 10 documents · 10 voices

"Figured I would post my thought to save everyone reading some money... CABOOM leads provides below average leads with a 20% answer rate when called 10-15 times in the first 3 days. Most of the IUL leads who answered were dead broke and unqualified. They were VERY FAR from high intent leads that were ready to buy. I should have known based on their advertising that it was sketchy, but I thought spending more would lead to higher quality leads. I was wrong. I started to focus more on buying annuity leads since this is my primary niche after a few weeks of failed IUL leads (that I thought were a fluke at the time - 60 leads total). I made the mistake of signing up for an annuity lead subscription after seeing high praise from an annuity producer I respect. I was even more disappointed with these leads. I ordered 20 leads per month for \$5000 and was told by my representative that I could cancel if I was very disappointed, but he assured me that I would have at least a 3x return on investment... Keep in mind that I actually have wealth management experience selling \$4M of annuities and mutual funds last year.... I ordered in mid-February and it's now early April and I STILL haven't received my first 20 leads. In late February, I ordered another 10 leads hoping that my lead flow would come in faster, and none have been delivered from this order. Most leads were not serious anyway and had no clue that the ad was talking about annuities... I had a similar experience on the IUL leads. I believe their ads are misleading and trick people into thinking they are getting some kind of free benefit that does not exist... I thought Cody was one of the good guys in the industry, but I'm not sure I trust him or his team. Quite frankly, their advertising is extremely misleading - "ready to buy" is garbage, but I blame this on myself for falling for the trap... Also, lots of other shady practices like offering discounts for POSITIVE reviews only, sending out a FAKE April fools message that they are no longer accepting new clients to trick people into buying with urgency, advertising that leads are vetted and ready to buy (all they do is respond to a text code - I'm not sure if I even believe this), and worst of all, not following through on promises. I have been unable to cancel my subscription order even though I am highly displeased and I have not even received 20 leads although I've ordered 30+ more than a month ago"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/mkvaioj/

"That is insane- I started ACA this past November. I didn't invest in leads or anything, just leaving with a small handful of clients. I'm desperately looking to build my book of business this year and I'm really looking for viable lead sources outside of open enrollment and would love to hear about the source you use during open enrollment to reach those numbers- I'm willing to invest in myself. Could you DM or reach back out on this post?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rx4iw2/enrolled_500_aca_clients_my_first_open_enrollment/ob4t2br/

"Great video. I am new and have rcvd a few leads. None panned out but hoping some good leads come during open enrollment"

— YouTube · FREE LEADS!! How to get free leads for ACA "Obamacare" · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sBopPuhBx74&lc=UgwxpRP-6mdv3iHEBMF4AaABAg>

↳ @InsuranceAgentTraining (1): "Thank you. It should be a lot better during open enrollment"

"Yes from my time around an insurance agency so far I learned about dnc, and I would include ways to opt out if I'm the one calling the leads, if I make the leads compliant and sell them I think they would just feed the leads into their own systems and would have to handle the dnc and opt outs through their system. I was planning on building a whole automation system, but I want to start with just lead generation to make things simpler at first because I feel if I can build a good collection of leads daily I could have a business pretty fast selling them, or calling them my self. I could offer my system that will have dnc and opt out later on . I know I would need to build a way to return bad leads, and all that which will be simple enough. I have many years of web developer experience. For now I'm thinking just start with a lead generator collecting leads from my sources and building a database that you know organize them and filters them and places the information together with the lead so I can have a list of leads daily. I was thinking if I don't want to cold call these leads because they didn't specifically request quotes my next step would be to take this massive bulk of really cold leads and create the platform to turn them warm. That would be were I ask them if they want a quote or find a way for them to want to do it through some sort of advertising directly to them."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oxahnm/leads_generation_new_agent_question/noziwhu/

"Leads: where to buy or how to self generate with Securities license + life/health insurance As title indicates, I am securities licensed as well as hold life, health, and annuities licenses. I would like advice on either a) a good lead source or b) how to generate my own (such as via a Facebook "funnel"), but it needs to be compliant with Finra regs, etc. Does such a thing exist? The marketing dept of my company quoted me a \$1,000 up front fee then \$100 per NON-EXCLUSIVE lead. That seems crazy. Or am I crazy to think that there must be a better way?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1c1m2eg/leads_where_to_buy_or_how_to_self_generate_with/

↳ One_Ad9555 (2): "Go introduce yourself to every accountant in the areas. Get them to refer you business. Find some p&C agencies that don't do investments. Get a p&C license and refer them business. Get a 15 to 20% referral fee for that. They refer you investments and etc, annuity that they don't write. Join all the local organizations."

↳ One_Ad9555 (2): "Accountants do taxes for individuals and businesses. They know which individuals and businesses have money to invest. What businesses need retirement plans. What individuals need IRAs. What individuals need 401k rollover. Having an accountant refer there clients to you is golden. Also you don't even need to sell them. The accountant has usually told them what to do and you just need to provide the paperwork so they can do it. Many times I never had to do anything other than listen to client and sign them up. Tax time gets really busy as accountants are telling people they need to pay the money in taxes or get IRAs."

↳ howtoreadspaghetti (1): "Makes perfect sense."

"I am currently ramping up to those numbers. I found that I was losing money for about the first 4-6 months. Then after constantly adjusting the filters, lead providers, incorporating ideas from here; I was able to make a profit. Now I take that profit and plow it back into the leads. I am hoping to get to \$1,000 a month with good filters and a good lead provider. I am current in the \$500 to \$600 range. All health, but this year will venture in to the life, annuity, homeowners, LTC leads."

— Insurance-Forums.com · How Much Does Everyone Spend on Leads\$\$\$ · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/how-much-does-everyone-spend-on-leads.9859/#post-131205>

"summerof18 said: I'll ask my lady is she's looking to take on another. You want me to have her email you if she's interested? Summer? If u ask & shes still available, pls forward her info to me too....Im not sure I want to use an appt setter (again) at this point, but I am ramping up my lead flow & within a few weeks its going to be 80/mo. Thx"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Looking for an Appointment Setter · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/looking-for-an-appointment-setter.61720/#post-802795>

"New agent planning to become an independent broker — looking for a remote, non-captive IMO (want to avoid mistakes). Need suggestions. I'm a college student getting licensed soon and I want to make sure I don't make the wrong choice with my first IMO. My long-term goal is to be an independent broker, not captive, so I'm looking for a fully remote, flexible, non-captive IMO that pays directly from carriers, gives day-one vested ownership, and doesn't have an MLM or sink-or-swim environment. I want structured training tied to real leads (not just videos) with a mentorship culture where I can learn through hybrid lead types (live transfers + fresh internet + aged leads). Long term, I want the freedom to stop buying IMO leads and outsource or generate my own once I can close consistently. I care about doing things right, so I want a client-first organization, not a numbers-only pressure model. I'll start with life insurance only, then expand into annuities after I build skill. Any IMO recommendations that fit this? Any industry advice is appreciated as I work toward becoming a fully independent broker, thank you! 🙏 "

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↳ (0): "SafeLife Policy is the place where I'm at and I've built a 6-figure business very quickly. You really should be looking for strong mentorship above all else though. My agents are successful because of our team, system, and training. Good luck!"

↳ (0): "Thank you! Definitely will search for the best mentorship I can find 🙏 "

↳ (0): "Ritter insurance . I have over 20 years with both!"

"Note To New Readers of This Thread: After starting and succeeding during my time at EFES, I have now moved on and started my own final expense agency where I specialize in training new agents to final expense, through personalized mentorship and providing a tried-and-tested sales and lead generation model. You can find out more by clicking this link to Final Expense Agent Mentor. Also check out my comprehensive free Final Expense Training YouTube Channel for more than 100 videos describing subjects such as: 1) How To Sell Final Expense Successfully, 2) How To Pick The Best Final Expense Leads, and 3) How to figure out whether or not the final expense opportunity you're being offered is a scam. Definitely check out the free resources above if you are investing the possibility of selling final expense. Thanks!

***** Hello all, Several months ago, I began investigating selling insurance in conjunction with my other business to help supplement my income. After searching insurance-forum.net deeply, I decided that final expense sales would be the product I would specialize in. Simply because the product made sense (backed by a fundamentally-sound shift in demographics) and wasn't too technically complicated, as I have never sold insurance before. I decided to contract through Equita Final Expense Services (EFES from now on), and wanted to share with you the results of my first month in business, what I liked, and what my complaints are. DISCLOSURE: I am willingly providing this information without any compensation or request. I'm mainly doing it because I'm sure there are others out there, researching various insurance products to rep, and would benefit from a newbie's first month perspective. Management: My direct manager is Andrew Fike out of Atlanta, GA, one of EFES's top agents. It has been a thorough pleasure working with him. He's totally supportive of my working schedule limitations, understanding that I'm only available 3 days in the field for 10-12 hours each day due to my other business. He's willing to take the time and teach me the finer points of selling, helping me modify my pitch and do a better job closing. Also, he's helped me with any questions or concerns I have had. All in all, it's been a 10/10 experience. Regional Management: My regional manager is Joe Ciaccio out of Tampa, FL. He's a great guy that has helped me with prospecting techniques and scripts. However, I've been more in contact with his office support staff, who've been wonderful helping me get on my feet. Definitely a 10/10 experience. EFES Corporate: My marketing manager is Chase Ulrich. He's a great guy to work with -- definitely in it to help you be productive. However, if you have read any of jdeasy's posts, one issue I've run into is getting consistent lead flow. Having run a business that's dependent on marketing, I understand response rates and the time it takes to tweak the sizes of drops to consistently produce the amount of leads you need. So far I've been selling through EFES for 4 weeks and I've averaged 9-10 leads a week. I've wanted 20+ weekly to work. I have probably spent 3-4 of the last 12-14 days without anyone to see. Nevertheless, I'm not worried about this long-term, and wouldn't have this hold me up from taking advantage of the EFES opportunity, as I'm confident the problem will be resolved within the next couple of weeks. A 9.5/10 experience, only because I'm hungry to get working all day long. With 2 days left in the month, I've posted nearly \$6,000.00 AP, which I consider decent as I'm new to the industry and have really worked an average of 2 full days each week through June. My goal is to double that for July and onward, once lead flow begins to pick up consistently. In the meantime, if you're one of the folks like me who are reading this, and are thinking about joining EFES, or are a little bit skeptical, I say give it a shot; it's worth the investment. The support staff and management is great -- they want you to succeed. Just be prepared to work hard at improving constantly, and wading through rat-hole trailers, too. Best, Dave D."

— Insurance-Forums.com · My 1st Month at EFES/Equita Final Expense · new or aspiring agent · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/my-1st-month-at-efes-equita-final-expense.32457/#post-406055>

"I would love to start buying my leads off of ca boom if it makes me more money than buying the leads that I am right now which aren't good leads.... is there a way I can book a 1 on 1 call with you, Cody???"

— YouTube · Life Insurance Leads - The Best Place To Get Them · 1 likes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dr_xERFNuH0&lc=UgwVp3Z8X9_p99I9qHt4AaABAq

↳ @usmanajibola6794 (1): "Cody has given us ways to get leads but personally and base on the life insurance agents I have discussed with buying leads don't work which you have also testified. Curious to know what are the other ways (maybe lead funnels, Facebook Ad, Google Ad, or through Press Release) you have Implement in making sure you start getting consistently qualified leads?"

↳ @NardiaStone (0): "@usmanajibola6794the ads method is what Cody uses he generates leads in real time"

Leads that answer and a phone that rings · 9 documents · 9 voices

"From Restaurant Owner to Bankruptcy: Charting My Path Back to Success Hi Reddit friends! I'm here to tell you about my journey and ask for a little help. I used to run a restaurant that I opened back in 2010. But when COVID-19 hit, I had to close it because of money problems. Before that, I worked with import and export between Dubai and Belgium. Right now, I'm working at a company to pay the bills and I'm still paying off some debts from my restaurant. I want to start working as an appointment setter and later on, I hope to become good at closing deals. I'm thankful for everything I've learned and I believe in myself. I know I can find my way back. Life has been tough, but I have faith. I'm from Belgium and I speak English, French, and Arabic. If you have any advice on how to get into appointment setting or know someone who can help, I'd be so grateful. Thanks for reading !"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1d8424p/>

↳ (0): "Appointment setting can be very ominous. Just get a good script and read it every call to get the client over to the closer."

"I've been hearing mixed things on inbound, and would love to try but unfortunately given the financial situation I'm in now I can't buy any more leads even if they are inbound. I would feel better about it but the vast majority of the people I spoke to that are tenured have told me it takes between 6-12 months just to become profitable. I don't have that kind of runway. But I pray it goes well for you! Please check back in and let me know how things are going I'm genuinely interested to hear how you do by sticking it out!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj5uxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/ourbvaq/

"Lead magnets don't work I followed the textbook advice: build generic lead magnets for prospects ("Medicare 101: A Beginner's Guide to Turning 65"), hoping to get more leads. I used these "magnets" to run ads and send them directly to prospective clients. **Spoiler alert: It was completely ineffective.** I learned the hard way that lead magnets only work when they answer the **specific question** the client is *actively* looking for. No one, especially not a busy prospect, is going to read through a large, generic PDF or blog post. *What worked for me:* 1. Finding social media posts for people asking questions about their insurance - it could be final expense, medicare or ACA - doesn't matter. Key is to find the real people asking questions on groups. 2. Based on the question, use ChatGPT or Gemini to generate an article (PDF or blog) to answer the specific question. It should be HELPFUL but not generic 3. Send it to the prospect. Follow up with questions, to help refine the material. Anyone tried this playbook? Any ways to make these even better? Tip: Having blog posts hosted on your website work great, as they allow you to build custom audiences for ad targeting on meta. Additionally, adding them to your social page works great as well."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1otr8l0/lead_magnets_dont_work/

↳ oogway_rox (2): "We use a tool to find and filter social media posts. You could use Google or ai tools, but it requires manual effort to weed out the irrelevant posts."

↳ firenace (2): "Fremium downloads are to get attention, not close a sale. Also defeats the purpose as IME paid ads have been ineffective for a long time. I've reviewed prob over 1,000 agency P&Ls by now, can count on one hand the number of agencies that get a true long term positive return from paid campaigns. I know plenty however that do Medicare 101 seminars or webinars and get hot leads from putting them in the right place right time. One even does them at the local library every few months, the library advertises it, and they consistently get sales from it."

↳ AbbreviationsGold587 (2): "So basically you see a question someone asked, put together a blog post on it, then say we just wrote a blog post on that exact topic?"

"Yeah if they're already on the phone the "I'm busy" thing imo is just a deflection, I usually say something "no problem this will just take a moment to see if you're even a good fit" or something along those lines to basically just keep it moving forward. My favorite especially with health products is like "I can tell by your tone that you take this seriously so I don't want to waste any time..." and then just continue moving forward. Personally I want them to either tell me yes or no, I don't like calling back or like indecisive answers if it's no it's no that's great let me move on, but if they're still talking then I'm gonna keep pushing forward in a respectful way. Them even answering in the first place is a good sign, and every moment afterwards that they remain on the line imo is a good sign. It's very easy to hang up the phone on a stranger yk? But there is nuance to all of this of course; in order to not sound too pushy and turn them off. I'm probably making it sound much more simple than it is in practice."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qrb80b/none_of_my_prospects_are_answering_my_calls_after/o2n5uzn/

"Help with my future plan in insurance at a young age. Aswell as sharing my story. Before you start reading this thinking that I'm some 15yo that doesn't know what he is talking about, let me start and tell the entire story of how I got the job and what I'm doing now. I am looking for advice for my future. I am currently a marketer for a Farmers Insurance agency in Southern MN, I got this job through my own wits and reaching out, not being a "nepo" by any means. HOW I FOUND AND GOT THE OPPORTUNITY - To start, I want/wanted a future in financial services, so I set up a meeting with my school guidance counselor, I told her about my dreams and aspirations. My guidance counselor was impressed by my ambition at my young age and my knowledge of investments and sales, she showed me a website for our county, and from which was a list of youth jobs/internships. Seeing the opportunity, as soon as I got home, I turned on my computer and scrolled through the list of opportunities, nothing much interested me as they were all internships/job shadows with no pay and tight schedules. As I scrolled further, I saw one that stood out to me, it said Farmers Insurance (Agency Name) (Work Experience, Data Entry, Administrative Duties) 17+, and it looked to be the best one to me and I could care less about not being 17+, so I skipped sending in any sort of form or resume as prompted. I searched up the office on google maps and called the agency #, from what I can remember the conversation is summarized by something like this. I called and said I saw the posted opportunity on said website and then asked if there was any wiggle room on the age, he told me yes and discussed some things I would be doing in the role, office work, calling and service. He asked me if I could meet with him on Monday to discuss it further and told me about how he would pay for all licensing when we get there and how there many ways to make a good income in this career, I told him about my interest in finance and investments. He asked me if insurance was a career I wanted (I told him yes, but I was unsure, but it was the most logical answer), then we finished up our conversation and set up a time that Monday. Afterwards I was so sure I had the job I rushed to tell my parents I'm putting in my 2 weeks at my former McDonalds job and canceling my lawn mowing business. They told me not to be so sure for my interview, I assured them I got the job and that it was just a meeting. When the "interview" came my dad came with me to the office as the owner invited him in as well, we sat down in his office, and he discussed more of what I would be doing and my future with Farmers Financial Services and discussed further things I would be doing with my now career, as well as asking how much I was looking to make an hour (He never said it was a paid position, and he never mentioned it being paid), I told him 16\$ an hour and he told me that could work. When me and my father left the office, we laughed in the car because my parents thought it was an interview, which as he found out in real time it most definitely was not, as the owner started the conversation with "This is what you'll be doing on Monday" LOL. FIRST MONTH OR SO OF THE JOB - The first day, I came to office early and the owner had me sit down and discussed about selling insurance, and after that brief conversation he sat me at my desk, gave me a pen and paper and told me to make a script that I would use (after he had me study a small Q&A packet). He left and told me I got 20 minutes and we'll check in, I sat perplexed and had no idea what I was going to write, after I took about 5 minutes to create a rough draft, I called my boss back to look it over, and we played pretend calling with a prospect/lead. When he threw out "I'm not interested" I sat frozen for a good couple of seconds trying to think of something, then we fixed and refined my script. The second day he told me I won't be ready for calling yet unless I thought otherwise, I said the latter. Then he showed my first look of a lead pipeline (Agency Zoom), and then told me to go ahead and dial these leads and many won't pick up and that I will mess up, so I sat calling these aged leads and working with my script I set 2 appts on my second day as a 15yo, he was surprised but told me to throw my bonus tag on them and showed me how to set the appt for the producer (it was just me and him in office at this time for now). For my first month I set many appts and had live transfers consistently (after my boss told me I would get a 25\$ bonus for anyone given estimates, regardless of closing), I asked what my title was for my position, he paused for a moment and then told me I was a "Marketer" SOME CONTEXT - My boss is highly impressed with me, as my predecessors in this role were a waste of his time and money, they were much older than me and worked longer hours, and they haven't had as many bonuses as I have from transfers or appts. He told me an okay one he had hired made about 4 bonuses in 2 months, for reference on a really good day I'll make 4 bonuses in a max of 5 hours dialing. Aswell as his compliments how he never has to watch me because I do my job consistently, and that I dial well above the industry average with a manual dial LOL. My boss is a great guy, he pays me well, I know he loses money on me when making new business but overtime he will make his money back with renewals. He also mentions he doesn't mind paying me about the 41\$ (1 Hour is average time for transfer, and the bonus added) because he pays for live dial transfers and they won't be nearly as good as my in-office transfer. I once cold called an aged lead, (wrong name and everything) and then created a new profile for them with data mid call, transferred and we closed on them with a full bundle. CONTINUING FURTHER - Continuing this job for 5 months now as a marketer, my role consists more of than just SDR work, I create ads and postcards, going door to door, running booths during events, creating leads in the local area with data, and I have completely moved away from a script when dialing. I have left a large gap in the timeline, so I just want to add some small things here, I transfer leads consistently and work 5-hour shifts Mon-Thurs during the summer working with a producer consistently giving them new business. I have consistent transfers and I follow and manage my lead pipeline smooth and efficiently all the way to the estimate stage. Aswell as him giving me access to more expensive and better leads (I still dial aged leads consistently), and he laughs that I have amazing transfer rates with s*** leads. I'm amazing at this job, and I can come up with phrases or things to say to potential clients on the fly. Aswell as having a great relationship with my boss, we went to a BBQ place one time and he gave the world of compliments to my recent bonuses, we talked about my future, and he told me stories of his past jobs. For questions about how much I make as a 15yo, my next check with be gross \$1152 after working 47 hours (over 2 weeks), roughly \$24.50 per hr at 15. The reason its that much is because I will have 16 bonuses with it (16 X 47)+(25 X 16). Now that you've heard my story, I'm looking for advice on continuing further with Farmers Insurance, where I currently am their rates are insanely competitive. Farmers is a hybrid; we can write through other carriers as well (which is amazing). How long do you guys think I should continue with my boss? Decades? I have aspirations to own my own Farmers Financial Services Agency, but how would be losing my clients and renewals taking the leap to open my agency when that time comes? Capital won't be an issue by the time I want to, I have over 11 thousand invested in the stock market, which is all of my own money, all worked for by me over time, with a Roth IRA and Brokerage. (I also want to note my parents knew nothing about investing this was all my idea and I even manage my Moms Roth IRA for her, and nor do I come from a wealthy family) How do you guys think my career path should look? I know I am very lucky to be working for a 3-year-old Farmers agency that is growing rapidly, soon becoming multi-office. With an ethical and amazing boss."

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uzpz51/help_with_my_future_plan_in_insurance_at_a_young/

↳ Character_Text_30 (2): "You are an amazing young person! Your work ethic will take you very far in life. Just don't burn any bridges. I say that because, in a year, you will have outgrown your current job and position. Get your license, if you said you have already' I apologize. Pay close attention to the things your mentor is doing to run the office. Learn those things and just know, you do the hardest part of all- get clients on on books and close deals. That's how that company is doing so well. And I hope you make what you deserve real soon. Keep going!"

↳ BuildingIndividual33 (1): "Yes, I am already starting to outgrow what I'm doing, I want to close deals, but my age is a restriction! My boss mentions I'll be a firecracker and will close deals as soon as I get my license, I also want to get my securities licenses after the P&C+L&H, so I can manage and sell securities."

↳ BuildingIndividual33 (-1): "No sir, I am a real person, I sat here typing all of this out for 2 hours last night. But thank you for compliments to my writing at 15! appreciate it! 🙏"

"What a bummer dude I'm just simply not a team guy I just want to get leads and close why tf all these top earners can't get it out the mud from there own sales all of its or majority is really from having kick backs from recruits under them? What a fckn joke man I was excited to join the industry"

— YouTube · Why I Left The Life Insurance Business (My Old MLM) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nguUnK7jDk&lc=UgxbSrA23j0smSCol_h4AaABAq

"Calling and handling warm leads is easy, I would love to see more cold-calling on final expense."

— YouTube · Live Dialing Insurance Leads! [Final Expense Insurance] · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RL6Y5qig0Wg&lc=UgyUkbP7y-Dj-vjxONZ4AaABAq>

"Note To New Readers of This Thread: After starting and succeeding during my time at EFES, I have now moved on and started my own final expense agency where I specialize in training new agents to final expense, through personalized mentorship and providing a tried-and-tested sales and lead generation model. You can find out more by clicking this link to Final Expense Agent Mentor. Also check out my comprehensive free Final Expense Training YouTube Channel for more than 100 videos describing subjects such as: 1) How To Sell Final Expense Successfully, 2) How To Pick The Best Final Expense Leads, and 3) How to figure out whether or not the final expense opportunity you're being offered is a scam. Definitely check out the free resources above if you are investing the possibility of selling final expense. Thanks!

***** Hello all, Several months ago, I began investigating selling insurance in conjunction with my other business to help supplement my income. After searching insurance-forum.net deeply, I decided that final expense sales would be the product I would specialize in. Simply because the product made sense (backed by a fundamentally-sound shift in demographics) and wasn't too technically complicated, as I have never sold insurance before. I decided to contract through Equita Final Expense Services (EFES from now on), and wanted to share with you the results of my first month in business, what I liked, and what my complaints are. DISCLOSURE: I am willingly providing this information without any compensation or request. I'm mainly doing it because I'm sure there are others out there, researching various insurance products to rep, and would benefit from a newbie's first month perspective. Management: My direct manager is Andrew Fike out of Atlanta, GA, one of EFES's top agents. It has been a thorough pleasure working with him. He's totally supportive of my working schedule limitations, understanding that I'm only available 3 days in the field for 10-12 hours each day due to my other business. He's willing to take the time and teach me the finer points of selling, helping me modify my pitch and do a better job closing. Also, he's helped me with any questions or concerns I have had. All in all, it's been a 10/10 experience. Regional Management: My regional manager is Joe Ciaccio out of Tampa, FL. He's a great guy that has helped me with prospecting techniques and scripts. However, I've been more in contact with his office support staff, who've been wonderful helping me get on my feet. Definitely a 10/10 experience. EFES Corporate: My marketing manager is Chase Ulrich. He's a great guy to work with -- definitely in it to help you be productive. However, if you have read any of jdeasy's posts, one issue I've run into is getting consistent lead flow. Having run a business that's dependent on marketing, I understand response rates and the time it takes to tweak the sizes of drops to consistently produce the amount of leads you need. So far I've been selling through EFES for 4 weeks and I've averaged 9-10 leads a week. I've wanted 20+ weekly to work. I have probably spent 3-4 of the last 12-14 days without anyone to see. Nevertheless, I'm not worried about this long-term, and wouldn't have this hold me up from taking advantage of the EFES opportunity, as I'm confident the problem will be resolved within the next couple of weeks. A 9.5/10 experience, only because I'm hungry to get working all day long. With 2 days left in the month, I've posted nearly \$6,000.00 AP, which I consider decent as I'm new to the industry and have really worked an average of 2 full days each week through June. My goal is to double that for July and onward, once lead flow begins to pick up consistently. In the meantime, if you're one of the folks like me who are reading this, and are thinking about joining EFES, or are a little bit skeptical, I say give it a shot; it's worth the investment. The support staff and management is great -- they want you to succeed. Just be prepared to work hard at improving constantly, and wading through rat-hole trailers, too. Best, Dave D."

— Insurance-Forums.com · My 1st Month at EFES/Equita Final Expense · new or aspiring agent · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/my-1st-month-at-efes-equita-final-expense.32457/#post-406055>

"I would love to start buying my leads off of ca boom if it makes me more money than buying the leads that I am right now which aren't good leads.... is there a way I can book a 1 on 1 call with you, Cody???"

— YouTube · Life Insurance Leads - The Best Place To Get Them · 1 likes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dr_xERFNuH0&lc=UgwVp3Z8X9_p99l9qHt4AaABAq

↳ @usmanajibola6794 (1): "Cody has given us ways to get leads but personally and base on the life insurance agents I have discussed with buying leads don't work which you have also testified. Curious to know what are the other ways (maybe lead funnels, Facebook Ad, Google Ad, or through Press Release) you have Implement in making sure you start getting consistently qualified leads?"

↳ @NardiaStone (0): "@usmanajibola6794the ads method is what Cody uses he generates leads in real time"

Helping people, not just selling · 7 documents · 6 voices

"Is a Life & Health Insurance License Useless? 🤔 I've had a Life & Health Insurance license for 2 weeks. It feels useless for finding a job. All the local captive agents focus on Property & Casualty. They like seeing L&H but they don't sell any. Even if they advertised for a L&H position. I applied to local banks and credit unions. I'm a notary too but heard nothing back. A recruiter from Brown & Brown reached out. She liked my resume and experience a lot. B2B Sales and Marketing, Tradeshows, SEO, etc. She has no job for me. I've had Life Insurance and Medicare outfits calling me. All commission based. They sound like scams and MLMs. I've tried getting an Employee Benefits Advisor job but these seem rare. Ideally I'd like to work at a hospital and help people choose health plans. Applied with health insurance companies. Haven't heard back. Are L&H license useful at all? What should I do to find a job? UPDATE - The Kaplan training I did was part of a hiring process for a Financial Services company. They paid with no strings attached as part of the final hiring process. They ended up not hiring me even after I passed the test. The goal was to do SIE and other FINRA certs. UPDATE 2 - Many of you are saying just go get a Property & Casualty license via DM. Yes would be good to do but I don't have a ton of money right now. Would much prefer to get a job that will pay for my P&C training and licensing. I was thinking of just watching Melissa from Insurance Exam Queen. She and Peter were so valuable for passing the L&H test."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lavqn1/is_a_life_health_insurance_license_useless/

↳ mental_mentalist (13): "You could find life and health carriers and go to their careers section (although they may want experience you may not have)"

↳ takeagander20 (9): "A couple of Medicare agencies who are frequently looking for remote workers, that pay a steady base and a little extra money for enrollments are ResultsCX, and Select Quote. You won't get rich working for either outfit but you can get your feet wet and gain the confidence necessary to go 1099, which is what I'm doing this year since my first AEP and OEP as an hourly sales agent went so well. Getting in is mainly a matter of timing though. Seems I got hired in mid July, to start late September, so you might be a little early. Keep looking on indeed, and you will progressively see more Medicare Sales ads show up day by day. You'll eventually see one or two that offer an hourly base. Good luck!"

↳ mkuz753 (7): "Brown & Brown is a large national independent agency/brokerage. There are many others. Keep in mind that most L&H licensed people end up in employee benefits, aka group plans."

"I am so grateful I came across your channel! I recently received my insurance license with California, and I was wondering if you have any tips to for a beginner in this health insurance industry. I currently work for a small firm in Los Angeles, and I want to become really good at helping people find the right coverage for them. Besides watching your videos, what do you suggest I study and read to become as successful as you? Thank you so much for sharing your knowledge!"

— YouTube · Health Insurance Subsidy Repayment Even If You Left Covered California with Higher Income · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4nPtphKvnic&lc=UgyXJFOxPL4sv1hlvxN4AaABAg>

↳ @KevinKnauss (3): "Pretend you are the client. What would you want to know about when it comes to how a health plan works? Understand how the subsidies are calculated. Don't forget about Medi-Cal and how children are often Medi-Cal and parents are in Covered California with the subsidy. Talk to your clients about how they use health insurance, what they need. Then there is HMO, EPO, and PPO plans, another confusing element. Most importantly, let your clients know they can call, text, or email you anytime with questions. You may not have the answer on the top of your desk, but let them know you will find it. Reading material includes the Evidence of Coverage for the various health plans offered in your area. Instructions for IRS form 8962 Premium Tax Credit reconciliation. Learn about how Medi-Cal works."

↳ @felixgarcia3184 (3): "@KevinKnauss Thank you so much for the advice Kevin. I will definitely start thinking like the client and pursue higher knowledge on the plans being offered by these insurance companies."

"Thanks for posting this! Been trying to wrap my head around all the changes. I truly hope most of these don't go through, I'm not sure why every single one is meant to hurt Americans, not help them."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m2m8ak/important_aca_changes_to_know_heading_into_2026/n3r4h3u/

"yeah well, unless you eat air and live in your mom's basement, i don't doubt that you do as your told at work too. but you sound like one of those throw out the baby with the bath water people. You feel pain so you want to spread that pain around regardless of who it lands on and who's to blame. this is a sales subreddit and sales people don't deny anything we help people with policy selection and hope the policy will pay out when the time comes. the pukes in the board room are the ones who force the denial of claims. you're trolling the wrong end of the problem. if you want to complain to someone then go protest at the problem end of the industry ie. the board rooms and your senator. You're not bugging anyone out in here. We know that health insurance companies can be stingy when paying claims and that it can be fixed with regulation. We also know that WE just like YOU are powerless to stop the practice."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hnr5qh/i_sold_two_policies_myself_today_lets_go/m3m4ynd/

"crabtrap said: Is it advisable to sell for more than one IMO/FMO? There are a few products not offered by my IMO and I would like to have them as an option to better serve the customer. Personal preference. Some say to not have all your contracts with one IMO but I prefer to have all of mine with one. But if they didn't carry a company I wanted I would pick it up elsewhere. I happen to be with an IMO, {FEX}, that will grant releases if I wanted to leave. If you are not with one that will release then it's a whole different ballgame. I certainly would not put all my contracts with an IMO that won't release. ----- crabtrap said: Is it advisable to sell for more than one IMO/FMO? There are a few products not offered by my IMO and I would like to have them as an option to better serve the customer. Personal preference. Some say to not have all your contracts with one IMO but I prefer to have all of mine with one. But if they didn't carry a company I wanted I would pick it up elsewhere. I happen to be with an IMO, {FEX}, that will grant releases if I wanted to leave. If you are not with one that will release then it's a whole different ballgame. I certainly would not put all my contracts with an IMO that won't release."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Selling for Multiple IMO/FMO'S · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/selling-for-multiple-imo-fmos.70645/#post-929096>

"Is it advisable to sell for more than one IMO/FMO? There are a few products not offered by my IMO and I would like to have them as an option to better serve the customer."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Selling for Multiple IMO/FMO'S · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/selling-for-multiple-imo-fmos.70645/#post-929085>

Tab 3 — Relationship Fears

Friends and family: the warm market and the referrals · 35 documents · 20 voices

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

↳ This-Armadillo9741 (7): "I've been wanting to share this insight for a while but never got the chance to. If you're considering being a life insurance agent- Specifically if you're considering working for globe life or American Income Life insurance (that was my run off branch) I'd like to offer you the most transparent what to expect in terms of your pay since I don't see anyone else being blunt with their numbers. I worked for AIL for 3 years from 2019 to 2022. on average my salary was around \$60-\$70k a year. With that income I was typically working 10 to 12 hours a day on the phone 7 days a week and attending weekly (and sometimes daily) training calls with my "team". I didn't do the recruitment side of the business, just the insurance hustle (I know this is where a lot of people are going to point out that THAT IS WHY I DIDNT MAKE AN EXTRAVENT AMOUNT PF MONEY) but let's be real, I didn't my my insurance liscence to recruit other people trying to get their insurance license, I did it to swell insurance. When you see that people are making "\$100k a month" or "\$MILLIONS a year" know this. If I sold a \$10,000 life insurance policy (which is a very minimum, basic, but affordable policy) I made \$55 in commission. with a \$1 residual pay that I would receive the following month. HOWEVER, when we hop on calls at the beginning of the week it would be announced that I "MADE" \$10,000 (completely untrue) and to capitalize on this they always ask "how much of that amount do you get to keep" to which you are trained to respond by saying "all of it" pretty manipulative too the new people huh? but we take what we can get and convince ourselves that if we just do that 10x over we'll eventually have what would look like a 'good check' here's the kicker about those "residuals" after the following month of each policy, you don't get them anymore. for whatever reason they give you, those get kicked to your upper and you basically only have that one time payment to count on. so if I can give you any advice on 'residual payments' it's that somewhere in the fine line of your contract I can guarantee they're not yours to keep. they will find some rhyme and reason as to why it will go back to the company. so, for over 10 hours of work a day, you might make \$55. "oh but what about those that ARE making millions" or "you just needed to work harder" let me tell you something: I busted my ass off on the phone and my spline KNEW I had no interest in recruiting people so EVENTUALLY (we'll say after a year) I got granted some pretty good leads. Now I was finally able to make some big bucks! Without getting too verbose the average policy amount for these clients would be ranging from \$150k ~ \$500k. The largest I ever sold was for a \$500k policy and here's the breakdown for that : I got paid a whopping \$1,300 in commission and a \$300 'residual' the following month. so ...you do the numbers"

↳ jroberts67 (6): "I'm sorry for your experience, but plenty of flags and not trying to come at you too hard, but a level of insanity that there's never been a time in history where we have more information available yet no one wants to research. Group interview? Huge flag. Paying for anything upfront? Huge flag. "Releasing your license" is absurd, once you've passed your exam your license is activated by your state, not any agency."

↳ Current_Bridge_3615 (4): "Worked for AIL as well, you wouldn't believe the horror stories I got during that short time. Let's just say there's a reason they've been sued multiple times and are currently under investigation for insurance fraud."

"I work at a brokerage in life. I have gotten people approved with one of 40 carriers I have that would have been turned down everywhere else. If I was captive at one of 97.5% of these carriers, I would have had to say "sorry" instead of "you'll receive your policy packet in the mail." That's the root issue with captive. Regarding strictly comp, having to buy leads isn't fun. I don't do warm market. Look a few years down the line if you're producing even low six figures in AP, paying \$50-80 per lead at ~100% commission sounds a lot more fun than 40% with some marginal guarantee and no lead spend. It boils down to being able to help the client and your goals and risk tolerance."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vz10ku/why_does_captive_get_so_much_hate_verses_brokerage/p61bv2i/

"It really just depends on the leads i buy, the most expensive ones right now for me are \$13.00 a lead.. Typically you want to reinvest 10-15% of what you're wanting to make back into your business. So if you want to make 10,000 a month you need to invest at LEAST 1,000 back into leads and stuff like that. It's all about your numbers too. Warm market leads are better than cold market in my opinion. I've spent about \$400 in leads and i've made 2 sales off of those that have covered the \$400 and then some. Life insurance is a little different than other insurance i feel like, you REALLYYYY have to grind. It's hard but once you figure out your numbers it's like a challenge against yourself every month haha."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jpsc95/it_finally_happened/ml267eh/

"Why does Captive get so much hate verses Brokerage? Every time it comes up on here it's the same stuff. MLM, pyramid, they'll eat your warm market and spit you out. and i get some of it, i've heard the stories. but independent has a washout rate too. people burn through lead money and quit in four months and nobody makes a thread about it. feels like about the same number of people fail either way, just for different reasons. stuff i've wondered about: is it just the language? downline, overrides, build your team, recruiting nights. to a normal person that sounds exactly like an MLM. except independent uses all those same words so i don't know why it sticks harder to one side. is it the warm market thing? that one actually does seem bad. if the model is you selling to your phone contacts then you're finished when the list runs out, and then somebody tells you it was your mindset. but plenty of independent shops run the same way, where the real money is lead markup and the agent is the customer. or is it that captive means two completely different things? a NYL or northwestern career agency is not the same business as an FE recruiting mill and they get lumped together constantly. seems like the career agents are the ones eating criticism meant for somebody else. also might just be that people who wash out have time to post and people doing ok are on the phone. If you're captive or came up captive, how much of it is fair? and what do independent guys always get wrong about your side?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vz10ku/why_does_captive_get_so_much_hate verses Brokerage/

↳ notatipo (12): "I work at a brokerage in life. I have gotten people approved with one of 40 carriers I have that would have been turned down everywhere else. If I was captive at one of 97.5% of these carriers, I would have had to say "sorry" instead of "you'll receive your policy packet in the mail." That's the root issue with captive. Regarding strictly comp, having to buy leads isn't fun. I don't do warm market. Look a few years down the line if you're producing even low six figures in AP, paying \$50-80 per lead at ~100% commission sounds a lot more fun than 40% with some marginal guarantee and no lead spend. It boils down to being able to help the client and your goals and risk tolerance."

↳ MoPhunk60 (6): "As a former captive agent things are great until they aren't. The your only company isnt competitive your close ratio goes way down. On the independent side its a lot easier to find a company that is competitive. Having multiple companies allows a far better opportunity to close business."

↳ SubstantialSea4943 (3): "At the end of the day - people struggle with being captive because they try and sell on price only. If you learn how to sell on value captive becomes real easy. I'm captive and I have personal relationships with my underwriters, my claims adjusters, my actuaries, etc. you don't get that being independent."

"Recent L/H licensed, selling medicare advantage, need career advice So I've been selling Medicare Advantage plans since last summer and it's been good overall. The agency culture is nice, fully remote, warmish inbound leads, good training, decent commission, and I sold 110 policies in AEP. I'm doing well during OEP so far and have averaged 2-3 policies a day. I just got my life license to sell final expense after OEP since many enrollment codes are going away. That being said, commission only is tough, but I'm lucky to have savings and to live with my parents. I don't want to live with them long term and am looking to move out later this year. I know final expense can be good, but I want to see what's out there. Does anyone here work for agencies on a remote basis that offer base + benefits or at least renewals while giving you decent leads? I get \$275 per policy but I have to wait until the policy clears 120 days to get the whole payment (get 50% upfront). I'm realizing that NAC and churn can screw with your pay too. It'd be great if I got some sort of renewal, but they are paying for leads so it's up front commission only. I just have my L/H licenses and I've heard good things about employee benefits too. I have a strong preference for fully remote, but am open to hybrid in San Diego if it's the right opportunity. I also don't want to get involved in MLMs or pitch friends and family. I'd be grateful for your 2 cents. Thanks in advance!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hx3ebv/recent_lh_licensed_selling_medicare_advantage/

↳ [deleted] (2): "You don't get any residual? And this is telesales correct? I have a friend in Medicare but never went into how it works"

↳ [deleted] (1): "May I ask how much commission you get selling MA?"

↳ dbrewster17 (1): "No problem! So it starts out at \$250 and can go up to \$350 based on production (i.e sell 50 polices a month 2x in a row to get \$300 and 70 for \$350). It's not bad we get 50% upfront and 50% 120 days later less chargebacks. Chargebacks and NAC policies suck"

"A joining fee of 200 dollars not for licensing just to recruit you.... you have to pay 250 per month to use there software because its there rules. You have to pay for there leads only that they sell to you. (Not bad but varies, use google) They tell you we will start you at 25% commision then you have to recruit family or friends or people then we will raise your commision to 50%. Sell to family and only sell to family (not a bad thing but please be human about it) but they keep urging you to only sell to friends over and over like a broken record to the point you pitch to family and friends and they leave you because you're being annoying. Hearing key words as lifetime income being streached and always going crazy on hura hura meetings and not actually teaching you how to sell. No one teaches you how a needs analysis works or what it is. Them always saying you will be a millionaire and showing so much money to glorify the idea. Granted yes agents can make this bank but lets think about this logically why are they showing these expensive things to us? Kind of suspisous? Sorry if i have disrespected any agency in any sort of way but this is my unbiased point of view on the industry as a whole."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p1o3ii/if_youre_an_insurance_agent_whats_the_biggest/nprizd4/

"I remember those days. I was trained by big mega life and the thought was just write and see what happens. When I went indie I set my agency up as a traditional life, health and p and c shop. I did a fair amount of health prior to the aca but it was so hard telling people that hey would not get coverage if any pre existing condition. I tried explaining that if you take anything other than Tylenol you were screwed. My wife had a preexisting condition and my state did not allow one man group so I was stuck stay in with golden rule until the aca came out. All the negative talk from family and friends regarding "Obamacare " would infuriate me. You could not explain to people just how bad the lack of a system was. I ended up going to the state exchange for myself so I stopped selling health completely (p and c renewals are my comp) and just started to send clients there. I'm semi retired now and my office does no health at all. But thankfully the aca has not been terminated."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lrh008/lets_remember_what_selling_health_was_like_preaca/n1byrtj/

"Life Insurance - Where to kickstart leads Starting tomorrow in Life insurance and do not want to sell to friends and family now. I have a budget of 10k to kick start my journey. Where would be the best option to start with leads. I've built a lead magnet and plan on running meta ads. Is there anything worth the shot? I'm seeing pregnant women lead at 6\$ a pop, life list at 60\$ a pop or from a comparable platform at 33\$ a pop. Also, in canada should I focus on life or CII is better. I've closed down my previous business to get into this - back against the wall, this as to work."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s150t5/life_insurance_where_to_kickstart_leads/

"Also in our small area we don't have a thriving market for DVH so that's out." Get out of here with that nonsense. DVH is an easy add on and you should be able to close 30% no problem. As for the MAPD's, the carrier doesn't want those plans sold, so find the next best thing that pays and make it happen. Regarding PDP's, it's a courtesy, and you shouldn't expect to get paid on them, you'll get paid by referral business if you do it right, and that is worth so much more than what you get paid. The money is in the grind my man. Just continue to do right by your clients and they will send friends and family to you. That's where you will find success. Don't get caught up selling the cheapest (Ace, Allstate) for obvious reasons, sell the quality product, attach a STC, DVH, HIP. There's plenty of ancillary products complement the health products. Just my two cents."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kotgtz/medicare_agent_commissions/msspech/

"I am physically disabled working from home. I would not be able to work 20-hours a week without bed rest intermediately. As a 1099 for life and health insurance, I'll be doing mock interviews with my family and friends. I plan on doing a lot of research on all of my products and the industry. I'm not worried about leads, because my previous job is resourceful. For someone in my situation, do you have any additional training advice?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vwadgv/independent_agency_owners_what_would_you_do/p5ges4r/

"You dont have to buy leads. You can hit up your warm market, you can get call lists (cheap) and go door knock, etc. Yes leads are great but you don't "need" leads to sell a policy. I began calling lists and setting appointments, and then door knocking those neighbors. Now I operate on referrals and generate all my own leads from various sources. Do you have any capital to spend?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/164ik21/are_there_any_truly_good_life_insurance_companies/jy8zoyl/

"Have a team of few hundred agents , the goal we set for agents is to write at least one policy a day if you are new. If you have been here for more than 90 days 2 policies a day. If you have been here for 6 months 3 policies a day. If you are a veteran agent the goal is 5-10 policies a day. The average policy is to 1000AP. So the question you need to solve first is do you have more time or do you have more money right now? Most agents have a lot more time than money. The next problem is that you need to know how to develop your skillset before you burn all of your marketing capital. You can take the slow route of forming referral partners, warm market, bingo nights etc. unless you are a boring 60yr old who started 20 years ago this isn't the move. Embrace the times, it's all about internet leads, a lead driven business, there is an endless amount of people to talk to and pitch insurance. It has never been easier. When we started it was suits and kitchen tables, now any Gen Z with a laptop and a Stiizy pen can sit in sweatpants with a Stanley and crush \$500-\$1000 a day in deposits like clockwork. It was hard to watch at first considering what use to have to be done, but we have to embrace the times. Tip: start with final expense leads that are less than \$1 , preferably something that is about 15 cents a lead. Yes, it's going to require a ton of dials. You will have to put a bunch of sweat work in before you get paid. I tell my kids , in order for you to start selling 2-3 policies a week in your first month, you need to spend 15 hours a day on the phone for a good 7-10 days in a row to develop some grit. Then someone can start working with you. The next most important thing is who you marry? It's not the IMO , it's not the carrier, it's not the comp plan , you need a solid mentor who can work with you daily and give you feedback. This will cut down the learning curve by 50%, having someone who sells at a high level giving you feedback is priceless. Accept that you can work your tail off and still not make 10k in your first month. That is ok, you are nothing less. Understand that when you have put enough time and reps in the 10k will come easy. Then you will start chasing the 20k, 30k and 40k of Deposits ; it's not that hard to write 10,000-20,000 AP a week. The hardest thing is going from 0-10,000 consistently. Once you have your skill set somewhat polished then you just scale up the marketing. Wish you the best , get after it !"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ouo21x/anybody_here_make_at_least_10k_a_month_in_life/nof72gg/

"That's the way they lie to tell you you not making cold calls, cuz someone has texted them from their family! The agency doesn't give you leads they pay for. They take yours! They asked me for 10 or more of my friends, and family. Shouldn't I be using my own contacts for me, and my possible success? THIS IS A SCHEME! I did this for over a month making thousands of calls to their horrible lead list, that if you delete them all too fast for not answering, you are stuck with no list til they rotate the lists and give you someone else's exhausted list! Money days are ONLY if you write policies! There is no advance as they call it, or bonus! Your manager ain't giving you anything! 9 times out of 10 they wrote 1 or 2 good policies, and were elevated to manager, not having any experience how to manage a team! I am still trying to dig myself out of the whole that they put me in financially! And I quit June of 2024! You are going to get thrown out there to do your first demo, with NO prior practice, and your manager sitting there on the call, basically telling people, she don't know what she doing, which straps the potential customer of all their confidence in you, and they are less like to buy a policy, or share any of their family and friends' information! They, knowing there were no policies to write in MO, hired me, made me pay for the exam, only to tell me they gave nothing in MO! I was furious! Now they wanted me to pay for a Texas license. When I refused they paid for it, but I still never made a dime. DONT WASTE YOUR TIME!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15wc7r0/recently_accepted_a_job_with_globe_life/mhwzr5v/

"I started with Globe & left after 6 months with 2 state licenses. Learned lots but not enough to go solo -- that's not part of the program. Landed at Symmetry as an independent. Now, 8 states and multiple carriers later, I'm learning TONS about all kinds of aspects: Products, sales & genuinely helping people, Customer Service - referrals, warm market and servicing, leads - evaluating vendors, purchasing, engaging & closing, in-depth use of insurance products for retirement & financial security...and the list goes on. Is there a grind? Absolutely, there always is. Am I alone in it? Not even close. I understand your anger...I've been there. My best recommendation is to evaluate what YOU want from this industry and let them go. They couldn't help you then and they won't be helping you now so just drop the extra head trash & move forward to where you want to be. You were fired up enough to write this post. You are fired up enough to find your tribe and run at this business with everything you've got! Wishing you well my friend!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1irtig7/never_work_or_get_lifehealth_through_globe_life/mducvio/

"Sounds like you've been there because you are spot on! I've been there and seen it first hand. Not all of them do the leads buy, but absolutely use friends and family to expand network reach to tap into a new market. There is always a pay to play aspect and very minimal trainings on sales / products because your growth isn't based on sales (some will argue this and they do but they're wrong). Literally, to increase your commission level, you must recruit. You can be the most knowledgeable sales rep and a product guru and if you don't recruit, you are considered a failure. It's all about getting you in in some emotional vulnerability and then keep moving the goal post. I swear I am going to write a book about this one day, I just feel it. It's very predatory. Psychological manipulation all in all."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p1o3ii/if_youre_an_insurance_agent_whats_the_biggest/nps4lyw/

"Worst of all they pay 25%... while NAA, FFL, SFG etc pay more than 3x that at like 80% or higher from day one!!! So they pay 25%, you sell \$100 a month policy that adds up \$1,200 a year or 1200 APV, you get \$300. The other 3 companies i mention you get 80% or \$960 !!!! The other companies want continuous growth so you buy leads, take out \$200-\$400 a deal for leads... now you have \$560 to \$760... When they pay you 25% most people quit after their warm market is destroyed and people avoid you at the BBQ BBQ's lol... me I'd rather buy leads..."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sj0pc6/primerica_almost_got_me/ofq8axv/

"If you don't have a steady stream of leads, you have no business. Warm market burns out fast, if you can get referrals consistently you can keep moving forward. But for me, I needed consistency. I'm on a standing lead order, fresh leads just drop into my crm. I supplement with bonus leads other agents drop the ball with. What access to leads do you have?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdj/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/mz2vz54/

"This is all weird because I just had a call with them. They are unionized. Their leads are all people from unions that have requested information. This "friends and family" lead thing must be a different company."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15wc7r0/recently_accepted_a_job_with_globe_life/ludf0p9/

"THIS! I joined maybe two weeks ago, and they are pretty good salespeople because I was definitely sold into it at first. Purchased my own training, licensing and bought my own leads which they did tell me I had to buy the lower level leads to "get a feel for it" as well. Was pressured into going to their national conference, which was VERY cultish and a lot of toxic positivity like you said and almost nobody would even speak to me because I hadn't made them any money yet. Or even look at me, not kidding they would look at me I would smile at them and they would just turn their head and walk away. First person I called when I bought the leads, the person who answered the phone told me they died 2 years ago and I was told to try to call the widow back after 6 months to see if she wants insurance for herself. What the actual fuck. Goes to show how OLD these leads are and how you're basically cold calling these people and being pushed to try to force them to buy something from you even if they don't want it. Currently trying to get out of it but I just feel so bad for my upline who is very nice but very immersed in this company, and I can tell she so badly wants the approval of these people and I was the first person she recruited who stuck around and she was just so excited and seems like she really wants me to succeed. I just feel like I didn't sign up for most of this, and was told one thing and am now being told a different thing. Like in my interview, they said I will not have to call my friends and family and are now asking me to call my friends and family. I don't want to and will not go broke doing this, or forfeit my integrity. I just feel so stupid lol"

— r/Insurance · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/Insurance/comments/1klwvqp/do_not_join_symmetry_financial_group_heres_the/n98m1gl/

"I see you've accepted the position. Congratulations. A few red flags here obviously. I would always ask the person interviewing how long they've been with the company. If they start saying things like "a year" or "9 months" and they're all of a sudden an agency manager that's usually MLM red flag. Also, if they start going into how they have a top producer who makes hundreds of thousands a quarter (usually they'll have "proof" of this that they will offer to show with you asking) then that is of course a red flag for MLM. If those two things check out and never come up, then your real issue becomes how does the agency source leads. Globe life, for example, will hire anyone and everyone willing to pay for their license then once they start, they're told to sell their family and friends insurance products. After that well runs dry, which for anyone with a backbone would be immediately because selling insurance to your family is corny as hell, then you're going to find out what it costs to legally speak to people about insurance products. Whether that be time or money. From what I've gathered with Colonial, you're going to be speaking with a lot of local businesses that have been pitched by the company and many others such as Aflac multiple times. It's not easy. If you really enjoy rejection, then it's insanely fun. There aren't too many "fresh" leads in B2B insurance sales. Also if they make you fill out an activity log, don't do it, it's their way of stealing any active promising leads."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wosqpi/colonial_life_agency_manager_question/pbx6jja/

Uplines, managers and recruiters who misled them · 19 documents · 19 voices

"NEVER work or get life/health through Globe Life 🌐 Worst recruiting experience I have ever had, didn't help with getting license at all, lead me on for weeks, paid everything out of pocket, had to have gallbladder removed right after starting and they told me to kick rocks. Just got off the phone with regional manager yelling and cussing me and they told me because I missed part of training and had a second job (security night shift) that I wasn't committed enough and should go to aflac that "committed" agents are a dime a dozen and they could hire any loser to fill my spot they didn't need me. I have 15+ years sales management and experience I even was on finals for the next great American speak off and I get treated like another entry level sales rep. Even in training they were more focused on the sale rather than the customer. I got into life/health to help people not suffer the same fate I did due to having an emergency hip replacement last year in May. It ruined me financially and cost me my business in adventure tourism. I just wanted to spread knowledge on the importance of coverage and actually get customers what they need, not just get their money for my own benefit like Globe Life's primary focus. I'm just pissed right now, dumped money I really couldn't afford at the time on the things I needed to be successful, the class, the license, everything and for nothing. Now I don't even know what to do with this license because 99% of the recruiters I talk to are still just wanting people for MLM crap or straight up scams. Just wanted to rant, if anyone sees this that is legit contact me. If you put me in a position to take EVERY contract from my local globe life offices I will make it my personal mission to take their business."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1irtig7/never_work_or_get_lifehealth_through_globe_life/

↳ Expert-Difficulty605 (7): "I worked business 2 business for 5 months and for me I was miserable. I made the switch to med Insurance for seniors and for me it's been night and day. I feel like I'm truly helping helping people who get lost in the shuffle"

↳ Unhappy_Corgi_6838 (6): "Sorry to hear about your experience. I recently got my life/health license through Bankers life and I'm having a similar experience. Haven't even made a prospect call yet and can't even sell until I do a 3-day training class 2 hours away from my home. It looks like the Insurance job market (really every industry) is filled with MLM companies and low paying call center contract jobs."

↳ katieintheozarks (6): "I was with Bankers Life for 2 weeks and quit in part because of their hard sell system and cold calls. Also I explicitly asked for work at home and then I was told I wouldn't be able to work at home. I interviewed six different places and landed with symmetry which is completely work at home and the outside leads are amazing. Jump ship. Every other company I interviewed with was better than Bankers Life."

"Beware of MLM structured companies (warning) So this was originally a response to a comment on this sub, but I see a ton of new people coming into insurance, (speaking to independent guys here) and there are many many hungry wolves waiting to recruit these naïve noobs and make a profit. So, I figured I could make a post using some of the content from my previous response to explain the caveats and expose the reality of these places. I come from a MLM originally, it was unbenounced to me at the time, but I'm still grateful because it gave me a first hand glance at what goes on there. How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. They will push you to build a team, because hey, don't you wanna make 6 figures "bro"??? Well then you gotta build a huge team so you get all those overrides off the guys under you. Now, there's nothing wrong necessarily with building a team, but in a MLM context and the way they act in a deceptive manner it is extremely unethical. The guys you see writing 100k plus in premium a year??? A fraction of that fell of the books and was a chargeback, then that guy like all of us has to pay taxes at the end of the year. He also probably was buying \$500 worth of leads a week. Burned gas every day meeting clients. He "maybe" profited 40k that year, and that's being generous. But as long as they can show boat how much premium they're writing a week? A month? A year? Then shove the rhetoric down new guys throats, boasting about how they too can make 100k a year? Then they're all good. I found out through a credible source, as well as David Dufford (has a youtube channel, good tips and insight for insurance) that alot of these "top producers" buy the trips that you can win with insurance carriers for writing a lot of AP. They do all of this and sugar coat their actual earnings because you'll buy the dream, go sell sell sell, and the guys above you get all the overrides off of you without investing any of their money into you at all. It's a fucking amazing model for the guys at the top to make a killing. They create a strong sense of family at those places to keep you on board as well. They push shitty products like Americo a ton too, because they get higher commissions off of that. Americo is also pricey, and you can easily find a cheaper product for that senior to actually help them out, but more than likely they won't have many cheap options that actually are economical for the client, because then you, and them get a lower commission. So MLM's will typically encourage you to get a higher premium out of the client and force a pricey carrier on them. Hope this helps. Reputable, ethical IMO's that offer you high commission contracts and don't push you to build teams are harder to find, because they don't market and recruit. Join an insurance forum, those guys are veterans and a lot of the IMO/Brokerage owners are members there. I've been in Life Insurance for a while now, and am branching into Health/Medicare, so anyone can feel free to PM me with Life Insurance questions if you'd like. Also it would be cool to maybe post any experiences you've had with these types of organizations."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/n4hblb/beware_of_mlm_structured_companies_warning/

↳ pdxoss (6): "I hate MLM too but if someone is making 100k and paying for leads/gas, taxes etc. Their take home isn't 40%. They're going to write off marketing expenses, gas, and everything they can on taxes"

↳ coreyjacrispy (5): "Haha, not specifically, they are are a known MLM company though. Them, Primerica, Symmetry etc etc. Anytime they're trying to force the Kool aid down your throat, with generic phrases and lectures like "You can take this and be BIG man, BIG...you want to have complete financial freedom? Be on your own clock? WE give you the tools to do that! We are a family, and want everyone to succeed" Blah blah blah lol, rest assured knowing they are indeed a MLM company."

↳ Tahoptions (3): ">How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. That is only for simplified products like final expense and mortgage protection. Street is no where near 120% for most traditional products. It is much closer to 85-100% (for term/GUL/IUL) and even lower for permanent products from big mutuals like Guardian and Mass. The post is a good warning though."

"I watched the FX vid that was posted here and he talked about a rogue agent writing 40k of bad business and fleeing the country. My Assurant regional manager told me a better one. Assurant came out with a feature where if an app was instantly approved - meaning the second you submitted the app it was approved without any UW, you got 12 months advanced commission. What could go wrong? A new agent signed up his entire network of friends. They chose the most expensive plans, listed zero health conditions and all were auto-approved, earning him \$48,000 in commissions. His friends all then cancelled the policies during the 10 day free look. His MGA apparently didn't think it was a flag that a new agent wrote that much in two weeks. Every dime was charged back to the MGA who had to file BK over it and the agent went off to Mexico."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lrh008/lets_remember_what_selling_health_was_like_preaca/n1b228y/

"Well... fuck it. Put the IMO on blast so we know who are scammers are who aren't. Ah just kidding I would never want to "break the rules of a subreddit!" Some things rhyme though and many things share the same acronym entirely unrelated!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1t9nf3b/seeking_advice_as_a_new_agent_struggling/ol4hk95/

"Is it necessary for independent agents to have an immediate upline? I've contracted with two different FMOs. On an application from one of my life carriers it asks me to list my immediate upline. My marketing person from the FMO the carrier is under told me I could put them (if I agreed). But I contracted with the other FMO first so idk if that makes them my upline or what 😬"

— YouTube · What Is The Best FMO or IMO For New Medicare Agents? · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XzJoCuAyo94&lc=Ugz6_5neTHWdTv4k3MB4AaABAg

"I didn't even make it to my first training with them. They had me sit in on a "mandatory" Zoom meeting (seriously? For 1099's?), which was an absolute shit-show of some agents making calls, others talking to one-another, and still others dicking around on video games--all at the same time, and with nothing muted. I couldn't take it. It also told me that nearly everything the recruiter had told me had been lies (a 30-hour week? Only 30 leads to call each week, and all of them union members who are sitting around twiddling their thumbs waiting for your call to complete their enrollment in benefits they're already signed up for? Cool! Easy money), which is why I opted out right then-and-there. Another thing about AIL I found to be VERY fishy was their requiring me to find a friend or associate to fill out an application and include all their personal information so that I could be appointed. When I asked what would then happen with the information, I was told not to worry, that it was just something necessary to be appointed and my friend, etc. wouldn't be liable for anything or be purchasing a policy. To this I asked why we can't just fudge things with made up info, but was told that "the system" wouldn't recognize it as a real person if we did. I also asked what happened to the information, and was told that it "...just goes to the company!" "And then what?" "Oh, I don't know, don't worry though!" Uh, when it comes to either mine or other people's personal information, yes, I worry. You may also want to take a look at all the BBB complaints against the company, of which there are shitloads. Though I realize that yes, AIL may be as legit as they come, I still don't like that they continuously speak of "uplines and downlines" since I'm leery of MLMs, and I sure as HELL ain't interested in having to lie to others to recruit them!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/164ik21/are_there_any_truly_good_life_insurance_companies/koigwvj/

"I'm not talking about earning potential/possibilities. But math like: \$10 cost per lead, 50% contact ratio, 20% closing ratio, \$780 avg AP, 75% comp with standard 75% advance = \$338.75 net/\$438.75 gross per \$100 spent on ads. Clearly numbers are taken out of thin air as an example and will differ on number of factors. But if one comes into this industry and operates (and is familiar with) with those metrics, as opposed to intangible "great leads" and "amazing income opportunity", he'll be much better off. Here's an example: one IMO heavily pushes that anyone who's able to simply read their script will close 50% of the appointments. And their leads have 25/40/80% booking ratio depending on the tier (age). Free money printer, ain't it? Put anyone who can't even spell the word "deductible" and he should be mansion-shopping in no time. Even if you discount those numbers by half to account for lack of experience. But they conveniently don't mention that leads have ~25% contact ratio. When agents struggle? Buy more leads! You may be a couple dials away from your big break! So new agent, who doesn't know any better and operates with the zero-to-hero story in his mind, will keep on going till he's broke without knowing that numbers wouldn't work out for him to begin with. Point being, I'm talking about basic/general point of reference and means to put the numbers together. So one can make better decisions based on factual information and have the means to understand that if 1/150 dials end up in a quote, it's very likely that there's nothing wrong with them, but leads just aren't as great as the recruiter promised."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/mlyvds3/

"I'm interested in seeing what responses you get, as in my experience, nobody is really compensating agents fairly right now. Additionally there's legislation in the pipeline that will more than likely have a lot of FMO's and IMO's closing up for Medicare sales as they won't be able to charge administrative fees (from my understanding) on top of taking a cut of your commissions. I've also been encountering a lot of MLM sounding "agencies." They become easier to spot once you recognize their goal is to recruit lol. The one thing I can't stand is these agencies refusing to release your appointments for months. For that I will definitely recommended staying far away from Assurance IQ who recruits agents by outright lying about the commissions you'll be looking forward to and then now looking to hold appointments for 120 days! Anyhow, good luck! Hoping we get some more optimistic answers in here lol."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1b3t4hx/been_out_of_the_medicare_sales_game_for_2_years/ksvk3d/

"So here's a funny twist in my insurance journey. I've been grinding, trying to build my agency, and for months I've been researching CRMs and dialers. I finally pulled the trigger and bought Ringy because everyone kept recommending it. Fast forward to this week... and I randomly discover I actually had access to Integrity's CRM, dialer, and lead marketplace the whole time for free through one of the agencies I'm contracted with. No one ever mentioned it. I literally stumbled into the dashboard by accident while looking for something else. Wild. I paid for a CRM meanwhile I already had access to one but my upline never brought it up. Smh Not mad about it though, just sharing in case any newer agents don't realize some FMOs/IMOs automatically give you tools like CRMs, dialers, quoting platforms, or lead systems that they never bother to highlight. Definitely worth double-checking what's included with your contracts before you go spending on extra software. If anyone else has had this happen or knows hidden features inside Integrity's system, drop some tips. I'm already finding stuff I didn't even know existed. However, I am going to keep the ringy platform. I really like the drip system they have for text and email and other features"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1odlyvq/solo_insurance_agent_looking_for_a_crm_dialer/no7l9a4/

"I only been the office a few times. I was referred by a buddy of mine. The branch manager told me about a training class at one location and then another 2 hours away from home when I missed the first initial one due to failing my L&H the first time. All my onboarding training is done and I'm just..waiting on an email regarding actually starting. I know starting out is very difficult bc you're basically starting your own book of business with their provided leads/training. I already been offered two contracts from different statefarm agencies so I may just have to start off captive to gain experience."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1irtig7/never_work_or_get_lifehealth_through_globe_life/mdehm9h/

"crabtrap said: Is it advisable to sell for more than one IMO/FMO? There are a few products not offered by my IMO and I would like to have them as an option to better serve the customer. Personal preference. Some say to not have all your contracts with one IMO but I prefer to have all of mine with one. But if they didn't carry a company I wanted I would pick it up elsewhere. I happen to be with an IMO, {FEX}, that will grant releases if I wanted to leave. If you are not with one that will release then it's a whole different ballgame. I certainly would not put all my contracts with an IMO that won't release. ----- crabtrap said: Is it advisable to sell for more than one IMO/FMO? There are a few products not offered by my IMO and I would like to have them as an option to better serve the customer. Personal preference. Some say to not have all your contracts with one IMO but I prefer to have all of mine with one. But if they didn't carry a company I wanted I would pick it up elsewhere. I happen to be with an IMO, {FEX}, that will grant releases if I wanted to leave. If you are not with one that will release then it's a whole different ballgame. I certainly would not put all my contracts with an IMO that won't release."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Selling for Multiple IMO/FMO'S · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/selling-for-multiple-imo-fmos.70645/#post-929096>

"jdeasy said: Personal preference. Some say to not have all your contracts with one IMO but I prefer to have all of mine with one. But if they didn't carry a company I wanted I would pick it up elsewhere. I happen to be with an IMO, {FEX}, that will grant releases if I wanted to leave. If you are not with one that will release then it's a whole different ballgame. I certainly would not put all my contracts with an IMO that won't release. ----- Personal preference. Some say to not have all your contracts with one IMO but I prefer to have all of mine with one. But if they didn't carry a company I wanted I would pick it up elsewhere. I happen to be with an IMO, {FEX}, that will grant releases if I wanted to leave. If you are not with one that will release then it's a whole different ballgame. I certainly would not put all my contracts with an IMO that won't release. Click to expand... Hmmm, I've sent two emails over the past few days requesting a release from just one carrier, all I've heard is crickets."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Selling for Multiple IMO/FMO'S · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/selling-for-multiple-imo-fmos.70645/#post-929350>

"heffhawk said: Thanks again for the input. I haven't sold much health insurance and this forum is a tremendous help. They continue to call me(pitch me) to get contracted, even though they won't tell me specific products, lead system, etc.. The recruiter basically told me to get contracted and then he'll talk specifics. You'll get a lot of highly enthusiastic pitches. Step One: Be very skeptical, step two, run it by the BBB and search for the scam. Step three: repeat step one!"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Anyone Heard of USHealth Advisors? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/anyone-heard-of-ushealth-advisors.33531/#post-454456>

"Thanks again for the input. I haven't sold much health insurance and this forum is a tremendous help. They continue to call me(pitch me) to get contracted, even though they won't tell me specific products, lead system, etc.. The recruiter basically told me to get contracted and then he'll talk specifics."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Anyone Heard of USHealth Advisors? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/anyone-heard-of-ushealth-advisors.33531/#post-421238>

"heffhawk said: They continue to call me(pitch me) to get contracted, even though they won't tell me specific products, lead system, etc.. The recruiter basically told me to get contracted and then he'll talk specifics. Haha, no red flag there."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Anyone Heard of USHealth Advisors? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/anyone-heard-of-ushealth-advisors.33531/#post-421241>

"Quitting after a month, am I alone in feeling this way? I think I just need to vent. 3 months ago I applied for a P&C producer position at a new Farmers agency that was opening in my town. Agent had a book in a different state and sold it to restart in my town where he is from. There are already 2 Farmers agents here in a town of roughly 15k people, this would be the 3rd. The recruiter told me there's big money in it and when I questioned him on having 3 agencies in a town this size where there are already several established agencies, he assured me there is plenty of business to go around. Pay is \$1500 base, 8% home and specialty, 7% auto, 30% life. I had, and have, no reference points on those numbers but I had no experience in insurance sales. Got licensed. Got started. First couple weeks were ok, but red flags started popping up. I thought it was odd I had to pay for my own background check, but chalked it up to it being a 1099 position which I have never had and maybe that's how it's done. Few days later, the agent tells me they ran the background check through his old agency and state and I would need to pay for a new background check. Pretty dumb mistake, and don't understand why it can't just be fixed or why he can't foot the bill since it was not my mistake, but I say ok. After a 2 week delay in start day, I finally get started. I've had plenty of jobs where you begin by watching hours of mind-numbing safety/training videos, but this was something else. The agent gives me a 10 minute crash course on Farmers quoting platform, which is completely convoluted and unintuitive, then sets me up in an office to watch a couple of Farmers agents teach a "one-call masterclass". I'm sure what they are teaching is tried and tested, but I spent 3 days going through this course and I have no idea at all what I am selling. No intimate knowledge of MY product. Just general knowledge. The pre-license courses teaches you plenty about what insurance is, how policies are made up and the different components....but I knew nothing of Farmers products. No details. What's the difference between rental and rental alternative? Roadside and enhanced roadside? Didn't know until 2 weeks in that Farmers has a \$100 glass deductible, and then the agent couldn't tell me if it covered all the glass on the vehicle or just the windshield, and how big the crack had to be before it's covered. I didn't know that if you bundle the roadside, rental and glass there is a discount. It took a full day to get Farmers home deductibles rules straightened out, wind/hail deductibles, when to put personal property on open vs broad named perils, and all kinds of other things. I came in with a notebook and multiple ink pens ready to take notes and soak up all kinds of info specific to Farmers. Like WHAT THE FUCK AM I GOING TO BE SELLING? I need to know more than the people I'm selling to. I know experience is a big thing, I don't need to know EVERYTHING day one, but for christ sake teach me something about the products. Then, Farmers is sky high on rates right now. Maybe they always have been? I can't sell a Farmers policy to save my life. And I know I'm new to insurance, but I've been in sales for 10 years. I know some sales savvy and how to talk to people, how to discover pain points and sell to my strengths and sell myself. Even with my experience, I followed the sales scripts and even made some of my own with some AI help. I'm dialing 5 warm home and 5 warm auto every morning, not one answer. Then I dialed around 100-150 cold leads. Absolutely useless. Come to find out the agent is purchasing \$5 leads that seem to have been recycled and several weeks old at best, pedaled to probably 10 other agencies. Ricky Roma couldn't sell this shit. So he switched and started purchasing \$15/pop leads. That lead to more quotes, but the price is too high. I can persuade a sale based on (what I have been told) is Farmers strong claims experience and payout record mixed with a steady rate. But when I am \$50-\$100/month higher on auto, or similar on homes but I require a 2% wind/hail deductible, what do I do? People buy on price, and my value proposition has to be much more than "I'll pay out" to justify someone paying that much more. And Farmers reconstruction cost on homes through 360Value is really high, which is good imo, but people hear that number and just think "how much cheaper would my insurance be if I only had 75% of that". Or "you expect me to pay \$8k dollars if I have a wind/hail claim while living in tornado alley?" Combine all of this with my agent trying a new phone system (RingCentral) that anytime you connect with a person the first thing they hear is "this call is being recorded" followed by a reminder beep every 15 seconds. If people ever do pick up, it's an immediate hang up. So we switch back to another system and he only wants to pay for one account with 4 lines. So every time one of us dial out, it goes to all 4 phones until one of us claim that call. Inbounds don't ring, you have to either be looking at your phone to see the flash or be on the right web page to see it say inbound. And I don't really want to get on a rant about Bristol West. I have no experience with them, they may be great, but they have terrible reviews online. And this agent wants me and my friends and family to get signed up with them because they are cheap. But my whole sales spiel for Farmers is "the cheapest rate is usually the cheapest coverage". I don't want to set people up on this if it's junk coverage. To anyone, but especially my friends and family. Finally, we have done nothing in the way of community outreach. Maybe that's the wrong term but literally no one knows we are here. He got the Google page going and got some reviews which has been great. But we are on a state highway outside of city limits, we have no signage, we are not joined with the chamber of commerce, and we have not networked with any real estate or car lots or mortgage companies at all. I personally made up some flyers for a few lawyers offices, accounting firms, and banks. I went out on my dime and canvassed. In all, I feel this agent thought because he was successful as his previous location, it would be the same here. But a lack of teaching and instruction, cheaping out on equipment and leads, lack of community visibility and no plan in place for a slow start has me looking elsewhere. This is my livelihood, I'm not lazy or complacent. Every single person I talk to I give my all. And maybe that's a problem, I come across too eager. But I have listened back to my calls. I ask my coworker to as well. I ask my wife too. I feel like P&C personal lines is dead for agent sales. All I've ever done is get online and collect quotes myself. It's not that hard. I don't want to speak to people. And if I have to, I'm sure as hell not going with a higher quote because they promise their product is better. Everyone says that. And this agent is living and dying by personal lines. He swears by it. Says it's so much easier to sell. I disagree. So I've been trying to focus the past few weeks on commercial. Met a few business owners who gave me the chance to quote their commercial autos. Sent their current policies, price and all. Yeah, Farmers was \$2k, \$3k and \$1800 a year higher for exact matching policies. That changed minimally when I upped their deductibles. Maybe I'm in a bad area or maybe I'm talking to subprime candidates or maybe I am just a shit salesman. I feel I would be a better fit if I had joined an established agency and learned that way. Maybe. Anyway, I'm being headhunted by a loan company and I'm seriously considering going to a W-2 position. I'm sure there are plenty of cons there as well though."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 13 upvotes · new or aspiring agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p0s3n8/quitting_after_a_month_am_i_alone_in_feeling_this/

↳ Heavy_Following_1114 (18): "Sounds like the typical insurance experience. Seen too many people think it was going to be a walk in the park because they had prior sales experience. There's a reason 90% of agents fail in their first 3 years. A very very small percentage succeed"

↳ eric199479 (11): "I know this is the insurance agent subreddit so I may catch some heat here, but this seems very common. I know we are told to sell on value not price, but the fact is most of these bad leads we get filled out an ad online for cheap insurance. And they get hammered with calls from every agent in the state for different companies. They don't care that they get better coverage on your quote if it is more expensive. Sure there are outliers, I have successfully sold on value before, but that is hard to do. And this is assuming they even answer. You can make great money in insurance but it is a grind and in this age of internet leads and being able to get a quote from anyone at any time, selling on value is old news, at least for these type of cheap leads"

↳ mkuz753 (10): "Your concerns are valid. I suggest looking up independents near you. They sell almost any type of insurance."

"Why i left the life insurance industry Here is the story as to why I left the life insurance industry as a whole and I'm going to let my license expire on December 31st, 2024. I saw somewhere that you can make 10k a month selling life insurance. I was hooked. I took the pre-licensing course and got my state license. I then got with an agency and the recruiter told me that the leads were exclusive and pre-qualified meaning I didn't have to do any cold calling or door knocking. I was even more hooked. This seemed too good to be true. I start working at the agency and the first alarm bell goes off in my head. I have to pay for leads. I asked my spline about this and he said the reason they cost money is because they are high quality leads. I said hm okay, so I purchased them. Turns out the leads were aged, recycled, and most of them claimed to never have shown an interest in life insurance, including usage of foul language and making threats to get law enforcement involved. I made no money, helped no families and was extremely dissatisfied. And mind you, my upline told me that the leads were exclusive and the best in the industry. What. Lie. I left that agency and got with another one. They also told em the same thing as the previous agency. No cold calling, no door knocking, we provide you with the best high quality leads in the industry with a blah blah closing ratio. Once again, the leads cost money but this time they were 1 month old instead of 3. I said hm okay, what can go wrong? Well, turns out that this agency was worse than the previous one. Once again despite me being told that the leads were high quality, I got ghosted a lot, cancelled appointments, loss of interest due to not being able to afford it, people claiming that they had never shown an interest in life insurance, insulting me and making threats over the phone. The whole thing was even worse than working retail during holiday season. This time, I lost \$1,000 buying E&O coverage, fingerprint background check, and overpriced leads that ended up not even working out. This is when reality hit me that this is not an industry I want to be in. At this point in my career I had felt the dirtiest I had ever felt and I wasn't even making any money to justify it. I was LOSING money while being treated like garbage by angry prospects. I rage quit that job. I ended up going to a THIRD agency because "third time's a charm". This company did not make you pay for leads, however, it had a very similar business structure as Herbalife and amway where you have to recruit. You have to ask your friends, family, neighbors, and social media followers if they are interested in working. Once again, I made no money, people knew it was a pyramid scheme and lost a couple of friends because they didn't want to deal with my sales tactics. This was it. I said I'm done. I'm done with insurance and I'm done with sales. I ended up going back to community college for an associates in I.T (paid for with FAFSA federal pell grants) and I'm also studying for my CompTIA certifications to work in the I.T industry and I could not be happier with my decision. Till this day I still get messages and calls from recruiters trying to hit me with the same "we are seeking licensed agents. No cold calling. We have the most exclusive leads in the industry" & it fills me with so much rage how stupid they think I am to fall for their nonsense again. Insurance sales recruiters are straight up liars and they seem to feel no shame towards it. Finally, a lot of them love to promote the lavish luxury lifestyle to reel people in. I also don't care about that. I am happy with what I have. Family and health is more important to me than some Tesla Model 3."

— r/LifeInsurance · 83 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/LifeInsurance/comments/1eqogok/why_i_left_the_life_insurance_industry/

↳ Prowlthang (29): "I understand the first agency not being good. The second, not so much but I can see it. By the third company where you seem to have taken the mlm route I'd surmise you're not very good at asking questions or making good decisions. You need to find a place and people who will teach you the basics. Unfortunately a lot of scummy organizations and people out there."

↳ lifeapprentice23 (26): "Welcome to sales. Take that license go get a job working for an agency that sells auto and home insurance. Lots of families in those books that need life insurance that have never been approached. With an existing license you can have a job next week."

↳ NAF1138 (20): "I'm almost positive I've read this exact same story, like almost word for word, before. Maybe not on Reddit? Maybe on Facebook. But... Exactly the same. I'm sorry you had a bad time and ended up in bad situations. Sucks for you."

"Why I left the life insurance industry I posted this in r/insurance but i'm going to post it here too. Here is the story as to why I left the life insurance industry as a whole and I'm going to let my license expire on December 31st, 2024. I saw somewhere that you can make 10k a month selling life insurance. I was hooked. I took the pre-licensing course and got my state license. I then got with an agency and the recruiter told me that the leads were exclusive and pre-qualified meaning I didn't have to do any cold calling or door knocking. I was even more hooked. This seemed too good to be true. I start working at the agency and the first alarm bell goes off in my head. I have to pay for leads. I asked my spline about this and he said the reason they cost money is because they are high quality leads. I said hm okay, so I purchased them. Turns out the leads were aged, recycled, and most of them claimed to never have shown an interest in life insurance, including usage of foul language and making threats to get law enforcement involved. I made no money, helped no families and was extremely dissatisfied. And mind you, my upline told me that the leads were exclusive and the best in the industry. What. Lie. I left that agency and got with another one. They also told em the same thing as the previous agency. No cold calling, no door knocking, we provide you with the best high quality leads in the industry with a blah blah closing ratio. Once again, the leads cost money but this time they were 1 month old instead of 3. I said hm okay, what can go wrong? Well, turns out that this agency was worse than the previous one. Once again despite me being told that the leads were high quality, I got ghosted a lot, cancelled appointments, loss of interest due to not being able to afford it, people claiming that they had never shown an interest in life insurance, insulting me and making threats over the phone. The whole thing was even worse than working retail during holiday season. This time, I lost \$1,000 buying E&O coverage, fingerprint background check, and overpriced leads that ended up not even working out. This is when reality hit me that this is not an industry I want to be in. At this point in my career I had felt the dirtiest I had ever felt and I wasn't even making any money to justify it. I was LOSING money while being treated like garbage by angry prospects. I rage quit that job. I ended up going to a THIRD agency because "third time's a charm". This company did not make you pay for leads, however, it had a very similar business structure as Herbalife and amway where you have to recruit. You have to ask your friends, family, neighbors, and social media followers if they are interested in working. Once again, I made no money, people knew it was a pyramid scheme and lost a couple of friends because they didn't want to deal with my sales tactics. This was it. I said I'm done. I'm done with insurance and I'm done with sales. I ended up going back to community college for an associates in I.T (paid for with FAFSA federal pell grants) and I'm also studying for my CompTIA certifications to work in the I.T industry and I could not be happier with my decision. Till this day I still get messages and calls from recruiters trying to hit me with the same "we are seeking licensed agents. No cold calling. We have the most exclusive leads in the industry" & it fills me with so much rage how stupid they think I am to fall for their nonsense again. Insurance sales recruiters are straight up liars and they seem to feel no shame towards it. Finally, a lot of them love to promote the lavish luxury lifestyle to reel people in. I also don't care about that. I am happy with what I have. Family and health is more important to me than some Tesla Model 3."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 46 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dt0fnh/why_i_left_the_life_insurance_industry/

↳ [deleted] (24): "Honestly the MLM bullshit is a real problem in the industry today. There are still some good employers out there that don't pull these stunts they are not very easy to find though. Good luck with IT I'm actually an Agency IT manager and IT is really fucking bad these days"

↳ Tahoptions (13): "Being an insurance agent is starting your own business. You have to pay for leads with either your money or your time. Anyone promising "free" leads is normally a complete scam (because any agency owner would just hire w2 employees to work the leads instead). The largest IMOs/agencies in the industry give you nothing but contracts (Crump, Ash, Simplicity, etc.) No recruiting or bullshit to make money. The rest is up to you."

↳ GOLDEN_KEYS_GAMING (12): "It's not cut out for everyone. I planted my flag in the financial industry and honestly it's a war of attrition the people who can make it past 3 years will win by default because the turnover rate is so high. Most people just never figure out how to make money. I don't care if you're independent, IMO, MLM, ABC, NBC you're not gonna make it if you can't persevere through charge backs, team mates quitting, dark houses, no shows cancelations, living and dying with every deal. I didn't give myself any options I had a wife and kids and I quit a 6 figure job to do this it was this or homeless and my upline was ass I didn't know anybody in the city I lived in because I had just moved there and I had no idea where to start. But guess what? I figured it out. I got licensed in multiple states got securities licensed and mortgage licensed and developed a strategy around only dealing with clients who have to buy my products and built a solid Referral business now my monthly residual is approaching, 6 figures a year. And I've only been in the business 2 and a half years. But I just got things figured out 6 months ago. It's not for everyone but it was definitely for me. come hell or high water I'm gonna make a million a year and now I'm gaurenteed to get there because of my strategy."

"Life Agents, how much premium are you selling every month? What products are you working with? I sell Final Expense it is an easy sale, though retention can be iffy (25% chargeback). I'm also in the health industry. I mainly work in person with cheap FE leads, and I set up events and have regular gigs around my town for health. I also pay for inbound leads a day or 2 a week for \$50/each (30% close rate). My main issue with FE would probably be the class of client, typically being low income and old. I have no issue with the product but Im not sure this is why I really got into it, to sell burial insurance to low income seniors. My FMO is pushing IUL and Annuities and such and Im always hearing about group and mortgage protection. I really don't know how to go about working them or what would be worth the pivot. I can do an FE sale on a 20-45 minute phone call or under hour in someone's home. There really isn't anything complicated about it. But some of the other products seem like a different beast. What are you guys selling? How much premium are you selling usually on a monthly basis? How do you work them? What should I look into?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mg7yiy/life_agents_how_much_premium_are_you_sellin_g/

↳ DavidDuford (4): "If FE wasn't a niche, I'd be working the business market for life insurance (voluntary payroll deduct for life/health, life sales to key person/business owners)."

↳ Vast-Gate8866 (2): "I sell Medicare advantage, Sups, ACA, and FE. Gearing up for AEP now. From February on up until now, I focus on FE. Hoping to write 30-50k in new business this AEP. This will be year 4 for me. The residual income is nice. I always stay in contact with my current clients through the year, so they can't be poached. Have to keep them happy all year. You do what it takes. I will say, the first couple years can be hard. Stick with it, keep grinding and you will be rewarded. First year I only made about 20k. Thankfully I had the perfect job, working 3 12 hour shifts a week in a warehouse."

↳ Vast-Gate8866 (2): "I've never paid for any leads. I have done a lot of dialing on certain days."

Clients who get angry when they are called · 16 documents · 16 voices

"8 Tips for New Agents to Sell Insurance Successfully Below I've compiled a list of 8 strategies imperative for new agents to execute on, if you want to see success selling insurance, regardless of the agency, niche, or product you sell. Here they are: # 1. Clear the Calculator Selling insurance is largely a mental game. In other words, you have to keep your emotions and focus in check at all times. This means you must not allow distractions from your personal life or sales calls gone sideways to affect your mindset. Here's some tips that have helped me stay mentally sharp: * Treat every sales call as a fresh start. Getting rejected on one sales call doesn't mean you'll get rejected on the next. * It's helpful to think of your clients rejecting **your offer**, not you. The rejection is business, not personal. * Maintain balance in your personal life—exercise, eat well, and manage relationships. Mental clarity fuels sales success. # 2. Eliminate Distractions Selling insurance is great, but especially those who sell remotely, it comes with endless distractions. To stay focused: * Set clear boundaries with family—work time is **work time**. Make sure your spouse and kids respect this. * Keep your phone muted and out of reach during work hours. Group your texts and calls to a scheduled time. Most of them can wait. * Social media and internet use while you should be selling kills productivity. Consider a low-cost app like Freedom.to limit internet access while you should be working. # 3. Prioritize Activity Over Everything Activity leads to "app-tivity." In other words, tracking your numbers is critical to uncovering opportunities to improve your results. Try tracking these metrics daily: * **Connection Rate** – How many people are you actually getting to pick up the phone? If this number is low, explore dialing technology that helps keep your number off the spam- and telemarketer-likely lists. I like Convoso and Kixie. * **Quality connections** – How many conversations last longer than two minutes? If you're having trouble keeping your prospects on the phone, work on your opening script by practicing objection rebuttals until you can say them on the fly without hesitation. * **Closing rate** – How many policies are you selling compared to presentations? If these numbers are low, adjust your strategy. Retrain your scripting. Success is a numbers AND a skill development game. # 4. Master Your Scripts and Rebuttals The best agents **sound natural** but follow a proven process. If you don't have a script, you're winging it! And winging it doesn't work long-term. A good script consists of the following: * A strong intro that overcomes initial objections while simultaneously helping the client remember that they in fact requested the information you're calling about. * A handful of effective fact-finding questions that help build value and urgency to buy what you're selling. * A good list of underwriting questions that help you figure out which product works best. I like using Insurance Tool Kits for life and final expense policy sales. * How to close confidently. # 5. Stay Consistent with Your Schedule Consistency wins. The more you treat your profession like a job, the better off you'll be. I recommend the following: * Set a fixed start and end time every day. Stay disciplined to this as much as possible. * Avoid checking email or social media during work hours. Schedule a time before and after work for this. * Batch tasks. Separate prospecting, calling, and follow-ups. # 6. Improve After Every Call After a completed sales presentation - whether you sell or not - don't just move on! Analyze what worked and what didn't. Ask yourself the following: * Did I control the conversation? Or did the prospect control the pace? Remember that the person asking questions is in control. * Did I handle objections smoothly? If you're stumbling in your script, practice it multiple times until it's smooth. * What could I do better next time? Biggest pro-tip I can offer is to record your sales calls and listen to them. You'll hear all sorts of opportunities to improve =). # 7. Develop Thick Skin Rejection is part of the game. If you get rattled after a bad call, you're losing twice. Keep moving. Instead, think about the following: * If someone hangs up? Act fast and dial the next lead instead of ruminating. Don't spiral out of control! * If a prospect is rude? Probably like that with everyone. Don't take it personal. Next! * If you get 50 rejections in a row? Think: a sale is that much closer =). # 8. Work Smarter, Not Harder Successful agents **leverage** tools and systems to increase efficiency: * Use a CRM to track leads and follow-ups. AgentCRM is a pretty good CRM to start if your agency doesn't provide it. * Automate tasks where possible such as a chat bot to speak with your leads. Or use a compliant powerdialer to speak with more prospects faster. Again, I like Kixie and Convoso. * Constantly refine your approach based on data. Hope this helps =)"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 84 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kfmhbp/8_tips_for_new_agents_to_sell_insurance/

↳ hawkwood76 (11): "Love it. I will only add If it isn't on our calendar, it doesn't exist."

↳ CGWInsurance (5): "Congrats on doing this for new agents. Extremely well written. I would have put thick skin at either 1 or 2. Seen many leave this industry who rocked everything, but just took everything that was said to them personally and they had to quit for their own mental health."

↳ DavidDuford (2): "Appreciate it. Selling insurance or doing something totally performance-based is not for the faint of heart."

"Main reason I got out of Medicare. I had nightmares about those garbage food/flex cards. I would have people literally cussing me out to get a \$10 increase in their welfare, I give them what they ask and then they say "Its not worth it for such a little increase." I had a soft spot for elderly people, not anymore, they are some major A-holes."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j8srq5/fired_from_my_medicare_advantage_job/mh7vk9p/

"My experience at bankers life as a new agent. I don't understand the distaste. I came across a post after my interview that made me even more skeptical of the job because I've never had a commission based job, didn't have an insurance license, and this would be my first real job after college. Here is the post I read. [https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/194rgk1/has_anyone_heard_of_bankers_life/] (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/194rgk1/has_anyone_heard_of_bankers_life/) I got my license and passed first try (idk how, I studied hard but the exam was harder than I thought, I couldn't see how many I got wrong). It's the beginning of my 4th week, I've made one small sale but I've set appointments with clients that have a lot of money so they're sending an FA to discuss retirement planning. I've made contact with some of these clients, I study really hard, I do what I'm told, and honestly it feels great. I feel like I'm the edge of something that could be really good. I'm good at what I do and I can tell because not only are the managers impressed with me but so are the other agents that are in their first year. I kind of feel like I'm outpacing a lot of my peers but I'm trying to stay humble. I took a chance with these people because I had limited options but I knew that even if this is the worst company I've ever worked with (it's not) then I would at least come out with a resume with more licenses than I came in with, and could take another swing at the job market. I've been getting calls from other companies since I got my license trying to recruit me, I don't listen to them much. I will be an FA in a year or less with this company, I don't intend to leave here unless I go broke (doubtful) or something unforeseen happens. I was extremely apprehensive when I started but I trusted my manager and gave it my all since if I'm going to try, I'm going to try so hard that I will know without a doubt if it is my fault or the company's if I fail. I'm not failing, I'm impressing and improving. People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager) but there's signs everywhere about being a top 125 training company, have I fact checked this? No, but I haven't felt like I needed to. when I feel like it I will. My managers answer all my questions, see me working hard, and include me on appointments that I can't contribute much to, and we still split the sale. The online resources are extensive and cover so much in a very user friendly way, 30-60 minute panels of top producers explaining what worked for them. I am told this is why they are such a highly rated company for its training. I am also told that this is why BL is unique, because it is 1099 commission based but the support is unmatched. I really enjoy this company so far and if I don't start seeing financial results soon (I'm positive I will) then I will remove this post. Maybe after AEP I'll just drop how much money I've made in the comments and pin it or something and we can see how this post ages. I anticipate a couple thousand dollars in the next couple weeks from less than a handful of sales. Someone who's worked in other insurance agencies tell me what I'm missing if this company is so bad? If I'm being cocky then check back in January to see my suffering and plans to go back on Glassdoor. \-sept 27, 2025 UPDATE It's December 17th, I'm going to try to keep this update relevant to my original. For context, I was let go two weeks ago and am not looking back. Issues had been brewing for weeks and I was already interviewing at another company in case I decided I needed to leave, initially, I didn't see myself being fired but as things escalated, I knew I'd be less surprised. I had the confidence in being hired at another company to stay true to my morals in how I dealt with Bankers. I'll talk about why I was let go later in this post. **Since I referred an older post in my original and commented on it, I'm going to dissect what I said and show a newer perspective:** "People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager)" Quoting the linked post, "being 1099 but being treated like an employee..." I still think the user on the linked post is misguided. You are 1099, and I don't know what negatives they were referring to when being "treated like an employee" but I can say that bankers really does do business in person, the initial interview was the only time I had a formal conversation with my bosses online. Working with my managers in person was something I liked, my new job has had more formal conversation over zoom than in person (so far, I don't officially start until January which is another downside over here) and I miss that about bankers. I also liked that the hierarchy of the office was relatively clear cut. My manager knows she is responsible for me. I liked how there was structure to the company, I was told by my managers and in hindsight still agree that this is GOOD and sets bankers aside from the competition. Agreed. My second sentence regarding insurance as far as I know now, is still completely correct. But working for bankers I realized that everything is a sale, hiring people, building confidence in subordinates, getting your manager to like you even if you don't like them. Everything is a game and everyone is playing. All the sales tactics apply in every corner of the office. Now we have "office politics" where generally, every participant is skilled in how to get what they want from other people, so now there is another layer of paranoia I had and I think rightfully so. I have no idea if becoming a manager and qualifying for bankers insurance is as easy as it was laid out in the interview. I can't tell you how many times, big or small, I thought something would be as easy as 1,2,3 because that was the way it was laid out, when in fact there were so many undisclosed micromanagement tasks attached. Some had to do with clients and don't result in being paid. (Prescription drug plans are needed by most of our clients, but we get paid nothing. And I had an experience that took way longer than it should have) **In regards to my overall outlook on bankers as a company and my experience at the time:** I was pretty successful as a new agent I think, I saw people come and go, I got better and was super proud of my accomplishments being a new grad and never having been in sales before but booking more appointments than some of my peers. I was confident and working hard, everyone in the office saw it. Peers would ask me questions and "most" managers were always eager to help. However management was the reason I was fired, after awhile I realized that I knew I would be very successful at this company and would do everything in my power, without hurting anyone, to accomplish my goals. Before I go into why I was let go I want to say that from my perspective, I think bankers as a company could be very good, it may already be a very good company to work for. I think the resources available online is extensive and very very valuable, I do think working face to face with your company is very valuable too. And I think from a baseline, makes bankers a company to consider. For awhile I really enjoyed it, and I was trying really hard not to drink too much "kool-aid" I wanted to stay humble and careful, celebrate my victories at home and not let anyone see anything they could take advantage of. Ultimately, it could be and probably was, my branch that failed me. Not the company. And the branch did fail me. **Here is why I was let go:** As I've said I was a good new agent, and proud of my progress. As I got better and better I became more and more independent. At first I didn't want to meet clients 1 on 1 because I felt so nervous in my capabilities, naturally management wanted me to go on my own and I understood even if I didn't want to. As I went on these appointments I was told I could call my manager "anytime." Sure enough, questions came up, and without disturbing my rapport with the client, would text or call my manager. Eventually the response I would get is "read the agent guide" or "we'll talk about it during our meeting" but I would never know which agent guide I was being referred to and anytime I looked at our resources they would be 40 pages of word salad and fluff that I mostly already knew with a few bits of new information. Not user friendly and certainly not a good use of time when I could be making new clients, working on my current clients, or learning how to present a new product. So the other response was our meeting. 3/5 days during the week we are on appointments, 2/5 days we are in the office and here is the schedule: 8-12 dial, dial, dial. That's it. 12-1 people trickle out o"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nircj1/my_experience_at_bankers_life_as_a_new_agent/

↳ Jonfers9 (14): "Congrats. It's funny you say you're good at what you do...you'll look back in 5 years and think man I didn't know anything back then."

↳ kevymetal87 (9): "A lot of the people knocking Bankers Life (myself included) do so because it's typically not setup for proper success for individuals. Churn and burn. That being said, like any other line of business/industry, there are always some good agents who will help you sincerely, and it sounds like you found one."

↳ Ok-Philosophy-3743 (8): "As in things only get better from here?"

"Agency M&A Market Update Sharing some current intel on the agency M&A market. Everything here is generalities, but current trends you won't see in press releases. I also won't cite multiples, because even within these segments there is a lot of nuance and "what ifs" that have to be answered. But some general intel on if you have an agency in this category, things to consider. **Size Matters** Always has, but many capital buyers are continuing to bump up their targets. If you are sub \$750K revenue then PE buyers aren't as active. Your best bet is another local agency, and the offers won't be the same. Some PE buyers will play in this space, but the offers are super complex with low guarantees and pie in the sky earn out potentials. This has always been the case, but we're seeing less interest from larger buyers in that segment. >\$750K-\$1M, is typically where the interest remains. Majority of large buyers are open to >\$1M EBITDA, so if you are \$2.5M-\$3M+ revenue, the market is dramatically different. If you are a small agency, and want/need the best exit scenario, your primary objective is quality growth. Makes sense to increase the sale of an asset you should increase what makes it valuable, but for some reason people don't make that connection. If you are content with a handshake deal to turn over the keys with an agency across town, great, but don't expect a high sale price. **Medicare and Non-standard P&C Agencies are Super Limited** The population of buyers has dwindled tremendously over the last 12-18 months. Opinion? It's political. Any time there is looming administration change on health care or immigration, these can be volatile. Medicare agencies are constantly facing changing carriers, comp rates, etc. so on a dime a successful agency can be at risk. Just this week a client, large FMO, learned their #2 carrier was pulling out of a territory and they were at risk to lose revenue on 2,000 policies unless they find a replacement this AEP. Buyers know that, and have only been offering low cash proceeds at close and significant rolled equity or growth earn outs. So when you only have a few options, and the options aren't great, it's hard to sell for a good price. Non-standard is similar, in that there are only a handful of large buyers. Even large (>\$3M revenue) non-standard P&C agencies are not getting good offers. So unless sellers have a motivation to get out, many are holding on. Small or local non-standard, practically your only option is selling to someone local or another non-standard. **Personal Lines is Getting Slightly Less Interest Compared to Last Year** Many large buyers are changing their buy-box criteria to focus on a minimum book mix, so unless an agency has a minimum of 30%-50% CL, many of the larger buyers aren't excited. That's not saying they aren't sellable, we still get great interest for good agencies, but when the buyer pool reduces that can be reflected in the offers. This is an observation, but on average we are seeing offers for PL focused agencies around 10% less compared to last year for guaranteed proceeds. When you think about it, property rates in many states have slowed or even started to decrease, so the due diligence standards are also looking at this. Many agencies have floated on rate the last few years, and now the tide has turned. Having history of client count or PIF is more important, and if your revenue is stable but you've lost clients and policies, that's flag being discussed. **CL, or HNW, Holds Strong Interest** There are still nuances within that, but many capital buyers are focusing their efforts on agencies with 50% or more CL. Even though we still see strong interest in PL, on average we see almost double the amount of qualified inquiries for a CL focused agency. **Earn out Structures are Evolving** People know "you have to stay on for 2-3 years" to work out an earnout, but candidly recent history has proven that many sellers almost don't care about earnouts, or that's all they care about then completely check out. For truly competitive offers, buyers are focusing more on true perpetuation planning vs buying an owner out and giving them a short term retirement window. This is the rare exception, but have seen it, where some buyers are now tying earnout performance to staff retention (AMs and producers) instead of just the owner. Not everyone will adopt this, but I wouldn't be surprised if more do. So perpetuation of culture and why your agency can perform will be tied to things other than strictly financials. **EDIT Diversified Agencies are Not Always A Good Idea** Agencies that offer derivative services like real estate, tax prep, bookkeeping, payroll, HR, etc. cause problems. Back in the day there used to be buyers for these, not anymore. They will be broken up if you want to sell. Even as far as P&C PL and Medicare. As much as you feel they are complimentary, they aren't. Different markets. Even things like group benefits and HR consulting. While complimentary not everyone who does group benefits wants HR consulting. If you look at diversified larger agencies you can see one clear trend. P&C CL and group benefits can have some compliment. That's it. Focus on doing one thing, really really well, and don't get distracted with other things."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vzu98u/>

↳ (0): "Nice write up. Kind of what I am seeing/hearing as well. Have had a few calls from some older agency owners under 1,000,000 in revenue noting that they haven't received much interest from PE. I asked if they had any younger producers and they noted they did not. With the lack of younger talent and revenue under a 1,000,000 they aren't getting much traction on being acquired or able to sell to PE."

↳ (0): "Yep. Stagnant or no growth is sellable, but the true difference is a well run business, good staffing, and history of organic growth."

↳ (0): "Great write up and insights. Appreciate your expertise here, as always."

"I need leads for contact rate. My sales skills are there I think because I have talked with people then sold policies but it seems like I am calling such bad leads that don't answer or hang up in my face in the first second of the call"

— YouTube · Insurance Agents: Should you buy leads or generate leads ? · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aGrUeGEYEpl&lc=UgxNQe5hKJ4AaABA9>

"Absolutely sir you are right but sometimes people are angry that why do you need my information basically we are brokerage working with top 25 a rated carrier through out the united states but some people think we are trying to steal money but no we just are broker"

— YouTube · Real Medicare Sales Call - Initial Resistance Smashed! · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=58cUUZmEQm4&lc=UgyCXOAZ6MVuhga3_UZ4AaABAg_9_FuCG863z89b3IVKakG7F

"I don't know a single person that has ever had success with purchased leads. The exception to that might be the Dave Ramsey leads, but I believe they run 10k/year. Also, you have to subscribe to his mindset, which unless you are talking about debt, is a hard "pass" for most professionals. The exception to the lead situation would be a company like Prudential or one of the mutuals perhaps where you the leads that are generated come from an existing relationship with the company. In a sense, they are "warm" leads. Purchased leads are usually frigid cold. The person has no relationship with you or the company you represent. Maybe they offered the info up willingly, but in a lot of those generations, the quality of intent is low to outright unintentional. Sorry that you're having a rough go with this. Hope you can find somewhere to land and build a career!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujxuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/p3xgu6d/

"You blame Medicare marketing compliance rules for this.. You CANNOT say Medicare is ANYTHING like ACA. ACA will become like Medicare with *compliance and disclosures*. AND with our new admin(🍌🍌). We might not have ACA anymore. Just STM. Some of those short term medical plans are only for 3 months in some states even after the recent changes. And there are rules where you can't reinstate with some carrier in same year. Health insurance is a circus right now. Medicare(MAPD) and ACA are typically uneducated people getting harassed all day during AEP/Open Enrollment. The chronic flips thinking they're getting something *more everytime added*. If you want to talk about "deceitful" then look at limited med with multiplan without major medical carrier with it. Which is way less compliant than ACA. And they're discount plans not real insurance for 2-300\$+ Yes people click once or couple times. And those leads are sold and sold again every month(.20 cents - 50\$). And 90% of that business you could get from those cheap leads will be flipped by end of the year or within 3 months clawback time. Vs your 30% you're suppose to lose on avg every year. Call Amazon or some other large company right now and watch you get redirected from Customer Service to Medicare agency. Sometimes the smaller newer agencies do spoof the numbers or emails to look like local food business even Amazon. Everyone wants a piece of the pie"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p0mqo2/is_it_just_me/npm451h/

"Pretty typical of any vendor, can run hot and cold. I'm not sure if you see the same leads that I do, but if there is a "questionnaire" lead, stay away from that one. It is full of people who are just filling out surveys. To be honest, I buy a mix of leads from them. That being said, every internet lead has to be worked. You are going to get plenty who say "wasn't me", or some other lame excuse or they just hang up on you. I'll simply put those leads to the side for a couple days, even a week and then call them again as if we've never spoken. It doesn't always work out, but the number of people who all but cussed me out a few days ago, now act like they've been waiting on my call is just weird. I like that Integrity doesn't force a specific number for a purchase. I work this business part time so it's nice to be able to control how many I get. I work with a team, and we have plenty of new agents come and go. I'll see them buy 5,10,20 leads, dial them a few times, not make a sale, then blame wherever the lead came from, say the whole thing is a scam and bounce. Working internet leads is not always an easy task."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/mnsacz5/

"See, I think we need to keep in mind most people - the *average* 'most people' - do not understand much about insurance *at all.* I have been reflecting lately on when I was in my 20s and even 30s, I really had no clue. That lady - \$100 says she thinks you decide the rates. When I was 20s, I wouldn't have known any better. I do remember getting auto insurance probably the first time and the agent said "ok so you want comp and collision" and I was like - "ok sure... if that's what I'm supposed to have. Is that what I'm supposed to have?" lol. I literally had no idea what that even meant. I never really thought much else about it until I needed to use it. Same with health insurance. So yeah - I think she probably believe that you absolutely do have a say in what the rates are that you're giving her. Maybe she just needed to hear the words "I really wish I could get you a lower rate. I would if I could to anything about it at all." Maybe it's also just cuz I've worked retail and I'm used to people yelling at me for stuff that has nothing to do with me, lol. It's just the way people are, sorry to say"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r99hmi/is_it_just_me_or_are_we_all_changing/o6d73ag/

"Try \$600 on leads and \$0 while getting screamed at and threatened with lawsuits because the lead claimed to had never show an interest in life insurance. I'll stick to my IT career."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fmntn2/life_insurance_recruiters_are_liars/logpc0o/

"My Blue Cross clients in Cook County are very angry! If they're subsidized, the presence of the dirt cheap Celtic-Ambetter HMO plans is causing their ATPC-subsidy \$\$\$ amount to actually DECREASE on 1/1/2016. I just spoke with a 62 year old Cook County client (60611). Her Blue Choice PPO plan is increasing by 45% and the subsidy decreasing by 11%. Net result is that her actual out-of-pocket increase in premium is a huge 56%! If they're not subsidized, they have to endure the entire 45% premium increase that will kick in on 1/1/2016. Or, change to Ambetter-Celtic and pray for the best of health in 2016. I'm pretty sure that Celtic-Ambetter is violating HHS-CMS rules by not having enough physicians and hospitals in Cook county. The problem is the Federal Government will not take any action until enough people are severely hurt with huge medical bills..and start filing official complaints. It would be nice if HHS-CMS would take proactive action, by telling Celtic-Ambetter to de-list itself from the Illinois Marketplace, but that's not going to happen. But, I will send a note to the Illinois Department of Insurance and the Governor's office. Almost zero chance of any response or action, but at least they'll have a record (and so will I) that at least one health insurance professional attempted to warn them of the problems that Celtic-Ambetter's presence will bring to lots of Illinois residents starting on 1/1/2016. ac"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Ambetter Insured by Celtic? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/ambetter-insured-by-celtic.78353/#post-1049179>

"Where are you buying leads from? I lost a lot of money when I started because I thought buying the best leads guarantee my success, but I didn't get the reps in to really grow. Even now I still like starting with 6 to 8 month olds leads because at the end of the day a lead is a lead. Instead of selling one and 10, you sell one in 100. I've sold leads that are two years old. It just comes down to realizing that the older the lead the more reps that's gonna take and the more hang up you're going to get. I would recommend meeting with your line and coming up with the lead strategy that way you don't burn through money and you grow"

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lmbcnj/anything_is_possible/n06mcbi/

"No single agent is calling 20 times in a row. 3 calls is the standard. Usually, the client has gone and submitted their information to multiple sites for quotes and therefore gets reached out to by multiple agents from different agencies. As an agent you really have no way of knowing this is happening before you call and hear that the client is angry."

— YouTube · Insurance Agent Calls An Angry Lead - Rate This Call! #insurance #insuranceagent #lifeinsu · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yc0XJA-IF5I&lc=Ugz-HFskLOI_FKsOXeN4AaABAg_A024EDgIgi1A0ngGPK3LGM

"Quitting after a month, am I alone in feeling this way? I think I just need to vent. 3 months ago I applied for a P&C producer position at a new Farmers agency that was opening in my town. Agent had a book in a different state and sold it to restart in my town where he is from. There are already 2 Farmers agents here in a town of roughly 15k people, this would be the 3rd. The recruiter told me there's big money in it and when I questioned him on having 3 agencies in a town this size where there are already several established agencies, he assured me there is plenty of business to go around. Pay is \$1500 base, 8% home and specialty, 7% auto, 30% life. I had, and have, no reference points on those numbers but I had no experience in insurance sales. Got licensed. Got started. First couple weeks were ok, but red flags started popping up. I thought it was odd I had to pay for my own background check, but chalked it up to it being a 1099 position which I have never had and maybe that's how it's done. Few days later, the agent tells me they ran the background check through his old agency and state and I would need to pay for a new background check. Pretty dumb mistake, and don't understand why it can't just be fixed or why he can't foot the bill since it was not my mistake, but I say ok. After a 2 week delay in start day, I finally get started. I've had plenty of jobs where you begin by watching hours of mind-numbing safety/training videos, but this was something else. The agent gives me a 10 minute crash course on Farmers quoting platform, which is completely convoluted and unintuitive, then sets me up in an office to watch a couple of Farmers agents teach a "one-call masterclass". I'm sure what they are teaching is tried and tested, but I spent 3 days going through this course and I have no idea at all what I am selling. No intimate knowledge of MY product. Just general knowledge. The pre-license courses teaches you plenty about what insurance is, how policies are made up and the different components....but I knew nothing of Farmers products. No details. What's the difference between rental and rental alternative? Roadside and enhanced roadside? Didn't know until 2 weeks in that Farmers has a \$100 glass deductible, and then the agent couldn't tell me if it covered all the glass on the vehicle or just the windshield, and how big the crack had to be before it's covered. I didn't know that if you bundle the roadside, rental and glass there is a discount. It took a full day to get Farmers home deductibles rules straightened out, wind/hail deductibles, when to put personal property on open vs broad named perils, and all kinds of other things. I came in with a notebook and multiple ink pens ready to take notes and soak up all kinds of info specific to Farmers. Like WHAT THE FUCK AM I GOING TO BE SELLING? I need to know more than the people I'm selling to. I know experience is a big thing, I don't need to know EVERYTHING day one, but for christ sake teach me something about the products. Then, Farmers is sky high on rates right now. Maybe they always have been? I can't sell a Farmers policy to save my life. And I know I'm new to insurance, but I've been in sales for 10 years. I know some sales savvy and how to talk to people, how to discover pain points and sell to my strengths and sell myself. Even with my experience, I followed the sales scripts and even made some of my own with some AI help. I'm dialing 5 warm home and 5 warm auto every morning, not one answer. Then I dialed around 100-150 cold leads. Absolutely useless. Come to find out the agent is purchasing \$5 leads that seem to have been recycled and several weeks old at best, pedaled to probably 10 other agencies. Ricky Roma couldn't sell this shit. So he switched and started purchasing \$15/pop leads. That lead to more quotes, but the price is too high. I can persuade a sale based on (what I have been told) is Farmers strong claims experience and payout record mixed with a steady rate. But when I am \$50-\$100/month higher on auto, or similar on homes but I require a 2% wind/hail deductible, what do I do? People buy on price, and my value proposition has to be much more than "I'll pay out" to justify someone paying that much more. And Farmers reconstruction cost on homes through 360Value is really high, which is good imo, but people hear that number and just think "how much cheaper would my insurance be if I only had 75% of that". Or "you expect me to pay \$8k dollars if I have a wind/hail claim while living in tornado alley?" Combine all of this with my agent trying a new phone system (RingCentral) that anytime you connect with a person the first thing they hear is "this call is being recorded" followed by a reminder beep every 15 seconds. If people ever do pick up, it's an immediate hang up. So we switch back to another system and he only wants to pay for one account with 4 lines. So every time one of us dial out, it goes to all 4 phones until one of us claim that call. Inbounds don't ring, you have to either be looking at your phone to see the flash or be on the right web page to see it say inbound. And I don't really want to get on a rant about Bristol West. I have no experience with them, they may be great, but they have terrible reviews online. And this agent wants me and my friends and family to get signed up with them because they are cheap. But my whole sales spiel for Farmers is "the cheapest rate is usually the cheapest coverage". I don't want to set people up on this if it's junk coverage. To anyone, but especially my friends and family. Finally, we have done nothing in the way of community outreach. Maybe that's the wrong term but literally no one knows we are here. He got the Google page going and got some reviews which has been great. But we are on a state highway outside of city limits, we have no signage, we are not joined with the chamber of commerce, and we have not networked with any real estate or car lots or mortgage companies at all. I personally made up some flyers for a few lawyers offices, accounting firms, and banks. I went out on my dime and canvassed. In all, I feel this agent thought because he was successful as his previous location, it would be the same here. But a lack of teaching and instruction, cheaping out on equipment and leads, lack of community visibility and no plan in place for a slow start has me looking elsewhere. This is my livelihood, I'm not lazy or complacent. Every single person I talk to I give my all. And maybe that's a problem, I come across too eager. But I have listened back to my calls. I ask my coworker to as well. I ask my wife too. I feel like P&C personal lines is dead for agent sales. All I've ever done is get online and collect quotes myself. It's not that hard. I don't want to speak to people. And if I have to, I'm sure as hell not going with a higher quote because they promise their product is better. Everyone says that. And this agent is living and dying by personal lines. He swears by it. Says it's so much easier to sell. I disagree. So I've been trying to focus the past few weeks on commercial. Met a few business owners who gave me the chance to quote their commercial autos. Sent their current policies, price and all. Yeah, Farmers was \$2k, \$3k and \$1800 a year higher for exact matching policies. That changed minimally when I upped their deductibles. Maybe I'm in a bad area or maybe I'm talking to subprime candidates or maybe I am just a shit salesman. I feel I would be a better fit if I had joined an established agency and learned that way. Maybe. Anyway, I'm being headhunted by a loan company and I'm seriously considering going to a W-2 position. I'm sure there are plenty of cons there as well though."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 13 upvotes · new or aspiring agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p0s3n8/quitting_after_a_month_am_i_alone_in_feeling_this/

↳ Heavy_Following_1114 (18): "Sounds like the typical insurance experience. Seen too many people think it was going to be a walk in the park because they had prior sales experience. There's a reason 90% of agents fail in their first 3 years. A very very small percentage succeed"

↳ eric199479 (11): "I know this is the insurance agent subreddit so I may catch some heat here, but this seems very common. I know we are told to sell on value not price, but the fact is most of these bad leads we get filled out an ad online for cheap insurance. And they get hammered with calls from every agent in the state for different companies. They don't care that they get better coverage on your quote if it is more expensive. Sure there are outliers, I have successfully sold on value before, but that is hard to do. And this is assuming they even answer. You can make great money in insurance but it is a grind and in this age of internet leads and being able to get a quote from anyone at any time, selling on value is old news, at least for these type of cheap leads"

↳ mkuz753 (10): "Your concerns are valid. I suggest looking up independents near you. They sell almost any type of insurance."

"I almost exclusively work aged leads. I've simply found better value and a higher return with them. But,, it takes volume and consistency. I keep my approach very simple and direct. "Hey (lead name), this is Caleb getting back with you on the life insurance information you requested. (short pause) Looks like you put (dob/age/location), is that correct?...." If they're still on the phone at this point I just work into my script/pitch. Working aged leads, I'm well aware and prepared that most are going to hang up on me if they answer at all. I don't really indicate or stress that they filled this thing out weeks/months ago, there isn't any value in that. They are either going to have a conversation with you or they aren't, just keep moving on. I get asked often where I buy my leads from, and I've been using usa life leads for the last year, I go through 100-300leads a week. Regardless of the vendor, you just have to work them. Most agents are going to buy leads (usually not enough), call through them a few times, make nothing, cuss everyone for their failures and either quit or look for the next "magic bullet"."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rkajao/aged_leads/o92556r/

Other agents: poaching, bad actors and the reputation · 6 documents · 6 voices

"Have agencies starting out new agents on aged leads even care about FDNC lists? I had to make a post about this because I used to be in these shoes. Given a list of couple hundred aged leads that were super cheap with no clue about FDNC. After building an agency and going through process of getting compliant leads it makes sense why agencies continue the easy route with cheap aged leads. Instagram ads I'm seeing are about the roadmap with new agents but most of these aged leads are all FDNC and new agents are getting screwed. These 18-19 year olds so excited for a new career just to be hit with a lawsuit or carrier violation because their agency set them up with non-compliant aged lead sheets. So many agencies could be doing right and not trying to make a quick dollar. There is a reason financial service/ insurance industry gets a bad rap when this is how you onboard new agents. When will it end with the bad apples that give this industry a bad rap?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1w0xb6x/have_agencies_starting_out_new_agents_on_aged/

↳ jroberts67 (2): "I guess the question I have, is when a customer requests a quote, there's fine print that allows agents to call them - so the question is how long are they allowed to be called."

↳ Spare-Package-2243 (1): "Before purchasing them try to scrub them through Federal or National Do not call list and then pay them for rest of leads."

"That's not a lead vendor, That's a criminal accomplice! marketing companies are not allowed to take personal client information give quotes etc... What you just described is **not** Lead generation. Its marketed as "pre sold policies by shady dudes in facebook groups" and its illegal.. If an agent doesn't know that they deserve to lose their license. There is no way this was surprising to him. he knew what was happening.. he paid more for this "service" specifically because he is Lazy..... There are in fact marketing companies that want to sell legitimate CMS/ carrier compliant leads and inbound calls. They do exist. You never interact with them because you are a professional litigator on the DNC list . Legitimate companies pay money for subscriptions like this <https://www.dnc.com/dncscrub/> and make api calls to stay DNC compliant. Those same API calls check Professional Litigator lists, which you are likely on..Any one who can afford \$300 per month and knows how to call an API will make sure they never call you. The only marketing companies you ever interact with are the Bad ones... here is the medicare manuals <https://www.cms.gov/medicare/health-drug-plans/managed-care-marketing/medicare-guidelines/> As you can see this is COMPLICATED. Many Insurance brokers choose to outsource marketing because there is a lot of rules to follow here. Some companies Aka "third party" marketing companies offer a legitimate service to insurance brokers , allowing them to legally outsource marketing.. just like very other industry. Some agents do get deceived by shady companies. many don't even think to ask marketers , "how do you check DNC /TCPA? how do you generate leads or data? "what qualifications do you use to turn data into a lead? how many people are you selling this data to? What liability do you have regarding DNC/TCPA violations? These are all legitimate questions any legitimate marketer will have no problem answering.. Keep up being a professional litigator. get the Bad apples out of the industry. you should put up a you tube channel like Coffeezilla. I bet it would be more entertaining than the most insurance industry content.. i think it would be helpful for a lot of agents if you posted content of this stuff. Its the dark underbelly that many agents never see.. they get pitched an offer that's too good to be true.. and well it is..."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nl7wbo/another_reason_not_to_trust_lead_brokersthird/nf78cv7/

"I see lots of comments about people's goals to sell so many APPS per day. Don't you get paid based on ENROLLMENTS? Is an APP an ENROLLMENT? There aren't any agents out there explaining the difference between a quote, an app, and an enrollment. Step 1 for the customer is to get QUOTES, then COMPARE PLANS, before ever APPLYING or ENROLLING for anything. Unscrupulous agents are starting applications for people who never asked for one, when the agent hasn't even given them prices and companies to compare. Looks like a racket. It's tough enough for first time customers to figure everything out, without having to clean up the messes of dishonest agents who seem to just want to be first....to beat other agents to the punch and pocket that commission. Their licenses should be revoked."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzI2ERN5LAeigkORJN4AaABAg>

"Sorry for the loss of your Father. That tragedy in itself should definitely be reported to your state's Insurance license Dept or whatever applicable department. I would also file a complaint with the insurance company your Father had. Don't give up on filing and following up with the complaints. Bad agents and companies get away with these things when people don't file complaints. Also file with the BBB (BETTER BUSINESS BUREAU). Good luck to you. 😊 "

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okb93m/how_a_bad_aca_enrollment_hit_my_family_and_why_i/nmanpbe/

"From other agents I've talked too, these leads have all info and all agent has to do is policy flip."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ukowmo/has_anyone_else_seen_these_black_market_leads/ov3zzsg/

"houcoogster said: Another little snapshot.... CBO report: Obamacare reduces federal deficit by \$286B over the next decade What a bunch of complete crap. Of course the ACA would lower the ESTIMATE Deficit. If I was the one creating estimates I could monkey with the numbers too. It doesn't do ANYTHING to actually lower anything other than the faith Americans have in our Government. All that is saying is simply not as many poor people have signed up for care as expected. I expect the numbers to be substantially greater in 2015 and 2016 due to the massive penalty for refusing to obtain coverage. If you folks think the premiums are ridiculous now you just wait until the Insurance companies jack the prices up even more knowing that we will get bankrupt by the IRS if we do not comply and sign up for subsidies thru the marketplace. If you really believe the ACA is helping anyone besides crooked agents, the Government and big insurance you are completely blind, deaf, and mentally challenged."

— Insurance-Forums.com · The Current State Of ObamaCare - ACA · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/the-current-state-of-obamacare-aca.64424/#post-841137>

Tab 4 — Relationship Soundbites

What the recruiter, trainer or upline told them · 28 documents · 20 voices

"Just got fired Got fired from my first insurance job because after 2 weeks i didnt make them enough money. I told them i did exactly what they told me to do in the trainings. And i had also told them that i have never sold before. But he didnt care. Literally in the training he told me "i want you to say this word for word". BUT HERE I AM. What do i do? Obviously besides get another job i already know that. I did sell, but now i wont have access to marX or sunfire which is what i used to do all this with. Just wondering what i should, how all that works. How does it work to be a independent agent? We sold medicare plans"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 92 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oezwib/just_got_fired/

↳ mythic_dot_rar (56): "Two weeks is insane so either they're crazy or there's something you aren't telling us. Either way, you're kind of boned for this AEP because all of the carriers are in their blackout period (meaning you can't switch uplines until January) and they'll probably drag their heels on getting you released. You should reach out to your MAPD carriers and at least submit a request for release right now to get the 3 or 6 month process or whatever it is going."

↳ itsalyfestyle (17): "Brutal. Unfortunately you won't get another job selling Medicare until January Name and shame the agency"

↳ itsalyfestyle (15): "Yea there's a blackout period during AEP so you won't be able to transfer your contracts until next year."

"New rules (with a slight change) Thank you to everyone that has assisted with helping with the new rules. Here's where we landed, and there is one small tweak: 1. This is not a place to sell your services or generate leads or recruit agents/downlines. Consumers should not get offers to quote or to privately "help". This includes asking people to vet your software/AI or other peripheral concepts as well as advertising your website or app (even if it is currently free). 2. Do not post any unethical, illegal or unhelpful content. 3. Be a good reflection of the industry and remain professional. The difference is in Rule #1, and it is specific to a pattern of behavior of some life agents that have been trying to recruit to some quasi-MLM companies (I say "quasi" because I don't think that any DOI has stated it as a fact). Many of those trying to recruit are doing so with little to no posting history, which makes it very odd. The sidebar will be reflected soon to reflect this, but you should consider that these rules are currently being enforced as of this post. Edit as of 7/23/26 - effective immediately, we're no longer allowing posts that are asking for help with ideas for software, websites, apps or other SaaS concepts. Even if it's currently free, if you're linking people to something of yours, expect it to be removed at a minimum. Even if you're just asking for people to vet an idea, expect it to be removed at a minimum."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 79 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cdomsd/new_rules_with_a_slight_change/

↳ SHURP (14): "I'm was actually thinking about finding a property and casualty specific subreddit. It hadn't even dawned on me till I saw the posts here that people actually view life and health in the same vein. I hate to sound like a purist or something but due to the way health and life insurance in American works, I feel like it's crazy to call any of the programs that isn't single payer, anything but MLM."

↳ Samwill226 (6): "I'd like a Reddit for just P&C Agents (no consumer questions there's plenty of that already). There's so much confusion on what someone is talking about sometimes you get an answer and its a life person thinking you are talking about life policies. I would like to be able to talk just to folks I can relate to."

↳ malachi347 (5): "did you ever find or make one? I'd love to be a part of a community like that as well. can't stand life/group med.. or personal lines for that matter heh"

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

↳ Legio-V-Alaudae (45): "If it was so easy and well paying, they wouldn't have to advertise the hell out of the jobs. I'm sorry you didn't have a healthy amount of skepticism when conducting due diligence."

↳ Candid_Worth_3629 (25): "Did you not ask for any advice from this subreddit or do any research prior to leaving your 9-5? Everyone would've told you to keep the main job and start out part time. It's also really important to be at a place that doesn't make you churn \$ for leads. Most are MLM schemes"

↳ jordan32025 (20): "Anyone who doesn't understand that AP written is not the same as the commission percentage shouldn't start a life insurance business. Also, going into it thinking it's a "job" is recipe for guaranteed failure. There is some financial literacy needed. This precisely why I don't recruit people who are not already actively selling consistently with a good carrier. They already know how to run a business."

"NEVER work or get life/health through Globe Life 🌐 Worst recruiting experience I have ever had, didn't help with getting license at all, lead me on for weeks, paid everything out of pocket, had to have gallbladder removed right after starting and they told me to kick rocks. Just got off the phone with regional manager yelling and cussing me and they told me because I missed part of training and had a second job (security night shift) that I wasn't committed enough and should go to a flack that "committed" agents are a dime a dozen and they could hire any loser to fill my spot they didn't need me. I have 15+ years sales management and experience I even was on finals for the next great American speak off and I get treated like another entry level sales rep. Even in training they were more focused on the sale rather than the customer. I got into life/health to help people not suffer the same fate I did due to having an emergency hip replacement last year in May. It ruined me financially and cost me my business in adventure tourism. I just wanted to spread knowledge on the importance of coverage and actually get customers what they need, not just get their money for my own benefit like Globe Life's primary focus. I'm just pissed right now, dumped money I really couldn't afford at the time on the things I needed to be successful, the class, the license, everything and for nothing. Now I don't even know what to do with this license because 99% of the recruiters I talk to are still just wanting people for MLM crap or straight up scams. Just wanted to rant, if anyone sees this that is legit contact me. If you put me in a position to take EVERY contract from my local globe life offices I will make it my personal mission to take their business."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1irtig7/never_work_or_get_lifehealth_through_globe_life/

↳ Expert-Difficulty605 (7): "I worked business 2 business for 5 months and for me I was miserable. I made the switch to med Insurance for seniors and for me it's been night and day. I feel like I'm truly helping helping people who get lost in the shuffle"

↳ Unhappy_Corgi_6838 (6): "Sorry to hear about your experience. I recently got my life/health license through Bankers life and I'm having a similar experience. Haven't even made a prospect call yet and can't even sell until I do a 3-day training class 2 hours away from my home. It looks like the Insurance job market (really every industry) is filled with MLM companies and low paying call center contract jobs."

↳ katieintheozarks (6): "I was with Bankers Life for 2 weeks and quit in part because of their hard sell system and cold calls. Also I explicitly asked for work at home and then I was told I wouldn't be able to work at home. I interviewed six different places and landed with symmetry which is completely work at home and the outside leads are amazing. Jump ship. Every other company I interviewed with was better than Bankers Life."

"What Uplines Don't Want you to Know - Carrier Release Process - Explained This is a question I get a ton from new agents, and its what every upline doesn't want you to learn, so please... learn it. Treat this information like it's required for you to be in the industry to know. Review your contracts with your uplines and make sure you have protection within them as well. Heck, get a lawyer to review it. Whatever it takes, I see too many agents getting trapped in awful comp deals and abusive uplines and get "Stockholm'd" into buying bad leads from them and then gaslighting them into thinking its their fault. I've been there done that. This info is for the agent that calls themselves independent:

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Demystifying Agent Contracting, Releases, and Blackout Periods I work directly with 54 carriers, 4 FMOs, multiple agencies, and nearly 1,000 independent agents. My role involves overseeing contracting, licensing, and agent/agency development. With experience spanning so many entities, I've had the chance to see the contracting process from all angles and business models. Let me break it down for anyone who's struggling to navigate this space. # Steps to Understand Contracting and Releases

1. **Contract Level (LOA vs. Broker):** * If you're directly contracted with a carrier as a truly independent broker *and* haven't signed an agreement restricting you to one entity (or an LOA contract, which assigns your commission to your upline), you should generally be free to contract with another carrier or upline without issues. 2. **Private Contracts (Non-Competes or No Non-Competes):** * If you're tied to a brokerage or agency and have a private contract (like a non-compete), get a lawyer to review your options. Some of these cannot be upheld in court, that's important for you to know. * Medicare agents may want to wait until the start of the year for a smoother transition —this avoids AEP complications. 3. **Carrier Blackout Periods:** * **New agents** can contract anytime, even during AEP, for Medicare Advantage (MA) and Medicare Supplement (Med-Supp) plans. * **Switching uplines or FMOs, however, is restricted** during AEP for MA carriers (typically September–December). * If you're contracting with a carrier for the first time, you can get a **new contract** during AEP, but you can't **switch uplines** until the blackout period ends. 4. **Release Process (To Release or Not):** * Brokers contracted directly with carriers usually retain their commissions unless restricted by a private contract (see Step 2). * You can file a self-release with an "intent to transfer". After 90–180 days, the carrier can re-contract you under a new upline while allowing you to keep producing during the interim. (you will be compensated according to your previous contract if you decide to continue producing, you wont get commission for producing if you WERE an LOA agent because your effective comp is 0%) * This safeguards agents from being stuck in unfavorable relationships. Most agents prefer waiting until the start of the year to minimize risks. The key is understanding your contract and navigating transitions safely, which is something many agents overlook. # A Brief History of the Release Process (why the heck is it this way?) The "agent-release" process emerged in the late 90s and early 2000s to manage transfers between FMOs and carriers. Unfortunately, it was often abused, with FMOs refusing to grant releases, especially during AEP, leaving agents trapped in bad contracts. To address this, carriers like UnitedHealthcare, Aetna, and Humana introduced transfer freezes during AEP to protect their investments. The "intent to transfer" process, developed in the late 2000s and early 2010s, aimed to fix these issues by providing agents a path to transfer without jeopardizing their business. # Misunderstandings About Releases If your agency/FMO/upline tells you "you can't transfer," it's likely because their training hasn't been updated to reflect the proper release procedures. This isn't usually malicious, they just want to ensure you're not left without commissions. Nobody wants to risk that. Also, the information is incredible "gate-kept", it's not a "sexy" process everyone wants to learn, until they need it... If you're looking for additional insight, this [YouTube video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NaExikyNwzo) (not affiliated with me or my company) provides a solid overview of the release process. However, it doesn't touch on the contract-level distinctions I've outlined here. Understanding these processes can help you avoid costly errors and confidently take control of your career. If you have questions or need clarification, feel free to ask!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gv923a/what_uplines_dont_want_you_to_know_carrier/

↳ Inner_Friendship5913 (2): "I just got my license in September and knew absolutely nothing about insurance. I started with Equis and had a very bad experience with my upline and felt like I was stuck with no one to teach me or train me. The top group person just blew smoke when I tried to get help so I left. I signed with Symmetry and I'm having a difficult time getting Equis to release me because they say they don't require it but Symmetry does require it. Symmetry has already started to get me started with other insurance carriers. I only had 5 with Equis. I have got no contracts with any carriers with Symmetry yet in my email but I know they started the process. BUT I was never told that I have to split my commissions 40%(me) and 60%(SME agent). I spoke to transamerica and Mutual of Omaha and they said I'd be penalized 90 days for ending the contract through Equis. So if I decide to not stay at Symmetry then that is even more insurance carriers that I'll be stuck waiting 90 days to work with again. I honestly have no idea where to go from here. I don't want to do all the work and a finalizing agent take 60% of my commissions. What company out there allows you to keep your commissions outside of the Small bit your upline gets? Or at least a fair amount?"

↳ RedditInsuranceGuy (1): "I would need to know what line of insurance you are talking about to get more specific. But basically its a standard wait of 6 months after a documented request of release from the contract for most carriers. Mutual of Omaha is pretty strict on that stuff. As far as what you do going forward is find an IMO that can fill the gaps with something competitive in the meantime while you process the releases and wait it out."

↳ Standard-Position698 (1): "I am in the process of trying to get a release/terminate contract. My up-line has refused to continue to reply and has removed me from all platforms and blocked me but will not release my contract."

"Hey, I'm a new Agent, I got licensed less then a year ago. During my training, I was taught for that rebuttal was "I don't do any second appointments, because we shop every A Rated carrier today to see who you would get approved for." Something within them lines. To avoid that rebuttal, I was taught to ask who they make their financial decisions with & if they was around. Hope this helps."

— YouTube · LIVE Dialing: Cold Calling Insurance Leads (SCRIPT GIVEAWAY) · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=POOoucTXJYc&lc=Ugxu8xdq4l-QqJxrU4x4AaABAg>

↳ @Countmoneyforever (4): "I think it helps! Also the better you qualify the better you'll close. for example i always ask "who makes financial decisions for you?" and "if we were able to find something affordable that meets your needs, when would you like that plan to start?" if they say today you keep going but if they say "im not sure" or anything else you gotta figure out why BEFORE you present any options! Our most important asset is time, dont let these ppl waste any"

↳ @bejrnews (0): "New agent here. How's your book of business doing?"

"Agreed. Old mentor of mine one told me "Medicare is the engine of your business, but Life insurance is the gas that makes it run" This has proven to be very true."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j8ra7h/the_realities_of_life_insurance_sales_what_it/mh9ojpx/

"Seeking to break into niche field, need advice Hi everyone, I'm currently in a parallel industry and just earned my P&C license with plans to pivot into insurance, ideally in a niche area like cyber risk. I'm open to either underwriting (with a production/sales focus) or brokerage. I'm planning to begin the ARM-to-CPCU path this month to start credentialing up. I'm targeting a transition in Q1 2026, so this isn't an urgent jump, more about laying the groundwork now for a meaningful pivot. A few questions for those who've walked this path: 1. Underwriting: Are most training programs geared toward general lines, or are there early-career paths that lead directly into specialty areas like cyber? Would they accept someone not college age (30s)? 2. Compensation: I've noticed some UW trainee roles come with lower salaries. I do have savings that could float me for a year or two, but for general context, what's a realistic salary trajectory for someone who completes a training program and specializes? 3. Broker Programs (Aon/Marsh, etc.): Do their producer programs train you as generalists, or can you specialize early in areas like cyber, etc? Is it just "here's a phone, you have to bring in x in premium before y date" or is it actual training on best practices, sales strategy, etc.? 4. Team Dynamics: In niche areas like cyber, do brokers tend to operate in teams, or is it more of a solo producer model? I'd prefer to work in a collaborative environment where I can learn from others before being expected to run solo if possible. As I would be leaving a decently established job, I want to ensure I am being set up for success. 5. Networking: Is it realistic to network my way into a role by attending conferences or reaching out to professionals on LinkedIn? Would you respond to a message from someone respectfully asking for a 15-30 min informational interview that you did not know? Any advice would be greatly appreciated. Thanks in advance!"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1lqb2i7/seeking_to_break_into_niche_field_need_advice/

↳ Typical_Texpat (6): "1- Yes, typically you usually start as a generalist and as you get more experience you move into a niche. Doesn't mean it isn't possible but the people to specialize straight away typically have prior industry experience where they're going to. They do accept people not in college but you have to show them why you're more valuable than someone that likely majored in risk management or something similar. 2- Trajectory depends on individual performance. \$100k within 3-5 years seems realistic. Starting is usually around \$65k, they're paying you to learn. 3- no experience here 4- most companies are collaborative and the best underwriters are the ones that know they don't know everything and are willing to learn. 5- not sure about attending conferences because more often than not those people are there to network for themselves, not meet with job seekers. Maybe look for insurance career fairs. Cold messaging for informationals may work but be prepared for people not to respond or say no. I would spend your own money on a CPCU. Wait until you're hired somewhere and have them pay for it. There's also a two year experience requirement to matriculate."

↳ bigmanwizard129 (3): "If you're looking at going the brokerage route, don't forget to look at positions at wholesalers - CRC, Amwins, RT just to name the big ones"

↳ National-Log6521 (2): "You'll likely get placed alongside a servicing team or another senior producer to get acclimated and learn. Corporate insurance is a technical product and you'll need context to advise non technical clients on what to buy. What you're selling is not insurance but your firm's advisory and brokering services. Brokerages are unlikely to risk their reputation on unproven staff so I wouldn't worry about going in blind."

> What is your plan for when the incoming calls stop? As cynical as this sounds - there is no plan. If you have a phone, the calls will never stop coming. The numbers are spoofed, the names are fake, and there is nothing you can do. Even if you're on every blacklist alliance list, DNC, TCPA litiagtor scrub, etc etc - they all disconnect the calls AFTER the happen. Its annoying and won't end. I can get 100 illegal calls in a day and get zero justice or I can get 100 illegal calls a day, sue on 3-4 of them and get \$10-20 grand worth of justice. This is the world we're living in. The calls will never stop. If they did, I'd have a much higher serenity around here and I could enjoy some of the money I've made over the years. > Can you say with absolute sincerity that you're not taking any action to receive these illegal calls? 100%. I do not sign up for ANYTHING. I sit at home watching TV or scratching myself and the calls come in. I'm too young for medicare, but I get 20+ calls a day for medicare advantage. I'm too young for final expense insurance, I get 30+ a day for final expense. It's insanity. > You sure you're not intentionally putting yourself in a position for opportunities to sue these companies/agents? Am I intentionally putting myself in a position to sue these people, absolutely. The same way a cop running radar that has a really good spot that nobody can see / knows about..... I have a charged gopro handy and I record the incoming calls. Yes, I intentionally prepare myself to get the most leverage and the best evidence capture of illegal telemarketing practices. >I can't tell if you're posting this to be a genuine warning or maybe even bragging... but it actually reads like "Careful about your lead source, or else people without real jobs like me are going to sue you." I've done several settlements with small brokers that have said "we can't pay you what you're asking" and I said that's fine, I'll hold your upline joint and severally liable. Next thing I know, a decent settlement offer comes my way. OR I hire an attorney, they file a class action against the upline, the brokerage, the broker and the agent PERSONALLY and everyone goes to court, the upline spends \$150-200k in defense costs that they subrogate back to the downline via payment plan/docked commissions/what have you and my attorneys add another win to their CV. The message here is that YOU MAY THINK this new lead vendor of yours is all great but if you get burned, you can potentially be involved in bet the company litigation. And this is the WORST kind of litigation to be in because you don't realize you're in bet the company litigation until you've wound up betting the company. >Do what everyone else does and block the numbers that call Not that easy. All the numbers are spoofed. I get calls from the hospital, chevy dealership, etc etc - all displayed on the caller ID that are overseas call centers. Your outlook is 100% flawed. >No I have never been sued by a serial litigator because I only receive direct inbound calls, but I can still cringe at you for bottom feeding You know what's funny? Every single broker I've sued says "we only recieve direct inbound calls" - you know why? THE LEAD GEN SPOOFS MY NUMBER, CALLS YOUR BROKERAGE SO YOU CAN CLAIM IT IS AN INBOUND CALL. The only counterbattery is my gopro video."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8y9glc/

"A joining fee of 200 dollars not for licensing just to recruit you.... you have to pay 250 per month to use there software because its there rules. You have to pay for there leads only that they sell to you. (Not bad but varies, use google) They tell you we will start you at 25% commision then you have to recruit family or friends or people then we will raise your commision to 50%. Sell to family and only sell to family (not a bad thing but please be human about it) but they keep urging you to only sell to friends over and over like a broken record to the point you pitch to family and friends and they leave you because you're being annoying. Hearing key words as lifetime income being streached and always going crazy on hura hura meetings and not actually teaching you how to sell. No one teaches you how a needs analysis works or what it is. Them always saying you will be a millionaire and showing so much money to glorify the idea. Granted yes agents can make this bank but lets think about this logically why are they showing these expensive things to us? Kind of suspius? Sorry if i have disrespected any agency in any sort of way but this is my unbiased point of view on the industry as a whole."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p1o3ii/if_youre_an_insurance_agent_whats_the_biggest/nprizd4/

"Jesus H. I get that teachers are looking for side hustles - and it's NOT okay that the 403(b) vendors are poaching INSIDE the schools to get their recruiting. I write 403(b) and am bringing it into my new broker dealer, as one of the only people in the entire company that understands it well enough to roll out some form of a workable 403(b)(7) system that lets us get paid AND write 403(b) accounts that do not charge the ridiculous fees that the insurance companies charge. I want it without surrender, high fee, or insurance-based products, but with access to an advisor they have a relationship with, not an 800 number. That's my mission. What you are describing? That's awful. I am one such recruit - though I was called by my home and auto agent to take a territory that needed an agent, and it was a completely protected territory the whole nine years I grew my book there. It wasn't anything like what you're describing. They also handed me the entire book on my way through the door and I vested my interest in it over four years while it covered my overhead and allowed for a base to expand from. I just went independent less than a year ago, from that role, and can say that there are ways to do what you're proposing, but you'd need to carefully look at potential and needs before you jump into the work. There's a lot of learning that is expensive, and if you choose the wrong org or arrangement, you could easily find yourself on the wrong end of validation requirements or running out of runway before you're comfortable. Spending time in the summer assisting an agent working in your target markets might be a great way to go. Being licensed, you can work as much or as little as you want when you are with an IMO, and the progress is yours to make. There is a certain level below which it doesn't make sense because you'll forget more than you learned before you do it again. Ten years in, I don't regret my time swap - I do four days in the office and one in the classroom as a sub somewhere. When I made my jump, I did so keeping all the same time expectations for everyone. My clients all are well aware that I'm not around on Fridays. My staff cheerfully let folks know that when they get calls for me on Friday - "Oh, would you like to send her an email or leave her a voicemail? She teaches on Fridays, and is out and about in the schools somewhere today wrangling some children whose teacher is out. I can probably help you, too. What's up?" It works like a charm and my clients love it. Sometimes I even teach for my clients, and then it's even more fun because we have that little conversation after like "Yeah... you weren't kidding. They were an interesting group!" or "Wow. Who did you make so happy last year that you got this amazing crop this year?! Lucky!!!" There are so many games in town - And the thing nobody will tell you is that the ones that find you are the ones that are the most desperate because they are the most exploitative. The ones you have to know someone to know how to get to are the ones that are truly orgs that you want to be in, because the people you know already who are in them are not trying to recruit as their primary mission. They are focused on the clients as clients and the client challenges are their job, not getting out of the client-facing work as soon as possible. Just some food for thought."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sj0pc6/primerica_almost_got_me/ofu1wzc/

"After spending 7 years with Primerica, from 2004 to 2011, I came to one conclusion. In a lot of Life insurance commission sales jobs, you're either in debt from chargebacks or you're in debt from buying leads. I believe if the opportunity is truly solid, the company should generate the leads, vet the salespeople, and assign qualified opportunities. Pay a little less commission if you have to, but build a higher-quality sales force instead of recruiting everyone with a pulse. The client loses too when a salesperson is struggling financially. When you're desperate for a commission, it's easy to develop "commission breath" and recommend what pays the most instead of what's best for the customer. For the last 14 years I've been in home improvement sales, and I honestly wish I had found this industry when I was 20. The company provides the leads. We sell large-ticket projects that are installed in a few weeks. Customers pay upfront. No chargebacks. No chasing renewals. No worrying about policies lapsing years later. Every sales job has its challenges, but if you're looking for a long-term sales career, don't overlook home services. I wish I had found it sooner."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/ouybo4c/

"Sounds like you've been there because you are spot on! I've been there and seen it first hand. Not all of them do the leads buy, but absolutely use friends and family to expand network reach to tap into a new market. There is always a pay to play aspect and very minimal trainings on sales / products because your growth isn't based on sales (some will argue this and they do but they're wrong). Literally, to increase your commission level, you must recruit. You can be the most knowledgeable sales rep and a product guru and if you don't recruit, you are considered a failure. It's all about getting you in in some emotional vulnerability and then keep moving the goal post. I swear I am going to write a book about this one day, I just feel it. It's very predatory. Psychological manipulation all in all."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p1o3ii/if_youre_an_insurance_agent_whats_the_biggest/nps4lyw/

"I sell recruiting leads and trust me if someone told me they were going to do something like that I wouldnt sell them shit and laugh at them."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tbn0hc/agency_owner_wanted_to_talk_to_my_current_boss/oljgfl/

"I didn't even make it to my first training with them. They had me sit in on a "mandatory" Zoom meeting (seriously? For 1099's?), which was an absolute shit-show of some agents making calls, others talking to one-another, and still others dicking around on video games--all at the same time, and with nothing muted. I couldn't take it. It also told me that nearly everything the recruiter had told me had been lies (a 30-hour week? Only 30 leads to call each week, and all of them union members who are sitting around twiddling their thumbs waiting for your call to complete their enrollment in benefits they're already signed up for? Cool! Easy money), which is why I opted out right then-and-there. Another thing about AIL I found to be VERY fishy was their requiring me to find a friend or associate to fill out an application and include all their personal information so that I could be appointed. When I asked what would then happen with the information, I was told not to worry, that it was just something necessary to be appointed and my friend, etc. wouldn't be liable for anything or be purchasing a policy. To this I asked why we can't just fudge things with made up info, but was told that "the system" wouldn't recognize it as a real person if we did. I also asked what happened to the information, and was told that it "...just goes to the company!" "And then what?" "Oh, I don't know, don't worry though!" Uh, when it comes to either mine or other people's personal information, yes, I worry. You may also want to take a look at all the BBB complaints against the company, of which there are shitloads. Though I realize that yes, AIL may be as legit as they come, I still don't like that they continuously speak of "uplines and downlines" since I'm leery of MLMs, and I sure as HELL ain't interested in having to lie to others to recruit them!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/164ik21/are_there_any_truly_good_life_insurance_companies/koigwvj/

"Digital BGA! I'm not independent anymore, but they were the most transparent and offer the highest pay with the strongest Leads (not cheap). They also have solid leads if you need them. They started at 110 when I was there and it went up from there. If you're providing your own leads and don't need training, you should be getting paid over 100%."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wi94nj/looking_to_switch_to_a_good_imo_for_final_expense/pa98hm0/

"To be fair a few things turned me off. A lot of it was commission structure. I used Agentero for small GL and although I do like them I don't like that I have no access to my larger policies and get as earned commissions. I'm used to managing my own accounts and getting up front payment. Also I need the full commissions paid for budget reasons. That is what I am used to. I don't want to write a \$6000 policy and get \$60 a month for a year. So that was a big portion of me backing off. I thought I'd see more commission growth. I would absolutely suggest them to anyone starting out but if you have a decent book already it's tough to get as earned. I know there were months and months I didn't get Life Insurance commissions from them and had to bug them to pay me. They did a little at a time then stopped again. It seemed to be off and on. I finally gave up. So that was a big part of my turn off as well, I just shouldn't have to bug you to pay me, they should have come to me about it first. I do wish now I would have just done direct appointments. I think had I done that I would find more reason to have stayed with it. I had a great mentor who was very helpful and I need to actually get in touch with him, but a lot of my issues stemmed from the size of my own book. I have a decent book and a staff. I am dealing with rate increases on personal lines which has taken a chunk of time. Being on social media stalking comments was proving to be very difficult. Add in the admin work, moving, new schools, new jobs, etc. I just didn't have room. Personal and business just kept me too busy. When I did it I realized it was on the weekends and taking time from my family and friends. I need that break for my own mental health. That was another part of it as well. You have to make the time and for me that was usually weekends. I say that to say if you have the time, are a smaller agency or building from scratch, you are 100% correct in your assessment, and I encourage anyone reading this that is getting a book going that this is a great avenue AND I can get you with a great mentor to help you. I just felt like for my size I was chasing small \$60 commissions being paid at \$6 a month, when I could devote the time to chase \$2000 commissions paid up front. I did not mean to question or push your methods, again I had someone helping me to do the same thing and I absolutely saw some good results! I just realized I was chasing smaller fish when I had bigger ones I could eat. However I think for me as well... I am ready to pull back and would rather pay someone else to do commercial. I've been in this for 30 years. I started at 19 and I just don't care to be in the agent seat anymore, I'd rather be behind the scenes. I'd also like to move on to overseeing other businesses ventures as well to diversify income. Using the social media method takes A LOT of time and you have to be ready to jump fast on a lead. I just realized for me I was going a different direction than I needed to. I have an overwhelming feeling the older I get the more I want my time back. For ME being on social media chasing leads was causing me to give more of it up. I'd rather at this point just have a remote commercial agent that works their own way but has access to my companies. I have 20 commercial companies as well as several huge broker network. All of them pay 10-25% up front of which we'd have a very fair split in their favor. It's a great opportunity for someone to build up a decent income even if it were part time. In other words I think I personally took on the project when after 30 years I just wasn't ready to give up that much time working it. Good luck to you as you go forward!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o1c6iq/how_keyboard_warrior_marketing_built_my_nlr0kp/

"Can I ask, have you spoken to a Mike from that company? L After I attended the group 'interview' spoke to the person who invited me to the zoom meeting, Alyssa was her name literally yesterday. Anyways I told her the training schedules were out of my ability to commit to and was no longer interested at this time. We said our goodbyes and she wished me good luck because I was taking my life insurance exam the same day (and I passed!!) And went on with my day. This was December 4th, 2025. Now today around 530pm CT time December 5th, 2025 this guy Mike calls me who lead the majority of the group interview. We spoke for about 30/40 minutes and honestly was excited. But now I decided to look up the company, read the reddit forums and now things are clicking. Im already working with a different company. Its a Brokerage and I feel more at peace/home with that company than Global life. Im just a 24 year old so someone please be honest. Im already struggling and i dont need a company to duck me over some more...."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mnj1p8/warning_globe_life_zuzick/nsioz39/

"I only been the office a few times. I was referred by a buddy of mine. The branch manager told me about a training class at one location and then another 2 hours away from home when I missed the first initial one due to failing my L&H the first time. All my onboarding training is done and I'm just..waiting on an email regarding actually starting. I know starting out is very difficult bc you're basically starting your own book of business with their provided leads/training. I already been offered two contracts from different statefarm agencies so I may just have to start off captive to gain experience."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1irtg7/never_work_or_get_lifehealth_through_globe_life/mdehm9h/

"This is a convo you should have with your up-line and mentors or someone doing this at a high-level. I've noticed from many agents that I work with from FFL many of the groups use a "cream rises to the top approach" to training. Many agencies that are using aged leads send them through an automated dialer and use AI to be more efficient. The two biggest challenges with telesales is getting someone on the phone or an appointment and finding a buyer. With aged leads you have to be able to solve both those issues. My agency uses inbound calls. Solves those two issues. Find a system that works and run with it."

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vftpsq/not_many_sales/p1w7sky/

'Don't buy leads, generate your own' · 22 documents · 20 voices

"Stop buying leads I constantly see people on here complaining about shitty, expensive, shared leads. Listen guys, YouTube exists, this stuff isn't hard. Facebook and Google have dumbed setting things up so much it's ridiculous. You want to know how to create your own leads? On Facebook you can find a built in tool called Facebook ads library. Type in the insurance product you sell and filter the results to show active ads that have been running 6month-1year. The older the ad the more successful. If the ad wasn't making money, they would have killed the ad. Copy/model that ad. For Google, pick a big city, Google <what you sell> <big city> whoever shows up at the top probably has a good ad. Look at their ad copy then look at the landing page they use. Copy/model them. It's simple, YouTube to figure out the setup, research what ads work, copy them.... And now you're getting your leads at cost and you have full control of them. It's easier than you would think."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 163 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466yi/stop_buying_leads/

↳ zb0324 (33): "If you want to get advanced: Google is the more expensive option but the leads are higher quality. Someone googling already has intent to buy, whereas on Facebook you're just scrolling your timeline and someone is interpreting you with an ad. Also there's more fake leads for some reason on Facebook, but they're also way cheaper. What we like to do is get traffic from Google ads and then use Facebook remarketing to put our Facebook ads in front of the expensive Google traffic that didn't buy."

↳ TheMatthewMurray (18): "This is good. I use the method called "Mimic it, Master it, Make it your own." However, copying and pasting will work for awhile, but understanding why ads work is fairly important. That way you're not constantly copying. When something goes wrong is when, people don't know how to fix it."

↳ Randomdeath (16): "did you just post Well thought out and simple strategies for success? Sacralige I say"

"I would say this is pretty accurate. I've been in the life insurance business since 2015 . I don't have any overhead and don't pay for leads . I'd say I am pretty average and work about 30 hrs /week. strictly personally producing right now . I have 90% retention and make about 5k a month . I've had a team before and was making considerably more money but was putting in considerably more hours. I also have seen people in my company that are more motivated than me make 20k+ a month. I don't have a spouse or kids so working remotely is perfect and lets me travel all over and I enjoy taking time off to explore . For someone that is willing to put in the time and effort , life insurance is a great long term career . Just make sure you look into leads , chargebacks , and residuals when you interview with a company and be prepared to put in work ."

— YouTube · I Asked 166 Life Insurance Agent How Much Money They ACTUALLY Make Per Month · 49 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MLoTTqEO2AY&lc=UgzvaarWYK3Ns1QxAWF4AaABAg>

↳ @MyPowerfulClips (4): "Where are you working where you don't pay for leads ?!"

↳ @patinamia (4): "how do you find clients without buying leads"

↳ @Lovebeyondfear1111 (0): "This is awesomeness !! Where do you see your career in the long run?"

"BadA\$\$leads scam I purchased some leads from badassleads.. those leads are a penny worth. Wrong numbers, disconnected numbers, bad emails. Just dont waste your money and generate your own. Seriously lead generation companies are ripping off Agents"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/

↳ bigalien1 (28): "Sometimes the name gives it away"

↳ Diligent_Throat304 (8): "They should rename bullsh*tleads lol"

↳ jwf1126 (7): "You should have taken your own names advice or even gone full deep throat with a company name like that. Lead gen sucks but there are companies out there that will at least put a good faith effort and give you the time a day and have some successes"

"Useful tip for new agents Stop paying for leads that's the wrong way to start off as a new agent you have to learn the business first so it's best to get with a agency that provides inbound leads and learning about handling chargebacks before you go independent it's a marathon not a sprint. If your with an agency that gives inbound leads and training your going to make money if your disciplined enough."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 16 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kxqsrvt/>

↳ (0): "Preach man, too many folks try to run before they can walk in this game. What kind of training setup helped you the most when you were just starting out?"

↳ (0): "Exactly man but I failed doing life insurance my success and sales came when I started doing Medicare and I would watch David Duford videos about tonality and sales techniques I still have more learning to go but it helped a lot bro"

↳ (0): "respect for you for not giving up"

"This is what they don't tell you is that you have to learn to generate your own leads. Don't waste your time I'm with the competitor of Aflac which is colonial life. I do Facebook ads, Tik Tok etc.. to generate my own leads it works. The old methods don't"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mcl3e3/i_already_hate_my_job/n5v01x4/

"Is buying leads just a "new agent" tax? When did you guys actually stop? I am coming up on my first year in Health (mostly ACA and some Medicare), and I've been consistently spending a lot on lead vendors. It's working okay—I'm closing deals, but my costs are also high. I was chatting with some vets in the industry, and I noticed that almost none of them seem to buy leads. Is buying leads is basically just a bridge tax you pay for the first 2–3 years? How did you guys stop buying leads - did you build a referral flywheel OR an inbound system? Looking to learn from your experiences. Thanks!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3obua/>

↳ (0): "Nope, purchased leads can be viable for agencies of any tenure-- it is assumed that by a couple years in you have found a lead provider that is providing you warm, actionable, relevant leads with a good close rate and ROI. Warm leads from your network will always trump these in cost and retention, however."

↳ (0): "Think about it this way: \-All agents have to have an abundance of prospects to have a chance of success. \-No prospects = No opportunities = you fail The question is: where do you get an abundance of prospects from? Some buy leads because it's the typical way to stay busy (think final expense, mortgage protection, etc.), while others successfully generate warm leads through referrals and organic strategies."

↳ (0): "Leads are just marketing. All businesses Market one way or another from Coca-Cola to real estate to insurance. You need to do a lot more marketing when people don't know you or your business or service. Here's a tip: you will do so much better to learn early in your career about two things to become a ratio to each other. The first is lifetime value of a client. That is how much money they make you from beginning and for as long as you have a business relationship with them. The second is the cost to acquire a client. You want your LTV to be as high as possible compared to your CAC as a ratio. Google and learn about this idea and do some thinking and apply it to your business and return to it week after week and it will become apparent and very important to you. Everything else revolves around this ratio from a business success standpoint in pure numbers. Myself and my agents use leads from many different sources. But about half my agents work almost purely on referrals now. It is very connected to time in the business. Obviously referrals produce better results than the vast majority of leads otherwise seen some interesting exceptions. Also it appears harder for phone sales agents to get a good referral engine going. My people are in person professionals doing this full time. So referrals build rather quickly and become highly valuable."

"It's just me, a solo agent now for 30 years. All health insurance, mostly Medicare. I work nothing but referrals, I don't buy leads at all. I work hard for 2 months and then cruise the rest of the year any taking a few appointments a week most on the phone anymore. I make about \$200k a year. I feel that's not bad at all considering how much time off I have. I'm always available for calls, so I go around the house doing projects most of the year with my Bluetooth headset on and when someone calls, I head into the office and work. I'm not out there to get rich or chest anyone. I have \$0 debt and my retirement is very well set. I figure I'm not going to burn myself out doing this job but work whenever I'm needed. It's a good life, but open enrollment is not easy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3z4tt/how_much_you_earn_as_insurance_agent/nq9pmvd/

"We don't cold call and we don't buy leads. We get steady clients but we aren't a huge agency at all. We're comfortable so we never really wrote like \$500k a year in new premium like some say here."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mk37eo/anyones_agency_not_do_coldcalling_for_leads/n7fvj7h/

"We do virtual. We are set up on first connect, Bolt, and smart choice. We don't buy leads. We work on referrals from people we know, existing customers, and relationships built with car dealerships and realtors or mortgage brokers. Would I have found that works best is to create a schedule that would set aside specific office hours for service work. Have certain times you do follow up for quotes. And have specific time to use to reach out to drum up new business. It's all about organizing."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wkdbcb/anyone_in_here_doing_solo_independent_from_home/pagr2rq/

"Don't buy leads from overseas!? Next you'll tell me not to send apple gift cards to the county sheriff with an Indian accent looking for me."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/mjvobq2/

"The best way to build a life insurance agency is to get referrals! The beneficiary is always your next prospect! Ask the open ended questions of who do you know.. Don't buy leads these IMO's serve as a in between and are just there to take part of your commission. Try to get as many direct contracts as possible! The industry is highly regulated so follow the rules. Sell to the need and service well and you will have a client for life and they will give you referrals! Been doing it for 23 years and I have a 1.7 million dollar book of business! Make sure to look at your contracts and make sure you get renewals because you will serve that customer for life and conduct annual policy reviews! Don't get caught up in the make 100,000 now! Don't take advance commissions get your commissions as earned!"

— YouTube · Why Do So Many Insurance Agents Quit? · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3jZki3D4Jok&lc=UgxxvRw-mF8yGzZmCd94AaABAq>

"So far, so good. Obviously, we all want more more more but given that I don't pay for leads or advertising, it's not a bad start at all."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lyho3b/i_started_my_own_agency_in_mid_may_been_in_the/n2u4dbj/

"You always got to look at your cost for acquisition or CPA when you buy leads and age leads might be really cheap and if they're 50 cents a piece but you have to buy a thousand to get a deal then your cost for acquisition is \$500 alternatively you can buy four or five live transfers and spend \$200 to \$250 or you can buy individual leads 10 to 30 each and spend two to \$300 besides the cost per acquisition there's the time aspect even if it costs the same amount of money it's better to use live transfers or leads because you don't have to work as art and you can close more business in the day Paige leads are great for people that are just starting out and don't have money for good leads You can pop them in a dialer or put them on automation It's not in my opinion a long-term strategy like live transfers or self generated leads are"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k24g9p/aged_leads_store/mnt6xv1/

"as someone who has been observing the lead vending space for a minute- everything you said is 100% accurate. i always tell people first and best bet is to generate your own leads through networking and referrals. second is to find a system and stick with it through thick and thin (within reason of course). My hope for this is to give the opportunity of direct mail to someone who feels priced out and hopefully we can get into a rhythm where they can be on board for a long period of time at a reasonable price. I agree with you, its gotten hit quite a bit in terms of pricing due to postage sky rocketing in the last 2-3 years. I believe postage alone has gone up over 12-15 cents in that span!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1quvey8/direct_mail_for_independent_agents/o3dfu9z/

"To answer your question of how to get better leads - dont pay for leads. Find out where the prospects you want to have as clients are and hang out there. Networking works when you have something in common. Not that buying leads won't work it's just inefficient and expensive. I've never bought something from a telemarketer or door knocker, would you? I'm glad you didn't sell to your friends and family though. Your book of business is captive there if you ever decide to leave. Good luck!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wgfngv/new_agent_at_new_york_life/paa3pz0/

"This happened to me too when I first started! When you do this with good intention you will do well. Insurance is not a get rich quick scheme no matter what anyone says. I left insurance sales and focused on ACA which aligns with my purpose which is to HELP people. Look into that and most importantly STOP paying for leads. Anytime a company is trying to sell you leads regardless of who they are, they are trying to scam you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/ouqr9cz/

"I mean, telling people to stop buying leads is an interesting way to put it then. Maybe stop buying shitty leads or scam websites who sell you old and worn out info. There's certainly lead sites that are custom to the individual agent, which can bring in more business. There's other agencies that do create ads for agents yes, but they don't give out information like numbers, emails, nor does it guarantee any interest."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466vj/stop_buying_leads/moachej/

"I don't pay for my leads at all my company pays for my leads I get paid \$250-500 per policy some days I make \$1000 a day just depends on the day it's the best move I've ever made my husband does the same job for a diff company so it's awesome"

— YouTube · How A Career Selling Medicare Policies Works · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=d2SmzwHbqfw&lc=Ugw3WNVLTbX-yv0OAd4AaABAq>

↳ @shoalingalarza3529 (2): "what company are you with may I ask?"

↳ @adampuentes4009 (0): "Please let me know what company you are with. That's exactly what I'm looking for"

"I dont buy leads either. Network. Write only quality business ask for referrals each time you do something great for your client. Book builds itself."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/n4kj8c9/

"Are you talking about ACA as in Affordable Care Act? Open enrollment for government health insurance is in November. No body is actively looking for health insurance unless they lost coverage. Don't buy aged leads. Waste of time and money."

— Facebook group comment · Insurance Agent Opportunities (USA) · 1 likes · <https://www.facebook.com/groups/2501016683509797/posts/4085419205069529/>

'It's a numbers game' · 18 documents · 18 voices

"The Lifeboat Mentality The art of selling is truly an art, and guess what, it's something that every single one of us needs to master - fast. I'm going to get the first, and what I think is the most important step out of the way immediately: **Stop trying to sell *products* and start selling *yourself*** When I first started, I always had this question in my sales experience: Why is it that one guy has extreme success selling the same product, and another guy doesn't? Let me tell you about a time when I sold life insurance that completely changed the way I sell, and will sell for the rest of my life. So, I got hired at a huge brokerage in Florida. We were contracted with 40+ different insurance agencies to market and sell their products. I had to be licensed to sell annuities, medicare products, health insurance, prescription drug packages, and life insurance. So, needless to say we had an **ARSENAL** of products to choose from. During the orientation, we were greeted by the companies top salesman. The idea was for him to come in and share his success, and answer any questions us newbies may have before we ventured out on our own. It came about time for him to come speak, and in my head I'm thinking some young 20-something was going to bolt through the door with excitement and enthusiasm. Wrong. In walks a 60-year old retired war-veteran who had been crushing the insurance game in this company for the last year, month after month! His annualized premium average was close to \$26,000 per month. (This is the amount of Premiums people that he sold to were paying on a monthly basis. He not only receives residuals off of this, sometimes he'll even receive a 90-95% commission off of the first-year premium total - If they pay \$100 per month, he receives around \$1000) I couldn't believe it. But, me transitioning from shock to understanding, I began to listen to him. His success was no secret. He literally worked "harder" than everyone else. His military mentality came into play big time in this field. Why? He would knock on 30 doors per day. Non stop, wake up at 7am, and not go home until 5pm, or until he successfully spoke to 30 people. His strength was in his numbers. Law of averages! If he got a "No." he wouldn't waste a second, bat an eye, or fold. He knew his power was in his ability to talk to as many people as possible. Day after day, same mentality: Do it, or die. (Not to that extent, but you get the idea!) **Takeaway One: Understand the law of averages, and commit to it!** However, although we had an arsenal to sell from, I became completely overwhelmed because it seemed impossible to take in all of the product specs and legalities, all while trying to create a smooth sales pitch. So, instead of focusing on things I didn't know, I just focused on one of the many things I could sell that would give me the best chance at success: life insurance. I modeled the success of the older salesman, and knocked door to door to offer our product relentlessly. But, door to door sales isn't as easy as it seems. Actually, it doesn't seem easy at all. Think about it. Have you ever bought anything from someone who randomly walked up to your door trying to sell something to you? The idea is crazy. But, it works. Numbers game. Same with cold calling, and same with any service. The idea is to put yourself in a position to collide your product with a consumer in demand, at the time they have made up their mind to purchase. If they haven't made up their mind to purchase, it's your job, as a salesman to help them. But, knowing how crazy this idea is, I had to separate myself and treat people as if they were my friends. I didn't come across as pushy, I came across as informative, and very confident - I adopted the **Life Boat Mentality** The Life Boat Mentality is simple: Your customers are drowning. They are drowning from poor quality products or services. You see them drowning in these products or services, and paddle on over in your Lifeboat. The idea is this: With impeccable trust, of course, you persuade your client to get in your life boat. Your life boat is the "best" option. And if it's not the best option, you need to find a company that offers the best option and sell that. (I'm not about selling garbage - Honestly) If you truly in your heart believe that what you are selling is the best option, the Lifeboat Mentality will help you tremendously. For example. I own a small residential repaint company now. I've taken the Lifeboat Mentality with me throughout my entire duration owning a business. I've got the branding where I want it, I have the production where it needs to be, and the Lifeboat mentality that I carry with me says this: Mr. & Mrs. Customer: I know that there is a TON of options in the marketplace. So many to choose from, however, I know this for a fact. There will be none other than my company that will show you the amount of respect and care you deserve throughout the entire tenure of us working for you. From the initial handshake to the final good-bye I can guarantee that our quality of service is of exemplary fashion. How do I ensure that this remains true? How do I have the confidence to pitch this? Because as the business owner, I insure it. My sales process is down to a science and has clear concise wording, professional formatting, and a great follow-up procedure. We have references and a great website for them to visit, and provide insurance and legal information up front. I ensure that I will be at each job to make sure that our quality of service is exactly as promised. In other words, I'm showing them that I "me", the "salesperson" am the lifeboat! It may seem silly at first, but think of yourself as a lifeboat. Start saving people! Happy selling! P.S if you're interested in knowing more about the painting business, feel free to PM me I'd be happy to answer any questions you may have!"

— r/sales · 47 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/7tph4u/the_lifeboat_mentality/

↳ krimpenrik (8): "Exactly how i sold used cars. After 10 years it was easy to see that a lot of times they buy the car from you because they trust you instead of a cheaper car at a competitor. I wasn't a sleek guy all dressed up. Often with a oil stained Polo because I was helping out in the garage. It doesn't matter, even helps to gain trust"

↳ JDogNumeroUno (5): "> Mr. & Mrs. Customer: I know that there is a TON of options in the marketplace. So many to choose from, however, I know this for a fact. There will be none other than my company that will show you the amount of respect and care you deserve throughout the entire tenure of us working for you. From the initial handshake to the final good-bye I can guarantee that our quality of service is of exemplary fashion. This is Brilliant! Very much like Jay Abraham, well done!"

↳ [deleted] (4): "Thanks for the great post!"

"The shxty part is most agencies teach their agents it's a numbers game while they sell you over priced aged leads. Then you're outside all day chasing shxx leads like an axxhole and then they give you poor sales training. My advice is to master reframing and tonality. Get those two aspects down and fine tune your pitch and you'll increase your close rate. I been there and it honestly was horrible. Left and got into AI SaaS but if i had to do it again I'd master those two aspects first. Also remember Chase compassion, not commission."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ueswou/i_fully_respect_the_hustle_that_is_insurance/otmgyw8/

"Great video. Could you possibly make a video discussing how to get better response rate for leads. I have leads coming in, but they never pickup / say they aren't interested before we even start talking. Is it just a numbers game?"

— YouTube · Day In The Life Of A Life Insurance Agent (Work From Home) · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=D8Uca74uodA&lc=Ugwynpxo6VmZ3oyIODh4AaABAg>

↳ @AdvancedAgentMarketing (1): "Yeah definitely, have you seen our video about Kixie?"

↳ @joego9851 (0): "@AdvancedAgentMarketingI will have to find it and check it out again."

↳ @eastcoastdevereaux7154 (0): "Same! Very frustrating"

"Following to hear others input. We have been struggling with quality leads as well. And I'm not talking we expect to close every deal, but we have purchased a ton of internet leads who said that they never requested a quote in the first place (InsuranceQuotes, Everquote, etc.). We understand its a numbers game at the end of the day. But we at least want a chance to win their business, and we aren't even getting that most of the time and just spending money on leads with 0 potential."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1orzwnm/leads/nnu829f/>

"My advice with these people, before you do anything see if they have an SEP. I know you're in open enrollment but for future reference. If they don't, go immediately to your SEP questions. If you don't have anything end the call. If they want an increase to their food card or giveback, filter them in Sunfire and find whatever has that specific thing that's higher than what they have. Pitch the increased benefits, if they bite great, if they don't move to the next thing that's better. Most of these people have no intentions of signing so get them off the phone fast. It's a numbers game."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1idj71g/i_sold_my_first_medicare_policy/ma31xog/

"Hi Cody, great insights! I completely agree that in order to have better results it's important to dial MORE. We've launched our AI Power Dialer that helps agents boost their pick-up rate, designed specifically for the insurance industry. I truly believe in the power of collaboration and the wisdom of the community, so I would really appreciate your insights as an industry expert to help us shape our product and ensure its alignment with agents' needs. Could you spare 20 minutes for a discussion? Thanks!"

— YouTube · How ALL Insurance Agents Should Dial Leads! (John Wetmore at 8% Virtual) · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eMbCoudLNaM&lc=UgzL8tmEF9gy4HG1-zN4AaABAq>

"That is fantastic! I am proud of you for trying something new and stepping outside of what some people find comfortable. My staff used to make fun of me, because I would always tell them that "consistency is key". If you are consistent in your process and you ask the questions each time, it will become easier, and you will feel better about it. Would I like every conversation to be a rapport building milestone and getting to know the client and getting to know their family? Sure. Is that reasonable expectation? Nope. Get the sale, get a policy. Get anything that gets your toes in the door. Then worry about rapport building. If your quote page or quote sheet is pages long, I would encourage you to sit with your manager or owner and see what can be done to shave that down. No one, and I mean NO ONE wants to spend an hour on the phone for an initial quote. Now, I stated initial. That first interaction, you have five, maybe ten minutes. However, if you can find out in that five to ten that this person has rentals, cars, boats, trailers, etc. THEN we can start having a longer conversation. Best of luck. It is a numbers game, the more you quote the more you sell. I still think 7 leads a day at a captive agency is light. If your agency averages a 15% close rate, that is one sale a day, and internet leads are typically going to be mono-line, single car policies, which that makes it tough. Even if you can keep at 15% close-rate, that is still only 25 items a month (or 25 policies however you want to track it). You could start a process, fourteen days after your sale, call what you sold, do a checkup, ask for referrals. Turn that into more sales. But now I am building out your follow-up process. You should talk to your boss about doing a follow-up process."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1w6w1cg/cheap_leads/p7yddru/

"I mean, I've had this same experience even when I worked at other agencies that were heavy outbound. I get that it's a numbers game and some of the data is always going to be a little chaotic, but when every other lead says they never requested anything, it kills the ROI. That's why I'm shifting my strategy. I'm trying to move toward generating more inbound interest, because people who actually raise their hand are way more open to having a real conversation compared to cold outbound. On top of that, I've been digging deep into all the carriers I'm contracted with and now I'm zoning in on specific counties where I can offer the strongest coverage. If I can tighten up the geography and focus only where the product lineup is strongest, I think the conversions will follow."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1orzwnm/leads/no7jr0d/>

"The last thing you want to explore is lower volume lead flow. You have to have a constant lead flow. For f2f direct mail was king for so long and still is viable of course if you keep the cost reasonable compared to social media leads (which is nigh impossible) lol (pirates reference) lol....anyhow ...in my opinion direct mail has been unseated due to the cost. I toggle on and off lead generators as needed creating my own leads for my daily work whether it is tele or f2f. The only 2 things that really matter are these....if you don't quit you won't failactivity triumphs over everything else. So regardless of lead types dont stop and stay f^*%^* active."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1quvey8/direct_mail_for_independent_agents/o3d7crb/

"Appreciate the honesty — that's exactly what I'm looking for. I may be defining "hunting" too loosely. Right now I'm quoting around \$10k-20k premium/day, following up with 20 old leads/day, and prospecting 10 commercial accounts/day, but I know old leads will dry up. When you were building from scratch, what did your actual daily hunting activity look like? And for a newer one-person agency, what revenue target would you reverse engineer everything from? Trying to figure out where my activity is productive vs. where I'm just staying busy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over/from/ooeq115/

"Hey Cody, I like your pitch. From my professional view point those folks won't not buy I know it's a numbers game, but if I was buying leads from you and went to talk to those people, I would consider those leads to be complete garbage. Very low quality. A Lotta time, gas money wasted. I think they need to be screened even more!"

— YouTube · Live Dialing Insurance Leads! [Final Expense Insurance] · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RL6Y5qig0Wg&lc=UgyUYtwQpRnzudXc0p4AaABAq>

"I had not tried them, so thanks for the warning. I have been using Integrity and usalifeleads. Neither are perfect, but I have yet to find an internet lead that is. Even my self-generated leads will get bad #s/info, it's all just a numbers game and I just look for the best value."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/mnpa4ta/

"Agreed. I use integrity and usalifeleads, I'd say they're similar in contact/conversion. It's all a numbers game, and with internet leads I've come to accept I need volume and then just grind through them."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/mnsnmgm/

"Do you sell group products or just individual? Almost all of my Life Insurance leads are referrals, so it might take time to build that. It's a numbers game"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rkajao/aged_leads/o8mp69/

"Well, while some of it may be close to hitting the point it fails in an overall sense of proper marketing 101. James's No #1 Rule, stay in front of the client, one way or another you have to stay in front of them so when they are ready you are there! So exactly how does one do that? Okay if you take the above advice, which is a tad short sighted you won't be in front of them unless you so happen to walk in or call at the very time they are ready. Which is the underlying reason that makes the response rate, basically if you get a 3% response rate what you have done is actually have good timing 3 out of 100 times you make contact. Now depending upon what you are selling and what you are making will have direct effect on what you can pay out to market. Yet though I can't imagine on picking one thing and sticking with it alone. So one does multiple systems to increase business, while B2B and Telemarketing is aggressive I can't imagine not including more passive systems to support your aggressive marketing. Such as, 1. Yellow Pages 2. Letters to leads that didn't buy and then the re-call. 3. Post Cards to prospects that didn't make initial appointment. 4. Ad's or submit articles to Trade Magazines and local papers. As always activity is the key. Warm markets, don't let that go by. Call it what you want but the fact is it is quite effective. Make the list of family and friends, now I don't support the idea of selling to family and friends but the contacts they can provide you is crucial. Take my wife, a Case Manager at UTMC, a highly awarded at that. Now how many contacts do you think I can work through her? There is not a Medical Durable Equipment or Home Care base in Knoxville that won't give me their ear. Of course sometimes you have to be real careful how you handle the communications. Have a friend that is a well known employee of a County Courthouse. Now I'm close in getting a contract for a voluntary LTC, he got me in to meet with the HR person and I simply presented a voluntary group JH to them. Looks good so far. First thing they told me is that they already have service, yet I ask how many of their employees know anything about it? The response was classic, no idea! Quite correct I said because I ask a few of your people and they had the same answer, no idea of the plan. Obviously their agent or agency is failing in their job and that is to promote their plan. Why bother having a benefit that isn't promoted, it isn't your job and they are failing. Just lets slide this over here and we'll take care of it for you!"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Individual Health Insurance Marketing · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/individual-health-insurance-marketing.34/#post-441>

"Health biz is great, just takes years to build. Have you looked at using ICHRA to get into the door? Do some research on IHCRA if you haven't. Some other things I'd try: look for new business formations in your local newspaper and go drop in on them. Fresh meat! =) Also, how much activity are you doing? Are you cold knocking 30 businesses daily or making 100+ phone calls daily? A lack of activity is usually the cause of all sales woes. If you're looking for ways to bridge the gap with final expense, consider doing in-person seminars at local independent senior living facilities. Did those for 9 months and made around 100 sales with zero expense. Have seen dozens of other agents do well at it, too. Further, you could look at doing talks at small group church meetings, senior activity centers, about Medicare, final expenses, etc. Cost nothing and creates the best leads. Good luck. Remember it's normal that the first few years are incredibly difficult as you find your place. Stick with it and eventually you'll find your niche and begin getting traction!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rgt03f/quit_150k_w2_sales_to_start_an_agency_6_months_in/o7wp2j/

"The world of cold calling and cold emailing is almost gone. Now it's about building relationships and developing loyal clients. That can take anywhere from 6 months - 2+ years. Some people will say the cold calling works but not everyone sells the same thing and I find that it's about timing. It's a numbers game because you are hoping that one of the people you call are having issues. If you find the company with an issue, the next challenge is, can you solve it."

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rgt03f/quit_150k_w2_sales_to_start_an_agency_6_months_in/o7x0lzi/

"How to Start an Insurance Agency (IMO) Okay, basically I'm at an Insurance Agency called Roman Financial that is providing me no value, apart from constant jargon and motivation and looking at fast cars. I'm 19 and hit the ground running right away selling 5 figures in my first few weeks. I quickly realized that I'm way underpaid as far as "street level" for the final expense providers we go through. Good news is I didn't sign any NDA or a non-compete. As of right now, I am 10000% unnecessarily paying my upline hundreds of dollars that I'm breaking my back to get dialing 8 hours a day on measly 75-80% commission. With little research I've found that the exact same insurance providers give 120% first year to agents. Apart from the 45% of my check that I'm giving to my undeserving upline they are also making me pay for my CRM and the shiddy leads. I've figured that I'd go my own way and own my own lead source to grab leads rather than listen to their manipulation all day. In this way, I want my recruits to be taken care of instead of letting people fail out of the industry going into debt through leads and chargebacks. Long story short, they keep telling me to dial more and to drop the ego. I know I'm worth more than what I'm getting commission wise and nobody is going to have control over how much money I make anymore. That being said, I plan to create my own agency/IMO. Where my agents aren't paying most of their checks to me and don't have to fend for themselves in a constant uphill battle. I plan to have everybody pool for leads to fund ads for the lead source and direct mail etc. I plan to promote recruiting but have everybody come in at a fairly decent commission. No rah rah bullshi, just effective business owners who want to succeed and slam deals. I plan to pay appt setters to book quality leads so guys don't have to dial like their lives depend on it. I have a general outline of what I need to do: name, logo, llc/scorp, e&o, recruiting, marketing, but as far as contracting with providers, what's the best way to go about doing that? If anybody has experience building an agency lmk? ORRR if anybody is seemingly in the same boat and would like to build an empire with me... i'm taking partner applications lol. EDIT: My upline saw this and "released" me which is hilarious since I was getting them paid in everyway. Unfortunately for them I have everything laid out already and already talked to a business accountant and everything. Roman if you guys are reading this, You are 100% correct when you say that I'm gonna try to take my recruits with me. Actually you're 90% correct because you used the word "try". As I was recruiting them I already told them it wouldn't be long until we left Roman just get your licensing course. And hey, when my agencies up and running you can always come work for me at a higher contract than Norm and Carlo got you at. Remember you're never gonna be richer than your upline. :)"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 24 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15nmmk7/how_to_start_an_insurance_agency_imo/

↳ Tahoptions (8): "You're still going to have to use an IMO for a long time until you can justify a direct contract (millions in production for most carriers). That said, if this is final expense, there are plenty of IMOs that will just give you the 120% out of the gate and move you higher with production (a few 100k vs millions), especially if you don't need anything except the contract. You may even be able to negotiate higher starting levels with some IMOs if you're actively recruiting. This just takes a lot of work asking around and finding a fit."

↳ z4ckm0rris (6): "You're describing exactly everything that is wrong within this segment of the business, it's pure MLM bullshit. No one should be giving up 25% of their comp for "training and support", not even the newest of agents especially if they're paying for their own leads out of pocket. Even at 100% commission levels, their upline is already making more than enough money off of whatever they write that they should be invested in that agent's success."

↳ Thin-Butterfly-4436 (4): "I just started doing all of this on my own as well and chose Ritter as my FMO. Couple reasons that I chose them is they follow the same commission and chargeback structure as you would contracting directly with carriers off the carrier website and they also "pay up to 50% of your expenses depending on how well you sell including lead costs and marketing" which would save a ton of money... there's a discord I just joined where I was able to ask questions to people who are already doing this on their own and have experience in the field! Also look in to getting your leads from sources where they are inbound, filtered to the states your licensed in, and prequalified so you don't waste your time dialing!!! Typically I close 40% of the inbound calls just to give you an idea."

'The money is in the renewals / your book' · 12 documents · 12 voices

"Possible complaint being filed against me. I am an independent life and health Insurance agent who may be having a complaint filed against me from a former client of mine. I have hundreds of clients enrolled in ACA plans (marketplace, Obamacare) and this person was one of them. He was enrolled in a plan and opted into automatic renewal. The plan was renewed and he called me back saying he was never aware his plan was renewed, because he was requiring a 1095 form to file his taxes. He called the marketplace and they told him to "file a complaint" against the agent. I have a recently recorded call where I told him he opted in for the automatic renewal and he didn't negate against it. I do have E&O insurance as well. I would never enroll a customer without their consent, I am just worried about what will happen next. He is losing \$1800 on his tax return due to him being enrolled in this plan, but it's not my fault. Any advice would be greatly appreciated, thank you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1c7go61/possible_complaint_being_filed_against_me/

↳ Stratosto3 (8): "Provide CMS with the info. Unfortunately they ARE cracking down, and you being independent means the heat goes to you. Explain to CMS that you have audio with explicit consent. He will then have to prove that he did not know, which you have consent to. That's your best solution. Make sure it's done by email if possible, any paper trail matters tremendously. You have no need to speak with the client in question, if you were wondering. Let CMS handle it. Sooner or later you will have this happen, mostly due to the clients being aloof during their own enrollment and not answering questions when you ask them if they have any."

↳ Stratosto3 (6): "There's no need to. If you did the income correctly and he didn't update it, then that's on him."

↳ [deleted] (5): "Don't sweat it! You've done nothing wrong. These complaints are filed all the time and 95% of them are found to be baseless. I know it's nerve wracking and it's not a good feeling but the truth is if you do this for any length of time you will eventually get a complaint filed against you. I have been through it myself and after providing all forms of documentation and being forthright and open with the claims investigator who is just doing their job, the claim was closed and found to be baseless. Believe me when I tell you that there are actual cases of malice and this certainly isn't one. You have not done anything wrong and you have it all on record. You're going to be fine."

"Yes, but years 1 & 2 are solid working years (build a base for renewals) in health expect about 40-60k in new business, (money to you). This is health insurance, my niche is Medicare and I love it. By year 5 you should be somewhere near 200k annually (gross) with renewals and new clients. Oh, and I don't really work that hard, if I did my numbers would be double..."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/pkdfdw/independent_insurance_agent_a_viable_career/hc6m3ct/

"I'm yet to find a decent lead vendor in many years in health. Best way is to build your book with referrals - like really be a good person to your clients, then when OEP/AEP get closer, you gotta ask those clients for referrals. Every once in a while, I'll try a new lead company and sometimes it works out but typically, the leads get worse and worse over time (that's their business model in many cases), so it becomes not worth the time or money."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p0mqo2/is_it_just_me/npo7fdj/

"Hey I'm curious about your thoughts, on how you should approach clients with older term policies that aren't up for renewal yet, but could have the potential for new insurance plans to be placed?"

— YouTube · Generate UNLIMITED Final Expense Leads On Facebook In 2024 (Full Tutorial) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aTFTo3FiUCM&lc=UgyvyhH5w4ifrYX9anR4AaABAq>

↳ @dylanlafollette7804 (2): "Term Policies typically pay out 2% of the time since people outlive that policy. I would just explain that life insurance should be there when something happens. Then you can offer to write whole life, or a longer new term policy. And I ask the client if they believe that as you get older, the more likely you'll have an illness or anything that would stop them from getting insurance. If they can agree to either of those, they're likely to move forward. Hope this helps."

↳ @aicejermiah4885 (2): "Let them know they are basically giving money to charity for the insurance, and show them the rate increase w their policy or call in to the company and ask them the questions so they can hear it, try to set them up w an IUL or whole depending on age. And let them know you may pay more but this will never end and it has living benefits."

↳ @rick73020 (1): "This is exactly why I offer a free "policy review" for anybody that already has a policy. Review their current policy and offer them something that's better than what they currently have in place. Make it a no-brainer for them to go with you."

"To be fair a few things turned me off. A lot of it was commission structure. I used Agentero for small GL and although I do like them I don't like that I have no access to my larger policies and get as earned commissions. I'm used to managing my own accounts and getting up front payment. Also I need the full commissions paid for budget reasons. That is what I am used to. I don't want to write a \$6000 policy and get \$60 a month for a year. So that was a big portion of me backing off. I thought I'd see more commission growth. I would absolutely suggest them to anyone starting out but if you have a decent book already it's tough to get as earned. I know there were months and months I didn't get Life Insurance commissions from them and had to bug them to pay me. They did a little at a time then stopped again. It seemed to be off and on. I finally gave up. So that was a big part of my turn off as well, I just shouldn't have to bug you to pay me, they should have come to me about it first. I do wish now I would have just done direct appointments. I think had I done that I would find more reason to have stayed with it. I had a great mentor who was very helpful and I need to actually get in touch with him, but a lot of my issues stemmed from the size of my own book. I have a decent book and a staff. I am dealing with rate increases on personal lines which has taken a chunk of time. Being on social media stalking comments was proving to be very difficult. Add in the admin work, moving, new schools, new jobs, etc. I just didn't have room. Personal and business just kept me too busy. When I did it I realized it was on the weekends and taking time from my family and friends. I need that break for my own mental health. That was another part of it as well. You have to make the time and for me that was usually weekends. I say that to say if you have the time, are a smaller agency or building from scratch, you are 100% correct in your assessment, and I encourage anyone reading this that is getting a book going that this is a great avenue AND I can get you with a great mentor to help you. I just felt like for my size I was chasing small \$60 commissions being paid at \$6 a month, when I could devote the time to chase \$2000 commissions paid up front. I did not mean to question or push your methods, again I had someone helping me to do the same thing and I absolutely saw some good results! I just realized I was chasing smaller fish when I had bigger ones I could eat. However I think for me as well... I am ready to pull back and would rather pay someone else to do commercial. I've been in this for 30 years. I started at 19 and I just don't care to be in the agent seat anymore, I'd rather be behind the scenes. I'd also like to move on to overseeing other businesses ventures as well to diversify income. Using the social media method takes A LOT of time and you have to be ready to jump fast on a lead. I just realized for me I was going a different direction than I needed to. I have an overwhelming feeling the older I get the more I want my time back. For ME being on social media chasing leads was causing me to give more of it up. I'd rather at this point just have a remote commercial agent that works their own way but has access to my companies. I have 20 commercial companies as well as several huge broker network. All of them pay 10-25% up front of which we'd have a very fair split in their favor. It's a great opportunity for someone to build up a decent income even if it were part time. In other words I think I personally took on the project when after 30 years I just wasn't ready to give up that much time working it. Good luck to you as you go forward!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o1c6iq/how_keyboard_warrior_marketing_built_my/nlr0kp/

"@WitsEndFL Thanks. I'll now pay special attention to max out of pocket when comparing plans. Some sources say you should start learning about Medicare 6 months before you are eligible, and as much as I hate it, it's true. It's scary to be near the enrollment deadline (whatever it is in relation to when you need your effective date to be, which I'm still not sure, due to unknown processing time after you apply), and you haven't learned enough about a very complicated topic. Just today, I'm learning from a BOOK on Medicare, that I have to produce a birth certificate which I don't even have, before I can sign up. So I have no clue how an agent even signs me up for a plan if I can't yet enroll with the government. One agent I know said Florida was a hugely expensive state for Medicare costs, so I don't know why you're calling their plans good. What prospecting methods did you use? Which ones work? Did you buy people free dinners? Do all the meals pay for themselves in commissions as a result? Did you use powerpoint in restaurant meeting rooms? You hated it, but I would enjoy it as long as the money was there. I've done 100% commission sales before, and only came to hate prospecting it when it didn't pay off after the real estate market tanked. I'm used to speaking in public and enjoy giving presentations. But I'm not paying for 25 dinners at \$20/pop if everybody just eats and leaves. I suspect good agents are eventually making thousands of dollars over time as a result of their meal investments. Some presentations are titled "Medicare Made Simple in 1 hour" which of course is a crock. Medicare is complicated, and you have to memorize a whole book to be able to answer anyone's odd questions. What they mean is, "I can give you a broad overview in 1 hour that barely scratches the surface." It allows prospects a chance to get to know the agent in a group setting, but that's about it. No one walks away remembering all that stuff. If anything, they walk away in a fog. I can already tell it will be much more costly in time, and possibly gas (if you can't get them to drive across town to come into your office) to sell to even half the room, as compared to a canned presentation to 15+ people at once, which is the easy part. The work comes later. But I'm surprised there aren't more people doing the free meal shotgun approach to maximize the hourly income. People I've met at meetings say they get 15-20 telemarketing calls per day, which I've read is against the law. I haven't gotten any. I mainly get junk in the mail, and there's no way to differentiate one agent from the next. Assuming a new agent did well and wanted to keep doing it, what's the minimum numbers of year you'd recommend it takes for the overall process of getting licensed and building up referrals and residuals for the whole thing to be worth it? I'm thinking that if you start young, it's more likely worth it, making more each year. But if you're looking for part-time income after retiring from your main career, it may be too late if you're going to quit in less than 5 years and retire for good. (or die)"

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgwznXpDAJG44WTG054AaABAg_9lUZZMzAxJm9loBO8nfeFK

"These sales are pretty easy though right? These are people that have actually requested info. on life insurance which they've realized they need and which means they're pretty much ready to buy? All you have to do is do a great presentation. It's a done sale. But what about when you have to reach out to cold leads who don't have life insurance on their mind, who are young and don't think they need life insurance now, who give you every rebuttal in the book from "I don't have any people who depend on me", "I have life insurance at work, I don't need more life insurance", "I don't have time today" and "Not interested"? Also, let me tell you, in this industry's male agents are looked upon more as the professional agent, and when you have female agents these folk usually think you're the secretary 😂😂😂 it sucks, but sadly that's how it is"

— YouTube · Live Dialing Insurance Leads! [Final Expense Insurance] · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RL6Y5qig0Wg&lc=UgzztREItkgrwd0U03hp4AaABAg>

"I currently work for Globe Life American Income and started about 2 months ago. Some of these comments are valid, especially about paying for licensing/training, but that's pretty standard for getting licensed in insurance anywhere. My experience personally has been very different from a lot of these comments. During training I called on my trainer's leads so he could teach me the system and help on appointments, but I was still getting paid on my own sales. It's definitely not easy money. You have to be willing to grind, make calls, book appointments, and handle rejection. Some people love that environment and some people hate it. I'm not here saying it's perfect, but I also don't think every office/agency experience is the same. Just wanted to share my honest experience so far."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlyhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/ol36w7y/

"How effective is the old lead hunting? Are you mostly personal lines? Most buyers in insurance are doing so ahead of a renewal, so your prospecting should be lined up accordingly. In personal lines and micro commercial, it's a very commoditized product where price is a majority buying driver. That space is really a numbers and efficiency game. I spend my time on commercial accounts in the \$50k-\$250k space, with a few accounts north of that. As far as reverse engineering numbers, you need to base them off your current book and then work towards going up market."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/oersjio/

"Because agents who provide renewals typically don't pay as high on first term, and also don't typically provide leads. If someone wants/needs to make more money in the short term, a captive paying 8% of first time and funneling the person quote opportunities is a much easier path. I've also seen so many producer arrangements where the person only gets renewals as long as they remain employed at the agency. If you don't actually own the book and can just be let go and lose it on a whim, that's really not something I'd put a lot of stock in."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wmlfyg/no_commission_on_renewals/pbaro4m/

"Our agency pays a base salary and drives every lead across the agents desk. We don't pay agents renewal comission."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wmlfyg/no_commission_on_renewals/pbexnnt/

"Real_AMG said: Nobody said you needed to write D-SNP to sell 12 months a year. I'm suggesting that you felt the need to undermine this thread with that T-65 comment because you are insecure that your book is small. So just to clarify: - Yes, not all agents sell D-SNP. - No, the fact that you don't sell D-SNP doesn't mean you have a small book. - Yes, the fact that you feel the need to undermine anybody talking about the D-SNP market positively suggests the fact that you are insecure about having a small BoB. Click to expand... Again, you should check your assumptions at the door. I don't undermine anyone talking positively about marketing DSNP. Maybe if you'd use more than a second grade reading comprehension, you'd be able to read where I actually say God love people that work DSNP their go to product, because I don't want to.... Meaning I'm glad others serve this niche, because I dont. That's not "undermining" DSNP, or anyone that markets them. It's saying you don't have to sell it to work year round. Whipping out the BoB line shows some pretty significant immaturity on your end. On my end, I turn business away that I don't want to deal with. If I was truly insecure about my book, I'd write every piece of garbage that came across my desk. Just because I understand your reading comprehension is poor, I'm not saying DSNP is garbage... I'm saying that I don't have to write everyone that CALLS ME (because I don't chase for work) which invalidates your very misinformed assumption that I'm insecure about my book."

— Insurance-Forums.com · 3 Reasons To Focus On DSNP · https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/3-reasons-to-focus-on-dsnp_107363/#post-1407311

'Read the contract: who owns your book?' · 11 documents · 11 voices

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

↳ Legio-V-Alaudae (45): "If it was so easy and well paying, they wouldn't have to advertise the hell out of the jobs. I'm sorry you didn't have a healthy amount of skepticism when conducting due diligence."

↳ Candid_Worth_3629 (25): "Did you not ask for any advice from this subreddit or do any research prior to leaving your 9-5? Everyone would've told you to keep the main job and start out part time. It's also really important to be at a place that doesn't make you churn \$ for leads. Most are MLM schemes"

↳ jordan32025 (20): "Anyone who doesn't understand that AP written is not the same as the commission percentage shouldn't start a life insurance business. Also, going into it thinking it's a "job" is recipe for guaranteed failure. There is some financial literacy needed. This precisely why I don't recruit people who are not already actively selling consistently with a good carrier. They already know how to run a business."

"Great idea. Favorite telesales carriers: RNA, Prosperity and Trinity. SS billing + voice sign for all 3. Favorite lead: Real-time telemarketed call back with verified checking, ages 50-79 and agrees to speak with an agent. Basically telemarketers calling on DNC scrubbed and TCPA verified data to call on (old FB leads or Journaya/Trusted Form verified) + scrubbed against TCPA Blacklist Alliance and inputting into a form to serve it up in a CRM immediately. Tip: You need proper training and sales systems to make telesales work. If you take your DM leads and try to sell them over the phone with your typical f2f presentation, you'll fail. If you buy internet leads and don't have proper sales training or sales systems, you'll fail. My advice is either partner with a telesales-focused agency with an open release policy (hey, telesales isn't for everyone) or wait it out. Don't waste any time/money unless there's a proven system in place."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Telesales Tips · 11 reactions · https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/final-expense-telesales-tips_101595/#post-1344555

"It really just depends on the leads i buy, the most expensive ones right now for me are \$13.00 a lead.. Typically you want to reinvest 10-15% of what you're wanting to make back into your business. So if you want to make 10,000 a month you need to invest at LEAST 1,000 back into leads and stuff like that. It's all about your numbers too. Warm market leads are better than cold market in my opinion. I've spent about \$400 in leads and i've made 2 sales off of those that have covered the \$400 and then some. Life insurance is a little different than other insurance i feel like, you REALLYYYYY have to grind. It's hard but once you figure out your numbers it's like a challenge against yourself every month haha."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jpsc95/it_finally_happened/ml267eh/

"You need to be released from your current broker, then you need to sign up with an IMO (not an FMO), which is an independent marketing organization. The easiest products to sell are final expense, mortgage protection, and Medicare Advantage. After that you can get into Annuities and so forth once you have a responding customer base. Our people sell two to six policies per week, grossing \$4k to \$10k gross per month. And you know you do not get paid the full amount, and you have your lead cost, so that comes out of your gross. Honestly, most agents do not make anything because they do not do the work or make the calls they need to make. 20% of agents sell more than 80% of policies."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1adi8ew/any_tips_on_succeeding_as_a_health_insurance_agent/kk28uwh/

"I wouldn't go with Amerilife. I started with them when I first entered in the industry, and when it was time for me to go, they locked all my carriers, and sent me an email saying I owe a bond of over a 1000 dollars. I couldn't work during the Medicare AEP with a different agency because they did not want to release me. Although it stopped me from working in Medicare last year, I was fortunate enough to get hired for ACA. If you don't pay their bond, you will have to go through a self release which is a headache."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wgp7hi/i_have_an_interview_for_amerilife_tomorrow_and_im/pa67a89/

"I'd suggest investing in Cole X-Dates - it's \$1k for a year but will give you nearly unlimited contacts to call state wide. Get yourself a dialer like CallTools and pair that up with a script and, whalah, many leads."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1e04srx/any_pc_agents_have_luck_door_knocking_to_start/lcnavqg/

"Help with my future plan in insurance at a young age. Aswell as sharing my story. Before you start reading this thinking that I'm some 15yo that doesn't know what he is talking about, let me start and tell the entire story of how I got the job and what I'm doing now. I am looking for advice for my future. I am currently a marketer for a Farmers Insurance agency in Southern MN, I got this job through my own wits and reaching out, not being a "nepo" by any means. HOW I FOUND AND GOT THE OPPORTUNITY - To start, I want/wanted a future in financial services, so I set up a meeting with my school guidance counselor, I told her about my dreams and aspirations. My guidance counselor was impressed by my ambition at my young age and my knowledge of investments and sales, she showed me a website for our county, and from which was a list of youth jobs/internships. Seeing the opportunity, as soon as I got home, I turned on my computer and scrolled through the list of opportunities, nothing much interested me as they were all internships/job shadows with no pay and tight schedules. As I scrolled further, I saw one that stood out to me, it said Farmers Insurance (Agency Name) (Work Experience, Data Entry, Administrative Duties) 17+, and it looked to be the best one to me and I could care less about not being 17+, so I skipped sending in any sort of form or resume as prompted. I searched up the office on google maps and called the agency #, from what I can remember the conversation is summarized by something like this. I called and said I saw the posted opportunity on said website and then asked if there was any wiggle room on the age, he told me yes and discussed some things I would be doing in the role, office work, calling and service. He asked me if I could meet with him on Monday to discuss it further and told me about how he would pay for all licensing when we get there and how there many ways to make a good income in this career, I told him about my interest in finance and investments. He asked me if insurance was a career I wanted (I told him yes, but I was unsure, but it was the most logical answer), then we finished up our conversation and set up a time that Monday. Afterwards I was so sure I had the job I rushed to tell my parents I'm putting in my 2 weeks at my former McDonalds job and canceling my lawn mowing business. They told me not to be so sure for my interview, I assured them I got the job and that it was just a meeting. When the "interview" came my dad came with me to the office as the owner invited him in as well, we sat down in his office, and he discussed more of what I would be doing and my future with Farmers Financial Services and discussed further things I would be doing with my now career, as well as asking how much I was looking to make an hour (He never said it was a paid position, and he never mentioned it being paid), I told him 16\$ an hour and he told me that could work. When me and my father left the office, we laughed in the car because my parents thought it was an interview, which as he found out in real time it most definitely was not, as the owner started the conversation with "This is what you'll be doing on Monday" LOL. FIRST MONTH OR SO OF THE JOB - The first day, I came to office early and the owner had me sit down and discussed about selling insurance, and after that brief conversation he sat me at my desk, gave me a pen and paper and told me to make a script that I would use (after he had me study a small Q&A packet). He left and told me I got 20 minutes and we'll check in, I sat perplexed and had no idea what I was going to write, after I took about 5 minutes to create a rough draft, I called my boss back to look it over, and we played pretend calling with a prospect/lead. When he threw out "I'm not interested" I sat frozen for a good couple of seconds trying to think of something, then we fixed and refined my script. The second day he told me I won't be ready for calling yet unless I thought otherwise, I said the latter. Then he showed my first look of a lead pipeline (Agency Zoom), and then told me to go ahead and dial these leads and many won't pick up and that I will mess up, so I sat calling these aged leads and working with my script I set 2 appts on my second day as a 15yo, he was surprised but told me to throw my bonus tag on them and showed me how to set the appt for the producer (it was just me and him in office at this time for now). For my first month I set many appts and had live transfers consistently (after my boss told me I would get a 25\$ bonus for anyone given estimates, regardless of closing), I asked what my title was for my position, he paused for a moment and then told me I was a "Marketer" SOME CONTEXT - My boss is highly impressed with me, as my predecessors in this role were a waste of his time and money, they were much older than me and worked longer hours, and they haven't had as many bonuses as I have from transfers or appts. He told me an okay one he had hired made about 4 bonuses in 2 months, for reference on a really good day I'll make 4 bonuses in a max of 5 hours dialing. Aswell as his compliments how he never has to watch me because I do my job consistently, and that I dial well above the industry average with a manual dial LOL. My boss is a great guy, he pays me well, I know he loses money on me when making new business but overtime he will make his money back with renewals. He also mentions he doesn't mind paying me about the 41\$ (1 Hour is average time for transfer, and the bonus added) because he pays for live dial transfers and they won't be nearly as good as my in-office transfer. I once cold called an aged lead, (wrong name and everything) and then created a new profile for them with data mid call, transferred and we closed on them with a full bundle. CONTINUING FURTHER - Continuing this job for 5 months now as a marketer, my role consists more of than just SDR work, I create ads and postcards, going door to door, running booths during events, creating leads in the local area with data, and I have completely moved away from a script when dialing. I have left a large gap in the timeline, so I just want to add some small things here, I transfer leads consistently and work 5-hour shifts Mon-Thurs during the summer working with a producer consistently giving them new business. I have consistent transfers and I follow and manage my lead pipeline smooth and efficiently all the way to the estimate stage. Aswell as him giving me access to more expensive and better leads (I still dial aged leads consistently), and he laughs that I have amazing transfer rates with s\" leads. I'm amazing at this job, and I can come up with phrases or things to say to potential clients on the fly. Aswell as having a great relationship with my boss, we went to a BBQ place one time and he gave the world of compliments to my recent bonuses, we talked about my future, and he told me stories of his past jobs. For questions about how much I make as a 15yo, my next check with be gross \$1152 after working 47 hours (over 2 weeks), roughly \$24.50 per hr at 15. The reason its that much is because I will have 16 bonuses with it (16 X 47)+(25 X 16). Now that you've heard my story, I'm looking for advice on continuing further with Farmers Insurance, where I currently am their rates are insanely competitive. Farmers is a hybrid; we can write through other carriers as well (which is amazing). How long do you guys think I should continue with my boss? Decades? I have aspirations to own my own Farmers Financial Services Agency, but how would be losing my clients and renewals taking the leap to open my agency when that time comes? Capital won't be an issue by the time I want to, I have over 11 thousand invested in the stock market, which is all of my own money, all worked for by me over time, with a Roth IRA and Brokerage. (I also want to note my parents knew nothing about investing this was all my idea and I even manage my Moms Roth IRA for her, and nor do I come from a wealthy family) How do you guys think my career path should look? I know I am very lucky to be working for a 3-year-old Farmers agency that is growing rapidly, soon becoming multi-office. With an ethical and amazing boss."

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uzpz51/help_with_my_future_plan_in_insurance_at_a_young/

↳ Character_Text_30 (2): "You are an amazing young person! Your work ethic will take you very far in life. Just don't burn any bridges. I say that because, in a year, you will have outgrown your current job and position. Get your license, if you said you have already' I apologize. Pay close attention to the things your mentor is doing to run the office. Learn those things and just know, you do the hardest part of all- get clients on on books and close deals. That's how that company is doing so well. And I hope you make what you deserve real soon. Keep going!"

↳ BuildingIndividual33 (1): "Yes, I am already starting to outgrow what I'm doing, I want to close deals, but my age is a restriction! My boss mentions I'll be a firecracker and will close deals as soon as I get my license, I also want to get my securities licenses after the P&C+L&H, so I can manage and sell securities."

↳ BuildingIndividual33 (-1): "No sir, I am a real person, I sat here typing all of this out for 2 hours last night. But thank you for compliments to my writing at 15! appreciate it! 🙏"

"in case the link goes away..... When Health Coverage Doesn't Hold Up (CBS) As more Americans are unable to get health insurance through their work, they often turn to the individual insurance market. Last night we told you how difficult it can be to get individual insurance, with companies turning down people with the most minor of medical problems. CBS News chief investigative correspondent Armen Keteyian takes a closer look at what happens when some people who actually have individual insurance try to collect on an expensive claim. Tod Smith, 54, was paying for an individual health insurance plan when he had a heart attack. It was only after he tried to collect on his claim that he learned how uncovered he was. (CBS) Quote "I certainly figured that a heart attack was a catastrophic event. So I figured I was covered." Walking along a stretch of road last summer, 54-year-old Tod Smith felt an intense burning in his chest and tightness in his arm — signs of a heart attack he never saw coming. "I was in good health," Smith said. "No major health problems or conditions." For Smith, an illustrator of children's books, his heart attack was the first shock. The second: more than \$40,000 in medical bills his insurance company refused to cover — after he figured the company, Assurant, would pay. "I certainly figured that a heart attack was a catastrophic event. So I figured I was covered," Smith said. A two-month CBS News investigation of the individual insurance market found that Smith's experience was far from unique. Because it was expensive, his claim was investigated for fraud by Assurant Health, his insurance company. After examining his medical records, the company refused to pay based on a 3-year old-reference to an "angina episode." Assurant said those words proved his condition was pre-existing, despite the fact that follow-up tests in the same file diagnose his "episode" as a case of acid reflux and ruled out a heart condition. "The claim about these pre-existing conditions was absolutely preposterous," Connecticut Attorney General Richard Blumenthal said. Check out our individual insurance resource page Watch Keteyian's interview with Maria Locker, who was given the health-care run-around when diagnosed with lymphoma Watch Keteyian's piece on "The Uninsurables" Blumenthal's office has investigated dozens of the more than 500 complaints nationwide against Assurant, a Milwaukee-based company that specializes in individual policies. Blumenthal charges Assurant has a pattern of "bad faith" when it comes to its customers. "What this company did was create the illusion of coverage, when in reality, it would challenge almost any expensive procedure as a pre-existing condition," he said. CBS' investigation of Assurant found a pattern of questionably denied claims and cancelled policies — and what a South Carolina judge called a culture of "secrecy, concealment ... and shredded documents." A video deposition from another court case describes what may have been cash incentives to the company's medical director to deny claims after the fact. Diane Winkowski, a former unit supervisor of Assurant, said she was part of a unit at Assurant that searched for reasons not to pay claims. She told us she quit because, she believed, many of the investigations were unfounded — and unjust. "A lot of time we felt that we had it all, and to try and keep looking was frustrating," she said. Assurant refused to discuss its denials of claims on camera, but it issued a statement saying it continually evaluates its claims process "to ensure it is fair, equitable and consistent with state laws and industry standards." However, at least 15 states have investigated Assurant's practices, forcing the company to pay millions of dollars in fines. The company now faces dozens of customer lawsuits, with another on the way — from Tod Smith. "It's about money," Smith said. "That's the bottom line." Smith hopes his legal action will cover that \$40,000 bill he felt assured his insurance company would pay."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Assurant on CBS news tonight · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/assurant-on-cbs-news-tonight.1424/#post-19384>

"I just want to say that I'm in the same boat. I went with American Income, a division of Globe Life. Wow, what a shit show I walked into. They are currently being investigated for fraud in the millions. So I'm back to square one. I just applied for food stamps and everything else and I told him exactly what you said, basically made one sale then cancelled that sale based on the huge fraud investigation among other lawsuits. I'm starting over again trying to find a job but in the meantime I'm 4 months behind on my mortgage and I'm freaking out. I live in Florida. It's freaking expensive down here. Single mom can't catch a break."

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1eep5i5/single_mom_on_public_assistance_is_struggling_at/fthjxs6/

"@Skully917 no one is saying it's a \$1,000 an hour. But trust what I'm telling you making \$1,000 plus a day is absolutely doable I see it everyday. In fact I've seen people make \$7,000 commission off one policy in a day. Life insurance sales are extremely lucrative. Most people choose not to do it because it's a commission based job and you have to invest into leads. Not to mention it is tedious."

— YouTube · My morning routine as an insurance broker making 10K per week 🌟 · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=w_Lcq9k9Mk&lc=UgyKK03mkRoyD1gjZi4AaABAg.ANE3v_WJZN8AaUZg3L-Agt

"Note To New Readers of This Thread: After starting and succeeding during my time at EFES, I have now moved on and started my own final expense agency where I specialize in training new agents to final expense, through personalized mentorship and providing a tried-and-tested sales and lead generation model. You can find out more by clicking this link to Final Expense Agent Mentor. Also check out my comprehensive free Final Expense Training YouTube Channel for more than 100 videos describing subjects such as: 1) How To Sell Final Expense Successfully, 2) How To Pick The Best Final Expense Leads, and 3) How to figure out whether or not the final expense opportunity you're being offered is a scam. Definitely check out the free resources above if you are investing the possibility of selling final expense. Thanks! ***** Hello all, Several months ago, I began investigating selling insurance in conjunction with my other business to help supplement my income. After searching insurance-forum.net deeply, I decided that final expense sales would be the product I would specialize in. Simply because the product made sense (backed by a fundamentally-sound shift in demographics) and wasn't too technically complicated, as I have never sold insurance before. I decided to contract through Equita Final Expense Services (EFES from now on), and wanted to share with you the results of my first month in business, what I liked, and what my complaints are. DISCLOSURE: I am willingly providing this information without any compensation or request. I'm mainly doing it because I'm sure there are others out there, researching various insurance products to rep, and would benefit from a newbie's first month perspective. Management: My direct manager is Andrew Fike out of Atlanta, GA, one of EFES's top agents. It has been a thorough pleasure working with him. He's totally supportive of my working schedule limitations, understanding that I'm only available 3 days in the field for 10-12 hours each day due to my other business. He's willing to take the time and teach me the finer points of selling, helping me modify my pitch and do a better job closing. Also, he's helped me with any questions or concerns I have had. All in all, it's been a 10/10 experience. Regional Management: My regional manager is Joe Ciaccio out of Tampa, FL. He's a great guy that has helped me with prospecting techniques and scripts. However, I've been more in contact with his office support staff, who've been wonderful helping me get on my feet. Definitely a 10/10 experience. EFES Corporate: My marketing manager is Chase Ulrich. He's a great guy to work with -- definitely in it to help you be productive. However, if you have read any of jdeasy's posts, one issue I've run into is getting consistent lead flow. Having run a business that's dependent on marketing, I understand response rates and the time it takes to tweak the sizes of drops to consistently produce the amount of leads you need. So far I've been selling through EFES for 4 weeks and I've averaged 9-10 leads a week. I've wanted 20+ weekly to work. I have probably spent 3-4 of the last 12-14 days without anyone to see. Nevertheless, I'm not worried about this long-term, and wouldn't have this hold me up from taking advantage of the EFES opportunity, as I'm confident the problem will be resolved within the next couple of weeks. A 9.5/10 experience, only because I'm hungry to get working all day long. With 2 days left in the month, I've posted nearly \$6,000.00 AP, which I consider decent as I'm new to the industry and have really worked an average of 2 full days each week through June. My goal is to double that for July and onward, once lead flow begins to pick up consistently. In the meantime, if you're one of the folks like me who are reading this, and are thinking about joining EFES, or are a little bit skeptical, I say give it a shot; it's worth the investment. The support staff and management is great -- they want you to succeed. Just be prepared to work hard at improving constantly, and wading through rat-hole trailers, too. Best, Dave D."

— Insurance-Forums.com · My 1st Month at EFES/Equita Final Expense · new or aspiring agent · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/my-1st-month-at-efes-equita-final-expense.32457/#post-406055>

Tab 5 — Frustrations

Leads that are old, fake, shared or never answer · 124 documents · 20 voices

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crid=11ZYLHHOAVSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&srefix=how+to+win+friend%2Caps%2C266&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_5?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: | Industry | Description | | --- | | Tech | You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. | | Med | You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in "The Pursuit of Happiness". | | Finance/Insurance | You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. | | Hardware/Construction | Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. | | Cars | You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. | | Door to Door | Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. | So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. | JOB TITLE | PAY RANGE (Salary) | PAY RANGE (OTE) | DESCRIPTION** | | --- | | --- | | SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) | £25,000 - £40,000 | £50,000 - £80,000 | Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. | | SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive | £30,000 - £60,000 | £50,000 - £140,000 | Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. | | MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive | £40,000 - £75,000 | £60,000 - £150,000 | Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. | | ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive | £50,000 - £100,000 | £70,000 - £250,000 | Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. | | SALES MANAGER | £60,000 - £120,000 | £80,000 - £200,000 | Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. | | MD: Managing Director | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. | | HEAD OF SALES | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. | | Terminology | Description | | --- | | Cold call | When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. | | Lead | This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a "lead", meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. | | Account | This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. | | Contact | This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. | | Example of a lead, a contact and an account. | Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

↳ vitaferox (58): "This was excellent advice for getting any sales job, honestly. And too many people skip those basics"

↳ titan623 (18): "I could kiss you right now. I've been a long time lurker and seen/saved a ton of great info for the job search, I've been meaning to sit down and organize it all. This is a SUCH a resource, especially with the concise examples, perfect for referencing. Thanks for putting this together."

↳ TheUneducatedPotato (14): "To add something that helped me land my new sales role: if you're asked to give a presentation like a 30/60/90 day plan, bring a paper copy in those cheap presentation folders. Give them out before the presentation so your interviewers can take notes. I had to fly across county to a hotel where they booked a conference room and guess what, the projector didn't work that morning. No worries. I had the power point, printed two slides per page, in a presentation folder, ready to go. Both interviewers were stunned with my fore thought and it saved me from having them crowd around my laptop looking over my shoulder. It's the little things that show you're thinking ahead."

"Be prepared for the phone apocalypse Apple dropped the hammer on all unsolicited calls. With the iOS 26 update in September, no calls will automatically go through unless their in your contacts. Instead, the person calling will have to state their name and the reason for the call. That will show up as a text and the caller decides whether or not to allow the call. Here's a demo: <https://youtu.be/4yFDvgEjciQ?feature=shared> Apple owns 60% of the market. If other phone manufacturers and even carrier follow, it's possible we see day where cold calling has died. This will have a direct, negative effect on leads, especially shared leads. Be prepared."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 50 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l8sgfs/be_prepared_for_the_phone_apocalypse/

↳ Pneuma_LooT (32): "Id say 90 to 95% of people do not answer phone calls anyways. Its not until they receive a text and set up a time to talk that they respond. This is what the industry has become the last few years for whatever reason."

↳ Madeanaccountforyou4 (25): "Google Pixel phones have had this since 2018"

↳ SilentFlames907 (15): "Then I guess agencies will actually have to provide us with viable leads?"

"Warning: My Experience with Symmetry Financial Group – Please Read Before Joining Hey Reddit, I've been in the insurance industry since 2021 and have had success in multiple roles. I know what real mentorship and growth look like. That's why I feel the need to warn others about my experience with Symmetry Financial Group — because it was one of the most toxic, disorganized, and emotionally draining environments I've ever worked in. Here are the biggest red flags I encountered: • The leads are extremely aged. I was handed leads from as far back as 2016. Calling people who haven't requested life insurance info in nearly a decade felt unethical — more like harassment than service. It genuinely made me uncomfortable. • The culture is toxic. Uplines and agency owners frequently humiliate agents on Zoom calls in front of everyone. There's no support — just power plays, ego, and public shaming. • You're not in control of your own business. They make you ask for permission to get licensed in new states, claiming they won't get paid if you get licensed somewhere they aren't. It's controlling and makes no sense if this is "your business." • Shaming over conferences. Can't afford to attend one of their big events? Be ready to get publicly called out and guilted like you're not serious about your career. It's manipulative and unprofessional. • The training is the worst I've seen in this industry. There's no real structure, no proper onboarding, and no consistent support. You're left confused, overwhelmed, and underprepared. • It affected my mental health. I've never struggled with anxiety — not even in high-pressure sales environments — but while working with SFG, I had debilitating anxiety that impacted every area of my life. As soon as I walked away, that anxiety vanished. That tells you everything. The good news? I've since joined a different IMO with real leadership, training, and respect — and I'm flourishing now. This experience taught me that it's not the industry that's the problem — it's the people you align yourself with. If you're thinking about joining Symmetry Financial Group, please think twice. Don't ignore the red flags. You deserve better."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtq3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/

↳ loan2you (6): "What IMO did you join since?"

↳ Will-Adair (6): "I work with Symmetry. I like it as an independent IMO. I buy only new leads generated in real time so that doesn't line with my experience. Value leads range from weeks to years. I've never seen a value lead over 3 years old. Culture does depend what agency you're with, sounds like you were in a bad one. I've owned my business for 3.5 years so not sure what happened wherever you were at. Conferences are optional but beneficial. Again sounds like your experience is much different than mine and I'm going on year four. How long were you there? National has decent training and good agencies have their own too, we have for over a year. Sorry your experience stunk. Did you reach out to corporate and use their mediation team? Even if that door is closed reach out because corporate may be able to help train your former up-lines. Alignment is key. Glad you found a better solution for you."

↳ OPlathome (3): "I work with Symmetry as well and I agree with Will. What owner you're with matters, and not all teams are built equally. I get tons of support and training, and I do pretty well even with the older d-e leads."

"Sick of lead companies It's amazing.... agency owners buy "premium" leads and no matter where you go theres trash mixed in. The excuses are incredible like " you aren't dialing them enough" "the prospect keyed in that fake address and number" ect. ect. The agency I work for literally has people dialing alllllll day constantly (over 1000 dials). The sales agents are also calling, emailing, and texting. None of that matters when I get someone on the phone that's already been called 15 times. How the hell do these leads get sold to 20+ agents? I even had a lead in which the guy was DEAD for two years. Where are they even getting this crap from? Any industry insiders that want to give me the 411?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/

↳ itsalyfestyle (16): "Your agency are buying the cheapest aged leads they can find"

↳ Monskiactual (11): "Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media. They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdoteal personal experience) Jornaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use jornaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower intent.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trustd lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. ,get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

↳ iamoptimusprime312 (6): "Most are resellers thats why! It is rare to find the actual source of the leads. Also the industry is drowned to the max with resellers who bought 7 day old leads in bulk for like \$1000 and reselling for \$10,000! That is why i only recommend direct mail and doing fb ads. They will be your exclusive leads! If you are not the first agency to call that person after they filled out the online form then it is most likely a useless window shopper. They will just spin your wheels and will never convert!"

"Bad\$\$\$leads scam I purchased some leads from badassleads.. those leads are a penny worth. Wrong numbers, disconnected numbers, bad emails. Just dont waste your money and generate your own. Seriously lead generation companies are ripping off Agents"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/

↳ bigalien1 (28): "Sometimes the name gives it away"

↳ Diligent_Throat304 (8): "They should rename bullsh*tleads lol"

↳ jwf1126 (7): "You should have taken your own names advice or even gone full deep throat with a company name like that. Lead gen sucks but there are companies out there that will at least put a good faith effort and give you the time a day and have some successes"

"The shxty part is most agencies teach their agents it's a numbers game while they sell you over priced aged leads. Then you're outside all day chasing shxx leads like an axxhole and then they give you poor sales training. My advice is to master reframing and tonality. Get those two aspects down and fine tune your pitch and you'll increase your close rate. I been there and it honestly was horrible. Left and got into AI SaaS but if i had to do it again I'd master those two aspects first. Also remember Chase compassion, not commission."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ueswou/i_fully_respect_the_hustle_that_is_insurance/otmgryw8/

"My number one recommendation is to buy leads. Not any leads, Aged Leads. Specifically leads that are 9-12 months old. Old enough where they don't get calls but need a policy or are open to getting a policy at a lower rate. The CPL and CPA are low enough to give you the ability to generate considerable revenue over a 90 day period. At that point in time you can pivot into more expensive marketing solutions or paying someone to run the marketing for you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/myqpk0u/

"I blocked out the agents name and face because I'm 100% sure they didn't allow their likeness to be used . At the end of the day these Lead venders charge us for crap leads ."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l1jvkn/psa_these_are_the_ads_that_lead_venders_use/mvlims7/

"I messed up. I quit my easy Medicare sales job and went to an industry and can't physically do anymore.im looking for susuggestions. I honestly don't want to go back to them. Go health, I feel they were slowly dying. Taking out massive loans to stay afloat, cut 1/3 of employees recently and telling shareholders they were doing great. So I don't want to go back. I can't get into another Medicare job for at least 6 months because of the non competes and the like. Carriers are in on it too so I can't do anything. I'm kinda scrambling for something. I know I wasn't making much there either. Top 10% agent year round. Top 5% in aep. But I only made 45k. It was all warm live inbound transfers that I didn't pay for. I'm looking at other insurance industries and I'm kinda scared. Each place I look at often turns into a sort of ponzi scheme that sells leads. Often getting you in with some decent leads at first and then giving you crap unless you pay for it. I don't mind pure commission but I'd like it to warm live transfers. Am I wishing for something that doesn't exist? I have life and health in like 20 states still. I'm debating getting property casualty license."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/111e1d0/>

↳ (0): "The problem you're having.. is that go health didn't teach you how to do the job. They didn't teach you the product or how to care for the needs of the client. They taught you how to poach books. But the reason they are slowly dying is because every time they have one of their extremely underpaid teleagents poach one of my clients i immediately put in a complaint to CMS and then flip them back. That's why the 3 month retention is less than 40% for both go health and assurance. Medicare isn't easy and shouldn't be. It should be about building relationships that in turn pay you very well for taking care of people. If you actually love it, find an upline that can show you how to build a book, not steal one for a churn and burn company like go health."

↳ (0): "I'm afraid to gamble that. Like I know it's possible and I know I could do it. I was good at what I did. And trust me. I was one of the few who actually read past the SOB and into into the EOC for plans. And many didn't even read the SOB... I'm just afraid to start it. I don't know who to trust for leads and I don't know how to get my own."

↳ (0): "Not sure how old you are or what your situation is like especially in regards to networking ability, etc besides what you've posted here, but it seems like there are a TON of Medicare agents around that do very well running a solo shop just cranking out leads + networking. And looking at the commission schedule, something like 100 Medicare sales would net about what you're making now. One hundred... in perpetuity (at least for a few years... lol). That's pretty easy, no? Granted that doesn't include benefits like health insurance, being W2, etc but... still decent. The one Medicare agent I know that works at a P&C shop, and is P&C licensed, works in ONLY Medicare and CRUSHES it, works 3-4 months out of the year, the rest of the year manages his book and lines up for the next year, but vacations / starts other business ventures 8 months out of the year. He's maybe 27 years old making \$300k-400k a year at least I'd bet - before bonus. As a P&C agent I look at those commission schedules and I get a little jealous. Something I'm hoping to learn more about in 2023."

"Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdoteal personal experience) Jornaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use jornaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower internt.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trustrd lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. ,get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer844c/

"Great idea. Favorite telesales carriers: RNA, Prosperity and Trinity. SS billing + voice sign for all 3. Favorite lead: Real-time telemarketed call back with verified checking, ages 50-79 and agrees to speak with an agent. Basically telemarketers calling on DNC scrubbed and TCPA verified data to call on (old FB leads or Journaya/Trusted Form verified) + scrubbed against TCPA Blacklist Alliance and inputting into a form to serve it up in a CRM immediately. Tip: You need proper training and sales systems to make telesales work. If you take your DM leads and try to sell them over the phone with your typical f2f presentation, you'll fail. If you buy internet leads and don't have proper sales training or sales systems, you'll fail. My advice is either partner with a telesales-focused agency with an open release policy (hey, telesales isn't for everyone) or wait it out. Don't waste any time/money unless there's a proven system in place."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Telesales Tips · 11 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/final-expense-telesales-tips.101595/#post-1344555>

"Is it me or is it my agency? Hi Reddit, I have been with my captive agency for 6 months as a Producer. I am now on a PIP and currently looking for a position as a CSR which I think might suit me better if my agency's standards for sales are pretty much the industry standard. I am not provided any leads, aged or live or info-only. They told me awhile ago they would like me to sell about 80,000-100,000 in premium a month ideally. I just don't see how that can be possible with just my natural market and going to dealerships/mortgage lenders/apartments and networking (which I have been doing) I don't live in a super huge city either like Houston/LA. I feel like if this is what most agencies expect I need to let the idea of making a Sales Producer my career go. So reddit, what would you do in my situation?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1t88v96/>

↳ (0): "Run and distance yourself as far away as you can. What is your commission structure like? If they are relying on your own production and marketing efforts you should have a high percentage payout such as 95% - 115% 1st year commission for Life Insurance. If you are doing P/C 11% of all premium received, that includes renewal."

↳ (0): "80k-100k as a new rep captive with no leads?? I mean can understand if you were on the broker side and the set up was like that. How much are you actually closing off the # of people you talking to is it the real question"

↳ (0): "Run. Fast. Far. You are given no leads and paid roughly 20% of what the owner gets for your work? Run. Just run. You are wasting your time with that waste of oxygen cheap owner. They need to provide you leads if they are only going to pay that much. At this point, you are doing 80% of the job (and the most difficult part, arguably) of working for yourself and getting none of the benefit. Someone else will appreciate your initiative far more and far more lucratively than your current owner. They don't deserve you."

"I need leads for contact rate. My sales skills are there I think because I have talked with people then sold policies but it seems like I am calling such bad leads that don't answer or hang up in my face in the first second of the call"

— YouTube · Insurance Agents: Should you buy leads or generate leads ? · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aGrUeGEYEpl&lc=UgxNQe5hKU22JZfoKKJ4AaABAg>

"AMEN! i have been on a similar journey. i left my last IMO after i had a "wait a second, am in a cult?" realization. it was led by a psychopathic narcissist, so that was the culture. like every psychopathic narcissist, there was the underlying truth and there was the surface of the mask and when in it, it can be hard to tell the difference. the surface mask was, "we are here to help people, we are here to support each other, we are so special". the underlying truth was that it was an MLM style parasitic predatory organization whose leadership was all about grabbing the money bag and draining as much blood from as many people as possible whether they were agents (through low commissions and crazy overpriced junk leads) or clients. they preyed on the vulnerable, the leader surrounded himself with women who had backgrounds in drug addiction, trauma, abusive parental and romantic relationship histories. later on i learned from women who had left that the founder/leader was sexually predatory and pressured women there to sleep with him by making them feel indebted to him for "saving" them. i was banned from my cult's group chat bc people asked me for help with better lead sources bc i was shooting up the leaderboard while everyone else was struggling so i shared some sources i was using and succeeding with. they punished and smeared me for that. so i left with 2 other top 10 leaderboard agents and started my own agency. several other top agents left to join other imo's at the same time we left. my old imo started me at 60% commission levels and 45% for GL. i start people with zero experience at 75-90%. my cult IMO charged \$27 per callback data lead that they made bank on. i offer leads that i make zero dollars on and it is pay per presentation for \$25 with a 20% min close rate promise (i'm closing double that rate and i am not an elite closer), not pay per lead who doesn't even answer the phone. cult imo was recruiting like 50 agents per week. we don't run recruiting campaigns and limit our growth according to how many leads we can provide our agents to make sure everyone is well fed. my cult IMO preached "only 8% of agents make it" but at my agency we make it our problem to solve if a full time agent is not writing at least \$15k AP per month. my cult IMO punished people for leaving, smeared them with made up lies, would call the new uplines of people who left to try and blacklist them. we have an open release policy and would always go out of our way to make any transition out as friendly and peaceful as possible. there are good IMO's and agencies out there. i can recommend some if people are looking."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1q6lb33/when_integrity_collides_with_the_insurance/ny9dvtm/

"I would love to have a sit down with John about this. This is such amazing advice. I'm an agent through a captive agency in NY and I have been having such a tough time, with what I thought was leads. My problem isn't that I can't get people to answer, my problem continues to be no shows and I feel like I'm stuck in that "hamster wheel" where I've called the leads to oblivion and have a tough time booking those. Mind you, some of the leads I'm given are 6 or 7 years old where we're told to, "throw them against the wall and see what sticks." I'm going to implement this more aggressive calling method and see how it helps. Thank you so much."

— YouTube · How To Work Insurance Leads Like A Pro! (Cody Askins & John Wetmore) · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nf_TnViVvls&lc=Ugy_-op6VjG4LLmRuwn4AaABAg

"This right here! So many unethical companies too that's exploit their agents and charge for bonk ass leads. My first experience was with HealthMarkets, horrible company, leads are \$36 each all of which are trash. I spent thousands of dollars on leads the first year. I also got taken by FFL, there I only burned \$3,000 in leads, I sold 5 policies, 4 charged back. I'm so happy now that I'm focused on the ACA market only. I don't care about selling life or any other supplemental. People are broke and they care barely afford health insurance as it is."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r86i3q/whats_the_hardest_part_of_being_an_insurance/o62tbgm/

"Turning 65 leads Medicare New agent need a few leads to get the hopper working. Tried data brokers old and tired lists. Just need like 4-10 sales a month. Passed the tests. With 12 carriers. Need to get the phone ringing. Independent. Who do I pay to get real leads. Can't be a secret."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1d5disv/turning_65_leads_medicare/

↳ Vast-Gate8866 (15): "Boots to the ground!!! It's free my man. That's how I got started 3 years ago. Go to every senior center, senior apartment, retirement homes, food banks and do table events wherever seniors show up. I have so many great relationships. I do a lot of fun events at these places. Keep at it, don't give up. After year 2, referrals start coming in, and you start seeing the fruits of your labor in monthly deposits into the bank account, just keeping your clients happy."

↳ proletariat_sips_tea (6): "How do you get around the legality of this? I feel like there's an AHIP question solely about this."

↳ noneyet1 (6): "You may be thinking about the limitations placed on medical facilities. Or the limitations placed on unsolicited contact. A table in a public place would not be unsolicited contact. Unless they are doing carnival barker style or something."

"> What is your plan for when the incoming calls stop? As cynical as this sounds - there is no plan. If you have a phone, the calls will never stop coming. The numbers are spoofed, the names are fake, and there is nothing you can do. Even if you're on every blacklist alliance list, DNC, TCPA litiagtor scrub, etc etc - they all disconnect the calls AFTER the happen. Its annoying and won't end. I can get 100 illegal calls in a day and get zero justice or I can get 100 illegal calls a day, sue on 3-4 of them and get \$10-20 grand worth of justice. This is the world we're living in. The calls will never stop. If they did, I'd have a much higher serenity around here and I could enjoy some of the money I've made over the years. > Can you say with absolute sincerity that you're not taking any action to receive these illegal calls? 100%. I do not sign up for ANYTHING. I sit at home watching TV or scratching myself and the calls come in. I'm too young for medicare, but I get 20+ calls a day for medicare advantage. I'm too young for final expense insurance, I get 30+ a day for final expense. It's insanity. > You sure you're not intentionally putting yourself in a position for opportunities to sue these companies/agents? Am I intentionally putting myself in a position to sue these people, absolutely. The same way a cop running radar that has a really good spot that nobody can see / knows about..... I have a charged gopro handy and I record the incoming calls. Yes, I intentionally prepare myself to get the most leverage and the best evidence capture of illegal telemarketing practices. >I can't tell if you're posting this to be a genuine warning or maybe even bragging... but it actually reads like "Careful about your lead source, or else people without real jobs like me are going to sue you." I've done several settlements with small brokers that have said "we can't pay you what you're asking" and I said that's fine, I'll hold your upline joint and severally liable. Next thing I know, a decent settlement offer comes my way. OR I hire an attorney, they file a class action against the upline, the brokerage, the broker and the agent PERSONALLY and everyone goes to court, the upline spends \$150-200k in defense costs that they subrogate back to the downline via payment plan/docked commissions/what have you and my attorneys add another win to their CV. The message here is that YOU MAY THINK this new lead vendor of yours is all great but if you get burned, you can potentially be involved in bet the company litigation. And this is the WORST kind of litigation to be in because you don't realize you're in bet the company litigation until you've wound up betting the company. >Do what everyone else does and block the numbers that call Not that easy. All the numbers are spoofed. I get calls from the hospital, chevy dealership, etc etc - all displayed on the caller ID that are overseas call centers. Your outlook is 100% flawed. >No I have never been sued by a serial litigator because I only receive direct inbound calls, but I can still cringe at you for bottom feeding You know what's funny? Every single broker I've sued says "we only recieve direct inbound calls" - you know why? THE LEAD GEN SPOOFS MY NUMBER, CALLS YOUR BROKERAGE SO YOU CAN CLAIM IT IS AN INBOUND CALL. The only counterbattery is my gopro video."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8y9glc/

"Here is a list of all I tested. Life leads Caboom : See above MediaApha : 1 out of 15 to 20 sale. ROI sucks Aria leads : crap. Their Instagram commercial is in a rented abandoned office, btw Smart Financial: spent 1500 for both data and live transfers. Nothing Everquote: I bought 50, and they canceled supporting life when I joined. No sale Benepath: 1 sale out of 10 leas, and they canceled life line as well Aged lead store: You better be ready to piss everyone off and dial a couple of weeks through wrong and not in service numbers before you get a hit. AWL: data leads suck. Live transfers 1 out of 4 normally sell, but they are overpriced, and if someone lapses or canceled, it ruins the whole ROI Integrity leadcenter: This has been the best of the worst so far, but buying the bronze is no different than the diamond. They say you get them exclusive on the sale, but that's bullshit because my upline bought me some from the same states I got, and they were duplicates. Google Ads : bots. I got all these leads at \$400 a week designed by a Google affiliated advertising company. I installed Captcha, and no more leads came in Fb: mostly people browsing. I feel like they are waiting for a gift after submitting the form. Money pit. Leadrilla: I never tried their campaigns, but if it's anything like the leads they sell in the marketplace, then it's shit too. USA DATA: 50% not in service and are all cold calls Direct mail: 1 to 2% return on mailers if you're lucky and you're always waiting. I sometimes wonder if they really mail anything out. Prospect 4 agent lead company: it was good in 2021, but by 2023, they caught the same disease all these other assholes have."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mezvm3q/

"I work with Symmetry. I like it as an independent IMO. I buy only new leads generated in real time so that doesn't line with my experience. Value leads range from weeks to years. I've never seen a value lead over 3 years old. Culture does depend what agency you're with , sounds like you were in a bad one. I've owned my business for 3.5 years so not sure what happened wherever you were at. Conferences are optional but beneficial. Again sounds like your experience is much different than mine and I'm going on year four. How long were you there? National has descent training and good agencies have their own too, we have for over a year. Sorry your experience stunk. Did you reach out to corporate and use their mediation team? Even if that door is closed reach out because corporate may be able to help train your former up-lines. Alignment is key. Glad you found a better solution for you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kitqo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/mrtbkig/

Prospects who ghost, no-show or already have an agent · 60 documents · 20 voices

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

↳ 3xploringforever (16): "As a lawyer, the insurance MLM industry ENRAGES me from several angles - scam insurance, misclassification of workers, unconscionable contracts signed under duress with obscenely one-sided and binding arbitration clauses, abuse of telemarketing practices, fraud/misrepresentation, toxic hustle culture, wage theft, tax theft and UI avoidance, exploitation of desperate people seeking the "American dream," I could go on."

↳ dillydeli1 (14): "Totally believe this, thanks for saying it outloud."

↳ iBaires (11): "Don't forget literally tens of thousands of TCPA violations every day lol"

"Warning: Globe Life Zuzick I was "hired" by these people after watching a prerecorded video and waiting for 45 minutes in an empty breakout room. Red flags from the beginning. I went through with getting my license that week and scheduled for a group training call. Towards the end of the call, the leader was explaining how we must respect the CEOs time and must have the contracts signed BEFORE he talks to us and welcomes us to the team. She then gives us a 7 page contract and less than 5 minutes to sign. Everyone signs without reading. I tried to read thru it before he joined, but didn't make it. She called me out on the call saying they're still waiting on me. I just turned my cam off and kept reading. Pressuring kids into signing a contract is super unethical and should be illegal. I knew I would find nuggets of garbage after this pressure. Sure enough, I did. The only reason why I was going to let them take 70% of my commission was because they said they provided leads for free. Funny, the contract says: we do not guarantee that you will receive any leads. I also was wondering how no one has ever written poorly of this branch online. There was a clause in there that says you may not say anything negative about our company once signed. Is that even allowed? I ghosted them and have been getting spammed with emails and texts as if I am still with them. Sad to see, taking advantage of people in desperate times."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mnj1p8/warning_globe_life_zuzick/

↳ jroberts67 (6): "Glad you sussed them out and didn't sign. And non-disparagement clauses are "barely" legal and rarely enforceable. For companies like this, free leads are typically aged leads."

↳ Livid-Acadia6078 (3): "I worked for them for like 3 months, it was a mess. Glad you dodged a bullet"

↳ Foreign_Advisor_7573 (3): "Kudos to you for standing your ground and being smart about it. Contracts -- some clauses are there to send you a scary legal letter threatening legal action by citing contract violation. You'd be surprised how many IMOs/agencies have appealingly bad contracts; you'd think you're signing your life and your keen away, not basic contractor agreement. Edit: free leads. Those will usually be very, very old, and worked through by many, many agents. Words like exclusive, premium, etc. mean nothing. How old is the lead, how many other agents have it, and how it was generated is what matters. So if recruiter won't answer those questions or give generic answers, the free leads they offer are worth little to nothing and not worth a bulk of your comp."

"How do y'all deal with actually insane clients? Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride. I answer the phone. Lady leads with "I went to your office and you guys vanished in the middle of the night! Do I even have insurance!? I'm reporting you to the government!" Reality: we moved nine months ago. Across the parking lot. Our Google listing has been updated. All our policy docs reflect the new address. There's a literal sign taped to the old door with an arrow saying "we moved next door." She then accuses me of not mailing her documents because I'm "screwing with her bill." Her payment has changed once in the last. It went down from \$92 to \$84. At this point she's yelling more about reporting me for moving. I told her "I'm not interested in getting yelled at. What would you like from me today?" She rants a bit more. I respond with "Okay. I am happy to transfer you to another office if that sounds good to you." She ranted more and eventually hung up. Curious how other agents handle the loons like this. I'd love to move her out of my book, but also can't really do it without her consent. People are nuts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

↳ Neither-Historian227 (19): "I had a dozen death threats during the pandemic when government locked everyone down and destroyed their businesses, this is cake walk"

↳ NovelMotor7972 (13): "Are you kidding me?I deal with crazy people for a living. Lol I've literally had people misstate their income on a recorded line, make a complaint against me to the office of financial regulation, and cause a whole ordeal over their own tax penalty, because they misstated their income. I learned my lesson, every single one of them signs a disclosure that this is the income that they are stating."

↳ BroWeBeChilling (12): "It wears on youafter ten years I have heard it all. About 20% of the people are always unhappy. This has worn on me everyday especially since most people don't take responsibility for not paying their bills, their bank made a mistake, they never got a notice in the mail or to their email. Then they take it out on me. I try brushing it off but for sure after one heart attack my life is shortening everyday."

"Update: Being let go from a toxic agency turned out to be the best thing that could have happened to me As you can see from my original post, I received a lot of negative comments. To be fair, I posted less than an hour after being let go and was extremely emotional. I should have taken some time to calm down before posting. That being said, I still stand by the main point of my post: a toxic workplace is not something anyone should be expected to tolerate simply because an industry can be stressful. The insurance field is not "too hard" for me. I have dealt with difficult customers throughout my entire working career. I have been yelled at, hung up on, spoken down to, and blamed for things outside of my control. That comes with working with the public. However, your boss should not tell you to "shut the hell up before I get nasty with you" in front of your coworkers, especially over a routine replacement or add-on — and especially when you did not make a mistake to begin with. In this situation, it was actually a replacement, and my former boss was the one who had it wrong.(never got that apology from him lol) After I formally addressed the way I was spoken to, the situation became retaliatory. My separation letter included five days as though I had called out repeatedly, when those were days I had asked to delay my original start date so I could handle personal matters and begin the following week with a clear schedule. I even found the email confirming that discussion. I was going to remind him of that by replying to the separation letter with that email, but at this point, I decided to leave it alone and move forward. And that brings me to the real update: To everyone who told me to look into working for an independent agency: **thank you**. I start my new position on Monday. It is much closer to the type of work I was doing before 🍷, but with an independent agency. I was told that others in the industry were already familiar with the turnover issues at my former office, which helped remind me that my experience was not simply a reflection of my ability to succeed in insurance. My new position includes: **A \$7,900 salary increase** Benefits beginning after 30 days A one-hour lunch instead of 30 minutes Five eight-hour workdays No weekends Paid nationwide holidays The employer covering 90% of the health insurance premium Looking back, being fired by that office may have been the best thing that could have happened to me. To anyone who said the insurance field was not for me: standing up for yourself does not mean you are incapable of doing your job. Refusing to accept humiliation, harassment, or retaliation does not make you lazy, overly sensitive, or full of excuses. If you wake up every morning wondering what the yelling, condescending remarks, or unnecessary criticism will be about that day, start looking for another job. I am not talking about someone who simply dislikes working or cannot accept constructive feedback. I am talking about people who work hard, are genuinely being treated poorly and starting to question their own abilities because of it. The insurance industry is huge. One toxic workplace does not represent the entire field, and one difficult boss does not determine your future. Sometimes one door shuts so that a much better one can open. **Thank you, independent agencies!"**

— r/InsuranceAgent · 34 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ty3ilq/update_being_let_go_from_a_toxic_agency_turned/

↳ CapitalE___ (8): "This legit gave me hope 🥰. I was just told by a recruiter the manager loved me (interview today). Hopefully Monday I get good news. Anyway, congrats!!! 🎉 May your journey go well. Btw, saw your last post, was a bit confusing but after reading I got the gist. Sorry you went through that, but as you said, one closed for an even better one right? Keeping that hope for myself. Have a great first day and enjoy your weekend"

↳ Natepeeeff (4): "So glad you made the choice! Seeing the horror stories of people working for captive companies and just being beaten down is awful. When I got into insurance a while back I knew that the agency I got with would take care of me. (A very well known one around here.) Like with any insurance agency, the numbers are the driving factor. But they'll at least treat you like a human being and not a machine. I hope it works out well, and very glad you tagged me in the comment on the other post with this update. Good work!"

↳ Terrible_Juice805 (3): "Good for you. It gives hope that those of us that are in shit pay environment and you are belittled and empowered at all can find something better."

"Buying an Independent Insurance Agency I am interested in purchasing my own independent agency and currently in the process of researching what that entails. Background: I currently work for a family agency where I am 3^(rd) generation. My grandfather started the business, and I work under my dad and alongside my siblings. I have been at the agency for 5 years. I thought that it was fixable, but things are not going the way I hoped. There is always a ton of family drama that spills into the workplace, and it is a very unprofessional environment that drives me crazy. I am the only one who has outside work experience (previously an engineer for 10 years). Everyone else came straight to the agency and lacks very common and important real-life skills. Managing a calendar, Microsoft office knowledge, how to communicate effectively (to carriers, customers, and co-workers), etc... I come from a sales background so managing a pipeline and working with business owners or homeowners comes naturally. I've also been managing marketing, accounting, and day-to-day business operations, referral commercial lines quoting, CL renewals and networking for the agency. 90% of the daily decisions are made by me and then my father just blindly signs off on them because he is the principal and checked out (ready to retire). I have transitioned the agency to a new AMS, new accounting software, and transitioned most of our book away from agency bill. I have successfully increased efficiency by taking our 8-person agency down to 3.5 people. No one was fired, we had old staff and everyone retired. I thought we were going to be able to work together as siblings and run the agency, I was wrong. I tried a couple times to sit everyone down individually and talk about goals, dream responsibilities, and other things that would help align all our visions but am always met with "I dunno", or "I don't care", or "This is stupid, stop trying to make this a corporate office". Anytime there is a disagreement there is either a huge fight or one sibling goes to our mom who manipulates my dad into making the decision behind our back. I am looking for guidance from agency owners or industry veterans. What mistakes did you make when starting out or how would you do it differently now. 1. I am not interested in a captive agency 2. I understand PE acquisitions are at an all-time high but there are a good number of small mom and pop shop agencies around with limited succession planning (Ohio) 3. I understand getting a new carrier appointment right now during the hard market is very difficult if not currently impossible, but I will weigh the agencies current carrier selection very carefully 4. I understand this is a HUGE undertaking and the YEARS of work it will require Thank you in advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l48ryh/buying_an_independent_insurance_agency/

↳ firenance (14): "Agency M&A consultant. I consult on situations like this all the time. Sadly it's super common. Unfortunately in many cases the answer is leave because you won't change the family dynamic. Listen to the scratch agency podcast. The host Stephen left a 4 generation family agency to start his own. Don't think it was similar drama, but similar decision. I'm sure he would chat with you about his journey. Yes you are right. Buying is expensive, but there can be great opportunities if you network directly with small town owners getting ready to retire. Do not buy a small book of business <\$300K through a broker, but do work with an advisor. I don't normally do this because they are a competitor of mine, but connect with IA Valuations, it's a division of OIA and they may be able to give you some pointers or recommendations in your state."

↳ Comprehensive_Act772 (7): "No experience with this...just want to say good luck and I hope this works out for you. Such a tough situation."

↳ firenance (5): "Under 300 K revenue through a business broker. In most cases, it's gonna be a book transfer and valuation is completely subjective. Small book brokers will just say 2.5 times revenue without really evaluating risk like carrier concentration, book mix, or policies per customer metrics. Or even how the book was built. If it was all online or purchased leads the retention on that is gonna be completely different than somebody with a high reputation local agency."

"I need leads for contact rate. My sales skills are there I think because I have talked with people then sold policies but it seems like I am calling such bad leads that don't answer or hang up in my face in the first second of the call"

— YouTube · Insurance Agents: Should you buy leads or generate leads ? · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aGrUeGEYEpl&lc=UgxNQe5hKU22JZfoKKJ4AaABAq>

"I would love to have a sit down with John about this. This is such amazing advice. I'm an agent through a captive agency in NY and I have been having such a tough time, with what I thought was leads. My problem isn't that I can't get people to answer, my problem continues to be no shows and I feel like I'm stuck in that "hamster wheel" where I've called the leads to oblivion and have a tough time booking those. Mind you, some of the leads I'm given are 6 or 7 years old where we're told to, "throw them against the wall and see what sticks." I'm going to implement this more aggressive calling method and see how it helps. Thank you so much."

— YouTube · How To Work Insurance Leads Like A Pro! (Cody Askins & John Wetmore) · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nf_TnViVvis&lc=Ugy_-op6VjG4LLmRuwn4AaABAq

"Cody you are a natural talent and I appreciate learning so much from you HOWEVER, in addition to just setting an appointment you MUST build rapport with the applicants. I noticed after you mention the color they chose, you rolled right into the business instead. This can create a lot of no shows. Your calls are a little too quick. Other than that, you are a rock star."

— YouTube · Live Dialing Insurance Leads! [Final Expense Insurance] · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RL6Y5qig0Wg&lc=UgxVYRL8-dnbSluQ_vh4AaABAq

↳ @terryrees7184 (16): "Sheek LIFE Insurance You have a valid point.. but actually, I personally admire Cody's grit. He's been around long enough to know not to waste time on the phone. Cold calling is an unnatural act and requires nerve & technique. Building rapport with a client is best served face to face when he knocks on the door where a smile goes a long way. Cheers"

↳ @ChocolateSheek (5): "Terry Rees Thank you so much!! Cody is awesome. I met him at the conference last year and won a phone call from him a couple months back. I've learned so much from him in the life insurance community. But I've personally been in sales for majority of my career. Building rapport is "immediately and on going" it doesn't matter if you're cold calling or meeting them in person. I promise you it works. Cheers to you too ❤️ "

↳ @CodyAskins (4): "Thank you for your perspective!"

"TCPA mainly focuses on robo calls and dialers. I don't use any of those to dial my leads. I'm pretty much old school and hand dial myself. It's been 2 years for me and I haven't had an issue yet. I also don't spam call my leads. If someone answers and states they're not interested, I move on to the next lead. I'm not in the business of begging or being pushy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/m9mifjh/

"None of my prospects are answering my calls after setting an appointment I'm just asking for a bit of advice and wisdom here. About a week or more ago I made a post about having trouble cold calling in the supplementary insurance industry. After changing my approach, this week I've had people be very responsive and receptive. I've gotten about 4 or 5 enthusiastic "yes" to appointments, as well as more neutral/curious yeses for a total of about 8 appointments for people ready to listen to the product and possibly buy. However, literally none of these prospects save for one have answered the phone when I call them in the appointed time. Is this normal? What could be the cause for an enthusiastic or very curious "yes" to completely ghost? My experience with sales has mostly been with warm leads or D2D approaches, so I'm very new to converting a cold call into a sale. I'm assuming it's just a form of sales that requires a lot of follow up but I'd like to see what you guys think. Here's my current approach: 1. Open with an upbeat tone ask if I'm talking to the person. 2. Give empathic line similar to "I know you weren't expecting this call. If this is a bad time you can let me know..." something like this. This was a change I made that worked surprisingly well and has pretty much gotten 90% of my leads to stay on the line curious on what I have to say, which was something I'd been struggling with for a while. 3. If they say it's a good time, I give a quick elevator pitch to pique their interest and test the waters if they want to know about the product fully at that moment or if we should set an appointment. Most times we set appointment. 4. A few of these have even given me their free time before I even ask them so they kinda close the appointment for me. So we set the time and I put it on the agenda. Then I call them and... radio silence. I usually send a text to let them know and call a few days later but still nothing. Today I have a long list of follow ups from the ones from last week to see if they pick up today. Assuming it's on me and it's not just the nature of the cold calling in the supplemental insurance industry, my suspicion is that I'm messing up somewhere in the follow up. I haven't gotten any answer from any of my texts so maybe I'm scaring them off? I dunno. Any feedback would be greatly appreciated!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qrb80b/none_of_my_prospects_are_answering_my_calls_after/

↳ InstructionOk3766 (6): "I would strongly recommend automating reminders. Use every channel available. Email. SMS. Phone calls. Voicemails. Every missed follow up is a leak in your funnel. Plug those leaks and the same leads you already have will start producing far more revenue over time. If you are serious about growth, this massive fix you can make."

↳ theluchador19 (3): "The client should be getting automated emails and texts without you having to do it for the follow up. Also it sounds like they just are saying anything to get you off the line and are too polite to say "I'm not interested". Maybe a little more forceful? That way they can tell you, no I'm not interested"

↳ DJSimmer305 (3): "When you call someone for an appointment are you calling them from a phone number that can send text messages? If so, this is what you need to do: When you set the appointment with the person, send them a text message while you are still on the phone with them. It can be a picture of your business card, your license, or even just "hi this is u/hey2394". I recommend sending your business card because it likely has your face on it and it humanizes you to the prospect. Tell them to just reply to that message "got it" or "okay" so you can confirm they received it and have your number saved. Do not let them hang up before they reply back. The reason you need them to reply is because when you send them reminders, they will see in the conversation that they replied and it reminds them that they actually spoke to you "oh yeah, this was the guy I talked to yesterday. I liked him." Immediately after you hang up send another message: "Hi John, it's u/hey2394. We just spoke on the phone. You're all set for Wednesday at 2:30pm. I value both your time and mine, so please let me know if anything changes or you need to reschedule. Looking forward to speaking with you again." Send them reminders leading up to the appointment as well and on the day of, also ask them to reply back and confirm that 2:30 is still a good time."

"Man, totally get how you feel. All week last week, I had 15 Medicare Appointments no show me. By some Miracle, I got 2 T65 enrollemts yesterday and another 3 T65 today. about \$3900 in commission. Making me feel like me chasing people around last week was worth it I guess."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1le5o1e/i_bought_an_ad_funnel_and_while_ive_booked_a_lot/mydnrpy/

"I will give some feedback on agency side. This past month I've had 10 carriers call me attempting to schedule lunch or invite me to a social event. Two years ago half of them told me to pound sand and stop wasting their time because they weren't writing. If you're from a surplus, niche, or general carrier that gave me the cold shoulder and I don't know you, it's not a priority to send you business unless you're absolutely crushing it. Usually if that's the case I'm doing everything I can to be your best friend. Call your agents if you want the business and have a question. Example on the ghost: If I have a hot lead and I submit it with a 3 day turn around from you with sup request email, when Joe at X company gave me a rate pending confirmation of remediation, after telling me previously it's his target market over lunch/scheduled call I'm pitching it 100% of the time. We live as agents on commission and the underwriters who helped us through hell, in the hardest market for 30+ years get remembered when doors open."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1tv8ja5/underwriting_frustrations_is_this_really_how_it_is/ophkcre/

"I've only done a little over a week of actual calls myself. Never regretted any choice so much as the one to go into selling life insurance. Though it's not the angry customers and hang ups that have me burnt out. I had no idea the costs involved in buying leads (on top of licenses), and started this job while already in debt in several areas of life. I'm looking at a foreclosure on my house while barely being able to afford 20 leads a week. Which is too few and only half of what my company expects me to get, and I'm constantly aware of what little money I have left for more leads. I've had very few people even answer the phone (and I call often and have left voicemails), and have yet to get through the first 10 seconds with those few that did, so my confidence has taken a dive. I've made changes to the way respond to those initial objections, I feel I'm better prepared to keep the call going, but I just can't afford to buy more leads to test them out. I'm about to try out a burner in the hopes I can breathe some life into one or two of my old leads and get them to pick up, as well as get the next leads to answer. With all that I might still be able to push through, but having my boss make comments about taking responsibility for ourselves and our destiny, and telling me he took out credit cards when he got started (which I wouldn't be approved for anyway, and already took out my 401k), pretty much led to a meltdown the other day. I'm aware of my shortcomings, and usually good with constructive criticism, but with those I can't control like finances, being told indirectly I'm making excuses has about done me in. Being in on our morning meetings usually gets me pumped and feeling confident but all of a sudden.. it's just gone, and I'm deflated like a balloon. I'm struggling to get back into the mindset I need to be in. Just 20 or so leads a week is costing me \$400, and I'll be almost broke after the next batch I get on Monday, and I just can't escape that thought of what do I do if I don't make a sale. And the live transfers go too fast for me to grab them. They're expensive but at least I would be able to do a presentation and not feel like such a failure so soon after starting. Sorry OP, I'm not very helpful lol. But I feel you. It's not an easy career by any means. I haven't given up but I'm not sure what else I can do when the money runs out. I feel like motivational books might be helpful for you though. Before the meltdown (as I already have issues being naturally confident) I was reading "The magic of thinking big" by David Schwartz. It really was helping with motivation and my frame of mind before now. You might give it a go, it can't hurt."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jxx2oa/i_am_burn_out_and_i_just_started_help/mmups74/

"I really suggest starting full time and going with Duford - but they do not take just anyone. Go through all of their YT videos and figure out if this is something you want to do. You will need to be licensed in your state AND you will have to pay to be licensed in 10 other states. After you get your state license you only have to pay a fee to the other states, but it will cost \$600 to \$900 depending on which states. Duford has a free lead service for full timers. That is the best way to start because it gets you fully trained and does not cost anything for leads. Once you start to close sales you can switch to the paid leads. You should be able to 2x or 3x the cost of leads every week, so as long as you have time, you can spend as much as you want and 2x or 3x on your spend. Duford and Globe Life Family Heritage Division both have in-person sales, too. You should be able to close 50% of your in person sales because they are usually more motivated, which is why they are letting you in their house. If you are very young, in person may not be the way to go. Regardless, you can still do the free leads full time with Duford to learn and start. Most people fail because they do not make the calls - you need to double and triple dial to get people to answer - and 80 to 90% of the people are not going to remember they asked for information and they are going to hang up on you. After a few weeks of that people get burned out and quit. BUT - if you make 3 to 7 sales per week, you will be on your way to a great income. I have another company I would recommend but I can't do it on here, they would be pissed and I do not know how or if I can DM from Reddit. Bottom line is to save your money for getting all of your state licenses, work free leads until you figure out if this is what you want to do, watch Duford's YouTube videos to learn about the business, figure out if you can stand to be hung up on and yelled at 20 times a day, and get your P and C license, too, so at worst, you can get a job in the local Allstate or State Farm agency and sell car insurance."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1adi8ew/any_tips_on_succeeding_as_a_health_insurance_agent/kk9tjuf/

"I dealt with this a lot when I first started. The most important thing is to practice your pitch, this helps calm the "what do I say if they pick up trigger". Realize that most dials won't answer, some will and really need help and you'll have a pleasant conversation and you'll either sell them or you won't, and if you get someone who is screaming and yelling, you hold all the power to hang up and dead the lead. Any shitty person you call you only have to talk to once. Also what helped me too was realizing THIS is the job I signed up for and while I hate bothering people A) they signed up for this, that's why they should have read the fine print when putting in their info and B) if it wasn't you in that seat dialing someone else would be there doing the same thing. Also it may feel like you're alone diving into a crowd but in reality the person you're dialing is dealing with a crowd stampeding their phone, you're just a faceless head in that stampede until you build rapport. I used to sit there and comb through the lead and think of who's going to be on the other line until I realized I would always be wrong and most of the time I'll probably never talk to them, so I kinda space out while dialing now and if someone picks up I just snap back with the pitch I've practiced a thousand times and start building rapport while I pull everything up. Also look at a bad phone call as taking them off your list and cleaning up your pipeline (which is still a win), my first thought after a shitty call is always "Thank god I never have to talk to that guy/gal again" then move them to dead."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wmt560/reluctance_to_dial/pbd1bx5/

"The problem is not putting hard work, if you went through the process you know that if you don't work hard you won't get any leads in r call people... The problems is that in the beginning they don't tell you but you will be getting old ass leads... and that's is frustrating... still not a cold call but some people don't even remember they signed up for... not to mention other agents that don't resolve their bad leads so it goes back to the pile as a no answer... and guess what? You will eventually call a bunch of people who already said are not interested many times... so I've seen some new agents taking many weeks just to book something remotely good... People who jump into this desperate for money and with no much time to climb up until get fresh leads will not last long, it's a fact, and they should be open about that from the get go... instead they hype you up, push you to learn all scripts and so on, and when you are finally ready you will spend 80 of you time going through a list of leads and calling people that never pickup the phone."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cy9b7k/im_stuck_at_globe_life_american_income_life_and_i/ms4ol22/

"Ringba Leads through Integrity Connect are a scam- Beware Hi All- This is an FYI and looking for an inbound lead company recommendations. I had 6 different issues where they are charging for calls under the 90 second buffer time, calls that were never happened, missed calls that never rang or stating there are missed calls where the consumer hung up. I have provided proof from my phone company/call logs to show the inaccurate data in their system but received the same cookie cutter response with no resolution or even a credit. \$55 a call is pricey when the calls never actually happened. If it is a valid call and the buffer time has been passed by al means charge me but don't charge me for systems issues or calls that never happened. Three other people on our team experienced the same types of issues. Also, 95% of the calls are for "free 25K coverage" which essentially is just an objection but my main point is they are not high intent leads. If anyone uses a reliable inbound call lead company, please drop it below. TYIA"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u9pr90/ringba_leads_through_integrity_connect_are_a_scam/

↳ adam_ringba (4): "Adam here, founder and CEO of Ringba. Our name is in the title so I wanted to respond directly. Quick context on how this actually works, because it matters: Ringba doesn't generate leads or calls. We're the technology platform behind the call exchange that Integrity buys through. There are hundreds of independent companies selling calls on the exchange, Integrity is one of the buyers, and our system handles the routing and tracking in between. So the calls you received came from one of those sellers, not from us, and I can't speak to how they were labeled inside Connect. What I can do is look at your actual calls. Every call that touches the exchange is tracked end to end. If you DM me the phone number you were taking calls on, or a few of the caller IDs with rough dates, I'll personally pull the logs and tell you exactly what happened: where each call originated, how long it rang, how long it connected, all of it. If something went wrong on our side, I'll tell you that too. The other thing I'd offer: we run a group with 600+ Connect agents in it where we help people troubleshoot exactly this, every day. I'm in there myself. Setup issues, routing issues, what the top agents do differently, all of it. Agents in that group wrote over \$1.2M in annual premium through Connect in the last 30 days, and most of the ones doing well hit walls early on too. Happy to get you in if you want. We also recorded a podcast with Integrity where agents on the exchange talk candidly about their experience: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=r4UBGoFkH9U>/(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=r4UBGoFkH9U>) Sorry you had a bad run. Send me those numbers and let's find out what really happened."

↳ Fun_Valuable_1765 (3): "Do you know if integrity connect has the same issues for Medicare health leads?"

↳ Willing-Landscape144 (2): "Honestly this is the case for all Inbound leads. I've tried them and got tired of the bait and switch marketing that would cause callers to assume the policies were "free". Not worth the hassle and chargebacks."

"If/when I retire, I think I might copy your setup here because I get these things all the time. Given my job, I can't just not answer the phone when it says "spam call" because it can sometimes be a client (that happens more than you probably think). If I have time, I'll fuck with them, and I've gotten as far as a US agent who hung up on me when I asked for his NPN. One day I'll sit down and memorize the script so that I can do my own damage. If you're hiring off-shore lead generators, I hate you. I don't care what your excuse is. Your vendor is illegally imposing on me, and I don't owe you shit. You and your vendor is making everyone else's life harder so that you can both make a buck. Do better. Down vote me to oblivion if you want. I'm with the OP, and if you're on the side of these assholes, you're the problem. I don't care."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1saqau4/your_pal_fc_discusses_lead_generators_here_if_you/odxyzor/

"I don't understand the whole lead thing. In my niche we can just look up RFPs. It's up to us to get the best coverage for the price to beat out the other brokers. Never heard of a single one of my \$5m revenue producers talk about buying a lead... I will say ten years ago I put my phone number into a site when I was looking for health insurance and was bombarded for months 50 times a day by people who bought that "lead". Always thought this would be a great way to get some petty revenge on someone, but never did it. I guess my point is, why are you buying leads? Sounds very lazy to me and I am not shocked it's not working out well. When I have anyone randomly contacting me without me wanting to hear from that person/company that's an instant hang up."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s5vcry/the_shared_leads_thing_is_such_a_scam_and_i_cant/ocyg4dy/

"FB lead costs doubling is hitting everyone right now. You're not alone in that struggle. Live transfers sound appealing but most vendors in this space are running the same garbage model as low-quality lead gen. They're buying aged data, cold calling people who filled out forms weeks ago, and claiming it's "inbound" because someone answered the phone. Real live transfers where someone actually called in asking for life insurance quotes are rare and expensive. Market rate for quality inbound calls is \$40-\$80+ per transfer depending on demographic and coverage type. Anyone promising \$15-\$20 transfers is either lying about volume or selling recycled contacts. How to vet vendors: Ask directly how they generate the calls. If they get vague about sources or say "we run campaigns," they're probably buying data and cold calling. Real inbound vendors can explain their call flow clearly. Request recorded sample calls before you commit. Listen to how prospects sound. Are they confused? Do they remember requesting information? That tells you if it's actually inbound or just someone who finally answered a cold call. Test volume claims with a small trial first. If they promise 50 transfers a day, start with 10 and see if they deliver consistent quality. Most can't scale without quality dropping hard. Watch for exclusivity clauses or mandatory minimums that lock you in. You want flexibility to walk away if quality tanks. The agents we work with who tried live transfers usually found cost per actual sale was higher than expected once you factor in no-shows, people who weren't actually interested, and transfers that were just cold calls. The math works if you're closing 30-40% but most see way lower conversion. If your current FB setup gets you to 60% contact eventually, you might be better off fixing your speed-to-lead and follow-up process instead of jumping to expensive live transfers. The difference between calling in 5 minutes vs 2 hours is massive for pickup rates."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qcyrm6/inbound_call_leads_for_struggling_life_insurance/nzsah6t/

Carriers: non-commissionable plans, cuts and service · 49 documents · 20 voices

"Let's remember what selling health was like pre-ACA Before 2010, I was running a rather large individual health insurance agency. Jan 2010 literally put me out of business overnight as commissions evaporated. I looked at my wife and said "well, this all needed to change." Commission rocked. 25% average on the front, 5% renewals on average. \$400/mo premium = \$1,200. Market was everyone that didn't have group. We could even pull people off group. Although highly unethical, it happened all the time. 1. Declines for all major health conditions. Diabetes? Decline. Heart? Decline. 2. Ratings or waivers/riders for every other health condition you can imagine. HBP, Asthma, etc...rated 25% to 50% or the condition was excluded from coverage. Some more mild conditions might have only resulted in a drug waiver. 3. Post claims underwriting. No carrier pulled medical records or MIB reports. Instead, they waited until they filed a claim. Any misrepresentation on the app resulted in either a denial of that claim or a policy rescission. For auto, imagine no one checked anything; no DMV report, didn't run their license and only did that when they went to file a claim, then cancelled the policy. 4. Fraud was everywhere. Agents knew they wouldn't get paid for putting conditions/meds on the app, so they excluded them. I was trained by Mega Life to never list health conditions. Tough conversations with newly self-employed people. Many simply could not get covered. People who had direct control over their health, like smokers I had little sympathy for. People with conditions out of their control? Horrible phone calls."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 48 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lrh008/lets_remember_what_selling_health_was_like_preaca/

↳ jroberts67 (43): "Some of my calls went like this: 'I'm sorry but due to your health conditions you'll be denied coverage.'" "That's fine, I'll call another agent." "There are 8 health insurance carriers in MD and I write for all of them. It's a decline for all of them." "So what do I do now, I don't have access to group." "You'd have to find a job that offered group health." "I run a business." "You'd have to close it down and get a job." "....really." "Yes, really. To anyone here who wants a ACA repeal and to go back to the way it was, if you're self employed and on any meds or have any conditions, you're ass out."

↳ Brown_Car1987 (29): "I reminded a client of this not that long ago. She was espousing repealing the ACA, and has been fighting cancer for years. When I reminisced about the old days of declined apps for med history, she didn't know what to say. People who were covered by employer plans then have no idea what happened if you wanted to retire before 65."

↳ Brown_Car1987 (16): "Sounds familiar. And retiring "early"? Don't think so. Marketplace isn't perfect, but it definitely solved several problems."

"RIP to Wellcare Wellcare decided to screw over their agents yesterday. They announced that they are terminating all agents for Medicare drug plans at the end of the year, and cutting all commissions for both new and renewal business. Allegedly this was live at a national conference and they were LITERALLY booed off the stage. It feels awfully salty that they offered some of the best plans in the market for 2 years in a row, bought the business, and are now cutting out all their agents. Thankfully we only have hundreds of clients to move, but I know some massive agencies that have thousands. We'll lose less than 2% of revenue, but we're done with Wellcare for good."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 34 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ezltc7/rip_to_wellcare/

↳ [deleted] (17): "They will come back to hire you. They think that they can sell online, and they are about to find out that this is not the case."

↳ NAF1138 (11): "It looks like Humana and UHC are about to get a LOT of new PDP customers"

↳ Itschmit (8): "Every company has the right to giveth and taketh away. But I agree it's just unethical bad business"

"Why aren't we talking about commission cuts? I've been lurking here for a while, and like many others, I've been considering getting licensed to sell health insurance. I've noticed there are "a ton" of weekly posts asking "Should I get into insurance?" and most of the responses are really positive and encouraging. But what surprises me is what's **NOT** being discussed much: **#1 Major carriers are cutting commissions or removing them entirely.** Here are some examples: * **United Health Care** will stop paying commissions on 100+ Medicare Advantage plans and all PDPs in over 20 states starting July 1, 2025. The NAIFA denounced UHC's decision to cut agent commissions. * **Aetna** is withdrawing from the ACA marketplace and slashing commissions after 2025. * **Cigna, Centene, Elevance (Anthem)** are all making similar moves. **#2 The recent passing of the new "Big Beautiful Bill".** From what I can tell, these are pretty major shifts and could seriously impact how agents make a living going forward. Yet almost none of this shows up in the "how do I start" threads. Why? So, I wanted to ask more directly: * Why isn't there more discussion about these changes here? Is the impact overstated, or are we just not seeing the effects "yet"? * Do veteran agents think ACA/Medicare will still be viable long-term? * Should newcomers treat this as a full-time career or more of a side hustle moving forward? * How are current agents planning to adapt in the next 5-10 years? Genuinely curious. I'm not trying to be negative. I'm just surprised there isn't more open talk about what seems like some pretty big red flags for the industry. Would love to hear what those of you already in the trenches think. Thanks!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/

↳ jroberts67 (17): "A solid career in insurance is either P&C or life products. Although I've seen a lot of talk (licensed since 2003) about the "wild riches" of Medicare, I've never seen it. That's not to say no one has built a solid career selling supps, just an extremely small percentage. Health insurance died Jan 1st 2010."

↳ brightladdy (12): "Overall there's just less chatter about Medicare here. I feel like majority of users in this sub are P&C agents, followed closely by the MLM Life Insurance folk. Could just be a demographic thing. Reddit users tend to be of the younger generations and maybe the majority of Medicare reps are all chatting in those cesspool Facebook groups."

↳ voidsarcastic (11): "United is simply restructuring and will release new plans for AEP. Obviously they were hit hard, notice they only decommissioned the extremely affordable PPOs going forward... thats because they don't want you to sell any more of them and they cant just release plan changes mid year. And you are talking about commission cuts when we were just announced a 10% increase in MAPD renewals and Initials for 2026. There are lots of carriers dying to throw agents money.... And new carriers are still getting in the game and expanding every year, which is a good sign. I agree it is a little unstable right now, but for agents that is a good thing. Medicare and ACA aren't going anywhere. And if they do, you have an entire book to convert to the new thing."

"Agency M&A Market Update Sharing some current intel on the agency M&A market. Everything here is generalities, but current trends you won't see in press releases. I also won't cite multiples, because even within these segments there is a lot of nuance and "what ifs" that have to be answered. But some general intel on if you have an agency in this category, things to consider. **Size Matters** Always has, but many capital buyers are continuing to bump up their targets. If you are sub \$750K revenue then PE buyers aren't as active. Your best bet is another local agency, and the offers won't be the same. Some PE buyers will play in this space, but the offers are super complex with low guarantees and pie in the sky earn out potentials. This has always been the case, but we're seeing less interest from larger buyers in that segment. >\$750K-\$1M, is typically where the interest remains. Majority of large buyers are open to >\$1M EBITDA, so if you are \$2.5M-\$3M+ revenue, the market is dramatically different. If you are a small agency, and want/need the best exit scenario, your primary objective is quality growth. Makes sense to increase the sale of an asset you should increase what makes it valuable, but for some reason people don't make that connection. If you are content with a handshake deal to turn over the keys with an agency across town, great, but don't expect a high sale price. **Medicare and Non-standard P&C Agencies are Super Limited** The population of buyers has dwindled tremendously over the last 12-18 months. Opinion? It's political. Any time there is looming administration change on health care or immigration, these can be volatile. Medicare agencies are constantly facing changing carriers, comp rates, etc. so on a dime a successful agency can be at risk. Just this week a client, large FMO, learned their #2 carrier was pulling out of a territory and they were at risk to lose revenue on 2,000 policies unless they find a replacement this AEP. Buyers know that, and have only been offering low cash proceeds at close and significant rolled equity or growth earn outs. So when you only have a few options, and the options aren't great, it's hard to sell for a good price. Non-standard is similar, in that there are only a handful of large buyers. Even large (>\$3M revenue) non-standard P&C agencies are not getting good offers. So unless sellers have a motivation to get out, many are holding on. Small or local non-standard, practically your only option is selling to someone local or another non-standard. **Personal Lines is Getting Slightly Less Interest Compared to Last Year** Many large buyers are changing their buy-box criteria to focus on a minimum book mix, so unless an agency has a minimum of 30%-50% CL, many of the larger buyers aren't excited. That's not saying they aren't sellable, we still get great interest for good agencies, but when the buyer pool reduces that can be reflected in the offers. This is an observation, but on average we are seeing offers for PL focused agencies around 10% less compared to last year for guaranteed proceeds. When you think about it, property rates in many states have slowed or even started to decrease, so the due diligence standards are also looking at this. Many agencies have floated on rate the last few years, and now the tide has turned. Having history of client count or PIF is more important, and if your revenue is stable but you've lost clients and policies, that's flag being discussed. **CL, or HNW, Holds Strong Interest** There are still nuances within that, but many capital buyers are focusing their efforts on agencies with 50% or more CL. Even though we still see strong interest in PL, on average we see almost double the amount of qualified inquiries for a CL focused agency. **Earn out Structures are Evolving** People know "you have to stay on for 2-3 years" to work out an earnout, but candidly recent history has proven that many sellers almost don't care about earnouts, or that's all they care about then completely check out. For truly competitive offers, buyers are focusing more on true perpetuation planning vs buying an owner out and giving them a short term retirement window. This is the rare exception, but have seen it, where some buyers are now tying earnout performance to staff retention (AMs and producers) instead of just the owner. Not everyone will adopt this, but I wouldn't be surprised if more do. So perpetuation of culture and why your agency can perform will be tied to things other than strictly financials. **EDIT Diversified Agencies are Not Always A Good Idea** Agencies that offer derivative services like real estate, tax prep, bookkeeping, payroll, HR, etc. cause problems. Back in the day there used to be buyers for these, not anymore. They will be broken up if you want to sell. Even as far as P&C PL and Medicare. As much as you feel they are complimentary, they aren't. Different markets. Even things like group benefits and HR consulting. While complimentary not everyone who does group benefits wants HR consulting. If you look at diversified larger agencies you can see one clear trend. P&C CL and group benefits can have some compliment. That's it. Focus on doing one thing, really really well, and don't get distracted with other things."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vzu98u/>

↳ (0): "Nice write up. Kind of what I am seeing/hearing as well. Have had a few calls from some older agency owners under 1,000,000 in revenue noting that they haven't received much interest from PE. I asked if they had any younger producers and they noted they did not. With the lack of younger talent and revenue under a 1,000,000 they aren't getting much traction on being acquired or able to sell to PE."

↳ (0): "Yep. Stagnant or no growth is sellable, but the true difference is a well run business, good staffing, and history of organic growth."

↳ (0): "Great write up and insights. Appreciate your expertise here, as always."

"For MAPD brokers, who is still writing UHC and Humana non-commissionable plans? Across most of the country over the past few years, UnitedHealthcare and Humana have made many of their MAPD plans non-commissionable. I refuse to work for free and represent these plans going forward. Are there any MAPD-certified brokers who are still willingly selling these plans? Just curious as to why you would put a client on a plan you receive no commissions on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1woc7yr/for_mapd_brokers_who_is_still_writing_uhc_and/

↳ Brown_Car1987 (12): "I have them available, and will put a client on one of it is clearly the only real option for them. Last year, of my 700+ clients, I think I used them for maybe 10-15 people, usually because of formulary. I believe I will keep more clients long term by doing the right thing. I generally tell them we're not getting paid on this one."

↳ Key_Astronomer6500 (5): "The issue is you're taking on liability without getting paid. Carriers are making it so much harder for agents to make money W2 places won't let you. Even the reduced commission plans. Can't do what's best for the client Edit: one reason is because you may be able to sell other types of plans or policies. Also, if it's a spouse in the house."

↳ the_walkingdad (3): "I think the liability issue isn't talked about enough! It's ridiculous that CMS doesn't want "incentive-based steering" on MA plans, so they put a cap on broker commissions. All that does is create more incentive-based steering in the opposite direction. CMS should enforce a minimum commission on MA plans as a back stop. That could still create incentive-based steering, so the best answer would just be flat commissions for any MA plan across the board."

"Medicare Agent Commissions I have a question for fellow Medicare agents. With carriers pulling commissions what are your plans to pivot to keep business alive? My clients and new individuals turning 65 still are in such need for help navigating through the weeds of the whole system along with their plan choices but working for free just can't go on. We have a higher MS clientele rate but now with those rates skyrocketing I'm concerned there will be a shift towards MAPD which a lot are going non-commissionable. Also in our small area we don't have a thriving market for DVH so that's out. What are you all doing to stay alive?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kotgtz/medicare_agent_commissions/

↳ TopperWildcat13 (7): "PDP's barely paid much to begin with, it's honestly not that big of a deal. Also, MOST of the non commissioned MAPD's are made that way because carriers are either about to sunset them anyway or they actively don't want you to sell that plan. Until a carrier makes their premier plan non commissioned, I wouldn't worry. My book is doing just fine"

↳ Lopsided_Ad_9166 (4): "What carriers are pulling commissions??"

↳ BangDingOwwwww (4): ""Also in our small area we don't have a thriving market for DVH so that's out." Get out of here with that nonsense. DVH is an easy add on and you should be able to close 30% no problem. As for the MAPD's, the carrier doesn't want those plans sold, so find the next best thing that pays and make it happen. Regarding PDP's, it's a courtesy, and you shouldn't expect to get paid on them, you'll get paid by referral business if you do it right, and that is worth so much more than what you get paid. The money is in the grind my man. Just continue to do right by your clients and they will send friends and family to you. That's where you will find success. Don't get caught up selling the cheapest (Ace, Allstate) for obvious reasons, sell the quality product, attach a STC, DVH, HIP. There's plenty of ancillary products complement the health products. Just my two cents."

"PDP's barely paid much to begin with, it's honestly not that big of a deal. Also, MOST of the non commissioned MAPD's are made that way because carriers are either about to sunset them anyway or they actively don't want you to sell that plan. Until a carrier makes their premier plan non commissioned, I wouldn't worry. My book is doing just fine"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kotgtz/medicare_agent_commissions/msu3uko/

"Ethical way around the best MAPD fit being de-commissioned? Hi Everyone, I wanted to inquire how everyone is handling the de-commissioning of plans in their area? In my area alone, fully half of the MAPD plans are no longer commissionable for agents/brokers. Unfortunately the best fit for a client, frequently ends up being a non-commissioned plan now. Having a greater than 50% of working for free when I'm working with a client is just way too high to continue. (The ACA market in my area is having similar issues between Medicaid plans, which never pay, and low cost ACA plans, many of which, no longer pay.) Has anyone figured out an ethical way around this conundrum? It doesn't look like the insurance commissioner is going to step in."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1t1tepy/ethical_way_around_the_best_mapd_fit_being/

↳ Tumadreee (3): "MAPD's are noncommissioned now too? No wonder I see so many Medicare agencies coming for sale"

↳ Moist-Meringue-1913 (2): "Give them the plan that they want and need. Get referrals from them."

↳ Tdiddy1500 (2): "Humana just decommissioned all plans in my area"

"In the original deal they also made ALL PLANS commissionable. The hold on the final rule burnt agents drastically as some carriers cut commissions mid AEP. Right in the middle of AEP, the carrier sent out an email less than 24hrs on Oct 31 and told us the plans would be non-commissionable as of Nov 1st. Not only can these companies make plans non-commissionable all year they can cut commissions on a plan whenever they want."

— YouTube · The Reality of A Career in Medicare Insurance Sales in 2025 · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Nwa60sSWldo&lc=UgxdalukEsc_mbiYbGR4AaABAg

"I am an agent, and was formerly an independent (which I know is the opposite of what you typically see), doesn't change much if you run your agency like a business imo. Carriers on the independent side cut contracts of stagnant agencies, so in my opinion I don't think there is any company out there that isn't looking for growth."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8e1j1/state_farm_team_members_how_are_you_guys_holding/os8w15i/

"I'm an ACA broker in about 15 states and the commissions are always \$15-\$30 per month per member, depending on the carrier. It's never a % of the monthly premium in my experience. There's no commission if you canceled before it started. That guy defo gave you bad info on filing status. Glad you got the right I fo here!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1woe9l3/is_my_insurance_broker_correct_that_filing_taxes/pbq7yor/

"Like commission rates? Luckily they're all pretty close carrier to carrier so sell the best plan for the client every-time, and every client is different so different plans and carriers work better for different people. Pretty sure MAPD is the same rate for every carrier (315 renewal 650 IEP) however over-rides may be different and some offer HRA bonus. Most supplements are 20-23% annual (first year advance), and dental/HI is like 45-50% annual (first year advance). Be careful some MAPD plans are non-commissionable i do avoid those, but there really aren't many. I have however done no commission part Ds, you gotta do what you gotta do. Life commissions should be between 80%-115% (9 month- 12 month advance) starting out, if you're taking a lower comp from the FMO make sure you are getting lots of support."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ijykig/new_agent_choosing_an_fmo_vs_going_direct_advice/mjrwf7/

"Appreciate the context! That helps me understand it better. Sounds like you're saying this is might be more of a market correction or rough patch than a permanent decline for agents. I've heard some of the chatter around UHC's situation but didn't realize it was that bad. Curious, do you think the carriers pulling commissions now might bring them back "if" the plans become profitable again? Or is that just wishful thinking and the trend toward no commissions is here to stay? And yeah, I agree...it feels like ACA/Medicaid are way more vulnerable, but hard to predict where this all ends up."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/n563vtn/

"MAPD's are noncommissioned now too? No wonder I see so many Medicare agencies coming for sale"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1t1tepy/ethical_way_around_the_best_mapd_fit_being/onogrqm/

"@Seniorbenes Well you are running an agency and that is not feasible for most new agents because they lack the capitol to start on a large scale like that. Yes if you scale to the point you are doing then it can work, but your investment is huge when this industry has 90% of new agents failing in the first 2 years. My description is what an average independent agent will perform. Nick from Medicare Millionaire is an independent agent and works by himself. He is a seasoned agent and very good at selling yet he only sold 127 policies in 2018 and he does this full time and employs his own telemarketer for \$3 per hour and uses direct mail leads. I was an assistant office manager for a Medicare brokerage firm for 9 years and out of 10 agents that our office had we only had 2 top producers and they each had about 1,500 clients. They serviced all of their clients and they were extremely stressed out all the time especially during AEP when MA plans became discontinued and they needed to review plan changes every year for their large client base. The average agent had about 500 clients. You need to provide customer service for your clients if you want to keep them long term and the sheer amount of work required to service MA plans simply isn't worth it. 95% of the calls we got at our agency was people having questions about their co-pays, the network, prescription drug co-pays, Part D late enrollment penalties, prescription drug issues, and how their plan worked. You spent all your time servicing MA and Part D clients and this is why you can't have more than 500 clients on your own before you are forced to hire help. Having 2,000 clients yourself means you aren't providing service to them when they have issues or you are just selling Medigap. Sorry to say but 70% of seniors on Medicare nationwide have Medicare Advantage. You and I both know how hard it is to market Part C and D plans selling over the phone as CMS makes this almost impossible. You need a partnership with a carrier to pull that off on a large scale and be successful which makes you captive to that carrier. I am in this industry to help seniors, not to help some corporate insurance carrier gain market share. CMS doesn't allow you to market Part C or Part D on social media, you need to read your AHIP test again my dude."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAq.9FNCTGBfz7K9FPVNMvVfon>

"Just a back story on my thought process....Market factors and the price offered was hard to pass up. I am in an area of the country where insurance carriers are trying to decrease capacity and they do not want our business. I also had 40 percent of our revenue with one carrier and that carrier is also pulling back in our area. I had three carriers pull out of my agency as well 12 months leading to the sell. After the sell Helene destroyed my area so the market has gotten even worse. Once I sold to PE I realized the leverage they have that I didn't have. My agency was a nice size (2.5 million in rev) but a 1 million book with a carrier isn't what it used to be in an unprofitable area. I have a commitment to my family and this allowed me to achieve my dream as well. If I am an idiot I could run through all my money but at the moment I am comfortable with no debt and a lot of zeros in my account. I did agree to a three year contract known as a work out to get even more money on top of the initial offer. So far I have gotten 1/3 of the additional money. I am hoping to get the remaining 2/3 and then evaluate what I want to do next. If they treat me fairly I may continue but time will tell. Also...If another hurricane hits my area this year or even next I suspect we are heading towards a Florida scenario. I am too old and too burned out to have to tackle that type of marketplace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kr7bqt/pc_agency_owners/mtgh4s0/

"W2 jobs I have found out there now are low commission to no commission meaning they don't really pay you what your time and effort are worth. However, there are some places that do 1099 and high commission AND they provide leads. That's where I am now and it's been working for all the agents. One of the issues I always had with people on W2 is that they just come for the paycheck and never seemed to be working to get sales. I hated that. I always felt like they were wasting good leads that I could have worked. 1099, no one does that as much lol. Because they know they get paid if they make sales."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1su3zm9/i_am_stuck_frustrated_and_ready_to_give_up_on_my/oi32vrz/

"An agent helped me evaluate some Medigap policies but I finally decided to take my employer's highly-subsidized, retiree-only Medicare Advantage plan. I respect the time and value agents bring to the table, and feel badly that this person earned no commission. I want to send him a payment for his help. Help me benchmark what would be appropriate. Or do agents just think this sort of thing just comes with the territory?"

— YouTube · How Much Money Can Medicare Sales Agents Make? · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vs4gz6CkKLk&lc=UgyLEcrLhNG9vJCKcRZ4AaABAq>

↳ @TheDIGAgency (2): "I wouldn't worry about it. It's part of the business for us =)"

"We still help them choose the appropriate drug plan for them and enroll them. Commissioned or not. That's what we're there for. It was just a hit for our company when a lot of the carriers pulled commissions and were still trying to gain back what we lost last AEP and grow. Also concerned about the future of the market as a whole."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kotgtz/medicare_agent_commissions/msym76d/

"I'm sorry I should have specified. It does spend on market. I'm in California in a small county and we have plans from Aetna, Anthem and Humana that are non commissionable for MAPD this year. We just heard UHC is pulling their PDP from is on July. And of course we don't have WellCare, Aetna certain Humana etc etc. for PDP."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kotgtz/medicare_agent_commissions/msslw1v/

Bait-and-switch marketing ('free' benefits, 'free' policies) · 46 documents · 20 voices

"New life insurance agent — how are y'all actually generating your own leads? I'm a newer life insurance agent and trying to figure out how to consistently get leads without spending a bunch of money. I see people on TikTok all the time talking about how they generate their own leads and don't have to buy any... but when I ask people in my group how they're doing it, I usually just hear stuff like "go pass out flyers at grocery stores." That's just not realistic for me. I've got three kids — two of them are still really little — so standing outside a store passing out flyers isn't something I can easily do. So for those of you who have actually found a way to generate leads yourself (especially from home), how are you doing it? Social media? Referrals? Something else? I'm willing to put in the effort, I just need a smarter strategy that works around my life. Appreciate any tips 😊"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/

↳ UnfairFloor3347 (25): "My number one recommendation is to buy leads. Not any leads, Aged Leads. Specifically leads that are 9-12 months old. Old enough where they don't get calls but need a policy or are open to getting a policy at a lower rate. The CPL and CPA are low enough to give you the ability to generate considerable revenue over a 90 day period. At that point in time you can pivot into more expensive marketing solutions or paying someone to run the marketing for you."

↳ [deleted] (13): "I looked into it and they were very expensive in my opinion. Plus it's usually some room full of very hungry people in the Philippines or someplace like that bullying people through a script and that could turn out to be a waste of time in many cases. So I bought the call list myself with certain parameters I set according to people of the ages that typically are thinking about life insurance (because they typically still have people they feel the need to provide for unlike Mrs Jones at 69 years old whose kids are all in their 40s and whose husband is typically dead. I figure if people get to their 60s or older and still have absolutely no final expense coverage it's usually either because they don't see the necessity of it or they just can't afford it. Sure there are exceptions to that but they're exceptions. That brought me to my other parameter of 40K plus income, people that can actually pay the premium. The way I see it I'll just call them myself and I'll be very direct. I won't tell them I'm a "benefits coordinator" or any other BS line. I'll flat out tell them I sell life insurance and if they have about 2 minutes I'd like to give them a quote and that if they like the price I'll come by and we'll do the paperwork in person and they can take out the policy. Then I'll tell them that I'll make no attempt to talk them into buying anything they don't want or can't afford. Then I'll pause for a second. They'll either let me quote them or they won't and then I'll move on down the list. No shady practices at all. Some people will appreciate that and may actually buy a policy. Some won't. Either way I won't feel smarmy and I won't waste several hours and x amount of money on gas driving all over the place trying to talk to people that don't want to talk to me anyway and probably have no intention of buying anything."

↳ Deadly3ffect (12): "I always hated this. "34 year agent and I've never used leads." Back when people would walk into your office to get an insurance policy. Fucking shocker, you started before anyone used the internet. By the time the industry changed you were already established. What you started with is completely different to what the insurance industry is now. Sorry, that shit seriously pisses me off. All these old timers are sitting below me on the monthly sales because they have this outdated mindset. You want to sell insurance? Buy fucking leads."

"Main reason I got out of Medicare. I had nightmares about those garbage food/flex cards. I would have people literally cussing me out to get a \$10 increase in their welfare, I give them what they ask and then they say "Its not worth it for such a little increase." I had a soft spot for elderly people, not anymore, they are some major A-holes."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jsrq5/fired_from_my_medicare_advantage_job/mh7vk9p/

"What in the actual fuck is happening in this industry. (ACA) Overused milked leads, marketplace looking like a brothel, people being promised subsidy cards, free grocery cards, nothing short than being promised a free Mercedes-Benz which I'm sure someone has been already promised. That being said, a great company I'm with, but holy cow man, what an actual cess-pool of agents just circle jerking each other with ol miss Emmy Lou in Lagrange, Mississippi's market-place profile. Luckily I have a 80% closing ratio on getting them to lock me down as their agent for 365. I love it"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j5cd0q/what_in_the_actual_fuck_is_happening_in_this/

↳ DJSimmer305 (23): "Nothing better than starting an application for someone and getting a pop up on HealthSherpa "Warning: this customer may be working with 11 other agents"

↳ brightladdy (13): "It's ACA dude... of course it's going to be a cesspool"

↳ Vast-Gate8866 (12): "Worked my ass off as a independent for almost 4 years now. Living off residuals and kinda taking a break. I make sure I never miss a birthday or holiday though. Always making calls and mailing cards to keep them on the books. Honestly, it's amazing how much that makes a difference. Especially after flipping a client. So many "wham bam" agents out there, make the sale and their clients never hear from them again!"

"I often wonder if homeowners vehemently complain so much that their home valuations went up so much in recent years. *Surely* not..... And the prices of vehicles haven't gone up dramatically since the turn of the century so insurance should be the same as a quarter century ago! Never mind a new or used car price off the lot. Let's pretend it is not much more likely total out a vehicle due to the engineering, complexity and expensive replacement parts have remained the same too. Health insurance is going up??? It's not like anyone is reporting how much healthcare costs have been outpacing inflation for decades... I am a cheap SOB personally. My wife is constantly telling me to shush when I gripe at prices while grocery shopping since Covid. But it actually is reality. Everything has gone up noticeably. Insurance is no different."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qqrxt/but_i_havent_had_any_claims/o2li6s6/

"I agree. Im an agent that handles every Medicare plan thats offered. MAPD, Supplements, and PDP. MAPD plans can work great for some people. Every single person is different and this video is misleading."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyZgiHmgfPQS0R9PLJ4AaABAg.9Z9YeUZeQye9ZCdRG0fPuf>

"Why I think you are a crummy agent: 1) Supplement plans in my state go for \$220 per month, plus the drug card at \$35 per month. That's over \$3,000 per year paid in premium WITHOUT FAIL! 2) Most Advantage plans have a \$0 premium with reasonable co-pays and no deductibles. 3) Although extremely unlikely, the maximum out of pocket could be as low as \$4,500. This compares favorably to the fixed out of pocket cost for a supplement of \$3,060. 4) Catch up with the times! Many Advantage plans are PPOs, which allow the enrollee to see any provider who takes Medicare. 5) You have to carry around only one card....only one party to call when there is an issue. With the supplement, you have to handle your Medicare card, the supplement card, and the drug card. Good luck getting to the right people. 6) Advantage plans offer extra stuff that isn't covered by Medicare nor its supplement. Dental, eye care, hearing aids, fitness memberships, Over the Counter items, flex cards to augment the Dental/Vision/Hearing, etc. 7) Even some HMOs, like Aetna, do not require a referral to an "in network" provider. BTW, I have been a Medicare agent for 10 years and have NEVER received a call from one of my clients complaining about a lack of a qualified specialist in the area. So, Mr. Expert, be careful the next time you say the word "NEVER". In the vast majority of situations, an Advantage plan is a much better deal to the consumer. About the only time a supplement is preferred is when the enrollee is on a Part B medication.....very rare."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgztJwcwLoaOA_tfvB4AaABAg

↳ @3121813 (1): "Many high end hospitals in California will not take advantage plans C supplemental coverage plans anymore they only accept A@B with D prescription coverage and G supplemental. Never get supplemental C advantage plans you will be denied medical care at many hospitals."

"Really depends on what kind man but I wish I knew how disgustingly vile the industry was and how disgustingly stupid medicare advantage clients are. I tried to be a knight. I really really did and got shit on over and over. Im still fully compliant but if Agnus wants the worst medical coverage I have ever seen in order to get a grocery card im sighning her up Had plenty of people turn down the beat coverage in their area because it didnt have a giveback or card and even one where EVERYTHING was better but he would lose just 20 bucks on his giveback, thats it. Save 100's on his meds and seeing doctors and great out of pocket too Still said nah over the 20. If theres a really good policy I see but it'd be humana hmo to humana hmo so I wont get paid I aint talking about it. The very very very few times when I ask about medical needs or coverage and they actually tell me something im more than happy to find best i can offer but that NEVER happens. Its always oh idk oh you tell me.which obviously I cant tell you. Maybe 2 of 300 conversations are about actual medical needs or concerns. I also see TONS that dont even know they were switched recently or pending a switch or any of that and when they say they didn't know I fully beleive them because the checked out ones or no medical decision ones I bang on anyway"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r86i3q/whats_the_hardest_part_of_being_an_insurance/o62oxd3/

"Well, the main ones I'm aware of and that I do are Medicare, ACA, Life/Final Expense, fixed Annuities and Ancillary (dental, vision). There is also Group, but I've never done it. Also be aware that some captive agencies operate like call centers and provide leads that are brought in with bait and switch ad tactics. I ran into quite a few of those early in my career. Don't be scared to ask any agency or company you join about their lead sources. Independent is definitely better, but requires you to invest more in yourself and your own marketing. ACA will require the FFM certification, which is free. Medicare requires AHIP certification or equivalent. I pay \$125 annually with the \$50 discount offered by some carriers. Life requires AML, which is free through the LIMRA website. Annuities generally require annuity training, and some states require Best Interest training to sell Life and Annuities. Definitely do more research before you sign any contracts, whether captive or independent. Hope this helps😊."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibn4xz/passed_my_life_and_health_exam_today_now_what/m9k6pkw/

"You can still sell medicare this AEP. You'll need to approach it as a field agent. You can set up an educational kiosk anywhere you can get permission where there's consistent senior foot traffic, like grocery stores. You can go visit a local networking group like a BNI and share how you can help folks and ask for referrals. You can introduce yourself to 64 year olds who aren't on Medicare yet but who likely have questions about the process - keeping the conversation education for compliance - by using the T65 Locator app in the App Store. Cold calling seniors during AEP was always and is always a plague in our society, fucking leeches. Go do the best you can and after AEP you can change your contracts to another FMO who supports healthy field agent marketing activities."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ofi9mo/i_was_a_1099_agent_and_got_terminated_today/nlat6zf/

"My advice with these people, before you do anything see if they have an SEP. I know you're in open enrollment but for future reference. If they don't, go immediately to your SEP questions. If you don't have anything end the call. If they want an increase to their food card or giveback, filter them in Sunfire and find whatever has that specific thing that's higher than what they have. Pitch the increased benefits, if they bite great, if they don't move to the next thing that's better. Most of these people have no intentions of signing so get them off the phone fast. It's a numbers game."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1idj71g/i_sold_my_first_medicare_policy/ma31xog/

"Having to explain that disclaimers don't apply to 100% of beneficiaries (for example Part D IRMAA). Having to explain that not every beneficiary will have plans in their area that offer benefits/be eligible for benefits like the Part B giveback or a grocery card, even though they may see it advertised. On the flip side, I love being able to educate beneficiaries on resources like Extra Help, or the Medicare Savings Program so that they can get additional help."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mwee78/besides_compliance_what_is_the_most_tedious_part/na0iqgz/

"My experience working for AIL so far: USA based here; i finished my training with them in early December and have been with them since. I encountered the same issues as OP with the MacBook compatibility issue however no one told me this beforehand. Instead i had to buy cheap windows laptops hoping they would work but ended up having to spend even more (\$300) on Parallels to run windows on my MacBook bc anything under that price in a laptop was absolute shit. I've made a few sales but nothing that allows me to even pay rent; I'm fortunate enough to have a partner who is able to support us during this time but if i had kids?? Forget it. I dont even have time for my 2 pups really, let alone the piling dishes, laundry, and other chores I'm falling behind with in the house. Most are not going to be successful in this field, and requires you to be a dog in sales while being taught that we're protecting families, this is true, but the lovely motivational words are blanketing bait-and-switch tactics we use with clients to force our products on them and force to make a decision that same night when they didn't even know they would be shown life insurance products in the first place. It doesn't make sense that we have to use such shady tactics to sell our products when the products themselves are very good honestly and at affordable comparative rates to other companies. I love helping people, and when i have to meet with someone who has a very limited income that knows for a fact they will be working until the day die, it becomes insensitive for me to say "okay but what's your retirement plan" and basically have to ignore their honesty about their financial situation and continue to push them into signing up for a life long bill to leave money for their family; obviously the concept of life insurance is valuable and i see the need for every family to have it, but I'm completely ignoring the reality that many people just cannot afford to take on another bill for whatever valuable reason it may be, and assuming there will be a time when they comfortably decide to stop working is just pretentious in today's reality. My background is working in retail/ management and for the life of me I can't get behind working for no base pay and all commission, the potential for getting rich is a long game here, and for anyone with recurring bills TODAY this is not the path for you (including myself). Everything you're taught about the customer being right is incorrect here and requires reworking that mentality to be pushy and somewhat tone deaf to accomplish your own goals while 'protecting a family's needs' (if their needs are X amount and they can only afford 1/4 of x amount, am i really properly protecting this family then or just making a buck??) Don't get me started on the leads we call. We are promised it's not cold calling and only requested by the people themselves but let me tell you there must be an underlying temporary amnesia issue going on in the world if so because half the people absolutely do not remember making a request that will be listed from a couple days before or the lead will be for a product they have 00000000 connection with (a single man with no gf or kids endin up as child safe kit lead in my pack). You'll also be contacting people other agents resolved so people will be pretty fed up on the phone, even policy holders who are harassed several times a year by us for a 'policy review' where we continue to upsell and tell them they're coverage isn't enough anymore. I have seen my relationship take a hit even though he's been as supportive as possible to see if this career can work for us. I am about to go back to retail bc i know i at least can depend on a check coming in after putting in 40 hours of effort every week For reference my work weeks have been 7 days a week for avg of 9 hours/day. Training takes up other hours in my day for work that has to be done on my personal time. There is a 'suggested' schedule but if you don't follow it you will be talked to over and over about it until you do. Honestly dangling the WFH carrot in my face blanketed me to doing any proper research before hand to see how the real employee experience is at ALL. Sorry for the super disorganized rant but I'm avoiding making dials right now LOL"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1i1evot/ailglobe_life_scam_employees_were_suing/m7mtwat/

"Figured I would post my thought to save everyone reading some money... CABOOM leads provides below average leads with a 20% answer rate when called 10-15 times in the first 3 days. Most of the IUL leads who answered were dead broke and unqualified. They were VERY FAR from high intent leads that were ready to buy. I should have known based on their advertising that it was sketchy, but I thought spending more would lead to higher quality leads. I was wrong. I started to focus more on buying annuity leads since this is my primary niche after a few weeks of failed IUL leads (that I thought were a fluke at the time - 60 leads total). I made the mistake of signing up for an annuity lead subscription after seeing high praise from an annuity producer I respect. I was even more disappointed with these leads. I ordered 20 leads per month for \$5000 and was told by my representative that I could cancel if I was very disappointed, but he assured me that I would have at least a 3x return on investment... Keep in mind that I actually have wealth management experience selling \$4M of annuities and mutual funds last year.... I ordered in mid-February and it's now early April and I STILL haven't received my first 20 leads. In late February, I ordered another 10 leads hoping that my lead flow would come in faster, and none have been delivered from this order. Most leads were not serious anyway and had no clue that the ad was talking about annuities... I had a similar experience on the IUL leads. I believe their ads are misleading and trick people into thinking they are getting some kind of free benefit that does not exist... I thought Cody was one of the good guys in the industry, but I'm not sure I trust him or his team. Quite frankly, their advertising is extremely misleading - "ready to buy" is garbage, but I blame this on myself for falling for the trap... Also, lots of other shady practices like offering discounts for POSITIVE reviews only, sending out a FAKE April fools message that they are no longer accepting new clients to trick people into buying with urgency, advertising that leads are vetted and ready to buy (all they do is respond to a text code - I'm not sure if I even believe this), and worst of all, not following through on promises. I have been unable to cancel my subscription order even though I am highly displeased and I have not even received 20 leads although I've ordered 30+ more than a month ago"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/mkvaioj/

"The problem with Globe life is that it can be really good or really bad depending on your branch and manager. Im working with them for about a month and is ok, the leads are from unions so the people that I call they requested so is not that invasive as a cold call. the thing about push people products is kinda a sale thing no matter the field, one thing that works for me is focus on the no cost benefits and just works as I'm hooking people up, be honest to them, if they say they don't want anything do a good deed and give them whatever free benefit you have, as long as they have your contact if one day they need something they gonna call that dude that hooked them up. Also I don't think is a good type of job if you a desperate for money since in the beginning it sucks, they give you old leads since they don't want you to burn bridges with new clients but as soon as you start to book appointments the leads get better, but it take time and lots of calls. I'm not a native english speaker and although I was scared about calling people, as long as you are nice and respectful they will be nice to you. I even make sure to let the ones that dont want to be bothered to know that I will make sure to exclude them from the leads so they wont get calls again, they really appreciate. So before you look for a new company, no matter which one you go, you gotta found a good branch and team, that's gonna make a huge difference, in the end of the day they are all the same. Also, the ones that offers some salary usually sucks in the commission, at least in my case the commission from the get go is already 50% so is not that bad. try to get a normal job, save some money to be good for a couple months and then try again... not having the pressure to have to make money ASAP can makes things easier on you. Good luck."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cy9b7k/im_stuck_at_globe_life_american_income_life_and/imra1242/

"FYI I'm a health insurance broker and he or she is misleading you on your application with the state. The issue is this: "Married" but file "Seperately". The IRS will pick up that you are receiving a subsidy and could audit you to pay back the subsidy through either your own will or through your paycheck. Take your pick. Here's the issue per the application the Feds or Marketplace want to know if someone else is living under the same roof and that income is now implemented into the "household" income. I do not know your tax situation but if you are both W2 it would be harder to get the subsidy but if both self-employed that could be a game changer."

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1woe9l3/is_my_insurance_broker_correct_that_filing_taxes/pbo7nn1/

"im not gonna say nothing to those claims. i don't work with those so i can't offer an opinion on how that works. i have no experience. but just as you've already said- there's gonna be a crap ton of bad reviews online, don't pay no mind you havta figure out what works for you. i work with globe, my particular agency doesn't "switch bait" as we don't handle child safety kits. we work a specialized lead that mentions burial, life insurance etc. cant mislead when it's right there in black and white print"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/164ik21/are_there_any_truly_good_life_insurance_companies/jy8xirm/

"I'm not talking about earning potential/possibilities. But math like: \$10 cost per lead, 50% contact ratio, 20% closing ratio, \$780 avg AP, 75% comp with standard 75% advance = \$338.75 net/\$438.75 gross per \$100 spent on ads. Clearly numbers are taken out of thin air as an example and will differ on number of factors. But if one comes into this industry and operates (and is familiar with) with those metrics, as opposed to intangible "great leads" and "amazing income opportunity", he'll be much better off. Here's an example: one IMO heavily pushes that anyone who's able to simply read their script will close 50% of the appointments. And their leads have 25/40/80% booking ratio depending on the tier (age). Free money printer, ain't it? Put anyone who can't even spell the word "deductible" and he should be mansion-shopping in no time. Even if you discount those numbers by half to account for lack of experience. But they conveniently don't mention that leads have ~25% contact ratio. When agents struggle? Buy more leads! You may be a couple dials away from your big break! So new agent, who doesn't know any better and operates with the zero-to-hero story in his mind, will keep on going till he's broke without knowing that numbers wouldn't work out for him to begin with. Point being, I'm talking about basic/general point of reference and means to put the numbers together. So one can make better decisions based on factual information and have the means to understand that if 1/150 dials end up in a quote, it's very likely that there's nothing wrong with them, but leads just aren't as great as the recruiter promised."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/mlyvds3/

"There were a few really well thought out responses to your BS so I don't try to 1up those. I'll be the typical social media response to tell you that YOU'RE the problem with America and directly contributing to hurting small businesses. You're not hurting the carrier because they aren't putting their actual money on the line. They pay commissions to tiny little mom and pop insurance agents just trying to feed their kids working 60 hour weeks then they had to deal with sharky lawyers and evil people like you to wreck their lives potentially. I can guarantee all of those 100 calls you claim to get from insurance agents were not just random spam calls. You absolutely at some point put your number in a list to get quotes on a website, credit karma, playing a game, etc just to bait them via the lead companies. You think you're doing some sort of social justice when in reality you're the actual scammer on the other line. I pray you find Jesus because there will be lots of people like you in hell."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n907j5r/

"That's a whole discussion! It really depends on how happy you are with the local TFL facilities/doctors! That's specific to area and how involved your healthcare needs are. So...usually TFL is fine. Where we get people asking for options is if they're not getting the services they want (mental health waiting periods, etc) OR some people will get a Part B GiveBack Advantage plan (if available in your area) to reduce their Part B. This reduces their cost, allows them to use TFL for most services, and yet get access to another network outside of it if needed. Also, see some pick Advantage to get dental, vision, etc. Happy to look at options in California of course!"

— YouTube · 6 BIGGEST Medicare Changes in 2027!! IMPORTANT 📢 · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1a0IVireAKg&lc=UgxWV0Nrxdr4-al0gQJ4AaABAg_AaJHuNcKv5gAaJKd7A1ofF

"I use an FMO as my main for Medicare, life, and annuities, i use an IMO for a couple of extra life carriers, and another FMO for my ACA carriers. Start with medicare/life/supplemental, add ACA later if you even want it, its free money to me (not much at first but...) As far as carriers i have all of the MAPD carriers (or most). Not sure about supp rates in VA, ask your FMO, i use allstate, medicco, aetna, united, humana, mutual, aflac for supps. For life go with mutual of Omaha, royal neighbors, and whatever else your FMO recommends. Make sure you can keep your business if you leave and compare comp rates before deciding!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jykgig/new_agent_choosing_an_fmo_vs_going_direct_advice/mjirwj5/

TCPA, consent and do-not-call exposure · 40 documents · 20 voices

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought *pre-sold leads* from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigant (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the *insurance carrier, not the agent*, for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigant wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigant. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

↳ HamiltonSt25 (75): "Quitting insurance today and becoming a professional litigant Imao"

↳ InsuranceEvangelist (70): "New income stream unlocked..."

↳ DavidDuford (24): "For real =). I should start selling info-product courses on how to do it, and partner with a lawyer to do all the work. "Make an easy \$1500 a day with one simple trick.""

"How is everyone marketing in 2025 without spending a fortune? For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down. Since, I've tried multiple vendors, and I've tried data leads + telemarketers. It feels like no matter what I do, I have to spend 5 grand a month in marketing at least for each of my producers just to hit our goals. It's way too much, and as we spend more to make less, I'm feeling bad burnout as my margins shrink. Primarily P&C, captive agent. So what is everybody doing that's working?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/

↳ BluebirdFast3963 (16): "Work for an independent that has the best prices in my province, so nothing. They come to me. We have 25 companies. Provide quick quotes, quick binds, quick service when they need something done to their policy. A variety of ways they can reach out. Retain most of my clientele year over year. Re-market my current clients if I need too. The way it should be. This lead factory head hunting, farming for clients you barely know and paying for someone to send you a list of numbers is wild to me - is this common in America? I think the Canadian industry is a bit different. I don't know anyone who has to buy leads. Seems like an awful way to retain a trustworthy client base. Is it just dog eat dog down there, constantly churning through clients or what?"

↳ registeredfake (9): "I've got to say, it does not matter what question is asked by anyone in this sub every one think the answer is Independent this independent that. OP is asking for marketing ideas, is already an agent where he has invested his time and money to build something and your first thought is to go independent. stupid"

↳ Armstrongs_ball (7): "Stop. Buying. Leads. Go independent, network, build your book of business by referrals and word of mouth. After a few years, you'll be living off your book of business and getting referrals left and right from clients, assuming you provide good service. Buying leads is literally the biggest waste of \$ in this industry and it's not even close. And good luck actually retaining those clients. They'll be the first to leave after their auto rate increases \$10/month of their first renewal."

"A few things: - Anyone you buy leads/calls from need to give you contract language specifically for this situation. - Litigators are 100% bad faith, this is how they "makes living". The upside is that between the "I paid for a live transfer and you'll need to talk to the company that drive the call" is valid - Litigators are lazy assholes. Best bet is to match their energy and say you will show up in court to litigate this. \$10k is the small claims limit in a few states. Some are \$5k and a few are higher. The MO is to file in SC, show up to the hearing and then get a judgement. That's why you should show up with a contract to give to the judge showing you are not responsible for this litigator doing what they're doing. That \$25k settlement is now Civil Court territory, meaning you need to retain representation... in other words, it's costs money. Call their bluff, show up to any SC hearing."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/mjv8uf0/

"Interesting to see the other side of a serial litigator. Questions for you: What is your plan for when the incoming calls stop? Can you say with absolute sincerity that you're not taking any action to receive these illegal calls? You sure you're not intentionally putting yourself in a position for opportunities to sue these companies/agents? I can't tell if you're posting this to be a genuine warning or maybe even bragging... but it actually reads like "Careful about your lead source, or else people without real jobs like me are going to sue you." Do what everyone else does and block the numbers that call and hop on Indeed dude. No I have never been sued by a serial litigator because I only receive direct inbound calls, but I can still cringe at you for bottom feeding."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8y0u2a/

"Great idea. Favorite telesales carriers: RNA, Prosperity and Trinity. SS billing + voice sign for all 3. Favorite lead: Real-time telemarketed call back with verified checking, ages 50-79 and agrees to speak with an agent. Basically telemarketers calling on DNC scrubbed and TCPA verified data to call on (old FB leads or Journaya/Trusted Form verified) + scrubbed against TCPA Blacklist Alliance and inputting into a form to serve it up in a CRM immediately. Tip: You need proper training and sales systems to make telesales work. If you take your DM leads and try to sell them over the phone with your typical f2f presentation, you'll fail. If you buy internet leads and don't have proper sales training or sales systems, you'll fail. My advice is either partner with a telesales-focused agency with an open release policy (hey, telesales isn't for everyone) or wait it out. Don't waste any time/money unless there's a proven system in place."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Telesales Tips · 11 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/final-expense-telesales-tips.101595/#post-1344555>

"TCPA mainly focuses on robo calls and dialers. I don't use any of those to dial my leads. I'm pretty much old school and hand dial myself. It's been 2 years for me and I haven't had an issue yet. I also don't spam call my leads. If someone answers and states they're not interested, I move on to the next lead. I'm not in the business of begging or being pushy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/m9mifjh/

"> What is your plan for when the incoming calls stop? As cynical as this sounds - there is no plan. If you have a phone, the calls will never stop coming. The numbers are spoofed, the names are fake, and there is nothing you can do. Even if you're on every blacklist alliance list, DNC, TCPA litigator scrub, etc etc - they all disconnect the calls AFTER the happen. Its annoying and won't end. I can get 100 illegal calls in a day and get zero justice or I can get 100 illegal calls a day, sue on 3-4 of them and get \$10-20 grand worth of justice. This is the world we're living in. The calls will never stop. If they did, I'd have a much higher serenity around here and I could enjoy some of the money I've made over the years. > Can you say with absolute sincerity that you're not taking any action to receive these illegal calls? 100%. I do not sign up for ANYTHING. I sit at home watching TV or scratching myself and the calls come in. I'm too young for medicare, but I get 20+ calls a day for medicare advantage. I'm too young for final expense insurance, I get 30+ a day for final expense. It's insanity. > You sure you're not intentionally putting yourself in a position for opportunities to sue these companies/agents? Am I intentionally putting myself in a position to sue these people, absolutely. The same way a cop running radar that has a really good spot that nobody can see / knows about..... I have a charged gopro handy and I record the incoming calls. Yes, I intentionally prepare myself to get the most leverage and the best evidence capture of illegal telemarketing practices. >I can't tell if you're posting this to be a genuine warning or maybe even bragging... but it actually reads like "Careful about your lead source, or else people without real jobs like me are going to sue you." I've done several settlements with small brokers that have said "we can't pay you what you're asking" and I said that's fine, I'll hold your upline joint and severally liable. Next thing I know, a decent settlement offer comes my way. OR I hire an attorney, they file a class action against the upline, the brokerage, the broker and the agent PERSONALLY and everyone goes to court, the upline spends \$150-200k in defense costs that they subrogate back to the downline via payment plan/docked commissions/what have you and my attorneys add another win to their CV. The message here is that YOU MAY THINK this new lead vendor of yours is all great but if you get burned, you can potentially be involved in bet the company litigation. And this is the WORST kind of litigation to be in because you don't realize you're in bet the company litigation until you've wound up betting the company. >Do what everyone else does and block the numbers that call Not that easy. All the numbers are spoofed. I get calls from the hospital, chevy dealership, etc etc - all displayed on the caller ID that are overseas call centers. Your outlook is 100% flawed. >No I have never been sued by a serial litigator because I only receive direct inbound calls, but I can still cringe at you for bottom feeding You know what's funny? Every single broker I've sued says "we only receive direct inbound calls" - you know why? THE LEAD GEN SPOOFS MY NUMBER, CALLS YOUR BROKERAGE SO YOU CAN CLAIM IT IS AN INBOUND CALL. The only counterbattery is my gopro video."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8y9glc/

"Inbounds suck for a number of reasons: 1. Scam Central: most inbounds are generated in Pakistan and India. Literally the guys scamming your Grandma out of your inheritance are the ones providing inbounds to you, with entry-level scammers starting in lead generation before moving on to ripping off Americans. 2. Legal Pandora's Box: India and Pakistan will not comply to Federal TCPA rules. They will call everyone - even on the DNC - and you, and your upline, bear the legal risk. I had a good agent of mine buy one of these leads earlier this year and had to settle for five figures for just one phone call. 3. Did I Mention They're A Scam? These call centers are known to share client information, list information, and rework the leads over and over again. There are organizations that sell "pre-sold leads," which includes all major information about the client, claiming they call ahead of time to collect the information before passing it along to the agent to sell. Unbeknownst to the agent, they resell this information over and over again and you end up with huge chargebacks. I think Facebook ads are a much more durable, long-lasting, and safe lead generation solution. You own the leads, you control the ad creative, and you have a track record of the client opting in. Plus, you can scale upward to the level you're comfortable with, and can tie in pre-set appointments or call-ins for added benefit. Lastly, if you don't want to do it yourself, there are many good lead management options available that will do all of the above."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oxuubl/is_this_a_good_offer/np4s2v6/

"Aged Leads Store Question about those leads because I don't want to get on anyone's shit list. Are those leads TCPA compliant?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k24g9p/aged_leads_store/

↳ Bright_Breadfruit_30 (3): "They areyou only hear shit from people that do not understand what it means to work aged leads. They are good about communicating with clients. I have never had an issue with them. They provide you with exactly what they say they do. That being said the leads are cheap so you got to get many many many of them to work and work them hard to get results. You are better off just getting live transfers and buying real time leads from the vendor of your choice, paying the new price, and selling policies. It is so much more time/cost effective. I started with aged leads working one day a week 5 years ago. I should have just grabbed a few new instead of many aged....productivity would have been so much better all around. Good luck!"

↳ Monskiaactual (3): "You always got to look at your cost for acquisition or CPA when you buy leads and age leads might be really cheap and if they're 50 cents a piece but you have to buy a thousand to get a deal then your cost for acquisition is \$500 alternatively you can buy four or five live transfers and spend \$200 to \$250 or you can buy individual leads 10 to 30 each and spend two to \$300 besides the cost per acquisition there's the time aspect even if it costs the same amount of money it's better to use live transfers or leads because you don't have to work as art and you can close more business in the day Paige leads are great for people that are just starting out and don't have money for good leads You can pop them in a dialer or put them on automation It's not in my opinion a long-term strategy like live transfers or self generated leads are"

↳ Playful-Lab5618 (2): "Thanks for the reply. I just don't want to put my license in jeopardy by calling them. That said, they're simply meant to be for me to fall back on when I run out of new leads."

"> It's a bit funny that the only thing you didn't acknowledge in my comment was the fact that you don't just get a regular job. ACTUALLY I worked in commercial finance for years + ran 3 small businesses so there's that. I actually got fired from the finance company partly because I couldn't get any work done with my home phone ringing 50 times before lunch. >There's absolutely no way you can convince me that you're making ZERO action to receive these calls. You're not getting 100's of illegal calls by being just a random needle in the haystack, you're intentionally seeding your number(s) out there. Of course the jig is up if you'd ever confess that, but also the calls would stop too and then there goes your income. Believe what you want to believe, but I feign interest to see who buys the lead and that's that. I do not opt in anywhere. >you're intentionally seeding your number(s) out there. I do no such thing and I dare anyone to prove that I do. >Of course the jig is up if you'd ever confess that, but also the calls would stop too and then there goes your income. I don't want the money. I want the calls to stop. Since the calls won't stop, I will take the money. >We all get random calls from shady oversea call centers. Will I get 2-3 of these calls on a bad day? Yes. Do I decide to engage the call, pretend to be interested so I can sue the American receiver of the illegal transfer who is likely unaware this call was generated illegally? Absolutely not. img-wouldbealotcoolerifyoudid.jpg >You're trying to call it justice but it's just not. TCPA/DNC laws are set up to protect regular consumers, especially vulnerable ones like seniors, not to create a side hustle for bottom feeders like you. I'd be willing to bet when you find a carrier/brokerage/agent who's willing to fight you instead of just throwing you a couple of bucks to save the legal fees - you drop the suit because you don't want this going to discovery. Believe what you want to believe. I don't opt in for ANYTHING and I'm on every single marketing database known to man. Landline is 40+ years old, same address. Cell is 20+ years old same subscriber Registered voter, property owner, business owner, etc etc. The dataminers have enough out there on me that I don't need to opt in for a single goddamn thing for them to already know me Oh and I guess I'll clarify that I'm a carrier rep, my calls come from our own marketing. We don't use third parties at all. I fight and litigate EVERY single suit until summary judgement/jury verdict. Don't put words in my mouth."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8ygyfc/

"What I would do if I were you: 1. Scrub your data against a litigator and changed number list on a regular basis. 2. Get Convoso. Kixie is OK. Most other dialers are terrible. Connection rate is everything. 3. Move out of New York. You cannot get contracted in New York with American Amicable as a New York resident. AmAm is arguably the best final expense telesales carrier available. Answers to your questions: 1. Maybe. Biggest levers to get best results: 1. Script and skillset 2. Dialer to maximize connection rates. 2. See above. 3. Convoso only. 4. Stay away from DSNP. 5. 100% TCPA compliance adherence. 6. Set daily activity goals. Consider bonuses/rewards for hitting call/conversion goals."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jnkha/advice_for_final_expense_startup_highvolume_cold/mko7utp/

"0, this agent handled this call very badly. You NEVER say yeah I know its annoying or I understand or I apologize. You are not to sympathize with the customer when your trying to close a sale. And then to turn around and say its none of my business to ask about funeral expenses when your calling to sell funeral expenses? Correct response on this call is Im sorry to disturb you and ill add your number to the do not call list, Have a good day sir. You dont string a call along when someone is threatening you and saying words like do not call or anything like that, regulations say that as soon as he said ill report you to no call you have to immediately add them to the do not call."

— YouTube · Insurance Agent Calls An Angry Lead - Rate This Call! #insurance #insuranceagent #lifeinsu · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yc0XJA-IF5l&lc=Ugx5lIUjyWITyTdTSgN4AaABAq>

↳ @thesonofcodhimself (3): "You never run a business in your life"

↳ @stevensanderson2817 (0): "@thesonofcodhimself Ive been a call center rep specializing in cold call sales for 15 years, ive won multiple contests and awards from every company that ive worked at and outsold veteran teams of salespeople while I was still in training for the company. You dont get my kind of experience by running a business, you get it from doing hundreds of calls 5 days a week for 15 years. This was a hostile call that had do not call written all over it, im not wasting my time getting threatened when I can just move on and get the next one, theres not a single QA rep out there that would fault an agent for dumping a call like this."

↳ @novembertango1298 (0): "@thesonofcodhimselfyou've never worked telephonic sales in your life. Depending on the state the prospect resides in this guy is absolutely correct. If it's a no rebuttals state the second they give pushback like this if you continue you can have your license revoked."

"Thats not a lead vendor, Thats a criminal accomplice! marketing companies are not allowed to take personal client information give quotes etc... What you just described is **not** Lead generation. Its marketed as "pre sold policies by shady dudes in facebook groups" and its illegal.. If an agent doesnt know that they deserve to lose their license. There is no way this was suprising to him. he knew what was happening.. he paid more for this "service" specficially because he is Lazy..... There are in fact marketing companies that want to sell legitimate CMS/ carrier compliant leads and inbound calls. They do exist. You never interact with them because you are a professional litagtor on the DNC list . Legitmate companies pay money for subscriptions like this <https://www.dnc.com/dncscrub/>(<https://www.dnc.com/dncscrub/>) and make api calls to stay DNC compliant. Those same API calls check Professional Litagator lists, which you are likely on..Any one who can afford \$300 per month and knows how to call an API will make sure they never call you. The only marketing companies you ever interact with are the Bad ones... here is the medicare manuals <https://www.cms.gov/medicare/health-drug-plans/managed-care-marketing/medicare-guidelines/>(<https://www.cms.gov/medicare/health-drug-plans/managed-care-marketing/medicare-guidelines/>) As you can see this is COMPLICATED. Many Insurance brokers choose to outsource marketing because there is a lot of rules to follow here. Some companies Aka "third party" marketing companies offer a legitimate service to insurance brokers , allowing them to legally outsource marketing.. just like very other industry. Some agents do get deceived by shady companies. many dont even think to ask marketers , "how do you check DNC /TCPA? how do you generate leads or data? "what qualifications do you use to turn data into a lead? how many people are you selling this data to? What lliability do you have regarding DNC/TCPA violations? These are all legitmate questions any legitimate marketer will have no problem answering.. Keep up being a professional litagtor. get the Bad apples out of the lindustry. you should put up a you tube channel like Coffeewizilla. I bet it would be more entertaining the most insurance indusrtury content.. i think it would be helpful for a lot of agents if you posted content of this stuff. Its the dark underbelly that many agents never see.. they get pitched an offer thats too good to be true.. and well it is..."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nl7wbo/another_reason_not_to_trust_lead_brokersthird/nf78cv7/

"live transfers can be amazing.. I am big fan of the ROI and productivity an agent can have with them. But they arent for everyone. its important to remember you are lliable for any TCPA violations they commit. Which you should be careful and use american companies that have procedures to scrub the leads in place. Quote wizard is a pretty well known website they will have high volume of leads. they may be lower quality than other transfers but they will be compliant. I only do Life and FE transfers so i dont have any specific experience with that quote wizard. I will tell you that working live transfers is a whole different game, you need to change the way you pitch on the phone, but if you can master it its a BEtter world than data leads. you also know every lead you pay for, you actually get to talk to and there is some itnent.. DATA stuffing is becoming a bigger problem, with traditional leads, where they are sold as optin leads and its actually just an entry in a data list you paid \$30 for. Thats my i prefer in bound sales calls to data leads..... I would ask quote wizard how they qualify the person and prove intent and compliance.. thats really the essence of getting good direct inbound sales calls. happy to answer any additional questions .."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ltitjz/quote_wizard_live_transfer_call/n1qsm03/

"Unfortunately, it is not a straightforward process. There are a lot of lead generation companies that offer DNC-Scrubbing as a service. However, many of them take shortcuts that can burn you legally (such as buying the DNC list once and not updating, etc.). We got burned by one such company. The surest way to check for DNC is: 1) Register with the National Do Not Call Registry at <https://telemarketing.donotcall.gov/>(<https://telemarketing.donotcall.gov/>) 2) Create a Telemarketer or Seller Account (you can set it up as an individual if you don't have a company) 3) Request access to area codes. You get 5 free area codes. Every additional area code costs \$80/year (\$22,038 for all area codes). If you are calling locally or even within the state, usually, the free area codes are sufficient. Search online for the list of area codes in your area to figure out. 4) To search the list with your list of phone numbers, you have 2 options: a) If your list is small (in the tens): Use the Search tool on the Registry's website (after logging in). You can search up to 10 numbers at a time for the area codes you have access to. b) Larger Lists: Download the list (CSV or XML file) and setup a lookup on Excel or any other spreadsheet software)."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466vj/stop_buying_leads/mu1ozqu/

"> in this instance would you even pursue this in court? HELL YES. Why wouldn't I? > You mentioned the complaint to the state legislator, but is this instance not something you would pursue in a lawsuit? They can run paralel. >I was under the impression that you signed up for the ACA plan? The minute the rep realized they couldn't pull off "Lindsay Smith" or whatever american name - they changed their tune. >Also aren't you afraid that someone Will steal your social security number? I'm 41 and my SSN has been lost in like 19 data breaches in the past 10 years. It's already out there, fuck it. >Or is that just the risk You're willing to accept for potentially being able to sue companies for breaking Do not call registry lists? Most of these calls are not scams, they're actual hard line attempts to sign you to an ACA plan and get a \$45 lead."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nl7wbo/another_reason_not_to_trust_lead_brokersthird/nfiv118/

"This isn't entirely true, again I buy hundreds of calls a day. It's my job to manage for our agency. I don't see where he said it was a live transfer. I forget the exact cost but I believe it is somewhere around \$1200 for a single violation. However there is a safe harbor law, basically if you have done everything in your power to prevent DNC violations then you should be fine. What we do: -Have a DNC block on our CRM that blocks all numbers on the national DNC and our internal scrub list. -Make sure it is in our signed contract with lead provider, that they ensure not to send any leads on the DNC. And that they agree to get consent on every call before transferring, and script is shared with us. -can also add in journaya tokens or similar. If we show all of these things we did our job, our cases have all been stopped dead in their tracks."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/mk0d3x3/

"Depends on what you're selling but they're not typically very responsive, and I'd avoid them personally. A lot of aged leads aren't even TCPA compliant much less FCC 1, which means one complaint to the DOI and you could be facing a lawsuit, license suspension/revocation, etc. When we ran a dialer it was about a 0.8% conversion rate on 30 day+ leads and about 0.2% on 365+ leads. Interestingly enough the 3-30 day leads were just as bad, my running theory is that a lot of those 3-30 day people are getting blown up by agents or just not in the mindset to buy at the time, but after 30 days the calls start to die down, they're in a clearer head space, and they're more receptive. I've spoken to many clients who just were overwhelmed and only responded to me because it had been a few weeks and things weren't as hectic."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pmr7pi/how_are_we_generating_leads_going_into_2026/nu3qz9h/

"100% agree. I highly doubt any of these agencies that cold call are following TCPA guidelines... I operated a callcenter for 17 years prior to starting my agency. We specialized in calling past customers for Newspapers. We had all the compliance in place because I kept abreast of it all for the states we operated in. We only had 1 violation that we paid out and it was to a massive litigator of call centers that would purchase people cell phone numbers from all over the country and then litigate against anyone that missed the port request in the 30 day window. If you aren't solely in the calling space it doesn't make sense to cold call... Calling paid for leads is different because they will normally come with a record of how the person opted in to receive the call."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mk37eo/anyones_agency_not_do_coldcalling_for_leads/n8ccb55/

"There was going to be a new rule from the FCC a little over a year ago that was killed in court. It was for one-to-one consent and would have been amazing for consumers. Alas, here we are. I do lead gen, but there is absolutely zero multi-selling, aged leads, anything like that. Just actual inbound calls that would be in compliance if the 1:1 rule were in place. The crappy "warm" transfers you talked about are awful, and those sellers generally know it's a very short lived scheme to make a few bucks since the consumer is also confused with WTF is going on, i.e., an agent gets a "transfer" and the consumer says "YOU called ME". Only real thing to do is highlight the few good lead gen companies and focus on building an internal organic+referral+paid set up."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1saqau4/your_pal_fc_discusses_lead_generators_here_if_you/ody19yf/

FMOs and uplines that own the book or won't release · 40 documents · 20 voices

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ads on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through (carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

↳ Legio-V-Alaudae (45): "If it was so easy and well paying, they wouldn't have to advertise the hell out of the jobs. I'm sorry you didn't have a healthy amount of skepticism when conducting due diligence."

↳ Candid_Worth_3629 (25): "Did you not ask for any advice from this subreddit or do any research prior to leaving your 9-5? Everyone would've told you to keep the main job and start out part time. It's also really important to be at a place that doesn't make you churn \$ for leads. Most are MLM schemes"

↳ jordan32025 (20): "Anyone who doesn't understand that AP written is not the same as the commission percentage shouldn't start a life insurance business. Also, going into it thinking it's a "job" is recipe for guaranteed failure. There is some financial literacy needed. This precisely why I don't recruit people who are not already actively selling consistently with a good carrier. They already know how to run a business."

"What Uplines Don't Want you to Know - Carrier Release Process - Explained This is a question I get a ton from new agents, and its what every upline doesn't want you to learn, so please... learn it. Treat this information like it's required for you to be in the industry to know. Review your contracts with your uplines and make sure you have protection within them as well. Heck, get a lawyer to review it. Whatever it takes, I see too many agents getting trapped in awful comp deals and abusive uplines and get "Stockholm'd" into buying bad leads from them and then gaslighting them into thinking its their fault. I've been there done that. This info is for the agent that calls themselves independent:

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Demystifying Agent Contracting, Releases, and Blackout Periods I work directly with 54 carriers, 4 FMOs, multiple agencies, and nearly 1,000 independent agents. My role involves overseeing contracting, licensing, and agent/agency development. With experience spanning so many entities, I've had the chance to see the contracting process from all angles and business models. Let me break it down for anyone who's struggling to navigate this space. # Steps to Understand Contracting and Releases

1. **Contract Level (LOA vs. Broker):** * If you're directly contracted with a carrier as a truly independent broker *and* haven't signed an agreement restricting you to one entity (or an LOA contract, which assigns your commission to your upline), you should generally be free to contract with another carrier or upline without issues. 2. **Private Contracts (Non-Competes or No Non-Competes):** * If you're tied to a brokerage or agency and have a private contract (like a non-compete), get a lawyer to review your options. Some of these cannot be upheld in court, that's important for you to know. * Medicare agents may want to wait until the start of the year for a smoother transition —this avoids AEP complications. 3. **Carrier Blackout Periods:** * **New agents** can contract anytime, even during AEP, for Medicare Advantage (MA) and Medicare Supplement (Med-Supp) plans. * **Switching uplines or FMOs, however, is restricted** during AEP for MA carriers (typically September–December). * If you're contracting with a carrier for the first time, you can get a **new contract** during AEP, but you can't **switch uplines** until the blackout period ends. 4. **Release Process (To Release or Not):** * Brokers contracted directly with carriers usually retain their commissions unless restricted by a private contract (see Step 2). * You can file a self-release with an "intent to transfer". After 90–180 days, the carrier can re-contract you under a new upline while allowing you to keep producing during the interim. (you will be compensated according to your previous contract if you decide to continue producing, you wont get commission for producing if you WERE an LOA agent because your effective comp is 0%) * This safeguards agents from being stuck in unfavorable relationships. Most agents prefer waiting until the start of the year to minimize risks. The key is understanding your contract and navigating transitions safely, which is something many agents overlook. # A Brief History of the Release Process (why the heck is it this way?) The "agent-release" process emerged in the late 90s and early 2000s to manage transfers between FMOs and carriers. Unfortunately, it was often abused, with FMOs refusing to grant releases, especially during AEP, leaving agents trapped in bad contracts. To address this, carriers like UnitedHealthcare, Aetna, and Humana introduced transfer freezes during AEP to protect their investments. The "intent to transfer" process, developed in the late 2000s and early 2010s, aimed to fix these issues by providing agents a path to transfer without jeopardizing their business. # Misunderstandings About Releases If your agency/FMO/upline tells you "you can't transfer," it's likely because their training hasn't been updated to reflect the proper release procedures. This isn't usually malicious, they just want to ensure you're not left without commissions. Nobody wants to risk that. Also, the information is incredible "gate-kept", it's not a "sexy" process everyone wants to learn, until they need it... If you're looking for additional insight, this [YouTube video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NaExikyNwzo) (not affiliated with me or my company) provides a solid overview of the release process. However, it doesn't touch on the contract-level distinctions I've outlined here. Understanding these processes can help you avoid costly errors and confidently take control of your career. If you have questions or need clarification, feel free to ask!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gv923a/what_uplines_dont_want_you_to_know_carrier/

↳ Inner_Friendship5913 (2): "I just got my license in September and knew absolutely nothing about insurance. I started with Equis and had a very bad experience with my upline and felt like I was stuck with no one to teach me or train me. The top group person just blew smoke when I tried to get help so I left. I signed with Symmetry and I'm having a difficult time getting Equis to release me because they say they don't require it but Symmetry does require it. Symmetry has already started to get me started with other insurance carriers. I only had 5 with Equis. I have got no contracts with any carriers with Symmetry yet in my email but I know they started the process. BUT I was never told that I have to split my commissions 40%(me) and 60%(SME agent). I spoke to transamerica and Mutual of Omaha and they said I'd be penalized 90 days for ending the contract through Equis. So if I decide to not stay at Symmetry then that is even more insurance carriers that I'll be stuck waiting 90 days to work with again. I honestly have no idea where to go from here. I don't want to do all the work and a finalizing agent take 60% of my commissions. What company out there allows you to keep your commissions outside of the Small bit your upline gets? Or at least a fair amount?"

↳ RedditInsuranceGuy (1): "I would need to know what line of insurance you are talking about to get more specific. But basically its a standard wait of 6 months after a documented request of release from the contract for most carriers. Mutual of Omaha is pretty strict on that stuff. As far as what you do going forward is find an IMO that can fill the gaps with something competitive in the meantime while you process the releases and wait it out."

↳ Standard-Position698 (1): "I am in the process of trying to get a release/terminate contract. My up-line has refused to continue to reply and has removed me from all platforms and blocked me but will not release my contract."

"Beware of MLM structured companies (warning) So this was originally a response to a comment on this sub, but I see a ton of new people coming into insurance, (speaking to independent guys here) and there are many many hungry wolves waiting to recruit these naïve noobs and make a profit. So, I figured I could make a post using some of the content from my previous response to explain the caveats and expose the reality of these places. I come from a MLM originally, it was unbenounced to me at the time, but I'm still grateful because it gave me a first hand glance at what goes on there. How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. They will push you to build a team, because hey, don't you wanna make 6 figures "bro"??? Well then you gotta build a huge team so you get all those overrides off the guys under you. Now, there's nothing wrong necessarily with building a team, but in a MLM context and the way they act in a deceptive manner it is extremely unethical. The guys you see writing 100k plus in premium a year??? A fraction of that fell of the books and was a chargeback, then that guy like all of us has to pay taxes at the end of the year. He also probably was buying \$500 worth of leads a week. Burned gas every day meeting clients. He "maybe" profited 40k that year, and that's being generous. But as long as they can show boat how much premium they're writing a week? A month? A year? Then shove the rhetoric down new guys throats, boasting about how they too can make 100k a year? Then they're all good. I found out through a credible source, as well as David Dufford (has a youtube channel, good tips and insight for insurance) that alot of these "top producers" buy the trips that you can win with insurance carriers for writing a lot of AP. They do all of this and sugar coat their actual earnings because you'll buy the dream, go sell sell sell, and the guys above you get all the overrides off of you without investing any of their money into you at all. It's a fucking amazing model for the guys at the top to make a killing. They create a strong sense of family at those places to keep you on board as well. They push shitty products like Americo a ton too, because they get higher commissions off of that. Americo is also pricey, and you can easily find a cheaper product for that senior to actually help them out, but more than likely they won't have many cheap options that actually are economical for the client, because then you, and them get a lower commission. So MLM's will typically encourage you to get a higher premium out of the client and force a pricey carrier on them. Hope this helps. Reputable, ethical IMO's that offer you high commission contracts and don't push you to build teams are harder to find, because they don't market and recruit. Join an insurance forum, those guys are veterans and a lot of the IMO/Brokerage owners are members there. I've been in Life Insurance for a while now, and am branching into Health/Medicare, so anyone can feel free to PM me with Life Insurance questions if you'd like. Also it would be cool to maybe post any experiences you've had with these types of organizations."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/n4hblb/beware_of_mlm_structured_companies_warning/

↳ pdxoss (6): "I hate MLM too but if someone is making 100k and paying for leads/gas, taxes etc. Their take home isn't 40%. They're going to write off marketing expenses, gas, and everything they can on taxes"

↳ coreyjacrispy (5): "Haha, not specifically, they are are a known MLM company though. Them, Primerica, Symmetry etc etc. Anytime they're trying to force the Kool aid down your throat, with generic phrases and lectures like "You can take this and be BIG man, BIG...you want to have complete financial freedom? Be on your own clock? WE give you the tools to do that! We are a family, and want everyone to succeed" Blah blah blah lol, rest assured knowing they are indeed a MLM company."

↳ Tahoptions (3): ">How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. That is only for simplified products like final expense and mortgage protection. Street is no where near 120% for most traditional products. It is much closer to 85-100% (for term/GUL/IUL) and even lower for permanent products from big mutuals like Guardian and Mass. The post is a good warning though."

"Man I wish someone told me about the cluster trap earlier. Joined a big one first year and the exit clause was basically "we own your book forever" - took me 3 years to buy my way out of that mess. Read every contract like your life depends on it, especially the part about who actually own the business when you leave For software don't go crazy at start. I spent like \$800/month on fancy CRM that I barely used first 6 months. Get good rater and simple accounting, rest can wait until you got actual revenue coming in. The only thing worth paying for right away is a decent phone system and maybe EZLynx if you do personal lines What worked best for leads was literally just walking into real estate offices with donuts on Saturday morning. Cost me 15 bucks and got more referrals than the \$500/month online leads I tried. Would specialize early too, I wasted 2 years trying to write everything and made no money until I focused only on contractors"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vwadgv/independent_agency_owners_what_would_you_do/p5fdhsa/

"I messed up. I quit my easy Medicare sales job and went to an industry and can't physically do anymore.im looking for susuggestions. I honestly don't want to go back to them. Go health, I feel they were slowly dying. Taking out massive loans to stay afloat, cut 1/3 of employees recebtly and telling shareholders they were doing great. So I don't want to go back. I can't get into another Medicare job for at least 6 months because of the non competes and the like. Carriers are in on it too so I can't do anything. I'm kinda scrambling for something. I know I wasn't making much there either. Top 10% agent year round. Top 5% in aep. But I only made 45k. It was all warm live inbound transfers that I didn't pay for. I'm looking at other insurance industries and I'm kinda scared. Each place I look at often turns into a sort of ponzi scheme that sells leads. Often getting you in with some decent leads at first and then giving you crap unless you pay for it. I don't mind pure commission but I'd like it to warm live transfers. Am I wishing for something that doesn't exist? I have life and health in like 20 states still. I'm debating getting property casualty license."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/111e1d0/>

↳ (0): "The problem you're having.. is that go health didn't teach you how to do the job. They didn't teach you the product or how to care for the needs of the client. They taught you how to poach books. But the reason they are slowly dying is because every time they have one of their extremely underpaid teleagents poach one of my clients i immediately put in a complaint to CMS and then flip them back. That's why the 3 month retention is less than 40% for both go health and assurance. Medicare isn't easy and shouldn't be. It should be about building relationships that in turn pay you very well for taking care of people. If you actually love it, find an upline that can show you how to build a book, not steal one for a churn and burn company like go health."

↳ (0): "I'm afraid to gamble that. Like I know it's possible and I know I could do it. I was good at what I did. And trust me. I was one of the few who actually read past the SOB and into into the EOC for plans. And many didn't even read the SOB... I'm just afraid to start it. I don't know who to trust for leads and I don't know how to get my own."

↳ (0): "Not sure how old you are or what your situation is like especially in regards to networking ability, etc besides what you've posted here, but it seems like there are a TON of Medicare agents around that do very well running a solo shop just cranking out leads + networking. And looking at the commission schedule, something like 100 Medicare sales would net about what you're making now. One hundred... in perpetuity (at least for a few years... lol). That's pretty easy, no? Granted that doesn't include benefits like health insurance, being W2, etc but... still decent. The one Medicare agent I know that works at a P&C shop, and is P&C licensed, works in ONLY Medicare and CRUSHES it, works 3-4 months out of the year, the rest of the year manages his book and lines up for the next year, but vacations / starts other business ventures 8 months out of the year. He's maybe 27 years old making \$300k-400k a year at least I'd bet - before bonus. As a P&C agent I look at those commission schedules and I get a little jealous. Something I'm hoping to learn more about in 2023."

"Leaving a \$50k banking job for a commercial insurance producer role, is it worth the risk? I'm currently making about \$50k at a bank with great benefits and 30 paid days off (including holidays). I've been offered a commercial insurance producer/Risk Advisor role at a small independent agency (5/6 person team), and I'm trying to decide whether the upside is worth leaving a stable job. The opportunity is roughly: \- 1099 \- 55k-\$70k draw + \$600/month vehicle allowance (negotiating this on Monday) \- Health/life benefits \- 40% commission on new business, 30% on renewals \- Agency acct averages about \$45k-\$50k premium per account \- They wrote about \$6M in new premium last year and manage ~\$22M total \- Owner has been in the business for 23 years (however the agency is just years old I believe) and plans to teach me everything he knows and believes \$1M in new premium is a realistic first major milestone \- First 60-90 days would mostly be training and pipeline building by month 6 expects policy's \- Owner might provide leads/referrals, but ultimately I'd be expected to generate my own pipeline \- Long-term appeal is building a recurring book of business rather than relying on salary increases My biggest unknowns are if the draw is recoverable if I don't produce enough, ownership of my book, it sounds like they'll own my book however there might be a vesting of ownership or when he plans on selling in 5-7 years he does plan to have clauses that allow me to keep my book (uncertain) For commercial P&C producers/agency owners: Does this sound like a good opportunity? What should I make sure is in the contract, and how realistic is \$1M-\$2M of premium for a new producer? (I have a small network, worked in B2B selling before) ALSO, anything more I should ask about on Monday?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wdgfsq/leaving_a_50k_banking_job_for_a_commercial/

↳ Ancient_Idea_1434 (17): "depends if you can stomach the ramp-up, 1099 with a draw that might be recoverable is a whole different kind of stress than a bank gig with 30 days off"

↳ Confident_Bats (4): "I don't know much about the commercial side as much as I do the personal. My agency I'm allowed to sell all the commercial I want and we have a team to help me. My salary is 50k, I make 70% on new business and only 30% on renewals. As my book grows, my salary will go down, and my renewals will go up. The end result is a \$0 salary I'll be 1099 with 50% renewals and still 70% new business. I get health insurance, retirement, etc."

↳ ChildishBalvino (4): "These businesses don't just cough up \$50k in premium unless they trust you and your agency. I'm not sure this is a good idea for you to completely switch over without any prior experience"

"HSAs and HDHPs Explained So you might've seen Dave Ramsey and other financial professionals throwing out the idea of HSAs and framing it like a secret hack to cheaper healthcare. With the rising health costs expected to come this OEP after the expiration of the famous subsidies, I was intrigued. As a licensed agent, I felt obligated to do a deep dive on this topic to see if all in all it is a better option for my clients. My findings are written in a blog style format below. *Yes it's long. It's an in-depth explanation so you can understand the full picture surrounding HSAs and HDHPs. Feel free to offer any corrections or suggestions in the comments.* With healthcare costs expected to hit all time highs, everyone from low income families and high income individuals are looking for a way out. The health insurance marketplace is a thick and complicated ungroomed jungle and without proper research and a solid understanding of all the acronyms and structures involved, your chances of affordable healthcare are pretty much non-existent. In these troubling times the financial and insurance gurus of social media have taken to the streets, or should I say screens, and are doing their best to educate their viewers on other options and structures when it comes to health insurance. One of the most popular alternative options being mentioned this year is a unique insurance structure called an HSA. **What the heck is an HSA?** An HSA, **Health Savings Account**, is a type of savings account that is tied to a HDHP, **High Deductible Health Plan**, that is said to work best for individuals on the extreme ends of the spectrum when it comes to insurance. What I mean by that is individuals or families who are either healthy and rarely use their insurance or ill and use their insurance heavily. The structure works as follows, the individual or family enrolls in a HDHP and then ties this HDHP to an HSA. Both the HDHP and HSA work to balance each other's cons and create an affordable health insurance option for these groups of people. Since the HDHP has a high deductible, it offers low premiums and pretty much complete coverage after the deductible and OOPM, out-of-pocket max, is hit. In order to help individuals meet this high deductible, the HDHP is paired with a tax free savings account known as an HSA. The individual can contribute extra savings, separate from their monthly premium, to this HSA completely tax free so that when it comes time to pay that high deductible, the accumulated funds in the HSA can be withdrawn to do just that. Using an HSA to pay down a high deductible is beneficial because individuals can invest tax free and avoid paying any income tax on funds used to pay high deductibles. **HSA Funds** Funds stored in a HSA are only allowed to be spent on qualifying medical expenses. Other than deductibles, HSA funds can be spent on a bunch of other things like copays, medicine like Advil and Pepto Bismol, and even contraceptives. HSA funds can only used to pay monthly premiums in special scenarios like paying for COBRA continuation coverage, while receiving unemployment benefits, or even some other unique circumstances. To make things easy, most HSA accounts come with their own debit card that can be used to pay for eligible expenses. Unused HSA funds rollover and are kept in the account pretty much indefinitely and most HSAs are interest bearing accounts. HSA withdrawals are completely tax-free and penalty-free as long as they are being used for eligible expenses. If you want to pull out the money for any other reason, you will be subject to a 20% penalty if you are under the age of 65. If you're over 65 you will still be taxed on the withdrawal as income. **Deposit Limits** An HSA, just like an IRA or 401K, has set annual contribution limits that are determined by your age and how many people are on your coverage. If your HDHP only covers yourself and no one else, your maximum annual contribution is capped at \$4,300. If your plan covers 2 or more people including yourself, the annual contribution is capped at \$8,550. Individuals at 55 years of age or older have an additional \$1,000 added to their maximum annual contribution per account, whether they are single individuals or under family coverage. Even contributions that are not made by you, such as employer contributions, are still counted under this contribution limit. Every dollar contributed over the max contribution limit is subject to both income tax, as it is not considered tax-free because it is over the limit, and a 6% penalty fee for every year that the excess of funds are left in the account. **Investing HSA Funds** After enrolling in an HDHP and fully maxing out your HSA, your HSA will become full of funds just waiting to be spent. What should you do? Well, what some financially savvy HSA owners like to do is invest the funds being held in their account. HSAs are great investment vehicles because they offer a triple tax advantage. This means that contributions, growth through investment or interest, and qualified withdrawals are all completely tax-free. It depends on the HSA provider but most offer investment options that can help put the sitting funds to work. Common options include stocks, bonds, mutual funds, ETFs, and more. Any gains realized within the account are tax-free but are still only allowed to be withdrawn for eligible medical expenses. **Does An HSA Actually Make Health Insurance Cheaper?** So is an HSA actually worth it? Let's do an experiment. I am going to compare quotes for 5 example applicants to determine whether they should choose an HDHP and HSA combo or stick to a normal Marketplace plan. The example applicant demographic are as follows: * **Single Applicant**, Age: **24**, Income: **\$22,000**, Name: **Tommy** * **Family of 2**, Ages: **41 and 43**, Income: **\$62,000**, Name: **Smith Family** * **Single Applicant**, Age: **51**, Income: **\$115,000**, Name: **Richard** * **Family of 3**, Ages: **6, 32, and 36**, Income: **\$42,000**, Name: **Willard Family** * **Family of 4**, Age: **16, 12, 52, and 57**, Income: **\$145,000**, Name: **Gonzalez Family** Please keep in mind that I am licensed in Florida and these quotes are coming from the Federally Facilitated Marketplace using my local zip code. These quotes may be different depending on what state you apply for coverage in. Also, quotes are subject to change, so even if you are in Florida these quotes still may not apply exactly. Since there are several options of each type of insurance, standard Marketplace and HDHP, available for every applicant, I went through and picked what I thought would be the best option out of the available plans. I ran these quotes on 10/21/25. With that out of the way, let's look at the numbers. <https://preview.redd.it/86z2kyzy9vwf1.png?width=981&format=png&auto=webp&s=e6b713046ca87d393814b817af99850e815f0862> **Findings & Summary** So after analyzing the numbers you can see that enrolling in an HSA eligible HDHP is never really the better option for anyone in this experiment. You could maybe make a case for Richard, the single applicant high earner demographic, depending on his priorities and plan usage but that's pretty much it. At least from the quotes I saw, both premiums AND deductibles end up being higher. Maybe you get a better out-of-pocket maximum but most people don't even come close to hitting their limit anyways so in my opinion it's not worth it. If you are enrolling in health insurance through the Federal Marketplace, I would not recommend you buy into the idea of an HSA if you are in the Florida area. That being said, I have no idea what other non-federal private insurer's HSA eligible quotes are so maybe there are some better options out there but from what I've seen, standard Marketplace plans seem to be the better option in this case. Again, to be clear, I am not saying that HSAs never work and you should always avoid them. Some employer options and private options might be awesome choices but if you are applying through the Federal Marketplace, I would just stick to the standard options. **Future Of HSAs and HDHPs** There are some pretty big changes coming to HSAs in 2026 that could really shake things up and make them much more useful. Starting on January 1st, 2026, all Bronze plans and Catastrophic ACA Marketplace plans will become HSA eligible opening up the power of HSAs to a new demographic for the first time. In the past these plans didn't hit the high deductible requirements to be HSA eligible under IRS rules but these rules are officially set to be changed. Also, contribution limits are expected to raise by an extra \$100 for individuals and an extra \$200 for families. This expanded eligibility looks like it's going to make HSAs much more competitive and accessible than ever before so be sure to ask your agent about your options and keep these upcoming changes in mind when shopping for plans."

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oe3dky/>

↳ (0): "You can't make recommendations based on your state. Florida is a disaster zone for insurance of any type, including health insurance. I've been reading some stories of people getting their Florida Blue 2026 quotes, and being absolutely floored by the increases. You are also discounting the value of putting extra money into an HSA, which is not only a tax deduction (which will increase the subsidy!), but is forever tax-free. Also, every Bronze plan in 2026 will be HSA-eligible, so that changes the calculation for many people."

↳ (0): "As of now, I am only licensed in Florida so I can only offer advice for Florida residents. I put multiple disclaimers in the article saying all of these numbers come from Florida and they can be disregarded if you are outside of Florida. And to your point, yea FB increases have been pretty steep but it's looking like that's going to be the reality for everyone. Also, AmeriHealth Caritas is offering some pretty competitive plans for 2026 and I think with the right agent people will be able to at least tolerate the price increases. I am not discounting the value of putting extra tax free money into an HSA. But, if you live in Florida and are looking to get Marketplace coverage it really only makes sense for a small group of people. About the Bronze plans, thanks for offering that information, that is news to me. Let's hope HSAs becomes more affordable when they can be tied to bronze plans. From my understanding though, bronze plans are going to become HSA eligible because there deductibles are going to get out of control, is this right? Regardless it should help keep the premium down so I'm definitely going to redo this once this rule comes in place starting January 1st."

↳ (0): ">Other than deductibles, HSA funds can be spent on a bunch of other things like monthly premiums, Just wanted to point out that HSA funds *cannot be used for monthly premiums* unless it's while you're on COBRA or while you're receiving unemployment benefits so most people cannot use their HSA funds to pay their premiums."

"I am tired of giving these Florida call centers my residuals, I am interested in the best IMO that offers support and great systems. I want vesting from day 1, and immediate release of my license in case if anything. I'm only interested in final expense/ mapd completely telesales only. Also I think the future is Live transfers... which company can help me."

— YouTube · What Is The Best FMO or IMO For New Medicare Agents? · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XzJoCuAyo94&lc=UgyiBOS3YlikdLiMo1V4AaABAg>

↳ @savannahsmiles1797 (3): "FL and IL have the worst cluster of them"

"New Agent Here! Hello! Medicare agent in her first month 🙌 I really want to know if it's very lucky of me to be part of an agency that offers me this; *Great and constant training (technical and motivational training) *inbound calls system and generated own leads through advertising. *Good office environment *Investing on provider marketing and events set ups. *\$50 for every switch and \$100 for T65 plus \$16/h I got 15 clients so far and I am really happy of being helping this people, I don't know if I'm being too naive for this industry but I do my best to help every single senior I talk to. I am feeling a lot of pressure tho and the fear of not being good enough for this. Would love to know how you manage your bad calls if you wanna share 🙏🙏"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jm9d8n/>

↳ (0): "Are you remote? If so, who are you working with? Sounds like a good way to get started."

↳ (0): "Thats decent base plus commission"

↳ (0): "Sounds really good. Would like to know more about this company"

"L&H broker considering transition to commercial P&C... Opinions? I currently broker Medicare plans as an independent agent. I do remote sales and do very well relative to most in the industry. I have some lead gen systems in place that I am confident can transfer to any other sales role. However, my one concern is the endless compliance regulations for selling Medicare plans to seniors. With almost every way of contacting a prospect being uncompliant, I can't help but worry that in the future one slip up could cause me to lose my business that I have gained over years of selling. I do ethical business and I will not screw someone over to make a commission, but I am looking for something else with less regulation on how I acquire a client, that also pays residuals and decent upfront commission. I am not going to go captive, I am a commission only type of person, I want to lose big and win big. I'd rather put in the work to own my book of business and get my full commission. Anyone with experience in independent commercial P&C brokering with some insight on my next steps or where to learn more? How is compliance and regulations in that sector? Is there anything better than commercial P&C as far as commission and residuals? I only mention commercial because I heard that can be big money. Let me know opinions and if there are any other commission only sales routes I should pursue for good residuals. Thank you!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dwvp5q/lh_broker_considering_transition_to_commercial_pc/

"Ppl get scared... I called them "pussies" But NDAs and Non-competes I throw in the trash at this point. Some recently told me it's a scare tactic and it's 100% true. But this is Reddit ffs, free exchange of information and ideas to be distributed for the betterment of us all. (Only sales bros. Fuck them other guys, gnomesayin?) Edit: I hate this website to a large degree, I really do... but it's taught me a lot and the best part about it is anonymity."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1t9nf3b/seeking_advice_as_a_new_agent_struggling/ol54mga/

"You are held hostage because you cannot easily switch to another IMO. There is typically a waiting period of 6 months because they're not going to give you a transfer. That means you can't sell insurance for any of those carriers that you were contracted with for 6 months. Most people need those carriers so they end up being held hostage end up staying with the company for years. Most people can't go 6 months without receiving income."

— YouTube · LIVE Dialing: Cold Calling Insurance Leads (SCRIPT GIVEAWAY) · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=POOoucTXJYc&lc=UgwAEyZDFbgbbKcQ2B4AaABAg.9x2MMdIAGOfA48rxdx3yP2>

"I was attempting to defend you that there are more than a half dozen variations of policies that replay was trying to say. There are truly many variations within those especially from carrier to carrier. It is NOT as simple as just learning those high level categories. We must learn all of the specifics of each plan. Learn how strict or what wiggle room there might be between them to get underwriting approvals. That account was making it overly simplistic. Then I added most kids and adults learn better with at least some structure and guidance. A few Zoom calls or links to a myriad of videos is no way to effectively help train someone. And that someone is who a agency owner or company leader is counting on to be strong in sales to help their own take home pay. A little bit more of investing in people, direct hires or contractors, is called leadership. Leadership also involves mentorship. Not just Zoom calls of changes to plans. Not just covering the week's leader boards. Mentorship is actually engaging with people. Finding what they are having issues with. Giving suggestions. Listening more than promoting. I am not seeing that from any of the agency owners so far. Just go hit the ground running and if it doesn't work out, they've already recruited 20 other people in those initial weeks. The current practices in the industry seem to be throw enough people at the wall in hopes one sticks. That is not leadership. That is not even being a great business owner themselves. That reminds me of a roommate back in our single days who handed out his business cards to every girl he met that had a pulse (not sure some of them were even human but that's a different topic). I told him he was sleazy and slimy. He never denied it and actually was proud of how many girls (even if not all human) he hooked up with. Concerning the cards, his view was it was all in the numbers. If he even got one call back in 100 or 200 cards he handed out, that was more than any of us. That is the hiring and "training" approach of the industry in a majority of cases. Churn through a couple of hundred recruits and maybe 1 will make them some money. No leadership. No real guidance. No mentorship. And a lot of vain, "I'm the Main Character" stuff. Look at me! I am successful! I have tons of money from being an effective ~~~seller~~~ recruiter of people in numbers that will make me money! I have a paid off home, nice cars, a hot spouse and travel the world! Look at me!! Now buy a lot of leads, subscribe to this or that and buy tickets to our seminars! Never mind if I may or may not make money off those things too. Just go out there and make some money for ~~~yourself~~~ me! I am going to look around for agencies not of this mold. If none exist, I'm moving on. I've been a decent salesperson since my school days in many different roles. But this just may not be a good fit for me. Plus thousands of outbound calls and never even an appointment. At this point, I'd probably have a heart attack if someone, anyone actually answered the phone or called/texted back."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1q6lb33/when_integrity_collides_with_the_insurance/nyj4idc/

"1099 Health & Life agent here. Im 100% commission based, and I'm associated with a brokerage which provides training, leads, and makes it very easy and simple to appoint with different carriers. I have heard lots of horror stories about how it can be, but I was very lucky to land at a place where it seems to be the dream which I'm sure there are others like it. My work life balance is what I choose. Since I am 1099/Independent- I work from where I want, however I want, for however long I want... sell the products that I choose. My brokerage provides an office space for free which you can go to 7 days a week and there are always people there willing to help or let you shadow while you learn. Pay depends on you. Last year was my first year and although it was rough (Chargebacks, customer service being the worst) I see the potential in the game especially since I have become close with some of the top producers at the brokerage. Although some decide to work 6 days a week for 10 hours or more (and make well into the 6 figures or even 7) others do what you want to do which is put their family first. I would take everything you are told with a grain of salt as it is heavily dependent on that person's experience. Mine has been great. If you are a resilient person, manage stress well, work hard on your own and don't need external motivation, this career could be good for you. It definitely has it's ups and downs (I'm a 100% commission based agent), but if you have enough money saved up to survive for a couple of months while you get started I would highly recommend a 100% commission based position if you can mentally handle it since you will get a much higher commission rate and you will own your book of business. Best of luck!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ax5nn1/what_is_it_like_being_an_insurance_agent/kr1sxi6/

"HELP - P&C I'm currently working toward my P&C license in South Carolina and plan to start my own independent agency once I pass. I currently have a successful career in app design, and my wife already runs a very successful Medicare business. We're now looking to partner and build an agency together, with me focusing primarily on the P&C side. My goal is to own the book from day one and build something long term under our own name. I've been researching direct carrier appointments versus joining an agency network or aggregator. I've looked into First Connect, Smart Choice SC, Firefly and SIAA, but I'm seeing mixed opinions everywhere. For those who have actually started an independent agency from scratch, what route did you take? Would you recommend trying for direct appointments immediately, joining a network first, or using a combination of both? Any help is appreciated"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wnhsew/help_pc/

↳ Any_Lengthiness_3555 (3): "With your total lack of experience, any direct appts will be shitty ones. No question start with an aggregator."

↳ Vegetable-Being2434 (1): "When I went independent, I used First Connect to fill the access gap while I figured out which direct relationships were actually worth chasing. That worked well for me because I could start quoting pretty quickly and their support team was useful when I was still learning different carrier appetites. Since you already have a Medicare book in the household, you've got a pretty natural cross sell opportunity too."

"Yes I had experience and training. Their training is the same as the training provided by Marketplace other than the short training on how to use their systems. But I have been told if you have a good sales leader they can take more time with you and have people on your team work with you or if you live near an office schedule a time for you to go in and work with someone. That was not the case for me. I was told to watch a YouTube video or figure things out on my own. You don't have your own book when you leave because they hold your appointments/contracts for six months so you are unable to sell or access you information with any carrier. They didn't tell me that when I started and I haven't been able to find a signed non compete agreement so this may become an issue soon as I am exploring other options."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cdomsd/new_rules_with_a_slight_change/mp52jw9/

"I started my agency 3 ish years ago. We do Medicare, Life, and Annuities. Find an FMO that'll contract you at the full street level comp. There are lots that'll do that if all you need is the contract. Make sure you're paid directly by the carriers and not through the FMO. Make sure you own your book not them. As others said, if you're a good producer you may be able to get above street level comp on your contracts. Build multiple pipelines to generate your own leads. Invest to build your brand and build a great website."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15nmmk7/how_to_start_an_insurance_agency_imo/jvo699f/

"And that's fine to feel that way, but then be a captive agent, not an independent one. Your IMO is not your "employer". You're 1099. You are free to choose what is more important to you... Working somewhere that provides everything and owns the business that goes through it, or investing in YOUR business and having ownership of it even if you decide to leave. You can't have both is all I am saying."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tnmhue/brand_new_independent_agents/onvopuw/

"To me its not captive vs independent vs mlm. Its - if im selling my warm market, creating my own market, working my own leads - shouldn't i OWN my book? That is dictated by your contract. Not what style of company you work in. It should clearly say - the agent owns the book. Not a the agent owns the book IF they xyz."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vz10ku/why_does_captive_get_so_much_hate_verses_brokerage/p9cvxt0/

"not in insurance personally but i run sales at a b2b software company so take what applies and ignore the rest the contracts thing is the one i'd hammer home hardest - book ownership is non-negotiable from day one. if you dont own your book you dont own your business, full stop. seen people get torched on that and its not pretty on niches - specialize early. i know everyone says "cast a wide net first" but the agencies i've seen scale fast picked a lane. contractors, trucking, whatever, just pick something you can actually get good at and where referrals compound lead gen: referral partnerships over paid leads, always. paid leads are a treadmill you never get off. find one or two good referral sources (mortgage brokers, accountants, whoever touches your niche) and go deep there software - dont overbuild your stack in year one. AMS is a non-negotiable, everything else can wait until you're actually producing revenue. the fancy quoting tools and automation stuff sounds good but you'll change your mind about what you actually need after 6 months of real volume anyway the aggregator question is the one i genuinely cant answer for you - that's too specific to insurance and regional carrier access for me to have a useful take"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vwadgv/independent_agency_owners_what_would_you_do/p60fzp7/

What a lead costs against what a sale pays · 30 documents · 20 voices

"Main reason I got out of Medicare. I had nightmares about those garbage food/flex cards. I would have people literally cussing me out to get a \$10 increase in their welfare, I give them what they ask and then they say "Its not worth it for such a little increase." I had a soft spot for elderly people, not anymore, they are some major A-holes."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j8srq5/fired_from_my_medicare_advantage_job/mh7vk9p/

"HSAs and HDHPs Explained So you might've seen Dave Ramsey and other financial professionals throwing out the idea of HSAs and framing it like a secret hack to cheaper healthcare. With the rising health costs expected to come this OEP after the expiration of the famous subsidies, I was intrigued. As a licensed agent, I felt obligated to do a deep dive on this topic to see if all in all it is a better option for my clients. My findings are written in a blog style format below. *Yes it's long. It's an in-depth explanation so you can understand the full picture surrounding HSAs and HDHPs. Feel free to offer any corrections or suggestions in the comments.* With healthcare costs expected to hit all time highs, everyone from low income families and high income individuals are looking for a way out. The health insurance marketplace is a thick and complicated ungroomed jungle and without proper research and a solid understanding of all the acronyms and structures involved, your chances of affordable healthcare are pretty much non-existent. In these troubling times the financial and insurance gurus of social media have taken to the streets, or should I say screens, and are doing their best to educate their viewers on other options and structures when it comes to health insurance. One of the most popular alternative options being mentioned this year is a unique insurance structure called an HSA. **What the heck is an HSA?** An HSA, **Health Savings Account**, is a type of savings account that is tied to a HDHP, **High Deductible Health Plan**, that is said to work best for individuals on the extreme ends of the spectrum when it comes to insurance. What I mean by that is individuals or families who are either healthy and rarely use their insurance or ill and use their insurance heavily. The structure works as follows, the individual or family enrolls in a HDHP and then ties this HDHP to an HSA. Both the HDHP and HSA work to balance each other's cons and create an affordable health insurance option for these groups of people. Since the HDHP has a high deductible, it offers low premiums and pretty much complete coverage after the deductible and OOPM, out-of-pocket max, is hit. In order to help individuals meet this high deductible, the HDHP is paired with a tax free savings account known as an HSA. The individual can contribute extra savings, separate from their monthly premium, to this HSA completely tax free so that when it comes time to pay that high deductible, the accumulated funds in the HSA can be withdrawn to do just that. Using an HSA to pay down a high deductible is beneficial because individuals can invest tax free and avoid paying any income tax on funds used to pay high deductibles. **HSA Funds** Funds stored in a HSA are only allowed to be spent on qualifying medical expenses. Other than deductibles, HSA funds can be spent on a bunch of other things like copays, medicine like Advil and Pepto Bismol, and even contraceptives. HSA funds can only used to pay monthly premiums in special scenarios like paying for COBRA continuation coverage, while receiving unemployment benefits, or even some other unique circumstances. To make things easy, most HSA accounts come with their own debit card that can be used to pay for eligible expenses. Unused HSA funds rollover and are kept in the account pretty much indefinitely and most HSAs are interest bearing accounts. HSA withdrawals are completely tax-free and penalty-free as long as they are being used for eligible expenses. If you want to pull out the money for any other reason, you will be subject to a 20% penalty if you are under the age of 65. If you're over 65 you will still be taxed on the withdrawal as income. **Deposit Limits** An HSA, just like an IRA or 401K, has set annual contribution limits that are determined by your age and how many people are on your coverage. If your HDHP only covers yourself and no one else, your maximum annual contribution is capped at \$4,300. If your plan covers 2 or more people including yourself, the annual contribution is capped at \$8,550. Individuals at 55 years of age or older have an additional \$1,000 added to their maximum annual contribution per account, whether they are single individuals or under family coverage. Even contributions that are not made by you, such as employer contributions, are still counted under this contribution limit. Every dollar contributed over the max contribution limit is subject to both income tax, as it is not considered tax-free because it is over the limit, and a 6% penalty fee for every year that the excess of funds are left in the account. **Investing HSA Funds** After enrolling in an HDHP and fully maxing out your HSA, your HSA will become full of funds just waiting to be spent. What should you do? Well, what some financially savvy HSA owners like to do is invest the funds being held in their account. HSAs are great investment vehicles because they offer a triple tax advantage. This means that contributions, growth through investment or interest, and qualified withdrawals are all completely tax-free. It depends on the HSA provider but most offer investment options that can help put the sitting funds to work. Common options include stocks, bonds, mutual funds, ETFs, and more. Any gains realized within the account are tax-free but are still only allowed to be withdrawn for eligible medical expenses. **Does An HSA Actually Make Health Insurance Cheaper?** So is an HSA actually worth it? Let's do an experiment. I am going to compare quotes for 5 example applicants to determine whether they should choose an HDHP and HSA combo or stick to a normal Marketplace plan. The example applicant demographic are as follows: * **Single Applicant**, Age: **24**, Income: **\$22,000**, Name: **Tommy** * **Family of 2**, Ages: **41 and 43**, Income: **\$62,000**, Name: **Smith Family** * **Single Applicant**, Age: **51**, Income: **\$115,000**, Name: **Richard** * **Family of 3**, Ages: **6, 32, and 36**, Income: **\$42,000**, Name: **Willard Family** * **Family of 4**, Age: **16, 12, 52, and 57**, Income: **\$145,000**, Name: **Gonzalez Family** Please keep in mind that I am licensed in Florida and these quotes are coming from the Federally Facilitated Marketplace using my local zip code. These quotes may be different depending on what state you apply for coverage in. Also, quotes are subject to change, so even if you are in Florida these quotes still may not apply exactly. Since there are several options of each type of insurance, standard Marketplace and HDHP, available for every applicant, I went through and picked what I thought would be the best option out of the available plans. I ran these quotes on 10/21/25. With that out of the way, let's look at the numbers. <https://preview.redd.it/86z2kyzy9vwf1.png?width=981&format=png&auto=webp&s=e6b713046ca87d393814b817af99850e815f0862> **Findings & Summary** So after analyzing the numbers you can see that enrolling in an HSA eligible HDHP is never really the better option for anyone in this experiment. You could maybe make a case for Richard, the single applicant high earner demographic, depending on his priorities and plan usage but that's pretty much it. At least from the quotes I saw, both premiums AND deductibles end up being higher. Maybe you get a better out-of-pocket maximum but most people don't even come close to hitting their limit anyways so in my opinion it's not worth it. If you are enrolling in health insurance through the Federal Marketplace, I would not recommend you buy into the idea of an HSA if you are in the Florida area. That being said, I have no idea what other non-federal private insurer's HSA eligible quotes are so maybe there are some better options out there but from what I've seen, standard Marketplace plans seem to be the better option in this case. Again, to be clear, I am not saying that HSAs never work and you should always avoid them. Some employer options and private options might be awesome choices but if you are applying through the Federal Marketplace, I would just stick to the standard options. **Future Of HSAs and HDHPs** There are some pretty big changes coming to HSAs in 2026 that could really shake things up and make them much more useful. Starting on January 1st, 2026, all Bronze plans and Catastrophic ACA Marketplace plans will become HSA eligible opening up the power of HSAs to a new demographic for the first time. In the past these plans didn't hit the high deductible requirements to be HSA eligible under IRS rules but these rules are officially set to be changed. Also, contribution limits are expected to raise by an extra \$100 for individuals and an extra \$200 for families. This expanded eligibility looks like it's going to make HSAs much more competitive and accessible then ever before so be sure to ask your agent about your options and keep these upcoming changes in mind when shopping for plans."

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oe3dky/>

↳ (0): "You can't make recommendations based on your state. Florida is a disaster zone for insurance of any type, including health insurance. I've been reading some stories of people getting their Florida Blue 2026 quotes, and being absolutely floored by the increases. You are also discounting the value of putting extra money into an HSA, which is not only a tax deduction (which will increase the subsidy!), but is forever tax-free. Also, every Bronze plan in 2026 will be HSA-eligible, so that changes the calculation for many people."

↳ (0): "As of now, I am only licensed in Florida so I can only offer advice for Florida residents. I put multiple disclaimers in the article saying all of these numbers come from Florida and they can be disregarded if you are outside of Florida. And to your point, yea FB increases have been pretty steep but it's looking like that's going to be the reality for everyone. Also, AmeriHealth Caritas is offering some pretty competitive plans for 2026 and I think with the right agent people will be able to at least tolerate the price increases. I am not discounting the value of putting extra tax free money into an HSA. But, if you live in Florida and are looking to get Marketplace coverage it really only makes sense for a small group of people. About the Bronze plans, thanks for offering that information, that is news to me. Let's hope HSAs becomes more affordable when they can be tied to bronze plans. From my understanding though, bronze plans are going to become HSA eligible because there deductibles are going to get out of control, is this right? Regardless it should help keep the premium down so I'm definitely going to redo this once this rule comes in place starting January 1st."

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"What lead vendors work for you? I'm a face to face final expense agent. I was using cheaper internet leads from integrity, social insurance leads, and leads direct. They aren't exclusive but they're anywhere from \$1-11 so I can get a lot of them, and if you dial enough you'll set up enough appointments. The ROI was great. As of recently though, they're just bad. And I've been with companies in the past that have had BAD leads before, I'm used to having to dial a lot and overcome objections, but this just isn't the way anymore. I've tried Facebook ads myself and I've come to the conclusion I'm just not a good marketer. It takes a lot of trial and error and time to figure it out so unless there's somewhere that'll give me a copy and pasted proven ad to post, I've decided it's not worth it. I'll take any recommendations on any direct mail or internet lead vendors. What works for you guys?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fmxcl1/what_lead_vendors_work_for_you/

↳ DavidDuford (5): "I'll second u/NAF1138 - just work direct mail leads. Aged direct mail leads can be great if you can find a quality distributor. Facebook leads can be good but you'll have a bunch more travel time to work them effectively."

↳ NAF1138 (4): "If you sell face to face, you should ONLY work direct mail. All other lead types are only good for filler leads or telesales. There are lots of good direct lead vendors The Lead Connection Lead Concepts Need a Lead RGI Are some places to start."

↳ dis_iz_funny_shit (4): "I've got a direct face to face method for finding new leads in the field - mortgage protection leads — so the tool helps you find people in any area that just bought a home in the last few months. It helps you locate a phone number also about 60-70% of the time"

"Independent Life Insurance Brokers: Is Anyone Else Struggling Right Now? I genuinely feel like selling life insurance as an independent broker has become a falling knife. The broader economy is putting immense pressure on both clients and agents. Families are dealing with inflation, high interest rates, mounting consumer debt, stagnant wages, and rising costs for necessities like housing, groceries, insurance, and utilities. When people are struggling just to cover essential bills, life insurance, despite its importance, is often one of the first expenses they postpone or cancel. As a result, brokers are facing a combination of declining sales, higher policy lapse rates, more difficult underwriting conversations, and clients who simply can't justify taking on another monthly payment. At the same time, lead costs remain high and declining in quality, chargebacks can erase months of income, and many brokers work entirely on commission without a guaranteed paycheck or benefits. It creates an environment where the financial risk falls heavily on the broker while the probability of closing business decreases. I still believe life insurance is one of the most valuable financial products a family can own. The need for protection has never disappeared. In fact, uncertain times often make that need even greater. The challenge is that economic hardship makes it significantly harder for people to act on that need. Until consumer confidence and household finances improve, I think independent life insurance brokers will continue facing an uphill battle, making the profession feel less like building momentum and more like trying to catch a falling knife."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vcziks/independent_life_insurance_brokers_is_anyone_else/

↳ Tahoptions (10): "Through the first quarter, LIMRA says life sales are up 7% year over year. If you're niche-focused, there hasn't been any slowdown. Middle market may be struggling, but people that make good money don't blink at spending 100/mo on a term policy or 200-300/m on a DI policy. Boomers are happy to use some of their assets to protect the rest via hybrid LTC. Final expense is still booming as well. So I guess the moral of the story is to stay on either end of the barbell. Either people who make almost no money (FE) or people who make a lot (LTC/DI/large term/GUL cases)"

↳ INKEDsage (8): "I just sold 31k APV for July and 25k in June. Doing pretty well on my end."

↳ Pubsubforpresident (7): "How long have you been in business?"

"\$36k annually on marketing??? Thats only \$3k a month! \$500k renewal revenue is about a \$7 million book with the "good hands" captive. I have never met an agent with a \$7 million book spending just \$3k on marketing per month!!! \$5k should be your minimum marketing budget per month if not \$7k for a book that size! Next you will say your cost per acquisition per item is just \$40 which is impossible with any lead gen program!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jrvwh5/please_stop_taking_sales_roles_that_pay_4/ml64xe/

"Results from running your own final expense Facebook ads? I'm being bombarded with Facebook ads for agencies trying to get me to hire them to run my ads, but I'm a pretty smart cookie and can figure it out myself. Any of you running your own final expense Facebook ads? How much is the cost per lead averaging at this time? June 2024?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dp7gjh/results_from_running_your_own_final_expense/

↳ lil-funky-t (3): "significantmoose1490 has helped me greatly. We are just starting and in testing but already have initial leads that are somewhat qualified. He charges a fair price and is very hands on in the education so that you can tweak the ad on your own down the road."

↳ curatedservices (1): "We give agents fex ad templates, landing pages, surveys, automations for the same price as a highlevel account subscription. Most marketing agencies want to charge large fees/subscriptions just for the setup. Plus we will help call your leads."

↳ thatbasicshit (1): "You call leads for us.... I assume you keep those commissions too..."

"I am currently working with HealthMarkets. There are positives and negatives as with any company. They do provide a free lead account and leads are half price when you are new to the company. They also offer cash and other bonuses along the way for new agents. You do not have to be new to the industry, just new to HM. There is not a lot of training on anything, so if you are new to the industry, this may not be for you. But, it depends on who your sales leader is as to how much they are willing to do to help you out. In my opinion, being told it's my own business so I need to figure everything out on my own, yet if I leave they will hold my contracts for six months is not worth it as there are other agencies that will either train you or not hold your contracts. If you want to make a decent living expect to put in at least 8 hours a day until you have built a book of business. This may not have been very helpful but I've been in the industry for a while and every company has their benefits and shortfalls. Overall, there is no micromanaging but there is no training that differs from Marketplace training."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cdomsd/new_rules_with_a_slight_change/mov08x4/

"You always got to look at your cost for acquisition or CPA when you buy leads and age leads might be really cheap and if they're 50 cents a piece but you have to buy a thousand to get a deal then your cost for acquisition is \$500 alternatively you can buy four or five live transfers and spend \$200 to \$250 or you can buy individual leads 10 to 30 each and spend two to \$300 besides the cost per acquisition there's the time aspect even if it costs the same amount of money it's better to use live transfers or leads because you don't have to work as hard and you can close more business in the day Paige leads are great for people that are just starting out and don't have money for good leads You can pop them in a dialer or put them on automation It's not in my opinion a long-term strategy like live transfers or self generated leads are"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k24g9p/aged_leads_store/mnt6xyv1/

"I'm not talking about earning potential/possibilities. But math like: \$10 cost per lead, 50% contact ratio, 20% closing ratio, \$780 avg AP, 75% comp with standard 75% advance = \$338.75 net/\$438.75 gross per \$100 spent on ads. Clearly numbers are taken out of thin air as an example and will differ on number of factors. But if one comes into this industry and operates (and is familiar with) with those metrics, as opposed to intangible "great leads" and "amazing income opportunity", he'll be much better off. Here's an example: one IMO heavily pushes that anyone who's able to simply read their script will close 50% of the appointments. And their leads have 25/40/80% booking ratio depending on the tier (age). Free money printer, ain't it? Put anyone who can't even spell the word "deductible" and he should be mansion-shopping in no time. Even if you discount those numbers by half to account for lack of experience. But they conveniently don't mention that leads have ~25% contact ratio. When agents struggle? Buy more leads! You may be a couple dials away from your big break! So new agent, who doesn't know any better and operates with the zero-to-hero story in his mind, will keep on going till he's broke without knowing that numbers wouldn't work out for him to begin with. Point being, I'm talking about basic/general point of reference and means to put the numbers together. So one can make better decisions based on factual information and have the means to understand that if 1/150 dials end up in a quote, it's very likely that there's nothing wrong with them, but leads just aren't as great as the recruiter promised."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/mlyvds3/

"I also went through the same thing with my 30 leads that I ordered from Caboom, there is no difference between these and regular \$1 leads. To me it was advertised as these leads have high intent or are looking to buy but when I call them they never pick up or when they do its always about some "free program" for coverage or a veterans free coverage. I highly suggest to anyone thinking about buying these DONT. They are not worth the money at all whatsoever, your better off lighting the \$700 on fire or spending them on aged leads and try your luck there since its all the same. Learn from my mistake and dont buy Caboom"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/o8thyji/

"In one of your other videos you mentioned how lead costs have increased from around \$5 to now \$15 per lead, and that you close 1/20 of the leads. I'm really confused how doing ACA is ever profitable or sustainable, as based on this math it would cost \$300 to enroll a single client for \$25/mo. which would take almost a year to recoup. Even if singing up multiple members or cross-selling, that's at least 3-4 months before seeing any return. Maybe I'm not understanding the numbers but I'm really lost on the ACA model. Can you clarify the numbers? Thanks."

— YouTube · How I Wrote 1300+ ACA Applications In One OEP — Strategies Agents Can Use In 2025 · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NHWQrBpOEb0&lc=UgyJDufp-qa9_9ewUTB4AaABAQ

↳ @InsuranceAgentTraining (0): "this is a complicated one. Here is what I will do. I will make another video to explain this better"

"I'm yet to find a decent lead vendor in many years in health. Best way is to build your book with referrals - like really be a good person to your clients, then when OEP/AEP get closer, you gotta ask those clients for referrals. Every once in a while, I'll try a new lead company and sometimes it works out but typically, the leads get worse and worse over time (that's their business model in many cases), so it becomes not worth the time or money."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p0mqo2/is_it_just_me/npo7fdj/

"If you don't want to spend hours and hours learning how. Pay someone a fee to set it all up for you. It's highly worth it in the long run with all the money you save on your cost per lead, and if you really just want to focus on your selling, pay them the add on to manage it for you. My recommendation from experience"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pmr7pi/how_are_we_generating_leads_going_into_2026/nusk74o/

"Honestly this is the case for all Inbound leads. I've tried them and got tired of the bait and switch marketing that would cause callers to assume the policies were "free". Not worth the hassle and chargebacks."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u9pr90/ringba_leads_through_integrity_connect_are_a_scam/osij5z6/

"I got out of insurance, both p&c and health for that reason. Unless you're an independent agent with years in the game it's really not worth it imo."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1b3t4hx/been_out_of_the_medicare_sales_game_for_2_years/ksuwdlt/

"Using this exact lead form and process, what were you getting for cost per lead?"

— YouTube · Facebook Ads For Insurance I Generate Your Own Insurance Live Transfer Leads · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KHDOh0sirw4&lc=Ugxs09HZC7SeYZamml14AaABAQ>

"That's a decent setup. I never heard of a 2 year wait with GIWL but that sounds like a neat product. Nothing is worse than having someone wanting to buy but is uninsurable. So having that option is solid. Especially with inbound leads with people actually interested. If I was in your position I would focus on what people qualify for, then pushing the best product for them and then try to network for referrals. Since you do inbound once you get a couple referrals going, you'll essentially be picking who and what to sell to people, rather than just trying to push whatever sticks. It'll take awhile to build your book and network but sounds like you have a decent setup. I feel you're already doing better than some agents who have to spam outbound leads all day everyday just to get someone on the phone. That being said, your lead cost to commission ratio seems high. That's a lot of \$ for leads while only getting 50%-70% comms but some solid referrals can fix that real quick."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj9u0m/had_my_first_sale_today/ovqr6w8/

"Facebook ad forms can work but you're fighting against cold audiences and high cost per lead, so most agents I know see better ROI by finding people already talking about their insurance needs on Reddit where intent is way higher. Instead of paying for clicks to a form, tools like Wantd scan Reddit in real-time to surface the posts where someone's actually asking about coverage or complaining about their current provider, then you can jump in with a genuine answer before they've already picked someone else. You'll spot way more qualified leads this way than you will with Facebook ad spend."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tcm0oa/fb_ad_manager_life_leads/oluk3dr/

"Okay let me get this straight. You're still offering MS&MA, right? Just thinking of dropping the PDP part, correct? If that's the case, at least for me, I just had my agents do it. I understand at a certain point it's really not worth it, but every AEP I average 20% new business from PDP clients / referrals. I let my new agents practice and take care of the appointment while discovering other business opportunities. But you're right. Medicare regulations are getting more and more complicated, that's why I'm shifting my focus."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fu74gk/question_for_other_medicare_agents_about_rx_plans/lq35a60/

"I use smart financial Ive gotten 160 leads so far from them. About 70 were instant trash, quoted 20, and sold 6. The rest wont respond to me so I keep at it. My cost per sale is about \$200 so losing money but its fun I just text them the second they pop in and then keep texting daily or every few days. I usually get a response and I always open with an easy question not just how are you today. edit: the response is usually STOP or Not interested Maybe one a day wants a quote sometimes none"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vyv0ou/150_internet_leads_bought_zero_sales/p60l7p3/

MLMs and captive agencies that recruit on promises · 28 documents · 20 voices

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

↳ This-Armadillo9741 (7): "I've been wanting to share this insight for a while but never got the chance to. If you're considering being a life insurance agent- Specifically if you're considering working for globe life or American Income Life insurance (that was my run off branch) I'd like to offer you the most transparent what to expect in terms of your pay since I don't see anyone else being blunt with their numbers. I worked for AIL for 3 years from 2019 to 2022. on average my salary was around \$60-\$70k a year. With that income I was typically working 10 to 12 hours a day on the phone 7 days a week and attending weekly (and sometimes daily) training calls with my "team". I didn't do the recruitment side of the business, just the insurance hustle (I know this is where a lot of people are going to point out that THAT IS WHY I DIDNT MAKE AN EXTRAVAGENT AMOUNT PF MONEY) but let's be real, I didn't my my insurance liscence to recruit other people trying to get their insurance license, I did it to swell insurance. When you see that people are making"\$100k a month" or "\$MILLIONS a year" know this. If I sold a \$10,000 life insurance policy (which is a very minimum, basic, but affordable policy) I made \$55 in commission. with a \$1 residual pay that I would receive the following month. HOWEVER, when we hop on calls at the beginning of the week it would be announced that I "MADE" \$10,000 (completely untrue) and to capitalize on this they always ask "how much of that amount do you get to keep" to which you are trained to respond by saying "all of it" pretty manipulative too the new people huh? but we take what we can get and convince ourselves that if we just do that 10x over we'll eventually have what would look like a 'good check' here's the kicker about those "residuals" after the following month of each policy, you don't get them anymore. for whatever reason they give you, those get kicked to your upper and you basically only have that one time payment to count on. so if I can give you any advice on 'residual payments' it's that somewhere in the fine line of your contract I can guarantee they're not yours to keep. they will find some rhyme and reason as to why it will go back to the company. so, for over 10 hours of work a day, you might make \$55. "oh but what about those that ARE making millions" or "you just needed to work harder" let me tell you something: I busted my as off on the phone and my spline KNEW I had no interest in recruiting people so EVENTUALLY (we'll say after a year) I got granted some pretty good leads. Now I was finally able to make some big bucks! Without getting too verbose the average policy amount for these clients would be ranging from \$150k ~ \$500k. The largest I ever sold was for a \$500k policy and here's the breakdown for that : I got paid a whopping \$1,300 in commission and a \$300 'residual' the following month. so ...you do the numbers"

↳ jroberts67 (6): "I'm sorry for your experience, but plenty of flags and not trying to come at you too hard, but a level of insanity that there's never been a time in history where we have more information available yet no one wants to research. Group interview? Huge flag. Paying for anything upfront? Huge flag. "Releasing your license" is absurd, once you've passed your exam your license is activated by your state, not any agency."

↳ Current_Bridge_3615 (4): "Worked for AIL as well, you wouldn't believe the horror stories I got during that short time. Let's just say there's a reason they've been sued multiple times and are currently under investigation for insurance fraud."

"NEVER work or get life/health through Globe Life 🌐 Worst recruiting experience I have ever had, didn't help with getting license at all, lead me on for weeks, paid everything out of pocket, had to have gallbladder removed right after starting and they told me to kick rocks. Just got off the phone with regional manager yelling and cussing me and they told me because I missed part of training and had a second job (security night shift) that I wasn't committed enough and should go to a fuck that "committed" agents are a dime a dozen and they could hire any loser to fill my spot they didn't need me. I have 15+ years sales management and experience I even was on finals for the next great American speak off and I get treated like another entry level sales rep. Even in training they were more focused on the sale rather than the customer. I got into life/health to help people not suffer the same fate I did due to having an emergency hip replacement last year in May. It ruined me financially and cost me my business in adventure tourism. I just wanted to spread knowledge on the importance of coverage and actually get customers what they need, not just get their money for my own benefit like Globe Life's primary focus. I'm just pissed right now, dumped money I really couldn't afford at the time on the things I needed to be successful, the class, the license, everything and for nothing. Now I don't even know what to do with this license because 99% of the recruiters I talk to are still just wanting people for MLM crap or straight up scams. Just wanted to rant, if anyone sees this that is legit contact me. If you put me in a position to take EVERY contract from my local globe life offices I will make it my personal mission to take their business."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1irtig7/never_work_or_get_lifehealth_through_globe_life/

↳ Expert-Difficulty605 (7): "I worked business 2 business for 5 months and for me I was miserable. I made the switch to med Insurance for seniors and for me it's been night and day. I feel like I'm truly helping helping people who get lost in the shuffle"

↳ Unhappy_Corgi_6838 (6): "Sorry to hear about your experience. I recently got my life/health license through Bankers life and I'm having a similar experience. Haven't even made a prospect call yet and can't even sell until I do a 3-day training class 2 hours away from my home. It looks like the Insurance job market (really every industry) is filled with MLM companies and low paying call center contract jobs."

↳ katieintheoazarks (6): "I was with Bankers Life for 2 weeks and quit in part because of their hard sell system and cold calls. Also I explicitly asked for work at home and then I was told I wouldn't be able to work at home. I interviewed six different places and landed with symmetry which is completely work at home and the outside leads are amazing. Jump ship. Every other company I interviewed with was better than Bankers Life."

"Beware of MLM structured companies (warning) So this was originally a response to a comment on this sub, but I see a ton of new people coming into insurance, (speaking to independent guys here) and there are many many hungry wolves waiting to recruit these naïve noobs and make a profit. So, I figured I could make a post using some of the content from my previous response to explain the caveats and expose the reality of these places. I come from a MLM originally, it was unbenounced to me at the time, but I'm still grateful because it gave me a first hand glance at what goes on there. How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. They will push you to build a team, because hey, don't you wanna make 6 figures "bro"??? Well then you gotta build a huge team so you get all those overrides off the guys under you. Now, there's nothing wrong necessarily with building a team, but in a MLM context and the way they act in a deceptive manner it is extremely unethical. The guys you see writing 100k plus in premium a year??? A fraction of that fell off the books and was a chargeback, then that guy like all of us has to pay taxes at the end of the year. He also probably was buying \$500 worth of leads a week. Burned gas every day meeting clients. He *maybe* profited 40k that year, and that's being generous. But as long as they can show boat how much premium they're writing a week? A month? A year? Then shove the rhetoric down new guys throats, boasting about how they too can make 100k a year? Then they're all good. I found out through a credible source, as well as David Dufford (has a youtube channel, good tips and insight for insurance) that alot of these "top producers" buy the trips that you can win with insurance carriers for writing a lot of AP. They do all of this and sugar coat their actual earnings because you'll buy the dream, go sell sell sell, and the guys above you get all the overrides off of you without investing any of their money into you at all. It's a fucking amazing model for the guys at the top to make a killing. They create a strong sense of family at those places to keep you on board as well. They push shitty products like Americo a ton too, because they get higher commissions off of that. Americo is also pricey, and you can easily find a cheaper product for that senior to actually help them out, but more than likely they won't have many cheap options that actually are economical for the client, because then you, and them get a lower commission. So MLM's will typically encourage you to get a higher premium out of the client and force a pricey carrier on them. Hope this helps. Reputable, ethical IMO's that offer you high commission contracts and don't push you to build teams are harder to find, because they don't market and recruit. Join an insurance forum, those guys are veterans and a lot of the IMO/Brokerage owners are members there. I've been in Life Insurance for a while now, and am branching into Health/Medicare, so anyone can feel free to PM me with Life Insurance questions if you'd like. Also it would be cool to maybe post any experiences you've had with these types of organizations."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/n4hblb/beware_of_mlm_structured_companies_warning/

↳ pdxoss (6): "I hate MLM too but if someone is making 100k and paying for leads/gas, taxes etc. Their take home isn't 40%. They're going to write off marketing expenses, gas, and everything they can on taxes"

↳ coreyjacrispy (5): "Haha, not specifically, they are are a known MLM company though. Them, Primerica, Symmetry etc etc. Anytime they're trying to force the Kool aid down your throat, with generic phrases and lectures like "You can take this and be BIG man, BIG...you want to have complete financial freedom? Be on your own clock? WE give you the tools to do that! We are a family, and want everyone to succeed" Blah blah blah lol, rest assured knowing they are indeed a MLM company."

↳ Tahoptions (3): ">How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. That is only for simplified products like final expense and mortgage protection. Street is no where near 120% for most traditional products. It is much closer to 85-100% (for term/GUL/IUL) and even lower for permanent products from big mutuals like Guardian and Mass. The post is a good warning though."

"Is selling life insurance what everyone makes it out to be? All over my social media page I am seeing 20 years olds post that they are making 10k or more a month by selling life insurance. I know that there a chargebacks, buying leads, and its commission only, but is it actually worth getting into? I feel like all the companies are MLM's and that they are only posting this content to recruit people to join."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1t35kdo/>

↳ (0): "No. Not saying don't attempt, do it, try to it, or that you couldn't achieve that level of success. But what your asking about. No"

↳ (0): "I'm gonna just go a step further and say don't do it, don't try it. Just my 2c"

↳ (0): "The truth is over 90% don't make it. That doesn't mean you can't be successful. There are many options. You can go independent and have a business or you can work for a company and be an employee. There are different lines you can sell. What you see advertised is the dream. The top few percentage of people make it to that level. It's not easy. I would suggest talking to actual agents. Possibly shadowing. Nothing wrong with starting as an employee and get a major company to pay you to get licensed and learn on their dime either. It depends on your personality, your drive, and what you're looking for. If it was easy, everyone would do it. It has one of the highest failure rates and it's also a career that makes the most amount of money. No one says, when I grow up i want to sell insurance. Like most finance careers, people do it because it's one of the easiest entry level careers that can make a lot of money."

"AMEN! i have been on a similar journey. i left my last IMO after i had a "wait a second, am in a cult?" realization. it was led by a psychopathic narcissist, so that was the culture. like every psychopathic narcissist, there was the underlying truth and there was the surface of the mask and when in it, it can be hard to tell the difference. the surface mask was, "we are here to help people, we are here to support each other, we are so special". the underlying truth was that it was an MLM style parasitic predatory organization whose leadership was all about grabbing the money bag and draining as much blood from as many people as possible whether they were agents (through low commissions and crazy overpriced junk leads) or clients. they preyed on the vulnerable, the leader surrounded himself with women who had backgrounds in drug addiction, trauma, abusive parental and romantic relationship histories. later on i learned from women who had left that the founder/leader was sexually predatory and pressured women there to sleep with him by making them feel indebted to him for "saving" them. i was banned from my cult's group chat bc people asked me for help with better lead sources bc i was shooting up the leaderboard while everyone else was struggling so i shared some sources i was using and succeeding with. they punished and smeared me for that. so i left with 2 other top 10 leaderboard agents and started my own agency. several other top agents left to join other imo's at the same time we left. my old imo started me at 60% commission levels and 45% for GI. i start people with zero experience at 75-90%. my cult IMO charged \$27 per callback data lead that they made bank on. i offer leads that i make zero dollars on and it is pay per presentation for \$25 with a 20% min close rate promise (i'm closing double that rate and i am not an elite closer), not pay per lead who doesn't even answer the phone. cult imo was recruiting like 50 agents per week. we don't run recruiting campaigns and limit our growth according to how many leads we can provide our agents to make sure everyone is well fed. my cult IMO preached "only 8% of agents make it" but at my agency we make it our problem to solve if a full time agent is not writing at least \$15k AP per month. my cult IMO punished people for leaving, smeared them with made up lies, would call the new uplines of people who left to try and blacklist them. we have an open release policy and would always go out of our way to make any transition out as friendly and peaceful as possible. there are good IMO's and agencies out there. i can recommend some if people are looking."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1q6lb33/when_integrity_collides_with_the_insurance/ny9dvtm/

"I've been wanting to share this insight for a while but never got the chance to. If you're considering being a life insurance agent- Specifically if you're considering working for globe life or American Income Life insurance (that was my run off branch) I'd like to offer you the most transparent what to expect in terms of your pay since I don't see anyone else being blunt with their numbers. I worked for AIL for 3 years from 2019 to 2022. on average my salary was around \$60-\$70k a year. With that income I was typically working 10 to 12 hours a day on the phone 7 days a week and attending weekly (and sometimes daily) training calls with my "team". I didn't do the recruitment side of the business, just the insurance hustle (I know this is where a lot of people are going to point out that THAT IS WHY I DIDNT MAKE AN EXTRAVAGENT AMOUNT PF MONEY) but let's be real, I didn't my my insurance liscence to recruit other people trying to get their insurance license, I did it to swell insurance. When you see that people are making "\$100k a month" or "\$MILLIONS a year" know this. If I sold a \$10,000 life insurance policy (which is a very minimum, basic, but affordable policy) I made \$55 in commission. with a \$1 residual pay that I would receive the following month. HOWEVER, when we hop on calls at the beginning of the week it would be announced that I "MADE" \$10,000 (completely untrue) and to capitalize on this they always ask "how much of that amount do you get to keep" to which you are trained to respond by saying "all of it" pretty manipulative too the new people huh? but we take what we can get and convince ourselves that if we just do that 10x over we'll eventually have what would look like a 'good check' here's the kicker about those "residuals" after the following month of each policy, you don't get them anymore. for whatever reason they give you, those get kicked to your upper and you basically only have that one time payment to count on. so if I can give you any advice on 'residual payments' it's that somewhere in the fine line of your contract I can guarantee they're not yours to keep. they will find some rhyme and reason as to why it will go back to the company. so, for over 10 hours of work a day, you might make \$55. "oh but what about those that ARE making millions" or "you just needed to work harder" let me tell you something: I busted my as off on the phone and my spline KNEW I had no interest in recruiting people so EVENTUALLY (we'll say after a year) I got granted some pretty good leads. Now I was finally able to make some big bucks! Without getting too verbose the average policy amount for these clients would be ranging from \$150k ~\$500k. The largest I ever sold was for a \$500k policy and here's the breakdown for that : I got paid a whopping \$1,300 in commission and a \$300 'residual' the following month. so ...you do the numbers"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/nhgtz0w/

"Though I just turned 19 three days ago, I came across your videos and taking into consideration everything you've said its truly an honor. A while back a primerica recruit recruited me, and I didn't abide by their morality, you want me to hurry up and recruit people and sell life insurance but I don't know what I'm selling and it may not at all be fair to their loved ones and after life. Bad enough I didn't even have my license yet and I'm selling something that effects people life savings???...that's crazy!!! I even asked the recruit I had what makes primerica a good life insurance and she couldn't even tell me all she said was "they're the best" from then I new their ethical code wasn't ethical and she was greedy. So I ended up taking advantage of their course and just studying for the exam that is not orchestrated with them but just the state. Unfortunately my mom has bought into a policy that I know for a fact once I get my license and actually see the contract I'll probably see the flaws in it. But then again that's why I'm here, to make sure just like my mom being a victim there won't be others that are victims as well. I love how you do everything from the heart and understand that other peoples livelihood matters. I tried to get my license by taking the test on my birthday but for some reason my computer crashed and prevented me from taking it. I have another appointment set coming up soon to take it but in the mean time I am blessed to receive some insight from you, especially considering I just started watching your videos within the past three days and haven't stopped since. I am at the moment very new to the game to meet the qualifications to work with you, but hopefully one day in the future you could see how far I've came and my work ethic so that we can change the game the right way, and I can be apart of that process. What you're doing is amazing understand always, positive thinking, brings positive faith, allowing positive anticipation, bringing positive hands and positive actions. Keep going, you're on to something great 🙏🏽 P.S I requested to join your Facebook group with gods will I can get approved 🙏🏽"

— YouTube · Why I Left The Life Insurance Business (My Old MLM) · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nguUnK7fjDk&lc=UgyN5DKzDq-_gsPHSe54AaABAq

↳ @DavidWWilliams5106 (0): "I'm new to Primerica too and it's a legit company yet the recruiting part is what's difficult. It makes sense though since the person has to decide if they see value in it as well. There are going to be more NOs then yes of course. It's just the nature of it. I passed my test and got my fingerprints done recently just waiting for the actual license to come through. Life insurance is important and investments are important too it's just difficult to have others see it too"

"Picking apart this story, I have a few things I want to point out: 1) Do as much research as possible into whoever you're going to interview with. Glassdoor, customer reviews, news articles that may or may not feature the company, etc. If you have to pay for your own leads, but only from company approved sources, stay away. Either they let you build your book your way or they provide you leads to work. 2) Never. Ever. Trust the "can make up to \$x/mo" line. What some of these companies do is hire anyone who comes in, milk the bottom tier until they leave, and promote up people who either pull deals out of thin air OR are really good at recruiting. The recruiter can probably make \$10k/mo by bringing in people to buy leads, like they did you. If some policies get written in the process, all the better. 3) If you know it's a Pyramid scheme, why even take the job? 4) Ask important questions during the interview, such as if the job is 1099 or W2. Where do the leads come from? What am I financially responsible for? Do you have any affiliations with major carriers? If it's 1099 and you're responsible for purchasing leads, do you have the freedom to purchase from where you'd like or are you restricted to those same old "approved provider" sources? My personal favorite thing to do is whenever I'm asked about a previous work story of any kind, I try to use something shady I've witnessed to get their reaction. My go to is a guy who took \$6k from an old woman who was still receiving notices from her recently passed son's tax debts. One phone call and a faxed death certificate fixed the whole problem, and this dude was proud of fleecing the old lady. If they get excited about that sort of mentality, don't go with them. Pursue agencies that balances sales volume with professional integrity, rather than closing as many deals as possible and hoping at least 50% make it to a yearly renewal, if that. 5) You will not find one industry that doesn't have cockroaches giving a bad name to the rest. My parents don't trust flooring installers they don't know personally, because they last time they hired someone to re-floor their kitchen and dining room, \$500 of jewelry mysteriously disappeared. 6) From my own experience, if you apply and get invited to an "informational meeting where we break down what we do and how before you decide to go to the next phase of the hiring process", view it as a massive red flag. Having a "short meeting to get to know each other and see if we can do business together" is fine, if not unconventional, but informational lectures as the first stage of hiring just screams "sketchy". Best of luck in whatever direction you'd go in, but I'd recommend maintaining your license and fulfilling your state requirements to keep it. Can always come in handy, no matter what you do. I let mine lapse after a rough gig and it's been a headache to get back now that I'm my current employer."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dt0fnh/why_i_left_the_life_insurance_industry/lc9vldd/

"Agree/not agree. MLM vibe? 100% yes. Manager/mentor...it depends. I work with an IMO as an independent. I have an Upline, those who started before me, have been at it longer, constantly provide training and mentorship and always lead from the front. I don't have a manager but I do have multiple mentors. However....In a case such as this I would have used a different phrase, something more like 'my senior agent/field underwriter/broker/etc'. And that is because mentorship is a personal relationship that can exist in a business context. When I ask one to step in to assist, to clients it is as my Sr Field Agent."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ihh3x2/is_this_normal_behavior_for_an_insurance_agent/mazkpv/

"🚩 American Income Life = Scam 🚩 I spent 6 months inside American Income Life, and if you're even thinking about working here, please hear me out: it's a trap. They lure you in with promises of six-figure income, freedom, luxury trips, and "helping families." What actually happens? You're bled dry from day one. You pay for your license, exam fees, Zoom account, computer—money, money, money out of your pocket. By the time you realize what's going on, you've already invested too much to walk away easily. The first week, they make you feel like you've accomplished something huge: passing the exam, starting your "career." But then you're thrown into terrible training and endless busywork—basically just making calls for your upline. When you finally get your own "opportunity," they hand you garbage leads that have been recycled a thousand times. People scream at you to stop calling, and you're forced to keep going. It's harassment, plain and simple. The schedule is insane: 12-hour days, almost no breaks, constant check-ins and micromanagement. When you finally catch someone, you drag them onto a Zoom call and read a script full of lies that you've been drilled on. Without even realizing it, you're tricking people into buying one of the worst insurance products out there. Meanwhile, you're broke, stressed, and exhausted. They parade "success stories" in front of you—agents claiming they were once in your shoes but now they're making six figures. Fake trips, fake recognition, fake promises. It's all smoke and mirrors. 🏹 If you're considering joining, or if you're already inside and thinking "I've put too much time and money in to quit now" — wake up. That's exactly how they keep you trapped. You're not building a business. You're being used. They're scamming new agents and clients alike. This place wrecks people's finances, mental health, and self-worth. It operates like a Ponzi scheme disguised as a career opportunity. To anyone on the fence: don't fall for it. Get out while you can. To the authorities: How is this still allowed to exist?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mh1vhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/nggbda7/

"New Agent Choosing an FMO vs. Going Direct – Advice Needed! Hello everyone, I'm a newly licensed agent in Virginia, and I'm currently in the process of choosing an FMO to work with. Right now, training and support are my biggest priorities—even more than commission splits—because I know that with excellent training, the money will follow. Primarily, I want to start off offering Medicare (with the hopes to offer my clients ACA & possibly Life at a much later date, after I gain an understanding of the industry, but only as supplements to their needs). It's my understanding that I could work for multiple FMOs, as one may not entirely fulfill my needs. 😊 I've been looking at Gordon Marketing, TR King Insurance Marketing, Ritter, and Redbird, but I've seen mixed feedback. Some people say Gordon Marketing gives off MLM vibes—does anyone here have experience with them? I've also seen advice about finding an upline and then letting them be your contact because going directly to an FMO will get you lost in their hierarchy without direct support and guidance. On the flip side, I came across a comment saying that going direct with carriers (rather than using an FMO) is a better route. I'd love to hear from anyone who's done this: Did you have prior experience before going direct? Do the carriers provide strong training & support, or would I be on my own? For those in Virginia, what are the most prevalent carriers I should consider contracting with? Also, I want to run my own agency and generate my own leads. I'm not looking for an FMO that requires me to buy leads from them or forces me into a specific system. I just want solid training. If, down the line, I decide to buy leads, I'd like the option, but I don't want to be locked into it. I want to set myself up for success long-term and avoid jumping around between FMOs. Any insights or personal experiences would be greatly appreciated! Thanks in advance!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ijykig/new_agent_choosing_an_fmo_vs_going_direct_advice/

↳ NAF1138 (4): "If you want your focus to be on Medicare, I would add, in order, 1) supplemental health (Hospital plans, Cancer plans, home health plans, dental plans.) All of your Medicare clients could likely use some or all of these. 2) Final Expense Life. Easy add on if you just look to fix problems with people's existing life insurance. 3) ACA but not to go after a large ACA book. So you can sell ACA to spouses and referrals. Mostly to grab them as future Medicare clients. 4) annuities. Lots of clients will have CDs, 401ks and other amounts of money that are essentially doing nothing for them. You probably can do number 1 after six months. 2 after 2 years. 3 a year after that. And 4 after you have been in the business for about 6 years. Go slow. Work intentionally. Build a long term business."

↳ NAF1138 (3): "If you want training and support you don't want to go direct. The carriers don't care about you and mostly don't know anything about selling insurance. They are not where you want to be trained. The only exception being the captive sales forces of certain carriers. You also, want to pick ONE of those things in your list. Do not come out the gate trying to sell Medicare, ACA, Annuities and Life. You will never learn to sell any of them that way. They are all different and sometimes conflicting sales processes. They can all easily keep you busy full time. You will essentially be doing 4 jobs full time badly. Of the FMOs you mentioned, TR King is actually run by a decent human who cares about his people. Ritter is good if you know what you are doing or are working with an agent who is running an agency under them, but doing direct to Ritter is the same as going direct to the carrier. Redbird, I don't know anyone who works their but they have a reasonably good reputation. I don't know Gordon Marketing at all. That doesn't mean anything though, no one knows everyone."

↳ voidsarcastic (3): "Like commission rates? Luckily they're all pretty close carrier to carrier so sell the best plan for the client every-time, and every client is different so different plans and carriers work better for different people. Pretty sure MAPD is the same rate for every carrier (315 renewal 650 IEP) however over-rides may be different and some offer HRA bonus. Most supplements are 20-23% annual (first year advance), and dental/HI is like 45-50% annual (first year advance). Be careful some MAPD plans are non-commissionable i do avoid those, but there really aren't many. I have however done no commission part Ds, you gotta do what you gotta do. Life commissions should be between 80%-115% (9 month- 12 month advance) starting out, if you're taking a lower comp from the FMO make sure you are getting lots of support."

"Worst of all they pay 25%... while NAA, FFL, SFG etc pay more than 3x that at like 80% or higher from day one!!! So they pay 25%, you sell \$100 a month policy that adds up \$1,200 a year or 1200 APV, you get \$300. The other 3 companies i mention you get 80% or \$960 !!!! The other companies want continuous growth so you buy leads, take out \$200-\$400 a deal for leads... now you have \$560 to \$760... When they pay you 25% most people quit after their warm market is destroyed and people avoid you at the BBQ BBQ's lol.... me I'd rather buy leads..."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sj0pc6/primerica_almost_got_me/ofq8axv/

"The culture is definitely going to depend on who you're uplines are and what agency you joined. Of course that's obviously going to be true for every IMO that exists personally I didn't have any issue with culture or any of the things op mentioned although I will say that there was a lot of focus on recruitment and I feel like that will probably be the same no matter what as symmetry has a heavy focus on recruiting. The leads are definitely junk. In my opinion that alone is the biggest reason not to join symmetry. Symmetry is not even an insurance agency they're a lead company that has a side hustle selling insurance. Even the \$50 fresh leads are a pile of junk that will give you no return on investment unless you're incredibly lucky."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtqo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/ms6l3wz/

"I don't want to sound harsh but the key to this business is having a lead budget. \$50/day equates to \$250/wk. I wouldn't recommend anyone get in this business if they don't have at least \$500/wk to work with. \$5/day wouldn't even buy one lead. How many people can you sell if you only have half of a lead? This industry is full of MLM companies that recruit vulnerable people and sell them on these grand ideas of making tons of money working from home. Because of this they recruit people with little to no money. You should not come in to this industry without a way to fund your business while you are getting your feet."

— YouTube · Generate UNLIMITED Final Expense Leads On Facebook In 2024 (Full Tutorial) · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aTFT03FiUCM&lc=UgywIms_i5HvirQshol4AaABAq_9opRFs4nUfr9xcb2V1gLIb

"I'm not a Globe Life hater or lover, but I will say this... Experiences WITHIN an IMO will vary person to person, brokerage to brokerage. It's very possible, you got in with someone who at least didn't show they cared or supported your success. I know a few people within Globe Life that are nice folks, genuinely, and love it. Admittedly, that's like 5% of what I hear about AIL/GL, but my point is is that one upline doesn't determine the culture all on their own. I hope you remain steadfast, vigilant, and open as you continue to find your "home." Best of luck."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mh1vhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/n6yvtwv/

"THIS IS THE WAY TO GO. I RETIRED AFTER BEING INDEPENDENT 10 YEARS. WORK HARD FOR TEN AND YOUR REAIDUALS WILL BE MONSTROUS. GLOBE LIFE IA A SCAM. .I HAD 15-20 COMPANIES TO SELL EVERYONE!!! NO WAY ANY SINGLE CARRIER COULD COMPETE WITH ME. ALSO, I HAD 140% COMMISSION RATES AND HIGHER. YES > I HAD TO PROVIDE MY OWN LEADS BUT THWY WERE MINE A D ONCE YOU SELL ONE, THEYRE LAJD FOR, I WOULD SELL 10, EASY"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1i1evot/ailglobe_life_scam_employees_were_suing/n6c7ooe/

"Yeah I'm Looking at IMO now and researching. I want nothing to do with MLM structure"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sj0pc6/primerica_almost_got_me/ofq9pv/

"With life and health, it's gonna be a few options. Now they'll be some places where you go more towards the Financial advisor side. Unfortunately, you're a couple months late for health. Everyone was hiring for the Annual enrollment period.. That's what I did for many years. I did get burned out and wanted to do more. But I did make Good money. Unfortunately, there are layoffs every year and every time I was up for promotion. There was a lay off, so I tried to go. Independent again myself. I may eventually go back to being independent one day, but I'm in the process of getting my series 7 and 66 while I get a base salary. It wasn't easy and it took four months of interviewing. After that, I plan on adding on with RICP and CFP. But that's because the company that I'm working for Will pay for it and try to grow with a W2 company. There are plenty of jobs. That will take a lot of work that pay well. I started as a W2, Medicare Agent, and made between 80 and 125,000 a year for the last six years. I wasn't doing that when I went. Independent, though, I had to spend so much money and the training, technology, Support just was so different. You gotta realize they are selling you. There's a few really good independent organizations out there, but it really depends on what you're good at and what you want. Most of them. Don't care because they get paid. Regardless. If you do nothing it doesn't matter to them. I hate MLM structure too so I stay away from those places. How have you spoken to over 50 different places and they all sound amazing, but a few actually follow through."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wlnr8v/pulling_my_hair_out/pb0iw84/

"I have been looking for a new job in the Tampa area... Health insurance sales was something I heavily considered, until for a week straight I had interview after interview with these scam feeling MLM companies. It totally disuaded me from joining the industry even though I feel I have the skills and mindset in order to succeed. this post is extremely validating and I also hate how half the job leads in this city seem to have something to do with US Health Advisors. TY OP"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k7b2kb/how_are_people_still_getting_sucked_into_mlms/mq54394/

"Because they suck! They work like and MLM and they are going to make buy leads that are bonk. I tried FFL when I first started and I got scammed by Brandon Seda he was my "upline" buying his shitty leads which were all ages. I spent close to \$3000 on his leads and only ONE client stuck. You don't need FFL they are going to want to appoint you work Mutual of Omaha and ethos's and you can appoint with those carriers directly you don't need FFL."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1w3rery/life_insurance_agents_what_companies_would_you/p7erwbo/

CMS rules and commission caps · 26 documents · 20 voices

"AMA - Never selling insurance to 85k monthly commissions starting my own agency **AMA: Nine months ago I'd never sold a policy. Today my ACA book does about \$85k/month with a \$34 CPA and ~3% loss. Here's what I wish I'd researched before spending money. Quick context** * Licensed end of Oct '24, started selling Jan '25 * Put **\$100k** in over the year * I buy **live inbound callers only** (no cold lists) **How I handle calls (this mattered most)** * Calls only route to me when I'm not already on the phone, so I don't miss people * If I miss a customer service call, I call back the same day—no exceptions * Clients get a real number that reaches me—my personal cell, 24/7. Hard work, but it built trust and referrals **What to research before you spend \$1** * Refund policy in writing: what counts as a bad call, how returns work, when credits land * Answer/contact rates by hour and source (real stats, not guesses) * County/ZIP targeting that matches ACA networks I can actually place * Consent/compliance language used before the call reaches me * Delivery control so I can cap/pause and touch every caller the same day **Money I wasted** * "Cheap" calls with vague or slow refunds * Buying volume before the intake script and follow-up rhythm were dialed in * Fancy software I didn't use every day **Money that paid off** * Speed + clarity: short script, quick verify, clear next step, same-day follow-up * Call recording + quick QC: 10 minutes a day fixed leaks I couldn't see in a spreadsheet * Knowing ACA cold: networks, formularies, prior auth, renewal quirks—explained in plain English (be the expert and put people at ease) **My lead-vendor checklist now** 1. Refund/credit rules and SLA (in writing) 2. Sample ads so I know there's no fake incentivizing 3. State targeting and delivery hours 4. I can throttle/stop calls instantly **Process that moved the needle** * 3 steps: verify basics → solve the real problem → set a specific next time/action * 1–2 plan options max, with reasons (menus slow everything down) * Same-day everything, or conversion drops * Post-enrollment customer care (ID cards, network checks, "what now?") drives referrals and keeps churn low (~3%) **Simple weekly scoreboard** * Reached calls / total calls * Kept appointments * Submits * Time to first touch * Service issues per member * Refund rate / turnaround * CPA (~\$34) and trend **If I had to start over (I could do it much cheaper—\$10–20k)** * Spend the first 2–3 weeks on scripts, routing, notes template, and a manual follow-up schedule * Trial multiple **live-call** vendors in tiny batches; only scale the one that proves contactability **and** refunds * Keep the tech boring: I run everything in Excel and Google Calendar * Give clients a real number and show up—that's what makes referrals happen That's my playbook and the lessons. AMA about the research, spend, setup, or what I'd cut or double down on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 62 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/

↳ Samwill226 (38): "24/7 cell is going to be your downfall."

↳ Samwill226 (10): "You know what huge risk it really opens up? E&O. I've been in this a long time. I can't tell you how many E&O claims come from cell phone communications. It's a HUGE vulnerability"

↳ Samwill226 (8): "It really is a huge hole for a claim. I have clients find me on social media and send me a message on a Saturday night about a change or coverage question I won't even look at it or respond. You gotta protect yourself on your personal time because they'll throw you under the bus quick! "I called and told him....""

"I have been in this industry for 14 years and it has become a shell of it's former self. Let me explain. In 2009 is when CMS enacted over 100 new regulations in the Medicare industry. New regulations included annual enrollment periods, government regulated commissions for Part C and D, a Scope of Appointment form that must be completed prior to an agent's presentation, annual AHIP certifications to be able to sell policies in addition to annual carrier certifications, soon after new legislation that required MA plans to have to have a network which killed PFFS plans which were the most popular MA plans at that time, laws which forbids agents to market Part C and D products, laws which govern every aspect of agents holding seminars even including not allowing agents to offer free meals for attendees, the inability to call referrals (the referral must contact you), regulations on carriers that made it illegal for carriers to offer bonuses and trips to agents for production rewards, and many more that I can't think of off the top of my head. After these draconian regulations were passed most agents left the industry. The only ones that stayed were the agents that had a solid book of business prior to these new regulations which is why the average age of a Medicare agent is 60 years old. This industry's golden age was from 1998 to 2008. Medicare Advantage was a brand new concept as well a few years later Part D was brand new as well. There were plenty of reasons why seniors needed to talk with an agent during this time and the big money was made at this time. That all changed in 2009. CMS used the excuse that since agents were getting compensated with taxpayer money (Medicare funding Dollars) that CMS had the right to regulated everything about the agent's existence in this industry. In 2020, very little has changed under the Trump administration. The only good thing to be improved upon was CMS not requiring the Scope of Appointment form to be filled out 48 hours prior to an agent's presentation and changed it to the same day as the appointment. Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as well for fear that the carrier will get in trouble with CMS and lose funding for their plans. Part D plans pay almost nothing for the sheer amount of work that needs to be done reviewing your client's drug list every year that you are almost working for free. MAPD plans pay the same commission as MA only plans. Now if you understand inflation this is another issue as well. The US Dollar loses 2%-3% of it's value every year which causes prices to increase, but you get paid renewals based upon commission rates from the first year you write the business. So while you do make renewals, those renewals become less and less every year. Now that MA plans have ironed out their networks and funding is stabilized, there is little need for seniors to switch Medicare plans every year because they already are in the best plan possible. You can go after T65 business, but that has also become problematic as well. Since Social Security has raised the full benefit retirement age from 65 to 67, most seniors are still working for an employer at 65 and have no need for Medicare coverage until they retire, especially since many spouses are not yet on Medicare and their spouse needs the group coverage. The (un)Affordable Care Act aka Obamacare is terrible and has made major medical coverage too expensive and too restrictive. After 14 years in the industry I have finally realized all that is bad and the bad FAR out weighs the good. The commissions are too small for an agent to make it especially with so few seniors actually needing a better plan plus with everything I previously mentioned you need to be insane to become a Medicare agent in 2020. If you do start off in this industry you need at LEAST 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months of marketing expenses saved or you will run out of money very quick and need to find an hourly job. You must write 100 policies every year to make it in this industry and you will max out at 400 to 500 clients because any more clients and you will have to hire help. So at \$250 commission per client earned every year you are looking at a max of \$100,000 to \$125,000 minus your marketing expenses which will cost you between \$12,000 to \$20,000 per year plus all the gas consumption and wear and tear on your vehicle driving all over town on appointments, double taxes you pay for FICA, Medicare and Social Security taxes, and lack of access yourself to affordable health insurance by not having access to group health policies. Covid-19 is a new hurdle agents must overcome and adds a dozens new challenges because of CMS regulations. The Medicare industry just isn't worth it anymore."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAg>

↳ @fleridalara888 (4): "@Seniorbenes everything he's saying is scary. I am interested in this business but I am new and don't have the capital even for leads rinow"

↳ @Seniorbenes (3): "@michaelhuebner6843 Michael Thanks for your response ,factually It is just me I am not an agency, I just did some pre-planning before getting into the business and some due diligence. I listened to the successful agents and worked my but of because I did not want to be part of the failure statistics. If you plan, execute, assess, and repeat it comes together before you know it. The secret is 12 hour days kkkkk"

↳ @michaelhuebner6843 (2): "@Seniorbenes Well you are running an agency and that is not feasible for most new agents because they lack the capitol to start on a large scale like that. Yes if you scale to the point you are doing then it can work, but your investment is huge when this industry has 90% of new agents failing in the first 2 years. My description is what an average independent agent will perform. Nick from Medicare Millionaire is an independent agent and works by himself. He is a seasoned agent and very good at selling yet he only sold 127 policies in 2018 and he does this full time and employs his own telemarketer for \$3 per hour and uses direct mail leads. I was an assistant office manager for a Medicare brokerage firm for 9 years and out of 10 agents that our office had we only had 2 top producers and they each had about 1,500 clients. They serviced all of their clients and they were extremely stressed out all the time especially during AEP when MA plans became discontinued and they needed to review plan changes every year for their large client base. The average agent had about 500 clients. You need to provide customer service for your clients if you want to keep them long term and the sheer amount of work required to service MA plans simply isn't worth it. 95% of the calls we got at our agency was people having questions about their co-pays, the network, prescription drug co-pays, Part D late enrollment penalties, prescription drug issues, and how their plan worked. You spent all your time servicing MA and Part D clients and this is why you can't have more than 500 clients on your own before you are forced to hire help. Having 2,000 clients yourself means you aren't providing service to them when they have issues or you are just selling Medigap. Sorry to say but 70% of seniors on Medicare nationwide have Medicare Advantage. You and I both know how hard it is to market Part C and D plans selling over the phone as CMS makes this almost impossible. You need a partnership with a carrier to pull that off on a large scale and be successful which makes you captive to that carrier. I am in this industry to help seniors, not to help some corporate insurance carrier gain market share. CMS doesn't allow you to market Part C or Part D on social media, you need to read your AHIP test again my dude."

"Just giving an update. I followed your video and my ad has been up and running. So far I've generated 2 leads going on 48 hours set at 50.00 daily."

— YouTube · Generate UNLIMITED Final Expense Leads On Facebook In 2024 (Full Tutorial) · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aTFT03FiUCM&lc=UgzHGMVmxVflzSg01N4AaABAg>

↳ @phylliskalu3442 (3): "I only recommend doing this if you have multiple states. I only have one state didn't generate enough leads."

↳ @amillionairerise (2): "@phylliskalu3442 what about the quality of leads?"

↳ @matthewjanssenAutoSavvy (0): "What state?@phylliskalu3442"

"In the original deal they also made ALL PLANS comissionable. The hold on the final rule burnt agents drastically as some carriers cut commissions mid AEP. Right in the middle of AEP, the carrier sent out an email less than 24hrs on Oct 31 and told us the plans would be non-commissionable as of Nov 1st. Not only can these companies make plans non-commissionable all year they can cut commissions on a plan whenever they want."

— YouTube · The Reality of A Career in Medicare Insurance Sales in 2025 · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Nwa60sSWldo&lc=UgxdalukEsc_mbiYbGR4AaABAg

"You can actually call CMS directly (email is better) and they actually can give real answers that are detailed. Its how i learned the ACA part so much, and also how i do so well. Rather than assume, its better to ask. CMS is cracking down on ACA a lot, with some new things like the whole recording needing to be sent and no longer the snippet for compliance (a LOT of agencies were doing this)."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1b6ebes/i_work_for_an_nmo_ask_me_anything/ktew87g/

"Almost a Decade in Group Medicare and I'm Not Sure Where to Go From Here I've been in Group Medicare for about 9 years, 2 as a Proposal Manager and 7 as a Proposal Director in New Business. While my title says "Proposals," the scope of what I actually do is much broader than that. Every bid that comes through the company goes through me. I'm analyzing incoming quotes, pulling claims data and backing into a PMPM, deciding on bid strategy, mapping census data to plan designs, analyzing group demographics like average age to anticipate how a group will be rated, and weighing plan design decisions including coordination of benefits. I stay on top of CMS regulations and make sure we understand how government rule changes impact our pricing and strategy. I develop the talking points and pitches, review who we're selling to, and tailor the strategy to each group. I present and walk through every bid with sales, my team, and C-suite leadership. On top of all that I keep the team aligned on documentation standards and maintain positive carrier relationships. I manage a team of 3 and sit at the Director level. Recently I've noticed that as the company grows, every promotion opportunity above my level is going to external hires. When I've raised it, the explanation has been that bringing in outside talent "signals legitimacy to the market." I understand the optics argument but it's left me feeling like there's no real path forward internally. From a compensation standpoint I feel like I've hit a ceiling. My total comp comes in around \$151K inclusive of a bonus up to \$20K, and we're moving to a flat annual pay scale of 1-4%. With that structure I don't see a meaningful path to grow my income here. On top of that, as the company expands into new products I can see myself getting siloed, just running Group Medicare analysis on every bid that comes in while the broader growth happens around me. I'm worried about becoming a cog at a fixed salary with no real upside. The world is asked of me and I have nothing to show for it except a growing company. So I'm genuinely asking, what's the move here? A few things I've been thinking about: 1. Should I be looking at pursuing actuarial credentials? I'm 38 with no formal actuarial background, just the exams ahead of me and my institutional knowledge from years of doing this work. By the time I'd be fully credentialed I'd be pushing 48. Is that a realistic path or am I too far in to start that climb? 2. Sales is the other obvious lever but I've never sold directly. I've always been the person behind the curtain, building the pitch, crafting the strategy, analyzing who we're selling to and why. To make that move I'd almost certainly have to leave my current company. Is that a realistic pivot? 3. Is there something else entirely I'm not seeing? For those who have been in a similar spot, deep domain expertise, doing the work of multiple functions, but feeling stuck with no clear internal path, what actually moved the needle for you?"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1sm953b/almost_a_decade_in_group_medicare_and_im_not_sure/

↳ Ok-Secret8873 (3): "Was doing P&C as an UW. Found this small company, joined, they had no one analyzing the claims, censuses, and plan designs as well as not having a proper documentation system. I told them what we did at my last company. I got put in charge of the unit, and here I am. I stumbled into this job as I was slated to be an UW a Life Ins company, but the CEO made me an offer and I accepted."

↳ Ok-Secret8873 (2): "Ya that's what my family has said. Was told I was underpaid and it maybe time to look for greener pastures."

↳ No_Buy_3201 (2): "How did you get into that gig? I kind of want to do what you do now, but it's hard to break in without those credentials or real world experience. I actually just had an interview along those lines. I'm currently an EB broker"

"I don't know anyone that actually waits 48 hours"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1g3w4zk/how_to_handle_prospect_call_before_scope_of/1s1cxd/

"The new rules dropped yesterday and I am copying the most interesting paragraphs below. Here is my admittedly optimistic reading of this rule. 1. Agents will get a \$100 increase in both MAPD and PDP commissions and CMS is anticipating adding an additional 2.5% on top of that. Commissions will be raised to \$726 for MAPD for most states, and PDP's will have a massive increase to \$200. 2. The new rule specifically states: This proposal, and all agent broker compensation rules at §422.2274(d) are limited to independent agents and brokers, and do not extend to TMPOs more generally. I am curious, is anyone as optimistic as me about the new rules? We do not get volume based enrollment bonuses from our NMA or the carriers and I have many levels under my FMO (SGA's, MGA's, GA's) I don't think this rule applies to overrides paid to them. I believe the rule is targeting HRA fee's and other administrative fee's such as some carriers paying you to get a clients email address, or paying a bonus if you select a PCP on an app. It also seems to be targeting "per app marketing money" that some carriers are paying outside of the override structure. I hope this is true. Read it and let me know what you think: We believe that increasing the FMV rate for new enrollments by a total of \$100, and therefore applied to renewals at a maximum amount of 50 percent of the total compensation amount, should provide agents and brokers with sufficient funds to continue to access necessary administrative tools and trainings, to offset appointment fees and encourage the representation of multiple plans, and therefore to continue providing adequate service to Medicare beneficiaries. Accordingly, based on the information provided in comments and for the reasons discussed in this final rule, we are finalizing a policy to make a one-time \$100 increase to the FMV compensation rate for agents and brokers for initial enrollments into MA plans for the 2025 plan contract year. TABLE FC-1: AGENT BROKER COMPENSATION UPDATES CY 2024–2026 2024 2025 2026 Initial Enrollment \$611 (FMV TBD) + \$100 FMV TBD Renewal \$305 (FMV TBD +100)*0.5 FMV TBD*0.5 By way of example, if we were to assume that the FMV increase in years 2025 and 2026 is 2.5 percent, the payment rates for those years would be as follows: TABLE FC-2: EXAMPLE AGENT BROKER COMPENSATION UPDATES CY 2024-2026 2024 2025 2026 Initial Enrollment \$611 \$726 \$744 Renewal \$305 \$313 \$372 Comment: Several comments expressed confusion about whether this payment is an "all in cap" that is intended to include all fees paid by an MA organization to an agent, broker, or other TPMO, and what that would mean for payments related to marketing activities. Response: This proposal, and all agent broker compensation rules at §422.2274(d) are limited to independent agents and brokers, and do not extend to TMPOs more generally. Therefore, this policy represents a limitation on payments in excess of those paid under "compensation" only for commissions paid for enrollments to independent agents and brokers. Though we are continuing to consider future rulemaking in this space, our current policy does not extend to placing limitations on payments from an MAO to a TPMO who is not an independent agent or broker for activities that are not undertaken as part of an enrollment by an independent agent or broker."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Is the New 2025 CMS Rule for Agent compensation actually GREAT news for AGENTS and FMOs? · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/is-the-new-2025-cms-rule-for-agent-compensation-actually-great-news-for-agents-and-fmos.112929/#post-1487879>

"The leads are virtually all the same and, for all intents and purposes, priced relevant to the quality. I have used: Smart Financial, TTC, Caboom, LeadCenter, All Web Leads, and even Everquote. Everquote was actually the best for the money however, they stopped doing life leads the first of the year due to the proposed rule changes that did not ever happen. The leads are getting worse and, it's all about the blocking features on the phone's. The industry is trying to mask this problem however, it's a big one! Moreover, the people that don't have their phones currently blocked from unknown calls, will soon be because there are so many more apps out there that they will eventually get sick of all the calls and we'll figure out how to get their phones blocked like all their friends and family are doing. Anybody who tries to refute this statement is either blatantly lying, or just that naive. Facts are facts! And the saddest thing is, the cost of the leads have not come down in price. Go ahead keep purchasing leads because it's nothing more than being on a hamster wheel. You make about enough sales that stick to cover the bills and that's about it. People can brag all they want about all these big numbers that they are doing but believe me, they're getting a shitload of chargebacks. And of course, that doesn't get mentioned!..... I am far from the best salesperson on the planet however, what I do write, sticks! Purchasing leads is a dying art. Anybody who disagrees with me now, fast forward 6 months or a year and then cast your opinion! 8% success rate in industry is always going to be 8% or less. That means 92% of everybody fails. Unless you got deep pockets and get with somebody who's going to hand feed you, you ain't making it! But no matter what, those numbers are never going to increase! Yeah nobody likes negative Nancy, but the truth is the truth. It would be nice to see more of that being spoken in the industry instead of all the smoke and mirrors..... Nothing against this channel as it actually isn't bad. That doesn't change the numbers however.... They got the coolest intro and exit song in the industry!"

— YouTube · Selling Life Insurance: The Best Leads Ep209 · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9ySCCpwyx-U&lc=Ugw-jye2CDWiTt5MKoN4AaABAg_AINLhc1HzrAJ-dgMOEzAM

"MedicareMillionair said: What I'm saying is that our agents are 100% compliant. We have been vetted by CMS. I typically don't use random videos to make decisions, instead CMS guidelines. Yes changes will come to this platform, but our system is proven compliant. We hear the talk and we see the nonsense posted online. Then we go to CMS and get the facts. Fair enough, so post the facts (from CMS) are SSN now required to sign someone up?"

— Insurance-Forums.com · ACA - NoCall Leads Compliance · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/aca-nocall-leads-compliance.110703/#post-1455771>

"Former w -2 medi agent myself, after 6 years I couldn't take it anymore. I got out just in time of seems. Food card benefits dried up, csnp rule changes, lis enrollment change, lots more non commissionable plans. The constant rat race during aep with clients being switched to crap plans by promising stuff that is not even possible etc etc. P & C is the way, come to the dark side lol"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1shv3xs/best_company_to_join_for_agents_new_to_medicare/ofj0xoo/

"You're absolutely correct. In this particular case Brandon was visiting active FE clients. Lots of compliance issues to understand and avoid, we don't teach shortcuts. Without getting into details, our system has been vetted and approved by all the major carriers. We also have in house compliance officers as well as legal to keep us abreast of rule changes."

— Insurance-Forums.com · My Medicare Advantage Experience Thus Far... · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/my-medicare-advantage-experience-thus-far.93168/#post-1232170>

"I agree with you! It's been so much harder. It's nice to see CMS loosen up some of the rules for 2027 but 6 years ago, i was making a lot more money. I am burned out."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1shv3xs/best_company_to_join_for_agents_new_to_medicare/og362z2/

"This is really helpful, I had been looking into call recording functionality for the VOIP im going to use, thank you"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vgg93g/questions_on_lead_vendors_for_life_insurance/p2dwohl/

"Not only did they just crush the STM market, but they will also attempt to steal your T65 medicare clients. Oooops.....they were never your client anyways. FACT SHEET FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE June 8, 2016 Contact: CMS Media Relations (202) 690-6145 | CMS Media Inquiries Strengthening the Marketplace – Actions to Improve the Risk Pool With millions of Americans insured through the Health Insurance Marketplaces, it's clear that Marketplace coverage is a product consumers want and need and an important business for insurers, with several major issuers expanding their Marketplace presence. At the Department of Health and Human Services (HHS), we are constantly monitoring the health of the Marketplace and are always looking to make improvements that benefit both consumers and issuers. Over the past several months, HHS has taken a series of actions to strengthen the Marketplace risk pool, limit upward pressure on rates, and ensure a strong Marketplace for the long term. We believe those actions are bringing positive results. As part of our continued commitment to the long-term strength of the Marketplace, we are announcing new measures to ensure that the Marketplace continues to provide affordable coverage for millions of Americans. During the month of June, HHS will make three announcements regarding our ongoing efforts to: strengthen the risk pool by spreading the costs of care over a diverse mix of enrollees, work with issuers and state Departments of Insurance to improve coverage options, and step up Marketplace outreach, especially to young adults and uninsured families in advance of Open Enrollment 4. Today, HHS is announcing a series of actions to strengthen the Marketplace risk pool. These actions include: · Curbing abuses of short-term plans that exploit gaps in current rules to use medical underwriting to keep some of the healthiest consumers out of the Affordable Care Act's single risk pool. · Improving the risk adjustment program to more accurately reflect the cost of partial-year enrollees and to incorporate prescription drug utilization data that provide a more complete picture of enrollees' health status. These improvements will ensure that the program continues to work as intended to compensate issuers with higher-risk enrollees and thereby help issuers sustainably serve all types of consumers. · Helping consumers who turn 65 make the transition to Medicare, so that older consumers are served by the program designed for them and their health needs. · Beginning full implementation of the Special Enrollment Confirmation Process, which ensures that eligible individuals continue to have access to coverage through Special Enrollment Periods (SEPs), but prevents people from misusing the system to enroll in coverage only if they get sick. · Continuing our efforts to reduce data-matching issues (DMIs). CMS outreach, education, and operational improvements have contributed to a sharp reduction in total data matching issues generated and an almost 40 percent year-over-year increase in documents submitted to help resolve income and citizenship and immigration data matching issues. Improving the resolution of DMIs benefits the risk pool because it keeps eligible consumers, often younger and healthier consumers less motivated to overcome obstacles such as extra paperwork, from losing coverage mid-year. Risk Pool Actions Curbing Abuse of Short-Term Limited Duration Plans Short-term limited duration coverage is health care coverage issued for a short period of time. Because short-term limited duration plans are designed to fill only very short coverage gaps, this coverage is not subject to any of the key rules governing the ACA's single risk pool: they can be priced based on health status (medically underwritten), can discriminate against consumers with pre-existing conditions, and do not have to cover essential health benefits. Some issuers are now offering short-term limited duration plans to consumers as their primary form of health coverage for periods that last nearly 12 months, allowing them to target only the healthiest consumers while avoiding consumer protections. As highlighted in recent press accounts, by keeping these consumers out of the ACA single risk pool, such abuses of limited duration coverage increase costs for everyone else, and they could have a greater impact over time if allowed to become more widespread. Today, the Department of Labor, Department of Treasury, and Department of Health and Human Services (HHS) issued a proposed rule to revise the definition of short-term, limited duration coverage. Under the new rules, short-term policies may be offered only for less than three months, and coverage cannot be renewed at the end of the three month period. The proposed rule also improves transparency for consumers by requiring issuers to provide notice to consumers that the coverage is not minimum essential coverage, does not satisfy the health coverage requirement of the ACA, and will not prevent the consumer from owing a tax penalty. The proposed changes will help strengthen the risk pool by ensuring that short term limited duration plans are used only as intended, to fill truly temporary gaps in coverage. Maturing the Risk Adjustment Program By reducing incentives for issuers to try to design products that attract a disproportionately healthy risk pool, risk adjustment lets them design products that meet the needs of all consumers, protecting consumers' access to a range of robust options. Updating risk adjustment to more accurately assess every enrollee's risk makes it more effective in achieving this goal. Earlier this year, CMS made a number of changes to improve the stability, predictability, and accuracy of the risk adjustment program for issuers. These changes include better modeling of costs for preventive services, changes to the data update schedule, and earlier reporting of preliminary risk adjustment data where available. We also published a Risk Adjustment White Paper and hosted a conference on March 31, 2016 to solicit feedback from issuers, consumers, and other stakeholders on additional areas for improvement. Building off the Risk Adjustment White Paper and stakeholder feedback, today we are announcing two additional important changes to risk adjustment that we intend to propose in future rulemaking. First, we intend to propose that, beginning for the 2017 benefit year, the risk adjustment model include an adjustment factor for partial-year enrollees. By more accurately accounting for the costs of short term enrollees in ACA-compliant risk pool, this change will support the Marketplace's important role as a source of coverage for people who are between jobs, experiencing life transitions, or otherwise need coverage for part of the year. Second, we intend to propose that, beginning for the 2018 benefit year, prescription drug utilization data be incorporated in risk adjustment, as a source of information about individuals' health status and the severity of their conditions. We are also considering proposing additional changes to the model for 2018 and beyond. Transitioning Consumers to Medicare The Marketplace serves as an essential backstop for consumers as they transition between different types of coverage over their lifetime. For example, many early retirees access Marketplace coverage until they become eligible for Medicare when they turn 65. But once individuals turn 65, most people should end their Marketplace coverage and switch to Medicare. In fact, if consumers do not enroll in Medicare Part B when they turn 65, they could face financial consequences for years into the future, because they could owe higher Medicare premiums. Meanwhile, the Marketplace is intended to serve consumers who are not Medicare eligible, and continued enrollment by individuals who are eligible for Medicare can raise costs for other consumers. To make sure consumers understand the steps they need to take to move to Medicare, this summer the Marketplace will start contacting enrollees as they near their 65th birthday. This outreach will provide consumers with the information they need to enroll in Medicare if they are eligible and end their Marketplace coverage if they choose to. This builds off the changes we made to the HealthCare.gov application this year which included new pop ups with reminders for consumers who are about to turn 65 that they may be eligible for Medicare. Implementing the Special Enrollment Confirmation Process Over the last several months, the Marketplace has taken a number of steps to ensure that Special Enrollment Periods (SEPs) are there for consumers when they need them while avoiding misuse or abuse. We've strengthened our rules and clarified our processes for SEPs, so that the people who need to can still easily get coverage, while making it hard for anyone thinking about taking advantage. We also eliminated 7 SEPs, including the SEP for individuals who paid the tax p"

— Insurance-Forums.com · CMS: STM Limited to 3 Months - No Renewal Allowed · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/cms-stm-limited-to-3-months-no-renewal-allowed.82709/#post-1106530>

"FMOadvisor said: The new rules dropped yesterday and I am copying the most interesting paragraphs below. Here is my admittedly optimistic reading of this rule. 1. Agents will get a \$100 increase in both MAPD and PDP commissions and CMS is anticipating adding an additional 2.5% on top of that. Commissions will be raised to \$726 for MAPD for most states, and PDP's will have a massive increase to \$200. 2. The new rule specifically states: This proposal, and all agent broker compensation rules at §422.2274(d) are limited to independent agents and brokers, and do not extend to TMPOs more generally. I am curious, is anyone as optimistic as me about the new rules? We do not get volume based enrollment bonuses from our NMA or the carriers and I have many levels under my FMO (SGA's, MGA's, GA's) I don't think this rule applies to overrides paid to them. I believe the rule is targeting HRA fee's and other administrative fee's such as some carriers paying you to get a clients email address, or paying a bonus if you select a PCP on an app. It also seems to be targeting "per app marketing money" that some carriers are paying outside of the override structure. I hope this is true. Read it and let me know what you think: We believe that increasing the FMV rate for new enrollments by a total of \$100, and therefore applied to renewals at a maximum amount of 50 percent of the total compensation amount, should provide agents and brokers with sufficient funds to continue to access necessary administrative tools and trainings, to offset appointment fees and encourage the representation of multiple plans, and therefore to continue providing adequate service to Medicare beneficiaries. Accordingly, based on the information provided in comments and for the reasons discussed in this final rule, we are finalizing a policy to make a one-time \$100 increase to the FMV compensation rate for agents and brokers for initial enrollments into MA plans for the 2025 plan contract year. TABLE FC-1: AGENT BROKER COMPENSATION UPDATES CY 2024–2026 2024 2025 2026 Initial Enrollment \$611 (FMV TBD) + \$100 FMV TBD Renewal \$305 (FMV TBD +100)*0.5 FMV TBD*0.5 By way of example, if we were to assume that the FMV increase in years 2025 and 2026 is 2.5 percent, the payment rates for those years would be as follows: TABLE FC-2: EXAMPLE AGENT BROKER COMPENSATION UPDATES CY 2024-2026 2024 2025 2026 Initial Enrollment \$611 \$726 \$744 Renewal \$305 \$313 \$372 Comment: Several comments expressed confusion about whether this payment is an "all in cap" that is intended to include all fees paid by an MA organization to an agent, broker, or other TPMO, and what that would mean for payments related to marketing activities. Response: This proposal, and all agent broker compensation rules at §422.2274(d) are limited to independent agents and brokers, and do not extend to TMPOs more generally. Therefore, this policy represents a limitation on payments in excess of those paid under "compensation" only for commissions paid for enrollments to independent agents and brokers. Though we are continuing to consider future rulemaking in this space, our current policy does not extend to placing limitations on payments from an MAO to a TPMO who is not an independent agent or broker for activities that are not undertaken as part of an enrollment by an independent agent or broker. Click to expand... Ask yourself a question . Do you really believe cms would have gone to all this trouble to give \$100 raise to agents and take away there marketing money and leave the fmo unscathed ? Lol . The fmo could give 2 damms about marketing money as most of that was paid by carriers . There could be some money structured for the top line fmo's for tasks such as licensing, training , software etc . But the Ga, mga , sga will 100% not get overrides on agents . Cms specifically has mentioned the \$1300 total comp for a mapd enrollment. They want to stem the flow of money . No matter how anyone chops this up much less total comp is out there for fmo's"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Is the New 2025 CMS Rule for Agent compensation actually GREAT news for AGENTS and FMOs? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/is-the-new-2025-cms-rule-for-agent-compensation-actually-great-news-for-agents-and-fmos.112929/#post-1487882>

"GNSBRG said: Maybe I've been in the insurance business too long, but it seems to me that prospects should call you to let you know they are interested in what you have to offer. They call for everything else, so why should insurance be any different? The cable company sends me a postcard advertising rates and an 800 number. The clothing store sends me a catalogue and an 800 number. If my car needs repair I call a mechanic. Globe Insurance and all those other TV ads you see have an 800 number at the end of their pitch. Last year I developed a postcard system to keep in touch with prospects in a different business I have. I decided against email because everybody uses email and you know how that goes. I didnt want to call them every month and I wanted to keep my costs down, my message short, and be able to change it at my whim. For the last 2 months I have been selling MA's through a direct mail lead program, and found that most seniors are not online, so sending them to a website is silly. I have developed a unique postcard for Final Expense that I have attached. Prospects call the number listed for pricing info. Through an online mailhouse you can send out as few or as many as you want, to any list you provide. They are printed, inkjetted with the address and sent out within 48 hours. Most Final Expense direct mail pieces all look the same. This one cuts to the chase.....most seniors don't want to burden their family with final expenses. So that's the question they are asked in the headline. Take a look. If interested in trying this out, I will customize it with your 800 number and setup the mailing to any list you provide. I can also provide a conversational script you can use which is basically one you would use in the house as well. I don't know what the response rate will be; I assume it will be around 1-1.5%. Maybe more, maybe less. Click to expand... How do I get the prospects to call me if I don't have the money to mail the Postcards?? What would be the best way in your opinion?? Thanks"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Prospects Should Call You · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/prospects-should-call-you.17287/#post-217745>

"Maybe I've been in the insurance business too long, but it seems to me that prospects should call you to let you know they are interested in what you have to offer. They call for everything else, so why should insurance be any different? The cable company sends me a postcard advertising rates and an 800 number. The clothing store sends me a catalogue and an 800 number. If my car needs repair I call a mechanic. Globe Insurance and all those other TV ads you see have an 800 number at the end of their pitch. Last year I developed a postcard system to keep in touch with prospects in a different business I have. I decided against email because everybody uses email and you know how that goes. I didnt want to call them every month and I wanted to keep my costs down, my message short, and be able to change it at my whim. For the last 2 months I have been selling MA's through a direct mail lead program, and found that most seniors are not online, so sending them to a website is silly. I have developed a unique postcard for Final Expense that I have attached. Prospects call the number listed for pricing info. Through an online mailhouse you can send out as few or as many as you want, to any list you provide. They are printed, inkjetted with the address and sent out within 48 hours. Most Final Expense direct mail pieces all look the same. This one cuts to the chase.....most seniors don't want to burden their family with final expenses. So that's the question they are asked in the headline. Take a look. If interested in trying this out, I will customize it with your 800 number and setup the mailing to any list you provide. I can also provide a conversational script you can use which is basically one you would use in the house as well. I don't know what the response rate will be; I assume it will be around 1-1.5%. Maybe more, maybe less."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Prospects Should Call You · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/prospects-should-call-you.17287/#post-217737>

"CMS has seen an increase in beneficiary complaints associated with third-party marketing organizations (TPMOs) and has received feedback from beneficiary advocates and stakeholders concerned about the marketing practices of TPMOs who sell multiple MA and Part D products. In 2020, we received a total of 15,497 complaints related to marketing. In 2021, excluding December, the total was 39,617. We are unable to say that every one of the complaints is a result of TPMO marketing activities, but based on a targeted search, we do know that many are related to TPMO marketing. In addition, we have seen an increase in third party print and television ads, which appears to be corroborated by State partners. Through this final rule, we will address the concerns with TPMOs by means of the following three updates to the communications and marketing requirements under 42 CFR parts 422 and 423, subpart V: (1) We define TPMOs in the regulation at §§ 422.2260 and 423.2260 to remove any ambiguity associated with MA plans/Part D sponsors responsibilities for TPMO activities associated with the selling of MA and Part D plans; (2) we add a new disclaimer that will be required when TPMOs market MA plans/Part D products (§§ 422.2267(e) and 423.2267(e)); and (3) we update §§ 422.2274 and 423.2274 to require additional plan oversight requirements associated with TPMOs, in addition to what is already required under §§ 422.504(i) and 423.505(i) if the TPMO is a first tier, downstream or related entity (FDR). ----- Pretty mind blowing the YOY increase in complaints to Medicare. But honestly surprised there weren't more complaints"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Suprised nobody's talking about the huge MAPD marketing rules handed down by CMS · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/thread/s/suprised-nobody%E2%80%99s-talking-about-the-huge-mapd-marketing-rules-handed-down-by-cms.108507/#post-1422047>

"My Blue Cross clients in Cook County are very angry! If they're subsidized, the presence of the dirt cheap Celtic-Ambetter HMO plans is causing their ATPC-subsidy \$\$\$ amount to actually DECREASE on 1/1/2016. I just spoke with a 62 year old Cook County client (60611). Her Blue Choice PPO plan is increasing by 45% and the subsidy decreasing by 11%. Net result is that her actual out-of-pocket increase in premium is a huge 56%! If they're not subsidized, they have to endure the entire 45% premium increase that will kick in on 1/1/2016. Or, change to Ambetter-Celtic and pray for the best of health in 2016. I'm pretty sure that Celtic-Ambetter is violating HHS-CMS rules by not having enough physicians and hospitals in Cook county. The problem is the Federal Government will not take any action until enough people are severely hurt with huge medical bills..and start filing official complaints. It would be nice if HHS-CMS would take proactive action, by telling Celtic-Ambetter to de-list itself from the Illinois Marketplace, but that's not going to happen. But, I will send a note to the Illinois Department of Insurance and the Governor's office. Almost zero chance of any response or action, but at least they'll have a record (and so will I) that at least one health insurance professional attempted to warn them of the problems that Celtic-Ambetter's presence will bring to lots of Illinois residents starting on 1/1/2016. ac"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Ambetter Insured by Celtic? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/ambetter-insured-by-celtic.78353/#post-1049179>

Inbound calls and transfers from offshore call centers · 18 documents · 18 voices

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought *pre-sold leads* from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigator (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the *insurance carrier, not the agent*, for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigator wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigator. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** \- If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

↳ HamiltonSt25 (75): "Quitting insurance today and becoming a professional litigator Imao"

↳ InsuranceEvangelist (70): "New income stream unlocked..."

↳ DavidDuford (24): "For real =). I should start selling info-product courses on how to do it, and partner with a lawyer to do all the work. "Make an easy \$1500 a day with one simple trick.""

"> What is your plan for when the incoming calls stop? As cynical as this sounds - there is no plan. If you have a phone, the calls will never stop coming. The numbers are spoofed, the names are fake, and there is nothing you can do. Even if you're on every blacklist alliance list, DNC, TCPA litiagtor scrub, etc etc - they all disconnect the calls AFTER the happen. Its annoying and won't end. I can get 100 illegal calls in a day and get zero justice or I can get 100 illegal calls a day, sue on 3-4 of them and get \$10-20 grand worth of justice. This is the world we're living in. The calls will never stop. If they did, I'd have a much higher serenity around here and I could enjoy some of the money I've made over the years. > Can you say with absolute sincerity that you're not taking any action to receive these illegal calls? 100%. I do not sign up for ANYTHING. I sit at home watching TV or scratching myself and the calls come in. I'm too young for medicare, but I get 20+ calls a day for medicare advantage. I'm too young for final expense insurance, I get 30+ a day for final expense. It's insanity. > You sure you're not intentionally putting yourself in a position for opportunities to sue these companies/agents? Am I intentionally putting myself in a position to sue these people, absolutely. The same way a cop running radar that has a really good spot that nobody can see / knows about..... I have a charged gopro handy and I record the incoming calls. Yes, I intentionally prepare myself to get the most leverage and the best evidence capture of illegal telemarketing practices. >I can't tell if you're posting this to be a genuine warning or maybe even bragging... but it actually reads like "Careful about your lead source, or else people without real jobs like me are going to sue you." I've done several settlements with small brokers that have said "we can't pay you what you're asking" and I said that's fine, I'll hold your upline joint and severally liable. Next thing I know, a decent settlement offer comes my way. OR I hire an attorney, they file a class action against the upline, the brokerage, the broker and the agent PERSONALLY and everyone goes to court, the upline spends \$150-200k in defense costs that they subrogate back to the downline via payment plan/docked commissions/what have you and my attorneys add another win to their CV. The message here is that YOU MAY THINK this new lead vendor of yours is all great but if you get burned, you can potentially be involved in bet the company litigation. And this is the WORST kind of litigation to be in because you don't realize you're in bet the company litigation until you've wound up betting the company. >Do what everyone else does and block the numbers that call Not that easy. All the numbers are spoofed. I get calls from the hospital, chevy dealership, etc etc - all displayed on the caller ID that are overseas call centers. Your outlook is 100% flawed. >No I have never been sued by a serial litigator because I only receive direct inbound calls, but I can still cringe at you for bottom feeding You know what's funny? Every single broker I've sued says "we only recieve direct inbound calls" - you know why? THE LEAD GEN SPOOFS MY NUMBER, CALLS YOUR BROKERAGE SO YOU CAN CLAIM IT IS AN INBOUND CALL. The only counterbattery is my gopro video."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8y9glc/

"Have you ever considered, you know, actually generating your own leads with community engagement in a niche market? Seriously... It works. I have done it for nine years. Wouldn't even know where to get a lead that was purchased if I tried. Also, thank God this is happening. The number of spam calls I get per day is ungodly and they interrupt my actual calls from call waiting. It's horrible. I hope all the overseas scammers shrivel up and go back to the holes they came from. I am tired of trying to tell my mom that I did not go to Mexico and will never be kidnapped there, she does not have a tax debt, and her Amazon order doesn't exist. Most of the time she is fine, and sends me an "lol you are not in Mexico getting robbed are you?" text. But I know the day is coming when that fails and I will be very grateful if it comes after this happens."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l8sgfs/be_prepared_for_the_phone_apocalypse/mx7qq7xl/

"Don't buy leads from overseas!? Next you'll tell me not to send apple gift cards to the county sheriff with an Indian accent looking for me."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/mjyobq2/

"Inbounds suck for a number of reasons: 1. Scam Central: most inbounds are generated in Pakistan and India. Literally the guys scamming your Grandma out of your inheritance are the ones providing inbounds to you, with entry-level scammers starting in lead generation before moving on to ripping off Americans. 2. Legal Pandora's Box: India and Pakistan will not comply to Federal TCPA rules. They will call everyone - even on the DNC - and you, and your upline, bear the legal risk. I had a good agent of mine buy one of these leads earlier this year and had to settle for five figures for just one phone call. 3. Did I Mention They're A Scam? These call centers are known to share client information, list information, and rework the leads over and over again. There are organizations that sell "pre-sold leads," which includes all major information about the client, claiming they call ahead of time to collect the information before passing it along to the agent to sell. Unbeknownst to the agent, they resell this information over and over again and you end up with huge chargebacks. I think Facebook ads are a much more durable, long-lasting, and safe lead generation solution. You own the leads, you control the ad creative, and you have a track record of the client opting in. Plus, you can scale upward to the level you're comfortable with, and can tie in pre-set appointments or call-ins for added benefit. Lastly, if you don't want to do it yourself, there are many good lead management options available that will do all of the above."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oxuubl/is_this_a_good_offer/np4s2v6/

"I did a lot of outbound when I was younger, but I eventually went to inbound. I never made close to 100k until I started working inbound. Being self aware is key. I know what my strengths are and I know my weaknesses are I could pay someone 2 to 3 dollars an hour in the Philippines or somewhere to dial for me if I had to why wasting my time calling there are so many more effective ways. I know it works, but I think it's just going to get more more difficult. I realized I'm much stronger at closing and consulting than I am at prospecting. Even when I owned my own business I used inbound marketing. It took a long time but it was way more effective. I utilize my website and I was able to get to the first page of Google. SEO and constant content. It did take over a year and a half in the meantime I had to buy Leads unfortunately Covid hit and I had to close my business, but it wasn't an insurance or financial services which is way more difficult because of compliance."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wmt560/reluctance_to_dial/pba8wsg/

"Lol you sound like a terrible person, not saying the agents dont suck and the offshore people dont suck but extorting agents smh. Use valid lead sources vetted by your company etc.. but to say leads suck is silly. We write 50+ policies off internet leads every month through vendors like everquote etc.. Use U.S based lead sources but going after agents trying to make a buck who messed up and trusted the wrong people makes you a terrible person. This is a tough industry people starting out and trying to make it should not have to deal with people like you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1saqau4/your_pal_fc_discusses_lead_generators_here_if_you/odyn7up/

"IUL Meta Ads Hey Folk, a friend of mine and I own a offshore Registered marketing agency, we wanted to try running ads for IULs (we do for recruiting which gave us a good ROI), I'm not quite sure on how much will it actually cost us to advertise with a pocket money budget from the Client since this is what us and the him agreed upon for starters, I'm Currently Making the draft but still contemplating since we agreed on getting Him APPOINTMETNS and not just leads, you can call me whatever but we had to take the risk to see if we can make it work on the long run for other agents. I'm Pretty good in what i do, Lead gen and appointment setting, i worked in various Industries so i trust my ability in this I'd love your advice on a few things: What are the best Facebook ad angles or creatives that have worked for IUL or financial services campaigns lately? How do you keep lead quality high without making the form too long? What's the best way to set expectations with the agent so they don't blame ad quality when the real issue is closing skill or follow-up? *(Not asking for self-promo or templates, just real experience-based advice.)"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o85k98/iul_meta_ads/

"Who is actually making money with inbound life insurance calls? I'm researching inbound life insurance calls and would love to hear from agents who are actively buying them. Are they worth the investment? Are they truly exclusive? How do they compare to Facebook leads, aged leads, or live transfers? Which companies have produced the best results, and which should be avoided? I've also noticed many vendors appear to operate overseas—has that mattered in terms of quality or customer experience? Looking for honest, unbiased feedback from agents who have actually used them. Thanks in advance for sharing your experience."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u49a29/who_is_actually_making_money_with_inbound_life/

↳ iBaires (1): "What is the cause of the persistency issue? Dropping 4/5 pieces of business post sale tells me something is wrong with the product, not the agent. If you can one call close, you are either very charismatic or at least very educated in your product. In either event, you need to be able to communicate well. So how does someone who can be charming or competent enough to one call close not maintain business..?"

↳ Acceptable_Dinner633 (1): "It's amazing the dishonesty associated with the "exclusive" lead!"

↳ iBaires (0): "That's weirdly unusual. Only time I've ever seen consistent one call closers lose business are from captive agencies whose prices get blown up the second a client does some due diligence with a broker."

"I would love for you to explain more about the ins and outs of Tricare and MA When I first went indy in 2011 from various FMO's and when I was trained in call center in 2008 I was always taught with VA its simple, Go to VA than VA pays, Go out in public then MA pays But don't mess with Tricare as Tricare acts a Medicare supplement and MA would interfere on how that works"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Know it All Veterans · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/know-it-all-veterans.108924/#post-1427894>

"Cody i have seen some of your videos but i've a question i really love this field cause i've worked one year on solar lead gen that was awkward but good and now i wanna start something new i've worked in office here and i'm from pakistan so what's your opinion? What should i do what you say?"

— YouTube · Calling Aged Final Expense Leads & Booking Appointments! · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6xb8wEsnIPY&lc=UgwBWv6h0KsDVCBZ4N54AaABAq>

↳ @CodyAskins (2): "I really enjoy the insurance field. If you're great on the phone, can handle objections, and have the drive to train every week, I believe you will have success."

"DonP said: I think they want to exclude face to face agents Everyone that's not associated with a call center in any way is considered f2f. Furthermore, if this is a real issue, the agent can just send the app link and the client fills it out."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Suprised nobody's talking about the huge MAPD marketing rules handed down by CMS · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/suprised-nobody%E2%80%99s-talking-about-the-huge-mapd-marketing-rules-handed-down-by-cms.108507/#post-1422053>

"Our back ground- Mortgage Marketing as well as Real Estate. We have been in business for over 4.5 years and in that time we earned one of the best reputations in the mortgage field for all forms of marketing. Our options include TM leads (24 man American call center), targeted lists, mailers and post cards, hosted dialer service, and call center set ups and consulting. Our capabilities- We have a 24 man call center in our corporate office in Las Vegas, NV. Currently we are going to dedicate this to Insurance lead generation only from 10 EST to 300 EST. With 24 reps we can generate just over 80 leads per day after our verifiers make sure the lead is valid. Very limited! In addition we do have printing capabilities with our presses to do any type of post cards or letter printing. BRR offers some of the best client retention packages in the country that not only retain your client but they also generate referrals for you as well. In addition to all of this we are also data brokers of the new business, as well as the consumer national database. We can filter just about anything! Our Goals- To provide a very high quality lead to a few companies or individual agents until our capacity is filled. We are not here to take over the field or put anyone out of business. Fact is that we can handle no more than 10-12 accounts in total for our TM leads. WE pride ourselves on customer service and making sure that each account has the best chance of making money. We literally want to retain every client that buys from us. As you all know residual income is the best! We will also offer a fair return policy as well as nothing but EXCLUSIVE LEADS, dialer services, and print and mail options, and New business database! Our Research- For the last 7 months or so we have been inquiring about and researching the insurance (primarily health) industry. I have learned a ton on this forum as well as others and by talking with many agents in the field. We even ran some beta testing for a few accounts that paid for their leads at cost while we were working the kinks out. During this time we got wonderful feedback from many agents that helped us mold what is now our final product. A lot of hours were spent on this project and we now have our marketing quality where we want them. You can view much of this on this forum on this thread.... Im seeking advice from health agents!! PROOF- before I take one order I will be giving a couple leads per day away for FREE on this thread starting next week. I'm going to pull 500 records from about 10 different states of new businesses set up in the last 12 months and under 8 employees. Then I will load this list into my dialer and pound away until we get the few leads needed per day. This is where I have had the most success. All these free leads will be given away on this thread in hopes that the recipients will report their feedback to the board. I will post the free lead and the first person that post that can do insurance in that state gets the lead! I will post the first leads 8-6-08! If you have any questions please post away! Let's let the FUN begin! STAY TUNED!"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Health Insurance Leads! Telemarketed! · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/health-insurance-leads-telemarketed.6703/#post-85556>

"I'm sorry you're going through this. The first step is to confirm which state your Ambetter plan is based in, since the appeal process can vary by state. As an agent, when a prior authorization is denied, I immediately submit an expedited appeal so the member can get a final resolution quickly. If that appeal is denied, I help them file an Independent Review Organization (IRO) request right away. The full process usually takes about 14 days. Most denials happen because the medical criteria simply aren't met — for example, when the provider prescribes something off-label, experimental, or fails to submit the required documentation. If the denial is due to a health plan error, the IRO often overturns it at no cost to the member. Sometimes appeals succeed because the Medical Director contacts the provider's office for more information. However, since Medical Directors handle dozens of cases per shift, if they can't connect with the provider promptly, the denial is usually upheld. The IRO process is more thorough because it requests documentation directly from the provider and reviews everything comprehensively. In certain states, like Florida, Centene Pharmacy Services handles appeals directly, leaving agents with little influence. Also, the so-called "Member Escalation Team" is essentially experienced customer service representatives — they don't escalate issues beyond standard procedures. True escalation happens through appeals or grievances, where the health plan must act according to your Evidence of Coverage and applicable law. Corporate staff may get involved, but unless your contract or policy language allows exceptions, their role is limited. Recommended Steps Call Ambetter and request to file an appeal as the patient for the denied prior authorization. Note the complaint number if your state allows appeals by phone, or complete the appeal form and send it to your state's designated address. Wait for the letter of determination. If denial is upheld, submit an IRO request. If the IRO also upholds the denial, you can file a complaint with your state's Department of Insurance. You can also skip directly to the Department of Insurance, but they'll usually redirect you back into the same process I described — only with corporate agents involved. That may be preferable if you'd rather speak with someone based in the U.S., since most contact center agents are overseas. Good luck — persistence is key in these cases, and following the proper steps gives you the best chance of success"

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1x9333/ambetter_admitting_to_missing_three_p2ps_and/opubd5s/

"JosephDeacon said: Anyone read this article yet? Allison Bell of LifeHealth Pro states comp will be set at 1.5-2.5%. If so, game over. PPACA strategist: IT companies need specs I LifeHealthPro Allison Bell from LifeHealthPro simply quoted her source. The statement came from John Sarich, vice president for strategy for a health plan software and service hosting company. He made very interesting statements, so I wonder how much he knows. Here are some quotes: In practice, Sarich said, because of PPACA limits on administrative costs, most carriers will try to hold individual QHP policy producer compensation to \$75 to \$100 per year, or about 1.5 percent to 2.5 percent of premium revenue. That level of compensation is much lower than the current typical health producer compensation, but "there's going to be a lot more agents," because many consumers will find that signing up for coverage is complicated, Sarich said. Some have suggested that producers might find that the new PPACA exchange QHP market is similar to the existing Medicare Advantage plan market. In the Medicare Advantage market, commissions average about 5 percent of premium revenue. Sarich said he thinks producers and issuers in the QHP market will have to provide more customer service than producers in the Medicare Advantage market do. To cope with the need for live-human advice, many insurers hope to make heavy use of customer service centers in India and the Philippines, Sarich said. Even though producer compensation levels will be low, the QHP carriers also will try to shift some of the work they do for commercial plans themselves onto the shoulders of the QHP producers, Sarich said. This is funny. He claims that the carriers plan to pay pennies, but expect "a lot more agents, because many consumers will find that signing up for coverage is complicated." Yea, sure, that will work. And then they plan to shift more customer service to agent/brokers? For less money? But you must admit that the last paragraph is funny. Since health insurance is so complicated, then customer service reps from India and the Philippines will certainly help clarify things!"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Exchange Commissions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/exchange-commissions.53360/#post-696347>

"> Lol you sound like a terrible person I'm a gun dealer, you're bringing that weak sauce up in here? Really? >not saying the agents dont suck and the offshore people dont suck but extorting agents smh. This is not extortion. The agents and brokers are hiring people doing illegal and unlawful and they're the ones who are ultimately responsible. >Use valid lead sources vetted by your company etc.. but to say leads suck is silly. We write 50+ policies off internet leads every month through vendors like everquote etc.. Are you SURE those leads are clean? Are you REALLY sure? >Use U.S based lead sources but going after agents trying to make a buck who messed up and trusted the wrong people makes you a terrible person. This is a tough industry people starting out and trying to make it should not have to deal with people like you. Actions - have consequences."

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sagau4/your_pal_fc_discusses_lead_generators_here_if_you/oe39z1h/

"vic120 said: I would love for you to explain more about the ins and outs of Tricare and MA When I first went indy in 2011 from various FMO's and when I was trained in call center in 2008 I was always taught with VA its simple, Go to VA then VA pays, Go out in public then MA pays But don't mess with Tricare as Tricare acts a Medicare supplement and MA would interfere on how that works Click to expand... You can go outside of the VA when you are in the VA system. If your appointment for whatever is going to be set out more than 2 months, you can request to go outside of the VA for care. Otherwise, everything but Dental is covered at the VA. So all those extra perks of an MA policy, except for dental, mean absolutely nothing."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Know it All Veterans · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/know-it-all-veterans.108924/#post-1427937>

"i work in offshore as an insurance agent, trust me i do not wanna call these people who are on DNC, but it just doesn't work"

— YouTube · How to STOP "Medicare" Phone Calls, Texts, Emails, and Letters · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cQh6ldSh6uc&lc=UgxXRlr7F4TKXAwqurB4AaABAg_AQNp6copZOJAT2zvQGnkPW

No training: all recruiting, no selling · 15 documents · 15 voices

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crid=11ZYLHHQAVSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&srefix=how+to+win+friend%2C&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_5?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: | Industry | Description | | --- | --- | | Tech | You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. | | Med | You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in *The Pursuit of Happiness*. | | Finance/Insurance | You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. | | Hardware/Construction | Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. | | Cars | You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. | | Door to Door | Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. | | So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. | JOB TITLE | PAY RANGE (Salary) | PAY RANGE (OTE) | DESCRIPTION** | | --- | --- | --- | --- | | SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) | £25,000 - £40,000 | £50,000 - £80,000 | Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. | | SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive | £30,000 - £60,000 | £50,000 - £140,000 | Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. | | MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive | £40,000 - £75,000 | £60,000 - £150,000 | Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. | | ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive | £50,000 - £100,000 | £70,000 - £250,000 | Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. | | SALES MANAGER | £60,000 - £120,000 | £80,000 - £200,000 | Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. | | MD: Managing Director | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. | | HEAD OF SALES | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. | | Terminology | Description | | --- | --- | | Cold call | When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. | | Lead | This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead'', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. | | Account | This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. | | Contact | This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. | | Example of a lead, a contact and an account. | Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

↳ vitaferox (58): "This was excellent advice for getting any sales job, honestly. And too many people skip those basics"

↳ titan623 (18): "I could kiss you right now. I've been a long time lurker and seen/saved a ton of great info for the job search, I've been meaning to sit down and organize it all. This is a SUCH a resource, especially with the concise examples, perfect for referencing. Thanks for putting this together."

↳ TheUneducatedPotato (14): "To add something that helped me land my new sales role: if you're asked to give a presentation like a 30/60/90 day plan, bring a paper copy in those cheap presentation folders. Give them out before the presentation so your interviewers can take notes. I had to fly across county to a hotel where they booked a conference room and guess what, the projector didn't work that morning. No worries. I had the power point, printed two slides per page, in a presentation folder, ready to go. Both interviewers were stunned with my fore thought and it saved me from having them crowd around my laptop looking over my shoulder. It's the little things that show you're thinking ahead."

"Warning: My Experience with Symmetry Financial Group – Please Read Before Joining Hey Reddit, I've been in the insurance industry since 2021 and have had success in multiple roles. I know what real mentorship and growth look like. That's why I feel the need to warn others about my experience with Symmetry Financial Group — because it was one of the most toxic, disorganized, and emotionally draining environments I've ever worked in. Here are the biggest red flags I encountered: • The leads are extremely aged. I was handed leads from as far back as 2016. Calling people who haven't requested life insurance info in nearly a decade felt unethical — more like harassment than service. It genuinely made me uncomfortable. • The culture is toxic. Uplines and agency owners frequently humiliate agents on Zoom calls in front of everyone. There's no support — just power plays, ego, and public shaming. • You're not in control of your own business. They make you ask for permission to get licensed in new states, claiming they won't get paid if you get licensed somewhere they aren't. It's controlling and makes no sense if this is "your business." • Shaming over conferences. Can't afford to attend one of their big events? Be ready to get publicly called out and guilted like you're not serious about your career. It's manipulative and unprofessional. • The training is the worst I've seen in this industry. There's no real structure, no proper onboarding, and no consistent support. You're left confused, overwhelmed, and underprepared. • It affected my mental health. I've never struggled with anxiety — not even in high-pressure sales environments — but while working with SFG, I had debilitating anxiety that impacted every area of my life. As soon as I walked away, that anxiety vanished. That tells you everything. The good news? I've since joined a different IMO with real leadership, training, and respect — and I'm flourishing now. This experience taught me that it's not the industry that's the problem — it's the people you align yourself with. If you're thinking about joining Symmetry Financial Group, please think twice. Don't ignore the red flags. You deserve better."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtqo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/

↳ loan2you (6): "What IMO did you join since?"

↳ Will-Adair (6): "I work with Symmetry. I like it as an independent IMO. I buy only new leads generated in real time so that doesn't line with my experience. Value leads range from weeks to years. I've never seen a value lead over 3 years old. Culture does depend what agency you're with, sounds like you were in a bad one. I've owned my business for 3.5 years so not sure what happened wherever you were at. Conferences are optional but beneficial. Again sounds like your experience is much different than mine and I'm going on year four. How long were you there? National has descent training and good agencies have their own too, we have for over a year. Sorry your experience stunk. Did you reach out to corporate and use their mediation team? Even if that door is closed reach out because corporate may be able to help train your former up-lines. Alignment is key. Glad you found a better solution for you."

↳ OPlathome (3): "I work with Symmetry as well and I agree with Will. What owner you're with matters, and not all teams are built equally. I get tons of support and training, and I do pretty well even with the older d-e leads."

"Senior Life offers a few different options. Expensive live transfers at \$70 a call. Discounted Facebook leads at \$10-\$15 a call. I'm a firm believer that you can be successful at any imo with any lead cost. The trick is that you have to get good at your craft before going broke. That is what nukes most agents. There is no shortcut. There is no magical lead. There is no magical training, there is no magical IMO. You have to put in a massive amount of Reps to get good at this. Once you sell your first 30-50 policies then start looking into higher cost marketing. I know you can do it, push yourself to do it. Keep your head up, you got this!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/mygsmm0/

"This rings true to my experience to a tee. The company is off the charts unethical and should be shut down imo. A lot of people don't realize AO Globe Life has 2 major hiring periods linked to bonus events within the org where managers are heavily incentivized to hire as many new people as possible. Many of the new hires at this time of year are hired solely for that bonus, with little to no intent to see them actually make it. Being strung along just long enough to qualify for the bonus then essentially left to sink or swim from there. This leaves such a bad taste in people's mouths for the industry as a whole when it's the company through and through And when you finally get a peak behind the curtain, it's like Oz all smoke & mirrors. Top tier agents aren't making 500-1000 calls a day like they brag in the videos and weekly calls. A few of them have their own appointment setting businesses and hire foreign call centers to push for live transfers. Sold leads are passed around to be sold again, multiple times. When I was with them you could look up a lead and be floored seeing how many times a person's been sold the same products by the org's top tier agents. And to this day, when I hear the phrase "you picking up what I'm putting down?" I just want to punch that guy in the face 🤨"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/on4jz8u/

"Is P&C insurance something worth actually considering for stability? 23M, I won't go into it deeply because it's twice now that reddit on my phone deletes my entire body post without any reason. But, is P&C insurance a field that actually has base commission and real world need? I currently sell Life insurance through FFL and my respective subagency, tldr i WFH and my boss barely helps me has thrown me into the deep end to either sink or swim and 3 months of solely commission pay, calling aged leads, trying to sell and actually help old people on fixed incomes with no other sources of income for me just isn't working as a Dick broke young dude. Nothing I'm trying to improve on myself works, the little help I get from other team leads or the big bosses are platitudes like "closed mouths don't get fed" while 55-60% of the agency at any one point hasn't made a sale and a vaguely inspirational message of, "No one cares how hard it is get to work, if you wanna succeed" is sent out almost daily. I really just feeling like I'm spiraling and looking for a change in what I'm doing to something that actually has success. I have made absolutely zero sales since I started mid November on aged leads anywhere from 6 months to 4+ years old from the convos I've had with clients. This of course means absolutely 0 pay, and with this being my only job and something I actually did really want to see success in, I don't want to throw away months of work and was interested if P&C was something really worth doing. I'm so desperate at this point if I knew I had even a base salary I'd be happy, is this something that's really possible with P&C and so I should focus on it studying and testing wise? Or is it better to just get out of insurance for a bit until outside money comes in because this entire 3 month process has been hell and maybe some outside money that makes me less desperate is what I need. I'd appreciate any advice at all, I just feel like I'm being kneecapped by everything recently, things in my control and things out of my control and a break feels like it's impossible."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qnrvv3/is_pc_insurance_something_worth_actually/

↳ hometown_quotes (8): "You're not failing because you're bad at sales. You're failing because you're calling contacts from 6 months to 4 years ago. Those aren't leads, that's expired garbage your agency recycles because it's free and they don't want to invest in actual sources. No amount of effort fixes calling contacts that old. Those people already bought coverage years ago or were never serious. You're bothering people who don't remember requesting anything while your upline sends motivational messages instead of acknowledging the real problem. Three months with zero income isn't sustainable. You need money now, not quotes about closed mouths. P&C can have base salary at some captive agencies, typically \$12-\$15/hour plus small commission splits. Not great but better than zero. The problem is most P&C agencies with base pay also expect you to generate your own business or work recycled leads just like your current setup. Switching to P&C doesn't solve your issue if the new place has the same garbage lead situation. Here's the reality: insurance sales works if you have quality leads. Real-time contacts from people who requested quotes in the last 24-48 hours. The agents we work with who are successful aren't better salespeople, they're just talking to prospects genuinely shopping right now instead of aged data from years ago. Your FFL setup churns through new agents every few months. They give you expired leads, provide zero support, and blame you when it doesn't work. Then they replace you with the next desperate person. If you're broke and need income immediately, get a W2 job with actual paychecks while you figure out your next move. Retail, restaurant, call center, whatever pays weekly. If you want to stay in insurance, find an agency with either base salary or real lead sources. Ask directly in interviews: what's your lead generation system? If they say "build your network" or hand you aged contacts, walk away. Don't beat yourself up about zero sales when you're working 4-year-old leads. Nobody converts that garbage consistently."

↳ driplessCoin (4): "why don't you work in account management or as a CSr at an agency somewhere with a base and see if you like it."

↳ EntertainmentHot4781 (2): "P&C can feel a lot saner than the life setup you just described. Most local agencies pay a modest salary or hourly draw because someone has to service policies, file claims, and cross sell. On top of that you stack new business commission plus renewals, so the income floor is higher and the upside is still there. The work is more transactional than life insurance so you are quoting all day, which helps keep the pipeline moving. Captive shops like State Farm, Allstate, or GEICO LSP programs are the fastest way to get that base. Independent agencies can be gold too if they have a marketing budget and a CSR team that lets you focus on selling instead of chasing ID cards. Interview them like crazy. Ask how many fresh inbound quotes come in every week and how long it takes for a new rep to hit break even. If they start talking about "buying aged internet leads" you already know that movie. Lead quality is everything. You can put in the same grind and end up paid or unpaid depending on what you are handed. So yeah, P&C can absolutely give you stability, but only if the agency's lead flow and comp plan are built for it. Otherwise you are just switching seats on the same sinking ship."

"I am currently working with HealthMarkets. There are positives and negatives as with any company. They do provide a free lead account and leads are half price when you are new to the company. They also offer cash and other bonuses along the way for new agents. You do not have to be new to the industry, just new to HM. There is not a lot of training on anything, so if you are new to the industry, this may not be for you. But, it depends on who your sales leader is as to how much they are willing to do to help you out. In my opinion, being told it's my own business so I need to figure everything out on my own, yet if I leave they will hold my contracts for six months is not worth it as there are other agencies that will either train you or not hold your contracts. If you want to make a decent living expect to put in at least 8 hours a day until you have built a book of business. This may not have been very helpful but I've been in the industry for a while and every company has their benefits and shortfalls. Overall, there is no micromanaging but there is no training that differs from Marketplace training."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cdomsd/new_rules_with_a_slight_change/mov08x4/

"Every one of these so called brokerages follow the same MLM blueprint as the previous ones. Little to no training, 8-8 schedule, zoom/discord rooms for "accountability", emphasis on lead spend through preferred vendors, recruit so the agency owner can get richer, reinvest everything into the business aka flow all of your money into their pockets. Oh and the best one: "We have the best systems." They love to throw the word systems around to attract new recruits. A poorly written script, leads that are ran through, and a schedule that is unrealistic. Remember you are 1099, not W2. Don't let the agency owner force any schedules or adherence on you. Sneaky little rats like to treat reps like W2 employees with zero benefits."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vtziac/my_experience_with_these_instagram_life_insurance/p4zf265/

"I was attempting to defend you that there are more than a half dozen variations of policies that replay was trying to say. There are truly many variations within those especially from carrier to carrier. It is NOT as simple as just learning those high level categories. We must learn all of the specifics of each plan. Learn how strict or what wiggle room there might be between them to get underwriting approvals. That account was making it overly simplistic. Then I added most kids and adults learn better with at least some structure and guidance. A few Zoom calls or links to a myriad of videos is no way to effectively help train someone. And that someone is who a agency owner or company leader is counting on to be strong in sales to help their own take home pay. A little bit more of investing in people, direct hires or contractors, is called leadership. Leadership also involves mentorship. Not just Zoom calls of changes to plans. Not just covering the week's leader boards. Mentorship is actually engaging with people. Finding what they are having issues with. Giving suggestions. Listening more than promoting. I am not seeing that from any of the agency owners so far. Just go hit the ground running and if it doesn't work out, they've already recruited 20 other people in those initial weeks. The current practices in the industry seem to be throw enough people at the wall in hopes one sticks. That is not even being a great business owner themselves. That reminds me of a roommate back in our single days who handed out his business cards to every girl he met that had a pulse (not sure some of them were even human but that's a different topic). I told him he was sleazy and slimy. He never denied it and actually was proud of how many girls (even if not all human) he hooked up with. Concerning the cards, his view was it was all in the numbers. If he even got one call back in 100 or 200 cards he handed out, that was more than any of us. That is the hiring and "training" approach of the industry in a majority of cases. Churn through a couple of hundred recruits and maybe 1 will make them some money. No leadership. No real guidance. No mentorship. And a lot of vain, "I'm the Main Character" stuff. Look at me! I am successful! I have tons of money from being an effective ~~~seller~~~ recruiter of people in numbers that will make me money! I have a paid off home, nice cars, a hot spouse and travel the world! Look at me!! Now buy a lot of leads, subscribe to this or that and buy tickets to our seminars! Never mind if I may or may not make money off those things too. Just go out there and make some money for ~~~yourself~~~ me! I am going to look around for agencies not of this mold. If none exist, I'm moving on. I've been a decent salesperson since my school days in many different roles. But this just may not be a good fit for me. Plus thousands of outbound calls and never even an appointment. At this point, I'd probably have a heart attack if someone, anyone actually answered the phone or called/texted back."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1q6lb33/when_integrity_collides_with_the_insurance/nyj4idc/

"WHY on earth would you bother friends, family, neighbors, coworkers & random people with this??? Find a company that gives you good leads. What happens after you blow through those 150? Are they going to make you find another 150? There's no support from a company like that. If my company didn't give me good leads I'd be out of here. I've been very well supported where I am and I'm not going anywhere anytime soon. You can do better! Good luck"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r2emia/how_to_create_a_client_list_it_doesnt_matter_if/o57pcx4/

"What about Amerilife? I think they are captive but they work with several carriers too. In the last 2 days I talked to a couple of agencies/IMO. They offer higher commissions but little to no training. Only watch a couple of videos and buy leads. Captive, I could find a mentor and better training + leads. Idk maybe I am wrong. There is a lot of info out there. I am overwhelmed already. Love your channel. Thanks"

— YouTube · How Do Medicare Brokers Get Paid? · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DBwUb_QfaB0&lc=UgwF8zwWYwXtoR9EBGI4AaABAq

"In an industry where most people fail, I'd be trying to ensure I gave myself every opportunity to succeed. Going out on your own with no leads, no training or support, and no proven system to follow... That's going to be tough."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wm0pti/newb_beginning/pb3e5a4/

"holy shit we are in the same boat man. my upline is basically recruiting like 8 people every week and its basically just sink or swim for me."

— YouTube · Real Medicare Sales Call - Initial Resistance Smashed! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=58cUJZmEQm4&lc=Ugzsa52GwYUv0RUCJFB4AaABAq.9THkSY9CHI59Y2we4026MT>

"@clydebarrow1933 sadly I was fooled lol I have the people skills and a little of the selling skills more people skills then I think selling I'm not sure to be honest I've done phone sells before and like AT&T Internet but I think the only reason I sold stuff was because people person I love talking to people getting to know them and helping them anyway I can so I never thought really into the idea of sales like being a good sales person because in my mind if I'm helping you find something that benefits you then I'm not selling anything to you I'm just using my knowledge of products and me getting to know you and bringing them together I've always thought that way selling phone food whatever even if I did not have the product or if I know your better with another person or product I was always truthful. But now I'm in insurance industry and have no support at all like I thought I would from my upline and so on so I'm just feeling depressed but I'm praying that it works out"

— YouTube · How I Sold \$56,038 Of Life Insurance In 30 Days With Self Generated Leads · 1 likes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=60LbRzSZNP&lc=Ugy9Nn6kB5qlc7mNTHZ4AaABAq.9mQFEIFlpjh9o_WHwIwXIB

"OMG yes. I joined a IMO that gives no training. And I get it because I'm jumping in a field saying I'm a "independent agent". Independent means independent lol. But my learning curve is getting dinged at every level. Anyway what's a good inexpensive CRM to buy? I would love one with a 1 person at a time dialer. I tried to use the one that came with insurance toolkits but I can't even import my leads into the CRM. I could go on and on with mistakes but I feel like I should throw in the towel and go with an imo that will give more hand holding like DUFORD5 group. I didn't go with him initially because he wanted \$500 upfront. I got it cause I'm older and still at my current job but at that time I didn't know if it was a racket. Now I think he's cool. But see what I mean... Hard decisions at every step"

— YouTube · Why I Left The Life Insurance Business (My Old MLM) · life / final-expense agent · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nguUnK7fjDk&lc=Ugz_oQmRJ6YkYJ7uOU14AaABAq.9q-8QhuE6C_9q0rRT0Wv55

"I started with symmetry as my first company as a new agent and it was going OK at first but my up line kept telling me just watch the videos just watch the videos just watch the videos and then one day she just kind of snapped on me and was telling me I just have to figure it out on my own and I Ended up just quitting because I told myself I'm not gonna work under somebody who's not willing to be there for me when I can have the simplest questions that a video can't answer as a new agent."

— YouTube · Live Dialing Insurance Leads! [Final Expense Insurance] · life / final-expense agent · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RL6Y5qig0Wg&lc=UgwGg_FVe6z7YmsJhJh4AaABAq.9Y1406U_DiF9fwQ1bnjeSc

Chargebacks and clawbacks · 9 documents · 9 voices

"It is definitely a grind the first 2 years. Our path is slightly behind the other gentleman's. Year 1 was ugly, thankfully we had savings. Year 2 was easier and 3+ are much better. We are a health insurance agency that sells ancillaries and the odd life policies.: There are pros and cons to all areas of sales. For instance: life insurance has more chargebacks than Medicare which is why we took commission as earned - less financial risk to payback Medicare is subject to rules and regulations and the vagaries of politics. Life pays more up front, health pays longer term - so short term cash for life, long term renewals for Medicare. Life is more sales because you have to sell people on the need for it. 10,000 seniors turn 65 every day and need insurance. Life is year round and you have no real busy season. Medicare has open enrollment which is similar to tax season for accountants, but January through May (after you are established) are 20 to 30 hour work weeks. As you can see I prefer Medicare, but I am not blind to the fact that if you hate rules and details, you will hate Medicare. Whatever you do, learn to read books on your industry and sales, associate with top producers and put your customers interest before yours and you will get paid back in referrals."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/pkdfdw/independent_insurance_agent_a_viable_career/hc4py0y/

"Congrats on passing! As a life agent, it is nice to get paid quickly and with the advance pay it adds up quickly as well. However, please be cautious of chargebacks if you are on advanced pay. A safer choice is to request "as earned" especially if you're not dialed in with managing your money. Have a solid schedule, good lead flow, and just stay consistent."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ju62n5/alright_i_passed/mm1gxex/

"AEP always feels like a gamble because the apps come in fast but the chargebacks hit months later when you least expect it. I've learned to treat a chunk of that commission as untouchable. Otherwise the clawbacks wreck your momentum and your sanity."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pgvbbq/aep_apps_vs_chargebacks/nsx1skx/

"Is this a good job? I was offered a job in health insurance. I have sales experience, but don't know much about the field. I'd love to hear everyone's opinions if this is a good job/opportunity. It's a 1099 role selling Medicare at a startup. I can work as many or as few hours as I want, as long as it is between 8-4:30. WFH available after a few weeks of in-person, as I don't have industry experience. Its 100% live phone transfers. Currently, they are getting so many, they are selling them to other companies but want to keep them in-house and are continuing to scale "pipeline partners"/lead generation. They say reps receive 15-25 transfers a day. Some days slower, but the bigger thing is how long it takes you to fill out an app. Pay is \$125 per sold policy. There are two, 4-tiered bonuses that pay based on conversion(17-26%) and take rate(72.5-80%). If I close 26%+ and have a take rate of 80%+, then I can make a total of \$350 per policy. The \$125 is paid weekly, and the bonuses are paid monthly after clawbacks. I also then get a \$5/mo residual once the policy hits 12 months. I was told most new reps with sales experience will do 40-50 policies a month, top performers will do 65-80+, and I will be making 8-12K/mo, except for the first month. Does this pay seem reasonable? They have a retention that tries to save any cancellations, so they say the take rate is 85% company wide. The only sketchy part I see is that I would have to pay for all my licensing, exams, and fingerprinting."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sh8q5w/is_this_a_good_job/

↳ Ch3N-ZoH (4): "When you realize what is actual street level commission from CMS, that is pretty low commission. NOW that being said, if they are supplying free leads it's not terrible. Medicare can be lucrative. I have 5 years experience in Medicare sales. The thing you would need to prepare for is most of the phone calls are NOT calling in to buy insurance or review insurance plans available. The marketing nowadays is all incentive based. "Seniors can get a food card to buy groceries!" So you'll have people calling in to claim their \$2000 food card and have to flip that into an insurance sale. Can be challenging but with the right framing I can easily explain to them that it's a real insurance benefit and not all people quality but the most important thing is their benefits. With that being said...can be a good field. Maybe shop around agencies there are a million that will hire with better comp than that. But it's not terrible as I mentioned,"

↳ g2murph (2): "Do you want to work with older, illiterate tech customers all day? That's what a lot of medicare sales is now. Prepare for a less than stellar experience, medicare sales are generally pretty rough. Since you are doing 1099, you will be responsible for 100% of everything related to your business. You'll prob need your own GL insurance and E&O as well. I'd keep looking if this is your first foray into insurance, get a w2 job with more actual training."

↳ Key_Astronomer6500 (1): "100% correct. I agree. Inbound is nice because they call you but most people are calling for a food card. The switch and bait ads get old. You can make good money but very few people are calling to buy. Everything has to fit. Even if you can get them a food card, you still have to make sure doctors and meds are covered. Always look out for their best interest. Benefits are more important than a food caed."

"After spending 7 years with Primerica, from 2004 to 2011, I came to one conclusion. In a lot of Life insurance commission sales jobs, you're either in debt from chargebacks or you're in debt from buying leads. I believe if the opportunity is truly solid, the company should generate the leads, vet the salespeople, and assign qualified opportunities. Pay a little less commission if you have to, but build a higher-quality sales force instead of recruiting everyone with a pulse. The client loses too when a salesperson is struggling financially. When you're desperate for a commission, it's easy to develop "commission breath" and recommend what pays the most instead of what's best for the customer. For the last 14 years I've been in home improvement sales, and I honestly wish I had found this industry when I was 20. The company provides the leads. We sell large-ticket projects that are installed in a few weeks. Customers pay upfront. No chargebacks. No chasing renewals. No worrying about policies lapsing years later. Every sales job has its challenges, but if you're looking for a long-term sales career, don't overlook home services. I wish I had found it sooner."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/ouyb04c/

"The leads are virtually all the same and, for all intents and purposes, priced relevant to the quality. I have used: Smart Financial, TTC, Caboom, LeadCenter, All Web Leads, and even Everquote. Everquote was actually the best for the money however, they stopped doing life leads the first of the year due to the proposed rule changes that did not ever happen. The leads are getting worse and, it's all about the blocking features on the phone's. The industry is trying to mask this problem however, it's a big one! Moreover, the people that don't have their phones currently blocked from unknown calls, will soon be because there are so many more apps out there that they will eventually get sick of all the calls and we'll figure out how to get their phones blocked like all their friends and family are doing. Anybody who tries to refute this statement is either blatantly lying, or just that naive. Facts are facts! And the saddest thing is, the cost of the leads have not come down in price. Go ahead keep purchasing leads because it's nothing more than being on a hamster wheel. You make about enough sales that stick to cover the bills and that's about it. People can brag all they want about all these big numbers that they are doing but believe me, they're getting a shitload of chargebacks. And of course, that doesn't get mentioned!..... I am far from the best salesperson on the planet however, what I do write, sticks! Purchasing leads is a dying art. Anybody who disagrees with me now, fast forward 6 months or a year and then cast your opinion! 8% success rate in industry is always going to be 8% or less. That means 92% of everybody fails. Unless you got deep pockets and get with somebody who's going to hand feed you, you ain't making it! But no matter what, those numbers are never going to increase! Yeah nobody likes negative Nancy, but the truth is the truth. It would be nice to see more of that being spoken in the industry instead of all the smoke and mirrors..... Nothing against this channel as it actually isn't bad. That doesn't change the numbers however.... They got the coolest intro and exit song in the industry!"

— YouTube · Selling Life Insurance: The Best Leads Ep209 · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9ySCCpwyx-U&lc=Ugw-jye2CDWiTt5MKoN4AaABAg_AINLhc1lh_zrAJ-dgMOEzAM

"You blame Medicare marketing compliance rules for this.. You CANNOT say Medicare is ANYTHING like ACA. ACA will become like Medicare with *compliance and disclosures*. AND with our new admin(🍌🍌). We might not have ACA anymore. Just STM. Some of those short term medical plans are only for 3 months in some states even after the recent changes. And there are rules where you can't reinstate with some carrier in same year. Health insurance is a circus right now. Medicare(MAPD) and ACA are typically uneducated people getting harassed all day during AEP/Open Enrollment. The chronic flips thinking they're getting something *more everytime added*. If you want to talk about "deceitful" then look at limited med with multiplan without major medical carrier with it. Which is way less compliant than ACA. And they're discount plans not real insurance for 2-300\$+ Yes people click once or couple times. And those leads are sold and sold again every month(.20 cents - 50\$). And 90% of that business you could get from those cheap leads will be flipped by end of the year or within 3 months clawback time. Vs your 30% you're suppose to lose on avg every year. Call Amazon or some other large company right now and watch you get redirected from Customer Service to Medicare agency. Sometimes the smaller newer agencies do spoof the numbers or emails to look like local food business even Amazon. Everyone wants a piece of the pie"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p0mqo2/is_it_just_me/npm451h/

"No problem! So it starts out at \$250 and can go up to \$350 based on production (i.e sell 50 polices a month 2x in a row to get \$300 and 70 for \$350). It's not bad we get 50% upfront and 50% 120 days later less chargebacks. Chargebacks and NAC policies suck"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hx3ebv/recent_lh_licensed_selling_medicare_advantage/m66bpr1/

"This is why I went from life to Medicare. Can't chargeback \$0 premiums!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ivriu5/typical/memb24u/>

Dialing all day for a handful of conversations · 9 documents · 9 voices

"anyone else hate receiving AI-voice generated cold calls? the usual AI-generated cold calls I got were usually those that assume you aren't interested. "hi. this is x from x company. we are calling to tell you that you are eligible for our medicare benefits. do you have plan A or plan B?" "plan A" "I understand, but this call will not take too much of your time. it will only take a minute to discuss your eligibility.""

— r/sales · 48 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1fhlgv1/anyone_else_hate_receiving_aivoice_generated_cold/

↳ bitslammer (25): "Not really, because they get to speak to my AI (Google Assistant) and I don't even know it. I only see the notification and block/mark them as SPAM when I do."

↳ [deleted] (19): "My favorite thing to do is wait until the AI prompt is over and then when the other person picks up yell "Kashmir belongs to Pakistan!"

↳ Reddevil313 (14): "Sometimes I get a call and the person is so rehearsed that I'm not sure if it's AI or not. I have to be careful not to get frustrated with a human being by mistake. I did once ask someone if they were AI and the response seemed strangely off so I hung up. I got an email immediately after saying he wasn't AI but the speed at which I received the email after hanging up was suspicious. I think about that one sometimes."

"AVOID: Bankers Life Had the worst experience with BL. No base pay! Horrible leads, cold calling, no benefits, wasting gas to go to appts and door knock, no reimbursements and you basically have to pay to work for them. I had to share leads with 20 other agents and we were all paying for these crap leads that don't even answer. Your managers make money off you when you sell and it's all triangle shaped.. AVOID!!!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gaf2yn/avoid_bankers_life/

↳ WorriedLow146 (2): "I'm 65 abd have an interview. Coming up should I go through with this or decline."

↳ OracleVision88 (2): "I just had an orientation with them today and I came on Reddit to do some snooping. No wonder they are all over Indeed, trying to get any and everyone they can, in the door. I'm going back next week for a one on one interview. I will keep you posted on whether or not I pursue this. The commission based system was of no surprise to me, and they claim they are looking for people that want to make a career of this, which at 36 and not quite so many prospects, this may be amongst the best I can get. Thoughts? Edit: I was told that Banker's Life provides the leads to the agents and that it doesn't come out of our pockets, but you're saying that these leads, in fact, do. I've heard of agents paying \$75-\$300 for leads, and that's not something that I am trying to do."

↳ Elegant_Support_8082 (1): "I would highly recommend you to find somewhere that pays a base salary. When I was with Bankers Life, they didn't pay any base and commissions were super low. 95% quit within 6 months. They are a very manipulative company and they're captive, which means every client you obtain is actually theirs and you don't get paid/get to work with them after you leave as they make you sign a non-compete so you can't try and switch firms and take your clients. They pay no base salary, so you'll have to invest your own cash alongside your time. Be prepared for lots of stops at the gas pump, long days walking thru neighborhoods door-knocking and getting yelled off properties. Most people don't appreciate strangers showing up to their door and some people thought I was a missionary, LOL. But what rarely happened is people buying from me. And guess what, even when you do get a sale, they can cancel for up to a year after you sold the policy to them and Bankers Life takes that money right back out your pocket and does what they call a chargeback. I remember one time I drove an hour away to an appt, sold the policy and the lady texted me on the drive back home she thought she made a rushed decision and wanted to cancel the policy, despite it being a very smooth appt in my eyes. So all that you earned is gone, all the time, effort, gas etc gone and it can happen at any point up to a year after. Man this is just the start. I would highly, highly recommend avoiding Bankers Life and most insurance companies in general. Look for something with a base pay, they can afford it. Goodluck!"

"How Keyboard Warrior Marketing Built My Commercial Book Faster Than Ads Ever Did I wanted to share a prospecting approach that has been huge for me, especially with small commercial accounts like pressure washers, lawn care, and other contractor niches. I call it **Keyboard Warrior Marketing**, and it is about showing up where potential clients already spend time online and leading with real underwriting insight instead of a hard sell. The workflow is simple. I join industry Facebook groups using my personal account, I watch for posts where people talk about pricing or ask coverage questions, and I jump in with quick risk checkups, not full quotes, just a few smart questions like what is your day to day, any employees, roof work, vehicles, or subs. It positions you as the expert and builds trust right away. After the comment I like and add the original poster and anyone else engaging. Over time Facebook starts suggesting me as a friend to more people in the same trade, which creates a passive lead funnel. From there I message when it feels natural, I quote small general liability policies in about five to ten minutes, I send PDFs and payment links so they can buy at their own pace, and I follow up one week, one month, and one quarter later if they do not close right away. It has been a steady stream of warm leads without ad spend. If you are an independent agent who wants to break into commercial, or you are tired of cold calls and expensive ads, this is worth trying. I am curious if anyone else here has been using something similar, or wants to share scripts and messaging strategies that work."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o1c6iq/how_keyboard_warrior_marketing_built_my/

↳ Monskiaactual (5): "this organic marketing sometimes call engagement marketing, it works, i used it early on in my mortgage career when i didnt know how to work leads two things. 1. It takes a fair amount of time and it is not inherently scalable.. there is only so people you can engage with 2. Its a unique skill set, not everyone can do it. but if you can do it and do it seriously you can get good business . Congrats!"

↳ InsuranceGnome (4): "100% it has pros and cons but it is free and generates revenue at \$0 cost, just time and sweat to grow is a good deal."

↳ InsuranceGnome (2): "You should consider finding yourself a virtual assistant who can buyback time and duplicate yourself in some of these tasks as well, I personally found a VA on Free Marketing was a better return then Paid Marketing funnels. I had a 50% to 60% margin with staffing cost with VA's averaged out over time."

"I dealt with this a lot when I first started. The most important thing is to practice your pitch, this helps calm the "what do I say if they pick up trigger". Realize that most dials won't answer, some will and really need help and you'll have a pleasant conversation and you'll either sell them or you won't, and if you get someone who is screaming and yelling, you hold all the power to hang up and dead the lead. Any shitty person you call you only have to talk to once. Also what helped me too was realizing THIS is the job I signed up for and while I hate bothering people A) they signed up for this, that's why they should have read the fine print when putting in their info and B) if it wasn't you in that seat dialing someone else would be there doing the same thing. Also it may feel like you're alone diving into a crowd but in reality the person you're dialing is dealing with a crowd stampeding their phone, you're just a faceless head in that stampede until you build rapport. I used to sit there and comb through the lead and think of who's going to be on the other line until I realized I would always be wrong and most of the time I'll probably never talk to them, so I kinda space out while dialing now and if someone picks up I just snap back with the pitch I've practiced a thousand times and start building rapport while I pull everything up. Also look at a bad phone call as taking them off your list and cleaning up your pipeline (which is still a win), my first thought after a shitty call is always "Thank god I never have to talk to that guy/gal again" then move them to dead."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wmt560/reluctance_to_dial/pbd1bx5/

"The problem is not putting hard work, if you went through the process you know that if you don't work hard you won't get any leads in r call people... The problems is that in the beginning they don't tell you but you will be getting old ass leads... and that's is frustrating... still not a cold call but some people don't even remember they signed up for... not to mention other agents that don't resolve their bad leads so it goes back to the pile as a no answer... and guess what? You will eventually call a bunch of people who already said are not interested many times... so I've seen some new agents taking many weeks just to book something remotely good... People who jump into this desperate for money and with no much time to climb up until get fresh leads will not last long, it's a fact, and they should be open about that from the get go... instead they hype you up, push you to learn all scripts and so on, and when you are finally ready you will spend 80 of you time going through a list of leads and calling people that never pickup the phone."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cy9b7k/im_stuck_at_globe_life_american_income_life_and_i/ms4ol22/

"What I would do if I were you: 1. Scrub your data against a litigator and changed number list on a regular basis. 2. Get Convoso. Kixie is OK. Most other dialers are terrible. Connection rate is everything. 3. Move out of New York. You cannot get contracted in New York with American Amicable as a New York resident. AmAm is arguably the best final expense telesales carrier available. Answers to your questions: 1. Maybe. Biggest levers to get best results: 1. Script and skillset 2. Dialer to maximize connection rates. 2. See above. 3. Convoso only. 4. Stay away from DSNP. 5. 100% TCPA compliance adherence. 6. Set daily activity goals. Consider bonuses/rewards for hitting call/conversion goals."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jnkha/advice_for_final_expense_startup_highvolume_cold/mko7utp/

"Go Back to the roots Please!! This is awesome!! I'm a bit frustrated with dialing, but If I get an in home apmt. Its like really easy. Keep the content coming, this is so beneficial to me as a rookie"

— YouTube · Cold Calling 3-Month-Old Leads LIVE – Watch Me Close Insurance Sales · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qvBEaHr_MGU&lc=UgzwhjnB0EL0gRPRrB54AaABAq

"Pretty typical of any vendor, can run hot and cold. I'm not sure if you see the same leads that I do, but if there is a "questionnaire" lead, stay away from that one. It is full of people who are just filling out surveys. To be honest, I buy a mix of leads from them. That being said, every internet lead has to be worked. You are going to get plenty who say "wasn't me", or some other lame excuse or they just hang up on you. I'll simply put those leads to the side for a couple days, even a week and then call them again as if we've never spoken. It doesn't always work out, but the number of people who all but cussed me out a few days ago, now act like they've been waiting on my call is just weird. I like that Integrity doesn't force a specific number for a purchase. I work this business part time so it's nice to be able to control how many I get. I work with a team, and we have plenty of new agents come and go. I'll see them buy 5,10,20 leads, dial them a few times, not make a sale, then blame wherever the lead came from, say the whole thing is a scam and bounce. Working internet leads is not always an easy task.."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/mnsacz5/

"Hi Cody this is very helpful, I just passed my NJ Life with New York Life so new at selling insurance. I come from a background of investments so planning to get my series 7 as well so I am able to work on insurance and investments. As a new Financial Advisor selling insurance any advice? I know most people hate receiving cold calls."

— YouTube · Live Dialing Insurance Leads! [Final Expense Insurance] · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RL6Y5qig0Wg&lc=UgyUFpcrDZlydw_0Z_Z4AaABAq

↳ @cassiopeia3602 (1): "Hi Sandra, I'm evaluating to work at NYL any advice to pass the interviews?"

↳ @SandraFernandes621 (0): "@cassiopeia3602 hi yes just be yourself getting in is not hard at all. Definitely be professional and dress the part during the interviews"

Clients poached or switched by call centers and other agents · 7 documents · 7 voices

"500 in your first OE is actually insane, congrats on that. tbh the thing i focused on after a big enrollment push was just making sure i kept the clients i already had because churn kills you way faster than slow growth. like i spent a week in january calling everyone to check in and my retention was noticeably better that year. referrals from those happy clients ended up being how i actually grew without spending more on leads."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rx4iw2/enrolled_500_aca_clients_my_first_open_enrollment/ob4bx8d/

"I am partnered with a tax office, and we have been running into people getting penalties for not having proper coverage. Most of these clients have been getting switched out each month by their telesales agents. I plan to sit with the clients on calls with Healthcare.gov and CMS and report every single one of these assholes that are doing this. The most recent one owes over \$1,500 in penalties. I am all for heavier ethics standards and stronger disciplinary action to stop agents from taking advantage of unsuspecting clients. The first step I would want to see is abolishing the tele sales agent. I feel like most telesales agents care for the clients' needs as good as they should because they don't have good symbiotic relationships with their book of business."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1bd66ik/aca_shitshow/kuo7i2d/

"You just need to partner with car dealerships, boat dealerships, motorcycle dealerships. They get high volume of people. To drive off the lot they NEED insurance. This starts the wheel of high volume, once you have those people, you have your foot in the door. "Hey man, that's an amazing boat you have there, I guess it doesn't tow itself hahahah! What heavy machine you have upfront? Awesome my brother as that aswell I love it. Hey man if we combine both, the amount you'll save is astronomical, would you be open to see a price for both? That's Great, I guess you don't park those in the street hahahah! You live anywhere near (popular location near boat dealership) right?" Bblablabla and it goes on. 1 lead turned into 2-3-4 policies = lower churn possible. Gave you some sauce, I love the hustle, keep going."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/ooh6ak4/

"I sell Medicare advantage, Sups, ACA, and FE. Gearing up for AEP now. From February on up until now, I focus on FE. Hoping to write 30-50k in new business this AEP. This will be year 4 for me. The residual income is nice. I always stay in contact with my current clients through the year, so they can't be poached. Have to keep them happy all year. You do what it takes. I will say, the first couple years can be hard. Stick with it, keep grinding and you will be rewarded. First year I only made about 20k. Thankfully I had the perfect job, working 3 12 hour shifts a week in a warehouse."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mg7yvj/life_agents_how_much_premium_are_you_selling/n6mvyzm/

"This is mostly the client themselves calling in. Make no mistake, CMS is getting on people for doing this but as long as they have a REAL recording that shows them stating the date and going over compliance, it's not even the vendors fault at that point. If the customer wants to keep calling after being told to stop calling (i see this in our office often)" then there's only so much that can be done. If it's really 70, it's about 95% chance the client keeps calling in and getting flipped."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1bd66ik/aca_shitshow/kun7d9z/

"Limoine said: I think the ultimate question is: "do agents add value commensurate to the renewal commissions received?" This is the only relevant question, because the need to service plan members isn't going away just because commissions are (presumably) cut. The reason MAPD renewals are higher than, say, Med sup renewals is because they require more hands-on babysitting. SOMEONE will have to do that babysitting, whether it's the agent, the carrier, or government nannies. I don't see how shifting the cost of that babysitting to the carriers saves the government money in the long run; the carriers aren't going to want a pay cut considering the fact that they'll need to hire more staff to handle the increased incident rates. If the govt presses the issue, more carriers will simply bow out, leaving fewer choices for the senior market, and then the next wave of complaints and suggestions will be how to revive MA again. It's all well and good for activists to say, "let's cut those nasty agent commissions" but you can't change basic market forces with good feelings and slogans. Click to expand... Member MAPD medical cards have 1800 to call in house agents. Just another red flag bc I am seeing in house agents aggressively steal clients by using words like "you don't need an agent, just call us (in house) You cannot change back a client with an AOR change form now either when they get stolen by in house agents. Just another red flag. Altogether I see this MAPD renewal party not ending well for broker agents. Just sayn bc I see the signs already heading that way. IMO"

— Insurance-Forums.com · MAPD commissions first to get the AXE? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/mapd-commissions-first-to-get-the-axe.110822/#post-1457806>

"The problem you're having.. is that go health didn't teach you how to do the job. They didn't teach you the product or how to care for the needs of the client. They taught you how to poach books. But the reason they are slowly dying is because every time they have one of their extremely underpaid teleagents poach one of my clients i immediately put in a complaint to CMS and then flip them back. That's why the 3 month retention is less than 40% for both go health and assurance. Medicare isn't easy and shouldn't be. It should be about building relationships that in turn pay you very well for taking care of people. If you actually love it, find an upline that can show you how to build a book, not steal one for a churn and burn company like go health."

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/111e1d0/i_messed_up_i_quit_my_easy_medicare_sales_job_and/j8fsxfc/

Tab 6 — Previous Solutions

Bought leads from vendors · 440 documents · 20 voices

"Stop buying leads I constantly see people on here complaining about shitty, expensive, shared leads. Listen guys, YouTube exists, this stuff isn't hard. Facebook and Google have dumbed setting things up so much it's ridiculous. You want to know how to create your own leads? On Facebook you can find a built in tool called Facebook ads library. Type in the insurance product you sell and filter the results to show active ads that have been running 6month-1year. The older the ad the more successful. If the ad wasn't making money, they would have killed the ad. Copy/model that ad. For Google, pick a big city, Google <what you sell> <big city> whoever shows up at the top probably has a good ad. Look at their ad copy then look at the landing page they use. Copy/model them. It's simple, YouTube to figure out the setup, research what ads work, copy them.... And now you're getting your leads at cost and you have full control of them. It's easier than you would think."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 163 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466vj/stop_buying_leads/

↳ zb0324 (33): "If you want to get advanced: Google is the more expensive option but the leads are higher quality. Someone googling already has intent to buy, whereas on Facebook you're just scrolling your timeline and someone is interpreting you with an ad. Also there's more fake leads for some reason on Facebook, but they're also way cheaper. What we like to do is get traffic from Google ads and then use Facebook remarketing to put our Facebook ads in front of the expensive Google traffic that didn't buy."

↳ TheMatthewMurray (18): "This is good. I use the method called "Mimic it, Master it, Make it your own." However, copying and pasting will work for awhile, but understanding why ads work is fairly important. That way you're not constantly copying. When something goes wrong is when, people don't know how to fix it."

↳ Randomdeath (16): "did you just post Well thought out and simple strategies for success? Sacralige I say"

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought "pre-sold leads" from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigant (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the "insurance carrier, not the agent", for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigant wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigant. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

↳ HamiltonSt25 (75): "Quitting insurance today and becoming a professional litigant Imao"

↳ InsuranceEvangelist (70): "New income stream unlocked..."

↳ DavidDuford (24): "For real =). I should start selling info-product courses on how to do it, and partner with a lawyer to do all the work. "Make an easy \$1500 a day with one simple trick.""

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

↳ Legio-V-Alaudae (45): "If it was so easy and well paying, they wouldn't have to advertise the hell out of the jobs. I'm sorry you didn't have a healthy amount of skepticism when conducting due diligence."

↳ Candid_Worth_3629 (25): "Did you not ask for any advice from this subreddit or do any research prior to leaving your 9-5? Everyone would've told you to keep the main job and start out part time. It's also really important to be at a place that doesn't make you churn \$ for leads. Most are MLM schemes"

↳ jordan32025 (20): "Anyone who doesn't understand that AP written is not the same as the commission percentage shouldn't start a life insurance business. Also, going into it thinking it's a "job" is recipe for guaranteed failure. There is some financial literacy needed. This precisely why I don't recruit people who are not already actively selling consistently with a good carrier. They already know how to run a business."

"AMA - Never selling insurance to 85k monthly commissions starting my own agency **AMA: Nine months ago I'd never sold a policy. Today my ACA book does about \$85k/month with a \$34 CPA and ~3% loss. Here's what I wish I'd researched before spending money. Quick context** * Licensed end of Oct '24, started selling Jan '25 * Put **\$100k** in over the year * I buy **live inbound callers only** (no cold lists) **How I handle calls (this mattered most)** * Calls only route to me when I'm not already on the phone, so I don't miss people * If I miss a customer service call, I call back the same day—no exceptions * Clients get a real number that reaches me—my personal cell, 24/7. Hard work, but it built trust and referrals **What to research before you spend \$1** * Refund policy in writing: what counts as a bad call, how returns work, when credits land * Answer/contact rates by hour and source (real stats, not guesses) * County/ZIP targeting that matches ACA networks I can actually place * Consent/compliance language used before the call reaches me * Delivery control so I can cap/pause and touch every caller the same day **Money I wasted** * "Cheap" calls with vague or slow refunds * Buying volume before the intake script and follow-up rhythm were dialed in * Fancy software I didn't use every day **Money that paid off** * Speed + clarity: short script, quick verify, clear next step, same-day follow-up * Call recording + quick QC: 10 minutes a day fixed leaks I couldn't see in a spreadsheet * Knowing ACA cold: networks, formularies, prior auth, renewal quirks—explained in plain English (be the expert and put people at ease) **My lead-vendor checklist now** 1. Refund/credit rules and SLA (in writing) 2. Sample ads so I know there's no fake incentivizing 3. State targeting and delivery hours 4. I can throttle/stop calls instantly **Process that moved the needle** * 3 steps: verify basics → solve the real problem → set a specific next time/action * 1–2 plan options max, with reasons (menus slow everything down) * Same-day everything, or conversion drops * Post-enrollment customer care (ID cards, network checks, "what now?") drives referrals and keeps churn low (~3%) **Simple weekly scoreboard** * Reached calls / total calls * Kept appointments * Submits * Time to first touch * Service issues per member * Refund rate / turnaround * CPA (~\$34) and trend **If I had to start over (I could do it much cheaper—\$10–20k)** * Spend the first 2–3 weeks on scripts, routing, notes template, and a manual follow-up schedule * Trial multiple **live-call** vendors in tiny batches; only scale the one that proves contactability **and** refunds * Keep the tech boring: I run everything in Excel and Google Calendar * Give clients a real number and show up—that's what makes referrals happen That's my playbook and the lessons. AMA about the research, spend, setup, or what I'd cut or double down on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 62 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/

↳ Samwill226 (38): "24/7 cell is going to be your downfall."

↳ Samwill226 (10): "You know what huge risk it really opens up? E&O. I've been in this a long time. I can't tell you how many E&O claims come from cell phone communications. It's a HUGE vulnerability"

↳ Samwill226 (8): "It really is a huge hole for a claim. I have clients find me on social media and send me a message on a Saturday night about a change or coverage question I won't even look at it or respond. You gotta protect yourself on your personal time because they'll throw you under the bus quick! "I called and told him....""

"Be your own boss" "80% starting commission" "change your life" Donated 100% of my income to my friendly lead vendor who definitely does not take advantage of agents"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 57 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s8e1si/be_your_own_boss_80_starting_commission_change/

↳ 1MillennialMind (18): "Boss really loves money out it seems 😊"

↳ OZKInsuranceGuy (14): "I've never bought leads and not made a profit on them. If you are consistently losing money on leads or breaking even, there's something seriously wrong in your process."

↳ jumpppppppp (11): "I love gambling my money away to the lead casino"

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workarounds to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of each other. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

↳ This-Armadillo9741 (7): "I've been wanting to share this insight for a while but never got the chance to. If you're considering being a life insurance agent- Specifically if you're considering working for globe life or American Income Life insurance (that was my run off branch) I'd like to offer you the most transparent what to expect in terms of your pay since I don't see anyone else being blunt with their numbers. I worked for AIL for 3 years from 2019 to 2022. on average my salary was around \$60-\$70k a year. With that income I was typically working 10 to 12 hours a day on the phone 7 days a week and attending weekly (and sometimes daily) training calls with my "team". I didn't do the recruitment side of the business, just the insurance hustle (I know this is where a lot of people are going to point out that THAT IS WHY I DIDNT MAKE AN EXTRAVAGANT AMOUNT PF MONEY) but let's be real, I didn't my my insurance liscence to recruit other people trying to get their insurance license, I did it to swell insurance. When you see that people are making "\$100k a month" or "\$MILLIONS a year" know this. If I sold a \$10,000 life insurance policy (which is a very minimum, basic, but affordable policy) I made \$55 in commission. with a \$1 residual pay that I would receive the following month. HOWEVER, when we hop on calls at the beginning of the week it would be announced that I "MADE" \$10,000 (completely untrue) and to capitalize on this they always ask "how much of that amount do you get to keep" to which you are trained to respond by saying "all of it" pretty manipulative too the new people huh? but we take what we can get and convince ourselves that if we just do that 10x over we'll eventually have what would look like a 'good check' here's the kicker about those "residuals" after the following month of each policy, you don't get them anymore. for whatever reason they give you, those get kicked to your upper and you basically only have that one time payment to count on. so if I can give you any advice on 'residual payments' it's that somewhere in the fine line of your contract I can guarantee they're not yours to keep. they will find some rhyme and reason as to why it will go back to the company. so, for over 10 hours of work a day, you might make \$55. "oh but what about those that ARE making millions" or "you just needed to work harder" let me tell you something: I busted my ass off on the phone and my spline KNEW I had no interest in recruiting people so EVENTUALLY (we'll say after a year) I got granted some pretty good leads. Now I was finally able to make some big bucks! Without getting too verbose the average policy amount for these clients would be ranging from \$150k ~ \$500k. The largest I ever sold was for a \$500k policy and here's the breakdown for that : I got paid a whopping \$1,300 in commission and a \$300 'residual' the following month. so ...you do the numbers"

↳ jroberts67 (6): "I'm sorry for your experience, but plenty of flags and not trying to come at you too hard, but a level of insanity that there's never been a time in history where we have more information available yet no one wants to research. Group interview? Huge flag. Paying for anything upfront? Huge flag. "Releasing your license" is absurd, once you've passed your exam your license is activated by your state, not any agency."

↳ Current_Bridge_3615 (4): "Worked for AIL as well, you wouldn't believe the horror stories I got during that short time. Let's just say there's a reason they've been sued multiple times and are currently under investigation for insurance fraud."

"Sorry I didn't provide value so I'll do it here: my favorite lead vendors I've used 1. Smart Finaical - seo leads 2. Happy agent - Fb leads 3. Nectar leads are insurance leads for seo and Fb Also if you are an agent your upline or leader should be able to provide you the best sources. Sorry for this I care about you"

— YouTube · The Best Life Insurance Leads For 2024 | My \$500k/Yr Lead Source · 44 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gtXNK0-8f7c&lc=UgxSK3d37q7CBMR8CY54AaABAg.9zPnaAfMyXt9zPrRMljeY8>

"How I retired my wife with my insurance agency, AMA I launched my agency in 2023 after working for years as a producer, underwriter, and consultant. It started as a side project with one goal in mind, to build enough recurring income to retire my wife and give us both more freedom. Within the first year I turned it into a full-time operation using an aggregator for market access and an organic marketing system that focused on building real relationships instead of buying leads. If you are trying to start or scale your own agency, here's what I can share: • How I used social media to generate consistent inbound leads without paying for ads • How I manage quoting, follow ups, and virtual assistant support to keep volume moving • How niche markets like pressure washing and contractors helped create stable renewals • What commission structures and business habits made the biggest difference early on • How to build an agency that supports your family and gives you time freedom Ask me anything about licensing, operations, staffing, lead generation, or what it actually takes to build an agency that can change your lifestyle."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o2ysrs/how_i_retired_my_wife_with_my_insurance_agency_ama/

↳ InsuranceGnome (10): "I never spent a dime on ads. Once you pick a niche, join the industry Facebook groups where your clients hang out. Do not spam, just wait for conversations where you can add value and show you understand their world. When people start asking for help, that is when you message them directly. I built trust by sharing tips that had nothing to do with buying from me, like safety guides since I am OSHA certified. Leave your two cents on as many posts as you can genuinely contribute to. Ideally do it from a personal profile instead of a business page, it gets much better organic reach. Once you start adding clients as friends, Facebook's algorithm does the heavy lifting. It will show you more people just like them, and that is where your next batch of leads usually comes from."

↳ InsuranceGnome (7): "TL;DR: Start with one niche and master it, keep costs low, lean into your strengths, buy back your time, and focus on turning your best skills into your biggest assets. P&C Insurance. Find a niche industry and learn as much as you can about it. For me, I did really well with service contractors and kept learning one trade after another. I often read policies cover to cover. I skim some sections, but I like to get a full understanding of how everything fits together. I kept software costs low at the start and added tools only when I could afford them. You do not need everything perfect to begin. It is better to get the ball rolling and improve along the way. Lean into your strengths. I am better with social media and chat since I am a gamer and always on my phone, so I made social media my number one funnel. Work with what you are naturally good at. Buy back time when you can. If you are bad at something like AMS entry, do not try to turn a zero into one hundred overnight. Hire someone on Fiverr to help while you also improve your own skills. Focus on turning A skills into A plus skills. The things you are weak at will improve over time, but your strengths will move the business forward faster."

↳ InsuranceGnome (5): "I went with Agentero because I was not planning on selling, and I was able to get my best commission rates by compiling everything under one broker. They were the only company I found that was willing to negotiate the contract. If you tell them you want to amend something, they will actually listen. It was by far the most personalized experience compared to Bolt, First Connect, or any others I reviewed."

"Finally got my dream job!! I don't know if anyone else is in Alabama but I finally found an agency where I don't have to buy a single lead and I can bring in consistent income, they have a nice office in Vestavia and they offered to pay for my licensing too though I already had mine! Really excited to see what the future holds, I also made my biggest check last week!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qxr5nv/finally_got_my_dream_job/

↳ Jazzlike_Cat6692 (1): "Congrats!! What company is this ?"

↳ Champion138 (1): "What company? I may be interested"

↳ [deleted] (1): "It's such a relief not having to constantly chase leads and spend a crazy amount of money doing it. I learned that the hard way after wasting almost \$1,000 on bought leads that went nowhere. After that, I decided to invest \$200 a month into a small SMM branding company instead. Best decision I made. My business is growing, the leads feel more natural, and it's proof that a small investment can have big potential."

"the shared leads thing is such a scam and I can't believe we all just accept it Bought a batch of "exclusive" commercial leads last month. Called the first ten. Three of them told me I was the fourth agent to call that week. Fourth. So I'm paying, what, \$14 a lead to race three other brokers to the same shipping company owner who's already annoyed before I even open my mouth? How is that a business model for anyone except the vendor selling the list four times? The aged leads are somehow worse. Bought some for like \$2-3 each thinking okay, these are old but at least they're cheap. Half the businesses had closed or changed ownership. One number was a Subway. Not a Subway that needed commercial coverage, just a Subway where some guy named Dave was confused about why insurance agents kept calling him. I don't even know what the alternative is honestly. Every lead vendor I've tried does the same thing with slightly different branding. You either pay a lot for leads that five people already called, or you pay a little for leads that are basically dead. Pick your poison I guess. anyway rant over, back to dialing"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 31 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s5vcry/the_shared_leads_thing_is_such_a_scam_and_i_cant/

↳ Available-Revenues (17): "The lead is exclusive to you from that specific lead company. Doesn't mean 5 other lead companies don't also have the information for that business."

↳ Acrobatic_Explorer_3 (13): "Generate your own. That is how most of us do it on Facebook."

↳ Toppoppler (11): "No, most will tell you they sell them to 2-3 other people"

"Imo owner now, it when I was independent as a Final Expense and Medicare agent I grossed 500k a year for 7 years in a row and 300k for several years before that. My first year in the business it was 180k. Net was lower, I had to buy my own leads, pay my own business expenses. But I don't know that I ever had more than 100k in expenses a year. I was an exceptionally good agent and I made sure to write business that paid renewals which is how my income grew to be so high."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 30 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3z4tt/how_much_you_earn_as_insurance_agent/nq85spe/

"Sick of lead companies It's amazing.... agency owners buy "premium" leads and no matter where you go theres trash mixed in. The excuses are incredible like " you aren't dialing them enough" "the prospect keyed in that fake address and number" ect. ect. The agency I work for literally has people dialing alllllll day constantly (over 1000 dials). The sales agents are also calling, emailing, and texting. None of that matters when I get someone on the phone that's already been called 15 times. How the hell do these leads get sold to 20+ agents? I even had a lead in which the guy was DEAD for two years. Where are they even getting this crap from? Any industry insiders that want to give me the 411?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/

↳ itsalyfestyle (16): "Your agency are buying the cheapest aged leads they can find"

↳ Monskiaactual (11): "Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdoteal personal experience) Jornaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use jornaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower internt.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trustd lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. .get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

↳ iamoptimusprime312 (6): "Most are resellers thats why! It is rare to find the actual source of the leads. Also the industry is drowned to the max with resellers who bought 7 day old leads in bulk for like \$1000 and reselling for \$10,000! That is why i only recommend direct mail and doing fb ads. They will be your exclusive leads! If you are not the first agency to call that person after they filled out the online form then it is most likely a useless window shopper. They will just spin your wheels and will never convert!"

"BadA\$\$leads scam I purchased some leads from badassleads.. those leads are a penny worth. Wrong numbers, disconnected numbers, bad emails. Just dont waste your money and generate your own. Seriously lead generation companies are ripping off Agents"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/

↳ bigalien1 (28): "Sometimes the name gives it away"

↳ Diligent_Throat304 (8): "They should rename bullsh*tleads lol"

↳ jwf1126 (7): "You should have taken your own names advice or even gone full deep throat with a company name like that. Lead gen sucks but there are companies out there that will at least put a good faith effort and give you the time a day and have some successes"

"My number one recommendation is to buy leads. Not any leads, Aged Leads. Specifically leads that are 9-12 months old. Old enough where they don't get calls but need a policy or are open to getting a policy at a lower rate. The CPL and CPA are low enough to give you the ability to generate considerable revenue over a 90 day period. At that point in time you can pivot into more expensive marketing solutions or paying someone to run the marketing for you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/mygpk0u/

"What Uplines Don't Want you to Know - Carrier Release Process - Explained This is a question I get a ton from new agents, and its what every upline doesn't want you to learn, so please... learn it. Treat this information like it's required for you to be in the industry to know. Review your contracts with your uplines and make sure you have protection within them as well. Heck, get a lawyer to review it. Whatever it takes, I see too many agents getting trapped in awful comp deals and abusive uplines and get "Stockholmed" into buying bad leads from them and then gaslighting them into thinking its their fault. I've been there done that. This info is for the agent that calls themselves independent:

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Demystifying Agent Contracting, Releases, and Blackout Periods I work directly with 54 carriers, 4 FMOs, multiple agencies, and nearly 1,000 independent agents. My role involves overseeing contracting, licensing, and agent/agency development. With experience spanning so many entities, I've had the chance to see the contracting process from all angles and business models. Let me break it down for anyone who's struggling to navigate this space. # Steps to Understand Contracting and Releases

1. **Contract Level (LOA vs. Broker):** * If you're directly contracted with a carrier as a truly independent broker *and* haven't signed an agreement restricting you to one entity (or an LOA contract, which assigns your commission to your upline), you should generally be free to contract with another carrier or upline without issues. 2. **Private Contracts (Non-Competes or No Non-Competes):** * If you're tied to a brokerage or agency and have a private contract (like a non-compete), get a lawyer to review your options. Some of these cannot be upheld in court, that's important for you to know. * Medicare agents may want to wait until the start of the year for a smoother transition —this avoids AEP complications. 3. **Carrier Blackout Periods:** * **New agents** can contract anytime, even during AEP, for Medicare Advantage (MA) and Medicare Supplement (Med-Supp) plans. * **Switching uplines or FMOs, however, is restricted** during AEP for MA carriers (typically September–December). * If you're contracting with a carrier for the first time, you can get a **new contract** during AEP, but you can't **switch uplines** until the blackout period ends. 4. **Release Process (To Release or Not):** * Brokers contracted directly with carriers usually retain their commissions unless restricted by a private contract (see Step 2). * You can file a self-release with an "intent to transfer". After 90–180 days, the carrier can re-contract you under a new upline while allowing you to keep producing during the interim. (you will be compensated according to your previous contract if you decide to continue producing, you wont get commission for producing if you WERE an LOA agent because your effective comp is 0%) * This safeguards agents from being stuck in unfavorable relationships. Most agents prefer waiting until the start of the year to minimize risks. The key is understanding your contract and navigating transitions safely, which is something many agents overlook. # A Brief History of the Release Process (why the heck is it this way?) The "agent-release" process emerged in the late 90s and early 2000s to manage transfers between FMOs and carriers. Unfortunately, it was often abused, with FMOs refusing to grant releases, especially during AEP, leaving agents trapped in bad contracts. To address this, carriers like UnitedHealthcare, Aetna, and Humana introduced transfer freezes during AEP to protect their investments. The "intent to transfer" process, developed in the late 2000s and early 2010s, aimed to fix these issues by providing agents a path to transfer without jeopardizing their business. # Misunderstandings About Releases If your agency/FMO/upline tells you "you can't transfer," it's likely because their training hasn't been updated to reflect the proper release procedures. This isn't usually malicious, they just want to ensure you're not left without commissions. Nobody wants to risk that. Also, the information is incredible "gate-kept", it's not a "sexy" process everyone wants to learn, until they need it... If you're looking for additional insight, this [YouTube video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NaExikyNwzo) (not affiliated with me or my company) provides a solid overview of the release process. However, it doesn't touch on the contract-level distinctions I've outlined here. Understanding these processes can help you avoid costly errors and confidently take control of your career. If you have questions or need clarification, feel free to ask!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gv923a/what_uplines_dont_want_you_to_know_carrier/

↳ Inner_Friendship5913 (2): "I just got my license in September and knew absolutely nothing about insurance. I started with Equis and had a very bad experience with my upline and felt like I was stuck with no one to teach me or train me. The top group person just blew smoke when I tried to get help so I left. I signed with Symmetry and I'm having a difficult time getting Equis to release me because they say they don't require it but Symmetry does require it. Symmetry has already started to get me started with other insurance carriers. I only had 5 with Equis. I have got no contracts with any carriers with Symmetry yet in my email but I know they started the process. BUT I was never told that I have to split my commissions 40%(me) and 60%(SME agent). I spoke to transamerica and Mutual of Omaha and they said I'd be penalized 90 days for ending the contract through Equis. So if I decide to not stay at Symmetry then that is even more insurance carriers that I'll be stuck waiting 90 days to work with again. I honestly have no idea where to go from here. I don't want to do all the work and a finalizing agent take 60% of my commissions. What company out there allows you to keep your commissions outside of the Small bit your upline gets? Or at least a fair amount?"

↳ RedditInsuranceGuy (1): "I would need to know what line of insurance you are talking about to get more specific. But basically its a standard wait of 6 months after a documented request of release from the contract for most carriers. Mutual of Omaha is pretty strict on that stuff. As far as what you do going forward is find an IMO that can fill the gaps with something competitive in the meantime while you process the releases and wait it out."

↳ Standard-Position698 (1): "I am in the process of trying to get a release/terminate contract. My up-line has refused to continue to reply and has removed me from all platforms and blocked me but will not release my contract."

"Beware of MLM structured companies (warning) So this was originally a response to a comment on this sub, but I see a ton of new people coming into insurance, (speaking to independent guys here) and there are many many hungry wolves waiting to recruit these naïve noobs and make a profit. So, I figured I could make a post using some of the content from my previous response to explain the caveats and expose the reality of these places. I come from a MLM originally, it was unbenounced to me at the time, but I'm still grateful because it gave me a first hand glance at what goes on there. How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. They will push you to build a team, because hey, don't you wanna make 6 figures "bro"??? Well then you gotta build a huge team so you get all those overrides off the guys under you. Now, there's nothing wrong necessarily with building a team, but in a MLM context and the way they act in a deceptive manner it is extremely unethical. The guys you see writing 100k plus in premium a year??? A fraction of that fell of the books and was a chargeback, then that guy like all of us has to pay taxes at the end of the year. He also probably was buying \$500 worth of leads a week. Burned gas every day meeting clients. He "maybe" profited 40k that year, and that's being generous. But as long as they can show boat how much premium they're writing a week? A month? A year? Then shove the rhetoric down new guys throats, boasting about how they too can make 100k a year? Then they're all good. I found out through a credible source, as well as David Dufford (has a youtube channel, good tips and insight for insurance) that alot of these "top producers" buy the trips that you can win with insurance carriers for writing a lot of AP. They do all of this and sugar coat their actual earnings because you'll buy the dream, go sell sell sell, and the guys above you get all the overrides off of you without investing any of their money into you at all. It's a fucking amazing model for the guys at the top to make a killing. They create a strong sense of family at those places to keep you on board as well. They push shitty products like Americo a ton too, because they get higher commissions off of that. Americo is also pricey, and you can easily find a cheaper product for that senior to actually help them out, but more than likely they won't have many cheap options that actually are economical for the client, because then you, and them get a lower commission. So MLM's will typically encourage you to get a higher premium out of the client and force a pricey carrier on them. Hope this helps. Reputable, ethical IMO's that offer you high commission contracts and don't push you to build teams are harder to find, because they don't market and recruit. Join an insurance forum, those guys are veterans and a lot of the IMO/Brokerage owners are members there. I've been in Life Insurance for a while now, and am branching into Health/Medicare, so anyone can feel free to PM me with Life Insurance questions if you'd like. Also it would be cool to maybe post any experiences you've had with these types of organizations."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/n4hblb/beware_of_mlm_structured_companies_warning/

↳ pdxoss (6): "I hate MLM too but if someone is making 100k and paying for leads/gas, taxes etc. Their take home isn't 40%. They're going to write off marketing expenses, gas, and everything they can on taxes"

↳ coreyjacrispy (5): "Haha, not specifically, they are are a known MLM company though. Them, Primerica, Symmetry etc etc. Anytime they're trying to force the Kool aid down your throat, with generic phrases and lectures like "You can take this and be BIG man, BIG...you want to have complete financial freedom? Be on your own clock? WE give you the tools to do that! We are a family, and want everyone to succeed" Blah blah blah lol, rest assured knowing they are indeed a MLM company."

↳ Tahoptions (3): ">How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. That is only for simplified products like final expense and mortgage protection. Street is no where near 120% for most traditional products. It is much closer to 85-100% (for term/GUL/IUL) and even lower for permanent products from big mutuals like Guardian and Mass. The post is a good warning though."

"I'm sorry you are in the wrong organization? I sell final expense and Medicare, I ended up with the lifestyle you talk about after about 3 years. I buy leads, but I've never spent more than 50k in leads in the course of a year. I've been insanely profitable, without needing to build a downline, for almost a decade. It exists. But, you do need to have good contracts and leads that don't bleed you and actual sales training."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nmbbqg/starting_to_think_the_money_and_lifestyle_is_a/nfbupuz/

"Is this really something you can do as a side hustle? I met someone the other day that apparently makes 50 grand in commission each year on medicare renewals alone, and she also does life insurance. She told all of us that she does this part time on the side as a side hustle independent. She has a full 9-5 job. She buys leads but most is from word of mouth. My question is for someone coming into this with no experience, do you think it's doable to start out doing this part time and expect to make decent income? Or... is this really a full time gig? I don't want to half dedicate myself to this when it really takes full dedication. Interested to hear your thoughts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vzuzbf/is_this_really_something_you_can_do_as_a_side/

↳ UrDeafFrdMikey (35): "No this is not a side hustle. Go ahead and be an insurance agent and if you need more money go become a bartender/server/delivery driver on the weekend nights."

↳ KiniShakenBake (15): "Not. It is not. Most definitely not. I would argue that two lines is a full time job. More than that is... More than a full time job. Ask me how I know...."

↳ StealthMcNinja (13): "It sounds like maybe she worked hard only on the insurance sales for a while and then backed off the aggressive sales when she had enough clients to make 50k in renewal commissions. At that point she could step away and work a regular job with the insurance on the side. It's definitely not a side hustle in the beginning."

"And find a solid lead source. I run my own ads on social media, and buy aged leads (30+ days) from USA Life Leads to help fill my day. I've wasted sooo much money on leads. More does not equal better.."

— YouTube · My BIGGEST Advice To A New Life Insurance Agent! 🌈 #insurance #insuranceagent #insurancesa · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AGiTFBC4oSM&lc=UgzcN16DCaTdKHMfyIB4AaABAg>

↳ @franko8572 (1): "Hi. About to be licensed. Where do you find your leads?"

↳ @DiabloPollo (0): "@franko8572! run ads on social media, and also use usa life leads. One of their packages is 100 leads for \$175, so I do 1-2 of those a week. Just depends on my schedule and how many leads my ads are pulling that week."

"Work for an independent that has the best prices in my province, so nothing. They come to me. We have 25 companies. Provide quick quotes, quick binds, quick service when they need something done to their policy. A variety of ways they can reach out. Retain most of my clientele year over year. Re-market my current clients if I need too. The way it should be. This lead factory head hunting, farming for clients you barely know and paying for someone to send you a list of numbers is wild to me - is this common in America? I think the Canadian industry is a bit different. I don't know anyone who has to buy leads. Seems like an awful way to retain a trustworthy client base. Is it just dog eat dog down there, constantly churning through clients or what?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/n4j6o3w/

Captive or call-center job first · 281 documents · 20 voices

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crid=11ZYLHHQAVSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&srefix=how+to+win+friend%2C&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: | Industry | Description | I --- I --- I | Tech | You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. | I | Med | You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in *The Pursuit of Happiness*. | I | Finance/Insurance | You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. | I | Hardware/Construction | Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. | I | Cars | You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. | I | Door to Door | Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. | I So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. | JOB TITLE | PAY RANGE (Salary) | PAY RANGE (OTE) | DESCRIPTION** | I --- I --- I --- I | SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) | £25,000 - £40,000 | £50,000 - £80,000 | Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. | I | SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive | £30,000 - £60,000 | £50,000 - £140,000 | Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. | I | MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive | £40,000 - £75,000 | £60,000 - £150,000 | Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. | I | ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive | £50,000 - £100,000 | £70,000 - £250,000 | Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. | I | SALES MANAGER | £60,000 - £120,000 | £80,000 - £200,000 | Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. | I | MD: Managing Director | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. | I | HEAD OF SALES | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. | I | Terminology | Description | I --- I --- I | Cold call | When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. | I | Lead | This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead'', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. | I | Account | This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. | I | Contact | This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. | I | Example of a lead, a contact and an account. | Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

↳ vitaferox (58): "This was excellent advice for getting any sales job, honestly. And too many people skip those basics"

↳ titan623 (18): "I could kiss you right now. I've been a long time lurker and seen/saved a ton of great info for the job search, I've been meaning to sit down and organize it all. This is a SUCH a resource, especially with the concise examples, perfect for referencing. Thanks for putting this together."

↳ TheUneducatedPotato (14): "To add something that helped me land my new sales role: if you're asked to give a presentation like a 30/60/90 day plan, bring a paper copy in those cheap presentation folders. Give them out before the presentation so your interviewers can take notes. I had to fly across county to a hotel where they booked a conference room and guess what, the projector didn't work that morning. No worries. I had the power point, printed two slides per page, in a presentation folder, ready to go. Both interviewers were stunned with my fore thought and it saved me from having them crowd around my laptop looking over my shoulder. It's the little things that show you're thinking ahead."

"Insurance sales is a joke, right? Former insurance salesman here(notice that it doesn't say agent) and after having several sales roles with varying commission structures consistently the worst ones were always the insurance roles besides working for a moving company. Having to pay for my licenses, taking 20-60 hours of coursework, having to deal with some of the worst pools of leads I've had to work with from people who don't even know who you are, to having to try to sell a 500\$ monthly premium to the couple paying a fourth of that through a local farm bureau. It just never, ever felt rewarding. The icing on the shit-cake being that you never even saw a lick of commission until you reach a certain threshold. Even the other shitty companies would let you have a crumb of the pie, but insurance tends to fall on the "salary" model so that while your base is higher than most, you better get used to that base. I've gotten good training in my career from jobs like this, but unless it's a me issue how the hell has anyone survived there longterm besides outlasting and inheriting books of business? I work in the dealership side of things now and do not regret it a sliver. edit: "clarification""

— r/sales · 202 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1wknc2q/insurance_sales_is_a_joke_right/

↳ Direct317 (269): "In school we used to go on a field trip to this place called JA Biztown. It's a fake town where all the kids have "jobs" and pay for stuff and be an adult for a day basically. Long story short I got in trouble at school and my punishment was to be an insurance salesman at JA Biztown instead of the job I picked "Radio DJ". Ever since then I knew insurance sales was a fate worse than death. Get outta there man find something else lol"

↳ International_Cow198 (174): "No harder way to make \$50k, no easier way to make \$500k"

↳ jroberts67 (170): "Saying insurance sales is a joke is a bit like saying selling real estate is a joke. Failure rate is insane. Those who dig in and become experts kill it."

"State Farm just rewrote 19,000 agents' contracts overnight. If you think a captive book is a retirement plan, read this If you somehow missed it: State Farm is moving all 19,000 of its agents onto a single standardized contract, ending their deferred-comp/retirement program (AIPP), and dropping health insurance for agents and spouses. Agents are reportedly looking at 30–40% less on base commissions depending on contract and book size. I can't believe State Farm disputes that number but hasn't offered its own. The core shift is from getting paid to "retain" a book to getting paid to "write new business". They also put buyout offers on the table with a Sept 30 deadline. P&C side, I know. But the lesson isn't carrier-specific and it's the thing I keep coming back to: you never actually owned that book. State Farm did. And a 20-year "trailing income" promise is only worth as much as the carrier's willingness to keep paying it which turned out to be "until it's inconvenient." The part that should get every agent's attention is the direction, not the one carrier. Comp is going performance-based across the board, trailing/renewal-style income is getting squeezed, and AI is going to absorb more of the service and retention work that used to justify those trails. The "come build a \$3–5M book and coast" pitch a lot of us were sold is quietly being retired. So I'm genuinely curious how the room sees it: Are you seeing comp pressure at your carrier/IMO too, or is this a State Farm-specific overreach? Does owning your book independently actually protect you here, or is that just trading carrier risk for lead-cost/chargeback risk? For the newer agents is anyone factoring "can they rewrite my deal in 5 years" into where they sign? Not trying to dunk on State Farm agents since a lot of them got blindsided and it's a rough spot. More interested in what this says about where the whole comp model is heading."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/

↳ MonLower (39): "Feeling good about being independent and part of multiple agent associations. While this industry is far from perfect, this is the best place to be in my estimation. I feel bad for the SF agents that are up against serious changes. State Farm is quite offended by Progressive taking their spot and is looking to get more flexible to compete. My carriers have lowered commission rates, but often times will renege due to our agencies ability to place with other carriers. Overall, comp has decreased in my 15 years but not to the point of being unsustainable. A few percentage points with most large carriers."

↳ Splodingseal (19): "It's a shit or get off the pot approach. They want agents that are hungry to write as much business as possible and to get rid of Bob and his secretary that kinda coast along only writing as much as he needs to keep the lights on."

↳ firenance (18): "Independents are more insulated as carriers tend to influence performance with contract terminations or adjusting profit share or bonus commission metrics. They don't like you, they just fire you."

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

↳ Heavy_Following_1114 (19): "You view it as a job, not a career, You have an income requirement that's initially unattainable, You're intimidated by being undercut, You don't have a solid support system, You need to be nurtured, You're not driven enough, You never learned sales and marketing, You don't forge good enough relationships with clients, You don't study enough, You don't adapt, You're not an effective communicator, You aren't familiar with the markets, You don't have enough confidence in your products, You don't have a mentor, You don't market online, You don't do enough prospecting, You don't try hard enough, You don't stay on top of trends, You don't use new technology, You don't network enough, You don't treat your role as a business, Your expectations are too big from the start, Your expectations are too small from the start, You didn't get a quality education and training, You aren't focused enough, You didn't save enough money to support yourself while you grow a book, You're using dead-end leads, You don't have the right mindset, You're not qualifying your clients, You're too emotional, You're easily intimidated, You're not hungry enough to succeed, You're selling insurance and not solutions, You don't know how to set appointments, You're not a good presenter, You're not picking the right carriers for your prospects, You're not locking down the markets, You're not offering enough value, You don't have enough practical knowledge, You're focusing on the wrong things, You have too much freedom, You're limiting yourself, You're not making good first impressions, You're not following up enough, You're following up too much and scaring clients away, The job is too stressful, You lack patience, You're not making yourself available enough for your clients, You're not being proactive, You're not participating enough in your community"

↳ ThatWideLife (12): "There's one main reason why agents leave, they are in poverty with a full time job. Insurance is great for those who live with parents and have minimal bills. I'd say for a majority of people, they don't have a year to sit back and hope they start making money."

↳ [deleted] (10): "Selling isn't for most people. Selling insurance isn't for most sales people.. selling life insurance isn't for 99% of licensed insurance agents.. I just started a few months ago and I write 5K issued AP per week on a bad week, 7K -8K on average weekly with a high of 11K weekly... this sht isn't rocket scientist like everyone makes it seem. It's ad spend, closing ratio and systems."

"Update: Being let go from a toxic agency turned out to be the best thing that could have happened to me As you can see from my original post, I received a lot of negative comments. To be fair, I posted less than an hour after being let go and was extremely emotional. I should have taken some time to calm down before posting. That being said, I still stand by the main point of my post: a toxic workplace is not something anyone should be expected to tolerate simply because an industry can be stressful. The insurance field is not "too hard" for me. I have dealt with difficult customers throughout my entire working career. I have been yelled at, hung up on, spoken down to, and blamed for things outside of my control. That comes with working with the public. However, your boss should not tell you to "shut the hell up before I get nasty with you" in front of your coworkers, especially over a routine replacement or add-on — and especially when you did not make a mistake to begin with. In this situation, it was actually a replacement, and my former boss was the one who had it wrong. (never got that apology from him lol) After I formally addressed the way I was spoken to, the situation became retaliatory. My separation letter included five days as though I had called out repeatedly, when those were days I had asked to delay my original start date so I could handle personal matters and begin the following week with a clear schedule. I even found the email confirming that discussion. I was going to remind him of that by replying to the separation letter with that email, but at this point, I decided to leave it alone and move forward. And that brings me to the real update: To everyone who told me to look into working for an independent agency: **thank you**. I start my new position on Monday. It is much closer to the type of work I was doing before 📍, but with an independent agency. I was told that others in the industry were already familiar with the turnover issues at my former office, which helped remind me that my experience was not simply a reflection of my ability to succeed in insurance. My new position includes: **A \$7,900 salary increase** Benefits beginning after 30 days A one-hour lunch instead of 30 minutes Five eight-hour workdays No weekends Paid nationwide holidays The employer covering 90% of the health insurance premium Looking back, being fired by that office may have been the best thing that could have happened to me. To anyone who said the insurance field was not for me: standing up for yourself does not mean you are incapable of doing your job. Refusing to accept humiliation, harassment, or retaliation does not make you lazy, overly sensitive, or full of excuses. If you wake up every morning wondering what the yelling, condescending remarks, or unnecessary criticism will be about that day, start looking for another job. I am not talking about someone who simply dislikes working or cannot accept constructive feedback. I am talking about people who work hard, are genuinely being treated poorly and starting to question their own abilities because of it. The insurance industry is huge. One toxic workplace does not represent the entire field, and one difficult boss does not determine your future. Sometimes one door shuts so that a much better one can open. **Thank you, independent agencies!"**

— r/InsuranceAgent · 34 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ty3ilq/update_being_let_go_from_a_toxic_agency_turned/

↳ CapitalE__ (8): "This legit gave me hope 🥰 . I was just told by a recruiter the manager loved me (interview today). Hopefully Monday I get good news. Anyway, congrats!!! 🎉 May your journey go well. Btw, saw your last post, was a bit confusing but after reading I got the gist. Sorry you went through that, but as you said, one closed for an even better one right? Keeping that hope for myself. Have a great first day and enjoy your weekend"

↳ Natepeeeff (4): "So glad you made the choice! Seeing the horror stories of people working for captive companies and just being beaten down is awful. When I got into insurance a while back I knew that the agency I got with would take care of me. (A very well known one around here.) Like with any insurance agency, the numbers are the driving factor. But they'll at least treat you like a human being and not a machine. I hope it works out well, and very glad you tagged me in the comment on the other post with this update. Good work!"

↳ Terrible_Juice805 (3): "Good for you. It gives hope that those of us that are in shit pay environment and you are belittleed and empowered at all can find something better."

"Brand New Independent Agents This is just a rant post. I find it extremely weird when brand new agents want to be independent but also expect everything to be given to them. The entire point of being independent is that you are the OWNER of YOUR business. If I decided to open to a floral shop, I would have to pay for inventory, supplies, a website, marketing, and anything else that I needed to run my business. I'd be responsible for going out and marketing myself & my business to attract customers. I wouldn't expect to make money if I was only open for a couple of hours a few days a week, because no one else is giving me a paycheck. And if I didn't know how to run a business, I would find someone who could give me the play by play. Not just someone who said they could, but someone who had proof they'd done it. Insurance is no different. New independent agents are constantly complaining about back office fees, that their IMO doesn't provide them free leads, being 1099, and having to actually bust their ass to make money... and after putting forth half ass effort, blame their agency or upline for not making money. If you want a paycheck, to clock out the same time every day, and someone to provide you leads, GO CAPTIVE. This is why most new agents fail because they saw someone on TikTok that told them they could make \$20,000 in a month. Which is POSSIBLE, I have seen it, not fresh out the gate. You don't even know what you're doing yet! And honestly, you already need to have money put back to carry you in the beginning months until you start to make money... that's where you need to start anyway. This isn't a get rich quick scheme. It's a real business that you have to put real work into."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tnmhue/brand_new_independent_agents/

↳ One-Stranger-6894 (12): "I have some 1099 agents that I furnish 90% of their leads, office space, phones, tech, marketing etc and they'll call me cheap for not covering their game of golf etc. Like, some of these people would never make it on their own from scratch like many of us had to do."

↳ WillBe-TheAgent (5): "It's a different generation. And I also think it has a lot to do with the false advertising on social media and bad groups out there selling 20 year olds a dream that they can make 6 figures in 3 months. Bring back door knocking, Walmart tables, and cold calling from a phone book. Lol. Jk. But they surely wouldn't have survived that"

↳ howtoreadspaghetti (5): ""If it has 1% to do with work or is adjacent to work then it should be fully covered by work otherwise I won't do it." It's a really stupid way to act and believe."

"Buying an Independent Insurance Agency I am interested in purchasing my own independent agency and currently in the process of researching what that entails. Background: I currently work for a family agency where I am 3rd generation. My grandfather started the business, and I work under my dad and alongside my siblings. I have been at the agency for 5 years. I thought that it was fixable, but things are not going the way I hoped. There is always a ton of family drama that spills into the workplace, and it is a very unprofessional environment that drives me crazy. I am the only one who has outside work experience (previously an engineer for 10 years). Everyone else came straight to the agency and lacks very common and important real-life skills. Managing a calendar, Microsoft office knowledge, how to communicate effectively (to carriers, customers, and co-workers), etc... I come from a sales background so managing a pipeline and working with business owners or homeowners comes naturally. I've also been managing marketing, accounting, and day-to-day business operations, referral commercial lines quoting, CL renewals and networking for the agency. 90% of the daily decisions are made by me and then my father just blindly signs off on them because he is the principal and checked out (ready to retire). I have transitioned the agency to a new AMS, new accounting software, and transitioned most of our book away from agency bill. I have successfully increased efficiency by taking our 8-person agency down to 3.5 people. No one was fired, we had old staff and everyone retired. I thought we were going to be able to work together as siblings and run the agency, I was wrong. I tried a couple times to sit everyone down individually and talk about goals, dream responsibilities, and other things that would help align all our visions but am always met with "I dunno", or "I don't care", or "This is stupid, stop trying to make this a corporate office". Anytime there is a disagreement there is either a huge fight or one sibling goes to our mom who manipulates my dad into making the decision behind our back. I am looking for guidance from agency owners or industry veterans. What mistakes did you make when starting out or how would you do it differently now. 1. I am not interested in a captive agency 2. I understand PE acquisitions are at an all-time high but there are a good number of small mom and pop shop agencies around with limited succession planning (Ohio) 3. I understand getting a new carrier appointment right now during the hard market is very difficult if not currently impossible, but I will weigh the agencies current carrier selection very carefully 4. I understand this is a HUGE undertaking and the YEARS of work it will require Thank you in advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l48ryh/buying_an_independent_insurance_agency/

↳ firenace (14): "Agency M&A consultant. I consult on situations like this all the time. Sadly it's super common. Unfortunately in many cases the answer is leave because you won't change the family dynamic. Listen to the scratch agency podcast. The host Stephen left a 4 generation family agency to start his own. Don't think it was similar drama, but similar decision. I'm sure he would chat with you about his journey. Yes you are right. Buying is expensive, but there can be great opportunities if you network directly with small town owners getting ready to retire. Do not buy a small book of business <\$300K through a broker, but do work with an advisor. I don't normally do this because they are a competitor of mine, but connect with IA Valuations, it's a division of OIA and they may be able to give you some pointers or recommendations in your state."

↳ Comprehensive_Act772 (7): "No experience with this...just want to say good luck and I hope this works out for you. Such a tough situation."

↳ firenace (5): "Under 300 K revenue through a business broker. In most cases, it's gonna be a book transfer and valuation is completely subjective. Small book brokers will just say 2.5 times revenue without really evaluating risk like carrier concentration, book mix, or policies per customer metrics. Or even how the book was built. If it was all online or purchased leads the retention on that is gonna be completely different than somebody with a high reputation local agency."

"Is a Life & Health Insurance License Useless? 🤔 I've had a Life & Health Insurance license for 2 weeks. It feels useless for finding a job. All the local captive agents focus on Property & Casualty. They like seeing L&H but they don't sell any. Even if they advertised for a L&H position. I applied to local banks and credit unions. I'm a notary too but heard nothing back. A recruiter from Brown & Brown reached out. She liked my resume and experience a lot. B2B Sales and Marketing, Tradeshows, SEO, etc. She has no job for me. I've had Life Insurance and Medicare outfits calling me. All commission based. They sound like scams and MLMs. I've tried getting an Employee Benefits Advisor job but these seem rare. Ideally I'd like to work at a hospital and help people choose health plans. Applied with health insurance companies. Haven't heard back. Are L&H license useful at all? What should I do to find a job? UPDATE - The Kaplan training I did was part of a hiring process for a Financial Services company. They paid with no strings attached as part of the final hiring process. They ended up not hiring me even after I passed the test. The goal was to do SIE and other FINRA certs. UPDATE 2 - Many of you are saying just go get a Property & Casualty license via DM. Yes would be good to do but I don't have a ton of money right now. Would much prefer to get a job that will pay for my P&C training and licensing. I was thinking of just watching Melissa from Insurance Exam Queen. She and Peter were so valuable for passing the L&H test."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lavq1r/is_a_life_health_insurance_license_useless/

↳ mental_mentalist (13): "You could find life and health carriers and go to their careers section (although they may want experience you may not have)"

↳ takeagander20 (9): "A couple of Medicare agencies who are frequently looking for remote workers, that pay a steady base and a little extra money for enrollments are ResultsCX, and Select Quote. You won't get rich working for either outfit but you can get your feet wet and gain the confidence necessary to go 1099, which is what I'm doing this year since my first AEP and OEP as an hourly sales agent went so well. Getting in is mainly a matter of timing though. Seems I got hired in mid July, to start late September, so you might be a little early. Keep looking on indeed, and you will progressively see more Medicare Sales ads show up day by day. You'll eventually see one or two that offer an hourly base. Good luck!"

↳ mkuz753 (7): "Brown & Brown is a large national independent agency/brokerage. There are many others. Keep in mind that most L&H licensed people end up in employee benefits, aka group plans."

"It's my first day as an independent insurance agent! I used to be a captive age but I didn't feel like I was able to provide the service I feel my community of artists so I quit and decided to become an independent agent. After 2 months of hemming and hawing applying to jobs in other sales fields I finally decided it was enough and found 2 IMOs. One focused on health the other focused on life and P&C. Today I signed my last contracts to be appointed with their major carriers and I started prospecting. I sent out maybe 50-70 linked in messages with one simple goal in mind. Ask 5 people to sit for an appointment with you. I accomplished my goal at 1 pm with one appointment set. Then I went out networking and was able to book a second. 5 is tomorrow's number as well. I want to go a full week with 5 tasks every day except Sunday. As a wise poet from the San Francisco Bay Area once said, "I'm feeling myself"."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pc01jr/its_my_first_day_as_an_independent_insurance_agent/

↳ QuiriousCoyote (3): "Nice to hear a positive story. Keep up the good work and good luck!"

↳ theimprovednatee (2): "What's systems? I work with 7 realtors who send me business VERY consistently. I don't want to be a captive agent anymore"

↳ Toppoppler (1): "You work with artists? As a new captive producer, thats the market I want to work within as its the market I come from. Would you have any tips on finding/connecting with artists, what type of coverages they might need, etc?"

"Incomes can widely vary based on captive or independent. When you have a salary or safety net, the incomes you mention are doable, it is recommend that newbies start out as captive before venturing out on your own. Most will fail in the first year going it alone. My agency did over 1.2 million and on track for 1.5 this year, but many years of hard work, it is definitely more rewarding on the independent side, but not for everyone."

— YouTube · How Much Does A Health Insurance Agent Makelbeingbougie · 21 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RrGUFRdgtZY&lc=UgxPaeU0nrh1AzCEkX94AaABAq>

↳ @catmouse2882 (0): "Is your agency hiring?"

"New job offer with an independent agency. So my base will actually be \$45,000 because I have all the licenses. But this comp structure seems very low. From what I understand during the interview I will not be doing much cold calling and I'll be working warm leads. I won't actually do many quotes either just build rapport and close. They have an in-house guy that looks at all the decs and puts some proposals together between multiple carriers. They showed me some reports and they do hit their goals/metrics pretty often and so it "shouldn't be hard" hitting goal. I am a very motivated sales rep. But the salary seemed really good and I think I see why. What are your thoughts?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tv96xv/>

↳ (0): "If you can hit 50+ a month it's good but Indy does not not usually have scaling commission like this. Seems fishy. I bet no one is selling more than 50/mo there. Oh actually after reading the text, go for it. If you aren't quoting and the leads are warm, if you are good at listening and a people person, know how to sell, you should be fine. Might not be a permanent deal but I'd rock this for a few years probably and maybe renegotiate. Big thing: Renewals?"

↳ (0): "I have to ask about renewals. We really didn't talk money when I was there today. One of his staff reached out with an offer letter just a little while ago. I'm going back Tuesday to discuss when to start and go over pay so I'll have to see."

↳ (0): "Agent is paying you less than 2% on P&C for \$40k—that's insultingly low in my opinion. Overall commission structure seems low for an independent. Do you get renewal commission on P&C?"

"How is everyone marketing in 2025 without spending a fortune? For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down. Since, I've tried multiple vendors, and I've tried data leads + telemarketers. It feels like no matter what I do, I have to spend 5 grand a month in marketing at least for each of my producers just to hit our goals. It's way too much, and as we spend more to make less, I'm feeling bad burnout as my margins shrink. Primarily P&C, captive agent. So what is everybody doing that's working?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2g/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/

↳ BluebirdFast3963 (16): "Work for an independent that has the best prices in my province, so nothing. They come to me. We have 25 companies. Provide quick quotes, quick binds, quick service when they need something done to their policy. A variety of ways they can reach out. Retain most of my clientele year over year. Re-market my current clients if I need too. The way it should be. This lead factory head hunting, farming for clients you barely know and paying for someone to send you a list of numbers is wild to me - is this common in America? I think the Canadian industry is a bit different. I don't know anyone who has to buy leads. Seems like an awful way to retain a trustworthy client base. Is it just dog eat dog down there, constantly churning through clients or what?"

↳ registeredfake (9): "ive got to say, it does not matter what question is asked by anyone in this sub every one think the answer is Independent this independent that. OP is asking for marking ideas, is already an agent where he has invested his time and money to build something and your first thought is to go independent. stupid"

↳ Armstrongs_ball (7): "Stop. Buying. Leads. Go independent, network, build your book of business by referrals and word of mouth. After a few years, you'll be living off your book of business and getting referrals left and right from clients, assuming you provide good service. Buying leads is literally the biggest waste of \$ in this industry and it's not even close. And good luck actually retaining those clients. They'll be the first to leave after their auto rate increases \$10/month of their first renewal."

"The thing that frustrates me about recent news is that many of us likely completely agree that for profit health insurance is just not a good model. But people who hear insurance just assume all of us are in health insurance and just rolling in cash and laughing. I'm a PC reinsurance broker working mainly with captives. People have no clue what I actually do."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1i58bx2/given_how_much_the_insurance_industry_has_been_in/m81suw3/

"When Integrity Collides With the Insurance Industry # When Integrity Collides With the Insurance Industry After a year as a licensed Life, Health & Accident insurance agent—with certifications in Medicare, Fixed Annuities, and Long- and Short-Term Care—I find myself disillusioned, but not defeated. I've worked with three agencies in twelve months. On paper, that looks like instability. In reality, it tells a much more uncomfortable story about how our industry often operates—and who it quietly pushes out. # The First Lesson: Sales Without Suitability My first agency offered free leads, a platform, and a fast track into final expense sales. What it also offered—though less transparently—was pressure. Pressure to sell without first asking whether clients had the financial capacity to participate at all. Pressure to push forward even when something felt wrong. I voiced my concern early. I was clear that bullying tactics and financial assumptions were not how I wanted to serve families. Insurance, after all, is meant to protect people—not corner them. That discomfort was my first warning sign. # The Second Lesson: Knowledge Without Direction The second agency was rich in information and poor in application. Training was constant. Zoom calls filled my days. Education was abundant—but clarity was not. At one point, I asked what I thought was a simple question: "Out of over 250 life insurance policies, which ones should I focus on when serving clients?" The answer was blunt: "Read them all and figure it out." Eventually, the trainings did help. But what was missing was real-world guidance—how to connect authentically with people, how to build relationships beyond vague social media posts that thousands of agents were already making with little return. Knowledge alone does not serve families. Applied wisdom does. # The Third Lesson: Ethics Versus Politics The third agency was captive. The training was solid. For the first time, I learned how to identify real markets and pursue them responsibly. But there was a problem—one that went far deeper than sales technique. A field agent, protected as the "golden child," consistently wrote bad business. Junior agents came and went. Clients were placed into policies that should never have been written. Accountability never traveled upward. When I raised concerns—concerns later corroborated by other agents—I became the problem. When a longstanding nerve issue flared and I was forced to work from home temporarily, the support others received quietly vanished for me. Where teammates had appointments covered during health or family crises, I was left alone. Eventually, I was let go—for "not taking my business seriously." Within five months, nearly everyone on that team was gone. # What This Taught Me I've been told I'm too honest. Too nice. Too much of a "Girl Scout." But here's what I know to be true: insurance done correctly can be a family's saving grace. It can create stability, preserve dignity, and protect generations—*if* it is written with intention, education, and suitability at its core. I believe clients deserve: * Clear explanations of what a policy **can and cannot** do * Solutions aligned with their actual income and goals * Time to understand, not pressure to comply * Guidance that considers today *and* tomorrow That shouldn't be radical. Yet too often, it is. # The Question I'm Asking Now Is there an agency that believes insurance should be built for generational impact—not quick commissions? An agency that values education over hype. Integrity over volume. Long-term relationships over short-term wins. I'm still here because I believe in this work. I believe in serving people honestly, even when honesty slows the sale. Especially then. If that makes me a "Girl Scout," I'll wear the badge. Because families don't need more salespeople. They need advocates."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1q6lb33/when_integrity_collides_with_the_insurance/

↳ Bendstowardsjustice (8): "AMEN! i have been on a similar journey. i left my last IMO after i had a "wait a second, am in a cult?" realization. it was led by a psychopathic narcissist, so that was the culture. like every psychopathic narcissist, there was the underlying truth and there was the surface of the mask and when in it, it can be hard to tell the difference. the surface mask was, "we are here to help people, we are here to support each other, we are so special". the underlying truth was that it was an MLM style parasitic predatory organization whose leadership was all about grabbing the money bag and draining as much blood from as many people as possible whether they were agents (through low commissions and crazy overpriced junk leads) or clients. they preyed on the vulnerable, the leader surrounded himself with women who had backgrounds in drug addiction, trauma, abusive parental and romantic relationship histories. later on i learned from women who had left that the founder/leader was sexually predatory and pressured women there to sleep with him by making them feel indebted to him for "saving" them. i was banned from my cult's group chat bc people asked me for help with better lead sources bc i was shooting up the leaderboard while everyone else was struggling so i shared some sources i was using and succeeding with. they punished and smeared me for that. so i left with 2 other top 10 leaderboard agents and started my own agency. several other top agents left to join other imo's at the same time we left. my old imo started me at 60% commission levels and 45% for GL. i start people with zero experience at 75-90%. my cult IMO charged \$27 per callback data lead that they made bank on. i offer leads that i make zero dollars on and it is pay per presentation for \$25 with a 20% min close rate promise (i'm closing double that rate and i am not an elite closer), not pay per lead who doesn't even answer the phone. cult imo was recruiting like 50 agents per week. we don't run recruiting campaigns and limit our growth according to how many leads we can provide our agents to make sure everyone is well fed. my cult IMO preached "only 8% of agents make it" but at my agency we make it our problem to solve if a full time agent is not writing at least \$15k AP per month. my cult IMO punished people for leaving, smeared them with made up lies, would call the new uplines of people who left to try and blacklist them. we have an open release policy and would always go out of our way to make any transition out as friendly and peaceful as possible. there are good IMO's and agencies out there. i can recommend some if people are looking."

↳ OdteSPYFDs (8): "Pretty much everything in commercial insurance, especially for middle market or larger. The larger the insured the more buttoned up their operation is usually."

↳ Time_Care_102 (4): "Love this. I think I have found success in insurance bc I am not here to misrepresent. My words are a check you can take to the bank every time, that account will never run out. My entire operating system: under promise over deliver. I too work with a golden child agent and know the second I start any conversation about the impact to others within the company, the customers, and our reputation I too will likely face being forced out and seen as the problem. Already dealt with it before once. If you find that unicorn company- I will leave the moment I know what company that is and apply until they take me. Don't ever stop doing the right thing."

"Being an insurance agent is starting your own business. You have to pay for leads with either your money or your time. Anyone promising "free" leads is normally a complete scam (because any agency owner would just hire w2 employees to work the leads instead). The largest IMOs/agencies in the industry give you nothing but contracts (Crump, Ash, Simplicity, etc.) No recruiting or bullshit to make money. The rest is up to you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dt0fnh/why_i_left_the_life_insurance_industry/lb64i6g/

"I run my regions claims department. If you have written proof we'd consider covering it. I will admit if your captive it's a lot more likely independent it becomes our discretion"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1n20wgr/i_accidentally_did_not_add_collision_on_a_clients/nb2k0su/

"Quit \$150k W2 Sales to start an Agency. 6 Months in: Lessons learned from the "FE Trap" and pivoting to Group Health/Life. Feedback? I'm in my late 20s and recently walked away from a \$150k+ W2 sales career to build my own independent agency. I started with a \$2,000/month residual base from a previous ACA book and a small group. The Failure: I fell for the Final Expense hype. I burned several thousand dollars on my own ads, lead vendors, and a marketing firm. After 6 months, I realized the "social worker" aspect of FE isn't for me. I'm a consultant and advisor, not a hand-holder for the unbanked. The Pivot: I've officially pivoted to Group Health (U65), Individual Health, and Term Life. My daily "Machine" looks like this: • Cold Knocking: Visiting local businesses daily to prospect for Group Health. • Strategic Partners: Building a referral network (CPAs, P&C agents) for Life/Health leads. • Efficiency: Cutting all paid lead spend once current FE ads die. Reallocating that budget to BNI and local SEO. The Concern: I'm 6 months in and not profitable yet. I live in a major city and the grind is real. Thank God for my savings and residual base, but I want to make sure I'm not missing a gear. My Questions: 1. Aside from BNI and cold knocking, what high-leverage community events or "advisor-level" prospecting am I missing?"
— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rgt03f/>

↳ (0): "Insurance Sales is hard, if you don't already have a book of business. It will take a while to build the business."

↳ (0): "How long did it take you to profit?"

↳ (0): "Health biz is great, just takes years to build. Have you looked at using ICHRA to get into the door? Do some research on ICHRA if you haven't. Some other things I'd try: look for new business formations in your local newspaper and go drop in on them. Fresh meat! =) Also, how much activity are you doing? Are you cold knocking 30 businesses daily or making 100+ phone calls daily? A lack of activity is usually the cause of all sales woes. If you're looking for ways to bridge the gap with final expense, consider doing in-person seminars at local independent senior living facilities. Did those for 9 months and made around 100 sales with zero expense. Have seen dozens of other agents do well at it, too. Further, you could look at doing talks at small group church meetings, senior activity centers, about Medicare, final expenses, etc. Cost nothing and creates the best leads. Good luck. Remember it's normal that the first few years are incredibly difficult as you find your place. Stick with it and eventually you'll find your niche and begin getting traction!"

"Lead Generation New Agent, started in Jan as a W2, VERY low base salary with a commission split and no agency marketing or lead generation happening at the firm level. Everyone is on their own. I am struggling big time on getting lead generation going. Have been trying social media but have gotten virtually nothing from this. I've also been going to several leads/networking groups, have gone to about 3 meetings each. Do I door knock at this point? Looking for any tips or guidance.....feeling very defeated. I've quoted and called on the x-dates that were available and got a few from this but that's about it. I've asked for referrals on each sale I have done. Not getting any guidance from the principle."
— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1shk3tg/>

↳ (0): "It's tough, I've been there. u/dk-just-a-username has great info, I agree with all of that. I have a friend who drove around and walked into local businesses cold-calling, every morning from 8am-noon, for months. He would just go door to door, ask to quote their commercial insurance, ask questions & make notes if they said yes, then go on to the next one until noon. Then he'd eat his lunch, and quote all afternoon. It took a few months, but he got to where he was writing \$100k/month in new business off those. I was more focused on personal lines when I started; I met with realtors and mortgage lenders, had 5-7 coffee meetings with them every week, and if we hit it off I'd try to schedule a time to visit one of their sales meetings at their office. Hit it off with more lenders/realtors, rinse and repeat. Refer realtors to the lenders you really like, so they want to refer their clients to you. This is how I've built my business; it's a great way to go. Takes some time to get going, but once you do, you're living on referrals, not cold calls. Referrals are a MUCH higher close ratio, and way more fun to work. In the early months, when I was building that up, I spent money on leads. I put them on credit cards if I couldn't afford to pay cash. I don't recommend that, but whatever. I did it. I tried Dave Ramsey leads, Datalot (I think they have another name now?), Hometown, and a bunch of others. Ramsey & Datalot were the best, but also the most expensive. Datalot are live leads; they literally transfer them to you. There's a commercial insurance version of this too called Tivly; they're worth looking up. Any leads you buy will be expensive, but if you need to manufacture some business quick, it can work. There are also Aged leads you can buy for cheaper than hot ones. If you work up a good Aged lead script, and you're willing to be told 'No' a bunch, they can be good. I would also sponsor events, sports teams, etc. Go to the nonprofit, talk with them, say you want to do a fundraiser, and see if they'll help you market it on their socials. I'd put out there with groups that followed those charities that I was raising money for their charity; if you'd get a quote from me, I'd donate \$20 to that charity. No obligation to buy anything, just get a quote. Lots of those quotes turned into business, because lots of them had been meaning to shop their insurance anyway, and this was the excuse they needed. Use being the 'new guy' to your advantage. I used to walk into local businesses and say "Hey, I'm new, just started out at xyz insurance agency down the road. I just wanted to stop by and meet the neighbors!" See if anybody there will talk to you, make it low key, be interested in them, ask questions, etc. Honestly, activity breeds opportunity. The more you're out there, talking to people, being in the community, you're going to get opportunities to quote. If you're not winning quotes, then maybe you need a different agency, or you need to evaluate your sales process, but it sounds like right now you just need more opportunities. Good luck! The first 6 months are tough, but this is a KILLER career if you can make it."

↳ (0): "Thanks for everyone's words of encouragement and feedback. Apparently I was a day late and dollar short. Boss calls me at 4:45 Friday afternoon to let me know he is letting me go. Said I hadn't brought any business in. I asked when would he pay the commission on the 50k+ WP I brought in and he said he didn't realize I wrote it although I sent him a monthly excel sheet. SMH As much as it sucks being laid off, it's for the best. Clearly, this office was not the right fit so now I move on. Still a gut punch, was laid off at 50 and now again at 51. Never have I experienced this."

↳ (0): "I'm assuming you're selling commercial based on the networking groups. Doing what you're doing now will only help you, about 2-3 years down the road though. But you already answered your own question. Get a list of x-dates and make a lot of calls. A new agent's greatest asset is time. You have no defense to play, no book to service. You can spend that time on social media, networking, cold-calling or doing all 3. The former 2 are long term plays, the latter is immediate impact. If cold-calling makes you nervous, just remember that you could be the agent that sheds light on a coverage gap that could have ended the business's existence, or reduce a balance sheet expense enough that they can hire a new employee. That's why we're professionals. Key to calling, in my opinion, is having the xdate. If you call in that 2-3 month period prior to renewal, they're thinking about it, they'll talk (not all of them of course). You call after they renew, it's a dead horse, you're a pest. I use Insurance Xdate because they are really easy to use and seem to be the only ones that actually have Workers Comp xdates, but at this point there are a couple options for insurance specific data. PS Feeling defeated is definitely part of the business. Just wait until you pick up a deposit check on a 500k deal only to have the check canceled b/c the owner's son is golf buddies with the incumbent...then get BOR'd on the monoline Umbrella. That was over a decade ago and I still want to throat punch that sack of shit Tim."

"I work at a brokerage in life. I have gotten people approved with one of 40 carriers I have that would have been turned down everywhere else. If I was captive at one of 97.5% of these carriers, I would have had to say "sorry" instead of "you'll receive your policy packet in the mail." That's the root issue with captive. Regarding strictly comp, having to buy leads isn't fun. I don't do warm market. Look a few years down the line if you're producing even low six figures in AP, paying \$50-80 per lead at ~100% commission sounds a lot more fun than 40% with some marginal guarantee and no lead spend. It boils down to being able to help the client and your goals and risk tolerance."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vz10ku/why_does_captive_get_so_much_hate_verses_brokerage/p61bv2i/

"Should I stick with 100% commission? My wife is pregnant and I am unable to pay my mortgage. When I tell my managers they explain that I'm just not trying hard enough. I currently sell final expense and Medicare supplements. Should I stick with this or switch to something with a salary plus commissions? My last checks have been \$0 despite running around 24 appointments per week."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l4vp1u/should_i_stick_with_100_commission/

↳ ayhme (19): "Definitely find something with a salary."

↳ OwnKaleidoscope9758 (9): "They are telling me I'm just lazy and that's why I haven't made much money. I sold a ton of advantage plans and only made like \$600"

↳ carrera76 (6): "Salary = safe, less earning potential. 100 commission = risky, high earning potential. More risk, more reward. Choose what you think it right for you"

Referrals and their own book · 279 documents · 20 voices

"I am a licensed agent since 2006 and have clients on both Medigaps and Advantage Plans. It's our duty and obligation to give each client to do a thorough presentation and give them their options. Medigap plans are excellent but not all can budget a Medigap plan which increase every year and when it's a husband and wife the expense can really be a hardship. Then they have to pay separate for their part D and separate for dental insurance and so on. On the other hand, my parents and in-laws with medical issues like cancer and diabetes have done very well with advantage plans and still continue up to this day. Not to mention some clients may also qualify for Low-income Subsidies and Medicaid programs from their state so truly they are covered even 100% for all Medicare costs. Although they are managed care plans there are many professional physicians who participate in these advantage plans and the referral process is not a headache. There are not a one size fits all plan. Every client has unique situations, lifestyles, income and so forth. So, at the end of the day give your clients the option because if you don't do a good job explaining their options as discussed on Medicare and You handbook, another agent will come along and enroll them in a managed care plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 93 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=Ugz1PoROzLPt1BvWDah4AaABAq>

↳ @davidcampo2902 (13): "Everything you said is spot on! I I don't understand how this guy can generalize something as broad as a medicare into a little 16 minute video. There's so many other reasons why somebody would choose a Medicare Advantage plan as opposed to a supplement plan. Aside from your part B why would you pay a monthly premium for some thing that keeps going up for the most part every single year plus pay a separate premium for your part D drug plan plus pay copayment on top of that. You mentioned low income subsidy there's also state Medicaid and that comes along with a bunch of other benefits."

↳ @roberthoeller5516 (5): "I too sell both and agree with you 110%."

↳ @rodbutler4054 (4): "Spoken like a true insurance salesman!"

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

↳ 3xploringforever (16): "As a lawyer, the insurance MLM industry ENRAGES me from several angles - scam insurance, misclassification of workers, unconscionable contracts signed under duress with obscenely one-sided and binding arbitration clauses, abuse of telemarketing practices, fraud/misrepresentation, toxic hustle culture, wage theft, tax theft and UI avoidance, exploitation of desperate people seeking the "American dream," I could go on."

↳ dillydeli1 (14): "Totally believe this, thanks for saying it outloud."

↳ iBaires (11): "Don't forget literally tens of thousands of TCPA violations every day lol"

"AMA - Never selling insurance to 85k monthly commissions starting my own agency **AMA: Nine months ago I'd never sold a policy. Today my ACA book does about \$85k/month with a \$34 CPA and ~3% loss. Here's what I wish I'd researched before spending money. Quick context** * Licensed end of Oct '24, started selling Jan '25 * Put **\$100k** in over the year * I buy **live inbound callers only** (no cold lists) **How I handle calls (this mattered most)** * Calls only route to me when I'm not already on the phone, so I don't miss people * If I miss a customer service call, I call back the same day—no exceptions * Clients get a real number that reaches me—my personal cell, 24/7. Hard work, but it built trust and referrals **What to research before you spend \$1** * Refund policy in writing: what counts as a bad call, how returns work, when credits land * Answer/contact rates by hour and source (real stats, not guesses) * County/ZIP targeting that matches ACA networks I can actually place * Consent/compliance language used before the call reaches me * Delivery control so I can cap/pause and touch every caller the same day **Money I wasted** * "Cheap" calls with vague or slow refunds * Buying volume before the intake script and follow-up rhythm were dialed in * Fancy software I didn't use every day **Money that paid off** * Speed + clarity: short script, quick verify, clear next step, same-day follow-up * Call recording + quick QC: 10 minutes a day fixed leaks I couldn't see in a spreadsheet * Knowing ACA cold: networks, formularies, prior auth, renewal quirks—explained in plain English (be the expert and put people at ease) **My lead-vendor checklist now** 1. Refund/credit rules and SLA (in writing) 2. Sample ads so I know there's no fake incentivizing 3. State targeting and delivery hours 4. I can throttle/stop calls instantly **Process that moved the needle** * 3 steps: verify basics → solve the real problem → set a specific next time/action * 1–2 plan options max, with reasons (menus slow everything down) * Same-day everything, or conversion drops * Post-enrollment customer care (ID cards, network checks, "what now?") drives referrals and keeps churn low (~3%) **Simple weekly scoreboard** * Reached calls / total calls * Kept appointments * Submits * Time to first touch * Service issues per member * Refund rate / turnaround * CPA (~\$34) and trend **If I had to start over (I could do it much cheaper—\$10–20k)** * Spend the first 2–3 weeks on scripts, routing, notes template, and a manual follow-up schedule * Trial multiple **live-call** vendors in tiny batches; only scale the one that proves contactability **and** refunds * Keep the tech boring: I run everything in Excel and Google Calendar * Give clients a real number and show up—that's what makes referrals happen That's my playbook and the lessons. AMA about the research, spend, setup, or what I'd cut or double down on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 62 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/

↳ Samwill226 (38): "24/7 cell is going to be your downfall."

↳ Samwill226 (10): "You know what huge risk it really opens up? E&O. I've been in this a long time. I can't tell you how many E&O claims come from cell phone communications. It's a HUGE vulnerability"

↳ Samwill226 (8): "It really is a huge hole for a claim. I have clients find me on social media and send me a message on a Saturday night about a change or coverage question I won't even look at it or respond. You gotta protect yourself on your personal time because they'll throw you under the bus quick! "I called and told him....""

"How do y'all deal with actually insane clients? Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride. I answer the phone. Lady leads with "I went to your office and you guys vanished in the middle of the night! Do I even have insurance!? I'm reporting you to the government!" Reality: we moved nine months ago. Across the parking lot. Our Google listing has been updated. All our policy docs reflect the new address. There's a literal sign taped to the old door with an arrow saying "we moved next door." She then accuses me of not mailing her documents because I'm "screwing with her bill." Her payment has changed once in the last. It went down from \$92 to \$84. At this point she's yelling more about reporting me for moving. I told her "I'm not interested in getting yelled at. What would you like from me today?" She rants a bit more. I respond with "Okay. I am happy to transfer you to another office if that sounds good to you." She ranted more and eventually hung up. Curious how other agents handle the loons like this. I'd love to move her out of my book, but also can't really do it without her consent. People are nuts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

↳ Neither-Historian227 (19): "I had a dozen death threats during the pandemic when government locked everyone down and destroyed their businesses, this is cake walk"

↳ NovelMotor7972 (13): "Are you kidding me? I deal with crazy people for a living. Lol I've literally had people misstate their income on a recorded line, make a complaint against me to the office of financial regulation, and cause a whole ordeal over their own tax penalty, because they misstated their income. I learned my lesson, every single one of them signs a disclosure that this is the income that they are stating."

↳ BroWeBeChilling (12): "It wears on youafter ten years I have heard it all. About 20% of the people are always unhappy. This has worn on me everyday especially since most people don't take responsibility for not paying their bills, their bank made a mistake, they never got a notice in the mail or to their email. Then they take it out on me. I try brushing it off but for sure after one heart attack my life is shortening everyday."

"Best leads in 2024???? This video had nothing to do with helping agents find reputable lead sources. You mentioned 10 different lead gen sources (none to be named) and said nothing referring to the actual title of your vid. Try renaming to " Don't make these mistakes ". I was looking for actual usable content with names of companies that are skilled at lead gen and are reputable. Waste of 14 minutes."

— YouTube · The Best Life Insurance Leads For 2024 I My \$500k/Yr Lead Source · 39 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gtXNK0-8f7c&lc=UgxSK3d37g7CBMR8CY54AaABAg>

↳ @Peter_Roberts01 (44): "Sorry I didn't provide value so I'll do it here: my favorite lead vendors I've used 1. Smart Finaical - seo leads 2. Happy agent - Fb leads 3. Nectar leads are insurance leads for seo and Fb Also if you are an agent your upline or leader should be able to provide you the best sources. Sorry for this I care about you"

↳ @itssmee1597 (9): "@Therealjames100you legit just did the same thing"

↳ @Therealjames100 (5): "You just wasted alot of time typing this pointless comment lol."

"Anyone's agency not do cold-calling for leads? I'm not sure if this will sound sane, but my agency grows solely off of referrals and advertising. Of course it's not the quickest growth, but it's been working for the past 5 years. We're a small independent agency that sells personal and commercial. I'm curious to hear others' thoughts and experiences!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 34 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mk37eo/anyones_agency_not_do_coldcalling_for_leads/

↳ Pudd12 (14): "This guy. Started my own agency about 3 and a half years ago now. Probably made 10-15 cold calls in that time, don't think I'll make many more. Advertising, referrals and company provided leads. I'm not trying to scale, I'm not trying to make a million a year. It's going well. Spend about \$20k a year on advertising. When I got in the business 25 years ago, I was a cold calling machine."

↳ Pudd12 (10): "I am an active trusted member of my community. Worked hard to become that. I spend money on direct mail, sponsoring things around town and I show up to lots of events."

↳ Samwill226 (7): "We don't cold call and we don't buy leads. We get steady clients but we aren't a huge agency at all. We're comfortable so we never really wrote like \$500k a year in new premium like some say here."

"Lessons from my first year as an agency owner. AMA I started my p&c agency in May 2025. For context, I posted when I first started and about half way through year one so go check those out. I started my agency because I had 10 years experience up to that point and I was tired of working for others and following their lead when I knew there was better ways to innovate and bring a superior experience to the clients. So after one year, what have I learned? 1) The power of taking 100% ownership for your life and business You will make mistakes, you will have setbacks, you will burn through money trying to figure things out. These are unavoidable and part of the learning process. Don't be reckless, but know that you will not have all of the answers out of the gate and that's okay. Accept your responsibility as the captain of the ship and you will find a way to overcome the hurdles that get in your way. 2) The power of the niche In the early months, I chased any and all kinds of business. That lead to me spinning my wheels but getting no traction. It was only after I picked a lane and stuck with it (for the most part, just because you pick a niche doesn't mean you have to turn away business that doesn't perfectly fit in the niche) that the trajectory of the business shifted. 3) The power of relationships and finding your tribe Once I picked a niche, I sought out power partners that I could help make their lives easier by offering their clients a needed product and service, so the power partner actually had an incentive (not a monetary kickback, although you'll find that helps grease the wheels) to refer me because I would strengthen their core offering. Think your typical referral partners (real estate agents, lenders, etc) but also think outside the box. 4) The power of delegation You cannot do everything. Know thyself, know what your strengths and weaknesses are. Hate doing your books? Get a bookkeeper. Not good at social media, find someone or a service that is good at it. Not a marketing guru? Find one. Don't try to be a hero, find others that have what you want and work out a deal. There's many more lessons, so ask me anything."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ts41sg/lessons_from_my_first_year_as_an_agency_owner_ama/

↳ broker965 (6): "Remember that I came in to agency ownership with 10 years of experience in the business working for others, 7 years working directly next to the agency owner. So I knew the lay of the land. If you don't know the lay of the land, don't be too proud to go learn under someone. I used the last 90 days of employment at my prior firm to set up my agency. The legal structure, the bank account, the website, etc. Then I spent the first 90 days of operations finding different opportunities to get appointments. But on day 1 I had 1 direct auto appointment and access to first connect carriers. From there I built it brick by brick. It's still a work in progress. It takes time to build a business. Whatever time frame you have in your mind now, double it. And settle in for the long haul."

↳ KiniShakenBake (3): "I am also about a year Indy after ten years captive. What niche did your agency settle into? I am finding it follows my mission statement. Have you identified any such thing? Also, 10/10 on hiring a bookkeeper. Mine is \$225 per month, with another \$500 per year for tax filings, and that includes payroll and a discount on my income tax annual filing."

↳ broker965 (3): "We have two main niches construction and real estate. We do insurance and bonds for contractors and tradesmen. Property is a side of the book that I want to grow. Yes, finding good people is 🤞"

"New life insurance agent — how are y'all actually generating your own leads? I'm a newer life insurance agent and trying to figure out how to consistently get leads without spending a bunch of money. I see people on TikTok all the time talking about how they generate their own leads and don't have to buy any... but when I ask people in my group how they're doing it, I usually just hear stuff like "go pass out flyers at grocery stores." That's just not realistic for me. I've got three kids — two of them are still really little — so standing outside a store passing out flyers isn't something I can easily do. So for those of you who have actually found a way to generate leads yourself (especially from home), how are you doing it? Social media? Referrals? Something else? I'm willing to put in the effort, I just need a smarter strategy that works around my life. Appreciate any tips 😊"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/

↳ UnfairFloor3347 (25): "My number one recommendation is to buy leads. Not any leads, Aged Leads. Specifically leads that are 9-12 months old. Old enough where they don't get calls but need a policy or are open to getting a policy at a lower rate. The CPL and CPA are low enough to give you the ability to generate considerable revenue over a 90 day period. At that point in time you can pivot into more expensive marketing solutions or paying someone to run the marketing for you."

↳ [deleted] (13): "I looked into it and they were very expensive in my opinion. Plus it's usually some room full of very hungry people in the Philippines or someplace like that bullying people through a script and that could turn out to be a waste of time in many cases. So I bought the call list myself with certain parameters I set according to people of the ages that typically are thinking about life insurance (because they typically still have people they feel the need to provide for unlike Mrs Jones at 69 years old whose kids are all in their 40s and whose husband is typically dead. I figure if people get to their 60s or older and still have absolutely no final expense coverage it's usually either because they don't see the necessity of it or they just can't afford it. Sure there are exceptions to that but they're exceptions. That brought me to my other parameter of 40K plus income, people that can actually pay the premium. The way I see it I'll just call them myself and I'll be very direct. I won't tell them I'm a "benefits coordinator" or any other BS line. I'll flat out tell them I sell life insurance and if they have about 2 minutes I'd like to give them a quote and that if they like the price I'll come by and we'll do the paperwork in person and they can take out the policy. Then I'll tell them that I'll make no attempt to talk them into buying anything they don't want or can't afford. Then I'll pause for a second. They'll either let me quote them or they won't and then I'll move on down the list. No shady practices at all. Some people will appreciate that and may actually buy a policy. Some won't. Either way I won't feel smarmy and I won't waste several hours and x amount of money on gas driving all over the place trying to talk to people that don't want to talk to me anyway and probably have no intention of buying anything."

↳ Deadly3ffect (12): "I always hated this. "34 year agent and I've never used leads." Back when people would walk into your office to get an insurance policy. Fucking shocker, you started before anyone used the internet. By the time the industry changed you were already established. What you started with is completely different to what the insurance industry is now. Sorry, that shit seriously pisses me off. All these old timers are sitting below me on the monthly sales because they have this outdated mindset. You want to sell insurance? Buy fucking leads."

"Buying an Independent Insurance Agency I am interested in purchasing my own independent agency and currently in the process of researching what that entails. Background: I currently work for a family agency where I am 3rd generation. My grandfather started the business, and I work under my dad and alongside my siblings. I have been at the agency for 5 years. I thought that it was fixable, but things are not going the way I hoped. There is always a ton of family drama that spills into the workplace, and it is a very unprofessional environment that drives me crazy. I am the only one who has outside work experience (previously an engineer for 10 years). Everyone else came straight to the agency and lacks very common and important real-life skills. Managing a calendar, Microsoft office knowledge, how to communicate effectively (to carriers, customers, and co-workers), etc... I come from a sales background so managing a pipeline and working with business owners or homeowners comes naturally. I've also been managing marketing, accounting, and day-to-day business operations, referral commercial lines quoting, CL renewals and networking for the agency. 90% of the daily decisions are made by me and then my father just blindly signs off on them because he is the principal and checked out (ready to retire). I have transitioned the agency to a new AMS, new accounting software, and transitioned most of our book away from agency bill. I have successfully increased efficiency by taking our 8-person agency down to 3.5 people. No one was fired, we had old staff and everyone retired. I thought we were going to be able to work together as siblings and run the agency, I was wrong. I tried a couple times to sit everyone down individually and talk about goals, dream responsibilities, and other things that would help align all our visions but am always met with "I dunno", or "I don't care", or "This is stupid, stop trying to make this a corporate office". Anytime there is a disagreement there is either a huge fight or one sibling goes to our mom who manipulates my dad into making the decision behind our back. I am looking for guidance from agency owners or industry veterans. What mistakes did you make when starting out or how would you do it differently now. 1. I am not interested in a captive agency 2. I understand PE acquisitions are at an all-time high but there are a good number of small mom and pop shop agencies around with limited succession planning (Ohio) 3. I understand getting a new carrier appointment right now during the hard market is very difficult if not currently impossible, but I will weigh the agencies current carrier selection very carefully 4. I understand this is a HUGE undertaking and the YEARS of work it will require Thank you in advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l48ryh/buying_an_independent_insurance_agency/

↳ firenance (14): "Agency M&A consultant. I consult on situations like this all the time. Sadly it's super common. Unfortunately in many cases the answer is leave because you won't change the family dynamic. Listen to the scratch agency podcast. The host Stephen left a 4 generation family agency to start his own. Don't think it was similar drama, but similar decision. I'm sure he would chat with you about his journey. Yes you are right. Buying is expensive, but there can be great opportunities if you network directly with small town owners getting ready to retire. Do not buy a small book of business <\$300K through a broker, but do work with an advisor. I don't normally do this because they are a competitor of mine, but connect with IA Valuations, it's a division of OIA and they may be able to give you some pointers or recommendations in your state."

↳ Comprehensive_Act772 (7): "No experience with this...just want to say good luck and I hope this works out for you. Such a tough situation."

↳ firenance (5): "Under 300 K revenue through a business broker. In most cases, it's gonna be a book transfer and valuation is completely subjective. Small book brokers will just say 2.5 times revenue without really evaluating risk like carrier concentration, book mix, or policies per customer metrics. Or even how the book was built. If it was all online or purchased leads the retention on that is gonna be completely different than somebody with a high reputation local agency."

"What would you do if you had to start over from scratch? I'm 2.5 years into owning my agency and my book is just over \$100k. I've had some rough patches, hell, the first 2 years was a rough patch- but about 6 months ago I came to the conclusion that I'm going to put everything in me and do whatever it takes to grow my business and make up for the two years of my life that I wasted. I've gone 25 years untreated for ADHD and 2 months ago finally made myself an appointment to see what the hell is wrong with me. Fast forward 2 months later and I can finally function like a normal human being. Not only am I able to focus better, talk to people better, feel knowledgeable and handle things more professionally, but I actually care. I want to build something that will feed my family one day, pass down to my children, something that will provide us stability. I scheduled a 30 minute call with an agent I met a few years ago to see how he was doing and quite frankly, how he was doing what he was doing. I took a sneak peek at our companies production reports and this guy was selling nearly \$100k in premium a month. This meeting ended up being an hour long, but the biggest thing I took away was when he said this: "Dude... I have 5 kids", and it clicked. I have to get into survival mode, as if it wasn't just me, but those who depended on me. I think about my parents (whom I want to help retire because they are helping me financially), my girlfriend (whom wants to get married and have children with me one day), and my future kids. At this turning point in my life I am constantly asking people who are doing better than me, or are in places that I want to be, what would you do if you were in my position right now? What can I do to grow amongst these huge \$10M+ book size agents in my area? My goal is to quote over \$160k in premium a month, hopefully the quote to sell conversion ratio turns out good. These are mostly old leads, and eventually I will run out. Every Friday I am going out to 5-6 locations with realtors/brokers/lenders/title agents and handing out cookies, business cards, and a handwritten letter. Hopefully this helps me build a pipeline. I did this last week and people seemed receptive and related to the hustle. What is something I should be focusing on everyday to maximize my agencies growth?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/

↳ DonicaLewinsky69420 (16): "Ask every client and new prospect for referrals. Let them know how important it is to you. Be the business. Not the Business professional. Live it, breathe it, learn it."

↳ FuzzyDice_12 (7): "My tips: 1) Networking: I'm an introvert that comes across as an extrovert. Great for sales but I dread going to events and force myself to go. Staying connected and going to Insurance Events, opens up connections, some you may not realize for years later. Perfect example is while I'm young, I got into insurance and owning my agency at 21ish. Many of the contacts at brokerages I've made, jump ship to other brokerages. The friendship will get you an appointment where normally you couldn't have. 2) Agency Software: This one is a big one. Many of the softwares are expensive and slow. Sometimes agents, when opening their own agencies, use the software from their previous agency, with outdated tech, solely because of familiarity. I learned this lesson the hard way. Thousands a year on crappy agency software. 3) Turning 1 New Business Insured and the policy they chose to have you quote, into multiple policies and new leads. This one is big. 4) This is personal to my niche (small/medium accounts are \$100k+), and builds on 3. Offer several smaller quotes for lines of insurance applicable to your line of business the insured may not have/have been offered previously, even if you don't think the insured will be interested. "If Any" Workers Comp would be applicable for my lines of business. 5) create partnerships with other independent agencies and agents. Self explanatory I would think. 6) SOP's, and building the agency with Franchising in mind. 7) Calendar: setting up reminders to touch base on insured's. If you are coming around only at renewal time, you easily become an agent that is replaceable. 8) As an agency owner, not only having SOP's, but understanding how every moving part of your agency works. From accounting, to customer service, to certificates of insurance, and on and on. Excuse any typos (at the barber shop), but this is what I could think of off the top of my head, and while some sections are more important than others, I didn't number them in any particular order."

↳ ChrisPbacon969 (5): "Commenting to follow along. I'm about to get started on my p and c journey."

"Dream came true at 19 Firstly, I want to preface I had never known anything about being an insurance agent until I was 16. When I was 16 I had the opportunity to work under a local State Farm agent and he showed me the ropes. I got hooked. In late 2024, when I turned 18, I immediately when for all 4 of my licenses and got a job at a larger State Farm agency as a producer. My plan then was to stay for 1-3 years then become an independent agent under an independent agency. Fast forward 10 months later and I was proud to say I was starting my own agency. The first months were tough. I didn't know what I was doing and I stepped into a world of uncertainty. But in May of this year I got myself a lease, and started working hard on digital ad campaigns. This month I will end the month with 55-60K in premium annualized. No paid internet leads, just \$500/mo in google ads (first month starting google ads), google reviews, referrals, an my office location. I'm so excited for what's to come and I just wanted to share my experience as a new agency owner. Dreams do come true, I'm just hitting a small milestone that I've dreamed of since I was 16. My plan is to end the year with a 400-500k book (all business written by myself) Next year I want to hire a producer. Agency owners, how were your first years? How did you manage growth and retention? And lastly, is this a realistic goal and plan? Thank you!!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uewxrx/dream_came_true_at_19/

↳ _Fr4g_ (9): "Bro I actually wrote all of it on my phone LMAO. But thank you for reading. Put it in an any AI checker. Wrote it all by myself. You can see my prior posts I use the same language, just wanted to format it in a way easy to read. Not everything is AI these days 🤔🤔"

↳ StephenDolo (7): "He's just being a hater"

↳ Altruistic_Fall_9843 (7): "New agent coming up on two years. Those sound like solid numbers, but we def have a diff frame of reference. We use mainly paid leads and calls and have our own telemarketing team. On an average month producers hit 30k in premium (some annualized, some not), and a good month 40-45k. But that's with a 2,000\$ budget per producer per month. Point being, spending only 500\$ a month but producing well over a fourth of what we're doing is def good!"

"My experience at bankers life as a new agent. I don't understand the distaste. I came across a post after my interview that made me even more skeptical of the job because I've never had a commission based job, didn't have an insurance license, and this would be my first real job after college. Here is the post I read. [https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/194rgk1/has_anyone_heard_of_bankers_life/] (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/194rgk1/has_anyone_heard_of_bankers_life/) I got my license and passed first try (idk how, I studied hard but the exam was harder than I thought, I couldn't see how many I got wrong). It's the beginning of my 4th week, I've made one small sale but I've set appointments with clients that have a lot of money so they're sending an FA to discuss retirement planning. I've made contact with some of these clients, I study really hard, I do what I'm told, and honestly it feels great. I feel like I'm the edge of something that could be really good. I'm good at what I do and I can tell because not only are the managers impressed with me but so are the other agents that are in their first year. I kind of feel like I'm outpacing a lot of my peers but I'm trying to stay humble. I took a chance with these people because I had limited options but I knew that even if this is the worst company I've ever worked with (it's not) then I would at least come out with a resume with more licenses than I came in with, and could take another swing at the job market. I've been getting calls from other companies since I got my license trying to recruit me, I don't listen to them much. I will be an FA in a year or less with this company, I don't intend to leave here unless I go broke (doubtful) or something unforeseen happens. I was extremely apprehensive when I started but I trusted my manager and gave it my all since if I'm going to try, I'm going to try so hard that I will know without a doubt if it is my fault or the company's if I fail. I'm not failing, I'm impressing and improving. People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager) but there's signs everywhere about being a top 125 training company, have I fact checked this? No, but I haven't felt like I needed to. when I feel like it I will. My managers answer all my questions, see me working hard, and include me on appointments that I can't contribute much to, and we still split the sale. The online resources are extensive and cover so much in a very user friendly way, 30-60 minute panels of top producers explaining what worked for them. I am told this is why they are such a highly rated company for its training. I am also told that this is why BL is unique, because it is 1099 commission based but the support is unmatched. I really enjoy this company so far and if I don't start seeing financial results soon (I'm positive I will) then I will remove this post. Maybe after AEP I'll just drop how much money I've made in the comments and pin it or something and we can see how this post ages. I anticipate a couple thousand dollars in the next couple weeks from less than a handful of sales. Someone who's worked in other insurance agencies tell me what I'm missing if this company is so bad? If I'm being cocky then check back in January to see my suffering and plans to go back on Glassdoor. \-sept 27, 2025 UPDATE It's December 17th, I'm going to try to keep this update relevant to my original. For context, I was let go two weeks ago and am not looking back. Issues had been brewing for weeks and I was already interviewing at another company in case I decided I needed to leave, initially, I didn't see myself being fired but as things escalated, I knew I'd be less surprised. I had the confidence in being hired at another company to stay true to my morals in how I dealt with Bankers. I'll talk about why I was let go later in this post. **Since I referred an older post in my original and commented on it, I'm going to dissect what I said and show a newer perspective:** "People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager)" Quoting the linked post, "being 1099 but being treated like an employee..." I still think the user on the linked post is misguided. You are 1099, and I don't know what negatives they were referring to when being "treated like an employee" but I can say that bankers really does do business in person, the initial interview was the only time I had a formal conversation with my bosses online. Working with my managers in person was something I liked, my new job has had more formal conversation over zoom than in person (so far, I don't officially start until January which is another downside over here) and I miss that about bankers. I also liked that the hierarchy of the office was relatively clear cut. My manager knows she is responsible for me. I liked how there was structure to the company, I was told by my managers and in hindsight still agree that this is GOOD and sets bankers aside from the competition. Agreed. My second sentence regarding insurance as far as I know now, is still completely correct. But working for bankers I realized that everything is a sale, hiring people, building confidence in subordinates, getting your manager to like you even if you don't like them. Everything is a game and everyone is playing. All the sales tactics apply in every corner of the office. Now we have "office politics" where generally, every participant is skilled in how to get what they want from other people, so now there is another layer of paranoia I had and I think rightfully so. I have no idea if becoming a manager and qualifying for bankers insurance is as easy as it was laid out in the interview. I can't tell you how many times, big or small, I thought something would be as easy as 1,2,3 because that was the way it was laid out, when in fact there were so many undisclosed micromanagement tasks attached. Some had to do with clients and don't result in being paid. (Prescription drug plans are needed by most of our clients, but we get paid nothing. And I had an experience that took way longer than it should have) **In regards to my overall outlook on bankers as a company and my experience at the time:** I was pretty successful as a new agent I think, I saw people come and go, I got better and was super proud of my accomplishments being a new grad and never having been in sales before but booking more appointments than some of my peers. I was confident and working hard, everyone in the office saw it. Peers would ask me questions and "most" managers were always eager to help. However management was the reason I was fired, after awhile I realized that I knew I would be very successful at this company and would do everything in my power, without hurting anyone, to accomplish my goals. Before I go into why I was let go I want to say that from my perspective, I think bankers as a company could be very good, it may already be a very good company to work for. I think the resources available online is extensive and very very valuable, I do think working face to face with your company is very valuable too. And I think from a baseline, makes bankers a company to consider. For awhile I really enjoyed it, and I was trying really hard not to drink too much "kool-aid" I wanted to stay humble and careful, celebrate my victories at home and not let anyone see anything they could take advantage of. Ultimately, it could be and probably was, my branch that failed me. Not the company. And the branch did fail me. **Here is why I was let go:** As I've said I was a good new agent, and proud of my progress. As I got better and better I became more and more independent. At first I didn't want to meet clients 1 on 1 because I felt so nervous in my capabilities, naturally management wanted me to go on my own and I understood even if I didn't want to. As I went on these appointments I was told I could call my manager "anytime." Sure enough, questions came up, and without disturbing my rapport with the client, would text or call my manager. Eventually the response I would get is "read the agent guide" or "we'll talk about it during our meeting" but I would never know which agent guide I was being referred to and anytime I looked at our resources they would be 40 pages of word salad and fluff that I mostly already knew with a few bits of new information. Not user friendly and certainly not a good use of time when I could be making new clients, working on my current clients, or learning how to present a new product. So the other response was our meeting. 3/5 days during the week we are on appointments, 2/5 days we are in the office and here is the schedule: 8-12 dial, dial, dial. That's it. 12-1 people trickle out o"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nircjl/my_experience_at_bankers_life_as_a_new_agent/

↳ Jonfers9 (14): "Congrats. It's funny you say you're good at what you do...you'll look back in 5 years and think man I didn't know anything back then."

↳ kevymetal87 (9): "A lot of the people knocking Bankers Life (myself included) do so because it's typically not setup for proper success for individuals. Churn and burn. That being said, like any other line of business/industry, there are always some good agents who will help you sincerely, and it sounds like you found one."

↳ Ok-Philosophy-3743 (8): "As in things only get better from here?"

"If you were starting over today with no book of business and no carrier appointments, what would you do first? Hi everyone, I officially passed my Texas Life & Health licensing exam yesterday (self studied via an online prep course), and I'm trying to be very intentional about how I build my business from Day 1. A little background: I'm 39 and transitioning from a successful corporate finance career (\$175k, annual) after being laid off in 2025. I want to use this unexpected time to invest in a career pivot to an independent producer, eventually building up to a small boutique style agency. Short-term, I plan to focus on Medicare, ACA, Life Insurance, and Supplemental Health. Longer-term, I'd like to expand into ICHRA and small employer benefits, but I don't want to spread myself too thin in the beginning. My vision is to build a referral- and relationship-based business. I'm much more interested in creating a trusted advisory practice than becoming a high-pressure salesperson. If you were in my shoes today —with no book of business, no carrier appointments, and no industry experience—but knowing what you know now: What would your first three steps be? What mistakes would you avoid? Would you join an agency/FMO first, or would you try to build independently from Day 1? Is there anything you wish someone had told you before your first year? I'm not necessarily looking for the "highest commission" straight away. Instead, I'm trying to build the strongest long-term foundation and book of business. I genuinely appreciate any advice from those who've been through it. Thanks in Advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uxw9ko/if_you_were_starting_over_today_with_no_book_of/

↳ idontknowhow2reddit (7): "I agree with all of this. Insurance is a crazy world so there's a ton of things to learn. The textbook and real world are very different so I would try to find an established company with good training to work for first. Without that, it will be hard to build a referral base or to gain that trusted advisor role. Your network and other professionals are going to need to see you in the industry a bit before they will trust you on your own."

↳ Key_Astronomer6500 (5): "Congrats! For someone who also got into insurance later in my career. 1. Pick one product and master it, then move into the second one, and so on. Medicare, ACA, Final Expense, Annuities, etc. 2. Training. Master that product and then move to the second. W 2 or Captive will give you the most training. 40 a week of training vs 1 or 2 hours a week. 3. Pick the right organization. Know the difference between recruiters selling me vs legitimate interviews. I wish someone told me about how many recruiters would try to sell me and then offer no support. I am so glad I left and went into a W2 to learn and get practice but I wish someone told me how difficult releases were! Best of luck but honestly someone with your degree of previous success should be fine. Just remember you're not gonna make as much money at first. You'll probably need to go independent to make more than 125k. However, I would suggest to build that foundation first but as long as you know what you're getting into I think you'll do great."

↳ OZKInsuranceGuy (5): "If I had to start over today, the first thing I'd do is choose my upline very carefully. The wrong agency/upline can cost you years of your career. Second, I'd pick one niche and master it before trying to sell everything. Too many new agents want to do Medicare, ACA, final expense, annuities, group benefits...and end up not getting very good at any of them. Third, I'd get in front of people every single workday. Nothing replaces activity. I'd rather have a decent script and 15 appointments than the perfect script and no one to talk to. The biggest mistakes I'd avoid are buying into recruiting hype (MLMs), signing contracts without understanding release policies, and spending time on useless activities, like tweaking logos, trying to figure out every detail of CRMs, or building websites than actually selling. I would absolutely suggest joining an agency first. I'd choose one based on transparency, track record, proven training and scripts, and upline (again, upline is very important). Make sure you're paid directly by the carriers, understand exactly how releases work (get it in writing), and ask a lot of questions before you sign anything. Once you start selling, consistency is key. Focus on activity, because your input determines your output. Work hard, follow your upline's advice and system, and don't get distracted by other opportunities or anything else."

"Man I wish someone told me about the cluster trap earlier. Joined a big one first year and the exit clause was basically "we own your book forever" - took me 3 years to buy my way out of that mess. Read every contract like your life depends on it, especially the part about who actually own the business when you leave For software don't go crazy at start. I spent like \$800/month on fancy CRM that I barely used first 6 months. Get good rater and simple accounting, rest can wait until you got actual revenue coming in. The only thing worth paying for right away is a decent phone system and maybe EZLynx if you do personal lines What worked best for leads was literally just walking into real estate offices with donuts on Saturday morning. Cost me 15 bucks and got more referrals than the \$500/month online leads I tried. Would specialize early too, I wasted 2 years trying to write everything and made no money until I focused only on contractors"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vwadgv/independent_agency_owners_what_would_you_do/p5fdhsa/

"How to create a client list, it doesn't matter if it's cold calling or not The company I'm trying to work for requires me to create a contact list of 150 people. They said it can include friends, family, former coworkers, Instagram, etc as long as I have their phone number and email. The list is confidential and won't be taken from me they just want me ready to call when I officially start. This is a test before they sponsor my health and life insurance. I've already gone through my contacts, social media, and friends, but so far I've only been able to gather around 20–40 people max. How do I go on about find more people and no I don't have any more personal leads or referrals that they could give. Edit: The company is called thoroughbred advisor, commission based and you keep your own book. Also they sponsor for series license which is my big incentive Edit 2: I have decided not to take the job after reading all the comments. I should instead just get my basic licenses and market myself better. This way I actually have a strong foundation. Thank you for everyone sharing their opinions"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r2emia/how_to_create_a_client_list_it_doesnt_matter_if/

↳ Glittering-Read-6906 (40): "This is a red flag. Don't do this."

↳ qmcnam4002 (17): "They want to sell to your contact list for you and call it "training""

↳ Glittering-Read-6906 (12): "It's because they are using OP as a free source of leads. It's an immediate red flag to me."

"Is this really something you can do as a side hustle? I met someone the other day that apparently makes 50 grand in commission each year on medicare renewals alone, and she also does life insurance. She told all of us that she does this part time on the side as a side hustle independent. She has a full 9-5 job. She buys leads but most is from word of mouth. My question is for someone coming into this with no experience, do you think it's doable to start out doing this part time and expect to make decent income? Or... is this really a full time gig? I don't want to half dedicate myself to this when it really takes full dedication. Interested to hear your thoughts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vzuzbf/is_this_really_something_you_can_do_as_a_side/

↳ UrDeafFrdMikey (35): "No this is not a side hustle. Go ahead and be an insurance agent and if you need more money go become a bartender/server/delivery driver on the weekend nights."

↳ KiniShakenBake (15): "Not. It is not. Most definitely not. I would argue that two lines is a full time job. More than that is... More than a full time job. Ask me how I know...."

↳ StealthMcNinja (13): "It sounds like maybe she worked hard only on the insurance sales for a while and then backed off the aggressive sales when she had enough clients to make 50k in renewal commissions. At that point she could step away and work a regular job with the insurance on the side. It's definitely not a side hustle in the beginning."

"I think the biggest factor in what you'll make, is the company you sell for. This is my 3rd year in the insurance industry, I sell both P&C and life/health insurance. Make sure your company pays you fairly, you would be shocked at the commission rate difference between companies. I have seen anywhere from 15% all the way up to 90% on FYC (first year commissions) on annual premium rate. Also brush up on your marketing skills, make your clients do your work for you with referrals! The closing ratio of referrals is so much higher than a client that you found on your own. The roof does not exist in this industry, sell as much as you can and live a good life!"

— YouTube · I Asked 166 Life Insurance Agent How Much Money They ACTUALLY Make Per Month · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MLoTTqEO2AY&lc=UgwGfQbhxRF2diL6pNh4AaABAq>

"AEP apps vs chargebacks Happy December, fellow medicare agents! We made it through AEP! Just here to get some perspectives and experiences of what to expect with AEP apps vs which ones actually follow through! For those of you who have been through multiple AEPs, how many apps do you usually write? This was my first year, and I wrote 172. The majority of them are renewals, but I did have a few initial enrollments. Do you think this is exceptional? Also, how many of your apps ended up being chargebacks/cancelled (due to enrolling with another agent)? I'm curious to know what to expect here for my book. Last question, I promise, what percentage of your book ends up sticking around the following year? I know everyone's market is different, but I'm trying to get a sense of what's "normal." Any insight from seasoned agents would help a ton. Thanks so much and happy holidays!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pgvbbq/aep_apps_vs_chargebacks/

↳ itsalyfestyle (6): "Yea those types of leads drop off big time.. keep a close eye on your book! They'll be attacked by other call centers during OEP"

↳ Salty-Passenger-4801 (6): "Can't believe people still fall for those shitty FB ads."

↳ Aus10Tip10 (5): "500 apps in my 3rd AEP 🍌"

"Boots to the ground!!! It's free my man. That's how I got started 3 years ago. Go to every senior center, senior apartment, retirement homes, food banks and do table events wherever seniors show up. I have so many great relationships. I do a lot of fun events at these places. Keep at it, don't give up. After year 2, referrals start coming in, and you start seeing the fruits of your labor in monthly deposits into the bank account, just keeping your clients happy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1d5disv/turning_65_leads_medicare/16l3fuc/

"Daniel, I completely agree!!! As a licensed independent health insurance agent for almost 15 years, I can tell you there is some serious "truth twisting" in this video. He is basically taking the worst HMO product and the worst MA features and casting a blanket about all MA's across the county. In our area, we have highly rated PPO (Non-referral) plans with huge premium savings and extra benefits compared to Medigap plans. If you want the absolute best coverage and are willing to pay the huge premiums, go ahead and get a Medicare Supplement plan but if you are healthy and want to act as your own insurance company (by keeping those premium savings in your pocket) the MA plans are a VERY good option!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 14 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgxXgatwixQRn4vQ4Bh4AaABAq.9Ybsc0dtWig9Z1d6pg3zOj>

Live transfers and inbound calls · 164 documents · 20 voices

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought "pre-sold leads" from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigator (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the "insurance carrier, not the agent", for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigator wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigator. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** \- If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

↳ HamiltonSt25 (75): "Quitting insurance today and becoming a professional litigator lmao"

↳ InsuranceEvangelist (70): "New income stream unlocked..."

↳ DavidDuford (24): "For real =). I should start selling info-product courses on how to do it, and partner with a lawyer to do all the work. "Make an easy \$1500 a day with one simple trick.""

"Had my first sale today! I'm a new agent in Florida, independent. All inbound leads. Today was my first day on my own after training. Just super excited n I needed to put it out there!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 122 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj9u0m/had_my_first_sale_today/

↳ DJSimmer305 (25): "Congrats! May your commissions be fat and your chargebacks be minimal!"

↳ Staugbeachbunny (7): "I work at an agency where we receive only inbound calls. We have a weekly charge of around \$850. This covers everything from the dialer to the office space and the leads as well The first two weeks are free though. My one call today covers that charge so I'm ok with it. People who have been doing it for a while are just killing it there. I used to work furniture sales and during slow season when the snowbirds were out of town, that was all I would make in one or two weeks occasionally. Definite Upgrade!"

↳ RancidSmellingShit (7): "How many inbound leads are you receiving for that \$850?"

"Let go at 6 months pregnant This happened yesterday. I'm still processing. Couldn't sleep all night. And this is long. I apologize in advance. Been an AE at this small private tech company for almost 2 years. They recently went through a rebrand and wanted us targeting completely new verticals. Leadership and overall processes were a complete mess, and it was honestly a shit show. I wanted to leave, but was holding out until after baby arrived this summer. Q4 was rough. Partly because we have zero good inbound leads and are 100% reliant on outbounds, and we have a 6 month sales cycle on average. Except our CEO acts like it should be a 2-meeting close. My old boss was fired and I got a new boss in January. In February, I was told I needed to hit my revenue numbers by end of March, along with all these KPIs metrics, and training a new guy he hired. I've never been on a PIP in my life (been an AE for 7 years), but it didn't feel formal in that there was no document and I never signed anything. Just told I need to do this and this. Now, normally the advice is to start applying immediately. And I did. However my situation is a bit different as I'm pregnant and due this summer. Made it to the offer stage at another company and then informed them I was pregnant, hoping to negotiate some sort of leave. Unfortunately they couldn't offer me any paid leave and my job also wouldn't be protected since I wouldn't qualify for FMLA. At my current company, I would. So it felt safer in the moment to stay. I worked my ass off. Consistently delivered on outreach KPIs, spent hours training the new hire, helped with new marketing initiatives developing new 1-pagers and helping with new outreach playbook development. Really trying to show I'm an asset and praying I could stay on through the summer. After that, I wouldn't care. Still, my revenue was down and my other deals were tied up in legal and I was starting to worry. But out of nowhere one of my old deals I closed last summer was acquired and the new company reached out per their recommendation, and wanted to move forward. This new deal would single handedly hit my revenue numbers. However the compliance aspect took forever. Our team is so disorganized and makes it so hard to buy. Then onboarding. Unfortunately I also sell a consumption based product. So even though they sign the contract and commit to X volume, the revenue generated is dependent on their ramp...which is in the hands of the client success team. And then wouldn't you have it, this CSM did the bare minimum to help them ramp. I felt like I was being sabotaged. Even my boss agreed that they were not doing their job. I stepped up and held meetings to help the client onboard, go through the set up and integration. The CSM completely dropped the ball. No reoccurring meetings in place until they fully ramped, nothing. Basically told them "if you need help lmk". Insane. So, yesterday arrived and I was below my revenue number. But I SHOULD have hit it. And I've been doing so much I really didn't feel worried. Mind you, my entire team was below as well. Revenue was stagnant across the company. But my boss called me out of the blue and I was terminated on the spot. No emotion. No severance. No paid out PTO. No extended insurance. Nothing. My income makes up 60% of our household income. And I use their insurance. Which I have doctors appointments set up every 2 weeks. They've completely fucked me as no company is going to hire me when I give birth in 3 months and also pay me for leave. I don't know what the fuck to do. We genuinely cannot afford to not have my income until Fall. Do I have any legal leg to stand on, or can they just say I fell short of performance, even if I'm dependent on others to do their job AND the entire company was stagnant on revenue? (For reference, I was the only one with a contract signed in Q1 and I had 2 others under review)."

— r/sales · 108 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1jp0avi/let_go_at_6_months_pregnant/

↳ IdgyThreadgoodee (145): "200% file a lawsuit. If they didn't formalize the PIP they fucked up. Also apply for ANY job with a good maternity policy and do not let the old guys know you're working (if hired). Edit: I did not state the PIP is required. I said they fucked up because they did. They now have zero formal documentation to support her firing. And I'm not gonna fight with people hating on women, y'all have serious issues and just get blocked when you come at it like that."

↳ Motor-Over (121): "What state are you in? Always free to talk with a lawyer. In the mean time file for unemployment."

↳ IdgyThreadgoodee (50): "The pip is part of it. They won't have documentation to support their claims. Source: just won against the biggest tech company in the world."

"AMA - Never selling insurance to 85k monthly commissions starting my own agency **AMA: Nine months ago I'd never sold a policy. Today my ACA book does about \$85k/month with a \$34 CPA and ~3% loss. Here's what I wish I'd researched before spending money. Quick context** * Licensed end of Oct '24, started selling Jan '25 * Put **\$100k** in over the year * I buy **live inbound callers only** (no cold lists) **How I handle calls (this mattered most)** * Calls only route to me when I'm not already on the phone, so I don't miss people * If I miss a customer service call, I call back the same day—no exceptions * Clients get a real number that reaches me—my personal cell, 24/7. Hard work, but it built trust and referrals **What to research before you spend \$1** * Refund policy in writing: what counts as a bad call, how returns work, when credits land * Answer/contact rates by hour and source (real stats, not guesses) * County/ZIP targeting that matches ACA networks I can actually place * Consent/compliance language used before the call reaches me * Delivery control so I can cap/pause and touch every caller the same day **Money I wasted** * "Cheap" calls with vague or slow refunds * Buying volume before the intake script and follow-up rhythm were dialed in * Fancy software I didn't use every day **Money that paid off** * Speed + clarity: short script, quick verify, clear next step, same-day follow-up * Call recording + quick QC: 10 minutes a day fixed leaks I couldn't see in a spreadsheet * Knowing ACA cold: networks, formularies, prior auth, renewal quirks—explained in plain English (be the expert and put people at ease) **My lead-vendor checklist now** 1. Refund/credit rules and SLA (in writing) 2. Sample ads so I know there's no fake incentivizing 3. State targeting and delivery hours 4. I can throttle/stop calls instantly **Process that moved the needle** * 3 steps: verify basics → solve the real problem → set a specific next time/action * 1–2 plan options max, with reasons (menus slow everything down) * Same-day everything, or conversion drops * Post-enrollment customer care (ID cards, network checks, "what now?") drives referrals and keeps churn low (~3%) **Simple weekly scoreboard** * Reached calls / total calls * Kept appointments * Submits * Time to first touch * Service issues per member * Refund rate / turnaround * CPA (~\$34) and trend **If I had to start over (I could do it much cheaper—\$10–20k)** * Spend the first 2–3 weeks on scripts, routing, notes template, and a manual follow-up schedule * Trial multiple **live-call** vendors in tiny batches; only scale the one that proves contactability and refunds * Keep the tech boring: I run everything in Excel and Google Calendar * Give clients a real number and show up—that's what makes referrals happen That's my playbook and the lessons. AMA about the research, spend, setup, or what I'd cut or double down on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 62 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/

↳ Samwill226 (38): "24/7 cell is going to be your downfall."

↳ Samwill226 (10): "You know what huge risk it really opens up? E&O. I've been in this a long time. I can't tell you how many E&O claims come from cell phone communications. It's a HUGE vulnerability"

↳ Samwill226 (8): "It really is a huge hole for a claim. I have clients find me on social media and send me a message on a Saturday night about a change or coverage question I won't even look at it or respond. You gotta protect yourself on your personal time because they'll throw you under the bus quick! "I called and told him....""

"How I retired my wife with my insurance agency, AMA I launched my agency in 2023 after working for years as a producer, underwriter, and consultant. It started as a side project with one goal in mind, to build enough recurring income to retire my wife and give us both more freedom. Within the first year I turned it into a full-time operation using an aggregator for market access and an organic marketing system that focused on building real relationships instead of buying leads. If you are trying to start or scale your own agency, here's what I can share: • How I used social media to generate consistent inbound leads without paying for ads • How I manage quoting, follow ups, and virtual assistant support to keep volume moving • How niche markets like pressure washing and contractors helped create stable renewals • What commission structures and business habits made the biggest difference early on • How to build an agency that supports your family and gives you time freedom Ask me anything about licensing, operations, staffing, lead generation, or what it actually takes to build an agency that can change your lifestyle."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o2ysrs/how_i_retired_my_wife_with_my_insurance_agency_ama/

↳ InsuranceGnome (10): "I never spent a dime on ads. Once you pick a niche, join the industry Facebook groups where your clients hang out. Do not spam, just wait for conversations where you can add value and show you understand their world. When people start asking for help, that is when you message them directly. I built trust by sharing tips that had nothing to do with buying from me, like safety guides since I am OSHA certified. Leave your two cents on as many posts as you can genuinely contribute to. Ideally do it from a personal profile instead of a business page, it gets much better organic reach. Once you start adding clients as friends, Facebook's algorithm does the heavy lifting. It will show you more people just like them, and that is where your next batch of leads usually comes from."

↳ InsuranceGnome (7): "TL;DR: Start with one niche and master it, keep costs low, lean into your strengths, buy back your time, and focus on turning your best skills into your biggest assets. P&C Insurance. Find a niche industry and learn as much as you can about it. For me, I did really well with service contractors and kept learning one trade after another. I often read policies cover to cover. I skim some sections, but I like to get a full understanding of how everything fits together. I kept software costs low at the start and added tools only when I could afford them. You do not need everything perfect to begin. It is better to get the ball rolling and improve along the way. Lean into your strengths. I am better with social media and chat since I am a gamer and always on my phone, so I made social media my number one funnel. Work with what you are naturally good at. Buy back time when you can. If you are bad at something like AMS entry, do not try to turn a zero into one hundred overnight. Hire someone on Fiverr to help while you also improve your own skills. Focus on turning A skills into A plus skills. The things you are weak at will improve over time, but your strengths will move the business forward faster."

↳ InsuranceGnome (5): "I went with Agentero because I was not planning on selling, and I was able to get my best commission rates by compiling everything under one broker. They were the only company I found that was willing to negotiate the contract. If you tell them you want to amend something, they will actually listen. It was by far the most personalized experience compared to Bolt, First Connect, or any others I reviewed."

"I've taken 5 inbound calls. Out of the five one wasn't interested. One got disconnected on app. Three I took to close. One was 89 and could only go Aetna and she got declined but I sold the other two. Spent like 250 to write 3k."

— YouTube · The King of Inbound Life Insurance Leads (Ep.286) · 19 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=21mejMXBn_Y&lc=UgwXBfpJr3TZxCCUikV4AaABAg

↳ @nerfbattleroyale8045 (3): "Where did you buy those inbounds brother? Integrity?"

↳ @ElitepressGaming-x1x (1): "Not too shabby. Did you use spekra"

↳ @bryanbowerschannel (0): "@nerfbattleroyale8045integrity"

"How is everyone marketing in 2025 without spending a fortune? For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down. Since, I've tried multiple vendors, and I've tried data leads + telemarketers. It feels like no matter what I do, I have to spend 5 grand a month in marketing at least for each of my producers just to hit our goals. It's way too much, and as we spend more to make less, I'm feeling bad burnout as my margins shrink. Primarily P&C, captive agent. So what is everybody doing that's working?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2g/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/

↳ BluebirdFast3963 (16): "Work for an independent that has the best prices in my province, so nothing. They come to me. We have 25 companies. Provide quick quotes, quick binds, quick service when they need something done to their policy. A variety of ways they can reach out. Retain most of my clientele year over year. Re-market my current clients if I need too. The way it should be. This lead factory head hunting, farming for clients you barely know and paying for someone to send you a list of numbers is wild to me - is this common in America? I think the Canadian industry is a bit different. I don't know anyone who has to buy leads. Seems like an awful way to retain a trustworthy client base. Is it just dog eat dog down there, constantly churning through clients or what?"

↳ registeredfake (9): "ive got to say, it does not matter what question is asked by anyone in this sub every one think the answer is Independent this independent that. OP is asking for marking ideas, is already an agent where he has invested his time and money to build something and your first thought is to go independent. stupid"

↳ Armstrongs_ball (7): "Stop. Buying. Leads. Go independent, network, build your book of business by referrals and word of mouth. After a few years, you'll be living off your book of business and getting referrals left and right from clients, assuming you provide good service. Buying leads is literally the biggest waste of \$ in this industry and it's not even close. And good luck actually retaining those clients. They'll be the first to leave after their auto rate increases \$10/month of their first renewal."

"Useful tip for new agents Stop paying for leads that's the wrong way to start off as a new agent you have to learn the business first so it's best to get with a agency that provides inbound leads and learning about handling chargebacks before you go independent it's a marathon not a sprint. If your with an agency that gives inbound leads and training your going to make money if your disciplined enough."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 16 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kxqsrv/>

↳ (0): "Preach man, too many folks try to run before they can walk in this game. What kind of training setup helped you the most when you were just starting out?"

↳ (0): "Exactly man but I failed doing life insurance my success and sales came when I started doing Medicare and I would watch David Duford videos about tonality and sales techniques I still have more learning to go but it helped a lot bro"

↳ (0): "respect for you for not giving up"

"A few things: - Anyone you buy leads/calls from need to give you contract language specifically for this situation. - Litigators are 100% bad faith, this is how they "makes living". The upside is that between the "I paid for a live transfer and you'll need to talk to the company that drive the call" is valid - Litigators are lazy assholes. Best bet is to match their energy and say you will show up in court to litigate this. \$10k is the small claims limit in a few states. Some are \$5k and a few are higher. The MO is to file in SC, show up to the hearing and then get a judgement. That's why you should show up with a contract to give to the judge showing you are not responsible for this litigator doing what they're doing. That \$25k settlement is now Civil Court territory, meaning you need to retain representation... in other words, it's costs money. Call their bluff, show up to any SC hearing."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/mjv8uf0/

"Interesting to see the other side of a serial litigator. Questions for you: What is your plan for when the incoming calls stop? Can you say with absolute sincerity that you're not taking any action to receive these illegal calls? You sure you're not intentionally putting yourself in a position for opportunities to sue these companies/agents? I can't tell if you're posting this to be a genuine warning or maybe even bragging... but it actually reads like "Careful about your lead source, or else people without real jobs like me are going to sue you." Do what everyone else does and block the numbers that call and hop on Indeed dude. No I have never been sued by a serial litigator because I only receive direct inbound calls, but I can still cringe at you for bottom feeding."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8yOu2a/

"I messed up. I quit my easy Medicare sales job and went to an industry and can't physically do anymore. I'm looking for suggestions. I honestly don't want to go back to them. Go health, I feel they were slowly dying. Taking out massive loans to stay afloat, cut 1/3 of employees recently and telling shareholders they were doing great. So I don't want to go back. I can't get into another Medicare job for at least 6 months because of the non competes and the like. Carriers are in on it too so I can't do anything. I'm kinda scrambling for something. I know I wasn't making much there either. Top 10% agent year round. Top 5% in aep. But I only made 45k. It was all warm live inbound transfers that I didn't pay for. I'm looking at other insurance industries and I'm kinda scared. Each place I look at often turns into a sort of ponzi scheme that sells leads. Often getting you in with some decent leads at first and then giving you crap unless you pay for it. I don't mind pure commission but I'd like it to warm live transfers. Am I wishing for something that doesn't exist? I have life and health in like 20 states still. I'm debating getting property casualty license."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/111e1d0/>

↳ (0): "The problem you're having.. is that go health didn't teach you how to do the job. They didn't teach you the product or how to care for the needs of the client. They taught you how to poach books. But the reason they are slowly dying is because every time they have one of their extremely underpaid teleagents poach one of my clients I immediately put in a complaint to CMS and then flip them back. That's why the 3 month retention is less than 40% for both go health and assurance. Medicare isn't easy and shouldn't be. It should be about building relationships that in turn pay you very well for taking care of people. If you actually love it, find an upline that can show you how to build a book, not steal one for a churn and burn company like go health."

↳ (0): "I'm afraid to gamble that. Like I know it's possible and I know I could do it. I was good at what I did. And trust me. I was one of the few who actually read past the SOB and into the EOC for plans. And many didn't even read the SOB... I'm just afraid to start it. I don't know who to trust for leads and I don't know how to get my own."

↳ (0): "Not sure how old you are or what your situation is like especially in regards to networking ability, etc besides what you've posted here, but it seems like there are a TON of Medicare agents around that do very well running a solo shop just cranking out leads + networking. And looking at the commission schedule, something like 100 Medicare sales would net about what you're making now. One hundred... in perpetuity (at least for a few years... lol). That's pretty easy, no? Granted that doesn't include benefits like health insurance, being W2, etc but... still decent. The one Medicare agent I know that works at a P&C shop, and is P&C licensed, works in ONLY Medicare and CRUSHES it, works 3-4 months out of the year, the rest of the year manages his book and lines up for the next year, but vacations / starts other business ventures 8 months out of the year. He's maybe 27 years old making \$300k-400k a year at least I'd bet - before bonus. As a P&C agent I look at those commission schedules and I get a little jealous. Something I'm hoping to learn more about in 2023."

"Is buying leads just a "new agent" tax? When did you guys actually stop? I am coming up on my first year in Health (mostly ACA and some Medicare), and I've been consistently spending a lot on lead vendors. It's working okay—I'm closing deals, but my costs are also high. I was chatting with some vets in the industry, and I noticed that almost none of them seem to buy leads. Is buying leads is basically just a bridge tax you pay for the first 2-3 years? How did you guys stop buying leads - did you build a referral flywheel OR an inbound system? Looking to learn from your experiences. Thanks!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3obua/>

↳ (0): "Nope, purchased leads can be viable for agencies of any tenure-- it is assumed that by a couple years in you have found a lead provider that is providing you warm, actionable, relevant leads with a good close rate and ROI. Warm leads from your network will always trump these in cost and retention, however."

↳ (0): "Think about it this way: \-All agents have to have an abundance of prospects to have a chance of success. \-No prospects = No opportunities = you fail The question is: where do you get an abundance of prospects from? Some buy leads because it's the typical way to stay busy (think final expense, mortgage protection, etc.), while others successfully generate warm leads through referrals and organic strategies."

↳ (0): "Leads are just marketing. All businesses Market one way or another from Coca-Cola to real estate to insurance. You need to do a lot more marketing when people don't know you or your business or service. Here's a tip: you will do so much better to learn early in your career about two things to become a ratio to each other. The first is lifetime value of a client. That is how much money they make you from beginning and for as long as you have a business relationship with them. The second is the cost to acquire a client. You want your LTV to be as high as possible compared to your CAC as a ratio. Google and learn about this idea and do some thinking and apply it to your business and return to it week after week and it will become apparent and very important to you. Everything else revolves around this ratio from a business success standpoint in pure numbers. Myself and my agents use leads from many different sources. But about half my agents work almost purely on referrals now. It is very connected to time in the business. Obviously referrals produce better results than the vast majority of leads otherwise seen some interesting exceptions. Also it appears harder for phone sales agents to get a good referral engine going. My people are in person professionals doing this full time. So referrals build rather quickly and become highly valuable."

"Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdotal personal experience) Jornaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use jornaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower intent.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trusted lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. ,get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer844c/

"Is this fraud? Im a 1099 who sells ACA and I just left a company due to some of their practices. As a 1099 they provide free inbound leads that you convert. However, a lot of these frontiers are telling callers they may qualify for a \$6400 subsidy/gift card before the warm transfer to me. Ive told the owner several times but he says "theyre leads you just have to convert them". I thought knowingly working with a vendor who does that is fraud....am I wrong?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lwzydf/>

↳ (0): "It's misleading and highly unethical, but I don't think it's fraudulent unless they say that it's guaranteed and not delivered. Let's see how other people chime in on this subject that may know better than I."

↳ (0): "As an independent broker you can be held responsible for misleading marketing tactics used in the chain of enrollment, even if it wasn't you who said those things. Someone you sell could later complain or sue you for something the lead generator said and it would be you and your Errors and Omissions policy who would be responsible for defending against legal claims. Additionally, a carrier could hold you responsible in the event of a complaint. Also takes into account how compliant you were in your sale, if the client was misled did you dissuade them from believing the questionable marketing claims? Did you also misrepresent benefits/eligibility? If you're doing everything right this does greatly diminish your potential liability in the event of a complaint/lawsuit. Edit: TLDR probably not fraud unless you also lie or misrepresent during the sale"

↳ (0): "Good for you for walking away from a bad company. That is not easy. Yes, pay attention to your lead sources. If you think that there is something unethical then drop them and document. Always refine your systems."

"General question about leads Hey everyone, I've been lurking the sub for a bit and have seen some similar issues arise but wasn't sure about my current situation.. \-I'm a P/C agent and working towards my L/H, hopefully within the month. \-I'm with a larger well known captive carrier. The Agency I'm with has been hit with non-renewals, some of the highest in the region. \-The new agent owner took on the role from the dying book of business (85% of the book was local, most of that was bundled with the non renewals) \-The name of the company is scarred in the area so there are no referrals and few renewals coming in to generate business. \-The majority of the agent owners time is spent saving the few renewals he is able to save \albeit as much as x4 the original rate. He is not generating any new leads for the business and hasn't for nearly 8 months. \-This agency being my first producer role, I was enticed with the prospect of (wait for it) paid leads. I didn't know better at the time and hadn't browsed this sub yet. Apologies in advance lol. \-I've had nearly 200 incoming paid leads since I started 6 months ago. I text often, email weekly and call daily. I even created my own spreadsheet to track the leads since no CRM is available. (I tried Monday and enjoyed it but couldn't convince the owner to adopt this.) \-The majority of these leads are instant denials without opportunity to give alternative answers. The few who do answer, the quoted rate isn't competitive. Still, I keep trying. I asked the boss and he said just keep dialing the leads, even after a "no". \-Of these paid leads, I've closed 1 thus far. A few in the "in progress " stage but that's it. I've had a few inbound calls and of the 5 available, I've closed 4... So assuming that someone wants insurance and I can beat the coverage, rate and service, people are buying. \-I'm supposed to bind at least 3% and need to hit \$20k in sales each month to be eligible for the "agent owner program". \-The owner has lamented to me that my minimal \$ value of premium is very low (I'm averaging about \$500 per lead) AND he is upset with his input of money to pay for the leads.. \-I have requested everyone at least 3 times and reached out to the 3000 odd old leads to cross sell, win back, etc. Using some math, at this rate I would need to bind more than 50% of the leads in a month's time to generate about \$10k in premium. My questions are: 1) What do you do to increase the amount of premium bound each month? 2) What do you do to increase the probability of direct contact with outbound leads? 3) Which paid lead companies work best or worst? 4) If you are unable to prospect in your local region, how do you generate business? Thanks for the read. I'm in a bit of a pickle."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1snoujd/general_question_about_leads/

↳ CFactor11 (4): "Sounds like you're beating up aged digital leads. Owner is cattle prodding you to maximize lead conversion. OR Take a look inward. How are you handling the call? Building rapport? Making human/genuine connection? Creating real value and urgency?"

↳ KN0W-IDEA (2): "I just reached out to the local chamber of commerce, made a social media page and am attempting to contact some of the local developers. Trying to put my name out there. But the agent owner doesn't have enough time to do these things himself."

↳ KN0W-IDEA (1): "Thanks for the reply! I've been curious myself for both.. it feels like the top answer but I'm always open to feedback. I have asked for input on my delivery for the few leads I've been able to connect with. I have tried many different approaches but the answer is usually the same: "stop contacting me"."

"Hi, I also work at an Allstate agency and this is my first insurance role. I just got licensed and accepted the first offer without doing much research. My day looks a lot like what you're describing: mostly outbound calls and working marketplace leads. There are people in my agency making six figures, but they're grinding hard like working Saturdays, staying late every day and they're extremely strong on the front end of the call. I've realized I'm probably not built for that style long-term. I don't think it's impossible at Allstate, but it's definitely a tough model and not for everyone. At my agency, the owner hired over 40 people this year and let about half go for performance, so the turnover is real. I'm personally looking at inbound roles (possibly Liberty Mutual) because I'm still very new and feel like I'd benefit more structured training and warm leads."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pp14vp/allstate/nujrd0/>

"You are spending a grand a week and your ending up with only a few "premium" ...your stuck in a tiered system. Who is your imo ...symmetry ...NASB...fll...they all do that to agents. Not cool. For a grand a week (which is a good budget) you should be getting brand new exclusive leads ...no aged recycled leads....none. Aged are good if they are super cheap ...but why bother if you have the budget for new? As far as the FB lead campaigns ...we use them ...they are good for agents so you have the control of your own leads. All fresh ...never re sold...and you know where they come from. The cost is so much better. We also use live transfers...again that way you know its your lead...and they are interested. Good luck!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mfu7pr/considering_trying_a_facebook_lead_campaign/n6jpo6o/

"I am tired of giving these Florida call centers my residuals, I am interested in the best IMO that offers support and great systems. I want vesting from day 1, and immediate release of my license in case if anything. I'm only interested in final expense/ mapd completely telesales only. Also I think the future is Live transfers... which company can help me."

— YouTube · What Is The Best FMO or IMO For New Medicare Agents? · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XzJoCuAyo94&lc=UgyiBOS3YlikdLiMo1V4AaABAg>

↳ @savannahsmiles1797 (3): "FL and IL have the worst cluster of them"

"Pulling my hair out I work for a small insurance agency in a commission-only sales role, and I'm trying to figure out whether I'm being unreasonable or whether I was genuinely misled about what this job would be. During my interview, I was specifically told that the phones were constantly ringing and that I wouldn't have to worry about finding enough opportunities. The impression I was given was that there was plenty of incoming business and that my job would primarily be to sell and close it. That ended up being very different from reality. After starting, I learned that I was expected to do a significant amount of networking, prospecting, attending events, making community connections, following up with cold or old leads, and essentially generating most of my own business. I understand that sales involves prospecting, especially when you're commission-only. My problem is that this wasn't how the position was presented when I accepted it. I'm also not the only sales agent who was hired with the same general pitch. It seems to be a pattern where people are brought in believing there will be substantial inbound opportunity, and then once they're there, they find out they're largely responsible for creating their own pipeline. More recently, the office structure has changed even further. Other employees now handle most incoming calls and leads, along with accounts that became available when another employee left. I've essentially been pushed into a purely outbound role. So at this point, unless I personally generate the lead, there's very little opportunity coming my way. What makes it more frustrating is that I've actually done what was asked. I've gone to networking events, built relationships, promoted the agency, followed up with prospects, and tried to create business from scratch. But if someone hears about the agency through something I did and then calls the main office without specifically asking for me, that business may go to someone else anyway. I've tried raising concerns about needing more opportunity to actually make money, but the response is basically that the company pays for some networking opportunities and I need to make those work. That leaves me feeling like the expectations have completely shifted from what I was originally told. Had I been told during the interview, "This is a commission-only role where you'll primarily be responsible for networking, cold prospecting, and building your own book from the ground up," I could have made an informed decision about whether I wanted that job. But being told that the phones were ringing off the hook and that lead flow wouldn't be an issue is very different. There have also been smaller things that have made me feel increasingly disconnected from the office, including seeing other employees receive opportunities, accounts, recognition, or inclusion that I don't seem to get. Those things wouldn't bother me nearly as much if I were actually making enough money for the job to be sustainable. I'm now updating my resume and considering other positions, either in personal-lines insurance with a more stable structure or possibly outside of insurance altogether. For people who have worked commission-only sales jobs or in small insurance agencies: would you consider this normal shifting expectations, or does it sound like the job was misrepresented during hiring? I'm especially curious how long you would give a situation like this before deciding it probably isn't going to change."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wlnr8v/pulling_my_hair_out/

↳ JustaMereHuman (6): "I can sympathize.. I was in the same boat. I was basically hired for my "connections" and when ppl didn't come running to me they let me go. I was brand new to the industry. Had a lot of contacts from my previous career. I wasn't given leads, my marketing was nill, and I felt like I was supposed to save the agency. At hiring I wasn't told about any commissions, I was paid a livable salary. The agency had family and other family friends (over 10 year friends). I was whispered about in a tiny office. After 6 weeks my anxiety was through the roof. When I was "let go" I was then able to express how hurt and misled I was. Best thing ever to NOT be there. My heart isn't racing and I can sleep at night. Move on fast. Dont let a separation negativity affect you. You separeate first."

↳ Key_Astronomer6500 (6): "Unfortunately, just happens very often. That's why most people don't make it in industry. If your license, and want an actual job, look for a job instead of running your own business. When you're a 1099 commission only, it's a business. I would much rather work somewhere where I'm getting some type of paycheck and have benefits to start. I have never been great at prospecting and I've been in sales pretty much my entire life. I've made low six figures in several different types of sales including insurance, but always on the W2 side. I've also realize that I do much better in an inbound environment. I'm more of a consultant and a closer. I'm not a Hunter. Nothing wrong with commission. But when you're 1099 and contracted, they really don't have to do anything. There are some legitimate places, but you have to either buy Leads or prospect. Or you can do what many people like myself did, and get a W2 Job where you're getting paid to base plus commission. People don't realize that benefits, social, security, tax, retirement savings, all those things add up, so you have to make way more money as a 1099 "employee" versus a w2 position. It's not difficult to make a minimum of 65,000 year and a W2 Job and the insurance industry. In fact, I know. Plenty of people who make 125,000 or more a year. I also also plenty of people who can't make it because of the KPIs and the burnout. I would never work for free. Well, never again because we've all fall for the sales pitch. I keep saying this and Will keep saying it, youre not being hired. You're being recruited. You have to interview them. It's so different than a traditional W2 Job, where they actually interview you. Most these places will hire anyone. That's breathing with the license."

↳ SlickWillie86 (3): "Deceptive but unfortunately common hiring practice. The owner has little financial investment with it being commission-based. Hire 5 producers and hope 1 makes it. The ones that fail, whatever business they did bring in is a bonus if it sticks. Honestly, it's essentially the captive hiring model - high fail rate/turnover, but benefits agency/company at scale. This doesn't mean you can't be successful there. Depending on your producer contract, namely non-solicitation, it could be an opportunity to learn + build resume before jumping ship for a better opportunity. If you have a proven track record of producing self-generated business, you'd be a highly attractive candidate for a reputable firm."

"Sorry. I have no interest in recruiting you. Just sincerely trying to help. Understand that DigitalBGA is a competitor of mine and I still recommended them, largely because the lead sources you recommended are extremely expensive or aren't very good. Sometimes you have to do more than just buy leads to actually \"get\" the good leads, as most vendors who create quality leads realize the money in this business is made in agency building, not lead selling. Here's my experience as an agency owner dealing with them: 1. Datalot: Very expensive - agents working with me in the past used them and did not get very good results. 2. SmartFinancial: I've talked to agents outside of my agency who used them. The one guy was getting 50 or 60 transfers a week and paying several thousand a week. He had to have extreme scale to get decent results (think it was \$10,000AP+ weekly). My thoughts were that his results would be good on production but considering the high cost and high volume of the inbounds, would yield him a low ROI on average, which could be potentially dangerous on low production weeks. 3. Benepath/NextGen Leads: Don't know anyone who has used them. Hope that helps."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f7rwk7/best_live_transfers/lcm82b/

Cold calling, door knocking and seminars · 163 documents · 20 voices

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crid=11ZYLLHQAIVSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&srefix=how+to+win+friend%2C&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: | Industry | Description | I --- I --- I | Tech | You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. | I | Med | You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in *The Pursuit of Happiness*. | I | Finance/Insurance | You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. | I | Hardware/Construction | Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. | I | Cars | You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. | I | Door to Door | Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. | I So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. | JOB TITLE | PAY RANGE (Salary) | PAY RANGE (OTE) | DESCRIPTION** | I --- I --- I --- I | SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) | £25,000 - £40,000 | £50,000 - £80,000 | Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. | I | SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive | £30,000 - £60,000 | £50,000 - £140,000 | Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. | I | MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive | £40,000 - £75,000 | £60,000 - £150,000 | Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. | I | ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive | £50,000 - £100,000 | £70,000 - £250,000 | Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. | I | SALES MANAGER | £60,000 - £120,000 | £80,000 - £200,000 | Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. | I | MD: Managing Director | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. | I | HEAD OF SALES | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. | I | Terminology | Description | I --- I --- I | Cold call | When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. | I | Lead | This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead'', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. | I | Account | This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. | I | Contact | This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. | I | Example of a lead, a contact and an account. | I Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

↳ vitaferox (58): "This was excellent advice for getting any sales job, honestly. And too many people skip those basics"

↳ titan623 (18): "I could kiss you right now. I've been a long time lurker and seen/saved a ton of great info for the job search, I've been meaning to sit down and organize it all. This is a SUCH a resource, especially with the concise examples, perfect for referencing. Thanks for putting this together."

↳ TheUneducatedPotato (14): "To add something that helped me land my new sales role: if you're asked to give a presentation like a 30/60/90 day plan, bring a paper copy in those cheap presentation folders. Give them out before the presentation so your interviewers can take notes. I had to fly across county to a hotel where they booked a conference room and guess what, the projector didn't work that morning. No worries. I had the power point, printed two slides per page, in a presentation folder, ready to go. Both interviewers were stunned with my fore thought and it saved me from having them crowd around my laptop looking over my shoulder. It's the little things that show you're thinking ahead."

"Why are we selling insurance like its 2005? Not trying to start drama just genuinely curious. We've got tech for everything now food shows up in 15 minutes, people find houses on their phones, we match with dates using algorithms. But when it comes to insurance? We're still cold calling, chasing unqualified leads, and quoting people we were never gonna close in the first place. We spend hours dialing and quoting but half the time it's with someone we can't even write a policy for. What if there was a smarter way to work where we only connect with people based on what they actually need and what we actually offer? Not saying tech solves everything, but there has to be a shift from the old school hustle to something more intentional. Anyone else feel like the traditional model is wearing thin?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 57 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l3wj8v/why_are_we_selling_insurance_like_its_2005/

↳ HamiltonSt25 (41): "I cold called in my first 6-8 months and completely stopped after that. That was years ago. Personally I just got out of the office and started talking to people. I enjoyed it way more. I'm mostly commercial these days so it's even different for me now, but I joined clubs, associations, so on so forth."

↳ pi20 (20): "You say 'connect with people based on what they need'. The reason consumers need agents is they don't always know what they need. The agent should be performing an exposure and risk analysis of the customer, their home and household, exposures, etc. and helping them select the coverages they should have. The agent has knowledge and expertise to know which coverages should be applied, and which carriers offer those coverages at competitive prices."

↳ DWIGHT_69_SCHRUTE (14): "Na fuck technology honestly and all this Ai bullshit"

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

↳ This-Armadillo9741 (7): "I've been wanting to share this insight for a while but never got the chance to. If you're considering being a life insurance agent- Specifically if you're considering working for globe life or American Income Life insurance (that was my run off branch) I'd like to offer you the most transparent what to expect in terms of your pay since I don't see anyone else being blunt with their numbers. I worked for AIL for 3 years from 2019 to 2022. on average my salary was around \$60-\$70k a year. With that income I was typically working 10 to 12 hours a day on the phone 7 days a week and attending weekly (and sometimes daily) training calls with my "team". I didn't do the recruitment side of the business, just the insurance hustle (I know this is where a lot of people are going to point out that THAT IS WHY I DIDNT MAKE AN EXTRAVAGANT AMOUNT PF MONEY) but let's be real, I didn't my my insurance liscence to recruit other people trying to get their insurance license, I did it to swell insurance. When you see that people are making "\$100k a month" or "\$MILLIONS a year" know this. If I sold a \$10,000 life insurance policy (which is a very minimum, basic, but affordable policy) I made \$55 in commission. with a \$1 residual pay that I would receive the following month. HOWEVER, when we hop on calls at the beginning of the week it would be announced that I "MADE" \$10,000 (completely untrue) and to capitalize on this they always ask "how much of that amount do you get to keep" to which you are trained to respond by saying "all of it" pretty manipulative too the new people huh? but we take what we can get and convince ourselves that if we just do that 10x over we'll eventually have what would look like a 'good check' here's the kicker about those "residuals" after the following month of each policy, you don't get them anymore. for whatever reason they give you, those get kicked to your upper and you basically only have that one time payment to count on. so if I can give you any advice on 'residual payments' it's that somewhere in the fine line of your contract I can guarantee they're not yours to keep. they will find some rhyme and reason as to why it will go back to the company. so, for over 10 hours of work a day, you might make \$55. "oh but what about those that ARE making millions" or "you just needed to work harder" let me tell you something: I busted my ass off on the phone and my spleine KNEW I had no interest in recruiting people so EVENTUALLY (we'll say after a year) I got granted some pretty good leads. Now I was finally able to make some big bucks! Without getting too verbose the average policy amount for these clients would be ranging from \$150k ~ \$500k. The largest I ever sold was for a \$500k policy and here's the breakdown for that : I got paid a whopping \$1,300 in commission and a \$300 'residual' the following month. so ...you do the numbers"

↳ jroberts67 (6): "I'm sorry for your experience, but plenty of flags and not trying to come at you too hard, but a level of insanity that there's never been a time in history where we have more information available yet no one wants to research. Group interview? Huge flag. Paying for anything upfront? Huge flag. "Releasing your license" is absurd, once you've passed your exam your license is activated by your state, not any agency."

↳ Current_Bridge_3615 (4): "Worked for AIL as well, you wouldn't believe the horror stories I got during that short time. Let's just say there's a reason they've been sued multiple times and are currently under investigation for insurance fraud."

"Be prepared for the phone apocalypse Apple dropped the hammer on all unsolicited calls. With the iOS 26 update in September, no calls will automatically go through unless their in your contacts. Instead, the person calling will have to state their name and the reason for the call. That will show up as a text and the caller decides whether or not to allow the call. Here's a demo: <https://youtu.be/4yFDvqEjciQ?feature=shared> Apple owns 60% of the market. If other phone manufacturers and even carrier follow, it's possible we see day where cold calling has died. This will have a direct, negative effect on leads, especially shared leads. Be prepared."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 50 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l8sgfs/be_prepared_for_the_phone_apocalypse/

↳ Pneuma_LooT (32): "Id say 90 to 95% of people do not answer phone calls anyways. Its not until they receive a text and set up a time to talk that they respond. This is what the industry has become the last few years for whatever reason."

↳ Madeanaccountforyou4 (25): "Google Pixel phones have had this since 2018"

↳ SilentFlames907 (15): "Then I guess agencies will actually have to provide us with viable leads?"

"anyone else hate receiving AI-voice generated cold calls? the usual AI-generated cold calls I got were usually those that assume you aren't interested. "hi. this is x from x company. we are calling to tell you that you are eligible for our medicare benefits. do you have plan A or plan B?" "plan A" "I understand, but this call will not take too much of your time. it will only take a minute to discuss your eligibility.""

— r/sales · 48 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1fhlgv1/anyone_else_hate_receiving_aivoice_generated_cold/

↳ bitslammer (25): "Not really, because they get to speak to my AI (Google Assistant) and I don't even know it. I only see the notification and block/mark them as SPAM when I do."

↳ [deleted] (19): "My favorite thing to do is wait until the AI prompt is over and then when the other person picks up yell "Kashmir belongs to Pakistan!"

↳ Reddevil313 (14): "Sometimes I get a call and the person is so rehearsed that I'm not sure if it's AI or not. I have to be careful not to get frustrated with a human being by mistake. I did once ask someone if they were AI and the response seemed strangely off so I hung up. I got an email immediately after saying he wasn't AI but the speed at which I received the email after hanging up was suspicious. I think about that one sometimes."

"The Lifeboat Mentality The art of selling is truly an art, and guess what, it's something that every single one of us needs to master - fast. I'm going to get the first, and what I think is the most important step out of the way immediately: **Stop trying to sell *products* and start selling *yourself*** When I first started, I always had this question in my sales experience: Why is it that one guy has extreme success selling the same product, and another guy doesn't? Let me tell you about a time when I sold life insurance that completely changed the way I sell, and will sell for the rest of my life. So, I got hired at a huge brokerage in Florida. We were contracted with 40+ different insurance agencies to market and sell their products. I had to be licensed to sell annuities, medicare products, health insurance, prescription drug packages, and life insurance. So, needless to say we had an **ARSENAL** of products to choose from. During the orientation, we were greeted by the companies top salesman. The idea was for him to come in and share his success, and answer any questions us newbies may have before we ventured out on our own. It came about time for him to come speak, and in my head I'm thinking some young 20-something was going to bolt through the door with excitement and enthusiasm. Wrong. In walks a 60-year old retired war-veteran who had been crushing the insurance game in this company for the last year, month after month! His annualized premium average was close to \$26,000 per month. (This is the amount of Premiums people that he sold to were paying on a monthly basis. He not only receives residuals off of this, sometimes he'll even receive a 90-95% commission off of the first-year premium total - If they pay \$100 per month, he receives around \$1000) I couldn't believe it. But, me transitioning from shock to understanding, I began to listen to him. His success was no secret. He literally worked "harder" than everyone else. His military mentality came into play big time in this field. Why? He would knock on 30 doors per day. Non stop, wake up at 7am, and not go home until 5pm, or until he successfully spoke to 30 people. His strength was in his numbers. Law of averages! If he got a "No." he wouldn't waste a second, bat an eye, or fold. He knew his power was in his ability to talk to as many people as possible. Day after day, same mentality: Do it, or die. (Not to that extent, but you get the idea!) **Takeaway One: Understand the law of averages, and commit to it!** However, although we had an arsenal to sell from, I became completely overwhelmed because it seemed impossible to take in all of the product specs and legalities, all while trying to create a smooth sales pitch. So, instead of focusing on things I didn't know, I just focused on one of the many things I could sell that would give me the best chance at success: life insurance. I modeled the success of the older salesman, and knocked door to door to offer our product relentlessly. But, door to door sales isn't as easy as it seems. Actually, it doesn't seem easy at all. Think about it. Have you ever bought anything from someone who randomly walked up to your door trying to sell something to you? The idea is crazy. But, it works. Numbers game. Same with cold calling, and same with any service. The idea is to put yourself in a position to collide your product with a consumer in demand, at the time they have made up their mind to purchase. If they haven't made up their mind to purchase, it's your job, as a salesman to help them. But, knowing how crazy this idea is, I had to separate myself and treat people as if they were my friends. I didn't come across as pushy, I came across as informative, and very confident - I adopted the **Life Boat Mentality** The Life Boat Mentality is simple: Your customers are drowning. They are drowning from poor quality products or services. You see them drowning in these products or services, and paddle on over in your Lifeboat. The idea is this: With impeccable trust, of course, you persuade your client to get in your life boat. Your life boat is the "best" option. And if it's not the best option, you need to find a company that offers the best option and sell that. (I'm not about selling garbage - Honestly) If you truly in your heart believe that what you are selling is the best option, the Lifeboat Mentality will help you tremendously. For example. I own a small residential repaint company now. I've taken the Lifeboat Mentality with me throughout my entire duration owning a business. I've got the branding where I want it, I have the production where it needs to be, and the Lifeboat mentality that I carry with me says this: Mr. & Mrs. Customer: I know that there is a TON of options in the marketplace. So many to choose from, however, I know this for a fact. There will be none other than my company that will show you the amount of respect and care you deserve throughout the entire tenure of us working for you. From the initial handshake to the final good-bye I can guarantee that our quality of service is of exemplary fashion. How do I ensure that this remains true? How do I have the confidence to pitch this? Because as the business owner, I insure it. My sales process is down to a science and has clear concise wording, professional formatting, and a great follow-up procedure. We have references and a great website for them to visit, and provide insurance and legal information up front. I ensure that I will be at each job to make sure that our quality of service is exactly as promised. In other words, I'm showing them that I *me*, the *salesperson* am the lifeboat! It may seem silly at first, but think of yourself as a lifeboat. Start saving people! Happy selling! P.S if you're interested in knowing more about the painting business, feel free to PM me I'd be happy to answer any questions you may have!"

— r/sales · 47 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/7tph4u/the_lifeboat_mentality/

↳ krimpenrik (8): "Exactly how i sold used cars. After 10 years it was easy to see that a lot of times they buy the car from you because they trust you instead of a cheaper car at a competitor. I wasn't a sleek guy all dressed up. Often with a oil stained Polo because I was helping out in the garage. It doesn't matter, even helps to gain trust"

↳ JDogNumeroUno (5): "> Mr. & Mrs. Customer: I know that there is a TON of options in the marketplace. So many to choose from, however, I know this for a fact. There will be none other than my company that will show you the amount of respect and care you deserve throughout the entire tenure of us working for you. From the initial handshake to the final good-bye I can guarantee that our quality of service is of exemplary fashion. This is Brilliant! Very much like Jay Abraham, well done!"

↳ [deleted] (4): "Thanks for the great post!"

"Is 41 too late to get into insurance? Hey guys, looking into getting my p&c license and give selling insurance a go. I currently bartend, but that's only a side hustle really, not an actual career path. So my questions to you are • Is 41 too late to get into the industry? • Am I going to be sitting at a desk/cubicle all day? Or can/will I be up and moving about? • What are some of the best companies to apply for entry level positions at? Places with some of the best training. •Am I gonna have to cold call every day? Are leads provided? And if there's any other info you'd like to provide on what to expect as a first year insurance agent please feel free to drop it here."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1id8ena/is_41_too_late_to_get_into_insurance/

↳ MeatballSandy22 (17): "I started at 47. You have plenty of runway to make a career change. All your other questions are heavily reliant on what type of company you start working for. I was able to land on the commercial lines side of an independent agency. I cold call and go visit businesses. No leads provided. Independents are different than captives (your State Farms, Farmers, Allstates), as we are appointed with dozens of carriers as opposed to only selling one product line."

↳ Zbinxxy (14): "Im 8 years in , first year I made like 20k, now I make over six figures. If you're willing to learn and be taught at 41 by people who are possibly in your 20s without resentment go for it. My only regret is that I didn't start earlier."

↳ blinndog81 (14): "I'm 43, started insurance in August."

"AVOID: Bankers Life Had the worst experience with BL. No base pay! Horrible leads, cold calling, no benefits, wasting gas to go to appts and door knock, no reimbursements and you basically have to pay to work for them. I had to share leads with 20 other agents and we were all paying for these crap leads that don't even answer. Your managers make money off you when you sell and it's all triangle shaped.. AVOID!!!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gaf2yn/avoid_bankers_life/

↳ WorriedLow146 (2): "I'm 65 abd have an interview. Coming up should I go through with this or decline."

↳ OracleVision88 (2): "I just had an orientation with them today and I came on Reddit to do some snooping. No wonder they are all over Indeed, trying to get any and everyone they can, in the door. I'm going back next week for a one on one interview. I will keep you posted on whether or not I pursue this. The commission based system was of no surprise to me, and they claim they are looking for people that want to make a career of this, which at 36 and not quite so many prospects, this may be amongst the best I can get. Thoughts? Edit: I was told that Banker's Life provides the leads to the agents and that it doesn't come out of our pockets, but you're saying that these leads, in fact, do. I've heard of agents paying \$75-\$300 for leads, and that's not something that I am trying to do."

↳ Elegant_Support_8082 (1): "I would highly recommend you to find somewhere that pays a base salary. When I was with Bankers Life, they didn't pay any base and commissions were super low. 95% quit within 6 months. They are a very manipulative company and they're captive, which means every client you obtain is actually theirs and you don't get paid/get to work with them after you leave as they make you sign a non-compete so you can't try and switch firms and take your clients. They pay no base salary, so you'll have to invest your own cash alongside your time. Be prepared for lots of stops at the gas pump, long days walking thru neighborhoods door-knocking and getting yelled off properties. Most people don't appreciate strangers showing up to their door and some people thought I was a missionary, LOL. But what rarely happened is people buying from me. And guess what, even when you do get a sale, they can cancel for up to a year after you sold the policy to them and Bankers Life takes that money right back out your pocket and does what they call a chargeback. I remember one time I drove an hour away to an appt, sold the policy and the lady texted me on the drive back home she thought she made a rushed decision and wanted to cancel the policy, despite it being a very smooth appt in my eyes. So all that you earned is gone, all the time, effort, gas etc gone and it can happen at any point up to a year after. Man this is just the start. I would highly, highly recommend avoiding Bankers Life and most insurance companies in general. Look for something with a base pay, they can afford it. Goodluck!"

"How Keyboard Warrior Marketing Built My Commercial Book Faster Than Ads Ever Did I wanted to share a prospecting approach that has been huge for me, especially with small commercial accounts like pressure washers, lawn care, and other contractor niches. I call it **Keyboard Warrior Marketing**, and it is about showing up where potential clients already spend time online and leading with real underwriting insight instead of a hard sell. The workflow is simple. I join industry Facebook groups using my personal account, I watch for posts where people talk about pricing or ask coverage questions, and I jump in with quick risk checkups, not full quotes, just a few smart questions like what is your day to day, any employees, roof work, vehicles, or subs. It positions you as the expert and builds trust right away. After the comment I like and add the original poster and anyone else engaging. Over time Facebook starts suggesting me as a friend to more people in the same trade, which creates a passive lead funnel. From there I message when it feels natural, I quote small general liability policies in about five to ten minutes, I send PDFs and payment links so they can buy at their own pace, and I follow up one week, one month, and one quarter later if they do not close right away. It has been a steady stream of warm leads without ad spend. If you are an independent agent who wants to break into commercial, or you are tired of cold calls and expensive ads, this is worth trying. I am curious if anyone else here has been using something similar, or wants to share scripts and messaging strategies that work."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o1c6iq/how_keyboard_warrior_marketing_built_my/

↳ Monskiaactual (5): "this organic marketing sometimes call engagement marketing, it works, i used it early on in my mortgage career when i didnt know how to work leads two things. 1. It takes a fair amount of time and it is not inherently scaleble.. there is only so people you can engage with 2. Its a unique skill set, not everyone can do it. but if you can do it and do it seriously you can get good business . Congrats!"

↳ InsuranceGnome (4): "100% it has pros and cons but it is free and generates revenue at \$0 cost, just time and sweat to grow is a good deal."

↳ InsuranceGnome (2): "You should consider finding yourself a virtual assistant who can buyback time and duplicate yourself in some of these tasks as well, I personally found a VA on Free Marketing was a better return then Paid Marketing funnels. I had a 50% to 60% margin with staffing cost with VA's averaged out over time."

"Dude I just want to say I started an ad. The first day not much happened. The second day I didn't think much was going to happen but then I got two leads. The third day I woke up to 4 leads and collected more throughout the day The fourth day I got even more. Every single one of these leads I can get on the phone I sale. I hit them as fast as I can, ideally within 60 seconds. My biggest challenge right now is just getting them to answer the phone. Peter I can't begin to thank you enough this gives me soooo much more flexibility in my business as before I looked into this I primarily relied on door knocking one year old leads and it was more expensive and time consuming. Thank you thank you thank you"

— YouTube · Generate UNLIMITED Final Expense Leads On Facebook In 2024 (Full Tutorial) · 22 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aTFT03FiUCM&lc=UgxcG3JURuxdb4y1pCR4AaABAq>

↳ @thethriller1287 (2): "Hey Man I just started running ads myself. How do you get notified when a lead comes in/fills out a form to call them so fast?"

↳ @sleaperr (0): "@thethriller1287 need to link it to your CRM"

↳ @HealthyHair424 (0): "What is your update on the facebook leads six months later?"

"It gets easier. Cold calls suck. I started on cold calls. You need an agency that invests in leads for their producers."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wd1ygk/i_got_my_licence_a_month_ago_ive_sold_zero/p92oxsp/

"New job offer with an independent agency. So my base will actually be \$45,000 because I have all the licenses. But this comp structure seems very low. From what I understand during the interview I will not be doing much cold calling and I'll be working warm leads. I won't actually do many quotes either just build rapport and close. They have an in-house guy that looks at all the decs and puts some proposals together between multiple carriers. They showed me some reports and they do hit their goals/metrics pretty often and so it "shouldn't be hard" hitting goal. I am a very motivated sales rep. But the salary seemed really good and I think I see why. What are your thoughts?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tv96xv/>

↳ (0): "If you can hit 50+ a month it's good but Indy does not not usually have scaling commission like this. Seems fishy. I bet no one is selling more than 50/mo there. Oh actually after reading the text, go for it. If you aren't quoting and the leads are warm, if you are good at listening and a people person, know how to sell, you should be fine. Might not be a permanent deal but I'd rock this for a few years probably and maybe renegotiate. Big thing: Renewals?"

↳ (0): "I have to ask about renewals. We really didn't talk money when I was there today. One of his staff reached out with an offer letter just a little while ago. I'm going back Tuesday to discuss when to start and go over pay so I'll have to see."

↳ (0): "Agent is paying you less than 2% on P&C for \$40k—that's insultingly low in my opinion. Overall commission structure seems low for an independent. Do you get renewal commission on P&C?"

"We need more live sales/ cold calls!! The best way to learn as a new agent"

— YouTube · Real Medicare Sales Call - Initial Resistance Smashed! · 20 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=58cUUZmEQm4&lc=Ugz7sRXZ99MaU_1vtGZ4AaABAg

↳ @medicarerockstars5172 (2): "More are definitely on the way! make sure you are subscribed! Thanks Marcus 🍌 "

↳ @crazysultan7101 (0): "Why people are saying that no medicare doesn't call people so what should we do is coustmor said that"

"How to create a client list, it doesn't matter if it's cold calling or not The company I'm trying to work for requires me to create a contact list of 150 people. They said it can include friends, family, former coworkers, Instagram, etc as long as I have their phone number and email. The list is confidential and won't be taken from me they just want me ready to call when I officially start. This is a test before they sponsor my health and life insurance. I've already gone through my contacts, social media, and friends, but so far I've only been able to gather around 20–40 people max. How do I go on about find more people and no I don't have any more personal leads or referrals that they could give. Edit: The company is called thoroughbred advisor, commission based and you keep your own book. Also they sponsor for series license which is my big incentive Edit 2: I have decided not to take the job after reading all the comments. I should instead just get my basic licenses and market myself better. This way I actually have a strong foundation. Thank you for everyone sharing their opinions"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r2emia/how_to_create_a_client_list_it_doesnt_matter_if/

↳ Glittering-Read-6906 (40): "This is a red flag. Don't do this."

↳ qmcnam4002 (17): "They want to sell to your contact list for you and call it "training""

↳ Glittering-Read-6906 (12): "It's because they are using OP as a free source of leads. It's an immediate red flag to me."

"Allstate? I accepted a sales position at an Allstate agency about a month ago and was told it would be a six figure opportunity. However, now that I'm in it, I don't see how. Allstate Marketplace Leads are pure shit. Anyone have experience working for an Allstate agent? Should I quit and just be independent? Seems like I might as well work for myself if all I'm doing is cold calling on bunk leads all day."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 19 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pp14vp/allstate/>

↳ InsuranceMD123 (18): "I can guarantee that you won't be anywhere close to 6 figures off of ALM alone. If you are waiting for the phone to ring, and relying on the leads your agent gives you, it's probably 50k at best. If there are other producers in your office that are successful, see what they are doing. Otherwise, you're going to need to find additional activity. Making outbound calls when the phone's not ringing. Utilize your lead management system to keep on top of old leads, and try to build a pipeline. Then build relationships with centers of influence such as realtors and mortgage brokers. That's really the only way. It's possible, but it's not easy."

↳ Many-Neat641 (11): "I worked at Allstate and made 6 figures in sales. My answer is most of my clients came to me eventually. I didn't start making 6 figures until my third year there. I scraped and went out to the community and got known. I was selective with the risks I would insure and as such got only qualified referrals on mid and high value individuals. First two years I hit hard and stayed late. Got to the point I was leaving early and only dealing with client referrals. The advice is the get out in the community. Meet and greet clients that you want to meet. Go to events for those with the background you are targeting and become an expert in an area or two over time. You aren't going to be given a book to manage worth what you want you need to grow it yourself. Allstate is interested in only one thing growth. Don't worry about renewals (despite it being good business practice) they don't care. Only new clients get you paid...so find new clients through the old ones."

↳ Tall_Emergency653 (9): "Hi, I also work at an Allstate agency and this is my first insurance role. I just got licensed and accepted the first offer without doing much research. My day looks a lot like what you're describing: mostly outbound calls and working marketplace leads. There are people in my agency making six figures, but they're grinding hard like working Saturdays, staying late every day and they're extremely strong on the front end of the call. I've realized I'm probably not built for that style long-term. I don't think it's impossible at Allstate, but it's definitely a tough model and not for everyone. At my agency, the owner hired over 40 people this year and let about half go for performance, so the turnover is real. I'm personally looking at inbound roles (possibly Liberty Mutual) because I'm still very new and feel like I'd benefit more structured training and warm leads."

"This guy. Started my own agency about 3 and a half years ago now. Probably made 10-15 cold calls in that time, don't think I'll make many more. Advertising, referrals and company provided leads. I'm not trying to scale, I'm not trying to make a million a year. It's going well. Spend about \$20k a year on advertising. When I got in the business 25 years ago, I was a cold calling machine."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mk37eo/anyones_agency_not_do_coldcalling_for_leads/n7fouui/

"Lead Generation New Agent, started in Jan as a W2, VERY low base salary with a commission split and no agency marketing or lead generation happening at the firm level. Everyone is on their own. I am struggling big time on getting lead generation going. Have been trying social media but have gotten virtually nothing from this. I've also been going to several leads/networking groups, have gone to about 3 meetings each. Do I door knock at this point? Looking for any tips or guidance.....feeling very defeated. I've quoted and called on the x-dates that were available and got a few from this but that's about it. I've asked for referrals on each sale I have done. Not getting any guidance from the principle."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1shk3tg/>

↳ (0): "It's tough, I've been there. u/idx-just-a-username has great info, I agree with all of that. I have a friend who drove around and walked into local businesses cold-calling, every morning from 8am-noon, for months. He would just go door to door, ask to quote their commercial insurance, ask questions & make notes if they said yes, then go on to the next one until noon. Then he'd eat his lunch, and quote all afternoon. It took a few months, but he got to where he was writing \$100k/month in new business off those. I was more focused on personal lines when I started; I met with realtors and mortgage lenders, had 5-7 coffee meetings with them every week, and if we hit it off I'd try to schedule a time to visit one of their sales meetings at their office. Hit it off with more lenders/realtors, rinse and repeat. Refer realtors to the lenders you really like, so they want to refer their clients to you. This is how I've built my business; it's a great way to go. Takes some time to get going, but once you do, you're living on referrals, not cold calls. Referrals are a MUCH higher close ratio, and way more fun to work. In the early months, when I was building that up, I spent money on leads. I put them on credit cards if I couldn't afford to pay cash. I don't recommend that, but whatever. I did it. I tried Dave Ramsey leads, Datalot (I think they have another name now?), Hometown, and a bunch of others. Ramsey & Datalot were the best, but also the most expensive. Datalot are live leads; they literally transfer them to you. There's a commercial insurance version of this too called Tivly; they're worth looking up. Any leads you buy will be expensive, but if you need to manufacture some business quick, it can work. There are also Aged leads you can buy for cheaper than hot ones. If you work up a good Aged lead script, and you're willing to be told 'No' a bunch, they can be good. I would also sponsor events, sports teams, etc. Go to the nonprofit, talk with them, say you want to do a fundraiser, and see if they'll help you market it on their socials. I'd put out there with groups that followed those charities that I was raising money for their charity; if you'd get a quote from me, I'd donate \$20 to that charity. No obligation to buy anything, just get a quote. Lots of those quotes turned into business, because lots of them had been meaning to shop their insurance anyway, and this was the excuse they needed. Use being the 'new guy' to your advantage. I used to walk into local businesses and say "Hey, I'm new, just started out at xyz insurance agency down the road. I just wanted to stop by and meet the neighbors!" See if anybody there will talk to you, make it low key, be interested in them, ask questions, etc. Honestly, activity breeds opportunity. The more you're out there, talking to people, being in the community, you're going to get opportunities to quote. If you're not winning quotes, then maybe you need a different agency, or you need to evaluate your sales process, but it sounds like right now you just need more opportunities. Good luck! The first 6 months are tough, but this is a KILLER career if you can make it."

↳ (0): "Thanks for everyone's words of encouragement and feedback. Apparently I was a day late and dollar short. Boss calls me at 4:45 Friday afternoon to let me know he is letting me go. Said I hadn't brought any business in. I asked when would he pay the commission on the 50k+ WP I brought in and he said he didn't realize I wrote it although I sent him a monthly excel sheet. SMH As much as it sucks being laid off, it's for the best. Clearly, this office was not the right fit so now I move on. Still a gut punch, was laid off at 50 and now again at 51. Never have I experienced this."

↳ (0): "I'm assuming you're selling commercial based on the networking groups. Doing what you're doing now will only help you, about 2-3 years down the road though. But you already answered your own question. Get a list of x-dates and make a lot of calls. A new agent's greatest asset is time. You have no defense to play, no book to service. You can spend that time on social media, networking, cold-calling or doing all 3. The former 2 are long term plays, the latter is immediate impact. If cold-calling makes you nervous, just remember that you could be the agent that sheds light on a coverage gap that could have ended the business's existence, or reduce a balance sheet expense enough that they can hire a new employee. That's why we're professionals. Key to calling, in my opinion, is having the xdate. If you call in that 2-3 month period prior to renewal, they're thinking about it, they'll talk (not all of them of course). You call after they renew, it's a dead horse, you're a pest. I use Insurance Xdate because they are really easy to use and seem to be the only ones that actually have Workers Comp xdates, but at this point there are a couple options for insurance specific data. PS Feeling defeated is definitely part of the business. Just wait until you pick up a deposit check on a 500k deal only to have the check canceled b/c the owner's son is golf buddies with the incumbent...then get BOR'd on the monoline Umbrella. That was over a decade ago and I still want to throat punch that sack of shit Tim."

"Tons and tons. How me and my business partner both started. Cold calling commercial. Sucked, was hard, learned a lot. Then built my agency with internet leads that felt easy by comparison. I wish I could upvote this thread 100x"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1udkyjb/just_do_itotdbpxd/

"I have been in this industry for 14 years and it has become a shell of it's former self. Let me explain. In 2009 is when CMS enacted over 100 new regulations in the Medicare industry. New regulations included annual enrollment periods, government regulated commissions for Part C and D, a Scope of Appointment form that must be completed prior to an agent's presentation, annual AHIP certifications to be able to sell policies in addition to annual carrier certifications, soon after new legislation that required MA plans to have to have a network which killed PFFS plans which were the most popular MA plans at that time, laws which forbids agents to market Part C and D products, laws which govern every aspect of agents holding seminars even including not allowing agents to offer free meals for attendees, the inability to call referrals (the referral must contact you), regulations on carriers that made it illegal for carriers to offer bonuses and trips to agents for production rewards, and many more that I can't think of off the top of my head. After these draconian regulations were passed most agents left the industry. The only ones that stayed were the agents that had a solid book of business prior to these new regulations which is why the average age of a Medicare agent is 60 years old. This industry's golden age was from 1998 to 2008. Medicare Advantage was a brand new concept as well a few years later Part D was brand new as well. There were plenty of reasons why seniors needed to talk with an agent during this time and the big money was made at this time. That all changed in 2009. CMS used the excuse that since agents were getting compensated with taxpayer money (Medicare funding Dollars) that CMS had the right to regulated everything about the agent's existence in this industry. In 2020, very little has changed under the Trump administration. The only good thing to be improved upon was CMS not requiring the Scope of Appointment form to be filled out 48 hours prior to an agent's presentation and changed it to the same day as the appointment. Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as well for fear that the carrier will get in trouble with CMS and lose funding for their plans. Part D plans pay almost nothing for the sheer amount of work that needs to be done reviewing your client's drug list every year that you are almost working for free. MAPD plans pay the same commission as MA only plans. Now if you understand inflation this is another issue as well. The US Dollar loses 2%-3% of it's value every year which causes prices to increase, but you get paid renewals based upon commission rates from the first year you write the business. So while you do make renewals, those renewals become less and less every year. Now that MA plans have ironed out their networks and funding is stabilized, there is little need for seniors to switch Medicare plans every year because they already are in the best plan possible. You can go after T65 business, but that has also become problematic as well. Since Social Security has raised the full benefit retirement age from 65 to 67, most seniors are still working for an employer at 65 and have no need for Medicare coverage until they retire, especially since many spouses are not yet on Medicare and their spouse needs the group coverage. The (un)Affordable Care Act aka Obamacare is terrible and has made major medical coverage too expensive and too restrictive. After 14 years in the industry I have finally realized all that is bad and the bad FAR out weighs the good. The commissions are too small for an agent to make it especially with so few seniors actually needing a better plan plus with everything I previously mentioned you need to be insane to become a Medicare agent in 2020. If you do start off in this industry you need at LEAST 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months of marketing expenses saved or you will run out of money very quick and need to find an hourly job. You must write 100 policies every year to make it in this industry and you will max out at 400 to 500 clients because any more clients and you will have to hire help. So at \$250 commission per client earned every year you are looking at a max of \$100,000 to \$125,000 minus your marketing expenses which will cost you between \$12,000 to \$20,000 per year plus all the gas consumption and wear and tear on your vehicle driving all over town on appointments, double taxes you pay for FICA, Medicare and Social Security taxes, and lack of access yourself to affordable health insurance by not having access to group health policies. Covid-19 is a new hurdle agents must overcome and adds a dozens new challenges because of CMS regulations. The Medicare industry just isn't worth it anymore."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAg>

↳ @fleridalara888 (4): "@Seniorbenes everything he's saying is scary. I am interested in this business but I am new and don't have the capital even for leads rinow"

↳ @Seniorbenes (3): "@michaelhuebner6843 Michael Thanks for your response ,factually It is just me I am not an agency, I just did some pre-planning before getting into the business and some due diligence. I listened to the successful agents and worked my but of because I did not want to be part of the failure statistics. If you plan, execute, assess, and repeat it comes together before you know it. The secret is 12 hour days kkkkk"

↳ @michaelhuebner6843 (2): "@Seniorbenes Well you are running an agency and that is not feasible for most new agents because they lack the capitol to start on a large scale like that. Yes if you scale to the point you are doing then it can work, but your investment is huge when this industry has 90% of new agents failing in the first 2 years. My description is what an average independent agent will perform. Nick from Medicare Millionaire is an independent agent and works by himself. He is a seasoned agent and very good at selling yet he only sold 127 policies in 2018 and he does this full time and employs his own telemarketer for \$3 per hour and uses direct mail leads. I was an assistant office manager for a Medicare brokerage firm for 9 years and out of 10 agents that our office had we only had 2 top producers and they each had about 1,500 clients. They serviced all of their clients and they were extremely stressed out all the time especially during AEP when MA plans became discontinued and they needed to review plan changes every year for their large client base. The average agent had about 500 clients. You need to provide customer service for your clients if you want to keep them long term and the sheer amount of work required to service MA plans simply isn't worth it. 95% of the calls we got at our agency was people having questions about their co-pays, the network, prescription drug co-pays, Part D late enrollment penalties, prescription drug issues, and how their plan worked. You spent all your time servicing MA and Part D clients and this is why you can't have more than 500 clients on your own before you are forced to hire help. Having 2,000 clients yourself means you aren't providing service to them when they have issues or you are just selling Medigap. Sorry to say but 70% of seniors on Medicare nationwide have Medicare Advantage. You and I both know how hard it is to market Part C and D plans selling over the phone as CMS makes this almost impossible. You need a partnership with a carrier to pull that off on a large scale and be successful which makes you captive to that carrier. I am in this industry to help seniors, not to help some corporate insurance carrier gain market share. CMS doesn't allow you to market Part C or Part D on social media, you need to read your AHIP test again my dude."

"First off, get the MLM idea out of your head. The whole insurance industry is built upon uplines and downlines that is fully commission based. If you want a salary, you'll have to find an agency (whose commission based and has an upline) that'll pay you something fixed. Tough to find something like that for L&H compared to P&C. FE is great for upfront funds, but know that there can be quite a few chargebacks, so 30% of your commissions should go into a side-account to pay for these until you get your lead saturation up and your sales skill level established. Yes, Medicare is a grind unless you know how to cross-sell ancillary, then it's better than FE. In fact I recommend this track for newer FE agents: 1. Contract with someone that can train you and gives you fair contracts 100+% for FE and 20% for Medicare Supplements. 2. Get leads (facebook and direct mail) EVERY week in the same 50 sq mile area, and work them hard, spend 40 hours a week in the field, getting in front of as many people as possible. Build up a saturation level so that when you invariably door knock your leads and they say no or they're not home, you can just simply go two streets down and knock the guy you could never get ahold of a month or two ago. 3. Take some sample lead info and put it into a Medicare Quoting tool and find out whose competitive in your area for supplements, advantage plans etc. Start building your Medicare knowledge up. Of course, first past the AHIP so you have a base understanding for it. Just a few hours a week can help build up a wealth of knowledge. Once you understand how everything works, any changes to plans, companies or Medicare itself is easily assimilable - whereas there's no changes to FE usually. 4. Tell every lead you'll follow up with them in September to schedule a meeting in October to go over their Medicare options - because you do that too. If you don't sell anyone any FE, that's ok, offer to contact them in September for their Medicare, you "help seniors save money on their prescriptions and get extra benefits at no cost to them." If you paid for the lead, might as well get as much use out of them. 5. Selling FE sucks in November to December, the holidays. It's way easier to work with warm leads, sell them Medicare, and also increase your persistency lapse rate on your FE policies as well as bring in tons of referrals and get paid 2x as you would've just selling an FE policy. You could have enough leads to keep you busy all AEP, so that when that ends, you have a 2 week lull before New Years where you can start the whole cycle up again. THIS is the secret to making big bucks imo. Cody and Dave are good guys, Dave helped me out when I was where you were at, 12 years ago. He comes on here sometimes, haven't seen Cody on here yet."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/svjgsv/help_i_passed_accidenthealth_and_life_now_im/hxgcw8n/

Aged leads · 141 documents · 20 voices

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought *pre-sold leads* from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigator (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the *insurance carrier, not the agent*, for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigator wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigator. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

↳ HamiltonSt25 (75): "Quitting insurance today and becoming a professional litigator Imao"

↳ InsuranceEvangelist (70): "New income stream unlocked..."

↳ DavidDuford (24): "For real =). I should start selling info-product courses on how to do it, and partner with a lawyer to do all the work. "Make an easy \$1500 a day with one simple trick.""

"Quiet quitting - byeeeeeee I'm an sdr at an insurance company. Fully remote. We grind hard every day - like 200+ dials. Warm and cold leads - no break in the calls or voicemails. All day. Every day. Calls and voicemails pop literally every 10-15 seconds. The commission is crap, but the base is comfortable. Here's the issue - I have decided this is not for me and I am going to quiet quit until they fire me. How do I disengage completely when I am compelled to do well and to succeed? Do I just ride the clock? Do I blow sales intentionally? Or what. A little help and guidance. TIA"

— r/sales · 105 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/14m75j1/quiet_quitting_byeeeeeee/

↳ Typical-Mouse-4804 (231): "Ride the clock. Do bare minimum. Apply for jobs. Block calendar for interviews with DOCTOR APT and DMV and shit like that."

↳ Eswift33 (101): "Pre-record a script and have the recording play when someone answers. If they bite then close the deal. Do this all while playing PlayStation 🎮"

↳ ATLS_finest (88): "I'm always amazed when I hear about the sheer number of calls some SDR types make. 200 calls per day is 25 calls per hour for 8 hours per day. In my first sales job I was making 60-70 calls per day and I thought that was a lot. You would basically never put the phone down. Do you have other training, reporting or administrative tasks to do or do you literally just pick up the phone and dial for 8 hours straight?"

"I'm learning off 5-10 year old leads making 300+ dials a day to learn as fast as possible made my first sale yesterday thanks for the video"

— YouTube · Cold Calling 3-Month-Old Leads LIVE – Watch Me Close Insurance Sales · 52 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qvBEaHr_MGU&lc=Ugybs2i2wGd1cChHPq54AaABAg

↳ @thomasmorris2245 (6): "Congratulations on your first sale"

↳ @15pluna (4): "hey quick question do you mean the leads are 5-10 yrs old???? impressiiveeee!"

↳ @oExlucive (0): "@15pluna I was calling aged mortgage leads, the company that had sent out the ads, sent mailers in around 2018-2022 was the earliest lead I seen, and so many people have already called on these people so the 2 sales I had off 600 leads had a lot of smoke screens and they already had policies so I had to switch them over, Mutual of Omaha and royal neighbors are the 2 carrier's we used to find more coverage at better rates"

"I've been calling very old leads, some a year plus. Wanted to share the opener I've been using & it's been working. "Hi Mark, my name is David, calling from not too far down the road here in Tampa. First & foremost i wanted to apologize for it taking so long to follow up with you, how have you been?" I've never talked to these people in my life, but guards seem to be let down. Great video. Keep it up."

— YouTube · LIVE Dialing: Cold Calling Insurance Leads (SCRIPT GIVEAWAY) · 47 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=POOoucTXJYc&lc=Ugy-hLbZx8ABAWNvJdX4AaABAg>

↳ @robofreak425 (2): "Well, first impressions are important after all. Best to start off showing that you care about them and their time. Helps you come across as amiable (friendly) and considerate."

"the shared leads thing is such a scam and I can't believe we all just accept it Bought a batch of "exclusive" commercial leads last month. Called the first ten. Three of them told me I was the fourth agent to call that week. Fourth. So I'm paying, what, \$14 a lead to race three other brokers to the same shipping company owner who's already annoyed before I even open my mouth? How is that a business model for anyone except the vendor selling the list four times? The aged leads are somehow worse. Bought some for like \$2-3 each thinking okay, these are old but at least they're cheap. Half the businesses had closed or changed ownership. One number was a Subway. Not a Subway that needed commercial coverage, just a Subway where some guy named Dave was confused about why insurance agents kept calling him. I don't even know what the alternative is honestly. Every lead vendor I've tried does the same thing with slightly different branding. You either pay a lot for leads that five people already called, or you pay a little for leads that are basically dead. Pick your poison I guess. anyway rant over, back to dialing"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 31 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s5vcry/the_shared_leads_thing_is_such_a_scam_and_i_cant/

↳ Available-Revenues (17): "The lead is exclusive to you from that specific lead company. Doesn't mean 5 other lead companies don't also have the information for that business."

↳ Acrobatic_Explorer_3 (13): "Generate your own. That is how most of us do it on Facebook."

↳ Toppoppler (11): "No, most will tell you they sell them to 2-3 other people"

"What would you do if you had to start over from scratch? I'm 2.5 years into owning my agency and my book is just over \$100k. I've had some rough patches, hell, the first 2 years was a rough patch- but about 6 months ago I came to the conclusion that I'm going to put everything in me and do whatever it takes to grow my business and make up for the two years of my life that I wasted. I've gone 25 years untreated for ADHD and 2 months ago finally made myself an appointment to see what the hell is wrong with me. Fast forward 2 months later and I can finally function like a normal human being. Not only am I able to focus better, talk to people better, feel knowledgeable and handle things more professionally, but I actually care. I want to build something that will feed my family one day, pass down to my children, something that will provide us stability. I scheduled a 30 minute call with an agent I met a few years ago to see how he was doing and quite frankly, how he was doing what he was doing. I took a sneak peek at our companies production reports and this guy was selling nearly \$100k in premium a month. This meeting ended up being an hour long, but the biggest thing I took away was when he said this: "Dude... I have 5 kids", and it clicked. I have to get into survival mode, as if it wasn't just me, but those who depended on me. I think about my parents (whom I want to help retire because they are helping me financially), my girlfriend (whom wants to get married and have children with me one day), and my future kids. At this turning point in my life I am constantly asking people who are doing better than me, or are in places that I want to be, what would you do if you were in my position right now? What can I do to grow amongst these huge \$10M+ book size agents in my area? My goal is to quote over \$160k in premium a month, hopefully the quote to sell conversion ratio turns out good. These are mostly old leads, and eventually I will run out. Every Friday I am going out to 5-6 locations with realtors/brokers/lenders/title agents and handing out cookies, business cards, and a handwritten letter. Hopefully this helps me build a pipeline. I did this last week and people seemed receptive and related to the hustle. What is something I should be focusing on everyday to maximize my agencies growth?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/

↳ DonicaLewinsky69420 (16): "Ask every client and new prospect for referrals. Let them know how important it is to you. Be the business. Not the Business professional. Live it, breathe it, learn it."

↳ FuzzyDice_12 (7): "My tips: 1) Networking: I'm an introvert that comes across as an extrovert. Great for sales but I dread going to events and force myself to go. Staying connected and going to Insurance Events, opens up connections, some you may not realize for years later. Perfect example is while I'm young, I got into insurance and owning my agency at 21ish. Many of the contacts at brokerages I've made, jump ship to other brokerages. The friendship will get you an appointment where normally you couldn't have. 2) Agency Software: This one is a big one. Many of the softwares are expensive and slow. Sometimes agents, when opening their own agencies, use the software from their previous agency, with outdated tech, solely because of familiarity. I learned this lesson the hard way. Thousands a year on crappy agency software. 3) Turning 1 New Business Insured and the policy they chose to have you quote, into multiple policies and new leads. This one is big. 4) This is personal to my niche (small/medium accounts are \$100k+), and builds on 3. Offer several smaller quotes for lines of insurance applicable to your line of business the insured may not have/have been offered previously, even if you don't think the insured will be interested. "If Any" Workers Comp would be applicable for my lines of business. 5) create partnerships with other independent agencies and agents. Self explanatory I would think. 6) SOP's, and building the agency with Franchising in mind. 7) Calendar: setting up reminders to touch base on insured's. If you are coming around only at renewal time, you easily become an agent that is replaceable. 8) As an agency owner, not only having SOP's, but understanding how every moving part of your agency works. From accounting, to customer service, to certificates of insurance, and on and on. Excuse any typos (at the barber shop), but this is what I could think of off the top of my head, and while some sections are more important than others, I didn't number them in any particular order."

↳ ChrisPbacon969 (5): "Commenting to follow along. I'm about to get started on my p and c journey."

"The shxty part is most agencies teach their agents it's a numbers game while they sell you over priced aged leads. Then you're outside all day chasing shxx leads like an axxhole and then they give you poor sales training. My advice is to master reframing and tonality. Get those two aspects down and fine tune your pitch and you'll increase your close rate. I been there and it honestly was horrible. Left and got into AI SaaS but if I had to do it again I'd master those two aspects first. Also remember Chase compassion, not commission."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ueswou/i_fully_respect_the_hustle_that_is_insurance/otmgyw8/

"My number one recommendation is to buy leads. Not any leads, Aged Leads. Specifically leads that are 9-12 months old. Old enough where they don't get calls but need a policy or are open to getting a policy at a lower rate. The CPL and CPA are low enough to give you the ability to generate considerable revenue over a 90 day period. At that point in time you can pivot into more expensive marketing solutions or paying someone to run the marketing for you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/mygpk0u/

"Dude I just want to say I started an ad. The first day not much happened. The second day I didn't think much was going to happen but then I got two leads. The third day I woke up to 4 leads and collected more throughout the day The fourth day I got even more. Every single one of these leads I can get on the phone I sale. I hit them as fast as I can, ideally within 60 seconds. My biggest challenge right now is just getting them to answer the phone. Peter I can't begin to thank you enough this gives me soooo much more flexibility in my business as before I looked into this I primarily relied on door knocking one year old leads and it was more expensive and time consuming. Thank you thank you thank you"

— YouTube · Generate UNLIMITED Final Expense Leads On Facebook In 2024 (Full Tutorial) · 22 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aTFT03FiUCM&lc=UgxcG3JUruxdb4y1pCR4AaABAq>

↳ @thethriller1287 (2): "Hey Man I just started running ads myself. How do you get notified when a lead comes in/fills out a form to call them so fast?"

↳ @sleeperr (0): "@thethriller1287 need to link it to your CRM"

↳ @HealthyHair424 (0): "What is your update on the facebook leads six months later?"

"And find a solid lead source. I run my own ads on social media, and buy aged leads (30+ days) from USA Life Leads to help fill my day. I've wasted sooo much money on leads. More does not equal better.."

— YouTube · My BIGGEST Advice To A New Life Insurance Agent! 🚀 #insurance #insuranceagent #insurancesa · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AGiTFBC4oSM&lc=Ugzcn16DCaTdKHMfYlB4AaABAq>

↳ @franko8572 (1): "Hi. About to be licensed. Where do you find your leads?"

↳ @DiabloPollo (0): "@franko8572I run ads on social media, and also use usa life leads. One of their packages is 100 leads for \$175, so I do 1-2 of those a week. Just depends on my schedule and how many leads my ads are pulling that week."

"Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdotal personal experience) Jornaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use jornaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower intent.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trustd lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. ,get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer844c/

"For those of us who've already been living in this final telesales telesales world, I thought it would be a good idea to share tips, carriers, and lead vendors to our cohorts to help them during these uncertain times. Whats your favorite carrier? Whats your favorite kind of lead? What tips do you have? --- My favorite carrier is American Amicable because of the ease of doing business. Although, I am finding, that many other carriers are getting better daily. The best lead for telesales is still TV. However, Facebook lead costs have CRASHED. This is a great time to jump in and get leads for \$2-\$3. I wouldnt use a vendor only to pay 200% more. Research and do it yourself. Heres my tip. Dont go back through all your old leads and think you are going to resurrect intrest. Buy new leads, and buy alot of them."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Telesales Tips · 11 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/final-expense-telesales-tips.101595/#post-1344504>

"Not many sales I work about 6-8 hrs 3-4 days a week and I suck. I have a script. I feel like I follow it pretty good. I call aged leads but I'm rarely getting a sale. Can go a few days without selling anything. Thinking of hanging it up but I don't want to give up at the same time. This is my 5th month. How long does it take to get this??"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vftpsq/>

↳ (0): "Could be the leads, the scripts or possibly just need more practice. Do you feel like you have mastered your scripts and objection handling?"

↳ (0): "No. I am terrible at objection handling"

↳ (0): "Are you getting alot of objections? Gotta master your craft if you want to close. Like the other person said 1 call close is the way to go. Most people forget about the appt and the others will just agree to be nice to get you off the phone."

"I need some advice I honestly don't know what to do with my career, I started working for State Farm 2 months ago after getting my license, it should have been a sales job, but after starting I notice we have to do everything, from customer support to car transfers. We are a small agency, the agent plus 4 team members, I enjoy helping the costumers way more than calling cold leads (that were supposed to be warm), and the prices are so ridiculously high that I know people can find the same coverages for lower prices, my ethics don't let me sell overpriced stuff. I know you guys are probably going to say that it's not been that long, give it some time, but my salary does not even pay babysitter + rent, I'm seriously considering going back to delivery so i can stay at home and cut the babysitter costs. I wanted to see how a broker works because that's what I used to do back in Brazil, giving more options to a client makes more sense in terms of being an insurance agent in my mind. But it just seems too much of a risk at this point of my life and making \$18/h in CT is just not enough to make a living. Should I find another agency, leave insurance for good, eat shit and maximize my cards until I have some success selling?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gy39og/>

↳ (0): "Hah. You sound exactly like me and my situation right now. Start applying for other jobs. It's just a job. Nothing more."

↳ (0): "Have you talked to the agent? Some agents separate sales and service... it's 2 different personalities. It sounds like you're more comfortable with service. Perhaps you could make a case for becoming a retention specialist or something like that. It costs less to retain customers than to get new ones. Also, rates are high everywhere so it's a tough job right now. You are not only selling policies, you are helping protect customers from financial ruin if they don't have the right coverages. So, what you do matters. But not everyone is a good fit for sales. I am more comfortable with service, myself. Equally important."

↳ (0): "I'm thinking about it, the problem is that he only has his wife doing service, new people do both and apparently he wants to keep it this way. But I'll try, thanks!"

"P&C leads Where are you P&C folks getting your leads from? I am fortunate that I have a place to get some verry old aged leads for about \$2 a piece, but was wondering where else y'all might be getting leads. I'm on a tight budget here, so the cheaper the better."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hz8fqg/>

↳ (0): "No one is going to give you a true answer. P&C agents are a paranoid bunch"

↳ (0): "Hahaha! Why's that? I'm very new to the industry so probably haven't picked up on that yet."

↳ (0): "No idea but rarely is an agent going to share what REALLY works. I'm a second generation agency owner, it's just how agents are."

"General question about leads Hey everyone, I've been lurking the sub for a bit and have seen some similar issues arise but wasn't sure about my current situation.. \-I'm a P/C agent and working towards my L/H, hopefully within the month. \-I'm with a larger well known captive carrier. The Agency I'm with has been hit with non-renewals, some of the highest in the region. \-The new agent owner took on the role from the dying book of business (85% of the book was local, most of that was bundled with the non renewals) \-The name of the company is scarred in the area so there are no referrals and few renewals coming in to generate business. \-The majority of the agent owners time is spent saving the few renewals he is able to save *albeit as much as x4 the original rate. He is not generating any new leads for the business and hasn't for nearly 8 months. \-This agency being my first producer role, I was enticed with the prospect of (wait for it) paid leads. I didn't know better at the time and hadn't browsed this sub yet. Apologies in advance lol. \-I've had nearly 200 incoming paid leads since I started 6 months ago. I text often, email weekly and call daily. I even created my own spreadsheet to track the leads since no CRM is available. (I tried Monday and enjoyed it but couldn't convince the owner to adopt this.) \-The majority of these leads are instant denials without opportunity to give alternative answers. The few who do answer, the quoted rate isn't competitive. Still, I keep trying. I asked the boss and he said just keep dialing the leads, even after a "no". \-Of these paid leads, I've closed 1 thus far. A few in the "in progress " stage but that's it. I've had a few inbound calls and of the 5 available, I've closed 4... So assuming that someone wants insurance and I can beat the coverage, rate and service, people are buying. \-I'm supposed to bind at least 3% and need to hit \$20k in sales each month to be eligible for the "agent owner program". \-The owner has lamented to me that my minimal \$ value of premium is very low (I'm averaging about \$500 per lead) AND he is upset with his input of money to pay for the leads.. \-I have requoted everyone at least 3 times and reached out to the 3000 odd old leads to cross sell, win back, etc. Using some math, at this rate I would need to bind more than 50% of the leads in a month's time to generate about \$10k in premium. My questions are: 1) What do you do to increase the amount of premium bound each month? 2) What do you do to increase the probability of direct contact with outbound leads? 3) Which paid lead companies work best or worst? 4) If you are unable to prospect in your local region, how do you generate business? Thanks for the read. I'm in a bit of a pickle."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1snoujd/general_question_about_leads/

↳ CFactor11 (4): "Sounds like you're beating up aged digital leads. Owner is cattle prodding you to maximize lead conversion. OR Take a look inward. How are you handling the call? Building rapport? Making human/genuine connection? Creating real value and urgency?"

↳ KN0W-IDEA (2): "I just reached out to the local chamber of commerce, made a social media page and am attempting to contact some of the local developers. Trying to put my name out there. But the agent owner doesn't have enough time to do these things himself."

↳ KN0W-IDEA (1): "Thanks for the reply! I've been curious myself for both.. it feels like the top answer but I'm always open to feedback. I have asked for input on my delivery for the few leads I've been able to connect with. I have tried many different approaches but the answer is usually the same: "stop contacting me"."

"Pulling my hair out I work for a small insurance agency in a commission-only sales role, and I'm trying to figure out whether I'm being unreasonable or whether I was genuinely misled about what this job would be. During my interview, I was specifically told that the phones were constantly ringing and that I wouldn't have to worry about finding enough opportunities. The impression I was given was that there was plenty of incoming business and that my job would primarily be to sell and close it. That ended up being very different from reality. After starting, I learned that I was expected to do a significant amount of networking, prospecting, attending events, making community connections, following up with cold or old leads, and essentially generating most of my own business. I understand that sales involves prospecting, especially when you're commission-only. My problem is that this wasn't how the position was presented when I accepted it. I'm also not the only sales agent who was hired with the same general pitch. It seems to be a pattern where people are brought in believing there will be substantial inbound opportunity, and then once they're there, they find out they're largely responsible for creating their own pipeline. More recently, the office structure has changed even further. Other employees now handle most incoming calls and leads, along with accounts that became available when another employee left. I've essentially been pushed into a purely outbound role. So at this point, unless I personally generate the lead, there's very little opportunity coming my way. What makes it more frustrating is that I've actually done what was asked. I've gone to networking events, built relationships, promoted the agency, followed up with prospects, and tried to create business from scratch. But if someone hears about the agency through something I did and then calls the main office without specifically asking for me, that business may go to someone else anyway. I've tried raising concerns about needing more opportunity to actually make money, but the response is basically that the company pays for some networking opportunities and I need to make those work. That leaves me feeling like the expectations have completely shifted from what I was originally told. Had I been told during the interview, "This is a commission-only role where you'll primarily be responsible for networking, cold prospecting, and building your own book from the ground up," I could have made an informed decision about whether I wanted that job. But being told that the phones were ringing off the hook and that lead flow wouldn't be an issue is very different. There have also been smaller things that have made me feel increasingly disconnected from the office, including seeing other employees receive opportunities, accounts, recognition, or inclusion that I don't seem to get. Those things wouldn't bother me nearly as much if I were actually making enough money for the job to be sustainable. I'm now updating my resume and considering other positions, either in personal-lines insurance with a more stable structure or possibly outside of insurance altogether. For people who have worked commission-only sales jobs or in small insurance agencies: would you consider this normal shifting expectations, or does it sound like the job was misrepresented during hiring? I'm especially curious how long you would give a situation like this before deciding it probably isn't going to change."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wlnr8v/pulling_my_hair_out/

↳ JustaMereHuman (6): "I can sympathize.. I was in the same boat. I was basically hired for my "connections" and when ppl didn't come running to me they let me go. I was brand new to the industry. Had a lot of contacts from my previous career. I wasn't given leads, my marketing was nill, and I felt like I was supposed to save the agency. At hiring I wasn't told about any commissions, I was paid a livable salary. The agency had family and other family friends (over 10 year friends). I was whispered about in a tiny office. After 6 weeks my anxiety was through the roof. When I was "let go" I was then able to express how hurt and misled I was. Best thing ever to NOT be there. My heart isn't racing and I can sleep at night. Move on fast. Dont let a separation negativity affect you. You separeate first."

↳ Key_Astronomer6500 (6): "Unfortunately, just happens very often. That's why most people don't make it in industry. If your license, and want an actual job, look for a job instead of running your own business. When you're a 1099 commission only, it's a business. I would much rather work somewhere where I'm getting some type of paycheck and have benefits to start. I have never been great at prospecting and I've been in sales pretty much my entire life. I've made low six figures in several different types of sales including insurance, but always on the W2 side. I've also realize that I do much better in an inbound environment. I'm more of a consultant and a closer. I'm not a Hunter. Nothing wrong with commission. But when you're 1099 and contracted, they really don't have to do anything. There are some legitimate places, but you have to either buy Leads or prospect. Or you can do what many people like myself did, and get a W2 Job where you're getting paid to base plus commission. People don't realize that benefits, social, security, tax, retirement savings, all those things add up, so you have to make way more money as a 1099 "employee" versus a w2 position. It's not difficult to make a minimum of 65,000 year and a W2 Job and the insurance industry. In fact, I know. Plenty of people who make 125,000 or more a year. I also also plenty of people who can't make it because of the KPIs and the burnout. I would never work for free. Well, never again because we've all fall for the sales pitch. I keep saying this and Will keep saying it, youre not being hired. You're being recruited. You have to interview them. It's so different than a traditional W2 Job, where they actually interview you. Most these places will hire anyone. That's breathing with the license."

↳ SlickWillie86 (3): "Deceptive but unfortunately common hiring practice. The owner has little financial investment with it being commission-based. Hire 5 producers and hope 1 makes it. The ones that fail, whatever business they did bring in is a bonus if it sticks. Honestly, it's essentially the captive hiring model - high fail rate/turnover, but benefits agency/company at scale. This doesn't mean you can't be successful there. Depending on your producer contract, namely non-solicitation, it could be an opportunity to learn + build resume before jumping ship for a better opportunity. If you have a proven track record of producing self-generated business, you'd be a highly attractive candidate for a reputable firm."

"Here is a list of all I tested. Life leads Caboom : See above MediaApha : 1 out of 15 to 20 sale. ROI sucks Aria leads : crap. Their Instagram commercial is in a rented abandoned office, btw Smart Financial: spent 1500 for both data and live transfers. Nothing Everquote: I bought 50, and they canceled supporting life when I joined. No sale Benepath: 1 sale out of 10 leas, and they canceled life line as well Aged lead store: You better be ready to piss everyone off and dial a couple of weeks through wrong and not in service numbers before you get a hit. AWL: data leads suck. Live transfers 1 out of 4 normally sell, but they are overpriced, and if someone lapses or canceled, it ruins the whole ROI Integrity leadcenter: This has been the best of the worst so far, but buying the bronze is no different than the diamond. They say you get them exclusive on the sale, but that's bullshit because my upline bought me some from the same states I got, and they were duplicates. Google Ads : bots. I got all these leads at \$400 a week designed by a Google affiliated advertising company. I installed Captcha, and no more leads came in Fb: mostly people browsing. I feel like they are waiting for a gift after submitting the form. Money pit. Leadrilla: I never tried their campaigns, but if it's anything like the leads they sell in the marketplace, then it's shit too. USA DATA: 50% not in service and are all cold calls Direct mail: 1 to 2% return on mailers if you're lucky and you're always waiting. I sometimes wonder if they really mail anything out. Prospect 4 agent lead company: it was good in 2021, but by 2023, they caught the same disease all these other assholes have."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mezvm3q/

"This rings true to my experience to a tee. The company is off the charts unethical and should be shut down imo. A lot of people don't realize AO Globe Life has 2 major hiring periods linked to bonus events within the org where managers are heavily incentivized to hire as many new people as possible. Many of the new hires at this time of year are hired solely for that bonus, with little to no intent to see them actually make it. Being strung along just long enough to qualify for the bonus then essentially left to sink or swim from there. This leaves such a bad taste in people's mouths for the industry as a whole when it's the company through and through And when you finally get a peak behind the curtain, it's like Oz all smoke & mirrors. Top tier agents aren't making 500-1000 calls a day like they brag in the videos and weekly calls. A few of them have their own appointment setting businesses and hire foreign call centers to push for live transfers. Sold leads are passed around to be sold again, multiple times. When I was with them you could look up a lead and be floored seeing how many times a person's been sold the same products by the org's top tier agents. And to this day, when I hear the phrase "you picking up what I'm putting down?" I just want to punch that guy in the face 🤡"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/on4jz8u/

"Back to school? I'm a Medicare Telesales (captive) agent for a large health insurance company. I'm doing fairly well, not the best on my team but not the worst, but I DO know that I hold leadership qualities that some do, and some do not possess. I really love my job, I love the my colleagues, and I really want to move up in my career. I have not been in school for 10+ years... I am honestly not even sure how going back to college would even work, entirely. I am a single mom of a four year old boy who's in preschool full time. (just to give a little background and knowledge of my very limited schedule) What classes should I take in order to make myself stand out ahead of anyone else who may be aiming for the same leadership roles, such as supervisor or lead? Bachelors in Heth Sciences? Any helpful advice/insight would be IMMENSELY appreciated. Thank you!"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1cqssyh/back_to_school/

FMO / agency leads and 'free leads' programs · 137 documents · 20 voices

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

↳ 3xploringforever (16): "As a lawyer, the insurance MLM industry ENRAGES me from several angles - scam insurance, misclassification of workers, unconscionable contracts signed under duress with obscenely one-sided and binding arbitration clauses, abuse of telemarketing practices, fraud/misrepresentation, toxic hustle culture, wage theft, tax theft and UI avoidance, exploitation of desperate people seeking the "American dream," I could go on."

↳ dillydeli1 (14): "Totally believe this, thanks for saying it outloud."

↳ iBaires (11): "Don't forget literally tens of thousands of TCPA violations every day lol"

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

↳ Heavy_Following_1114 (19): "You view it as a job, not a career, You have an income requirement that's initially unattainable, You're intimidated by being undercut, You don't have a solid support system, You need to be nurtured, You're not driven enough, You never learned sales and marketing, You don't forge good enough relationships with clients, You don't study enough, You don't adapt, You're not an effective communicator, You aren't familiar with the markets, You don't have enough confidence in your products, You don't have a mentor, You don't market online, You don't do enough prospecting, You don't try hard enough, You don't stay on top of trends, You don't use new technology, You don't network enough, You don't treat your role as a business, Your expectations are too big from the start, Your expectations are too small from the start, You didn't get a quality education and training, You aren't focused enough, You didn't save enough money to support yourself while you grow a book, You're using dead-end leads, You don't have the right mindset, You're not qualifying your clients, You're too emotional, You're easily intimidated, You're not hungry enough to succeed, You're selling insurance and not solutions, You don't know how to set appointments, You're not a good presenter, You're not picking the right carriers for your prospects, You're not locking down the markets, You're not offering enough value, You don't have enough practical knowledge, You're focusing on the wrong things, You have too much freedom, You're limiting yourself, You're not making good first impressions, You're not following up enough, You're following up too much and scaring clients away, The job is too stressful, You lack patience, You're not making yourself available enough for your clients, You're not being proactive, You're not participating enough in your community"

↳ ThatWideLife (12): "There's one main reason why agents leave, they are in poverty with a full time job. Insurance is great for those who live with parents and have minimal bills. I'd say for a majority of people, they don't have a year to sit back and hope they start making money."

↳ [deleted] (10): "Selling isn't for most people. Selling insurance isn't for most sales people.. selling life insurance isn't for 99% of licensed insurance agents.. I just started a few months ago and I write 5K issued AP per week on a bad week, 7K -8K on average weekly with a high of 11K weekly... this sht isn't rocket scientist like everyone makes it seem. It's ad spend, closing ratio and systems."

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

↳ This-Armadillo9741 (7): "I've been wanting to share this insight for a while but never got the chance to. If you're considering being a life insurance agent- Specifically if you're considering working for globe life or American Income Life insurance (that was my run off branch) I'd like to offer you the most transparent what to expect in terms of your pay since I don't see anyone else being blunt with their numbers. I worked for AIL for 3 years from 2019 to 2022. on average my salary was around \$60-\$70k a year. With that income I was typically working 10 to 12 hours a day on the phone 7 days a week and attending weekly (and sometimes daily) training calls with my "team". I didn't do the recruitment side of the business, just the insurance hustle (I know this is where a lot of people are going to point out that THAT IS WHY I DIDNT MAKE AN EXTRAVAGANT AMOUNT PF MONEY) but let's be real, I didn't my my insurance liscence to recruit other people trying to get their insurance license, I did it to swell insurance. When you see that people are making "\$100k a month" or "\$MILLIONS a year" know this. If I sold a \$10,000 life insurance policy (which is a very minimum, basic, but affordable policy) I made \$55 in commission. with a \$1 residual pay that I would receive the following month. HOWEVER, when we hop on calls at the beginning of the week it would be announced that I "MADE" \$10,000 (completely untrue) and to capitalize on this they always ask "how much of that amount do you get to keep" to which you are trained to respond by saying "all of it" pretty manipulative too the new people huh? but we take what we can get and convince ourselves that if we just do that 10x over we'll eventually have what would look like a 'good check' here's the kicker about those "residuals" after the following month of each policy, you don't get them anymore. for whatever reason they give you, those get kicked to your upper and you basically only have that one time payment to count on. so if I can give you any advice on 'residual payments' it's that somewhere in the fine line of your contract I can guarantee they're not yours to keep. they will find some rhyme and reason as to why it will go back to the company. so, for over 10 hours of work a day, you might make \$55. "oh but what about those that ARE making millions" or "you just needed to work harder" let me tell you something: I busted my ass off on the phone and my spline KNEW I had no interest in recruiting people so EVENTUALLY (we'll say after a year) I got granted some pretty good leads. Now I was finally able to make some big bucks! Without getting too verbose the average policy amount for these clients would be ranging from \$150k ~ \$500k. The largest I ever sold was for a \$500k policy and here's the breakdown for that : I got paid a whopping \$1,300 in commission and a \$300 'residual' the following month. so ...you do the numbers"

↳ jroberts67 (6): "I'm sorry for your experience, but plenty of flags and not trying to come at you too hard, but a level of insanity that there's never been a time in history where we have more information available yet no one wants to research. Group interview? Huge flag. Paying for anything upfront? Huge flag. "Releasing your license" is absurd, once you've passed your exam your license is activated by your state, not any agency."

↳ Current_Bridge_3615 (4): "Worked for AIL as well, you wouldn't believe the horror stories I got during that short time. Let's just say there's a reason they've been sued multiple times and are currently under investigation for insurance fraud."

"Sorry I didn't provide value so I'll do it here: my favorite lead vendors I've used 1. Smart Finaical - seo leads 2. Happy agent - Fb leads 3. Nectar leads are insurance leads for seo and Fb Also if you are an agent your upline or leader should be able to provide you the best sources. Sorry for this I care about you"

— YouTube · The Best Life Insurance Leads For 2024 | My \$500k/Yr Lead Source · 44 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gjXNK0-8f7c&lc=UgxSK3d37q7CBMR8CY54AaABAg_9zPnaAfMyXt9zPrRMjjeY8

"Finally got my dream job!! I don't know if anyone else is in Alabama but I finally found an agency where I don't have to buy a single lead and I can bring in consistent income, they have a nice office in Vestavia and they offered to pay for my licensing too though I already had mine! Really excited to see what the future holds, I also made my biggest check last week!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qxr5nv/finally_got_my_dream_job/

↳ Jazzlike_Cat6692 (1): "Congrats!! What company is this ?"

↳ Champion138 (1): "What company? I may be interested"

↳ [deleted] (1): "It's such a relief not having to constantly chase leads and spend a crazy amount of money doing it. I learned that the hard way after wasting almost \$1,000 on bought leads that went nowhere. After that, I decided to invest \$200 a month into a small SMM branding company instead. Best decision I made. My business is growing, the leads feel more natural, and it's proof that a small investment can have big potential."

"Anyone's agency not do cold-calling for leads? I'm not sure if this will sound sane, but my agency grows solely off of referrals and advertising. Of course it's not the quickest growth, but it's been working for the past 5 years. We're a small independent agency that sells personal and commercial. I'm curious to hear others' thoughts and experiences!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 34 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mk37eo/anyones_agency_not_do_coldcalling_for_leads/

↳ Pudd12 (14): "This guy. Started my own agency about 3 and a half years ago now. Probably made 10-15 cold calls in that time, don't think I'll make many more. Advertising, referrals and company provided leads. I'm not trying to scale, I'm not trying to make a million a year. It's going well. Spend about \$20k a year on advertising. When I got in the business 25 years ago, I was a cold calling machine."

↳ Pudd12 (10): "I am an active trusted member of my community. Worked hard to become that. I spend money on direct mail, sponsoring things around town and I show up to lots of events."

↳ Samwill226 (7): "We don't cold call and we don't buy leads. We get steady clients but we aren't a huge agency at all. We're comfortable so we never really wrote like \$500k a year in new premium like some say here."

"Brand New Independent Agents This is just a rant post. I find it extremely weird when brand new agents want to be independent but also expect everything to be given to them. The entire point of being independent is that you are the OWNER of YOUR business. If I decided to open to a floral shop, I would have to pay for inventory, supplies, a website, marketing, and anything else that I needed to run my business. I'd be responsible for going out and marketing myself & my business to attract customers. I wouldn't expect to make money if I was only open for a couple of hours a few days a week, because no one else is giving me a paycheck. And if I didn't know how to run a business, I would find someone who could give me the play by play. Not just someone who said they could, but someone who had proof they'd done it. Insurance is no different. New independent agents are constantly complaining about back office fees, that their IMO doesn't provide them free leads, being 1099, and having to actually bust their ass to make money... and after putting forth half ass effort, blame their agency or upline for not making money. If you want a paycheck, to clock out the same time every day, and someone to provide you leads, GO CAPTIVE. This is why most new agents fail because they saw someone on TikTok that told them they could make \$20,000 in a month. Which is POSSIBLE, I have seen it, not fresh out the gate. You don't even know what you're doing yet! And honestly, you already need to have money put back to carry you in the beginning months until you start to make money... that's where you need to start anyway. This isn't a get rich quick scheme. It's a real business that you have to put real work into."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tnmhue/brand_new_independent_agents/

↳ One-Stranger-6894 (12): "I have some 1099 agents that I furnish 90% of their leads, office space, phones, tech, marketing etc and they'll call me cheap for not covering their game of golf etc. Like, some of these people would never make it on their own from scratch like many of us had to do."

↳ WillBe-TheAgent (5): "It's a different generation. And I also think it has a lot to do with the false advertising on social media and bad groups out there selling 20 year olds a dream that they can make 6 figures in 3 months. Bring back door knocking, Walmart tables, and cold calling from a phone book. Lol. Jk. But they surely wouldn't have survived that"

↳ howtoreadspaghetti (5): ""If it has 1% to do with work or is adjacent to work then it should be fully covered by work otherwise I won't do it." It's a really stupid way to act and believe."

"Warning: My Experience with Symmetry Financial Group – Please Read Before Joining Hey Reddit, I've been in the insurance industry since 2021 and have had success in multiple roles. I know what real mentorship and growth look like. That's why I feel the need to warn others about my experience with Symmetry Financial Group — because it was one of the most toxic, disorganized, and emotionally draining environments I've ever worked in. Here are the biggest red flags I encountered: • The leads are extremely aged. I was handed leads from as far back as 2016. Calling people who haven't requested life insurance info in nearly a decade felt unethical — more like harassment than service. It genuinely made me uncomfortable. • The culture is toxic. Uplines and agency owners frequently humiliate agents on Zoom calls in front of everyone. There's no support — just power plays, ego, and public shaming. • You're not in control of your own business. They make you ask for permission to get licensed in new states, claiming they won't get paid if you get licensed somewhere they aren't. It's controlling and makes no sense if this is "your business." • Shaming over conferences. Can't afford to attend one of their big events? Be ready to get publicly called out and guilted like you're not serious about your career. It's manipulative and unprofessional. • The training is the worst I've seen in this industry. There's no real structure, no proper onboarding, and no consistent support. You're left confused, overwhelmed, and underprepared. • It affected my mental health. I've never struggled with anxiety — not even in high-pressure sales environments — but while working with SFG, I had debilitating anxiety that impacted every area of my life. As soon as I walked away, that anxiety vanished. That tells you everything. The good news? I've since joined a different IMO with real leadership, training, and respect — and I'm flourishing now. This experience taught me that it's not the industry that's the problem — it's the people you align yourself with. If you're thinking about joining Symmetry Financial Group, please think twice. Don't ignore the red flags. You deserve better."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtq3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/

↳ loan2you (6): "What IMO did you join since?"

↳ Will-Adair (6): "I work with Symmetry. I like it as an independent IMO. I buy only new leads generated in real time so that doesn't line with my experience. Value leads range from weeks to years. I've never seen a value lead over 3 years old. Culture does depend what agency you're with, sounds like you were in a bad one. I've owned my business for 3.5 years so not sure what happened wherever you were at. Conferences are optional but beneficial. Again sounds like your experience is much different than mine and I'm going on year four. How long were you there? National has descent training and good agencies have their own too, we have for over a year. Sorry your experience stunk. Did you reach out to corporate and use their mediation team? Even if that door is closed reach out because corporate may be able to help train your former up-lines. Alignment is key. Glad you found a better solution for you."

↳ OPlathome (3): "I work with Symmetry as well and I agree with Will. What owner you're with matters, and not all teams are built equally. I get tons of support and training, and I do pretty well even with the older d-e leads."

"Sick of lead companies It's amazing.... agency owners buy "premium" leads and no matter where you go theres trash mixed in. The excuses are incredible like " you aren't dialing them enough" "the prospect keyed in that fake address and number" ect. ect. The agency I work for literally has people dialing alllllll day constantly (over 1000 dials). The sales agents are also calling, emailing, and texting. None of that matters when I get someone on the phone that's already been called 15 times. How the hell do these leads get sold to 20+ agents? I even had a lead in which the guy was DEAD for two years. Where are they even getting this crap from? Any industry insiders that want to give me the 411?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/

↳ itsalyfestyle (16): "Your agency are buying the cheapest aged leads they can find"

↳ Monskiactual (11): "Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdoteal personal experience) Jornaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use jornaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower internt.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trustrd lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. .get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

↳ iamoptimusprime312 (6): "Most are resellers thats why! It is rare to find the actual source of the leads. Also the industry is drowned to the max with resellers who bought 7 day old leads in bulk for like \$1000 and reselling for \$10,000! That is why i only recommend direct mail and doing fb ads. They will be your exclusive leads! If you are not the first agency to call that person after they filled out the online form then it is most likely a useless window shopper. They will just spin your wheels and will never convert!"

"Is 41 too late to get into insurance? Hey guys, looking into getting my p&c license and give selling insurance a go. I currently bartend, but that's only a side hustle really, not an actual career path. So my questions to you are • Is 41 too late to get into the industry? • Am I going to be sitting at a desk/cubicle all day? Or can/will I be up and moving about? • What are some of the best companies to apply for entry level positions at? Places with some of the best training. •Am I gonna have to cold call every day? Are leads provided? And if there's any other info you'd like to provide on what to expect as a first year insurance agent please feel free to drop it here."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1id8ena/is_41_too_late_to_get_into_insurance/

↳ MeatballSandy22 (17): "I started at 47. You have plenty of runway to make a career change. All your other questions are heavily reliant on what type of company you start working for. I was able to land on the commercial lines side of an independent agency. I cold call and go visit businesses. No leads provided. Independents are different than captives (your State Farms, Farmers, Allstates), as we are appointed with dozens of carriers as opposed to only selling one product line."

↳ Zbinxxy (14): "Im 8 years in , first year I made like 20k, now I make over six figures. If you're willing to learn and be taught at 41 by people who are possibly in your 20s without resentment go for it. My only regret is that I didn't start earlier."

↳ blinndog81 (14): "I'm 43, started insurance in August."

"What Uplines Don't Want you to Know - Carrier Release Process - Explained This is a question I get a ton from new agents, and its what every upline doesn't want you to learn, so please... learn it. Treat this information like it's required for you to be in the industry to know. Review your contracts with your uplines and make sure you have protection within them as well. Heck, get a lawyer to review it. Whatever it takes, I see too many agents getting trapped in awful comp deals and abusive uplines and get "Stockholm'd" into buying bad leads from them and then gaslighting them into thinking its their fault. I've been there done that. This info is for the agent that calls themselves independent:

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Demystifying Agent Contracting, Releases, and Blackout Periods I work directly with 54 carriers, 4 FMOs, multiple agencies, and nearly 1,000 independent agents. My role involves overseeing contracting, licensing, and agent/agency development. With experience spanning so many entities, I've had the chance to see the contracting process from all angles and business models. Let me break it down for anyone who's struggling to navigate this space. # Steps to Understand Contracting and Releases

1. **Contract Level (LOA vs. Broker):** * If you're directly contracted with a carrier as a truly independent broker *and* haven't signed an agreement restricting you to one entity (or an LOA contract, which assigns your commission to your upline), you should generally be free to contract with another carrier or upline without issues. 2. **Private Contracts (Non-Competes or No Non-Competes):** * If you're tied to a brokerage or agency and have a private contract (like a non-compete), get a lawyer to review your options. Some of these cannot be upheld in court, that's important for you to know. * Medicare agents may want to wait until the start of the year for a smoother transition —this avoids AEP complications. 3. **Carrier Blackout Periods:** * **New agents** can contract anytime, even during AEP, for Medicare Advantage (MA) and Medicare Supplement (Med-Supp) plans. * **Switching uplines or FMOs, however, is restricted** during AEP for MA carriers (typically September–December). * If you're contracting with a carrier for the first time, you can get a **new contract** during AEP, but you can't **switch uplines** until the blackout period ends. 4. **Release Process (To Release or Not):** * Brokers contracted directly with carriers usually retain their commissions unless restricted by a private contract (see Step 2). * You can file a self-release with an "intent to transfer". After 90–180 days, the carrier can re-contract you under a new upline while allowing you to keep producing during the interim. (you will be compensated according to your previous contract if you decide to continue producing, you wont get commission for producing if you WERE an LOA agent because your effective comp is 0%) * This safeguards agents from being stuck in unfavorable relationships. Most agents prefer waiting until the start of the year to minimize risks. The key is understanding your contract and navigating transitions safely, which is something many agents overlook. # A Brief History of the Release Process (why the heck is it this way?) The "agent-release" process emerged in the late 90s and early 2000s to manage transfers between FMOs and carriers. Unfortunately, it was often abused, with FMOs refusing to grant releases, especially during AEP, leaving agents trapped in bad contracts. To address this, carriers like UnitedHealthcare, Aetna, and Humana introduced transfer freezes during AEP to protect their investments. The "intent to transfer" process, developed in the late 2000s and early 2010s, aimed to fix these issues by providing agents a path to transfer without jeopardizing their business. # Misunderstandings About Releases If your agency/FMO/upline tells you "you can't transfer," it's likely because their training hasn't been updated to reflect the proper release procedures. This isn't usually malicious, they just want to ensure you're not left without commissions. Nobody wants to risk that. Also, the information is incredible "gate-kept", it's not a "sexy" process everyone wants to learn, until they need it... If you're looking for additional insight, this [YouTube video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NaExikyNwzo) (not affiliated with me or my company) provides a solid overview of the release process. However, it doesn't touch on the contract-level distinctions I've outlined here. Understanding these processes can help you avoid costly errors and confidently take control of your career. If you have questions or need clarification, feel free to ask!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gv923a/what_uplines_dont_want_you_to_know_carrier/

↳ Inner_Friendship5913 (2): "I just got my license in September and knew absolutely nothing about insurance. I started with Equis and had a very bad experience with my upline and felt like I was stuck with no one to teach me or train me. The top group person just blew smoke when I tried to get help so I left. I signed with Symmetry and I'm having a difficult time getting Equis to release me because they say they don't require it but Symmetry does require it. Symmetry has already started to get me started with other insurance carriers. I only had 5 with Equis. I have got no contracts with any carriers with Symmetry yet in my email but I know they started the process. BUT I was never told that I have to split my commissions 40%(me) and 60%(SME agent). I spoke to transamerica and Mutual of Omaha and they said I'd be penalized 90 days for ending the contract through Equis. So if I decide to not stay at Symmetry then that is even more insurance carriers that I'll be stuck waiting 90 days to work with again. I honestly have no idea where to go from here. I don't want to do all the work and a finalizing agent take 60% of my commissions. What company out there allows you to keep your commissions outside of the Small bit your upline gets? Or at least a fair amount?"

↳ RedditInsuranceGuy (1): "I would need to know what line of insurance you are talking about to get more specific. But basically its a standard wait of 6 months after a documented request of release from the contract for most carriers. Mutual of Omaha is pretty strict on that stuff. As far as what you do going forward is find an IMO that can fill the gaps with something competitive in the meantime while you process the releases and wait it out."

↳ Standard-Position698 (1): "I am in the process of trying to get a release/terminate contract. My up-line has refused to continue to reply and has removed me from all platforms and blocked me but will not release my contract."

"Am I Crazy for Wanting to Leave My \$200k+ Job to Start and Independent Agency Background, I'm mid 30s, 2 kids, and I've just about had it with my extremely high stress/toxic culture job (in a healthcare/pharma marketing related field). I have a few years of savings and I'm ready to pivot my career into something more personally rewarding.....I'm seriously considering insurance! I know how to build a brand, manage CRM systems, create effective communications (the one-on-one sales aspect is new to me, but I know I can figure it out). Plus I have a solid background in many aspects of prescription drugs and healthcare (i've taken a practice licensing test without cracking a book and got a 72%, so there's more for me to learn, but a solid foundation) The idea is to start a medicare-focused agency, brand it to appeal to the communities I want to target, partner with an FMO, and begin sourcing paid and earned leads directly (this is not a challenge for me, I'm been doing it in the pharma space for years). My goal is to use the next 6 months to start up the business, get my licenses and begin lead generation. I would then quit my job in time for the end of year enrollment season, see how that goes - (pick up some light contract work throughout next year to supplement my income) and then go all-in on the business late 2026 - hoping that I can be clearing \$150k+ in 2027 and back to 200k+ earnings in 2028. Over time I'd branch out into other lines, but I want to keep a narrow focus for now so I can effectively source clients. That's the high-level plan, of course there are many more details that I'm figuring out (I'm building financial projections, comparing FMOs, analyzing the competitive landscape for local agents and the large nationals...and a lot more to make sure I'm going in with solid goals and expectations) So, am I crazy to get into this world? What are the biggest pitfalls to watch out for that will get in the way of me being successful? What is the biggest deterrents for those starting out that will my make feel burnt?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jdknqh/am_i_crazy_for_wanting_to_leave_my_200k_job_to/

↳ HamiltonSt25 (39): "I didn't read everything you wrote, but just keep in mind, it's a tough insurance climate right now (Assuming you're in the US). Doing it right now would leave you struggling to get contracts. I'm an independent and almost all of my major carriers are not giving new contracts at this time. This will drain your assets extremely fast. I'd hold out until it softens up a bit."

↳ Acceptable-Tip7886 (28): "Times are tough, if you're making 200k plus I would stay and invest. Money now is more important than money later plus you'll retire sooner"

↳ HamiltonSt25 (10): "I'm sorry, let me clarify. I'm speaking as far as P&C goes. So if you're asking about life/health, I have no idea. If you're talking P&C, then I'm speaking about direct contracts with carriers/companies."

"It gets easier. Cold calls suck. I started on cold calls. You need an agency that invests in leads for their producers."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wd1ygk/i_got_my_licence_a_month_ago_ive_sold_zero/p92oxsp/

"ALRIGHT I PASSED! So I passed finished my pre-licensing course on Saturday midnight and scheduled the state exam at 8am for that morning. I passed! I currently am getting contracted for an agency that does medicare - they have their own leads coming in and a good team it seems like. As well as training. Now that's the health side. I already did my fingerprints, got my license approved and I am waiting for the next steps. However, I have been seeing people make money in life insurance and what excites me is the 2-3 day deposits of commissions in the bank. Since I had the license I am thinking of doing this as well but don't know where to start. What are you opinions or advice you'd give to me? P.S. I got my license because I am having a baby soon and my goal is to get my wife out of work and stay at home. I was going to college and working part-time but now I am trying to ramp things up. College still is a priority for me because I promised my mom I'd finish before she passed away. But right now I believe and seen results through Life/Health to make something happen for my future family."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ju62n5/alright_i_passed/

↳ PristineAsk6192 (6): "Congrats on passing! As a life agent, it is nice to get paid quickly and with the advance pay it adds up quickly as well. However, please be cautious of chargebacks if you are on advanced pay. A safer choice is to request "as earned" especially if you're not dialed in with managing your money. Have a solid schedule, good lead flow, and just stay consistent."

↳ PristineAsk6192 (3): "I do this part-time and I've been licensed since 2021. For me chargebacks fluctuate by the product type and client age. For me, the highest chargeback product is whole life, especially for those over 60. Lowest chargeback are from Term/mortgage protection and IUL's."

↳ hawkwood76 (3): "1 of 2 ways, your upline should be providing access to training as should the carriers you represent. Also there are about a 100 different certifications you can get. Most of them are over rated, and in and of themselves will not get you more money, but some of them are valuable will teach you a lot. LUTCF is one that is quite good if you are looking to specialize in the Life/ annuity space."

"Useful tip for new agents Stop paying for leads that's the wrong way to start off as a new agent you have to learn the business first so it's best to get with a agency that provides inbound leads and learning about handling chargebacks before you go independent it's a marathon not a sprint. If your with an agency that gives inbound leads and training your going to make money if your disciplined enough."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 16 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kxqsr/>

↳ (0): "Preach man, too many folks try to run before they can walk in this game. What kind of training setup helped you the most when you were just starting out?"

↳ (0): "Exactly man but I failed doing life insurance my success and sales came when I started doing Medicare and I would watch David Duford videos about tonality and sales techniques I still have more learning to go but it helped a lot bro"

↳ (0): "respect for you for not giving up"

"When Integrity Collides With the Insurance Industry # When Integrity Collides With the Insurance Industry After a year as a licensed Life, Health & Accident insurance agent—with certifications in Medicare, Fixed Annuities, and Long- and Short-Term Care—I find myself disillusioned, but not defeated. I've worked with three agencies in twelve months. On paper, that looks like instability. In reality, it tells a much more uncomfortable story about how our industry often operates—and who it quietly pushes out. # The First Lesson: Sales Without Suitability My first agency offered free leads, a platform, and a fast track into final expense sales. What it also offered—though less transparently—was pressure. Pressure to sell without first asking whether clients had the financial capacity to participate at all. Pressure to push forward even when something felt wrong. I voiced my concern early. I was clear that bullying tactics and financial assumptions were not how I wanted to serve families. Insurance, after all, is meant to protect people—not corner them. That discomfort was my first warning sign. # The Second Lesson: Knowledge Without Direction The second agency was rich in information and poor in application. Training was constant. Zoom calls filled my days. Education was abundant—but clarity was not. At one point, I asked what I thought was a simple question: "Out of over 250 life insurance policies, which ones should I focus on when serving clients?" The answer was blunt: "Read them all and figure it out." Eventually, the trainings did help. But what was missing was real-world guidance—how to connect authentically with people, how to build relationships beyond vague social media posts that thousands of agents were already making with little return. Knowledge alone does not serve families. Applied wisdom does. # The Third Lesson: Ethics Versus Politics The third agency was captive. The training was solid. For the first time, I learned how to identify real markets and pursue them responsibly. But there was a problem—one that went far deeper than sales technique. A field agent, protected as the "golden child," consistently wrote bad business. Junior agents came and went. Clients were placed into policies that should never have been written. Accountability never traveled upward. When I raised concerns—concerns later corroborated by other agents—I became the problem. When a longstanding nerve issue flared and I was forced to work from home temporarily, the support others received quietly vanished for me. Where teammates had appointments covered during health or family crises, I was left alone. Eventually, I was let go—for "not taking my business seriously." Within five months, nearly everyone on that team was gone. # What This Taught Me I've been told I'm too honest. Too nice. Too much of a "Girl Scout." But here's what I know to be true: insurance done correctly can be a family's saving grace. It can create stability, preserve dignity, and protect generations—*if* it is written with intention, education, and suitability at its core. I believe clients deserve: * Clear explanations of what a policy **can and cannot** do * Solutions aligned with their actual income and goals * Time to understand, not pressure to comply * Guidance that considers today *and* tomorrow That shouldn't be radical. Yet too often, it is. # The Question I'm Asking Now Is there an agency that believes insurance should be built for generational impact—not quick commissions? An agency that values education over hype. Integrity over volume. Long-term relationships over short-term wins. I'm still here because I believe in this work. I believe in serving people honestly, even when honesty slows the sale. Especially then. If that makes me a "Girl Scout," I'll wear the badge. Because families don't need more salespeople. They need advocates."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1q6lb33/when_integrity_collides_with_the_insurance/

↳ Bendstowardsjustice (8): "AMEN! i have been on a similar journey. i left my last IMO after i had a "wait a second, am in a cult?" realization. it was led by a psychopathic narcissist, so that was the culture. like every psychopathic narcissist, there was the underlying truth and there was the surface of the mask and when in it, it can be hard to tell the difference. the surface mask was, "we are here to help people, we are here to support each other, we are so special". the underlying truth was that it was an MLM style parasitic predatory organization whose leadership was all about grabbing the money bag and draining as much blood from as many people as possible whether they were agents (through low commissions and crazy overpriced junk leads) or clients. they preyed on the vulnerable, the leader surrounded himself with women who had backgrounds in drug addiction, trauma, abusive parental and romantic relationship histories. later on i learned from women who had left that the founder/leader was sexually predatory and pressured women there to sleep with him by making them feel indebted to him for "saving" them. i was banned from my cult's group chat bc people asked me for help with better lead sources bc i was shooting up the leaderboard while everyone else was struggling so i shared some sources i was using and succeeding with. they punished and smeared me for that. so i left with 2 other top 10 leaderboard agents and started my own agency. several other top agents left to join other imo's at the same time we left. my old imo started me at 60% commission levels and 45% for GL. i start people with zero experience at 75-90%. my cult IMO charged \$27 per callback data lead that they made bank on. i offer leads that i make zero dollars on and it is pay per presentation for \$25 with a 20% min close rate promise (i'm closing double that rate and i am not an elite closer), not pay per lead who doesn't even answer the phone. cult imo was recruiting like 50 agents per week. we don't run recruiting campaigns and limit our growth according to how many leads we can provide our agents to make sure everyone is well fed. my cult IMO preached "only 8% of agents make it" but at my agency we make it our problem to solve if a full time agent is not writing at least \$15k AP per month. my cult IMO punished people for leaving, smeared them with made up lies, would call the new uplines of people who left to try and blacklist them. we have an open release policy and would always go out of our way to make any transition out as friendly and peaceful as possible. there are good IMO's and agencies out there. i can recommend some if people are looking."

↳ OdteSPYFDs (8): "Pretty much everything in commercial insurance, especially for middle market or larger. The larger the insured the more buttoned up their operation is usually."

↳ Time_Care_102 (4): "Love this. I think I have found success in insurance bc I am not here to misrepresent. My words are a check you can take to the bank every time, that account will never run out. My entire operating system: under promise over deliver. I too work with a golden child agent and know the second I start any conversation about the impact to others within the company, the customers, and our reputation I too will likely face being forced out and seen as the problem. Already dealt with it before once. If you find that unicorn company- I will leave the moment I know what company that is and apply until they take me. Don't ever stop doing the right thing."

"Being an insurance agent is starting your own business. You have to pay for leads with either your money or your time. Anyone promising "free" leads is normally a complete scam (because any agency owner would just hire w2 employees to work the leads instead). The largest IMOs/agencies in the industry give you nothing but contracts (Crump, Ash, Simplicity, etc.) No recruiting or bullshit to make money. The rest is up to you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dt0fnh/why_i_left_the_life_insurance_industry/lb64i6q/

"Lead Generation New Agent, started in Jan as a W2, VERY low base salary with a commission split and no agency marketing or lead generation happening at the firm level. Everyone is on their own. I am struggling big time on getting lead generation going. Have been trying social media but have gotten virtually nothing from this. I've also been going to several leads/networking groups, have gone to about 3 meetings each. Do I door knock at this point? Looking for any tips or guidance.....feeling very defeated. I've quoted and called on the x-dates that were available and got a few from this but that's about it. I've asked for referrals on each sale I have done. Not getting any guidance from the principle."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1shk3tg/>

↳ (0): "It's tough, I've been there. u/idk-just-a-username has great info, I agree with all of that. I have a friend who drove around and walked into local businesses cold-calling, every morning from 8am-noon, for months. He would just go door to door, ask to quote their commercial insurance, ask questions & make notes if they said yes, then go on to the next one until noon. Then he'd eat his lunch, and quote all afternoon. It took a few months, but he got to where he was writing \$100k/month in new business off those. I was more focused on personal lines when I started; I met with realtors and mortgage lenders, had 5-7 coffee meetings with them every week, and if we hit it off I'd try to schedule a time to visit one of their sales meetings at their office. Hit it off with more lenders/realtors, rinse and repeat. Refer realtors to the lenders you really like, so they want to refer their clients to you. This is how I've built my business; it's a great way to go. Takes some time to get going, but once you do, you're living on referrals, not cold calls. Referrals are a MUCH higher close ratio, and way more fun to work. In the early months, when I was building that up, I spent money on leads. I put them on credit cards if I couldn't afford to pay cash. I don't recommend that, but whatever. I did it. I tried Dave Ramsey leads, Datalot (I think they have another name now?), Hometown, and a bunch of others. Ramsey & Datalot were the best, but also the most expensive. Datalot are live leads; they literally transfer them to you. There's a commercial insurance version of this too called Tivly; they're worth looking up. Any leads you buy will be expensive, but if you need to manufacture some business quick, it can work. There are also Aged leads you can buy for cheaper than hot ones. If you work up a good Aged lead script, and you're willing to be told 'No' a bunch, they can be good. I would also sponsor events, sports teams, etc. Go to the nonprofit, talk with them, say you want to do a fundraiser, and see if they'll help you market it on their socials. I'd put out there with groups that followed those charities that I was raising money for their charity; if you'd get a quote from me, I'd donate \$20 to that charity. No obligation to buy anything, just get a quote. Lots of those quotes turned into business, because lots of them had been meaning to shop their insurance anyway, and this was the excuse they needed. Use being the 'new guy' to your advantage. I used to walk into local businesses and say "Hey, I'm new, just started out at xyz insurance agency down the road. I just wanted to stop by and meet the neighbors!" See if anybody there will talk to you, make it low key, be interested in them, ask questions, etc. Honestly, activity breeds opportunity. The more you're out there, talking to people, being in the community, you're going to get opportunities to quote. If you're not winning quotes, then maybe you need a different agency, or you need to evaluate your sales process, but it sounds like right now you just need more opportunities. Good luck! The first 6 months are tough, but this is a KILLER career if you can make it."

↳ (0): "Thanks for everyone's words of encouragement and feedback. Apparently I was a day late and dollar short. Boss calls me at 4:45 Friday afternoon to let me know he is letting me go. Said I hadn't brought any business in. I asked when would he pay the commission on the 50k+ WP I brought in and he said he didn't realize I wrote it although I sent him a monthly excel sheet. SMH As much as it sucks being laid off, it's for the best. Clearly, this office was not the right fit so now I move on. Still a gut punch, was laid off at 50 and now again at 51. Never have I experienced this."

↳ (0): "I'm assuming you're selling commercial based on the networking groups. Doing what you're doing now will only help you, about 2-3 years down the road though. But you already answered your own question. Get a list of x-dates and make a lot of calls. A new agent's greatest asset is time. You have no defense to play, no book to service. You can spend that time on social media, networking, cold-calling or doing all 3. The former 2 are long term plays, the latter is immediate impact. If cold-calling makes you nervous, just remember that you could be the agent that sheds light on a coverage gap that could have ended the business's existence, or reduce a balance sheet expense enough that they can hire a new employee. That's why we're professionals. Key to calling, in my opinion, is having the xdate. If you call in that 2-3 month period prior to renewal, they're thinking about it, they'll talk (not all of them of course). You call after they renew, it's a dead horse, you're a pest. I use Insurance Xdate because they are really easy to use and seem to be the only ones that actually have Workers Comp xdates, but at this point there are a couple options for insurance specific data. PS Feeling defeated is definitely part of the business. Just wait until you pick up a deposit check on a 500k deal only to have the check canceled b/c the owner's son is golf buddies with the incumbent...then get BOR'd on the monoline Umbrella. That was over a decade ago and I still want to throat punch that sack of shit Tim."

"Leads! So here's my situation. In the last few years, I've consistently closed 2 to 3 out of every 10 phone calls, and about 1 out of every 3 full pitches. But the agency I used to work for masked the lead provider and changed the names, so we never actually knew where the leads came from. Now that I'm working for myself, finding a solid lead provider has been way harder than I expected. I really didn't think it would be this difficult. Out of 46 ACA leads from NextGen, I've closed zero. Not even a maybe. Does anyone have recommendations for good lead providers, or even insight on how they generate their own leads? Open to any direction at this point."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1orzwnm/leads/>

↳ FirearmConcierge (7): "DO NOT HIRE LEAD PROVIDERS They are all shit and will just take your money and not deliver and do dirty things to fuck you and your upline."

↳ Ashamed_Promise7726 (6): "Following to hear others input. We have been struggling with quality leads as well. And I'm not talking we expect to close every deal, but we have purchased a ton of internet leads who said that they never requested a quote in the first place (InsuranceQuotes, Everquote, etc.). We understand its a numbers game at the end of the day. But we at least want a chance to win their business, and we aren't even getting that most of the time and just spending money on leads with 0 potential."

↳ MysticMaxwell (3): "This is your chance to stand out and be helpful. I get leads all the time that say they didn't request anything, tired of the calls/texts, or any excuse they want to use. Call with purpose. You are calling because you are reviewing the recent changes, since it shows they have not updated their options for next year. Hey \[first].....glad I was able to catch you. I am actually calling to review your \\\ options for next year. Now this is not a sales call quite yet, but if you give me 2 mins, I can review a couple options and make sure you are in the best spot. If so, we end the call there.....sound fair? Generate your own leads. Talk to everyone you meet. Figure out your advantage and find the people that can use the help."

"Tons and tons. How me and my business partner both started. Cold calling commercial. Sucked, was hard, learned a lot. Then built my agency with internet leads that felt easy by comparison. I wish I could upvote this thread 100x"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1udkyjb/just_do_itotdbpxd/

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crid=11ZYLLHQAOSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&srefix=how+to+win+friend%2C&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: | Industry | Description | | --- | --- | | Tech | You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. | | Med | You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in *The Pursuit of Happiness*. | | Finance/Insurance | You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. | | Hardware/Construction | Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. | | Cars | You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. | | Door to Door | Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. | | So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. | JOB TITLE | PAY RANGE (Salary) | PAY RANGE (OTE) | DESCRIPTION** | | --- | --- | --- | --- | | SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) | £25,000 - £40,000 | £50,000 - £80,000 | Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. | | SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive | £30,000 - £60,000 | £50,000 - £140,000 | Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. | | MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive | £40,000 - £75,000 | £60,000 - £150,000 | Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. | | ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive | £50,000 - £100,000 | £70,000 - £250,000 | Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. | | SALES MANAGER | £60,000 - £120,000 | £80,000 - £200,000 | Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. | | MD: Managing Director | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. | | HEAD OF SALES | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. | | Terminology | Description | | --- | --- | | Cold call | When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. | | Lead | This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead'', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. | | Account | This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. | | Contact | This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. | | Example of a lead, a contact and an account. | Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

↳ vitaferox (58): "This was excellent advice for getting any sales job, honestly. And too many people skip those basics"

↳ titan623 (18): "I could kiss you right now. I've been a long time lurker and seen/saved a ton of great info for the job search, I've been meaning to sit down and organize it all. This is a SUCH a resource, especially with the concise examples, perfect for referencing. Thanks for putting this together."

↳ TheUneducatedPotato (14): "To add something that helped me land my new sales role: if you're asked to give a presentation like a 30/60/90 day plan, bring a paper copy in those cheap presentation folders. Give them out before the presentation so your interviewers can take notes. I had to fly across county to a hotel where they booked a conference room and guess what, the projector didn't work that morning. No worries. I had the power point, printed two slides per page, in a presentation folder, ready to go. Both interviewers were stunned with my fore thought and it saved me from having them crowd around my laptop looking over my shoulder. It's the little things that show you're thinking ahead."

"Stop buying leads I constantly see people on here complaining about shitty, expensive, shared leads. Listen guys, YouTube exists, this stuff isn't hard. Facebook and Google have dumbed setting things up so much it's ridiculous. You want to know how to create your own leads? On Facebook you can find a built in tool called Facebook ads library. Type in the insurance product you sell and filter the results to show active ads that have been running 6month-1year. The older the ad the more successful. If the ad wasn't making money, they would have killed the ad. Copy/model that ad. For Google, pick a big city, Google <what you sell> <big city> whoever shows up at the top probably has a good ad. Look at their ad copy then look at the landing page they use. Copy/model them. It's simple, YouTube to figure out the setup, research what ads work, copy them.... And now you're getting your leads at cost and you have full control of them. It's easier than you would think."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 163 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466vj/stop_buying_leads/

↳ zb0324 (33): "If you want to get advanced: Google is the more expensive option but the leads are higher quality. Someone googling already has intent to buy, whereas on Facebook you're just scrolling your timeline and someone is interpreting you with an ad. Also there's more fake leads for some reason on Facebook, but they're also way cheaper. What we like to do is get traffic from Google ads and then use Facebook remarketing to put our Facebook ads in front of the expensive Google traffic that didn't buy."

↳ TheMatthewMurray (18): "This is good. I use the method called "Mimic it, Master it, Make it your own." However, copying and pasting will work for awhile, but understanding why ads work is fairly important. That way you're not constantly copying. When something goes wrong is when, people don't know how to fix it."

↳ Randomdeath (16): "did you just post Well thought out and simple strategies for success? Sacralige I say"

"New rules (with a slight change) Thank you to everyone that has assisted with helping with the new rules. Here's where we landed, and there is one small tweak: 1. This is not a place to sell your services or generate leads or recruit agents/downlines. Consumers should not get offers to quote or to privately "help". This includes asking people to vet your software/AI or other peripheral concepts as well as advertising your website or app (even if it is currently free). 2. Do not post any unethical, illegal or unhelpful content. 3. Be a good reflection of the industry and remain professional. The difference is in Rule #1, and it is specific to a pattern of behavior of some life agents that have been trying to recruit to some quasi-MLM companies (I say "quasi" because I don't think that any DOI has stated it as a fact). Many of those trying to recruit are doing so with little to no posting history, which makes it very odd. The sidebar will be reflected soon to reflect this, but you should consider that these rules are currently being enforced as of this post. Edit as of 7/23/26 - effective immediately, we're no longer allowing posts that are asking for help with ideas for software, websites, apps or other SaaS concepts. Even if it's currently free, if you're linking people to something of yours, expect it to be removed at a minimum. Even if you're just asking for people to vet an idea, expect it to be removed at a minimum."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 79 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cdomsd/new_rules_with_a_slight_change/

↳ SHURP (14): "I'm was actually thinking about finding a property and casualty specific subreddit. It hadn't even dawned on me till I saw the posts here that people actually view life and health in the same vein. I hate to sound like a purist or something but due to the way health and life insurance in American works, I feel like it's crazy to call any of the programs that isn't single payer, anything but MLM."

↳ Samwill226 (6): "I'd like a Reddit for just P&C Agents (no consumer questions there's plenty of that already). There's so much confusion on what someone is talking about sometimes you get an answer and its a life person thinking you are talking about life policies. I would like to be able to talk just to folks I can relate to."

↳ malachi347 (5): "did you ever find or make one? I'd love to be a part of a community like that as well. can't stand life/group med.. or personal lines for that matter heh"

"The Lifeboat Mentality The art of selling is truly an art, and guess what, it's something that every single one of us needs to master - fast. I'm going to get the first, and what I think is the most important step out of the way immediately: **Stop trying to sell *products* and start selling *yourself*** When I first started, I always had this question in my sales experience: Why is it that one guy has extreme success selling the same product, and another guy doesn't? Let me tell you about a time when I sold life insurance that completely changed the way I sell, and will sell for the rest of my life. So, I got hired at a huge brokerage in Florida. We were contracted with 40+ different insurance agencies to market and sell their products. I had to be licensed to sell annuities, medicare products, health insurance, prescription drug packages, and life insurance. So, needless to say we had an **ARSENAL** of products to choose from. During the orientation, we were greeted by the companies top salesman. The idea was for him to come in and share his success, and answer any questions us newbies may have before we ventured out on our own. It came about time for him to come speak, and in my head I'm thinking some young 20-something was going to bolt through the door with excitement and enthusiasm. Wrong. In walks a 60-year old retired war-veteran who had been crushing the insurance game in this company for the last year, month after month! His annualized premium average was close to \$26,000 per month. (This is the amount of Premiums people that he sold to were paying on a monthly basis. He not only receives residuals off of this, sometimes he'll even receive a 90-95% commission off of the first-year premium total - If they pay \$100 per month, he receives around \$1000) I couldn't believe it. But, me transitioning from shock to understanding, I began to listen to him. His success was no secret. He literally worked "harder" than everyone else. His military mentality came into play big time in this field. Why? He would knock on 30 doors per day. Non stop, wake up at 7am, and not go home until 5pm, or until he successfully spoke to 30 people. His strength was in his numbers. Law of averages! If he got a "No." he wouldn't waste a second, bat an eye, or fold. He knew his power was in his ability to talk to as many people as possible. Day after day, same mentality: Do it, or die. (Not to that extent, but you get the idea!) **Takeaway One: Understand the law of averages, and commit to it!** However, although we had an arsenal to sell from, I became completely overwhelmed because it seemed impossible to take in all of the product specs and legalities, all while trying to create a smooth sales pitch. So, instead of focusing on things I didn't know, I just focused on one of the many things I could sell that would give me the best chance at success: life insurance. I modeled the success of the older salesman, and knocked door to door to offer our product relentlessly. But, door to door sales isn't as easy as it seems. Actually, it doesn't seem easy at all. Think about it. Have you ever bought anything from someone who randomly walked up to your door trying to sell something to you? The idea is crazy. But, it works. Numbers game. Same with cold calling, and same with any service. The idea is to put yourself in a position to collide your product with a consumer in demand, at the time they have made up their mind to purchase. If they haven't made up their mind to purchase, it's your job, as a salesman to help them. But, knowing how crazy this idea is, I had to separate myself and treat people as if they were my friends. I didn't come across as pushy, I came across as informative, and very confident - I adopted the **Life Boat Mentality** The Life Boat Mentality is simple: Your customers are drowning. They are drowning from poor quality products or services. You see them drowning in these products or services, and paddle on over in your Lifeboat. The idea is this: With impeccable trust, of course, you persuade your client to get in your life boat. Your life boat is the "best" option. And if it's not the best option, you need to find a company that offers the best option and sell that. (I'm not about selling garbage - Honestly) If you truly in your heart believe that what you are selling is the best option, the Lifeboat Mentality will help you tremendously. For example. I own a small residential repaint company now. I've taken the Lifeboat Mentality with me throughout my entire duration owning a business. I've got the branding where I want it, I have the production where it needs to be, and the Lifeboat mentality that I carry with me says this: Mr. & Mrs. Customer: I know that there is a TON of options in the marketplace. So many to choose from, however, I know this for a fact. There will be none other than my company that will show you the amount of respect and care you deserve throughout the entire tenure of us working for you. From the initial handshake to the final good-bye I can guarantee that our quality of service is of exemplary fashion. How do I ensure that this remains true? How do I have the confidence to pitch this? Because as the business owner, I insure it. My sales process is down to a science and has clear concise wording, professional formatting, and a great follow-up procedure. We have references and a great website for them to visit, and provide insurance and legal information up front. I ensure that I will be at each job to make sure that our quality of service is exactly as promised. In other words, I'm showing them that I "me", the "salesperson" am the lifeboat! It may seem silly at first, but think of yourself as a lifeboat. Start saving people! Happy selling! P.S if you're interested in knowing more about the painting business, feel free to PM me I'd be happy to answer any questions you may have!"

— r/sales · 47 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/7tph4u/the_lifeboat_mentality/

↳ krimpenrik (8): "Exactly how i sold used cars. After 10 years it was easy to see that a lot of times they buy the car from you because they trust you instead of a cheaper car at a competitor. I wasn't a sleek guy all dressed up. Often with a oil stained Polo because I was helping out in the garage. It doesn't matter, even helps to gain trust"

↳ JDogNumeroUno (5): "> Mr. & Mrs. Customer: I know that there is a TON of options in the marketplace. So many to choose from, however, I know this for a fact. There will be none other than my company that will show you the amount of respect and care you deserve throughout the entire tenure of us working for you. From the initial handshake to the final good-bye I can guarantee that our quality of service is of exemplary fashion. This is Brilliant! Very much like Jay Abraham, well done!"

↳ [deleted] (4): "Thanks for the great post!"

"Sorry I didn't provide value so I'll do it here: my favorite lead vendors I've used 1. Smart Finaical - seo leads 2. Happy agent - Fb leads 3. Nectar leads are insurance leads for seo and Fb Also if you are an agent your upline or leader should be able to provide you the best sources. Sorry for this I care about you"

— YouTube · The Best Life Insurance Leads For 2024 I My \$500k/Yr Lead Source · 44 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gtXNK0-8f7c&lc=UgxSK3d37g7CBMR8CY54AaABAg_9zPnaAfMyXt9zPrRMljeY8

"If you want to get advanced: Google is the more expensive option but the leads are higher quality. Someone googling already has intent to buy, whereas on Facebook you're just scrolling your timeline and someone is interpreting you with an ad. Also there's more fake leads for some reason on Facebook, but they're also way cheaper. What we like to do is get traffic from Google ads and then use Facebook remarketing to put our Facebook ads in front of the expensive Google traffic that didn't buy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466yj/stop_buying_leads/mo7pbhg/

"Brand New Independent Agents This is just a rant post. I find it extremely weird when brand new agents want to be independent but also expect everything to be given to them. The entire point of being independent is that you are the OWNER of YOUR business. If I decided to open to a floral shop, I would have to pay for inventory, supplies, a website, marketing, and anything else that I needed to run my business. I'd be responsible for going out and marketing myself & my business to attract customers. I wouldn't expect to make money if I was only open for a couple of hours a few days a week, because no one else is giving me a paycheck. And if I didn't know how to run a business, I would find someone who could give me the play by play. Not just someone who said they could, but someone who had proof they'd done it. Insurance is no different. New independent agents are constantly complaining about back office fees, that their IMO doesn't provide them free leads, being 1099, and having to actually bust their ass to make money... and after putting forth half ass effort, blame their agency or upline for not making money. If you want a paycheck, to clock out the same time every day, and someone to provide you leads, GO CAPTIVE. This is why most new agents fail because they saw someone on TikTok that told them they could make \$20,000 in a month. Which is POSSIBLE, I have seen it, not fresh out the gate. You don't even know what you're doing yet! And honestly, you already need to have money put back to carry you in the beginning months until you start to make money... that's where you need to start anyway. This isn't a get rich quick scheme. It's a real business that you have to put real work into."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tnmhue/brand_new_independent_agents/

↳ One-Stranger-6894 (12): "I have some 1099 agents that I furnish 90% of their leads, office space, phones, tech, marketing etc and they'll call me cheap for not covering their game of golf etc. Like, some of these people would never make it on their own from scratch like many of us had to do."

↳ WillBe-TheAgent (5): "It's a different generation. And I also think it has a lot to do with the false advertising on social media and bad groups out there selling 20 year olds a dream that they can make 6 figures in 3 months. Bring back door knocking, Walmart tables, and cold calling from a phone book. Lol. Jk. But they surely wouldn't have survived that"

↳ howtoreadspaghetti (5): ""If it has 1% to do with work or is adjacent to work then it should be fully covered by work otherwise I won't do it." It's a really stupid way to act and believe."

"Is a Life & Health Insurance License Useless? 🤔 I've had a Life & Health Insurance license for 2 weeks. It feels useless for finding a job. All the local captive agents focus on Property & Casualty. They like seeing L&H but they don't sell any. Even if they advertised for a L&H position. I applied to local banks and credit unions. I'm a notary too but heard nothing back. A recruiter from Brown & Brown reached out. She liked my resume and experience a lot. B2B Sales and Marketing, Tradeshows, SEO, etc. She has no job for me. I've had Life Insurance and Medicare outfits calling me. All commission based. They sound like scams and MLMs. I've tried getting an Employee Benefits Advisor job but these seem rare. Ideally I'd like to work at a hospital and help people choose health plans. Applied with health insurance companies. Haven't heard back. Are L&H license useful at all? What should I do to find a job? UPDATE - The Kaplan training I did was part of a hiring process for a Financial Services company. They paid with no strings attached as part of the final hiring process. They ended up not hiring me even after I passed the test. The goal was to do SIE and other FINRA certs. UPDATE 2 - Many of you are saying just go get a Property & Casualty license via DM. Yes would be good to do but I don't have a ton of money right now. Would much prefer to get a job that will pay for my P&C training and licensing. I was thinking of just watching Melissa from Insurance Exam Queen. She and Peter were so valuable for passing the L&H test."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lavqn1/is_a_life_health_insurance_license_useless/

↳ mental_mentalist (13): "You could find life and health carriers and go to their careers section (although they may want experience you may not have)"

↳ takeagander20 (9): "A couple of Medicare agencies who are frequently looking for remote workers, that pay a steady base and a little extra money for enrollments are ResultsCX, and Select Quote. You won't get rich working for either outfit but you can get your feet wet and gain the confidence necessary to go 1099, which is what I'm doing this year since my first AEP and OEP as an hourly sales agent went so well. Getting in is mainly a matter of timing though. Seems I got hired in mid July, to start late September, so you might be a little early. Keep looking on indeed, and you will progressively see more Medicare Sales ads show up day by day. You'll eventually see one or two that offer an hourly base. Good luck!"

↳ mkuz753 (7): "Brown & Brown is a large national independent agency/brokerage. There are many others. Keep in mind that most L&H licensed people end up in employee benefits, aka group plans."

"Dream came true at 19 Firstly, I want to preface I had never known anything about being an insurance agent until I was 16. When I was 16 I had the opportunity to work under a local State Farm agent and he showed me the ropes. I got hooked. In late 2024, when I turned 18, I immediately when for all 4 of my licenses and got a job at a larger State Farm agency as a producer. My plan then was to stay for 1-3 years then become an independent agent under an independent agency. Fast forward 10 months later and I was proud to say I was starting my own agency. The first months were tough. I didn't know what I was doing and I stepped into a world of uncertainty. But in May of this year I got myself a lease, and started working hard on digital ad campaigns. This month I will end the month with 55-60K in premium annualized. No paid internet leads, just \$500/mo in google ads (first month starting google ads), google reviews, referrals, an my office location. I'm so excited for what's to come and I just wanted to share my experience as a new agency owner. Dreams do come true, I'm just hitting a small milestone that I've dreamed of since I was 16. My plan is to end the year with a 400-500k book (all business written by myself) Next year I want to hire a producer. Agency owners, how were your first years? How did you manage growth and retention? And lastly, is this a realistic goal and plan? Thank you!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uewxrx/dream_came_true_at_19/

↳ _Fr4g_ (9): "Bro I actually wrote all of it on my phone LMAO. But thank you for reading. Put it in an any AI checker. Wrote it all by myself. You can see my prior posts I use the same language, just wanted to format it in a way easy to read. Not everything is AI these days 🤔🤔"

↳ StephenDolo (7): "He's just being a hater"

↳ Altruistic_Fall_9843 (7): "New agent coming up on two years. Those sound like solid numbers, but we def have a diff frame of reference. We use mainly paid leads and calls and have our own telemarketing team. On an average month producers hit 30k in premium (some annualized, some not), and a good month 40-45k. But that's with a 2,000\$ budget per producer per month. Point being, spending only 500\$ a month but producing well over a fourth of what we're doing is def good!"

"He had to search us out, go to our website, and submit a form with info about the company so that an agent can get in touch"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rsznnr/text_exchange_from_a_prospect_who_reached_out_to/oaarlbi/

"As an Independent Broker, what is the best way to generate leads? I recently got my Life & Health license in NY and I am trying to figure out how to structure my business ONLINE. I've been appointed with several carriers over the past few months. My background is in marketing, specifically Ecommerce so I have a solid understanding of running Facebook ads. However, I am having trouble pulling the trigger and actually getting started due to trying to figure out all of the rules and regulations. Analysis paralysis. I plan on pumping out quality content on my website and socials both of which are not yet created. As an Independent in NY, my business name is my first and last name. Does my domain name and socials have to be my first and last name or can it be something random like "High Creek Financial", for example? I guess I am having trouble with establishing my brand identity. Should it be ME posting content and interacting in the community or should it be "High Creek Financial". I'm apprehensive to just use my name for my brand because it will make me appear like the one man show that I am. My thoughts are that if I was able to use "High Creek Financial" for example, that it would give off the vibe that I'm with a big, legit company. I don't know if any of this is even making sense so I apologize in advance. As I'm writing this, I keep thinking to myself, "wtf am I even saying?" Should I do something like this: <https://www.marblepay.com/> and be in the background or should I just use my personal brand and not care that people will see that I'm a one man show? If anyone has any experience with generating their own leads, could I pick your brain a little bit? Thanks!!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 18 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fj86x3/as_an_independent_broker_what_is_the_best_way_to/

↳ General_Let7384 (9): "1. You are a one man show. why pretend to be something you're not ? 2. if you think it's bad to be a one man show, then maybe add another man or 5 ? 3. Do you want to someday have a big legit company ? Maybe you can partner with an established one man show. The personal /business relationships you build are the source of your income. That takes place one-to-one. You might prefer to be the marketing guy and let someone else write the business."

↳ Wide-Holiday9430 (5): "All your questions make sense, my experience is no one cares about your name as an Indy broker. Dial in on the type of business you want to niche and marketing becomes easy. Life insurance is sold not bought. I would suggest working somewhere to make mistakes on someone else's dime unless you have a nice fund to carry you for a year. It will take you 2-3 years to hit your stride. This is my advice experience from the P and C world and watching other L and H people build their business. Look into Medicare good returns and lots of leads from employers."

↳ Superb_Advisor7885 (4): "The reason is because your model is hard to scale. It's hard to hire sales people and give them enough lead volume to recreate success."

"Medicare brokers, help me set realistic goals for years 1-3 as an independent agent. Background: I just got my insurance license this week, planning on finding a good, not shady FMO/IMO in the next month. I am a full time engineer so I will be selling Medicare part time as an independent broker. Plan is to leave work at 2pm and start doing Medicare. I understand that this will be insanely difficult and time consuming. I don't feel comfortable leaving my job with out trying this part time first. Completely fine working long hours. Medicare is quite confusing but I am very active on the Medicare subreddit answering questions I know and learning from the posts I don't. I want to do this to provide the best care for the seniors in my area not just shove MA plans down their throat. Now my main question. Are my goals realistic. 1st year (now through open enrollment): 10 clients mixture of MA and medigap (roughly \$3000-4000) 2nd year: 50 new clients roughly (\$17000 - 20000) 3rd year: 125 clients total (\$35000-50000) quit job and do Medicare FT. Marketing plan: I will be doing in person in my local area. Already signed up for a very popular Saturday farmers market and a couple county fairs. All marketing will be in person + local advertising. I am active in the community and just generally enjoy talking to people. Thoughts are struggle year 1-2 with a lot of local events on weekends and then word of mouth will hopefully pick up if I am able to provide the assistance and knowledge I strive to. Create an easy to use website (I'm a software engineer) and optimize SEO so it shows up to locals searching. Facebook page and local Facebook advertising"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j6vyj8/medicare_brokers_help_me_set_realistic_goals_for/

↳ mbkr148 (4): "I like the idea of setting up at a farmers market. I'd also look at doing Medicare 101 at senior apartments/community centers."

↳ BangDingOwwwww (3): "I think your numbers are great, and not outrageous. How do you see yourself getting the business? You might find it challenging to reach those numbers if you're part time. But depending on how you market yourself I'd say realistically by year three might be closer to 75-100? The whole part time thing is where it makes things a bit more challenging bc of schedule conflicts, if you're looking to establish a local presence or calling leads etc."

↳ polach11 (3): "Updated post. Plan to do everything in person"

"Quit \$150k W2 Sales to start an Agency. 6 Months in: Lessons learned from the "FE Trap" and pivoting to Group Health/Life. Feedback? I'm in my late 20s and recently walked away from a \$150k+ W2 sales career to build my own independent agency. I started with a \$2,000/month residual base from a previous ACA book and a small group. The Failure: I fell for the Final Expense hype. I burned several thousand dollars on my own ads, lead vendors, and a marketing firm. After 6 months, I realized the "social worker" aspect of FE isn't for me. I'm a consultant and advisor, not a hand-holder for the unbanked. The Pivot: I've officially pivoted to Group Health (U65), Individual Health, and Term Life. My daily "Machine" looks like this: • Cold Knocking: Visiting local businesses daily to prospect for Group Health. • Strategic Partners: Building a referral network (CPAs, P&C agents) for Life/Health leads. • Efficiency: Cutting all paid lead spend once current FE ads die. Reallocating that budget to BNI and local SEO. The Concern: I'm 6 months in and not profitable yet. I live in a major city and the grind is real. Thank God for my savings and residual base, but I want to make sure I'm not missing a gear. My Questions: 1. Aside from BNI and cold knocking, what high-leverage community events or "advisor-level" prospecting am I missing?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rgt03f/>

↳ (0): "Insurance Sales is hard, if you don't already have a book of business. It will take a while to build the business."

↳ (0): "How long did it take you to profit?"

↳ (0): "Health biz is great, just takes years to build. Have you looked at using ICHRA to get into the door? Do some research on ICHRA if you haven't. Some other things I'd try: look for new business formations in your local newspaper and go drop in on them. Fresh meat! =) Also, how much activity are you doing? Are you cold knocking 30 businesses daily or making 100+ phone calls daily? A lack of activity is usually the cause of all sales woes. If you're looking for ways to bridge the gap with final expense, consider doing in-person seminars at local independent senior living facilities. Did those for 9 months and made around 100 sales with zero expense. Have seen dozens of other agents do well at it, too. Further, you could look at doing talks at small group church meetings, senior activity centers, about Medicare, final expenses, etc. Cost nothing and creates the best leads. Good luck. Remember it's normal that the first few years are incredibly difficult as you find your place. Stick with it and eventually you'll find your niche and begin getting traction!"

"How to get contracted as an independent health ins agent! I recently got licensed as a health insurance agent and am currently selling Obamacare. It took me forever to figure out who to contact within each insurance company to get contracted (their websites are a labyrinth!!) so I'm making this post to help out future agents! <https://agent.communityhealthchoice.org/becoming-an-agent/> <https://www.aetna.com/insurance-producer/become-appointed-with-aetna.html> <https://www.molinamarketplace.com/marketplace/brokers/en-us/Become-A-Broker/Agent-Appointment.aspx> <https://www.bcbstx.com/producer/prospective.htm> <https://www.humana.com/agent/contract-with-humana> <https://www.ambetterhealth.com/for-brokers.html> <https://www.uhc.com/broker-consultant> (email [appoint@uhc.com])(<mailto:appoint@uhc.com>), it took FOREVER to find this email and I found it on some random blank contract they had on google but NOWHERE on their website) BONUS use <https://www.healthsherpa.com/> to compare insurance plans, generate quotes, and complete applications! They have a rly nice interface c."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/q17051/how_to_get_contracted_as_an_independent_health/

↳ [deleted] (5): "As someone just getting into Obamacare, you are a hero. It's surprisingly hard to find good information."

↳ IndividualUbermensch (2): "You can, I think this individual just wanted to contract directly with the company themselves as compared to going through an IMO."

↳ IndividualUbermensch (2): "By default, it is not the same commission structure. You will get top commission usually going straight to the source (insurance companies) as compared to going through an IMO (which literally is just a middle man for you and the insurance companies). The IMO's have to make money somehow, they do this by contracting with the insurance companies directly, getting top commission, then giving you only a portion of that commission with your contracts. If the IMO is contracted with a Final Expense life insurance company say at 160% commission levels, they are going to have a hierarchical structure that is (usually) like a pyramid. The guys at the top get 150%, the guys below them they hired get 140%, guys below them maybe get 120% etc etc. The IMO dictates what commission you get entirely, not the insurance company. Usually IMOs are great ways for the top guys (not top sales people, people at the top of the pyramid) to make a killing because of all the over rides (e.g. everytime you make a sale at 100% commission, the guy above you gets 20% or so). IMOs are for people who don't want to be locked into some captive company like State Farm, AllState etc, but at the same time need SOME type of guidance still. That's usually where IMOs come into play, to have some form of structure and guidance for independent agents, but usually they're just one big churn and burn money making machine for the guys at the top of that pyramid at the expense of the new people at the bottom. There are some solid IMOs out there, but they're the anomalies. Take it from a guy who was at one, and who has friends that own them or are high up in them."

"I think this is accurate. However I think there's also a huge disconnect with many agency owners and their expectations of their employees. Yes gaining 6-18 months of experience working under someone is huge for experience. Also when someone is new and they come into an agency that expects them to do everything, from buying leads and networking to building lead generation websites and social media pages to produce more sales while retaining no book ownership and working off a half broken commission structure any one in their right mind ponders why they wouldn't just open up an agency themselves. It's also a fairly different landscape now with many more tools to help inexperienced agents. Yes they may fall flat on their face in the first year or two but many would rather do that than run on the hamster wheel of someone else's race. Most people get caught in someone else's hamster wheel easily and they watched their parents do it their whole lives and they told themselves they would never let it happen to them and that's what keep them driven and motivated to keep pushing even if it takes working other jobs too keep it pushing until they reach the pinnacles of success."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p0yu3l/rash_of_inexperienced_agency_owners/npor2g6/

"Your numbers don't math. A 100% commission is a net loss to agency. You need to add on the cost of employee benefits, work comp, 401(k) profit sharing, unemployment, payroll taxes. Payroll tax is 6.2% Now let's add in all the agency costs. Phone system, agency management system, E&O, rater, training, website, marketing, leads, Microsoft office, accounting software, accountant, etc. Let's not forget the big expenses, account reps. That's 5 to 8k a month per rep. Plus by only paying first year commission your screwing your agents over. Agents don't get rich by first year commission. Agents get rich by keeping their accounts. An agent is limited to how much they can sell each year. There is no limit to how big of book they can retain At the top 100 insurance journal agency I was at about 15% of the Agents produced over 1 million in annual revenue. 1 produced almost 2.5 million in annual revenue. That's a minimum book size for each one of these agents of about 9 million in annual premium. Everyone of these Agents had over decade with the agency."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jrvwh5/please_stop_taking_sales_roles_that_pay_4/mlixnh3/

"Well, the main ones I'm aware of and that I do are Medicare, ACA, Life/Final Expense, fixed Annuities and Ancillary (dental, vision). There is also Group, but I've never done it. Also be aware that some captive agencies operate like call centers and provide leads that are brought in with bait and switch ad tactics. I ran into quite a few of those early in my career. Don't be scared to ask any agency or company you join about their lead sources. Independent is definitely better, but requires you to invest more in yourself and your own marketing. ACA will require the FFM certification, which is free. Medicare requires AHIP certification or equivalent. I pay \$125 annually with the \$50 discount offered by some carriers. Life requires AML, which is free through the LIMRA website. Annuities generally require annuity training, and some states require Best Interest training to sell Life and Annuities. Definitely do more research before you sign any contracts, whether captive or independent. Hope this helps 😊."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibn4xz/passed_my_life_and_health_exam_today_now_what/m9k6pkw/

"Leads for P&C I posted a while ago and started this conversation but bringing it back to get an updated list of lead companies that are worth it. \- exclusive \- high contact rates \- high close rates (preferably 10-15% or more) If anyone is using anything that is for outbound data leads lets help eachother out and me too honestly 🤔 I use Google ads for inbound calls right now and they are great just for some extra advice. Just needing a good outbound vendor or company that can generate them for me."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1st8dk0/leads_for_pc/

↳ MiscBlackKnight (3): "10-15% close rates don't exist in P&C data leads. We are captive and do 4-6% close on data leads. Live transfers we do 15-20-% and could probs close more if we had multiple carriers."

↳ Repulsive_Lime_4433 (3): "Done research with 20 different companies (literally) but they all have the same pitch. Thats why im seeing what others are getting good results from. P&c is typically home and auto plus life which is what i sell so any category can be helpful for not only me but others too. Not everyone is going to gatekeep. Some people may be willing to share their experiences which is why im posting again because I've had this same conversation before and had some great advice."

↳ Repulsive_Lime_4433 (2): "Quotely - they only work with a couple of people per state to avoid oversaturation right now."

"Here is a list of all I tested. Life leads Caboom : See above MediaApha : 1 out of 15 to 20 sale. ROI sucks Aria leads : crap. Their Instagram commercial is in a rented abandoned office, btw Smart Financial: spent 1500 for both data and live transfers. Nothing Everquote: I bought 50, and they canceled supporting life when I joined. No sale Benepath: 1 sale out of 10 leads, and they canceled life line as well Aged lead store: You better be ready to piss everyone off and dial a couple of weeks through wrong and not in service numbers before you get a hit. AWL: data leads suck. Live transfers 1 out of 4 normally sell, but they are overpriced, and if someone lapses or canceled, it ruins the whole ROI Integrity leadcenter: This has been the best of the worst so far, but buying the bronze is no different than the diamond. They say you get them exclusive on the sale, but that's bullshit because my upline bought me some from the same states I got, and they were duplicates. Google Ads : bots. I got all these leads at \$400 a week designed by a Google affiliated advertising company. I installed Captcha, and no more leads came in Fb: mostly people browsing. I feel like they are waiting for a gift after submitting the form. Money pit. Leadrilla: I never tried their campaigns, but if it's anything like the leads they sell in the marketplace, then it's shit too. USA DATA: 50% not in service and are all cold calls Direct mail: 1 to 2% return on mailers if you're lucky and you're always waiting. I sometimes wonder if they really mail anything out. Prospect 4 agent lead company: it was good in 2021, but by 2023, they caught the same disease all these other assholes have."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mezvm3q/

"I agree, it doesn't matter who you buy leads from. I've tried quotely google ads (terrible ROI), quotewizard/smart financial leads. I would call the lead the moment they would come through. The amount of times the prospect would tell me they submitted the form online for their insurance request 2-7 days ago and they have already now purchased a different policy from a caller already was massive. They all sell you aged leads even though they all say they are given in real time the moment they submit the form or they are fake information. I think cold calling/referrals from current clients/referrals from referral partners are the only ways to truly get people. I hear of agents who spend \$5-\$10k on leads a month and write \$200-\$500k of premium a month, those just feel fake lol."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer7u8e/

Self-generated leads (Facebook ads, own marketing) · 124 documents · 20 voices

"Stop buying leads I constantly see people on here complaining about shitty, expensive, shared leads. Listen guys, YouTube exists, this stuff isn't hard. Facebook and Google have dumbed setting things up so much it's ridiculous. You want to know how to create your own leads? On Facebook you can find a built in tool called Facebook ads library. Type in the insurance product you sell and filter the results to show active ads that have been running 6month-1year. The older the ad the more successful. If the ad wasn't making money, they would have killed the ad. Copy/model that ad. For Google, pick a big city, Google <what you sell> <big city> whoever shows up at the top probably has a good ad. Look at their ad copy then look at the landing page they use. Copy/model them. It's simple, YouTube to figure out the setup, research what ads work, copy them.... And now you're getting your leads at cost and you have full control of them. It's easier than you would think."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 163 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466yj/stop_buying_leads/

↳ zb0324 (33): "If you want to get advanced: Google is the more expensive option but the leads are higher quality. Someone googling already has intent to buy, whereas on Facebook you're just scrolling your timeline and someone is interpreting you with an ad. Also there's more fake leads for some reason on Facebook, but they're also way cheaper. What we like to do is get traffic from Google ads and then use Facebook remarketing to put our Facebook ads in front of the expensive Google traffic that didn't buy."

↳ TheMatthewMurray (18): "This is good. I use the method called "Mimic it, Master it, Make it your own." However, copying and pasting will work for awhile, but understanding why ads work is fairly important. That way you're not constantly copying. When something goes wrong is when, people don't know how to fix it."

↳ Randomdeath (16): "did you just post Well thought out and simple strategies for success? Sacralige I say"

"If you want to get advanced: Google is the more expensive option but the leads are higher quality. Someone googling already has intent to buy, whereas on Facebook you're just scrolling your timeline and someone is interpreting you with an ad. Also there's more fake leads for some reason on Facebook, but they're also way cheaper. What we like to do is get traffic from Google ads and then use Facebook remarketing to put our Facebook ads in front of the expensive Google traffic that didn't buy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466yj/stop_buying_leads/mo7pbhg/

"New life insurance agent — how are y'all actually generating your own leads? I'm a newer life insurance agent and trying to figure out how to consistently get leads without spending a bunch of money. I see people on TikTok all the time talking about how they generate their own leads and don't have to buy any... but when I ask people in my group how they're doing it, I usually just hear stuff like "go pass out flyers at grocery stores." That's just not realistic for me. I've got three kids — two of them are still really little — so standing outside a store passing out flyers isn't something I can easily do. So for those of you who have actually found a way to generate leads yourself (especially from home), how are you doing it? Social media? Referrals? Something else? I'm willing to put in the effort, I just need a smarter strategy that works around my life. Appreciate any tips 😊"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/

↳ UnfairFloor3347 (25): "My number one recommendation is to buy leads. Not any leads, Aged Leads. Specifically leads that are 9-12 months old. Old enough where they don't get calls but need a policy or are open to getting a policy at a lower rate. The CPL and CPA are low enough to give you the ability to generate considerable revenue over a 90 day period. At that point in time you can pivot into more expensive marketing solutions or paying someone to run the marketing for you."

↳ [deleted] (13): "I looked into it and they were very expensive in my opinion. Plus it's usually some room full of very hungry people in the Philippines or someplace like that bullying people through a script and that could turn out to be a waste of time in many cases. So I bought the call list myself with certain parameters I set according to people of the ages that typically are thinking about life insurance (because they typically still have people they feel the need to provide for unlike Mrs Jones at 69 years old whose kids are all in their 40s and whose husband is typically dead. I figure if people get to their 60s or older and still have absolutely no final expense coverage it's usually either because they don't see the necessity of it or they just can't afford it. Sure there are exceptions to that but they're exceptions. That brought me to my other parameter of 40K plus income, people that can actually pay the premium. The way I see it I'll just call them myself and I'll be very direct. I won't tell them I'm a "benefits coordinator" or any other BS line. I'll flat out tell them I sell life insurance and if they have about 2 minutes I'd like to give them a quote and that if they like the price I'll come by and we'll do the paperwork in person and they can take out the policy. Then I'll tell them that I'll make no attempt to talk them into buying anything they don't want or can't afford. Then I'll pause for a second. They'll either let me quote them or they won't and then I'll move on down the list. No shady practices at all. Some people will appreciate that and may actually buy a policy. Some won't. Either way I won't feel smarmy and I won't waste several hours and x amount of money on gas driving all over the place trying to talk to people that don't want to talk to me anyway and probably have no intention of buying anything."

↳ Deadly3ffect (12): "I always hated this. "34 year agent and I've never used leads." Back when people would walk into your office to get an insurance policy. Fucking shocker, you started before anyone used the internet. By the time the industry changed you were already established. What you started with is completely different to what the insurance industry is now. Sorry, that shit seriously pisses me off. All these old timers are sitting below me on the monthly sales because they have this outdated mindset. You want to sell insurance? Buy fucking leads."

"BadA\$\$leads scam I purchased some leads from badassleads.. those leads are a penny worth. Wrong numbers, disconnected numbers, bad emails. Just dont waste your money and generate your own. Seriously lead generation companies are ripping off Agents"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/

↳ bigalien1 (28): "Sometimes the name gives it away"

↳ Diligent_Throat304 (8): "They should rename bullsh*tleads lol"

↳ jwf1126 (7): "You should have taken your own names advice or even gone full deep throat with a company name like that. Lead gen sucks but there are companies out there that will at least put a good faith effort and give you the time a day and have some successes"

"And find a solid lead source. I run my own ads on social media, and buy aged leads (30+ days) from USA Life Leads to help fill my day. I've wasted sooo much money on leads. More does not equal better.."

— YouTube · My BIGGEST Advice To A New Life Insurance Agent! 🚀 #insurance #insuranceagent #insurancesa · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AGiTFBC4oSM&lc=UgzcN16DCaTdKHMfyIB4AaABAq>

↳ @franko8572 (1): "Hi. About to be licensed. Where do you find your leads?"

↳ @DiabloPollo (0): "@franko8572I run ads on social media, and also use usa life leads. One of their packages is 100 leads for \$175, so I do 1-2 of those a week. Just depends on my schedule and how many leads my ads are pulling that week."

"As an Independent Broker, what is the best way to generate leads? I recently got my Life & Health license in NY and I am trying to figure out how to structure my business ONLINE. I've been appointed with several carriers over the past few months. My background is in marketing, specifically Ecommerce so I have a solid understanding of running Facebook ads. However, I am having trouble pulling the trigger and actually getting started due to trying to figure out all of the rules and regulations. Analysis paralysis. I plan on pumping out quality content on my website and socials both of which are not yet created. As an Independent in NY, my business name is my first and last name. Does my domain name and socials have to be my first and last name or can it be something random like "High Creek Financial", for example? I guess I am having trouble with establishing my brand identity. Should it be ME posting content and interacting in the community or should it be "High Creek Financial". I'm apprehensive to just use my name for my brand because it will make me appear like the one man show that I am. My thoughts are that if I was able to use "High Creek Financial" for example, that it would give off the vibe that I'm with a big, legit company. I don't know if any of this is even making sense so I apologize in advance. As I'm writing this, I keep thinking to myself, "wtf am I even saying?" Should I do something like this: <https://www.marblepay.com/> and be in the background or should I just use my personal brand and not care that people will see that I'm a one man show? If anyone has any experience with generating their own leads, could I pick your brain a little bit? Thanks!!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 18 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fj86x3/as_an_independent_broker_what_is_the_best_way_to/

↳ General_Let7384 (9): "1. You are a one man show. why pretend to be something you're not ? 2. if you think it's bad to be a one man show, then maybe add another man or 5 ? 3. Do you want to someday have a big legit company ? Maybe you can partner with an established one man show. The personal /business relationships you build are the source of your income. That takes place one-to-one. You might prefer to be the marketing guy and let someone else write the business."

↳ Wide-Holiday9430 (5): "All your questions make sense, my experience is no one cares about your name as an Indy broker. Dial in on the type of business you want to niche and marketing becomes easy. Life insurance is sold not bought. I would suggest working somewhere to make mistakes on someone else's dime unless you have a nice fund to carry you for a year. It will take you 2-3 years to hit your stride. This is my advice experience from the P and C world and watching other L and H people build their business. Look into Medicare good returns and lots of leads from employers."

↳ Superb_Advisor7885 (4): "The reason is because your model is hard to scale. It's hard to hire sales people and give them enough lead volume to recreate success."

"This is what they don't tell you is that you have to learn to generate your own leads. Don't waste your time I'm with the competitor of Aflac which is colonial life. I do Facebook ads, Tik Tok etc.. to generate my own leads it works. The old methods don't"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mcl3e3/i_already_hate_my_job/n5v01x4/

"Medicare brokers, help me set realistic goals for years 1-3 as an independent agent. Background: I just got my insurance license this week, planning on finding a good, not shady FMO/IMO in the next month. I am a full time engineer so I will be selling Medicare part time as an independent broker. Plan is to leave work at 2pm and start doing Medicare. I understand that this will be insanely difficult and time consuming. I don't feel comfortable leaving my job with out trying this part time first. Completely fine working long hours. Medicare is quite confusing but I am very active on the Medicare subreddit answering questions I know and learning from the posts I don't. I want to do this to provide the best care for the seniors in my area not just shove MA plans down their throat. Now my main question. Are my goals realistic. 1st year (now through open enrollment): 10 clients mixture of MA and medigap (roughly \$3000-4000) 2nd year: 50 new clients roughly (\$17000 - 20000) 3rd year: 125 clients total (\$35000-50000) quit job and do Medicare FT. Marketing plan: I will be doing in person in my local area. Already signed up for a very popular Saturday farmers market and a couple county fairs. All marketing will be in person + local advertising. I am active in the community and just generally enjoy talking to people. Thoughts are struggle year 1-2 with a lot of local events on weekends and then word of mouth will hopefully pick up if I am able to provide the assistance and knowledge I strive to. Create an easy to use website (I'm a software engineer) and optimize SEO so it shows up to locals searching. Facebook page and local Facebook advertising"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j6vj8/medicare_brokers_help_me_set_realistic_goals_for/

↳ mbkr148 (4): "I like the idea of setting up at a farmers market. I'd also look at doing Medicare 101 at senior apartments/community centers."

↳ BangDingOwwwww (3): "I think your numbers are great, and not outrageous. How do you see yourself getting the business? You might find it challenging to reach those numbers if you're part time. But depending on how you market yourself I'd say realistically by year three might be closer to 75-100? The whole part time thing is where it makes things a bit more challenging bc of schedule conflicts, if you're looking to establish a local presence or calling leads etc."

↳ polach11 (3): "Updated post. Plan to do everything in person"

"Hi I have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdotal personal experience) Jornaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use jornaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower intent.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trusted lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. .get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer844c/

"I toggle generators on as I need them. If I am going to be writing that day I turn on a generator around 530 am or so for that day. Sometimes I just leave one running. I spend anywhere from 20 to 50 per day myself depending on what I need. Number of leads depends on the spend. Self gen takes time to learn and can be very frustrating while you are in the learning curve. This is why most agents simply go to vendors even for outbound. Much like the rest of the industry only a small % of us are successful long term with this. I should add that we do this mainly because I do not like to be stuck needing anyone but myself to run my business. If you are independent then you should be independent....lol. So to me that means growing your own food from start to finish!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pmr7pi/how_are_we_generating_leads_going_into_2026/nu2l322/

"I run a digital agency. Turn on monetization on this video, cause I want to run my ad letting life insurance agents know that I can run their FB ads for them, for a nominal monthly fee."

— YouTube · How I Sold \$56,038 Of Life Insurance In 30 Days With Self Generated Leads · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=60LbRzSZNP&lc=UgzQoMbhX0odje7KfcZ4AaABAq>

↳ @clydebarrow1933 (5): "@coffee.cup123 His channel has zero content!"

↳ @coffee.cup123 (0): "let's do business where can i contact you ?"

"Leaving a \$50k banking job for a commercial insurance producer role, is it worth the risk? I'm currently making about \$50k at a bank with great benefits and 30 paid days off (including holidays). I've been offered a commercial insurance producer/Risk Advisor role at a small independent agency (5/6 person team), and I'm trying to decide whether the upside is worth leaving a stable job. The opportunity is roughly: \- 1099 \- 55k-\$70k draw + \$600/month vehicle allowance (negotiating this on Monday) \- Health/life benefits \- 40% commission on new business, 30% on renewals \- Agency acct averages about \$45k-\$50k premium per account \- They wrote about \$6M in new premium last year and manage \-\$22M total \- Owner has been in the business for 23 years (however the agency is just years old I believe) and plans to teach me everything he knows and believes \$1M in new premium is a realistic first major milestone \- First 60-90 days would mostly be training and pipeline building by month 6 expects policy's \- Owner might provide leads/referrals, but ultimately I'd be expected to generate my own pipeline \- Long-term appeal is building a recurring book of business rather than relying on salary increases My biggest unknowns are if the draw is recoverable if I don't produce enough, ownership of my book, it sounds like they'll own my book however there might be a vesting of ownership or when he plans on selling in 5-7 years he does plan to have clauses that allow me to keep my book (uncertain) For commercial P&C producers/agency owners: Does this sound like a good opportunity? What should I make sure is in the contract, and how realistic is \$1M-\$2M of premium for a new producer? (I have a small network, worked in B2B selling before) ALSO, anything more I should ask about on Monday?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wdgfsq/leaving_a_50k_banking_job_for_a_commercial/

↳ Ancient_Idea_1434 (17): "depends if you can stomach the ramp-up, 1099 with a draw that might be recoverable is a whole different kind of stress than a bank gig with 30 days off"

↳ Confident_Bats (4): "I don't know much about the commercial side as much as I do the personal. My agency I'm allowed to sell all the commercial I want and we have a team to help me. My salary is 50k, I make 70% on new business and only 30% on renewals. As my book grows, my salary will go down, and my renewals will go up. The end result is a \$0 salary I'll be 1099 with 50% renewals and still 70% new business. I get health insurance, retirement, etc."

↳ ChildishBalvino (4): "These businesses don't just cough up \$50k in premium unless they trust you and your agency. I'm not sure this is a good idea for you to completely switch over without any prior experience"

"Am I doing this wrong? (Final Expense) So a brief run down, I started at an agency. Payout is 90% commission (75% upfront with 25% paid out over the rest of the year) I pay for mail-in leads at 35 bucks a pop. Obviously first couple months great but the last 4 weeks have been terrible. I haven't changed my approach or anything but I've only made two sales in these four weeks and they've really only covered my chargebacks lol with mail ins obviously I go to their homes and door knock. (spent \$742 on gas last month) I wouldn't feel bad if I was still making sales but it just seems to have dried up. Is it the time of year? Am I not being pushy enough? Thinking about running Facebook ad campaigns for some hotter leads to maybe help get out of this funk. anyone have experience with this or any tips?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p57gp5/>

↳ (0): "Veteran Face-to-face final expense agent here. Don't waste time building ad campaigns. That's a good idea for telesales but not for field sales. Use caution with some of the advice on here; a lot of ideas sound good on paper but are actually a waste of time in practice. I am guessing it's likely one or more of these things. But you tell me 1) The problem is usually lack of activity. Be honest with yourself about how hard you're working these leads, how many doors you've knocked, etc. 2) If you're honestly putting in the hours, then it's your mindset. You are not working them the right way. You're looking for easy sales, giving up as soon as you get resistance, skipping steps, and not following the process. It happens 3) If you're telling me it's neither of those things, then I'd have to assume your script needs work. Or you're not being assumptive enough (constantly asking permission when you should be moving forward in the sales process)."

↳ (0): "What kind of training are you getting? Are you setting appointments or just knocking at random times? Your comp is low, but not so low it should be impossible to make a profit. I'm happy to help, but it's hard to diagnose the issue without knowing more."

↳ (0): "What are mail in leads?"

"What lead vendors work for you? I'm a face to face final expense agent. I was using cheaper internet leads from integrity, social insurance leads, and leads direct. They aren't exclusive but they're anywhere from \$1-11 so I can get a lot of them, and if you dial enough you'll set up enough appointments. The ROI was great. As of recently though, they're just bad. And I've been with companies in the past that have had BAD leads before, I'm used to having to dial a lot and overcome objections, but this just isn't the way anymore. I've tried Facebook ads myself and I've come to the conclusion I'm just not a good marketer. It takes a lot of trial and error and time to figure it out so unless there's somewhere that'll give me a copy and pasted proven ad to post, I've decided it's not worth it. I'll take any recommendations on any direct mail or internet lead vendors. What works for you guys?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fmxcl1/what_lead_vendors_work_for_you/

↳ DavidDuford (5): "I'll second u/NAF1138 - just work direct mail leads. Aged direct mail leads can be great if you can find a quality distributor. Facebook leads can be good but you'll have a bunch more travel time to work them effectively."

↳ NAF1138 (4): "If you sell face to face, you should ONLY work direct mail. All other lead types are only good for filler leads or telesales. There are lots of good direct lead vendors The Lead Connection Lead Concepts Need a Lead RGI Are some places to start."

↳ dis_iz_funny_shit (4): "I've got a direct face to face method for finding new leads in the field - mortgage protection leads --- so the tool helps you find people in any area that just bought a home in the last few months. It helps you locate a phone number also about 60-70% of the time"

"Here's what I'm doing (not be construed as legal advice): 1. Update your compliance language on all opt-in forms. 2. Switch from shared/data leads to self-generated leads if you're doing anything more powerful than manual dialing. 3. My interpretation is that you can work aged/data leads on a single-line dialer as that counts as manual dialing. However, doing so would be akin to self-mutilation. Overall, the spirit of the law is great and hopefully will greatly limit call centers and the amount of mass dialing data "leads" they do."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hszzi5/doing_anything_about_the_new_tcpa_rule_whats_your/m59vn00/

"I don't have any clients just started im learning Facebook ads at the moment"

— YouTube · How to Generate FREE Life Insurance Leads in 2026 (My 3 Easy Methods) · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=z_3cxs9kjSk&lc=Ugw5VzELgf-cD39uoJN4AaABAg

↳ @El-Buddah (1): "Facebook Ads are a waste"

↳ @brilliantSolutionz (0): "Hi, are you getting the hang of it?"

↳ @brilliantSolutionz (0): "@El-Buddah why do you say so?"

"Lead generation systems I recently started as a Medicare agent and started about a month before AEP. I was given 15 Medicare express leads which are very good thus far and sold 13. I definitely have seen the benefit in this. The problem is the leads are \$100 each and plan to plan is mostly what they have, which is only \$300. 1. I have met with at least 10 different qualified leads businesses. The one I'm considering the most is Lead Latchers, which can target solely T-65 leads. I like that it's guaranteed to a certain amount and is relatively inexpensive compared to other companies. It's ran from meta ads and screening process to send qualified inbound calls to you and uses AI to keep in touch with potential clients. It's is stated to have a 43 % conversion rate so on average 2 policies out of 5. 2. I thought I was ready start using Lead Latchers until I started seeing a lot of terrible reviews. I get that we are in a sales environment but every company is claiming you will get more appointments than you can handle. They also suggest to get at least 5 state licenses to increase traffic, which doesn't seem like a terrible idea. 3. So here are my questions. (A) For those who use lead generators, have you found a good service that can target T-65 and who did you have the most appointments with? (B). Is it possible to build a successful insurance business based solely on qualified inbound telephone leads? Did multiple states help? , Thank you for your time and insight!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hlgw4i/lead_generation_systems/

↳ Expert-Difficulty605 (1): "Thanks! This was very helpful."

↳ Expert-Difficulty605 (1): "Thank you, much appreciated."

↳ Delicious-Adeptness5 (1): "That is a great conversion rate and it sounds like you are paying a high premium for it. We went the opposite direction for leads, focused on SEO and WOM. It's more time focused."

"Have you ever considered, you know, actually generating your own leads with community engagement in a niche market? Seriously... It works. I have done it for nine years. Wouldn't even know where to get a lead that was purchased if I tried. Also, thank God this is happening. The number of spam calls I get per day is ungodly and they interrupt my actual calls from call waiting. It's horrible. I hope all the overseas scammers shrivel up and go back to the holes they came from. I am tired of trying to tell my mom that I did not go to Mexico and will never be kidnapped there, she does not have a tax debt, and her Amazon order doesn't exist. Most of the time she is fine, and sends me an 'lol you are not in Mexico getting robbed are you?' text. But I know the day is coming when that fails and I will be very grateful if it comes after this happens."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l8sgfs/be_prepared_for_the_phone_apocalypse/mx7qq7x/

"Life Insurance - Where to kickstart leads Starting tomorrow in Life insurance and do not want to sell to friends and family now. I have a budget of 10k to kick start my journey. Where would be the best option to start with leads. I've built a lead magnet and plan on running meta ads. Is there anything worth the shot? I'm seeing pregnant women lead at 6\$ a pop, life list at 60\$ a pop or from a comparable platform at 33\$ a pop. Also, in Canada should I focus on life or CII is better. I've closed down my previous business to get into this - back against the wall, this as to work."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s150t5/life_insurance_where_to_kickstart_leads/

"Most are resellers that's why! It is rare to find the actual source of the leads. Also the industry is drowned to the max with resellers who bought 7 day old leads in bulk for like \$1000 and reselling for \$10,000! That is why I only recommend direct mail and doing fb ads. They will be your exclusive leads! If you are not the first agency to call that person after they filled out the online form then it is most likely a useless window shopper. They will just spin your wheels and will never convert!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer5k7f/

Dialers, CRMs and text campaigns · 115 documents · 20 voices

"8 Tips for New Agents to Sell Insurance Successfully Below I've compiled a list of 8 strategies imperative for new agents to execute on, if you want to see success selling insurance, regardless of the agency, niche, or product you sell. Here they are: # 1. Clear the Calculator Selling insurance is largely a mental game. In other words, you have to keep your emotions and focus in check at all times. This means you must not allow distractions from your personal life or sales calls gone sideways to affect your mindset. Here's some tips that have helped me stay mentally sharp: * Treat every sales call as a fresh start. Getting rejected on one sales call doesn't mean you'll get rejected on the next. * It's helpful to think of your clients rejecting **your offer**, not you. The rejection is business, not personal. * Maintain balance in your personal life—exercise, eat well, and manage relationships. Mental clarity fuels sales success. # 2. Eliminate Distractions Selling insurance is great, but especially those who sell remotely, it comes with endless distractions. To stay focused: * Set clear boundaries with family—work time is **work time**. Make sure your spouse and kids respect this. * Keep your phone muted and out of reach during work hours. Group your texts and calls to a scheduled time. Most of them can wait. * Social media and internet use while you should be selling kills productivity. Consider a low-cost app like Freedom.to limit internet access while you should be working. # 3. Prioritize Activity Over Everything Activity leads to "app-tivity." In other words, tracking your numbers is critical to uncovering opportunities to improve your results. Try tracking these metrics daily: * **Connection Rate** — How many people are you actually getting to pick up the phone? If this number is low, explore dialing technology that helps keep your number off the spam- and telemarketer-likely lists. I like Convoso and Kixie. * **Quality connections** — How many conversations last longer than two minutes? If you're having trouble keeping your prospects on the phone, work on your opening script by practicing objection rebuttals until you can say them on the fly without hesitation. * **Closing rate** — How many policies are you selling compared to presentations? If these numbers are low, adjust your strategy. Retrain your scripting. Success is a numbers AND a skill development game. # 4. Master Your Scripts and Rebuttals The best agents **sound natural** but follow a proven process. If you don't have a script, you're winging it! And winging it doesn't work long-term. A good script consists of the following: * A strong intro that overcomes initial objections while simultaneously helping the client remember that they in fact requested the information you're calling about. * A handful of effective fact-finding questions that help build value and urgency to buy what you're selling. * A good list of underwriting questions that help you figure out which product works best. I like using Insurance Tool Kits for life and final expense policy sales. * How to close confidently. # 5. Stay Consistent with Your Schedule Consistency wins. The more you treat your profession like a job, the better off you'll be. I recommend the following: * Set a fixed start and end time every day. Stay disciplined to this as much as possible. * Avoid checking email or social media during work hours. Schedule a time before and after work for this. * Batch tasks. Separate prospecting, calling, and follow-ups. # 6. Improve After Every Call After a completed sales presentation - whether you sell or not - don't just move on! Analyze what worked and what didn't. Ask yourself the following: * Did I control the conversation? Or did the prospect control the pace? Remember that the person asking questions is in control. * Did I handle objections smoothly? If you're stumbling in your script, practice it multiple times until it's smooth. * What could I do better next time? Biggest pro-tip I can offer is to record your sales calls and listen to them. You'll hear all sorts of opportunities to improve =). # 7. Develop Thick Skin Rejection is part of the game. If you get rattled after a bad call, you're losing twice. Keep moving. Instead, think about the following: * If someone hangs up? Act fast and dial the next lead instead of ruminating. Don't spiral out of control! * If a prospect is rude? Probably like that with everyone. Don't take it personal. Next! * If you get 50 rejections in a row? Think: a sale is that much closer =). # 8. Work Smarter, Not Harder Successful agents **leverage** tools and systems to increase efficiency: * Use a CRM to track leads and follow-ups. AgentCRM is a pretty good CRM to start if your agency doesn't provide it. * Automate tasks where possible such as a chat bot to speak with your leads. Or use a compliant powerdialer to speak with more prospects faster. Again, I like Kixie and Convoso. * Constantly refine your approach based on data. Hope this helps =)"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 84 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kfmhbp/8_tips_for_new_agents_to_sell_insurance/

↳ hawkwood76 (11): "Love it. I will only add If it isn't on our calendar, it doesn't exist."

↳ CGWInsurance (5): "Congrats on doing this for new agents. Extremely well written. I would have put thick skin at either 1 or 2. Seen many leave this industry who rocked everything, but just took everything that was said to them personally and they had to quit for their own mental health."

↳ DavidDuford (2): "Appreciate it. Selling insurance or doing something totally performance-based is not for the faint of heart."

"Independent Agency Owners, What Would You Do Differently Starting From Scratch? If you were starting a brand-new independent insurance agency today, knowing what you know now, what would you recommend? I'm especially interested in hearing about: \- Agency networks / aggregators / clusters: Who would you join—or avoid? \- Carrier appointments: Which appointments would you prioritize first? \- Programs & software: AMS, CRM, comparative raters, quoting tools, automation, accounting, etc. What's actually worth paying for? \- Non-negotiables: What absolutely needs to be in place from day one? \- Negotiables: What can wait until the agency starts producing revenue? \- Contracts: What terms would you refuse to sign? Book ownership, commission splits, exit provisions, non-solicitation, production requirements, fees, etc. \- Expenses: Where is it worth spending money upfront, and where would you stay lean? \- Lead generation: What actually worked for you versus what was a complete waste of money? \- Niches: Would you start broad or specialize early? \- Lessons learned: What mistake cost you the most time, money, or headache? Basically, if you had to build your agency again from \$0 in premium and no existing book, what would your blueprint look like? I'm less interested in sales pitches and more interested in hearing from agents who have actually built or operated an independent agency, give me the good, the bad, and the "absolutely do not sign that contract" lessons."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vwadqv/independent_agency_owners_what_would_you_do/

↳ InstructionWarm2840 (20): "Man I wish someone told me about the cluster trap earlier. Joined a big one first year and the exit clause was basically "we own your book forever" - took me 3 years to buy my way out of that mess. Read every contract like your life depends on it, especially the part about who actually own the business when you leave For software don't go crazy at start. I spent like \$800/month on fancy CRM that I barely used first 6 months. Get good rater and simple accounting, rest can wait until you got actual revenue coming in. The only thing worth paying for right away is a decent phone system and maybe EZLynx if you do personal lines What worked best for leads was literally just walking into real estate offices with donuts on Saturday morning. Cost me 15 bucks and got more referrals than the \$500/month online leads I tried. Would specialize early too, I wasted 2 years trying to write everything and made no money until I focused only on contractors"

↳ broker965 (8): "Riches are in the niches. Pick one. One niche makes market selection and appointments much easier. Promote only that niche, become known for that niche, watch the money pile up. Promote. Promote. Promote. If you're bashful to self-promote, do not become a small business owner. When you're a scratch agency, no one other than your mom will know you exist. It's 100% up to you to get the word out. Most agency owners get side tracked with this and that marketing system and lead gen yatta yatta... 99% of it is pure BS marketing hype trying to sell you something. Stick to the basics. Pick a CRM, AMS and phone system you can afford and block out all the other noise. And for God's sake, don't open an agency if you've never spent 1 hour of your life working in one. This is a non-negotiable. If you don't have industry experience and you open an insurance agency, you're doing your future clients a disservice by being an inexperienced insurance agent."

↳ Knucklecum (7): "I'm literally about to start my own independent agency, as a new agent. Thank you for submitting this post. lol"

"Am I Crazy for Wanting to Leave My \$200k+ Job to Start and Independent Agency Background, I'm mid 30s, 2 kids, and I've just about had it with my extremely high stress/toxic culture job (in a healthcare/pharma marketing related field). I have a few years of savings and I'm ready to pivot my career into something more personally rewarding.....I'm seriously considering insurance! I know how to build a brand, manage CRM systems, create effective communications (the one-on-one sales aspect is new to me, but I know I can figure it out). Plus I have a solid background in many aspects of prescription drugs and healthcare (i've taken a practice licensing test without cracking a book and got a 72%, so there's more for me to learn, but a solid foundation) The idea is to start a medicare-focused agency, brand it to appeal to the communities I want to target, partner with an FMO, and begin sourcing paid and earned leads directly (this is not a challenge for me, I'm been doing it in the pharma space for years). My goal is to use the next 6 months to start up the business, get my licenses and begin lead generation. I would then quit my job in time for the end of year enrollment season, see how that goes - (pick up some light contract work throughout next year to supplement my income) and then go all-in on the business late 2026 - hoping that I can be clearing \$150k+ in 2027 and back to 200k+ earnings in 2028. Over time I'd branch out into other lines, but I want to keep a narrow focus for now so I can effectively source clients. That's the high-level plan, of course there are many more details that I'm figuring out (I'm building financial projections, comparing FMOs, analyzing the competitive landscape for local agents and the large nationals...and a lot more to make sure I'm going in with solid goals and expectations) So, am I crazy to get into this world? What are the biggest pitfalls to watch out for that will get in the way of me being successful? What is the biggest deterrents for those starting out that will make me feel burnt?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jdknqh/am_i_crazy_for_wanting_to_leave_my_200k_job_to/

↳ HamiltonSt25 (39): "I didn't read everything you wrote, but just keep in mind, it's a tough insurance climate right now (Assuming you're in the US). Doing it right now would leave you struggling to get contracts. I'm an independent and almost all of my major carriers are not giving new contracts at this time. This will drain your assets extremely fast. I'd hold out until it softens up a bit."

↳ Acceptable-Tip7886 (28): "Times are tough, if you're making 200k plus I would stay and invest. Money now is more important than money later plus you'll retire sooner"

↳ HamiltonSt25 (10): "I'm sorry, let me clarify. I'm speaking as far as P&C goes. So if you're asking about life/health, I have no idea. If you're talking P&C, then I'm speaking about direct contracts with carriers/companies."

"Man I wish someone told me about the cluster trap earlier. Joined a big one first year and the exit clause was basically "we own your book forever" - took me 3 years to buy my way out of that mess. Read every contract like your life depends on it, especially the part about who actually own the business when you leave For software don't go crazy at start. I spent like \$800/month on fancy CRM that I barely used first 6 months. Get good rater and simple accounting, rest can wait until you got actual revenue coming in. The only thing worth paying for right away is a decent phone system and maybe EZLynx if you do personal lines What worked best for leads was literally just walking into real estate offices with donuts on Saturday morning. Cost me 15 bucks and got more referrals than the \$500/month online leads I tried. Would specialize early too, I wasted 2 years trying to write everything and made no money until I focused only on contractors"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vwadgv/independent_agency_owners_what_would_you_do/p5fdhsa/

"Yeah your resume can use work. Are you applying for insurance overall? 1. I'd take off the warehouse associate 2. One page only 3. don't see the point in core competencies, I'd just do skills - include bilingual and like CRM or software you're familiar with 4. Similarly I wouldn't list education on hold. I'd move education section up and just list your associates - no need to mention GED Edit to add 5. I'd update some of the names / position "licensed health insurance agent" you can just put agent - you mention these were season so I'd include that Agent, XYZ, Remote Date XYZ - DATE XYZ (seasonal/temporary) I personally don't do a personal summary - so someone else can maybe mention if it's good to keep. But you repeat the same stuff as core competencies. I'd also add more to the work you did. I typically have 2-3 bullet points"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1upsd1s/i_cant_seem_to_land_a_job_is_my_resume_bad/iow2ffw/

"Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdoteal personal experience) Journaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use journaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower intent.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trustrd lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. ,get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer844c/

"Great idea. Favorite telesales carriers: RNA, Prosperity and Trinity. SS billing + voice sign for all 3. Favorite lead: Real-time telemarketed call back with verified checking, ages 50-79 and agrees to speak with an agent. Basically telemarketers calling on DNC scrubbed and TCPA verified data to call on (old FB leads or Journaya/Trusted Form verified) + scrubbed against TCPA Blacklist Alliance and inputting into a form to serve it up in a CRM immediately. Tip: You need proper training and sales systems to make telesales work. If you take your DM leads and try to sell them over the phone with your typical f2f presentation, you'll fail. If you buy internet leads and don't have proper sales training or sales systems, you'll fail. My advice is either partner with a telesales-focused agency with an open release policy (hey, telesales isn't for everyone) or wait it out. Don't waste any time/money unless there's a proven system in place."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Telesales Tips · 11 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/final-expense-telesales-tips.101595/#post-1344555>

"I'll give you the secret sauce. Go to Claude A.I think about an ad you want to create. Take the creatives and go to Facebook and create an ad. Then have the lead transfer into your crm that will text them within 30 seconds of them responding keeping them warm and active until you call the client. Sounds harder than what it is. Or pay someone to set it up. But it's your leads exclusive to you. Never resold."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s5vcry/the_shared_leads_thing_is_such_a_scam_and_i_cant/ocy1xro/

"Independent agent looking for IMO with no requirements — just carrier access Independent agent here. I run my own leads and dialer and don't need training or a system. Looking for a true hands-off IMO/FMO that offers: \- Street-level comp \- No required meetings or Zoom \- No CRM fees \- Full contract ownership Just want carrier access and to be left alone to produce. Any recommendations?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s75pbn/independent_agent_looking_for_imo_with_no/

↳ Hot-Trainer1209 (2): "Safe Life - use go high level for CRM, it's \$10/yr. Meet all your other requirements, if you want to learn about inbound leads, we have those too."

↳ Tahoptions (1): "Any of the large IMOs that service the financial advisor world would fit these requests. Crump, Ash, FIG, Back9, TMA, CPS, there are a ton of them."

↳ Dependent_Estimate83 (1): "Yeah, looking into crump right now, looks good!"

"General question about leads Hey everyone, I've been lurking the sub for a bit and have seen some similar issues arise but wasn't sure about my current situation.. \-I'm a P/C agent and working towards my L/H, hopefully within the month. \-I'm with a larger well known captive carrier. The Agency I'm with has been hit with non-renewals, some of the highest in the region. \-The new agent owner took on the role from the dying book of business (85% of the book was local, most of that was bundled with the non renewals) \-The name of the company is scarred in the area so there are no referrals and few renewals coming in to generate business. \-The majority of the agent owners time is spent saving the few renewals he is able to save *albeit as much as x4 the original rate. He is not generating any new leads for the business and hasn't for nearly 8 months. \-This agency being my first producer role, I was enticed with the prospect of (wait for it) paid leads. I didn't know better at the time and hadn't browsed this sub yet. Apologies in advance lol. \-I've had nearly 200 incoming paid leads since I started 6 months ago. I text often, email weekly and call daily. I even created my own spreadsheet to track the leads since no CRM is available. (I tried Monday and enjoyed it but couldn't convince the owner to adopt this.) \-The majority of these leads are instant denials without opportunity to give alternative answers. The few who do answer, the quoted rate isn't competitive. Still, I keep trying. I asked the boss and he said just keep dialing the leads, even after a "no". \-Of these paid leads, I've closed 1 thus far. A few in the "in progress" stage but that's it. I've had a few inbound calls and of the 5 available, I've closed 4... So assuming that someone wants insurance and I can beat the coverage, rate and service, people are buying. \-I'm supposed to bind at least 3% and need to hit \$20k in sales each month to be eligible for the "agent owner program". \-The owner has lamented to me that my minimal \$ value of premium is very low (I'm averaging about \$500 per lead) AND he is upset with his input of money to pay for the leads.. \-I have requoted everyone at least 3 times and reached out to the 3000 odd old leads to cross sell, win back, etc. Using some math, at this rate I would need to bind more than 50% of the leads in a month's time to generate about \$10k in premium. My questions are: 1) What do you do to increase the amount of premium bound each month? 2) What do you do to increase the probability of direct contact with outbound leads? 3) Which paid lead companies work best or worst? 4) If you are unable to prospect in your local region, how do you generate business? Thanks for the read. I'm in a bit of a pickle."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1snoujd/general_question_about_leads/

↳ CFactor11 (4): "Sounds like you're beating up aged digital leads. Owner is cattle prodding you to maximize lead conversion. OR Take a look inward. How are you handling the call? Building rapport? Making human/genuine connection? Creating real value and urgency?"

↳ KN0W-IDEA (2): "I just reached out to the local chamber of commerce, made a social media page and am attempting to contact some of the local developers. Trying to put my name out there. But the agent owner doesn't have enough time to do these things himself."

↳ KN0W-IDEA (1): "Thanks for the reply! I've been curious myself for both.. it feels like the top answer but I'm always open to feedback. I have asked for input on my delivery for the few leads I've been able to connect with. I have tried many different approaches but the answer is usually the same: "stop contacting me"."

"Here's what I'm doing (not be construed as legal advice): 1. Update your compliance language on all opt-in forms. 2. Switch from shared/data leads to self-generated leads if you're doing anything more powerful than manual dialing. 3. My interpretation is that you can work aged/data leads on a single-line dialer as that counts as manual dialing. However, doing so would be akin to self-mutilation. Overall, the spirit of the law is great and hopefully will greatly limit call centers and the amount of mass dialing data "leads" they do."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hszzi5/doing_anything_about_the_new_tcpa_rule_whats_your/m59vn00/

"Advice for Final Expense Startup (High-Volume Cold Calling Team) Hi everyone, I'm planning to start selling final expense insurance within the next month or two. I'll be going all-in on cold calling and wanted to get feedback from experienced agents before launch. My Plan: I'll (22M) be working with my two 18-year-old brothers and operating in new york state Each of us will make 1,000 cold calls/day, 6 days a week We'll work 12-13 hour shifts, using a CRM + power dialer system We plan to buy leads daily at \$0.30 to \$0.50 each We're all bilingual (English/Spanish) and comfortable with high-volume sales We're not strangers to long hours or consistent effort — and we plan to maintain tone and energy throughout. Goals: Start with final expense sales Gradually add Medicare Scope of Appointments (SOA), enrollments, and eventually Medicare Supplements After a few months of production, I plan to negotiate a 140% commission contract We're expecting a 0.3% to 0.5% close rate based on what we've researched A friend of mine who only does medicare will share his hot leads with me since i will do final expense so i am guaranteed some early success at least if i dont screw it up --- My Questions: 1. Is this call volume and close rate realistic for a new team using aged or low-cost leads? 2. Is there anything crucial I'm overlooking in terms of compliance, licensing, or daily execution? 3. Are there any CRM + dialer combos you highly recommend for high-volume final expense/Medicare telesales? 4. For Medicare broker changes, is it realistic to expect consistent volume or are those more seasonal? 5. Are there any major red flags or rookie mistakes we should avoid early on? 6. Any advice for scripting, retention, or mental pacing during long dialing days? Thanks in advance — I really respect the grind this industry takes and want to do it the right way."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jnkha/advice_for_final_expense_startup_highvolume_cold/

↳ DavidDuford (7): "Guaranteed Issue = lapse-o-matic. Arguably better to just not write it."

↳ SnooLemons398 (5): "If you're gonna do final expense, make sure one or more carriers can do guaranteed policies. There are a lot of sick people out there. There are also many poor people out there. Make sure they can afford it, or you'll see more chargebacks than you think. Try to close on the first call. 80% of FE appointments are a no show. Good luck!"

↳ DavidDuford (3): "What I would do if I were you: 1. Scrub your data against a litigator and changed number list on a regular basis. 2. Get Convoso. Kixie is OK. Most other dialers are terrible. Connection rate is everything. 3. Move out of New York. You cannot get contracted in New York with American Amicable as a New York resident. AmAm is arguably the best final expense telesales carrier available. Answers to your questions: 1. Maybe. Biggest levers to get best results: 1. Script and skillset 2. Dialer to maximize connection rates. 2. See above. 3. Convoso only. 4. Stay away from DSNP. 5. 100% TCPA compliance adherence. 6. Set daily activity goals. Consider bonuses/rewards for hitting call/conversion goals."

"I work at an agency where we receive only inbound calls. We have a weekly charge of around \$850. This covers everything from the dialer to the office space and the leads as well The first two weeks are free though. My one call today covers that charge so I'm ok with it. People who have been doing it for a while are just killing it there. I used to work furniture sales and during slow season when the snowbirds were out of town, that was all I would make in one or two weeks occasionally. Definite Upgrade!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj9u0m/had_my_first_sale_today/oum8y9g/

"TCPA mainly focuses on robo calls and dialers. I don't use any of those to dial my leads. I'm pretty much old school and hand dial myself. It's been 2 years for me and I haven't had an issue yet. I also don't spam call my leads. If someone answers and states they're not interested, I move on to the next lead. I'm not in the business of begging or being pushy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/m9mifjh/

"I did spend thousand dollars a CRM leads and Vendor's leads and I didn't get my ROI Back"

— YouTube · How I Sold \$56,038 Of Life Insurance In 30 Days With Self Generated Leads · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=60LbRzSZNP&lc=Ugz1KF5U5nR_P3pGczkB4AaABAg

↳ @jayg5888 (3): "Yeah this business is brutal."

"I would strongly recommend automating reminders. Use every channel available. Email. SMS. Phone calls. Voicemails. Every missed follow up is a leak in your funnel. Plug those leaks and the same leads you already have will start producing far more revenue over time. If you are serious about growth, this massive fix you can make."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qrb80b/none_of_my_prospects_are_answering_my_calls_after/o2mxixs/

"Going independent...suggestions? Hello! I currently sell Medicare advantage and looking to go independent for more opportunity and flexibility (less administrative work thrown on me that has absolutely nothing to do with Medicare). For those of you that sell Medicare from home: what services and software platforms do you use? Which up line do you use? Should I invest in a CRM right away or wait? It's \$75/month for AgencyBloc. Should I get the commissions processing module for an additional \$125/month? Phone system.... RingCentral is like \$30 a month and has calling and texting so I think I might go this route. Other suggestions? Any ideas for marketing to get started? I know my up line can spend some. I would like to work entirely remote if possible. Most people just turning 65 are decent enough with technology. Thanks in advance!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/17mm0vw/going_independentsuggestions/

↳ rdubbbya (2): "I'm looking to take a jump into the insurance industry and specifically Medicare advantage. Did you make decent money as a captive agent? I want to learn and train at a captive agency before trying my hand at being an independent. Is 65-70k to keep my head above water first year attainable and realistic?"

↳ Frequent-Ad8306 (2): "Thank you for the help! I think I'm going to use an Integrity partner for FMO. I'll into intulse. They have RingCentral listed but it looks like it's through Zapier so probably an extra charge. Do you use AgencyBloc's commissions module? Is it necessary when starting out? Do you use another accounting platform like quick books to keep track of everything?"

↳ [deleted] (1): "Agency bloc's radiusbob not even up on deadline day smh"

"Crm leads please share what crm your telesales agent uses. I've been selling dentists marketing tools for 14 years. I'm all in but systems are critical"

— YouTube · How To Sell 40 Medicare Policies In Your 1st Month As A New Agent · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JXevbbScVp0&lc=Ugz8BVG-uykQ5wldmZ_N4AaABAg

"newbie2001 said: Hey everybody, thought i'd put this out here for general discussion and to share my thoughts. We all know what a Medicare renewal pays, approximately \$300 per year. To gross \$90,000 a year you need approximately 300 clients, then you have business expenses like marketing/leads, office space, CRM, and other general business expenses. I understand those things are the cost of doing business but a small office space could easily cost you \$6,000 a year. My point being, that even if you were to say achieve a remarkable client base of 1,000 individuals you're only making \$300,000 a year and having to service all of these people. Then factor in churn of 10% a year between switchers/death/moving/adverse events. Now you're needing to still add 100 additional new clients a year just to keep pace. Now while \$300,000 is nothing to scoff at it takes a lot of time and resources to even reach that 1,000 client mark in the first place. Then at that point you ask yourself do I need to hire staff to help handle renewals and service calls? Another expense. I was brought into this business in a MLM life only outfit and sold the dream. It just seems almost impossible to scale your way to \$500,000 \$600,000 \$700,000 \$1,000,000 a year without becoming some faceless call center. With overrides going away you can't really hire 1099 agents anymore and collect a small override on there book either. Is there anyone here with a large book (500+) who could give this situation some clarity? I don't want to work a salary job my entire life but when you look at cost of acquisition + how many people it takes to make a decent living it makes you wander. Click to expand... questions what are you making at your w2 job per year, 2. Why do you need an office? I will say this with all of the changes coming in 2025 in terms of agent comp it will become harder to make the same amount of money, if I was starting over I would build my aca book as big as I could, most people don't understand that there are more people on aca plans than Medicare"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Does anyone really get "rich" selling Medicare · 4 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/does-anyone-really-get-rich-selling-medicare.113372/#post-1494949>

"I started at 24 years old and just started my agency exactly a year ago after 12 years of being a captive agent. I would suggest you don't rush to any conclusions before thinking them over. Everything sounds great what you said, but not that easy and very expensive. I made a substantial investment in purchasing direct mailing equipment to create leads at cost for my agents. I pay for all leads and I still have agents not wanting to "work" and complain the leads don't work. I have over \$55k worth of direct mail equipment that will "handwrite", insert in envelopes, and apply postage. My costs for postage, mailing permits, CRM software, scrubbing software, etc are about a Mercedes car payment. I recently ran the numbers and cleared profit working on my own. I think I'm going to focus on myself working in the field and sell my direct mailing services to agents with other agencies that want to follow what I do to offset my costs of operation. My suggestion would be for you to find a good FMO/IMO as an agent first. Build your business in a year and decide to take on new agents. I show my 1099 to prospective agents to show them to follow my lead and everything I do."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15nmmk7/how_to_start_an_insurance_agency_imo/jygguy7/

Facebook groups, social media and content · 97 documents · 20 voices

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crd=11ZYLHHA0VSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&sprex=how+to+win+friend%2C266&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_5?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: | Industry | Description | | --- | --- | | Tech | You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. | | Med | You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in *The Pursuit of Happiness*. | | Finance/Insurance | You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. | | Hardware/Construction | Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. | | Cars | You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. | | Door to Door | Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. | | So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. | JOB TITLE | PAY RANGE (Salary) | PAY RANGE (OTE) | DESCRIPTION** | | --- | --- | --- | --- | | SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) | £25,000 - £40,000 | £50,000 - £80,000 | Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. | | SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive | £30,000 - £60,000 | £50,000 - £140,000 | Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. | | MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive | £40,000 - £75,000 | £60,000 - £150,000 | Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. | | ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive | £50,000 - £100,000 | £70,000 - £250,000 | Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. | | SALES MANAGER | £60,000 - £120,000 | £80,000 - £200,000 | Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. | | MD: Managing Director | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. | | HEAD OF SALES | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. | | Terminology | Description | | --- | --- | | Cold call | When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. | | Lead | This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead'', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. | | Account | This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. | | Contact | This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. | | Example of a lead, a contact and an account. | Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

↳ vitaferox (58): "This was excellent advice for getting any sales job, honestly. And too many people skip those basics"

↳ titan623 (18): "I could kiss you right now. I've been a long time lurker and seen/saved a ton of great info for the job search, I've been meaning to sit down and organize it all. This is a SUCH a resource, especially with the concise examples, perfect for referencing. Thanks for putting this together."

↳ TheUneducatedPotato (14): "To add something that helped me land my new sales role: if you're asked to give a presentation like a 30/60/90 day plan, bring a paper copy in those cheap presentation folders. Give them out before the presentation so your interviewers can take notes. I had to fly across county to a hotel where they booked a conference room and guess what, the projector didn't work that morning. No worries. I had the power point, printed two slides per page, in a presentation folder, ready to go. Both interviewers were stunned with my fore thought and it saved me from having them crowd around my laptop looking over my shoulder. It's the little things that show you're thinking ahead."

"8 Tips for New Agents to Sell Insurance Successfully Below I've compiled a list of 8 strategies imperative for new agents to execute on, if you want to see success selling insurance, regardless of the agency, niche, or product you sell. Here they are: # 1. Clear the Calculator Selling insurance is largely a mental game. In other words, you have to keep your emotions and focus in check at all times. This means you must not allow distractions from your personal life or sales calls gone sideways to affect your mindset. Here's some tips that have helped me stay mentally sharp: * Treat every sales call as a fresh start. Getting rejected on one sales call doesn't mean you'll get rejected on the next. * It's helpful to think of your clients rejecting **your offer**, not you. The rejection is business, not personal. * Maintain balance in your personal life—exercise, eat well, and manage relationships. Mental clarity fuels sales success. # 2. Eliminate Distractions Selling insurance is great, but especially those who sell remotely, it comes with endless distractions. To stay focused: * Set clear boundaries with family—work time is **work time**. Make sure your spouse and kids respect this. * Keep your phone muted and out of reach during work hours. Group your texts and calls to a scheduled time. Most of them can wait. * Social media and internet use while you should be selling kills productivity. Consider a low-cost app like Freedom.to limit internet access while you should be working. # 3. Prioritize Activity Over Everything Activity leads to "app-tivity." In other words, tracking your numbers is critical to uncovering opportunities to improve your results. Try tracking these metrics daily: * **Connection Rate** — How many people are you actually getting to pick up the phone? If this number is low, explore dialing technology that helps keep your number off the spam- and telemarketer-likely lists. I like Convoso and Kixie. * **Quality connections** — How many conversations last longer than two minutes? If you're having trouble keeping your prospects on the phone, work on your opening script by practicing objection rebuttals until you can say them on the fly without hesitation. * **Closing rate** — How many policies are you selling compared to presentations? If these numbers are low, adjust your strategy. Retrain your scripting. Success is a numbers AND a skill development game. # 4. Master Your Scripts and Rebuttals The best agents **sound natural** but follow a proven process. If you don't have a script, you're winging it! And winging it doesn't work long-term. A good script consists of the following: * A strong intro that overcomes initial objections while simultaneously helping the client remember that they in fact requested the information you're calling about. * A handful of effective fact-finding questions that help build value and urgency to buy what you're selling. * A good list of underwriting questions that help you figure out which product works best. I like using Insurance Tool Kits for life and final expense policy sales. * How to close confidently. # 5. Stay Consistent with Your Schedule Consistency wins. The more you treat your profession like a job, the better off you'll be. I recommend the following: * Set a fixed start and end time every day. Stay disciplined to this as much as possible. * Avoid checking email or social media during work hours. Schedule a time before and after work for this. * Batch tasks. Separate prospecting, calling, and follow-ups. # 6. Improve After Every Call After a completed sales presentation - whether you sell or not - don't just move on! Analyze what worked and what didn't. Ask yourself the following: * Did I control the conversation? Or did the prospect control the pace? Remember that the person asking questions is in control. * Did I handle objections smoothly? If you're stumbling in your script, practice it multiple times until it's smooth. * What could I do better next time? Biggest pro-tip I can offer is to record your sales calls and listen to them. You'll hear all sorts of opportunities to improve =). # 7. Develop Thick Skin Rejection is part of the game. If you get rattled after a bad call, you're losing twice. Keep moving. Instead, think about the following: * If someone hangs up? Act fast and dial the next lead instead of ruminating. Don't spiral out of control! * If a prospect is rude? Probably like that with everyone. Don't take it personal. Next! * If you get 50 rejections in a row? Think: a sale is that much closer =). # 8. Work Smarter, Not Harder Successful agents **leverage** tools and systems to increase efficiency: * Use a CRM to track leads and follow-ups. AgentCRM is a pretty good CRM to start if your agency doesn't provide it. * Automate tasks where possible such as a chat bot to speak with your leads. Or use a compliant powerdialer to speak with more prospects faster. Again, I like Kixie and Convoso. * Constantly refine your approach based on data. Hope this helps =)"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 84 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kfmhbp/8_tips_for_new_agents_to_sell_insurance/

↳ hawkwood76 (11): "Love it. I will only add If it isn't on our calendar, it doesn't exist."

↳ CGWInsurance (5): "Congrats on doing this for new agents. Extremely well written. I would have put thick skin at either 1 or 2. Seen many leave this industry who rocked everything, but just took everything that was said to them personally and they had to quit for their own mental health."

↳ DavidDuford (2): "Appreciate it. Selling insurance or doing something totally performance-based is not for the faint of heart."

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

↳ 3xploringforever (16): "As a lawyer, the insurance MLM industry ENRAGES me from several angles - scam insurance, misclassification of workers, unconscionable contracts signed under duress with obscenely one-sided and binding arbitration clauses, abuse of telemarketing practices, fraud/misrepresentation, toxic hustle culture, wage theft, tax theft and UI avoidance, exploitation of desperate people seeking the "American dream," I could go on."

↳ dillydeli1 (14): "Totally believe this, thanks for saying it outloud."

↳ iBaires (11): "Don't forget literally tens of thousands of TCPA violations every day lol"

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

↳ Legio-V-Alaudae (45): "If it was so easy and well paying, they wouldn't have to advertise the hell out of the jobs. I'm sorry you didn't have a healthy amount of skepticism when conducting due diligence."

↳ Candid_Worth_3629 (25): "Did you not ask for any advice from this subreddit or do any research prior to leaving your 9-5? Everyone would've told you to keep the main job and start out part time. It's also really important to be at a place that doesn't make you churn \$ for leads. Most are MLM schemes"

↳ jordan32025 (20): "Anyone who doesn't understand that AP written is not the same as the commission percentage shouldn't start a life insurance business. Also, going into it thinking it's a "job" is recipe for guaranteed failure. There is some financial literacy needed. This precisely why I don't recruit people who are not already actively selling consistently with a good carrier. They already know how to run a business."

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

↳ This-Armadillo9741 (7): "I've been wanting to share this insight for a while but never got the chance to. If you're considering being a life insurance agent- Specifically if you're considering working for globe life or American Income Life insurance (that was my run off branch) I'd like to offer you the most transparent what to expect in terms of your pay since I don't see anyone else being blunt with their numbers. I worked for AIL for 3 years from 2019 to 2022. on average my salary was around \$60-\$70k a year. With that income I was typically working 10 to 12 hours a day on the phone 7 days a week and attending weekly (and sometimes daily) training calls with my "team". I didn't do the recruitment side of the business, just the insurance hustle (I know this is where a lot of people are going to point out that THAT IS WHY I DIDNT MAKE AN EXTRAVAGANT AMOUNT PF MONEY) but let's be real, I didn't my my insurance liscence to recruit other people trying to get their insurance license, I did it to swell insurance. When you see that people are making"\$100k a month" or "\$MILLIONS a year" know this. If I sold a \$10,000 life insurance policy (which is a very minimum, basic, but affordable policy) I made \$55 in commission. with a \$1 residual pay that I would receive the following month. HOWEVER, when we hop on calls at the beginning of the week it would be announced that I "MADE" \$10,000 (completely untrue) and to capitalize on this they always ask "how much of that amount do you get to keep" to which you are trained to respond by saying "all of it" pretty manipulative too the new people huh? but we take what we can get and convince ourselves that if we just do that 10x over we'll eventually have what would look like a 'good check' here's the kicker about those "residuals" after the following month of each policy, you don't get them anymore. for whatever reason they give you, those get kicked to your upper and you basically only have that one time payment to count on. so if I can give you any advice on 'residual payments' it's that somewhere in the fine line of your contract I can guarantee they're not yours to keep. they will find some rhyme and reason as to why it will go back to the company. so, for over 10 hours of work a day, you might make \$55. "oh but what about those that ARE making millions" or "you just needed to work harder" let me tell you something: I busted my ass off on the phone and my spline KNEW I had no interest in recruiting people so EVENTUALLY (we'll say after a year) I got granted some pretty good leads. Now I was finally able to make some big bucks! Without getting too verbose the average policy amount for these clients would be ranging from \$150k ~ \$500k. The largest I ever sold was for a \$500k policy and here's the breakdown for that : I got paid a whopping \$1,300 in commission and a \$300 'residual' the following month. so ...you do the numbers"

↳ jroberts67 (6): "I'm sorry for your experience, but plenty of flags and not trying to come at you too hard, but a level of insanity that there's never been a time in history where we have more information available yet no one wants to research. Group interview? Huge flag. Paying for anything upfront? Huge flag. "Releasing your license" is absurd, once you've passed your exam your license is activated by your state, not any agency."

↳ Current_Bridge_3615 (4): "Worked for AIL as well, you wouldn't believe the horror stories I got during that short time. Let's just say there's a reason they've been sued multiple times and are currently under investigation for insurance fraud."

"How I retired my wife with my insurance agency, AMA I launched my agency in 2023 after working for years as a producer, underwriter, and consultant. It started as a side project with one goal in mind, to build enough recurring income to retire my wife and give us both more freedom. Within the first year I turned it into a full-time operation using an aggregator for market access and an organic marketing system that focused on building real relationships instead of buying leads. If you are trying to start or scale your own agency, here's what I can share: • How I used social media to generate consistent inbound leads without paying for ads • How I manage quoting, follow ups, and virtual assistant support to keep volume moving • How niche markets like pressure washing and contractors helped create stable renewals • What commission structures and business habits made the biggest difference early on • How to build an agency that supports your family and gives you time freedom Ask me anything about licensing, operations, staffing, lead generation, or what it actually takes to build an agency that can change your lifestyle."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o2ysrs/how_i_retired_my_wife_with_my_insurance_agency_ama/

↳ InsuranceGnome (10): "I never spent a dime on ads. Once you pick a niche, join the industry Facebook groups where your clients hang out. Do not spam, just wait for conversations where you can add value and show you understand their world. When people start asking for help, that is when you message them directly. I built trust by sharing tips that had nothing to do with buying from me, like safety guides since I am OSHA certified. Leave your two cents on as many posts as you can genuinely contribute to. Ideally do it from a personal profile instead of a business page, it gets much better organic reach. Once you start adding clients as friends, Facebook's algorithm does the heavy lifting. It will show you more people just like them, and that is where your next batch of leads usually comes from."

↳ InsuranceGnome (7): "TL;DR: Start with one niche and master it, keep costs low, lean into your strengths, buy back your time, and focus on turning your best skills into your biggest assets. P&C Insurance. Find a niche industry and learn as much as you can about it. For me, I did really well with service contractors and kept learning one trade after another. I often read policies cover to cover. I skim some sections, but I like to get a full understanding of how everything fits together. I kept software costs low at the start and added tools only when I could afford them. You do not need everything perfect to begin. It is better to get the ball rolling and improve along the way. Lean into your strengths. I am better with social media and chat since I am a gamer and always on my phone, so I made social media my number one funnel. Work with what you are naturally good at. Buy back time when you can. If you are bad at something like AMS entry, do not try to turn a zero into one hundred overnight. Hire someone on Fiverr to help while you also improve your own skills. Focus on turning A skills into A plus skills. The things you are weak at will improve over time, but your strengths will move the business forward faster."

↳ InsuranceGnome (5): "I went with Agentero because I was not planning on selling, and I was able to get my best commission rates by compiling everything under one broker. They were the only company I found that was willing to negotiate the contract. If you tell them you want to amend something, they will actually listen. It was by far the most personalized experience compared to Bolt, First Connect, or any others I reviewed."

"Lessons from my first year as an agency owner. AMA I started my p&c agency in May 2025. For context, I posted when I first started and about half way through year one so go check those out. I started my agency because I had 10 years experience up to that point and I was tired of working for others and following their lead when I knew there was better ways to innovate and bring a superior experience to the clients. So after one year, what have I learned? 1) The power of taking 100% ownership for your life and business You will make mistakes, you will have setbacks, you will burn through money trying to figure things out. These are unavoidable and part of the learning process. Don't be reckless, but know that you will not have all of the answers out of the gate and that's okay. Accept your responsibility as the captain of the ship and you will find a way to overcome the hurdles that get in your way. 2) The power of the niche In the early months, I chased any and all kinds of business. That lead to me spinning my wheels but getting no traction. It was only after I picked a lane and stuck with it (for the most part, just because you pick a niche doesn't mean you have to turn away business that doesn't perfectly fit in the niche) that the trajectory of the business shifted. 3) The power of relationships and finding your tribe Once I picked a niche, I sought out power partners that I could help make their lives easier by offering their clients a needed product and service, so the power partner actually had an incentive (not a monetary kickback, although you'll find that helps grease the wheels) to refer me because I would strengthen their core offering. Think your typical referral partners (real estate agents, lenders, etc) but also think outside the box. 4) The power of delegation You cannot do everything. Know thyself, know what your strengths and weaknesses are. Hate doing your books? Get a bookkeeper. Not good at social media, find someone or a service that is good at it. Not a marketing guru? Find one. Don't try to be a hero, find others that have what you want and work out a deal. There's many more lessons, so ask me anything."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ts41sg/lessons_from_my_first_year_as_an_agency_owner_ama/

↳ broker965 (6): "Remember that I came in to agency ownership with 10 years of experience in the business working for others, 7 years working directly next to the agency owner. So I knew the lay of the land. If you don't know the lay of the land, don't be too proud to go learn under someone. I used the last 90 days of employment at my prior firm to set up my agency. The legal structure, the bank account, the website, etc. Then I spent the first 90 days of operations finding different opportunities to get appointments. But on day 1 I had 1 direct auto appointment and access to first connect carriers. From there I built it brick by brick. It's still a work in progress. It takes time to build a business. Whatever time frame you have in your mind now, double it. And settle in for the long haul."

↳ KiniShakenBake (3): "I am also about a year Indy after ten years captive. What niche did your agency settle into? I am finding it follows my mission statement. Have you identified any such thing? Also, 10/10 on hiring a bookkeeper. Mine is \$225 per month, with another \$500 per year for tax filings, and that includes payroll and a discount on my income tax annual filing."

↳ broker965 (3): "We have two main niches construction and real estate. We do insurance and bonds for contractors and tradesmen. Property is a side of the book that I want to grow. Yes, finding good people is 🤞"

"New life insurance agent — how are y'all actually generating your own leads? I'm a newer life insurance agent and trying to figure out how to consistently get leads without spending a bunch of money. I see people on TikTok all the time talking about how they generate their own leads and don't have to buy any... but when I ask people in my group how they're doing it, I usually just hear stuff like "go pass out flyers at grocery stores." That's just not realistic for me. I've got three kids — two of them are still really little — so standing outside a store passing out flyers isn't something I can easily do. So for those of you who have actually found a way to generate leads yourself (especially from home), how are you doing it? Social media? Referrals? Something else? I'm willing to put in the effort, I just need a smarter strategy that works around my life. Appreciate any tips 😊 "

— r/InsuranceAgent · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/

↳ UnfairFloor3347 (25): "My number one recommendation is to buy leads. Not any leads, Aged Leads. Specifically leads that are 9-12 months old. Old enough where they don't get calls but need a policy or are open to getting a policy at a lower rate. The CPL and CPA are low enough to give you the ability to generate considerable revenue over a 90 day period. At that point in time you can pivot into more expensive marketing solutions or paying someone to run the marketing for you."

↳ [deleted] (13): "I looked into it and they were very expensive in my opinion. Plus it's usually some room full of very hungry people in the Philippines or someplace like that bullying people through a script and that could turn out to be a waste of time in many cases. So I bought the call list myself with certain parameters I set according to people of the ages that typically are thinking about life insurance (because they typically still have people they feel the need to provide for unlike Mrs Jones at 69 years old whose kids are all in their 40s and whose husband is typically dead. I figure if people get to their 60s or older and still have absolutely no final expense coverage it's usually either because they don't see the necessity of it or they just can't afford it. Sure there are exceptions to that but they're exceptions. That brought me to my other parameter of 40K plus income, people that can actually pay the premium. The way I see it I'll just call them myself and I'll be very direct. I won't tell them I'm a "benefits coordinator" or any other BS line. I'll flat out tell them I sell life insurance and if they have about 2 minutes I'd like to give them a quote and that if they like the price I'll come by and we'll do the paperwork in person and they can take out the policy. Then I'll tell them that I'll make no attempt to talk them into buying anything they don't want or can't afford. Then I'll pause for a second. They'll either let me quote them or they won't and then I'll move on down the list. No shady practices at all. Some people will appreciate that and may actually buy a policy. Some won't. Either way I won't feel smarmy and I won't waste several hours and x amount of money on gas driving all over the place trying to talk to people that don't want to talk to me anyway and probably have no intention of buying anything."

↳ Deadly3ffect (12): "I always hated this. "34 year agent and I've never used leads." Back when people would walk into your office to get an insurance policy. Fucking shocker, you started before anyone used the internet. By the time the industry changed you were already established. What you started with is completely different to what the insurance industry is now. Sorry, that shit seriously pisses me off. All these old timers are sitting below me on the monthly sales because they have this outdated mindset. You want to sell insurance? Buy fucking leads."

"Brand New Independent Agents This is just a rant post. I find it extremely weird when brand new agents want to be independent but also expect everything to be given to them. The entire point of being independent is that you are the OWNER of YOUR business. If I decided to open to a floral shop, I would have to pay for inventory, supplies, a website, marketing, and anything else that I needed to run my business. I'd be responsible for going out and marketing myself & my business to attract customers. I wouldn't expect to make money if I was only open for a couple of hours a few days a week, because no one else is giving me a paycheck. And if I didn't know how to run a business, I would find someone who could give me the play by play. Not just someone who said they could, but someone who had proof they'd done it. Insurance is no different. New independent agents are constantly complaining about back office fees, that their IMO doesn't provide them free leads, being 1099, and having to actually bust their ass to make money... and after putting forth half ass effort, blame their agency or upline for not making money. If you want a paycheck, to clock out the same time every day, and someone to provide you leads, GO CAPTIVE. This is why most new agents fail because they saw someone on TikTok that told them they could make \$20,000 in a month. Which is POSSIBLE, I have seen it, not fresh out the gate. You don't even know what you're doing yet! And honestly, you already need to have money put back to carry you in the beginning months until you start to make money... that's where you need to start anyway. This isn't a get rich quick scheme. It's a real business that you have to put real work into."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tnmhue/brand_new_independent_agents/

↳ One-Stranger-6894 (12): "I have some 1099 agents that I furnish 90% of their leads, office space, phones, tech, marketing etc and they'll call me cheap for not covering their game of golf etc. Like, some of these people would never make it on their own from scratch like many of us had to do."

↳ WillBe-TheAgent (5): "It's a different generation. And I also think it has a lot to do with the false advertising on social media and bad groups out there selling 20 year olds a dream that they can make 6 figures in 3 months. Bring back door knocking, Walmart tables, and cold calling from a phone book. Lol. Jk. But they surely wouldn't have survived that"

↳ howtoreadspaghetti (5): ""If it has 1% to do with work or is adjacent to work then it should be fully covered by work otherwise I won't do it." It's a really stupid way to act and believe."

"How Keyboard Warrior Marketing Built My Commercial Book Faster Than Ads Ever Did I wanted to share a prospecting approach that has been huge for me, especially with small commercial accounts like pressure washers, lawn care, and other contractor niches. I call it **Keyboard Warrior Marketing**, and it is about showing up where potential clients already spend time online and leading with real underwriting insight instead of a hard sell. The workflow is simple. I join industry Facebook groups using my personal account, I watch for posts where people talk about pricing or ask coverage questions, and I jump in with quick risk checkups, not full quotes, just a few smart questions like what is your day to day, any employees, roof work, vehicles, or subs. It positions you as the expert and builds trust right away. After the comment I like and add the original poster and anyone else engaging. Over time Facebook starts suggesting me as a friend to more people in the same trade, which creates a passive lead funnel. From there I message when it feels natural, I quote small general liability policies in about five to ten minutes, I send PDFs and payment links so they can buy at their own pace, and I follow up one week, one month, and one quarter later if they do not close right away. It has been a steady stream of warm leads without ad spend. If you are an independent agent who wants to break into commercial, or you are tired of cold calls and expensive ads, this is worth trying. I am curious if anyone else here has been using something similar, or wants to share scripts and messaging strategies that work."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o1c6iq/how_keyboard_warrior_marketing_built_my/

↳ Monskiaactual (5): "this organic marketing sometimes call engagement marketing, it works, i used it early on in my mortgage career when i didnt know how to work leads two things. 1. It takes a fair amount of time and it is not inherently scalable.. there is only so people you can engage with 2. Its a unique skill set, not everyone can do it. but if you can do it and do it seriously you can get good business . Congrats!"

↳ InsuranceGnome (4): "100% it has pros and cons but it is free and generates revenue at \$0 cost, just time and sweat to grow is a good deal."

↳ InsuranceGnome (2): "You should consider finding yourself a virtual assistant who can buyback time and duplicate yourself in some of these tasks as well, I personally found a VA on Free Marketing was a better return then Paid Marketing funnels. I had a 50% to 60% margin with staffing cost with VA's averaged out over time."

"Beware of MLM structured companies (warning) So this was originally a response to a comment on this sub, but I see a ton of new people coming into insurance, (speaking to independent guys here) and there are many many hungry wolves waiting to recruit these naïve noobs and make a profit. So, I figured I could make a post using some of the content from my previous response to explain the caveats and expose the reality of these places. I come from a MLM originally, it was unbenounced to me at the time, but I'm still grateful because it gave me a first hand glance at what goes on there. How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. They will push you to build a team, because hey, don't you wanna make 6 figures "bro"??? Well then you gotta build a huge team so you get all those overrides off the guys under you. Now, there's nothing wrong necessarily with building a team, but in a MLM context and the way they act in a deceptive manner it is extremely unethical. The guys you see writing 100k plus in premium a year??? A fraction of that fell of the books and was a chargeback, then that guy like all of us has to pay taxes at the end of the year. He also probably was buying \$500 worth of leads a week. Burned gas every day meeting clients. He *maybe* profited 40k that year, and that's being generous. But as long as they can show boat how much premium they're writing a week? A month? A year? Then shove the rhetoric down new guys throats, boasting about how they too can make 100k a year? Then they're all good. I found out through a credible source, as well as David Dufford (has a youtube channel, good tips and insight for insurance) that alot of these "top producers" buy the trips that you can win with insurance carriers for writing a lot of AP. They do all of this and sugar coat their actual earnings because you'll buy the dream, go sell sell sell, and the guys above you get all the overrides off of you without investing any of their money into you at all. It's a fucking amazing model for the guys at the top to make a killing. They create a strong sense of family at those places to keep you on board as well. They push shitty products like Americo a ton too, because they get higher commissions off of that. Americo is also pricey, and you can easily find a cheaper product for that senior to actually help them out, but more than likely they won't have many cheap options that actually are economical for the client, because then you, and them get a lower commission. So MLM's will typically encourage you to get a higher premium out of the client and force a pricey carrier on them. Hope this helps. Reputable, ethical IMO's that offer you high commission contracts and don't push you to build teams are harder to find, because they don't market and recruit. Join an insurance forum, those guys are veterans and a lot of the IMO/Brokerage owners are members there. I've been in Life Insurance for a while now, and am branching into Health/Medicare, so anyone can feel free to PM me with Life Insurance questions if you'd like. Also it would be cool to maybe post any experiences you've had with these types of organizations."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/n4hblb/beware_of_mlm_structured_companies_warning/

↳ pdxoss (6): "I hate MLM too but if someone is making 100k and paying for leads/gas, taxes etc. Their take home isn't 40%. They're going to write off marketing expenses, gas, and everything they can on taxes"

↳ coreyjacrispy (5): "Haha, not specifically, they are are a known MLM company though. Them, Primerica, Symmetry etc etc. Anytime they're trying to force the Kool aid down your throat, with generic phrases and lectures like "You can take this and be BIG man, BIG...you want to have complete financial freedom? Be on your own clock? WE give you the tools to do that! We are a family, and want everyone to succeed" Blah blah blah lol, rest assured knowing they are indeed a MLM company."

↳ Tahoptions (3): ">How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. That is only for simplified products like final expense and mortgage protection. Street is no where near 120% for most traditional products. It is much closer to 85-100% (for term/GUL/IUL) and even lower for permanent products from big mutuals like Guardian and Mass. The post is a good warning though."

"How to create a client list, it doesn't matter if it's cold calling or not The company I'm trying to work for requires me to create a contact list of 150 people. They said it can include friends, family, former coworkers, Instagram, etc as long as I have their phone number and email. The list is confidential and won't be taken from me they just want me ready to call when I officially start. This is a test before they sponsor my health and life insurance. I've already gone through my contacts, social media, and friends, but so far I've only been able to gather around 20-40 people max. How do I go on about find more people and no I don't have any more personal leads or referrals that they could give. Edit: The company is called thoroughbred advisor, commission based and you keep your own book. Also they sponsor for series license which is my big incentive Edit 2: I have decided not to take the job after reading all the comments. I should instead just get my basic licenses and market myself better. This way I actually have a strong foundation. Thank you for everyone sharing their opinions"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r2emia/how_to_create_a_client_list_it_doesnt_matter_if/

↳ Glittering-Read-6906 (40): "This is a red flag. Don't do this."

↳ qmcnam4002 (17): "They want to sell to your contact list for you and call it "training""

↳ Glittering-Read-6906 (12): "It's because they are using OP as a free source of leads. It's an immediate red flag to me."

"And find a solid lead source. I run my own ads on social media, and buy aged leads (30+ days) from USA Life Leads to help fill my day. I've wasted sooo much money on leads. More does not equal better.."

— YouTube · My BIGGEST Advice To A New Life Insurance Agent! 🚀 #insurance #insuranceagent #insurancesa · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AGiTFBC4oSM&lc=UgzcN16DCaTdKHMfYlB4AaABAq>

↳ @franko8572 (1): "Hi. About to be licensed. Where do you find your leads?"

↳ @DiabloPollo (0): "@franko8572 I run ads on social media, and also use usa life leads. One of their packages is 100 leads for \$175, so I do 1-2 of those a week. Just depends on my schedule and how many leads my ads are pulling that week."

"As an Independent Broker, what is the best way to generate leads? I recently got my Life & Health license in NY and I am trying to figure out how to structure my business ONLINE. I've been appointed with several carriers over the past few months. My background is in marketing, specifically Ecommerce so I have a solid understanding of running Facebook ads. However, I am having trouble pulling the trigger and actually getting started due to trying to figure out all of the rules and regulations. Analysis paralysis. I plan on pumping out quality content on my website and socials both of which are not yet created. As an Independent in NY, my business name is my first and last name. Does my domain name and socials have to be my first and last name or can it be something random like "High Creek Financial", for example? I guess I am having trouble with establishing my brand identity. Should it be ME posting content and interacting in the community or should it be "High Creek Financial". I'm apprehensive to just use my name for my brand because it will make me appear like the one man show that I am. My thoughts are that if I was able to use "High Creek Financial" for example, that it would give off the vibe that I'm with a big, legit company. I don't know if any of this is even making sense so I apologize in advance. As I'm writing this, I keep thinking to myself, "wtf am I even saying?" Should I do something like this: <https://www.marblepay.com/> and be in the background or should I just use my personal brand and not care that people will see that I'm a one man show? If anyone has any experience with generating their own leads, could I pick your brain a little bit? Thanks!!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 18 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fj86x3/as_an_independent_broker_what_is_the_best_way_to/

↳ General_Let7384 (9): "1. You are a one man show. why pretend to be something you're not ? 2. if you think it's bad to be a one man show, then maybe add another man or 5 ? 3. Do you want to someday have a big legit company ? Maybe you can partner with an established one man show. The personal /business relationships you build are the source of your income. That takes place one-to one. You might prefer to be the marketing guy and let someone else write the business."

↳ Wide-Holiday9430 (5): "All your questions make sense, my experience is no one cares about your name as an Indy broker. Dial in on the type of business you want to niche and marketing becomes easy. Life insurance is sold not bought. I would suggest working somewhere to make mistakes on someone else's dime unless you have a nice fund to carry you for a year. It will take you 2-3 years to hit your stride. This is my advice experience from the P and C world and watching other L and H people build their business. Look into Medicare good returns and lots of leads from employers."

↳ Superb_Advisor7885 (4): "The reason is because your model is hard to scale. It's hard to hire sales people and give them enough lead volume to recreate success."

"Is selling life insurance what everyone makes it out to be? All over my social media page I am seeing 20 years olds post that they are making 10k or more a month by selling life insurance. I know that there are chargebacks, buying leads, and its commission only, but is it actually worth getting into? I feel like all the companies are MLM's and that they are only posting this content to recruit people to join."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1t35kdo/>

↳ (0): "No. Not saying don't attempt, do it, try to it, or that you couldn't achieve that level of success. But what your asking about. No"

↳ (0): "I'm gonna just go a step further and say don't do it, don't try it. Just my 2c"

↳ (0): "The truth is over 90% don't make it. That doesn't mean you can't be successful. There are many options. You can go independent and have a business or you can work for a company and be an employee. There are different lines you can sell. What you see advertised is the dream. The top few percentage of people make it to that level. It's not easy. I would suggest talking to actual agents. Possibly shadowing. Nothing wrong with starting as an employee and get a major company to pay you to get licensed and learn on their dime either. It depends on your personality, your drive, and what you're looking for. If it was easy, everyone would do it. It has one of the highest failure rates and it's also a career that makes the most amount of money. No one says, when I grow up I want to sell insurance. Like most finance careers, people do it because it's one of the easiest entry level careers that can make a lot of money."

"When Integrity Collides With the Insurance Industry # When Integrity Collides With the Insurance Industry After a year as a licensed Life, Health & Accident insurance agent—with certifications in Medicare, Fixed Annuities, and Long- and Short-Term Care—I find myself disillusioned, but not defeated. I've worked with three agencies in twelve months. On paper, that looks like instability. In reality, it tells a much more uncomfortable story about how our industry often operates—and who it quietly pushes out. # The First Lesson: Sales Without Suitability My first agency offered free leads, a platform, and a fast track into final expense sales. What it also offered—though less transparently—was pressure. Pressure to sell without first asking whether clients had the financial capacity to participate at all. Pressure to push forward even when something felt wrong. I voiced my concern early. I was clear that bullying tactics and financial assumptions were not how I wanted to serve families. Insurance, after all, is meant to protect people—not corner them. That discomfort was my first warning sign. # The Second Lesson: Knowledge Without Direction The second agency was rich in information and poor in application. Training was constant. Zoom calls filled my days. Education was abundant—but clarity was not. At one point, I asked what I thought was a simple question: "Out of over 250 life insurance policies, which ones should I focus on when serving clients?" The answer was blunt: "Read them all and figure it out." Eventually, the trainings did help. But what was missing was real-world guidance—how to connect authentically with people, how to build relationships beyond vague social media posts that thousands of agents were already making with little return. Knowledge alone does not serve families. Applied wisdom does. # The Third Lesson: Ethics Versus Politics The third agency was captive. The training was solid. For the first time, I learned how to identify real markets and pursue them responsibly. But there was a problem—one that went far deeper than sales technique. A field agent, protected as the "golden child," consistently wrote bad business. Junior agents came and went. Clients were placed into policies that should never have been written. Accountability never traveled upward. When I raised concerns—concerns later corroborated by other agents—I became the problem. When a longstanding nerve issue flared and I was forced to work from home temporarily, the support others received quietly vanished for me. Where teammates had appointments covered during health or family crises, I was left alone. Eventually, I was let go—for "not taking my business seriously." Within five months, nearly everyone on that team was gone. # What This Taught Me I've been told I'm too honest. Too nice. Too much of a "Girl Scout." But here's what I know to be true: insurance done correctly can be a family's saving grace. It can create stability, preserve dignity, and protect generations—*if* it is written with intention, education, and suitability at its core. I believe clients deserve: * Clear explanations of what a policy **can and cannot** do * Solutions aligned with their actual income and goals * Time to understand, not pressure to comply * Guidance that considers today *and* tomorrow That shouldn't be radical. Yet too often, it is. # The Question I'm Asking Now Is there an agency that believes insurance should be built for generational impact—not quick commissions? An agency that values education over hype. Integrity over volume. Long-term relationships over short-term wins. I'm still here because I believe in this work. I believe in serving people honestly, even when honesty slows the sale. Especially then. If that makes me a "Girl Scout," I'll wear the badge. Because families don't need more salespeople. They need advocates."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1q6lb33/when_integrity_collides_with_the_insurance/

↳ Bendstowardsjustice (8): "AMEN! i have been on a similar journey. i left my last IMO after i had a "wait a second, am in a cult?" realization. it was led by a psychopathic narcissist, so that was the culture. like every psychopathic narcissist, there was the underlying truth and there was the surface of the mask and when in it, it can be hard to tell the difference. the surface mask was, "we are here to help people, we are here to support each other, we are so special". the underlying truth was that it was an MLM style parasitic predatory organization whose leadership was all about grabbing the money bag and draining as much blood from as many people as possible whether they were agents (through low commissions and crazy overpriced junk leads) or clients. they preyed on the vulnerable, the leader surrounded himself with women who had backgrounds in drug addiction, trauma, abusive parental and romantic relationship histories. later on i learned from women who had left that the founder/leader was sexually predatory and pressured women there to sleep with him by making them feel indebted to him for "saving" them. i was banned from my cult's group chat bc people asked me for help with better lead sources bc i was shooting up the leaderboard while everyone else was struggling so i shared some sources i was using and succeeding with. they punished and smeared me for that. so i left with 2 other top 10 leaderboard agents and started my own agency. several other top agents left to join other imo's at the same time we left. my old imo started me at 60% commission levels and 45% for GI. i start people with zero experience at 75-90%. my cult IMO charged \$27 per callback data lead that they made bank on. i offer leads that i make zero dollars on and it is pay per presentation for \$25 with a 20% min close rate promise (i'm closing double that rate and i am not an elite closer), not pay per lead who doesn't even answer the phone. cult imo was recruiting like 50 agents per week. we don't run recruiting campaigns and limit our growth according to how many leads we can provide our agents to make sure everyone is well fed. my cult IMO preached "only 8% of agents make it" but at my agency we make it our problem to solve if a full time agent is not writing at least \$15k AP per month. my cult IMO punished people for leaving, smeared them with made up lies, would call the new uplines of people who left to try and blacklist them. we have an open release policy and would always go out of our way to make any transition out as friendly and peaceful as possible. there are good IMO's and agencies out there. i can recommend some if people are looking."

↳ OdteSPYFDs (8): "Pretty much everything in commercial insurance, especially for middle market or larger. The larger the insured the more buttoned up their operation is usually."

↳ Time_Care_102 (4): "Love this. I think I have found success in insurance bc I am not here to misrepresent. My words are a check you can take to the bank every time, that account will never run out. My entire operating system: under promise over deliver. I too work with a golden child agent and know the second I start any conversation about the impact to others within the company, the customers, and our reputation I too will likely face being forced out and seen as the problem. Already dealt with it before once. If you find that unicorn company- I will leave the moment I know what company that is and apply until they take me. Don't ever stop doing the right thing."

"Lead Generation New Agent, started in Jan as a W2, VERY low base salary with a commission split and no agency marketing or lead generation happening at the firm level. Everyone is on their own. I am struggling big time on getting lead generation going. Have been trying social media but have gotten virtually nothing from this. I've also been going to several leads/networking groups, have gone to about 3 meetings each. Do I door knock at this point? Looking for any tips or guidance.....feeling very defeated. I've quoted and called on the x-dates that were available and got a few from this but that's about it. I've asked for referrals on each sale I have done. Not getting any guidance from the principle."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1shk3tg/>

↳ (0): "It's tough, I've been there. u/idk-just-a-username has great info, I agree with all of that. I have a friend who drove around and walked into local businesses cold-calling, every morning from 8am-noon, for months. He would just go door to door, ask to quote their commercial insurance, ask questions & make notes if they said yes, then go on to the next one until noon. Then he'd eat his lunch, and quote all afternoon. It took a few months, but he got to where he was writing \$100k/month in new business off those. I was more focused on personal lines when I started; I met with realtors and mortgage lenders, had 5-7 coffee meetings with them every week, and if we hit it off I'd try to schedule a time to visit one of their sales meetings at their office. Hit it off with more lenders/realtors, rinse and repeat. Refer realtors to the lenders you really like, so they want to refer their clients to you. This is how I've built my business; it's a great way to go. Takes some time to get going, but once you do, you're living on referrals, not cold calls. Referrals are a MUCH higher close ratio, and way more fun to work. In the early months, when I was building that up, I spent money on leads. I put them on credit cards if I couldn't afford to pay cash. I don't recommend that, but whatever. I did it. I tried Dave Ramsey leads, Datalot (I think they have another name now?), Hometown, and a bunch of others. Ramsey & Datalot were the best, but also the most expensive. Datalot are live leads; they literally transfer them to you. There's a commercial insurance version of this too called Tivly; they're worth looking up. Any leads you buy will be expensive, but if you need to manufacture some business quick, it can work. There are also Aged leads you can buy for cheaper than hot ones. If you work up a good Aged lead script, and you're willing to be told 'No' a bunch, they can be good. I would also sponsor events, sports teams, etc. Go to the nonprofit, talk with them, say you want to do a fundraiser, and see if they'll help you market it on their socials. I'd put out there with groups that followed those charities that I was raising money for their charity; if you'd get a quote from me, I'd donate \$20 to that charity. No obligation to buy anything, just get a quote. Lots of those quotes turned into business, because lots of them had been meaning to shop their insurance anyway, and this was the excuse they needed. Use being the 'new guy' to your advantage. I used to walk into local businesses and say "Hey, I'm new, just started out at xyz insurance agency down the road. I just wanted to stop by and meet the neighbors!" See if anybody there will talk to you, make it low key, be interested in them, ask questions, etc. Honestly, activity breeds opportunity. The more you're out there, talking to people, being in the community, you're going to get opportunities to quote. If you're not winning quotes, then maybe you need a different agency, or you need to evaluate your sales process, but it sounds like right now you just need more opportunities. Good luck! The first 6 months are tough, but this is a KILLER career if you can make it."

↳ (0): "Thanks for everyone's words of encouragement and feedback. Apparently I was a day late and dollar short. Boss calls me at 4:45 Friday afternoon to let me know he is letting me go. Said I hadn't brought any business in. I asked when would he pay the commission on the 50k+ WP I brought in and he said he didn't realize I wrote it although I sent him a monthly excel sheet. SMH As much as it sucks being laid off, it's for the best. Clearly, this office was not the right fit so now I move on. Still a gut punch, was laid off at 50 and now again at 51. Never have I experienced this."

↳ (0): "I'm assuming you're selling commercial based on the networking groups. Doing what you're doing now will only help you, about 2-3 years down the road though. But you already answered your own question. Get a list of x-dates and make a lot of calls. A new agent's greatest asset is time. You have no defense to play, no book to service. You can spend that time on social media, networking, cold-calling or doing all 3. The former 2 are long term plays, the latter is immediate impact. If cold-calling makes you nervous, just remember that you could be the agent that sheds light on a coverage gap that could have ended the business's existence, or reduce a balance sheet expense enough that they can hire a new employee. That's why we're professionals. Key to calling, in my opinion, is having the xdate. If you call in that 2-3 month period prior to renewal, they're thinking about it, they'll talk (not all of them of course). You call after they renew, it's a dead horse, you're a pest. I use Insurance Xdate because they are really easy to use and seem to be the only ones that actually have Workers Comp xdates, but at this point there are a couple options for insurance specific data. PS Feeling defeated is definitely part of the business. Just wait until you pick up a deposit check on a 500k deal only to have the check canceled b/c the owner's son is golf buddies with the incumbent...then get BOR'd on the monoline Umbrella. That was over a decade ago and I still want to throat punch that sack of shit Tim."

"Overall there's just less chatter about Medicare here. I feel like majority of users in this sub are P&C agents, followed closely by the MLM Life Insurance folk. Could just be a demographic thing. Reddit users tend to be of the younger generations and maybe the majority of Medicare reps are all chatting in those cesspool Facebook groups."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/n565vur/

"Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdotal personal experience) Jornaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use jornaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower intent.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trustd lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. ,get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer844c/

"I think this is accurate. However I think there's also a huge disconnect with many agency owners and their expectations of their employees. Yes gaining 6-18 months of experience working under someone is huge for experience. Also when someone is new and they come into an agency that expects them to do everything, from buying leads and networking to building lead generation websites and social media pages to produce more sales while retaining no book ownership and working off a half broken commission structure any one in their right mind ponders why they wouldn't just open up an agency themselves. It's also a fairly different landscape now with many more tools to help inexperienced agents. Yes they may fall flat on their face in the first year or two but many would rather do that than run on the hamster wheel of someone else's race. Most people get caught in someone else's hamster wheel easily and they watched their parents do it their whole lives and they told themselves they would never let it happen to them and that's what keep them driven and motivated to keep pushing even if it takes working other jobs too keep it pushing until they reach the pinnacles of success."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p0yu3l/rash_of_inexperienced_agency_owners/npor2g6/

Direct mail and T65 mailers · 92 documents · 20 voices

"Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdotal personal experience) Jornaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use jornaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower internet.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trusted lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. ,get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer844c/

"First off, get the MLM idea out of your head. The whole insurance industry is built upon uplines and downlines that is fully commission based. If you want a salary, you'll have to find an agency (whose commission based and has an upline) that'll pay you something fixed. Tough to find something like that for L&H compared to P&C. FE is great for upfront funds, but know that there can be quite a few chargebacks, so 30% of your commissions should go into a side-account to pay for these until you get your lead saturation up and your sales skill level established. Yes, Medicare is a grind unless you know how to cross-sell ancillary, then it's better than FE. In fact I recommend this track for newer FE agents: 1. Contract with someone that can train you and gives you fair contracts 100+% for FE and 20% for Medicare Supplements. 2. Get leads (facebook and direct mail) EVERY week in the same 50 sq mile area, and work them hard, spend 40 hours a week in the field, getting in front of as many people as possible. Build up a saturation level so that when you invariably door knock your leads and they say no or they're not home, you can just simply go two streets down and knock the guy you could never get ahold of a month or two ago. 3. Take some sample lead info and put it into a Medicare Quoting tool and find out whose competitive in your area for supplements, advantage plans etc. Start building your Medicare knowledge up. Of course, first past the AHIP so you have a base understanding for it. Just a few hours a week can help build up a wealth of knowledge. Once you understand how everything works, any changes to plans, companies or Medicare itself is easily assimilable - whereas there's no changes to FE usually. 4. Tell every lead you'll follow up with them in September to schedule a meeting in October to go over their Medicare options - because you do that too. If you don't sell anyone any FE, that's ok, offer to contact them in September for their Medicare, you "help seniors save money on their prescriptions and get extra benefits at no cost to them." If you paid for the lead, might as well get as much use out of them. 5. Selling FE sucks in November to December, the holidays. It's way easier to work with warm leads, sell them Medicare, and also increase your persistency lapse rate on your FE policies as well as bring in tons of referrals and get paid 2x as you would've just selling an FE policy. You could have enough leads to keep you busy all AEP, so that when that ends, you have a 2 week lull before New Years where you can start the whole cycle up again. THIS is the secret to making big bucks imo. Cody and Dave are good guys, Dave helped me out when I was where you were at, 12 years ago. He comes on here sometimes, haven't seen Cody on here yet."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/svjgsv/help_i_passed_accidenthealth_and_life_now_im/hxgcw8n/

"What lead vendors work for you? I'm a face to face final expense agent. I was using cheaper internet leads from integrity, social insurance leads, and leads direct. They aren't exclusive but they're anywhere from \$1-11 so I can get a lot of them, and if you dial enough you'll set up enough appointments. The ROI was great. As of recently though, they're just bad. And I've been with companies in the past that have had BAD leads before, I'm used to having to dial a lot and overcome objections, but this just isn't the way anymore. I've tried Facebook ads myself and I've come to the conclusion I'm just not a good marketer. It takes a lot of trial and error and time to figure it out so unless there's somewhere that'll give me a copy and pasted proven ad to post, I've decided it's not worth it. I'll take any recommendations on any direct mail or internet lead vendors. What works for you guys?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fmxcl1/what_lead_vendors_work_for_you/

↳ DavidDuford (5): "I'll second u/NAF1138 - just work direct mail leads. Aged direct mail leads can be great if you can find a quality distributor. Facebook leads can be good but you'll have a bunch more travel time to work them effectively."

↳ NAF1138 (4): "If you sell face to face, you should ONLY work direct mail. All other lead types are only good for filler leads or telesales. There are lots of good direct lead vendors The Lead Connection Lead Concepts Need a Lead RGI Are some places to start."

↳ dis_iz_funny_shit (4): "I've got a direct face to face method for finding new leads in the field - mortgage protection leads --- so the tool helps you find people in any area that just bought a home in the last few months. It helps you locate a phone number also about 60-70% of the time"

"Lead Generation - Strategies for Insurance Agencies in 2021 - That actually work - #1 Post This did not have to have this clickbaity kind of title with 2021 and all that, but here is the point. 2021 is not just 2 years ahead of 2019. The last year and a half have seen a shift fit for a century. A bit of back story. I started a tech platform to solve a search problem when it comes to people. Like google but very focused on people around me. Wanted to reach business owners to pitch or plain recruiting. Then one of my friends running digital marketing for Insurance Agents popped the question. How can we use it for lead generation for agencies? Fast forward after a few dozen deep-dive discussions with agents (just starting out - to multi-million ones) and running pilots with about 20 odd agents here is my summary. This includes the comments you shared in my previous post when researching this topic. My Admission: I am not from the insurance industry and therefore this is more of an outside-in perspective. That means out of depth in some areas and browsed ideas from other domains applied with a twist to shake things up. Anyways, my goal is to share and see if any of it is relevant with the goal to push it further for all of us. So, here you go. ## Top 3 strategies that people are willing to bet their money on. * Build a strong referral network. * Seminars, Lunch'n'learn sessions for niche groups. * Mailers, Cold Calling, Door knocking - Lot of effort but still works. Before you say "That depends", I agree. Depends on the size of the county, city, demographics, and blah blah. These are based on what I heard in most cases. The devil here is internet leads. When starting out, this is probably the only way and so, agencies are definitely buying leads but always looking to figure out options that have better close rates. Some even questioned the 5 odd % close rate to cold-calling. Internet leads are addictive too and very soon you may end up blowing a big hole in your budget. At least 2 agents shared, they had to take loans to cover up overindulgence. My goal was not to build this exhaustive list or even a popular choice list but to identify the effective ones and see if we can make them better. I am still working on them and running trials and wanted to share only after I felt good, but then one of you reminded me and so thought why not? The rest of this thread is a narration of work in progress. I will continue to share back updates including what we tried and didn't work. ## Observation #1 All 3 strategies required a ready cleaned-up list of target users in the community. We needed something much better than yellow pages. Explored several approaches including searching Google Business listings, Google Reviews to Facebook & LinkedIn groups. ## Observation #2 Self-building a quality list seems to pay off for a long time v/s purchased leads. I came across agencies who did some guest shows on local radio 2 years ago and still converting from that list every month. Maybe an exception but then winning is an exception. ## Observation #3 Many of the agents have been successful with these strategies when executing on their own in the early days. As they grew and added staff, no longer it was the same. Not very relevant to lead generation, but almost all agents said, the biggest challenge is recruiting. They badly need people to run the regular stuff so that they have more time to focus on business development. ## What we have done so far? ### Local list building My starting point was P&C and figured the best way to break in is through the small business owner to cover liability and then expand to vehicles, cars, and houses. While identifying businesses on Google was easy but the contacts were mostly sales and had to deal with gate-keepers. LinkedIn provided a better option to reach the decision-maker directly. This approach helped in another way. Instead of cold emails or cold calls, you could take a warm message approach. Staying away from the email noise for better conversion. Saw 3-4x better results so far. ### Give before you ask The whole content marketing strategy is based on this premise. For insurance, it may be a free review or workshop. However, to get people interested needed bite-sized value options to open doors. Sharing value stories has been effective. Currently experimenting with audio stories. The bottom line? Small business owners have to deal with lots of things and so, any help is appreciated. Local networking and playing matchmaker is being used effectively but remains largely adhoc. This is a big area to possible impact. Currently exploring online meets and maybe clubhouse. ### Referral funnel Has been a mixed bag for some but everyone agreed, this is better than others and they want to do a lot more in referrals. So, it made sense to explore ways to structure referrals with integrated incentives, follow-up, tracking, and trigger points to make it a process than people. Most of the existing tools or platforms for managing referrals are just emails and spreadsheets. They are ok for tracking but not quite enough to make it a power play. This is getting long and so let me pause here for now. I will follow up with a detailed post on each of the strategies and hacks. Meanwhile, if you agree/disagree or have observations, would love to know, including critical ones."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/p0k9de/lead_generation_strategies_for_insurance_agencies/

↳ Chewbixcube (1): "First, I love this post. Second, we are newer agency owners (wife and I,) and we are figuring out all of the marketing ideas without breaking the bank. Third, I think digital ad space is pricing themselves out as most new agency owners cannot afford this. For us, networking has been the best tool. We've spent several thousand on live marketing events that don't work at all. Our next adventure is a billboard that will be up and running soon, (much cheaper than a live marketing event.) after that, we are going to try mailers because we will be bring on another employee. Lead generation is tough when most DONT like talking insurance."

↳ linkdra (1): "Glad you like it. I did a couple of follow up posts on how to search and target with precision on LinkedIn to build that network in a systematic , month over month manner without breaking the bank. I am also hosting an open meet on Sept 23 titled "\$0 Lead Generation for SMB on LinkedIn". I am not sharing the link here to avoid breaking the rules , you can easily find it on LinkedIn under search , filter by events. It's free and we are covering detailed execution and conversion steps. I will shortly put up a post here."

"I'd personally look into medical sales. I have several friends in the industry and they're all killing it. Medicare It's very competitive and saturated at this point. Turning 65's are bombarded with hundreds of mailers, phone calls, emails, etc. Every AEP, same exact thing. 90% of the call centers arent CMS compliant. It's just a shit show honestly. On top of that...with the new CMS legislation, call centers will be basically nonexistent same with many IMO/FMO's due to the money being taken away, so there is no incentive for IMO/FMO to hire anyone since they can't make overrides."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1b3t4hx/been_out_of_the_medicare_sales_game_for_2_years/ksvi9cr/

"I set direct mail leads for 7 agents weekly... This is decent presentation... I would use full name, leave the pencil and paper out lol and don't have for a reason lol just reconfirm Don't give them a way out... Good luck man!"

— YouTube · Live Dialing Insurance Leads! [Final Expense Insurance] · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RL6Y5qig0Wg&lc=UgzyZ5VoLLQmfeLn-ut4AaABAg>

↳ @everythingtesla1635 (0): "@surreal75yt32 I'm independent. I have 7 guy life insurance agents I set for every week... its not a bad gig. I set appointments while I trade stocks."

"I'll second u/NAF1138 - just work direct mail leads. Aged direct mail leads can be great if you can find a quality distributor. Facebook leads can be good but you'll have a bunch more travel time to work them effectively."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fmxcl1/what_lead_vendors_work_for_you/loero64/

"I started at 24 years old and just started my agency exactly a year ago after 12 years of being a captive agent. I would suggest you don't rush to any conclusions before thinking them over. Everything sounds great what you said, but not that easy and very expensive. I made a substantial investment in purchasing direct mailing equipment to create leads at cost for my agents. I pay for all leads and I still have agents not wanting to "work" and complain the leads don't work. I have over \$55k worth of direct mail equipment that will "handwrite", insert in envelopes, and apply postage. My costs for postage, mailing permits, CRM software, scrubbing software, etc are about a Mercedes car payment. I recently ran the numbers and cleared profit working on my own. I think I'm going to focus on myself working in the field and sell my direct mailing services to agents with other agencies that want to follow what I do to offset my costs of operation. My suggestion would be for you to find a good FMO/IMO as an agent first. Build your business in a year and decide to take on new agents. I show my 1099 to prospective agents to show them to follow my lead and everything I do."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15nmmk7/how_to_start_an_insurance_agency_imo/yqguy7/

"Experienced Face-to-Face Agent LOOKING for an EXPERIENCED Telesales OUTBOUND Agent/Agency Owner for advise **Long Story Short:** I've been a field agent (face-to-face agent) for 13 years, **commission only**. I recently made the transition from a captive agent to an agent/agency owner last year. I'm used to making cold calls and door-knocking since I started. My previous company instilled prospecting for Turning 65 and only gave us only a spreadsheet with a name, address, and month/year of turning 65 and called it a "lead". We "bird-dog" for the financial advisors to sell annuities once we sold a product and completed a fact-finder. Their system worked, but commissions on insurance products were extremely low as a captive agent. Now I'm going on a prospecting binge when I can make money \$\$\$\$ peddling final expenses and Medicare insurance(RENEWALS) products. I'm making more money and larger renewals just sell insurance products than annuities! Blows my mind. **Problem:** I've proven the system I followed for 13 years works, but it takes time and effort since I started over (left the captive company & lost renewals) again last year. I'm now working 50-72 hours a week in the Texas heat. I'm doorknocking booking for appointments and realistically booking 8-10 per week Medicare and Life appointments. I sell an average of 2 New-to-Medicare MAPDs and 1 life insurance product per week after appointment cancellations. I've seen the trend from the "old fashion" ways to the "telesales" method after COVID. I'm looking for an agent/agency owner who has a proven method. Everyone I talked with about this works for Assurance IQ and brags about how they sell 100 MAPD plans a year. That's easy when you have inbound calls and entice them by "adding more benefits". That is not sales. That is order taking. I'm trying to figure out this telesales method for life insurance more than anything to help my downline agents. I want to get new agents making money on final expense products first before prospecting for Medicare insurance. I feel they can get a great start making money before they try my proven method to build Medicare RENEWALS. I don't want to be stubborn in my ways and learn other methods to fish. **Solution?:** I want to learn from anyone who can help me. I'm very honest and transparent. I'm willing to show you my book on Medicare business including renewals and operations. Maybe we can learn from each other if you are trying to find methods to build a large Medicare renewal clientele and sell multiple products in a household. My method isn't sexy but you will have solid renewals with a very low cancellation rate than as a telesales agent. I can get into the house with T65 and sell multiple products. I have invested \$40,000 in direct mailing equipment and could barter services if you are very useful."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/14fpiln/experienced_facetoface_agent_looking_for_an/

"Medicare Agent Needs Help Finding Clients Hello, I'm seeking advice from Medicare agents that are finding clients. I'm two years in and pretty much only have friends for clients. To pay the bills I'm working a part time job in the afternoons and evenings. I work on my Medicare business in the mornings. I have tried various things but have not gotten much traction. I have several financial advisors that send my name out with a list of other Medicare professionals when a client is a few months before 65. I have only gotten one client from that. I manned a table at CVS every day during AEP and spoke with a least a few people each day. That led to one client. I have been attending networking groups 3 times a week where we refer clients to each other whenever possible. I have had one referral and that has not become a client yet. The bulk of my clients have just been friends or friends of friends that I've known for years. My clients all really like me and feel that I have helped them tremendously. The problem is it is simply going too slowly. At this point, I'm planning to continue with the networking groups but maybe reduce to one or two days a week. I'm considering reaching out to more financial advisors. I'm considering hitting up all of the P & C folks in my area and seeing if they want to partner with a Medicare person. Reluctantly, I'm considering spending money on direct mail campaigns or maybe transfer phone call leads. I've heard such mixed opinions on those I'm not sure what to think but willing to try. I'm a bit on my own and could really benefit from the wisdom and experience of some of you that are succeeding. Would love to know what you consider worth doing and what you consider a waste of time."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kp95ck/medicare_agent_needs_help_finding_clients/

"Help me grow Hello, I've been with my health, life, accident, and sickness in Ct for about 3 years now. 2 aeps on the books. My book of business is only 80 Medicare right now. 60 of which being in the last aep. My fmo is senior market sales, and so far I've been happy with them. I have a high closure and retention rate, never losing a client, and very few that I haven't done business with. I focus on educating, and nurturing relationships with my clients. Most of this is from some word of mouth and purchased data leads. I'm starting to feel frustrated and I was hoping for help with how I can grow without lots of capital right now. I have some stuff in the works such as regular seminars in local centers, and I just sent out a t65 mailer. I'd appreciate some support and I'm open to helpful criticism. Thank you all 😊"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l4f1ur/>

↳ (0): "Another person at my office handles it, the aca is a great entryway to t65. However ct makes it a nightmare for very little compensation. I'd like to do that eventually, but not soon I don't think."

↳ (0): "You work at an agency and not your own?"

↳ (0): "I own my book and I don't share any commissions. My agency makes overrides on me and it's just a 3 man show. It saves me money on software, servers, and resources. I'm fortunate to have freedom in what I do and how I do it."

"Wow, I never thought of that—thank you so much! I've been looking into doing ads too, but I know I need a bigger budget to really test and make sure I'm doing it right. Just trying to be smart so I don't burn through money too fast. Also, really appreciate your tip about skipping the direct mail leads. What are your thoughts on telemarketing leads?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/mygqfig/

"Anybody have experience is building Facebook ads for Medicare advantage? Looking to learn how to generate Facebook leads for Medicare. How are people building out adds on Facebook or google and how do they work? I've bought Facebook leads but I primarily do direct mail. Id like to become completely remote and self sufficient within the next year"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j7g5lb/anybody_have_experience_is_building_facebook_ads/

↳ petras2019 (1): "My experience with then isn't great either I've only bought them from vendors, but if done properly I think they can be really good, I know a guy who works with diversified integrity group and he wrote 350 something medicare plans this aep off Facebook leads only. I know several other agents that hit over 150 apps with internet leads too."

↳ petras2019 (1): "Right! I think the adds are very personalized to the agent. But he was spending right around 300 dollars a day is what my brother told me."

↳ astas_demon (1): "did you ever get those rolling"

"Hire someone to run ads for you. Best leads are ALWAYS the ones you generate yourself. Obviously buying leads works; however it is not optimal. I will say that since you sell face to face, Internet leads are going to be more expensive. Try direct mail leads from a vendor, I suppose."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fmxc1/what_lead_vendors_work_for_you/ody0so/

"Oh jeez, where to even start on this one. Leads...the biggest hurdle on your way to success in sales. I struggled with a decent lead source for a while after leaving the agency I started with. They ran direct mail leads and financed them to agents...we had it made. They trained to door knock your leads and only call to set appointments as a last stitch effort. They were very "old school" in all areas of their business, but I have to say...it worked. It worked well. I was a new agent and I didn't realize how good I had it at my first agency and allowed myself to get recruited by FFL. They had all the glitz and glamour and the agent that recruited me was persistent to say the least. The lead store was so appealing to me ...the idea of hopping online and buying leads at 1/4 the cost of the ones i was using was obviously too good to be true. I would buy "instant" internet leads for \$30 each to later find out that they were over a month old and been dialed 2000 times already. I bought 3 months "aged" leads that were actually over 8 years old....it was nothing short of diabolical what they were doing to agents. They wound up with a lawsuit over it all thank God, but it doesn't make up for how shitty they were doing these brand new agents they were recruiting by the dozens. Me being the resourceful and gritty bitch that I am decided to say fuck it and do what I had learned from the beginning and door knock all these shitty leads I had bought and.....it worked. It worked well. Idk what is in the psychology of someone being at your door, but whatever it is...it works. People let you in, they buy from you, you make money and lifelong clients. After that I found a good direct mail company and just keep a steady drop going with them. I never get an objection from someone when I'm at their door holding a piece of paper with their handwriting on it asking for life insurance. I get plenty of objections during the sales process, but I almost ALWAYS get in the door and give a presentation. Take the phones and the uncertainty out of the equation and just show up there....as the real person you are....and talk to these folks. Also....sourcing your own leads is always an option. I learned how to do this and can help you set up a pipeline but I will say that it is A LOT of work and it's expensive. I'm busy and don't like to deal with all the work that goes into it so I just pay about the same price for direct mail and enjoy my time off."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mewzaun/

"@Seniorbenes Well you are running an agency and that is not feasible for most new agents because they lack the capitol to start on a large scale like that. Yes if you scale to the point you are doing then it can work, but your investment is huge when this industry has 90% of new agents failing in the first 2 years. My description is what an average independent agent will perform. Nick from Medicare Millionaire is an independent agent and works by himself. He is a seasoned agent and very good at selling yet he only sold 127 policies in 2018 and he does this full time and employs his own telemarketer for \$3 per hour and uses direct mail leads. I was an assistant office manager for a Medicare brokerage firm for 9 years and out of 10 agents that our office had we only had 2 top producers and they each had about 1,500 clients. They serviced all of their clients and they were extremely stressed out all the time especially during AEP when MA plans became discontinued and they needed to review plan changes every year for their large client base. The average agent had about 500 clients. You need to provide customer service for your clients if you want to keep them long term and the sheer amount of work required to service MA plans simply isn't worth it. 95% of the calls we got at our agency was people having questions about their co-pays, the network, prescription drug co-pays, Part D late enrollment penalties, prescription drug issues, and how their plan worked. You spent all your time servicing MA and Part D clients and this is why you can't have more than 500 clients on your own before you are forced to hire help. Having 2,000 clients yourself means you aren't providing service to them when they have issues or you are just selling Medigap. Sorry to say but 70% of seniors on Medicare nationwide have Medicare Advantage. You and I both know how hard it is to market Part C and D plans selling over the phone as CMS makes this almost impossible. You need a partnership with a carrier to pull that off on a large scale and be successful which makes you captive to that carrier. I am in this industry to help seniors, not to help some corporate insurance carrier gain market share. CMS doesn't allow you to market Part C or Part D on social media, you need to read your AHIP test again my dude."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfQtB4AaABAq.9FNCTGBfz7K9FPVNMvVfon>

Lead vendors by name · 81 documents · 20 voices

"I have no idea how internet leads are profitable, even by their own claimed results. I spoke with Smart Financial last week because I could use another source to supplement my office's quote volume. Leads are \$10 each. They are claiming a 3-5% close rate based on the internal agent dashboard results they can see. I started to build a spreadsheet out to model both 3% and 5% scenarios, using my average new policy auto premium. After paying between \$200 and \$330 for the sale, and paying my sales guy out on it, my break even would be like 1.5 to 2.5 years. 2.5 years is longer than the average customer lifespan for the internet leads we have previously written. I'd say "well, we make money by selling additional lines of coverage" normally. But the customer quality on internet leads is usually renters. It's been a long time since I've run internet leads at any volume. Are any of you actually tracking ROI and coming out ahead on these?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ucbfrx/i_have_no_idea_how_internet_leads_are_profitable/

↳ Routine-Wish-4984 (9): "the math really does not work out the way they present it, and I think most agents figure this out only after they already spent the budget the only way I ever saw it pencil out was if your retention on those customers is unusually high, but like you said, internet shoppers tend to be the first ones to re-shop at renewal"

↳ flobblobblob (9): "Carriers and bigger agencies are buying those and like you calculated, lose money on year 1 and often 2. Because they are funded or have revenue in the millions, they can play the long game. The fastest growing agencies I've seen put their effort into finding referral partners, typical lenders and realtors for personal lines."

↳ MikeTouchedMyDitka (8): "Build a website (doesn't have to be great) and do google ads. Would you rather talk to people that searched "insurance rates" or someone who sees your ad while doomscrolling"

"150 Internet Leads Bought & ZERO Sales. Just took over an agency (P&C) from an agent that sold out and since the start of the month we've been getting internet leads. I am using Smart Financial but we haven't gotten any closes on these leads or even really any correspondence. Are we doing something wrong in the office or is that just the name of the game?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vy00u/150_internet_leads_bought_zero_sales/

↳ KindlyWelcomeAdvice (27): "Internet leads are the worst, 95% of them are just people clicking around for fun while they wait for their coffee. They fill out one form and suddenly 15 agents call them in same minute, nobody picks up after that. Smart Financial leads are recycled like crazy, you're probably the fourth person calling that same number today. Try calling at weird hours, early morning or late evening, I got few people that way when I did P&C. Also check if your team is waiting too long to call, if you're not dialing within 30 seconds someone else already got them."

↳ KiniShakenBake (13): "I generate all my own leads. We spend time at local events, being interesting and fun collateral to share, and usually lace our conversations with puns and things like "have an agent? Want one?" It's so ridiculous that it works. The last one I did was a back to school event where we took yo-yos from Progressive and handed them to the kids who promised to take the saving pledge and not to walk, ride, or drive distracted on their way to school. We had so much fun! 3 hours, we got fed while we were there, and we had three of those folks call into us, asking for help with their stuff. Then we did a lunch which ran about \$8 per head, and \$10 per lead we got out of it. But they are also calling in and responding when we call them. They had to use a QR code to let me know which protein they wanted, and of course the lead was part of that. I love local events because we paid nothing to be at the first one. We talked to one of our reps to get help paying for the second (the market served is right in their pocket of happy clients) and the most recent one is one I have done literally every year for the last ten years, and is a great time, every time. Those three events, all in the last two weeks, generated about 150 leads. I probably spent about \$10-12 per lead and we actually struggle to call them fast enough because they genuinely want to talk to us. That's why they filled out the card or mentioned they wanted to talk about something on the form. For give aways, I usually have a table full of random snacks from Costco and a paper bag with a label on it. They pick and choose their snacks for the bag and we chatter about how important protection from the little stuff (hangry at work) vs. The big stuff is. And we handle both gracefully. I always have my table littered with random swag from various carriers, stuff I ordered that is agency branded, and literature relevant to the audience. Telling kids they could have a yo-yo if they promised not to drive, walk, or ride like a yo-yo was one of my favorite marketing campaigns to date. Giving folks little folders from travelers with the pockets and car accident info list was great. Travelers also has 10 minute fire audits available and I ordered a bunch of those in both English and Spanish. Those were super popular, and lots of people took them because a lot of folks in these groups were impacted by fires to homes last year. The other piece I love is travelers personal household inventory. Those are customized and I take them to every event. I am slapping a label on the back that suggests taking a video of the home alongside the inventory itself. I don't go to events with the idea that anyone there is going to magically want to become my client. I go there to let the community know that there is a great resource for good information about insurance in their community and we would love to be their agents. I have a meeting tomorrow that will likely generate about 750 in revenue, from one such event. I already told the client that they need to start teaching their kids to drive with their brains before they drive with their feet and hands, so all the kids are now "licensed side-seat drivers" who can and should ask questions, look around the car for hazards and people driving like yo-yos to let their driver know that they are there, and to mentally think about next moves and timing them, spacing them, etc. The parents love the idea of teaching their kids to drive with their brains before their hands and feet, and are sold on the kids side-seat driving. That family is going to have a great time for the next six years or so while all three of their kids get to 16. Come up with a value add and really lean into it. Make it something your community can get excited about. Improving community safety and resilience is one of my favourite things to do."

↳ jake112399 (3): "Any other recommended avenues? lol"

"Online leads Hello, been an agent for 8 years never had a good experience with online lead companies. I see most people here are active with online leads. Any life lead companies worth suggesting to try out ? Appreciate all the suggestions. Not afraid of the competition I believe it's enough money to go around for all of us that put in the work. These are the companies that were pretty much trash and disappointments for me, I wouldn't suggest any of you wasting time and money with them. A plus leads , Hometown quote, Everq, QuoteWizard, Smart financial."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dfe69c/online_leads/

↳ OZKInsuranceGuy (5): "Agent here. I don't sell leads, but I buy lots of leads lol. What type of life leads are you looking for (Final expense, annuities, mortgage protection)?"

↳ Any_Narwhal6344 (3): "I currently work with White Glove, and they do it all for me, from marketing to booking the venue and help with follow-up. They also offer a webinar that allows you to record the seminar and run it all year. My other thought is that we have 13 tax preparers in my city on 20k. I was planning to chat with them to see if they see a need with their clients for even basic information about taxes in retirement. If so, offer to host a no cost seminar and offer the preparer \$25 per person that shows. It get them extra income and get me a lower seminar cost."

↳ Quiet-Knee2142 (3): "Quote Wizard was the worst thing I ever tried..... horrible they did give me my money back though"

"How do I sign up for the ringba leads"

— YouTube · This Could Change Life Insurance Sales Forever (Ep. 271) · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=r4UBGoFkH9U&lc=UgxR5uRsBA2F57yiPEp4AaABAg>

↳ @fflusa (4): "Log into the FFL Gateway and click "IntegrityCONNECT Leads" > Create a Campaign w/ Type "Call, Product Type "Life", Lead Type "Ringba X 90 Second Direct Inbound". Send us a text to 702-766-3486 if you need help!"

↳ @fflusa (1): "@M.11-u4k At this time, yes"

↳ @fflusa (1): "As of this comment, the cost per billable call is \$55. What comp is determined by a lot of factors (your starting FFL comp, carrier product, health/age of client, term of product, etc.)"

"Sorry. I have no interest in recruiting you. Just sincerely trying to help. Understand that DigitalBGA is a competitor of mine and I still recommended them, largely because the lead sources you recommended are extremely expensive or aren't very good. Sometimes you have to do more than just buy leads to actually "get" the good leads, as most vendors who create quality leads realize the money in this business is made in agency building, not lead selling. Here's my experience as an agency owner dealing with them: 1. Datalot: Very expensive - agents working with me in the past used them and did not get very good results. 2. SmartFinancial: I've talked to agents outside of my agency who used them. The one guy was getting 50 or 60 transfers a week and paying several thousand a week. He had to have extreme scale to get decent results (think it was \$10,000AP+ weekly). My thoughts were that his results would be good on production but considering the high cost and high volume of the inbounds, would yield him a low ROI on average, which could be potentially dangerous on low production weeks. 3. Benepath/NextGen Leads: Don't know anyone who has used them. Hope that helps."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f7rwk7/best_live_transfers/lcm82b/

"Here is a list of all I tested. Life leads Caboom : See above MediaApha : 1 out of 15 to 20 sale. ROI sucks Aria leads : crap. Their Instagram commercial is in a rented abandoned office, btw Smart Financial: spent 1500 for both data and live transfers. Nothing Everquote: I bought 50, and they canceled supporting life when I joined. No sale Benepath: 1 sale out of 10 leads, and they canceled life line as well Aged lead store: You better be ready to piss everyone off and dial a couple of weeks through wrong and not in service numbers before you get a hit. AWL: data leads suck. Live transfers 1 out of 4 normally sell, but they are overpriced, and if someone lapses or canceled, it ruins the whole ROI Integrity leadcenter: This has been the best of the worst so far, but buying the bronze is no different than the diamond. They say you get them exclusive on the sale, but that's bullshit because my upline bought me some from the same states I got, and they were duplicates. Google Ads : bots. I got all these leads at \$400 a week designed by a Google affiliated advertising company. I installed Captcha, and no more leads came in Fb: mostly people browsing. I feel like they are waiting for a gift after submitting the form. Money pit. Leadrilla: I never tried their campaigns, but if it's anything like the leads they sell in the marketplace, then it's shit too. USA DATA: 50% not in service and are all cold calls Direct mail: 1 to 2% return on mailers if you're lucky and you're always waiting. I sometimes wonder if they really mail anything out. Prospect 4 agent lead company: it was good in 2021, but by 2023, they caught the same disease all these other assholes have."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mezvm3q/

"I agree, it doesn't matter who you buy leads from. I've tried quotely google ads (terrible ROI), quotewizard/smart financial leads. I would call the lead the moment they would come through. The amount of times the prospect would tell me they submitted the form online for their insurance request 2-7 days ago and they have already now purchased a different policy from a caller already was massive. They all sell you aged leads even though they all say they are given in real time the moment they submit the form or they are fake information. I think cold calling/referrals from current clients/referrals from referral partners are the only ways to truly get people. I hear of agents who spend \$5-\$10k on leads a month and write \$200-\$500k of premium a month, those just feel fake lol."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer7u8e/

"Its \$1M, but policy count is correct about 45avg/month ~25 household average. I get enhanced commissions first year. Its a grind but I dont quote everyone I come across. I have a really good idea of my company's sweet spot rates. I can also guess peoples rates with my company & competitors and be within ~5% nearly every time lol. Saves time on quoting which to me is the time consuming part. I dont quote people whom I know I have a high chance of being slaughtered. Working this way increases my closing rate from 15% to 40%. Less time quoting more time selling. Leads from quotewizard & my own marketing."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oma6hp/whats_everyones_total_compensation_for_2025/nmr46z6/

"Following to hear others input. We have been struggling with quality leads as well. And I'm not talking we expect to close every deal, but we have purchased a ton of internet leads who said that they never requested a quote in the first place (InsuranceQuotes, Everquote, etc.). We understand its a numbers game at the end of the day. But we at least want a chance to win their business, and we aren't even getting that most of the time and just spending money on leads with 0 potential."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1orzwnm/leads/nnu829f/>

"Best live transfers?? What live transfers have you had the most success? From my research the top three are Smart financial (contactability)- Lead star- Datalot- There are also these companies: Benepath Next gen leads Insurance quotes- What company should I sign up with? Any recommendations? Thanks"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f7rwk7/best_live_transfers/

↳ DavidDuford (7): "Sorry. I have no interest in recruiting you. Just sincerely trying to help. Understand that DigitalBGA is a competitor of mine and I still recommended them, largely because the lead sources you recommended are extremely expensive or aren't very good. Sometimes you have to do more than just buy leads to actually "get" the good leads, as most vendors who create quality leads realize the money in this business is made in agency building, not lead selling. Here's my experience as an agency owner dealing with them: 1. Datalot: Very expensive - agents working with me in the past used them and did not get very good results. 2. SmartFinancial: I've talked to agents outside of my agency who used them. The one guy was getting 50 or 60 transfers a week and paying several thousand a week. He had to have extreme scale to get decent results (think it was \$10,000AP+ weekly). My thoughts were that his results would be good on production but considering the high cost and high volume of the inbounds, would yield him a low ROI on average, which could be potentially dangerous on low production weeks. 3. Benepath/NextGen Leads: Don't know anyone who has used them. Hope that helps."

↳ DavidDuford (6): "DigitalBGA has solid TV inbound leads. Other than that, most suck unless you're controlling the lead generation process. Consider outbound instead. Cost per acquisition is usually way lower if the campaign is set up correctly. Plus, you can get pre-set appointments from 20% to 30% of your leads, which tend to close at a higher level."

↳ Due-Potential4637 (6): "It's DD! SMH. He's not trying to recruit you, of any one comment on your post, his advice is solid and unbiased. Annoying.... 😞"

"I'm assuming you're in a sales role. Are you getting renewal commissions currently? If you are, I'd look at what your retention rates are and what you can do to improve retention. Something that was helpful for me was that I make it a point to see every single one of my clients in person at least once a year and speak to them at least one additional time....i found that to be a good way to build a relationship and get referrals. I also found that I got a very good ROI using warm transfer leads like Tivly and Smart Financial. I had some learning pains initially, but once I figured out the filters that worked for me, they were very useful in growing my book. Something else would be to try and focus on a specific industry or a couple of industries that you like and have good carriers for."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1ntvaed/burnt_out/ngwz3p2/

"Lol you sound like a terrible person, not saying the agents dont suck and the offshore people dont suck but extorting agents smh. Use valid lead sources vetted by your company etc.. but to say leads suck is silly. We write 50+ policies off internet leads every month through vendors like everquote etc.. Use U.S based lead sources but going after agents trying to make a buck who messed up and trusted the wrong people makes you a terrible person. This is a tough industry people starting out and trying to make it should not have to deal with people like you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1saqau4/your_pal_fc_discusses_lead_generators_here_if_you/odyn7up/

"Running list of P&C lead companies to try I know this could help me as well as a lot of people in here. I'm currently looking for less expensive leads and also live transfer companies that won't break the bank until i can start generating my own leads and running off of referrals. What are you using and what does your close rate look like? I'll start: Smart financial: 3.2% Everquote: 2.6% Will soon be testing out Quotely for live transfers."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pri2ui/running_list_of_pc_lead_companies_to_try/

↳ MonkeyOnAnOar (2): "Hometown, ZipQuote, Quote Wizard, and AWL is what we have access to. I am brand new to this. Farmers gave me \$500 to "spend on leads" and I have no idea where to get started."

↳ Warm_Log5206 (2): "Let me know, I'll soon be trying out Smart Financial Live Transfers for the slow days"

↳ Repulsive_Lime_4433 (1): "Yeah its really tough to figure it out but you have to really hit the leads hard. I would start there with zipquote. Work your way up to some live transfers and look for someone to help you create fb ads so you can generate your own leads"

"We used Everquote: They promised us that the leads we were buying were people who had JUST filled out their information online because they were interested. As in, as soon as they clicked submit, we received the email. This turned out to be a lie; almost one of the people who "had just submitted a request to be contacted" would even answer the phone, let alone showed an interest in the product they supposedly just asked to be contacted about."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l101rg/internet_lead_company_reviews_my_experience/mvjjn2q/

"Smart financial and everquote don't tell you this but they sell to eachother. So many times a day I would get a lead from everquote and then Get the same exact lead 10 seconds later from Smart financial. I caught them doing this with over 700 leads in a span of 2 months. They claim it goes to a total of 3 agencies but it's a lie. It's 3 they send from smart financial and 3 more to everquote. Total of 6 agencies, maybe more."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l101rg/internet_lead_company_reviews_my_experience/mvilqdu/

"Looking for advice on starting an independent brokerage Hey everybody, Captive producer going on two years in production at SF. Licensed in P&C and L&H. Goal was always to start an agency (captive or independent) after gaining some good experience; however, due to circumstances out of my control, it looks like I'll need to make that jump sooner rather than later. I'm located in Colorado. I've averaged \$45k in premium a month with 5-7 life policies working 32 hours a week solely on internet leads (Everquote and Quote wizard, plus my captives leads that come in). Due to some personal things I've been dealing with in the past 2 years, I'd say my prospecting and overall activity has been half-assed at best. Prior to this, I worked as a finance director/Sales manager in dealerships for 13 years, so hiring, firing, training, placing loans with banks, working long hours etc. are all very familiar to me. I assume this experience should translate well to the independent world. I'm working through a business plan now and have hit a few bumps on the road. I'm planning on primarily personal lines, though I'll sell life and health incidentally and hopefully land some large commercial accounts as well 1) I'm looking at Agentero Elite and First Connect as aggregators. Does anyone know if they can be enrolled in simultaneously? Agentero has some non-standard carriers I'd like access to, but First Connect seems to be the standard as far as commissions, fees and payment. 2) I'll lean heavily on Facebook Ads for marketing, but of course plan on building a referral pipeline and supplement with paid leads to keep me busy dialing the phone. Can this be done initially around \$1500/month? Or is that spend too low? 3) Outside of setting up a commission account, PFA, obtaining my LLC, and purchasing E&O, am I missing any major components? I'm looking at different AMS platforms (First Connect provides a discount on EZlynx), but might wait 6 months or so before enrolling unless I absolutely need it immediately. 4) Goal is to end the first year with \$500,000 in premium with an average 12% commission. Hoping to average 8% on renewals and shooting for a retention around 85% before scaling and employing a CSR and an additional 1099 producer. Is this realistic? Too high or low? Hiring too fast? Thanks in advance for any answers and advice!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sav5b8/looking_for_advice_on_starting_an_independent/

↳ Torread091 (2): "Thanks for the reply! 1. I just took a look at Iron Peak and, for my state at least, it looks like they have an excellent selection of carriers. I'll put in a call to get more information, but of the 6 or so aggregators I've been talking to, they seem to have the largest variety by far. 3. I'm also calling on AMS providers as it seems the general consensus is to get that set up prior to going fully operational. Leaning towards EZlynx at the moment. Do you have any experience with their set up? Seems affordable enough and widespread enough that they must have some good things going for them. 4. I guess I should have defined the commercial account size I'd be targeting. Ideally, I'd be looking at contractors and small business owners requiring BOP, Workers comp and commercial auto totalling ~\$50k annual premium and under. I'm under the impression that over the last few years, large firms have bought out local shops in my market and their comp plan doesn't really incentivize their AM's to maintain constant contact with accounts this size. All of the commercial business I've written has been this size across a variety of industries, but the number one complaint I've heard is that the last company didn't communicate in a timely manner. That said, I really anticipate the vast majority of my prospecting to be personal line centric and gradually branch out into commercial accounts as I gain more knowledge in that area. Realistically, I'd be happy to write 4-5 accounts that size per year and increase annual production by a quarter mil in addition to the personal lines business I produce. Honestly, that's the only way I can see a pathway to meaningful scale within the first 3 years. Thanks again for the advice and the Iron Peak recommendation. Very excited to talk to them and learn more!"

↳ Torread091 (1): "That is really what my gut said. I'm not sure how these platforms all integrate and work together, so I kind of wanted to get a feel for the aggregator site/software and then find which AMS will work best for my needs. Honestly, the amount of unfamiliar software is a bit daunting, only because I'm used to living in my carriers software. But it does make sense to define and streamline process from the beginning. I guess my fear is choosing a subpar AMS, getting started and then having to navigate the transfer of info from one AMS to a better one. Although, I guess those kind of questions are probably best geared towards an AM for one of those companies. Thanks!"

↳ Torread091 (1): "That was my primary concern as well. I expect the vast majority of leads would come from Facebook Ads initially. I've got a pretty solid book that I can mine for referrals here, but I have absolutely no intention of taking customers with me, so it would specifically be people referred from my existing clients that contact me directly, a few partners I have (roofers, realtors, etc.) and I assume I'll do some cold calling on paid internet leads and in person introductions with business owners to start filling a commercial funnel. My focus would initially be non-standard home and auto; anything that needs a little extra attention, then fill in with standard home and auto from referrals and by then, I'd expect to have a funnel of commercial leads approaching their renewals. Life and health would go hand in hand with home/auto and hopefully grow quickly when commercial ramps up, ideally by setting up time to talk with their employees. At that point, I'll need to find someone that would offer an appointment for health (disability, hospital income, etc.)"

"I'm gonna say this again... There are better internet leads out there if you know where to find them. It's not gonna be a mega corp like Smart Financial... 3-5% close shows that they are recycled non exclusive bullshit. I asked a rep and she basically told me so herself. Very pushy sales tactics like your expected to just say yes... anyways. I digress. I have a lead vendor once that ran adds through radio and online click for quote, the ones that responded (75%~), my close ratio was 80%. Unfortunately, these are highly exclusive and hard to come by BUT, my point is... fuck smart financial and if you use your wits a bit and think outside the box, you can have the business come to you. I've seen it happen in a VERY beautiful way. Wish I was still at that company sometimes since I lost my book (I was pretty green about laws regarding that). But I know the blueprint 🙌"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ucbfrx/i_have_no_idea_how_internet_leads_are_profitable/ot6ab8m/

"There was a lot of hype when Caboom first came on the scene (Cody is a great marketer), unfortunately they didn't live up to the hype. I know a few brokers who had no luck using his leads. Speakeasyleads is usually a safe choice, they also have a great replacement policy and are pretty generous if leads need to be credited back. Do you have any experience hiring anyone to manage your own campaigns?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/merhkij/

"Figured I would post my thought to save everyone reading some money... CABOOM leads provides below average leads with a 20% answer rate when called 10-15 times in the first 3 days. Most of the IUL leads who answered were dead broke and unqualified. They were VERY FAR from high intent leads that were ready to buy. I should have known based on their advertising that it was sketchy, but I thought spending more would lead to higher quality leads. I was wrong. I started to focus more on buying annuity leads since this is my primary niche after a few weeks of failed IUL leads (that I thought were a fluke at the time - 60 leads total). I made the mistake of signing up for an annuity lead subscription after seeing high praise from an annuity producer I respect. I was even more disappointed with these leads. I ordered 20 leads per month for \$5000 and was told by my representative that I could cancel if I was very disappointed, but he assured me that I would have at least a 3x return on investment... Keep in mind that I actually have wealth management experience selling \$4M of annuities and mutual funds last year.... I ordered in mid-February and it's now early April and I STILL haven't received my first 20 leads. In late February, I ordered another 10 leads hoping that my lead flow would come in faster, and none have been delivered from this order. Most leads were not serious anyway and had no clue that the ad was talking about annuities... I had a similar experience on the IUL leads. I believe their ads are misleading and trick people into thinking they are getting some kind of free benefit that does not exist... I thought Cody was one of the good guys in the industry, but I'm not sure I trust him or his team. Quite frankly, their advertising is extremely misleading - "ready to buy" is garbage.m, but I blame this on myself for falling for the trap... Also, lots of other shady practices like offering discounts for POSITIVE reviews only, sending out a FAKE April fools message that they are no longer accepting new clients to trick people into buying with urgency, advertising that leads are vetted and ready to buy (all they do is respond to a text code - I'm not sure if I even believe this), and worst of all, not following through on promises. I have been unable to cancel my subscription order even though I am highly displeased and I have not even received 20 leads although I've ordered 30+ more than a month ago"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/mkvaioj/

"New Medicare Insurance agent with questions My name is Robert and I am a licensed insurance agent contracted through Cigna as my only carrier. I am interested in learning more about your leads and how I can partner with you to sell Cigna Medicare plans. I understand that Medicare can be confusing, and I want to make sure that I am providing my clients with the best possible service. I have a few questions that I would like to ask you: Can I walk a client through the [Medicare.gov](<https://Medicare.gov>) website and refer them to an agent who is licensed to sell the product that is the best deal for them? Can I make sure that a client does not have a group health plan, has Medicare, and that their doctor and prescriptions are covered? Can I explain plan benefits and costs, and compare Cigna plans to other plans that might cost less? Can I mention that another plan might be a better fit for a client, or try to compare Cigna plans to other plans that might be better for them? Can I offer them a referral to see someone who is licensed to sell the plan that may be better for them? Can I invite them to talk to me about Medicare 101 through email, then get an SOA to talk to them about Cigna? Should I just sell them the plan that is the best fit for them out of the products that I'm licensed to sell? I'm trying to imagine what my plan is, but I can't find any good scripts or guidance for selling Cigna. I want to gain clients through an email list that isn't specifically targeting Medicare and through Next Gen Leads. I understand that Medicare has a lot of rules, and I am not here to challenge them. I am here to ask questions to help me better understand how I can work with you to provide my clients with the best possible service. Thank you for your time and consideration. "

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/17j8bis/new_medicare_insurance_agent_with_questions/

↳ ImaginationNo9487 (0): "All of these questions are answered in AHIP and Cigna carrier training. If you aren't sure of these answers, I would strongly advise that you get with your up line to properly train you in proper CMS compliance. If you go out there and wing it, you take the chance of incurring violations that can cost you a ton of money and your license. Whoever is above you in your hierarchy is getting a kickback from your sales, so make them earn it by answering any questions you have about procedures and regulations."

Pharmacies, doctors' offices and community partners · 51 documents · 20 voices

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crid=11ZYLLHHAOSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&srefix=how+to+win+friend%2C&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: | Industry | Description | | --- | --- | | Tech | You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. | | Med | You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in *The Pursuit of Happiness*. | | Finance/Insurance | You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. | | Hardware/Construction | Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. | | Cars | You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. | | Door to Door | Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. | | So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. | JOB TITLE | PAY RANGE (Salary) | PAY RANGE (OTE) | DESCRIPTION** | | --- | --- | --- | --- | | SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) | £25,000 - £40,000 | £50,000 - £80,000 | Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. | | SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive | £30,000 - £60,000 | £50,000 - £140,000 | Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. | | MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive | £40,000 - £75,000 | £60,000 - £150,000 | Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. | | ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive | £50,000 - £100,000 | £70,000 - £250,000 | Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. | | SALES MANAGER | £60,000 - £120,000 | £80,000 - £200,000 | Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. | | MD: Managing Director | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. | | HEAD OF SALES | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. | | Terminology | Description | | --- | --- | | Cold call | When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. | | Lead | This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead'', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. | | Account | This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. | | Contact | This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. | | Example of a lead, a contact and an account. | Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

↳ vitaferox (58): "This was excellent advice for getting any sales job, honestly. And too many people skip those basics"

↳ titan623 (18): "I could kiss you right now. I've been a long time lurker and seen/saved a ton of great info for the job search, I've been meaning to sit down and organize it all. This is a SUCH a resource, especially with the concise examples, perfect for referencing. Thanks for putting this together."

↳ TheUneducatedPotato (14): "To add something that helped me land my new sales role: if you're asked to give a presentation like a 30/60/90 day plan, bring a paper copy in those cheap presentation folders. Give them out before the presentation so your interviewers can take notes. I had to fly across county to a hotel where they booked a conference room and guess what, the projector didn't work that morning. No worries. I had the power point, printed two slides per page, in a presentation folder, ready to go. Both interviewers were stunned with my fore thought and it saved me from having them crowd around my laptop looking over my shoulder. It's the little things that show you're thinking ahead."

"I agree with the pro of being independent and not micromanaged. Long rant but I just quit my fairly new job where I knew NOTHING. I had no experience. They said training would be 2 months.. Unfortunately, only 3 weeks in the boss kept pulling me aside literally every day and telling me I was too slow, not doing good enough, and that I should know a lot more. Then she wanted me to study at home to "catch up" without paying me. As well as the senior staff member would make comments throughout the day like "come on. you should know this already" The problem was I knew the information. It just got very difficult to focus because of the negativity. I was sweating and so anxious all day and because of that kept making mistakes. I woke up one day and said fuck this and quit. I work best when not micromanaged. I need to take the time to learn things at my own pace. I cannot tolerate negativity. My previous job was a pharmacy technician. I did it for 5 years and I loved it and I was badass at it. It made me realize that I love talking to customers about health insurance. I hope I do well as an insurance agent :D I'm about to take the licensing exam. Yay!"

— YouTube · PROS & CONS OF BEING AN INSURANCE AGENT · 122 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UfHT3xWg4TY&lc=UgwNWyFPgvNrc06hZcd4AaABAg>

↳ @ErinNogueira (15): "Best of luck Jane! Proud of you for sticking to your guns and doing what's best for you!"

↳ @nerd6646 (5): "how is it going? i'm about to do the same move you did lol"

↳ @dianaag28 (1): "Good for you, good luck 🍀 🍊 "

"Thank you, Matthew. Until I watched this podcast, I had no idea that my Aetna Medicare Premier Advantra PPO was actually provided by a privately owned company. Now it makes sense why I was suddenly being encouraged to change my pharmacy to CVS. My local CVS employees are great, but I was a happy, dedicated Walgreens customer for decades. Of more significance is the frightening information about the proven interference in health care delivery from doctors to patients based on the Inspector General's published three-year study. I realize that you earn a living as an insurance agent, but you are earning an honorable living by spreading truth and educating consumers like me. Thank you."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 39 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgyikF0_s_gj4oa98_B4AaABAg

↳ @MedigapSeminars (13): "There is a lot more money made selling Medicare Advantage Plans than Medicare supplements, by a wide margin. I set myself and my company up as a true independent, able to offer anything the customer needs. That way we can represent the clients best interest. It's what i call good business"

↳ @jleechadwick (2): "@MedigapSeminars I discovered this listening to some other videos here on YouTube. I decided to switch to original Medicare and got both a Part D and Part G (I was approved for both). I am so thankful that I watched these videos (and I'm impressed by yours as well)."

↳ @toriless (1): "Drop them! Get medicare!"

"Am I Crazy for Wanting to Leave My \$200k+ Job to Start and Independent Agency Background, I'm mid 30s, 2 kids, and I've just about had it with my extremely high stress/toxic culture job (in a healthcare/pharma marketing related field). I have a few years of savings and I'm ready to pivot my career into something more personally rewarding.....I'm seriously considering insurance! I know how to build a brand, manage CRM systems, create effective communications (the one-on-one sales aspect is new to me, but I know I can figure it out). Plus I have a solid background in many aspects of prescription drugs and healthcare (i've taken a practice licensing test without cracking a book and got a 72%, so there's more for me to learn, but a solid foundation) The idea is to start a medicare-focused agency, brand it to appeal to the communities I want to target, partner with an FMO, and begin sourcing paid and earned leads directly (this is not a challenge for me, I've been doing it in the pharma space for years). My goal is to use the next 6 months to start up the business, get my licenses and begin lead generation. I would then quit my job in time for the end of year enrollment season, see how that goes - (pick up some light contract work throughout next year to supplement my income) and then go all-in on the business late 2026 - hoping that I can be clearing \$150k+ in 2027 and back to 200k+ earnings in 2028. Over time I'd branch out into other lines, but I want to keep a narrow focus for now so I can effectively source clients. That's the high-level plan, of course there are many more details that I'm figuring out (I'm building financial projections, comparing FMOs, analyzing the competitive landscape for local agents and the large nationals...and a lot more to make sure I'm going in with solid goals and expectations) So, am I crazy to get into this world? What are the biggest pitfalls to watch out for that will get in the way of me being successful? What is the biggest deterrents for those starting out that will make me feel burnt?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jdknqh/am_i_crazy_for_wanting_to_leave_my_200k_job_to/

↳ HamiltonSt25 (39): "I didn't read everything you wrote, but just keep in mind, it's a tough insurance climate right now (Assuming you're in the US). Doing it right now would leave you struggling to get contracts. I'm an independent and almost all of my major carriers are not giving new contracts at this time. This will drain your assets extremely fast. I'd hold out until it softens up a bit."

↳ Acceptable-Tip7886 (28): "Times are tough, if you're making 200k plus I would stay and invest. Money now is more important than money later plus you'll retire sooner"

↳ HamiltonSt25 (10): "I'm sorry, let me clarify. I'm speaking as far as P&C goes. So if you're asking about life/health, I have no idea. If you're talking P&C, then I'm speaking about direct contracts with carriers/companies."

"Boots to the ground!!! It's free my man. That's how I got started 3 years ago. Go to every senior center, senior apartment, retirement homes, food banks and do table events wherever seniors show up. I have so many great relationships. I do a lot of fun events at these places. Keep at it, don't give up. After year 2, referrals start coming in, and you start seeing the fruits of your labor in monthly deposits into the bank account, just keeping your clients happy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1d5disv/turning_65_leads_medicare/16l3fuc/

"Quit \$150k W2 Sales to start an Agency. 6 Months in: Lessons learned from the "FE Trap" and pivoting to Group Health/Life. Feedback? I'm in my late 20s and recently walked away from a \$150k+ W2 sales career to build my own independent agency. I started with a \$2,000/month residual base from a previous ACA book and a small group. The Failure: I fell for the Final Expense hype. I burned several thousand dollars on my own ads, lead vendors, and a marketing firm. After 6 months, I realized the "social worker" aspect of FE isn't for me. I'm a consultant and advisor, not a hand-holder for the unbanked. The Pivot: I've officially pivoted to Group Health (U65), Individual Health, and Term Life. My daily "Machine" looks like this: • Cold Knocking: Visiting local businesses daily to prospect for Group Health. • Strategic Partners: Building a referral network (CPAs, P&C agents) for Life/Health leads. • Efficiency: Cutting all paid lead spend once current FE ads die. Reallocating that budget to BNI and local SEO. The Concern: I'm 6 months in and not profitable yet. I live in a major city and the grind is real. Thank God for my savings and residual base, but I want to make sure I'm not missing a gear. My Questions: 1. Aside from BNI and cold knocking, what high-leverage community events or "advisor-level" prospecting am I missing?"
— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rgt03f/>

↳ (0): "Insurance Sales is hard, if you don't already have a book of business. It will take a while to build the business."

↳ (0): "How long did it take you to profit?"

↳ (0): "Health biz is great, just takes years to build. Have you looked at using ICHRA to get into the door? Do some research on ICHRA if you haven't. Some other things I'd try: look for new business formations in your local newspaper and go drop in on them. Fresh meat! =) Also, how much activity are you doing? Are you cold knocking 30 businesses daily or making 100+ phone calls daily? A lack of activity is usually the cause of all sales woes. If you're looking for ways to bridge the gap with final expense, consider doing in-person seminars at local independent senior living facilities. Did those for 9 months and made around 100 sales with zero expense. Have seen dozens of other agents do well at it, too. Further, you could look at doing talks at small group church meetings, senior activity centers, about Medicare, final expenses, etc. Cost nothing and creates the best leads. Good luck. Remember it's normal that the first few years are incredibly difficult as you find your place. Stick with it and eventually you'll find your niche and begin getting traction!"

"Great idea. Favorite telesales carriers: RNA, Prosperity and Trinity. SS billing + voice sign for all 3. Favorite lead: Real-time telemarketed call back with verified checking, ages 50-79 and agrees to speak with an agent. Basically telemarketers calling on DNC scrubbed and TCPA verified data to call on (old FB leads or Journaya/Trusted Form verified) + scrubbed against TCPA Blacklist Alliance and inputting into a form to serve it up in a CRM immediately. Tip: You need proper training and sales systems to make telesales work. If you take your DM leads and try to sell them over the phone with your typical f2f presentation, you'll fail. If you buy internet leads and don't have proper sales training or sales systems, you'll fail. My advice is either partner with a telesales-focused agency with an open release policy (hey, telesales isn't for everyone) or wait it out. Don't waste any time/money unless there's a proven system in place."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Telesales Tips · 11 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/final-expense-telesales-tips.101595/#post-1344555>

"My tips: 1) Networking: I'm an introvert that comes across as an extrovert. Great for sales but I dread going to events and force myself to go. Staying connected and going to Insurance Events, opens up connections, some you may not realize for years later. Perfect example is while I'm young, I got into insurance and owning my agency at 21ish. Many of the contacts at brokerages I've made, jump ship to other brokerages. The friendship will get you an appointment where normally you couldn't have. 2) Agency Software: This one is a big one. Many of the softwares are expensive and slow. Sometimes agents, when opening their own agencies, use the software from their previous agency, with outdated tech, solely because of familiarity. I learned this lesson the hard way. Thousands a year on crappy agency software. 3) Turning 1 New Business Insured and the policy they chose to have you quote, into multiple policies and new leads. This one is big. 4) This is personal to my niche (small/medium accounts are \$100k+), and builds on 3. Offer several smaller quotes for lines of insurance applicable to your line of business the insured may not have/have been offered previously, even if you don't think the insured will be interested. "If Any" Workers Comp would be applicable for my lines of business. 5) create partnerships with other independent agencies and agents. Self explanatory I would think. 6) SOP's, and building the agency with Franchising in mind. 7) Calendar: setting up reminders to touch base on insured's. If you are coming around only at renewal time, you easily become an agent that is replaceable. 8) As an agency owner, not only having SOP's, but understanding how every moving part of your agency works. From accounting, to customer service, to certificates of insurance, and on and on. Excuse any typos (at the barber shop), but this is what I could think of off the top of my head, and while some sections are more important than others, I didn't number them in any particular order."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/oodxkae/

"Medicare agency owner here. Been full time for 7 years. Like u/geetarman84 said, getting people is the hardest part. I'll tell you what I did, but you won't like it. I do most business in person, so I've done very little internet or phone leads. I started with and still do in person seminars. I do 20-25 a year. They don't work as well as they used to, but I still get solid leads from them. Attendees are motivated and ready to shop so they're good leads. The key is getting an insurer or FMO to co-op or better yet, fully cover the cost of marketing. I used to also do Q+A sessions, and meetings at senior centers, retirement homes, large senior apartment complexes, etc. The nice part about those was if you could convince the activities manager or building manager that you were providing a service for their people, they'd advertise it for you. When I was getting started I had a Walmart booth. Also tried CVS, but those never worked for me. Walmart was boring, and slow. Literally just waiting around for people to approach. But people did. Over a 4 hour shift I'd typically get 2-3 leads. Do 4 shifts a week, and that's a decent workload, but generally not great clients. Find people to partner with for referrals. Your clients are your best place to prospect. My dad always said the magic word is "ask". Once you have a book, if you do it right, the referrals will pour in. Beyond your clients, I've had luck with financial advisors, who want to refer their clients to someone that won't compete on the money management side. I do mailings too. They are tough way to go. I've only bought leads once, and they were not great. I'd rather spend money building up my name as the local Medicare guy."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 4 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/15ksxo7/medicare/jva9z3q/>

"Average Broker Closing Rate - Is This Realistic Recently got a job offer at a brokerage that specializes in HO insurance and partners with Morgatg Services, they say all leads are high intent individuals who have just either purchased or refinanced a home and the leads are exclusive (estimated 200-275 a month). The hiring manager said they expect 40% closing rates on these leads and the average agent is doing 77k in premium. Im newer to the insurance world with only experience in captive so im a bit clueless but this just sounds insane to me. Are these realistic numbers? What are people in similar situations doing? Thanks"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1xf17z/average_broker_closing_rate_is_this_realistic/

↳ Remote-Meat6841 (6): "Being a preferred insurance vendor is the way to go with realtors, builders and loan officers. If you need a mortgage you need insurance."

↳ TX-Pete (3): "Yes. Extremely realistic with that type of referral source. I had a partnership with a national lender with my past agency I built and we'd run about 60-70% in peak seasons in the right markets. Some like CA and FL and LA and TX were problems, but everyone had the same problems so most of those deals fell apart due to DTI issues over insurance than anything else. The only downside is you are married to the RE market as a whole, which is about to flat out tank."

↳ TX-Pete (3): "RE = real estate home sales are slowing at the same time premiums are rising."

"Maybe you could find a Medicare agent in your area to partner with and turn that part of the business over to them. I work with several financial planners who don't want to take the time to do all of the trainings each year or meet with clients so they send all their clients to me. Its a win for everyone. I focus just on health insurance and they get to focus on the financial side."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fu74gk/question_for_other_medicare_agents_about_rx_plans/lpxg80n/

"I like the idea of setting up at a farmers market. I'd also look at doing Medicare 101 at senior apartments/community centers."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j6vyj8/medicare_brokers_help_me_set_realistic_goals_for/mgs5au0/

"New Medicare Insurance agent with questions My name is Robert and I am a licensed insurance agent contracted through Cigna as my only carrier. I am interested in learning more about your leads and how I can partner with you to sell Cigna Medicare plans. I understand that Medicare can be confusing, and I want to make sure that I am providing my clients with the best possible service. I have a few questions that I would like to ask you: Can I walk a client through the [Medicare.gov](<https://www.Medicare.gov>) website and refer them to an agent who is licensed to sell the product that is the best deal for them? Can I make sure that a client does not have a group health plan, has Medicare, and that their doctor and prescriptions are covered? Can I explain plan benefits and costs, and compare Cigna plans to other plans that might cost less? Can I mention that another plan might be a better fit for a client, or try to compare Cigna plans to other plans that might be better for them? Can I offer them a referral to see someone who is licensed to sell the plan that may be better for them? Can I invite them to talk to me about Medicare 101 through email, then get an SOA to talk to them about Cigna? Should I just sell them the plan that is the best fit for them out of the products that I'm licensed to sell? I'm trying to imagine what my plan is, but I can't find any good scripts or guidance for selling Cigna. I want to gain clients through an email list that isn't specifically targeting Medicare and through Next Gen Leads. I understand that Medicare has a lot of rules, and I am not here to challenge them. I am here to ask questions to help me better understand how I can work with you to provide my clients with the best possible service. Thank you for your time and consideration. "

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/17j8bis/new_medicare_insurance_agent_with_questions/

↳ ImaginationNo9487 (0): "All of these questions are answered in AHIP and Cigna carrier training. If you aren't sure of these answers, I would strongly advise that you get with your up line to properly train you in proper CMS compliance. If you go out there and wing it, you take the chance of incurring violations that can cost you a ton of money and your license. Whoever is above you in your hierarchy is getting a kickback from your sales, so make them earn it by answering any questions you have about procedures and regulations."

"Medicare Agent Needs Help Finding Clients Hello, I'm seeking advice from Medicare agents that are finding clients. I'm two years in and pretty much only have friends for clients. To pay the bills I'm working a part time job in the afternoons and evenings. I work on my Medicare business in the mornings. I have tried various things but have not gotten much traction. I have several financial advisors that send my name out with a list of other Medicare professionals when a client is a few months before 65. I have only gotten one client from that. I manned a table at CVS every day during AEP and spoke with a least a few people each day. That led to one client. I have been attending networking groups 3 times a week where we refer clients to each other whenever possible. I have had one referral and that has not become a client yet. The bulk of my clients have just been friends or friends of friends that I've known for years. My clients all really like me and feel that I have helped them tremendously. The problem is it is simply going too slowly. At this point, I'm planning to continue with the networking groups but maybe reduce to one or two days a week. I'm considering reaching out to more financial advisors. I'm considering hitting up all of the P & C folks in my area and seeing if they want to partner with a Medicare person. Reluctantly, I'm considering spending money on direct mail campaigns or maybe transfer phone call leads. I've heard such mixed opinions on those I'm not sure what to think but willing to try. I'm a bit on my own and could really benefit from the wisdom and experience of some of you that are succeeding. Would love to know what you consider worth doing and what you consider a waste of time."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kp95ck/medicare_agent_needs_help_finding_clients/

"That managing partner takes meetings all day long. If you're willing to cater lunch to the office on a day a pharmaceutical rep isn't then he and his office manager will sit down with you for an hour to hear how you can help his practice and vice versa. That's very much part of his job as managing partner. OP isn't saying hand out a business card and watch the money roll in either. He said start building a relationship with someone you're sending clients to already. I would recommend hosting an occasional lunch for the staff where you educate them on Medicare so they're informed enough to answer basic questions from their patients as they transition to it. And obviously you make sure to leave pamphlets and business cards because you're happy to help with any further questions they might have. Do this for a little while and you'll be the "Medicare guy" around the office. And, depending on your licenses, you can host other lunches about things like retirement planning, life insurance, P&C, etc. so you start to become the "finance guy" or whatever."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vg9a6q/medicare_agents_are_overlooking_business_thats/p1vpv9v/

"I am partnered with a tax office, and we have been running into people getting penalties for not having proper coverage. Most of these clients have been getting switched out each month by their telesales agents. I plan to sit with the clients on calls with Healthcare.gov and CMS and report every single one of these assholes that are doing this. The most recent one owes over \$1,500 in penalties. I am all for heavier ethics standards and stronger disciplinary action to stop agents from taking advantage of unsuspecting clients. The first step I would want to see is abolishing the tele sales agent. I feel like most telesales agents care for the clients' needs as good as they should because they don't have good symbiotic relationships with their book of business."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1bd66ik/aca_shitshow/kuo7i2d/

"Wow! Awesome video! Couldn't ❤️ it more! I do not buy leads, all grassroots hustle! I had to learn everything you just said all on my own through trial and error ..but it's critical to know how to present yourself and build those referral partners, create and do events etc. I sold 100 all self gen grassroots apps last AEP and this year my goal is 125!! I have 53 events booked ...you just got me super pumped to get out there ..., my plan is set ..let's goooo!!! And don't forget the coffee !! 🍵🍵🍵🍵🍵🍵🍵🍵🍵🍵🍵🍵"

— YouTube · How To Make \$100,000 During AEP! (Medicare Sales Training) · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gjtqnbZFWCA&lc=UgyNVhn8NjRoStitCaZ4AaABAg>

↳ @JamesSmith-b3m (0): "What kind of events are you doing? I want to get into it but not sure how or where to do events"

"No joke... Just start looking at various civic events and stuff like community fairs. I table in lots of different places. I used to be only one profession to focus. But it turns out there are some really great opportunities out there in the general public that genuinely wants to be educated. I might actually develop a workshop based on my "Learn to Drive, as slowly as possible," concept for families to have the conversation around driving and responsibility and get the kids noses out of their phones when they are in the car as a habit. Looking around at other cars and drivers to predict what may happen at the next movement. Which lights are turning next? Where will the pedestrians come from? Are any turns unprotected or are they all protected. Can you turn right on red here? Is there a bike box that needs to be minded? It's all driving with your brain before you drive with your body. Inviting parents to talk to their kids about their own driving, making the kids navigate them to school and home or the nearest whatever. That needs to become the kids job at 10 or even earlier. Which turn and when you take it. Let them tell you when to get into the correct lane and which lane that is. If there is anyone there, they should tell you that too. Obvi don't hit anyone, but let them tell you as you tell yourself in your head. See one. Teach one. Do one. A different model, to be sure, but it gets their brains used to the amount of information they must take in to be a good driver making seasoned calls, before they ever have their hands on the wheel. It addresses a lot of the anxiety I see from the kids I do talk to. And you know who makes a great family for premium when you bring them on? Families with teenage drivers. Boy are they great for premium it you can control the loss ratio. That's simply a good relationship with the insureds so they make good decisions. I also work the room at every event. I show up as early as I can and make a point to connect with other community orgs that might want to have us table. I love doing diverse community events because people who are gender and orientation diverse have a ton of questions about insurance, gender, family composition, driving, etc. When folks feel safe, they will relax tremendously and lean into everything you offer. Connecting with the community orgs that are there is how you get more invites to more community events. But don't just be collecting leads with a giveaway. You need to have a real value proposition beyond the insurance."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vyv0ou/150_internet_leads_bought_zero_sales/p61f1se/

"@Seniorbenes Well you are running an agency and that is not feasible for most new agents because they lack the capital to start on a large scale like that. Yes if you scale to the point you are doing then it can work, but your investment is huge when this industry has 90% of new agents failing in the first 2 years. My description is what an average independent agent will perform. Nick from Medicare Millionaire is an independent agent and works by himself. He is a seasoned agent and very good at selling yet he only sold 127 policies in 2018 and he does this full time and employs his own telemarketer for \$3 per hour and uses direct mail leads. I was an assistant office manager for a Medicare brokerage firm for 9 years and out of 10 agents that our office had we only had 2 top producers and they each had about 1,500 clients. They serviced all of their clients and they were extremely stressed out all the time especially during AEP when MA plans became discontinued and they needed to review plan changes every year for their large client base. The average agent had about 500 clients. You need to provide customer service for your clients if you want to keep them long term and the sheer amount of work required to service MA plans simply isn't worth it. 95% of the calls we got at our agency was people having questions about their co-pays, the network, prescription drug co-pays, Part D late enrollment penalties, prescription drug issues, and how their plan worked. You spent all your time servicing MA and Part D clients and this is why you can't have more than 500 clients on your own before you are forced to hire help. Having 2,000 clients yourself means you aren't providing service to them when they have issues or you are just selling Medigap. Sorry to say but 70% of seniors on Medicare nationwide have Medicare Advantage. You and I both know how hard it is to market Part C and D plans selling over the phone as CMS makes this almost impossible. You need a partnership with a carrier to pull that off on a large scale and be successful which makes you captive to that carrier. I am in this industry to help seniors, not to help some corporate insurance carrier gain market share. CMS doesn't allow you to market Part C or Part D on social media, you need to read your AHIP test again my dude."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABA9.9FNCTGBfz7K9FPVNMvVfon>

"Thank you for all the comments! I understand this isn't necessarily "fun" work, but after spending 50+ hours per week at car dealerships for most of the last 20 years, having the ability to make a living while traveling and spending time with loved ones is my primary goal now that my kids are self-sufficient. I also appreciate the ability to earn money through helping people as corny as that may sound, but the older I get and more corruption I see, the more morality shapes my motivations. Does anyone have experience with TAIA? They have 2 roles, fully independent or telesales broker where they pay 50% CMS commission and give you free call transfers. I don't know if they pay renewals on free call transfer leads, but pretty sure they aren't vested to you. But this seems somewhat fair overall. I realize partnering with a small independent FMO (or a few if possible) is probably the way to go long term, but to gain initial experience, learn the landscape, and start making decent money right away, this sounded like it might be a decent option to start. I do have digital marketing/lead gen experience from my time managing dealerships, but I also know how expensive it can be as they require constant testing. Spending thousands of dollars to target a landscape I'm not 100% familiar with, isn't a smart investment. So to start, I'm looking to partner with a FMO that has a successful system in place that provides ample opportunity. I'm considering speaking with TAIA to see if I could sign up as a telesales broker but still keep the renewals (and a higher %) on any self generated business. Any other comments or ideas would be appreciated! As far as transitioning to P&C, focus on Life or other lines, sure, maybe I will try that if this doesn't workout, but I have too much time, money and effort invested at this point not to give this a shot. I have 17 state licenses, E&O, AHIP & CMS FFM, so yeah..."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1shv3xs/best_company_to_join_for_agents_new_to_medicare/ofcscz0/

Appointment setters and telemarketers · 45 documents · 20 voices

"8 Tips for New Agents to Sell Insurance Successfully Below I've compiled a list of 8 strategies imperative for new agents to execute on, if you want to see success selling insurance, regardless of the agency, niche, or product you sell. Here they are: # 1. Clear the Calculator Selling insurance is largely a mental game. In other words, you have to keep your emotions and focus in check at all times. This means you must not allow distractions from your personal life or sales calls gone sideways to affect your mindset. Here's some tips that have helped me stay mentally sharp: * Treat every sales call as a fresh start. Getting rejected on one sales call doesn't mean you'll get rejected on the next. * It's helpful to think of your clients rejecting **your offer**, not you. The rejection is business, not personal. * Maintain balance in your personal life—exercise, eat well, and manage relationships. Mental clarity fuels sales success. # 2. Eliminate Distractions Selling insurance is great, but especially those who sell remotely, it comes with endless distractions. To stay focused: * Set clear boundaries with family—work time is **work time**. Make sure your spouse and kids respect this. * Keep your phone muted and out of reach during work hours. Group your texts and calls to a scheduled time. Most of them can wait. * Social media and internet use while you should be selling kills productivity. Consider a low-cost app like Freedom.to limit internet access while you should be working. # 3. Prioritize Activity Over Everything Activity leads to "app-tivity." In other words, tracking your numbers is critical to uncovering opportunities to improve your results. Try tracking these metrics daily: * **Connection Rate** — How many people are you actually getting to pick up the phone? If this number is low, explore dialing technology that helps keep your number off the spam- and telemarketer-likely lists. I like Convoso and Kixie. * **Quality connections** — How many conversations last longer than two minutes? If you're having trouble keeping your prospects on the phone, work on your opening script by practicing objection rebuttals until you can say them on the fly without hesitation. * **Closing rate** — How many policies are you selling compared to presentations? If these numbers are low, adjust your strategy. Retrain your scripting. Success is a numbers AND a skill development game. # 4. Master Your Scripts and Rebuttals The best agents **sound natural** but follow a proven process. If you don't have a script, you're winging it! And winging it doesn't work long-term. A good script consists of the following: * A strong intro that overcomes initial objections while simultaneously helping the client remember that they in fact requested the information you're calling about. * A handful of effective fact-finding questions that help build value and urgency to buy what you're selling. * A good list of underwriting questions that help you figure out which product works best. I like using Insurance Tool Kits for life and final expense policy sales. * How to close confidently. # 5. Stay Consistent with Your Schedule Consistency wins. The more you treat your profession like a job, the better off you'll be. I recommend the following: * Set a fixed start and end time every day. Stay disciplined to this as much as possible. * Avoid checking email or social media during work hours. Schedule a time before and after work for this. * Batch tasks. Separate prospecting, calling, and follow-ups. # 6. Improve After Every Call After a completed sales presentation - whether you sell or not - don't just move on! Analyze what worked and what didn't. Ask yourself the following: * Did I control the conversation? Or did the prospect control the pace? Remember that the person asking questions is in control. * Did I handle objections smoothly? If you're stumbling in your script, practice it multiple times until it's smooth. * What could I do better next time? Biggest pro-tip I can offer is to record your sales calls and listen to them. You'll hear all sorts of opportunities to improve =). # 7. Develop Thick Skin Rejection is part of the game. If you get rattled after a bad call, you're losing twice. Keep moving. Instead, think about the following: * If someone hangs up? Act fast and dial the next lead instead of ruminating. Don't spiral out of control! * If a prospect is rude? Probably like that with everyone. Don't take it personal. Next! * If you get 50 rejections in a row? Think: a sale is that much closer =). # 8. Work Smarter, Not Harder Successful agents **leverage** tools and systems to increase efficiency: * Use a CRM to track leads and follow-ups. AgentCRM is a pretty good CRM to start if your agency doesn't provide it. * Automate tasks where possible such as a chat bot to speak with your leads. Or use a compliant powerdialer to speak with more prospects faster. Again, I like Kixie and Convoso. * Constantly refine your approach based on data. Hope this helps =)"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 84 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kfmhbp/8_tips_for_new_agents_to_sell_insurance/

↳ hawkwood76 (11): "Love it. I will only add If it isn't on our calendar, it doesn't exist."

↳ CGWInsurance (5): "Congrats on doing this for new agents. Extremely well written. I would have put thick skin at either 1 or 2. Seen many leave this industry who rocked everything, but just took everything that was said to them personally and they had to quit for their own mental health."

↳ DavidDuford (2): "Appreciate it. Selling insurance or doing something totally performance-based is not for the faint of heart."

"How I retired my wife with my insurance agency, AMA I launched my agency in 2023 after working for years as a producer, underwriter, and consultant. It started as a side project with one goal in mind, to build enough recurring income to retire my wife and give us both more freedom. Within the first year I turned it into a full-time operation using an aggregator for market access and an organic marketing system that focused on building real relationships instead of buying leads. If you are trying to start or scale your own agency, here's what I can share: • How I used social media to generate consistent inbound leads without paying for ads • How I manage quoting, follow ups, and virtual assistant support to keep volume moving • How niche markets like pressure washing and contractors helped create stable renewals • What commission structures and business habits made the biggest difference early on • How to build an agency that supports your family and gives you time freedom Ask me anything about licensing, operations, staffing, lead generation, or what it actually takes to build an agency that can change your lifestyle."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o2ysrs/how_i_retired_my_wife_with_my_insurance_agency_ama/

↳ InsuranceGnome (10): "I never spent a dime on ads. Once you pick a niche, join the industry Facebook groups where your clients hang out. Do not spam, just wait for conversations where you can add value and show you understand their world. When people start asking for help, that is when you message them directly. I built trust by sharing tips that had nothing to do with buying from me, like safety guides since I am OSHA certified. Leave your two cents on as many posts as you can genuinely contribute to. Ideally do it from a personal profile instead of a business page, it gets much better organic reach. Once you start adding clients as friends, Facebook's algorithm does the heavy lifting. It will show you more people just like them, and that is where your next batch of leads usually comes from."

↳ InsuranceGnome (7): "TL;DR: Start with one niche and master it, keep costs low, lean into your strengths, buy back your time, and focus on turning your best skills into your biggest assets. P&C Insurance. Find a niche industry and learn as much as you can about it. For me, I did really well with service contractors and kept learning one trade after another. I often read policies cover to cover. I skim some sections, but I like to get a full understanding of how everything fits together. I kept software costs low at the start and added tools only when I could afford them. You do not need everything perfect to begin. It is better to get the ball rolling and improve along the way. Lean into your strengths. I am better with social media and chat since I am a gamer and always on my phone, so I made social media my number one funnel. Work with what you are naturally good at. Buy back time when you can. If you are bad at something like AMS entry, do not try to turn a zero into one hundred overnight. Hire someone on Fiverr to help while you also improve your own skills. Focus on turning A skills into A plus skills. The things you are weak at will improve over time, but your strengths will move the business forward faster."

↳ InsuranceGnome (5): "I went with Agentero because I was not planning on selling, and I was able to get my best commission rates by compiling everything under one broker. They were the only company I found that was willing to negotiate the contract. If you tell them you want to amend something, they will actually listen. It was by far the most personalized experience compared to Bolt, First Connect, or any others I reviewed."

"How is everyone marketing in 2025 without spending a fortune? For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down. Since, I've tried multiple vendors, and I've tried data leads + telemarketers. It feels like no matter what I do, I have to spend 5 grand a month in marketing at least for each of my producers just to hit our goals. It's way too much, and as we spend more to make less, I'm feeling bad burnout as my margins shrink. Primarily P&C, captive agent. So what is everybody doing that's working?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/

↳ BluebirdFast3963 (16): "Work for an independent that has the best prices in my province, so nothing. They come to me. We have 25 companies. Provide quick quotes, quick binds, quick service when they need something done to their policy. A variety of ways they can reach out. Retain most of my clientele year over year. Re-market my current clients if I need too. The way it should be. This lead factory head hunting, farming for clients you barely know and paying for someone to send you a list of numbers is wild to me - is this common in America? I think the Canadian industry is a bit different. I don't know anyone who has to buy leads. Seems like an awful way to retain a trustworthy client base. Is it just dog eat dog down there, constantly churning through clients or what?"

↳ registeredfake (9): "I've got to say, it does not matter what question is asked by anyone in this sub every one think the answer is Independent this independent that. OP is asking for marketing ideas, is already an agent where he has invested his time and money to build something and your first thought is to go independent. stupid"

↳ Armstrongs_ball (7): "Stop. Buying. Leads. Go independent, network, build your book of business by referrals and word of mouth. After a few years, you'll be living off your book of business and getting referrals left and right from clients, assuming you provide good service. Buying leads is literally the biggest waste of \$ in this industry and it's not even close. And good luck actually retaining those clients. They'll be the first to leave after their auto rate increases \$10/month of their first renewal."

"To form an LLC or to not form an LLC? 🤔👉 That is the question.... \"/>

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mp3psz/to_form_an_llc_or_to_not_form_an_llc_that_is_the/

↳ noneyet1 (3): "Great points. It is also worth noting that some states make LLC's register with the Secretary of State whenever they get a nonresident agency license. That means they need to file income taxes there even if they didn't make any money in that state. it really adds an extra burden of costs because you have to pay your CPA whether you made money or not."

↳ zenbusinesscommunity (3): "This is a really solid breakdown and really covers the practical considerations well. One thing to keep in mind is that even if you start as a sole proprietor or use a DBA, having a clear plan for separating business and personal finances can save headaches down the line. Getting an EIN from the IRS early on, for example, makes it easier to open a business bank account and track income and expenses cleanly. It's also worth thinking about privacy, like using a registered agent can keep your personal address off public filings if you do eventually form an LLC."

↳ RedditInsuranceGuy (2): "I agree, organizationally, thats solid advice."

"Great idea. Favorite telesales carriers: RNA, Prosperity and Trinity. SS billing + voice sign for all 3. Favorite lead: Real-time telemarketed call back with verified checking, ages 50-79 and agrees to speak with an agent. Basically telemarketers calling on DNC scrubbed and TCPA verified data to call on (old FB leads or Journaya/Trusted Form verified) + scrubbed against TCPA Blacklist Alliance and inputting into a form to serve it up in a CRM immediately. Tip: You need proper training and sales systems to make telesales work. If you take your DM leads and try to sell them over the phone with your typical f2f presentation, you'll fail. If you buy internet leads and don't have proper sales training or sales systems, you'll fail. My advice is either partner with a telesales-focused agency with an open release policy (hey, telesales isn't for everyone) or wait it out. Don't waste any time/money unless there's a proven system in place."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Telesales Tips · 11 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/final-expense-telesales-tips.101595/#post-1344555>

"This rings true to my experience to a tee. The company is off the charts unethical and should be shut down imo. A lot of people don't realize AO Globe Life has 2 major hiring periods linked to bonus events within the org where managers are heavily incentivized to hire as many new people as possible. Many of the new hires at this time of year are hired solely for that bonus, with little to no intent to see them actually make it. Being strung along just long enough to qualify for the bonus then essentially left to sink or swim from there. This leaves such a bad taste in people's mouths for the industry as a whole when it's the company through and through And when you finally get a peak behind the curtain, it's like Oz all smoke & mirrors. Top tier agents aren't making 500-1000 calls a day like they brag in the videos and weekly calls. A few of them have their own appointment setting businesses and hire foreign call centers to push for live transfers. Sold leads are passed around to be sold again, multiple times. When I was with them you could look up a lead and be floored seeing how many times a person's been sold the same products by the org's top tier agents. And to this day, when I hear the phrase "you picking up what I'm putting down?" I just want to punch that guy in the face 🤡"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/on4jz8u/

"Aged FE leads are my favorite type. Getting in the door is all about how you handle the appointment setting call."

— YouTube · Aged Final Expense Leads [3 Best Sales Tips] · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KRaHtVeE7HU&lc=Ugzxlfwur4gxWhO8nIZ4AaABAg>

↳ @LMC5280 (1): "Please share any tips you have. Thanks"

"New Agent having difficulty closing. I've been a new agent for two months now and I'm having difficulty closing! I'm averaging 100 calls a day with 2-4 hours of talk time. I'm a captive agent and I'm almost double the price people are currently paying. I stopped asking "how much do you pay" and started taking the conversation a different route to where I'm explaining and advising on what they need. I used to sell solar and never had this much difficulty in closing. I would like some tips on how other agents are closing even at a higher price for the same coverage. I would also like to hear some tips on how agents are getting more people on the phone or referrals as a remote agent. I did solar sales before Insurance and was a top performer as an telephone appointment setter, door knocker, and consultant. I don't know if I lost my touch or what I'm experiencing is out of my hands. I want to the best!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ve4p1s/>

↳ (0): "Two months is good. I owned an Agency for 25 years and have done a ton of marketing. If you're twice the price and selling on the phone that is hard. I think it's better to get face to face with them. You can review their dec page and start talking about what they need and why. You also need to realize you're not selling a tangible product. That makes it harder. I would use different marketing plans through out the day and night. If one's not working then you have another that could be working. It's a good thing you're good on the phone. I could talk hours on this. I think you need to set appointments and sale needs and come up with other marketing ideas. Keep moving forward and you will win."

↳ (0): "Personal opinion: You are marking to the wrong demographic. A big part of being a capitive agent is understanding your local market and marketing to those demographic you can win in. This would be something a sales leader/manager can help you pin point. From there, some captives are just going to be higher still. At this point you have to create a problem and the provide a solution. Winning deals if you are selling the same coverage is incredibly hard. One of my tactics is to not try to sell the exact same coverage, this is easier said then done but goes back to the create a problem and give a solution. This could be bundling for discounts, increasing limits, adding optional coverage, anything that is going to provide value over their current policy and gives you a reason to ask for more"

↳ (0): "I have trouble just getting people to come to their Zoom appointments. And I send reminders and call. I repeatedly get ghosted."

"Hi Cody! I am actually an appointment setter and one of my problems is they don't want to meet up. What is the best rebuttal for this?"

— YouTube · Live Dialing Insurance Leads! [Final Expense Insurance] · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RL6Y5qig0Wg&lc=UgzDfCXwolwYWP0z7Z14AaABAg>

↳ @CodyAskins (9): "I would say something like, "I understand. I'm getting back to you about the information you requested. I understand you don't want to meet about this, but since you requested it, I have to bring it by. Now, I'll be out in your area on (insert day), so should I drop this information off in the morning or afternoon?""

↳ @Pou-b58 (1): "@CodyAskins Thabks Cody! You really are the best! love your videos btw. They are all very helpful. Keep it up"

↳ @CodyAskins (0): "@Pou-b58 Thank you! We sure will."

"@Seniorbenes Well you are running an agency and that is not feasible for most new agents because they lack the capitol to start on a large scale like that. Yes if you scale to the point you are doing then it can work, but your investment is huge when this industry has 90% of new agents failing in the first 2 years. My description is what an average independent agent will perform. Nick from Medicare Millionaire is an independent agent and works by himself. He is a seasoned agent and very good at selling yet he only sold 127 policies in 2018 and he does this full time and employs his own telemarketer for \$3 per hour and uses direct mail leads. I was an assistant office manager for a Medicare brokerage firm for 9 years and out of 10 agents that our office had we only had 2 top producers and they each had about 1,500 clients. They serviced all of their clients and they were extremely stressed out all the time especially during AEP when MA plans became discontinued and they needed to review plan changes every year for their large client base. The average agent had about 500 clients. You need to provide customer service for your clients if you want to keep them long term and the sheer amount of work required to service MA plans simply isn't worth it. 95% of the calls we got at our agency was people having questions about their co-pays, the network, prescription drug co-pays, Part D late enrollment penalties, prescription drug issues, and how their plan worked. You spent all your time servicing MA and Part D clients and this is why you can't have more than 500 clients on your own before you are forced to hire help. Having 2,000 clients yourself means you aren't providing service to them when they have issues or you are just selling Medigap. Sorry to say but 70% of seniors on Medicare nationwide have Medicare Advantage. You and I both know how hard it is to market Part C and D plans selling over the phone as CMS makes this almost impossible. You need a partnership with a carrier to pull that off on a large scale and be successful which makes you captive to that carrier. I am in this industry to help seniors, not to help some corporate insurance carrier gain market share. CMS doesn't allow you to market Part C or Part D on social media, you need to read your AHIP test again my dude."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAg.9FNCTGBfz7K9FPVNMvVofn>

"Does this setup make sense for starting my own insurance business? Hi everyone, I'm currently studying to get my insurance license and wanted to share my plan to see if this setup makes sense. I'm also hoping to connect with experienced agents for advice. A little about me: • I'm the lead Data/AI Engineer at an investment bank, so I would like to keep this job for now but I'm looking to start my own insurance business. • I've got sales experience from wholesaling mobile homes, where I was a one man team handling both acquisitions and dispositions. I also worked as a wealth advisor at a top 3 RIA, and in my current role, I pitch AI concepts to secure funding from management. Honestly, I think insurance might be easier than what I've done before but I can be wrong. Here's my setup so far: -Focus: final expense insurance -I have a virtual assistant I'll train as an appointment setter to call leads, prequalify prospects with a free financial assessment, and schedule follow-ups with me as the closer. -I'm already running Facebook ads with a CPL of \$5-\$7. -My marketing experience comes from previous dropshipping endeavors, so I know how to test and optimize campaigns. -For CRM, I built a custom Google Sheets system with automations (follow-up emails, date tracking, etc.). -I'm also working on an AI receptionist to handle inbound calls while I'm at my 9-5. Here's what I'd love feedback on: 1. Does this sound like a good setup for someone starting out? 2. Would anyone here be open to mentorship in exchange for me helping introduce AI tools/automation into your agency? 3. What's the best IMO/FMO for my situation? I'm leaning toward EFES but open to suggestions. 4. Do you think it is possible to do this part time? Any advice would be appreciated I want to make sure I set this up the right way from the start. Thanks!"
— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m12x1l/does_this_setup_make_sense_for_starting_my_own/

↳ myeasykyng (4): "If you sold Mobile Homes and were a Wealth Advisor why not focus on that? If you were going to do insurance at least leverage knowledge and do maybe sell insurance for Mobile Homes."

↳ Designer_Manner_6924 (2): "can i ask how exactly are you creating an AI receptionist? because, considering you'd be implementing one at times when you're not present, it will be solely responsible for anyone who reaches out to your business. if you're looking for a tool that can receive calls & book meetings for you, i have a suggestion that could work really well for you."

↳ Imaginary-Carob8711 (2): "I've done a few things on the side over the years: • Dropshipping: Made around \$300K-\$500K lifetime from Facebook to TikTok. What I hated here was how much external factors (platform changes, ad costs, suppliers, etc.) controlled the business. • Mobile home wholesaling: Made about \$5K. What I hated was the low deal flow and the relatively small returns. Both of these were more like side hustles than actual businesses. They never felt like something I could scale into a real, lasting company. Which is what I hope to make insurance be. As for AI: I work full time as an engineer focused on data and AI. Trust me it's not replacing humans anytime soon. If it could, I'd already be cloning my voice with ElevenLabs and teaching an AI to start cold calling for me. Right now, even the best systems can ask questions and record answers, but they can't replicate the warmth of a real human conversation or make nuanced decisions or even comply with law. That said, if we ever do get there, people like me (who can build and train these systems) would probably use them in their own agencies to replace call centers."

"Unfortunately, it is not a straightforward process. There are a lot of lead generation companies that offer DNC-Scrubbing as a service. However, many of them take shortcuts that can burn you legally (such as buying the DNC list once and not updating, etc.). We got burned by one such company. The surest way to check for DNC is: 1) Register with the National Do Not Call Registry at <https://telemarketing.donotcall.gov/> 2) Create a Telemarketer or Seller Account (you can set it up as an individual if you don't have a company) 3) Request access to area codes. You get 5 free area codes. Every additional area code costs \$80/year (\$22,038 for all area codes). If you are calling locally or even within the state, usually, the free area codes are sufficient. Search online for the list of area codes in your area to figure out. 4) To search the list with your list of phone numbers, you have 2 options: a) If your list is small (in the tens): Use the Search tool on the Registry's website (after logging in). You can search up to 10 numbers at a time for the area codes you have access to. b) Larger Lists: Download the list (CSV or XML file) and setup a lookup on Excel or any other spreadsheet software)."
— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466vj/stop_buying_leads/mu1ozqu/

"IUL Meta Ads Hey Folk, a friend of mine and I own a offshore Registered marketing agency, we wanted to try running ads for IULs (we do for recruiting which gave us a good ROI), I'm not quite sure on how much will it actually cost us to advertise with a pocket money budget from the Client since this is what us and the him agreed upon for starters, I'm Currently Making the draft but still contemplating since we agreed on getting Him APPOINTMETNS and not just leads, you can call me whatever but we had to take the risk to see if we can make it work on the long run for other agents. I'm Pretty good in what i do, Lead gen and appointment setting, i worked in various Industries so i trust my ability in this I'd love your advice on a few things: What are the best Facebook ad angles or creatives that have worked for IUL or financial services campaigns lately? How do you keep lead quality high without making the form too long? What's the best way to set expectations with the agent so they don't blame ad quality when the real issue is closing skill or follow-up? *(Not asking for self-promo or templates, just real experience-based advice.)"
— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o85k98/iul_meta_ads/

"From Restaurant Owner to Bankruptcy: Charting My Path Back to Success Hi Reddit friends! I'm here to tell you about my journey and ask for a little help. I used to run a restaurant that I opened back in 2010. But when COVID-19 hit, I had to close it because of money problems. Before that, I worked with import and export between Dubai and Belgium. Right now, I'm working at a company to pay the bills and I'm still paying off some debts from my restaurant. I want to start working as an appointment setter and later on, I hope to become good at closing deals. I'm thankful for everything I've learned and I believe in myself. I know I can find my way back. Life has been tough, but I have faith. I'm from Belgium and I speak English, French, and Arabic. If you have any advice on how to get into appointment setting or know someone who can help, I'd be so grateful. Thanks for reading!"
— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1d8424p/>

↳ (0): "Appointment setting can be very ominous. Just get a good script and read it every call to get the client over to the closer."

"Thank you all for the honest feedback. The overwhelming majority say that the things f*cking it up for me are the fact that I don't give any type of reminder before the appointed call (nor do I have any system in place for follow up and appointment setting) and that I was naively taking the positive appointment setting from my prospects as a good sign when it's very possible it's a deflection. I do have a sales call in half an hour, though (where I confirmed with the prospect through email, funny enough), so it hasn't been all bad. I have a long list of leads so I have plenty of room to adjust."
— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qrb80b/none_of_my_prospects_are_answering_my_calls_after/o2nc3rg/

"To answer your question of how to get better leads - dont pay for leads. Find out where the prospects you want to have as clients are and hang out there. Networking works when you have something in common. Not that buying leads won't work it's just inefficient and expensive. I've never bought something from a telemarketer or door knocker, would you? I'm glad you didn't sell to your friends and family though. Your book of business is captive there if you ever decide to leave. Good luck!"
— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wgfnvg/new_agent_at_new_york_life/paa3pz0/

"sana all "fresh leads" hahaha i am an appointment setter for a life insurance agent but he usually gives us old leads like 2 or 3 year old leads imagine how struggling/hard that is for me. of course u can never imagine hahaha i'm a fan of your channel been watching ur vids, enjoying it and learning a lot at the same time. xoxo"

— YouTube · Live Dialing Insurance Leads! [Final Expense Insurance] · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RL6Y5qig0Wg&lc=UgyIjeB-T5Iben6ItY94AaABAq>

↳ @CodyAskins (0): "Glad you're learning something! Appreciate the comment!"

↳ @SPHINX144 (0): "Why not just become a licensed agent and sell insurance yourself? You probably have a lot of practice on the phone!"

↳ @charmainecordoviz2390 (0): "Jonathan M sadly, i'm not from the US"

"I think your numbers are a little low tbh, depending on how much time you put in 10/month is extremely feasible and thats on the low end alot of the FMO's do lead outreach appt setting etc, Saturdays though are the best!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j6vyj8/medicare_brokers_help_me_set_realistic_goals_for/mh5yarb/

@christianbrindle Thanks....I believe you said in the video you could put a link here for the actual phone appointment setting script? Maybe it's on your page...!ll look there too"

— YouTube · How To Make \$500k A Year As A Medicare Agent In 2023! (Medicare Sales Training) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SmpppgLPuqeQ&lc=UgwI9PiWNLPjZc84RoR4AaABAq.9nh-ql3iu8x9nibzZu4Z3s>

"Not trying to be disagreeable but that's not a complete picture imho. You're not wrong that you need to work large numbers to arrive at consistency. However, the openers that get taught are generally assumptive (I don't know anyone who teaches permission based) and tonality is either not taught at all or it's not taught very well. I did a deep dive into the b2b sdr appointment setting training and it really improved my first :30 seconds for personal lines and actually gave me a chance to win commercial accounts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1twistot/is_insurance_really_this_bad_or_i_have_terrible/pafxy8f/

Tab 7 — Solution Soundbites

Looking for a lead source that isn't a scam · 27 documents · 20 voices

"Best leads in 2024???? This video had nothing to do with helping agents find reputable lead sources. You mentioned 10 different lead gen sources (none to be named) and said nothing referring to the actual title of your vid. Try renaming to " Don't make these mistakes ". I was looking for actual usable content with names of companies that are skilled at lead gen and are reputable. Waste of 14 minutes."

— YouTube · The Best Life Insurance Leads For 2024 I My \$500k/Yr Lead Source · 39 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gtXNK0-8f7c&lc=UgxSK3d37q7CBMR8CY54AaABAq>

↳ @Peter_Roberts01 (44): "Sorry I didn't provide value so I'll do it here: my favorite lead vendors I've used 1. Smart Finaical - seo leads 2. Happy agent - Fb leads 3. Nectar leads are insurance leads for seo and Fb Also if you are an agent your upline or leader should be able to provide you the best sources. Sorry for this I care about you"

↳ @itssmee1597 (9): "@Therealjames100you legit just did the same thing"

↳ @Therealjames100 (5): "You just wasted alot of time typing this pointless comment lol."

"Leads! So here's my situation. In the last few years, I've consistently closed 2 to 3 out of every 10 phone calls, and about 1 out of every 3 full pitches. But the agency I used to work for masked the lead provider and changed the names, so we never actually knew where the leads came from. Now that I'm working for myself, finding a solid lead provider has been way harder than I expected. I really didn't think it would be this difficult. Out of 46 ACA leads from NextGen, I've closed zero. Not even a maybe. Does anyone have recommendations for good lead providers, or even insight on how they generate their own leads? Open to any direction at this point."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1orzwnm/leads/>

↳ FirearmConcierge (7): "DO NOT HIRE LEAD PROVIDERS They are all shit and will just take your money and not deliver and do dirty things to fuck you and your upline."

↳ Ashamed_Promise7726 (6): "Following to hear others input. We have been struggling with quality leads as well. And I'm not talking we expect to close every deal, but we have purchased a ton of internet leads who said that they never requested a quote in the first place (InsuranceQuotes, Everquote, etc.). We understand its a numbers game at the end of the day. But we at least want a chance to win their business, and we aren't even getting that most of the time and just spending money on leads with 0 potential."

↳ MysticMaxwell (3): "This is your chance to stand out and be helpful. I get leads all the time that say they didn't request anything, tired of the calls/texts, or any excuse they want to use. Call with purpose. You are calling because you are reviewing the recent changes, since it shows they have not updated their options for next year. Hey \ [first].....glad I was able to catch you. I am actually calling to review your \ \ \ \ \ options for next year. Now this is not a sales call quite yet, but if you give me 2 mins, I can review a couple options and make sure you are in the best spot. If so, we end the call there.....sound fair? Generate your own leads. Talk to everyone you meet. Figure out your advantage and find the people that can use the help."

"What lead vendors work for you? I'm a face to face final expense agent. I was using cheaper internet leads from integrity, social insurance leads, and leads direct. They aren't exclusive but they're anywhere from \$1-11 so I can get a lot of them, and if you dial enough you'll set up enough appointments. The ROI was great. As of recently though, they're just bad. And I've been with companies in the past that have had BAD leads before, I'm used to having to dial a lot and overcome objections, but this just isn't the way anymore. I've tried Facebook ads myself and I've come to the conclusion I'm just not a good marketer. It takes a lot of trial and error and time to figure it out so unless there's somewhere that'll give me a copy and pasted proven ad to post, I've decided it's not worth it. I'll take any recommendations on any direct mail or internet lead vendors. What works for you guys?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fmxcl1/what_lead_vendors_work_for_you/

↳ DavidDuford (5): "I'll second u/NAF1138 - just work direct mail leads. Aged direct mail leads can be great if you can find a quality distributor. Facebook leads can be good but you'll have a bunch more travel time to work them effectively."

↳ NAF1138 (4): "If you sell face to face, you should ONLY work direct mail. All other lead types are only good for filler leads or telesales. There are lots of good direct lead vendors The Lead Connection Lead Concepts Need a Lead RGI Are some places to start."

↳ dis_iz_funny_shit (4): "I've got a direct face to face method for finding new leads in the field - mortgage protection leads --- so the tool helps you find people in any area that just bought a home in the last few months. It helps you locate a phone number also about 60-70% of the time"

"Jesus H. I get that teachers are looking for side hustles - and it's NOT okay that the 403(b) vendors are poaching INSIDE the schools to get their recruiting. I write 403(b) and am bringing it into my new broker dealer, as one of the only people in the entire company that understands it well enough to roll out some form of a workable 403(b)(7) system that lets us get paid AND write 403(b) accounts that do not charge the ridiculous fees that the insurance companies charge. I want it without surrender, high fee, or insurance-based products, but with access to an advisor they have a relationship with, not an 800 number. That's my mission. What you are describing? That's awful. I am one such recruit - though I was called by my home and auto agent to take a territory that needed an agent, and it was a completely protected territory the whole nine years I grew my book there. It wasn't anything like what you're describing. They also handed me the entire book on my way through the door and I vested my interest in it over four years while it covered my overhead and allowed for a base to expand from. I just went independent less than a year ago, from that role, and can say that there are ways to do what you're proposing, but you'd need to carefully look at potential and needs before you jump into the work. There's a lot of learning that is expensive, and if you choose the wrong org or arrangement, you could easily find yourself on the wrong end of validation requirements or running out of runway before you're comfortable. Spending time in the summer assisting an agent working in your target markets might be a great way to go. Being licensed, you can work as much or as little as you want when you are with an IMO, and the progress is yours to make. There is a certain level below which it doesn't make sense because you'll forget more than you learned before you do it again. Ten years in, I don't regret my time swap - I do four days in the office and one in the classroom as a sub somewhere. When I made my jump, I did so keeping all the same time expectations for everyone. My clients all are well aware that I'm not around on Fridays. My staff cheerfully let folks know that when they get calls for me on Friday - "Oh, would you like to send her an email or leave her a voicemail? She teaches on Fridays, and is out and about in the schools somewhere today wrangling some children whose teacher is out. I can probably help you, too. What's up?" It works like a charm and my clients love it. Sometimes I even teach for my clients, and then it's even more fun because we have that little conversation after like "Yeah... you weren't kidding. They were an interesting group!" or "Wow. Who did you make so happy last year that you got this amazing crop this year?! Lucky!!!" There are so many games in town - And the thing nobody will tell you is that the ones that find you are the ones that are the most desperate because they are the most exploitative. The ones you have to know someone to know how to get to are the ones that are truly orgs that you want to be in, because the people you know already who are in them are not trying to recruit as their primary mission. They are focused on the clients as clients and the client challenges are their job, not getting out of the client-facing work as soon as possible. Just some food for thought."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sj0pc6/primerica_almost_got_me/ofu1wzc/

"Ringba Leads through Integrity Connect are a scam- Beware Hi All- This is an FYI and looking for an inbound lead company recommendations. I had 6 different issues where they are charging for calls under the 90 second buffer time, calls that were never happened, missed calls that never rang or stating there are missed calls where the consumer hung up. I have provided proof from my phone company/call logs to show the inaccurate data in their system but received the same cookie cutter response with no resolution or even a credit. \$55 a call is pricey when the calls never actually happened. If it is a valid call and the buffer time has been passed by al means charge me but don't charge me for systems issues or calls that never happened. Three other people on our team experienced the same types of issues. Also, 95% of the calls are for "free 25K coverage" which essentially is just an objection but my main point is they are not high intent leads. If anyone uses a reliable inbound call lead company, please drop it below. TYIA"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u9pr90/ringba_leads_through_integrity_connect_are_a_scam/

↳ adam_ringba (4): "Adam here, founder and CEO of Ringba. Our name is in the title so I wanted to respond directly. Quick context on how this actually works, because it matters: Ringba doesn't generate leads or calls. We're the technology platform behind the call exchange that Integrity buys through. There are hundreds of independent companies selling calls on the exchange, Integrity is one of the buyers, and our system handles the routing and tracking in between. So the calls you received came from one of those sellers, not from us, and I can't speak to how they were labeled inside Connect. What I can do is look at your actual calls. Every call that touches the exchange is tracked end to end. If you DM me the phone number you were taking calls on, or a few of the caller IDs with rough dates, I'll personally pull the logs and tell you exactly what happened: where each call originated, how long it rang, how long it connected, all of it. If something went wrong on our side, I'll tell you that too. The other thing I'd offer: we run a group with 600+ Connect agents in it where we help people troubleshoot exactly this, every day. I'm in there myself. Setup issues, routing issues, what the top agents do differently, all of it. Agents in that group wrote over \$1.2M in annual premium through Connect in the last 30 days, and most of the ones doing well hit walls early on too. Happy to get you in if you want. We also recorded a podcast with Integrity where agents on the exchange talk candidly about their experience: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=r4UBGoFkH9U>/(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=r4UBGoFkH9U>) Sorry you had a bad run. Send me those numbers and let's find out what really happened."

↳ Fun_Valuable_1765 (3): "Do you know if integrity connect has the same issues for Medicare health leads?"

↳ Willing-Landscape144 (2): "Honestly this is the case for all Inbound leads. I've tried them and got tired of the bait and switch marketing that would cause callers to assume the policies were "free". Not worth the hassle and chargebacks."

"Is anyone focusing on live transfers for final expense or mortgage protection? If so how's it been and what do your typical costs look like? Actively trying to work through the best way to scale production and want to incorporate live transfers as the focal point of my strategy. Exclusive leads regardless of where are increasingly getting more difficult to get a hold off and I'm fine spending more money to get someone on the call in the moment. Just curious to know how that's been for everyone and what vendors you'd recommend as a good starting place for it."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq7mu0/is_anyone_focusing_on_live_transfers_for_final/

↳ Curious-Housing-8051 (2): "Live transfers definitely cost more upfront but the conversion rate makes it worth it in most cases"

↳ tacticalsarcasm167 (2): "I was wondering the same and asked a commenter about allcalls a few days ago. He seemed to do fine and some of his agents do also. Feel free to dm me. Im curious too."

↳ allthingsnev (1): "Are you actively doing live transfers? & if so what are you seeing from a costs point of view as an ideal baseline for getting at least 1 policy done per day assuming you're a competent agent."

"That is insane- I started ACA this past November. I didn't invest in leads or anything, just leaving with a small handful of clients. I'm desperately looking to build my book of business this year and I'm really looking for viable lead sources outside of open enrollment and would love to hear about the source you use during open enrollment to reach those numbers- I'm willing to invest in myself. Could you DM or reach back out on this post?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rx4iw2/enrolled_500_aca_clients_my_first_open_enrollment/ob4t2br/

"Experience with buying ACA/Medicare leads? Have any of you ever bought ACA, or Medicare, leads? I'm looking to grow my prepubescent BOB every and any way I can, generating and buying leads. I've looked around online and a lot of the lead vendors out there seem to be pretty sketchy. Do any of you have any solid recommendations for lead vendors and wouldn't mind sharing your experience?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m8ia5u/experience_with_buying_acamedicare_leads/

↳ al_cisneros_beard (2): "Use your existing clients for referrals, any type of community outreach and online marketing. My new client acquisition is about 70% from online, 20% referrals and 10% from local events and the monthly farmer's market. Most of my online business is from out of state or in other parts of my state so I like to do the other stuff to get local business too. I run my own online ads though, don't use a vendor."

↳ notmarcusanthony (1): "Yea I've seen live transfers and aged leads but I wanted to see if anyone had a reputable vendors."

↳ SnooChickens9030 (1): "Thank you for sharing. What platforms do you have the most success with for running your own ads? Also, do you have an idea of average amount you spend per exclusive lead?"

"I get lots of "qualified" leads from people who "accidentally" filled out the info form. I'd love if a lead vendor could weed those out."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kyev2f/curious_what_makes_a_lead_good_or_useless_for/muwvuo/

"I agree with Pete, your upline/agency/IMO should have a system in place without using 3rd party vendors."

— Facebook group comment · People Looking for Life insurance · 3 likes · <https://www.facebook.com/groups/273498442314660/posts/797029163294916/>

"Yes I have heard that there are a lot of people Acting in bad faith in the lead industry (on line and off line) in terms of reselling leads to pump their numbers up. Makes sense why people would want to go with the cheaper alternative if you feel that you're going to get screwed. As far as mail pieces directly, I would recommend seeing if you can talk to the vendor directly to see if you can work with them to make it more in line with your voice. I'd like to think there are still a few good ones out there Thank you for sharing @jroberts67"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1quvey8/direct_mail_for_independent_agents/o3d2x5h/

"Mr David firstly thank you for the video very informative. Secondly what lead source would you recommend for a WFG agent who mainly deals in as you know Term, IUL, and FIA I would also like to learn more about your company keeping my options open as you also recommended in another one of your videos sir"

— YouTube · Best Life Insurance Leads For 2020 [Vendor & Lead Review] · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=faFKfYtPADk&lc=UqxhGYvjVdHCJl2_sF4AaABAq

↳ @TheDIGAgency (5): "None for WFG. Your commission level is too low to support a lead source in my opinion. If I can help in any way, please let me know =)"

"Looking for Legit T65 Leads Like the title says does anyone know of any legit compliant T65 lead companies I can speak with? Thanks!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r39olh/looking_for_legit_t65_leads/

↳ noexcuses14 (4): "The T65 people get absolutely buried in mailers. Most of them get their names sold over and over, even when the company claims they are only going to one person. You will do better with finding partnership lead sources. Try financial planners who need a health insurance agent to partner with. You will do even better if you are also selling under 65."

↳ Sir-Ult-Dank (3): "Self generated thru networking or doing own seminars. Medicare requires being really compliant or falls back to you. Good luck"

↳ TruckInn (2): "I found an agency that offer 1-4 seminars per month to their LOAs. Helped at the beginning tremendously. Dialling or doing mail leads never worked for me tbh"

"I see. Thanks for sharing that. I hope things work out for you. I'll comment on the sales piece. We have some former UW's on the P&C side that crush it in broking because they can explain things in a way that someone with no UW experience can't. Benefits underwriting background gives you a leg up because you'll also be able to explain to prospects the factors that impact their rate. You'll need to be able to couple that knowledge with knowledge of the different vendors and solutions out there to optimize for cost/efficiency/wellbeing/retention or any other concern/need your clients will want to solve for. I can't speak to Medicare sales but Group Health is super lucrative. If you got any broker buddies id talk through with them about what the job looks like and get a feel for it see if its something you'd want to do."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1sm953b/almost_a_decade_in_group_medicare_and_im_not_sure/ogg2h6m/

"> I'm a little confused. I am a new broker aka 2 months ago and I don't even make enough to make ends meet. You're telling me you would sue me to bankruptcy if I bought leads and called you? You bought the lead, right? You bought the liability. Yes I would have no problem suing you and reporting you to the regulator. > Isn't it legal to call since you sign off on it with the lead company???? This is so confusing The lead company calls me illegally with an automated system, uses a fake name, uses a spoofed number, calls my DNC number and because I agreed to the transfer you should be off the hook?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/nfmqzdg/

"Leads: where to buy or how to self generate with Securities license + life/health insurance As title indicates, I am securities licensed as well as hold life, health, and annuities licenses. I would like advice on either a) a good lead source or b) how to generate my own (such as via a Facebook "funnel"), but it needs to be compliant with Finra regs, etc. Does such a thing exist? The marketing dept of my company quoted me a \$1,000 up front fee then \$100 per NON-EXCLUSIVE lead. That seems crazy. Or am I crazy to think that there must be a better way?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1c1m2eg/leads_where_to_buy_or_how_to_self_generate_with/

↳ One_Ad9555 (2): "Go introduce yourself to every accountant in the areas. Get them to refer you business. Find some p&C agencies that don't do investments. Get a p&C license and refer them business. Get a 15 to 20% referral fee for that. They refer you investments and etc, annuity that they don't write. Join all the local organizations."

↳ One_Ad9555 (2): "Accountants do taxes for individuals and businesses. They know which individuals and businesses have money to invest. What businesses need retirement plans. What individuals need IRAs. What individuals need 401k rollover. Having an accountant refer there clients to you is golden. Also you don't even need to sell them. The accountant has usually told them what to do and you just need to provide the paperwork so they can do it. Many times I never had to do anything other than listen to client and sign them up. Tax time gets really busy as accountants are telling people they need to pay the money in taxes or get IRAs."

↳ howtoreadspaghetti (1): "Makes perfect sense."

"You should have seen some of the crap that came in over the years buying leads, finding a reliable vendor is like finding gold. Our ACA book is a little over 5,000 clients now from mostly aged leads. We pay around 20¢ each, the data is still pretty solid because its new enough and they were in the market for coverage so many havent had it resolved yet and we scoop them up. So many vendors push junk idk how they can get away with it."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466yj/stop_buying_leads/nf3obri/

"I purchased a mix of live and slightly aged leads from a few vendors, paying \$50 per lead, but ended up wasting a lot of money. I've dialed over 100 leads so far with zero results. Could you please recommend a better strategy and share the names of any lead vendors you're currently working with successfully?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lmbcnj/anything_is_possible/n10wio5/

"I am referring to using a different lead vendor. Vendors offering exclusive leads are more expensive, but worth it to get a client that is looking for insurance. BA Leads are the only leads I received that were absolutely horrible — not recommending you buy more of them by any means! (Just wanted to clarify)"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/movynrx/

"High quality leads. High quality leads! My account manager Lisa Montgomery has been so helpful and is so knowledgeable when it comes to lead buying strategy. She explained from the beginning that buying data leads means you need to purchase a good amount of volume and be prepared to put in some elbow grease to be successful. She set up all my campaigns to make sure I get the best cost for the most volume. I'm a new broker and have been able to scale my business faster than I imagined over the past few months. NextGen is my primary lead vendor and I would recommend everyone use them."

— TrustPilot · NextGen Leads · 5★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/606cf280f85d7508704c4877>

Wanting a CRM or system that does the follow-up · 21 documents · 20 voices

"These appointments are good, but there is an additional follow up question that I would believe needs to be asked to ensure the actual appointment is able to be closed. An additional question I would ask is, "besides yourself, is there anybody else that needs to hear and see the information when I arrive? If so, will they be there, too?"

— YouTube · Live Dialing Insurance Leads! [Final Expense Insurance] · 115 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RL6Y5qig0Wg&lc=Ugww1Q61-0Bd46Njld4AaABAg>

↳ @charlesphoenix4383 (12): "Yes. You want all of the decision makers present. A husband may be the prime decision maker, but he will require input from his significant other... Your statement is on point."

↳ @MyDiscountsNow (5): "@ModeCyber I have 25 years in sales. :)"

"Advice for Final Expense Startup (High-Volume Cold Calling Team) Hi everyone, I'm planning to start selling final expense insurance within the next month or two. I'll be going all-in on cold calling and wanted to get feedback from experienced agents before launch. My Plan: I'll (22M) be working with my two 18-year-old brothers and operating in new york state Each of us will make 1,000 cold calls/day, 6 days a week We'll work 12-13 hour shifts, using a CRM + power dialer system We plan to buy leads daily at \$0.30 to \$0.50 each We're all bilingual (English/Spanish) and comfortable with high-volume sales We're not strangers to long hours or consistent effort — and we plan to maintain tone and energy throughout. Goals: Start with final expense sales Gradually add Medicare Scope of Appointments (SOA), enrollments, and eventually Medicare Supplements After a few months of production, I plan to negotiate a 140% commission contract We're expecting a 0.3% to 0.5% close rate based on what we've researched A friend of mine who only does medicare will share his hot leads with me since i will do final expense so i am guaranteed some early success at least if i dont screw it up --- My Questions: 1. Is this call volume and close rate realistic for a new team using aged or low-cost leads? 2. Is there anything crucial I'm overlooking in terms of compliance, licensing, or daily execution? 3. Are there any CRM + dialer combos you highly recommend for high-volume final expense/Medicare telesales? 4. For Medicare broker changes, is it realistic to expect consistent volume or are those more seasonal? 5. Are there any major red flags or rookie mistakes we should avoid early on? 6. Any advice for scripting, retention, or mental pacing during long dialing days? Thanks in advance — I really respect the grind this industry takes and want to do it the right way."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jnkha/advice_for_final_expense_startup_highvolume_cold/

↳ DavidDuford (7): "Guaranteed Issue = lapse-o-matic. Arguably better to just not write it."

↳ SnooLemons398 (5): "If you're gonna do final expense, make sure one or more carriers can do guaranteed policies. There are a lot of sick people out there. There are also many poor people out there. Make sure they can afford it, or you'll see more chargebacks than you think. Try to close on the first call. 80% of FE appointments are a no show. Good luck!"

↳ DavidDuford (3): "What I would do if I were you: 1. Scrub your data against a litigator and changed number list on a regular basis. 2. Get Convoso. Kixie is OK. Most other dialers are terrible. Connection rate is everything. 3. Move out of New York. You cannot get contracted in New York with American Amicable as a New York resident. AmAm is arguably the best final expense telesales carrier available. Answers to your questions: 1. Maybe. Biggest levers to get best results: 1. Script and skillset 2. Dialer to maximize connection rates. 2. See above. 3. Convoso only. 4. Stay away from DSNP. 5. 100% TCPA compliance adherence. 6. Set daily activity goals. Consider bonuses/rewards for hitting call/conversion goals."

"I would strongly recommend automating reminders. Use every channel available. Email. SMS. Phone calls. Voicemails. Every missed follow up is a leak in your funnel. Plug those leaks and the same leads you already have will start producing far more revenue over time. If you are serious about growth, this massive fix you can make."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qrb80b/none_of_my_prospects_are_answering_my_calls_after/o2mxlxs/

"100% identify as an insurance agent! This is my number one rule about social media is you need to be using them as a business tool. If nobody knows you are an agent, they'll never know to reach out when they need you! Lead with value and education and the rest will follow but most definitely tell people you are in insurance!"

— YouTube · How To Use Facebook To Generate FREE Insurance Leads! · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=D7pgdwro3GY&lc=Ugwuot31BYznZsDHnd4AaABAg.9NoZnNzxomg9O2tcSjEpOu>

"New Agent Choosing an FMO vs. Going Direct – Advice Needed! Hello everyone, I'm a newly licensed agent in Virginia, and I'm currently in the process of choosing an FMO to work with. Right now, training and support are my biggest priorities—even more than commission splits—because I know that with excellent training, the money will follow. Primarily, I want to start off offering Medicare (with the hopes to offer my clients ACA & possibly Life at a much later date, after I gain an understanding of the industry, but only as supplements to their needs). It's my understanding that I could work for multiple FMOs, as one may not entirely fulfill my needs. 😊 I've been looking at Gordon Marketing, TR King Insurance Marketing, Ritter, and Redbird, but I've seen mixed feedback. Some people say Gordon Marketing gives off MLM vibes—does anyone here have experience with them? I've also seen advice about finding an upline and then letting them be your contact because going directly to an FMO will get you lost in their hierarchy without direct support and guidance. On the flip side, I came across a comment saying that going direct with carriers (rather than using an FMO) is a better route. I'd love to hear from anyone who's done this: Did you have prior experience before going direct? Do the carriers provide strong training & support, or would I be on my own? For those in Virginia, what are the most prevalent carriers I should consider contracting with? Also, I want to run my own agency and generate my own leads. I'm not looking for an FMO that requires me to buy leads from them or forces me into a specific system. I just want solid training. If, down the line, I decide to buy leads, I'd like the option, but I don't want to be locked into it. I want to set myself up for success long-term and avoid jumping around between FMOs. Any insights or personal experiences would be greatly appreciated! Thanks in advance!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jykgig/new_agent_choosing_an_fmo_vs_going_direct_advice/

↳ NAF1138 (4): "If you want your focus to be on Medicare, I would add, in order, 1) supplemental health (Hospital plans, Cancer plans, home health plans, dental plans.) All of your Medicare clients could likely use some or all of these. 2) Final Expense Life. Easy add on if you just look to fix problems with people's existing life insurance. 3) ACA but not to go after a large ACA book. So you can sell ACA to spouses and referrals. Mostly to grab them as future Medicare clients. 4) annuities. Lots of clients will have CDs, 401ks and other amounts of money that are essentially doing nothing for them. You probably can do number 1 after six months. 2 after 2 years. 3 a year after that. And 4 after you have been in the business for about 6 years. Go slow. Work intentionally. Build a long term business."

↳ NAF1138 (3): "If you want training and support you don't want to go direct. The carriers don't care about you and mostly don't know anything about selling insurance. They are not where you want to be trained. The only exception being the captive sales forces of certain carriers. You also, want to pick ONE of those things in your list. Do not come out the gate trying to sell Medicare, ACA, Annuities and Life. You will never learn to sell any of them that way. They are all different and sometimes conflicting sales processes. They can all easily keep you busy full time. You will essentially be doing 4 jobs full time badly. Of the FMOs you mentioned, TR King is actually run by a decent human who cares about his people. Ritter is good if you know what you are doing or are working with an agent who is running an agency under them, but doing direct to Ritter is the same as going direct to the carrier. Redbird, I don't know anyone who works their but they have a reasonably good reputation. I don't know Gordon Marketing at all. That doesn't mean anything though, no one knows everyone."

↳ voidsarcastic (3): "Like commission rates? Luckily they're all pretty close carrier to carrier so sell the best plan for the client every-time, and every client is different so different plans and carriers work better for different people. Pretty sure MAPD is the same rate for every carrier (315 renewal 650 IEP) however over-rides may be different and some offer HRA bonus. Most supplements are 20-23% annual (first year advance), and dental/HI is like 45-50% annual (first year advance). Be careful some MAPD plans are non-commissionable i do avoid those, but there really aren't many. I have however done no commission part Ds, you gotta do what you gotta do. Life commissions should be between 80%-115% (9 month- 12 month advance) starting out, if you're taking a lower comp from the FMO make sure you are getting lots of support."

"Congratulations on reaching (and surpassing) the 100K subscriber mark! You provide an exceptional service (honest information and educating us with important knowledge). I've been a subscriber for a few years now and have forwarded many of your videos along to friends. If we move to a Medicare For All system, you should be named director of the agency and all your staff should become part of it. Thank you so much for what you do! 😊"

— YouTube · How to choose a Medicare agent · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Goeyplo7WZU&lc=UgyViSqNROvLMvDx_2R4AaABAq

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (1): "@MrTwistoff what a compliment!"

"I agree with Pete, your upline/agency/IMO should have a system in place without using 3rd party vendors."

— Facebook group comment · People Looking for Life insurance · 3 likes · <https://www.facebook.com/groups/273498442314660/posts/797029163294916/>

"I just had an orientation with them today and I came on Reddit to do some snooping. No wonder they are all over Indeed, trying to get any and everyone they can, in the door. I'm going back next week for a one on one interview. I will keep you posted on whether or not I pursue this. The commission based system was of no surprise to me, and they claim they are looking for people that want to make a career of this, which at 36 and not quite so many prospects, this may be amongst the best I can get. Thoughts? Edit: I was told that Banker's Life provides the leads to the agents and that it doesn't come out of our pockets, but you're saying that these leads, in fact, do. I've heard of agents paying \$75-\$300 for leads, and that's not something that I am trying to do."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gaf2yn/avoid_bankers_life/mjp297q/

"Go to Denmark, Spain, France, the Netherlands, Canada etc and the tell them they should have the same health care system the US has. You will get thrown off the Euro Rail. Lower costs in all these countries and healthier populations. We have the worst health care of any first world nation and its because of the absence of a national health care system. The thing we excel at in the US, elective cosmetic surgery."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1othjel/cold_reality_of_aca_from_an_experienced_agent/no6qd3v/

"Hi I just started in Medicare insurance last August. I have t done great in my first year.. maybe 30K. I think I'll make \$30K in January 2026 alone from AEP. Is most of your income residual? Do you reach out to your book of business to ask for referrals? If so, what kind of software do you recommend to reach out to them regularly as only about half of mine have emails? Many thanks"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3z4tt/how_much_you_earn_as_insurance_agent/nqb080c/

"I use a Go High Level that I built myself, but if you don't want to do that (and I don't blame you) I would recommend DFY CRM <https://www.dfycrm.com/> The guy who runs it is a former insurance agent and knows what agents need. He can also help you customize it for your own needs. It's good and reasonably priced."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fdphl7/crm_for_medicare_agents_what_do_you_use/lmhgbio/

"Oh I'm a fan. If you're going to get a subsidy based on income, that income should be verified during the enrollment process. Failing to file a return (if required) should be an automatic decline. Failing to provide proof of income should be a decline. Failing to fill out the ACA form - decline."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jpvkoz/big_beautiful_bills_aca_impact/n0zct7v/

"Hi Luis, Brandy Cameron. I have subscribed to your channel and love your videos, I also signed up for Shaun's course so I have your work flows. You have great content, I'm planning to get agent CRM soon but wondered if you have a slide show presentation you use with a client, or is it your smart book you use, I'm wondering how to use a presentation to help cross sale more, any thought about buying your books but wanted your opinion, if you have a presentation I would love to see it and your intake form as well. This video was so helpful and sending out that intake form may help me to. Thank you, keep up the good work. 😊"

— YouTube · 📌 ACA Agents: This Sales Script Closes More Obamacare Clients (Copy & Paste) 📌 · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cLRWdaqypkc&lc=UgzAEaxYtDlgywh7Ox94AaABAq>

↳ @InsuranceAgentTraining (1): "Here is the link to get the ACA and/or Smartbooks: <https://simplyhealthinsurance.thinkific.com/>";

↳ @InsuranceAgentTraining (1): "thank you for watching and commenting"

↳ @InsuranceAgentTraining (1): "I am going make a video this week on cross selling. Stay tuned!! I assume this for cross selling ancillaries to ACA book?"

"> I'm a little confused. I am a new broker aka 2 months ago and I don't even make enough to make ends meet. You're telling me you would sue me to bankruptcy if I bought leads and called you? You bought the lead, right? You bought the liability. Yes I would have no problem suing you and reporting you to the regulator. > Isn't it legal to call since you sign off on it with the lead company???? This is so confusing The lead company calls me illegally with an automated system, uses a fake name, uses a spoofed number, calls my DNC number and because I agreed to the transfer you should be off the hook?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/nfmqzdg/

"Your FMO should be providing the CRM and quoting tools. If you're looking to go independent you should look for an FMO that can provide more specialized services in that area. I would check out this list: <https://redbirdagents.com/medicare-fmo/>;

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/17mm0vw/going_independentsuggestions/k7qclmr/

"Thanks for this! I'm pretty new and structuring my days have been difficult so far. What CRM do you use/recommend? I use Monday & Apollo for my own leads, and Advisor360 for company leads (I work for a MassMutual firm as FA). u/Andrew-Ins-NCC"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1i86tym/how_to_contact_your_leads_a_guide/nki5d8x/

"This is a completely unsolicited review of ACA Express and solely my opinion: I went through the demo video last night and am enrolling in the standard package today (no set up, no monthly, \$20 per app)-this is truly a no brainer for a single producer. I give ACA Express enormous credit on this because they have figured out a great business model-they built in a supplemental benefits option (called Out of Pocket Protector) that, if only added on 10% of the apps, will more than pay the application fees in full for using the system for the first year and provide an on-going stream of income in future years (renewal commissions on the lowest level package are 20% or \$200 per year). For them, of course, as an upline, they get the overrides on all of these sales and I'm sure this will be a significant revenue stream. Just a quickie on the Out of Pocket Protector-it is a typical gap plan, the base premium for an individual is \$69 per month (\$89 for a couple) and includes about \$300 a year in 'routine benefits' for office visits and lab tests-so the actual cost is about \$45 per month Individual and \$39 per month (couple) for all of the other stuff (figure an Accident indemnity plan plus benefits for hospital stays, outpatient surgery, and \$250 for an ER visit) and not a bad deal-I wish there was a critical illness rider that could be added, that would make it even better. In addition to the Standard package they do have a Pro package that is more for call centers and agencies with multiple agents with a monthly fee and lower fee per app. On a scale of 1-10, I give ACA Express an initial 9.2 (if they could eliminate carriers on the agent facing website it would be a 9.9-nothing is a '10' except Bo Derek about 35 years ago)."

— Insurance-Forums.com · ACAexpress.com · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/acaexpress-com.69122/#post-910567>

"I have a high immigrant market in my area. I had a person call last week wanting to cancel their policy because they were not going to renew their expired work permit. They wanted to know if they would need to pay back their subsidy and pay for the services they used during the time they were covered. The Marketplace told them once the insurance company checked their documents they could be libel for paying back the company. I told them that the Marketplace is the only ones that look at documents. The companies do not verify anything. All they need to do is have a social security number. I'm not even sure if it needs to be valid because the system will just say the SSN# you provided could not be verified do you want to reenter it or continue. If you do not add immigration documents and keep hitting continue the application will let you proceed. It will give you a 90 day pass letting you get temporary insurance for that time period with full subsidy and all. That's plenty of time to have major surgery, follow visits and recover for most ailments. I had two with expired documents one presented them and is fine this one did not and asked the suspicious questions. There is a lot of potential for abuse but of course the government thinks people are not smart enough to game the system. The companies are naive to think SEP business is the problem they can be fleeced on both ends during OEP and SEP. Solution give them 90 days to present their documents barring them from full enrollment. If the documents are not presented in that time frame sorry no insurance. Come back next year."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Senate Report: Illegal Immigrants Benefited from Up to \$750M in ObamaCare Subsidies · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/senate-report-illegal-immigrants-benefited-from-up-to-750m-in-obamacare-subsidies.80525/#post-1077573>

"I believe in a system, a plan and if the plan is one contact then move on might be an activity but not a system nor a thorough plan! The idea of drip marketing as in email contact or P/C isn't to make a sale but simply stay in contact. As the above poster noted, the idea is to use it as one of many legs to stay in front of your client. No need to dump any great sizeable amount on it, unless you have a lot of contacts such as an Agency that employs multiple agents! Lets see how this would look. 1st. contact via phone, a call. (apt find but not or no sale go on to step two) 2nd. Actually walk into business with Flyer. (same as 1 go on to step three) 3rd. Letter and brochure as a stuffer. (same as 1 go on to step four) 4th. Call. (same as 1 go on to step five) 5th. P/C (same as 1 go on to step six) Have as many steps as you want, plus mix up the offering. If you place yourself as a Health Expert, okay one can't argue that LTC, DI are not health related! Nor or the up and coming LTC Annuities! Not only but make emphasis on how these Contracts can be used. Such as DI, not only is it health related and should be a part of the big picture of Health Risk but also a valuable Continuation tool employed by businesses!"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Individual Health Insurance Marketing · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/individual-health-insurance-marketing.34/#post-449>

"Selling to 8 agents is completely absurd. Expat may be highly skilled enough to deal with that - which is great, but the average agent is not. Also people tend not to answer their phone on oversold leads. The main issue in my view is who uses affiliates. InsureMe uses affiliates very heavy - I know I sold them leads for many years. Affiliate leads are complete junk as a whole, very low quality. There is a way to run affiliate leads in the mix but it needs to be highly monitored and controlled so your system doesn't get dumped on with a bunch of garbage which is basically what is going on industry wide."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Midyear-2008 Lead Company Update · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/midyear-2008-lead-company-update.6075/#post-79491>

Wishing for a mentor or real training · 16 documents · 16 voices

"I'm a new agent and looking for a IMO that provides proper mentoring and training. I'm currently with an IMO but not a fan of the environment. I want honest sales and reliable income."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3z4t/how_much_you_earn_as_insurance_agent/nq8czox/

"@RedShipsofSpainAgain To be clear Im talking about dental insurance, not health insurance. The original commentor I was responding to said they were looking for dental. The waiting periods for dental make 100% sense. If there werent waiting periods then dental insurance companies would go out of business immediately and dental insurance wouldnt exist. Just think it through logically, if there is no waiting period, then people wouldnt buy dental insurance until they need it. So now, in this example, someone needs some work done thats going to cost them \$3000. They then buy a dental insurance policy for like \$30 - \$50/month, get the work done, make the dental insurance company pay their claim, and then they just cancel the insurance once the work is done. The insurance company made \$30 - \$50 off you but you made them pay hundreds or thousands of dollars. There would be zero reason for you to keep paying your monthly premium because you would just wait until you need some work again and then buy the insurance again. Obviously, that wont work and the company would go under in month 1. With that said for health insurance, its normally just a 14 or 30 day waiting period. And thats because plans have a 30 day free look period. Meaning if for any reason you decide to cancel your plan in the first 30 days, they would refund your first premium. So imagine you get the insurance, go to the hospital or put any claim in and make the insurance company pay out your claim, which again is hundreds or thousands, then you just cancel the policy during the free look period and they refund you your money. You just stole from the insurance company, in that example, they made nothing from you but you got paid out thousands. With that said, I do have access to plans where you could get service immediately, although maybe at a slightly reduced benefit amount, but I always advise my clients to just wait the 30 days. Also, in any other insurance, whether its car insurance or house insurance. You cant wait for your car to get into an accident and then try to buy car insurance and make them pay for your accident. Or wait till your house burns up in flames and then buy house insurance and make them pay for it. No insurance works that way, you need to be responsible and buy it before the issue occurs. So people, wait till they are really sick and need an operation and THEN want to finally get health insurance, once they already have a pre-existing condition. At that point your only option with pre-existing is employer plan or marketplace plan if its open enrollment. Marketplace plans have some waiting periods as well on pre-existing. But again, its just like any other insurance on anything, you cant expect to only buy insurance AFTER the thing they insure comes into question and then say, "insure this immediately!"

— YouTube · The Best and Cheapest Health Insurance for Freelancers in 2020 #freelance #healthinsurance · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Pif7NmPTF-k&lc=UgZCKbTOPfgH56DiQz4AaABAg.994WrBp-VGw99e48xTiVwW>

"Addiction Treatment Facility's Receptionist is Playing Medical Insurance Agent. A "Provider" can't make these types of recommendations? (hint: i'm noticing so much corruption in this industry...but I forget the specific laws regarding this situation). Hi All! I was a Group Medical Benefits Agent/Producer for 6 years...licensed...stopped in 2018. (I live in WA State but I imagine the laws for what I'm explaining here should probably be similar from state to state). I'm not in insurance now...I'm in an "adjacent" industry. Anyway, in late 2018 I got a DUI...and I've been completely sober since...don't judge. 😊 However, as part of the conditions from the court I was required to attend Intensive Outpatient Treatment. I went to a place my lawyer recommended. (I'm 90% positive he receives kickbacks from the treatment center for sending his clients with court orders...but that's for another post...this could easily become a series...truly...the crookedness—on so many layers—in the treatment industry is shocking...and they're doing it all in plain sight). Anyway, I'm 45-years-old...and there are a lot of young folks who attend the program with me. (Learned my lesson later In life maybe? 🙄) I found out that I'm paying MUCH more than MOST of the other people in my "group". My monthly out-of-pocket cost/monthly bill is much higher—obscenely higher—than most everyone else I attend with. I understand VERY well how every plan is different...they reimburse differently...cost shares vary as do deductibles and OOP Max's. I get that...I have BCBS of IL...I work for a large public ally-traded company and my insurance is considered "really good"...it reimburses well...\$1000 ded...and it's a 90% plan...but that's not the point of this post. This specific question came from a girl named Megan who just turned 21. (I changed her name to protect the...er...young :). Anyway, when I asked her about her costs each month she told me that after a month of evening "groups" at "The Center"...the girl who answers phones at the front desk of the treatment center (she makes coffee for before groups too) told her, "Oh you should definitely change your insurance carrier to Amerigroup...it has WAY better coverage and "pays more". Then she said, "I tell EVERYONE to switch to them...I should get commission, haha!". Well...I talked to an old coworker who sells individual policies and, sure enough, Amerigroup definitely reimburses/pays the Treatment Provider aka "The Center" more...so Megan pays less. In other words...it's much better for "The Center" if more of their patients have Amerigroup as their carrier. When I heard this, my ex Agent/Producer ears perked up and I thought, "Wait...I'm pretty sure that NOBODY—in a professional setting, dealing with customers—is supposed to give insurance advice to relative strangers on what insurance to buy or what carrier they should choose, right? Or can they? But I'm pretty positive that Medical or Treatment Providers, specifically, aren't supposed to recommend specific carriers to their patients...or can they?" That's why I'm here asking. My opinion—due to several other reasons—is that this place is crooked and corrupt. First, I want to look into this practice at "The Center". In this specific instance, I'm quite sure the front desk staff has been coached on what plans to recommend "in passing"...and she is making these recommendations based on which Carriers/Plans "reimburse" the most to "The Center"...and she interfaces with 100s of clients/patients every day. Seems like a conflict of interest...right? The WA OIC probably wouldn't like this...ya? Pretty sure I had to take a test, work for a broker, and take C.E. classes periodically; in order to sell health insurance policies...yep...I do remember that. :) Can anyone explain the law here...I'm a bit rusty. Can the Provider in this case potentially be in hot water for this practice? What about the front desk receptionist herself? She is giving advice to people to switch carriers specifically based on how much it reimburses the Provider...or, "because this carrier covers more than your current carrier"...can she potentially be in trouble? Or is it "The Center" who would take the heat for training her that way? She's a nice girl...the front desk gal...but I'm afraid her corrupt overlords could get her in trouble. Thanks for reading all of that!!! This place is advising and billing lots of youngn's...but mostly bilking ACA/State-sponsored insurance plans/carriers...aka Uncle Sam. I kinda wanna "get em". Feel free to ask what else is corrupt there...I'm learning a LOT! :)"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/4n1tg/addiction_treatment_facilitys_receptionist_is/

"It's a little late right now, but if you were looking a month or two ago, everybody was hiring for Medicare and ACA. It's just too late to get appointed. You have to probably go with the W-2 job hard to tell if the higher again during the open enrollment period in January or if they'll start doing their layoffs. There's a lot of seasonal work in this industry. You might be able to find somewhere that has Final Expense by looking on LinkedIn and indeed they're still places reaching out to me for Medicare, but I already have my license and most of them are looking for experience people to hit the ground running because it's so close most places started their training programs already"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wiv3s3/companies_that_train_pay_for_healthlife_insurance/pagzqgd/

"Digital BGA! I'm not independent anymore, but they were the most transparent and offer the highest pay with the strongest Leads (not cheap). They also have solid leads if you need them. They started at 110 when I was there and it went up from there. If you're providing your own leads and don't need training, you should be getting paid over 100%."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wi94nj/looking_to_switch_to_a_good_imo_for_final_expense/pa98hm0/

"Thought I'd add my 2 cents...I joined in July of this year and I still believe there is a lot of potential. I'm tracking everything right now. My costs, my earnings, my hours and I've decided to give it 1 year before redirecting because it is a steep, rough learning curve and people say it can take a year to acclimate. But if you are average and you acclimate, you can be quite successful. Don't compare SFG to an hourly job somewhere else, this is much closer to entrepreneurship and with that in mind you're spending more than you are making at the beginning. Here is my opinion on OP's red flags: 1. Aged leads. Yes, if you buy those ones. Which are great for new agents because they offer practice (and possible sales) for a fraction of the cost. For example, my first sale was with an H lead...that's the cheapest .40 cent lead. I spent \$10 in leads and turned that into \$1000. But I've recently been buying A leads (fresh new leads) and it's much more disappointing not to convert those to sales. I estimate that I've spent \$800 on fresh leads this month and have converted that to about \$4000 income. 2. Culture. I love the group/agency I am a part of. A lot of support. A lot of resources. A lot of community and communication. We just got done doing a 60 day health challenge for anyone who wanted to join. The agency has several leaders and I can validate that some leaders ego's and shame responses are too much for me. I don't like how they talk and I don't respond well to that. They are not my direct upline and I'm glad, but my direct upline is fantastic. 3. Permission for licensing. I've never heard of this. I licensed when and where I wanted to. My upline didn't mention anything other than it will help me succeed if I license in more than one state. They helped me find states that have a lot of leads. 4. Shaming over conferences. Yes. I joined a couple months before their conference and the amount of "if you're not signed up for conference, it shows that you are not committed" type of comments were totally off putting. Again my uplines were not a part of that type of verbiage and in fact some of the leaders were encouraging with, "don't worry if you can't make it, those of us that can make it will share what we learn and use it to bring everyone up" type of conversations. I think conference must feel like some kind of club or like even religion and some people believe in it so much that they think it's the truth and way for everyone. I don't subscribe to that type of hype, but I do hope I can go next year because it not only looked educational, but fun...karaoke and costume party and dinners so if I make it past my 1 year mark I plan to attend. 5. The training. This is my first experience in this training so I can't say it's the worst. Probably again depends on the help you get from your agency. I will say, even though I had a very supportive group it felt very self-taught. But they have the resources for it and there are a lot of different trainings to participate in so it is possible to be self taught. It's hard though. Doable for sure! 6. Mental health. I can absolutely understand the toll an unsupported position could and would have on someone...ESPECIALLY in sales. Sales is a beast. You learn a lot about yourself. It's painful at times and I wish it was a nice cut and dry training and 1 month later you feel great. I'm 3 months in with high highs and low lows. A lot of days I want to give up. But ultimately, I want to give it a full chance. I'm making more than I'm spending (including costs for licensing in other states, dialing subscriptions, and the more expensive A leads) and I think that's pretty good for a new agent. These are just my new agent opinions. I haven't had any experiences with other IMOs or insurance jobs or anything like that. My background is stay at home mom, into mental health practice ownership with my husband, back to stay at home mom, and now SFG."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtqo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/nlrman3/

"This is a very good question. I'll speak from the life and health industry being a daily grind agent for roughly ten years and more of an agency builder/operator for another ten. I've been in a zoom room with several dozen of the largest FMO's for L&H in the US. We were all asked to quickly share our biggest pain point. What happened has stuck with me for the last couple years since. Every single one of the FMO's said the exact same thing. They all had 80% turn over of their agent force per year. I'd always known the 8% number generally for the agency, which I believe is partly that bad because of some of the life insurance MLMs, but it was still amazing to hear from the horses mouth like that. These FMOs represent tens of thousands of agents. There were a few agencies in that group. We didn't have the same answer. I don't remember what each of us said, but, other than I think one agency, it wasn't retention. My father did very well as an agent and then an agency builder for Prudential, Met Life, BMA, in the 80's and 90's when the primary model was brick and mortar agencies with local management and mentorship owned by upline carriers. Retention has ALWAYS been a challenge in the insurance industry largely because it has such promise but such a low initial barrier to entry. That is the #1 reason. Too many people under-estimate the work they will have to do in return for the financial upside. In the last 25 years, though, technology has allow brokers to flourish in comparison to the 80's and 90's. Tech has helped overcome much of the administrative complexity of accessing a wide range of carriers. But the cost has been the erosion of mentorship. This was further exacerbated by some of the big companies becoming poorly managed, either with sick cultures (Bankers after Conseco buy out), bad CEOs (Beneficial Life), a lack of vision to adapt (imo Prudential, NYL, NWM, and many, many old school captives), or even economic tidal waves (Met Life after 2008). All of those companies are shadows of what they used to be. In their place now are FMO/IMOs as the most influential model today. I refer to most of them as 'contract collectors'. They are very, very much in the business of gobbling up as many agent contracts as possible to add to their books and hope they sell something. They focus on scale. This is not bad by itself, but I believe the people running these organizations don't know how to train and support agents at the most human level. By and large, they never (successfully) got in a car over and over and over again with agents to drive to customer houses to sell insurance - successfully. The art and science of developing individual human agents from the ground up and providing effective support has become elusive to a very large portion of the industry. About 5-10% of the people entering the industry will be successful almost no matter the model they land with. They might tumble with some of the worst, but they're made of something special and find success no matter what. 20-30% of people entering will not be successful no matter what. They simply cannot show up to work without the threat of being fired or they may not have or be able to develop the communication skills. Great teachers, trainers, and mentors are determined by what they do with the remaining 75-60% of new agents. The problem is that there's not a lot of those people. Some of them are also now behind screens talking to large audiences and the scale simply dilutes the impact they can have with any individual. There are a number of pieces I think the ideal career model should be made up of, but german to this question is the healthy, talented, and experienced mentor who is there day to day - and that is probably the most valuable piece regardless of the rest of the model."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wq22lv/are_retention_issues_really_one_of_the_biggest_pcp0pmbly/

"Thank you for your feedback. This is just what I am looking for. Curious how much insurance industry experience you had when you went independent? Just passed my certification exam for Property yesterday. As soon as I receive the certificate I can schedule my IL Property License Exams and then get moving. I'll start contacting IMO's next week after my That setup with First Connect and Back9 sounds perfect. Starting out solo I don't want to be going back and forth through a ton of different systems. Curious if anyone has any recommendations for sales training. I came across The Hartford's School of Insurance (HSI). Looks like they cover everything....its for independent agents and carrier neutral. Curious if anyone knows of any others. Planning to start a new post on this as well."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s9z5gr/new_independent_agent_best_imoaggregators/gqxc05/

"Hello from Tampa Area, can you recommend anyone with mentor & "free leads" to start up? I have my Health insurance with 18 states...I make a living as a 1099 Boilerroom Employee LOTS of B.S forever changing pay structure always to the benefit of the partners who play golf till noon come in dressed like GQ & leave 2-3 hours before I lock up I'm a divorced father of 3, 1 in college & 2 wanting to go Expendable cash isn't available to buy leads but I been loyally grinding for the same Insurance Group for 3yrs 6 days a week 9-7 Monday though Friday & half days on Saturday \$2-3k a week isn't cutting IT! I got girls hair, clothes, cars, insurance, tuition + child support I haven't had a vacation in 7yrs Any recommendations?"

— YouTube · I quit my 9 to 5 to sell life insurance (my story) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=waB54YVcAF8&lc=UgzB26ZkOMFtVyQJntJ4AaABAq>

"Liked & Subbed, thank you for this. I have just gotten my Life & Health License and AHIP Certification, and I have signed on with an agency I feel great about and am going through their training to sell Medicare Supps and Adv, and this is exactly the kind of supplemental learning material I came to YT looking for. You're right, the scare tactics work, but I'm looking for how to look out for the best interests of ALL of my clients, and those will be diverse. Thank you for taking the time to be a trustworthy and (as much as possible) unbiased source of information. I will be watching more of your videos now. 🙏🙏🙏"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzASioCYNGGRocd_VR4AaABAq

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much, Layla! 🙏🙏"

"Thanks for sharing your experience! Was it one major issue or a combination of things? In my research, I've noticed they seem to push a lot of additional products—CRM, website, leads, etc.— so I'm curious if that played a role in your decision. I would love to have more of a grassroots type agency, only leaning on them for access to the carriers & training. Of course, those perks would come with a premium, but I want the freedom to use or not use them. Any insights you can share would be invaluable. Thanks again!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jykgig/new_agent_choosing_an_fmo_vs_going_direct_advice/mjrxfgb/

"I'm open, but I don't feel I'd get the training I'd need to be successful. I worked at a captive agency for about a month in a producer role and was learning both insurance and working aged leads and was let go for not meeting expectations. I've had sales jobs in the past and been able to perform, but not sure if I'll be given any grace to start learning the ropes"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wmw7pl/what_would_you_do/pbab9af/

"This is a convo you should have with your up-line and mentors or someone doing this at a high-level. I've noticed from many agents that I work with from FFL many of the groups use a "cream rises to the top approach" to training. Many agencies that are using aged leads send them through an automated dialer and use AI to be more efficient. The two biggest challenges with telesales is getting someone on the phone or an appointment and finding a buyer. With aged leads you have to be able to solve both those issues. My agency uses inbound calls. Solves those two issues. Find a system that works and run with it."

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vftpsq/not_many_sales/p1w7sky/

"steven2244 said: Am new to this site... hi everyone! Am a long time Indiv broker who sees \$\$ coming. At any rate, I completed the training - anyone know anything about Step 2 - registering to work the Fed & State marketplaces? I'll take all the news on that you've got, thanks! Part 2 is still getting thrown together. p.s. You may want to take one of those dollar signs away once you hear your commission %"

— Insurance-Forums.com · CMS - Marketplace Registration · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/cms-marketplace-registration.56716/#post-740518>

"Am new to this site... hi everyone! Am a long time Indiv broker who sees \$\$ coming. At any rate, I completed the training - anyone know anything about Step 2 - registering to work the Fed & State marketplaces? I'll take all the news on that you've got, thanks!"

— Insurance-Forums.com · CMS - Marketplace Registration · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/cms-marketplace-registration.56716/#post-740516>

"SafeLife Policy is the place where I'm at and I've built a 6-figure business very quickly. You really should be looking for strong mentorship above all else though. My agents are successful because of our team, system, and training. Good luck!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pftb0n/new_agent_planning_to_become_an_independent/nsoj1x0/

Looking for a new FMO / IMO that delivers · 13 documents · 13 voices

"Independent agent looking for IMO with no requirements — just carrier access Independent agent here. I run my own leads and dialer and don't need training or a system. Looking for a true hands-off IMO/FMO that offers: \- Street-level comp \- No required meetings or Zoom \- No CRM fees \- Full contract ownership Just want carrier access and to be left alone to produce. Any recommendations?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s75pbn/independent_agent_looking_for_imo_with_no/

↳ Hot-Trainer1209 (2): "Safe Life - use go high level for CRM, it's \$10/yr. Meet all your other requirements, if you want to learn about inbound leads, we have those too."

↳ Tahoptions (1): "Any of the large IMOs that service the financial advisor world would fit these requests. Crump, Ash, FIG, Back9, TMA, CPS, there are a ton of them."

↳ Dependent_Estimate83 (1): "Yeah, looking into crump right now, looks good!"

"I'm a new agent and looking for a IMO that provides proper mentoring and training. I'm currently with an IMO but not a fan of the environment. I want honest sales and reliable income."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3z4tt/how_much_you_earn_as_insurance_agent/nq8czox/

"I'm primarily looking for a FMO that will send me a birthday card."

— Insurance-Forums.com · What is important to you in selecting an upline FMO? · 4 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/what-is-important-to-you-in-selecting-an-upline-fmo.94948/#post-1259111>

"New Agent Choosing an FMO vs. Going Direct – Advice Needed! Hello everyone, I'm a newly licensed agent in Virginia, and I'm currently in the process of choosing an FMO to work with. Right now, training and support are my biggest priorities—even more than commission splits—because I know that with excellent training, the money will follow. Primarily, I want to start off offering Medicare (with the hopes to offer my clients ACA & possibly Life at a much later date, after I gain an understanding of the industry, but only as supplements to their needs). It's my understanding that I could work for multiple FMOs, as one may not entirely fulfill my needs. 😊 I've been looking at Gordon Marketing, TR King Insurance Marketing, Ritter, and Redbird, but I've seen mixed feedback. Some people say Gordon Marketing gives off MLM vibes—does anyone here have experience with them? I've also seen advice about finding an upline and then letting them be your contact because going directly to an FMO will get you lost in their hierarchy without direct support and guidance. On the flip side, I came across a comment saying that going direct with carriers (rather than using an FMO) is a better route. I'd love to hear from anyone who's done this: Did you have prior experience before going direct? Do the carriers provide strong training & support, or would I be on my own? For those in Virginia, what are the most prevalent carriers I should consider contracting with? Also, I want to run my own agency and generate my own leads. I'm not looking for an FMO that requires me to buy leads from them or forces me into a specific system. I just want solid training. If, down the line, I decide to buy leads, I'd like the option, but I don't want to be locked into it. I want to set myself up for success long-term and avoid jumping around between FMOs. Any insights or personal experiences would be greatly appreciated! Thanks in advance!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jyikig/new_agent_choosing_an_fmo_vs_going_direct_advice/

↳ NAF1138 (4): "If you want your focus to be on Medicare, I would add, in order, 1) supplemental health (Hospital plans, Cancer plans, home health plans, dental plans.) All of your Medicare clients could likely use some or all of these. 2) Final Expense Life. Easy add on if you just look to fix problems with people's existing life insurance. 3) ACA but not to go after a large ACA book. So you can sell ACA to spouses and referrals. Mostly to grab them as future Medicare clients. 4) annuities. Lots of clients will have CDs, 401ks and other amounts of money that are essentially doing nothing for them. You probably can do number 1 after six months. 2 after 2 years. 3 a year after that. And 4 after you have been in the business for about 6 years. Go slow. Work intentionally. Build a long term business."

↳ NAF1138 (3): "If you want training and support you don't want to go direct. The carriers don't care about you and mostly don't know anything about selling insurance. They are not where you want to be trained. The only exception being the captive sales forces of certain carriers. You also, want to pick ONE of those things in your list. Do not come out the gate trying to sell Medicare, ACA, Annuities and Life. You will never learn to sell any of them that way. They are all different and sometimes conflicting sales processes. They can all easily keep you busy full time. You will essentially be doing 4 jobs full time badly. Of the FMOs you mentioned, TR King is actually run by a decent human who cares about his people. Ritter is good if you know what you are doing or are working with an agent who is running an agency under them, but doing direct to Ritter is the same as going direct to the carrier. Redbird, I don't know anyone who works their but they have a reasonably good reputation. I don't know Gordon Marketing at all. That doesn't mean anything though, no one knows everyone."

↳ voidsarcastic (3): "Like commission rates? Luckily they're all pretty close carrier to carrier so sell the best plan for the client every-time, and every client is different so different plans and carriers work better for different people. Pretty sure MAPD is the same rate for every carrier (315 renewal 650 IEP) however over-rides may be different and some offer HRA bonus. Most supplements are 20-23% annual (first year advance), and dental/HI is like 45-50% annual (first year advance). Be careful some MAPD plans are non-commissionable i do avoid those, but there really aren't many. I have however done no commission part Ds, you gotta do what you gotta do. Life commissions should be between 80%-115% (9 month- 12 month advance) starting out, if you're taking a lower comp from the FMO make sure you are getting lots of support."

"I do Say at least a 2 week free lead gen , to help agents generate some income , or a month . training , make agents feel like their somewhere where they are serious ab improving, inbound sounds great as well . Also looking for a new agency , sign me up lol !! 🍷 "

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p7ouj4/starting_my_own_life_insurance_agency_i_have/nqzfi9w/

"Looking for FMO Comparison Chart Hi all, I'm about to become an independent insurance producer in Michigan, and looking to sell only medicare products. There are so many FMO/IMO available, but cannot decide which ones to choose. Any charts/comparison available for most FMO stating what insurance they contract and what commission?"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1ty6ew/looking_for_fmo_comparison_chart/

↳ [deleted] (2): "Not sure about a comparison chart but I would look into Futurity First. It was formerly Senior Market Sales."

"Curious who your company is cause I am looking for a new IMO/FMO and yours sounds legit... coming from a mlm type of agency"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/mkv0ypx/

"Anyone have Humana take their book of business when they switched from Individual to a new Upline? Humana calls it a strategic partner move, so therefore they've moved my commissions to a house account." I just received another communication, that they say I owe them money, too."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kotgtz/medicare_agent_commissions/mxc3knm/

"I get what you mean, but a lot of carriers don't contract directly with individual agents. I'm looking for an IMO mainly for access to multiple carriers and good compensation."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wi94nj/looking_to_switch_to_a_good_imo_for_final_expense/pa8q9z4/

"DS4 said: I'm primarily looking for a FMO that will send me a birthday card. low expectations..."

— Insurance-Forums.com · What is important to you in selecting an upline FMO? · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/what-is-important-to-you-in-selecting-an-upline-fmo.94948/#post-1259140>

"In search of Mortgage Protection Upline who is excellent at selling I just passed my life insurance exam. More importantly than an IMO, I am looking for an upline that is excellent at sales. I have multiple opportunities at different IMOs but those uplines do not have records of big numbers and have just switched to recruiting because it is easier for them. I am looking for someone to go all in under."

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wk2l9f/in_search_of_mortgage_protection_upline_who_is/

↳ dumnm (2): "You aren't going to find it here. It's against the rules for us to recruit in this subreddit. Anyone who dms you to join is breaking the rules. We can however recommend companies and agencies."

↳ Striped-Tiger28 (1): "Where would I find it?"

"Looking to switch to a good IMO for Final Expense Looking for a good IMO for Final Expense. I'm already licensed and actively producing, so I'm mainly looking for a solid IMO to get contracted through. I don't need leads, training, scripts, or coaching. Just looking for good carrier access, competitive comp, and a straightforward contracting process. Any recommendations?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wi94nj/looking_to_switch_to_a_good_imo_for_final_expense/

↳ Key_Astronomer6500 (2): "Digital BGA! I'm not independent anymore, but they were the most transparent and offer the highest pay with the strongest Leads (not cheap). They also have solid leads if you need them. They started at 110 when I was there and it went up from there. If you're providing your own leads and don't need training, you should be getting paid over 100%."

↳ Sirrophog (2): "I can get you a direct contract with ethos"

↳ Internal_Rain3145 (1): "I get what you mean, but a lot of carriers don't contract directly with individual agents. I'm looking for an IMO mainly for access to multiple carriers and good compensation."

"I'm looking for recommendations for a solid life insurance IMO/FMO. Hello! I'm a new agent and I'm looking for an IMO/FMO that has a solid free lead program but also will gives the option of moving up to independent 100%+ commission. I really think I need a foundation to learn and I want to be trained in different types of life insurance like final expense, term, IUL, etc. I also would need it to be flexible as I work as a full time nurse 3 12hr shifts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wfvv2/im_looking_for_recommendations_for_a_solid_lif_e/

↳ Hot-Trainer1209 (1): "You need a free leads program to start and get established. I know there are a few."

↳ Witty_Escape_269 (1): "Any that you recommend?"

↳ dumnm (1): "Insurtech, Insurance Supermarket, and Dig Agency are all fully remote. Dig agency now has a fee to join (which gets to my understanding refunded 125% if you sell 10 policies in 30 days) but they're super solid. I work for Insurance Supermarket, and they offer 18-30 base pay, license reimbursement, 15-40% commission based on performance, and free inbound leads. Insurtech does a base pay but idk about their commission structure. Watch David Duford's video on how to choose an agency: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZhiCl9Mnrvq>;

Wishing someone had told them the truth about the job · 9 documents · 9 voices

"Rant- Big Red is one of the worst employers (and the most petty) I've had a long career and in my 25 years I've worked at a lot of carriers. Some were better than others but most of them weren't terrible. That is until I worked for Big Red. I should have known from the horrible interviewing/hiring process it was going to be bad. A recruiter reached out because a colleague gave them my name. I applied and didn't hear back for three months. They initially offered me to interview for section manager position but after the interview they decided to offer me a team manager position. I wasn't going to accept but my wife convinced me that it could be a good opportunity. I agreed to the position. Then my first day it was absolute chaos. 900 people starting at the exact time as me and my credentials not working. No phone number to call or anything. Finally at 3pm after panicking that I left my consulting gig and wasn't getting hired I got a phone call asking why I wasn't online. This lead to them telling me I never signed my offer letter. Fast forward and it turns out they changed their mind and were offering me the section manager position but no one called. I'm now a section manager Fast forward a few months and this job is hell. I spent two months getting the most basic training ever. None of it has anything to do with management. None. I am never taught how to use the time card system. I'm not taught T2 or Workday. Nothing. Then I'm saddled with a team that has questions from minor claim stuff to HR issues. That I have no idea on how to handle. Then my claim manager has the nerve to tell me I need to get my CPCU, that management is expected to have their CPCU. I have my CPCU. So I tell him that. He asks why I haven't been putting it in signature. It's simple I don't see value in it when I have decades of real experience. He then tells me that I need to continuously improve and to sign up for another designation. I choose the ARe. I go on and buy the three ARe exams study material and sign up for the tests. I take the first one and pass. Then I sign up for the next two. I decided to get all the materials for a few other designations that overlap the CPCU (like 6 other study materials). Keep in mind I'm using the corporate codes. While all this is going on I am still trying to figure out the job. I have leaders asking me questions and talking to me like I should know how certain obscure systems work. The absolute worst part is the other new folks. I had four brand new team managers reporting to me. Three were external hires and one was an internal hire. I honestly felt like every day I was letting down my team because I didn't have the faintest clue how to teach them systems that I didn't have any clue how to use. There was zero training for them. These folks had brand new adjusters of their own and they didn't know how to help them. I had one associate get out to the middle of the country in their van and their gas card stopped working. This is a 22 year old recent grad with no real world experience. Stuck in the middle of the country because they don't have enough spare credit to pay to keep filling up that gas hog. Their team manager had no clue how to fix the situation and I had no clue. It took us three days to find someone to fix it. I felt like pure dog shit. No one would respond to emails other than giving a vague area of the internal portal. All the while my one on ones were just my claim manager asking me about personal development. Develop my skills in how all this runs.... I resigned a couple of weeks ago and it was the most asinine process I've ever seen. My claim manager was on time off. None of his colleagues would respond. I go to HR and they don't have a process for it. Finally after they fail to reach anyone they "take a message". Eventually I get an email saying mail back the laptop, phone, and mifi. The final touch is that they emailed me a list of stuff to return them. Which is a lot more exhaustive than they originally said. It's not like I wanted to keep the equipment. It's honestly that I didn't even keep most of it. When I got hired on I was originally going to be a team manager so they sent me adjusting equipment. I've worked at this so long I've got better equipment than the junk they gave me. So I literally threw a lot of it away and gave the rest to younger adjusters I knew. I didn't even keep the monitors because I had a nice office already. They hounded me for weeks over it. The box I did send back was so small the laptop had to sit diagonal and I got a nasty email about the laptop being damaged. (They provided the box) Then they did the most petty thing ever.... I had a test scheduled with The Institutes for April 15th. Today they had the institutes send me an email asking for certain printed material back and they removed my online access to all the material and my last scheduled test. I understand the test, sure you don't want to pay for that. But to go back and retroactively remove study material is absolutely insane work. Especially because I purchased corresponding tests to that material with my own money since they only pay for one exam per quarter. End rant. Actually P.S.- when people say that the company is failing. It's not for all the obvious reasons. At its heart it's because it's become a bloated bureaucracy. In all their efforts to streamline and create operating procedures for everything, they have made the whole process inefficient. They can't keep employees because they won't invest in their training. New adjusters with two months of training shouldn't be set wild to figure it out on their own. Designations shouldn't become the goal of what success looks like."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 76 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1jzcv0m/rant_big_red_is_one_of_the_worst_employers_and/

↳ UpOutThatJam (36): "I'm always confused on if big red is the umbrella or the farm."

↳ TheHiddenMessenger (26): "In this case the farm lol. I'm the same way with "big blue". Is it the emu or the good hands"

↳ snuggly-kitten (18): "This is one of the reasons I'm terrified of leaving my position at a smaller carrier. I've been asked to apply at places that pay more and couldnt do it. I can figure out almost anything on my own with a couple emails. Your experience is my worst nightmare. What are your next steps, if you don't mind sharing?"

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

↳ Legio-V-Alaudae (45): "If it was so easy and well paying, they wouldn't have to advertise the hell out of the jobs. I'm sorry you didn't have a healthy amount of skepticism when conducting due diligence."

↳ Candid_Worth_3629 (25): "Did you not ask for any advice from this subreddit or do any research prior to leaving your 9-5? Everyone would've told you to keep the main job and start out part time. It's also really important to be at a place that doesn't make you churn \$ for leads. Most are MLM schemes"

↳ jordan32025 (20): "Anyone who doesn't understand that AP written is not the same as the commission percentage shouldn't start a life insurance business. Also, going into it thinking it's a "job" is recipe for guaranteed failure. There is some financial literacy needed. This precisely why I don't recruit people who are not already actively selling consistently with a good carrier. They already know how to run a business."

"If you were starting over today with no book of business and no carrier appointments, what would you do first? Hi everyone, I officially passed my Texas Life & Health licensing exam yesterday (self studied via an online prep course), and I'm trying to be very intentional about how I build my business from Day 1. A little background: I'm 39 and transitioning from a successful corporate finance career (\$175k, annual) after being laid off in 2025. I want to use this unexpected time to invest in a career pivot to an independent producer, eventually building up to a small boutique style agency. Short-term, I plan to focus on Medicare, ACA, Life Insurance, and Supplemental Health. Longer-term, I'd like to expand into ICHRA and small employer benefits, but I don't want to spread myself too thin in the beginning. My vision is to build a referral- and relationship-based business. I'm much more interested in creating a trusted advisory practice than becoming a high-pressure salesperson. If you were in my shoes today —with no book of business, no carrier appointments, and no industry experience—but knowing what you know now: What would your first three steps be? What mistakes would you avoid? Would you join an agency/FMO first, or would you try to build independently from Day 1? Is there anything you wish someone had told you before your first year? I'm not necessarily looking for the "highest commission" straight away. Instead, I'm trying to build the strongest long-term foundation and book of business. I genuinely appreciate any advice from those who've been through it. Thanks in Advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uxw9ko/if_you_were_starting_over_today_with_no_book_of/

↳ idontknowhow2reddit (7): "I agree with all of this. Insurance is a crazy world so there's a ton of things to learn. The textbook and real world are very different so I would try to find an established company with good training to work for first. Without that, it will be hard to build a referral base or to gain that trusted advisor role. Your network and other professionals are going to need to see you in the industry a bit before they will trust you on your own."

↳ Key_Astronomer6500 (5): "Congrats! For someone who also got into insurance later in my career. 1. Pick one product and master it, then move into the second one, and so on. Medicare, ACA, Final Expense, Annuities, etc. 2. Training. Master that product and then move to the second. W 2 or Captive will give you the most training. 40 a week of training vs 1 or 2 hours a week. 3. Pick the right organization. Know the difference between recruiters selling me vs legitimate interviews. I wish someone told me about how many recruiters would try to sell me and then offer no support. I am so glad I left and went into a W2 to learn and get practice but I wish someone told me how difficult releases were! Best of luck but honestly someone with your degree of previous success should be fine. Just remember you're not gonna make as much money at first. You'll probably need to go independent to make more than 125k. However, I would suggest to build that foundation first but as long as you know what you're getting into I think you'll do great."

↳ OZKInsuranceGuy (5): "If I had to start over today, the first thing I'd do is choose my upline very carefully. The wrong agency/upline can cost you years of your career. Second, I'd pick one niche and master it before trying to sell everything. Too many new agents want to do Medicare, ACA, final expense, annuities, group benefits...and end up not getting very good at any of them. Third, I'd get in front of people every single workday. Nothing replaces activity. I'd rather have a decent script and 15 appointments than the perfect script and no one to talk to. The biggest mistakes I'd avoid are buying into recruiting hype (MLMs), signing contracts without understanding release policies, and spending time on useless activities, like tweaking logos, trying to figure out every detail of CRMs, or building websites than actually selling. I would absolutely suggest joining an agency first. I'd choose one based on transparency, track record, proven training and scripts, and upline (again, upline is very important). Make sure you're paid directly by the carriers, understand exactly how releases work (get it in writing), and ask a lot of questions before you sign anything. Once you start selling, consistency is key. Focus on activity, because your input determines your output. Work hard, follow your upline's advice and system, and don't get distracted by other opportunities or anything else."

"Man I wish someone told me about the cluster trap earlier. Joined a big one first year and the exit clause was basically "we own your book forever" - took me 3 years to buy my way out of that mess. Read every contract like your life depends on it, especially the part about who actually own the business when you leave For software don't go crazy at start. I spent like \$800/month on fancy CRM that I barely used first 6 months. Get good rater and simple accounting, rest can wait until you got actual revenue coming in. The only thing worth paying for right away is a decent phone system and maybe EZLynx if you do personal lines What worked best for leads was literally just walking into real estate offices with donuts on Saturday morning. Cost me 15 bucks and got more referrals than the \$500/month online leads I tried. Would specialize early too, I wasted 2 years trying to write everything and made no money until I focused only on contractors"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vwadgv/independent_agency_owners_what_would_you_do/p5fdhsa/

"Really depends on what kind man but I wish I knew how disgustingly vile the industry was and how disgustingly stupid medicare advantage clients are. I tried to be a knight. I really really did and got shit on over and over. Im still fully compliant but if Agnus wants the worst medical coverage I have ever seen in order to get a grocery card im sighning her up Had plenty of people turn down the beat coverage in their area because it didnt have a giveback or card and even one where EVERYTHING was better but he would lose just 20 bucks on his giveback, thats it. Save 100's on his meds and seeing doctors and great out of pocket too Still said nah over the 20. If theres a really good policy I see but it'd be humana hmo to humana hmo so I wont get paid I aint talking about it. The very very very few times when I ask about medical needs or coverage and they actually tell me something im more than happy to find best i can offer but that NEVER happens. Its always oh idk oh you tell me.which obviously I cant tell you. Maybe 2 of 300 conversations are about actual medical needs or concerns. I also see TONS that dont even know they were switched recently or pending a switch or any of that and when they say they didn't know I fully beleive them because the checked out ones or no medical decision ones I bang on anyway"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r86i3q/whats_the_hardest_part_of_being_an_insurance/o62oxd3/

"My experience working for AIL so far: USA based here; i finished my training with them in early December and have been with them since. I encountered the same issues as OP with the MacBook compatibility issue however no one told me this beforehand. Instead i had to buy cheap windows laptops hoping they would work but ended up having to spend even more (\$300) on Parallels to run windows on my MacBook bc anything under that price in a laptop was absolute shit. I've made a few sales but nothing that allows me to even pay rent; I'm fortunate enough to have a partner who is able to support us during this time but if i had kids?? Forget it. I dont even have time for my 2 pups really, let alone the piling dishes, laundry, and other chores I'm falling behind with in the house. Most are not going to be successful in this field, and requires you to be a dog in sales while being taught that we're protecting families, this is true, but the lovely motivational words are blanketing bait-and-switch tactics we use with clients to force our products on them and force to make a decision that same night when they didn't even know they would be shown life insurance products in the first place. It doesn't make sense that we have to use such shady tactics to sell our products when the products themselves are very good honestly and at affordable comparative rates to other companies. I love helping people, and when i have to meet with someone who has a very limited income that knows for a fact they will be working until the day die, it becomes insensitive for me to say "okay but what's your retirement plan" and basically have to ignore their honesty about their financial situation and continue to push them into signing up for a life long bill to leave money for their family; obviously the concept of life insurance is valuable and i see the need for every family to have it, but I'm completely ignoring the reality that many people just cannot afford to take on another bill for whatever valuable reason it may be, and assuming there will be a time when they comfortably decide to stop working is just pretentious in today's reality. My background is working in retail/ management and for the life of me I can't get behind working for no base pay and all commission, the potential for getting rich is a long game here, and for anyone with recurring bills TODAY this is not the path for you (including myself). Everything you're taught about the customer being right is incorrect here and requires reworking that mentality to be pushy and somewhat tone deaf to accomplish your own goals while 'protecting a family's needs' (if their needs are X amount and they can only afford 1/4 of x amount, am i really properly protecting this family then or just making a buck??) Don't get me started on the leads we call. We are promised it's not cold calling and only requested by the people themselves but let me tell you there must be an underlying temporary amnesia issue going on in the world if so because half the people absolutely do not remember making a request that will be listed from a couple days before or the lead will be for a product they have 00000000 connection with (a single man with no gf or kids endin up as child safe kit lead in my pack). You'll also be contacting people other agents resolved so people will be pretty fed up on the phone, even policy holders who are harassed several times a year by us for a 'policy review' where we continue to upsell and tell them they're coverage isn't enough anymore. I have seen my relationship take a hit even though he's been as supportive as possible to see if this career can work for us. I am about to go back to retail bc i know i at least can depend on a check coming in after putting in 40 hours of effort every week For reference my work weeks have been 7 days a week for avg of 9 hours/day. Training takes up other hours in my day for work that has to be done on my personal time. There is a 'suggested' schedule but if you don't follow it you will be talked to over and over about it until you do. Honestly dangling the WFH carrot in my face blanketed me to doing any proper research before hand to see how the real employee experience is at AIL. Sorry for the super disorganized rant but I'm avoiding making dials right now LOL"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1i1evot/ailglobe_life_scam_employees_were_suing/m7mtwat/

"Figured I would post my thought to save everyone reading some money... CABOOM leads provides below average leads with a 20% answer rate when called 10-15 times in the first 3 days. Most of the IUL leads who answered were dead broke and unqualified. They were VERY FAR from high intent leads that were ready to buy. I should have known based on their advertising that it was sketchy, but I thought spending more would lead to higher quality leads. I was wrong. I started to focus more on buying annuity leads since this is my primary niche after a few weeks of failed IUL leads (that I thought were a fluke at the time - 60 leads total). I made the mistake of signing up for an annuity lead subscription after seeing high praise from an annuity producer I respect. I was even more disappointed with these leads. I ordered 20 leads per month for \$5000 and was told by my representative that I could cancel if I was very disappointed, but he assured me that I would have at least a 3x return on investment... Keep in mind that I actually have wealth management experience selling \$4M of annuities and mutual funds last year.... I ordered in mid-February and it's now early April and I STILL haven't received my first 20 leads. In late February, I ordered another 10 leads hoping that my lead flow would come in faster, and none have been delivered from this order. Most leads were not serious anyway and had no clue that the ad was talking about annuities... I had a similar experience on the IUL leads. I believe their ads are misleading and trick people into thinking they are getting some kind of free benefit that does not exist... I thought Cody was one of the good guys in the industry, but I'm not sure I trust him or his team. Quite frankly, their advertising is extremely misleading - "ready to buy" is garbage.m, but I blame this on myself for falling for the trap... Also, lots of other shady practices like offering discounts for POSITIVE reviews only, sending out a FAKE April fools message that they are no longer accepting new clients to trick people into buying with urgency, advertising that leads are vetted and ready to buy (all they do is respond to a text code - I'm not sure if I even believe this), and worst of all, not following through on promises. I have been unable to cancel my subscription order even though I am highly displeased and I have not even received 20 leads although I've ordered 30+ more than a month ago"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/mkvaioj/

"There was an AMA on here a few months ago where the dude swears on his ACA success comes from buying leads, but qualifying the lead companies. I'm like you, everything in person for the older folks, but I do wonder if there's anything to lead generation. I should add when pressed on sharing the lead generation companies he works with, the AMA OP wouldn't share publicly. Now was that out of competitive advantage or is that dude full of it? I wish I knew. Guess AMA doesn't mean I'll answer anything 🤔"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s8e1si/be_your_own_boss_80_starting_commission_change/odoknzo/

"Girl, same I feel you on this. I started a year ago being an independent life insurance agent and buying leads is crazy and nobody tells you they just tell you about getting a license, but no one talks about the startup cost of the fingerprints. The license is for each state and also how expensive fresh leads are and even aged leads so I had to look for a company that provided leads to get my feet wet and get experience because it was so discouraging."

— YouTube · A REAL Day in the Life of a Life Insurance Agent (Work from home) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JDaChBx6i6Q&lc=Ugxy16rMqeHI7akC9dd4AaABAg_AM3ga4OZquAA_u1B2vB5Vvk

Wishing for leads that are real, exclusive and consented · 7 documents · 7 voices

"How do y'all deal with actually insane clients? Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride. I answer the phone. Lady leads with "I went to your office and you guys vanished in the middle of the night! Do I even have insurance!? I'm reporting you to the government!" Reality: we moved nine months ago. Across the parking lot. Our Google listing has been updated. All our policy docs reflect the new address. There's a literal sign taped to the old door with an arrow saying "we moved next door." She then accuses me of not mailing her documents because I'm "screwing with her bill." Her payment has changed once in the last. It went down from \$92 to \$84. At this point she's yelling more about reporting me for moving. I told her "I'm not interested in getting yelled at. What would you like from me today?" She rants a bit more. I respond with "Okay. I am happy to transfer you to another office if that sounds good to you." She ranted more and eventually hung up. Curious how other agents handle the loons like this. I'd love to move her out of my book, but also can't really do it without her consent. People are nuts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

↳ Neither-Historian227 (19): "I had a dozen death threats during the pandemic when government locked everyone down and destroyed their businesses, this is cake walk"

↳ NovelMotor7972 (13): "Are you kidding me? I deal with crazy people for a living. Lol I've literally had people misstate their income on a recorded line, make a complaint against me to the office of financial regulation, and cause a whole ordeal over their own tax penalty, because they misstated their income. I learned my lesson, every single one of them signs a disclosure that this is the income that they are stating."

↳ BroWeBeChilling (12): "It wears on youafter ten years I have heard it all. About 20% of the people are always unhappy. This has worn on me everyday especially since most people don't take responsibility for not paying their bills, their bank made a mistake, they never got a notice in the mail or to their email. Then they take it out on me. I try brushing it off but for sure after one heart attack my life is shortening everyday."

"You are spending a grand a week and your ending up with only a few "premium" ...your stuck in a tiered system. Who is your imo ...symmetry ...NASB...ffl...they all do that to agents. Not cool. For a grand a week (which is a good budget) you should be getting brand new exclusive leads ...no aged recycled leads....none. Aged are good if they are super cheap ...but why bother if you have the budget for new? As far as the FB lead campaigns ...we use them ...they are good for agents so you have the control of your own leads. All fresh ...never re sold...and you know where they come from. The cost is so much better. We also use live transfers...again that way you know its your lead...and they are interested. Good luck!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mfu7pr/considering_trying_a_facebook_lead_campaign/n6jpo6o/

"Figured I would post my thought to save everyone reading some money... CABOOM leads provides below average leads with a 20% answer rate when called 10-15 times in the first 3 days. Most of the IUL leads who answered were dead broke and unqualified. They were VERY FAR from high intent leads that were ready to buy. I should have known based on their advertising that it was sketchy, but I thought spending more would lead to higher quality leads. I was wrong. I started to focus more on buying annuity leads since this is my primary niche after a few weeks of failed IUL leads (that I thought were a fluke at the time - 60 leads total). I made the mistake of signing up for an annuity lead subscription after seeing high praise from an annuity producer I respect. I was even more disappointed with these leads. I ordered 20 leads per month for \$5000 and was told by my representative that I could cancel if I was very disappointed, but he assured me that I would have at least a 3x return on investment... Keep in mind that I actually have wealth management experience selling \$4M of annuities and mutual funds last year.... I ordered in mid-February and it's now early April and I STILL haven't received my first 20 leads. In late February, I ordered another 10 leads hoping that my lead flow would come in faster, and none have been delivered from this order. Most leads were not serious anyway and had no clue that the ad was talking about annuities... I had a similar experience on the IUL leads. I believe their ads are misleading and trick people into thinking they are getting some kind of free benefit that does not exist... I thought Cody was one of the good guys in the industry, but I'm not sure I trust him or his team. Quite frankly, their advertising is extremely misleading - "ready to buy" is garbage.m, but I blame this on myself for falling for the trap... Also, lots of other shady practices like offering discounts for POSITIVE reviews only, sending out a FAKE April fools message that they are no longer accepting new clients to trick people into buying with urgency, advertising that leads are vetted and ready to buy (all they do is respond to a text code - I'm not sure if I even believe this), and worst of all, not following through on promises. I have been unable to cancel my subscription order even though I am highly displeased and I have not even received 20 leads although I've ordered 30+ more than a month ago"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/mkvaioj/

"The problem is not putting hard work, if you went through the process you know that if you don't work hard you won't get any leads in r call people... The problems is that in the beginning they don't tell you but you will be getting old ass leads... and that's is frustrating... still not a cold call but some people don't even remember they signed up for... not to mention other agents that don't resolve their bad leads so it goes back to the pile as a no answer... and guess what? You will eventually call a bunch of people who already said are not interested many times... so I've seen some new agents taking many weeks just to book something remotely good... People who jump into this desperate for money and with no much time to climb up until get fresh leads will not last long, it's a fact, and they should be open about that from the get go... instead they hype you up, push you to learn all scripts and so on, and when you are finally ready you will spend 80 of you time going through a list of leads and calling people that never pickup the phone."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cy9b7k/im_stuck_at_globe_life_american_income_life_and_i/ms4ol22/

"Looking for Legit T65 Leads Like the title says does anyone know of any legit compliant T65 lead companies I can speak with? Thanks!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r39olh/looking_for_legit_t65_leads/

↳ noexcuses14 (4): "The T65 people get absolutely buried in mailers. Most of them get their names sold over and over, even when the company claims they are only going to one person. You will do better with finding partnership lead sources. Try financial planners who need a health insurance agent to partner with. You will do even better if you are also selling under 65."

↳ Sir-Ult-Dank (3): "Self generated thru networking or doing own seminars. Medicare requires being really compliant or falls back to you. Good luck"

↳ TruckInn (2): "I found an agency that offer 1-4 seminars per month to their LOAs. Helped at the beginning tremendously. Dialling or doing mail leads never worked for me tbh"

"I am referring to using a different lead vendor. Vendors offering exclusive leads are more expensive, but worth it to get a client that is looking for insurance. BA Leads are the only leads I received that were absolutely horrible — not recommending you buy more of them by any means! (Just wanted to clarify)"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/movynrx/

"I have had them since last October. The leads lately have been difficult to contact and my wife is not setting a high pct. They have been ok at times. My acct runs out of money in a week or two and I am still undecided if I will reactivate and re-fund the acct. We have more success with Insureme overall, but their appts have slipped in quality also. Setting too high an expectation for lead companies will result in disappointment. If you are struggling and depending on lead companies for most of your business it is going to be very difficult to find satisfaction. I would pay more for an honest exclusive lead, but at this point I have not found a source that is willing to take it on. It is very expensive to do, and it requires a commitment of resources aimed at a specific geographic area. Lead companies have as much trouble trusting agents and their level of commitment as agents have of lead companies. It is a two way street, and both parties have commitment anxieties."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Insuranceleads.com · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/insuranceleads-com.10352/#post-137981>

Tab 8 — Desired Outcomes

A book of business paying renewals · 64 documents · 20 voices

"State Farm just rewrote 19,000 agents' contracts overnight. If you think a captive book is a retirement plan, read this If you somehow missed it: State Farm is moving all 19,000 of its agents onto a single standardized contract, ending their deferred-comp/retirement program (AIPP), and dropping health insurance for agents and spouses. Agents are reportedly looking at 30–40% less on base commissions depending on contract and book size. I can't believe State Farm disputes that number but hasn't offered its own. The core shift is from getting paid to "retain" a book to getting paid to "write new business". They also put buyout offers on the table with a Sept 30 deadline. P&C side, I know. But the lesson isn't carrier-specific and it's the thing I keep coming back to: you never actually owned that book. State Farm did. And a 20-year "trailing income" promise is only worth as much as the carrier's willingness to keep paying it which turned out to be "until it's inconvenient." The part that should get every agent's attention is the direction, not the one carrier. Comp is going performance-based across the board, trailing/renewal-style income is getting squeezed, and AI is going to absorb more of the service and retention work that used to justify those trails. The "come build a \$3–5M book and coast" pitch a lot of us were sold is quietly being retired. So I'm genuinely curious how the room sees it: Are you seeing comp pressure at your carrier/IMO too, or is this a State Farm-specific overreach? Does owning your book independently actually protect you here, or is that just trading carrier risk for lead-cost/chargeback risk? For the newer agents is anyone factoring "can they rewrite my deal in 5 years" into where they sign? Not trying to dunk on State Farm agents since a lot of them got blindsided and it's a rough spot. More interested in what this says about where the whole comp model is heading."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/

↳ MonLower (39): "Feeling good about being independent and part of multiple agent associations. While this industry is far from perfect, this is the best place to be in my estimation. I feel bad for the SF agents that are up against serious changes. State Farm is quite offended by Progressive taking their spot and is looking to get more flexible to compete. My carriers have lowered commission rates, but often times will renege due to our agencies ability to place with other carriers. Overall, comp has decreased in my 15 years but not to the point of being unsustainable. A few percentage points with most large carriers."

↳ Splodingseal (19): "It's a shit or get off the pot approach. They want agents that are hungry to write as much business as possible and to get rid of Bob and his secretary that kinda coast along only writing as much as he needs to keep the lights on."

↳ firenance (18): "Independents are more insulated as carriers tend to influence performance with contract terminations or adjusting profit share or bonus commission metrics. They don't like you, they just fire you."

"Imo owner now, it when I was independent as a Final Expense and Medicare agent I grossed 500k a year for 7 years in a row and 300k for several years before that. My first year in the business it was 180k. Net was lower, I had to buy my own leads, pay my own business expenses. But I don't know that I ever had more than 100k in expenses a year. I was an exceptionally good agent and I made sure to write business that paid renewals which is how my income grew to be so high."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 30 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3z4tt/how_much_you_earn_as_insurance_agent/hq85spe/

"What would you do if you had to start over from scratch? I'm 2.5 years into owning my agency and my book is just over \$100k. I've had some rough patches, hell, the first 2 years was a rough patch- but about 6 months ago I came to the conclusion that I'm going to put everything in me and do whatever it takes to grow my business and make up for the two years of my life that I wasted. I've gone 25 years untreated for ADHD and 2 months ago finally made myself an appointment to see what the hell is wrong with me. Fast forward 2 months later and I can finally function like a normal human being. Not only am I able to focus better, talk to people better, feel knowledgeable and handle things more professionally, but I actually care. I want to build something that will feed my family one day, pass down to my children, something that will provide us stability. I scheduled a 30 minute call with an agent I met a few years ago to see how he was doing and quite frankly, how he was doing what he was doing. I took a sneak peek at our companies production reports and this guy was selling nearly \$100k in premium a month. This meeting ended up being an hour long, but the biggest thing I took away was when he said this: "Dude... I have 5 kids", and it clicked. I have to get into survival mode, as if it wasn't just me, but those who depended on me. I think about my parents (whom I want to help retire because they are helping me financially), my girlfriend (whom wants to get married and have children with me one day), and my future kids. At this turning point in my life I am constantly asking people who are doing better than me, or are in places that I want to be, what would you do if you were in my position right now? What can I do to grow amongst these huge \$10M+ book size agents in my area? My goal is to quote over \$160k in premium a month, hopefully the quote to sell conversion ratio turns out good. These are mostly old leads, and eventually I will run out. Every Friday I am going out to 5-6 locations with realtors/brokers/lenders/title agents and handing out cookies, business cards, and a handwritten letter. Hopefully this helps me build a pipeline. I did this last week and people seemed receptive and related to the hustle. What is something I should be focusing on everyday to maximize my agencies growth?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/

↳ DonicaLewinsky69420 (16): "Ask every client and new prospect for referrals. Let them know how important it is to you. Be the business. Not the Business professional. Live it, breathe it, learn it."

↳ FuzzyDice_12 (7): "My tips: 1) Networking: I'm an introvert that comes across as an extrovert. Great for sales but I dread going to events and force myself to go. Staying connected and going to Insurance Events, opens up connections, some you may not realize for years later. Perfect example is while I'm young, I got into insurance and owning my agency at 21ish. Many of the contacts at brokerages I've made, jump ship to other brokerages. The friendship will get you an appointment where normally you couldn't have. 2) Agency Software: This one is a big one. Many of the softwares are expensive and slow. Sometimes agents, when opening their own agencies, use the software from their previous agency, with outdated tech, solely because of familiarity. I learned this lesson the hard way. Thousands a year on crappy agency software. 3) Turning 1 New Business Insured and the policy they chose to have you quote, into multiple policies and new leads. This one is big. 4) This is personal to my niche (small/medium accounts are \$100k+), and builds on 3. Offer several smaller quotes for lines of insurance applicable to your line of business the insured may not have/have been offered previously, even if you don't think the insured will be interested. "If Any" Workers Comp would be applicable for my lines of business. 5) create partnerships with other independent agencies and agents. Self explanatory I would think. 6) SOP's, and building the agency with Franchising in mind. 7) Calendar: setting up reminders to touch base on insured's. If you are coming around only at renewal time, you easily become an agent that is replaceable. 8) As an agency owner, not only having SOP's, but understanding how every moving part of your agency works. From accounting, to customer service, to certificates of insurance, and on and on. Excuse any typos (at the barber shop), but this is what I could think of off the top of my head, and while some sections are more important than others, I didn't number them in any particular order."

↳ ChrisPbacon969 (5): "Commenting to follow along. I'm about to get started on my p and c journey."

"Agency M&A consultant. I consult on situations like this all the time. Sadly it's super common. Unfortunately in many cases the answer is leave because you won't change the family dynamic. Listen to the scratch agency podcast. The host Stephen left a 4 generation family agency to start his own. Don't think it was similar drama, but similar decision. I'm sure he would chat with you about his journey. Yes you are right. Buying is expensive, but there can be great opportunities if you network directly with small town owners getting ready to retire. Do not buy a small book of business <\$300K through a broker, but do work with an advisor. I don't normally do this because they are a competitor of mine, but connect with IA Valuations, it's a division of OIA and they may be able to give you some pointers or recommendations in your state."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l48ryh/buying_an_independent_insurance_agency/mw77c7q/

"I have been in this industry for 14 years and it has become a shell of it's former self. Let me explain. In 2009 is when CMS enacted over 100 new regulations in the Medicare industry. New regulations included annual enrollment periods, government regulated commissions for Part C and D, a Scope of Appointment form that must be completed prior to an agent's presentation, annual AHIP certifications to be able to sell policies in addition to annual carrier certifications, soon after new legislation that required MA plans to have to have a network which killed PFFS plans which were the most popular MA plans at that time, laws which forbids agents to market Part C and D products, laws which govern every aspect of agents holding seminars even including not allowing agents to offer free meals for attendees, the inability to call referrals (the referral must contact you), regulations on carriers that made it illegal for carriers to offer bonuses and trips to agents for production rewards, and many more that I can't think of off the top of my head. After these draconian regulations were passed most agents left the industry. The only ones that stayed were the agents that had a solid book of business prior to these new regulations which is why the average age of a Medicare agent is 60 years old. This industry's golden age was from 1998 to 2008. Medicare Advantage was a brand new concept as well a few years later Part D was brand new as well. There were plenty of reasons why seniors needed to talk with an agent during this time and the big money was made at this time. That all changed in 2009. CMS used the excuse that since agents were getting compensated with taxpayer money (Medicare funding Dollars) that CMS had the right to regulated everything about the agent's existence in this industry. In 2020, very little has changed under the Trump administration. The only good thing to be improved upon was CMS not requiring the Scope of Appointment form to be filled out 48 hours prior to an agent's presentation and changed it to the same day as the appointment. Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as well for fear that the carrier will get in trouble with CMS and lose funding for their plans. Part D plans pay almost nothing for the sheer amount of work that needs to be done reviewing your client's drug list every year that you are almost working for free. MAPD plans pay the same commission as MA only plans. Now if you understand inflation this is another issue as well. The US Dollar loses 2%-3% of it's value every year which causes prices to increase, but you get paid renewals based upon commission rates from the first year you write the business. So while you do make renewals, those renewals become less and less every year. Now that MA plans have ironed out their networks and funding is stabilized, there is little need for seniors to switch Medicare plans every year because they already are in the best plan possible. You can go after T65 business, but that has also become problematic as well. Since Social Security has raised the full benefit retirement age from 65 to 67, most seniors are still working for an employer at 65 and have no need for Medicare coverage until they retire, especially since many spouses are not yet on Medicare and their spouse needs the group coverage. The (un)Affordable Care Act aka Obamacare is terrible and has made major medical coverage too expensive and too restrictive. After 14 years in the industry I have finally realized all that is bad and the bad FAR out weighs the good. The commissions are too small for an agent to make it especially with so few seniors actually needing a better plan plus with everything I previously mentioned you need to be insane to become a Medicare agent in 2020. If you do start off in this industry you need at LEAST 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months of marketing expenses saved or you will run out of money very quick and need to find an hourly job. You must write 100 policies every year to make it in this industry and you will max out at 400 to 500 clients because any more clients and you will have to hire help. So at \$250 commission per client earned every year you are looking at a max of \$100,000 to \$125,000 minus your marketing expenses which will cost you between \$12,000 to \$20,000 per year plus all the gas consumption and wear and tear on your vehicle driving all over town on appointments, double taxes you pay for FICA, Medicare and Social Security taxes, and lack of access yourself to affordable health insurance by not having access to group health policies. Covid-19 is a new hurdle agents must overcome and adds a dozens new challenges because of CMS regulations. The Medicare industry just isn't worth it anymore."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAg>

↳ @fleridalara888 (4): "@Seniorbenes everything he's saying is scary. I am interested in this business but I am new and don't have the capital even for leads rinow"

↳ @Seniorbenes (3): "@michaelhuebner6843 Michael Thanks for your response ,factually It is just me I am not an agency, I just did some pre-planning before getting into the business and some due diligence. I listened to the successful agents and worked my but of because I did not want to be part of the failure statistics. If you plan, execute, assess, and repeat it comes together before you know it. The secret is 12 hour days kkkkk"

↳ @michaelhuebner6843 (2): "@Seniorbenes Well you are running an agency and that is not feasible for most new agents because they lack the capitol to start on a large scale like that. Yes if you scale to the point you are doing then it can work, but your investment is huge when this industry has 90% of new agents failing in the first 2 years. My description is what an average independent agent will perform. Nick from Medicare Millionaire is an independent agent and works by himself. He is a seasoned agent and very good at selling yet he only sold 127 policies in 2018 and he does this full time and employs his own telemarketer for \$3 per hour and uses direct mail leads. I was an assistant office manager for a Medicare brokerage firm for 9 years and out of 10 agents that our office had we only had 2 top producers and they each had about 1,500 clients. They serviced all of their clients and they were extremely stressed out all the time especially during AEP when MA plans became discontinued and they needed to review plan changes every year for their large client base. The average agent had about 500 clients. You need to provide customer service for your clients if you want to keep them long term and the sheer amount of work required to service MA plans simply isn't worth it. 95% of the calls we got at our agency was people having questions about their co-pays, the network, prescription drug co-pays, Part D late enrollment penalties, prescription drug issues, and how their plan worked. You spent all your time servicing MA and Part D clients and this is why you can't have more than 500 clients on your own before you are forced to hire help. Having 2,000 clients yourself means you aren't providing service to them when they have issues or you are just selling Medigap. Sorry to say but 70% of seniors on Medicare nationwide have Medicare Advantage. You and I both know how hard it is to market Part C and D plans selling over the phone as CMS makes this almost impossible. You need a partnership with a carrier to pull that off on a large scale and be successful which makes you captive to that carrier. I am in this industry to help seniors, not to help some corporate insurance carrier gain market share. CMS doesn't allow you to market Part C or Part D on social media, you need to read your AHIP test again my dude."

"Independent final expense agent here. Many agents I know and respect are earning over \$300K a year from a combination of renewals and new commissions—just on their own pen, with no downlines or employees. The smart ones started with final expense and gradually shifted their focus to Medicare for the higher renewal income. They still sell final expense, but their renewals alone bring in over \$250K a year. Once you add new commissions on top of that, many are clearing \$500K annually."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kkwa3n/survey_most_profitable_area_of_insurance/mrpyxec/

↳ KNOW-IDEA (2): "I just reached out to the local chamber of commerce, made a social media page and am attempting to contact some of the local developers. Trying to put my name out there. But the agent owner doesn't have enough time to do these things himself."

"P&C builds a book of business with renewals but also client relationship which leads to sales of other ancillary products. The shoe can drop on the captive side if the carrier decides to blow their rates out of the water in your area. Life pays the best but there's zero client relationship after the sale. ACA is a grind, especially going into this year's enrollment with the new rules in place, small per-person as-earned commissions where you'd need to enroll a lot of people for years and years to really see it start to add up. I sell life to small business owners, but with no renewals, it's great money but it's also Groundhog day every day."

"If one does much digging whether here on the forums or just out in the general "interwebs" there seems to be somewhat of a consensus that a high level final expense producer cannot "add-on" Medicare Advantage successfully; that for some unknown reason it just doesn't work. Well I ascribed to that moniker for several years until 2016 when I decided that I needed to discover for myself whether what I was reading/hearing was the truth or whether it was marketing mumbo-jumbo. So I passed my AHIP, all the certifications and druuuuuummmmmrollllllll.....stopped dead in my tracks lol. While I was pretty convinced at the time that cross-selling Medicare Advantage was an outstanding idea financially for my business, primarily because it picks up where FE leaves off in building phenomenal long-term high level renewals, I just didn't have the support needed to gain any traction without my life insurance taking a big hit so ultimately I put it on pause. Fast forward to the end of 2017 with Equita where I start hearing the success stories of many of our final expense producers selling what amounts to buckets full of MAPD policies using the same exact FE direct mail lead they've already purchased. So with that said my competitive juices started flowing and I had to get in on the action. I completed the AHIP (again), along with the certifications, but this time I was surrounded by a cohesive team that I could use as a support structure which has really help cut down my learning curve. I immediately started selling a few per month. In fact, my friend Peter Walker aka Springbok flew into St. Louis for about a day and a half this past week to check out some of the idiosyncrasies of my local market (I gave him a hard time because I was seemingly towards the bottom of the list of dozens agents across the country that he has personally travelled to in order to train how to cross-sell MAPD with Final Expense). With that said we wrote 10 Medicare Advantage policies in a day and a half. I want to say I couldn't believe it, but I knew I was on to something back in 2016, but I just couldn't quite pull it off all by myself. He showed me how to turn over every imaginable leaf in order to help these seniors with their Medicare. We found cases where a military veteran could keep getting his prescriptions from the Veterans Hospital, but also enroll in a special Medicare Advantage Plan Part B only, which will actually pay the insured \$40 back on his Part B premium. We also found some cases where we could save the senior over \$1000 per year on their drug costs and still others where a Medicaid client got a plethora of additional benefits like comprehensive dental and over the counter drugs for free!!! So if I did my math right I believe I added almost \$190 per month of renewals to my income for the next seven years or so in a day and half's work. The exceptional aspect of this whole deal is that the MAPD plan easily goes hand-in-hand with the prototypical final expense client. What that means for me is I don't have to adjust my well-developed Final Expense system one iota to add in many many MAPD sales. I've already purchase the FE lead AND I'm already out seeing a bunch of these clients week-in-week-out because I'm on a fixed price lead program only now that I know what to look for I'm confident that at least two per week will ultimately "fall in my lap". And while yes, I'll have to pass the AHIP and certifications every year, I feel like that's a small price to add in an extra \$20,000 plus to my income that will only compound year after year by simply knowing the right questions to ask. Now there are those out there preaching that Medicare Supplements fit the bill as far as some of this is concerned, but that hasn't been my personal experience at all. I would say 5% or less of the targeted final expense demographic can afford a supplement, which averages anywhere between \$100-\$200plus per month; maybe if you bought Medicare Supplement specific leads on top of your final expense leads, but that would be like adding on an additional/separate j.o.b., which I wasn't interested in."

"Or just do Medicare and ACA, after 8 years my life renewals are less than what my dental policies pay every month, and in my office life renewals across the board with other agents are maybe a few grand a year?"

251 / 360

"Recent L/H licensed, selling medicare advantage, need career advice So I've been selling Medicare Advantage plans since last summer and it's been good overall. The agency culture is nice, fully remote, warmish inbound leads, good training, decent commission, and I sold 110 policies in AEP. I'm doing well during OEP so far and have averaged 2-3 policies a day. I just got my life license to sell final expense after OEP since many enrollment codes are going away. That being said, commission only is tough, but I'm lucky to have savings and to live with my parents. I don't want to live with them long term and am looking to move out later this year. I know final expense can be good, but I want to see what's out there. Does anyone here work for agencies on a remote basis that offer base + benefits or at least renewals while giving you decent leads? I get \$275 per policy but I have to wait until the policy clears 120 days to get the whole payment (get 50% upfront). I'm realizing that NAC and churn can screw with your pay too. It'd be great if I got some sort of renewal, but they are paying for leads so it's up front commission only. I just have my L/H licenses and I've heard good things about employee benefits too. I have a strong preference for fully remote, but am open to hybrid in San Diego if it's the right opportunity. I also don't want to get involved in MLMs or pitch friends and family. I'd be grateful for your 2 cents. Thanks in advance!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hx3ebv/recent_lh_licensed_selling_medicare_advantage/

↳ [deleted] (2): "You don't get any residual? And this is telesales correct? I have a friend in Medicare but never went into how it works"

↳ [deleted] (1): "May I ask how much commission you get selling MA?"

↳ dbrewster17 (1): "No problem! So it starts out at \$250 and can go up to \$350 based on production (i.e sell 50 polices a month 2x in a row to get \$300 and 70 for \$350). It's not bad we get 50% upfront and 50% 120 days later less chargebacks. Chargebacks and NAC policies suck"

"I work for a fairly large IMO, which is family owned. I'm in my 3rd year of selling Medicare and life. What's up with the recruiting thing? I've never once been asked to recruit anyone, nor would I ever want to? As a company, my managers do host recruiting events such as lunches and events at our office, but it's not a thing that they push on agents to do. That is what the managers do, as it's a huge part of their jobs. Edit: wanted to add that I am 100% independent. I started off independent the first year, went captive with a salary of \$2500 plus commission for 8 months and switched back to independent. Residual income is too good to be captive, IMO."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hmdw46/failed_mlm_insurance_agent/m3u8hc7/

"Having done Medicare, I'd do ACA. Your odds are high that you will write the entire family versus Medicare where it's mostly one person. While you can sometimes do husband and wife enrollments it's very rare. Your goal is to build residual income. Plus, no longer dealing with pain the butt elderly people with a 2 minute attention span wanting \$5k/month in food cards who change policies multiple times per year is a bonus. I'm thankful for the experience in Medicare because it really does teach you to overcome objections and pivot pitch. Beyond that, I would never want to sell it again."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kmjoeq/whats_better_aca_or_medicare_sales/msbxwrl/

"\$36k annually on marketing??? Thats only \$3k a month! \$500k renewal revenue is about a \$7 million book with the "good hands" captive. I have never met an agent with a \$7 million book spending just \$3k on marketing per month!!! \$5k should be your minimum marketing budget per month if not \$7k for a book that size! Next you will say your cost per acquisition per item is just \$40 which is impossible with any lead gen program!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jrvwh5/please_stop_taking_sales_roles_that_pay_4/ml64xe/

"newbie2001 said: Hey everybody, thought i'd put this out here for general discussion and to share my thoughts. We all know what a Medicare renewal pays, approximately \$300 per year. To gross \$90,000 a year you need approximately 300 clients, then you have business expenses like marketing/leads, office space, CRM, and other general business expenses. I understand those things are the cost of doing business but a small office space could easily cost you \$6,000 a year. My point being, that even if you were to say achieve a remarkable client base of 1,000 individuals you're only making \$300,000 a year and having to service all of these people. Then factor in churn of 10% a year between switchers/death/moving/adverse events. Now you're needing to still add 100 additional new clients a year just to keep pace. Now while \$300,000 is nothing to scoff at it takes a lot of time and resources to even reach that 1,000 client mark in the first place. Then at that point you ask yourself do I need to hire staff to help handle renewals and service calls? Another expense. I was brought into this business in a MLM life only outfit and sold the dream. It just seems almost impossible to scale your way to \$500,000 \$600,000 \$700,000 \$1,000,000 a year without becoming some faceless call center. With overrides going away you can't really hire 1099 agents anymore and collect a small override on there book either. Is there anyone here with a large book (500+) who could give this situation some clarity? I don't want to work a salary job my entire life but when you look at cost of acquisition + how many people it takes to make a decent living it makes you wander. Click to expand... questions what are you making at your w2 job per year, 2. Why do you need an office? I will say this with all of the changes coming in 2025 in terms of agent comp it will become harder to make the same amount of money, if I was starting over I would build my aca book as big as I could, most people don't understand that there are more people on aca plans than Medicare"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Does anyone really get "rich" selling Medicare · 4 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/does-anyone-really-get-rich-selling-medicare.113372/#post-1494949>

"I also own a Medicare agency, what NAF1138 is saying is very true. The upfront commission is higher then ACA but it gets prorated through out the year, highest in January lowest in Oct-Dec. But you get a monthly residual on everyone in your book of biz the next year as long as they stay with you, don't die, and don't lose Eligibility. This will be my 4th year in Medicare and I'm in the 6Figure+ residual income range. Not including overrides. It's a great business to be in."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k042ke/i_need_a_realistic_understanding_of_what_i_can/mnc6sff/

"I don't know much about the commercial side as much as I do the personal. My agency I'm allowed to sell all the commercial I want and we have a team to help me. My salary is 50k, I make 70% on new business and only 30% on renewals. As my book grows, my salary will go down, and my renewals will go up. The end result is a \$0 salary I'll be 1099 with 50% renewals and still 70% new business. I get health insurance, retirement, etc."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wdgfsq/leaving_a_50k_banking_job_for_a_commercial/p95n50l/

"Jesus H. I get that teachers are looking for side hustles - and it's NOT okay that the 403(b) vendors are poaching INSIDE the schools to get their recruiting. I write 403(b) and am bringing it into my new broker dealer, as one of the only people in the entire company that understands it well enough to roll out some form of a workable 403(b)(7) system that lets us get paid AND write 403(b) accounts that do not charge the ridiculous fees that the insurance companies charge. I want it without surrender, high fee, or insurance-based products, but with access to an advisor they have a relationship with, not an 800 number. That's my mission. What you are describing? That's awful. I am one such recruit - though I was called by my home and auto agent to take a territory that needed an agent, and it was a completely protected territory the whole nine years I grew my book there. It wasn't anything like what you're describing. They also handed me the entire book on my way through the door and I vested my interest in it over four years while it covered my overhead and allowed for a base to expand from. I just went independent less than a year ago, from that role, and can say that there are ways to do what you're proposing, but you'd need to carefully look at potential and needs before you jump into the work. There's a lot of learning that is expensive, and if you choose the wrong org or arrangement, you could easily find yourself on the wrong end of validation requirements or running out of runway before you're comfortable. Spending time in the summer assisting an agent working in your target markets might be a great way to go. Being licensed, you can work as much or as little as you want when you are with an IMO, and the progress is yours to make. There is a certain level below which it doesn't make sense because you'll forget more than you learned before you do it again. Ten years in, I don't regret my time swap - I do four days in the office and one in the classroom as a sub somewhere. When I made my jump, I did so keeping all the same time expectations for everyone. My clients all are well aware that I'm not around on Fridays. My staff cheerfully let folks know that when they get calls for me on Friday - "Oh, would you like to send her an email or leave her a voicemail? She teaches on Fridays, and is out and about in the schools somewhere today wrangling some children whose teacher is out. I can probably help you, too. What's up?" It works like a charm and my clients love it. Sometimes I even teach for my clients, and then it's even more fun because we have that little conversation after like "Yeah... you weren't kidding. They were an interesting group!" or "Wow. Who did you make so happy last year that you got this amazing crop this year?! Lucky!!!" There are so many games in town - And the thing nobody will tell you is that the ones that find you are the ones that are the most desperate because they are the most exploitative. The ones you have to know someone to know how to get to are the ones that are truly orgs that you want to be in, because the people you know already who are in them are not trying to recruit as their primary mission. They are focused on the clients as clients and the client challenges are their job, not getting out of the client-facing work as soon as possible. Just some food for thought."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sj0pc6/primerica_almost_got_me/ofu1wzc/

"Experienced Face-to-Face Agent LOOKING for an EXPERIENCED Telesales OUTBOUND Agent/Agency Owner for advise **Long Story Short:** I've been a field agent (face-to-face agent) for 13 years, **commission only**. I recently made the transition from a captive agent to an agent/agency owner last year. I'm used to making cold calls and door-knocking since I started. My previous company instilled prospecting for Turning 65 and only gave us only a spreadsheet with a name, address, and month/year of turning 65 and called it a "lead". We "bird-dog" for the financial advisors to sell annuities once we sold a product and completed a fact-finder. Their system worked, but commissions on insurance products were extremely low as a captive agent. Now I'm going on a prospecting binge when I can make money \$\$\$\$ peddling final expenses and Medicare insurance(RENEWALS) products. I'm making more money and larger renewals just sell insurance products than annuities! Blows my mind. **Problem:** I've proven the system I followed for 13 years works, but it takes time and effort since I started over (left the captive company & lost renewals) again last year. I'm now working 50-72 hours a week in the Texas heat. I'm doorknocking booking for appointments and realistically booking 8-10 per week Medicare and Life appointments. I sell an average of 2 New-to-Medicare MAPDs and 1 life insurance product per week after appointment cancellations. I've seen the trend from the "old fashion" ways to the "telesales" method after COVID. I'm looking for an agent/agency owner who has a proven method. Everyone I talked with about this works for Assurance IQ and brags about how they sell 100 MAPD plans a year. That's easy when you have inbound calls and entice them by "adding more benefits". That is not sales. That is order taking. I'm trying to figure out this telesales method for life insurance more than anything to help my downline agents. I want to get new agents making money on final expense products first before prospecting for Medicare insurance. I feel they can get a great start making money before they try my proven method to build Medicare RENEWALS. I don't want to be stubborn in my ways and learn other methods to fish. **Solution?:** I want to learn from anyone who can help me. I'm very honest and transparent. I'm willing to show you my book on Medicare business including renewals and operations. Maybe we can learn from each other if you are trying to find methods to build a large Medicare renewal clientele and sell multiple products in a household. My method isn't sexy but you will have solid renewals with a very low cancellation rate than as a telesales agent. I can get into the house with T65 and sell multiple products. I have invested \$40,000 in direct mailing equipment and could barter services if you are very useful."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/14fpiln/experienced_facetoface_agent_looking_for_an/

"Best strategy to start selling health insurance (Medicare + ACA) Hi everyone, I recently earned my accident & health license and I am excited to begin my journey as a health insurance agent. I am still in the early stages of learning how the sales process and industry work, so I would appreciate any advice or insights from experienced colleagues. My goal is to build residual income by focusing on health insurance (either ACA or Medicare). For ACA, I am considering using HealthSherpa for their platform and training resources. For Medicare, I am thinking of starting with 1 or 2 carriers as a captive to access knowledge. I look at this as a short-term plan (about 6 months) to build a solid foundation to then transition to a broker or agency to access multiple carriers to provide best plan and maybe better commissions. Does this sound like a good plan? Are there downsides of going captive with more than 1 carrier? I see some offer AHIP certification discount, should I take it? I would love to hear your thoughts and any suggestions you might have. Thank you so much!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1i3ms00/best_strategy_to_start_selling_health_insurance/

↳ Usual_Ad_2834 (2): "Most captive places offer a discount for ahip. Not a bad plan if it aligns with your goals honestly. Just know when your captive you wont keep your book of business and thats what you need to build residuals if you ever plan on leaving. And when you do leave if they are scummy they will force you to stay by making you wait 3-6 months with no income and cant sell that carrier. Its just the bullshit you have to deal with in the industry. So be prepared for that route. You could go independent off jump learn that way but then u have to figure out lead cost and sales in general if your new to B2C for insurance."

↳ Usual_Ad_2834 (2): "Just because you get the ahip discount does not mean you have to sign up with that company you can ghost if you want after you get it for free or reduced. Your only locked in once you get the contracts with the company. Thats the only time your locked in on only selling for the company."

↳ Usual_Ad_2834 (2): "Dm me if you have any more questions 🍌"

Six figures, or the month it finally worked · 58 documents · 20 voices

"Sales jobs that pay more than 100-120k a year Just curious it seems like most of us are around 80-120k a year in our sales jobs no matter what industry we are in. Is there industries that pay more? Like 150-200k a year? I do have one of my ex coworkers that just reached out to me and sent me his ytd\$ for last year and it was 265k selling Medicare supplements/FE&life seems too good to be true tho."

— r/sales · 154 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/ru0huv/sales_jobs_that_pay_more_than_100120k_a_year/

↳ [deleted] (146): "Saas. I have a \$200k OTE in midmarket. Enterprise is \$250-260k. That's just the OTE. A guy in my team took down over \$300k this year"

↳ Both-Ad-7757 (90): "Cloud sales is really lucrative. I made 150K as an SDR at a FAANG company my first year."

↳ Huntthatmoney (42): "Damn, like it's only been a couple of days"

"Imo owner now, it when I was independent as a Final Expense and Medicare agent I grossed 500k a year for 7 years in a row and 300k for several years before that. My first year in the business it was 180k. Net was lower, I had to buy my own leads, pay my own business expenses. But I don't know that I ever had more than 100k in expenses a year. I was an exceptionally good agent and I made sure to write business that paid renewals which is how my income grew to be so high."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 30 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3z4tt/how_much_you_earn_as_insurance_agent/hq85spe/

"Independent insurance agent a viable career? I have a buddy who's been in the industry for 11 years and he's quite obviously very successful. He suggested that I get into the business as he knows I'm at a career crossroads and looking to make more money. For a bit of background, I'm married with 3 young children. My wife is in a position to keep us afloat while I build my business. I'd be working as an independent sales agent utilizing warm leads and marketing tools from Alliance Group. My buddy said he made 110k his first year (with a few years prior sales experience) and he said he's confident I can make at least 70k my first year without working 80 hour weeks. He's going to fly down to take me out on sales calls. We'd split the initial commission from whatever sales we close that week. This sounds like a great opportunity and I don't mind hustling to get myself established in the industry but I don't want to put everything I have into this if what he's saying sounds far fetched."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/pkdfdw/independent_insurance_agent_a_viable_career/

↳ Islandbeachandrum (23): "To be honest, insurance is a GRIND the first couple years. It is incredibly rewarding once you have built up a book of business though. As an agency owner, I caution people who are the breadwinners of the household against jumping into the industry unless they are highly motivated by pressure, or are able to land a job at a large agency where there is a base plus commission (which can be shark tanks). Your situation sounds a little different since you have a wife who is able to float the family for a period of time, so you can take on more risk. One thing I would caution you on is that you'll be taking quite a bit of time away from your family the first couple years. They may not be 80 hour weeks, but there will be networking events, association events, breakfast meetings, etc, multiple times a week that carve into your family time. I viewed it as delayed gratification - I was investing in a much brighter future, and more time with my family, by putting in a ton of hard work while my kids were little. I don't know if this is helpful, but sometimes seeing real life numbers help me in evaluating a decision. And hey, I'm just a random guy on the internet, so I don't mind sharing details. Here is my career income progression as best as I can remember: * Year 1: \$18,500 * Year 2: \$34,000 * Year 3: \$57,000 * Year 4: \$104,000 * Year 5: \$130,000 * Year 6: \$237,000 (The year I opened my own agency with a partner) * Year 7: \$252,000 * Year 8: \$330,000 * Year 9: \$410,000 * Year 10: \$450,000 * Year 11: \$512,000 * Year 12: \$550,000+ As you can see, there is definitely a couple years where you are just trying to figure things out. Once you have a solid knowledge base, then you can work as hard as you want, but at a certain point, the growth becomes more linear than exponential due to the time constraints of dealing with your clients, staff, accounting, etc, etc. If there was one thing I would recommend, it's pick your niche early on and become the top 1% in the country in that one area. That was the year my income almost doubled. The years prior to that, I was floundering and writing anything and everything that came my way. You just can't optimize or streamline a bunch of random accounts like you can a niche or program. Edit: hit enter before I finished typing."

↳ aschaefer63 (9): "It is definitely a grind the first 2 years. Our path is slightly behind the other gentleman's. Year 1 was ugly, thankfully we had savings. Year 2 was easier and 3+ are much better. We are a health insurance agency that sells ancillaries and the odd life policies.: There are pros and cons to all areas of sales. For instance: life insurance has more chargebacks than Medicare which is why we took commission as earned - less financial risk to payback Medicare is subject to rules and regulations and the vagaries of politics. Life pays more up front, health pays longer term - so short term cash for life, long term renewals for Medicare. Life is more sales because you have to sell people on the need for it. 10,000 seniors turn 65 every day and need insurance. Life is year round and you have no real busy season. Medicare has open enrollment which is similar to tax season for accountants, but January through May (after you are established) are 20 to 30 hour work weeks. As you can see I prefer Medicare, but I am not blind to the fact that if you hate rules and details, you will hate Medicare. Whatever you do, learn to read books on your industry and sales, associate with top producers and put your customers interest before yours and you will get paid back in referrals."

↳ jhark1 (7): "This is why I became a broker 3 years ago, Already getting close to the 150k as an independent."

"Beware of MLM structured companies (warning) So this was originally a response to a comment on this sub, but I see a ton of new people coming into insurance, (speaking to independent guys here) and there are many many hungry wolves waiting to recruit these naïve noobs and make a profit. So, I figured I could make a post using some of the content from my previous response to explain the caveats and expose the reality of these places. I come from a MLM originally, it was unbenounced to me at the time, but I'm still grateful because it gave me a first hand glance at what goes on there. How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. They will push you to build a team, because hey, don't you wanna make 6 figures "bro"??? Well then you gotta build a huge team so you get all those overrides off the guys under you. Now, there's nothing wrong necessarily with building a team, but in a MLM context and the way they act in a deceptive manner it is extremely unethical. The guys you see writing 100k plus in premium a year??? A fraction of that fell of the books and was a chargeback, then that guy like all of us has to pay taxes at the end of the year. He also probably was buying \$500 worth of leads a week. Burned gas every day meeting clients. He "maybe" profited 40k that year, and that's being generous. But as long as they can show boat how much premium they're writing a week? A month? A year? Then shove the rhetoric down new guys throats, boasting about how they too can make 100k a year? Then they're all good. I found out through a credible source, as well as David Dufford (has a youtube channel, good tips and insight for insurance) that alot of these "top producers" buy the trips that you can win with insurance carriers for writing a lot of AP. They do all of this and sugar coat their actual earnings because you'll buy the dream, go sell sell sell, and the guys above you get all the overrides off of you without investing any of their money into you at all. It's a fucking amazing model for the guys at the top to make a killing. They create a strong sense of family at those places to keep you on board as well. They push shitty products like Americo a ton too, because they get higher commissions off of that. Americo is also pricey, and you can easily find a cheaper product for that senior to actually help them out, but more than likely they won't have many cheap options that actually are economical for the client, because then you, and them get a lower commission. So MLM's will typically encourage you to get a higher premium out of the client and force a pricey carrier on them. Hope this helps. Reputable, ethical IMO's that offer you high commission contracts and don't push you to build teams are harder to find, because they don't market and recruit. Join an insurance forum, those guys are veterans and a lot of the IMO/Brokerage owners are members there. I've been in Life Insurance for a while now, and am branching into Health/Medicare, so anyone can feel free to PM me with Life Insurance questions if you'd like. Also it would be cool to maybe post any experiences you've had with these types of organizations."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/n4hblb/beware_of_mlm_structured_companies_warning/

↳ pdxoss (6): "I hate MLM too but if someone is making 100k and paying for leads/gas, taxes etc. Their take home isn't 40%. They're going to write off marketing expenses, gas, and everything they can on taxes"

↳ coreyjacrispy (5): "Haha, not specifically, they are are a known MLM company though. Them, Primerica, Symmetry etc etc. Anytime they're trying to force the Kool aid down your throat, with generic phrases and lectures like "You can take this and be BIG man, BIG...you want to have complete financial freedom? Be on your own clock? WE give you the tools to do that! We are a family, and want everyone to succeed" Blah blah blah lol, rest assured knowing they are indeed a MLM company."

↳ Tahoptions (3): ">How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. That is only for simplified products like final expense and mortgage protection. Street is no where near 120% for most traditional products. It is much closer to 85-100% (for term/GUL/IUL) and even lower for permanent products from big mutuals like Guardian and Mass. The post is a good warning though."

"This guy. Started my own agency about 3 and a half years ago now. Probably made 10-15 cold calls in that time, don't think I'll make many more. Advertising, referrals and company provided leads. I'm not trying to scale, I'm not trying to make a million a year. It's going well. Spend about \$20k a year on advertising. When I got in the business 25 years ago, I was a cold calling machine."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mk37eo/anyones_agency_not_do_coldcalling_for_leads/n7fouui/

"Life and health agent primarily in the senior medicare space. 11 years in the industry, about 2.5 years fully independent. Last year I made 135k, about 113k in profit. This year on course to do 200k, maybe 170k in profit."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1t12zow/how_much_do_you_make_as_an_insurance_agent/ond7yz2/

"I messed up. I quit my easy Medicare sales job and went to an industry and can't physically do anymore.im looking for susuggestions. I honestly don't want to go back to them. Go health, I feel they were slowly dying. Taking out massive loans to stay afloat, cut 1/3 of employees recebtly and telling shareholders they were doing great. So I don't want to go back. I can't get into another Medicare job for at least 6 months because of the non competes and the like. Carriers are in on it too so I can't do anything. I'm kinda scrambling for something. I know I wasn't making much there either. Top 10% agent year round. Top 5% in aep. But I only made 45k. It was all warm live inbound transfers that I didn't pay for. I'm looking at other insurance industries and I'm kinda scared. Each place I look at often turns into a sort of ponzi scheme that sells leads. Often getting you in with some decent leads at first and then giving you crap unless you pay for it. I don't mind pure commission but I'd like it to warm live transfers. Am I wishing for something that doesn't exist? I have life and health in like 20 states still. I'm debating getting property casualty license."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/111e1d0/>

↳ (0): "The problem you're having.. is that go health didn't teach you how to do the job. They didn't teach you the product or how to care for the needs of the client. They taught you how to poach books. But the reason they are slowly dying is because every time they have one of their extremely underpaid teleagents poach one of my clients i immediately put in a complaint to CMS and then flip them back. That's why the 3 month retention is less than 40% for both go health and assurance. Medicare isn't easy and shouldn't be. It should be about building relationships that in turn pay you very well for taking care of people. If you actually love it, find an upline that can show you how to build a book, not steal one for a churn and burn company like go health."

↳ (0): "I'm afraid to gamble that. Like I know it's possible and I know I could do it. I was good at what I did. And trust me. I was one of the few who actually read past the SOB and into into the EOC for plans. And many didn't even read the SOB... I'm just afraid to start it. I don't know who to trust for leads and I don't know how to get my own."

↳ (0): "Not sure how old you are or what your situation is like especially in regards to networking ability, etc besides what you've posted here, but it seems like there are a TON of Medicare agents around that do very well running a solo shop just cranking out leads + networking. And looking at the commission schedule, something like 100 Medicare sales would net about what you're making now. One hundred... in perpetuity (at least for a few years... lol). That's pretty easy, no? Granted that doesn't include benefits like health insurance, being W2, etc but... still decent. The one Medicare agent I know that works at a P&C shop, and is P&C licensed, works in ONLY Medicare and CRUSHES it, works 3-4 months out of the year, the rest of the year manages his book and lines up for the next year, but vacations / starts other business ventures 8 months out of the year. He's maybe 27 years old making \$300k-400k a year at least I'd bet - before bonus. As a P&C agent I look at those commission schedules and I get a little jealous. Something I'm hoping to learn more about in 2023."

"I work at a brokerage in life. I have gotten people approved with one of 40 carriers I have that would have been turned down everywhere else. If I was captive at one of 97.5% of these carriers, I would have had to say "sorry" instead of "you'll receive your policy packet in the mail." That's the root issue with captive. Regarding strictly comp, having to buy leads isn't fun. I don't do warm market. Look a few years down the line if you're producing even low six figures in AP, paying \$50-80 per lead at ~100% commission sounds a lot more fun than 40% with some marginal guarantee and no lead spend. It boils down to being able to help the client and your goals and risk tolerance."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vz10ku/why_does_captive_get_so_much_hate_verses_brokerage/p61bv2i/

"Which is better: selling Life & Health Insurance or P&C? I've heard that selling ACA affordable care act is easy and enjoyable. I also came across a few job ads for an insurance sales position selling Medicare policies, which mentioned \$100,000 minimum your first year (most likely) and also seems so much more straight forward in terms of: they give you all the leads. Anyone have any experience in these industries? Thanks 🙏😊"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/17wzic7/>

↳ (0): "Don't trust anyone promising \$100k a year minimum in your first year if they it is commission based insurance sales."

↳ (0): "And it goes up from there."

↳ (0): "Definitely L&H I sell PNC and LH. If I had to start over I would just focus on LH & Financial Services PNC is over rated"

"Independent final expense agent here. Many agents I know and respect are earning over \$300K a year from a combination of renewals and new commissions—just on their own pen, with no downlines or employees. The smart ones started with final expense and gradually shifted their focus to Medicare for the higher renewal income. They still sell final expense, but their renewals alone bring in over \$250K a year. Once you add new commissions on top of that, many are clearing \$500K annually."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kkwa3n/survey_most_profitable_area_of_insurance/mrypxec/

"Hi, I also work at an Allstate agency and this is my first insurance role. I just got licensed and accepted the first offer without doing much research. My day looks a lot like what you're describing: mostly outbound calls and working marketplace leads. There are people in my agency making six figures, but they're grinding hard like working Saturdays, staying late every day and they're extremely strong on the front end of the call. I've realized I'm probably not built for that style long-term. I don't think it's impossible at Allstate, but it's definitely a tough model and not for everyone. At my agency, the owner hired over 40 people this year and let about half go for performance, so the turnover is real. I'm personally looking at inbound roles (possibly Liberty Mutual) because I'm still very new and feel like I'd benefit more structured training and warm leads."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pp14vp/allstate/nujrdl0/>

"It's just me, a solo agent now for 30 years. All health insurance, mostly Medicare. I work nothing but referrals, I don't buy leads at all. I work hard for 2 months and then cruise the rest of the year any taking a few appointments a week most on the phone anymore. I make about \$200k a year. I feel that's not bad at all considering how much time off I have. I'm always available for calls, so I go around the house doing projects most of the year with my Bluetooth headset on and when someone calls, I head into the office and work. I'm not out there to get rich or chest anyone. I have \$0 debt and my retirement is very well set. I figure I'm not going to burn myself out doing this job but work whenever I'm needed. It's a good life, but open enrollment is not easy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3z4tt/how_much_you_earn_as_insurance_agent/nq9pmvd/

"I'm a captive Medicare agent, formerly a life/health broker and I have zero interest in going back to the 1099 life. I get PTO, I work from home, I just sit here and take calls all day and I get to truly clock out and spend time with my family instead of always feeling like I should be dialing leads. I'm a carrier rep and made \$130k last year, on pace to break \$150k this year. So yea, the broker path has a higher ceiling but w-2 isn't poverty."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1v1wdq6/why_would_anybody_want_to_be_a_captive_agent/oyqslzd/

"I work as property and causality agent for a major insurance carrier. My leads are given to me but they are mostly bullshit. Pretty much a name and number. I work pretty hard as a captive agent. Our goals are set and we need to hit or exceed them to make any money. I am paid salary plus bonus. I am a top 5% producer and clear over 125k a year."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ax5nn1/what_is_it_like_being_an_insurance_agent/krm96tw/

"Hey Peter, I just found your channel. I am curious. What's your IMO/FMO? I am captive selling P&C over the phone for a carrier. I want to learn how to sell FE over the phone. My 1st year I made \$62K 2nd year \$65K This year prob \$67K I am now your 167th agent on your list 😊 Good video."

— YouTube · I Asked 166 Life Insurance Agent How Much Money They ACTUALLY Make Per Month · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MLoTTqEO2AY&lc=UgwSEHphWvAV6SZTnp14AaABAq>

"Life and health, mostly Medicare, here in California. \$225K last year. Love most of the year, AEP are long days. I don't market, I don't hustle for that next deal, referrals just come in on a very regular basis. Either direction you go, I wish you the best."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tl2zow/how_much_do_you_make_as_an_insurance_agent/ondc9yo/

"I've been wanting to share this insight for a while but never got the chance to. If you're considering being a life insurance agent- Specifically if you're considering working for globe life or American Income Life insurance (that was my run off branch) I'd like to offer you the most transparent what to expect in terms of your pay since I don't see anyone else being blunt with their numbers. I worked for AIL for 3 years from 2019 to 2022. on average my salary was around \$60-\$70k a year. With that income I was typically working 10 to 12 hours a day on the phone 7 days a week and attending weekly (and sometimes daily) training calls with my "team". I didn't do the recruitment side of the business, just the insurance hustle (I know this is where a lot of people are going to point out that THAT IS WHY I DIDNT MAKE AN EXTRAVAGENT AMOUNT PF MONEY) but let's be real, I didn't my my insurance liscence to recruit other people trying to get their insurance license, I did it to swell insurance. When you see that people are making "\$100k a month" or "\$MILLIONS a year" know this. If I sold a \$10,000 life insurance policy (which is a very minimum, basic, but affordable policy) I made \$55 in commission. with a \$1 residual pay that I would receive the following month. HOWEVER, when we hop on calls at the beginning of the week it would be announced that I "MADE" \$10,000 (completely untrue) and to capitalize on this they always ask "how much of that amount do you get to keep" to which you are trained to respond by saying "all of it" pretty manipulative too the new people huh? but we take what we can get and convince ourselves that if we just do that 10x over we'll eventually have what would look like a 'good check' here's the kicker about those "residuals" after the following month of each policy, you don't get them anymore. for whatever reason they give you, those get kicked to your upper and you basically only have that one time payment to count on. so if I can give you any advice on 'residual payments' it's that somewhere in the fine line of your contract I can guarantee they're not yours to keep. they will find some rhyme and reason as to why it will go back to the company. so, for over 10 hours of work a day, you might make \$55. "oh but what about those that ARE making millions" or "you just needed to work harder" let me tell you something: I busted my as off on the phone and my spline KNEW I had no interest in recruiting people so EVENTUALLY (we'll say after a year) I got granted some pretty good leads. Now I was finally able to make some big bucks! Without getting too verbose the average policy amount for these clients would be ranging from \$150k ~\$500k. The largest I ever sold was for a \$500k policy and here's the breakdown for that : I got paid a whopping \$1,300 in commission and a \$300 'residual' the following month. so ...you do the numbers"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/nhgtz0w/

"We don't cold call and we don't buy leads. We get steady clients but we aren't a huge agency at all. We're comfortable so we never really wrote like \$500k a year in new premium like some say here."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mk37eo/anyones_agency_not_do_coldcalling_for_leads/n7fvj7h/

"Unfortunately, just happens very often. That's why most people don't make it in industry. If your license, and want an actual job, look for a job instead of running your own business. When you're a 1099 commission only, it's a business. I would much rather work somewhere where I'm getting some type of paycheck and have benefits to start. I have never been great at prospecting and I've been in sales pretty much my entire life. I've made low six figures in several different types of sales including insurance, but always on the W2 side. I've also realize that I do much better in an inbound environment. I'm more of a consultant and a closer. I'm not a Hunter. Nothing wrong with commission. But when you're 1099 and contracted, they really don't have to do anything. There are some legitimate places, but you have to either buy Leads or prospect. Or you can do what many people like myself did, and get a W2 Job where you're getting paid to base plus commission. People don't realize that benefits, social, security, tax, retirement savings, all those things add up, so you have to make way more money as a 1099 "employee" versus a w2 position. It's not difficult to make a minimum of 65,000 year and a W2 Job and the insurance industry. In fact, I know. Plenty of people who make 125,000 or more a year. I also also plenty of people who can't make it because of the KPIs and the burnout. I would never work for free. Well, never again because we've all fall for the sales pitch. I keep saying this and Will keep saying it, youre not being hired. You're being recruited. You have to interview them. It's so different than a traditional W2 Job, where they actually interview you. Most these places will hire anyone. That's breathing with the license."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wlnr8v/pulling_my_hair_out/pb0bm9o/

"I'm a Medicare insurance agent work 25-30 hours part time a week and make 70k a year working from home. Been selling insurance for about 7 years. When I first started I didn't make much but as i practiced and got better I started making more. If I worked full time I could make 6 figures. Really it's just asking questions and finding out what people are in need of and why they are talking to you and seeing if your product caters to there needs."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/mlyf6ku/

A lead source that finally paid · 22 documents · 20 voices

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

↳ Legio-V-Alaudae (45): "If it was so easy and well paying, they wouldn't have to advertise the hell out of the jobs. I'm sorry you didn't have a healthy amount of skepticism when conducting due diligence."

↳ Candid_Worth_3629 (25): "Did you not ask for any advice from this subreddit or do any research prior to leaving your 9-5? Everyone would've told you to keep the main job and start out part time. It's also really important to be at a place that doesn't make you churn \$ for leads. Most are MLM schemes"

↳ jordan32025 (20): "Anyone who doesn't understand that AP written is not the same as the commission percentage shouldn't start a life insurance business. Also, going into it thinking it's a "job" is recipe for guaranteed failure. There is some financial literacy needed. This precisely why I don't recruit people who are not already actively selling consistently with a good carrier. They already know how to run a business."

"First off, get the MLM idea out of your head. The whole insurance industry is built upon uplines and downlines that is fully commission based. If you want a salary, you'll have to find an agency (whose commission based and has an upline) that'll pay you something fixed. Tough to find something like that for L&H compared to P&C. FE is great for upfront funds, but know that there can be quite a few chargebacks, so 30% of your commissions should go into a side-account to pay for these until you get your lead saturation up and your sales skill level established. Yes, Medicare is a grind unless you know how to cross-sell ancillary, then it's better than FE. In fact I recommend this track for newer FE agents: 1. Contract with someone that can train you and gives you fair contracts 100+% for FE and 20% for Medicare Supplements. 2. Get leads (facebook and direct mail) EVERY week in the same 50 sq mile area, and work them hard, spend 40 hours a week in the field, getting in front of as many people as possible. Build up a saturation level so that when you invariably door knock your leads and they say no or they're not home, you can just simply go two streets down and knock the guy you could never get ahold of a month or two ago. 3. Take some sample lead info and put it into a Medicare Quoting tool and find out whose competitive in your area for supplements, advantage plans etc. Start building your Medicare knowledge up. Of course, first past the AHIP so you have a base understanding for it. Just a few hours a week can help build up a wealth of knowledge. Once you understand how everything works, any changes to plans, companies or Medicare itself is easily assimilable - whereas there's no changes to FE usually. 4. Tell every lead you'll follow up with them in September to schedule a meeting in October to go over their Medicare options - because you do that too. If you don't sell anyone any FE, that's ok, offer to contact them in September for their Medicare, you "help seniors save money on their prescriptions and get extra benefits at no cost to them." If you paid for the lead, might as well get as much use out of them. 5. Selling FE sucks in November to December, the holidays. It's way easier to work with warm leads, sell them Medicare, and also increase your persistency lapse rate on your FE policies as well as bring in tons of referrals and get paid 2x as you would've just selling an FE policy. You could have enough leads to keep you busy all AEP, so that when that ends, you have a 2 week lull before New Years where you can start the whole cycle up again. THIS is the secret to making big bucks imo. Cody and Dave are good guys, Dave helped me out when I was where you were at, 12 years ago. He comes on here sometimes, haven't seen Cody on here yet."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/svjgsv/help_i_passed_accidenthealth_and_life_now_im/hxgcw8n/

"General question about leads Hey everyone, I've been lurking the sub for a bit and have seen some similar issues arise but wasn't sure about my current situation.. \-I'm a P/C agent and working towards my L/H, hopefully within the month. \-I'm with a larger well known captive carrier. The Agency I'm with has been hit with non-renewals, some of the highest in the region. \-The new agent owner took on the role from the dying book of business (85% of the book was local, most of that was bundled with the non renewals) \-The name of the company is scarred in the area so there are no referrals and few renewals coming in to generate business. \-The majority of the agent owners time is spent saving the few renewals he is able to save *albeit as much as x4 the original rate. He is not generating any new leads for the business and hasn't for nearly 8 months. \-This agency being my first producer role, I was enticed with the prospect of (wait for it) paid leads. I didn't know better at the time and hadn't browsed this sub yet. Apologies in advance lol. \-I've had nearly 200 incoming paid leads since I started 6 months ago. I text often, email weekly and call daily. I even created my own spreadsheet to track the leads since no CRM is available. (I tried Monday and enjoyed it but couldn't convince the owner to adopt this.) \-The majority of these leads are instant denials without opportunity to give alternative answers. The few who do answer, the quoted rate isn't competitive. Still, I keep trying. I asked the boss and he said just keep dialing the leads, even after a "no". \-Of these paid leads, I've closed 1 thus far. A few in the "in progress " stage but that's it. I've had a few inbound calls and of the 5 available, I've closed 4... So assuming that someone wants insurance and I can beat the coverage, rate and service, people are buying. \-I'm supposed to bind at least 3% and need to hit \$20k in sales each month to be eligible for the "agent owner program". \-The owner has lamented to me that my minimal \$ value of premium is very low (I'm averaging about \$500 per lead) AND he is upset with his input of money to pay for the leads.. \-I have requoted everyone at least 3 times and reached out to the 3000 odd old leads to cross sell, win back, etc. Using some math, at this rate I would need to bind more than 50% of the leads in a month's time to generate about \$10k in premium. My questions are: 1) What do you do to increase the amount of premium bound each month? 2) What do you do to increase the probability of direct contact with outbound leads? 3) Which paid lead companies work best or worst? 4) If you are unable to prospect in your local region, how do you generate business? Thanks for the read. I'm in a bit of a pickle."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1snoujd/general_question_about_leads/

↳ CFactor11 (4): "Sounds like you're beating up aged digital leads. Owner is cattle prodding you to maximize lead conversion. OR Take a look inward. How are you handling the call? Building rapport? Making human/genuine connection? Creating real value and urgency?"

↳ KN0W-IDEA (2): "I just reached out to the local chamber of commerce, made a social media page and am attempting to contact some of the local developers. Trying to put my name out there. But the agent owner doesn't have enough time to do these things himself."

↳ KN0W-IDEA (1): "Thanks for the reply! I've been curious myself for both.. it feels like the top answer but I'm always open to feedback. I have asked for input on my delivery for the few leads I've been able to connect with. I have tried many different approaches but the answer is usually the same: "stop contacting me"."

"It really just depends on the leads i buy, the most expensive ones right now for me are \$13.00 a lead.. Typically you want to reinvest 10-15% of what you're wanting to make back into your business. So if you want to make 10,000 a month you need to invest at LEAST 1,000 back into leads and stuff like that. It's all about your numbers too. Warm market leads are better than cold market in my opinion. I've spent about \$400 in leads and i've made 2 sales off of those that have covered the \$400 and then some. Life insurance is a little different than other insurance i feel like, you REALLYYYY have to grind. It's hard but once you figure out your numbers it's like a challenge against yourself every month haha."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jpsc95/it_finally_happened/ml267eh/

"Leads for P&C I posted a while ago and started this conversation but bringing it back to get an updated list of lead companies that are worth it. \- exclusive \- high contact rates \- high close rates (preferably 10-15% or more) If anyone is using anything that is for outbound data leads lets help eachother out and me too honestly 😊 I use Google ads for inbound calls right now and they are great just for some extra advice. Just needing a good outbound vendor or company that can generate them for me."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1st8dk0/leads_for_pc/

↳ MiscBlackKnight (3): "10-15% close rates don't exist in P&C data leads. We are captive and do 4-6% close on data leads. Live transfers we do 15-20-% and could probs close more if we had multiple carriers."

↳ Repulsive_Lime_4433 (3): "Done research with 20 different companies (literally) but they all have the same pitch. Thats why im seeing what others are getting good results from. P&c is typically home and auto plus life which is what i sell so any category can be helpful for not only me but others too. Not everyone is going to gatekeep. Some people may be willing to share their experiences which is why im posting again because I've had this same conversation before and had some great advice."

↳ Repulsive_Lime_4433 (2): "Quotely - they only work with a couple of people per state to avoid oversaturation right now."

"5 deals a day is high unless they're doing shady things and selecting SEP's that are not valid. In other wods, they're not compliant. I'm an independent agent and do inbound calls too and having 2-3 sales in a day is an awesome day for me. so two scenarios Is what I'm gathering here; your co-workers were burning through calls and hanging up on people they couldnt service. and those who they could service, they're non compliantly selecting SEPS"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j8srq5/fired_from_my_medicare_advantage_job/mh7v52z/

"Recent L/H licensed, selling medicare advantage, need career advice So I've been selling Medicare Advantage plans since last summer and it's been good overall. The agency culture is nice, fully remote, warmish inbound leads, good training, decent commission, and I sold 110 policies in AEP. I'm doing well during OEP so far and have averaged 2-3 policies a day. I just got my life license to sell final expense after OEP since many enrollment codes are going away. That being said, commission only is tough, but I'm lucky to have savings and to live with my parents. I don't want to live with them long term and am looking to move out later this year. I know final expense can be good, but I want to see what's out there. Does anyone here work for agencies on a remote basis that offer base + benefits or at least renewals while giving you decent leads? I get \$275 per policy but I have to wait until the policy clears 120 days to get the whole payment (get 50% upfront). I'm realizing that NAC and churn can screw with your pay too. It'd be great if I got some sort of renewal, but they are paying for leads so it's up front commission only. I just have my L/H licenses and I've heard good things about employee benefits too. I have a strong preference for fully remote, but am open to hybrid in San Diego if it's the right opportunity. I also don't want to get involved in MLMs or pitch friends and family. I'd be grateful for your 2 cents. Thanks in advance!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hx3ebv/recent_lh_licensed_selling_medicare_advantage/

↳ [deleted] (2): "You don't get any residual? And this is telesales correct? I have a friend in Medicare but never went into how it works"

↳ [deleted] (1): "May I ask how much commission you get selling MA?"

↳ dbrewster17 (1): "No problem! So it starts out at \$250 and can go up to \$350 based on production (i.e sell 50 polices a month 2x in a row to get \$300 and 70 for \$350). It's not bad we get 50% upfront and 50% 120 days later less chargebacks. Chargebacks and NAC policies suck"

"Seeking advice as a new agent, struggling Hi guys. I recently got into the industry, i've been in sales my whole life and i figured i'd pick this up quickly. Last month i bought my first 40 leads, closed 3 of them, thought it would all be sweet from there and locked myself into a lead subscription. The next 100 leads i ordered were different. They're supposed to come in live but the vendor started delivering them in batches at 3am, clearly something changed. Out of those 100 I barely even made any contacts and I was just getting told to fuck off. i paid \$24 each for these and later found out someone in my IMO owns the lead vendor which is why they sent me there. then i tried to launch my own ad campaigns but meta auto flagged me (they thought I was AI?) and now im not allowed to run facebook ads, cant appeal. i tried hiring an ads company but they said their hands are tied since i'm banned from meta. my upline isn't much help as he's honestly not doing that well either even though it was made to seem that way when i was recruited. on top of that i was started at 80 comp which i'm told is low, and i really get paid about 65% depending on the carrier contract. I genuinely do like this industry, i'm not against cold calling and i'm not against risking my own money if it comes with this level of freedom. I certainly don't want to quit but right now I'm negative. my question is, where do i go from here? should i switch IMOs for a better commission structure? from there where do i get leads if vendors aren't genuine and meta wont let me appeal my ad account? google ads? do i just pivot to medicare? any advice would be appreciated or if any of you have experienced similar things."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1t9nf3b/seeking_advice_as_a_new_agent_struggling/

↳ driplessCoin (15): "don't have your answer but I figure you know the answer on if you should stick around with the folks that are suckering you on leads. They hit you with some hot ones so you stick with it a little and keep buying. Like the temu spin wheel."

↳ JazzHandsMinuteman (8): "Well... fuck it. Put the IMO on blast so we know who are scammers are who aren't. Ah just kidding I would never want to "break the rules of a subreddit!" Some things rhyme though and many things share the same acronym entirely unrelated!"

↳ concordbabe (5): "Please, please, please just run. Seriously. IMOs of this caliber are corrupt, and you already found the evidence yourself with the lead vendor conflict of interest. The word "upline" repulses me for exactly this reason. You have three closes on your first 40 leads. That is not a struggling agent. That is a capable salesperson inside a broken system. I built a firm specifically because I was tired of watching this happen to good people. My agents do not chase leads. We schedule qualified appointments for them every single day. I invest \$5,000 per agent per month into the infrastructure that makes that possible, because I believe the more I put into my agents, the more we all produce together. My compensation grid is tiered to reflect exactly that relationship. As your production grows, so does what I put behind you. The lead vendor situation, the 65% comp masquerading as 80%, the upline who isn't producing what they sold you on - none of that is the industry. That's just a bad shop. My vision is bigger than one recruiting comment on Reddit. There is a massive void between the institutional brands, your NWLs, Guardians, Mass Mutuals, MetLifes, and the low-caliber, blood-sucking IMOs that churn through agents like they're disposable. I am building the platform that fills that gap. Independent, professional, agent-first. My goal is to relegate the churn and burn shops to the bottom of the rankings where they belong and change what this industry looks like for financial services professionals who actually deserve a real shot. If you are willing to invest in yourself DM me and I'll refer to the guys and gals that are running my campaigns and funnels."

"I really suggest starting full time and going with Duford - but they do not take just anyone. Go through all of their YT videos and figure out if this is something you want to do. You will need to be licensed in your state AND you will have to pay to be licensed in 10 other states. After you get your state license you only have to pay a fee to the other states, but it will cost \$600 to \$900 depending on which states. Duford has a free lead service for full timers. That is the best way to start because it gets you fully trained and does not cost anything for leads. Once you start to close sales you can switch to the paid leads. You should be able to 2x or 3x the cost of leads every week, so as long as you have time, you can spend as much as you want and 2x or 3x on your spend. Duford and Globe Life Family Heritage Division both have in-person sales, too. You should be able to close 50% of your in person sales because they are usually more motivated, which is why they are letting you in their house. If you are very young, in person may not be the way to go. Regardless, you can still do the free leads full time with Duford to learn and start. Most people fail because they do not make the calls - you need to double and triple dial to get people to answer - and 80 to 90% of the people are not going to remember they asked for information and they are going to hang up on you. After a few weeks of that people get burned out and quit. BUT - if you make 3 to 7 sales per week, you will be on your way to a great income. I have another company I would recommend but I can't do it on here, they would be pissed and I do not know how or if I can DM from Reddit. Bottom line is to save your money for getting all of your state licenses, work free leads until you figure out if this is what you want to do, watch Duford's YouTube videos to learn about the business, figure out if you can stand to be hung up on and yelled at 20 times a day, and get your P and C license, too, so at worst, you can get a job in the local Allstate or State Farm agency and sell car insurance."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1adi8ew/any_tips_on_succeeding_as_a_health_insurance_agent/kk9tjuf/

"You will be spending \$1,000 at least per month just in marketing expenses to get leads and at best you will sell 100 policies per year. So your first year commission will be \$25,000 minus your marketing expense of \$12,000 not counting all the gas money, car maintenance, and increased taxes you will have to pay. Now this amount stacks and you will average out 6 years due to churn, death, and your inability to take on more clients because of service work that needs to be done with your existing client base. This is if all works out well, but 90% of insurance agents fail. The main reason is alack of income and no savings. You need at least 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months worth of marketing expenses saved or you will go broke as an agent very fast. Hope you like working 80 hours per week (as an agent and some random part time evening job) or eating rice and beans for 12 months straight."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=Ugx8OyibkzzH7x1UDdR4AaABAq_9DkyEcAY4um9FNFP4v7DSH

"You just need to partner with car dealerships, boat dealerships, motorcycle dealerships. They get high volume of people. To drive off the lot they NEED insurance. This starts the wheel of high volume, once you have those people, you have your foot in the door. "Hey man, that's an amazing boat you have there, I guess it dosen't tow itself hahahah! What heavy machine you have upfront? Awesome my brother as that aswell I love it. Hey man if we combine both, the amount you'll save is astronomical, would you be open to see a price for both? Thats Great, I guess you don't park those in the street hahahah! You live anywhere near (popular location near boat dealership) right?" Bblablabla and it goes on. 1 lead turned into 2-3-4 policies = lower churn possible. Gave you some sauce, I love the hustle, keep going."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/ooh6ak4/

"No one said anything about easily, I went In to this knowing I'd have to work 10-12 hour days with high volume outbound dials. But the issue is more mathematical, if I had 10k laying around to spend on leads then of course I could hit 20k my first month at a 2X return. But the point is most people don't have that kind of money to start and it's not really disclosed well enough what the difference is between **selling** 20k+ and **netting** 20k+. 2 completely different things"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj5uxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/our7433/

"It sounds like you're just selling the core product? 4-5 monthly referrals from any source is great for cash flow, but you should be averaging 3-4 sales per beneficiary MAPD= HIP, STC; Medigap= PDP,DVH, STC giving you \$1K-\$1.3K pp. I'd go back to the drawing board on your presentation, fine tune it, and focus on selling the whole package. Just my thoughts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ktuf3k/agency_owner_hitting_a_wall_wondering_where_to_go/muc29bo/

"Yeah Im not good front of a camera but I made some AI creatives and for the past week I have boosted them on facebook and google \$25 a day in total. 8 days x \$25 = \$200 spent in return I got 8 leads and closed 1 My commissions are above \$400 on average but I feel like \$200 is super high for a CPA. What is mass outreach?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u47vjb/where_to_get_leads_as_an_insurance_agent/orb34q1/

"I was with State Farm at the start of my career. My SF agent was a total jerk but he bought a ton of leads for 4 sales agents. Minimal service work. SF agent also get a huge subsidy on leads purchase."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gum1sc/the_state_farm_agent_i_work_for_does_not_buy_leads/lxy0mva/

"healthagent said: It's taken them around 2 to 3 weeks to get them out in the past. My return in the past has been .05% closing 1 out of 6 with average premium of around \$3,100. Easy: 10,000 X .05 = 50 leads = 8 apps X \$3,100 = \$24,800 AV X 20% = \$4,960. The investment was \$299 and a 5K return is great. So what's your time worth to put them out? Dunno - what's your time worth while your spending non-productive hours each day in your office. Your time only has value if it would have been spent doing another client-gaining activity which is not often the case. Often new agents have a lot of down time during the day - 100% unproductive. I do indeed personally place 200 per hour in townhome areas - 2 hrs per day = 10 hours per week = 2,000 hangers which means in 2.5 week you'll have placed 5K worth of business. Downsides? Hop on a stairmaster for 2 hours a day - that's what it feels like. However, also great for getting much needed excercise. Click to expand... After doing this myself, I will farm out the BS work. I'm thinking about having my sub-agents do this to generate leads, or look at dropping 20k or 30k flyers and selling the leads to my agents at cost or giving leads out based on production (assuming my ROI numbers are about like yours) I also agree that there are several unproductive hours in a day that I could better spend doing this. I also go to the gym and run about 30 minutes each night which takes about an hour after driving there, so I could potentially cut my gym time out for a couple of weeks while doing this experiment."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Door hangers-Real ROI numbers · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/door-hangers-real-roi-numbers.5397/#post-70298>

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— Insurance-Forums.com · Door hangers-Real ROI numbers · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/door-hangers-real-roi-numbers.5397/#post-70298>

"I after many, many, many years took a call from a yelp sales rep and bit the bullet on their ads. Ad started December 17th give or take, to date these are my numbers. 32 leads, 12 contacts, 7 quotes and 2 sales. My response time is 15 minutes because I have the app on my phone. I can tell you prior to the ad my last lead from yelp was 2 years prior. We have a product that is mandatory and with all the rate increases everyone's rates are going up, so they're shopping. I'm in Southern California which is saturated with agents and even still I'm seeing positive results .google ads are next! We set a monthly budget of \$450 Those 2 sales covered the cost. I have 3 others in the pipeline. We are in our first month but the results have been pretty impressive so far."

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hz8fgq/pc_leads/m6p9onc/

"Medicare school on YouTube is good like others have said. Myself as a broker I hold seminar workshops at local libraries 4-6x a month just educating people on Medicare and how it works and how sign up works and take people through the whole gamet. I'm sure something like this is available in your area... other YouTube videos as well.. there is a lot of info out there. A lot of people good at explaining it. Mesticare.gov is another unbiased source that is a government site.. can be cumbersome to get through, but worth a shot."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1m3bhdj/just_a_quick_bit_of_advice_to_those_who_readpost/n3xiixp/

"@15pluna I was calling aged mortgage leads, the company that had sent out the ads, sent mailers in around 2018-2022 was the earliest lead I seen, and so many people have already called on these people so the 2 sales I had off 600 leads had a lot of smoke screens and they already had policies so I had to switch them over, Mutual of Omaha and royal neighbors are the 2 carrier's we used to find more coverage at better rates"

— YouTube · Cold Calling 3-Month-Old Leads LIVE – Watch Me Close Insurance Sales · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qvBEaHr_MGU&lc=Ugybs2i2wGd1cChHPg54AaABAg_AKdoBZVNynNAKy9rJ9xz-f

AEP numbers: applications written · 18 documents · 18 voices

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj5uxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

↳ Legio-V-Alaudae (45): "If it was so easy and well paying, they wouldn't have to advertise the hell out of the jobs. I'm sorry you didn't have a healthy amount of skepticism when conducting due diligence."

↳ Candid_Worth_3629 (25): "Did you not ask for any advice from this subreddit or do any research prior to leaving your 9-5? Everyone would've told you to keep the main job and start out part time. It's also really important to be at a place that doesn't make you churn \$ for leads. Most are MLM schemes"

↳ jordan32025 (20): "Anyone who doesn't understand that AP written is not the same as the commission percentage shouldn't start a life insurance business. Also, going into it thinking it's a "job" is recipe for guaranteed failure. There is some financial literacy needed. This precisely why I don't recruit people who are not already actively selling consistently with a good carrier. They already know how to run a business."

"Very very little of what I studied for is my real life day to day. I only sale final expense for one carrier. I meet with 90% seniors. My company finances leads and they are really decent leads. I've been on the field 3 days for about 20 hours total and was driving ten of those hours and I have already sold 3 clients."

— YouTube · What To Expect Your First 90 Days As An Insurance Agent! · 33 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HF4onytV3c&lc=UqzsDbo33pREIn35Gzp4AaABAg>

↳ @fatimasow5151 (1): "Any updates as of today? How is it going? I'm just curious!"

↳ @joshacox3110 (0): "@fatimasow5151 it was a crock. I got back into factory supervision. It's basically a ponzie scheme. A few make it but most leave owing money."

↳ @justjordan4995 (0): "@joshacox3110what makes you say this? I'm about to take my test and trying to see what non YouTubers say/think about it"

"This right here! So many unethical companies too that's exploit their agents and charge for bonk ass leads. My first experience was with HealthMarkets, horrible company, leads are \$36 each all of which are trash. I spent thousands of dollars on leads the first year. I also got taken by FFL, there I only burned \$3,000 in leads, I sold 5 policies, 4 charged back. I'm so happy now that I'm focused on the ACA market only. I don't care about selling life or any other supplemental. People are broke and they care barely afford health insurance as it is."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r86i3g/whats_the_hardest_part_of_being_an_insurance/o62tbgm/

"Recent L/H licensed, selling medicare advantage, need career advice So I've been selling Medicare Advantage plans since last summer and it's been good overall. The agency culture is nice, fully remote, warmish inbound leads, good training, decent commission, and I sold 110 policies in AEP. I'm doing well during OEP so far and have averaged 2-3 policies a day. I just got my life license to sell final expense after OEP since many enrollment codes are going away. That being said, commission only is tough, but I'm lucky to have savings and to live with my parents. I don't want to live with them long term and am looking to move out later this year. I know final expense can be good, but I want to see what's out there. Does anyone here work for agencies on a remote basis that offer base + benefits or at least renewals while giving you decent leads? I get \$275 per policy but I have to wait until the policy clears 120 days to get the whole payment (get 50% upfront). I'm realizing that NAC and churn can screw with your pay too. It'd be great if I got some sort of renewal, but they are paying for leads so it's up front commission only. I just have my L/H licenses and I've heard good things about employee benefits too. I have a strong preference for fully remote, but am open to hybrid in San Diego if it's the right opportunity. I also don't want to get involved in MLMs or pitch friends and family. I'd be grateful for your 2 cents. Thanks in advance!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hx3ebv/recent_lh_licensed_selling_medicare_advantage/

↳ [deleted] (2): "You don't get any residual? And this is telesales correct? I have a friend in Medicare but never went into how it works"

↳ [deleted] (1): "May I ask how much commission you get selling MA?"

↳ dbrewster17 (1): "No problem! So it starts out at \$250 and can go up to \$350 based on production (i.e sell 50 polices a month 2x in a row to get \$300 and 70 for \$350). It's not bad we get 50% upfront and 50% 120 days later less chargebacks. Chargebacks and NAC policies suck"

"I barely got 20 apps this month. It's tough as hell. Does your agent buy leads?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ol3p93/sf_is_stressing_me_out/nmfhjjea/

"Most likely Universal and Whole Life downsell to Final Expense, which I think is pretty standard. We will be launching Annuities pretty quickly though. Great to know about 110%+ uncapped. I am so bullish on providing free leads to Agents, but only if they show up to training sessions and maintaining a certain close rate. Month 1 is going to be about onboarding, building local presence/credibility, SEO and branding. This will both help create quick wins and filter out unreliable Agents before our real investment begins. Agents are also required to attend every training session (twice per week). Month 2, onward: Access to the inbound call platform. In order to maintain access, Agents will need to either close 4 policies per month or attend 4 training sessions per month. If Agents aren't closing deals, we need to know they are at least motivated to by showing up for training. Thanks for your advice. It's much appreciated."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p7ouj4/starting_my_own_life_insurance_agency_i_have/nr2ydud/

"@Seniorbenes Well you are running an agency and that is not feasible for most new agents because they lack the capitol to start on a large scale like that. Yes if you scale to the point you are doing then it can work, but your investment is huge when this industry has 90% of new agents failing in the first 2 years. My description is what an average independent agent will perform. Nick from Medicare Millionaire is an independent agent and works by himself. He is a seasoned agent and very good at selling yet he only sold 127 policies in 2018 and he does this full time and employs his own telemarketer for \$3 per hour and uses direct mail leads. I was an assistant office manager for a Medicare brokerage firm for 9 years and out of 10 agents that our office had we only had 2 top producers and they each had about 1,500 clients. They serviced all of their clients and they were extremely stressed out all the time especially during AEP when MA plans became discontinued and they needed to review plan changes every year for their large client base. The average agent had about 500 clients. You need to provide customer service for your clients if you want to keep them long term and the sheer amount of work required to service MA plans simply isn't worth it. 95% of the calls we got at our agency was people having questions about their co-pays, the network, prescription drug co-pays, Part D late enrollment penalties, prescription drug issues, and how their plan worked. You spent all your time servicing MA and Part D clients and this is why you can't have more than 500 clients on your own before you are forced to hire help. Having 2,000 clients yourself means you aren't providing service to them when they have issues or you are just selling Medigap. Sorry to say but 70% of seniors on Medicare nationwide have Medicare Advantage. You and I both know how hard it is to market Part C and D plans selling over the phone as CMS makes this almost impossible. You need a partnership with a carrier to pull that off on a large scale and be successful which makes you captive to that carrier. I am in this industry to help seniors, not to help some corporate insurance carrier gain market share. CMS doesn't allow you to market Part C or Part D on social media, you need to read your AHIP test again my dude."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAg.9FNCTGBfz7K9FPVNMvVfon>

"You will be spending \$1,000 at least per month just in marketing expenses to get leads and at best you will sell 100 policies per year. So your first year commission will be \$25,000 minus your marketing expense of \$12,000 not counting all the gas money, car maintenance, and increased taxes you will have to pay. Now this amount stacks and you will average out 6 years due to churn, death, and your inability to take on more clients because of service work that needs to be done with your existing client base. This is if all works out well, but 90% of insurance agents fail. The main reason is alack of income and no savings. You need at least 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months worth of marketing expenses saved or you will go broke as an agent very fast. Hope you like working 80 hours per week (as an agent and some random part time evening job) or eating rice and beans for 12 months straight."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=Ugx8QyibkzzH7x1UDdR4AaABAg.9DkyEcAY4um9FNFP4v7DSH>

"Okay. I mostly just do Medicare. I am licensed in everything. I get \$250 - \$350 per enrollment, and they supply all the calls. I make my own hours. During AEP, which is 10/15 - 12/7, I did 170 enrollments working around 6 hours a day. The go-getters did 400+ enrollments. The second busy season is 1/1 - 3/31. After that, I'll do some odd jobs until next season. I do have the option of grinding it out all year. They are going to incorporate life insurance, along with Medicare and ACA, to keep us busy. I'd rather not work the slower season because you have more opportunities for personalities to clash when it's slow, and management needs something to do."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pwf3y3/how_much_do_insurance_brokers_actually_make/nwgjplm/

"I sold for an agency like this during the pandemic and lasted about 5 months (AEP & half of OEP). I got into a good rhythm on Medicare requirements, but I was an average performer in this model and closed about 12-15 policies per month on 8-12 transfers per day. If your conversion numbers aren't solid, they will definitely throttle your live transfer lead volume. Is there a base salary? You will need to be licensed in at least 10 states to make decent money and some states have expensive licensing (IL, NJ, NY, etc.) so I would not agree to pay for licensing in more than 2-3 states--the agency should cover additional ones. Does this shop sell Medicare Advantage only or do they offer Medigap as well? If they're MA only, it's likely earnings will be slim from now until AEP starts in October. This is a decent entry point to the industry if you're interested in Medicare and you may stick with it longer than 6 months, but I doubt you'll like this particular company for more than a year. Learn what you can and then open your own Medicare shop or expand to different health lines."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sh8q5w/is_this_a_good_job/offl6o0r/

Cool— I didn't include it in the post, but with our inbound call platform we are taking the approach that an Agent either needs to close 4 policies per month or attend 4 training sessions a month to maintain access to the platform. It would make sense to use 1st month on building a new Agent's brand and local presence and then after 4-8 training sessions in their 1st month (We're having them twice per week), they are ready to join the platform."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p7ouj4/starting_my_own_life_insurance_agency_i_have/ngzgn87/

"I wrote 84 apps but it was my first AEP I am worried about charge backs and how much it all equals out to be come Jan 1st. How many did you do in renewals?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pgvbbq/aep_apps_vs_chargebacks/nszamaq/

"Sold 2 policies yesterday, straight over text. Everyone is different, but i can't get people on the phone sometimes. Until i text them"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u56tl4/texting_leads_to_appointment_set/orihick/

"I have been ruminating on door knocking cold for FE, got a ton of flack from other agents saying it couldn't be done. Yesterday I went out, at 11:30am (it took that long to build myself up to do it), and I door knocked fifteen doors, talked to two people. One said he didn't need it, BECAUSE HE WILL BE DEAD! lol, and the other woman is a lead for medicare and final expense (she has a 9k paid up policy and she is younger), gonna send her a SOC card today. I quit after awhile, nobody was home, and apartments were a waste of my time. Wanna know what else is a waste of my time? High Income Neighborhoods. So I was in the wrong part of town. This morning, reorganized my data, found the parts of town I want to be in, and off I went. First door I knocked on, BAM! Sold 2 policies. It woulda been better except I was taking them down the wrong application, of which the right one I forgot at the office! Had to quickly save it and go with door #2, SETTLERS! It was a ton of fun! I am also shopping their auto and home, and I have an appointment at the end of the year to review his medicare. All from knocking just ONE door. Quick notes I learned. Don't offer to SAVE people money, saving money for people is like trying to convince them that something is free when it isn't. Offer them, "If you could have MORE coverage for what your already paying, is it worth 10 minutes to take a look"? That appeals to the GREED button more than SAVING them money. I thought about going back out today, but I have a ton of cases to complete for commercial, auto, health and some paid up at 65's. So why write this? To show agents you don't need to wait weeks for a mailing, just GET OUT THERE and ask!! process bodies!! p.s. wanna easy way to intro if you are stuck for cash? Grab a senior mailing that you see locally (my father gets a ton), and just tell them that the company had sent this about 3-4 weeks ago/recently, and your just stopping by to see if they already have a plan that covers their funeral and other final expenses, technically your not lying"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Never Pay for a Lead Again! · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/never-pay-for-a-lead-again.52274/#post-679734>

"Good listen, Dave and Cody! The discussion has a lot of layers to it.. * Primary reason SAM/Cody sticks with Telesales? - He doesn't like to drive.. (2:35) *First Call Center month(with four guys) they made 9 total sales.." (6:30) *You need A LOT more leads - It takes a lot more time-ALOT!(11:30-11:45) *99.5% of telesales reps will fail.."(12:13) SAM *You need a two player model - one person to qualify another to close.." SAM *Production; 80-100 policies per month. - "Someday if I(Call Center) can write 1-5K per mo -- great.." (20:15) *2 openers\$8hr + small bonus(21:00) *4 closers(Hrly plus 'small' com or straight com).."(21:15) Is Dave going to open a call center with Cody? * Cody/Dave NEVER let door knockers in their home. *Growing trend in FE toward digital leads(hot off the press)..(33:40) * Duford's leaning toward favoring digital leads (34:25) * 'Mildred' has 6-8 DM cards - saturated with reps - can not get an affordable price in certain areas Dave(37:05) When Cody/SAM was discussing the pay structure, he had a very dismissive look toward the amount of money he's paying his 'openers' and to a lesser extent his closers. My main take away is what JD has been saying all along - the OWNERS of Telesales Call Centers ultimately are the winners who make the big \$\$\$.. There is a trend with reps growing more and more dissatisfied with lead cost, over saturation with agents and how to shift with the times and somehow capitalize on the digital world. 99.5% will fail in Telesales. (SAM) Without a two pronged approach probably 99.9999999999999999%(Me 1:23pm) What do you think - is it getting disheartening going to homes where you know they have 6-8 other mailers within the same month?"

— Insurance-Forums.com · "99.5% WILL FAIL.." - SAM · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/99-5-will-fail-sam.92470/#post-1219532>

"Your target market is seniors. It's not about beating on doors. You go where the seniors are. I'm in year 3, and I was boots to the ground, right out the gate. Huge struggle the first year, I think I did 19 apps. But last year I did over 50. Your goal is to make yourself as popular as you can. Network with everybody. Do events in senior communities. Referrals will start to come. The thrill of the hunt. Never give up and you can't lose!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · [https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fqcdel/how do i get started into selling medicare/in1ra80/](https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fqcdel/how_do_i_get_started_into_selling_medicare/in1ra80/)

@Peter_Roberts01 I am trying to generate lead ads and I am failing miserably even though I have followed all step. I have only closed 3 deals in 2 weeks so I wanted to see if I could learn something from you. I really am trying to get my own lead source but Its hard to trust people at fb because of all scam going around. thank you for replying ."

— YouTube · Generate UNLIMITED Final Expense Leads On Facebook In 2024 (Full Tutorial) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aTFTo3FiUCM&lc=UgzpFYFjDkTdY-FoRDd4AaABAg.9nHXXmK_Ydz9nKYcJEoOrt

"Best life insurance leads vendors 2024 Hey guys! I started as a life insurance agent 1 month ago, i'm loving it, i sold 3 policies but I'm struggling with leads, the vendors from where i'm buying leads are selling me leads already called from idk how many agents yet, with the results of tired and angry clients = very hard sales. What are the top vendors name for internet leads? I'm searching leads that are fresh and not resold. probably they would be more expensive but i'm willing to pay. Thanks guys!!!! ⚡ "

— r/LifeInsurance · 54 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · [https://www.reddit.com/r/LifeInsurance/comments/1brnkep/best life insurance leads vendors 2024/](https://www.reddit.com/r/LifeInsurance/comments/1brnkep/best_life_insurance_leads_vendors_2024/)

↳ Tacosmell9000 (19): "The lead market is tough right now. We spent all of last year trialing lead vendors with similar results among all vendors. Our best success has been in partnering with P&C agencies to work their book and do 50:50 commission splits. Among all lead vendors we have trialed our best success has been with Datalot. I can share the contact info for our rep if you're interested"

↳ Soggy Curve 2988 (14): "It's called Datalot because when you see the price you say "Datalot!"

↳ obiwantkobe (13): "I have over 500,000 Insurance leads that I'm trying to get ride of at a deep discount. No longer in the industry and would love to clear up some space on my Mac."

Tab 9 — Typical Day

Dialing and the phone, all day · 68 documents · 20 voices

"Quiet quitting - byeeeeeee I'm an sdr at an insurance company. Fully remote. We grind hard every day - like 200+ dials. Warm and cold leads - no break in the calls or voicemails. All day. Every day. Calls and voicemails pop literally every 10-15 seconds. The commission is crap, but the base is comfortable. Here's the issue - I have decided this is not for me and I am going to quiet quit until they fire me. How do I disengage completely when I am compelled to do well and to succeed? Do I just ride the clock? Do I blow sales intentionally? Or what. A little help and guidance. TIA"

— r/sales · 105 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/14m75j1/quiet_quitting_byeeeeeee/

↳ Typical-Mouse-4804 (231): "Ride the clock. Do bare minimum. Apply for jobs. Block calendar for interviews with DOCTOR APT and DMV and shit like that."

↳ Eswift33 (101): "Pre-record a script and have the recording play when someone answers. If they bite then close the deal. Do this all while playing PlayStation 🤪 "

↳ ATLS_finest (88): "I'm always amazed when I hear about the sheer number of calls some SDR types make. 200 calls per day is 25 calls per hour for 8 hours per day. In my first sales job I was making 60-70 calls per day and I thought that was a lot. You would basically never put the phone down. Do you have other training, reporting or administrative tasks to do or do you literally just pick up the phone and dial for 8 hours straight?"

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

↳ 3xploringforever (16): "As a lawyer, the insurance MLM industry ENRAGES me from several angles - scam insurance, misclassification of workers, unconscionable contracts signed under duress with obscenely one-sided and binding arbitration clauses, abuse of telemarketing practices, fraud/misrepresentation, toxic hustle culture, wage theft, tax theft and UI avoidance, exploitation of desperate people seeking the "American dream," I could go on."

↳ dillydeli1 (14): "Totally believe this, thanks for saying it outloud."

↳ iBaires (11): "Don't forget literally tens of thousands of TCPA violations every day lol"

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

↳ This-Armadillo9741 (7): "I've been wanting to share this insight for a while but never got the chance to. If you're considering being a life insurance agent- Specifically if you're considering working for globe life or American Income Life insurance (that was my run off branch) I'd like to offer you the most transparent what to expect in terms of your pay since I don't see anyone else being blunt with their numbers. I worked for AIL for 3 years from 2019 to 2022. on average my salary was around \$60-\$70k a year. With that income I was typically working 10 to 12 hours a day on the phone 7 days a week and attending weekly (and sometimes daily) training calls with my "team". I didn't do the recruitment side of the business, just the insurance hustle (I know this is where a lot of people are going to point out that THAT IS WHY I DIDNT MAKE AN EXTRAVAGANT AMOUNT PF MONEY) but let's be real, I didn't my my insurance liscence to recruit other people trying to get their insurance license, I did it to swell insurance. When you see that people are making"\$100k a month" or "\$MILLIONS a year" know this. If I sold a \$10,000 life insurance policy (which is a very minimum, basic, but affordable policy) I made \$55 in commission. with a \$1 residual pay that I would receive the following month. HOWEVER, when we hop on calls at the beginning of the week it would be announced that I "MADE" \$10,000 (completely untrue) and to capitalize on this they always ask "how much of that amount do you get to keep" to which you are trained to respond by saying "all of it" pretty manipulative too the new people huh? but we take what we can get and convince ourselves that if we just do that 10x over we'll eventually have what would look like a 'good check' here's the kicker about those "residuals" after the following month of each policy, you don't get them anymore. for whatever reason they give you, those get kicked to your upper and you basically only have that one time payment to count on. so if I can give you any advice on 'residual payments' it's that somewhere in the fine line of your contract I can guarantee they're not yours to keep. they will find some rhyme and reason as to why it will go back to the company. so, for over 10 hours of work a day, you might make \$55. "oh but what about those that ARE making millions" or "you just needed to work harder" let me tell you something: I busted my ass off on the phone and my spline KNEW I had no interest in recruiting people so EVENTUALLY (we'll say after a year) I got granted some pretty good leads. Now I was finally able to make some big bucks! Without getting too verbose the average policy amount for these clients would be ranging from \$150k ~ \$500k. The largest I ever sold was for a \$500k policy and here's the breakdown for that : I got paid a whopping \$1,300 in commission and a \$300 'residual' the following month. so ...you do the numbers"

↳ jroberts67 (6): "I'm sorry for your experience, but plenty of flags and not trying to come at you too hard, but a level of insanity that there's never been a time in history where we have more information available yet no one wants to research. Group interview? Huge flag. Paying for anything upfront? Huge flag. "Releasing your license" is absurd, once you've passed your exam your license is activated by your state, not any agency."

↳ Current_Bridge_3615 (4): "Worked for AIL as well, you wouldn't believe the horror stories I got during that short time. Let's just say there's a reason they've been sued multiple times and are currently under investigation for insurance fraud."

"How do y'all deal with actually insane clients? Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride. I answer the phone. Lady leads with "I went to your office and you guys vanished in the middle of the night! Do I even have insurance!? I'm reporting you to the government!" Reality: we moved nine months ago. Across the parking lot. Our Google listing has been updated. All our policy docs reflect the new address. There's a literal sign taped to the old door with an arrow saying "we moved next door." She then accuses me of not mailing her documents because I'm "screwing with her bill." Her payment has changed once in the last. It went down from \$92 to \$84. At this point she's yelling more about reporting me for moving. I told her "I'm not interested in getting yelled at. What would you like from me today?" She rants a bit more. I respond with "Okay. I am happy to transfer you to another office if that sounds good to you." She ranted more and eventually hung up. Curious how other agents handle the loons like this. I'd love to move her out of my book, but also can't really do it without her consent. People are nuts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

↳ Neither-Historian227 (19): "I had a dozen death threats during the pandemic when government locked everyone down and destroyed their businesses, this is cake walk"

↳ NovelMotor7972 (13): "Are you kidding me? I deal with crazy people for a living. Lol I've literally had people misstate their income on a recorded line, make a complaint against me to the office of financial regulation, and cause a whole ordeal over their own tax penalty, because they misstated their income. I learned my lesson, every single one of them signs a disclosure that this is the income that they are stating."

↳ BroWeBeChilling (12): "It wears on youafter ten years I have heard it all. About 20% of the people are always unhappy. This has worn on me everyday especially since most people don't take responsibility for not paying their bills, their bank made a mistake, they never got a notice in the mail or to their email. Then they take it out on me. I try brushing it off but for sure after one heart attack my life is shortening everyday."

"Is 41 too late to get into insurance? Hey guys, looking into getting my p&c license and give selling insurance a go. I currently bartend, but that's only a side hustle really, not an actual career path. So my questions to you are • Is 41 too late to get into the industry? • Am I going to be sitting at a desk/cubicle all day? Or can/will I be up and moving about? • What are some of the best companies to apply for entry level positions at? Places with some of the best training. •Am I gonna have to cold call every day? Are leads provided? And if there's any other info you'd like to provide on what to expect as a first year insurance agent please feel free to drop it here."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1id8ena/is_41_too_late_to_get_into_insurance/

↳ MeatballSandy22 (17): "I started at 47. You have plenty of runway to make a career change. All your other questions are heavily reliant on what type of company you start working for. I was able to land on the commercial lines side of an independent agency. I cold call and go visit businesses. No leads provided. Independents are different than captives (your State Farms, Farmers, Allstates), as we are appointed with dozens of carriers as opposed to only selling one product line."

↳ Zbinxsy (14): "Im 8 years in , first year I made like 20k, now I make over six figures. If you're willing to learn and be taught at 41 by people who are possibly in your 20s without resentment go for it. My only regret is that I didn't start earlier."

↳ blinddog81 (14): "I'm 43, started insurance in August."

"Big Daddy leads (BDL) Leads Review TL;DR: Tried Big Daddy Leads for Mortgage Protection. Lots of disconnected numbers (they did replace some), most people never picked up despite hammering them with 8–10 calls a day + texts, and the show rate was awful. The ones who did pick up all expected their entire mortgage covered at ~70 years old. I tried downselling to equity protection/payment protector, but they wanted all-or-nothing. Honestly, you'll get better results just running your own ads. And yes I did track my numbers for everything. --- I tested Big Daddy Leads for Mortgage Protection recently and wanted to share an honest review for anyone thinking about it. Lead quality: Pretty bad overall. I got a lot of disconnected numbers — to be fair, they did replace those — but even with the "good" ones, most people didn't answer after I hammered them: 8–10 calls a day, double-dialing, leaving voicemails once, and texting every time. Show rate was rough. Expectations: This was the biggest killer. Every single MP lead I got seemed to expect their whole mortgage covered. I did try to downsell into equity protection/payment protector plans (covering monthly payments for a set amount of time), but they flat-out didn't want it. It was whole coverage or nothing. And look — I've been doing this for years, I'm a ~\$30k/month producer, I know how to handle objections, but I couldn't flip that expectation. These leads were just set up the wrong way from the start. How they generate leads: You don't control or even see the ads. They run simple image ads into Facebook lead forms, optimized for cheapest CPL, not quality. If you've been around marketing, you know that's not the same thing. Not trying to bash them unfairly — just being real about my experience."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nxhzu2/big_daddy_leads_bdl_leads_review/

↳ joeboo5150 (5): ">> you don't control or even see the ads This is one of the biggest problems with lead vendors. The ads they are using to produce clicks and gather contact info are RIDICULOUS. Auto insurance ads promoting \$19.99/mo car insurance. Home insurance ads promoting \$500/yr home insurance, etc. They run the most unbelievably ridiculous ads that prey on the most gullible and uninformed portions of the population and the entire process starts off under a horrible set of expectations."

↳ TeamDisrespect (1): "Had a lead provider run "Senior Citizens get FREE insurance thanks to (dubious made up government program)" Literally people answering asking how they can sign up for the free insurance."

↳ No-Background-4858 (1): "Thanks for the heads up"

"We do. But we also pay commission only since we are a younger agency. There are other agencies out there that would too. We buy 15-30 leads a day a producer. Warm leads. They average 30-40 calls a day, sell between 15-25k in premium a month. 3% ish close rate, quote about 10%. Not great, but every source we've tried sucks, this is the cheapest and the leads are decent."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wd1ygk/i_got_my_liscence_a_month_ago_ive_sold_zero/p93nnh0/

"General question about leads Hey everyone, I've been lurking the sub for a bit and have seen some similar issues arise but wasn't sure about my current situation.. \-I'm a P/C agent and working towards my L/H, hopefully within the month. \-I'm with a larger well known captive carrier. The Agency I'm with has been hit with non-renewals, some of the highest in the region. \-The new agent owner took on the role from the dying book of business (85% of the book was local, most of that was bundled with the non renewals) \-The name of the company is scarred in the area so there are no referrals and few renewals coming in to generate business. \-The majority of the agent owners time is spent saving the few renewals he is able to save *albeit as much as x4 the original rate. He is not generating any new leads for the business and hasn't for nearly 8 months. \-This agency being my first producer role, I was enticed with the prospect of (wait for it) paid leads. I didn't know better at the time and hadn't browsed this sub yet. Apologies in advance lol. \-I've had nearly 200 incoming paid leads since I started 6 months ago. I text often, email weekly and call daily. I even created my own spreadsheet to track the leads since no CRM is available. (I tried Monday and enjoyed it but couldn't convince the owner to adopt this.) \-The majority of these leads are instant denials without opportunity to give alternative answers. The few who do answer, the quoted rate isn't competitive. Still, I keep trying. I asked the boss and he said just keep dialing the leads, even after a "no". \-Of these paid leads, I've closed 1 thus far. A few in the "in progress " stage but that's it. I've had a few inbound calls and of the 5 available, I've closed 4... So assuming that someone wants insurance and I can beat the coverage, rate and service, people are buying. \-I'm supposed to bind at least 3% and need to hit \$20k in sales each month to be eligible for the "agent owner program". \-The owner has lamented to me that my minimal \$ value of premium is very low (I'm averaging about \$500 per lead) AND he is upset with his input of money to pay for the leads.. \-I have requoted everyone at least 3 times and reached out to the 3000 odd old leads to cross sell, win back, etc. Using some math, at this rate I would need to bind more than 50% of the leads in a month's time to generate about \$10k in premium. My questions are: 1) What do you do to increase the amount of premium bound each month? 2) What do you do to increase the probability of direct contact with outbound leads? 3) Which paid lead companies work best or worst? 4) If you are unable to prospect in your local region, how do you generate business? Thanks for the read. I'm in a bit of a pickle."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1snoujd/general_question_about_leads/

↳ CFactor11 (4): "Sounds like you're beating up aged digital leads. Owner is cattle prodding you to maximize lead conversion. OR Take a look inward. How are you handling the call? Building rapport? Making human/genuine connection? Creating real value and urgency?"

↳ KN0W-IDEA (2): "I just reached out to the local chamber of commerce, made a social media page and am attempting to contact some of the local developers. Trying to put my name out there. But the agent owner doesn't have enough time to do these things himself."

↳ KN0W-IDEA (1): "Thanks for the reply! I've been curious myself for both.. it feels like the top answer but I'm always open to feedback. I have asked for input on my delivery for the few leads I've been able to connect with. I have tried many different approaches but the answer is usually the same: "stop contacting me"."

"Hi, I also work at an Allstate agency and this is my first insurance role. I just got licensed and accepted the first offer without doing much research. My day looks a lot like what you're describing: mostly outbound calls and working marketplace leads. There are people in my agency making six figures, but they're grinding hard like working Saturdays, staying late every day and they're extremely strong on the front end of the call. I've realized I'm probably not built for that style long-term. I don't think it's impossible at Allstate, but it's definitely a tough model and not for everyone. At my agency, the owner hired over 40 people this year and let about half go for performance, so the turnover is real. I'm personally looking at inbound roles (possibly Liberty Mutual) because I'm still very new and feel like I'd benefit more structured training and warm leads."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pp14vp/allstate/nujrdl0/>

"I'm now hearing Fauci talk about issuing immunity certificates, aka "freedom papers." I don't care who the President is - we cannot go down the road. While no one can deny the virulence of this disease and its ability to cause lasting damage to some and to kill others, we have to remember that this world survived the Black Plague and the Spanish Flu, both of which seemed far worse than this. This morning we find that researchers at Stanford now believe Corona came to California in the Fall, and the reason that Cali hasn't been hit as hard as New York is that millions of Californians had been exposed and thus allowed to develop herd immunity: Coronavirus herd immunity in California? Dr. Alok Patel shares his thoughts If that is true, then we have been going about this too severely. I do not know, but we should at least be as willing to consider that we have over reacted as we have been willing to consider this the end of the world as we know it. I posted an article the other day claiming COVID-19 was now leading cause of death. Today the CDC calls bull\$hit on that claim. Coronavirus is not the leading cause of death in the US, CDC says - CNN Now, how do we know the CDC isn't BS'ing us? I don't know. But with respect to the CDC and our government, we need to resume a healthy skepticism (not a hard-headed skepticism as some have displayed but not a naive Panglossian denial either). I've been struggling to understand what has been happening the same as y'all. What seems certain to us one day is revealed as misinformation or outright lies the next. But this is not the plague. This isn't even Spanish Flu. This outbreak should not be used to create what would necessarily become a police state: "Papers, sir? Where are they? Sir, turn and face the wall and place your hands behind your back." So I think it is time we start paying attention to what is being done to us and who is doing it and to stop letting folks convince us that life has to be different when we come out of this. We will come out of this quicker than many think, imo. And we need to be prepared to resume living our lives as free citizens. The only way we come out of this "changed forever" is if we let it change us. There is no reason we need to become card-carrying, mask wearing, slavish subjects of the Bureau of Truth. I still am committed to better safe than sorry. But I am unwilling to go beyond that. And if there appears evidence that we'd be safer by protecting the seniors and others at risk while the rest of us take our rational chances and go about our business, I'm ready to commit to that as well. Trust, but verify. And don't let them hide evidence from us. We need to keep our eyes out for all of us. We're all in this together in a way we haven't been in anything together, in my lifetime. We must expect the return of normalcy. We must not sit here planning for anything other than a return to normal American life - with as much Freedom as we had before going into this crisis. So, I'm getting ready to door knock, and I am expecting to be at it sooner than later (but probably not too soon, and certainly not soon enough). How about y'all?"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Post-Corona, Preparing for Normalcy · 8 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/post-corona-preparing-for-normalcy.101857/#post-1348228>

"I'm a captive Medicare agent, formerly a life/health broker and I have zero interest in going back to the 1099 life. I get PTO, I work from home, I just sit here and take calls all day and I get to truly clock out and spend time with my family instead of always feeling like I should be dialing leads. I'm a carrier rep and made \$130k last year, on pace to break \$150k this year. So yea, the broker path has a higher ceiling but w-2 isn't poverty."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1v1wdq6/why_would_anybody_want_to_be_a_captive_agent/oysqslzd/

"I've been wanting to share this insight for a while but never got the chance to. If you're considering being a life insurance agent- Specifically if you're considering working for globe life or American Income Life insurance (that was my run off branch) I'd like to offer you the most transparent what to expect in terms of your pay since I don't see anyone else being blunt with their numbers. I worked for AIL for 3 years from 2019 to 2022. on average my salary was around \$60-\$70k a year. With that income I was typically working 10 to 12 hours a day on the phone 7 days a week and attending weekly (and sometimes daily) training calls with my "team". I didn't do the recruitment side of the business, just the insurance hustle (I know this is where a lot of people are going to point out that THAT IS WHY I DIDNT MAKE AN EXTRAVAGENT AMOUNT PF MONEY) but let's be real, I didn't my my insurance liscence to recruit other people trying to get their insurance license, I did it to swell insurance. When you see that people are making "\$100k a month" or "\$MILLIONS a year" know this. If I sold a \$10,000 life insurance policy (which is a very minimum, basic, but affordable policy) I made \$55 in commission. with a \$1 residual pay that I would receive the following month. HOWEVER, when we hop on calls at the beginning of the week it would be announced that I "MADE" \$10,000 (completely untrue) and to capitalize on this they always ask "how much of that amount do you get to keep" to which you are trained to respond by saying "all of it" pretty manipulative too the new people huh? but we take what we can get and convince ourselves that if we just do that 10x over we'll eventually have what would look like a 'good check' here's the kicker about those "residuals" after the following month of each policy, you don't get them anymore. for whatever reason they give you, those get kicked to your upper and you basically only have that one time payment to count on. so if I can give you any advice on 'residual payments' it's that somewhere in the fine line of your contract I can guarantee they're not yours to keep. they will find some rhyme and reason as to why it will go back to the company. so, for over 10 hours of work a day, you might make \$55. "oh but what about those that ARE making millions" or "you just needed to work harder" let me tell you something: I busted my ass off on the phone and my spine KNEW I had no interest in recruiting people so EVENTUALLY (we'll say after a year) I got granted some pretty good leads. Now I was finally able to make some big bucks! Without getting too verbose the average policy amount for these clients would be ranging from \$150k ~\$500k. The largest I ever sold was for a \$500k policy and here's the breakdown for that : I got paid a whopping \$1,300 in commission and a \$300 'residual' the following month. so ...you do the numbers"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mh1vhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/nhgtz0w/

"I work at an agency where we receive only inbound calls. We have a weekly charge of around \$850. This covers everything from the dialer to the office space and the leads as well The first two weeks are free though. My one call today covers that charge so I'm ok with it. People who have been doing it for a while are just killing it there. I used to work furniture sales and during slow season when the snowbirds were out of town, that was all I would make in one or two weeks occasionally. Definite Upgrade!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj9u0m/had_my_first_sale_today/oum8y9g/

"This rings true to my experience to a tee. The company is off the charts unethical and should be shut down imo. A lot of people don't realize AO Globe Life has 2 major hiring periods linked to bonus events within the org where managers are heavily incentivized to hire as many new people as possible. Many of the new hires at this time of year are hired solely for that bonus, with little to no intent to see them actually make it. Being strung along just long enough to qualify for the bonus then essentially left to sink or swim from there. This leaves such a bad taste in people's mouths for the industry as a whole when it's the company through and through And when you finally get a peak behind the curtain, it's like Oz all smoke & mirrors. Top tier agents aren't making 500-1000 calls a day like they brag in the videos and weekly calls. A few of them have their own appointment setting businesses and hire foreign call centers to push for live transfers. Sold leads are passed around to be sold again, multiple times. When I was with them you could look up a lead and be floored seeing how many times a person's been sold the same products by the org's top tier agents. And to this day, when I hear the phrase "you picking up what I'm putting down?" I just want to punch that guy in the face 🤨"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/on4jz8u/

"I mean I started in insurance 7 years ago and first 2 years was basically all cold calling. Sold U65, just call up and say, "hey my name is Bob, I help people with their health insurance coverage, do you feel like your getting good coverage for what your paying?" 400+ calls every day and made a good little book of business but haven't done that in awhile and I know things have changed"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1udkyjb/just_do_it/otdok1t/

"Yeah I'm a captive agent. Do you think I should call the claims department first thing in the morning and explain the whole situation? It should I wait for them to try and deny the claim and then bring up the mistake and written proof"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1n20wgr/i_accidentally_did_not_add_collision_on_a_clients/nb2kmpn/

"Penguin leads Hello everyone,I have just started an insurance agency in Tampa Florida and my biggest feat is finding a really good lead vendor,preferably inbound leads,to help support me and my agents.the main product to sell is life insurance. Health insurance like Medicare is also going to be a focus very soon.i was just wondering what your guys go to leads vendors are. I've been looking to possibly purchase some leads from penguin so if anyone has used them and can elaborate please do. Any and all information on this topic or just tips on agency success would help tremendously! UPDATE: I purchased these leads and ran the unlimited 500/week leads for about 3 weeks. 90% of my day was spent dispo voicemails or dead air calls. The rest were people who answered and mixed interest. I agree with one comment where just about every single call I received was well out of the 30 day that the vendor advertises. I was able to write just about 15k in AP. Are they workable 100%, is there a way better bang for your buck elsewhere, 110%. I've ran closetech this last week and a half and definitely a way more improved pickup rate,but extreme disinterest from the leads. At least they are advertised as well aged. My honest approach is either trying to start doing inbound with policy printer, talked with them and they seem like great guys, have some buddy's running them and good success. Or to possibly run my own meta ads. If anyone has more follow up suggestions for lead vendors they had success with drop some knowledge."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tcdwze/penguin_leads/

↳ Sudden_Ask_2319 (2): "**Warning: Penguin Leads is selling aged leads (over 30 days)** Just wanted to put this out there for anyone considering Penguin Leads. I recently purchased from them, and they are not delivering what they advertise. Their website clearly guarantees that leads are under 30 days old. Yet, every single lead I received was timestamped well past the 30-day mark. Can you still work them and get results? Maybe. But do I trust them? Absolutely not. I canceled my service because I refuse to work with dishonest vendors who use false advertising to get sign-ups. **A quick PSA for anyone dealing with sketchy lead vendors:** If you buy leads and they aren't as advertised, request a refund. Do not let them hide behind a "no refund policy." Legally, a no-refund policy is void if the company fails to actually deliver the service they advertised. If they refuse to cooperate: * **File a chargeback** with your credit card company (use "Services Not as Described" and show screenshots of their site promises vs. your lead timestamps). * **File complaints** with the FTC and the state consumer protection divisions (file in your home state, the state the merchant is located in, and the state of their payment processor if they use a third party). We need to start holding these deceptive lead companies accountable. Save your money and buy elsewhere!"

↳ Turbulent_Piece4208 (1): "I'm interested in how your getting leads as well I'm new to the industry and want to get producing."

↳ KCMOTC (1): "I just sent you a DM too. Please let me know!"

"New Agent having difficulty closing. I've been a new agent for two months now and I'm having difficulty closing! I'm averaging 100 calls a day with 2-4 hours of talk time. I'm a captive agent and I'm almost double the price people are currently paying. I stopped asking "how much do you pay" and started taking the conversation a different route to where I'm explaining and advising on what they need. I used to sell solar and never had this much difficulty in closing. I would like some tips on how other agents are closing even at a higher price for the same coverage. I would also like to hear some tips on how agents are getting more people on the phone or referrals as a remote agent. I did solar sales before Insurance and was a top performer as an telephone appointment setter, door knocker, and consultant. I don't know if I lost my touch or what I'm experiencing is out of my hands. I want to the best!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ve4p1s/>

↳ (0): "Two months is good. I owned an Agency for 25 years and have done a ton of marketing. If you're twice the price and selling on the phone that is hard. I think it's better to get face to face with them. You can review their dec page and start talking about what they need and why. You also need to realize you're not selling a tangible product. That makes it harder. I would use different marketing plans through out the day and night. If one's not working then you have another that could be working. It's a good thing you're good on the phone. I could talk hours on this. I think you need to set appointments and sale needs and come up with other marketing ideas. Keep moving forward and you will win."

↳ (0): "Personal opinion: You are marking to the wrong demographic. A big part of being a capitive agent is understanding your local market and marketing to those demographic you can win in. This would be something a sales leader/manager can help you pin point. From there, some captives are just going to be higher still. At this point you have to create a problem and the provide a solution. Winning deals if you are selling the same coverage is incredibly hard. One of my tactics is to not try to sell the exact same coverage, this is easier said then done but goes back to the create a problem and give a solution. This could be bundling for discounts, increasing limits, adding optional coverage, anything that is going to provide value over their current policy and gives you a reason to ask for more"

↳ (0): "I have trouble just getting people to come to their Zoom appointments. And I send reminders and call. I repeatedly get ghosted."

"I remember a few years back, I searched out a specific insurance company, filled out my info and the next 3 months of my life was nonstop phone calls from so many different companies. Very aggressive too. Eventually after nicely asking each to lose my number, I would answer and immediately get juvenile. Eventually they gave up"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rsznnc/text_exchange_from_a_prospect_who_reached_out_to/oab35b8/

"Hey Cody. I have a full time job and starting to sell insurances part time until I make the same or more than what I do with my current full time job which is 8-5pm and I can only make calls after 5pm. Is it best to call on weekends and make appointments for weekends instead of weekdays after 5pm?"

— YouTube · Live Dialing Insurance Leads! [Final Expense Insurance] · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RL6Y5qig0Wg&lc=Ugyc7DepZeChP9veRdZ4AaABAq>

↳ @CodyAskins (1): "Not necessarily. I would try calling in the evenings because they'll be home."

↳ @CodyAskins (0): "@yasielfigueroa7871 you're welcome!"

Service work: renewals, changes, client problems · 29 documents · 20 voices

"How do y'all deal with actually insane clients? Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride. I answer the phone. Lady leads with "I went to your office and you guys vanished in the middle of the night! Do I even have insurance!? I'm reporting you to the government!" Reality: we moved nine months ago. Across the parking lot. Our Google listing has been updated. All our policy docs reflect the new address. There's a literal sign taped to the old door with an arrow saying "we moved next door." She then accuses me of not mailing her documents because I'm "screwing with her bill." Her payment has changed once in the last. It went down from \$92 to \$84. At this point she's yelling more about reporting me for moving. I told her "I'm not interested in getting yelled at. What would you like from me today?" She rants a bit more. I respond with "Okay. I am happy to transfer you to another office if that sounds good to you." She ranted more and eventually hung up. Curious how other agents handle the loons like this. I'd love to move her out of my book, but also can't really do it without her consent. People are nuts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

↳ Neither-Historian227 (19): "I had a dozen death threats during the pandemic when government locked everyone down and destroyed their businesses, this is cake walk"

↳ NovelMotor7972 (13): "Are you kidding me?I deal with crazy people for a living. Lol I've literally had people misstate their income on a recorded line, make a complaint against me to the office of financial regulation, and cause a whole ordeal over their own tax penalty, because they misstated their income. I learned my lesson, every single one of them signs a disclosure that this is the income that they are stating."

↳ BroWeBeChilling (12): "It wears on youafter ten years I have heard it all. About 20% of the people are always unhappy. This has worn on me everyday especially since most people don't take responsibility for not paying their bills, their bank made a mistake, they never got a notice in the mail or to their email. Then they take it out on me. I try brushing it off but for sure after one heart attack my life is shortening everyday."

"It's my first day as an independent insurance agent! I used to be a captive agent but I didn't feel like I was able to provide the service I feel my community of artists so I quit and decided to become an independent agent. After 2 months of hemming and hawing applying to jobs in other sales fields I finally decided it was enough and found 2 IMOs. One focused on health the other focused on life and P&C. Today I signed my last contracts to be appointed with their major carriers and I started prospecting. I sent out maybe 50-70 linked in messages with one simple goal in mind. Ask 5 people to sit for an appointment with you. I accomplished my goal at 1 pm with one appointment set. Then I went out networking and was able to book a second. 5 is tomorrow's number as well. I want to go a full week with 5 tasks every day except Sunday. As a wise poet from the San Francisco Bay Area once said, "I'm feeling myself"."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pc01jr/its_my_first_day_as_an_independent_insurance_agent/

↳ QuiriousCoyote (3): "Nice to hear a positive story. Keep up the good work and good luck!"

↳ theimprovednatee (2): "What's systems? I work with 7 realtors who send me business VERY consistently. I don't want to be a captive agent anymore"

↳ Toppoppler (1): "You work with artists? As a new captive producer, that's the market I want to work within as it's the market I come from. Would you have any tips on finding/connecting with artists, what type of coverages they might need, etc?"

"If you were starting over today with no book of business and no carrier appointments, what would you do first? Hi everyone, I officially passed my Texas Life & Health licensing exam yesterday (self studied via an online prep course), and I'm trying to be very intentional about how I build my business from Day 1. A little background: I'm 39 and transitioning from a successful corporate finance career (\$175k, annual) after being laid off in 2025. I want to use this unexpected time to invest in a career pivot to an independent producer, eventually building up to a small boutique style agency. Short-term, I plan to focus on Medicare, ACA, Life Insurance, and Supplemental Health. Longer-term, I'd like to expand into ICHRA and small employer benefits, but I don't want to spread myself too thin in the beginning. My vision is to build a referral- and relationship-based business. I'm much more interested in creating a trusted advisory practice than becoming a high-pressure salesperson. If you were in my shoes today —with no book of business, no carrier appointments, and no industry experience—but knowing what you know now: What would your first three steps be? What mistakes would you avoid? Would you join an agency/FMO first, or would you try to build independently from Day 1? Is there anything you wish someone had told you before your first year? I'm not necessarily looking for the "highest commission" straight away. Instead, I'm trying to build the strongest long-term foundation and book of business. I genuinely appreciate any advice from those who've been through it. Thanks in Advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uxw9ko/if_you_were_starting_over_today_with_no_book_of/

↳ idontknowhow2reddit (7): "I agree with all of this. Insurance is a crazy world so there's a ton of things to learn. The textbook and real world are very different so I would try to find an established company with good training to work for first. Without that, it will be hard to build a referral base or to gain that trusted advisor role. Your network and other professionals are going to need to see you in the industry a bit before they will trust you on your own."

↳ Key_Astronomer6500 (5): "Congrats! For someone who also got into insurance later in my career. 1. Pick one product and master it, then move into the second one, and so on. Medicare, ACA, Final Expense, Annuities, etc. 2. Training. Master that product and then move to the second. W 2 or Captive will give you the most training. 40 a week of training vs 1 or 2 hours a week. 3. Pick the right organization. Know the difference between recruiters selling me vs legitimate interviews. I wish someone told me about how many recruiters would try to sell me and then offer no support. I am so glad I left and went into a W2 to learn and get practice but I wish someone told me how difficult releases were! Best of luck but honestly someone with your degree of previous success should be fine. Just remember you're not gonna make as much money at first. You'll probably need to go independent to make more than 125k. However, I would suggest to build that foundation first but as long as you know what you're getting into I think you'll do great."

↳ OZKInsuranceGuy (5): "If I had to start over today, the first thing I'd do is choose my upline very carefully. The wrong agency/upline can cost you years of your career. Second, I'd pick one niche and master it before trying to sell everything. Too many new agents want to do Medicare, ACA, final expense, annuities, group benefits...and end up not getting very good at any of them. Third, I'd get in front of people every single workday. Nothing replaces activity. I'd rather have a decent script and 15 appointments than the perfect script and no one to talk to. The biggest mistakes I'd avoid are buying into recruiting hype (MLMs), signing contracts without understanding release policies, and spending time on useless activities, like tweaking logos, trying to figure out every detail of CRMs, or building websites than actually selling. I would absolutely suggest joining an agency first. I'd choose one based on transparency, track record, proven training and scripts, and upline (again, upline is very important). Make sure you're paid directly by the carriers, understand exactly how releases work (get it in writing), and ask a lot of questions before you sign anything. Once you start selling, consistency is key. Focus on activity, because your input determines your output. Work hard, follow your upline's advice and system, and don't get distracted by other opportunities or anything else."

"Beware of MLM structured companies (warning) So this was originally a response to a comment on this sub, but I see a ton of new people coming into insurance, (speaking to independent guys here) and there are many many hungry wolves waiting to recruit these naïve noobs and make a profit. So, I figured I could make a post using some of the content from my previous response to explain the caveats and expose the reality of these places. I come from a MLM originally, it was unbenounced to me at the time, but I'm still grateful because it gave me a first hand glance at what goes on there. How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. They will push you to build a team, because hey, don't you wanna make 6 figures "bro"??? Well then you gotta build a huge team so you get all those overrides off the guys under you. Now, there's nothing wrong necessarily with building a team, but in a MLM context and the way they act in a deceptive manner it is extremely unethical. The guys you see writing 100k plus in premium a year??? A fraction of that fell of the books and was a chargeback, then that guy like all of us has to pay taxes at the end of the year. He also probably was buying \$500 worth of leads a week. Burned gas every day meeting clients. He "maybe" profited 40k that year, and that's being generous. But as long as they can show boat how much premium they're writing a week? A month? A year? Then shove the rhetoric down new guys throats, boasting about how they too can make 100k a year? Then they're all good. I found out through a credible source, as well as David Dufford (has a youtube channel, good tips and insight for insurance) that alot of these "top producers" buy the trips that you can win with insurance carriers for writing a lot of AP. They do all of this and sugar coat their actual earnings because you'll buy the dream, go sell sell sell, and the guys above you get all the overrides off of you without investing any of their money into you at all. It's a fucking amazing model for the guys at the top to make a killing. They create a strong sense of family at those places to keep you on board as well. They push shitty products like Americo a ton too, because they get higher commissions off of that. Americo is also pricey, and you can easily find a cheaper product for that senior to actually help them out, but more than likely they won't have many cheap options that actually are economical for the client, because then you, and them get a lower commission. So MLM's will typically encourage you to get a higher premium out of the client and force a pricey carrier on them. Hope this helps. Reputable, ethical IMO's that offer you high commission contracts and don't push you to build teams are harder to find, because they don't market and recruit. Join an insurance forum, those guys are veterans and a lot of the IMO/Brokerage owners are members there. I've been in Life Insurance for a while now, and am branching into Health/Medicare, so anyone can feel free to PM me with Life Insurance questions if you'd like. Also it would be cool to maybe post any experiences you've had with these types of organizations."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/n4hblb/beware_of_mlm_structured_companies_warning/

↳ pdxoss (6): "I hate MLM too but if someone is making 100k and paying for leads/gas, taxes etc. Their take home isn't 40%. They're going to write off marketing expenses, gas, and everything they can on taxes"

↳ coreyjacrispy (5): "Haha, not specifically, they are are a known MLM company though. Them, Primerica, Symmetry etc etc. Anytime they're trying to force the Kool aid down your throat, with generic phrases and lectures like "You can take this and be BIG man, BIG...you want to have complete financial freedom? Be on your own clock? WE give you the tools to do that! We are a family, and want everyone to succeed" Blah blah blah lol, rest assured knowing they are indeed a MLM company."

↳ Tahoptions (3): ">How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. That is only for simplified products like final expense and mortgage protection. Street is no where near 120% for most traditional products. It is much closer to 85-100% (for term/GUL/IUL) and even lower for permanent products from big mutuals like Guardian and Mass. The post is a good warning though."

"For those of us who've already been living in this final telesales telesales world, I thought it would be a good idea to share tips, carriers, and lead vendors to our cohorts to help them during these uncertain times. Whats your favorite carrier? Whats your favorite kind of lead? What tips do you have? --- My favorite carrier is American Amicable because of the ease of doing business. Although, I am finding, that many other carriers are getting better daily. The best lead for telesales is still TV. However, Facebook lead costs have CRASHED. This is a great time to jump in and get leads for \$2-\$3. I wouldnt use a vendor only to pay 200% more. Research and do it yourself. Heres my tip. Dont go back through all your old leads and think you are going to resurrect intrest. Buy new leads, and buy alot of them."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Telesales Tips · 11 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/final-expense-telesales-tips.101595/#post-1344504>

"Hey, I'm a new Agent, I got licensed less then a year ago. During my training, I was taught for that rebuttal was "I don't do any second appointments, because we shop every A Rated carrier today to see who you would get approved for." Something within them lines. To avoid that rebuttal, I was taught to ask who they make their financial decisions with & if they was around. Hope this helps."

— YouTube · LIVE Dialing: Cold Calling Insurance Leads (SCRIPT GIVEAWAY) · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=POOoucTXJYc&lc=Ugxu8xdg4l-QqJxrU4x4AaABAg>

↳ @Countmoneyforever (4): "i think it helps! Also the better you qualify the better youll close. for example i always ask "who makes financial decisions for you?" and "if were able to find something affordable that meets your needs, when would you like that plan to start?" if they say today you keep going but if they say "im not sure" or anything else you gotta figure out why BEFORE you present any options! Our most important asset is time, dont let these ppl waste any"

↳ @bejrnews (0): "New agent here. How's your book of business doing?"

"The date of the accident was today and she formally requested "both Comprehensive and collision please" over text last Wednesday to me. I tried going in there today and making an endorsement backdating 3 days ago but I'm sure they will see that and question it or deny the claim, so I don't know what I should do"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1n20wgr/i_accidentally_did_not_add_collision_on_a_clients/nb2eytp/

"P&C builds a book of business with renewals but also client relationship which leads to sales of other ancillary products. The shoe can drop on the captive side if the carrier decides to blow their rates out of the water in your area. Life pays the best but there's zero client relationship after the sale. ACA is a grind, especially going into this year's enrollment with the new rules in place, small per-person as-earned commissions where you'd need to enroll a lot of people for years and years to really see it start to add up. I sell life to small business owners, but with no renewals, it's great money but it's also Groundhog day every day."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/n5603iv/

"Great video! I have been doing the ACA since it's inception. I started selling Medicare about 5 years ago. Half of my business is ACA and the other is Medicare. Many of my ACA clients are aging into Medicare and I help them through the transition. I have a Medicare appointment today, with a client who has been an ACA client for years now. I also get referrals from ACA clients who have friends or relatives that need ACA plans or Medicare. I also speak fluent Spanish and get many referrals from Spanish speaking only clients."

— YouTube · Is It Worth Selling ACA Plans as a Medicare Agent? · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ERXhOx7N_N8&lc=Ugz6DeDmMx0U56Cotz14AaABAg

↳ @MedicareMillennials (1): "That's awesome man! I wish I wouldn't have been so hesitant to sell it before"

↳ @gyannevent (0): "I new help, I have my license but need mentoring"

↳ @GaryPhelps55 (0): "@gyannevent In which state are you licensed."

"I'm now hearing Fauci talk about issuing immunity certificates, aka "freedom papers." I don't care who the President is - we cannot go down the road. While no one can deny the virulence of this disease and its ability to cause lasting damage to some and to kill others, we have to remember that this world survived the Black Plague and the Spanish Flu, both of which seemed far worse than this. This morning we find that researchers at Stanford now believe Corona came to California in the Fall, and the reason that Cali hasn't been hit as hard as New York is that millions of Californians had been exposed and thus allowed to develop herd immunity: Coronavirus herd immunity in California? Dr. Alok Patel shares his thoughts If that is true, then we have been going about this too severely. I do not know, but we should at least be as willing to consider that we have over reacted as we have been willing to consider this the end of the world as we know it. I posted an article the other day claiming COVID-19 was now leading cause of death. Today the CDC calls bull\$hit on that claim. Coronavirus is not the leading cause of death in the US, CDC says - CNN Now, how do we know the CDC isn't BS'ing us? I don't know. But with respect to the CDC and out government, we need to resume a healthy skepticism (not a hard-headed skepticism as some have displayed but not a naive Panglossian denial either). I've been struggling to understand what has ben happening the same as y'all. What seems certain to us one day is revealed as misinformation or outright lies the next. But this is not the plague. This isn't even Spanish Flu. This outbreak should not be used to create what would necessarily become a police state: "Papers, sir? Where are they? Sir, turn and face the wall and place your hands behind your back." So I think it is time we start paying attention to what is being done to us and who is doing it and to stop letting folks convince us that life has to be different when we come out of this. We will come out of this quicker than many think, imo. And we need to be prepared to resume living our lives as free citizens. The only way we come out of this "changed forever" is if we let it change us. There is no reason we need to become card-carrying, mask wearing, slavish subjects of the Bureau of Truth. I still am committed to better safe than sorry. But I am unwilling to go beyond that. And if there appears evidence that we'd be safer by protecting the seniors and others at risk while the rest of us take our rational chances and go about out business, I'm ready to commit to that as well. Trust, but verify. And don't let them hide evidence from us. We need to keep our eyes out for all of us. We're all in this together in a way we haven't been in anything together, in my lifetime. We must expect the return of normalcy. We must not sit here planning for anything other than a return to normal American life - with as much Freedom as we had before going into this crisis. So, I'm getting ready to door knock, and I am expecting to be at it sooner than later (but probably not too soon, and certainly not soon enough). How about y'all?"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Post-Corona, Preparing for Normalcy · 8 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/post-corona-preparing-for-normalcy.101857/#post-1348228>

"Yeah I'm a captive agent. Do you think I should call the claims department first thing in the morning and explain the whole situation? It should I wait for them to try and deny the claim and then bring up the mistake and written proof"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1n20wgr/i_accidentally_did_not_add_collision_on_a_clients/nb2kmmr/

"Addiction Treatment Facility's Receptionist is Playing Medical Insurance Agent. A "Provider" can't make these types of recommendations? (hint: i'm noticing so much corruption in this industry...but I forget the specific laws regarding this situation). Hi All! I was a Group Medical Benefits Agent/Producer for 6 years...licensed...stopped in 2018. (I live in WA State but I imagine the laws for what I'm explaining here should probably be similar from state to state). I'm not in insurance now...I'm in an "adjacent" industry. Anyway, in late 2018 I got a DUI...and I've been completely sober since...don't judge. 😊 However, as part of the conditions from the court I was required to attend Intensive Outpatient Treatment. I went to a place my lawyer recommended. (I'm 90% positive he receives kickbacks from the treatment center for sending his clients with court orders...but that's for another post...this could easily become a series...truly...the crookedness—on so many layers—in the treatment industry is shocking...and they're doing it all in plain sight). Anyway, I'm 45-years-old...and there are a lot of young folks who attend the program with me. (Learned my lesson later In life maybe? 🙄) I found out that I'm paying MUCH more than MOST of the other people in my "group". My monthly out-of-pocket cost/monthly bill is much higher—obscenely higher—than most everyone else I attend with. I understand VERY well how every plan is different...they reimburse differently...cost shares vary as do deductibles and OOP Max's. I get that...I have BCBS of IL...I work for a large public ally-traded company and my insurance is considered "really good"...it reimburses well...\$1000 ded...and it's a 90% plan...but that's not the point of this post. This specific question came from a girl named Megan who just turned 21. (I changed her name to protect the...er...young :)). Anyway, when i asked her about her costs each month she told me that after a month of evening "groups" at "The Center"...the girl who answers phones at the front desk of the treatment center (she makes coffee for before groups too) told her, "Oh you should definitely change your insurance carrier to Amerigroup...it has WAY better coverage and "pays more". Then she said, "I tell EVERYONE to switch to them...I should get commission , haha!". Well...i talked to an old coworker who sells individual policies and, sure enough, Amerigroup definitely reimburses/pays the Treatment Provider aka "The Center" more...so Megan pays less. In other words...it's much better for "The Center" if more of their patients have Amerigroup as their carrier. When I heard this, my ex Agent/Producer ears perked up and I thought, "Wait...I'm pretty sure that NOBODY—in a professional setting, dealing with customers—is supposed to give insurance advice to relative strangers on what insurance to buy or what carrier they should choose, right? Or can they? But I'm pretty positive that Medical or Treatment Providers, specifically, aren't supposed to recommend specific carriers to their patients...or can they?" That's why I'm here asking. My opinion—due to several other reasons—is that this place is crooked and corrupt. First, I want to look into this practice at "The Center". In this specific instance, I'm quite sure the front desk staff has been coached on what plans to recommend "in passing"...and she is making these recommendations based on which Carriers/Plans "reimburse" the most to "The Center"...and she interfaces with 100s of clients/patients every day. Seems like a conflict of interest...right? The WA OIC probably wouldn't like this...ya? Pretty sure I had to take a test, work for a broker, and take C.E. classes periodically; in order to sell health insurance policies...yep...I do remember that. :) Can anyone explain the law here...I'm a bit rusty. Can the Provider in this case potentially be in hot water for this practice? What about the front desk receptionist herself? She is giving advice to people to switch carriers specifically based on how much it reimburses the Provider...or, "because this carrier covers more than your current carrier"...can she potentially be in trouble? Or is it "The Center" who would take the heat for training her that way? She's a nice girl...the front desk gal...but I'm afraid her corrupt overlords could get her in trouble. Thanks for reading all of that!!! This place is advising and billing lots of youn'g's...but mostly bilking ACA/State-sponsored insurance plans/carriers...aka Uncle Sam. I kinda wanna "get em". Feel free to ask what else is corrupt there...I'm learning a LOT! :)"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/i4n1tq/addiction_treatment_facilitys_receptionist_is/

"Have a team of few hundred agents , the goal we set for agents is to write at least one policy a day if you are new. If you have been here for more than 90 days 2 policies a day. If you have been here for 6 months 3 policies a day. If you are a veteran agent the goal is 5-10 policies a day. The average policy is to 1000AP. So the question you need to solve first is do you have more time or do you have more money right now? Most agents have a lot more time than money. The next problem is that you need to know how to develop your skillset before you burn all of your marketing capital. You can take the slow route of forming referral partners, warm market, bingo nights etc. unless you are a boring 60yr old who started 20 years ago this isn't the move. Embrace the times, it's all about internet leads, a lead driven business, there is an endless amount of people to talk to and pitch insurance. It has never been easier. When we started it was suits and kitchen tables, now any Gen Z with a laptop and a Stiiizy pen can sit in sweatpants with a Stanley and crush \$500-\$1000 a day in deposits like clockwork. It was hard to watch at first considering what use to have to be done, but we have to embrace the times. Tip: start with final expense leads that are less than \$1 , preferably something that is about 15 cents a lead. Yes, it's going to require a ton of dials. You will have to put a bunch of sweat work in before you get paid. I tell my kids , in order for you to start selling 2-3 policies a week in your first month, you need to spend 15 hours a day on the phone for a good 7-10 days in a row to develop some grit. Then someone can start working with you. The next most important thing is who you marry? It's not the IMO , it's not the carrier, it's not the comp plan , you need a solid mentor who can work with you daily and give you feedback. This will cut down the learning curve by 50%, having someone who sells at a high level giving you feedback is priceless. Accept that you can work your tail off and still not make 10k in your first month. That is ok, you are nothing less. Understand that when you have put enough time and reps in the 10k will come easy. Then you will start chasing the 20k, 30k and 40k of Deposits ; it's not that hard to write 10,000-20,000 AP a week. The hardest thing is going from 0-10,000 consistently. Once you have your skill set somewhat polished then you just scale up the marketing. Wish you the best , get after it !"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ouo21x/anybody_here_make_at_least_10k_a_month_in_life/nof72gg/

"I have been contracted with about seven carriers for life insurance and I'm slowly getting the rest of them but yes I just got licensed left my 16 year career in the dental field and I have not yet sold one policy but I am officially two weeks and after getting carriers And I'm currently working still at a dental office helping a dentist for three days while I transfer out completely but I own my own small business seeing clients and also now trying to sit behind a desk and dial all day it's a lot, but I know I can do it. Glad I found this videos for more information on how a life insurance agent career is pass my exam the first time and have bought leads, but haven't had much success so I've made flyers."

— YouTube · PROS & CONS OF BEING AN INSURANCE AGENT · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UfiHT3xWq4TY&lc=Ugzr4N3sCTVahCgXMbd4AaABAq>

"Kinda already is (for Medicare with strict rules) but these ad agencies just use oversea lead generators who have very little regulation. Literally spam an ad out saying "click here for \$3000" and then sell that as a lead. It's pretty ridiculous they allowed it to get to this point, Something has to give. My clients say they can't even use their phone because of these call centers and ads popping up nonstop. Nonstop ads spamming them from every direction with spam calls that follow."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pgvbbq/aep_apps_vs_chargebacks/nszc7mq/

"I actually work for this company and have been for almost 10 years. I'm sorry you had a bad experience but your take on this is pretty jaded and not to mention one-sided. This industry might not have worked for you, but if you go anywhere else, you would probably have the same complaint. I remember when I first started I had a really rough start, I started 2018 with almost \$1,500 in chargebacks. But I worked my ass off and actually made productive agent that quarter. I focus mainly on Medicare; generally, the clients I talk to aren't interested in \$ 15 to \$ 30-a-month life insurance policies. It's pretty obvious you didn't research this company or the business before you got into it. Almost every single company out there is 1099; yes, there are W-2s, which is nice, but a lot of those are P&C. All of the products we sell are legitimate and offered by almost every insurance company out there. The government mandates Medicare supplements, and a supplement from Bankers or XYZ company is the same. Not to mention, Medicare Advantage is the same across the board. Our universal Life policies are very competitive in the market and are quality products; not to mention, we are one of the few companies still selling long-term care. As far as that lady goes who bought her own car, well, that's sort of on her. Bankers didn't force her to buy that car. I rode around in a 99 CRV for 4 years, then a 04 Accord for 2, and then I bought my next car outright in cash. The insurance industry in general has tons of turnover just like any other sales position. I realized Bankers gets a lot of hate here and across the industry, but insurance is personal responsibility and holding yourself accountable. I sleep very well at night knowing that my clients are well taken care of and are on compliant, good products that serve their needs."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wn5pwj/do_not_work_for_bankers_life/pbk7ksx/

"Medicare consumers are actively searching for licensed agents who can help them compare Medicare Supplement plans and understand options in their state. MedicareSupp.org helps them find you. [Get Listed on MedicareSupp.org] MedicareSupp.org gives agents a low-cost, high-visibility way to build credibility, generate quality leads, and grow their book of business, without cold calling. Over the past year, MedicareSupp.org has had 85,000+ new users and 10,000+ directory searches by Medicare consumers. "I got three new clients within the first month of joining. Best investment I've made in my Medicare business." — David R., Licensed Agent in Ohio Claim your listing today and start getting discovered by Medicare consumers nationwide. [Get Listed on MedicareSupp.org Today]"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Join MedicareSupp.org: More Than a Directory — A Trusted Medicare Marketplace · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/join-medicare-supp-org-more-than-a-directory-%E2%80%94-a-trusted-medicare-marketplace.117749/#post-1583206>

"LostDollar said: So it is my opinion that a significant portion of today's (Today meaning something like current decade) hoopla over how wonderful MA coverage is for vets stems from financial incentives created by carriers for those selling and holding MA-MAPD type insurance plans. I think that High Deductible medigap plans could also continue to be viable supplementary Medicare insurance products for some veterans. lol..... You're a one-trick pony. LD's insurance services: "Have you considered a high deductible med supp?" That's probably the last option I'd recommend to someone with TriCare or even non-Tricare VA Benefits. (And in your mind, you'll think I'm saying this only for financial reasons. You'd be wrong)."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Know it All Veterans · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/know-it-all-veterans.108924/#post-1427998>

"Get a job at Neilson Financial Services in Downtown Toronto I got the job here after working at AIL and going through an interview with Serenia life too this company pays you handsomely for Salary and a good amount for commission they generate actual good quality warm leads that allow you to call all day and actually perform I been here for approx 2 months now and the benefits start for me next month I'm loving it so far and they are always hiring and the companies they represent have great reviews from actual customers who talk to advisors on a daily basis they also pay you while getting ur license if u don't have it already and they have fair metrics"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fx4zhe/i_hate_american_income_life_ail_so_bad/maaa35u/

"Midlevel said: I got a call today from a non clients daughter who said they already got their UH PDP ANOC and it's going from 140 to like 210/month and he takes 4 generic drugs. I said he needs a new agent first of all. Never been this late in the game and not known all the PDP information. I had a call like that in Indiana today too. But the UHC plan was the correct plan for her due to meds. But the rate which was already the highest of all is going to double for next year."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Humana is taking suppression to a new level · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/humana-is-taking-suppression-on-to-a-new-level.118143/#post-1594028>

Texting, voicemail and follow-up · 13 documents · 13 voices

"Rant- Big Red is one of the worst employers (and the most petty) I've had a long career and in my 25 years I've worked at a lot of carriers. Some were better than others but most of them weren't terrible. That is until I worked for Big Red. I should have known from the horrible interviewing/hiring process it was going to be bad. A recruiter reached out because a colleague gave them my name. I applied and didn't hear back for three months. They initially offered me to interview for section manager position but after the interview they decided to offer me a team manager position. I wasn't going to accept but my wife convinced me that it could be a good opportunity. I agreed to the position. Then my first day it was absolute chaos. 900 people starting at the exact time as me and my credentials not working. No phone number to call or anything. Finally at 3pm after panicking that I left my consulting gig and wasn't getting hired I got a phone call asking why I wasn't online. This lead to them telling me I never signed my offer letter. Fast forward and it turns out they changed their mind and were offering me the section manager position but no one called. I'm now a section manager Fast forward a few months and this job is hell. I spent two months getting the most basic training ever. None of it has anything to do with management. None. I am never taught how to use the time card system. I'm not taught T2 or Workday. Nothing. Then I'm saddled with a team that has questions from minor claim stuff to HR issues. That I have no idea on how to handle. Then my claim manager has the nerve to tell me I need to get my CPCU, that management is expected to have their CPCU. I have my CPCU. So I tell him that. He asks why I haven't been putting it in signature. It's simple I don't see value in it when I have decades of real experience. He then tells me that I need to continuously improve and to sign up for another designation. I choose the ARe. I go on and buy the three ARe exams study material and sign up for the tests. I take the first one and pass. Then I sign up for the next two. I decided to get all the materials for a few other designations that overlap the CPCU (like 6 other study materials). Keep in mind I'm using the corporate codes. While all this is going on I am still trying to figure out the job. I have leaders asking me questions and talking to me like I should know how certain obscure systems work. The absolute worst part is the other new folks. I had four brand new team managers reporting to me. Three were external hires and one was an internal hire. I honestly felt like every day I was letting down my team because I didn't have the faintest clue how to teach them systems that I didn't have any clue how to use. There was zero training for them. These folks had brand new adjusters of their own and they didn't know how to help them. I had one associate get out to the middle of the country in their van and their gas card stopped working. This is a 22 year old recent grad with no real world experience. Stuck in the middle of the country because they don't have enough spare credit to pay to keep filling up that gas hog. Their team manager had no clue how to fix the situation and I had no clue. It took us three days to find someone to fix it. I felt like pure dog shit. No one would respond to emails other than giving a vague area of the internal portal. All the while my one on ones were just my claim manager asking me about personal development. Develop my skills in how all this runs.... I resigned a couple of weeks ago and it was the most asinine process I've ever seen. My claim manager was on time off. None of his colleagues would respond. I go to HR and they don't have a process for it. Finally after they fail to reach anyone they "take a message". Eventually I get an email saying mail back the laptop, phone, and mifi. The final touch is that they emailed me a list of stuff to return them. Which is a lot more exhaustive than they originally said. It's not like I wanted to keep the equipment. It's honestly that I didn't even keep most of it. When I got hired on I was originally going to be a team manager so they sent me adjusting equipment. I've worked at this so long I've got better equipment than the junk they gave me. So I literally threw a lot of it away and gave the rest to younger adjusters I knew. I didn't even keep the monitors because I had a nice office already. They hounded me for weeks over it. The box I did send back was so small the laptop had to sit diagonal and I got a nasty email about the laptop being damaged. (They provided the box) Then they did the most petty thing ever... I had a test scheduled with The Institutes for April 15th. Today they had the institutes send me an email asking for certain printed material back and they removed my online access to all the material and my last scheduled test. I understand the test, sure you don't want to pay for that. But to go back and retroactively remove study material is absolutely insane work. Especially because I purchased corresponding tests to that material with my own money since they only pay for one exam per quarter. End rant. Actually P.S.- when people say that the company is failing. It's not for all the obvious reasons. At its heart it's because it's become a bloated bureaucracy. In all their efforts to streamline and create operating procedures for everything, they have made the whole process inefficient. They can't keep employees because they won't invest in their training. New adjusters with two months of training shouldn't be set wild to figure it out on their own. Designations shouldn't become the goal of what success looks like."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 76 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1jzcv0m/rant_big_red_is_one_of_the_worst_employers_and/

↳ UpOutThatJam (36): "I'm always confused on if big red is the umbrella or the farm."

↳ TheHiddenMessenger (26): "In this case the farm lol. I'm the same way with "big blue". Is it the emu or the good hands"

↳ snuggly-kitten (18): "This is one of the reasons I'm terrified of leaving my position at a smaller carrier. I've been asked to apply at places that pay more and couldnt do it. I can figure out almost anything on my own with a couple emails. Your experience is my worst nightmare. What are your next steps, if you don't mind sharing?"

"Big Daddy leads (BDL) Leads Review TL;DR: Tried Big Daddy Leads for Mortgage Protection. Lots of disconnected numbers (they did replace some), most people never picked up despite hammering them with 8–10 calls a day + texts, and the show rate was awful. The ones who did pick up all expected their entire mortgage covered at ~70 years old. I tried downselling to equity protection/payment protector, but they wanted all-or-nothing. Honestly, you'll get better results just running your own ads. And yes I did track my numbers for everything. --- I tested Big Daddy Leads for Mortgage Protection recently and wanted to share an honest review for anyone thinking about it. Lead quality: Pretty bad overall. I got a lot of disconnected numbers — to be fair, they did replace those — but even with the "good" ones, most people didn't answer after I hammered them: 8–10 calls a day, double-dialing, leaving voicemails once, and texting every time. Show rate was rough. Expectations: This was the biggest killer. Every single MP lead I got seemed to expect their whole mortgage covered. I did try to downsell into equity protection/payment protector plans (covering monthly payments for a set amount of time), but they flat-out didn't want it. It was whole coverage or nothing. And look — I've been doing this for years, I'm a ~\$30k/month producer, I know how to handle objections, but I couldn't flip that expectation. These leads were just set up the wrong way from the start. How they generate leads: You don't control or even see the ads. They run simple image ads into Facebook lead forms, optimized for cheapest CPL, not quality. If you've been around marketing, you know that's not the same thing. Not trying to bash them unfairly — just being real about my experience."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nxhzu2/big_daddy_leads_bdl_leads_review/

↳ joeboo5150 (5): ">> you don't control or even see the ads This is one of the biggest problems with lead vendors. The ads they are using to produce clicks and gather contact info are RIDICULOUS. Auto insurance ads promoting \$19.99/mo car insurance. Home insurance ads promoting \$500/yr home insurance, etc. They run the most unbelievably ridiculous ads that prey on the most gullible and uninformed portions of the population and the entire process starts off under a horrible set of expectations."

↳ TeamDisrespect (1): "Had a lead provider run "Senior Citizens get FREE insurance thanks to (dubious made up government program)" Literally people answering asking how they can sign up for the free insurance."

↳ No-Background-4858 (1): "Thanks for the heads up"

"The date of the accident was today and she formally requested "both Comprehensive and collision please" over text last Wednesday to me. I tried going in there today and making an endorsement backdating 3 days ago but I'm sure they will see that and question it or deny the claim, so I don't know what I should do"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1n20wgr/i_accidentally_did_not_add_collision_on_a_clients/nb2eytp/

"General question about leads Hey everyone, I've been lurking the sub for a bit and have seen some similar issues arise but wasn't sure about my current situation.. \-I'm a P/C agent and working towards my L/H, hopefully within the month. \-I'm with a larger well known captive carrier. The Agency I'm with has been hit with non-renewals, some of the highest in the region. \-The new agent owner took on the role from the dying book of business (85% of the book was local, most of that was bundled with the non renewals) \-The name of the company is scarred in the area so there are no referrals and few renewals coming in to generate business. \-The majority of the agent owners time is spent saving the few renewals he is able to save *albeit as much as x4 the original rate. He is not generating any new leads for the business and hasn't for nearly 8 months. \-This agency being my first producer role, I was enticed with the prospect of (wait for it) paid leads. I didn't know better at the time and hadn't browsed this sub yet. Apologies in advance lol. \-I've had nearly 200 incoming paid leads since I started 6 months ago. I text often, email weekly and call daily. I even created my own spreadsheet to track the leads since no CRM is available. (I tried Monday and enjoyed it but couldn't convince the owner to adopt this.) \-The majority of these leads are instant denials without opportunity to give alternative answers. The few who do answer, the quoted rate isn't competitive. Still, I keep trying. I asked the boss and he said just keep dialing the leads, even after a "no". \-Of these paid leads, I've closed 1 thus far. A few in the "in progress " stage but that's it. I've had a few inbound calls and of the 5 available, I've closed 4... So assuming that someone wants insurance and I can beat the coverage, rate and service, people are buying. \-I'm supposed to bind at least 3% and need to hit \$20k in sales each month to be eligible for the "agent owner program". \-The owner has lamented to me that my minimal \$ value of premium is very low (I'm averaging about \$500 per lead) AND he is upset with his input of money to pay for the leads.. \-I have requoted everyone at least 3 times and reached out to the 3000 odd old leads to cross sell, win back, etc. Using some math, at this rate I would need to bind more than 50% of the leads in a month's time to generate about \$10k in premium. My questions are: 1) What do you do to increase the amount of premium bound each month? 2) What do you do to increase the probability of direct contact with outbound leads? 3) Which paid lead companies work best or worst? 4) If you are unable to prospect in your local region, how do you generate business? Thanks for the read. I'm in a bit of a pickle."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1snoujd/general_question_about_leads/

↳ CFactor11 (4): "Sounds like you're beating up aged digital leads. Owner is cattle prodding you to maximize lead conversion. OR Take a look inward. How are you handling the call? Building rapport? Making human/genuine connection? Creating real value and urgency?"

↳ KN0W-IDEA (2): "I just reached out to the local chamber of commerce, made a social media page and am attempting to contact some of the local developers. Trying to put my name out there. But the agent owner doesn't have enough time to do these things himself."

↳ KN0W-IDEA (1): "Thanks for the reply! I've been curious myself for both.. it feels like the top answer but I'm always open to feedback. I have asked for input on my delivery for the few leads I've been able to connect with. I have tried many different approaches but the answer is usually the same: "stop contacting me"."

"None of my prospects are answering my calls after setting an appointment I'm just asking for a bit of advice and wisdom here. About a week or more ago I made a post about having trouble cold calling in the supplementary insurance industry. After changing my approach, this week I've had people be very responsive and receptive. I've gotten about 4 or 5 enthusiastic "yes" to appointments, as well as more neutral/curious yeses for a total of about 8 appointments for people ready to listen to the product and possibly buy. However, literally none of these prospects save for one have answered the phone when I call them in the appointed time. Is this normal? What could be the cause for an enthusiastic or very curious "yes" to completely ghost? My experience with sales has mostly been with warm leads or D2D approaches, so I'm very new to converting a cold call into a sale. I'm assuming it's just a form of sales that requires a lot of follow up but I'd like to see what you guys think. Here's my current approach: 1. Open with an upbeat tone ask if I'm talking to the person. 2. Give empathic line similar to "I know you weren't expecting this call. If this is a bad time you can let me know..." something like this. This was a change I made that worked surprisingly well and has pretty much gotten 90% of my leads to stay on the line curious on what I have to say, which was something I'd been struggling with for a while. 3. If they say it's a good time, I give a quick elevator pitch to pique their interest and test the waters if they want to know about the product fully at that moment or if we should set an appointment. Most times we set appointment. 4. A few of these have even given me their free time before I even ask them so they kinda close the appointment for me. So we set the time and I put it on the agenda. Then I call them and... radio silence. I usually send a text to let them know and call a few days later but still nothing. Today I have a long list of follow ups from the ones from last week to see if they pick up today. Assuming it's on me and it's not just the nature of the cold calling in the supplemental insurance industry, my suspicion is that I'm messing up somewhere in the follow up. I haven't gotten any answer from any of my texts so maybe I'm scaring them off? I dunno. Any feedback would be greatly appreciated!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qrb80b/none_of_my_prospects_are_answering_my_calls_after/

↳ InstructionOk3766 (6): "I would strongly recommend automating reminders. Use every channel available. Email. SMS. Phone calls. Voicemails. Every missed follow up is a leak in your funnel. Plug those leaks and the same leads you already have will start producing far more revenue over time. If you are serious about growth, this massive fix you can make."

↳ theluchador19 (3): "The client should be getting automated emails and texts without you having to do it for the follow up. Also it sounds like they just are saying anything to get you off the line and are too polite to say "I'm not interested". Maybe a little more forceful? That way they can tell you, no I'm not interested"

↳ DJSimmer305 (3): "When you call someone for an appointment are you calling them from a phone number that can send text messages? If so, this is what you need to do: When you set the appointment with the person, send them a text message while you are still on the phone with them. It can be a picture of your business card, your license, or even just "hi this is u/hey2394". I recommend sending your business card because it likely has your face on it and it humanizes you to the prospect. Tell them to just reply to that message "got it" or "okay" so you can confirm they received it and have your number saved. Do not let them hang up before they reply back. The reason you need them to reply is because when you send them reminders, they will see in the conversation that they replied and it reminds them that they actually spoke to you "oh yeah, this was the guy I talked to yesterday. I liked him." Immediately after you hang up send another message: "Hi John, it's u/hey2394. We just spoke on the phone. You're all set for Wednesday at 2:30pm. I value both your time and mine, so please let me know if anything changes or you need to reschedule. Looking forward to speaking with you again." Send them reminders leading up to the appointment as well and on the day of, also ask them to reply back and confirm that 2:30 is still a good time."

"Penguin leads Hello everyone, I have just started an insurance agency in Tampa Florida and my biggest feat is finding a really good lead vendor, preferably inbound leads, to help support me and my agents. The main product to sell is life insurance. Health insurance like Medicare is also going to be a focus very soon. I was just wondering what your guys go to leads vendors are. I've been looking to possibly purchase some leads from penguin so if anyone has used them and can elaborate please do. Any and all information on this topic or just tips on agency success would help tremendously! UPDATE: I purchased these leads and ran the unlimited 500/week leads for about 3 weeks. 90% of my day was spent disposing voicemails or dead air calls. The rest were people who answered and mixed interest. I agree with one comment where just about every single call I received was well out of the 30 day that the vendor advertises. I was able to write just about 15k in AP. Are they workable 100%, is there a way better bang for your buck elsewhere, 110%. I've ran closetech this last week and a half and definitely a way more improved pickup rate, but extreme disinterest from the leads. At least they are advertised as well aged. My honest approach is either trying to start doing inbound with policy printer, talked with them and they seem like great guys, have some buddy's running them and good success. Or to possibly run my own meta ads. If anyone has more follow up suggestions for lead vendors they had success with drop some knowledge."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tcdwze/penguin_leads/

↳ Sudden_Ask_2319 (2): "**Warning: Penguin Leads is selling aged leads (over 30 days)** Just wanted to put this out there for anyone considering Penguin Leads. I recently purchased from them, and they are not delivering what they advertise. Their website clearly guarantees that leads are under 30 days old. Yet, every single lead I received was timestamped well past the 30-day mark. Can you still work them and get results? Maybe. But do I trust them? Absolutely not. I canceled my service because I refuse to work with dishonest vendors who use false advertising to get sign-ups. **A quick PSA for anyone dealing with sketchy lead vendors:** If you buy leads and they aren't as advertised, request a refund. Do not let them hide behind a "no refund policy." Legally, a no-refund policy is void if the company fails to actually deliver the service they advertised. If they refuse to cooperate: * **File a chargeback** with your credit card company (use "Services Not as Described" and show screenshots of their site promises vs. your lead timestamps). * **File complaints** with the FTC and the state consumer protection divisions (file in your home state, the state the merchant is located in, and the state of their payment processor if they use a third party). We need to start holding these deceptive lead companies accountable. Save your money and buy elsewhere!"

↳ Turbulent_Piece4208 (1): "I'm interested in how your getting leads as well I'm new to the industry and want to get producing."

↳ KCMOTC (1): "I just sent you a DM too. Please let me know!"

"The sales tactics make me laugh 🤔 I get them daily via text and email. Also just ignore them. Right to Block and spam they go. No lead is the best or exclusive, it's simply just a request for information. It's expensive data, but also the life blood of building a book. Nor do I desire to be sold on your agency, nor do I desire to recruit people, nor do I want to buy your limited addition leads 🤔"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fmntn2/life_insurance_recruiters_are_liars/lodc4di/

"goillini52 said: I'm sure it's AFLAC. I've gotten several AFLAC emails from Integrity FMO's today. I've got a bunch too, But surly they wouldn't hype like this about Aflac, ENORMOUS New Medicare Supplement Bigger than chick fila and coke The only thing big about them are the increases left to clients stuck with them after they exited last time"

— Insurance-Forums.com · ENORMOUS New Medicare Supplement Product Launch · 2 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/enormous-new-medicare-supplement-product-launch.108945/#post-1428179>

"I use smart financial I've gotten 160 leads so far from them. About 70 were instant trash, quoted 20, and sold 6. The rest won't respond to me so I keep at it. My cost per sale is about \$200 so losing money but its fun I just text them the second they pop in and then keep texting daily or every few days. I usually get a response and I always open with an easy question not just how are you today. edit: the response is usually STOP or Not interested Maybe one a day wants a quote sometimes none"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vy0ou/150_internet_leads_bought_zero_sales/p60l7p3/

"Los angeles, and yeah he wants me to sell at least one policy a day, but I really can't see how that's possible with so little leads and how bad they all are. I usually spend most of my day just following up and blowing up their texts or phone which I know isn't good but what else can I do."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1w6w1cg/cheap_leads/p7s8n4p/

"vic120 said: With such hype it better not be Aflac, In fairness they didn't mention a name said call them for a name I would be really annoyed if I called and they said Aflac I'm sure it's AFLAC. I've gotten several AFLAC emails from Integrity FMO's today."

— Insurance-Forums.com · ENORMOUS New Medicare Supplement Product Launch · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/enormous-new-medicare-supplement-product-launch.108945/#post-1428176>

"I'm registered with help on demand. I'm available regular business hours. Today was the first day of open enrollment and I got no leads, no texts, emails or calls. I guess I just have to be patient?"

— YouTube · How To Get FREE ACA Leads From Healthcare.gov In 2025 (Step-By-Step Guide For Agents) · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6RnCN4Ob2zM&lc=UqzERvZb_8mx2U7Lu7J4AaABAq

↳ @InsuranceAgentTraining (0): "yes, be patient. I will get better as we get closer to the deadline"

"bought a lead today off a site that will let you buy by the lead one at a time....well needless to say I knew they were being bombarded but both were smokers so I knew aetna was the lowest smoking rate so forked \$6 to see if any agents were throwing aetna down....came up with unicare,assurant,NASE,and some one who said that aetna was there best rate and waiting for the email....so after about 45 min's on the phone he says your the agent we have been looking for and for grins ran the nase agents record for him and sent him to google for nase sucks,.....so I come up with a tag team husb. and wife team with these stats... wife General Lines Agent Life, Accident, Health and HMO 03/2006 03/2008 Active MEGA LIFE AND HEALTH INSURANCE COMPANY, THE 03/2006 husband General Lines Agent Life, Accident, Health and HMO 04/2006 04/2008 Active MEGA LIFE AND HEALTH INSURANCE COMPANY, THE 04/2006 guess the guy had to take the test a few times.....but at any rate I thought I would give them a call and find out how it was going and give some pointersand ask how serious do they take health insurancethen this broad she freaks out...and launches into this we are saving the world nase speech and hangs up on me.....you know man I try....."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Mega Strikes Again NASE/UGA/HEALTHMARKETS · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/mega-strikes-again-nase-uga-healthmarkets.4533/#post-542>

Driving to appointments and kitchen tables · 13 documents · 13 voices

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

↳ 3xploringforever (16): "As a lawyer, the insurance MLM industry ENRAGES me from several angles - scam insurance, misclassification of workers, unconscionable contracts signed under duress with obscenely one-sided and binding arbitration clauses, abuse of telemarketing practices, fraud/misrepresentation, toxic hustle culture, wage theft, tax theft and UI avoidance, exploitation of desperate people seeking the "American dream," I could go on."

↳ dillydeli1 (14): "Totally believe this, thanks for saying it outloud."

↳ iBaires (11): "Don't forget literally tens of thousands of TCPA violations every day lol"

"If you were starting over today with no book of business and no carrier appointments, what would you do first? Hi everyone, I officially passed my Texas Life & Health licensing exam yesterday (self studied via an online prep course), and I'm trying to be very intentional about how I build my business from Day 1. A little background: I'm 39 and transitioning from a successful corporate finance career (\$175k, annual) after being laid off in 2025. I want to use this unexpected time to invest in a career pivot to an independent producer, eventually building up to a small boutique style agency. Short-term, I plan to focus on Medicare, ACA, Life Insurance, and Supplemental Health. Longer-term, I'd like to expand into ICHRA and small employer benefits, but I don't want to spread myself too thin in the beginning. My vision is to build a referral- and relationship-based business. I'm much more interested in creating a trusted advisory practice than becoming a high-pressure salesperson. If you were in my shoes today —with no book of business, no carrier appointments, and no industry experience—but knowing what you know now: What would your first three steps be? What mistakes would you avoid? Would you join an agency/FMO first, or would you try to build independently from Day 1? Is there anything you wish someone had told you before your first year? I'm not necessarily looking for the "highest commission" straight away. Instead, I'm trying to build the strongest long-term foundation and book of business. I genuinely appreciate any advice from those who've been through it. Thanks in Advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uxw9ko/if_you_were_starting_over_today_with_no_book_of/

↳ idontknowhow2reddit (7): "I agree with all of this. Insurance is a crazy world so there's a ton of things to learn. The textbook and real world are very different so I would try to find an established company with good training to work for first. Without that, it will be hard to build a referral base or to gain that trusted advisor role. Your network and other professionals are going to need to see you in the industry a bit before they will trust you on your own."

↳ Key_Astronomer6500 (5): "Congrats! For someone who also got into insurance later in my career. 1. Pick one product and master it, then move into the second one, and so on. Medicare, ACA, Final Expense, Annuities, etc. 2. Training. Master that product and then move to the second. W 2 or Captive will give you the most training. 40 a week of training vs 1 or 2 hours a week. 3. Pick the right organization. Know the difference between recruiters selling me vs legitimate interviews. I wish someone told me about how many recruiters would try to sell me and then offer no support. I am so glad I left and went into a W2 to learn and get practice but I wish someone told me how difficult releases were! Best of luck but honestly someone with your degree of previous success should be fine. Just remember you're not gonna make as much money at first. You'll probably need to go independent to make more than 125k. However, I would suggest to build that foundation first but as long as you know what you're getting into I think you'll do great."

↳ OZKInsuranceGuy (5): "If I had to start over today, the first thing I'd do is choose my upline very carefully. The wrong agency/upline can cost you years of your career. Second, I'd pick one niche and master it before trying to sell everything. Too many new agents want to do Medicare, ACA, final expense, annuities, group benefits...and end up not getting very good at any of them. Third, I'd get in front of people every single workday. Nothing replaces activity. I'd rather have a decent script and 15 appointments than the perfect script and no one to talk to. The biggest mistakes I'd avoid are buying into recruiting hype (MLMs), signing contracts without understanding release policies, and spending time on useless activities, like tweaking logos, trying to figure out every detail of CRMs, or building websites than actually selling. I would absolutely suggest joining an agency first. I'd choose one based on transparency, track record, proven training and scripts, and upline (again, upline is very important). Make sure you're paid directly by the carriers, understand exactly how releases work (get it in writing), and ask a lot of questions before you sign anything. Once you start selling, consistency is key. Focus on activity, because your input determines your output. Work hard, follow your upline's advice and system, and don't get distracted by other opportunities or anything else."

"Hey, I'm a new Agent, I got licensed less than a year ago. During my training, I was taught for that rebuttal was "I don't do any second appointments, because we shop every A Rated carrier today to see who you would get approved for." Something within them lines. To avoid that rebuttal, I was taught to ask who they make their financial decisions with & if they was around. Hope this helps."

— YouTube · LIVE Dialing: Cold Calling Insurance Leads (SCRIPT GIVEAWAY) · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=POOoucTXJYc&lc=Ugxu8xdg4l-QqJxrU4x4AaABAg>

↳ @Countmoneyforever (4): "i think it helps! Also the better you qualify the better youll close. for example i always ask "who makes financial decisions for you?" and "if were able to find something affordable that meets your needs, when would you like that plan to start?" if they say today you keep going but if they say "im not sure" or anything else you gotta figure out why BEFORE you present any options! Our most important asset is time, dont let these ppl waste any"

↳ @bejrnews (0): "New agent here. How's your book of business doing?"

"Great video! I have been doing the ACA since it's inception. I started selling Medicare about 5 years ago. Half of my business is ACA and the other is Medicare. Many of my ACA clients are aging into Medicare and I help them through the transition. I have a Medicare appointment today, with a client who has been an ACA client for years now. I also get referrals from ACA clients who have friends or relatives that need ACA plans or Medicare. I also speak fluent Spanish and get many referrals from Spanish speaking only clients."

— YouTube · Is It Worth Selling ACA Plans as a Medicare Agent? · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ERXhOx7N_N8&lc=Ugz6DeDmMx0U56Cotz14AaABAg

↳ @MedicareMillennials (1): "That's awesome man! I wish I wouldn't have been so hesitant to sell it before"

↳ @gyannevent (0): "I new help, I have my license but need mentoring"

↳ @GaryPhelps55 (0): "@gyannevent In which state are you licensed."

"When I first started colonial life brought me on. Had me drive 45 min to have lunch with these two dudes, hyped me up about income potential and then the guy told me and the other guy to carpool to businesses all day seeing if they want to talk about group benefits like dental and life. The guy I car pooled with that day said he joined 90 days ago and still hasn't gotten paid or made a sale but that he's "in it for the long run". Bro must have either already been a millionaire and didn't mind wasting time money gas etc or was being delusional. I left after that day and I'm still in insurance and doing good just not with a place that makes me do all that extra stuff I rather focus on closing deals not marketing"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mcl3e3/i_already_hate_my_job/n5xjnr7/

"Hey Cody. I have a full time job and starting to sell insurances part time until I make the same or more than what I do with my current full time job which is 8-5pm and I can only make calls after 5pm. Is it best to call on weekends and make appointments for weekends instead of weekdays after 5pm?"

— YouTube · Live Dialing Insurance Leads! [Final Expense Insurance] · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RL6Y5qigOWg&lc=Ugyc7DepZeChP9veRdZ4AaABAq>

↳ @CodyAskins (1): "Not necessarily. I would try calling in the evenings because they'll be home."

↳ @CodyAskins (0): "@yasielfigueroa7871 you're welcome!"

"Thank you. I am just doing the K.I.S.S. And hop the Wheel and Do Not Reinvent the Wheel. Thank you, again. Last, today is a Door Knocking day because the leads today are ones I hit every day of the week except Sunday. I find it is common for this target market have full time job and 1 part job. Also, they work 2nd or Graveyard shift too."

— YouTube · The Best Door-Knocking Tips & Tricks For Life Insurance Agents! (Cody Askins & David Dufor · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ppeyGVeq5Bk&lc=Ugyer7nxJdHA4IRqKi14AaABAq>

"I get unlimited decent leads 8-10 hours a day, health benefits nice office and desk and they pay for all my appointments and I make \$100 a deal and I was looking around cause I thought that was low 🥰 but yeah these deals take at LEAST an hour to do Any updates to your situation?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o7cpaf/medicare_agents_please_give_me_advice/othbquz/

"Thanks so much. I'm on my 11th client who either doesn't qualify or doesn't want a plan or cancels appointment. And today was the day I was suppose to get a easy sale but client canceled appointment ans it just broke me. I'm 2 weeks out and normally avarage about 80 calls a day."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1idj71g/i_sold_my_first_medicare_policy/mrfp51y/

"I am trying link leads for bulk sms and bulk email, gonna send like 5k texts a day and work the positive responses. That beats knocking doors or cold calling all day for me, and its cheap asf"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u47vjb/where_to_get_leads_as_an_insurance_agent/origkmg/

"I'll agree. If you're not on your A game you need to think about it. This is for people who know their products extremely well and are well established closers. This doesn't mean new agents don't have a shot - but I'd recommend some phone and sales experience. Regardless, if you don't have very sharp phone skills and know how to take clients from A to B to C you'll want to proceed with caution. I personally have not experienced low income but I'm sure it's coming. If I can close 1 out of 4 I'm still all over it. Again, at \$30 a pop on average I'll pay \$120 for a deal. I'm personally not seeing a scenario where ROI doesn't work out for me. What I won't do is call 20 leads, have 3 pick up and get bitched out by 2. I don't enjoy calling people who don't know I'm calling and don't want me to call. That's why I farm out telemarketing and am not a fan of cold-calling myself. I guess what can be discussed if if you're not sharp enough to close an exclusive prospect who's waiting on hold to talk to you, how well are you gonna fair fighting other agents for business. And if you're not willing to spend \$30 to speak with someone how do you have the funds to spend \$140 on 20 leads and only speak to 1 to 3 people? Also, shared leads are by far not income qualified and you call those 20 shared leads and still get "\$150 per MONTH?" I think this works very well with quote engines like Norvax - take 'em to your site and show 'em rates and plans. I'm taking people to my site while on the phone so they can run rates. It keeps them engaged when they're playing around with buttons instead of just listening to you. They obviously have a bit of time if they're waiting to speak to an agent. I disagree that is needs to be a one-shot-one-kill close. I've set two in-person appointments - closed the one this morning. The girl I spoke with yesterday was at work, I called her back at 1pm and signed her up online then. That being said, these are indeed people anxious enough to want to speak with an agent. Let's look at companies like Geico. Go call a Geico rep and see if they just want to email you stuff to review. Yeah...right. If they go over your scenario and can save you money they're taking the app right then. It's not gonna be "we'll email our brochure and call you back tomorrow.""

— Insurance-Forums.com · Vimo live transfers · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/vimo-live-transfers.3746/#post-41301>

"Re: Any Info About Insphere Insurance Solutions Career? funny this thread pops up today.....had a UC client that finely got my message's and he tells me he could not find my # then says checked and old answering machine on a number he does not use...at any rate says he and family applied with CHESAPEAKE LIFE INSURANCE COMPANY...thru Alliance for Affordable Services...ask him what his agents name was and of course has only been in for 4 to 5 months with these appointments and address..goggled the address ..seems the are moving away from pushing Mega...but why not GR..... 1333 CORPORATE DR NO 318 IRVING, TX 75038 Appointments Company Active CHESAPEAKE LIFE INSURANCE COMPANY, THE 06/23/2009 GOLDEN RULE INSURANCE COMPANY 11/06/2009 MEGA LIFE AND HEALTH INSURANCE COMPANY, THE 06/10/2009 MID-WEST NATIONAL LIFE INSURANCE COMPANY OF TENNESSEE 06/10/2009"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Insphere Insurance Solutions. Any Info About Career ? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/insphere-insurance-solutions-a-ny-info-about-career.17461/#post-219906>

"Can we set appointments for weekend after after 5 pm hours?"

— YouTube · Live Dialing Insurance Leads! [Final Expense Insurance] · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RL6Y5qigOWg&lc=UgyFJje69obUR-rqg0R4AaABAq>

Quoting, applications and carrier portals · 12 documents · 12 voices

"Man, totally get how you feel. All week last week, I had 15 Medicare Appointments no show me. By some Miracle, I got 2 T65 enrollemnts yesterday and another 3 T65 today. about \$3900 in commission. Making me feel like me chasing people around last week was worth it I guess."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1le5o1e/i_bought_an_ad_funnel_and_while_ive_booked_a_lot/mydnrpy/

"Okay. I mostly just do Medicare. I am licensed in everything. I get \$250 - \$350 per enrollment, and they supply all the calls. I make my own hours. During AEP, which is 10/15 - 12/7, I did 170 enrollments working around 6 hours a day. The go-getters did 400+ enrollments. The second busy season is 1/1 - 3/31. After that, I'll do some odd jobs until next season. I do have the option of grinding it out all year. They are going to incorporate life insurance, along with Medicare and ACA, to keep us busy. I'd rather not work the slower season because you have more opportunities for personalities to clash when it's slow, and management needs something to do."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pwf3y3/how_much_do_insurance_brokers_actually_make/nwgjplm/

"Hello! This is Ning from the HealthSherpa. We are a certified Web Based Entity, partnered with CMS. We have a direct integration with the federal data hub, and are allowed to enroll people that submit applications through us. In response to AllenChicago: 1) We are required to get the consent of the user to the statements you list. They are directly from Healthcare.gov, and part of the terms of our agreement with CMS. 2) We just launched this flow today, without any press, so the # of applications is small. 3) We process and email confirmations within the same day, often within an hour or two. For fake applications like the one you submitted, we ignore. 4) We are planning on releasing this functionality to agents and brokers as well, so that they can complete applications rapidly and are guaranteed to get their NPN / FFM ID on the enrollment (i.e. compensated). Our goal is to turn the long, difficult signup process on Healthcare.gov into a short, 10 minute process. Today marked a big step but we will continue to improve the site and turnaround times. Thanks for talking a look, Cheers, Ning"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Health Sherpa · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/health-sherpa.63093/#post-821649>

"Thank-you for that valuable feedback MWoodbrid! It sounds like HealthSherpa would be your primary go-to WBE, if it was as accurate, and intuitive, as ACA Express. I haven't had anyone "get lost" in HealthSherpa this year. Last year, their labeling of the application fields was screwy, which generated quite a few phone calls from people who were right in the middle of the enrollment process. I'm going to Google locate an ACA Express quoting site, and test the workflow to see if it's more intuitive than Sherpa. The two different quoting platforms Health Sherpa uses are at odds with each other. I totally dislike the "public facing" version. Prefer the Agent platform, but it's somewhat awkward to have to log into your Dashboard and run quotes from there. Especially when sitting next to your client, because He/she sees other people you've enrolled. Thanks again for taking the time to share your experience-based insights, MWoodbrid. And congratulations on being able to enroll 9 people every day during the open enrollment. Quite a feat for a 1-man operation! -Allen"

— Insurance-Forums.com · ACA Express -vs- HealthSherpa · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/aca-express-vs-healthsherpa.78694/#post-1050570>

"WinoBlues said: Got two apps in today from a referral little over \$3,000,(2apps) a little over \$6,000 (4 apps) on a compulife lead today, F2F. Well I really didn't expect to look that bad. You are the poster boy for what a life insurance agent can do with a client base who trusts you and some hard work."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Post Your Daily/Weekly Numbers · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/post-your-daily-weekly-numbers.68548/#post-90186>

AEP and enrollment season hours · 8 documents · 8 voices

"Medicare Agent Needs Help Finding Clients Hello, I'm seeking advice from Medicare agents that are finding clients. I'm two years in and pretty much only have friends for clients. To pay the bills I'm working a part time job in the afternoons and evenings. I work on my Medicare business in the mornings. I have tried various things but have not gotten much traction. I have several financial advisors that send my name out with a list of other Medicare professionals when a client is a few months before 65. I have only gotten one client from that. I manned a table at CVS every day during AEP and spoke with a least a few people each day. That led to one client. I have been attending networking groups 3 times a week where we refer clients to each other whenever possible. I have had one referral and that has not become a client yet. The bulk of my clients have just been friends or friends of friends that I've known for years. My clients all really like me and feel that I have helped them tremendously. The problem is it is simply going too slowly. At this point, I'm planning to continue with the networking groups but maybe reduce to one or two days a week. I'm considering reaching out to more financial advisors. I'm considering hitting up all of the P & C folks in my area and seeing if they want to partner with a Medicare person. Reluctantly, I'm considering spending money on direct mail campaigns or maybe transfer phone call leads. I've heard such mixed opinions on those I'm not sure what to think but willing to try. I'm a bit on my own and could really benefit from the wisdom and experience of some of you that are succeeding. Would love to know what you consider worth doing and what you consider a waste of time."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kp95ck/medicare_agent_needs_help_finding_clients/

"Okay. I mostly just do Medicare. I am licensed in everything. I get \$250 - \$350 per enrollment, and they supply all the calls. I make my own hours. During AEP, which is 10/15 - 12/7, I did 170 enrollments working around 6 hours a day. The go-getters did 400+ enrollments. The second busy season is 1/1 - 3/31. After that, I'll do some odd jobs until next season. I do have the option of grinding it out all year. They are going to incorporate life insurance, along with Medicare and ACA, to keep us busy. I'd rather not work the slower season because you have more opportunities for personalities to clash when it's slow, and management needs something to do."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pwf3y3/how_much_do_insurance_brokers_actually_make/nwgjplm/

"Well this is where thr studying comes in. I the first quarter you have OEP and in the rest of the year (ROY) you have various other enrollment periods and 10k people turning 65 every day. Lots of opportunities. But you have to learn to understand the system first. Your ability to sell is directly proportional to how well you can navigate Medicare and the various rules."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f81t9g/nyc_im_a_terrible_life_insurance_agent_can_i_sell/ldlzz3/

"You blame Medicare marketing compliance rules for this.. You CANNOT say Medicare is ANYTHING like ACA. ACA will become like Medicare with *compliance and disclosures*. AND with our new admin(👉👉). We might not have ACA anymore. Just STM. Some of those short term medical plans are only for 3 months in some states even after the recent changes. And there are rules where you can't reinstate with some carrier in same year. Health insurance is a circus right now. Medicare(MAPD) and ACA are typically uneducated people getting harassed all day during AEP/Open Enrollment. The chronic flips thinking they're getting something *more everytime added*. If you want to talk about "deceitful" then look at limited med with multiplan without major medical carrier with it. Which is way less compliant than ACA. And they're discount plans not real insurance for 2-300\$+ Yes people click once or couple times. And those leads are sold and sold again every month(.20 cents - 50\$). And 90% of that business you could get from those cheap leads will be flipped by end of the year or within 3 months clawback time. Vs your 30% you're suppose to lose on avg every year. Call Amazon or some other large company right now and watch you get redirected from Customer Service to Medicare agency. Sometimes the smaller newer agencies do spoof the numbers or emails to look like local food business even Amazon. Everyone wants a piece of the pie"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p0mqo2/is_it_just_me/npm451h/

"Can I ask, have you spoken to a Mike from that company? L After I attended the group 'interview' spoke to the person who invited me to the zoom meeting, Alyssa was her name literally yesterday. Anyways I told her the training schedules were out of my ability to commit to and was no longer interested at this time. We said our goodbyes and she wished me good luck because I was taking my life insurance exam the same day (and I passed!!) And went on with my day. This was December 4th, 2025. Now today around 530pm CT time December 5th, 2025 this guy Mike calls me who lead the majority of the group interview. We spoke for about 30/40 minutes and honestly was excited. But now I decided to look up the company, read the reddit forums and now things are clicking. Im already working with a different company. Its a Brokerage and I feel more at peace/home with that company than Global life. Im just a 24 year old so someone please be honest. Im already struggling and i dont need a company to duck me over some more...."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mnj1p8/warning_globe_life_zuzick/nsioz39/

"I'm registered with help on demand . I'm available regular business hours. Today was the first day of open enrollment and I got no leads, no texts, emails or calls. I guess I just have to be patient?"

— YouTube · How To Get FREE ACA Leads From Healthcare.gov In 2025 (Step-By-Step Guide For Agents) · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6RnCN4Ob2zM&lc=UgZERvZb_8mx2U7Lu7J4AaABAq

↳ @InsuranceAgentTraining (0): "yes, be patient. I will get better as we get closer to the deadline"

"AllenChicago said: Thank-you for that valuable feedback MWoodbrid! It sounds like HealthSherpa would be your primary go-to WBE, if it was as accurate, and intuitive, as ACA Express. I am not reading it that way since we provide additional benefits such as AgencyBlock integration, i.e. all things being equal we still have features they do not. While he did not compare customer service response directly in his post, he did say we have many options and have been responsive. <snip> AllenChicago said: I'm going to Google locate an ACA Express quoting site, and test the workflow to see if it's more intuitive than Sherpa. We will be providing an option soon to have on the CFS (Client Facing Site) the current flow which is, as MWOODBIRD said, better than theirs, but also flow more similar to last years. AFS (agent Dashboard) already has this option via "Quick Quote" or "Create Applicant". AllenChicago said: The two different quoting platforms Health Sherpa uses are at odds with each other. I totally dislike the "public facing" version. Prefer the Agent platform, but it's somewhat awkward to have to log into your Dashboard and run quotes from there. Especially when sitting next to your client, because He/she sees other people you've enrolled. Thanks again for taking the time to share your experience-based insights, MWoodbrid. And congratulations on being able to enroll 9 people every day during the open enrollment. Quite a feat for a 1-man operation! -Allen Click to expand... Agreed! And glad to be part of it for him!"

— Insurance-Forums.com · ACA Express -vs- HealthSherpa · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/aca-express-vs-healthsherpa.78694/#post-1050586>

"Thank-you for that valuable feedback MWoodbrid! It sounds like HealthSherpa would be your primary go-to WBE, if it was as accurate, and intuitive, as ACA Express. I haven't had anyone "get lost" in HealthSherpa this year. Last year, their labeling of the application fields was screwy, which generated quite a few phone calls from people who were right in the middle of the enrollment process. I'm going to Google locate an ACA Express quoting site, and test the workflow to see if it's more intuitive than Sherpa. The two different quoting platforms Health Sherpa uses are at odds with each other. I totally dislike the "public facing" version. Prefer the Agent platform, but it's somewhat awkward to have to log into your Dashboard and run quotes from there. Especially when sitting next to your client, because He/she sees other people you've enrolled. Thanks again for taking the time to share your experience-based insights, MWoodbrid. And congratulations on being able to enroll 9 people every day during the open enrollment. Quite a feat for a 1-man operation! -Allen"

— Insurance-Forums.com · ACA Express -vs- HealthSherpa · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/aca-express-vs-healthsherpa.78694/#post-1050570>

Private Worries

Not making money, no sales, broke in year one · 23 documents

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

"Brand New Independent Agents This is just a rant post. I find it extremely weird when brand new agents want to be independent but also expect everything to be given to them. The entire point of being independent is that you are the OWNER of YOUR business. If I decided to open to a floral shop, I would have to pay for inventory, supplies, a website, marketing, and anything else that I needed to run my business. I'd be responsible for going out and marketing myself & my business to attract customers. I wouldn't expect to make money if I was only open for a couple of hours a few days a week, because no one else is giving me a paycheck. And if I didn't know how to run a business, I would find someone who could give me the play by play. Not just someone who said they could, but someone who had proof they'd done it. Insurance is no different. New independent agents are constantly complaining about back office fees, that their IMO doesn't provide them free leads, being 1099, and having to actually bust their ass to make money... and after putting forth half ass effort, blame their agency or upline for not making money. If you want a paycheck, to clock out the same time every day, and someone to provide you leads, GO CAPTIVE. This is why most new agents fail because they saw someone on TikTok that told them they could make \$20,000 in a month. Which is POSSIBLE, I have seen it, not fresh out the gate. You don't even know what you're doing yet! And honestly, you already need to have money put back to carry you in the beginning months until you start to make money... that's where you need to start anyway. This isn't a get rich quick scheme. It's a real business that you have to put real work into."

— InsuranceAgent · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tnmhue/brand_new_independent_agents/

"Is selling life insurance what everyone makes it out to be? All over my social media page I am seeing 20 years olds post that they are making 10k or more a month by selling life insurance. I know that there a chargebacks, buying leads, and its commission only, but is it actually worth getting into? I feel like all the companies are MLM's and that they are only posting this content to recruit people to join."

— InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1t35kdo/>

"We do. But we also pay commission only since we are a younger agency. There are other agencies out there that would too. We buy 15-30 leads a day a producer. Warm leads. They average 30-40 calls a day, sell between 15-25k in premium a month. 3% ish close rate, quote about 10%. Not great, but every source we've tried sucks, this is the cheapest and the leads are decent."

— InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wd1ygk/i_got_my_liscence_a_month_ago_ive_sold_zero/p93nnh0/

"I went broke trying to sell insurance. I drained my savings and had to take money out of my annuity. I left owing the company I worked for over \$2500 for customers who flaked out on their policies. I worked over time, never missed a training meeting, joined the chamber of commerce, bought leads, went to promotional events, spoke to members of rotary clubs and held an informational brunch which I paid for. I did all this because I truly believed I would succeed. Now I'm broke."

— YouTube · 102 Former Insurance Agents Explain Why They Quit [No BS] · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xv8pQ6cZ7oU&lc=Ugzxfw9nKcH1vVv4XF14AaABAg>

"Unfortunately, just happens very often. That's why most people don't make it in industry. If your license, and want an actual job, look for a job instead of running your own business. When you're a 1099 commission only, it's a business. I would much rather work somewhere where I'm getting some type of paycheck and have benefits to start. I have never been great at prospecting and I've been in sales pretty much my entire life. I've made low six figures in several different types of sales including insurance, but always on the W2 side. I've also realize that I do much better in an inbound environment. I'm more of a consultant and a closer. I'm not a Hunter. Nothing wrong with commission. But when you're 1099 and contracted, they really don't have to do anything. There are some legitimate places, but you have to either buy Leads or prospect. Or you can do what many people like myself did, and get a W2 Job where you're getting paid to base plus commission. People don't realize that benefits, social, security, tax, retirement savings, all those things add up, so you have to make way more money as a 1099 "employee" versus a w2 position. It's not difficult to make a minimum of 65,000 year and a W2 Job and the insurance industry. In fact, I know. Plenty of people who make 125,000 or more a year. I also also plenty of people who can't make it because of the KPIs and the burnout. I would never work for free. Well, never again because we've all fall for the sales pitch. I keep saying this and Will keep saying it, youre not being hired. You're being recruited. You have to interview them. It's so different than a traditional W2 Job, where they actually interview you. Most these places will hire anyone. That's breathing with the license."

— InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wlnr8v/pulling_my_hair_out/pb0bm9o/

"Recent L/H licensed, selling medicare advantage, need career advice So I've been selling Medicare Advantage plans since last summer and it's been good overall. The agency culture is nice, fully remote, warmish inbound leads, good training, decent commission, and I sold 110 policies in AEP. I'm doing well during OEP so far and have averaged 2-3 policies a day. I just got my life license to sell final expense after OEP since many enrollment codes are going away. That being said, commission only is tough, but I'm lucky to have savings and to live with my parents. I don't want to live with them long term and am looking to move out later this year. I know final expense can be good, but I want to see what's out there. Does anyone here work for agencies on a remote basis that offer base + benefits or at least renewals while giving you decent leads? I get \$275 per policy but I have to wait until the policy clears 120 days to get the whole payment (get 50% upfront). I'm realizing that NAC and churn can screw with your pay too. It'd be great if I got some sort of renewal, but they are paying for leads so it's up front commission only. I just have my L/H licenses and I've heard good things about employee benefits too. I have a strong preference for fully remote, but am open to hybrid in San Diego if it's the right opportunity. I also don't want to get involved in MLMs or pitch friends and family. I'd be grateful for your 2 cents. Thanks in advance!"

— InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hx3ebv/recent_lh_licensed_selling_medicare_advantage/

"L&H broker considering transition to commercial P&C... Opinions? I currently broker Medicare plans as an independent agent. I do remote sales and do very well relative to most in the industry. I have some lead gen systems in place that I am confident can transfer to any other sales role. However, my one concern is the endless compliance regulations for selling Medicare plans to seniors. With almost every way of contacting a prospect being uncompliant, I can't help but worry that in the future one slip up could cause me to lose my business that I have gained over years of selling. I do ethical business and I will not screw someone over to make a commission, but I am looking for something else with less regulation on how I acquire a client, that also pays residuals and decent upfront commission. I am not going to go captive, I am a commission only type of person, I want to lose big and win big. I'd rather put in the work to own my book of business and get my full commission. Anyone with experience in independent commercial P&C brokering with some insight on my next steps or where to learn more? How is compliance and regulations in that sector? Is there anything better than commercial P&C as far as commission and residuals? I only mention commercial because I heard that can be big money. Let me know opinions and if there are any other commission only sales routes I should pursue for good residuals. Thank you!"

— InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dwyp5q/lh_broker_considering_transition_to_commercial_pc/

"Is P&C insurance something worth actually considering for stability? 23M, I won't go into it deeply because it's twice now that reddit on my phone deletes my entire body post without any reason. But, is P&C insurance a field that actually has base commission and real world need? I currently sell Life insurance through FFL and my respective subagency, tldr i WFH and my boss barely helps me has thrown me into the deep end to either sink or swim and 3 months of solely commission pay, calling aged leads, trying to sell and actually help old people on fixed incomes with no other sources of income for me just isnt working as a Dick broke young dude. Nothing I'm trying to improve on myself works, the little help I get from other team leads or the big bosses are platitudes like "closed mouths don't get fed" while 55-60% of the agency at any one point hasn't made a sale and a vaguely inspirational message of, "No one cares how hard it is get to work, if you wanna succeed" is sent out almost daily. I really just feeling like I'm spiraling and looking for a change in what I'm doing to something that actually has success. I have made absolutely zero sales since I started mid November on aged leads anywhere from 6 months to 4+ years old from the convos I've had with clients. This of course means absolutely 0 pay, and with this being my only job and something I actually did really want to see success in, I don't want to throw away months of work and was interested if P&C was something really worth doing. I'm so desperate at this point if I knew I had even a base salary I'd be happy, is this something that's really possible with P&C and so I should focus on it studying and testing wise? Or is it better to just get out of insurance for a bit until outside money comes in because this entire 3 month process has been hell and maybe some outside money that makes me less desperate is what I need. I'd appreciate any advice at all, I just feel like I'm being kneecapped by everything recently, things in my control and things out of my control and a break feels like it's impossible."

— InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qnrsv3/is_pc_insurance_something_worth_actually/

"bro! everything you said in your spunky 6 min recruitment video was awesome, everything you said is exactly what my IMO says i should do or say door knocking and chargebacks are ruining me, i sell Fex with transamerica, RNA, Liberty Bankers, prosperity i can do upgrades policy reviews im very good at this but sadly i just lost my car due to an asshole who crashed my car while it was parked in my driveway plus like i said chargebacks are ruining me, i liked your working from home setup.... BUT!!!!!!! i skimmed towards the end and i saw your catch, its sad because you sound like whats wrong with this world, if i had \$1000 to invest in your little setup here i wouldnt be so stressed about how im not making a penny in this bussiness. im broke and thats why i need to make money but if i have to invest \$1000 i cant join because im broke hence why i would like to join so i can make money, seems more like you make more by having pepole join and by the time they notice its just like every gimmick out there you already made a grand each person that joins. maybe one day ill make money but so far i dont see that any time soon. nice try."

— YouTube · Day In The Life Of A Life Insurance Agent (Work From Home) · 5 likes · life / final-expense agent · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=D8Uca74uodA&lc=Ugzj6AUt086V5zoqcR4AaABAq>

"I am in for 2 years doing great-no sales to family yet-leads provided!"

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15wc7r0/recently_accepted_a_job_with_globe_life/ojxdiul/

"Most I've seen are commission only. Several are reaching out to me lol. Which did you work for?"

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lavqn1/is_a_life_health_insurance_license_useless/mxper3h/

"Experienced Face-to-Face Agent LOOKING for an EXPERIENCED Telesales OUTBOUND Agent/Agency Owner for advise **Long Story Short:** I've been a field agent (face-to-face agent) for 13 years, **commission only**. I recently made the transition from a captive agent to an agent/agency owner last year. I'm used to making cold calls and door-knocking since I started. My previous company instilled prospecting for Turning 65 and only gave us only a spreadsheet with a name, address, and month/year of turning 65 and called it a "lead". We "bird-dog" for the financial advisors to sell annuities once we sold a product and completed a fact-finder. Their system worked, but commissions on insurance products were extremely low as a captive agent. Now I'm going on a prospecting binge when I can make money \$\$\$\$ peddling final expenses and Medicare insurance(RENEWALS) products. I'm making more money and larger renewals just sell insurance products than annuities! Blows my mind. ​
Problem: I've proven the system I followed for 13 years works, but it takes time and effort since I started over (left the captive company & lost renewals) again last year. I'm now working 50-72 hours a week in the Texas heat. I'm doorknocking booking for appointments and realistically booking 8-10 per week Medicare and Life appointments. I sell an average of 2 New-to-Medicare MAPDs and 1 life insurance product per week after appointment cancellations. I've seen the trend from the "old fashion" ways to the "telesales" method after COVID. I'm looking for an agent/agency owner who has a proven method. Everyone I talked with about this works for Assurance IQ and brags about how they sell 100 MAPD plans a year. That's easy when you have inbound calls and entice them by "adding more benefits". That is not sales. That is order taking. I'm trying to figure out this telesales method for life insurance more than anything to help my downline agents. I want to get new agents making money on final expense products first before prospecting for Medicare insurance. I feel they can get a great start making money before they try my proven method to build Medicare RENEWALS. I don't want to be stubborn in my ways and learn other methods to fish. ​
Solution?: I want to learn from anyone who can help me. I'm very honest and transparent. I'm willing to show you my book on Medicare business including renewals and operations. Maybe we can learn from each other if you are trying to find methods to build a large Medicare renewal clientele and sell multiple products in a household. My method isn't sexy but you will have solid renewals with a very low cancellation rate than as a telesales agent. I can get into the house with T65 and sell multiple products. I have invested \$40,000 in direct mailing equipment and could barter services if you are very useful."

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/14fpiln/experienced_facetoface_agent_looking_for_an/

"Thank you so much for showing how to do this! I knew it existed but could never figure out how to set it up. I have a question - If I wanted to switch uplines :-)As long as my current upline agrees to release me, does the 6 month waiting period before the ACA carriers will change my upline still apply? I just became contracted with the ACA carriers recently and haven't made any sales yet, if that matters."

— YouTube · FREE LEADS!! How to get free leads for ACA "Obamacare" · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sBopPuhBx74&lc=UgwM4KV9akHGUUfoIWV4AaABAg>

"I've spent the last year and a half looking for an IT job. 🤔 I have my CompTIA A+, studying for my security+, and haven't been able to find a job. So I got my insurance license. And I've been working for a subsidiary of Globe life/ American Income life called AO. I love all the people on my team and they are all very helpful when it comes to training, and they paid me for the two weeks of training. I've had my own leads for about a week and a half. I haven't made any sales yet, but I'm still giving it a shot. At the same time, I have still been applying to IT jobs, so hopefully, I can find something. I don't think I'm made for insurance. Lol but IT seems to be really hard to get into if you have no experience. That being said, I wish you all the luck!"

— InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fmntn2/life_insurance_recruiters_are_liars/lojcm6s/

"What numbers are you calling. We are a commercial independent agency and my agents make 50 to 100 calls a day based on x dated leads in industry they focus on. They write 100k to 400k a month in premium and make 5k to 20k a month as 1099 commission only agents. They get 50% of what agency gets in commission new and renewal."

— InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wjj70/what_are_your_thoughts/paefk5l/

"Do you have any additional licenses? One of the training agencies I know focus a lot on helping people on the PNC side cross cell multiple lines or bring in commission only reps to assist. Also finding a cost-efficient way to market. What ratio of live transfers are converting to a quote and then to a sale?"

— InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1w0agml/insurance_broker_advice_needed/p6bj8dd/

"if selling as a broker, it's commission only, but the renewals are amazing. basically, find an FMO and get contracts through them, I don't mind giving you the number for Golden Age Marketing, they are great and in most states"

— InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fgcdel/how_do_i_get_started_into_selling_medicare/in1377y/

"Am i making a mistake with a pivot into a sales agent role? I unfortunately got laid off from my dream remote job in fitness at the start of the month and ive been in a desperate applying spree ever since. I currently work as an appointment setter with an HVAC company and honestly, its pretty ass. During my first week I got approached by an insurance sales rep in my DMs and sent me info on his agency role they are trying to fill. Its a life, accident and health insurance sales agent role. Ive never sold insurance, i was a personal trainer for 10+ years and while i did have a few years of selling memberships/training packages, this is an entirely new world to me. I did about 3 full days of research and there are some things that do stick out to me as good and bad so i wanted to get some advice on if im just coping here. The good: \- Renewals are a pretty damn interesting long term financial plan that i had never heard of and could honestly set me up for the rest of my life as i age into retirement (fitness is known for zero retirement options so this was a key one for me) \- The agency has a very strong onboarding process compared to what seems to be industry norms. 1. They give you free/back up leads for 6 months while they train you then you move into a pooled lead pile for 6 more months. This seems to be very uncommon and it can give me a large buffer to start up without being thrown to the sharks 2. 4 week bootcamp to get me up to speed and making sales pretty much right away. They have numerous people who made 1-2 sales within their training window so the options of making immediate money is there. 3. They genuinely want to keep their agency small, tactile and hitting the ground very hard so everyone makes money. They seem very specific on how many people they want on the team to avoid everyone fighting over leads 4. I can make more money than I've ever made in my life. i grew up extremely poor so this is a big driver for me. The Bad: \- Its 1099/commission only. I got a small severance with my layoff and including my savings, i only have enough to live on for \-10-12 weeks, which honestly has me worried that i wont make any early sales and end up a bit stuck with my hands in my pockets. \- I have to commit to 10-12 hour days during the first 6 months. Their words were "we give you free leads, we expect you to really take that serious and build up early so you have to be here a lot to accomplish this". I can work hard, but given that its only commission, the stress of having ZERO income coming in while im training raises my anxiety a bit. Am i being delusional stepping into this industry and this role given where i am in life?"

— InsuranceAgent · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj1b8/>

"I make 2000-3000 outside of open enrollment and 3000-8000 in open enrollment... commission only"

— YouTube · How Much Does A Health Insurance Agent Makelbeingbougie · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RrGUFRdgtZY&lc=Ugxp475MeA9l4l3wXEJ4AaABAq>

Money burned on leads that never answer · 43 documents

"If you want to get advanced: Google is the more expensive option but the leads are higher quality. Someone googling already has intent to buy, whereas on Facebook you're just scrolling your timeline and someone is interpreting you with an ad. Also there's more fake leads for some reason on Facebook, but they're also way cheaper. What we like to do is get traffic from Google ads and then use Facebook remarketing to put our Facebook ads in front of the expensive Google traffic that didn't buy."

— InsuranceAgent · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466vj/stop_buying_leads/mo7pbhg/

"BadA\$\$leads scam I purchased some leads from badassleads.. those leads are a penny worth. Wrong numbers, disconnected numbers, bad emails. Just dont waste your money and generate your own. Seriously lead generation companies are ripping off Agents"

— InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/

"What Uplines Don't Want you to Know - Carrier Release Process - Explained This is a question I get a ton from new agents, and its what every upline doesn't want you to learn, so please... learn it. Treat this information like it's required for you to be in the industry to know. Review your contracts with your uplines and make sure you have protection within them as well. Heck, get a lawyer to review it. Whatever it takes, I see too many agents getting trapped in awful comp deals and abusive uplines and get "Stockholmed" into buying bad leads from them and then gaslighting them into thinking its their fault. I've been there done that. This info is for the agent that calls themselves independent:

Demystifying Agent Contracting, Releases, and Blackout Periods I work directly with 54 carriers, 4 FMOs, multiple agencies, and nearly 1,000 independent agents. My role involves overseeing contracting, licensing, and agent/agency development. With experience spanning so many entities, I've had the chance to see the contracting process from all angles and business models. Let me break it down for anyone who's struggling to navigate this space. # Steps to Understand Contracting and Releases

1. **Contract Level (LOA vs. Broker):** * If you're directly contracted with a carrier as a truly independent broker *and* haven't signed an agreement restricting you to one entity (or an LOA contract, which assigns your commission to your upline), you should generally be free to contract with another carrier or upline without issues.
2. **Private Contracts (Non-Competes or No Non-Competes):** * If you're tied to a brokerage or agency and have a private contract (like a non-compete), get a lawyer to review your options. Some of these cannot be upheld in court, that's important for you to know. * Medicare agents may want to wait until the start of the year for a smoother transition —this avoids AEP complications.
3. **Carrier Blackout Periods:** * **New agents** can contract anytime, even during AEP, for Medicare Advantage (MA) and Medicare Supplement (Med-Supp) plans. * **Switching uplines or FMOs, however, is restricted** during AEP for MA carriers (typically September–December). * If you're contracting with a carrier for the first time, you can get a **new contract** during AEP, but you can't **switch uplines** until the blackout period ends.
4. **Release Process (To Release or Not):** * Brokers contracted directly with carriers usually retain their commissions unless restricted by a private contract (see Step 2). * You can file a self-release with an *intent to transfer*. After 90–180 days, the carrier can re-contract you under a new upline while allowing you to keep producing during the interim. (you will be compensated according to your previous contract if you decide to continue producing, you wont get commission for producing if you WERE an LOA agent because your effective comp is 0%) * This safeguards agents from being stuck in unfavorable relationships. Most agents prefer waiting until the start of the year to minimize risks. The key is understanding your contract and navigating transitions safely, which is something many agents overlook. # A Brief History of the Release Process (why the heck is it this way?) The "agent-release" process emerged in the late 90s and early 2000s to manage transfers between FMOs and carriers. Unfortunately, it was often abused, with FMOs refusing to grant releases, especially during AEP, leaving agents trapped in bad contracts. To address this, carriers like UnitedHealthcare, Aetna, and Humana introduced transfer freezes during AEP to protect their investments. The *intent to transfer* process, developed in the late 2000s and early 2010s, aimed to fix these issues by providing agents a path to transfer without jeopardizing their business. # Misunderstandings About Releases If your agency/FMO/upline tells you "you can't transfer," it's likely because their training hasn't been updated to reflect the proper release procedures. This isn't usually malicious, they just want to ensure you're not left without commissions. Nobody wants to risk that. Also, the information is incredible "gate-kept", it's not a "sexy" process everyone wants to learn, until they need it... If you're looking for additional insight, this [YouTube video](<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NaExikyNwzo>) (not affiliated with me or my company) provides a solid overview of the release process. However, it doesn't touch on the contract-level distinctions I've outlined here. Understanding these processes can help you avoid costly errors and confidently take control of your career. If you have questions or need clarification, feel free to ask!"

— InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gy923a/what_uplines_dont_want_you_to_know_carrier/

"Big Daddy leads (BDL) Leads Review TL;DR: Tried Big Daddy Leads for Mortgage Protection. Lots of disconnected numbers (they did replace some), most people never picked up despite hammering them with 8-10 calls a day + texts, and the show rate was awful. The ones who did pick up all expected their entire mortgage covered at ~70 years old. I tried downselling to equity protection/payment protector, but they wanted all-or-nothing. Honestly, you'll get better results just running your own ads. And yes I did track my numbers for everything. --- I tested Big Daddy Leads for Mortgage Protection recently and wanted to share an honest review for anyone thinking about it. Lead quality: Pretty bad overall. I got a lot of disconnected numbers — to be fair, they did replace those — but even with the "good" ones, most people didn't answer after I hammered them: 8-10 calls a day, double-dialing, leaving voicemails once, and texting every time. Show rate was rough. Expectations: This was the biggest killer. Every single MP lead I got seemed to expect their whole mortgage covered. I did try to downsell into equity protection/payment protector plans (covering monthly payments for a set amount of time), but they flat-out didn't want it. It was whole coverage or nothing. And look — I've been doing this for years, I'm a ~\$30k/month producer, I know how to handle objections, but I couldn't flip that expectation. These leads were just set up the wrong way from the start. How they generate leads: You don't control or even see the ads. They run simple image ads into Facebook lead forms, optimized for cheapest CPL, not quality. If you've been around marketing, you know that's not the same thing. Not trying to bash them unfairly — just being real about my experience."

— InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nxh2u/big_daddy_leads_bdl_leads_review/

"I know this is the insurance agent subreddit so I may catch some heat here, but this seems very common. I know we are told to sell on value not price, but the fact is most of these bad leads we get filled out an ad online for cheap insurance. And they get hammered with calls from every agent in the state for different companies. They don't care that they get better coverage on your quote if it is more expensive. Sure there are outliers, I have successfully sold on value before, but that is hard to do. And this is assuming they even answer. You can make great money in insurance but it is a grind and in this age of internet leads and being able to get a quote from anyone at any time, selling on value is old news, at least for these type of cheap leads"

— InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p0s3n8/quitting_after_a_month_am_i_alone_in_feeling_this/npl7u6u/

"I need leads for contact rate. My sales skills are there I think because I have talked with people then sold policies but it seems like I am calling such bad leads that don't answer or hang up in my face in the first second of the call"

— YouTube · Insurance Agents: Should you buy leads or generate leads ? · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aGrUeGEYEpl&lc=UgxNQe5hKU22JZfoKKJ4AaABAq>

"It really just depends on the leads i buy, the most expensive ones right now for me are \$13.00 a lead.. Typically you want to reinvest 10-15% of what you're wanting to make back into your business. So if you want to make 10,000 a month you need to invest at LEAST 1,000 back into leads and stuff like that. It's all about your numbers too. Warm market leads are better than cold market in my opinion. I've spent about \$400 in leads and i've made 2 sales off of those that have covered the \$400 and then some. Life insurance is a little different than other insurance i feel like, you REALLYYYY have to grind. It's hard but once you figure out your numbers it's like a challenge against yourself every month haha."

— InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jpsc95/it_finally_happened/ml267eh/

"What lead vendors work for you? I'm a face to face final expense agent. I was using cheaper internet leads from integrity, social insurance leads, and leads direct. They aren't exclusive but they're anywhere from \$1-11 so I can get a lot of them, and if you dial enough you'll set up enough appointments. The ROI was great. As of recently though, they're just bad. And I've been with companies in the past that have had BAD leads before, I'm used to having to dial a lot and overcome objections, but this just isn't the way anymore. I've tried Facebook ads myself and I've come to the conclusion I'm just not a good marketer. It takes a lot of trial and error and time to figure it out so unless there's somewhere that'll give me a copy and pasted proven ad to post, I've decided it's not worth it. I'll take any recommendations on any direct mail or internet lead vendors. What works for you guys?"

— InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fmxc1/what_lead_vendors_work_for_you/

"AMEN! i have been on a similar journey. i left my last IMO after i had a "wait a second, am in a cult?" realization. it was led by a psychopathic narcissist, so that was the culture. like every psychopathic narcissist, there was the underlying truth and there was the surface of the mask and when in it, it can be hard to tell the difference. the surface mask was, "we are here to help people, we are here to support each other, we are so special". the underlying truth was that it was an MLM style parasitic predatory organization whose leadership was all about grabbing the money bag and draining as much blood from as many people as possible whether they were agents (through low commissions and crazy overpriced junk leads) or clients. they preyed on the vulnerable, the leader surrounded himself with women who had backgrounds in drug addiction, trauma, abusive parental and romantic relationship histories. later on i learned from women who had left that the founder/leader was sexually predatory and pressured women there to sleep with him by making them feel indebted to him for "saving" them. i was banned from my cult's group chat bc people asked me for help with better lead sources bc i was shooting up the leaderboard while everyone else was struggling so i shared some sources i was using and succeeding with. they punished and smeared me for that. so i left with 2 other top 10 leaderboard agents and started my own agency. several other top agents left to join other imo's at the same time we left. my old imo started me at 60% commission levels and 45% for GL. i start people with zero experience at 75-90%. my cult IMO charged \$27 per callback data lead that they made bank on. i offer leads that i make zero dollars on and it is pay per presentation for \$25 with a 20% min close rate promise (i'm closing double that rate and i am not an elite closer), not pay per lead who doesn't even answer the phone. cult imo was recruiting like 50 agents per week. we don't run recruiting campaigns and limit our growth according to how many leads we can provide our agents to make sure everyone is well fed. my cult IMO preached "only 8% of agents make it" but at my agency we make it our problem to solve if a full time agent is not writing at least \$15k AP per month. my cult IMO punished people for leaving, smeared them with made up lies, would call the new uplines of people who left to try and blacklist them. we have an open release policy and would always go out of our way to make any transition out as friendly and peaceful as possible. there are good IMO's and agencies out there. i can recommend some if people are looking."

— InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1q6lb33/when_integrity_collides_with_the_insurance/ny9dvtm/

"This right here! So many unethical companies too that's exploit their agents and charge for bonk ass leads. My first experience was with HealthMarkets, horrible company, leads are \$36 each all of which are trash. I spent thousands of dollars on leads the first year. I also got taken by FFL, there I only burned \$3,000 in leads, I sold 5 policies, 4 charged back. I'm so happy now that I'm focused on the ACA market only. I don't care about selling life or any other supplemental. People are broke and they care barely afford health insurance as it is."

— InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r86i3g/whats_the_hardest_part_of_being_an_insurance/o62tbgm/

"Internet leads are terrible for the reasons you just described and they are only going to continue getting worse. Cheap leads typically equal bad leads. Your agent knows these leads are bad, but they are being told that this is how they should be growing their business. It is a volume game, if someone is concerned with price, then coverage conversations go out the window. If you are stuck to a very strict script, that also stinks. If internet leads are the only way you have to market, then I would look at your three biggest qualifying issues. Accidents, DUI's, Insurance history. For example, if the above three are your top three sticking points, as soon as I get the person on the phone "Hi Mr. SoandSo I am calling to see if we can offer you lower insurance, let me just qualify you real fast. Do you have any accidents or DUI's? No, great. How long have you had insurance for, oh, only three months, sorry I can not help you. I will call in six months!" If you can shave that down even more, great. Qualify the lead within the first two minutes and save yourself a lot of time. Then, if they qualify, I like to ask "what is important to you, price or coverage?" If they say price, and 90% will say price, then I quote State minimum with max ded's. I explain everything about the coverage. When they scoff at a 2k deductible, and they will scoff. I explain that THEY are the ones who said price. You can not have a low price and good coverage. If they are adamant they are paying \$40 a month, they likely do not know what coverage they have. Ask for a declaration page for your review. 5-7 leads is not enough for internet leads, you need about 40 a day. More is better. Not working them is just as good."

— InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1w6w1cg/cheap_leads/p7r5te0/

"You answered your own question. Leads are shit abd the vendors are reselling leads. In my state, there will be a new 1:1 consent law possibly going into effect early 2026. This will prevent lead vendors from reselling the same fucking lead to 10 different agents. Leads are just shit overall right now. My close right is the worst it has ever been because of these trash leads. Half of them don't even qualify because they have no prior."

— InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer9kzq/

"Yea it's crazy, I would spend about \$42 on a "fresh" exclusive lead just to finally get a hold of them after 10+ tries for them to tell me they already signed up with another agent a while ago... and of course the lead company doesn't reimburse unless it's a disconnected number, so the agent is forced to eat that cost"

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj5uxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/ourb2oq/

"that's a honestly great question. I guess I have two sides to it. 1st. Do not leverage yourself past your means for leads as far as I'm concerned that's gambling and not a good idea. 2nd. while the slow grind sucks, I would do what you can to safe every dollar to buy high quality leads. buy one a month two a month whatever you can afford and work events out side of that. This industry can snowball and quickly if you provide exceptional customer service. But just because you can make 100K plus commissions easily doesn't mean there isn't people out there and didn't go broke and a lot in my opinion is having bad leads. With good leads it's nearly impossible to lose money, but that's the trick finding good leads I would say for every good source there is 50 bad ones if not more. I went through 30-40 before I found the one I have now. that's just my 2 cents I'm by no way or shape an expert I'm not even with 1 year under my belt I get my story is unique and I got very lucky and swung for the fences. I only did it cause I had the income to burn and it wasn't going to leverage me in the slightest. Even knowing the future I wouldn't have put it on a credit card."

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/nantrn/

⚠️ American Income Life = Scam ⚠️ I spent 6 months inside American Income Life, and if you're even thinking about working here, please hear me out: it's a trap. They lure you in with promises of six-figure income, freedom, luxury trips, and "helping families." What actually happens? You're bled dry from day one. You pay for your license, exam fees, Zoom account, computer—money, money, money out of your pocket. By the time you realize what's going on, you've already invested too much to walk away easily. The first week, they make you feel like you've accomplished something huge: passing the exam, starting your "career." But then you're thrown into terrible training and endless busywork—basically just making calls for your upline. When you finally get your own "opportunity," they hand you garbage leads that have been recycled a thousand times. People scream at you to stop calling, and you're forced to keep going. It's harassment, plain and simple. The schedule is insane: 12-hour days, almost no breaks, constant check-ins and micromanagement. When you finally catch someone, you drag them onto a Zoom call and read a script full of lies that you've been drilled on. Without even realizing it, you're tricking people into buying one of the worst insurance products out there. Meanwhile, you're broke, stressed, and exhausted. They parade "success stories" in front of you—agents claiming they were once in your shoes but now they're making six figures. Fake trips, fake recognition, fake promises. It's all smoke and mirrors. 🚩 If you're considering joining, or if you're already inside and thinking "I've put too much time and money in to quit now" — wake up. That's exactly how they keep you trapped. You're not building a business. You're being used. They're scamming new agents and clients alike. This place wrecks people's finances, mental health, and self-worth. It operates like a Ponzi scheme disguised as a career opportunity. To anyone on the fence: don't fall for it. Get out while you can. To the authorities: How is this still allowed to exist?"

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/nggbda7/

"The problem is not putting hard work, if you went through the process you know that if you don't work hard you won't get any leads in r call people... The problems is that in the beginning they don't tell you but you will be getting old ass leads... and that's is frustrating... still not a cold call but some people don't even remember they signed up for... not to mention other agents that don't resolve their bad leads so it goes back to the pile as a no answer... and guess what? You will eventually call a bunch of people who already said are not interested many times... so I've seen some new agents taking many weeks just to book something remotely good... People who jump into this desperate for money and with no much time to climb up until get fresh leads will not last long, it's a fact, and they should be open about that from the get go... instead they hype you up, push you to learn all scripts and so on, and when you are finally ready you will spend 80 of you time going through a list of leads and calling people that never pickup the phone."

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cy9b7k/im_stuck_at_globe_life_american_income_life_and_i/ms4ol22/

"I guess my question is why would you ever stay somewhere that has bad leads where you don't actually own the client and work to generate your own leads that ultimately you basically give the value of to somebody else just so you can get a commission that is ultimately inferior compensation to you doing the exact same amount of work at an agency where you own your client? Where you are in effect compensated for finding your own leads."

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1egg6kv/my_agency_is_targeting_the_wrong_crowd_and_its/lfvun7o/

"New Agent Advice I got my life insurance license back in February (at the same time I was let go from my previous W2 position). I have really struggled to find my footing with IMOs and FMOs. A lot of these companies just throw trash leads at new agents and expect you to find gold. To make matters worse, my current company's inbound transfer leads completely dried up because another agent didn't pay their invoice. The system was supposed to be you receive inbound transfers, get paid from your commission Thursday and pay the invoice Friday. Since I'm currently unemployed and don't have any savings, I can't afford to buy expensive leads or wait out cash-flow gaps. I recently interviewed with State Farm but didn't hear back. At this point, I really need a W2 captive agent role or an independent position that offers exclusive, provided leads for a lower commission cut so I can build a stable bankroll are my thoughts. Does anyone have any help or suggestions?"

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wgdgt5/new_agent_advice/

"Whats killing your close rate? bad leads or bad follow up? Been in insurance sales a long time and I see agents blame leads when it's follow-up, and blame follow-up when the leads were trash to begin with. So which is it for you? For me the game didn't change until I fixed data quality first. better leads in, and suddenly the follow-up that "wasn't working" started working. Made me think most of us are solving the wrong end of the problem. Curious where everyone actually lands on this. What's your real bottleneck right now?"

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u43285/whats_killing_your_close_rate_bad_leads_or_bad/

"Hi I'm a life insurance broker and have been struggling with bad leads can you help out with that?"

— YouTube · Pros and Cons of Being a Medicare Agent | Life & Health Insurance Sells · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TsUtv9Z3_uo&lc=Ugz1FPpA2zF9FZBbQ6l4AaABAg

Chargebacks and clawed-back commissions · 71 documents

"State Farm just rewrote 19,000 agents' contracts overnight. If you think a captive book is a retirement plan, read this If you somehow missed it: State Farm is moving all 19,000 of its agents onto a single standardized contract, ending their deferred-comp/retirement program (AIPP), and dropping health insurance for agents and spouses. Agents are reportedly looking at 30–40% less on base commissions depending on contract and book size. I can't believe State Farm disputes that number but hasn't offered its own. The core shift is from getting paid to *retain* a book to getting paid to *write new business*. They also put buyout offers on the table with a Sept 30 deadline. P&C side, I know. But the lesson isn't carrier-specific and it's the thing I keep coming back to: you never actually owned that book. State Farm did. And a 20-year "trailing income" promise is only worth as much as the carrier's willingness to keep paying it which turned out to be "until it's inconvenient." The part that should get every agent's attention is the direction, not the one carrier. Comp is going performance-based across the board, trailing/renewal-style income is getting squeezed, and AI is going to absorb more of the service and retention work that used to justify those trails. The "come build a \$3–5M book and coast" pitch a lot of us were sold is quietly being retired. So I'm genuinely curious how the room sees it: Are you seeing comp pressure at your carrier/IMO too, or is this a State Farm-specific overreach? Does owning your book independently actually protect you here, or is that just trading carrier risk for lead-cost/chargeback risk? For the newer agents is anyone factoring "can they rewrite my deal in 5 years" into where they sign? Not trying to dunk on State Farm agents since a lot of them got blindsided and it's a rough spot. More interested in what this says about where the whole comp model is heading."

— InsuranceAgent · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/

"I love my commission. I get 70% advance commission on an annual premium. So if I sign a person up for an \$80 a month policy, I make \$672. The downside is I have to get my own leads. I really don't care lol. I make around 12k a month on a lazy month."

— YouTube · How much an insurance agent makes per policy · 70 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-cowanj3iGc&lc=UgwPMB48SnKhhAz7HdF4AaABAg>

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

"Starting to think the money and lifestyle is a pipe dream from the depths of my soul I really need to know the truth of this I have a family to support. i've been selling life insurance for about two years now. I was attracted to all these big checks and the lifestyle that you can control your money and just buy leads and set appointments and do one call closes over the phone and you could make 200k, 300k 500 K a year. and there are tons of people showcase that are doing it. Even twenty something yr olds. So I got in and I bought the leads and I grinded my face off. I managed to make over 100 K within a handful of months. I thought I had it made and I cracked the code. And then I realized I still felt broke. all these crappy lead companies. these leads were supposed to be exclusive and I know they sold them to 10 other agents. I would sometimes dial eight hours a day and only have 1 to 3 genuine conversations. that's crap. I was on the phone all day long I was buying thousands of dollars a month in Leads. Then the chargebacks started hitting me. And now I have to work for free for the rest of the month. But you Gotta keep buying more leads And then customers would call in and need things. I needed to call the carriers. but I didn't really have time to talk to them because I need to buy more leads and call more people and make more sales. eventually I realized how unhappy I was I was working a lot and yet I still felt paycheck to paycheck despite writing 20-30k a month. and I feel like I could not get ahead. What the heck? Then I looked at some of my leaders I was following and they were making 400 K plus a year. and I thought if I ever get to their level then I will be an easy Street then I could take my foot off the gas and I could have a great lifestyle. Wrong. All of them are working their faces off. they couldn't take time off. they weren't spending time with her kids. they didn't have time to answer my calls. Or to train me really. And what's more they didn't even seem happy. they had this stressed out look in their face all the time. I thought how could that be? was this all a lie? is the money and lifestyle even real? I saw this guy who wrote \$1 million on stage. Come to find out he spent 250 K on Leads 30 to 40% fall off. and then minus the guaranteed issue and administrative costs like his dialer or admin... really he was making like 150-200k. That ain't a million. And. He was working 7 days a week. And stressed out couldn't take his foot off the gas. Not worth it. I don't want that lifestyle. If I'm making 400 K a year I better be able to enjoy time with my family and come home for dinner and take nice vacations and make money moves and investments. My goal is to have the lifestyle not to be a slave on the phone seven days a week 10 hours a day. I'm assuming it's just unsustainable biz model. and you're always fighting off chargebacks . And the lead cost will eat up all your profits and that's why most agents won't stick around. Is that the cold truth? am I chasing a pipe dream ? is there ever a way off the escalator if you are selling by yourself without a team? I was mainly doing final expense and mortgage protection.."

— InsuranceAgent · 59 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nmbggg/starting_to_think_the_money_and_lifestyle_is_a/

"I would say this is pretty accurate. I've been in the life insurance business since 2015 . I don't have any overhead and don't pay for leads . Id say I am pretty average and work about 30 hrs /week. strictly personally producing right now . I have 90% retention and make about 5k a month . I've had a team before and was making considerably more money but was putting in considerably more hours. I also have seen people in my company that are more motivated than me make 20k+ a month. I don't have a spouse or kids so working remotely is perfect and lets me travel all over and I enjoy taking time off to explore . For someone that is willing to put in the time and effort , life insurance is a great long term career . Just make sure you look into leads , chargebacks , and residuals when you interview with a company and be prepared to put in work ."

— YouTube · I Asked 166 Life Insurance Agent How Much Money They ACTUALLY Make Per Month · 49 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MLoTTqEO2AY&lc=UgzvaarWYK3Ns1QxAWF4AaABAq>

"How to Start an Insurance Agency (IMO) Okay, basically I'm at an Insurance Agency called Roman Financial that is providing me no value, apart from constant jargon and motivation and looking at fast cars. I'm 19 and hit the ground running right away selling 5 figures in my first few weeks. I quickly realized that I'm way underpaid as far as "street level" for the final expense providers we go through. Good news is I didn't sign any NDA or a non-compete. As of right now, I am 10000% unnecessarily paying my upline hundreds of dollars that I'm breaking my back to get dialing 8 hours a day on measly 75-80% commission. With little research I've found that the exact same insurance providers give 120% first year to agents. Apart from the 45% of my check that I'm giving to my undeserving upline they are also making me pay for my CRM and the shiddy leads. I've figured that I'd go my own way and own my own lead source to grab leads rather than listen to their manipulation all day. In this way, I want my recruits to be taken care of instead of letting people fail out of the industry going into debt through leads and chargebacks. Long story short, they keep telling me to dial more and to drop the ego. I know I'm worth more than what I'm getting commission wise and nobody is going to have control over how much money I make anymore. That being said, I plan to create my own agency/IMO. Where my agents aren't paying most of their checks to me and don't have to fend for themselves in a constant uphill battle. I plan to have everybody pool for leads to fund ads for the lead source and direct mail etc. I plan to promote recruiting but have everybody come in at a fairly decent commission. No rah rah bullshi, just effective business owners who want to succeed and slam deals. I plan to pay appt setters to book quality leads so guys don't have to dial like their lives depend on it. I have a general outline of what I need to do: name, logo, llc/scorp, e&o, recruiting, marketing, but as far as contracting with providers, whats the best way to go about doing that? If anybody has experience building an agency lmk? ORRR if anybody is seemingly in the same boat and would like to build an empire with me... i'm taking partner applications lol. EDIT: My upline saw this and "released" me which is hilarious since I was getting them paid in everyway. Unfortunately for them I have everything laid out already and already talked to a business accountant and everything. Roman if you guys are reading this, You are 100% correct when you say that I'm gonna try to take my recruits with me. Actually you're 90% correct because you used the word "try". As I was recruiting them I already told them it wouldn't be long until we left Roman just get your licensing course. And hey, when my agencies up and running you can always come work for me at a higher contract than Norm and Carlo got you at. Remember you're never gonna be richer than your upline. :)"

— InsuranceAgent · 24 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15nmmk7/how_to_start_an_insurance_agency_imo/

"That's me too, but no lead purchases, no charge back, but extremely low sales!"

— YouTube · My First 90 Days As A Life Insurance Agent · 24 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9lF5hTEjK7U&lc=UgzUzfl62c3LV5cDsJt4AaABAq>

"Beware of MLM structured companies (warning) So this was originally a response to a comment on this sub, but I see a ton of new people coming into insurance, (speaking to independent guys here) and there are many many hungry wolves waiting to recruit these naïve noobs and make a profit. So, I figured I could make a post using some of the content from my previous response to explain the caveats and expose the reality of these places. I come from a MLM originally, it was unenounced to me at the time, but I'm still grateful because it gave me a first hand glance at what goes on there. How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. They will push you to build a team, because hey, don't you wanna make 6 figures "bro"??? Well then you gotta build a huge team so you get all those overrides off the guys under you. Now, there's nothing wrong necessarily with building a team, but in a MLM context and the way they act in a deceptive manner it is extremely unethical. The guys you see writing 100k plus in premium a year??? A fraction of that fell of the books and was a chargeback, then that guy like all of us has to pay taxes at the end of the year. He also probably was buying \$500 worth of leads a week. Burned gas every day meeting clients. He "maybe" profited 40k that year, and that's being generous. But as long as they can show boat how much premium they're writing a week? A month? A year? Then shove the rhetoric down new guys throats, boasting about how they too can make 100k a year? Then they're all good. I found out through a credible source, as well as David Dufford (has a youtube channel, good tips and insight for insurance) that alot of these "top producers" buy the trips that you can win with insurance carriers for writing a lot of AP. They do all of this and sugar coat their actual earnings because you'll buy the dream, go sell sell sell, and the guys above you get all the overrides off of you without investing any of their money into you at all. It's a fucking amazing model for the guys at the top to make a killing. They create a strong sense of family at those places to keep you on board as well. They push shitty products like Americo a ton too, because they get higher commissions off of that. Americo is also pricey, and you can easily find a cheaper product for that senior to actually help them out, but more than likely they won't have many cheap options that actually are economical for the client, because then you, and them get a lower commission. So MLM's will typically encourage you to get a higher premium out of the client and force a pricey carrier on them. Hope this helps. Reputable, ethical IMO's that offer you high commission contracts and don't push you to build teams are harder to find, because they don't market and recruit. Join an insurance forum, those guys are veterans and a lot of the IMO/Brokerage owners are members there. I've been in Life Insurance for a while now, and am branching into Health/Medicare, so anyone can feel free to PM me with Life Insurance questions if you'd like. Also it would be cool to maybe post any experiences you've had with these types of organizations."

— InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/n4hblb/beware_of_mlm_structured_companies_warning/

"Useful tip for new agents Stop paying for leads that's the wrong way to start off as a new agent you have to learn the business first so it's best to get with a agency that provides inbound leads and learning about handling chargebacks before you go independent it's a marathon not a sprint. If your with an agency that gives inbound leads and training your going to make money if your disciplined enough."

— InsuranceAgent · 16 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kxgsrv/>

"AEP apps vs chargebacks Happy December, fellow medicare agents! We made it through AEP! Just here to get some perspectives and experiences of what to expect with AEP apps vs which ones actually follow through! For those of you who have been through multiple AEPs, how many apps do you usually write? This was my first year, and I wrote 172. The majority of them are renewals, but I did have a few initial enrollments. Do you think this is exceptional? Also, how many of your apps ended up being chargebacks/cancelled (due to enrolling with another agent)? I'm curious to know what to expect here for my book. Last question, I promise, what percentage of your book ends up sticking around the following year? I know everyone's market is different, but I'm trying to get a sense of what's "normal." Any insight from seasoned agents would help a ton. Thanks so much and happy holidays!"

— InsuranceAgent · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pgvbbq/aep_apps_vs_chargebacks/

"Is selling life insurance what everyone makes it out to be? All over my social media page I am seeing 20 years olds post that they are making 10k or more a month by selling life insurance. I know that there a chargebacks, buying leads, and its commission only, but is it actually worth getting into? I feel like all the companies are MLM's and that they are only posting this content to recruit people to join."

— InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1t35kdo/>

"First off, get the MLM idea out of your head. The whole insurance industry is built upon uplines and downlines that is fully commission based. If you want a salary, you'll have to find an agency (whose commission based and has an upline) that'll pay you something fixed. Tough to find something like that for L&H compared to P&C. FE is great for upfront funds, but know that there can be quite a few chargebacks, so 30% of your commissions should go into a side-account to pay for these until you get your lead saturation up and your sales skill level established. Yes, Medicare is a grind unless you know how to cross-sell ancillary, then it's better than FE. In fact I recommend this track for newer FE agents: 1. Contract with someone that can train you and gives you fair contracts 100+% for FE and 20% for Medicare Supplements. 2. Get leads (facebook and direct mail) EVERY week in the same 50 sq mile area, and work them hard, spend 40 hours a week in the field, getting in front of as many people as possible. Build up a saturation level so that when you invariably door knock your leads and they say no or they're not home, you can just simply go two streets down and knock the guy you could never get ahold of a month or two ago. 3. Take some sample lead info and put it into a Medicare Quoting tool and find out whose competitive in your area for supplements, advantage plans etc. Start building your Medicare knowledge up. Of course, first past the AHIP so you have a base understanding for it. Just a few hours a week can help build up a wealth of knowledge. Once you understand how everything works, any changes to plans, companies or Medicare itself is easily assimilable - whereas there's no changes to FE usually. 4. Tell every lead you'll follow up with them in September to schedule a meeting in October to go over their Medicare options - because you do that too. If you don't sell anyone any FE, that's ok, offer to contact them in September for their Medicare, you "help seniors save money on their prescriptions and get extra benefits at no cost to them." If you paid for the lead, might as well get as much use out of them. 5. Selling FE sucks in November to December, the holidays. It's way easier to work with warm leads, sell them Medicare, and also increase your persistency lapse rate on your FE policies as well as bring in tons of referrals and get paid 2x as you would've just selling an FE policy. You could have enough leads to keep you busy all AEP, so that when that ends, you have a 2 week lull before New Years where you can start the whole cycle up again. THIS is the secret to making big bucks imo. Cody and Dave are good guys, Dave helped me out when I was where you were at, 12 years ago. He comes on here sometimes, haven't seen Cody on here yet."

— InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/svjgsv/help_i_passed_accidenthealth_and_life_now_im/hxgcw8n/

"Making too little for Marketplace Insurance?? I am a college student live in FL. I enrolled health insurance through Marketplace and received premium tax credit in year 2025. Now when I'm trying to enroll for 2026, my estimated income for 2026 is lower due to job change. The Marketplace shows I have \$0 premium tax credit. I called them, they say I make too little to qualify the premium tax credit. Although they mentioned I make too much to qualify for Medicaid, I don't qualify Medicaid anyway. My question is: - My income dropped tremendously in 2025 due to job change. Is it possible that I have to pay back the Tax Credit if I made less than 2025 100%FPL? I am worried now that when I file taxes, I might owe crazy amount of money for the insurance. - how do I get cheap insurance coverage (just for serious emergency like accidents or unforeseeable disease. I normally don't go to the hospital to get checked up or for some small things like cold cuz I literally can't afford it right now) P.S.: My school don't have anything. It's a very small private school & they don't care. I'm waitressing and they do not offer insurance. I can't get on my parent's plan either."

— HealthInsurance · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1plaiyv/>

"Am I doing this wrong? (Final Expense) So a brief run down, I started at an agency. Payout is 90% commission (75% upfront with 25% paid out over the rest of the year) I pay for mail-in leads at 35 bucks a pop. Obviously first couple months great but the last 4 weeks have been terrible. I haven't changed my approach or anything but I've only made two sales in these four weeks and they've really only covered my chargebacks lol with mail ins obviously I go to their homes and door knock. (spent \$742 on gas last month) I wouldn't feel bad if I was still making sales but it just seems to have dried up. Is it the time of year? Am I not being pushy enough? Thinking about running Facebook ad campaigns for some hotter leads to maybe help get out of this funk. anyone have experience with this or any tips?"

— InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p57gp5/>

"I watched the FX vid that was posted here and he talked about a rogue agent writing 40k of bad business and fleeing the country. My Assurant regional manager told me a better one. Assurant came out with a feature where if an app was instantly approved - meaning the second you submitted the app it was approved without any UW, you got 12 months advanced commission. What could go wrong? A new agent signed up his entire network of friends. They chose the most expensive plans, listed zero health conditions and all were auto-approved, earning him \$48,000 in commissions. His friends all then cancelled the policies during the 10 day free look. His MGA apparently didn't think it was a flag that a new agent wrote that much in two weeks. Every dime was charged back to the MGA who had to file BK over it and the agent went off to Mexico."

— InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lrh008/lets_remember_what_selling_health_was_like_preaca/n1b228y/

"It is definitely a grind the first 2 years. Our path is slightly behind the other gentleman's. Year 1 was ugly, thankfully we had savings. Year 2 was easier and 3+ are much better. We are a health insurance agency that sells ancillaries and the odd life policies. There are pros and cons to all areas of sales. For instance: life insurance has more chargebacks than Medicare which is why we took commission as earned - less financial risk to payback Medicare is subject to rules and regulations and the vagaries of politics. Life pays more up front, health pays longer term - so short term cash for life, long term renewals for Medicare. Life is more sales because you have to sell people on the need for it. 10,000 seniors turn 65 every day and need insurance. Life is year round and you have no real busy season. Medicare has open enrollment which is similar to tax season for accountants, but January through May (after you are established) are 20 to 30 hour work weeks. As you can see I prefer Medicare, but I am not blind to the fact that if you hate rules and details, you will hate Medicare. Whatever you do, learn to read books on your industry and sales, associate with top producers and put your customers interest before yours and you will get paid back in referrals."

— InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/pkdfdw/independent_insurance_agent_a_viable_career/hc4py0y/

"Hi OP! I'm a relatively new insurance agent been license for almost years and yes no one is ever transparent about leads, how to generate those and how costly they can be. To get leads you either pay a lot of money for them or spend a lot of your time chasing them. I personally gave up selling life insurance and supplementals because the amount of chargebacks was awful. Now I just focus on U65 ACA marketplace plans. I am also part of the HealthSherpa enrollee assistance program which pays me per person I have enrolled. I prefer this over getting commissions from the insurance carriers. I'll be happy to offer some feedback but you can also do your research."

— InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mcl3e3/i_already_hate_my_job/n5veshz/

"As a new agent, 99% of the game is TRIAL BY FIRE. Get yourself in front of people, understand selling to their needs vs selling for commission (charge backs aren't fun) your different types of objections and how to overcome them, tuning your tonality, the product knowledge comes from time and closes, which you can't get studying all the time. You gotta dial, you gotta BUY leads from different sources until you find one that works great for you."

— YouTube · What To Expect Your First 90 Days As An Insurance Agent! · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HF4onytV3c&lc=UgzDFYFSFfBFMw6QScV4AaABAg>

"Congrats on passing! As a life agent, it is nice to get paid quickly and with the advance pay it adds up quickly as well. However, please be cautious of chargebacks if you are on advanced pay. A safer choice is to request "as earned" especially if you're not dialed in with managing your money. Have a solid schedule, good lead flow, and just stay consistent."

— InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ju62n5/alright_i_passed/mm1gxco/

"Thank you. After dealing with MLM's for years (mixture of insurance and product sales), I don't want to deal with the structure anymore. "No More Recruiting". I moved into the medical field for a change in pace but now I need to make more money. Looking into life insurance and I'm getting told to recruit. I'm glad I ran across this video. I support you in this. I just want to sell policies with great leads with no charge backs. On your application you ask for prior sales proof. I been out of the game for years and don't have anything to show proof of past successes. Can I still join your team?"

— YouTube · Why I Left The Life Insurance Business (My Old MLM) · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nguUnK7fjDk&lc=UgzJaldo-PZu7wQUNsB4AaABAg>

CMS, carrier and TCPA exposure · 55 documents

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought "pre-sold leads" from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigator (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the "insurance carrier, not the agent", for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigator wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigator. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

"Be honest, how many of you are too hungry or greedy to actually care about your clients? Too often on this sub, I see posts full of frustration: "I can't close deals because customers are cheap." "The competition is undercutting me." "I need a new company with lower rates." Sound familiar? Complaining doesn't sell policies, and it certainly doesn't build trust with clients. What does work? Taking a step back and focusing on what you can control—helping people understand their risks and providing the guidance they need. Like Zig Ziglar and Jerry Acuff teach: "Help people get what they need, and you'll have all you need." Show, Don't Just Tell: Use Real-World Stories One of the best ways to help people understand the importance of proper coverage is by sharing real-life examples. Here's one: Imagine you're driving and accidentally hit a pedestrian—a 43-year-old father of three making \$90,000 a year. You only have \$100,000 in bodily injury coverage on your auto policy. Do you think \$100,000 goes far in this situation? Absolutely not. This man's medical bills could exceed \$500,000. He may lose his income while recovering, or worse, never return to work. The court won't just hold you responsible for his current medical costs—they'll look at his lifetime earning potential. That's millions of dollars. Now picture yourself on the stand in a courtroom. The plaintiff's attorney asks, "Why did you carry only \$100,000 in bodily injury coverage?" You respond, "Because that's all I could afford." (Which is a total lie) Then the attorney points out you're driving a \$60,000 vehicle with a \$600 monthly payment, yet you chose to skim on your liability coverage. How does that look to a judge? Conversely, you get a \$2000 vehicle with bad breaks or ball joints, hit the same pedestrian and not only will the judge be siding with the widow, if the judge finds out that you knew about the bad parts, you may be in for a manslaughter charge because of willful endangerment. Odds are, the widow will be awarded 40% of your pre-tax income until her children turn 18, then 20% for the rest of her life. I would tell the client that the 57 dollars a month in savings just cost you everything. This is why your job as an agent isn't just to sell policies—it's to help people manage their risks. Clients often don't understand the implications of their choices, and it's our responsibility to make those risks tangible. When we fail to explain the "why" behind higher limits, we're doing them a disservice. Here are other examples: A client with only \$150,000 in dwelling coverage on their home didn't realize rebuilding after a fire would cost \$244,000. They had to pay the difference out of pocket and face years of financial hardship. A business owner declined professional liability insurance, only to be sued for \$1 million after an employee error caused significant losses for a client. That lawsuit forced them into bankruptcy. Conversely, a family that opted for umbrella coverage was protected from losing their home after their teenage son caused a major accident. These stories aren't scare tactics; they're real-life scenarios. And they underscore the importance of listening to your clients, helping them understand their risks, and showing them why the right coverage matters. People don't want to feel "sold." They want someone who cares about their well-being and offers real solutions. Ask thoughtful questions. Share stories that make the risks relatable. Build trust by focusing on their needs—not your commission. When clients understand how proper coverage protects their family, their assets, and their peace of mind, they're more likely to say yes to higher limits. As agents, our job isn't just to provide a quote—it's to protect lives and livelihoods. Stop blaming external factors for lost sales. Instead, focus on what you can do better: Educate, advise, and build trust. Help your clients understand that managing their risks now can save them from life-altering consequences later. Let's stop complaining and start helping. Have any of you used similar real-life stories to educate clients? How did it work? Let's share ideas!"

— InsuranceAgent · 65 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hj1p7v/be_honest_how_many_of_you_are_too_hungry_or/

"Is this against AIL or Globe Life in general because I worked for the Liberty National division and if it's a class action lawsuit against globe, I would love to become a part of it."

— InsuranceAgent · 18 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1i1evot/ailglobe_life_scam_employees_were_suing/m75jzrt/

"How is everyone marketing in 2025 without spending a fortune? For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down. Since, I've tried multiple vendors, and I've tried data leads + telemarketers. It feels like no matter what I do, I have to spend 5 grand a month in marketing at least for each of my producers just to hit our goals. It's way too much, and as we spend more to make less, I'm feeling bad burnout as my margins shrink. Primarily P&C, captive agent. So what is everybody doing that's working?"

— InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/

"Great idea. Favorite telesales carriers: RNA, Prosperity and Trinity. SS billing + voice sign for all 3. Favorite lead: Real-time telemarketed call back with verified checking, ages 50-79 and agrees to speak with an agent. Basically telemarketers calling on DNC scrubbed and TCPA verified data to call on (old FB leads or Journaya/Trusted Form verified) + scrubbed against TCPA Blacklist Alliance and inputting into a form to serve it up in a CRM immediately. Tip: You need proper training and sales systems to make telesales work. If you take your DM leads and try to sell them over the phone with your typical f2f presentation, you'll fail. If you buy internet leads and don't have proper sales training or sales systems, you'll fail. My advice is either partner with a telesales-focused agency with an open release policy (hey, telesales isn't for everyone) or wait it out. Don't waste any time/money unless there's a proven system in place."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Telesales Tips · 11 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/final-expense-telesales-tips.101595/#post-1344555>

"I have been in this industry for 14 years and it has become a shell of it's former self. Let me explain. In 2009 is when CMS enacted over 100 new regulations in the Medicare industry. New regulations included annual enrollment periods, government regulated commissions for Part C and D, a Scope of Appointment form that must be completed prior to an agent's presentation, annual AHIP certifications to be able to sell policies in addition to annual carrier certifications, soon after new legislation that required MA plans to have to have a network which killed PFFS plans which were the most popular MA plans at that time, laws which forbids agents to market Part C and D products, laws which govern every aspect of agents holding seminars even including not allowing agents to offer free meals for attendees, the inability to call referrals (the referral must contact you), regulations on carriers that made it illegal for carriers to offer bonuses and trips to agents for production rewards, and many more that I can't think of off the top of my head. After these draconian regulations were passed most agents left the industry. The only ones that stayed were the agents that had a solid book of business prior to these new regulations which is why the average age of a Medicare agent is 60 years old. This industry's golden age was from 1998 to 2008. Medicare Advantage was a brand new concept as well a few years later Part D was brand new as well. There were plenty of reasons why seniors needed to talk with an agent during this time and the big money was made at this time. That all changed in 2009. CMS used the excuse that since agents were getting compensated with taxpayer money (Medicare funding Dollars) that CMS had the right to regulated everything about the agent's existence in this industry. In 2020, very little has changed under the Trump administration. The only good thing to be improved upon was CMS not requiring the Scope of Appointment form to be filled out 48 hours prior to an agent's presentation and changed it to the same day as the appointment. Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as well for fear that the carrier will get in trouble with CMS and lose funding for their plans. Part D plans pay almost nothing for the sheer amount of work that needs to be done reviewing your client's drug list every year that you are almost working for free. MAPD plans pay the same commission as MA only plans. Now if you understand inflation this is another issue as well. The US Dollar loses 2%-3% of it's value every year which causes prices to increase, but you get paid renewals based upon commission rates from the first year you write the business. So while you do make renewals, those renewals become less and less every year. Now that MA plans have ironed out their networks and funding is stabilized, there is little need for seniors to switch Medicare plans every year because they already are in the best plan possible. You can go after T65 business, but that has also become problematic as well. Since Social Security has raised the full benefit retirement age from 65 to 67, most seniors are still working for an employer at 65 and have no need for Medicare coverage until they retire, especially since many spouses are not yet on Medicare and their spouse needs the group coverage. The (un)Affordable Care Act aka Obamacare is terrible and has made major medical coverage too expensive and too restrictive. After 14 years in the industry I have finally realized all that is bad and the bad FAR out weighs the good. The commissions are too small for an agent to make it especially with so few seniors actually needing a better plan plus with everything I previously mentioned you need to be insane to become a Medicare agent in 2020. If you do start off in this industry you need at LEAST 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months of marketing expenses saved or you will run out of money very quick and need to find an hourly job. You must write 100 policies every year to make it in this industry and you will max out at 400 to 500 clients because any more clients and you will have to hire help. So at \$250 commission per client earned every year you are looking at a max of \$100,000 to \$125,000 minus your marketing expenses which will cost you between \$12,000 to \$20,000 per year plus all the gas consumption and wear and tear on your vehicle driving all over town on appointments, double taxes you pay for FICA, Medicare and Social Security taxes, and lack of access yourself to affordable health insurance by not having access to group health policies. Covid-19 is a new hurdle agents must overcome and adds a dozens new challenges because of CMS regulations. The Medicare industry just isn't worth it anymore."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAg>

"Hi David! I always appreciate your videos, so thank you for making them and sharing your knowledge so freely and often. I passed the AHIP but haven't had really any training on how to sell Medicare plans, which is frustrating because I don't want to be out that test money and not using that knowledge to help people. I do telesales for FE and plan to for Medicare but I'm nervous about all the upfront compliance stuff (like fitting in SOA over the phone for example). I have reached out to my agency about it but haven't had any assistance as of yet. Any chance you're planning on a video like this, or have a start to finish example of a Medicare call that could help put me at ease to get started?"

— YouTube · How A Career Selling Medicare Policies Works · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=d2SmzwHbqfw&lc=UgzJ1e_zsWcOx83Umx4AaABAg

"TCPA mainly focuses on robo calls and dialers. I don't use any of those to dial my leads. I'm pretty much old school and hand dial myself. It's been 2 years for me and I haven't had an issue yet. I also don't spam call my leads. If someone answers and states they're not interested, I move on to the next lead. I'm not in the business of begging or being pushy."

— InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/m9mifjh/

"Advice for Final Expense Startup (High-Volume Cold Calling Team) Hi everyone, I'm planning to start selling final expense insurance within the next month or two. I'll be going all-in on cold calling and wanted to get feedback from experienced agents before launch. My Plan: I'll (22M) be working with my two 18-year-old brothers and operating im new york state Each of us will make 1,000 cold calls/day, 6 days a week We'll work 12-13 hour shifts, using a CRM + power dialer system We plan to buy leads daily at \$0.30 to \$0.50 each We're all bilingual (English/Spanish) and comfortable with high-volume sales We're not strangers to long hours or consistent effort — and we plan to maintain tone and energy throughout. Goals: Start with final expense sales Gradually add Medicare Scope of Appointments (SOA), enrollments, and eventually Medicare Supplements After a few months of production, I plan to negotiate a 140% commission contract We're expecting a 0.3% to 0.5% close rate based on what we've researched A friend of mine who only does medicare will share his hot leads with me since i will do final expense so i am guaranteed some early success at least if i dont screw it up --- My Questions: 1. Is this call volume and close rate realistic for a new team using aged or low-cost leads? 2. Is there anything crucial I'm overlooking in terms of compliance, licensing, or daily execution? 3. Are there any CRM + dialer combos you highly recommend for high-volume final expense/Medicare telesales? 4. For Medicare broker changes, is it realistic to expect consistent volume or are those more seasonal? 5. Are there any major red flags or rookie mistakes we should avoid early on? 6. Any advice for scripting, retention, or mental pacing during long dialing days? Thanks in advance — I really respect the grind this industry takes and want to do it the right way."

— InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jnkha/advice_for_final_expense_startup_highvolume_cold/

"I spent my first year in the industry at BL. Fortunately I was in CLT which seemed to be one of the better-ran offices. Management was realistic with us - if you don't work, you don't get paid. If you don't want to do this, don't. There was a lot I learned that I'm very grateful for. Lots of training in Medicare, life, annuities, securities. I was able to parlay that experience for a much higher paying role as a broker elsewhere. 16 months later, put all that experience on a resume and secured a nice position in employee benefits making more than I ever did in 1099, as a w-2. With commissions on top. All of this to say - the 1099 side of personal lines insurance will probably feel scammy wherever you go. You can choose to make less money and use it for the experience, only writing business where you think it's 100% ethical. You will not be a top performer that way. I wasn't. But my head hit the pillow easily every night, never had any compliance issues, and walked away from the position on good terms with everybody because I was a team player there to learn and grow in the industry. Any 1099 position like this is going to dangle the carrot in front of you, using their top performers' books of business as an example. "This guy has been here 10 years and makes over 6 figures off of residuals alone" is one you'll hear often. Congrats to the people who stick around and make it work. But stats show about 92% of people don't stick around after a year."

— InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wn5pwj/do_not_work_for_bankers_life/pbchnca/

"> What is your plan for when the incoming calls stop? As cynical as this sounds - there is no plan. If you have a phone, the calls will never stop coming. The numbers are spoofed, the names are fake, and there is nothing you can do. Even if you're on every blacklist alliance list, DNC, TCPA litigator scrub, etc etc - they all disconnect the calls AFTER the happen. Its annoying and won't end. I can get 100 illegal calls in a day and get zero justice or I can get 100 illegal calls a day, sue on 3-4 of them and get \$10-20 grand worth of justice. This is the world we're living in. The calls will never stop. If they did, I'd have a much higher serenity around here and I could enjoy some of the money I've made over the years. > Can you say with absolute sincerity that you're not taking any action to receive these illegal calls? 100%. I do not sign up for ANYTHING. I sit at home watching TV or scratching myself and the calls come in. I'm too young for medicare, but I get 20+ calls a day for medicare advantage. I'm too young for final expense insurance, I get 30+ a day for final expense. It's insanity. > You sure you're not intentionally putting yourself in a position for opportunities to sue these companies/agents? Am I intentionally putting myself in a position to sue these people, absolutely. The same way a cop running radar that has a really good spot that nobody can see / knows about..... I have a charged gopro handy and I record the incoming calls. Yes, I intentionally prepare myself to get the most leverage and the best evidence capture of illegal telemarketing practices. >I can't tell if you're posting this to be a genuine warning or maybe even bragging... but it actually reads like "Careful about your lead source, or else people without real jobs like me are going to sue you." I've done several settlements with small brokers that have said "we can't pay you what you're asking" and I said that's fine, I'll hold your upline joint and severally liable. Next thing I know, a decent settlement offer comes my way. OR I hire an attorney, they file a class action against the upline, the brokerage, the broker and the agent PERSONALLY and everyone goes to court, the upline spends \$150-200k in defense costs that they subrogate back to the downline via payment plan/docked commissions/what have you and my attorneys add another win to their CV. The message here is that YOU MAY THINK this new lead vendor of yours is all great but if you get burned, you can potentially be involved in bet the company litigation. And this is the WORST kind of litigation to be in because you don't realize you're in bet the company litigation until you've wound up betting the company. >Do what everyone else does and block the numbers that call Not that easy. All the numbers are spoofed. I get calls from the hospital, chevy dealership, etc etc - all displayed on the caller ID that are overseas call centers. Your outlook is 100% flawed. >No I have never been sued by a serial litigator because I only receive direct inbound calls, but I can still cringe at you for bottom feeding You know what's funny? Every single broker I've sued says "we only receive direct inbound calls" - you know why? THE LEAD GEN SPOOFS MY NUMBER, CALLS YOUR BROKERAGE SO YOU CAN CLAIM IT IS AN INBOUND CALL. The only counterbattery is my gopro video."

— InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8y9glc/

"Inbounds suck for a number of reasons: 1. Scam Central: most inbounds are generated in Pakistan and India. Literally the guys scamming your Grandma out of your inheritance are the ones providing inbounds to you, with entry-level scammers starting in lead generation before moving on to ripping off Americans. 2. Legal Pandora's Box: India and Pakistan will not comply to Federal TCPA rules. They will call everyone - even on the DNC - and you, and your upline, bear the legal risk. I had a good agent of mine buy one of these leads earlier this year and had to settle for five figures for just one phone call. 3. Did I Mention They're A Scam? These call centers are known to share client information, list information, and rework the leads over and over again. There are organizations that sell "pre-sold leads," which includes all major information about the client, claiming they call ahead of time to collect the information before passing it along to the agent to sell. Unbeknownst to the agent, they resell this information over and over again and you end up with huge chargebacks. I think Facebook ads are a much more durable, long-lasting, and safe lead generation solution. You own the leads, you control the ad creative, and you have a track record of the client opting in. Plus, you can scale upward to the level you're comfortable with, and can tie in pre-set appointments or call-ins for added benefit. Lastly, if you don't want to do it yourself, there are many good lead management options available that will do all of the above."

— InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oxuubl/is_this_a_good_offer/np4s2v6/

"Aged Leads Store Question about those leads because I don't want to get on anyone's shit list. Are those leads TCPA compliant?"

— InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k24g9p/aged_leads_store/

"Have agencies starting out new agents on aged leads even care about FDNC lists? I had to make a post about this because I used to be in these shoes. Given a list of couple hundred aged leads that were super cheap with no clue about FDNC. After building an agency and going through process of getting compliant leads it makes sense why agencies continue the easy route with cheap aged leads. Instagram ads I'm seeing are about the roadmap with new agents but most of these aged leads are all FDNC and new agents are getting screwed. These 18-19 year olds so excited for a new career just to be hit with a lawsuit or carrier violation because their agency set them up with non-compliant aged lead sheets. So many agencies could be doing right and not trying to make a quick dollar. There is a reason financial service/ insurance industry gets a bad rap when this is how you onboard new agents. When will it end with the bad apples that give this industry a bad rap?"

— InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1w0xb6x/have_agencies_starting_out_new_agents_on_aged/

"What I would do if I were you: 1. Scrub your data against a litigator and changed number list on a regular basis. 2. Get Convoso. Kixie is OK. Most other dialers are terrible. Connection rate is everything. 3. Move out of New York. You cannot get contracted in New York with American Amicable as a New York resident. AmAm is arguably the best final expense telesales carrier available. Answers to your questions: 1. Maybe. Biggest levers to get best results: 1. Script and skillset 2. Dialer to maximize connection rates. 2. See above. 3. Convoso only. 4. Stay away from DSNP. 5. 100% TCPA compliance adherence. 6. Set daily activity goals. Consider bonuses/rewards for hitting call/conversion goals."

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jnkhia/advice_for_final_expense_startup_highvolume_cold/mko7utp/

"I do an educational only call. "Medicare 101", just an overview of the program and supp vs mapd etc. Not breaking any rules there. Then get SOA and schedule follow up call to talk details"

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1g3w4zk/how_to_handle_prospect_call_before_scope_of/sajuu2/

"> It's a bit funny that the only thing you didn't acknowledge in my comment was the fact that you don't just get a regular job. ACTUALLY I worked in commercial finance for years + ran 3 small businesses so there's that. I actually got fired from the finance company partly because I couldn't get any work done with my home phone ringing 50 times before lunch. >There's absolutely no way you can convince me that you're making ZERO action to receive these calls. You're not getting 100's of illegal calls by being just a random needle in the haystack, you're intentionally seeding your number(s) out there. Of course the jig is up if you'd ever confess that, but also the calls would stop too and then there goes your income. Believe what you want to believe, but I feign interest to see who buys the lead and that's that. I do not opt in anywhere. >you're intentionally seeding your number(s) out there. I do no such thing and I dare anyone to prove that I do. >Of course the jig is up if you'd ever confess that, but also the calls would stop too and then there goes your income. I don't want the money. I want the calls to stop. Since the calls won't stop, I will take the money. >We all get random calls from shady oversea call centers. Will I get 2-3 of these calls on a bad day? Yes. Do I decide to engage the call, pretend to be interested so I can sue the American receiver of the illegal transfer who is likely unaware this call was generated illegally? Absolutely not. img-wouldbealotcoolerifyoudid.jpg >You're trying to call it justice but it's just not. TCPA/DNC laws are set up to protect regular consumers, especially vulnerable ones like seniors, not to create a side hustle for bottom feeders like you. I'd be willing to bet when you find a carrier/brokerage/agent who's willing to fight you instead of just throwing you a couple of bucks to save the legal fees - you drop the suit because you don't want this going to discovery. Believe what you want to believe. I don't opt in for ANYTHING and I'm on every single marketing database known to man. Landline is 40+ years old, same address. Cell is 20+ years old same subscriber Registered voter, property owner, business owner, etc etc. The dataminers have enough out there on me that I don't need to opt in for a single goddamn thing for them to already know me Oh and I guess I'll clarify that I'm a carrier rep, my calls come from our own marketing. We don't use third parties at all. I fight and litigate EVERY single suit until summary judgement/jury verdict. Don't put words in my mouth."

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8ygvfc/

"New Medicare Insurance agent with questions ​ ​ My name is Robert and I am a licensed insurance agent contracted through Cigna as my only carrier. I am interested in learning more about your leads and how I can partner with you to sell Cigna Medicare plans. ​ I understand that Medicare can be confusing, and I want to make sure that I am providing my clients with the best possible service. I have a few questions that I would like to ask you: ​ Can I walk a client through the [Medicare.gov](https://www.Medicare.gov) website and refer them to an agent who is licensed to sell the product that is the best deal for them? Can I make sure that a client does not have a group health plan, has Medicare, and that their doctor and prescriptions are covered? Can I explain plan benefits and costs, and compare Cigna plans to other plans that might cost less? Can I mention that another plan might be a better fit for a client, or try to compare Cigna plans to other plans that might be better for them? Can I offer them a referral to see someone who is licensed to sell the plan that may be better for them? Can I invite them to talk to me about Medicare 101 through email, then get an SOA to talk to them about Cigna? Should I just sell them the plan that is the best fit for them out of the products that I'm licensed to sell? I'm trying to imagine what my plan is, but I can't find any good scripts or guidance for selling Cigna. I want to gain clients through an email list that isn't specifically targeting Medicare and through Next Gen Leads. I understand that Medicare has a lot of rules, and I am not here to challenge them. I am here to ask questions to help me better understand how I can work with you to provide my clients with the best possible service. ​ Thank you for your time and consideration. ​ ​"

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/17j8bis/new_medicare_insurance_agent_with_questions/

"How are you working aged leads and keeping TCPA compliant? I'm genuinely interested. I stopped working aged leads 4 years ago after I saw a bunch of agents get fined."

— InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/m9ley0w/

"Depends on what you're selling but they're not typically very responsive, and I'd avoid them personally. A lot of aged leads aren't even TCPA compliant much less FCC 1, which means one complaint to the DOI and you could be facing a lawsuit, license suspension/revocation, etc. When we ran a dialer it was about a 0.8% conversion rate on 30 day+ leads and about 0.2% on 365+ leads. Interestingly enough the 3-30 day leads were just as bad, my running theory is that a lot of those 3-30 day people are getting blown up by agents or just not in the mindset to buy at the time, but after 30 days the calls start to die down, they're in a clearer head space, and they're more receptive. I've spoken to many clients who just were overwhelmed and only responded to me because it had been a few weeks and things weren't as hectic."

— InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pmr7pi/how_are_we_generating_leads_going_into_2026/nu3qz9h/

ACA marketplace suspensions and enrollment-fraud fallout · 4 documents

"If I contract, will I get fillable forms the consent forms? What about for recording? would not the CRM automatically record calls? I also need this recordings for Medicare as well I am probably going to buy if its workable depending on few other questions I gave you about leads What is voice consent with that just be the easiest way to do it?"

— YouTube · 🔥 ACA Agents: This Sales Script Closes More Obamacare Clients (Copy & Paste) 🗨️ · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cL.RWdaqypkc&lc=UgzFPjoJDBVsQUI7VN54AaABAq>

"ABC said: I called to speak with them and no one was available, I am really suspect since they are an Insurance Agency now. I don't think they are an insurance agency. I did some research and I think its a startup and they are running it out of their house. The owner has 2 jobs, check him out on Linked In. I want to know what happens a week later with the app. And a week after that with the feed to the carriers. I want something in writing that they aren't stealing my clients. (Which probably won't do any good, but it will make me feel better) For this year, I will probably use them on my webpage and also to send to people when I have run out of time. But not for people I am running the clients on via join.me"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Health Sherpa New Portal For Agents Working On the Exchange · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/health-sherpa-new-p-ortal-for-agents-working-on-the-exchange.66461/#post-874324>

"Yes. I just had the first one terminated by the Marketplace for not sending in income verification documentation. This person is self employed; owns a flooring company. His adjusted gross income for 2014 was \$50,000. His taxes are with the tax accountant now. He is out of the country with no insurance. He does not know his income for 2015 yet. He thinks it may be higher. I called the Marketplace. They insist they have to have a bank statement; something. They said there was a discrepancy in his income. I was wondering how long it would take for this to begin? Now, I know."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Can Marketplace Health Insurance Terminate for Not Sending In Documents? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/can-mar-ketplace-health-insurance-terminate-for-not-sending-in-documents.73346/#post-971669>

"MaryDallas said: Yes. I just had the first one terminated by the Marketplace for not sending in income verification documentation. This person is self employed; owns a flooring company. His adjusted gross income for 2014 was \$50,000. His taxes are with the tax accountant now. He is out of the country with no insurance. He does not know his income for 2015 yet. He thinks it may be higher. I called the Marketplace. They insist they have to have a bank statement; something. They said there was a discrepancy in his income. I was wondering how long it would take for this to begin? Now, I know. Click to expand... Why would they cancel coverage? Why not just terminate the subsidy? The income has zero to do with their health insurance (other than if they receive the cost sharing subsidy)."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Can Marketplace Health Insurance Terminate for Not Sending In Documents? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/can-marketplace-health-insurance-terminate-for-not-sending-in-documents.73346/#post-971722>

FMO / upline lock-in and release fights · 109 documents

"Why i left the life insurance industry Here is the story as to why I left the life insurance industry as a whole and I'm going to let my license expire on December 31st, 2024. I saw somewhere that you can make 10k a month selling life insurance. I was hooked. I took the pre-licensing course and got my state license. I then got with an agency and the recruiter told me that the leads were exclusive and pre-qualified meaning I didn't have to do any cold calling or door knocking. I was even more hooked. This seemed too good to be true. I start working at the agency and the first alarm bell goes off in my head. I have to pay for leads. I asked my spline about this and he said the reason they cost money is because they are high quality leads. I said hm okay, so I purchased them. Turns out the leads were aged, recycled, and most of them claimed to never have shown an interest in life insurance, including usage of foul language and making threats to get law enforcement involved. I made no money, helped no families and was extremely dissatisfied. And mind you, my upline told me that the leads were exclusive and the best in the industry. What. Lie. I left that agency and got with another one. They also told em the same thing as the previous agency. No cold calling, no door knocking, we provide you with the best high quality leads in the industry with a blah blah closing ratio. Once again, the leads cost money but this time they were 1 month old instead of 3. I said hm okay, what can go wrong? Well, turns out that this agency was worse than the previous one. Once again despite me being told that the leads were high quality, I got ghosted a lot, cancelled appointments, loss of interest due to not being able to afford it, people claiming that they had never shown an interest in life insurance, insulting me and making threats over the phone. The whole thing was even worse than working retail during holiday season. This time, I lost \$1,000 buying E&O coverage, fingerprint background check, and overpriced leads that ended up not even working out. This is when reality hit me that this is not an industry I want to be in. At this point in my career I had felt the dirtiest I had ever felt and I wasn't even making any money to justify it. I was LOSING money while being treated like garbage by angry prospects. I rage quit that job. I ended up going to a THIRD agency because "third time's a charm". This company did not make you pay for leads, however, it had a very similar business structure as Herbalife and amway where you have to recruit. You have to ask your friends, family, neighbors, and social media followers if they are interested in working. Once again, I made no money, people knew it was a pyramid scheme and lost a couple of friends because they didn't want to deal with my sales tactics. This was it. I said I'm done. I'm done with insurance and I'm done with sales. I ended up going back to community college for an associates in I.T (paid for with FAFSA federal pell grants) and I'm also studying for my CompTIA certifications to work in the I.T industry and I could not be happier with my decision. Till this day I still get messages and calls from recruiters trying to hit me with the same "we are seeking licensed agents. No cold calling. We have the most exclusive leads in the industry" & it fills me with so much rage how stupid they think I am to fall for their nonsense again. Insurance sales recruiters are straight up liars and they seem to feel no shame towards it. Finally, a lot of them love to promote the lavish luxury lifestyle to reel people in. I also don't care about that. I am happy with what I have. Family and health is more important to me than some Tesla Model 3."

— LifeInsurance · 83 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/LifeInsurance/comments/1eqgqgk/why_i_left_the_life_insurance_industry/

"New rules (with a slight change) Thank you to everyone that has assisted with helping with the new rules. Here's where we landed, and there is one small tweak: 1. This is not a place to sell your services or generate leads or recruit agents/downlines. Consumers should not get offers to quote or to privately "help". This includes asking people to vet your software/AI or other peripheral concepts as well as advertising your website or app (even if it is currently free). 2. Do not post any unethical, illegal or unhelpful content. 3. Be a good reflection of the industry and remain professional. The difference is in Rule #1, and it is specific to a pattern of behavior of some life agents that have been trying to recruit to some quasi-MLM companies (I say "quasi" because I don't think that any DOI has stated it as a fact). Many of those trying to recruit are doing so with little to no posting history, which makes it very odd. The sidebar will be reflected soon to reflect this, but you should consider that these rules are currently being enforced as of this post. Edit as of 7/23/26 - effective immediately, we're no longer allowing posts that are asking for help with ideas for software, websites, apps or other SaaS concepts. Even if it's currently free, if you're linking people to something of yours, expect it to be removed at a minimum. Even if you're just asking for people to vet an idea, expect it to be removed at a minimum."

— InsuranceAgent · 79 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cdomsd/new_rules_with_a_slight_change/

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

"Why I left the life insurance industry I posted this in r/insurance but i'm going to post it here too. Here is the story as to why I left the life insurance industry as a whole and I'm going to let my license expire on December 31st, 2024. I saw somewhere that you can make 10k a month selling life insurance. I was hooked. I took the pre-licensing course and got my state license. I then got with an agency and the recruiter told me that the leads were exclusive and pre-qualified meaning I didn't have to do any cold calling or door knocking. I was even more hooked. This seemed too good to be true. I start working at the agency and the first alarm bell goes off in my head. I have to pay for leads. I asked my spline about this and he said the reason they cost money is because they are high quality leads. I said hm okay, so I purchased them. Turns out the leads were aged, recycled, and most of them claimed to never have shown an interest in life insurance, including usage of foul language and making threats to get law enforcement involved. I made no money, helped no families and was extremely dissatisfied. And mind you, my upline told me that the leads were exclusive and the best in the industry. What. Lie. I left that agency and got with another one. They also told em the same thing as the previous agency. No cold calling, no door knocking, we provide you with the best high quality leads in the industry with a blah blah closing ratio. Once again, the leads cost money but this time they were 1 month old instead of 3. I said hm okay, what can go wrong? Well, turns out that this agency was worse than the previous one. Once again despite me being told that the leads were high quality, I got ghosted a lot, cancelled appointments, loss of interest due to not being able to afford it, people claiming that they had never shown an interest in life insurance, insulting me and making threats over the phone. The whole thing was even worse than working retail during holiday season. This time, I lost \$1,000 buying E&O coverage, fingerprint background check, and overpriced leads that ended up not even working out. This is when reality hit me that this is not an industry I want to be in. At this point in my career I had felt the dirtiest I had ever felt and I wasn't even making any money to justify it. I was LOSING money while being treated like garbage by angry prospects. I rage quit that job. I ended up going to a THIRD agency because "third time's a charm". This company did not make you pay for leads, however, it had a very similar business structure as Herbalife and amway where you have to recruit. You have to ask your friends, family, neighbors, and social media followers if they are interested in working. Once again, I made no money, people knew it was a pyramid scheme and lost a couple of friends because they didn't want to deal with my sales tactics. This was it. I said I'm done. I'm done with insurance and I'm done with sales. I ended up going back to community college for an associates in I.T (paid for with FAFSA federal pell grants) and I'm also studying for my CompTIA certifications to work in the I.T industry and I could not be happier with my decision. Till this day I still get messages and calls from recruiters trying to hit me with the same "we are seeking licensed agents. No cold calling. We have the most exclusive leads in the industry" & it fills me with so much rage how stupid they think I am to fall for their nonsense again. Insurance sales recruiters are straight up liars and they seem to feel no shame towards it. Finally, a lot of them love to promote the lavish luxury lifestyle to reel people in. I also don't care about that. I am happy with what I have. Family and health is more important to me than some Tesla Model 3."

— InsuranceAgent · 46 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dt0fnh/why_i_left_the_life_insurance_industry/

"Legit life insurance wfh job I recently took a job with primerica not realizing it was an mlm after the fact I'm following through and getting my licensing because they provided that but after that does anyone have any legit recommendations for an entry level wfh not mlm insurance company I don't mind them being 1099 but I don't want to have to spend a lot on leads when I'm just learning"

— InsuranceAgent · 42 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f816tw/legit_life_insurance_wfh_job/

"Are there ANY truly "good" life insurance companies to work for?? I'm in the process of getting my license, so still very new to the biz. I've read the horror stories of truly bad MLM-like companies and am staying away from those (although strangely, they seem to have their fair share of happy employees), so I did a very basic Google search of "The Best Life Insurance Companies to Work For." I got answers like Northwestern, Mutual of Omaha, New York Life, etc. So I go to Glassdoor & Indeed to read employee reviews, and those are just as all over the place as the MLMs! "Best company in the world, changed my life", "Shit leads, non-existent training, if you don't meet production goals you're fired". My question is: How do I know where the truly GOOD companies are if all the reviews are like this? I just want an entry-level role to get my feet wet, aiming for \$80k/yr in the first couple years. Nothing crazy. Thanks for any advice!"

— InsuranceAgent · 41 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/164ik21/are_there_any_truly_good_life_insurance_companies/

"NEVER work or get life/health through Globe Life 🌐 Worst recruiting experience I have ever had, didn't help with getting license at all, lead me on for weeks, paid everything out of pocket, had to have gallbladder removed right after starting and they told me to kick rocks. Just got off the phone with regional manager yelling and cussing me and they told me because I missed part of training and had a second job (security night shift) that I wasn't committed enough and should go to a fuck that "committed" agents are a dime a dozen and they could hire any loser to fill my spot they didn't need me. I have 15+ years sales management and experience I even was on finals for the next great American speak off and I get treated like another entry level sales rep. Even in training they were more focused on the sale rather than the customer. I got into life/health to help people not suffer the same fate I did due to having an emergency hip replacement last year in May. It ruined me financially and cost me my business in adventure tourism. I just wanted to spread knowledge on the importance of coverage and actually get customers what they need, not just get their money for my own benefit like Globe Life's primary focus. I'm just pissed right now, dumped money I really couldn't afford at the time on the things I needed to be successful, the class, the license, everything and for nothing. Now I don't even know what to do with this license because 99% of the recruiters I talk to are still just wanting people for MLM crap or straight up scams. Just wanted to rant, if anyone sees this that is legit contact me. If you put me in a position to take EVERY contract from my local globe life offices I will make it my personal mission to take their business."

— InsuranceAgent · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1irtig7/never_work_or_get_lifehealth_through_globe_life/

"Is a Life & Health Insurance License Useless? 🤔 I've had a Life & Health Insurance license for 2 weeks. It feels useless for finding a job. All the local captive agents focus on Property & Casualty. They like seeing L&H but they don't sell any. Even if they advertised for a L&H position. I applied to local banks and credit unions. I'm a nobody too but heard nothing back. A recruiter from Brown & Brown reached out. She liked my resume and experience a lot. B2B Sales and Marketing, Tradeshows, SEO, etc. She has no job for me. I've had Life Insurance and Medicare outfits calling me. All commission based. They sound like scams and MLMs. I've tried getting an Employee Benefits Advisor job but these seem rare. Ideally I'd like to work at a hospital and help people choose health plans. Applied with health insurance companies. Haven't heard back. Are L&H license useful at all? What should I do to find a job? UPDATE - The Kaplan training I did was part of a hiring process for a Financial Services company. They paid with no strings attached as part of the final hiring process. They ended up not hiring me even after I passed the test. The goal was to do SIE and other FINRA certs. UPDATE 2 - Many of you are saying just go get a Property & Casualty license via DM. Yes would be good to do but I don't have a ton of money right now. Would much prefer to get a job that will pay for my P&C training and licensing. I was thinking of just watching Melissa from Insurance Exam Queen. She and Peter were so valuable for passing the L&H test."

— InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lavqn1/is_a_life_health_insurance_license_useless/

"Buying an Independent Insurance Agency I am interested in purchasing my own independent agency and currently in the process of researching what that entails. Background: I currently work for a family agency where I am 3rd generation. My grandfather started the business, and I work under my dad and alongside my siblings. I have been at the agency for 5 years. I thought that it was fixable, but things are not going the way I hoped. There is always a ton of family drama that spills into the workplace, and it is a very unprofessional environment that drives me crazy. I am the only one who has outside work experience (previously an engineer for 10 years). Everyone else came straight to the agency and lacks very common and important real-life skills. Managing a calendar, Microsoft office knowledge, how to communicate effectively (to carriers, customers, and co-workers), etc... I come from a sales background so managing a pipeline and working with business owners or homeowners comes naturally. I've also been managing marketing, accounting, and day-to-day business operations, referral commercial lines quoting, CL renewals and networking for the agency. 90% of the daily decisions are made by me and then my father just blindly signs off on them because he is the principal and checked out (ready to retire). I have transitioned the agency to a new AMS, new accounting software, and transitioned most of our book away from agency bill. I have successfully increased efficiency by taking our 8-person agency down to 3.5 people. No one was fired, we had old staff and everyone retired. I thought we were going to be able to work together as siblings and run the agency, I was wrong. I tried a couple times to sit everyone down individually and talk about goals, dream responsibilities, and other things that would help align all our visions but am always met with "I dunno", or "I don't care", or "This is stupid, stop trying to make this a corporate office". Anytime there is a disagreement there is either a huge fight or one sibling goes to our mom who manipulates my dad into making the decision behind our back. I am looking for guidance from agency owners or industry veterans. What mistakes did you make when starting out or how would you do it differently now. 1. I am not interested in a captive agency 2. I understand PE acquisitions are at an all-time high but there are a good number of small mom and pop shop agencies around with limited succession planning (Ohio) 3. I understand getting a new carrier appointment right now during the hard market is very difficult if not currently impossible, but I will weigh the agencies current carrier selection very carefully 4. I understand this is a HUGE undertaking and the YEARS of work it will require Thank you in advance"

— InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l48ryh/buying_an_independent_insurance_agency/

"Beware of MLM structured companies (warning) So this was originally a response to a comment on this sub, but I see a ton of new people coming into insurance, (speaking to independent guys here) and there are many many hungry wolves waiting to recruit these naïve noobs and make a profit. So, I figured I could make a post using some of the content from my previous response to explain the caveats and expose the reality of these places. I come from a MLM originally, it was unbenounced to me at the time, but I'm still grateful because it gave me a first hand glance at what goes on there. How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. They will push you to build a team, because hey, don't you wanna make 6 figures "bro"??? Well then you gotta build a huge team so you get all those overrides off the guys under you. Now, there's nothing wrong necessarily with building a team, but in a MLM context and the way they act in a deceptive manner it is extremely unethical. The guys you see writing 100k plus in premium a year??? A fraction of that fell off the books and was a chargeback, then that guy like all of us has to pay taxes at the end of the year. He also probably was buying \$500 worth of leads a week. Burned gas every day meeting clients. He *maybe* profited 40k that year, and that's being generous. But as long as they can show boat how much premium they're writing a week? A month? A year? Then shove the rhetoric down new guys throats, boasting about how they too can make 100k a year? Then they're all good. I found out through a credible source, as well as David Dufford (has a youtube channel, good tips and insight for insurance) that alot of these "top producers" buy the trips that you can win with insurance carriers for writing a lot of AP. They do all of this and sugar coat their actual earnings because you'll buy the dream, go sell sell sell, and the guys above you get all the overrides off of you without investing any of their money into you at all. It's a fucking amazing model for the guys at the top to make a killing. They create a strong sense of family at those places to keep you on board as well. They push shitty products like Americo a ton too, because they get higher commissions off of that. Americo is also pricey, and you can easily find a cheaper product for that senior to actually help them out, but more than likely they won't have many cheap options that actually are economical for the client, because then you, and them get a lower commission. So MLM's will typically encourage you to get a higher premium out of the client and force a pricey carrier on them. Hope this helps. Reputable, ethical IMO's that offer you high commission contracts and don't push you to build teams are harder to find, because they don't market and recruit. Join an insurance forum, those guys are veterans and a lot of the IMO/Brokerage owners are members there. I've been in Life Insurance for a while now, and am branching into Health/Medicare, so anyone can feel free to PM me with Life Insurance questions if you'd like. Also it would be cool to maybe post any experiences you've had with these types of organizations."

— InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/n4hblb/beware_of_mlm_structured_companies_warning/

"How is everyone marketing in 2025 without spending a fortune? For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down. Since, I've tried multiple vendors, and I've tried data leads + telemarketers. It feels like no matter what I do, I have to spend 5 grand a month in marketing at least for each of my producers just to hit our goals. It's way too much, and as we spend more to make less, I'm feeling bad burnout as my margins shrink. Primarily P&C, captive agent. So what is everybody doing that's working?"

— InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/

"Is selling life insurance what everyone makes it out to be? All over my social media page I am seeing 20 years olds post that they are making 10k or more a month by selling life insurance. I know that there a chargebacks, buying leads, and its commission only, but is it actually worth getting into? I feel like all the companies are MLM's and that they are only posting this content to recruit people to join."

— InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1t35kdo/>

"Overall there's just less chatter about Medicare here. I feel like majority of users in this sub are P&C agents, followed closely by the MLM Life Insurance folk. Could just be a demographic thing. Reddit users tend to be of the younger generations and maybe the majority of Medicare reps are all chatting in those cesspool Facebook groups."

— InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/n565vur/

"New agent planning to become an independent broker — looking for a remote, non-captive IMO (want to avoid mistakes). Need suggestions. I'm a college student getting licensed soon and I want to make sure I don't make the wrong choice with my first IMO. My long-term goal is to be an independent broker, not captive, so I'm looking for a fully remote, flexible, non-captive IMO that pays directly from carriers, gives day-one vested ownership, and doesn't have an MLM or sink-or-swim environment. I want structured training tied to real leads (not just videos) with a mentorship culture where I can learn through hybrid lead types (live transfers + fresh internet + aged leads). Long term, I want the freedom to stop buying IMO leads and outsource or generate my own once I can close consistently. I care about doing things right, so I want a client-first organization, not a numbers-only pressure model. I'll start with life insurance only, then expand into annuities after I build skill. Any IMO recommendations that fit this? Any industry advice is appreciated as I work toward becoming a fully independent broker, thank you! 🙏"

— InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · new or aspiring agent · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ptfb0n/>

"Is it me or is it my agency? Hi Reddit, I have been with my captive agency for 6 months as a Producer. I am now on a PIP and currently looking for a position as a CSR which I think might suit me better if my agency's standards for sales are pretty much the industry standard. I am not provided any leads, aged or live or info-only. They told me awhile ago they would like me to sell about 80,000-100,000 in premium a month ideally. I just don't see how that can be possible with just my natural market and going to dealerships/mortgage lenders/apartments and networking (which I have been doing) I don't live in a super huge city either like Houston/LA. I feel like if this is what most agencies expect I need to let the idea of making a Sales Producer my career go. So reddit, what would you do in my situation?"

— InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1t88v96/>

"I am a captive agent and this is the best What, Where, How of explanations I've seen anywhere. It is bookmarked so I can review in many times."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=Ugw7egC7OJvuRYAZuFF4AaABAg>

"First off, get the MLM idea out of your head. The whole insurance industry is built upon uplines and downlines that is fully commission based. If you want a salary, you'll have to find an agency (whose commission based and has an upline) that'll pay you something fixed. Tough to find something like that for L&H compared to P&C. FE is great for upfront funds, but know that there can be quite a few chargebacks, so 30% of your commissions should go into a side-account to pay for these until you get your lead saturation up and your sales skill level established. Yes, Medicare is a grind unless you know how to cross-sell ancillary, then it's better than FE. In fact I recommend this track for newer FE agents: 1. Contract with someone that can train you and gives you fair contracts 100+% for FE and 20% for Medicare Supplements. 2. Get leads (facebook and direct mail) EVERY week in the same 50 sq mile area, and work them hard, spend 40 hours a week in the field, getting in front of as many people as possible. Build up a saturation level so that when you invariably door knock your leads and they say no or they're not home, you can just simply go two streets down and knock the guy you could never get ahold of a month or two ago. 3. Take some sample lead info and put it into a Medicare Quoting tool and find out whose competitive in your area for supplements, advantage plans etc. Start building your Medicare knowledge up. Of course, first past the AHIP so you have a base understanding for it. Just a few hours a week can help build up a wealth of knowledge. Once you understand how everything works, any changes to plans, companies or Medicare itself is easily assimilable - whereas there's no changes to FE usually. 4. Tell every lead you'll follow up with them in September to schedule a meeting in October to go over their Medicare options - because you do that too. If you don't sell anyone any FE, that's ok, offer to contact them in September for their Medicare, you "help seniors save money on their prescriptions and get extra benefits at no cost to them." If you paid for the lead, might as well get as much use out of them. 5. Selling FE sucks in November to December, the holidays. It's way easier to work with warm leads, sell them Medicare, and also increase your persistency lapse rate on your FE policies as well as bring in tons of referrals and get paid 2x as you would've just selling an FE policy. You could have enough leads to keep you busy all AEP, so that when that ends, you have a 2 week lull before New Years where you can start the whole cycle up again. THIS is the secret to making big bucks imo. Cody and Dave are good guys, Dave helped me out when I was where you were at, 12 years ago. He comes on here sometimes, haven't seen Cody on here yet."

— InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/svjgsv/help_i_passed_accidenthealth_and_life_now_im/hxgcw8n/

"Primerica, World Financial Groups, and other MLMs So currently I work with an independent financial advisor, we are under an RIA and an FMO that gives us insurance product access. I have been in the business for a few short years starting out with a larger insurance firm, then eventually into a wealth management firm. So I've been around the insurance and financial services block. How do you guys deal with these agents from these MLMs? I just found out my Aunt is in it and she's trying to recruit me to WFG. While I don't consider them competition, they are getting annoying. They also seem to really go after colored communities. I was in the North Jersey/NYC area talking to community leaders that I was reconnecting with. And the first thing they say is, "You're not with Primerica or WFG, right?:" There is enough distrust in the insurance and banking industry in general, and these MLM outfits make it worse."

— Insurance · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/Insurance/comments/b8o8hz/primerica_world_financial_groups_and_other_mlms/

"Do you know of any health insurance companies who pays their captive agent on an per hourly basis plus commissions? I just started with mine and its only 100% commission based, so for starters who dont have yet their clientele, money is a struggle. Do you have any advices?"

— YouTube · How Much Does A Health Insurance Agent Makelbeingbougie · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RrGUFRdgtZY&lc=UgzzDyeN1Egxb-37nx4AaABAg>

Wanting to quit: rejection, hang-ups, burnout · 21 documents

"Update: Being let go from a toxic agency turned out to be the best thing that could have happened to me As you can see from my original post, I received a lot of negative comments. To be fair, I posted less than an hour after being let go and was extremely emotional. I should have taken some time to calm down before posting. That being said, I still stand by the main point of my post: a toxic workplace is not something anyone should be expected to tolerate simply because an industry can be stressful. The insurance field is not "too hard" for me. I have dealt with difficult customers throughout my entire working career. I have been yelled at, hung up on, spoken down to, and blamed for things outside of my control. That comes with working with the public. However, your boss should not tell you to "shut the hell up before I get nasty with you" in front of your coworkers, especially over a routine replacement or add-on — and especially when you did not make a mistake to begin with. In this situation, it was actually a replacement, and my former boss was the one who had it wrong.(never got that apology from him lol) After I formally addressed the way I was spoken to, the situation became retaliatory. My separation letter included five days as though I had called out repeatedly, when those were days I had asked to delay my original start date so I could handle personal matters and begin the following week with a clear schedule. I even found the email confirming that discussion. I was going to remind him of that by replying to the separation letter with that email, but at this point, I decided to leave it alone and move forward. And that brings me to the real update: To everyone who told me to look into working for an independent agency: **thank you**. I start my new position on Monday. It is much closer to the type of work I was doing before , but with an independent agency. I was told that others in the industry were already familiar with the turnover issues at my former office, which helped remind me that my experience was not simply a reflection of my ability to succeed in insurance. My new position includes: **A \$7,900 salary increase** Benefits beginning after 30 days A one-hour lunch instead of 30 minutes Five eight-hour workdays No weekends Paid nationwide holidays The employer covering 90% of the health insurance premium Looking back, being fired by that office may have been the best thing that could have happened to me. To anyone who said the insurance field was not for me: standing up for yourself does not mean you are incapable of doing your job. Refusing to accept humiliation, harassment, or retaliation does not make you lazy, overly sensitive, or full of excuses. If you wake up every morning wondering what the yelling, condescending remarks, or unnecessary criticism will be about that day, start looking for another job. I am not talking about someone who simply dislikes working or cannot accept constructive feedback. I am talking about people who work hard, are genuinely being treated poorly and starting to question their own abilities because of it. The insurance industry is huge. One toxic workplace does not represent the entire field, and one difficult boss does not determine your future. Sometimes one door shuts so that a much better one can open. **Thank you, independent agencies!"**

— InsuranceAgent · 34 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ty3ilq/update_being_let_go_from_a_toxic_agency_turned/

"How is everyone marketing in 2025 without spending a fortune? For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down. Since, I've tried multiple vendors, and I've tried data leads + telemarketers. It feels like no matter what I do, I have to spend 5 grand a month in marketing at least for each of my producers just to hit our goals. It's way too much, and as we spend more to make less, I'm feeling bad burnout as my margins shrink. Primarily P&C, captive agent. So what is everybody doing that's working?"

— InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/

"Depending on what state you're in, we're in the middle of a lot of rate increase. Can't do much about it realistically but I took as much of that off of my CSR's as I could and did it myself (review/explanation/solutions). Do I feel burned out? Yea but my name is on the door and my CSRs haven't left and morale is good. We do what we can and don't get overwhelmed with things we can't control. Better for me to do the "tough" stuff than them IMO because I can't afford for them to get burned out and quit."

— InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gagmgg/23_years_in_this_business_and_ive_never_seen/nz6ed67/

"If they fired you after two weeks then that's not the type of company you want to work for, Medicare is an endurance test the only way someone fails is if they get fired or give up. As an independent it's a little scrappier, you eat what you kill so to speak. You do earn monthly passive income off of your sales as well as new commission but if you don't sell you don't get paid. Find a good FMO and up-line who actually cares. It's hard at times, the industry is chaotic right now, I want to quit all the time but the money is great and the relationships you build with your clients are priceless. 10/10 would recommend going independent."

— InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oezwib/just_got_fired/nl629qgw/

"Unfortunately, just happens very often. That's why most people don't make it in industry. If your license, and want an actual job, look for a job instead of running your own business. When you're a 1099 commission only, it's a business. I would much rather work somewhere where I'm getting some type of paycheck and have benefits to start. I have never been great at prospecting and I've been in sales pretty much my entire life. I've made low six figures in several different types of sales including insurance, but always on the W2 side. I've also realize that I do much better in an inbound environment. I'm more of a consultant and a closer. I'm not a Hunter. Nothing wrong with commission. But when you're 1099 and contracted, they really don't have to do anything. There are some legitimate places, but you have to either buy Leads or prospect. Or you can do what many people like myself did, and get a W2 Job where you're getting paid to base plus commission. People don't realize that benefits, social, security, tax, retirement savings, all those things add up, so you have to make way more money as a 1099 "employee" versus a w2 position. It's not difficult to make a minimum of 65,000 year and a W2 Job and the insurance industry. In fact, I know. Plenty of people who make 125,000 or more a year. I also also plenty of people who can't make it because of the KPIs and the burnout. I would never work for free. Well, never again because we've all fall for the sales pitch. I keep saying this and Will keep saying it, you're not being hired. You're being recruited. You have to interview them. It's so different than a traditional W2 Job, where they actually interview you. Most these places will hire anyone. That's breathing with the license."

— InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wlnr8v/pulling_my_hair_out/pb0bm9o/

"I hate my job 100%. My agency is so desperate we just sign any and all ghetto lead sources that send us the worst of the worst for leads. Carriers have restrictions so we can barely sell, yet we have big sales goals put on us."

— InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1bogj6l/how_is_everyone_handling_burnout_during_these/kx4smcf/

"They are gonna say "oh yeah, we got a lot of hot internet leads and in-bound calls. We usually give the warm-leads to the juniors to cut their teeth." The fact of the matter is you're gonna be grinding cold calls for months to a couple years, you will have to show activity s until you get decent leads. Occasionally you'll get some hot transfers; then once in a blue moon a bunch of hot leads will fall in your lap because everybody got too busy, somebody quit, or you happen to call a cold lead who was just about to turn hot. Honestly, the book Fanatical Prospecting is a solid quick read to prepare you for the cold call mindset. It's pretty straight forward, practical, and easy to remember. Its so practical that it sounds like you should already know these things about prospecting LOL. It'll help you workflow your calls for the day and qualify leads so you don't burn out on dead leads. Unless you're lucky, most agents won't teach you how to prospect, they'll teach basic selling techniques, presenting the product and maybe, maybe teaching you how to effectively close. Prospecting is an important technique and skill to learn, it extends past the phone and you'll start to see everyday situations to potentially to prospect for future customers."

— InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wl6371/i_just_became_licensed_in_pc_shortly_becoming/pawdym3/

"Seeking advice as a new agent, struggling Hi guys. I recently got into the industry, i've been in sales my whole life and i figured i'd pick this up quickly. Last month i bought my first 40 leads, closed 3 of them, thought it would all be sweet from there and locked myself into a lead subscription. The next 100 leads i ordered were different. They're supposed to come in live but the vendor started delivering them in batches at 3am, clearly something changed. Out of those 100 I barely even made any contacts and I was just getting told to fuck off. i paid \$24 each for these and later found out someone in my IMO owns the lead vendor which is why they sent me there. then i tried to launch my own ad campaigns but meta auto flagged me (they thought I was AI?) and now im not allowed to run facebook ads, cant appeal. i tried hiring an ads company but they said their hands are tied since i'm banned from meta. my upline isn't much help as he's honestly not doing that well either even though it was made to seem that way when i was recruited. on top of that i was started at 80 comp which i'm told is low, and i really get paid about 65% depending on the carrier contract. I genuinely do like this industry, i'm not against cold calling and i'm not against risking my own money if it comes with this level of freedom. I certainly don't want to quit but right now I'm negative. my question is, where do i go from here? should i switch IMOs for a better commission structure? from there where do i get leads if vendors aren't genuine and meta wont let me appeal my ad account? google ads? do i just pivot to medicare? any advice would be appreciated or if any of you have experienced similar things."

— InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1t9nf3b/seeking_advice_as_a_new_agent_struggling/

"I cold call people who expressed an interest in receiving more info about Medicare plans and quality them and send them to an agent. I'm a licensed agent as well. My problem is I had a stroke and my words don't come out as smoothly as I'd like them to. I've been yelled at by many people on the phone because I can't always get my words out because of nerves and anxiety on the phone. I'm about to quit. Any advice for me?"

— YouTube · Live Dialing Insurance Leads! [Final Expense Insurance] · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RL6Y5qig0Wg&lc=Ugy8EEQj7tGos4hGJ3R4AaABAq>

"I've only done a little over a week of actual calls myself. Never regretted any choice so much as the one to go into selling life insurance. Though it's not the angry customers and hang ups that have me burnt out. I had no idea the costs involved in buying leads (on top of licenses), and started this job while already in debt in several areas of life. I'm looking at a foreclosure on my house while barely being able to afford 20 leads a week. Which is too few and only half of what my company expects me to get, and I'm constantly aware of what little money I have left for more leads. I've had very few people even answer the phone (and I call often and have left voicemails), and have yet to get through the first 10 seconds with those few that did, so my confidence has taken a dive. I've made changes to the way respond to those initial objections, I feel I'm better prepared to keep the call going, but I just can't afford to buy more leads to test them out. I'm about to try out a burner in the hopes I can breathe some life into one or two of my old leads and get them to pick up, as well as get the next leads to answer. With all that I might still be able to push through, but having my boss make comments about taking responsibility for ourselves and our destiny, and telling me he took out credit cards when he got started (which I wouldn't be approved for anyway, and already took out my 401k), pretty much led to a meltdown the other day. I'm aware of my shortcomings, and usually good with constructive criticism, but with those I can't control like finances, being told indirectly I'm making excuses has about done me in. Being in on our morning meetings usually gets me pumped and feeling confident but all of a sudden.. it's just gone, and I'm deflated like a balloon. I'm struggling to get back into the mindset I need to be in. Just 20 or so leads a week is costing me \$400, and I'll be almost broke after the next batch I get on Monday, and I just can't escape that thought of what do I do if I don't make a sale. And the live transfers go too fast for me to grab them. They're expensive but at least I would be able to do a presentation and not feel like such a failure so soon after starting. Sorry OP, I'm not very helpful lol. But I feel you. It's not an easy career by any means. I haven't given up but I'm not sure what else I can do when the money runs out. I feel like motivational books might be helpful for you though. Before the meltdown (as I already have issues being naturally confident) I was reading "The magic of thinking big" by David Schwartz. It really was helping with motivation and my frame of mind before now. You might give it a go, it can't hurt."

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jxx2oafi_am_burn_out_and_i_just_started_help/mmups74/

"I really suggest starting full time and going with Duford - but they do not take just anyone. Go through all of their YT videos and figure out if this is something you want to do. You will need to be licensed in your state AND you will have to pay to be licensed in 10 other states. After you get your state license you only have to pay a fee to the other states, but it will cost \$600 to \$900 depending on which states. Duford has a free lead service for full timers. That is the best way to start because it gets you fully trained and does not cost anything for leads. Once you start to close sales you can switch to the paid leads. You should be able to 2x or 3x the cost of leads every week, so as long as you have time, you can spend as much as you want and 2x or 3x on your spend. Duford and Globe Life Family Heritage Division both have in-person sales, too. You should be able to close 50% of your in person sales because they are usually more motivated, which is why they are letting you in their house. If you are very young, in person may not be the way to go. Regardless, you can still do the free leads full time with Duford to learn and start. Most people fail because they do not make the calls - you need to double and triple dial to get people to answer - and 80 to 90% of the people are not going to remember they asked for information and they are going to hang up on you. After a few weeks of that people get burned out and quit. BUT - if you make 3 to 7 sales per week, you will be on your way to a great income. I have another company I would recommend but I can't do it on here, they would be pissed and I do not know how or if I can DM from Reddit. Bottom line is to save your money for getting all of your state licenses, work free leads until you figure out if this is what you want to do, watch Duford's YouTube videos to learn about the business, figure out if you can stand to be hung up on and yelled at 20 times a day, and get your P and C license, too, so at worst, you can get a job in the local Allstate or State Farm agency and sell car insurance."

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1adi8ew/any_tips_on_succeeding_as_a_health_insurance_agent/kk9tjuf/

"If/when I retire, I think I might copy your setup here because I get these things all the time. Given my job, I can't just not answer the phone when it says "spam call" because it can sometimes be a client (that happens more than you probably think). If I have time, I'll fuck with them, and I've gotten as far as a US agent who hung up on me when I asked for his NPN. One day I'll sit down and memorize the script so that I can do my own damage. If you're hiring off-shore lead generators, I hate you. I don't care what your excuse is. Your vendor is illegally imposing on me, and I don't owe you shit. You and your vendor is making everyone else's life harder so that you can both make a buck. Do better. Down vote me to oblivion if you want. I'm with the OP, and if you're on the side of these assholes, you're the problem. I don't care."

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1saqau4/your_pal_fc_discusses_lead_generators_here_if_you/odxyzor/

"I had a guy scream at me... "I keep getting calls all day! what if I come down there and blow you!? Will you then stop calling me!?" Then he hung up on me. He was fed tf up."

— InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rsznnc/text_exchange_from_a_prospect_who_reached_out_to/oahvpk2/

"Just a back story on my thought process....Market factors and the price offered was hard to pass up. I am in an area of the country where insurance carriers are trying to decrease capacity and they do not want our business. I also had 40 percent of our revenue with one carrier and that carrier is also pulling back in our area. I had three carriers pull out of my agency as well 12 months leading to the sell. After the sell Helene destroyed my area so the market has gotten even worse. Once I sold to PE I realized the leverage they have that I didn't have. My agency was a nice size (2.5 million in rev) but a 1 million book with a carrier isn't what it used to be in an unprofitable area. I have a commitment to my family and this allowed me to achieve my dream as well. If I am an idiot I could run through all my money but at the moment I am comfortable with no debt and a lot of zeros in my account. I did agree to a three year contract known as a work out to get even more money on top of the initial offer. So far I have gotten 1/3 of the additional money. I am hoping to get the remaining 2/3 and then evaluate what I want to do next. If they treat me fairly I may continue but time will tell. Also...If another hurricane hits my area this year or even next I suspect we are heading towards a Florida scenario. I am too old and too burned out to have to tackle that type of marketplace."

— InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kr7bqt/pc_agency_owners/mtgh4s0/

"See, I think we need to keep in mind most people - the "average" "most people" - do not understand much about insurance "at all." I have been reflecting lately on when I was in my 20s and even 30s, I really had no clue. That lady - \$100 says she thinks you decide the rates. When I was 20s, I wouldn't have known any better. I do remember getting auto insurance probably the first time and the agent said "ok so you want comp and collision" and I was like - "ok sure... if that's what I'm supposed to have. Is that what I'm supposed to have?" lol. I literally had no idea what that even meant. I never really thought much else about it until I needed to use it. Same with health insurance. So yeah - I think she probably believe that you absolutely do have a say in what the rates are that you're giving her. Maybe she just needed to hear the words "I really wish I could get you a lower rate. I would if I could to anything about it at all." Maybe it's also just cuz I've worked retail and I'm used to people yelling at me for stuff that has nothing to do with me, lol. It's just the way people are, sorry to say"

— InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r99hmi/is_it_just_me_or_are_we_all_changing/o6d73ag/

"The income potential with insurance is 100% higher than with a vet tech job. So if the work is more satisfying to you with being a vet tech, then absolutely it's such a win. Especially if you can afford to live on that income. But just because you weren't making enough money in the insurance industry at that current point in time, doesn't mean that you wouldn't have worked up to it. It sounds like maybe you worked in the personal division, which has limitations and also has a really high burnout rate. The average commercial lines account manager makes near six figures, more with heavy experience. My only point is that you can make a really good living in the industry, but it does require sacrifices."

— InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rek2rd/be_honest_how_many_of_you_lost_your_soul_in_this/o7l0slm/

"With life and health, it's gonna be a few options. Now they'll be some places where you go more towards the Financial advisor side. Unfortunately, you're a couple months late for health. Everyone was hiring for the Annual enrollment period.. That's what I did for many years. I did get burned out and wanted to do more. But I did make Good money. Unfortunately, there are layoffs every year and every time I was up for promotion. There was a lay off, so I tried to go. Independent again myself. I may eventually go back to being independent one day, but I'm in the process of getting my series 7 and 66 while I get a base salary. It wasn't easy and it took four months of interviewing. After that, I plan on adding on with RICP and CFP. But that's because the company that I'm working for Will pay for it and try to grow with a W2 company. There are plenty of jobs. That will take a lot of work that pay well. I started as a W2, Medicare Agent, and made between 80 and 125,000 a year for the last six years. I wasn't doing that when I went. Independent, though, I had to spend so much money and the training, technology, Support just was so different. You gotta realize they are selling you. There's a few really good independent organizations out there, but it really depends on what you're good at and what you want. Most of them. Don't care because they get paid. Regardless. If you do nothing it doesn't matter to them. I hate MLM structure too so I stay away from those places. How have you spoken to over 50 different places and they all sound amazing, but a few actually follow through."

— InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wlnr8v/pulling_my_hair_out/pb0iw84/

"I agree with you! It's been so much harder. It's nice to see CMS loosen up some of the rules for 2027 but 6 years ago, i was making a lot more money. I am burned out."

— InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1shv3xs/best_company_to_join_for_agents_new_to_medicare/og362z2/

"@WitsEndFL Thanks. I'll now pay special attention to max out of pocket when comparing plans. Some sources say you should start learning about Medicare 6 months before you are eligible, and as much as I hate it, it's true. It's scary to be near the enrollment deadline (whatever it is in relation to when you need your effective date to be, which I'm still not sure, due to unknown processing time after you apply), and you haven't learned enough about a very complicated topic. Just today, I'm learning from a BOOK on Medicare, that I have to produce a birth certificate which I don't even have, before I can sign up. So I have no clue how an agent even signs me up for a plan if I can't yet enroll with the government. One agent I know said Florida was a hugely expensive state for Medicare costs, so I don't know why you're calling their plans good. What prospecting methods did you use? Which ones work? Did you buy people free dinners? Do all the meals pay for themselves in commissions as a result? Did you use powerpoint in restaurant meeting rooms? You hated it, but I would enjoy it as long as the money was there. I've done 100% commission sales before, and only came to hate prospecting it when it didn't pay off after the real estate market tanked. I'm used to speaking in public and enjoy giving presentations. But I'm not paying for 25 dinners at \$20/pop if everybody just eats and leaves. I suspect good agents are eventually making thousands of dollars over time as a result of their meal investments. Some presentations are titled "Medicare Made Simple in 1 hour" which of course is a crock. Medicare is complicated, and you have to memorize a whole book to be able to answer anyone's odd questions. What they mean is, "I can give you a broad overview in 1 hour that barely scratches the surface." It allows prospects a chance to get to know the agent in a group setting, but that's about it. No one walks away remembering all that stuff. If anything, they walk away in a fog. I can already tell it will be much more costly in time, and possibly gas (if you can't get them to drive across town to come into your office) to sell to even half the room, as compared to a canned presentation to 15+ people at once, which is the easy part. The work comes later. But I'm surprised there aren't more people doing the free meal shotgun approach to maximize the hourly income. People I've met at meetings say they get 15-20 telemarketing calls per day, which I've read is against the law. I haven't gotten any. I mainly get junk in the mail, and there's no way to differentiate one agent from the next. Assuming a new agent did well and wanted to keep doing it, what's the minimum numbers of year you'd recommend it takes for the overall process of getting licensed and building up referrals and residuals for the whole thing to be worth it? I'm thinking that if you start young, it's more likely worth it, making more each year. But if you're looking for part-time income after retiring from your main career, it may be too late if you're going to quit in less than 5 years and retire for good. (or die)"

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgwznXpDAJJG44WTG054AaABAg.9lUZZMzAxJm9loB08nfeFK>

"I want to sell health insurance. I work full time and I do not want to quit my full time job (at least not just yet). I just do not know where to start on selling health insurance. I am licensed (health and life). GA."

— YouTube · How To Make Six-Figures Selling Health Insurance! \$ \$ · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=abG7Q3fGe6o&lc=UgzgeB-4dBGCM2qPfeJ4AaABA>

Lead Sources

FMO / IMO lead programs · 417 documents

"State Farm just rewrote 19,000 agents' contracts overnight. If you think a captive book is a retirement plan, read this If you somehow missed it: State Farm is moving all 19,000 of its agents onto a single standardized contract, ending their deferred-comp/retirement program (AIPP), and dropping health insurance for agents and spouses. Agents are reportedly looking at 30–40% less on base commissions depending on contract and book size. I can't believe State Farm disputes that number but hasn't offered its own. The core shift is from getting paid to *retain* a book to getting paid to *write new business*. They also put buyout offers on the table with a Sept 30 deadline. P&C side, I know. But the lesson isn't carrier-specific and it's the thing I keep coming back to: you never actually owned that book. State Farm did. And a 20-year "trailing income" promise is only worth as much as the carrier's willingness to keep paying it which turned out to be "until it's inconvenient." The part that should get every agent's attention is the direction, not the one carrier. Comp is going performance-based across the board, trailing/renewal-style income is getting squeezed, and AI is going to absorb more of the service and retention work that used to justify those trails. The "come build a \$3–5M book and coast" pitch a lot of us were sold is quietly being retired. So I'm genuinely curious how the room sees it: Are you seeing comp pressure at your carrier/IMO too, or is this a State Farm-specific overreach? Does owning your book independently actually protect you here, or is that just trading carrier risk for lead-cost/chargeback risk? For the newer agents is anyone factoring "can they rewrite my deal in 5 years" into where they sign? Not trying to dunk on State Farm agents since a lot of them got blindsided and it's a rough spot. More interested in what this says about where the whole comp model is heading."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend so that I sold 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj5uxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

"Sorry I didn't provide value so I'll do it here: my favorite lead vendors I've used 1. Smart Finaical - seo leads 2. Happy agent - Fb leads 3. Nectar leads are insurance leads for seo and Fb Also if you are an agent your upline or leader should be able to provide you the best sources. Sorry for this I care about you"

— YouTube · The Best Life Insurance Leads For 2024 | My \$500k/Yr Lead Source · 44 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gtXNK0-8f7c&lc=UgxSK3d37gZCBMR8CY54AaABA9z9zPnaAfMyXt9zPrRMljeY8>

"Imo owner now, it when I was independent as a Final Expense and Medicare agent I grossed 500k a year for 7 years in a row and 300k for several years before that. My first year in the business it was 180k. Net was lower, I had to buy my own leads, pay my own business expenses. But I don't know that I ever had more than 100k in expenses a year. I was an exceptionally good agent and I made sure to write business that paid renewals which is how my income grew to be so high."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 30 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3z4tt/how_much_you_earn_as_insurance_agent/hq85spe/

"Brand New Independent Agents This is just a rant post. I find it extremely weird when brand new agents want to be independent but also expect everything to be given to them. The entire point of being independent is that you are the OWNER of YOUR business. If I decided to open to a floral shop, I would have to pay for inventory, supplies, a website, marketing, and anything else that I needed to run my business. I'd be responsible for going out and marketing myself & my business to attract customers. I wouldn't expect to make money if I was only open for a couple of hours a few days a week, because no one else is giving me a paycheck. And if I didn't know how to run a business, I would find someone who could give me the play by play. Not just someone who said they could, but someone who had proof they'd done it. Insurance is no different. New independent agents are constantly complaining about back office fees, that their IMO doesn't provide them free leads, being 1099, and having to actually bust their ass to make money... and after putting forth half ass effort, blame their agency or upline for not making money. If you want a paycheck, to clock out the same time every day, and someone to provide you leads, GO CAPTIVE. This is why most new agents fail because they saw someone on TikTok that told them they could make \$20,000 in a month. Which is POSSIBLE, I have seen it, not fresh out the gate. You don't even know what you're doing yet! And honestly, you already need to have money put back to carry you in the beginning months until you start to make money... that's where you need to start anyway. This isn't a get rich quick scheme. It's a real business that you have to put real work into."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tnmhue/brand_new_independent_agents/

"Warning: My Experience with Symmetry Financial Group – Please Read Before Joining Hey Reddit, I've been in the insurance industry since 2021 and have had success in multiple roles. I know what real mentorship and growth look like. That's why I feel the need to warn others about my experience with Symmetry Financial Group — because it was one of the most toxic, disorganized, and emotionally draining environments I've ever worked in. Here are the biggest red flags I encountered: • The leads are extremely aged. I was handed leads from as far back as 2016. Calling people who haven't requested life insurance info in nearly a decade felt unethical — more like harassment than service. It genuinely made me uncomfortable. • The culture is toxic. Uplines and agency owners frequently humiliate agents on Zoom calls in front of everyone. There's no support — just power plays, ego, and public shaming. • You're not in control of your own business. They make you ask for permission to get licensed in new states, claiming they won't get paid if you get licensed somewhere they aren't. It's controlling and makes no sense if this is "your business." • Shaming over conferences. Can't afford to attend one of their big events? Be ready to get publicly called out and guilted like you're not serious about your career. It's manipulative and unprofessional. • The training is the worst I've seen in this industry. There's no real structure, no proper onboarding, and no consistent support. You're left confused, overwhelmed, and underprepared. • It affected my mental health. I've never struggled with anxiety — not even in high-pressure sales environments — but while working with SFG, I had debilitating anxiety that impacted every area of my life. As soon as I walked away, that anxiety vanished. That tells you everything. The good news? I've since joined a different IMO with real leadership, training, and respect — and I'm flourishing now. This experience taught me that it's not the industry that's the problem — it's the people you align yourself with. If you're thinking about joining Symmetry Financial Group, please think twice. Don't ignore the red flags. You deserve better."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtqo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/

"Has anyone else seen these black market leads going around? Ok so I gotta talk about this because it's getting way too normal and nobody's saying anything. There's these "black market leads" floating around right now that are stupid cheap and come loaded with everything. Like everything. Carrier, coverage amount, draft date, personal info. The agent doesn't even have to prospect. You just call someone who already has a policy and flip them into a new one. Sounds like a cheat code right? It's not. That data is straight up stolen. Breaches, insider leaks, sketchy vendors selling info that was never theirs to sell. This isn't a gray area, it's illegal. Depending on what you actually do with it you're stacking felonies without even realizing it. And half the time the "sale" is just twisting anyway. You're replacing a policy the client already had, restarting their contestability, and usually leaving them worse off, all so somebody can grab a fresh commission. It's crazy how many new agents have no clue what they're holding. Upline hands them a list, says start dialing, and the kid thinks he hit the lottery. Nah. You're the one whose license and voice is on that recorded call. Not them. When is the fraud gonna end lol."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ukowmo/has_anyone_else_seen_these_black_market_leads/

"NYC Im a terrible life insurance agent. Can I sell medicare plans? I've posted before about not being able to sell Life Insurance even though I work for one of the biggest companies. I need to transition into something lucrative yet flexible as I have a child and they have a million days off and school events etc. I thought maybe I could get into health care sales but tons of reddit post say that NY is the worst place for health care sale due to the restrictions. If health care is so restrictive, what does everyone over 65 do for medicare?? I hear about FMOs and IMOs but no one lists the good FMO companies in NYC. Anyway, Im at a loss. I need income and flexibility but I don't know how to get that. Any advice?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f81t9g/nyc_im_a_terrible_life_insurance_agent_can_i_sell/

"What Uplines Don't Want you to Know - Carrier Release Process - Explained This is a question I get a ton from new agents, and its what every upline doesn't want you to learn, so please... learn it. Treat this information like it's required for you to be in the industry to know. Review your contracts with your uplines and make sure you have protection within them as well. Heck, get a lawyer to review it. Whatever it takes, I see too many agents getting trapped in awful comp deals and abusive uplines and get "Stockholm'd" into buying bad leads from them and then gaslighting them into thinking its their fault. I've been there done that. This info is for the agent that calls themselves independent:

Demystifying Agent Contracting, Releases, and Blackout Periods I work directly with 54 carriers, 4 FMOs, multiple agencies, and nearly 1,000 independent agents. My role involves overseeing contracting, licensing, and agent/agency development. With experience spanning so many entities, I've had the chance to see the contracting process from all angles and business models. Let me break it down for anyone who's struggling to navigate this space. # Steps to Understand Contracting and Releases

- 1. Contract Level (LOA vs. Broker):** * If you're directly contracted with a carrier as a truly independent broker *and* haven't signed an agreement restricting you to one entity (or an LOA contract, which assigns your commission to your upline), you should generally be free to contract with another carrier or upline without issues.
- 2. Private Contracts (Non-Competes or No Non-Competes):** * If you're tied to a brokerage or agency and have a private contract (like a non-compete), get a lawyer to review your options. Some of these cannot be upheld in court, that's important for you to know. * Medicare agents may want to wait until the start of the year for a smoother transition —this avoids AEP complications.
- 3. Carrier Blackout Periods:** * **New agents** can contract anytime, even during AEP, for Medicare Advantage (MA) and Medicare Supplement (Med-Supp) plans. * **Switching uplines or FMOs, however, is restricted** during AEP for MA carriers (typically September–December). * If you're contracting with a carrier for the first time, you can get a **new contract** during AEP, but you can't **switch uplines** until the blackout period ends.
- 4. Release Process (To Release or Not):** * Brokers contracted directly with carriers usually retain their commissions unless restricted by a private contract (see Step 2). * You can file a self-release with an "intent to transfer". After 90–180 days, the carrier can re-contract you under a new upline while allowing you to keep producing during the interim. (you will be compensated according to your previous contract if you decide to continue producing, you wont get commission for producing if you WERE an LOA agent because your effective comp is 0%) * This safeguards agents from being stuck in unfavorable relationships. Most agents prefer waiting until the start of the year to minimize risks. The key is understanding your contract and navigating transitions safely, which is something many agents overlook. # A Brief History of the Release Process (why the heck is it this way?) The "agent-release" process emerged in the late 90s and early 2000s to manage transfers between FMOs and carriers. Unfortunately, it was often abused, with FMOs refusing to grant releases, especially during AEP, leaving agents trapped in bad contracts. To address this, carriers like UnitedHealthcare, Aetna, and Humana introduced transfer freezes during AEP to protect their investments. The "intent to transfer" process, developed in the late 2000s and early 2010s, aimed to fix these issues by providing agents a path to transfer without jeopardizing their business. # Misunderstandings About Releases If your agency/FMO/upline tells you "you can't transfer," it's likely because their training hasn't been updated to reflect the proper release procedures. This isn't usually malicious, they just want to ensure you're not left without commissions. Nobody wants to risk that. Also, the information is incredible "gate-kept", it's not a "sexy" process everyone wants to learn, until they need it... If you're looking for additional insight, this [YouTube video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NaExikyNwzo) (not affiliated with me or my company) provides a solid overview of the release process. However, it doesn't touch on the contract-level distinctions I've outlined here. Understanding these processes can help you avoid costly errors and confidently take control of your career. If you have questions or need clarification, feel free to ask!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gv923a/what_uplines_dont_want_you_to_know_carrier/

"Am I Crazy for Wanting to Leave My \$200k+ Job to Start and Independent Agency Background, I'm mid 30s, 2 kids, and I've just about had it with my extremely high stress/toxic culture job (in a healthcare/pharma marketing related field). I have a few years of savings and I'm ready to pivot my career into something more personally rewarding.....I'm seriously considering insurance! I know how to build a brand, manage CRM systems, create effective communications (the one-on-one sales aspect is new to me, but I know I can figure it out). Plus I have a solid background in many aspects of prescription drugs and healthcare (i've taken a practice licensing test without cracking a book and got a 72%, so there's more for me to learn, but a solid foundation) The idea is to start a medicare-focused agency, brand it to appeal to the communities I want to target, partner with an FMO, and begin sourcing paid and earned leads directly (this is not a challenge for me, I'm been doing it in the pharma space for years). My goal is to use the next 6 months to start up the business, get my licenses and begin lead generation. I would then quit my job in time for the end of year enrollment season, see how that goes - (pick up some light contract work throughout next year to supplement my income) and then go all-in on the business late 2026 - hoping that I can be clearing \$150k+ in 2027 and back to 200k+ earnings in 2028. Over time I'd branch out into other lines, but I want to keep a narrow focus for now so I can effectively source clients. That's the high-level plan, of course their are many more details that I'm figuring out (I'm building financial projections, comparing FMOs, analyzing the competitive landscape for local agents and the large nationals...and a lot more to make sure I'm going in with solid goals and expectations) So, am I crazy to get into this world? What are the biggest pitfalls to watch out for that will get in the way of me being successful? What is the biggest deterrents for those starting out that will my make feel burnt?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jdknqh/am_i_crazy_for_wanting_to_leave_my_200k_job_to/

Referrals and word of mouth · 274 documents

"I am a licensed agent since 2006 and have clients on both Medigaps and Advantage Plans. It's our duty and obligation to give each client to do a thorough presentation and give them their options. Medigap plans are excellent but not all can budget a Medigap plan which increase every year and when it's a husband and wife the expense can really be a hardship. Then they have to pay separate for their part D and separate for dental insurance and so on. On the other hand, my parents and in-laws with medical issues like cancer and diabetes have done very well with advantage plans and still continue up to this day. Not to mention some clients may also qualify for Low-income Subsidies and Medicaid programs from their state so truly they are covered even 100% for all Medicare costs. Although they are managed care plans there are many professional physicians who participate in these advantage plans and the referral process is not a headache. There are not a one size fits all plan. Every client has unique situations, lifestyles, income and so forth. So, at the end of the day give your clients the option because if you don't do a good job explaining their options as discussed on Medicare and You handbook, another agent will come along and enroll them in a managed care plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 93 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=Ugz1PoROzLPt1BvWDah4AaABAq>

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

"AMA - Never selling insurance to 85k monthly commissions starting my own agency **AMA: Nine months ago I'd never sold a policy. Today my ACA book does about \$85k/month with a \$34 CPA and ~3% loss. Here's what I wish I'd researched before spending money. Quick context** * Licensed end of Oct '24, started selling Jan '25 * Put **\$100k** in over the year * I buy **live inbound callers only** (no cold lists) **How I handle calls (this mattered most)** * Calls only route to me when I'm not already on the phone, so I don't miss people * If I miss a customer service call, I call back the same day—no exceptions * Clients get a real number that reaches me—my personal cell, 24/7. Hard work, but it built trust and referrals **What to research before you spend \$1** * Refund policy in writing: what counts as a bad call, how returns work, when credits land * Answer/contact rates by hour and source (real stats, not guesses) * County/ZIP targeting that matches ACA networks I can actually place * Consent/compliance language used before the call reaches me * Delivery control so I can cap/pause and touch every caller the same day **Money I wasted** * "Cheap" calls that vague or slow refunds * Buying volume before the intake script and follow-up rhythm were dialed in * Fancy software I didn't use every day **Money that paid off** * Speed + clarity: short script, quick verify, clear next step, same-day follow-up * Call recording + quick QC: 10 minutes a day fixed leaks I couldn't see in a spreadsheet * Knowing ACA cold: networks, formularies, prior auth, renewal quirks—explained in plain English (be the expert and put people at ease) **My lead-vendor checklist now** 1. Refund/credit rules and SLA (in writing) 2. Sample ads so I know there's no fake incentivizing 3. State targeting and delivery hours 4. I can throttle/stop calls instantly **Process that moved the needle** * 3 steps: verify basics → solve the real problem → set a specific next time/action * 1–2 plan options max, with reasons (menus slow everything down) * Same-day everything, or conversion drops * Post-enrollment customer care (ID cards, network checks, "what now?") drives referrals and keeps churn low (~3%) **Simple weekly scoreboard** * Reached calls / total calls * Kept appointments * Submits * Time to first touch * Service issues per member * Refund rate / turnaround * CPA (~\$34) and trend **If I had to start over (I could do it much cheaper—\$10–20k)** * Spend the first 2–3 weeks on scripts, routing, notes template, and a manual follow-up schedule * Trial multiple **live-call** vendors in tiny batches; only scale the one that proves contactability and refunds * Keep the tech boring: I run everything in Excel and Google Calendar * Give clients a real number and show up—that's what makes referrals happen That's my playbook and the lessons. AMA about the research, spend, setup, or what I'd cut or double down on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 62 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/

"How do y'all deal with actually insane clients? Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride. I answer the phone. Lady leads with "I went to your office and you guys vanished in the middle of the night! Do I even have insurance!? I'm reporting you to the government!" Reality: we moved nine months ago. Across the parking lot. Our Google listing has been updated. All our policy docs reflect the new address. There's a literal sign taped to the old door with an arrow saying "we moved next door." She then accuses me of not mailing her documents because I'm "screwing with her bill." Her payment has changed once in the last. It went down from \$92 to \$84. At this point she's yelling more about reporting me for moving. I told her "I'm not interested in getting yelled at. What would you like from me today?" She rants a bit more. I respond with "Okay. I am happy to transfer you to another office if that sounds good to you." She ranted more and eventually hung up. Curious how other agents handle the loons like this. I'd love to move her out of my book, but also can't really do it without her consent. People are nuts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

"Best leads in 2024???? This video had nothing to do with helping agents find reputable lead sources. You mentioned 10 different lead gen sources (none to be named) and said nothing referring to the actual title of your vid. Try renaming to "Don't make these mistakes". I was looking for actual usable content with names of companies that are skilled at lead gen and are reputable. Waste of 14 minutes."

— YouTube · The Best Life Insurance Leads For 2024 | My \$500k/Yr Lead Source · 39 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gtXNK0-8f7c&lc=UgxSK3d37q7CBMR8CY54AaABAg>

"Anyone's agency not do cold-calling for leads? I'm not sure if this will sound sane, but my agency grows solely off of referrals and advertising. Of course it's not the quickest growth, but it's been working for the past 5 years. We're a small independent agency that sells personal and commercial. I'm curious to hear others' thoughts and experiences!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 34 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mk37eo/anyones_agency_not_do_coldcalling_for_leads/

"Lessons from my first year as an agency owner. AMA I started my p&c agency in May 2025. For context, I posted when I first started and about half way through year one so go check those out. I started my agency because I had 10 years experience up to that point and I was tired of working for others and following their lead when I knew there was better ways to innovate and bring a superior experience to the clients. So after one year, what have I learned? 1) The power of taking 100% ownership for your life and business You will make mistakes, you will have setbacks, you will burn through money trying to figure things out. These are unavoidable and part of the learning process. Don't be reckless, but know that you will not have all of the answers out of the gate and that's okay. Accept your responsibility as the captain of the ship and you will find a way to overcome the hurdles that get in your way. 2) The power of the niche In the early months, I chased any and all kinds of business. That lead to me spinning my wheels but getting no traction. It was only after I picked a lane and stuck with it (for the most part, just because you pick a niche doesn't mean you have to turn away business that doesn't perfectly fit in the niche) that the trajectory of the business shifted. 3) The power of relationships and finding your tribe Once I picked a niche, I sought out power partners that I could help make their lives easier by offering their clients a needed product and service, so the power partner actually had an incentive (not a monetary kickback, although you'll find that helps grease the wheels) to refer me because I would strengthen their core offering. Think your typical referral partners (real estate agents, lenders, etc) but also think outside the box. 4) The power of delegation You cannot do everything. Know thyself, know what your strengths and weaknesses are. Hate doing your books? Get a bookkeeper. Not good at social media, find someone or a service that is good at it. Not a marketing guru? Find one. Don't try to be a hero, find others that have what you want and work out a deal. There's many more lessons, so ask me anything."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ts41sg/lessons_from_my_first_year_as_an_agency_owner_ama/

"New life insurance agent — how are y'all actually generating your own leads? I'm a newer life insurance agent and trying to figure out how to consistently get leads without spending a bunch of money. I see people on TikTok all the time talking about how they generate their own leads and don't have to buy any... but when I ask people in my group how they're doing it, I usually just hear stuff like "go pass out flyers at grocery stores." That's just not realistic for me. I've got three kids — two of them are still really little — so standing outside a store passing out flyers isn't something I can easily do. So for those of you who have actually found a way to generate leads yourself (especially from home), how are you doing it? Social media? Referrals? Something else? I'm willing to put in the effort, I just need a smarter strategy that works around my life. Appreciate any tips 😊"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/

"Buying an Independent Insurance Agency I am interested in purchasing my own independent agency and currently in the process of researching what that entails. Background: I currently work for a family agency where I am 3rd generation. My grandfather started the business, and I work under my dad and alongside my siblings. I have been at the agency for 5 years. I thought that it was fixable, but things are not going the way I hoped. There is always a ton of family drama that spills into the workplace, and it is a very unprofessional environment that drives me crazy. I am the only one who has outside work experience (previously an engineer for 10 years). Everyone else came straight to the agency and lacks very common and important real-life skills. Managing a calendar, Microsoft office knowledge, how to communicate effectively (to carriers, customers, and co-workers), etc... I come from a sales background so managing a pipeline and working with business owners or homeowners comes naturally. I've also been managing marketing, accounting, and day-to-day business operations, referral commercial lines quoting, CL renewals and networking for the agency. 90% of the daily decisions are made by me and then my father just blindly signs off on them because he is the principal and checked out (ready to retire). I have transitioned the agency to a new AMS, new accounting software, and transitioned most of our book away from agency bill. I have successfully increased efficiency by taking our 8-person agency down to 3.5 people. No one was fired, we had old staff and everyone retired. I thought we were going to be able to work together as siblings and run the agency, I was wrong. I tried a couple times to sit everyone down individually and talk about goals, dream responsibilities, and other things that would help align all our visions but am always met with "I dunno", or "I don't care", or "This is stupid, stop trying to make this a corporate office". Anytime there is a disagreement there is either a huge fight or one sibling goes to our mom who manipulates my dad into making the decision behind our back. I am looking for guidance from agency owners or industry veterans. What mistakes did you make when starting out or how would you do it differently now. 1. I am not interested in a captive agency 2. I understand PE acquisitions are at an all-time high but there are a good number of small mom and pop shop agencies around with limited succession planning (Ohio) 3. I understand getting a new carrier appointment right now during the hard market is very difficult if not currently impossible, but I will weigh the agencies current carrier selection very carefully 4. I understand this is a HUGE undertaking and the YEARS of work it will require Thank you in advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l48ryh/buying_an_independent_insurance_agency/

"What would you do if you had to start over from scratch? I'm 2.5 years into owning my agency and my book is just over \$100k. I've had some rough patches, hell, the first 2 years was a rough patch- but about 6 months ago I came to the conclusion that I'm going to put everything in me and do whatever it takes to grow my business and make up for the two years of my life that I wasted. I've gone 25 years untreated for ADHD and 2 months ago finally made myself an appointment to see what the hell is wrong with me. Fast forward 2 months later and I can finally function like a normal human being. Not only am I able to focus better, talk to people better, feel knowledgeable and handle things more professionally, but I actually care. I want to build something that will feed my family one day, pass down to my children, something that will provide us stability. I scheduled a 30 minute call with an agent I met a few years ago to see how he was doing and quite frankly, how he was doing what he was doing. I took a sneak peek at our companies production reports and this guy was selling nearly \$100k in premium a month. This meeting ended up being an hour long, but the biggest thing I took away was when he said this: "Dude... I have 5 kids", and it clicked. I have to get into survival mode, as if it wasn't just me, but those who depended on me. I think about my parents (whom I want to help retire because they are helping me financially), my girlfriend (whom wants to get married and have children with me one day), and my future kids. At this turning point in my life I am constantly asking people who are doing better than me, or are in places that I want to be, what would you do if you were in my position right now? What can I do to grow amongst these huge \$10M+ book size agents in my area? My goal is to quote over \$160k in premium a month, hopefully the quote to sell conversion ratio turns out good. These are mostly old leads, and eventually I will run out. Every Friday I am going out to 5-6 locations with realtors/brokers/lenders/title agents and handing out cookies, business cards, and a handwritten letter. Hopefully this helps me build a pipeline. I did this last week and people seemed receptive and related to the hustle. What is something I should be focusing on everyday to maximize my agencies growth?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/

"Dream came true at 19 Firstly, I want to preface I had never known anything about being an insurance agent until I was 16. When I was 16 I had the opportunity to work under a local State Farm agent and he showed me the ropes. I got hooked. In late 2024, when I turned 18, I immediately when for all 4 of my licenses and got a job at a larger State Farm agency as a producer. My plan then was to stay for 1-3 years then become an independent agent under an independent agency. Fast forward 10 months later and I was proud to say I was starting my own agency. The first months were tough. I didn't know what I was doing and I stepped into a world of uncertainty. But in May of this year I got myself a lease, and started working hard on digital ad campaigns. This month I will end the month with 55-60K in premium annualized. No paid internet leads, just \$500/mo in google ads (first month starting google ads), google reviews, referrals, an my office location. I'm so excited for what's to come and I just wanted to share my experience as a new agency owner. Dreams do come true, I'm just hitting a small milestone that I've dreamed of since I was 16. My plan is to end the year with a 400-500k book (all business written by myself) Next year I want to hire a producer. Agency owners, how were your first years? How did you manage growth and retention? And lastly, is this a realistic goal and plan? Thank you!!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uewxrx/dream_came_true_at_19/

"My experience at bankers life as a new agent. I don't understand the distaste. I came across a post after my interview that made me even more skeptical of the job because I've never had a commission based job, didn't have an insurance license, and this would be my first real job after college. Here is the post I read. [https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/194rgk1/has_anyone_heard_of_bankers_life/] (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/194rgk1/has_anyone_heard_of_bankers_life/) I got my license and passed first try (idk how, I studied hard but the exam was harder than I thought, I couldn't see how many I got wrong). It's the beginning of my 4th week, I've made one small sale but I've set appointments with clients that have a lot of money so they're sending an FA to discuss retirement planning. I've made contact with some of these clients, I study really hard, I do what I'm told, and honestly it feels great. I feel like I'm the edge of something that could be really good. I'm good at what I do and I can tell because not only are the managers impressed with me but so are the other agents that are in their first year. I kind of feel like I'm outpacing a lot of my peers but I'm trying to stay humble. I took a chance with these people because I had limited options but I knew that even if this is the worst company I've ever worked with (it's not) then I would at least come out with a resume with more licenses than I came in with, and could take another swing at the job market. I've been getting calls from other companies since I got my license trying to recruit me, I don't listen to them much. I will be an FA in a year or less with this company, I don't intend to leave here unless I go broke (doubtful) or something unforeseen happens. I was extremely apprehensive when I started but I trusted my manager and gave it my all since if I'm going to try, I'm going to try so hard that I will know without a doubt if it is my fault or the company's if I fail. I'm not failing, I'm impressing and improving. People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager) but there's signs everywhere about being a top 125 training company, have I fact checked this? No, but I haven't felt like I needed to. when I feel like it I will. My managers answer all my questions, see me working hard, and include me on appointments that I can't contribute much to, and we still split the sale. The online resources are extensive and cover so much in a very user friendly way, 30-60 minute panels of top producers explaining what worked for them. I am told this is why they are such a highly rated company for its training. I am also told that this is why BL is unique, because it is 1099 commission based but the support is unmatched. I really enjoy this company so far and if I don't start seeing financial results soon (I'm positive I will) then I will remove this post. Maybe after AEP I'll just drop how much money I've made in the comments and pin it or something and we can see how this post ages. I anticipate a couple thousand dollars in the next couple weeks from less than a handful of sales. Someone who's worked in other insurance agencies tell me what I'm missing if this company is so bad? If I'm being cocky then check back in January to see my suffering and plans to go back on Glassdoor. \sept 27, 2025 UPDATE It's December 17th, I'm going to try to keep this update relevant to my original. For context, I was let go two weeks ago and am not looking back. Issues had been brewing for weeks and I was already interviewing at another company in case I decided I needed to leave, initially, I didn't see myself being fired but as things escalated, I knew I'd be less surprised. I had the confidence in being hired at another company to stay true to my morals in how I dealt with Bankers. I'll talk about why I was let go later in this post. **Since I referred an older post in my original and commented on it, I'm going to dissect what I said and show a newer perspective:** "People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager)" Quoting the linked post, "being 1099 but being treated like an employee..." I still think the user on the linked post is misguided. You are 1099, and I don't know what negatives they were referring to when being "treated like an employee" but I can say that bankers really does do business in person, the initial interview was the only time I had a formal conversation with my bosses online. Working with my managers in person was something I liked, my new job has had more formal conversation over zoom than in person (so far, I don't officially start until January which is another downside over here) and I miss that about bankers. I also liked that the hierarchy of the office was relatively clear cut. My manager knows she is responsible for me. I liked how there was structure to the company, I was told by my managers and in hindsight still agree that this is GOOD and sets bankers aside from the competition. Agreed. My second sentence regarding insurance as far as I know now, is still completely correct. But working for bankers I realized that everything is a sale, hiring people, building confidence in subordinates, getting your manager to like you even if you don't like them. Everything is a game and everyone is playing. All the sales tactics apply in every corner of the office. Now we have "office politics" where generally, every participant is skilled in how to get what they want from other people, so now there is another layer of paranoia I had and I think rightfully so. I have no idea if becoming a manager and qualifying for bankers insurance is as easy as it was laid out in the interview. I can't tell you how many times, big or small, I thought something would be as easy as 1,2,3 because that was the way it was laid out, when in fact there were so many undisclosed micromanagement tasks attached. Some had to do with clients and don't result in being paid. (Prescription drug plans are needed by most of our clients, but we get paid nothing. And I had an experience that took way longer than it should have) **In regards to my overall outlook on bankers as a company and my experience at the time:** I was pretty successful as a new agent I think, I saw people come and go, I got better and was super proud of my accomplishments being a new grad and never having been in sales before but booking more appointments than some of my peers. I was confident and working hard, everyone in the office saw it. Peers would ask me questions and "most" managers were always eager to help. However management was the reason I was fired, after awhile I realized that I knew I would be very successful at this company and would do everything in my power, without hurting anyone, to accomplish my goals. Before I go into why I was let go I want to say that from my perspective, I think bankers as a company could be very good, it may already be a very good company to work for. I think the resources available online is extensive and very very valuable, I do think working face to face with your company is very valuable too. And I think from a baseline, makes bankers a company to consider. For awhile I really enjoyed it, and I was trying really hard not to drink too much "kool-aid" I wanted to stay humble and careful, celebrate my victories at home and not let anyone see anything they could take advantage of. Ultimately, it could be and probably was, my branch that failed me. Not the company. And the branch did fail me. **Here is why I was let go:** As I've said I was a good new agent, and proud of my progress. As I got better and better I became more and more independent. At first I didn't want to meet clients 1 on 1 because I felt so nervous in my capabilities, naturally management wanted me to go on my own and I understood even if I didn't want to. As I went on these appointments I was told I could call my manager "anytime." Sure enough, questions came up, and without disturbing my rapport with the client, would text or call my manager. Eventually the response I would get is "read the agent guide" or "we'll talk about it during our meeting" but I would never know which agent guide I was being referred to and anytime I looked at our resources they would be 40 pages of word salad and fluff that I mostly already knew with a few bits of new information. Not user friendly and certainly not a good use of time when I could be making new clients, working on my current clients, or learning how to present a new product. So the other response was our meeting. 3/5 days during the week we are on appointments, 2/5 days we are in the office and here is the schedule: 8-12 dial, dial, dial. That's it. 12-1 people trickle out o"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nircjl/my_experience_at_bankers_life_as_a_new_agent/

Cold calling, door knocking, dialing · 270 documents

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crd=11ZYLHHAOSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&srefix=how+to+win+friend%2C%266&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_5?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: | Industry | Description | | --- | --- | | Tech | You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. | | Med | You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in *The Pursuit of Happiness*. | | Finance/Insurance | You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. | | Hardware/Construction | Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. | | Cars | You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. | | Door to Door | Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. | | So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. | JOB TITLE | PAY RANGE (Salary) | PAY RANGE (OTE) | DESCRIPTION** | | --- | --- | --- | --- | | SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) | £25,000 - £40,000 | £50,000 - £80,000 | Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. | | SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive | £30,000 - £60,000 | £50,000 - £140,000 | Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. | | MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive | £40,000 - £75,000 | £60,000 - £150,000 | Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. | | ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive | £50,000 - £100,000 | £70,000 - £250,000 | Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. | | SALES MANAGER | £60,000 - £120,000 | £80,000 - £200,000 | Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. | | MD: Managing Director | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. | | HEAD OF SALES | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. | | Terminology | Description | | --- | --- | | Cold call | When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. | | Lead | This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead'', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. | | Account | This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. | | Contact | This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. | | Example of a lead, a contact and an account. | Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought *pre-sold leads* from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigator (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the *insurance carrier, not the agent*, for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigator wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigator. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

"Quiet quitting - byeeeeeeee I'm an sdr at an insurance company. Fully remote. We grind hard every day - like 200+ dials. Warm and cold leads - no break in the calls or voicemails. All day. Every day. Calls and voicemails pop literally every 10-15 seconds. The commission is crap, but the base is comfortable. Here's the issue - I have decided this is not for me and I am going to quiet quit until they fire me. How do I disengage completely when I am compelled to do well and to succeed? Do I just ride the clock? Do I blow sales intentionally? Or what. A little help and guidance. TIA"

— r/sales · 105 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/14m75j1/quiet_quitting_byeeeeeeee/

"8 Tips for New Agents to Sell Insurance Successfully Below I've compiled a list of 8 strategies imperative for new agents to execute on, if you want to see success selling insurance, regardless of the agency, niche, or product you sell. Here they are: # 1. Clear the Calculator Selling insurance is largely a mental game. In other words, you have to keep your emotions and focus in check at all times. This means you must not allow distractions from your personal life or sales calls gone sideways to affect your mindset. Here's some tips that have helped me stay mentally sharp: * Treat every sales call as a fresh start. Getting rejected on one sales call doesn't mean you'll get rejected on the next. * It's helpful to think of your clients rejecting **your offer**, not you. The rejection is business, not personal. * Maintain balance in your personal life—exercise, eat well, and manage relationships. Mental clarity fuels sales success. # 2. Eliminate Distractions Selling insurance is great, but especially those who sell remotely, it comes with endless distractions. To stay focused: * Set clear boundaries with family—work time is **work time**. Make sure your spouse and kids respect this. * Keep your phone muted and out of reach during work hours. Group your texts and calls to a scheduled time. Most of them can wait. * Social media and internet use while you should be selling kills productivity. Consider a low-cost app like Freedom.to limit internet access while you should be working. # 3. Prioritize Activity Over Everything Activity leads to "app-tivity." In other words, tracking your numbers is critical to uncovering opportunities to improve your results. Try tracking these metrics daily: * **Connection Rate** – How many people are you actually getting to pick up the phone? If this number is low, explore dialing technology that helps keep your number off the spam- and telemarketer-likely lists. I like Convoso and Kixie. * **Quality connections** – How many conversations last longer than two minutes? If you're having trouble keeping your prospects on the phone, work on your opening script by practicing objection rebuttals until you can say them on the fly without hesitation. * **Closing rate** – How many policies are you selling compared to presentations? If these numbers are low, adjust your strategy. Retrain your scripting. Success is a numbers AND a skill development game. # 4. Master Your Scripts and Rebuttals The best agents **sound natural** but follow a proven process. If you don't have a script, you're winging it! And winging it doesn't work long-term. A good script consists of the following: * A strong intro that overcomes initial objections while simultaneously helping the client remember that they in fact requested the information you're calling about. * A handful of effective fact-finding questions that help build value and urgency to buy what you're selling. * A good list of underwriting questions that help you figure out which product works best. I like using Insurance Tool Kits for life and final expense policy sales. * How to close confidently. # 5. Stay Consistent with Your Schedule Consistency wins. The more you treat your profession like a job, the better off you'll be. I recommend the following: * Set a fixed start and end time every day. Stay disciplined to this as much as possible. * Avoid checking email or social media during work hours. Schedule a time before and after work for this. * Batch tasks. Separate prospecting, calling, and follow-ups. # 6. Improve After Every Call After a completed sales presentation - whether you sell or not - don't just move on! Analyze what worked and what didn't. Ask yourself the following: * Did I control the conversation? Or did the prospect control the pace? Remember that the person asking questions is in control. * Did I handle objections smoothly? If you're stumbling in your script, practice it multiple times until it's smooth. * What could I do better next time? Biggest pro-tip I can offer is to record your sales calls and listen to them. You'll hear all sorts of opportunities to improve =). # 7. Develop Thick Skin Rejection is part of the game. If you get rattled after a bad call, you're losing twice. Keep moving. Instead, think about the following: * If someone hangs up? Act fast and dial the next lead instead of ruminating. Don't spiral out of control! * If a prospect is rude? Probably like that with everyone. Don't take it personal. Next! * If you get 50 rejections in a row? Think: a sale is that much closer =). # 8. Work Smarter, Not Harder Successful agents **leverage** tools and systems to increase efficiency: * Use a CRM to track leads and follow-ups. AgentCRM is a pretty good CRM to start if your agency doesn't provide it. * Automate tasks where possible such as a chat bot to speak with your leads. Or use a compliant powerdialer to speak with more prospects faster. Again, I like Kixie and Convoso. * Constantly refine your approach based on data. Hope this helps =)"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 84 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kfmbhp/8_tips_for_new_agents_to_sell_insurance/

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

"AMA - Never selling insurance to 85k monthly commissions starting my own agency **AMA: Nine months ago I'd never sold a policy. Today my ACA book does about \$85k/month with a \$34 CPA and ~3% loss. Here's what I wish I'd researched before spending money. Quick context** * Licensed end of Oct '24, started selling Jan '25 * Put **\$100k** in over the year * I buy **live inbound callers only** (no cold lists) **How I handle calls (this mattered most)** * Calls only route to me when I'm not already on the phone, so I don't miss people * If I miss a customer service call, I call back the same day—no exceptions * Clients get a real number that reaches me—my personal cell, 24/7. Hard work, but it built trust and referrals **What to research before you spend \$1** * Refund policy in writing: what counts as a bad call, how returns work, when credits land * Answer/contact rates by hour and source (real stats, not guesses) * County/ZIP targeting that matches ACA networks I can actually place * Consent/compliance language used before the call reaches me * Delivery control so I can cap/pause and touch every caller the same day **Money I wasted** * "Cheap" calls with vague or slow refunds * Buying volume before the intake script and follow-up rhythm were dialed in * Fancy software I didn't use every day **Money that paid off** * Speed + clarity: short script, quick verify, clear next step, same-day follow-up * Call recording + quick QC: 10 minutes a day fixed leaks I couldn't see in a spreadsheet * Knowing ACA cold: networks, formularies, prior auth, renewal quirks—explained in plain English (be the expert and put people at ease) **My lead-vendor checklist now** 1. Refund/credit rules and SLA (in writing) 2. Sample ads so I know there's no fake incentivizing 3. State targeting and delivery hours 4. I can throttle/stop calls instantly **Process that moved the needle** * 3 steps: verify basics → solve the real problem → set a specific next time/action * 1–2 plan options max, with reasons (menus slow everything down) * Same-day everything, or conversion drops * Post-enrollment customer care (ID cards, network checks, "what now?") drives referrals and keeps churn low (~3%) **Simple weekly scoreboard** * Reached calls / total calls * Kept appointments * Submits * Time to first touch * Service issues per member * Refund rate / turnaround * CPA (~\$34) and trend **If I had to start over (I could do it much cheaper—\$10–20k)** * Spend the first 2–3 weeks on scripts, routing, notes template, and a manual follow-up schedule * Trial multiple **live-call** vendors in tiny batches; only scale the one that proves contactability **and** refunds * Keep the tech boring: I run everything in Excel and Google Calendar * Give clients a real number and show up—that's what makes referrals happen That's my playbook and the lessons. AMA about the research, spend, setup, or what I'd cut or double down on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 62 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/

"Why are we selling insurance like its 2005? Not trying to start drama just genuinely curious. We've got tech for everything now food shows up in 15 minutes, people find houses on their phones, we match with dates using algorithms. But when it comes to insurance? We're still cold calling, chasing unqualified leads, and quoting people we were never gonna close in the first place. We spend hours dialing and quoting but half the time it's with someone we can't even write a policy for. What if there was a smarter way to work where we only connect with people based on what they actually need and what we actually offer? Not saying tech solves everything, but there has to be a shift from the old school hustle to something more intentional. Anyone else feel like the traditional model is wearing thin?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 57 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l3wj8v/why_are_we_selling_insurance_like_its_2005/

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

"I'm learning off 5-10 year old leads making 300+ dials a day to learn as fast as possible made my first sale yesterday thanks for the video"

— YouTube · Cold Calling 3-Month-Old Leads LIVE – Watch Me Close Insurance Sales · 52 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qvBEaHr_MGU&lc=Ugybs2i2wGd1cChHPq54AaABAq

"Be prepared for the phone apocalypse Apple dropped the hammer on all unsolicited calls. With the iOS 26 update in September, no calls will automatically go through unless their in your contacts. Instead, the person calling will have to state their name and the reason for the call. That will show up as a text and the caller decides whether or not to allow the call. Here's a demo: <https://youtu.be/4yFDvqEjciQ?feature=shared> Apple owns 60% of the market. If other phone manufacturers and even carrier follow, it's possible we see day where cold calling has died. This will have a direct, negative effect on leads, especially shared leads. Be prepared."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 50 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l8sgfs/be_prepared_for_the_phone_apocalypse/

"anyone else hate receiving AI-voice generated cold calls? the usual AI-generated cold calls I got were usually those that assume you aren't interested. "hi. this is x from x company. we are calling to tell you that you are eligible for our medicare benefits. do you have plan A or plan B?" "plan A" "I understand, but this call will not take too much of your time. it will only take a minute to discuss your eligibility.""

— r/sales · 48 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1fhlgv1/anyone_else_hate_receiving_aivoice_generated_cold/

"The Lifeboat Mentality The art of selling is truly an art, and guess what, it's something that every single one of us needs to master - fast. I'm going to get the first, and what I think is the most important step out of the way immediately: **Stop trying to sell *products* and start selling *yourself*** When I first started, I always had this question in my sales experience: Why is it that one guy has extreme success selling the same product, and another guy doesn't? Let me tell you about a time when I sold life insurance that completely changed the way I sell, and will sell for the rest of my life. So, I got hired at a huge brokerage in Florida. We were contracted with 40+ different insurance agencies to market and sell their products. I had to be licensed to sell annuities, medicare products, health insurance, prescription drug packages, and life insurance. So, needless to say we had an **ARSENAL** of products to choose from. During the orientation, we were greeted by the companies top salesman. The idea was for him to come in and share his success, and answer any questions us newbies may have before we ventured out on our own. It came about time for him to come speak, and in my head I'm thinking some young 20-something was going to bolt through the door with excitement and enthusiasm. Wrong. In walks a 60-year old retired war-veteran who had been crushing the insurance game in this company for the last year, month after month! His annualized premium average was close to \$26,000 per month. (This is the amount of Premiums people that he sold to were paying on a monthly basis. He not only receives residuals off of this, sometimes he'll even receive a 90-95% commission off of the first-year premium total - If they pay \$100 per month, he receives around \$1000) I couldn't believe it. But, me transitioning from shock to understanding, I began to listen to him. His success was no secret. He literally worked "harder" than everyone else. His military mentality came into play big time in this field. Why? He would knock on 30 doors per day. Non stop, wake up at 7am, and not go home until 5pm, or until he successfully spoke to 30 people. His strength was in his numbers. Law of averages! If he got a "No." he wouldn't waste a second, bat an eye, or fold. He knew his power was in his ability to talk to as many people as possible. Day after day, same mentality: Do it, or die. (Not to that extent, but you get the idea!) **Takeaway One: Understand the law of averages, and commit to it!** However, although we had an arsenal to sell from, I became completely overwhelmed because it seemed impossible to take in all of the product specs and legalities, all while trying to create a smooth sales pitch. So, instead of focusing on things I didn't know, I just focused on one of the many things I could sell that would give me the best chance at success: life insurance. I modeled the success of the older salesman, and knocked door to door to offer our product relentlessly. But, door to door sales isn't as easy as it seems. Actually, it doesn't seem easy at all. Think about it. Have you ever bought anything from someone who randomly walked up to your door trying to sell something to you? The idea is crazy. But, it works. Numbers game. Same with cold calling, and same with any service. The idea is to put yourself in a position to collide your product with a consumer in demand, at the time they have made up their mind to purchase. If they haven't made up their mind to purchase, it's your job, as a salesman to help them. But, knowing how crazy this idea is, I had to separate myself and treat people as if they were my friends. I didn't come across as pushy, I came across as informative, and very confident - I adopted the **Life Boat Mentality** The Life Boat Mentality is simple: Your customers are drowning. They are drowning from poor quality products or services. You see them drowning in these products or services, and paddle on over in your Lifeboat. The idea is this: With impeccable trust, of course, you persuade your client to get in your life boat. Your life boat is the "best" option. And if it's not the best option, you need to find a company that offers the best option and sell that. (I'm not about selling garbage - Honestly) If you truly in your heart believe that what you are selling is the best option, the Lifeboat Mentality will help you tremendously. For example. I own a small residential repaint company now. I've taken the Lifeboat Mentality with me throughout my entire duration owning a business. I've got the branding where I want it, I have the production where it needs to be, and the Lifeboat mentality that I carry with me says this: Mr. & Mrs. Customer: I know that there is a TON of options in the marketplace. So many to choose from, however, I know this for a fact. There will be none other than my company that will show you the amount of respect and care you deserve throughout the entire tenure of us working for you. From the initial handshake to the final good-bye I can guarantee that our quality of service is of exemplary fashion. How do I ensure that this remains true? How do I have the confidence to pitch this? Because as the business owner, I insure it. My sales process is down to a science and has clear concise wording, professional formatting, and a great follow-up procedure. We have references and a great website for them to visit, and provide insurance and legal information up front. I ensure that I will be at each job to make sure that our quality of service is exactly as promised. In other words, I'm showing them that I "me", the "salesperson" am the lifeboat! It may seem silly at first, but think of yourself as a lifeboat. Start saving people! Happy selling! P.S if you're interested in knowing more about the painting business, feel free to PM me I'd be happy to answer any questions you may have!"

— r/sales · 47 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/7tph4u/the_lifeboat_mentality/

Call centers / captive employers · 223 documents

"State Farm just rewrote 19,000 agents' contracts overnight. If you think a captive book is a retirement plan, read this If you somehow missed it: State Farm is moving all 19,000 of its agents onto a single standardized contract, ending their deferred-comp/retirement program (AIPP), and dropping health insurance for agents and spouses. Agents are reportedly looking at 30–40% less on base commissions depending on contract and book size. I can't believe State Farm disputes that number but hasn't offered its own. The core shift is from getting paid to "retain" a book to getting paid to "write new business". They also put buyout offers on the table with a Sept 30 deadline. P&C side, I know. But the lesson isn't carrier-specific and it's the thing I keep coming back to: you never actually owned that book. State Farm did. And a 20-year "trailing income" promise is only worth as much as the carrier's willingness to keep paying it which turned out to be "until it's inconvenient." The part that should get every agent's attention is the direction, not the one carrier. Comp is going performance-based across the board, trailing/renewal-style income is getting squeezed, and AI is going to absorb more of the service and retention work that used to justify those trails. The "come build a \$3–5M book and coast" pitch a lot of us were sold is quietly being retired. So I'm genuinely curious how the room sees it: Are you seeing comp pressure at your carrier/IMO too, or is this a State Farm-specific overreach? Does owning your book independently actually protect you here, or is that just trading carrier risk for lead-cost/chargeback risk? For the newer agents is anyone factoring "can they rewrite my deal in 5 years" into where they sign? Not trying to dunk on State Farm agents since a lot of them got blindsided and it's a rough spot. More interested in what this says about where the whole comp model is heading."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/

"Brand New Independent Agents This is just a rant post. I find it extremely weird when brand new agents want to be independent but also expect everything to be given to them. The entire point of being independent is that you are the OWNER of YOUR business. If I decided to open to a floral shop, I would have to pay for inventory, supplies, a website, marketing, and anything else that I needed to run my business. I'd be responsible for going out and marketing myself & my business to attract customers. I wouldn't expect to make money if I was only open for a couple of hours a few days a week, because no one else is giving me a paycheck. And if I didn't know how to run a business, I would find someone who could give me the play by play. Not just someone who said they could, but someone who had proof they'd done it. Insurance is no different. New independent agents are constantly complaining about back office fees, that their IMO doesn't provide them free leads, being 1099, and having to actually bust their ass to make money... and after putting forth half ass effort, blame their agency or upline for not making money. If you want a paycheck, to clock out the same time every day, and someone to provide you leads, GO CAPTIVE. This is why most new agents fail because they saw someone on TikTok that told them they could make \$20,000 in a month. Which is POSSIBLE, I have seen it, not fresh out the gate. You don't even know what you're doing yet! And honestly, you already need to have money put back to carry you in the beginning months until you start to make money... that's where you need to start anyway. This isn't a get rich quick scheme. It's a real business that you have to put real work into."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tnmhue/brand_new_independent_agents/

"Buying an Independent Insurance Agency I am interested in purchasing my own independent agency and currently in the process of researching what that entails. Background: I currently work for a family agency where I am 3rd generation. My grandfather started the business, and I work under my dad and alongside my siblings. I have been at the agency for 5 years. I thought that it was fixable, but things are not going the way I hoped. There is always a ton of family drama that spills into the workplace, and it is a very unprofessional environment that drives me crazy. I am the only one who has outside work experience (previously an engineer for 10 years). Everyone else came straight to the agency and lacks very common and important real-life skills. Managing a calendar, Microsoft office knowledge, how to communicate effectively (to carriers, customers, and co-workers), etc... I come from a sales background so managing a pipeline and working with business owners or homeowners comes naturally. I've also been managing marketing, accounting, and day-to-day business operations, referral commercial lines quoting, CL renewals and networking for the agency. 90% of the daily decisions are made by me and then my father just blindly signs off on them because he is the principal and checked out (ready to retire). I have transitioned the agency to a new AMS, new accounting software, and transitioned most of our book away from agency bill. I have successfully increased efficiency by taking our 8-person agency down to 3.5 people. No one was fired, we had old staff and everyone retired. I thought we were going to be able to work together as siblings and run the agency, I was wrong. I tried a couple times to sit everyone down individually and talk about goals, dream responsibilities, and other things that would help align all our visions but am always met with "I dunno", or "I don't care", or "This is stupid, stop trying to make this a corporate office". Anytime there is a disagreement there is either a huge fight or one sibling goes to our mom who manipulates my dad into making the decision behind our back. I am looking for guidance from agency owners or industry veterans. What mistakes did you make when starting out or how would you do it differently now. 1. I am not interested in a captive agency 2. I understand PE acquisitions are at an all-time high but there are a good number of small mom and pop shop agencies around with limited succession planning (Ohio) 3. I understand getting a new carrier appointment right now during the hard market is very difficult if not currently impossible, but I will weigh the agencies current carrier selection very carefully 4. I understand this is a HUGE undertaking and the YEARS of work it will require Thank you in advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l48ryh/buying_an_independent_insurance_agency/

"Is a Life & Health Insurance License Useless? 🤔 I've had a Life & Health Insurance license for 2 weeks. It feels useless for finding a job. All the local captive agents focus on Property & Casualty. They like seeing L&H but they don't sell any. Even if they advertised for a L&H position. I applied to local banks and credit unions. I'm a notary too but heard nothing back. A recruiter from Brown & Brown reached out. She liked my resume and experience a lot. B2B Sales and Marketing, Tradeshows, SEO, etc. She has no job for me. I've had Life Insurance and Medicare outfits calling me. All commission based. They sound like scams and MLMs. I've tried getting an Employee Benefits Advisor job but these seem rare. Ideally I'd like to work at a hospital and help people choose health plans. Applied with health insurance companies. Haven't heard back. Are L&H license useful at all? What should I do to find a job? UPDATE - The Kaplan training I did was part of a hiring process for a Financial Services company. They paid with no strings attached as part of the final hiring process. They ended up not hiring me even after I passed the test. The goal was to do SIE and other FINRA certs. UPDATE 2 - Many of you are saying just go get a Property & Casualty license via DM. Yes would be good to do but I don't have a ton of money right now. Would much prefer to get a job that will pay for my P&C training and licensing. I was thinking of just watching Melissa from Insurance Exam Queen. She and Peter were so valuable for passing the L&H test."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lavgn1/is_a_life_health_insurance_license_useless/

"It's my first day as an independent insurance agent! I used to be a captive age but I didn't feel like I was able to provide the service I feel my community of artists so I quit and decided to become an independent agent. After 2 months of hemming and hawing applying to jobs in other sales fields I finally decided it was enough and found 2 IMOs. One focused on health the other focused on life and P&C. Today I signed my last contracts to be appointed with their major carriers and I started prospecting. I sent out maybe 50-70 linked in messages with one simple goal in mind. Ask 5 people to sit for an appointment with you. I accomplished my goal at 1 pm with one appointment set. Then I went out networking and was able to book a second. 5 is tomorrow's number as well. I want to go a full week with 5 tasks every day except Sunday. As a wise poet from the San Francisco Bay Area once said, "I'm feeling myself"."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pc01jr/its_my_first_day_as_an_independent_insurance_agent/

"Incomes can widely vary based on captive or independent. When you have a salary or safety net, the incomes you mention are doable, it is recommend that newbies start out as captive before venturing out on your own. Most will fail in the first year going it alone. My agency did over 1.2 million and on track for 1.5 this year, but many years of hard work, it is definitely more rewarding on the independent side, but not for everyone."

— YouTube · How Much Does A Health Insurance Agent Makelbeingbougie · 21 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RrGUFRdgtZY&lc=UgxPaeU0nrh1AzCEkX94AaABAa>

"How is everyone marketing in 2025 without spending a fortune? For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down. Since, I've tried multiple vendors, and I've tried data leads + telemarketers. It feels like no matter what I do, I have to spend 5 grand a month in marketing at least for each of my producers just to hit our goals. It's way too much, and as we spend more to make less, I'm feeling bad burnout as my margins shrink. Primarily P&C, captive agent. So what is everybody doing that's working?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/

"The thing that frustrates me about recent news is that many of us likely completely agree that for profit health insurance is just not a good model. But people who hear insurance just assume all of us are in health insurance and just rolling in cash and laughing. I'm a PC reinsurance broker working mainly with captives. People have no clue what I actually do."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1i58bx2/given_how_much_the_insurance_industry_has_been_in/m81suw3/

"When Integrity Collides With the Insurance Industry # When Integrity Collides With the Insurance Industry After a year as a licensed Life, Health & Accident insurance agent—with certifications in Medicare, Fixed Annuities, and Long- and Short-Term Care—I find myself disillusioned, but not defeated. I've worked with three agencies in twelve months. On paper, that looks like instability. In reality, it tells a much more uncomfortable story about how our industry often operates—and who it quietly pushes out. # The First Lesson: Sales Without Suitability My first agency offered free leads, a platform, and a fast track into final expense sales. What it also offered—though less transparently—was pressure. Pressure to sell without first asking whether clients had the financial capacity to participate at all. Pressure to push forward even when something felt wrong. I voiced my concern early. I was clear that bullying tactics and financial assumptions were not how I wanted to serve families. Insurance, after all, is meant to protect people—not corner them. That discomfort was my first warning sign. # The Second Lesson: Knowledge Without Direction The second agency was rich in information and poor in application. Training was constant. Zoom calls filled my days. Education was abundant—but clarity was not. At one point, I asked what I thought was a simple question: "Out of over 250 life insurance policies, which ones should I focus on when serving clients?" The answer was blunt: "Read them all and figure it out." Eventually, the trainings did help. But what was missing was real-world guidance—how to connect authentically with people, how to build relationships beyond vague social media posts that thousands of agents were already making with little return. Knowledge alone does not serve families. Applied wisdom does. # The Third Lesson: Ethics Versus Politics The third agency was captive. The training was solid. For the first time, I learned how to identify real markets and pursue them responsibly. But there was a problem—one that went far deeper than sales technique. A field agent, protected as the "golden child," consistently wrote bad business. Junior agents came and went. Clients were placed into policies that should never have been written. Accountability never traveled upward. When I raised concerns—concerns later corroborated by other agents—I became the problem. When a longstanding nerve issue flared and I was forced to work from home temporarily, the support others received quietly vanished for me. Where teammates had appointments covered during health or family crises, I was left alone. Eventually, I was let go—for "not taking my business seriously." Within five months, nearly everyone on that team was gone. # What This Taught Me I've been told I'm too honest. Too nice. Too much of a "Girl Scout." But here's what I know to be true: insurance done correctly can be a family's saving grace. It can create stability, preserve dignity, and protect generations—*if* it is written with intention, education, and suitability at its core. I believe clients deserve: * Clear explanations of what a policy **can and cannot** do * Solutions aligned with their actual income and goals * Time to understand, not pressure to comply * Guidance that considers today *and* tomorrow That shouldn't be radical. Yet too often, it is. # The Question I'm Asking Now Is there an agency that believes insurance should be built for generational impact—not quick commissions? An agency that values education over hype. Integrity over volume. Long-term relationships over short-term wins. I'm still here because I believe in this work. I believe in serving people honestly, even when honesty slows the sale. Especially then. If that makes me a "Girl Scout," I'll wear the badge. Because families don't need more salespeople. They need advocates."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1q6lb33/when_integrity_collides_with_the_insurance/

"Being an insurance agent is starting your own business. You have to pay for leads with either your money or your time. Anyone promising "free" leads is normally a complete scam (because any agency owner would just hire w2 employees to work the leads instead). The largest IMOs/agencies in the industry give you nothing but contracts (Crump, Ash, Simplicity, etc.) No recruiting or bullshit to make money. The rest is up to you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dt0fnh/why_i_left_the_life_insurance_industry/lb64i6q/

"I run my regions claims department. If you have written proof we'd consider covering it. I will admit if your captive it's a lot more likely independent it becomes our discretion"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1n20wgr/i_accidentally_did_not_add_collision_on_a_clients/nb2k0su/

"Quit \$150k W2 Sales to start an Agency. 6 Months in: Lessons learned from the "FE Trap" and pivoting to Group Health/Life. Feedback? I'm in my late 20s and recently walked away from a \$150k+ W2 sales career to build my own independent agency. I started with a \$2,000/month residual base from a previous ACA book and a small group. The Failure: I fell for the Final Expense hype. I burned several thousand dollars on my own ads, lead vendors, and a marketing firm. After 6 months, I realized the "social worker" aspect of FE isn't for me. I'm a consultant and advisor, not a hand-holder for the unbanked. The Pivot: I've officially pivoted to Group Health (U65), Individual Health, and Term Life. My daily "Machine" looks like this: • Cold Knocking: Visiting local businesses daily to prospect for Group Health. • Strategic Partners: Building a referral network (CPAs, P&C agents) for Life/Health leads. • Efficiency: Cutting all paid lead spend once current FE ads die. Reallocating that budget to BNI and local SEO. The Concern: I'm 6 months in and not profitable yet. I live in a major city and the grind is real. Thank God for my savings and residual base, but I want to make sure I'm not missing a gear. My Questions: 1. Aside from BNI and cold knocking, what high-leverage community events or "advisor-level" prospecting am I missing?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rgt03f/>

Seminars, events, workshops · 169 documents

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

"Rant- Big Red is one of the worst employers (and the most petty) I've had a long career and in my 25 years I've worked at a lot of carriers. Some were better than others but most of them weren't terrible. That is until I worked for Big Red. I should have known from the horrible interviewing/hiring process it was going to be bad. A recruiter reached out because a colleague gave them my name. I applied and didn't hear back for three months. They initially offered me to interview for section manager position but after the interview they decided to offer me a team manager position. I wasn't going to accept but my wife convinced me that it could be a good opportunity. I agreed to the position. Then my first day it was absolute chaos. 900 people starting at the exact time as me and my credentials not working. No phone number to call or anything. Finally at 3pm after panicking that I left my consulting gig and wasn't getting hired I got a phone call asking why I wasn't online. This lead to them telling me I never signed my offer letter. Fast forward and it turns out they changed their mind and were offering me the section manager position but no one called. I'm now a section manager Fast forward a few months and this job is hell. I spent two months getting the most basic training ever. None of it has anything to do with management. None. I am never taught how to use the time card system. I'm not taught T2 or Workday. Nothing. Then I'm saddled with a team that has questions from minor claim stuff to HR issues. That I have no idea on how to handle. Then my claim manager has the nerve to tell me I need to get my CPCU, that management is expected to have their CPCU. I have my CPCU. So I tell him that. He asks why I haven't been putting it in signature. It's simple I don't see value in it when I have decades of real experience. He then tells me that I need to continuously improve and to sign up for another designation. I choose the ARe. I go on and buy the three ARe exams study material and sign up for the tests. I take the first one and pass. Then I sign up for the next two. I decided to get all the materials for a few other designations that overlap the CPCU (like 6 other study materials). Keep in mind I'm using the corporate codes. While all this is going on I am still trying to figure out the job. I have leaders asking me questions and talking to me like I should know how certain obscure systems work. The absolute worst part is the other new folks. I had four brand new team managers reporting to me. Three were external hires and one was an internal hire. I honestly felt like every day I was letting down my team because I didn't have the faintest clue how to teach them systems that I didn't have any clue how to use. There was zero training for them. These folks had brand new adjusters of their own and they didn't know how to help them. I had one associate get out to the middle of the country in their van and their gas card stopped working. This is a 22 year old recent grad with no real world experience. Stuck in the middle of the country because they don't have enough spare credit to pay to keep filling up that gas hog. Their team manager had no clue how to fix the situation and I had no clue. It took us three days to find someone to fix it. I felt like pure dog shit. No one would respond to emails other than giving a vague area of the internal portal. All the while my one on ones were just my claim manager asking me about personal development. Develop my skills in how all this runs.... I resigned a couple of weeks ago and it was the most asinine process I've ever seen. My claim manager was on time off. None of his colleagues would respond. I go to HR and they don't have a process for it. Finally after they fail to reach anyone they "take a message". Eventually I get an email saying mail back the laptop, phone, and mifi. The final touch is that they emailed me a list of stuff to return them. Which is a lot more exhaustive than they originally said. It's not like I wanted to keep the equipment. It's honestly that I didn't even keep most of it. When I got hired on I was originally going to be a team manager so they sent me adjusting equipment. I've worked at this so long I've got better equipment than the junk they gave me. So I literally threw a lot of it away and gave the rest to younger adjusters I knew. I didn't even keep the monitors because I had a nice office already. They hounded me for weeks over it. The box I did send back was so small the laptop had to sit diagonal and I got a nasty email about the laptop being damaged. (They provided the box) Then they did the most petty thing ever.... I had a test scheduled with The Institutes for April 15th. Today they had the institutes send me an email asking for certain printed material back and they removed my online access to all the material and my last scheduled test. I understand the test, sure you don't want to pay for that. But to go back and retroactively remove study material is absolutely insane work. Especially because I purchased corresponding tests to that material with my own money since they only pay for one exam per quarter. End rant. Actually P.S.- when people say that the company is failing. It's not for all the obvious reasons. At its heart it's because it's become a bloated bureaucracy. In all their efforts to streamline and create operating procedures for everything, they have made the whole process inefficient. They can't keep employees because they won't invest in their training. New adjusters with two months of training shouldn't be set wild to figure it out on their own. Designations shouldn't become the goal of what success looks like."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 76 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1jzcv0m/rant_big_red_is_one_of_the_worst_employers_and/

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

"How do y'all deal with actually insane clients? Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride. I answer the phone. Lady leads with "I went to your office and you guys vanished in the middle of the night! Do I even have insurance? I'm reporting you to the government!" Reality: we moved nine months ago. Across the parking lot. Our Google listing has been updated. All our policy docs reflect the new address. There's a literal sign taped to the old door with an arrow saying "we moved next door." She then accuses me of not mailing her documents because I'm "screwing with her bill." Her payment has changed once in the last. It went down from \$92 to \$84. At this point she's yelling more about reporting me for moving. I told her "I'm not interested in getting yelled at. What would you like from me today?" She rants a bit more. I respond with "Okay. I am happy to transfer you to another office if that sounds good to you." She ranted more and eventually hung up. Curious how other agents handle the loons like this. I'd love to move her out of my book, but also can't really do it without her consent. People are nuts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

"Warning: My Experience with Symmetry Financial Group – Please Read Before Joining Hey Reddit, I've been in the insurance industry since 2021 and have had success in multiple roles. I know what real mentorship and growth look like. That's why I feel the need to warn others about my experience with Symmetry Financial Group — because it was one of the most toxic, disorganized, and emotionally draining environments I've ever worked in. Here are the biggest red flags I encountered: • The leads are extremely aged. I was handed leads from as far back as 2016. Calling people who haven't requested life insurance info in nearly a decade felt unethical — more like harassment than service. It genuinely made me uncomfortable. • The culture is toxic. Uplines and agency owners frequently humiliate agents on Zoom calls in front of everyone. There's no support — just power plays, ego, and public shaming. • You're not in control of your own business. They make you ask for permission to get licensed in new states, claiming they won't get paid if you get licensed somewhere they aren't. It's controlling and makes no sense if this is "your business." • Shaming over conferences. Can't afford to attend one of their big events? Be ready to get publicly called out and guilted like you're not serious about your career. It's manipulative and unprofessional. • The training is the worst I've seen in this industry. There's no real structure, no proper onboarding, and no consistent support. You're left confused, overwhelmed, and underprepared. • It affected my mental health. I've never struggled with anxiety — not even in high-pressure sales environments — but while working with SFG, I had debilitating anxiety that impacted every area of my life. As soon as I walked away, that anxiety vanished. That tells you everything. The good news? I've since joined a different IMO with real leadership, training, and respect — and I'm flourishing now. This experience taught me that it's not the industry that's the problem — it's the people you align yourself with. If you're thinking about joining Symmetry Financial Group, please think twice. Don't ignore the red flags. You deserve better."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtqo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/

"What would you do if you had to start over from scratch? I'm 2.5 years into owning my agency and my book is just over \$100k. I've had some rough patches, hell, the first 2 years was a rough patch- but about 6 months ago I came to the conclusion that I'm going to put everything in me and do whatever it takes to grow my business and make up for the two years of my life that I wasted. I've gone 25 years untreated for ADHD and 2 months ago finally made myself an appointment to see what the hell is wrong with me. Fast forward 2 months later and I can finally function like a normal human being. Not only am I able to focus better, talk to people better, feel knowledgeable and handle things more professionally, but I actually care. I want to build something that will feed my family one day, pass down to my children, something that will provide us stability. I scheduled a 30 minute call with an agent I met a few years ago to see how he was doing and quite frankly, how he was doing what he was doing. I took a sneak peek at our companies production reports and this guy was selling nearly \$100k in premium a month. This meeting ended up being an hour long, but the biggest thing I took away was when he said this: "Dude... I have 5 kids", and it clicked. I have to get into survival mode, as if it wasn't just me, but those who depended on me. I think about my parents (whom I want to help retire because they are helping me financially), my girlfriend (whom wants to get married and have children with me one day), and my future kids. At this turning point in my life I am constantly asking people who are doing better than me, or are in places that I want to be, what would you do if you were in my position right now? What can I do to grow amongst these huge \$10M+ book size agents in my area? My goal is to quote over \$160k in premium a month, hopefully the quote to sell conversion ratio turns out good. These are mostly old leads, and eventually I will run out. Every Friday I am going out to 5-6 locations with realtors/brokers/lenders/title agents and handing out cookies, business cards, and a handwritten letter. Hopefully this helps me build a pipeline. I did this last week and people seemed receptive and related to the hustle. What is something I should be focusing on everyday to maximize my agencies growth?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/

"NYC Im a terrible life insurance agent. Can I sell medicare plans? I've posted before about not being able to sell Life Insurance even though I work for one of the biggest companies. I need to transition into something lucrative yet flexible as I have a child and they have a million days off and school events etc. I thought maybe I could get into health care sales but tons of reddit post say that NY is the worst place for health care sale due to the restrictions. If health care is so restrictive, what does everyone over 65 do for medicare?? I hear about FMOs and IMO's but no one lists the good FMO companies in NYC. Anyway, Im at a loss. I need income and flexibility but I dont know how to get that. Any advice?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f81t9g/nyc_im_a_terrible_life_insurance_agent_can_i_sell/

"My experience at bankers life as a new agent. I don't understand the distaste. I came across a post after my interview that made me even more skeptical of the job because I've never had a commission based job, didn't have an insurance license, and this would be my first real job after college. Here is the post I read. [https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/194rgk1/has_anyone_heard_of_bankers_life/](https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/194rgk1/has_anyone_heard_of_bankers_life/) I got my license and passed first try (idk how, I studied hard but the exam was harder than I thought, I couldn't see how many I got wrong). It's the beginning of my 4th week, I've made one small sale but I've set appointments with clients that have a lot of money so they're sending an FA to discuss retirement planning. I've made contact with some of these clients, I study really hard, I do what I'm told, and honestly it feels great. I feel like I'm the edge of something that could be really good. I'm good at what I do and I can tell because not only are the managers impressed with me but so are the other agents that are in their first year. I kind of feel like I'm outpacing a lot of my peers but I'm trying to stay humble. I took a chance with these people because I had limited options but I knew that even if this is the worst company I've ever worked with (it's not) then I would at least come out with a resume with more licenses than I came in with, and could take another swing at the job market. I've been getting calls from other companies since I got my license trying to recruit me, I don't listen to them much. I will be an FA in a year or less with this company, I don't intend to leave here unless I go broke (doubtful) or something unforeseen happens. I was extremely apprehensive when I started but I trusted my manager and gave it my all since if I'm going to try, I'm going to try so hard that I will know without a doubt if it is my fault or the company's if I fail. I'm not failing, I'm impressing and improving. People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager) but there's signs everywhere about being a top 125 training company, have I fact checked this? No, but I haven't felt like I needed to. When I feel like it I will. My managers answer all my questions, see me working hard, and include me on appointments that I can't contribute much to, and we still split the sale. The online resources are extensive and cover so much in a very user friendly way, 30-60 minute panels of top producers explaining what worked for them. I am told this is why they are such a highly rated company for its training. I am also told that this is why BL is unique, because it is 1099 commission based but the support is unmatched. I really enjoy this company so far and if I don't start seeing financial results soon (I'm positive I will) then I will remove this post. Maybe after AEP I'll just drop how much money I've made in the comments and pin it or something and we can see how this post ages. I anticipate a couple thousand dollars in the next couple weeks from less than a handful of sales. Someone who's worked in other insurance agencies tell me what I'm missing if this company is so bad? If I'm being cocky then check back in January to see my suffering and plans to go back on Glassdoor. \-sept 27, 2025 UPDATE It's December 17th, I'm going to try to keep this update relevant to my original. For context, I was let go two weeks ago and am not looking back. Issues had been brewing for weeks and I was already interviewing at another company in case I decided I needed to leave, initially, I didn't see myself being fired but as things escalated, I knew I'd be less surprised. I had the confidence in being hired at another company to stay true to my morals in how I dealt with Bankers. I'll talk about why I was let go later in this post. **Since I referred an older post in my original and commented on it, I'm going to dissect what I said and show a newer perspective:** "People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager)" Quoting the linked post, "being 1099 but being treated like an employee..." I still think the user on the linked post is misguided. You are 1099, and I don't know what negatives they were referring to when being "treated like an employee" but I can say that bankers really does do business in person, the initial interview was the only time I had a formal conversation with my bosses online. Working with my managers in person was something I liked, my new job has had more formal conversation over zoom than in person (so far, I don't officially start until January which is another downside over here) and I miss that about bankers. I also liked that the hierarchy of the office was relatively clear cut. My manager knows she is responsible for me. I liked how there was structure to the company, I was told by my managers and in hindsight still agree that this is GOOD and sets bankers aside from the competition. Agreed. My second sentence regarding insurance as far as I know now, is still completely correct. But working for bankers I realized that everything is a sale, hiring people, building confidence in subordinates, getting your manager to like you even if you don't like them. Everything is a game and everyone is playing. All the sales tactics apply in every corner of the office. Now we have "office politics" where generally, every participant is skilled in how to get what they want from other people, so now there is another layer of paranoia I had and I think rightfully so. I have no idea if becoming a manager and qualifying for bankers insurance is as easy as it was laid out in the interview. I can't tell you how many times, big or small, I thought something would be as easy as 1,2,3 because that was the way it was laid out, when in fact there were so many undisclosed micromanagement tasks attached. Some had to do with clients and don't result in being paid. (Prescription drug plans are needed by most of our clients, but we get paid nothing. And I had an experience that took way longer than it should have) **In regards to my overall outlook on bankers as a company and my experience at the time:** I was pretty successful as a new agent I think, I saw people come and go, I got better and was super proud of my accomplishments being a new grad and never having been in sales before but booking more appointments than some of my peers. I was confident and working hard, everyone in the office saw it. Peers would ask me questions and "most" managers were always eager to help. However management was the reason I was fired, after awhile I realized that I knew I would be very successful at this company and would do everything in my power, without hurting anyone, to accomplish my goals. Before I go into why I was let go I want to say that from my perspective, I think bankers as a company could be very good, it may already be a very good company to work for. I think the resources available online is extensive and very very valuable, I do think working face to face with your company is very valuable too. And I think from a baseline, makes bankers a company to consider. For awhile I really enjoyed it, and I was trying really hard not to drink too much "kool-aid" I wanted to stay humble and careful, celebrate my victories at home and not let anyone see anything they could take advantage of. Ultimately, it could be and probably was, my branch that failed me. Not the company. And the branch did fail me. **Here is why I was let go:** As I've said I was a good new agent, and proud of my progress. As I got better and better I became more and more independent. At first I didn't want to meet clients 1 on 1 because I felt so nervous in my capabilities, naturally management wanted me to go on my own and I understood even if I didn't want to. As I went on these appointments I was told I could call my manager "anytime." Sure enough, questions came up, and without disturbing my rapport with the client, would text or call my manager. Eventually the response I would get is "read the agent guide" or "we'll talk about it during our meeting" but I would never know which agent guide I was being referred to and anytime I looked at our resources they would be 40 pages of word salad and fluff that I mostly already knew with a few bits of new information. Not user friendly and certainly not a good use of time when I could be making new clients, working on my current clients, or learning how to present a new product. So the other response was our meeting. 3/5 days during the week we are on appointments, 2/5 days we are in the office and here is the schedule: 8-12 dial, dial, dial. That's it. 12-1 people trickle out o"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nircj/my_experience_at_bankers_life_as_a_new_agent_i/

"If you were starting over today with no book of business and no carrier appointments, what would you do first? Hi everyone, I officially passed my Texas Life & Health licensing exam yesterday (self studied via an online prep course), and I'm trying to be very intentional about how I build my business from Day 1. A little background: I'm 39 and transitioning from a successful corporate finance career (\$175k, annual) after being laid off in 2025. I want to use this unexpected time to invest in a career pivot to an independent producer, eventually building up to a small boutique style agency. Short-term, I plan to focus on Medicare, ACA, Life Insurance, and Supplemental Health. Longer-term, I'd like to expand into ICHRA and small employer benefits, but I don't want to spread myself too thin in the beginning. My vision is to build a referral- and relationship-based business. I'm much more interested in creating a trusted advisory practice than becoming a high-pressure salesperson. If you were in my shoes today —with no book of business, no carrier appointments, and no industry experience—but knowing what you know now: What would your first three steps be? What mistakes would you avoid? Would you join an agency/FMO first, or would you try to build independently from Day 1? Is there anything you wish someone had told you before your first year? I'm not necessarily looking for the "highest commission" straight away. Instead, I'm trying to build the strongest long-term foundation and book of business. I genuinely appreciate any advice from those who've been through it. Thanks in Advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uxw9ko/if_you_were_starting_over_today_with_no_book_of/

"Boots to the ground!!! It's free my man. That's how I got started 3 years ago. Go to every senior center, senior apartment, retirement homes, food banks and do table events wherever seniors show up. I have so many great relationships. I do a lot of fun events at these places. Keep at it, don't give up. After year 2, referrals start coming in, and you start seeing the fruits of your labor in monthly deposits into the bank account, just keeping your clients happy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1d5disv/turning_65_leads_medicare/16l3fuc/

"When Integrity Collides With the Insurance Industry # When Integrity Collides With the Insurance Industry After a year as a licensed Life, Health & Accident insurance agent—with certifications in Medicare, Fixed Annuities, and Long- and Short-Term Care—I find myself disillusioned, but not defeated. I've worked with three agencies in twelve months. On paper, that looks like instability. In reality, it tells a much more uncomfortable story about how our industry often operates—and who it quietly pushes out. # The First Lesson: Sales Without Suitability My first agency offered free leads, a platform, and a fast track into final expense sales. What it also offered—though less transparently—was pressure. Pressure to sell without first asking whether clients had the financial capacity to participate at all. Pressure to push forward even when something felt wrong. I voiced my concern early. I was clear that bullying tactics and financial assumptions were not how I wanted to serve families. Insurance, after all, is meant to protect people—not corner them. That discomfort was my first warning sign. # The Second Lesson: Knowledge Without Direction The second agency was rich in information and poor in application. Training was constant. Zoom calls filled my days. Education was abundant—but clarity was not. At one point, I asked what I thought was a simple question: "Out of over 250 life insurance policies, which ones should I focus on when serving clients?" The answer was blunt: "Read them all and figure it out." Eventually, the trainings did help. But what was missing was real-world guidance—how to connect authentically with people, how to build relationships beyond vague social media posts that thousands of agents were already making with little return. Knowledge alone does not serve families. Applied wisdom does. # The Third Lesson: Ethics Versus Politics The third agency was captive. The training was solid. For the first time, I learned how to identify real markets and pursue them responsibly. But there was a problem—one that went far deeper than sales technique. A field agent, protected as the "golden child," consistently wrote bad business. Junior agents came and went. Clients were placed into policies that should never have been written. Accountability never traveled upward. When I raised concerns—concerns later corroborated by other agents—I became the problem. When a longstanding nerve issue flared and I was forced to work from home temporarily, the support others received quietly vanished for me. Where teammates had appointments covered during health or family crises, I was left alone. Eventually, I was let go—for "not taking my business seriously." Within five months, nearly everyone on that team was gone. # What This Taught Me I've been told I'm too honest. Too nice. Too much of a "Girl Scout." But here's what I know to be true: insurance done correctly can be a family's saving grace. It can create stability, preserve dignity, and protect generations—if it is written with intention, education, and suitability at its core. I believe clients deserve: * Clear explanations of what a policy **can and cannot** do * Solutions aligned with their actual income and goals * Time to understand, not pressure to comply * Guidance that considers today *and* tomorrow That shouldn't be radical. Yet too often, it is. # The Question I'm Asking Now Is there an agency that believes insurance should be built for generational impact—not quick commissions? An agency that values education over hype. Integrity over volume. Long-term relationships over short-term wins. I'm still here because I believe in this work. I believe in serving people honestly, even when honesty slows the sale. Especially then. If that makes me a "Girl Scout," I'll wear the badge. Because families don't need more salespeople. They need advocates."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1q6lb33/when_integrity_collides_with_the_insurance/

Live transfers and inbound calls (pay per call) · 167 documents

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought "pre-sold leads" from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigant (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the "insurance carrier, not the agent", for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigant wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigant. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

"Had my first sale today! I'm a new agent in Florida, independent. All inbound leads. Today was my first day on my own after training. Just super excited n I needed to put it out there!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 122 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj9u0m/had_my_first_sale_today/

"Let go at 6 months pregnant This happened yesterday. I'm still processing. Couldn't sleep all night. And this is long. I apologize in advance. Been an AE at this small private tech company for almost 2 years. They recently went through a rebrand and wanted us targeting completely new verticals. Leadership and overall processes were a complete mess, and it was honestly a shit show. I wanted to leave, but was holding out until after baby arrived this summer. Q4 was rough. Partly because we have zero good inbound leads and are 100% reliant on outbounds, and we have a 6 month sales cycle on average. Except our CEO acts like it should be a 2-meeting close. My old boss was fired and I got a new boss in January. In February, I was told I needed to hit my revenue numbers by end of March, along with all these KPIs metrics, and training a new guy he hired. I've never been on a PIP in my life (been an AE for 7 years), but it didn't feel formal in that there was no document and I never signed anything. Just told I need to do this and this. Now, normally the advice is to start applying immediately. And I did. However my situation is a bit different as I'm pregnant and due this summer. Made it to the offer stage at another company and then informed them I was pregnant, hoping to negotiate some sort of leave. Unfortunately they couldn't offer me any paid leave and my job also wouldn't be protected since I wouldn't qualify for FMLA. At my current company, I would. So it felt safer in the moment to stay. I worked my ass off. Consistently delivered on outreach KPIs, spent hours training the new hire, helped with new marketing initiatives developing new 1-pagers and helping with new outreach playbook development. Really trying to show I'm an asset and praying I could stay on through the summer. After that, I wouldn't care. Still, my revenue was down and my other deals were tied up in legal and I was starting to worry. But out of nowhere one of my old deals I closed last summer was acquired and the new company reached out per their recommendation, and wanted to move forward. This new deal would single handedly hit my revenue numbers. However the compliance aspect took forever. Our team is so disorganized and makes it so hard to buy. Then onboarding. Unfortunately I also sell a consumption based product. So even though they sign the contract and commit to X volume, the revenue generated is dependent on their ramp...which is in the hands of the client success team. And then wouldn't you have it, this CSM did the bare minimum to help them ramp. I felt like I was being sabotaged. Even my boss agreed that they were not doing their job. I stepped up and held meetings to help the client onboard, go through the set up and integration. The CSM completely dropped the ball. No reoccurring meetings in place until they fully ramped, nothing. Basically told them "if you need help lmk". Insane. So, yesterday arrived and I was below my revenue number. But I SHOULD have hit it. And I've been doing so much I really didn't feel worried. Mind you, my entire team was below as well. Revenue was stagnant across the company. But my boss called me out of the blue and I was terminated on the spot. No emotion. No severance. No paid out PTO. No extended insurance. Nothing. My income makes up 60% of our household income. And I use their insurance. Which I have doctors appointments set up every 2 weeks. They've completely fucked me as no company is going to hire me when I give birth in 3 months and also pay me for leave. I don't know what the fuck to do. We genuinely cannot afford to not have my income until Fall. Do I have any legal leg to stand on, or can they just say I fell short of performance, even if I'm dependent on others to do their job AND the entire company was stagnant on revenue? (For reference, I was the only one with a contract signed in Q1 and I had 2 others under review)."

— r/sales · 108 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1jp0avi/let_go_at_6_months_pregnant/

"AMA - Never selling insurance to 85k monthly commissions starting my own agency **AMA: Nine months ago I'd never sold a policy. Today my ACA book does about \$85k/month with a \$34 CPA and ~3% loss. Here's what I wish I'd researched before spending money. Quick context** * Licensed end of Oct '24, started selling Jan '25 * Put **\$100k** in over the year * I buy **live inbound callers only** (no cold lists) **How I handle calls (this mattered most)** * Calls only route to me when I'm not already on the phone, so I don't miss people * If I miss a customer service call, I call back the same day—no exceptions * Clients get a real number that reaches me—my personal cell, 24/7. Hard work, but it built trust and referrals **What to research before you spend \$1** * Refund policy in writing: what counts as a bad call, how returns work, when credits land * Answer/contact rates by hour and source (real stats, not guesses) * County/ZIP targeting that matches ACA networks I can actually place * Consent/compliance language used before the call reaches me * Delivery control so I can cap/pause and touch every caller the same day **Money I wasted** * "Cheap" calls with vague or slow refunds * Buying volume before the intake script and follow-up rhythm were dialed in * Fancy software I didn't use every day **Money that paid off** * Speed + clarity: short script, quick verify, clear next step, same-day follow-up * Call recording + quick QC: 10 minutes a day fixed leaks I couldn't see in a spreadsheet * Knowing ACA cold: networks, formularies, prior auth, renewal quirks—explained in plain English (be the expert and put people at ease) **My lead-vendor checklist now** 1. Refund/credit rules and SLA (in writing) 2. Sample ads so I know there's no fake incentivizing 3. State targeting and delivery hours 4. I can throttle/stop calls instantly **Process that moved the needle** * 3 steps: verify basics → solve the real problem → set a specific next time/action * 1–2 plan options max, with reasons (menus slow everything down) * Same-day everything, or conversion drops * Post-enrollment customer care (ID cards, network checks, "what now?") drives referrals and keeps churn low (~3%) **Simple weekly scoreboard** * Reached calls / total calls * Kept appointments * Submits * Time to first touch * Service issues per member * Refund rate / turnaround * CPA (~\$34) and trend **If I had to start over (I could do it much cheaper—\$10–20k)** * Spend the first 2–3 weeks on scripts, routing, notes template, and a manual follow-up schedule * Trial multiple **live-call** vendors in tiny batches; only scale the one that proves contactability and refunds * Keep the tech boring: I run everything in Excel and Google Calendar * Give clients a real number and show up—that's what makes referrals happen That's my playbook and the lessons. AMA about the research, spend, setup, or what I'd cut or double down on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 62 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/

"How do y'all deal with actually insane clients? Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride. I answer the phone. Lady leads with "I went to your office and you guys vanished in the middle of the night! Do I even have insurance!? I'm reporting you to the government!" Reality: we moved nine months ago. Across the parking lot. Our Google listing has been updated. All our policy docs reflect the new address. There's a literal sign taped to the old door with an arrow saying "we moved next door." She then accuses me of not mailing her documents because I'm "screwing with her bill." Her payment has changed once in the last. It went down from \$92 to \$84. At this point she's yelling more about reporting me for moving. I told her "I'm not interested in getting yelled at. What would you like from me today?" She rants a bit more. I respond with "Okay. I am happy to transfer you to another office if that sounds good to you." She ranted more and eventually hung up. Curious how other agents handle the loons like this. I'd love to move her out of my book, but also can't really do it without her consent. People are nuts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

"How I retired my wife with my insurance agency, AMA I launched my agency in 2023 after working for years as a producer, underwriter, and consultant. It started as a side project with one goal in mind, to build enough recurring income to retire my wife and give us both more freedom. Within the first year I turned it into a full-time operation using an aggregator for market access and an organic marketing system that focused on building real relationships instead of buying leads. If you are trying to start or scale your own agency, here's what I can share: • How I used social media to generate consistent inbound leads without paying for ads • How I manage quoting, follow ups, and virtual assistant support to keep volume moving • How niche markets like pressure washing and contractors helped create stable renewals • What commission structures and business habits made the biggest difference early on • How to build an agency that supports your family and gives you time freedom Ask me anything about licensing, operations, staffing, lead generation, or what it actually takes to build an agency that can change your lifestyle."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o2ysrs/how_i_retired_my_wife_with_my_insurance_agency_ama/

"What Uplines Don't Want you to Know - Carrier Release Process - Explained This is a question I get a ton from new agents, and its what every upline doesn't want you to learn, so please... learn it. Treat this information like it's required for you to be in the industry to know. Review your contracts with your uplines and make sure you have protection within them as well. Heck, get a lawyer to review it. Whatever it takes, I see too many agents getting trapped in awful comp deals and abusive uplines and get "Stockholmed" into buying bad leads from them and then gaslighting them into thinking its their fault. I've been there done that. This info is for the agent that calls themselves independent:

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Demystifying Agent Contracting, Releases, and Blackout Periods I work directly with 54 carriers, 4 FMOs, multiple agencies, and nearly 1,000 independent agents. My role involves overseeing contracting, licensing, and agent/agency development. With experience spanning so many entities, I've had the chance to see the contracting process from all angles and business models. Let me break it down for anyone who's struggling to navigate this space. # Steps to Understand Contracting and Releases

1. **Contract Level (LOA vs. Broker):** * If you're directly contracted with a carrier as a truly independent broker *and* haven't signed an agreement restricting you to one entity (or an LOA contract, which assigns your commission to your upline), you should generally be free to contract with another carrier or upline without issues. 2. **Private Contracts (Non-Competes or No Non-Competes):** * If you're tied to a brokerage or agency and have a private contract (like a non-compete), get a lawyer to review your options. Some of these cannot be upheld in court, that's important for you to know. * Medicare agents may want to wait until the start of the year for a smoother transition —this avoids AEP complications. 3. **Carrier Blackout Periods:** * **New agents** can contract anytime, even during AEP, for Medicare Advantage (MA) and Medicare Supplement (Med-Supp) plans. * **Switching uplines or FMOs, however, is restricted** during AEP for MA carriers (typically September–December). * If you're contracting with a carrier for the first time, you can get a **new contract** during AEP, but you can't **switch uplines** until the blackout period ends. 4. **Release Process (To Release or Not):** * Brokers contracted directly with carriers usually retain their commissions unless restricted by a private contract (see Step 2). * You can file a self-release with an "intent to transfer". After 90–180 days, the carrier can re-contract you under a new upline while allowing you to keep producing during the interim. (you will be compensated according to your previous contract if you decide to continue producing, you wont get commission for producing if you WERE an LOA agent because your effective comp is 0%) * This safeguards agents from being stuck in unfavorable relationships. Most agents prefer waiting until the start of the year to minimize risks. The key is understanding your contract and navigating transitions safely, which is something many agents overlook. # A Brief History of the Release Process (why the heck is it this way?) The "agent-release" process emerged in the late 90s and early 2000s to manage transfers between FMOs and carriers. Unfortunately, it was often abused, with FMOs refusing to grant releases, especially during AEP, leaving agents trapped in bad contracts. To address this, carriers like UnitedHealthcare, Aetna, and Humana introduced transfer freezes during AEP to protect their investments. The "intent to transfer" process, developed in the late 2000s and early 2010s, aimed to fix these issues by providing agents a path to transfer without jeopardizing their business. # Misunderstandings About Releases If your agency/FMO/upline tells you "you can't transfer," it's likely because their training hasn't been updated to reflect the proper release procedures. This isn't usually malicious, they just want to ensure you're not left without commissions. Nobody wants to risk that. Also, the information is incredible "gate-kept", it's not a "sexy" process everyone wants to learn, until they need it... If you're looking for additional insight, this [YouTube video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NaExikyNwzo) (not affiliated with me or my company) provides a solid overview of the release process. However, it doesn't touch on the contract-level distinctions I've outlined here. Understanding these processes can help you avoid costly errors and confidently take control of your career. If you have questions or need clarification, feel free to ask!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gv923a/what_uplines_dont_want_you_to_know_carrier/

"I've taken 5 inbound calls. Out of the five one wasn't interested. One got disconnected on app. Three I took to close. One was 89 and could only go Aetna and she got declined but I sold the other two. Spent like 250 to write 3k."

— YouTube · The King of Inbound Life Insurance Leads (Ep.286) · 19 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=21mejMXBn_Y&lc=UgwXBfpJr3TZxCCUiKV4AaABAq

"How is everyone marketing in 2025 without spending a fortune? For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down. Since, I've tried multiple vendors, and I've tried data leads + telemarketers. It feels like no matter what I do, I have to spend 5 grand a month in marketing at least for each of my producers just to hit our goals. It's way too much, and as we spend more to make less, I'm feeling bad burnout as my margins shrink. Primarily P&C, captive agent. So what is everybody doing that's working?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/

"Useful tip for new agents Stop paying for leads that's the wrong way to start off as a new agent you have to learn the business first so it's best to get with a agency that provides inbound leads and learning about handling chargebacks before you go independent it's a marathon not a sprint. If your with an agency that gives inbound leads and training your going to make money if your disciplined enough."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 16 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kxqsr/>

"A few things: - Anyone you buy leads/calls from need to give you contract language specifically for this situation. - Litigators are 100% bad faith, this is how they "makes living". The upside is that between the "I paid for a live transfer and you'll need to talk to the company that drive the call" is valid - Litigators are lazy assholes. Best bet is to match their energy and say you will show up in court to litigate this. \$10k is the small claims limit in a few states. Some are \$5k and a few are higher. The MO is to file in SC, show up to the hearing and then get a judgement. That's why you should show up with a contract to give to the judge showing you are not responsible for this litigator doing what they're doing. That \$25k settlement is now Civil Court territory, meaning you need to retain representation... in other words, it's costs money. Call their bluff, show up to any SC hearing."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/mjv8uf0/

"Interesting to see the other side of a serial litigator. Questions for you: What is your plan for when the incoming calls stop? Can you say with absolute sincerity that you're not taking any action to receive these illegal calls? You sure you're not intentionally putting yourself in a position for opportunities to sue these companies/agents? I can't tell if you're posting this to be a genuine warning or maybe even bragging... but it actually reads like "Careful about your lead source, or else people without real jobs like me are going to sue you." Do what everyone else does and block the numbers that call and hop on Indeed dude. No I have never been sued by a serial litigator because I only receive direct inbound calls, but I can still cringe at you for bottom feeding."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8y0u2a/

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crid=11ZYLLHHAOSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&srefix=how+to+win+friend%2C&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_5?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: I Industry I Description I I --- I --- I Tech I You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. I Med I You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in *The Pursuit of Happiness*. I Finance/Insurance I You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. I Hardware/Construction I Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. I Cars I You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. I Door to Door I Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. I So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. I JOB TITLE I PAY RANGE (Salary) I PAY RANGE (OTE) I DESCRIPTION** I I --- I --- I --- I SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) I £25,000 - £40,000 I £50,000 - £80,000 I Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. I SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive I £30,000 - £60,000 I £50,000 - £140,000 I Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. I MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive I £40,000 - £75,000 I £60,000 - £150,000 I Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. I ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive I £50,000 - £100,000 I £70,000 - £250,000 I Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. I SALES MANAGER I £60,000 - £120,000 I £80,000 - £200,000 I Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. I MD: Managing Director I £100,000+ I £100,000+ I Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. I HEAD OF SALES I £100,000+ I £100,000+ I Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. I Terminology I Description I I --- I --- I Cold call I When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. I Lead I This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead'', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. I Account I This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. I Contact I This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. I Example of a lead, a contact and an account. I Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

"Stop buying leads I constantly see people on here complaining about shitty, expensive, shared leads. Listen guys, YouTube exists, this stuff isn't hard. Facebook and Google have dumbed setting things up so much it's ridiculous. You want to know how to create your own leads? On Facebook you can find a built in tool called Facebook ads library. Type in the insurance product you sell and filter the results to show active ads that have been running 6month-1year. The older the ad the more successful. If the ad wasn't making money, they would have killed the ad. Copy/model that ad. For Google, pick a big city, Google <what you sell> <big city> whoever shows up at the top probably has a good ad. Look at their ad copy then look at the landing page they use. Copy/model them. It's simple, YouTube to figure out the setup, research what ads work, copy them.... And now you're getting your leads at cost and you have full control of them. It's easier than you would think."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 163 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466yj/stop_buying_leads/

"New rules (with a slight change) Thank you to everyone that has assisted with helping with the new rules. Here's where we landed, and there is one small tweak: 1. This is not a place to sell your services or generate leads or recruit agents/downlines. Consumers should not get offers to quote or to privately "help". This includes asking people to vet your software/AI or other peripheral concepts as well as advertising your website or app (even if it is currently free). 2. Do not post any unethical, illegal or unhelpful content. 3. Be a good reflection of the industry and remain professional. The difference is in Rule #1, and it is specific to a pattern of behavior of some life agents that have been trying to recruit to some quasi-MLM companies (I say "quasi" because I don't think that any DOI has stated it as a fact). Many of those trying to recruit are doing so with little to no posting history, which makes it very odd. The sidebar will be reflected soon to reflect this, but you should consider that these rules are currently being enforced as of this post. Edit as of 7/23/26 - effective immediately, we're no longer allowing posts that are asking for help with ideas for software, websites, apps or other SaaS concepts. Even if it's currently free, if you're linking people to something of yours, expect it to be removed at a minimum. Even if you're just asking for people to vet an idea, expect it to be removed at a minimum."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 79 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cdomsd/new_rules_with_a_slight_change/

"The Lifeboat Mentality The art of selling is truly an art, and guess what, it's something that every single one of us needs to master - fast. I'm going to get the first, and what I think is the most important step out of the way immediately: **Stop trying to sell *products* and start selling *yourself*** When I first started, I always had this question in my sales experience: Why is it that one guy has extreme success selling the same product, and another guy doesn't? Let me tell you about a time when I sold life insurance that completely changed the way I sell, and will sell for the rest of my life. So, I got hired at a huge brokerage in Florida. We were contracted with 40+ different insurance agencies to market and sell their products. I had to be licensed to sell annuities, medicare products, health insurance, prescription drug packages, and life insurance. So, needless to say we had an **ARSENAL** of products to choose from. During the orientation, we were greeted by the companies top salesman. The idea was for him to come in and share his success, and answer any questions us newbies may have before we ventured out on our own. It came about time for him to come speak, and in my head I'm thinking some young 20-something was going to bolt through the door with excitement and enthusiasm. Wrong. In walks a 60-year old retired war-veteran who had been crushing the insurance game in this company for the last year, month after month! His annualized premium average was close to \$26,000 per month. (This is the amount of Premiums people that he sold to were paying on a monthly basis. He not only receives residuals off of this, sometimes he'll even receive a 90-95% commission off of the first-year premium total - If they pay \$100 per month, he receives around \$1000) I couldn't believe it. But, me transitioning from shock to understanding, I began to listen to him. His success was no secret. He literally worked "harder" than everyone else. His military mentality came into play big time in this field. Why? He would knock on 30 doors per day. Non stop, wake up at 7am, and not go home until 5pm, or until he successfully spoke to 30 people. His strength was in his numbers. Law of averages! If he got a "No." he wouldn't waste a second, bat an eye, or fold. He knew his power was in his ability to talk to as many people as possible. Day after day, same mentality: Do it, or die. (Not to that extent, but you get the idea!) **Takeaway One: Understand the law of averages, and commit to it!** However, although we had an arsenal to sell from, I became completely overwhelmed because it seemed impossible to take in all of the product specs and legalities, all while trying to create a smooth sales pitch. So, instead of focusing on things I didn't know, I just focused on one of the many things I could sell that would give me the best chance at success: life insurance. I modeled the success of the older salesman, and knocked door to door to offer our product relentlessly. But, door to door sales isn't as easy as it seems. Actually, it doesn't seem easy at all. Think about it. Have you ever bought anything from someone who randomly walked up to your door trying to sell something to you? The idea is crazy. But, it works. Numbers game. Same with cold calling, and same with any service. The idea is to put yourself in a position to collide your product with a consumer in demand, at the time they have made up their mind to purchase. If they haven't made up their mind to purchase, it's your job, as a salesman to help them. But, knowing how crazy this idea is, I had to separate myself and treat people as if they were my friends. I didn't come across as pushy, I came across as informative, and very confident - I adopted the **Life Boat Mentality** The Life Boat Mentality is simple: Your customers are drowning. They are drowning from poor quality products or services. You see them drowning in these products or services, and paddle on over in your Lifeboat. The idea is this: With impeccable trust, of course, you persuade your client to get in your life boat. Your life boat is the "best" option. And if it's not the best option, you need to find a company that offers the best option and sell that. (I'm not about selling garbage - Honestly) If you truly in your heart believe that what you are selling is the best option, the Lifeboat Mentality will help you tremendously. For example. I own a small residential repaint company now. I've taken the Lifeboat Mentality with me throughout my entire duration owning a business. I've got the branding where I want it, I have the production where it needs to be, and the Lifeboat mentality that I carry with me says this: Mr. & Mrs. Customer: I know that there is a TON of options in the marketplace. So many to choose from, however, I know this for a fact. There will be none other than my company that will show you the amount of respect and care you deserve throughout the entire tenure of us working for you. From the initial handshake to the final good-bye I can guarantee that our quality of service is of exemplary fashion. How do I ensure that this remains true? How do I have the confidence to pitch this? Because as the business owner, I insure it. My sales process is down to a science and has clear concise wording, professional formatting, and a great follow-up procedure. We have references and a great website for them to visit, and provide insurance and legal information up front. I ensure that I will be at each job to make sure that our quality of service is exactly as promised. In other words, I'm showing them that I "me", the "salesperson" am the lifeboat! It may seem silly at first, but think of yourself as a lifeboat. Start saving people! Happy selling! P.S if you're interested in knowing more about the painting business, feel free to PM me I'd be happy to answer any questions you may have!"

— r/sales · 47 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/7tph4u/the_lifeboat_mentality/

"Sorry I didn't provide value so I'll do it here: my favorite lead vendors I've used 1. Smart Finaical - seo leads 2. Happy agent - Fb leads 3. Nectar leads are insurance leads for seo and Fb Also if you are an agent your upline or leader should be able to provide you the best sources. Sorry for this I care about you"

— YouTube · The Best Life Insurance Leads For 2024 | My \$500k/Yr Lead Source · 44 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gtXNK0-8f7c&lc=UgxSK3d37q7CBMR8CY54AaABAg.9zPnaAfMyXt9zPrRMljeY8>

"Are there ANY truly "good" life insurance companies to work for?? I'm in the process of getting my license, so still very new to the biz. I've read the horror stories of truly bad MLM-like companies and am staying away from those (although strangely, they seem to have their fair share of happy employees), so I did a very basic Google search of "The Best Life Insurance Companies to Work For." I got answers like Northwestern, Mutual of Omaha, New York Life, etc. So I go to Glassdoor & Indeed to read employee reviews, and those are just as all over the place as the MLMs! "Best company in the world, changed my life", "Shit leads, non-existent training, if you don't meet production goals you're fired". My question is: How do I know where the truly GOOD companies are if all the reviews are like this? I just want an entry-level role to get my feet wet, aiming for \$80k/yr in the first couple years. Nothing crazy. Thanks for any advice!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 41 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/164ik21/are_there_any_truly_good_life_insurance_companies/

"If you want to get advanced: Google is the more expensive option but the leads are higher quality. Someone googling already has intent to buy, whereas on Facebook you're just scrolling your timeline and someone is interpreting you with an ad. Also there's more fake leads for some reason on Facebook, but they're also way cheaper. What we like to do is get traffic from Google ads and then use Facebook remarketing to put our Facebook ads in front of the expensive Google traffic that didn't buy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466yj/stop_buying_leads/mo7pbhg/

"Brand New Independent Agents This is just a rant post. I find it extremely weird when brand new agents want to be independent but also expect everything to be given to them. The entire point of being independent is that you are the OWNER of YOUR business. If I decided to open to a floral shop, I would have to pay for inventory, supplies, a website, marketing, and anything else that I needed to run my business. I'd be responsible for going out and marketing myself & my business to attract customers. I wouldn't expect to make money if I was only open for a couple of hours a few days a week, because no one else is giving me a paycheck. And if I didn't know how to run a business, I would find someone who could give me the play by play. Not just someone who said they could, but someone who had proof they'd done it. Insurance is no different. New independent agents are constantly complaining about back office fees, that their IMO doesn't provide them free leads, being 1099, and having to actually bust their ass to make money... and after putting forth half ass effort, blame their agency or upline for not making money. If you want a paycheck, to clock out the same time every day, and someone to provide you leads, GO CAPTIVE. This is why most new agents fail because they saw someone on TikTok that told them they could make \$20,000 in a month. Which is POSSIBLE, I have seen it, not fresh out the gate. You don't even know what you're doing yet! And honestly, you already need to have money put back to carry you in the beginning months until you start to make money... that's where you need to start anyway. This isn't a get rich quick scheme. It's a real business that you have to put real work into."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tnmhue/brand_new_independent_agents/

"Is a Life & Health Insurance License Useless? 🤔 I've had a Life & Health Insurance license for 2 weeks. It feels useless for finding a job. All the local captive agents focus on Property & Casualty. They like seeing L&H but they don't sell any. Even if they advertised for a L&H position. I applied to local banks and credit unions. I'm a notary too but heard nothing back. A recruiter from Brown & Brown reached out. She liked my resume and experience a lot. B2B Sales and Marketing, Tradeshow, SEO, etc. She has no job for me. I've had Life Insurance and Medicare outfits calling me. All commission based. They sound like scams and MLMs. I've tried getting an Employee Benefits Advisor job but these seem rare. Ideally I'd like to work at a hospital and help people choose health plans. Applied with health insurance companies. Haven't heard back. Are L&H license useful at all? What should I do to find a job? UPDATE - The Kaplan training I did was part of a hiring process for a Financial Services company. They paid with no strings attached as part of the final hiring process. They ended up not hiring me even after I passed the test. The goal was to do SIE and other FINRA certs. UPDATE 2 - Many of you are saying just go get a Property & Casualty license via DM. Yes would be good to do but I don't have a ton of money right now. Would much prefer to get a job that will pay for my P&C training and licensing. I was thinking of just watching Melissa from Insurance Exam Queen. She and Peter were so valuable for passing the L&H test."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lavqn1/is_a_life_health_insurance_license_useless/

"Dream came true at 19 Firstly, I want to preface I had never known anything about being an insurance agent until I was 16. When I was 16 I had the opportunity to work under a local State Farm agent and he showed me the ropes. I got hooked. In late 2024, when I turned 18, I immediately when for all 4 of my licenses and got a job at a larger State Farm agency as a producer. My plan then was to stay for 1-3 years then become an independent agent under an independent agency. Fast forward 10 months later and I was proud to say I was starting my own agency. The first months were tough. I didn't know what I was doing and I stepped into a world of uncertainty. But in May of this year I got myself a lease, and started working hard on digital ad campaigns. This month I will end the month with 55-60K in premium annualized. No paid internet leads, just \$500/mo in google ads (first month starting google ads), google reviews, referrals, an my office location. I'm so excited for what's to come and I just wanted to share my experience as a new agency owner. Dreams do come true, I'm just hitting a small milestone that I've dreamed of since I was 16. My plan is to end the year with a 400-500k book (all business written by myself) Next year I want to hire a producer. Agency owners, how were your first years? How did you manage growth and retention? And lastly, is this a realistic goal and plan? Thank you!!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uewxrx/dream_came_true_at_19/

"He had to search us out, go to our website, and submit a form with info about the company so that an agent can get in touch"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rsznnr/text_exchange_from_a_prospect_who_reached_out_to/oaarbi/

"As an Independent Broker, what is the best way to generate leads? I recently got my Life & Health license in NY and I am trying to figure out how to structure my business ONLINE. I've been appointed with several carriers over the past few months. My background is in marketing, specifically Ecommerce so I have a solid understanding of running Facebook ads. However, I am having trouble pulling the trigger and actually getting started due to trying to figure out all of the rules and regulations. Analysis paralysis. I plan on pumping out quality content on my website and socials both of which are not yet created. As an Independent in NY, my business name is my first and last name. Does my domain name and socials have to be my first and last name or can it be something random like "High Creek Financial", for example? I guess I am having trouble with establishing my brand identity. Should it be ME posting content and interacting in the community or should it be "High Creek Financial". I'm apprehensive to just use my name for my brand because it will make me appear like the one man show that I am. My thoughts are that if I was able to use "High Creek Financial" for example, that it would give off the vibe that I'm with a big, legit company. I don't know if any of this is even making sense so I apologize in advance. As I'm writing this, I keep thinking to myself, "wtf am i even saying?" Should I do something like this: <https://www.marblepay.com/> and be in the background or should I just use my personal brand and not care that people will see that I'm a one man show? If anyone has any experience with generating their own leads, could I pick your brain a little bit? Thanks!!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 18 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fj86x3/as_an_independent_broker_what_is_the_best_way_to/

Aged leads · 123 documents

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought "pre-sold leads" from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigator (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the "insurance carrier, not the agent", for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigator wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigator. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

"Quiet quitting - byeeeeeeee I'm an sdr at an insurance company. Fully remote. We grind hard every day - like 200+ dials. Warm and cold leads - no break in the calls or voicemails. All day. Every day. Calls and voicemails pop literally every 10-15 seconds. The commission is crap, but the base is comfortable. Here's the issue - I have decided this is not for me and I am going to quiet quit until they fire me. How do I disengage completely when I am compelled to do well and to succeed? Do I just ride the clock? Do I blow sales intentionally? Or what. A little help and guidance. TIA"

— r/sales · 105 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/14m75j1/quiet_quitting_byeeeeeeee/

"I'm learning off 5-10 year old leads making 300+ dials a day to learn as fast as possible made my first sale yesterday thanks for the video"

— YouTube · Cold Calling 3-Month-Old Leads LIVE – Watch Me Close Insurance Sales · 52 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qvBEaHr_MGU&lc=Ugybs2i2wGd1cChHPq54AaABAg

"I've been calling very old leads, some a year plus. Wanted to share the opener I've been using & it's been working. "Hi Mark, my name is David, calling from not too far down the road here in Tampa. First & foremost I wanted to apologize for it taking so long to follow up with you, how have you been?" I've never talked to these people in my life, but guards seem to be let down. Great video. Keep it up."

— YouTube · LIVE Dialing: Cold Calling Insurance Leads (SCRIPT GIVEAWAY) · 47 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=POOoucTXJYc&lc=Ugy-hLbZx8ABAWNvJd44AaABAg>

"the shared leads thing is such a scam and I can't believe we all just accept it Bought a batch of "exclusive" commercial leads last month. Called the first ten. Three of them told me I was the fourth agent to call that week. Fourth. So I'm paying, what, \$14 a lead to race three other brokers to the same shipping company owner who's already annoyed before I even open my mouth? How is that a business model for anyone except the vendor selling the list four times? The aged leads are somehow worse. Bought some for like \$2-3 each thinking okay, these are old but at least they're cheap. Half the businesses had closed or changed ownership. One number was a Subway. Not a Subway that needed commercial coverage, just a Subway where some guy named Dave was confused about why insurance agents kept calling him. I don't even know what the alternative is honestly. Every lead vendor I've tried does the same thing with slightly different branding. You either pay a lot for leads that five people already called, or you pay a little for leads that are basically dead. Pick your poison I guess. anyway rant over, back to dialing"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 31 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s5vcry/the_shared_leads_thing_is_such_a_scam_and_i_cant/

"What would you do if you had to start over from scratch? I'm 2.5 years into owning my agency and my book is just over \$100k. I've had some rough patches, hell, the first 2 years was a rough patch- but about 6 months ago I came to the conclusion that I'm going to put everything in me and do whatever it takes to grow my business and make up for the two years of my life that I wasted. I've gone 25 years untreated for ADHD and 2 months ago finally made myself an appointment to see what the hell is wrong with me. Fast forward 2 months later and I can finally function like a normal human being. Not only am I able to focus better, talk to people better, feel knowledgeable and handle things more professionally, but I actually care. I want to build something that will feed my family one day, pass down to my children, something that will provide us stability. I scheduled a 30 minute call with an agent I met a few years ago to see how he was doing and quite frankly, how he was doing what he was doing. I took a sneak peek at our companies production reports and this guy was selling nearly \$100k in premium a month. This meeting ended up being an hour long, but the biggest thing I took away was when he said this: "Dude... I have 5 kids", and it clicked. I have to get into survival mode, as if it wasn't just me, but those who depended on me. I think about my parents (whom I want to help retire because they are helping me financially), my girlfriend (whom wants to get married and have children with me one day), and my future kids. At this turning point in my life I am constantly asking people who are doing better than me, or are in places that I want to be, what would you do if you were in my position right now? What can I do to grow amongst these huge \$10M+ book size agents in my area? My goal is to quote over \$160k in premium a month, hopefully the quote to sell conversion ratio turns out good. These are mostly old leads, and eventually I will run out. Every Friday I am going out to 5-6 locations with realtors/brokers/lenders/title agents and handing out cookies, business cards, and a handwritten letter. Hopefully this helps me build a pipeline. I did this last week and people seemed receptive and related to the hustle. What is something I should be focusing on everyday to maximize my agencies growth?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/

"The shxty part is most agencies teach their agents it's a numbers game while they sell you over priced aged leads. Then you're outside all day chasing shxx leads like an axxhole and then they give you poor sales training. My advice is to master reframing and tonality. Get those two aspects down and fine tune your pitch and you'll increase your close rate. I been there and it honestly was horrible. Left and got into AI SaaS but if I had to do it again I'd master those two aspects first. Also remember Chase compassion, not commission."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ueswou/i_fully_respect_the_hustle_that_is_insurance/otmgwyw8/

"My number one recommendation is to buy leads. Not any leads, Aged Leads. Specifically leads that are 9-12 months old. Old enough where they don't get calls but need a policy or are open to getting a policy at a lower rate. The CPL and CPA are low enough to give you the ability to generate considerable revenue over a 90 day period. At that point in time you can pivot into more expensive marketing solutions or paying someone to run the marketing for you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/mygpk0u/

"Dude I just want to say I started an ad. The first day not much happened. The second day I didn't think much was going to happen but then I got two leads. The third day I woke up to 4 leads and collected more throughout the day The fourth day I got even more. Every single one of these leads I can get on the phone I sale. I hit them as fast as I can, ideally within 60 seconds. My biggest challenge right now is just getting them to answer the phone. Peter I can't begin to thank you enough this gives me soooo much more flexibility in my business as before I looked into this I primarily relied on door knocking one year old leads and it was more expensive and time consuming.

Thank you thank you thank you"

— YouTube · Generate UNLIMITED Final Expense Leads On Facebook In 2024 (Full Tutorial) · 22 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aTFT03FiUCM&lc=UgxcG3JUruxdb4y1pCR4AaABAq>

"And find a solid lead source. I run my own ads on social media, and buy aged leads (30+ days) from USA Life Leads to help fill my day. I've wasted sooo much money on leads. More does not equal better.."

— YouTube · My BIGGEST Advice To A New Life Insurance Agent! 🚀 #insurance #insuranceagent #insurancesa · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AGiTFBC4oSM&lc=UgzcN16DCaTdKHMfyIB4AaABAq>

"Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdoteal personal experience) Jornaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use jornaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower intent.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trustd lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. ,get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer844c/

"For those of us who've already been living in this final telesales telesales world, I thought it would be a good idea to share tips, carriers, and lead vendors to our cohorts to help them during these uncertain times. Whats your favorite carrier? Whats your favorite kind of lead? What tips do you have? --- My favorite carrier is American Amicable because of the ease of doing business. Although, I am finding, that many other carriers are getting better daily. The best lead for telesales is still TV. However, Facebook lead costs have CRASHED. This is a great time to jump in and get leads for \$2-\$3. I wouldnt use a vendor only to pay 200% more. Research and do it yourself. Heres my tip. Dont go back through all your old leads and think you are going to resurrect intrest. Buy new leads, and buy alot of them."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Forum · 11 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/final-expense-telesales-tips.101595/#post-134450>
[4](#)

T65 lists, direct mail, mailers · 120 documents

"Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdoteal personal experience) Jornaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use jornaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower intent.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trustd lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. ,get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer844c/

"I have been in this industry for 14 years and it has become a shell of it's former self. Let me explain. In 2009 is when CMS enacted over 100 new regulations in the Medicare industry. New regulations included annual enrollment periods, government regulated commissions for Part C and D, a Scope of Appointment form that must be completed prior to an agent's presentation, annual AHIP certifications to be able to sell policies in addition to annual carrier certifications, soon after new legislation that required MA plans to have to have a network which killed PFFS plans which were the most popular MA plans at that time, laws which forbids agents to market Part C and D products, laws which govern every aspect of agents holding seminars even including not allowing agents to offer free meals for attendees, the inability to call referrals (the referral must contact you), regulations on carriers that made it illegal for carriers to offer bonuses and trips to agents for production rewards, and many more that I can't think of off the top of my head. After these draconian regulations were passed most agents left the industry. The only ones that stayed were the agents that had a solid book of business prior to these new regulations which is why the average age of a Medicare agent is 60 years old. This industry's golden age was from 1998 to 2008. Medicare Advantage was a brand new concept as well a few years later Part D was brand new as well. There were plenty of reasons why seniors needed to talk with an agent during this time and the big money was made at this time. That all changed in 2009. CMS used the excuse that since agents were getting compensated with taxpayer money (Medicare funding Dollars) that CMS had the right to regulated everything about the agent's existence in this industry. In 2020, very little has changed under the Trump administration. The only good thing to be improved upon was CMS not requiring the Scope of Appointment form to be filled out 48 hours prior to an agent's presentation and changed it to the same day as the appointment. Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as well for fear that the carrier will get in trouble with CMS and lose funding for their plans. Part D plans pay almost nothing for the sheer amount of work that needs to be done reviewing your client's drug list every year that you are almost working for free. MAPD plans pay the same commission as MA only plans. Now if you understand inflation this is another issue as well. The US Dollar loses 2%-3% of it's value every year which causes prices to increase, but you get paid renewals based upon commission rates from the first year you write the business. So while you do make renewals, those renewals become less and less every year. Now that MA plans have ironed out their networks and funding is stabilized, there is little need for seniors to switch Medicare plans every year because they already are in the best plan possible. You can go after T65 business, but that has also become problematic as well. Since Social Security has raised the full benefit retirement age from 65 to 67, most seniors are still working for an employer at 65 and have no need for Medicare coverage until they retire, especially since many spouses are not yet on Medicare and their spouse needs the group coverage. The (un)Affordable Care Act aka Obamacare is terrible and has made major medical coverage too expensive and too restrictive. After 14 years in the industry I have finally realized all that is bad and the bad FAR out weighs the good. The commissions are too small for an agent to make it especially with so few seniors actually needing a better plan plus with everything I previously mentioned you need to be insane to become a Medicare agent in 2020. If you do start off in this industry you need at LEAST 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months of marketing expenses saved or you will run out of money very quick and need to find an hourly job. You must write 100 policies every year to make it in this industry and you will max out at 400 to 500 clients because any more clients and you will have to hire help. So at \$250 commission per client earned every year you are looking at a max of \$100,000 to \$125,000 minus your marketing expenses which will cost you between \$12,000 to \$20,000 per year plus all the gas consumption and wear and tear on your vehicle driving all over town on appointments, double taxes you pay for FICA, Medicare and Social Security taxes, and lack of access yourself to affordable health insurance by not having access to group health policies. Covid-19 is a new hurdle agents must overcome and adds a dozens new challenges because of CMS regulations. The Medicare industry just isn't worth it anymore."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAg>

"First off, get the MLM idea out of your head. The whole insurance industry is built upon uplines and downlines that is fully commission based. If you want a salary, you'll have to find an agency (whose commission based and has an upline) that'll pay you something fixed. Tough to find something like that for L&H compared to P&C. FE is great for upfront funds, but know that there can be quite a few chargebacks, so 30% of your commissions should go into a side-account to pay for these until you get your lead saturation up and your sales skill level established. Yes, Medicare is a grind unless you know how to cross-sell ancillary, then it's better than FE. In fact I recommend this track for newer FE agents: 1. Contract with someone that can train you and gives you fair contracts 100+% for FE and 20% for Medicare Supplements. 2. Get leads (facebook and direct mail) EVERY week in the same 50 sq mile area, and work them hard, spend 40 hours a week in the field, getting in front of as many people as possible. Build up a saturation level so that when you invariably door knock your leads and they say no or they're not home, you can just simply go two streets down and knock the guy you could never get ahold of a month or two ago. 3. Take some sample lead info and put it into a Medicare Quoting tool and find out whose competitive in your area for supplements, advantage plans etc. Start building your Medicare knowledge up. Of course, first past the AHIP so you have a base understanding for it. Just a few hours a week can help build up a wealth of knowledge. Once you understand how everything works, any changes to plans, companies or Medicare itself is easily assimilable - whereas there's no changes to FE usually. 4. Tell every lead you'll follow up with them in September to schedule a meeting in October to go over their Medicare options - because you do that too. If you don't sell anyone any FE, that's ok, offer to contact them in September for their Medicare, you "help seniors save money on their prescriptions and get extra benefits at no cost to them." If you paid for the lead, might as well get as much use out of them. 5. Selling FE sucks in November to December, the holidays. It's way easier to work with warm leads, sell them Medicare, and also increase your persistency lapse rate on your FE policies as well as bring in tons of referrals and get paid 2x as you would've just selling an FE policy. You could have enough leads to keep you busy all AEP, so that when that ends, you have a 2 week lull before New Years where you can start the whole cycle up again. THIS is the secret to making big bucks imo. Cody and Dave are good guys, Dave helped me out when I was where you were at, 12 years ago. He comes on here sometimes, haven't seen Cody on here yet."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/svjgsv/help_i_passed_accidenthealth_and_life_now_im/hxgcw8n/

"Medicare - first year client # goals Hey! I'm new to the medicare broker world - started in March (this month will be my 6th month) and have acquired approximately 60 clients (mainly dsnp and some t65). Just wondering if anyone has any insights or input regarding approximate goal for number of clients within first year, how many to shoot for for AEP, etc. Obviously the sky is the limit but just curious to see if what I'm doing is on track/what I should shoot for overall as AEP approaches. Thank you!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fcv0gg/>

"What lead vendors work for you? I'm a face to face final expense agent. I was using cheaper internet leads from integrity, social insurance leads, and leads direct. They aren't exclusive but they're anywhere from \$1-11 so I can get a lot of them, and if you dial enough you'll set up enough appointments. The ROI was great. As of recently though, they're just bad. And I've been with companies in the past that have had BAD leads before, I'm used to having to dial a lot and overcome objections, but this just isn't the way anymore. I've tried Facebook ads myself and I've come to the conclusion I'm just not a good marketer. It takes a lot of trial and error and time to figure it out so unless there's somewhere that'll give me a copy and pasted proven ad to post, I've decided it's not worth it. I'll take any recommendations on any direct mail or internet lead vendors. What works for you guys?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fmxcl1/what_lead_vendors_work_for_you/

"I have no idea how internet leads are profitable, even by their own claimed results. I spoke with Smart Financial last week because I could use another source to supplement my office's quote volume. Leads are \$10 each. They are claiming a 3-5% close rate based on the internal agent dashboard results they can see. I started to build a spreadsheet out to model both 3% and 5% scenarios, using my average new policy auto premium. After paying between \$200 and \$330 for the sale, and paying my sales guy out on it, my break even would be like 1.5 to 2.5 years. 2.5 years is longer than the average customer lifespan for the internet leads we have previously written. I'd say "well, we make money by selling additional lines of coverage" normally. But the customer quality on internet leads is usually renters. It's been a long time since I've run internet leads at any volume. Are any of you actually tracking ROI and coming out ahead on these?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ucbfrx/i_have_no_idea_how_internet_leads_are_profitable/

"150 Internet Leads Bought & ZERO Sales. Just took over an agency (P&C) from an agent that sold out and since the start of the month we've been getting internet leads. I am using Smart Financial but we haven't gotten any closes on these leads or even really any correspondence. Are we doing something wrong in the office or is that just the name of the game?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vyy0ou/150_internet_leads_bought_zero_sales/

"Leads! So here's my situation. In the last few years, I've consistently closed 2 to 3 out of every 10 phone calls, and about 1 out of every 3 full pitches. But the agency I used to work for masked the lead provider and changed the names, so we never actually knew where the leads came from. Now that I'm working for myself, finding a solid lead provider has been way harder than I expected. I really didn't think it would be this difficult. Out of 46 ACA leads from NextGen, I've closed zero. Not even a maybe. Does anyone have recommendations for good lead providers, or even insight on how they generate their own leads? Open to any direction at this point."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1orzwnm/leads/>

"Online leads Hello, been an agent for 8 years never had a good experience with online lead companies. I see most people here are active with online leads. Any life lead companies worth suggesting to try out? Appreciate all the suggestions. Not afraid of the competition I believe it's enough money to go around for all of us that put in the work. These are the companies that were pretty much trash and disappointments for me, I wouldn't suggest any of you wasting time and money with them. A plus leads, Hometown quote, Everq, QuoteWizard, Smart financial."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dfe69c/online_leads/

"Just got a position at usha as a health insurance agent I'm currently getting my license I'm excited they were showing me all this crazy amount of money like 5 to 11k a week i star Monday n i just hope it's true they are currently doing 4.6 mill a week in that single office what do you think"

— YouTube · How To Make Six-Figures Selling Health Insurance! \$ \$ · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=abG7Q3fGe6o&lc=UgyYcuDkeaznGLPTI3l4AaABAq>

"Sorry. I have no interest in recruiting you. Just sincerely trying to help. Understand that DigitalBGA is a competitor of mine and I still recommended them, largely because the lead sources you recommended are extremely expensive or aren't very good. Sometimes you have to do more than just buy leads to actually "get" the good leads, as most vendors who create quality leads realize the money in this business is made in agency building, not lead selling. Here's my experience as an agency owner dealing with them: 1. Datalot: Very expensive - agents working with me in the past used them and did not get very good results. 2. SmartFinancial: I've talked to agents outside of my agency who used them. The one guy was getting 50 or 60 transfers a week and paying several thousand a week. He had to have extreme scale to get decent results (think it was \$10,000AP+ weekly). My thoughts were that his results would be good on production but considering the high cost and high volume of the inbounds, would yield him a low ROI on average, which could be potentially dangerous on low production weeks. 3. Benepath/NextGen Leads: Don't know anyone who has used them. Hope that helps."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f7rwk7/best_live_transfers/lcm82b/

"This right here! So many unethical companies too that's exploit their agents and charge for bonk ass leads. My first experience was with HealthMarkets, horrible company, leads are \$36 each all of which are trash. I spent thousands of dollars on leads the first year. I also got taken by FFL, there I only burned \$3,000 in leads, I sold 5 policies, 4 charged back. I'm so happy now that I'm focused on the ACA market only. I don't care about selling life or any other supplemental. People are broke and they care barely afford health insurance as it is."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r86l3q/whats_the_hardest_part_of_being_an_insurance/o62tbgm/

"Here is a list of all I tested. Life leads Caboom : See above MediaApha : 1 out of 15 to 20 sale. ROI sucks Aria leads : crap. Their Instagram commercial is in a rented abandoned office, btw Smart Financial: spent 1500 for both data and live transfers. Nothing Everquote: I bought 50, and they canceled supporting life when I joined. No sale Benepath: 1 sale out of 10 leads, and they canceled life line as well Aged lead store: You better be ready to piss everyone off and dial a couple of weeks through wrong and not in service numbers before you get a hit. AWL: data leads suck. Live transfers 1 out of 4 normally sell, but they are overpriced, and if someone lapses or canceled, it ruins the whole ROI Integrity leadcenter: This has been the best of the worst so far, but buying the bronze is no different than the diamond. They say you get them exclusive on the sale, but that's bullshit because my upline bought me some from the same states I got, and they were duplicates. Google Ads : bots. I got all these leads at \$400 a week designed by a Google affiliated advertising company. I installed Captcha, and no more leads came in Fb: mostly people browsing. I feel like they are waiting for a gift after submitting the form. Money pit. Leadrilla: I never tried their campaigns, but if it's anything like the leads they sell in the marketplace, then it's shit too. USA DATA: 50% not in service and are all cold calls Direct mail: 1 to 2% return on mailers if you're lucky and you're always waiting. I sometimes wonder if they really mail anything out. Prospect 4 agent lead company: it was good in 2021, but by 2023, they caught the same disease all these other assholes have."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mezvm3q/

"I agree, it doesn't matter who you buy leads from. I've tried quotely google ads (terrible ROI), quotewizard/smart financial leads. I would call the lead the moment they would come through. The amount of times the prospect would tell me they submitted the form online for their insurance request 2-7 days ago and they have already now purchased a different policy from a caller already was massive. They all sell you aged leads even though they all say they are given in real time the moment they submit the form or they are fake information. I think cold calling/referrals from current clients/referrals from referral partners are the only ways to truly get people. I hear of agents who spend \$5-\$10k on leads a month and write \$200-\$500k of premium a month, those just feel fake lol."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer7u8e/

"Its \$1M, but policy count is correct about 45avg/month ~25 household average. I get enhanced commissions first year. Its a grind but I dont quote everyone I come across. I have a really good idea of my company's sweet spot rates. I can also guess peoples rates with my company & competitors and be within ~5% nearly every time lol. Saves time on quoting which to me is the time consuming part. I dont quote people whom I know I have a high chance of being slaughtered. Working this way increases my closing rate from 15% to 40%. Less time quoting more time selling. Leads from quotewizard & my own marketing."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oma6hp/whats_everyones_total_compensation_for_2025/nmr46z6/

"Following to hear others input. We have been struggling with quality leads as well. And I'm not talking we expect to close every deal, but we have purchased a ton of internet leads who said that they never requested a quote in the first place (InsuranceQuotes, Everquote, etc.). We understand its a numbers game at the end of the day. But we at least want a chance to win their business, and we aren't even getting that most of the time and just spending money on leads with 0 potential."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1orzwnm/leads/nnu829f/>

"Best live transfers?? What live transfers have you had the most success? From my research the top three are Smart financial (contactability)- Lead star- Datalot- There are also these companies: Benepath Next gen leads Insurance quotes- What company should I sign up with? Any recommendations? Thanks"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f7rwk7/best_live_transfers/

Facebook / Meta ads (self-generated) · 87 documents

"Stop buying leads I constantly see people on here complaining about shitty, expensive, shared leads. Listen guys, YouTube exists, this stuff isn't hard. Facebook and Google have dumbed setting things up so much it's ridiculous. You want to know how to create your own leads? On Facebook you can find a built in tool called Facebook ads library. Type in the insurance product you sell and filter the results to show active ads that have been running 6month-1year. The older the ad the more successful. If the ad wasn't making money, they would have killed the ad. Copy/model that ad. For Google, pick a big city, Google <what you sell> <big city> whoever shows up at the top probably has a good ad. Look at their ad copy then look at the landing page they use. Copy/model them. It's simple, YouTube to figure out the setup, research what ads work, copy them.... And now you're getting your leads at cost and you have full control of them. It's easier than you would think."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 163 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466vj/stop_buying_leads/

"If you want to get advanced: Google is the more expensive option but the leads are higher quality. Someone googling already has intent to buy, whereas on Facebook you're just scrolling your timeline and someone is interpreting you with an ad. Also there's more fake leads for some reason on Facebook, but they're also way cheaper. What we like to do is get traffic from Google ads and then use Facebook remarketing to put our Facebook ads in front of the expensive Google traffic that didn't buy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466vj/stop_buying_leads/mo7pbhg/

"How to create a client list, it doesn't matter if it's cold calling or not The company I'm trying to work for requires me to create a contact list of 150 people. They said it can include friends, family, former coworkers, Instagram, etc as long as I have their phone number and email. The list is confidential and won't be taken from me they just want me ready to call when I officially start. This is a test before they sponsor my health and life insurance. I've already gone through my contacts, social media, and friends, but so far I've only been able to gather around 20-40 people max. How do I go on about find more people and no I don't have any more personal leads or referrals that they could give. Edit: The company is called thoroughbred advisor, commission based and you keep your own book. Also they sponsor for series license which is my big incentive Edit 2: I have decided not to take the job after reading all the comments. I should instead just get my basic licenses and market myself better. This way I actually have a strong foundation. Thank you for everyone sharing their opinions"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r2emia/how_to_create_a_client_list_it_doesnt_matter_if/

"And find a solid lead source. I run my own ads on social media, and buy aged leads (30+ days) from USA Life Leads to help fill my day. I've wasted sooo much money on leads. More does not equal better.."

— YouTube · My BIGGEST Advice To A New Life Insurance Agent! 🚀 #insurance #insuranceagent #insurancesca · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AGiTFBC4oSM&lc=UgzcN16DCaTdKHMfYlB4AaABAq>

"As an Independent Broker, what is the best way to generate leads? I recently got my Life & Health license in NY and I am trying to figure out how to structure my business ONLINE. I've been appointed with several carriers over the past few months. My background is in marketing, specifically Ecommerce so I have a solid understanding of running Facebook ads. However, I am having trouble pulling the trigger and actually getting started due to trying to figure out all of the rules and regulations. Analysis paralysis. I plan on pumping out quality content on my website and socials both of which are not yet created. As an Independent in NY, my business name is my first and last name. Does my domain name and socials have to be my first and last name or can it be something random like "High Creek Financial", for example? I guess I am having trouble with establishing my brand identity. Should it be ME posting content and interacting in the community or should it be "High Creek Financial". I'm apprehensive to just use my name for my brand because it will make me appear like the one man show that I am. My thoughts are that if I was able to use "High Creek Financial" for example, that it would give off the vibe that I'm with a big, legit company. I dont know if any of this is even making sense so I apologize in advance. As I'm writing this, I keep thinking to myself, "wtf am i even saying?" Should I do something like this: <https://www.marblepay.com/> and be in the background or should I just use my personal brand and not care that people will see that I'm a one man show? If anyone has any experience with generating their own leads, could I pick your brain a little bit? Thanks!!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 18 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fj86x3/as_an_independent_broker_what_is_the_best_way_to/

"This is what they don't tell you is that you have to learn to generate your own leads. Don't waste your time I'm with the competitor of Aflac which is colonial life. I do Facebook ads, Tik Tok etc.. to generate my own leads it works. The old methods don't"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mcl3e3/i_already_hate_my_job/n5v01x4/

"Medicare brokers, help me set realistic goals for years 1-3 as an independent agent. Background: I just got my insurance license this week, planning on finding a good, not shady FMO/IMO in the next month. I am a full time engineer so I will be selling Medicare part time as an independent broker. Plan is to leave work at 2pm and start doing Medicare. I understand that this will be insanely difficult and time consuming. I don't feel comfortable leaving my job with out trying this part time first. Completely fine working long hours. Medicare is quite confusing but I am very active on the Medicare subreddit answering questions I know and learning from the posts I don't. I want to do this to provide the best care for the seniors in my area not just shove MA plans down their throat. Now my main question. Are my goals realistic. 1st year (now through open enrollment): 10 clients mixture of MA and medigap (roughly \$3000-4000) 2nd year: 50 new clients roughly (\$17000 - 20000) 3rd year: 125 clients total (\$35000-50000) quit job and do Medicare FT. Marketing plan: I will be doing in person in my local area. Already signed up for a very popular Saturday farmers market and a couple county fairs. All marketing will be in person + local advertising. I am active in the community and just generally enjoy talking to people. Thoughts are struggle year 1-2 with a lot of local events on weekends and then word of mouth will hopefully pick up if I am able to provide the assistance and knowledge I strive to. Create an easy to use website (I'm a software engineer) and optimize SEO so it shows up to locals searching. Facebook page and local Facebook advertising"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j6vyj8/medicare_brokers_help_me_set_realistic_goals_for/

"Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdoteal personal experience) Jornaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use jornaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower internt.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trustrd lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. ,get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer844c/

"Big Daddy leads (BDL) Leads Review TL;DR: Tried Big Daddy Leads for Mortgage Protection. Lots of disconnected numbers (they did replace some), most people never picked up despite hammering them with 8–10 calls a day + texts, and the show rate was awful. The ones who did pick up all expected their entire mortgage covered at ~70 years old. I tried downselling to equity protection/payment protector, but they wanted all-or-nothing. Honestly, you'll get better results just running your own ads. And yes I did track my numbers for everything. --- I tested Big Daddy Leads for Mortgage Protection recently and wanted to share an honest review for anyone thinking about it. Lead quality: Pretty bad overall. I got a lot of disconnected numbers — to be fair, they did replace those — but even with the "good" ones, most people didn't answer after I hammered them: 8–10 calls a day, double-dialing, leaving voicemails once, and texting every time. Show rate was rough. Expectations: This was the biggest killer. Every single MP lead I got seemed to expect their whole mortgage covered. I did try to downsell into equity protection/payment protector plans (covering monthly payments for a set amount of time), but they flat-out didn't want it. It was whole coverage or nothing. And look — I've been doing this for years, I'm a ~\$30k/month producer, I know how to handle objections, but I couldn't flip that expectation. These leads were just set up the wrong way from the start. How they generate leads: You don't control or even see the ads. They run simple image ads into Facebook lead forms, optimized for cheapest CPL, not quality. If you've been around marketing, you know that's not the same thing. Not trying to bash them unfairly — just being real about my experience."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nxhu2/big_daddy_leads_bdl_leads_review/

"I run a digital agency. Turn on monetization on this video, cause I want to run my ad letting life insurance agents know that I can run their FB ads for them, for a nominal monthly fee."

— YouTube · How I Sold \$56,038 Of Life Insurance In 30 Days With Self Generated Leads · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=60LbRzSZNP&lc=UgzQoMbhX0odje7KfcZ4AaABAq>

"Am I doing this wrong? (Final Expense) So a brief run down, I started at an agency. Payout is 90% commission (75% upfront with 25% paid out over the rest of the year) I pay for mail-in leads at 35 bucks a pop. Obviously first couple months great but the last 4 weeks have been terrible. I haven't changed my approach or anything but I've only made two sales in these four weeks and they've really only covered my chargebacks lol with mail ins obviously I go to their homes and door knock. (spent \$742 on gas last month) I wouldn't feel bad if I was still making sales but it just seems to have dried up. Is it the time of year? Am I not being pushy enough? Thinking about running Facebook ad campaigns for some hotter leads to maybe help get out of this funk. anyone have experience with this or any tips?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p57gp5/>

"What lead vendors work for you? I'm a face to face final expense agent. I was using cheaper internet leads from integrity, social insurance leads, and leads direct. They aren't exclusive but they're anywhere from \$1-11 so I can get a lot of them, and if you dial enough you'll set up enough appointments. The ROI was great. As of recently though, they're just bad. And I've been with companies in the past that have had BAD leads before, I'm used to having to dial a lot and overcome objections, but this just isn't the way anymore. I've tried Facebook ads myself and I've come to the conclusion I'm just not a good marketer. It takes a lot of trial and error and time to figure it out so unless there's somewhere that'll give me a copy and pasted proven ad to post, I've decided it's not worth it. I'll take any recommendations on any direct mail or internet lead vendors. What works for you guys?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fmxc1/what_lead_vendors_work_for_you/

Exclusive real-time leads · 50 documents

"You are spending a grand a week and your ending up with only a few "premium" ...your stuck in a tiered system. Who is your imo ...symmetry ...NASB...ffl...they all do that to agents. Not cool. For a grand a week (which is a good budget) you should be getting brand new exclusive leads ...no aged recycled leads....none. Aged are good if they are super cheap ..but why bother if you have the budget for new? As far as the FB lead campaigns ...we use them ...they are good for agents so you have the control of your own leads. All fresh ...never re sold...and you know where they come from. The cost is so much better. We also use live transfers...again that way you know its your lead...and they are interested. Good luck!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mfu7pr/considering_trying_a_facebook_lead_campaign/n6jpo6o/

"Most are resellers that's why! It is rare to find the actual source of the leads. Also the industry is drowned to the max with resellers who bought 7 day old leads in bulk for like \$1000 and reselling for \$10,000! That is why I only recommend direct mail and doing fb ads. They will be your exclusive leads! If you are not the first agency to call that person after they filled out the online form then it is most likely a useless window shopper. They will just spin your wheels and will never convert!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer5k7f/

"The problem is not putting hard work, if you went through the process you know that if you don't work hard you won't get any leads in r call people... The problems is that in the beginning they don't tell you but you will be getting old ass leads... and that's is frustrating... still not a cold call but some people don't even remember they signed up for... not to mention other agents that don't resolve their bad leads so it goes back to the pile as a no answer... and guess what? You will eventually call a bunch of people who already said are not interested many times... so I've seen some new agents taking many weeks just to book something remotely good... People who jump into this desperate for money and with no much time to climb up until get fresh leads will not last long, it's a fact, and they should be open about that from the get go... instead they hype you up, push you to learn all scripts and so on, and when you are finally ready you will spend 80 of you time going through a list of leads and calling people that never pickup the phone."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cy9b7k/im_stuck_at_globe_life_american_income_life_and_i/ms4ol22/

"They areyou only hear shit from people that do not understand what it means to work aged leads. They are good about communicating with clients. I have never had an issue with them. They provide you with exactly what they say they do. That being said the leads are cheap so you got to get many many many of them to work and work them hard to get results. You are better off just getting live transfers and buying real time leads from the vendor of your choice, paying the new price, and selling policies. It is so much more time/cost effective. I started with aged leads working one day a week 5 years ago. I should have just grabbed a few new instead of many aged....productivity would have been so much better all around. Good luck!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k24g9p/aged_leads_store/mnrmlmd/

"Is anyone focusing on live transfers for final expense or mortgage protection? If so how's it been and what do your typical costs look like? Actively trying to work through the best way to scale production and want to incorporate live transfers as the focal point of my strategy. Exclusive leads regardless of where are increasingly getting more difficult to get a hold off and I'm fine spending more money to get someone on the call in the moment. Just curious to know how that's been for everyone and what vendors you'd recommend as a good starting place for it."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq7mu0/is_anyone_focusing_on_live_transfers_for_final/

"If you don't have a steady stream of leads, you have no business. Warm market burns out fast, if you can get referrals consistently you can keep moving forward. But for me, I needed consistency. I'm on a standing lead order, fresh leads just drop into my crm. I supplement with bonus leads other agents drop the ball with . What access to leads do you have?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/mz2vz54/

"I am also at 100% comp rate. Purchasing aged leads allow me to keep my investments low and ROI high. With purchasing CABOOM's fresh leads, I assumed that it would give me an instant return- but I was wrong. Please feel free to comment or share your experience. I'd love to hear from other life insurance agents! Bless 🙏"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/m9k9w6y/

"Yea it's crazy, I would spend about \$42 on a "fresh" exclusive lead just to finally get a hold of them after 10+ tries for them to tell me they already signed up with another agent a while ago... and of course the lead company doesn't reimburse unless it's a disconnected number, so the agent is forced to eat that cost"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/ourb2oq/

"Mine was that I paid for exclusive leads and were fed people who had been called 100 times already. I cancelled them."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fmxcl1/what_lead_vendors_work_for_you/lohs0jd/

"I hardly write reviews but do not want people to go through the same thing as me. I was excited to try Caboom leads as they "are warm exclusive leads" but once they started coming through and making calls everything seemed off. I made over 400 dials on 50 leads purchased with several different numbers matched to the area code of the lead. My numbers are fresh and not tested multiple times for spam. Id also call within 3 minutes of the lead as speed to lead is important. I had 17 answers with 9 saying they had no clue what I was talking about and that they did not fill in any form. I have followed up with leads for a week to not have one single person interested ready to discuss any final expense or term life coverage. Not one. Hope this helps!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/mgr265r/

"The culture is definitely going to depend on who you're uplines are and what agency you joined. Of course that's obviously going to be true for every IMO that exists personally I didn't have any issue with culture or any of the things op mentioned although I will say that there was a lot of focus on recruitment and I feel like that will probably be the same no matter what as symmetry has a heavy focus on recruiting. The leads are definitely junk. In my opinion that alone is the biggest reason not to join symmetry. Symmetry is not even an insurance agency they're a lead company that has a side hustle selling insurance. Even the \$50 fresh leads are a pile of junk that will give you no return on investment unless you're incredibly lucky."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtqo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/ms6l3wz/

"I'll check it out don't know if I'd rather fail out of the biz or recoup with aged leads. Been through the wringer I'm 18 been in the business for 7ish months did my fair share of dialing aged to hell leads. Intent behind the real time leads is wildly inconsistent some weeks it's like calling through the white pages others I'm on a hot streak. Seems too random for the price I'm paying for leads advertised as exclusive. Lost all my capital this month and am debating on just quitting all together. Also feel as if the top producers at my office are all also kind of winging it because the advice I'm given is "believe harder" essentially"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s8e1si/be_your_own_boss_80_starting_commission_change/odlxjip/

Booked appointments · 44 documents

"My experience at bankers life as a new agent. I don't understand the distaste. I came across a post after my interview that made me even more skeptical of the job because I've never had a commission based job, didn't have an insurance license, and this would be my first real job after college. Here is the post I read. [https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/194rgk1/has_anyone_heard_of_bankers_life/] I got my license and passed first try (idk how, I studied hard but the exam was harder than I thought, I couldn't see how many I got wrong). It's the beginning of my 4th week, I've made one small sale but I've set appointments with clients that have a lot of money so they're sending an FA to discuss retirement planning. I've made contact with some of these clients, I study really hard, I do what I'm told, and honestly it feels great. I feel like I'm the edge of something that could be really good. I'm good at what I do and I can tell because not only are the managers impressed with me but so are the other agents that are in their first year. I kind of feel like I'm outpacing a lot of my peers but I'm trying to stay humble. I took a chance with these people because I had limited options but I knew that even if this is the worst company I've ever worked with (it's not) then I would at least come out with a resume with more licenses than I came in with, and could take another swing at the job market. I've been getting calls from other companies since I got my license trying to recruit me, I don't listen to them much. I will be an FA in a year or less with this company, I don't intend to leave here unless I go broke (doubtful) or something unforeseen happens. I was extremely apprehensive when I started but I trusted my manager and gave it my all since if I'm going to try, I'm going to try so hard that I will know without a doubt if it is my fault or the company's if I fail. I'm not failing, I'm impressing and improving. People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager) but there's signs everywhere about being a top 125 training company, have I fact checked this? No, but I haven't felt like I needed to. when I feel like it I will. My managers answer all my questions, see me working hard, and include me on appointments that I can't contribute much to, and we still split the sale. The online resources are extensive and cover so much in a very user friendly way, 30-60 minute panels of top producers explaining what worked for them. I am told this is why they are such a highly rated company for its training. I am also told that this is why BL is unique, because it is 1099 commission based but the support is unmatched. I really enjoy this company so far and if I don't start seeing financial results soon (I'm positive I will) then I will remove this post. Maybe after AEP I'll just drop how much money I've made in the comments and pin it or something and we can see how this post ages. I anticipate a couple thousand dollars in the next couple weeks from less than a handful of sales. Someone who's worked in other insurance agencies tell me what I'm missing if this company is so bad? If I'm being cocky then check back in January to see my suffering and plans to go back on Glassdoor. \-sept 27, 2025 UPDATE It's December 17th, I'm going to try to keep this update relevant to my original. For context, I was let go two weeks ago and am not looking back. Issues had been brewing for weeks and I was already interviewing at another company in case I decided I needed to leave, initially, I didn't see myself being fired but as things escalated, I knew I'd be less surprised. I had the confidence in being hired at another company to stay true to my morals in how I dealt with Bankers. I'll talk about why I was let go later in this post. **Since I referred an older post in my original and commented on it, I'm going to dissect what I said and show a newer perspective:** "People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager)" Quoting the linked post, "being 1099 but being treated like an employee..." I still think the user on the linked post is misguided. You are 1099, and I don't know what negatives they were referring to when being "treated like an employee" but I can say that bankers really does do business in person, the initial interview was the only time I had a formal conversation with my bosses online. Working with my managers in person was something I liked, my new job has had more formal conversation over zoom than in person (so far, I don't officially start until January which is another downside over here) and I miss that about bankers. I also liked that the hierarchy of the office was relatively clear cut. My manager knows she is responsible for me. I liked how there was structure to the company, I was told by my managers and in hindsight still agree that this is GOOD and sets bankers aside from the competition. Agreed. My second sentence regarding insurance as far as I know now, is still completely correct. But working for bankers I realized that everything is a sale, hiring people, building confidence in subordinates, getting your manager to like you even if you don't like them. Everything is a game and everyone is playing. All the sales tactics apply in every corner of the office. Now we have "office politics" where generally, every participant is skilled in how to get what they want from other people, so now there is another layer of paranoia I had and I think rightfully so. I have no idea if becoming a manager and qualifying for bankers insurance is as easy as it was laid out in the interview. I can't tell you how many times, big or small, I thought something would be as easy as 1,2,3 because that was the way it was laid out, when in fact there were so many undisclosed micromanagement tasks attached. Some had to do with clients and don't result in being paid. (Prescription drug plans are needed by most of our clients, but we get paid nothing. And I had an experience that took way longer than it should have) **In regards to my overall outlook on bankers as a company and my experience at the time:** I was pretty successful as a new agent I think, I saw people come and go, I got better and was super proud of my accomplishments being a new grad and never having been in sales before but booking more appointments than some of my peers. I was confident and working hard, everyone in the office saw it. Peers would ask me questions and "most" managers were always eager to help. However management was the reason I was fired, after awhile I realized that I knew I would be very successful at this company and would do everything in my power, without hurting anyone, to accomplish my goals. Before I go into why I was let go I want to say that from my perspective, I think bankers as a company could be very good, it may already be a very good company to work for. I think the resources available online is extensive and very very valuable, I do think working face to face with your company is very valuable too. And I think from a baseline, makes bankers a company to consider. For awhile I really enjoyed it, and I was trying really hard not to drink too much "kool-aid" I wanted to stay humble and careful, celebrate my victories at home and not let anyone see anything they could take advantage of. Ultimately, it could be and probably was, my branch that failed me. Not the company. And the branch did fail me. **Here is why I was let go:** As I've said I was a good new agent, and proud of my progress. As I got better and better I became more and more independent. At first I didn't want to meet clients 1 on 1 because I felt so nervous in my capabilities, naturally management wanted me to go on my own and I understood even if I didn't want to. As I went on these appointments I was told I could call my manager "anytime." Sure enough, questions came up, and without disturbing my rapport with the client, would text or call my manager. Eventually the response I would get is "read the agent guide" or "we'll talk about it during our meeting" but I would never know which agent guide I was being referred to and anytime I looked at our resources they would be 40 pages of word salad and fluff that I mostly already knew with a few bits of new information. Not user friendly and certainly not a good use of time when I could be making new clients, working on my current clients, or learning how to present a new product. So the other response was our meeting. 3/5 days during the week we are on appointments, 2/5 days we are in the office and here is the schedule: 8-12 dial, dial, dial. That's it. 12-1 people trickle out o"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nircjl/my_experience_at_bankers_life_as_a_new_agent/

"To form an LLC or to not form an LLC? 🤖🤖 That is the question.... 🤖🤖 Many people get the advice to spread out their liability and form an LLC with a business. If you are forming practically any other business, I would almost always say yes, go for it. In the insurance business, however, there are costs as well as administrative and compliance considerations to consider when forming an entity that could make things unnecessarily complicated for you in the beginning. In addition, for most independent agents E&O insurance is required for carrier appointments and covers you in the case of liability for any errors or omissions that pose the highest risk of liability. Now if you're concerned that maybe you go door-to-door or do appointment setting or something along those lines and an old lady trips and falls and blames you for it, that's a whole nother story of liability and perhaps a reason that you should form an LLC. The risk of that is very low in that regard, unless tripping old ladies is something that you're accustomed to. There are three scenarios in which I tell independent agents to go ahead and form an entity. #1 - you already have high Revenue Revenue can get to a certain point where you can file to be taxed as a corporation and get owner's distribution to lower overall tax burden. #2 - you have high production There are certain carriers in the industry that are worth having and also require an entity in order to attain certain contract levels (compensation levels). Some carriers also require an entity if you have downlines or a certain number of downlines. #3 - you have downlines (agents working for your agency) When other people's income start to get involved, other people's families, other peoples things, etc. it is always smart to have an LLC to limit your liability as a company. It's smart and it protects you from that liability of the many, many things that could potentially happen as business grows. I tend to advise not to give yourself an extra headache by forming an entity early. If you are going solo and are holding contracts independently, an entity typically does not need to be formed until these scenarios arise. A DBA is just fine until you produce, you get agents, or you get high enough revenue for a tax advantage. 🤖🤖 Please consult with a lawyer and CPA, as I am not a lawyer or a CPA, and this does not constitute official or licensed legal or financial advice."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mp3psz/to_form_an_llc_or_to_not_form_an_llc_that_is_the/

"None of my prospects are answering my calls after setting an appointment I'm just asking for a bit of advice and wisdom here. About a week or more ago I made a post about having trouble cold calling in the supplementary insurance industry. After changing my approach, this week I've had people be very responsive and receptive. I've gotten about 4 or 5 enthusiastic "yes" to appointments, as well as more neutral/curious yeses for a total of about 8 appointments for people ready to listen to the product and possibly buy. However, literally none of these prospects save for one have answered the phone when I call them in the appointed time. Is this normal? What could be the cause for an enthusiastic or very curious "yes" to completely ghost? My experience with sales has mostly been with warm leads or D2D approaches, so I'm very new to converting a cold call into a sale. I'm assuming it's just a form of sales that requires a lot of follow up but I'd like to see what you guys think. Here's my current approach: 1. Open with an upbeat tone ask if I'm talking to the person. 2. Give empathic line similar to "I know you weren't expecting this call. If this is a bad time you can let me know..." something like this. This was a change I made that worked surprisingly well and has pretty much gotten 90% of my leads to stay on the line curious on what I have to say, which was something I'd been struggling with for a while. 3. If they say it's a good time, I give a quick elevator pitch to pique their interest and test the waters if they want to know about the product fully at that moment or if we should set an appointment. Most times we set appointment. 4. A few of these have even given me their free time before I even ask them so they kinda close the appointment for me. So we set the time and I put it on the agenda. Then I call them and... radio silence. I usually send a text to let them know and call a few days later but still nothing. Today I have a long list of follow ups from the ones from last week to see if they pick up today. Assuming it's on me and it's not just the nature of the cold calling in the supplemental insurance industry, my suspicion is that I'm messing up somewhere in the follow up. I haven't gotten any answer from any of my texts so maybe I'm scaring them off? I dunno. Any feedback would be greatly appreciated!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qrb80b/none_of_my_prospects_are_answering_my_calls_after/

"This rings true to my experience to a tee. The company is off the charts unethical and should be shut down imo. A lot of people don't realize AO Globe Life has 2 major hiring periods linked to bonus events within the org where managers are heavily incentivized to hire as many new people as possible. Many of the new hires at this time of year are hired solely for that bonus, with little to no intent to see them actually make it. Being strung along just long enough to qualify for the bonus then essentially left to sink or swim from there. This leaves such a bad taste in people's mouths for the industry as a whole when it's the company through and through And when you finally get a peak behind the curtain, it's like Oz all smoke & mirrors. Top tier agents aren't making 500-1000 calls a day like they brag in the videos and weekly calls. A few of them have their own appointment setting businesses and hire foreign call centers to push for live transfers. Sold leads are passed around to be sold again, multiple times. When I was with them you could look up a lead and be floored seeing how many times a person's been sold the same products by the org's top tier agents. And to this day, when I hear the phrase "you picking up what I'm putting down?" I just want to punch that guy in the face 🤖"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/on4jz8u/

"Inbounds suck for a number of reasons: 1. Scam Central: most inbounds are generated in Pakistan and India. Literally the guys scamming your Grandma out of your inheritance are the ones providing inbounds to you, with entry-level scammers starting in lead generation before moving on to ripping off Americans. 2. Legal Pandora's Box: India and Pakistan will not comply to Federal TCPA rules. They will call everyone - even on the DNC - and you, and your upline, bear the legal risk. I had a good agent of mine buy one of these leads earlier this year and had to settle for five figures for just one phone call. 3. Did I Mention They're A Scam? These call centers are known to share client information, list information, and rework the leads over and over again. There are organizations that sell "pre-sold leads," which includes all major information about the client, claiming they call ahead of time to collect the information before passing it along to the agent to sell. Unbeknownst to the agent, they resell this information over and over again and you end up with huge chargebacks. I think Facebook ads are a much more durable, long-lasting, and safe lead generation solution. You own the leads, you control the ad creative, and you have a track record of the client opting in. Plus, you can scale upward to the level you're comfortable with, and can tie in pre-set appointments or call-ins for added benefit. Lastly, if you don't want to do it yourself, there are many good lead management options available that will do all of the above."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oxuubl/is_this_a_good_offer/np4s2v6/

"Aged FE leads are my favorite type. Getting in the door is all about how you handle the appointment setting call."

— YouTube · Aged Final Expense Leads [3 Best Sales Tips] · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KRaHtVeE7HU&lc=Ugzxlfw49gxWhO8nIZ4AaABAq>

"New Agent having difficulty closing. I've been a new agent for two months now and I'm having difficulty closing! I'm averaging 100 calls a day with 2-4 hours of talk time. I'm a captive agent and I'm almost double the price people are currently paying. I stopped asking "how much do you pay" and started taking the conversation a different route to where I'm explaining and advising on what they need. I used to sell solar and never had this much difficulty in closing. I would like some tips on how other agents are closing even at a higher price for the same coverage. I would also like to hear some tips on how agents are getting more people on the phone or referrals as a remote agent. I did solar sales before Insurance and was a top performer as an telephone appointment setter, door knocker, and consultant. I don't know if I lost my touch or what I'm experiencing is out of my hands. I want to the best!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ve4p1s/>

"Hi Cody! I am actually an appointment setter and one of my problems is they don't want to meet up. What is the best rebuttal for this?"

— YouTube · Live Dialing Insurance Leads! [Final Expense Insurance] · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RL6Y5qig0Wg&lc=UgzDfCXwolvYW0z7Z14AaABAq>

"Oh jeez, where to even start on this one. Leads...the biggest hurdle on your way to success in sales. I struggled with a decent lead source for a while after leaving the agency I started with. They ran direct mail leads and financed them to agents...we had it made. They trained to door knock your leads and only call to set appointments as a last stitch effort. They were very "old school" in all areas of their business, but I have to say...it worked. It worked well. I was a new agent and I didn't realize how good I had it at my first agency and allowed myself to get recruited by FFL. They had all the glitz and glamour and the agent that recruited me was persistent to say the least. The lead store was so appealing to me ...the idea of hopping online and buying leads at 1/4 the cost of the ones i was using was obviously too good to be true. I would buy "instant" internet leads for \$30 each to later find out that they were over a month old and been dialed 2000 times already. I bought 3 months "aged" leads that were actually over 8 years old....it was nothing short of diabolical what they were doing to agents. They wound up with a lawsuit over it all thank God, but it doesn't make up for how shitty they were doing these brand new agents they were recruiting by the dozens. Me being the resourceful and gritty bitch that I am decided to say fuck it and do what I had learned from the beginning and door knock all these shitty leads I had bought and.....it worked. It worked well. Idk what is in the psychology of someone being at your door, but whatever it is...it works. People let you in, they buy from you, you make money and lifelong clients. After that I found a good direct mail company and just keep a steady drop going with them. I never get an objection from someone when I'm at their door holding a piece of paper with their handwriting on it asking for life insurance. I get plenty of objections during the sales process, but I almost ALWAYS get in the door and give a presentation. Take the phones and the uncertainty out of the equation and just show up there....as the real person you are....and talk to these folks. Also....sourcing your own leads is always an option. I learned how to do this and can help you set up a pipeline but I will say that it is A LOT of work and it's expensive. I'm busy and don't like to deal with all the work that goes into it so I just pay about the same price for direct mail and enjoy my time off."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mewzaun/

"Does this setup make sense for starting my own insurance business? Hi everyone, I'm currently studying to get my insurance license and wanted to share my plan to see if this setup makes sense. I'm also hoping to connect with experienced agents for advice. A little about me: • I'm the lead Data/AI Engineer at an investment bank, so I would like to keep this job for now but I'm looking to start my own insurance business. • I've got sales experience from wholesaling mobile homes, where I was a one man team handling both acquisitions and dispositions. I also worked as a wealth advisor at a top 3 RIA, and in my current role, I pitch AI concepts to secure funding from management. Honestly, I think insurance might be easier than what I've done before but I can be wrong. Here's my setup so far: -Focus: final expense insurance -I have a virtual assistant I'll train as an appointment setter to call leads, prequalify prospects with a free financial assessment, and schedule follow-ups with me as the closer. -I'm already running Facebook ads with a CPL of \$5-\$7. -My marketing experience comes from previous dropshipping endeavors, so I know how to test and optimize campaigns. -For CRM, I built a custom Google Sheets system with automations (follow-up emails, date tracking, etc.). -I'm also working on an AI receptionist to handle inbound calls while I'm at my 9-5. Here's what I'd love feedback on: 1. Does this sound like a good setup for someone starting out? 2. Would anyone here be open to mentorship in exchange for me helping introduce AI tools/automation into your agency? 3. What's the best IMO/FMO for my situation? I'm leaning toward EFES but open to suggestions. 4. Do you think it is possible to do this part time? Any advice would be appreciated I want to make sure I set this up the right way from the start. Thanks!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m12x1l/does_this_setup_make_sense_for_starting_my_own/

"IUL Meta Ads Hey Folk, a friend of mine and I own a offshore Registered marketing agency, we wanted to try running ads for IULs (we do for recruiting which gave us a good ROI), I'm not quite sure on how much will it actually cost us to advertise with a pocket money budget from the Client since this is what us and the him agreed upon for starters, I'm Currently Making the draft but still contemplating since we agreed on getting Him APPOINTMETNS and not just leads, you can call me whatever but we had to take the risk to see if we can make it work on the long run for other agents. I'm Pretty good in what i do, Lead gen and appointment setting, i worked in various Industries so i trust my ability in this I'd love your advice on a few things: What are the best Facebook ad angles or creatives that have worked for IUL or financial services campaigns lately? How do you keep lead quality high without making the form too long? What's the best way to set expectations with the agent so they don't blame ad quality when the real issue is closing skill or follow-up? *(Not asking for self-promo or templates, just real experience-based advice.)"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o85k98/iul_meta_ads/

"Sure, I'll explain: 1. Inbound leads are leads that call you (you already know this but explaining for all the new agents reading this). So... TV leads, live transfers, etc. 2. Outbound leads are leads that *you* have to call. Think leads generated on Facebook, for example. Someone fills out a form to express interest, and then the agent is responsible for the callback. With outbound leads generated on social media, you can program an option for prospects to schedule a time for you to call them. It only works for the minority of people filling out the form, but those who do book and show up, they are pretty good prospects that close at a higher rate. Pre-set appointments tend to no show at a 70% to 80% rate depending on how well you set the appointment in my experience. That's probably the biggest downside to them. However, plenty of those leads that did *not* set an appointment will buy from you, if you consistently dial them long enough."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f7rwk7/best_live_transfers/lcn7ls/

Shared real-time leads · 26 documents

"Stop buying leads I constantly see people on here complaining about shitty, expensive, shared leads. Listen guys, YouTube exists, this stuff isn't hard. Facebook and Google have dumbed setting things up so much it's ridiculous. You want to know how to create your own leads? On Facebook you can find a built in tool called Facebook ads library. Type in the insurance product you sell and filter the results to show active ads that have been running 6month-1year. The older the ad the more successful. If the ad wasn't making money, they would have killed the ad. Copy/model that ad. For Google, pick a big city, Google <what you sell> <big city> whoever shows up at the top probably has a good ad. Look at their ad copy then look at the landing page they use. Copy/model them. It's simple, YouTube to figure out the setup, research what ads work, copy them.... And now you're getting your leads at cost and you have full control of them. It's easier than you would think."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 163 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466vj/stop_buying_leads/

"Be prepared for the phone apocalypse Apple dropped the hammer on all unsolicited calls. With the iOS 26 update in September, no calls will automatically go through unless their in your contacts. Instead, the person calling will have to state their name and the reason for the call. That will show up as a text and the caller decides whether or not to allow the call. Here's a demo: <https://youtu.be/4yFDvqEjciQ?feature=shared> Apple owns 60% of the market. If other phone manufacturers and even carrier follow, it's possible we see day where cold calling has died. This will have a direct, negative effect on leads, especially shared leads. Be prepared."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 50 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l8sgfs/be_prepared_for_the_phone_apocalypse/

"the shared leads thing is such a scam and I can't believe we all just accept it Bought a batch of "exclusive" commercial leads last month. Called the first ten. Three of them told me I was the fourth agent to call that week. Fourth. So I'm paying, what, \$14 a lead to race three other brokers to the same shipping company owner who's already annoyed before I even open my mouth? How is that a business model for anyone except the vendor selling the list four times? The aged leads are somehow worse. Bought some for like \$2-3 each thinking okay, these are old but at least they're cheap. Half the businesses had closed or changed ownership. One number was a Subway. Not a Subway that needed commercial coverage, just a Subway where some guy named Dave was confused about why insurance agents kept calling him. I don't even know what the alternative is honestly. Every lead vendor I've tried does the same thing with slightly different branding. You either pay a lot for leads that five people already called, or you pay a little for leads that are basically dead. Pick your poison I guess. anyway rant over, back to dialing"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 31 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s5vcry/the_shared_leads_thing_is_such_a_scam_and_i_cant/

"Hahaha. Looks like a lead that has been tormented by countless calls from agents. I blame the lead vendors that resell the same leads to 5 different offices"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rsznnr/text_exchange_from_a_prospect_who_reached_out_to_oaaq95t/

"Back to school? I'm a Medicare Telesales (captive) agent for a large health insurance company. I'm doing fairly well, not the best on my team but not the worst, but I DO know that I hold leadership qualities that some do, and some do not possess. I really love my job, I love the my colleagues, and I really want to move up in my career. I have not been in school for 10+ years... I am honestly not even sure how going back to college would even work, entirely. I am a single mom of a four year old boy who's in preschool full time. (just to give a little background and knowledge of my very limited schedule) What classes should I take in order to make myself stand out ahead of anyone else who may be aiming for the same leadership roles, such as supervisor or lead? Bachelors in Heth Sciences? Any helpful advice/insight would be IMMENSELY appreciated. Thank you!"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1cqssyh/back_to_school/

"I would strongly recommend automating reminders. Use every channel available. Email. SMS. Phone calls. Voicemails. Every missed follow up is a leak in your funnel. Plug those leaks and the same leads you already have will start producing far more revenue over time. If you are serious about growth, this massive fix you can make."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qrb80b/none_of_my_prospects_are_answering_my_calls_after_o2mxlxs/

"Good lead vendors these days? I just started using PitchPrftc.com) to send SMS at scale since they're only \$0.007 per text so I figured it might be worth a shot finding affordable aged (<30 day) or shared lead vendors. Anyone know of any good ones?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rxhfgn/good_lead_vendors_these_days/

"Pretty typical of any vendor, can run hot and cold. I'm not sure if you see the same leads that I do, but if there is a "questionnaire" lead, stay away from that one. It is full of people who are just filling out surveys. To be honest, I buy a mix of leads from them. That being said, every internet lead has to be worked. You are going to get plenty who say "wasn't me", or some other lame excuse or they just hang up on you. I'll simply put those leads to the side for a couple days, even a week and then call them again as if we've never spoken. It doesn't always work out, but the number of people who all but cussed me out a few days ago, now act like they've been waiting on my call is just weird. I like that Integrity doesn't force a specific number for a purchase. I work this business part time so it's nice to be able to control how many I get. I work with a team, and we have plenty of new agents come and go. I'll see them buy 5,10,20 leads, dial them a few times, not make a sale, then blame wherever the lead came from, say the whole thing is a scam and bounce. Working internet leads is not always an easy task.."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/mnsacz5/

"Well, two things: - There are still plenty of top producers doing well, but some who aren't (like me), and some who used to do well (like our Agent of the Year in 2017) who did not do well last year, but are now doing well again. There are agents that I have consistently outsold in my time here that are performing better than me now. - My best guess as to why it's been crappy for me lately is that I consumed a lot of leads during our AEP and although I converted many of them (and placed 7th out of about 300 during AEP), there were plenty I did not convert and taking those leads "counts against me." My main goal right now is becoming more efficient so that my contact-to-close ratio improves, as that's what dictates the quality of lead you're generally getting (people inquiring directly on our website vs. shared leads), but it feels like I've dug myself into a hole I can't get out of."

— r/sales · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/bg1nab/anyone_here_work_in_medigapmedicare_supplemental/elkg0w8/

"Thank you for taking the time to explain that. The tiered system is absolutely an issue. Those "premium" leads will be absolutely re sold to other agents (most of the time sooner than the purchasing agent is aware) and then resold again over and over. Hence the actual title of they system. If you are happy with the system and do not mind other agents (possibly very competent ones) following up with your clients later than by all means keep with this style of system. We all need to work within the system we create. I create (as do all in my group) our own leads via self built lead generators as individuals...or purchase from trusted vendors exclusive leads...or live transfers that we qualify ourselves. Just some food for thought. To each their own....good luck on the stair steps ...be careful."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mfu7pr/considering_trying_a_facebook_lead_campaign/n6lrhq2/

"Cold call lists and Leads P&C Where do yall get your leads? We pay 1\$ a lead right now, and have about the same close rates as we experienced paying 15\$ for leads. We've been using the same lead source for 9 months now. Problem is - these leads are always charging back, wasting our time, etc. How do you generate decent leads? We're trying to connect with realtors and such, but can't seem to generate the inbound calls. Google does okay, but now we're fighting to keep our business ad up since they said we violated policies(major captive company, we literally did nothing but advertise our location 🤔). Where do you buy decent leads or cold call lists? What's your strategy? Anyone wanna help out a young agency?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p6wc9w/cold_call_lists_and_leads_pc/

"I am not sure your industry, but our agency has crossed a little over 6,000 members on our book for ACA. What has helped us a lot is texting first to setup a call not just calling out of the blue. There are many other things that can help but this is a big thing we have found. We have been using the same lead source for a while so my perception may be a bit skewed from how it really is out there."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rkajao/aged_leads/o8jtuci/

HealthSherpa / marketplace tools (ACA) · 24 documents

"How to get contracted as an independent health ins agent! I recently got licensed as a health insurance agent and am currently selling Obamacare. It took me forever to figure out who to contact within each insurance company to get contracted (their websites are a labyrinth!!) so I'm making this post to help out future agents! <https://agent.communityhealthchoice.org/becoming-an-agent/> <https://www.aetna.com/insurance-producer/become-appointed-with-aetna.html> <https://www.molinamarketplace.com/marketplace/brokers/en-us/Become-A-Broker/Agent-Appointment.aspx> <https://www.bcbstx.com/producer/prospective.htm> <https://www.humana.com/agent/contract-with-humana> <https://www.ambetterhealth.com/for-brokers.html> <https://www.uhc.com/broker-consultant> (email [appoint@uhc.com])(<mailto:appoint@uhc.com>), it took FOREVER to find this email and I found it on some random blank contract they had on google but NOWHERE on their website) BONUS use <https://www.healthsherpa.com/> to compare insurance plans, generate quotes, and complete applications! They have a rly nice interface c."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/q1705l/how_to_get_contracted_as_an_independent_health/

"ACA Shit-Show I am recently getting leads and I am using Health Sherpa for enrollments. I just came across a few clients who had 70 + writing agents ! Like WTF. Is this a data bresch , scam or what. In some cases I would actually call the person and they seem clueless about it when I would tell them you marketplace profile looks like a brothel with agents cocking each other. Secondly how does this effect their tax returns, since most of them are somehow enrolled in two three market place plans, all with premium subsidy applied, which as far as I know doesn't work like that. My question is should I presume such leads? Should I tell them to call CMS and report ? Or just ignore such customers. I feel like my inner conscious doesn't let it go I feel like I should help these people, because is most cases they are unaware."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1bd66ik/aca_shitshow/

"Hi OP! I'm a relatively new insurance agent been license for almost years and yes no one is ever transparent about leads, how to generate those and how costly they can be. To get leads you either pay a lot of money for them or spend a lot of your time chasing them. I personally gave up selling life insurance and supplementals because the amount of chargebacks was awful. Now I just focus on U65 ACA marketplace plans. I am also part of the HealthSherpa enrollee assistance program which pays me per person I have enrolled. I prefer this over getting commissions from the insurance carriers. I'll be happy to offer some feedback but you can also do your research."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mcl3e3/i_already_hate_my_job/n5veshz/

"Any tips on succeeding as a health insurance agent? How to succeed as an agent on my own? I work for an insurance broker which currently sells aca (Obamacare) products. I've thought about going solo so I can have more freedom with my schedule. I also have a partner who'd like to join with me. I can't get a straight answer when I research online. Do I need to be contracted with an fmo in order to be appointed with multiple carriers? I saw somewhere online that you do need an fmo. Also for anyone familiar with HealthSherpa, do they pay commission monthly on the plans or just a on time payment. Any advice or general help on how to get started would be greatly appreciated!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1adi8ew/any_tips_on_succeeding_as_a_health_insurance_agent/

"Best strategy to start selling health insurance (Medicare + ACA) Hi everyone, I recently earned my accident & health license and I am excited to begin my journey as a health insurance agent. I am still in the early stages of learning how the sales process and industry work, so I would appreciate any advice or insights from experienced colleagues. My goal is to build residual income by focusing on health insurance (either ACA or Medicare). For ACA, I am considering using HealthSherpa for their platform and training resources. For Medicare, I am thinking of starting with 1 or 2 carriers as a captive to access knowledge. I look at this as a short-term plan (about 6 months) to build a solid foundation to then transition to a broker or agency to access multiple carriers to provide best plan and maybe better commissions. Does this sound like a good plan? Are there downsides of going captive with more than 1 carrier? I see some offer AHIP certification discount, should I take it? I would love to hear your thoughts and any suggestions you might have. Thank you so much!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1i3ms00/best_strategy_to_start_selling_health_insurance/

"Medicare Enrollment Tools Hi all, I am an insurance agent and looking to expand into Medicare plans. I currently sell ACA plans through Healthsherpa and am looking to see if there is a good platform to quote and sell Medicare plans. Any insights are appreciated. Thanks!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gz0ref/medicare_enrollment_tools/

"Yes they all so this is disgusting. The last company I worked for (HealthMarkets) did exactly this and charged us \$36 per call we answered, mind you none of those calls turned to sales. You should get appointed directly with the carriers you want to sell and then use HealthSherpa to enroll and keep track of your clients and commissions. That's what I did and it's been a game changer."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p0mqo2/is_it_just_me/nps166v/

"I referred my clients to Healthsherpa because I didn't get appointed at the time of enrollment. But now I get appointed, can I get my clients back?"

— YouTube · How to process Agent of Record (AOR) changes for ACA "Obamacare" policies!! · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=iXCp-KwfMwY&lc=UgyPs8jfr2fb2lljG7N4AaABAg>

"I agree that learning new system is PITA, but one think that saved me ton of time is that I don't have to rewrite the whole application to renew plan. But yes, the rest is not agent friendly. Good thing that Get Covered has monthly meeting with agents and they actually listen, so I hope for the next year they will improve few things. You cannot do simple quote in the agent system. You just go to the public site and quote Prescreener enroll.getcovered.illinois.gov To get quote when you are logged in as agent, you first need to Search Existing Customer, and add them, and I'm not even sure if you have to first fill eligibility determination, before getting quote. That's why I do public quotes and save screenshots for future conversations. You cannot save quotes, like in Health Sherpa, and it's difficult to edit. Healthcare.gov in 2013-2014 was MUCH WORST, but they had 13 years, they should make it better now."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Health Insurance Exchange Forum · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/get-covered-il-please-help.116785/#post-1560728>

"Special Agent said: the UHC Anocs are on Jarvis.Health Sherpa will show all plans but you have to change filter to show non commissionable plans.Hope that still applies for 2027 Not with suppressed plans. Non commissionable yes but not suppressed. i just ran a quote on healthsherpa and looking at PDP plans and Humana isnt even listed under the carriers available. Totally gone from the platform."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Senior Insurance Forum · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/humana-is-taking-suppression-to-a-new-level.118143/#post-1594080>

"Yagents said: Blue options ppo is on market also Maybe it's because I used healthsherpa to look but my blue select ppo 1442 wasn't listed. My wife is a FI blue captive agent and we had to do it off exchange. But you're right. Blue options is on there. Wish I could have kept my old pre ACA FI blue plan. But wife and kid got in the way."
— Insurance-Forums.com · Health Insurance Exchange Forum · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/off-exchange-carriers-appointments-what-do-i-need-to-know.115010/#post-1523755>

"prencik said: I agree that learning new system is PITA, but one think that saved me ton of time is that I don't have to rewrite the whole application to renew plan. But yes, the rest is not agent friendly. Good thing that Get Covered has monthly meeting with agents and they actually listen, so I hope for the next year they will improve few things. You cannot do simple quote in the agent system. You just go to the public site and quote Prescreener enroll.getcovered.illinois.gov To get quote when you are logged in as agent, you first need to Search Existing Customer, and add them, and I'm not even sure if you have to first fill eligibility determination, before getting quote. That's why I do public quotes and save screenshots for future conversations. You cannot save quotes, like in Health Sherpa, and it's difficult to edit. Healthcare.gov in 2013-2014 was MUCH WORST, but they had 13 years, they should make it better now. Click to expand... I don't know anything about a monthly meeting, I did not even know I was going to need to do a new certification 2 days before OEP I did not know I would not be able to use HS like with GAs new exchange still allowed and Certainly cant get any reasonable information from the Robot on the site nor the over seas help you get when you call in The whole thing was a nightmare especially getting locked out till 2 weeks ago I am lucky I only had a few IL ACA clients, though one was a really good one I had hoped to talk about larger policies as far as annuities and such with, This is not going to happen now Hopefully there will be some resources to learn the system before to much longer"
— Insurance-Forums.com · Health Insurance Exchange Forum · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/get-covered-il-please-help.116785/#post-1560735>

Dislikes

Compliance and carrier rules

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought "pre-sold leads" from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigator (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the "insurance carrier, not the agent", for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigator wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigator. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."
— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

"Let go at 6 months pregnant This happened yesterday. I'm still processing. Couldn't sleep all night. And this is long. I apologize in advance. Been an AE at this small private tech company for almost 2 years. They recently went through a rebrand and wanted us targeting completely new verticals. Leadership and overall processes were a complete mess, and it was honestly a shit show. I wanted to leave, but was holding out until after baby arrived this summer. Q4 was rough. Partly because we have zero good inbound leads and are 100% reliant on outbound, and we have a 6 month sales cycle on average. Except our CEO acts like it should be a 2-meeting close. My old boss was fired and I got a new boss in January. In February, I was told I needed to hit my revenue numbers by end of March, along with all these KPIs metrics, and training a new guy he hired. I've never been on a PIP in my life (been an AE for 7 years), but it didn't feel formal in that there was no document and I never signed anything. Just told I need to do this and this. Now, normally the advice is to start applying immediately. And I did. However my situation is a bit different as I'm pregnant and due this summer. Made it to the offer stage at another company and then informed them I was pregnant, hoping to negotiate some sort of leave. Unfortunately they couldn't offer me any paid leave and my job also wouldn't be protected since I wouldn't qualify for FMLA. At my current company, I would. So it felt safer in the moment to stay. I worked my ass off. Consistently delivered on outreach KPIs, spent hours training the new hire, helped with new marketing initiatives developing new 1-pagers and helping with new outreach playbook development. Really trying to show I'm an asset and praying I could stay on through the summer. After that, I wouldn't care. Still, my revenue was down and my other deals were tied up in legal and I was starting to worry. But out of nowhere one of my old deals I closed last summer was acquired and the new company reached out per their recommendation, and wanted to move forward. This new deal would single handedly hit my revenue numbers. However the compliance aspect took forever. Our team is so disorganized and makes it so hard to buy. Then onboarding. Unfortunately I also sell a consumption based product. So even though they sign the contract and commit to X volume, the revenue generated is dependent on their ramp....which is in the hands of the client success team. And then wouldn't you have it, this CSM did the bare minimum to help them ramp. I felt like I was being sabotaged. Even my boss agreed that they were not doing their job. I stepped up and held meetings to help the client onboard, go through the set up and integration. The CSM completely dropped the ball. No reoccurring meetings in place until they fully ramped, nothing. Basically told them "if you need help lmk". Insane. So, yesterday arrived and I was below my revenue number. But I SHOULD have hit it. And I've been doing so much I really didn't feel worried. Mind you, my entire team was below as well. Revenue was stagnant across the company. But my boss called me out of the blue and I was terminated on the spot. No emotion. No severance. No paid out PTO. No extended insurance. Nothing. My income makes up 60% of our household income. And I use their insurance. Which I have doctors appointments set up every 2 weeks. They've completely fucked me as no company is going to hire me when I give birth in 3 months and also pay me for leave. I dont know what the fuck to do. We genuinely cannot afford to not have my income until Fall. Do I have any legal leg to stand on, or can they just say I fell short of performance, even if I'm dependent on others to do their job AND the entire company was stagnant on revenue? (For reference, I was the only one with a contract signed in Q1 and I had 2 others under review)."
— r/sales · 108 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1jp0avi/let_go_at_6_months_pregnant/

"AMA - Never selling insurance to 85k monthly commissions starting my own agency **AMA: Nine months ago I'd never sold a policy. Today my ACA book does about \$85k/month with a \$34 CPA and ~3% loss. Here's what I wish I'd researched before spending money. Quick context** * Licensed end of Oct '24, started selling Jan '25 * Put **\$100k** in over the year * I buy **live inbound callers only** (no cold lists) **How I handle calls (this mattered most)** * Calls only route to me when I'm not already on the phone, so I don't miss people * If I miss a customer service call, I call back the same day—no exceptions * Clients get a real number that reaches me—my personal cell, 24/7. Hard work, but it built trust and referrals **What to research before you spend \$1** * Refund policy in writing: what counts as a bad call, how returns work, when credits land * Answer/contact rates by hour and source (real stats, not guesses) * County/ZIP targeting that matches ACA networks I can actually place * Consent/compliance language used before the call reaches me * Delivery control so I can cap/pause and touch every caller the same day **Money I wasted** * "Cheap" calls with vague or slow refunds * Buying volume before the intake script and follow-up rhythm were dialed in * Fancy software I didn't use every day **Money that paid off** * Speed + clarity: short script, quick verify, clear next step, same-day follow-up * Call recording + quick QC: 10 minutes a day fixed leaks I couldn't see in a spreadsheet * Knowing ACA cold: networks, formularies, prior auth, renewal quirks—explained in plain English (be the expert and put people at ease) **My lead-vendor checklist now** 1. Refund/credit rules and SLA (in writing) 2. Sample ads so I know there's no fake incentivizing 3. State targeting and delivery hours 4. I can throttle/stop calls instantly **Process that moved the needle** * 3 steps: verify basics → solve the real problem → set a specific next time/action * 1–2 plan options max, with reasons (menus slow everything down) * Same-day everything, or conversion drops * Post-enrollment customer care (ID cards, network checks, "what now?") drives referrals and keeps churn low (~3%) **Simple weekly scoreboard** * Reached calls / total calls * Kept appointments * Submits * Time to first touch * Service issues per member * Refund rate / turnaround * CPA (~\$34) and trend **If I had to start over (I could do it much cheaper—\$10–20k)** * Spend the first 2–3 weeks on scripts, routing, notes template, and a manual follow-up schedule * Trial multiple **live-call** vendors in tiny batches; only scale the one that proves contactability **and** refunds * Keep the tech boring: I run everything in Excel and Google Calendar * Give clients a real number and show up—that's what makes referrals happen That's my playbook and the lessons. AMA about the research, spend, setup, or what I'd cut or double down on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 62 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/

"To form an LLC or to not form an LLC? 🤖🤖 That is the question.... 🤖🤖 Many people get the advice to spread out their liability and form an LLC with a business. If you are forming practically any other business, I would almost always say yes, go for it. In the insurance business, however, there are costs as well as administrative and compliance considerations to consider when forming an entity that could make things unnecessarily complicated for you in the beginning. In addition, for most independent agents E&O insurance is required for carrier appointments and covers you in the case of liability for any errors or omissions that pose the highest risk of liability. Now if you're concerned that maybe you go door-to-door or do appointment setting or something along those lines and an old lady trips and falls and blames you for it, that's a whole nother story of liability and perhaps a reason that you should form an LLC. The risk of that is very low in that regard, unless tripping old ladies is something that you're accustomed to. There are three scenarios in which I tell independent agents to go ahead and form an entity. 🤖1 - you already have high Revenue Revenue can get to a certain point where you can file to be taxed as a corporation and get owner's distribution to lower overall tax burden. 🤖2 - you have high production There are certain carriers in the industry that are worth having and also require an entity in order to attain certain contract levels (compensation levels). Some carriers also require an entity if you have downlines or a certain number of downlines. 🤖3 - you have downlines (agents working for your agency) When other people's income start to get involved, other people's families, other peoples things, etc. it is always smart to have an LLC to limit your liability as a company. It's smart and it protects you from that liability of the many, many things that could potentially happen as business grows. I tend to advise not to give yourself an extra headache by forming an entity early. If you are going solo and are holding contracts independently, an entity typically does not need to be formed until these scenarios arise. A DBA is just fine until you produce, you get agents, or you get high enough revenue for a tax advantage. 🤖🤖 Please consult with a lawyer and CPA, as I am not a lawyer or a CPA, and this does not constitute official or licensed legal or financial advice."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mp3psz/to_form_an_llc_or_to_not_form_an_llc_that_is_the/

"Great idea. Favorite telesales carriers: RNA, Prosperity and Trinity. SS billing + voice sign for all 3. Favorite lead: Real-time telemarketed call back with verified checking, ages 50-79 and agrees to speak with an agent. Basically telemarketers calling on DNC scrubbed and TCPA verified data to call on (old FB leads or Journaya/Trusted Form verified) + scrubbed against TCPA Blacklist Alliance and inputting into a form to serve it up in a CRM immediately. Tip: You need proper training and sales systems to make telesales work. If you take your DM leads and try to sell them over the phone with your typical f2f presentation, you'll fail. If you buy internet leads and don't have proper sales training or sales systems, you'll fail. My advice is either partner with a telesales-focused agency with an open release policy (hey, telesales isn't for everyone) or wait it out. Don't waste any time/money unless there's a proven system in place."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Forum · 11 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/final-expense-telesales-tips.101595/#post-134455>
5

"I have been in this industry for 14 years and it has become a shell of it's former self. Let me explain. In 2009 is when CMS enacted over 100 new regulations in the Medicare industry. New regulations included annual enrollment periods, government regulated commissions for Part C and D, a Scope of Appointment form that must be completed prior to an agent's presentation, annual AHIP certifications to be able to sell policies in addition to annual carrier certifications, soon after new legislation that required MA plans to have to have a network which killed PFFS plans which were the most popular MA plans at that time, laws which forbids agents to market Part C and D products, laws which govern every aspect of agents holding seminars even including not allowing agents to offer free meals for attendees, the inability to call referrals (the referral must contact you), regulations on carriers that made it illegal for carriers to offer bonuses and trips to agents for production rewards, and many more that I can't think of off the top of my head. After these draconian regulations were passed most agents left the industry. The only ones that stayed were the agents that had a solid book of business prior to these new regulations which is why the average age of a Medicare agent is 60 years old. This industry's golden age was from 1998 to 2008. Medicare Advantage was a brand new concept as well a few years later Part D was brand new as well. There were plenty of reasons why seniors needed to talk with an agent during this time and the big money was made at this time. That all changed in 2009. CMS used the excuse that since agents were getting compensated with taxpayer money (Medicare funding Dollars) that CMS had the right to regulated everything about the agent's existence in this industry. In 2020, very little has changed under the Trump administration. The only good thing to be improved upon was CMS not requiring the Scope of Appointment form to be filled out 48 hours prior to an agent's presentation and changed it to the same day as the appointment. Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as well for fear that the carrier will get in trouble with CMS and lose funding for their plans. Part D plans pay almost nothing for the sheer amount of work that needs to be done reviewing your client's drug list every year that you are almost working for free. MAPD plans pay the same commission as MA only plans. Now if you understand inflation this is another issue as well. The US Dollar loses 2%-3% of it's value every year which causes prices to increase, but you get paid renewals based upon commission rates from the first year you write the business. So while you do make renewals, those renewals become less and less every year. Now that MA plans have ironed out their networks and funding is stabilized, there is little need for seniors to switch Medicare plans every year because they already are in the best plan possible. You can go after T65 business, but that has also become problematic as well. Since Social Security has raised the full benefit retirement age from 65 to 67, most seniors are still working for an employer at 65 and have no need for Medicare coverage until they retire, especially since many spouses are not yet on Medicare and their spouse needs the group coverage. The (un)Affordable Care Act aka Obamacare is terrible and has made major medical coverage too expensive and too restrictive. After 14 years in the industry I have finally realized all that is bad and the bad FAR out weighs the good. The commissions are too small for an agent to make it especially with so few seniors actually needing a better plan plus with everything I previously mentioned you need to be insane to become a Medicare agent in 2020. If you do start off in this industry you need at LEAST 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months of marketing expenses saved or you will run out of money very quick and need to find an hourly job. You must write 100 policies every year to make it in this industry and you will max out at 400 to 500 clients because any more clients and you will have to hire help. So at \$250 commission per client earned every year you are looking at a max of \$100,000 to \$125,000 minus your marketing expenses which will cost you between \$12,000 to \$20,000 per year plus all the gas consumption and wear and tear on your vehicle driving all over town on appointments, double taxes you pay for FICA, Medicare and Social Security taxes, and lack of access yourself to affordable health insurance by not having access to group health policies. Covid-19 is a new hurdle agents must overcome and adds a dozens new challenges because of CMS regulations. The Medicare industry just isn't worth it anymore."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAg>

"Hi David! I always appreciate your videos, so thank you for making them and sharing your knowledge so freely and often. I passed the AHIP but haven't had really any training on how to sell Medicare plans, which is frustrating because I don't want to be out that test money and not using that knowledge to help people. I do telesales for FE and plan to for Medicare but I'm nervous about all the upfront compliance stuff (like fitting in SOA over the phone for example). I have reached out to my agency about it but haven't had any assistance as of yet. Any chance you're planning on a video like this, or have a start to finish example of a Medicare call that could help put me at ease to get started?"

— YouTube · How A Career Selling Medicare Policies Works · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=d2SmzwHbqfw&lc=UgzJ1e_zsWcOx83Umx4AaABAg

"Here's what I'm doing (not be construed as legal advice): 1. Update your compliance language on all opt-in forms. 2. Switch from shared/data leads to self-generated leads if you're doing anything more powerful than manual dialing. 3. My interpretation is that you can work aged/data leads on a single-line dialer as that counts as manual dialing. However, doing so would be akin to self-mutilation. Overall, the spirit of the law is great and hopefully will greatly limit call centers and the amount of mass dialing data "leads" they do."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hszzi5/doing_anything_about_the_new_tcpa_rule_whats_your/m59vn00/

"Advice for Final Expense Startup (High-Volume Cold Calling Team) Hi everyone, I'm planning to start selling final expense insurance within the next month or two. I'll be going all-in on cold calling and wanted to get feedback from experienced agents before launch. My Plan: I'll (22M) be working with my two 18-year-old brothers and operating in new york state Each of us will make 1,000 cold calls/day, 6 days a week We'll work 12-13 hour shifts, using a CRM + power dialer system We plan to buy leads daily at \$0.30 to \$0.50 each We're all bilingual (English/Spanish) and comfortable with high-volume sales We're not strangers to long hours or consistent effort — and we plan to maintain tone and energy throughout. Goals: Start with final expense sales Gradually add Medicare Scope of Appointments (SOA), enrollments, and eventually Medicare Supplements After a few months of production, I plan to negotiate a 140% commission contract We're expecting a 0.3% to 0.5% close rate based on what we've researched A friend of mine who only does medicare will share his hot leads with me since i will do final expense so i am guaranteed some early success at least if i dont screw it up --- My Questions: 1. Is this call volume and close rate realistic for a new team using aged or low-cost leads? 2. Is there anything crucial I'm overlooking in terms of compliance, licensing, or daily execution? 3. Are there any CRM + dialer combos you highly recommend for high-volume final expense/Medicare telesales? 4. For Medicare broker changes, is it realistic to expect consistent volume or are those more seasonal? 5. Are there any major red flags or rookie mistakes we should avoid early on? 6. Any advice for scripting, retention, or mental pacing during long dialing days? Thanks in advance — I really respect the grind this industry takes and want to do it the right way."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jnkha/advice_for_final_expense_startup_highvolume_cold/

"You can still sell medicare this AEP. You'll need to approach it as a field agent. You can set up an educational kiosk anywhere you can get permission where there's consistent senior foot traffic, like grocery stores. You can go visit a local networking group like a BNI and share how you can help folks and ask for referrals. You can introduce yourself to 64 year olds who aren't on Medicare yet but who likely have questions about the process - keeping the conversation education for compliance - by using the T65 Locator app in the App Store. Cold calling seniors during AEP was always and is always a plague in our society, fucking leeches. Go do the best you can and after AEP you can change your contracts to another FMO who supports healthy field agent marketing activities."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ofi9mo/i_was_a_1099_agent_and_got_terminated_today/nlat6zf/

"TCPA mainly focuses on robo calls and dialers. I don't use any of those to dial my leads. I'm pretty much old school and hand dial myself. It's been 2 years for me and I haven't had an issue yet. I also don't spam call my leads. If someone answers and states they're not interested, I move on to the next lead. I'm not in the business of begging or being pushy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/m9mifjh/

"> What is your plan for when the incoming calls stop? As cynical as this sounds - there is no plan. If you have a phone, the calls will never stop coming. The numbers are spoofed, the names are fake, and there is nothing you can do. Even if you're on every blacklist alliance list, DNC, TCPA litigator scrub, etc etc - they all disconnect the calls AFTER the happen. Its annoying and won't end. I can get 100 illegal calls in a day and get zero justice or I can get 100 illegal calls a day, sue on 3-4 of them and get \$10-20 grand worth of justice. This is the world we're living in. The calls will never stop. If they did, I'd have a much higher serenity around here and I could enjoy some of the money I've made over the years. > Can you say with absolute sincerity that you're not taking any action to receive these illegal calls? 100%. I do not sign up for ANYTHING. I sit at home watching TV or scratching myself and the calls come in. I'm too young for medicare, but I get 20+ calls a day for medicare advantage. I'm too young for final expense insurance, I get 30+ a day for final expense. It's insanity. > You sure you're not intentionally putting yourself in a position for opportunities to sue these companies/agents? Am I intentionally putting myself in a position to sue these people, absolutely. The same way a cop running radar that has a really good spot that nobody can see / knows about..... I have a charged gopro handy and I record the incoming calls. Yes, I intentionally prepare myself to get the most leverage and the best evidence capture of illegal telemarketing practices. > I can't tell if you're posting this to be a genuine warning or maybe even bragging... but it actually reads like "Careful about your lead source, or else people without real jobs like me are going to sue you." I've done several settlements with small brokers that have said "we can't pay you what you're asking" and I said that's fine, I'll hold your upline joint and severally liable. Next thing I know, a decent settlement offer comes my way. OR I hire an attorney, they file a class action against the upline, the brokerage, the broker and the agent PERSONALLY and everyone goes to court, the upline spends \$150-200k in defense costs that they subrogate back to the downline via payment plan/docked commissions/what have you and my attorneys add another win to their CV. The message here is that YOU MAY THINK this new lead vendor of yours is all great but if you get burned, you can potentially be involved in bet the company litigation. And this is the WORST kind of litigation to be in because you don't realize you're in bet the company litigation until you've wound up betting the company. >Do what everyone else does and block the numbers that call Not that easy. All the numbers are spoofed. I get calls from the hospital, chevy dealership, etc etc - all displayed on the caller ID that are overseas call centers. Your outlook is 100% flawed. >No I have never been sued by a serial litigator because I only receive direct inbound calls, but I can still cringe at you for bottom feeding You know what's funny? Every single broker I've sued says "we only recieve direct inbound calls" - you know why? THE LEAD GEN SPOOFS MY NUMBER, CALLS YOUR BROKERAGE SO YOU CAN CLAIM IT IS AN INBOUND CALL. The only counterbattery is my gopro video."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8y9glc/

"Devoted Health is engaging in bad-faith.... Devoted Health is engaging in bad-faith claims adjudication by intentionally weaponizing administrative obstacles to systematically withhold mandated Medicare benefits under National Coverage Determination (NCD) 150.3.Detailed Description:I am escalating this dispute because Devoted Health is utilizing intentional administrative barrier tactics to evade its federal statutory obligations under my Devoted Choice Giveback ("Pay Back") PPO plan. The plan explicitly affirmed my clinical eligibility for chronic low back pain acupuncture in a formal postal letter and established a precedent by successfully reimbursing session one. Their subsequent withholding of payments for five identical, consecutive sessions is not an operational oversight; it is a calculated non-delivery of baseline federal Medicare benefits.Devoted's out-of-state corporate management team is exploiting its remote structure to issue repetitive, bad-faith demands for "insufficient information". Because the billing codes, clinician credentials, and clinical documentation submitted for the unpaid sessions are completely identical to the approved first session, these demands constitute an intentional strategy to create a cycle of administrative exhaustion.By forcing a local Hawaii senior to finance a federally protected benefit out-of-pocket, Devoted Health is in direct, willful breach of its CMS contract. I request that CMS bypass the plan's failed internal grievance metrics, launch an immediate compliance audit into Devoted's Hawaii PPO reimbursement protocols, and compel immediate restitution. Devoted Health formally established eligibility criteria and authorized coverage for the chronic low back pain acupuncture treatments via written postal correspondence. Under established Medicare Advantage guidelines, an insurer cannot arbitrarily revoke or obstruct an active, written authorization when the subsequent medical claims present identical clinical indicators and treatment modalities.Arbitrary and Capricious Claims Processing: The plan's administrative team has acted inconsistently by successfully reimbursing the initial acupuncture session, yet denying or withholding payment for the subsequent 5 identical sessions. Because the exact same provider information, billing codes, and clinical documentation were submitted across all claims, the plan's repeated assertion that there is "insufficient information" constitutes an arbitrary administrative barrier.Improper Adjudication and Unreasonable Administrative Burden: By demanding additional, unspecified information for ongoing sessions that identical documentation already sufficed to cover, Devoted Health is creating an uncertified administrative hurdle. This violates CMS expectations for fair claims processing, shifting an unlawful financial and administrative burden onto the beneficiary after prior approval was secured.Violation of CMS Chronic Low Back Pain Coverage Mandates: National Coverage Determination (NCD) 150.3 dictates that Medicare covers up to 12 initial acupuncture sessions within a 90-day window for chronic low back pain. By withholding payment for 5 consecutive sessions within this approved window, Devoted Health is failing to deliver the baseline federal benefits mandated under its Medicare Advantage contract.Demand for Prompt Equitable Estoppel and Immediate Reimbursement: Because the beneficiary reasonably relied on Devoted Health's explicit written assurances and the initial successful reimbursement to continue necessary medical treatments, the plan is legally and equitably estopped from denying coverage. Devoted Health must immediately resolve this internal processing error, honor their written commitment, and issue full reimbursement for the 5 outstanding sessions to prevent further financial injury to the beneficiary. On top of it all, they have escalated the excessive stress on MY HEALTH."

— TrustPilot · Devoted Health · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a8d09f0594549203e916983>

"Fraudulent policies. . The situation with Oscar Health Insurance is not merely a personal grievance; it is a glaring example of systemic malpractice that undermines the integrity of the healthcare system. The company has allowed unscrupulous agents, motivated solely by commission, to exploit the marketplace, enrolling individuals without their informed consent. This is a blatant violation of ethical standards and consumer rights. Despite having secured legitimate coverage through United Healthcare since 2023, I have been subjected to the unauthorized use of my personal information by these fraudsters from 2024 to 2026. Oscar Health's refusal to rectify this situation, despite clear evidence of fraudulent applications from 2024 and 2025, is not just negligent; it is a calculated disregard for the trust placed in them by their members. This behavior is not just bad business; it is an affront to the principles of honesty and transparency that should govern the healthcare industry. Oscar Health claims to prioritize integrity and compliance, yet their actions tell a different story. They have failed to uphold their own Code of Conduct, which mandates ethical dealings and respect for member privacy. I urge anyone who suspects they may be victims of similar fraudulent practices to take immediate action. Verify your enrollment status and ensure that your personal information is not being misused. The Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS) has acknowledged the rise in improper enrollments and provides resources for reporting such incidents. It is imperative that we hold companies like Oscar Health accountable for their unethical practices and demand a healthcare system that truly serves the interests of its members."

— TrustPilot · Oscar Health · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6983aef32974cbe9e9b23298>

Chargebacks and clawbacks

"State Farm just rewrote 19,000 agents' contracts overnight. If you think a captive book is a retirement plan, read this If you somehow missed it: State Farm is moving all 19,000 of its agents onto a single standardized contract, ending their deferred-comp/retirement program (AIPP), and dropping health insurance for agents and spouses. Agents are reportedly looking at 30–40% less on base commissions depending on contract and book size. I can't believe State Farm disputes that number but hasn't offered its own. The core shift is from getting paid to "retain" a book to getting paid to "write new business". They also put buyout offers on the table with a Sept 30 deadline. P&C side, I know. But the lesson isn't carrier-specific and it's the thing I keep coming back to: you never actually owned that book. State Farm did. And a 20-year "trailing income" promise is only worth as much as the carrier's willingness to keep paying it which turned out to be "until it's inconvenient." The part that should get every agent's attention is the direction, not the one carrier. Comp is going performance-based across the board, trailing/renewal-style income is getting squeezed, and AI is going to absorb more of the service and retention work that used to justify those trails. The "come build a \$3–5M book and coast" pitch a lot of us were sold is quietly being retired. So I'm genuinely curious how the room sees it: Are you seeing comp pressure at your carrier/IMO too, or is this a State Farm-specific overreach? Does owning your book independently actually protect you here, or is that just trading carrier risk for lead-cost/chargeback risk? For the newer agents is anyone factoring "can they rewrite my deal in 5 years" into where they sign? Not trying to dunk on State Farm agents since a lot of them got blindsided and it's a rough spot. More interested in what this says about where the whole comp model is heading."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

"Starting to think the money and lifestyle is a pipe dream from the depths of my soul I really need to know the truth of this I have a family to support. i've been selling life insurance for about two years now. I was attracted to all these big checks and the lifestyle that you can control your money and just buy leads and set appointments and do one call closes over the phone and you could make 200k, 300k 500 K a year. and there are tons of people showcase that are doing it. Even twenty something yr olds. So I got in and I bought the leads and I grinded my face off. I managed to make over 100 K within a handful of months. I thought I had it made and I cracked the code. And then I realized I still felt broke. all these crappy lead companies. these leads were supposed to be exclusive and I know they sold them to 10 other agents. I would sometimes dial eight hours a day and only have 1 to 3 genuine conversations. that's crap. I was on the phone all day long I was buying thousands of dollars a month in Leads. Then the chargebacks started hitting me. And now I have to work for free for the rest of the month. But you Gotta keep buying more leads And then customers would call in and need things. I needed to call the carriers. but I didn't really have time to talk to them because I need to buy more leads and call more people and make more sales. eventually I realized how unhappy I was I was working a lot and yet I still felt paycheck to paycheck despite writing 20-30k a month. and I feel like I could not get ahead. What the heck? Then I looked at some of my leaders I was following and they were making 400 K plus a year. and I thought if I ever get to their level then I will be an easy Street then I could take my foot off the gas and I could have a great lifestyle. Wrong. All of them are working their faces off. they couldn't take time off. they weren't spending time with her kids. they didn't have time to answer my calls. Or to train me really. And what's more they didn't even seem happy. they had this stressed out look in their face all the time. I thought how could that be? was this all a lie? is the money and lifestyle even real? I saw this guy who wrote \$1 million on stage. Come to find out he spent 250 K on Leads 30 to 40% fall off. and then minus the guaranteed issue and administrative costs like his dialer or admin... really he was making like 150-200k. That ain't a million. And. He was working 7 days a week. And stressed out couldn't take his foot off the gas. Not worth it. I don't want that lifestyle. If I'm making 400 K a year I better be able to enjoy time with my family and come home for dinner and take nice vacations and make money moves and investments. My goal is to have the lifestyle not to be a slave on the phone seven days a week 10 hours a day. I'm assuming it's just unsustainable biz model. and you're always fighting off chargebacks . And the lead cost will eat up all your profits and that's why most agents won't stick around. Is that the cold truth? am I chasing a pipe dream ? is there ever a way off the escalator if you are selling by yourself without a team? I was mainly doing final expense and mortgage protection.."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 59 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nmbbqg/starting_to_think_the_money_and_lifestyle_is_a/

"I would say this is pretty accurate. I've been in the life insurance business since 2015. I don't have any overhead and don't pay for leads. I'd say I am pretty average and work about 30 hrs /week. strictly personally producing right now. I have 90% retention and make about 5k a month. I've had a team before and was making considerably more money but was putting in considerably more hours. I also have seen people in my company that are more motivated than me make 20k+ a month. I don't have a spouse or kids so working remotely is perfect and lets me travel all over and I enjoy taking time off to explore. For someone that is willing to put in the time and effort, life insurance is a great long term career. Just make sure you look into leads, chargebacks, and residuals when you interview with a company and be prepared to put in work."

— YouTube · I Asked 166 Life Insurance Agent How Much Money They ACTUALLY Make Per Month · 49 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MLoTTqEO2AY&lc=UgzvaarWYK3Ns1QxAWF4AaABAg>

"How to Start an Insurance Agency (IMO) Okay, basically I'm at an Insurance Agency called Roman Financial that is providing me no value, apart from constant jargon and motivation and looking at fast cars. I'm 19 and hit the ground running right away selling 5 figures in my first few weeks. I quickly realized that I'm way underpaid as far as "street level" for the final expense providers we go through. Good news is I didn't sign any NDA or a non-compete. As of right now, I am 10000% unnecessarily paying my upline hundreds of dollars that I'm breaking my back to get dialing 8 hours a day on measly 75-80% commission. With little research I've found that the exact same insurance providers give 120% first year to agents. Apart from the 45% of my check that I'm giving to my undeserving upline they are also making me pay for my CRM and the shiddy leads. I've figured that I'd go my own way and own my own lead source to grab leads rather than listen to their manipulation all day. In this way, I want my recruits to be taken care of instead of letting people fail out of the industry going into debt through leads and chargebacks. Long story short, they keep telling me to dial more and to drop the ego. I know I'm worth more than what I'm getting commission wise and nobody is going to have control over how much money I make anymore. That being said, I plan to create my own agency/IMO. Where my agents aren't paying most of their checks to me and don't have to fend for themselves in a constant uphill battle. I plan to have everybody pool for leads to fund ads for the lead source and direct mail etc. I plan to promote recruiting but have everybody come in at a fairly decent commission. No rah rah bullshi, just effective business owners who want to succeed and slam deals. I plan to pay appt setters to book quality leads so guys don't have to dial like their lives depend on it. I have a general outline of what I need to do: name, logo, llc/scorp, e&o, recruiting, marketing, but as far as contracting with providers, what's the best way to go about doing that? If anybody has experience building an agency lmk? ORRR if anybody is seemingly in the same boat and would like to build an empire with me... i'm taking partner applications lol. EDIT: My upline saw this and "released" me which is hilarious since I was getting them paid in everyway. Unfortunately for them I have everything laid out already and already talked to a business accountant and everything. Roman if you guys are reading this, You are 100% correct when you say that I'm gonna try to take my recruits with me. Actually you're 90% correct because you used the word "try". As I was recruiting them I already told them it wouldn't be long until we left Roman just get your licensing course. And hey, when my agencies up and running you can always come work for me at a higher contract than Norm and Carlo got you at. Remember you're never gonna be richer than your upline. :)"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 24 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15nmmk7/how_to_start_an_insurance_agency_imo/

"That's me too, but no lead purchases, no charge back, but extremely low sales!"

— YouTube · My First 90 Days As A Life Insurance Agent · 24 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9lF5hTEjK7U&lc=UgzUzfl62c3LV5cDsJt4AaABAg>

"Beware of MLM structured companies (warning) So this was originally a response to a comment on this sub, but I see a ton of new people coming into insurance, (speaking to independent guys here) and there are many many hungry wolves waiting to recruit these naïve noobs and make a profit. So, I figured I could make a post using some of the content from my previous response to explain the caveats and expose the reality of these places. I come from a MLM originally, it was unbenounced to me at the time, but I'm still grateful because it gave me a first hand glance at what goes on there. How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. They will push you to build a team, because hey, don't you wanna make 6 figures "bro"??? Well then you gotta build a huge team so you get all those overrides off the guys under you. Now, there's nothing wrong necessarily with building a team, but in a MLM context and the way they act in a deceptive manner it is extremely unethical. The guys you see writing 100k plus in premium a year??? A fraction of that fell off the books and was a chargeback, then that guy like all of us has to pay taxes at the end of the year. He also probably was buying \$500 worth of leads a week. Burned gas every day meeting clients. He *maybe* profited 40k that year, and that's being generous. But as long as they can show boat how much premium they're writing a week? A month? A year? Then shove the rhetoric down new guys throats, boasting about how they too can make 100k a year? Then they're all good. I found out through a credible source, as well as David Dufford (has a youtube channel, good tips and insight for insurance) that alot of these "top producers" buy the trips that you can win with insurance carriers for writing a lot of AP. They do all of this and sugar coat their actual earnings because you'll buy the dream, go sell sell sell, and the guys above you get all the overrides off of you without investing any of their money into you at all. It's a fucking amazing model for the guys at the top to make a killing. They create a strong sense of family at those places to keep you on board as well. They push shitty products like Americo a ton too, because they get higher commissions off of that. Americo is also pricey, and you can easily find a cheaper product for that senior to actually help them out, but more than likely they won't have many cheap options that actually are economical for the client, because then you, and them get a lower commission. So MLM's will typically encourage you to get a higher premium out of the client and force a pricey carrier on them. Hope this helps. Reputable, ethical IMO's that offer you high commission contracts and don't push you to build teams are harder to find, because they don't market and recruit. Join an insurance forum, those guys are veterans and a lot of the IMO/Brokerage owners are members there. I've been in Life Insurance for a while now, and am branching into Health/Medicare, so anyone can feel free to PM me with Life Insurance questions if you'd like. Also it would be cool to maybe post any experiences you've had with these types of organizations."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/n4hblb/beware_of_mlm_structured_companies_warning/

"Useful tip for new agents Stop paying for leads that's the wrong way to start off as a new agent you have to learn the business first so it's best to get with a agency that provides inbound leads and learning about handling chargebacks before you go independent it's a marathon not a sprint. If your with an agency that gives inbound leads and training your going to make money if your disciplined enough."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 16 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kxqsr/>

"AEP apps vs chargebacks Happy December, fellow medicare agents! We made it through AEP! Just here to get some perspectives and experiences of what to expect with AEP apps vs which ones actually follow through! For those of you who have been through multiple AEPs, how many apps do you usually write? This was my first year, and I wrote 172. The majority of them are renewals, but I did have a few initial enrollments. Do you think this is exceptional? Also, how many of your apps ended up being chargebacks/cancelled (due to enrolling with another agent)? I'm curious to know what to expect here for my book. Last question, I promise, what percentage of your book ends up sticking around the following year? I know everyone's market is different, but I'm trying to get a sense of what's "normal." Any insight from seasoned agents would help a ton. Thanks so much and happy holidays!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pgvbbq/aep_apps_vs_chargebacks/

"Is selling life insurance what everyone makes it out to be? All over my social media page I am seeing 20 years olds post that they are making 10k or more a month by selling life insurance. I know that there a chargebacks, buying leads, and its commission only, but is it actually worth getting into? I feel like all the companies are MLM's and that they are only posting this content to recruit people to join."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1t35kdo/>

"First off, get the MLM idea out of your head. The whole insurance industry is built upon uplines and downlines that is fully commission based. If you want a salary, you'll have to find an agency (whose commission based and has an upline) that'll pay you something fixed. Tough to find something like that for L&H compared to P&C. FE is great for upfront funds, but know that there can be quite a few chargebacks, so 30% of your commissions should go into a side-account to pay for these until you get your lead saturation up and your sales skill level established. Yes, Medicare is a grind unless you know how to cross-sell ancillary, then it's better than FE. In fact I recommend this track for newer FE agents: 1. Contract with someone that can train you and gives you fair contracts 100+% for FE and 20% for Medicare Supplements. 2. Get leads (facebook and direct mail) EVERY week in the same 50 sq mile area, and work them hard, spend 40 hours a week in the field, getting in front of as many people as possible. Build up a saturation level so that when you invariably door knock your leads and they say no or they're not home, you can just simply go two streets down and knock the guy you could never get ahold of a month or two ago. 3. Take some sample lead info and put it into a Medicare Quoting tool and find out whose competitive in your area for supplements, advantage plans etc. Start building your Medicare knowledge up. Of course, first past the AHIP so you have a base understanding for it. Just a few hours a week can help build up a wealth of knowledge. Once you understand how everything works, any changes to plans, companies or Medicare itself is easily assimilable - whereas there's no changes to FE usually. 4. Tell every lead you'll follow up with them in September to schedule a meeting in October to go over their Medicare options - because you do that too. If you don't sell anyone any FE, that's ok, offer to contact them in September for their Medicare, you "help seniors save money on their prescriptions and get extra benefits at no cost to them." If you paid for the lead, might as well get as much use out of them. 5. Selling FE sucks in November to December, the holidays. It's way easier to work with warm leads, sell them Medicare, and also increase your persistency lapse rate on your FE policies as well as bring in tons of referrals and get paid 2x as you would've just selling an FE policy. You could have enough leads to keep you busy all AEP, so that when that ends, you have a 2 week lull before New Years where you can start the whole cycle up again. THIS is the secret to making big bucks imo. Cody and Dave are good guys, Dave helped me out when I was where you were at, 12 years ago. He comes on here sometimes, haven't seen Cody on here yet."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/svjgsv/help_i_passed_accidenthealth_and_life_now_im/hxgcw8n/

"Am I doing this wrong? (Final Expense) So a brief run down, I started at an agency. Payout is 90% commission (75% upfront with 25% paid out over the rest of the year) I pay for mail-in leads at 35 bucks a pop. Obviously first couple months great but the last 4 weeks have been terrible. I haven't changed my approach or anything but I've only made two sales in these four weeks and they've really only covered my chargebacks lol with mail ins obviously I go to their homes and door knock. (spent \$742 on gas last month) I wouldn't feel bad if I was still making sales but it just seems to have dried up. Is it the time of year? Am I not being pushy enough? Thinking about running Facebook ad campaigns for some hotter leads to maybe help get out of this funk. anyone have experience with this or any tips?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p57gp5/>

Leads that never answer or are fake

"Sick of lead companies It's amazing.... agency owners buy "premium" leads and no matter where you go theres trash mixed in. The excuses are incredible like " you aren't dialing them enough" "the prospect keyed in that fake address and number" ect. ect. The agency I work for literally has people dialing alllllll day constantly (over 1000 dials). The sales agents are also calling, emailing, and texting. None of that matters when I get someone on the phone that's already been called 15 times. How the hell do these leads get sold to 20+ agents? I even had a lead in which the guy was DEAD for two years. Where are they even getting this crap from? Any industry insiders that want to give me the 411?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/

"BadA\$\$leads scam I purchased some leads from badassleads.. those leads are a penny worth. Wrong numbers, disconnected numbers, bad emails. Just dont waste your money and generate your own. Seriously lead generation companies are ripping off Agents"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/

"I need leads for contact rate. My sales skills are there I think because I have talked with people then sold policies but it seems like I am calling such bad leads that don't answer or hang up in my face in the first second of the call"

— YouTube · Insurance Agents: Should you buy leads or generate leads ? · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aGrUeGEYEpl&lc=UgxNQe5hKU22JZfoKKJ4AaABAa>

"This right here! So many unethical companies too that's exploit their agents and charge for bonk ass leads. My first experience was with HealthMarkets, horrible company, leads are \$36 each all of which are trash. I spent thousands of dollars on leads the first year. I also got taken by FFL, there I only burned \$3,000 in leads, I sold 5 policies, 4 charged back. I'm so happy now that I'm focused on the ACA market only. I don't care about selling life or any other supplemental. People are broke and they care barely afford health insurance as it is."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r86i3q/whats_the_hardest_part_of_being_an_insurance/o62tbgm/

"> What is your plan for when the incoming calls stop? As cynical as this sounds - there is no plan. If you have a phone, the calls will never stop coming. The numbers are spoofed, the names are fake, and there is nothing you can do. Even if you're on every blacklist alliance list, DNC, TCPA litigator scrub, etc etc - they all disconnect the calls AFTER the happen. Its annoying and won't end. I can get 100 illegal calls in a day and get zero justice or I can get 100 illegal calls a day, sue on 3-4 of them and get \$10-20 grand worth of justice. This is the world we're living in. The calls will never stop. If they did, I'd have a much higher serenity around here and I could enjoy some of the money I've made over the years. > Can you say with absolute sincerity that you're not taking any action to receive these illegal calls? 100%. I do not sign up for ANYTHING. I sit at home watching TV or scratching myself and the calls come in. I'm too young for medicare, but I get 20+ calls a day for medicare advantage. I'm too young for final expense insurance, I get 30+ a day for final expense. It's insanity. > You sure you're not intentionally putting yourself in a position for opportunities to sue these companies/agents? Am I intentionally putting myself in a position to sue these people, absolutely. The same way a cop running radar that has a really good spot that nobody can see / knows about..... I have a charged gopro handy and I record the incoming calls. Yes, I intentionally prepare myself to get the most leverage and the best evidence capture of illegal telemarketing practices. >I can't tell if you're posting this to be a genuine warning or maybe even bragging... but it actually reads like "Careful about your lead source, or else people without real jobs like me are going to sue you." I've done several settlements with small brokers that have said "we can't pay you what you're asking" and I said that's fine, I'll hold your upline joint and severally liable. Next thing I know, a decent settlement offer comes my way. OR I hire an attorney, they file a class action against the upline, the brokerage, the broker and the agent PERSONALLY and everyone goes to court, the upline spends \$150-200k in defense costs that they subrogate back to the downline via payment plan/docked commissions/what have you and my attorneys add another win to their CV. The message here is that YOU MAY THINK this new lead vendor of yours is all great but if you get burned, you can potentially be involved in bet the company litigation. And this is the WORST kind of litigation to be in because you don't realize you're in bet the company litigation until you've wound up betting the company. >Do what everyone else does and block the numbers that call Not that easy. All the numbers are spoofed. I get calls from the hospital, chevy dealership, etc etc - all displayed on the caller ID that are overseas call centers. Your outlook is 100% flawed. >No I have never been sued by a serial litigator because I only receive direct inbound calls, but I can still cringe at you for bottom feeding You know what's funny? Every single broker I've sued says "we only receive direct inbound calls" - you know why? THE LEAD GEN SPOOFS MY NUMBER, CALLS YOUR BROKERAGE SO YOU CAN CLAIM IT IS AN INBOUND CALL. The only counterbattery is my gopro video."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8y9glc/

"Some lead vendors are honest stating their leads are sold to multiple agents, others however claim their leads are exclusive while recycling and selling the same lead multiple times over. You can definitely still find prospects that have yet to purchase a policy or even some that you may be able to offer a better rate to, but for the most part this type of lead is garbage and a headache to deal with. My agency has been using Speakeasy Leads for almost a year now for final expense and general life insurance leads. Agent Advantage has also been great for IUL leads. Both seem to be the few that offer legitimately exclusive leads and I rarely get the "I've already spoken to 10 agents" bs lol. A few vendors I would avoid from previous personal experience: Integrity Lead Center - these leads are definitely resold to multiple agents Leadrilla - Garbage TTC Leads - They were great, but since their original owner past away the lead quality suffered Caboom Leads - Overpriced + prospects seem to be just shoppers MediaAlpha - I've received numerous leads in the past that had disconnected #'s paired with many prospects who have been deceased for years, overall just seems like fake data. Overall, the best method is to learn how to generate your own leads or hire an expert to setup your campaigns/lead capture funnels. This however is much easier said than done as it does take some time, effort and money to effectively learn paid ads, and if you do hire an individual or agency to manage this for you their fees are steep with no results guaranteed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/merel99/

"Normal for farmers? Hi all, I started at farmers a month ago. Was working in a Medicare agency before this. The issue I'm having is I'm my managers only employee and she is an agency owner and I'm basically completely on my own. I don't fully know what's expected of me and I've been struggling to get sales. Has anyone else dealt with this? I wanted to go to State Farm but I don't have my life license yet. I still feel like I don't know what I'm talking about and she gives me 5 leads a day, I'm calling out to current clients and old leads but like 90% of the old leads are disconnected or don't qualify for Farmers. I kinda hate it and idk if this is normal"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wocjrp/normal_for_farmers/

"Im licensed, now what? Part time life ins sales ideas Im new to posting but I will try to keep it short but a little background for context is necessary. I have been in P&C insurance sales for 4 years for a small but successful independent agency. I got my License to sell Life to round out my P&C accounts and got my health&accident license with it. With no real future career opportunity at our 3 man agency and the principal agent screwing my commission and treating me like trash, I took a job selling medicare health insurance for a major provider in my area for open enrollment. This new healthcare job is WFH and so much slower paced than what i am used to, until things get busier in Sept i have nothing but spare time and a life insurance license that i dont know how to use to sell independently part time. Does anyone have any ideas on companies or carriers or aggregators that would help me sell some life insurance in my spare time? I have the ins sales experience so the real challenge is leads i suppose. I know there are plenty of carriers that will appoint me to sell their products. But how does one drum up business/contacts/leads that arent the total junk recycled crap, because I have been down that road. I have an LLC and insurance company already registered and ready to go from back when i almost went out on my own in P&C. The best idea i can think of is to use some of my marketing from that and invest some \$\$ into google ads and FB marketing and go the digital advertising route. Try to funnel in some leads from there? Short of that im not really sure. I am open to any and all ideas. Thanks all."

— r/LifeInsurance · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/LifeInsurance/comments/1eepurt/im_licensed_now_what_part_time_life_ins_sales/

"Medicare I am a P&C guy who owns an agency. I have two people working personal lines and I was doing commercial, which is slow at times. I wanted to get into Medicare Insurance so I went with the FMO Ritter and they have been great but...outside of my own prospect in house I am unsure how to jumpstart my book. My goal is 4 a month to start out since I do already have an income and have other daily responsibilities as an agency owner. I feel like everyone is buying leads and no one is happy with those leads so its hard to trust any lead source. Then the cost seems crazy to me for those leads. I would do live transfers but at \$45-\$60...I am not even sure I could afford enough to even try. I do have a sign coming for outside my office that basically says "We Offer Medicare Supplements!". I am hoping passing traffic will bring in some organic business. I guess what I am asking is how did some of you guys really start from scratch? Are leads pointless? For every "I like so and so leads" there's a "Really they sent me trash!". Do you really need to expand into other states? Do you need to forego the data leads and do transfers? Do your FMOs help you with leads (Ritter doesn't offer leads)?"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 4 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/15ksxo7/medicare/>

"Lead Stuffing" so that's the term..... i noticed like a certain percent of leads are fake addresses and they come in batches"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mercnjo/

"Figured I would post my thought to save everyone reading some money... CABOOM leads provides below average leads with a 20% answer rate when called 10-15 times in the first 3 days. Most of the IUL leads who answered were dead broke and unqualified. They were VERY FAR from high intent leads that were ready to buy. I should have known based on their advertising that it was sketchy, but I thought spending more would lead to higher quality leads. I was wrong. I started to focus more on buying annuity leads since this is my primary niche after a few weeks of failed IUL leads (that I thought were a fluke at the time - 60 leads total). I made the mistake of signing up for an annuity lead subscription after seeing high praise from an annuity producer I respect. I was even more disappointed with these leads. I ordered 20 leads per month for \$5000 and was told by my representative that I could cancel if I was very disappointed, but he assured me that I would have at least a 3x return on investment... Keep in mind that I actually have wealth management experience selling \$4M of annuities and mutual funds last year.... I ordered in mid-February and it's now early April and I STILL haven't received my first 20 leads. In late February, I ordered another 10 leads hoping that my lead flow would come in faster, and none have been delivered from this order. Most leads were not serious anyway and had no clue that the ad was talking about annuities... I had a similar experience on the IUL leads. I believe their ads are misleading and trick people into thinking they are getting some kind of free benefit that does not exist... I thought Cody was one of the good guys in the industry, but I'm not sure I trust him or his team. Quite frankly, their advertising is extremely misleading - "ready to buy" is garbage.m, but I blame this on myself for falling for the trap... Also, lots of other shady practices like offering discounts for POSITIVE reviews only, sending out a FAKE April fools message that they are no longer accepting new clients to trick people into buying with urgency, advertising that leads are vetted and ready to buy (all they do is respond to a text code - I'm not sure if I even believe this), and worst of all, not following through on promises. I have been unable to cancel my subscription order even though I am highly displeased and I have not even received 20 leads although I've ordered 30+ more than a month ago"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/mkvaioj/

"The problem is not putting hard work, if you went through the process you know that if you don't work hard you won't get any leads in r call people... The problems is that in the beginning they don't tell you but you will be getting old ass leads... and that's is frustrating... still not a cold call but some people don't even remember they signed up for... not to mention other agents that don't resolve their bad leads so it goes back to the pile as a no answer... and guess what? You will eventually call a bunch of people who already said are not interested many times... so I've seen some new agents taking many weeks just to book something remotely good... People who jump into this desperate for money and with no much time to climb up until get fresh leads will not last long, it's a fact, and they should be open about that from the get go... instead they hype you up, push you to learn all scripts and so on, and when you are finally ready you will spend 80 of you time going through a list of leads and calling people that never pickup the phone."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cy9b7k/im_stuck_at_globe_life_american_income_life_and_i/ms4ol22/

"NextGenLeads is a SCAM. NextGenLeads is a SCAM. They sell fraudulent data leads of Medicare which doesn't exist. Every lead I received was fake, disconnected, or for a person who never existed. Their refund algorithm claims are lies and support refuses to take responsibility. This is stolen money — don't sign up. Stay far away. They are a complete fraud"

— TrustPilot · NextGen Leads · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6914a10a157e1b9986febe4b>

"Find another Leads provider!. I worked with Nick E. He was very helpful in setting up my campaign for their discounted weekend leads. I ended up spending Three hundred dollars on about 60 health leads. About 20% of the leads had disconnected or bad numbers. All of these Nick told me I would get reimbursed - but that did not happen. The other 80% of these leads, 90% did not answer the phone with about 1/2 going to voice mail, and the other half having no voice mail set up. The final 10% that I did speak to (briefly) either hung up immediately or claimed that they never requested information. This appears to be a scam - \$300 for no real leads. Giving Money to Nextgen Leads is unprofitable and a waste of your time!"

— TrustPilot · NextGen Leads · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6046708ff85d75064c3b712f>

"majority of leads are disconnected.... majority of leads are disconnected numbers, wrong numbers, or don't fall within the filters that are set - very frustrating!!!"

— TrustPilot · NextGen Leads · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5d66efbaf0186907ac964388>

"I have the leads to be over sold and.... I have the leads to be over sold and not qualified. They also have a very strict returns program so you can return leads that are garbage. Your better off taking your money to Las Vegas!"

— TrustPilot · NextGen Leads · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5d66e6b1f0186907ac963f50>

"The leads are rarely qualified, or in service.. The leads are only qualified and in service 15-20% of the time. There are numbers that are completely out of service but the returns get rejected. The only people that seem to answer (MAYBE 1 out of 10 leads that I get) don't qualify and don't match the health filters. I don't even see how it's legal to only return 10-15% of leads that are blatantly bad or not in service. Also, I'd say half the individuals I speak to are getting blown up with calls... making those leads, in fact, NOT exclusive. For \$30/lead on tier 1, I can go to another lead system and pay literally half for the exact same lead. I figured only bidding on tier 1 would give a better contact, but the leads are just as garbage at the tier 3. I've taken 2 separate webinars with nextgen hoping to learn how to better setup my campaigns and even after doing it exactly as you suggest, I still get contact on maybe 1 out of 10 leads that I get... that's 1/10 I even get to say hey to. So far, definitely hasn't been work the investments."

— TrustPilot · NextGen Leads · 2 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5d683ffef0186907108933e4>

"RUN FROM THIS COMPANY. Absolutely furious and beyond disappointed with Smart Financial. If I could give them -20 stars, I would!! Their service is an absolute nightmare, and as others have mentioned, dealing with Jairus Garcia is a disaster. They refuse to address your concerns properly and go as far as blame you for their garbage leads. My husband and I purchased some leads, and every single one was trash. Most were disconnected numbers or had numbers that were restricted- yet they claim these are "hot leads." When we confronted Jairus about this, he has the audacity to say it was our fault for not working the leads correctly. To make matters worse, we asked 3 separate times to have our account closed and when that didn't work, I had to call them. Even calling them didn't help. Jairus would dodge my calls and call me days later telling my coworkers that I kept giving him the run around. As you can tell by reading this far, it was always my fault for everything. No accountability on their behalf. Anyway I ended up disputing charges and they went back around and disputed my claim and I ended up having to pay for their crappy leads anyway. It doesn't end there. They have different agents calling us from different numbers trying to rope us back in, even though I have insistently told them we are not interested in their services. It's beyond ridiculous. Save yourself the headache and run from this company. They don't care about you or your business, they just want the money and will stoop to any level to make sure they get it. This is by far the worst experience I've ever had!"

— TrustPilot · SmartFinancial · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/678581ea14d36aed0c9a3a43>

"Waste of money. The sales people don't do anything to help or respond to emails unless its in regards to an agent wanting to put more money in. Trying to communicate with the company is impossible. Most leads were either at a disconnected number or they had already gotten a quote and a policy from somewhere else."

— TrustPilot · QuoteWizard · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a29772b56d8c4ad541b990a>

"Terrible leads. Terrible leads. Half the numbers are disconnected. The ones that do answer already have insurance. Save your \$\$\$. And they only give you credit a quarter of the disc. numbers and that's not enough."

— TrustPilot · QuoteWizard · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/690bdabc9fe15b15007b8b03>

Commission cuts and carriers pulling commissions

"Why aren't we talking about commission cuts? I've been lurking here for a while, and like many others, I've been considering getting licensed to sell health insurance. I've noticed there are a ton of weekly posts asking "Should I get into insurance?" and most of the responses are really positive and encouraging. But what surprises me is what's **NOT** being discussed much: **#1 Major carriers are cutting commissions or removing them entirely.** Here are some examples: * **United Health Care** will stop paying commissions on 100+ Medicare Advantage plans and all PDPs in over 20 states starting July 1, 2025. The NAIFA denounced UHC's decision to cut agent commissions. * **Aetna** is withdrawing from the ACA marketplace and slashing commissions after 2025. * **Cigna, Centene, Elevance (Anthem)** are all making similar moves. **#2 The recent passing of the new "Big Beautiful Bill".** From what I can tell, these are pretty major shifts and could seriously impact how agents make a living going forward. Yet almost none of this shows up in the "how do I start" threads. Why? So, I wanted to ask more directly: * Why isn't there more discussion about these changes here? Is the impact overstated, or are we just not seeing the effects "yet"? * Do veteran agents think ACA/Medicare will still be viable long-term? * Should newcomers treat this as a full-time career or more of a side hustle moving forward? * How are current agents planning to adapt in the next 5-10 years? Genuinely curious. I'm not trying to be negative. I'm just surprised there isn't more open talk about what seems like some pretty big red flags for the industry. Would love to hear what those of you already in the trenches think. Thanks!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/

"United is simply restructuring and will release new plans for AEP. Obviously they were hit hard, notice they only decommissioned the extremely affordable PPOs going forward... that's because they don't want you to sell any more of them and they can't just release plan changes mid year. And you are talking about commission cuts when we were just announced a 10% increase in MAPD renewals and Initials for 2026. There are lots of carriers dying to throw agents money.... And new carriers are still getting in the game and expanding every year, which is a good sign. I agree it is a little unstable right now, but for agents that is a good thing. Medicare and ACA aren't going anywhere. And if they do, you have an entire book to convert to the new thing."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/n56ide4/

"For MAPD brokers, who is still writing UHC and Humana non-commissionable plans? Across most of the country over the past few years, UnitedHealthcare and Humana have made many of their MAPD plans non-commissionable. I refuse to work for free and represent these plans going forward. Are there any MAPD-certified brokers who are still willingly selling these plans? Just curious as to why you would put a client on a plan you receive no commissions on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1woc7yr/for_mapd_brokers_who_is_still_writing_uhc_and/

"Medicare Agent Commissions I have a question for fellow Medicare agents. With carriers pulling commissions what are your plans to pivot to keep business alive? My clients and new individuals turning 65 still are in such need for help navigating through the weeds of the whole system along with their plan choices but working for free just can't go on. We have a higher MS clientele rate but now with those rates skyrocketing I'm concerned there will be a shift towards MAPD which a lot are going non-commissionable. Also in our small area we don't have a thriving market for DVH so that's out. What are you all doing to stay alive?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kotgtz/medicare_agent_commissions/

"In the original deal they also made ALL PLANS commissionable. The hold on the final rule burnt agents drastically as some carriers cut commissions mid AEP. Right in the middle of AEP, the carrier sent out an email less than 24hrs on Oct 31 and told us the plans would be non-commissionable as of Nov 1st. Not only can these companies make plans non-commissionable all year they can cut commissions on a plan whenever they want."

— YouTube · The Reality of A Career in Medicare Insurance Sales in 2025 · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Nwa60sSWldo&lc=UgxdalukEsc_mbiYbGR4AaABAg

"I'm an ACA broker in about 15 states and the commissions are always \$15-\$30 per month per member, depending on the carrier. It's never a % of the monthly premium in my experience. There's no commission if you canceled before it started. That guy deffo gave you bad info on filing status. Glad you got the right info here!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1woe9l3/is_my_insurance_broker_correct_that_filing_taxes/pbq7yor/

"I've been predicting that (the 2nd wave of commission cuts) for several years. Fortunately I've been wrong so far. I think it will come but no reason agents shouldn't sell all of them they can sell currently. Just don't put ALL your eggs in that basket."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Senior Insurance Forum · 4 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/mapd-commissions-first-to-get-the-axe.110822/#post-1457732>

"I am a Medicare Insurance Broker in California with over 20 years experience. We were just notified yesterday of commission cuts with 68 pages of information. For new plans starting January 2026 we have received the usual commission increase, however, for renewals it appears that we will only receive renewal commissions based on 2025 residuals instead of 2026 rates. It's disappointing, but it won't kill us. In my area, the only plans that are being discontinued are the unpopular plans. Would I say, go ahead and get licensed and certified to sell Medicare? I would not, knowing what I know now. It's a lot of work annually getting certified to sell Medicare with hundreds, if not thousands of regulations. Not to mention all the competition from other agents. I can tell anyone who wants to know, I'm looking for another way to supplement my income in the future because I think what will happen to non-Medicare plans will eventually happen to us, that being up to 4% commission instead of 20% like it used to be."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/ndjpk27/

"New Agent Advice I got my life insurance license back in February (at the same time I was let go from my previous W2 position). I have really struggled to find my footing with IMOs and FMOs. A lot of these companies just throw trash leads at new agents and expect you to find gold. To make matters worse, my current company's inbound transfer leads completely dried up because another agent didn't pay their invoice. The system was supposed to be you receive inbound transfers, get paid from your commission Thursday and pay the invoice Friday. Since I'm currently unemployed and don't have any savings, I can't afford to buy expensive leads or wait out cash-flow gaps. I recently interviewed with State Farm but didn't hear back. At this point, I really need a W2 captive agent role or an independent position that offers exclusive, provided leads for a lower commission cut so I can build a stable bankroll are my thoughts. Does anyone have any help or suggestions?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wgdgt5/new_agent_advice/

"Like commission rates? Luckily they're all pretty close carrier to carrier so sell the best plan for the client every-time, and every client is different so different plans and carriers work better for different people. Pretty sure MAPD is the same rate for every carrier (315 renewal 650 IEP) however over-rides may be different and some offer HRA bonus. Most supplements are 20-23% annual (first year advance), and dental/HI is like 45-50% annual (first year advance). Be careful some MAPD plans are non-commissionable i do avoid those, but there really aren't many. I have however done no commission part Ds, you gotta do what you gotta do. Life commissions should be between 80%-115% (9 month- 12 month advance) starting out, if you're taking a lower comp from the FMO make sure you are getting lots of support."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ijykig/new_agent_choosing_an_fmo_vs_going_direct_advice/mjrwf7/

"Appreciate the context! That helps me understand it better. Sounds like you're saying this is might be more of a market correction or rough patch than a permanent decline for agents. I've heard some of the chatter around UHC's situation but didn't realize it was that bad. Curious, do you think the carriers pulling commissions now might bring them back "if" the plans become profitable again? Or is that just wishful thinking and the trend toward no commissions is here to stay? And yeah, I agree...it feels like ACA/Medicaid are way more vulnerable, but hard to predict where this all ends up."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/n563vtn/

"W2 jobs I have found out there now are low commission to no commission meaning they don't really pay you what your time and effort are worth. However, there are some places that do 1099 and high commission AND they provide leads. That's where I am now and it's been working for all the agents. One of the issues I always had with people on W2 is that they just come for the paycheck and never seemed to be working to get sales. I hated that. I always felt like they were wasting good leads that I could have worked. 1099, no one does that as much lol. Because they know they get paid if they make sales."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1su3zm9/i_am_stuck_frustrated_and_ready_to_give_up_on_my/ois2vrz/

Shared leads sold to many agents

"Hahaha. Looks like a lead that has been tormented by countless calls from agents. I blame the lead vendors that resell the same leads to 5 different offices"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rsznnr/text_exchange_from_a_prospect_who_reached_out_to/oaag95t/

"Former MGA here. I worked the TMK system (AIL Globe NILICO) for about 5 years and was VERY successful. So it is possible however I left and went independent for several reasons. 1. Everyone and anyone at AIL that talks about free leads vs paying for leads doesn't quite understand that they aren't comparing apples to apples here. Most leads at AIL aren't people who are looking FOR or interested in life insurance, the union leads are sort of close but they all think you're just coming to endorse the free AD&D. Most agencies these days aren't even running union leads anymore but running Will Kits Child Safe/mcgruff veterans etc. (my agency tested several other "kits" too like Cancer kits) Another thing is they recycle leads just as much as everyone else but they limit the amount you get and control when you get them. So yes they are free but imagine getting 60-100 leads and being told that's all you get for 60-90 days so you better collect referrals. (Heck you're trained NOT to say "insurance" on the phones 😂) 2. Starting at 50% comp these days is just silly when everyone else except WFG Primerica and PHP are starting new agents between 75-110% 3. The leaderboard is a liar, most (not all) of the people in the spotlight or whatever that magazine was called are not running the same leads that regular new agents are, they're running POS aka calling clients that purchased policies from different agents and then upselling them. Those that aren't are sometimes just chasing advance and doing shady things. 4. The rates for policies ESPECIALLY for people over 60 are laughable... example: I can get a 60 year old Male non tobacco user can get straight whole life NONE GRADED day 1 coverage (meaning the policy is issued and in force when you write it bc it's UW is electronic... no extra phone calls) 20,000 for 68.50 but since I don't like that specific carrier I'd get them a better policy or carrier with Mutual of Omaha for 84.32. Check the price on eapp for the difference and keep in mind... those prices aren't graded. Which brings me to number 5. It's hard to have residuals and renewals when your policies are being replaced. TLDR: It's a decent starter company and yes you CAN make good money but to all of us outside of it we look at AIL Prime WFG and PHP like middle schoolers trying to look cool wearing mom and dad's clothes."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15wc7r0/recently_accepted_a_job_with_globe_life/jx47s9/

"Some lead vendors are honest stating their leads are sold to multiple agents, others however claim their leads are exclusive while recycling and selling the same lead multiple times over. You can definitely still find prospects that have yet to purchase a policy or even some that you may be able to offer a better rate to, but for the most part this type of lead is garbage and a headache to deal with. My agency has been using Speakeasy Leads for almost a year now for final expense and general life insurance leads. Agent Advantage has also been great for IUL leads. Both seem to be the few that offer legitimately exclusive leads and I rarely get the "I've already spoken to 10 agents" bs lol. A few vendors I would avoid from previous personal experience: Integrity Lead Center - these leads are definitely resold to multiple agents Leadrilla - Garbage TTC Leads - They were great, but since their original owner past away the lead quality suffered Caboom Leads - Overpriced + prospects seem to be just shoppers MediaAlpha - I've received numerous leads in the past that had disconnected #'s paired with many prospects who have been deceased for years, overall just seems like fake data. Overall, the best method is to learn how to generate your own leads or hire an expert to setup your campaigns/lead capture funnels. This however is much easier said than done as it does take some time, effort and money to effectively learn paid ads, and if you do hire an individual or agency to manage this for you their fees are steep with no results guaranteed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/merel99/

"Back to school? I'm a Medicare Telesales (captive) agent for a large health insurance company. I'm doing fairly well, not the best on my team but not the worst, but I DO know that I hold leadership qualities that some do, and some do not possess. I really love my job, I love the my colleagues, and I really want to move up in my career. I have not been in school for 10+ years... I am honestly not even sure how going back to college would even work, entirely. I am a single mom of a four year old boy who's in preschool full time. (just to give a little background and knowledge of my very limited schedule) What classes should I take in order to make myself stand out ahead of anyone else who may be aiming for the same leadership roles, such as supervisor or lead? Bachelors in Heth Sciences? Any helpful advice/insight would be IMMENSELY appreciated. Thank you!"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1cqssyh/back_to_school/

"I would strongly recommend automating reminders. Use every channel available. Email. SMS. Phone calls. Voicemails. Every missed follow up is a leak in your funnel. Plug those leaks and the same leads you already have will start producing far more revenue over time. If you are serious about growth, this massive fix you can make."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qrb80b/none_of_my_prospects_are_answering_my_calls_after/o2mxlxs/

"Pretty typical of any vendor, can run hot and cold. I'm not sure if you see the same leads that I do, but if there is a "questionnaire" lead, stay away from that one. It is full of people who are just filling out surveys. To be honest, I buy a mix of leads from them. That being said, every internet lead has to be worked. You are going to get plenty who say "wasn't me", or some other lame excuse or they just hang up on you. I'll simply put those leads to the side for a couple days, even a week and then call them again as if we've never spoken. It doesn't always work out, but the number of people who all but cussed me out a few days ago, now act like they've been waiting on my call is just weird. I like that Integrity doesn't force a specific number for a purchase. I work this business part time so it's nice to be able to control how many I get. I work with a team, and we have plenty of new agents come and go. I'll see them buy 5,10,20 leads, dial them a few times, not make a sale, then blame wherever the lead came from, say the whole thing is a scam and bounce. Working internet leads is not always an easy task."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/mnsacz5/

"Thank you for taking the time to explain that. The tiered system is absolutely an issue. Those "premium" leads will be absolutely re sold to other agents (most of the time sooner than the purchasing agent is aware) and them resold again over and over. Hence the actual title of they system. If you are happy with the system and do not mind other agents (possibly very competent ones) following up with your clients later than by all means keep with this style of system. We all need to work within the system we create. I create (as do all in my group) our own leads via self built lead generators as individuals...or purchase from trusted vendors exclusive leads...or live transfers that we qualify ourselves. Just some food for thought. To each their own....good luck on the stair steps ...be careful."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mfu7pr/considering_trying_a_facebook_lead_campaign/n6lrhq2/

"Cold call lists and Leads P&C Where do yall get your leads? We pay 1\$ a lead right now, and have about the same close rates as we experienced paying 15\$ for leads. We've been using the same lead source for 9 months now. Problem is - these leads are always charging back, wasting our time, etc. How do you generate decent leads? We're trying to connect with realtors and such, but can't seem to generate the inbound calls. Google does okay, but now we're fighting to keep our business ad up since they said we violated policies(major captive company, we literally did nothing but advertise our location 😊). Where do you buy decent leads or cold call lists? What's your strategy? Anyone wanna help out a young agency?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p6wc9w/cold_call_lists_and_leads_pc/

"I am not sure your industry, but our agency has crossed a little over 6,000 members on our book for ACA. What has helped us a lot is texting first to setup a call not just calling out of the blue. There are many other things that can help but this is a big thing we have found. We have been using the same lead source for a while so my perception may be a bit skewed from how it really is out there."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rkajao/aged_leads/o8jtuci/

"@michellejones9265 Wrong! They respond to one ad, and the lead is sold to 100 agents who then blow their phone up non-stop. Then their information is loaded into databases and put of call rotations and this data is out there for anyone to purchase. I am an insurance telesales agent, and I pay for EXCLUSIVE INBOUND RAW LEADS so that the person responding to the ad gets only me. And I convert 73% of the time because I am not selling them, I am helping them."

— YouTube · Insurance Agent Calls An Angry Lead - Rate This Call! #insurance #insuranceagent #lifeinsu · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yc0XJA-IF5I&lc=Ugw49oUdeZR-fn3Bn0R4AaABAg_Alg9l0V7W9YAUH4bNyS2V1

"My question is do they sell the same leads to more then one agent. A lot of the lead companies out there are selling the same lead to up to 8 agents. I hate to be the client that responded to a card in the mail, or ask for an agent to call them and then have 8 agents calling me, and each one would tell me the other 7 agents are out to screw me."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Health Insurance and Ancillary Benefits · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/asap-quotes.1599/#post-108183>

"Horrible company with bad cutomer.... Horrible company with bad cutomer service. You have to constantly contact them to ask questions and no one ever gives you the same answer. They also resell leads. My colleague and I would get the same leads and found out we were quoting the same people and competing with each other using the same service."

— TrustPilot · NextGen Leads · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/68fa6ecffc19918761585390>

"The leads are rarely qualified, or in service.. The leads are only qualified and in service 15-20% of the time. There are numbers that are completely out of service but the returns get rejected. The only people that seem to answer (MAYBE 1 out of 10 leads that I get) don't qualify and don't match the health filters. I don't even see how it's legal to only return 10-15% of leads that are blatantly bad or not in service. Also, I'd say half the individuals I speak to are getting blown up with calls... making those leads, in fact, NOT exclusive. For \$30/lead on tier 1, I can go to another lead system and pay literally half for the exact same lead. I figured only bidding on tier 1 would give a better contact, but the leads are just as garbage at the tier 3. I've taken 2 separate webinars with nextgen hoping to learn how to better setup my campaigns and even after doing it exactly as you suggest, I still get contact on maybe 1 out of 10 leads that I get... that's 1/10 I even get to say hey to. So far, definitely hasn't been work the investments."

— TrustPilot · NextGen Leads · 2 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5d683ffe0186907108933e4>

"Their leads are aged. Their leads are aged, not valid phone # and shared with multiple agents within the same company. Never waste your time with a phony lead company!"

— TrustPilot · QuoteWizard · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6862dd5f5e2b91e0fa8ea1f8>

"Because GoHealth flagged this. Because GoHealth flagged this, I am posting it again. If you don't like it, gohealth, then it's time to make changes within the company instead of suppressing voices. This company engages in shady practices to inflate their numbers. I am a current top performing employee and can assure you that we are pressured to sell anything to anyone as long as we can get it to pass with Medicare and as long as we can get you to say yes on a recording. We are incentivized with large amounts of cash to worry about sales per day and not how many people actually stayed enrolled for longer than 3 months. We are reprimanded if we are not converting our leads, that means I lose my job and can't feed my family if I don't do everything in my power to enroll you, whether or not it's of any benefit to you or even if you're the client of another agent, I'm required to attempt to enroll you and take credit for that. I can assure you that we will call you several times a day with 5+ agents working the same lead, calling up to three times a day and no, the company does not acknowledge your Do Not Call request even if we say we do, someone else will call you within the day I promise. I can assure you that the company will do whatever it takes to make that bottom line and show growth in each department, in each quarter, no matter what we have to do or who we have to do it to, agent or client. Business is business. I can't share every detail in one go but I post this because I'm deeply concerned with the things we as a society accept as a normality, and I wonder how much corporate abuse will we normalize before we give up our rights entirely."

— TrustPilot · GoHealth · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/672c105acdb77a125b4bfed>

"This company engages in shady practices.... This company engages in shady practices to inflate their numbers. I am a current top performing employee and can assure you that we are pressured to sell anything to anyone as long as we can get it to pass with Medicare and as long as we can get you to say yes on a recording. We are incentivized with large amounts of cash to worry about sales per day and not how many people actually stayed enrolled for longer than 3 months. We are reprimanded if we are not converting our leads, that means I lose my job and can't feed my family if I don't do everything in my power to enroll you, whether or not it's of any benefit to you or even if you're the client of another agent, I'm required to attempt to enroll you and take credit for that. I can assure you that we will call you several times a day with 5+ agents working the same lead, calling up to three times a day and no, the company does not acknowledge your Do Not Call request even if we say we do, someone else will call you within the day I promise. I can assure you that the company will do whatever it takes to make that bottom line and show growth in each department, in each quarter, no matter what we have to do or who we have to do it to, agent or client. Business is business. I can't share every detail in one go but I post this because I'm deeply concerned with the things we as a society accept as a normality, and I wonder how much corporate abuse will we normalize before we give up our rights entirely."

— TrustPilot · GoHealth · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/67296e0cbbcd446c179ddeb1>

FMOs and uplines that don't deliver or won't release

"Well... fuck it. Put the IMO on blast so we know who are scammers are who aren't. Ah just kidding I would never want to "break the rules of a subreddit!" Some things rhyme though and many things share the same acronym entirely unrelated!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1t9nf3b/seeking_advice_as_a_new_agent_struggling/ol4hk95/

"I didn't even make it to my first training with them. They had me sit in on a "mandatory" Zoom meeting (seriously? For 1099's?), which was an absolute shit-show of some agents making calls, others talking to one-another, and still others dicking around on video games--all at the same time, and with nothing muted. I couldn't take it. It also told me that nearly everything the recruiter had told me had been lies (a 30-hour week? Only 30 leads to call each week, and all of them union members who are sitting around twiddling their thumbs waiting for your call to complete their enrollment in benefits they're already signed up for? Cool! Easy money), which is why I opted out right then-and-there. Another thing about AIL I found to be VERY fishy was their requiring me to find a friend or associate to fill out an application and include all their personal information so that I could be appointed. When I asked what would then happen with the information, I was told not to worry, that it was just something necessary to be appointed and my friend, etc. wouldn't be liable for anything or be purchasing a policy. To this I asked why we can't just fudge things with made up info, but was told that "the system" wouldn't recognize it as a real person if we did. I also asked what happened to the information, and was told that it "...just goes to the company!" "And then what?" "Oh, I don't know, don't worry though!" Uh, when it comes to either mine or other people's personal information, yes, I worry. You may also want to take a look at all the BBB complaints against the company, of which there are shitloads. Though I realize that yes, AIL may be as legit as they come, I still don't like that they continuously speak of "uplines and downlines" since I'm leery of MLMs, and I sure as HELL ain't interested in having to lie to others to recruit them!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/164ik21/are_there_any_truly_good_life_insurance_companies/koigwvj/

"So here's a funny twist in my insurance journey. I've been grinding, trying to build my agency, and for months I've been researching CRMs and dialers. I finally pulled the trigger and bought Ringy because everyone kept recommending it. Fast forward to this week... and I randomly discover I actually had access to Integrity's CRM, dialer, and lead marketplace the whole time for free through one of the agencies I'm contracted with. No one ever mentioned it. I literally stumbled into the dashboard by accident while looking for something else. Wild. I paid for a CRM meanwhile I already had access to one but my upline never brought it up. Smh Not mad about it though, just sharing in case any newer agents don't realize some FMOs/IMOs automatically give you tools like CRMs, dialers, quoting platforms, or lead systems that they never bother to highlight. Definitely worth double-checking what's included with your contracts before you go spending on extra software. If anyone else has had this happen or knows hidden features inside Integrity's system, drop some tips. I'm already finding stuff I didn't even know existed. However, I am going to keep the ringy platform. I really like the drip system they have for text and email and other features"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1odlyvq/solo_insurance_agent_looking_for_a_crm_dialer/no7l9a4/

"I would need to know what line of insurance you are talking about to get more specific. But basically its a standard wait of 6 months after a documented request of release from the contract for most carriers. Mutual of Omaha is pretty strict on that stuff. As far as what you do going forward is find an IMO that can fill the gaps with something competitive in the meantime while you process the releases and wait it out."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gy923a/what_uplines_dont_want_you_to_know_carrier/nktnyr6/

"I read all of your comments. I do Medicare, as well. Just curious if you have anything in your former contract preventing you from just quickly moving under another FMO. As in, do you need a release from your former upline in order to get under anyone else?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ofi9mo/i_was_a_1099_agent_and_got_terminated_today/nld6ghk/

"ya, I worked for them for a short stint. wasn't a fan of the structure and now ik with an IMO that is the opposite of an MLM, they help me as much as I need it and tell me where to privately purchase leads as opposed to purchasing it through them."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f816tw/legit_life_insurance_wfh_job/lcsa40/

"I decided to get into this business after a friend of mine died with no life insurance, leaving his wife and two daughters destitute. My main focus, eventually, will be selling term insurance to families to protect them from a similar fate. I do write term cases now, but it is not my primary focus just yet. I decided to focus on final expense life insurance because it pays well and quickly and I am changing careers, so I do need to replace my income. Also, insurance is a complicated product, at least it is to me. Final expense gives me a nice, simple, narrow focus by which to build my foundation of knowledge of and experience in the insurance industry. In either case, I believe folks need life insurance. I have a wife and three kids. Every time my wife and I had a new child, I increased my life insurance. I'm a believer in the real risk of death and dying without leaving financial protection in place for those I love, and I believe each of us has a moral obligation to protect those who depend upon us from the potential loss of our income through death, and likewise to make sure we do not leave behind a financial burden for our children in the event we die without sufficient savings to pay our final expenses. When I talk to a prospect about life insurance, whether it is a family with children who need a large term policy or a senior who needs a small whole life policy, they know without a doubt how important I feel it is that they do something to protect themselves and their family. I always say to them at some point during the presentation, "This isn't about me or the insurance company or whatever commission I may hope to be paid for selling you this policy. This is about the obligation you and I have to our families. I believe having life insurance, and just having it, but having enough of it, and the right kind of it, is simply the right thing to do." And they always nod their heads in agreement, and say "I know you do. I can tell you really believe in what you're doing." If you believe as I do, then you should have no qualms about the moral basis of this business you are contemplating entering. Protect yourself from the IMO's who are focused on recruiting and the MLM aspect of this business, and find an IMO that is focused on service to the agent. As far as the product goes, as long as you are helping folks get policies with highly rated carriers that they can comfortably afford so that they are not wasting money on a policy that they will have to let lapse, a policy that will provide them with a real benefit that they themselves, through your efforts, recognize as solving a problem that they have, then you are on the firmest of moral footings."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Forum · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/fe-shady-niche-advice.86106/#post-1152180>

"crabtrap said: Is it advisable to sell for more than one IMO/FMO? There are a few products not offered by my IMO and I would like to have them as an option to better serve the customer. Personal preference. Some say to not have all your contracts with one IMO but I prefer to have all of mine with one. But if they didn't carry a company I wanted I would pick it up elsewhere. I happen to be with an IMO, {FEX}, that will grant releases if I wanted to leave. If you are not with one that will release then it's a whole different ballgame. I certainly would not put all my contracts with an IMO that won't release. ----- crabtrap said: Is it advisable to sell for more than one IMO/FMO? There are a few products not offered by my IMO and I would like to have them as an option to better serve the customer. Personal preference. Some say to not have all your contracts with one IMO but I prefer to have all of mine with one. But if they didn't carry a company I wanted I would pick it up elsewhere. I happen to be with an IMO, {FEX}, that will grant releases if I wanted to leave. If you are not with one that will release then it's a whole different ballgame. I certainly would not put all my contracts with an IMO that won't release."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Forum · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/selling-for-multiple-imo-fmos.70645/#post-929096>

"jdeasy said: Personal preference. Some say to not have all your contracts with one IMO but I prefer to have all of mine with one. But if they didn't carry a company I wanted I would pick it up elsewhere. I happen to be with an IMO, {FEX}, that will grant releases if I wanted to leave. If you are not with one that will release then it's a whole different ballgame. I certainly would not put all my contracts with an IMO that won't release. ----- Personal preference. Some say to not have all your contracts with one IMO but I prefer to have all of mine with one. But if they didn't carry a company I wanted I would pick it up elsewhere. I happen to be with an IMO, {FEX}, that will grant releases if I wanted to leave. If you are not with one that will release then it's a whole different ballgame. I certainly would not put all my contracts with an IMO that won't release. Click to expand... Hmmm, I've sent two emails over the past few days requesting a release from just one carrier, all I've heard is crickets."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Forum · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/selling-for-multiple-imo-fmos.70645/#post-929350>

"John Galt said: Hmmm, I've sent two emails over the past few days requesting a release from just one carrier, all I've heard is crickets. I got it this morning. I thought you and Travis were communications on it. I'll call you today. Just need to verify that you are transferring all contracts that have any risk of debt roll up. Then all is good."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Forum · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/selling-for-multiple-imo-fmos.70645/#post-929396>

"Diversified is offering this right now and hiring over 40 agents before July 1st but absolutely require atleast a year of experience and a release letter, but at least I know it's an option down the road. Can anyone recommend anywhere else in the meantime?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1shv3xs/best_company_to_join_for_agents_new_to_medicare/ofgofhm/

"John Galt said: Hmmm, I've sent two emails over the past few days requesting a release from just one carrier, all I've heard is crickets. Don't beat around the bush...what are you trying to say?"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Forum · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/selling-for-multiple-imo-fmos.70645/#post-929356>

Lead debt and money burned

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj5uxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

"It really just depends on the leads i buy, the most expensive ones right now for me are \$13.00 a lead.. Typically you want to reinvest 10-15% of what you're wanting to make back into your business. So if you want to make 10,000 a month you need to invest at LEAST 1,000 back into leads and stuff like that. It's all about your numbers too. Warm market leads are better than cold market in my opinion. I've spent about \$400 in leads and i've made 2 sales off of those that have covered the \$400 and then some. Life insurance is a little different than other insurance i feel like, you REALLYYYYY have to grind. It's hard but once you figure out your numbers it's like a challenge against yourself every month haha."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jp9c95/it_finally_happened/ml267eh/

"This right here! So many unethical companies too that's exploit their agents and charge for bonk ass leads. My first experience was with HealthMarkets, horrible company, leads are \$36 each all of which are trash. I spent thousands of dollars on leads the first year. I also got taken by FFL, there I only burned \$3,000 in leads, I sold 5 policies, 4 charged back. I'm so happy now that I'm focused on the ACA market only. I don't care about selling life or any other supplemental. People are broke and they care barely afford health insurance as it is."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r86i3q/whats_the_hardest_part_of_being_an_insurance/o62tbgm/

"I've only done a little over a week of actual calls myself. Never regretted any choice so much as the one to go into selling life insurance. Though it's not the angry customers and hang ups that have me burnt out. I had no idea the costs involved in buying leads (on top of licenses), and started this job while already in debt in several areas of life. I'm looking at a foreclosure on my house while barely being able to afford 20 leads a week. Which is too few and only half of what my company expects me to get, and I'm constantly aware of what little money I have left for more leads. I've had very few people even answer the phone (and I call often and have left voicemails), and have yet to get through the first 10 seconds with those few that did, so my confidence has taken a dive. I've made changes to the way respond to those initial objections, I feel I'm better prepared to keep the call going, but I just can't afford to buy more leads to test them out. I'm about to try out a burner in the hopes I can breathe some life into one or two of my old leads and get them to pick up, as well as get the next leads to answer. With all that I might still be able to push through, but having my boss make comments about taking responsibility for ourselves and our destiny, and telling me he took out credit cards when he got started (which I wouldn't be approved for anyway, and already took out my 401k), pretty much led to a meltdown the other day. I'm aware of my shortcomings, and usually good with constructive criticism, but with those I can't control like finances, being told indirectly I'm making excuses has about done me in. Being in on our morning meetings usually gets me pumped and feeling confident but all of a sudden.. it's just gone, and I'm deflated like a balloon. I'm struggling to get back into the mindset I need to be in. Just 20 or so leads a week is costing me \$400, and I'll be almost broke after the next batch I get on Monday, and I just can't escape that thought of what do I do if I don't make a sale. And the live transfers go too fast for me to grab them. They're expensive but at least I would be able to do a presentation and not feel like such a failure so soon after starting. Sorry OP, I'm not very helpful lol. But I feel you. It's not an easy career by any means. I haven't given up but I'm not sure what else I can do when the money runs out. I feel like motivational books might be helpful for you though. Before the meltdown (as I already have issues being naturally confident) I was reading "The magic of thinking big" by David Schwartz. It really was helping with motivation and my frame of mind before now. You might give it a go, it can't hurt."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jxx2oa/i_am_burn_out_and_i_just_started_help/mmups74/

"After spending 7 years with Primerica, from 2004 to 2011, I came to one conclusion. In a lot of Life insurance commission sales jobs, you're either in debt from chargebacks or you're in debt from buying leads. I believe if the opportunity is truly solid, the company should generate the leads, vet the salespeople, and assign qualified opportunities. Pay a little less commission if you have to, but build a higher-quality sales force instead of recruiting everyone with a pulse. The client loses too when a salesperson is struggling financially. When you're desperate for a commission, it's easy to develop "commission breath" and recommend what pays the most instead of what's best for the customer. For the last 14 years I've been in home improvement sales, and I honestly wish I had found this industry when I was 20. The company provides the leads. We sell large-ticket projects that are installed in a few weeks. Customers pay upfront. No chargebacks. No chasing renewals. No worrying about policies lapsing years later. Every sales job has its challenges, but if you're looking for a long-term sales career, don't overlook home services. I wish I had found it sooner."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj5uxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/ouybo4c/

"Thought I'd add my 2 cents...I joined in July of this year and I still believe there is a lot of potential. I'm tracking everything right now. My costs, my earnings, my hours and I've decided to give it 1 year before redirecting because it is a steep, rough learning curve and people say it can take a year to acclimate. But if you are average and you acclimate, you can be quite successful. Don't compare SFG to an hourly job somewhere else, this is much closer to entrepreneurship and with that in mind you're spending more than you are making at the beginning. Here is my opinion on OP's red flags: 1. Aged leads. Yes, if you buy those ones. Which are great for new agents because they offer practice (and possible sales) for a fraction of the cost. For example, my first sale was with an H lead...that's the cheapest .40 cent lead. I spent \$10 in leads and turned that into \$1000. But I've recently been buying A leads (fresh new leads) and it's much more disappointing not to convert those to sales. I estimate that I've spent \$800 on fresh leads this month and have converted that to about \$4000 income. 2. Culture. I love the group/agency I am a part of. A lot of support. A lot of resources. A lot of community and communication. We just got done doing a 60 day health challenge for anyone who wanted to join. The agency has several leaders and I can validate that some leaders ego's and shame responses are too much for me. I don't like how they talk and I don't respond well to that. They are not my direct upline and I'm glad, but my direct upline is fantastic. 3. Permission for licensing. I've never heard of this. I licensed when and where I wanted to. My upline didn't mention anything other than it will help me succeed if I license in more than one state. They helped me find states that have a lot of leads. 4. Shaming over conferences. Yes. I joined a couple months before their conference and the amount of "if you're not signed up for conference, it shows that you are not committed" type of comments were totally off putting. Again my uplines were not a part of that type of verbiage and in fact some of the leaders were encouraging with, "don't worry if you can't make it, those of us that can make it will share what we learn and use it to bring everyone up" type of conversations. I think conference must feel like some kind of club or like even religion and some people believe in it so much that they think it's the truth and way for everyone. I don't subscribe to that type of hype, but I do hope I can go next year because it not only looked educational, but fun...karaoke and costume party and dinners so if I make it past my 1 year mark I plan to attend. 5. The training. This is my first experience in this training so I can't say it's the worst. Probably again depends on the help you get from your agency. I will say, even though I had a very supportive group it felt very self-taught. But they have the resources for it and there are a lot of different trainings to participate in so it is possible to be self taught. It's hard though. Doable for sure! 6. Mental health. I can absolutely understand the toll an unsupported position could and would have on someone...ESPECIALLY in sales. Sales is a beast. You learn a lot about yourself. It's painful at times and I wish it was a nice cut and dry training and 1 month later you feel great. I'm 3 months in with high highs and low lows. A lot of days I want to give up. But ultimately, I want to give it a full chance. I'm making more than I'm spending (including costs for licensing in other states, dialing subscriptions, and the more expensive A leads) and I think that's pretty good for a new agent. These are just my new agent opinions. I haven't had any experiences with other IMOs or insurance jobs or anything like that. My background is stay at home mom, into mental health practice ownership with my husband, back to stay at home mom, and now SFG."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtgo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/nlrman3/

"I spent \$0 on leads as I focused on developing an organic marketing strategy that enabled me to find clients when they needed insurance solve one need reliably and then get the chance to cross sale from that stage."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o2ysrs/how_i_retired_my_wife_with_my_insurance_agency_ama/niyyoc7/

"Get a base plus commission job and life insurance is a hard shitty business imo it's exhausting always making these emotional sales if you want a chill work from home job I did aca insurance from home and made decent money then I went independent spent 40k on leads got defrauded then had to pay back 80k in commissions all at 21 years old we all fuck up sometimes very big lk I have many times but keep on pushing and striving for more eventually u will get it right and it just takes a lot of wrongs I'm routing for you 🍀"

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1eeps5/single_mom_on_public_assistance_is_struggling_at/lfhviti/

"I honestly would love to do this, we spent 6k on leads last month. We did sell 170k in new business (3 producers) but if we could get that lead cost down it would be great. I've never looked into it and would need pointers on where to even start."

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466yj/stop_buying_leads/mo9g2gs/

Captive and call-center jobs: quotas, pay, pressure

"Do you know of any health insurance companies who pays their captive agent on an per hourly basis plus commissions? I just started with mine and its only 100% commission based, so for starters who dont have yet their clientele, money is a struggle. Do you have any advices?"

— YouTube · How Much Does A Health Insurance Agent Makelbeingbougie · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RrGUFRdgtZY&lc=UgzzDyeN1Egxb-37nx4AaABAg>

"I can relate. As a captive agent I get lots of pressure to meet unrealistic sales quotas without any consideration for the quality of calls we are receiving etc. Hostile /cluelessly ignorant management just push harder for the dollar on the ones trying the most instead of boost the team and skill build. Top performing agents are the ones getting quality sale inbound directed to them on the backend through que assignment which I think is sus because it's clear those couple agents will continue doing big numbers while management whips us and acts like we should be able to do the same slam dunk on an outbound quote that was a no sale from the jump. There's some benefits working from home but yeah if the stress and money doesn't make sense it's confusing at times. But aye I worked hard to get where I'm at, ill continue to give my best - just not burn myself out because I've seen my enthusiasm and efforts be taken advantage of or unappreciated. Sometimes I wonder if I'm actually a licensed health insurance broker with a fiduciary responsibility or just a fkn used car salesman 🤔 cause God damn lol Hoping this week is much better tho for everyone here ❤️"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1bggj6l/how_is_everyone_handling_burnout_during_these/kxeuukb/

"If you're building your own P&C book, why not go out and get appointed directly from the carrier? I'm a young P&C agency owner as well, and I've had my life license for about a year now (when I was with State Farm.) I never really liked life, but I know it builds solid retention within your book. So here in the next couple months I'll be looking out for life insurance company appointments. I'd rather sell life occasionally than be stuck working for an upline that mandates sales quotas and gives you crappy leads + takes a large chunk of your commission."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vtziac/my_experience_with_these_instagram_life_insurance/p54kywp/

"I agree with you about the leads determining how you succeed. Where I work we get gaslighted about 'You all get the same phone calls'. LOL, yeah sure. We know the top reps are in a queue where they get 3 deals by noon and us newbies don't get 3 quotable leads by noon ever. By quotable I mean, the lead is either on a DSNP and the next closest Plan has 100 less OTC and both plans have 0 co-pays for everything, like for like or calls where there is no SEP to use or the only SEP is Chronic and there are no CSNP plans in the area."

— YouTube · How To Sell 1 Medicare Policy Daily! [The Complete Blueprint] · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TVurscsiJKY&lc=Ugx9YbTFp6404-rkkAp4AaABAgA11aVXaQAIuA7qYB8iYOkD>

"Off-Market plans are OFTEN (though not always) NOT ACA compliant- meaning they don't necessarily cover every one of the 10 Essential Health Benefits (may not cover hospital stays, may not cover pharmacy, may limit the number of visits to a PCP they'll cover, may not cover maternity, may not cover mental health, may not cover preventive 100%-- All things that ACA compliant plans MUST cover to some degree). In general, you may find some comparable plans by going to a carrier directly or hiring a broker to help you research off-market plans. I would urge you not to just "google" and select a random google website and start entering your information- that's how you end up in an ENDLESS cycle of "agents" (and I use this in quotations, because I question their credentials) spam calling you because that website just sold your information to 10,000 "agents". Research reputable brokerage firms in your area- the big names in the game are Lockton, Gallagher, AON, USI, Hub International, Willis Towers Watson, Brown & Brown, etc. and they should all have a department that handles individual coverages. These big firms have LICENSED brokers. \Ask for an ACA compliant plan if you're needing everything I've listed above to be covered and/or if you have pre-existing conditions (non ACA compliant plans can deny a claim just for being pre-existing). If you're asked to fill out any personal health information besides if you're a smoker (they ask for past diagnosis, past surgeries, family history of certain things, etc. in your application) it's a Medically Underwritten plan and not an ACA compliant plan. A reputable licensed broker is connected with several carriers vs. potentially just pushing one carrier or one type of plan (for instance a MEC plan or an indemnity plan-- which are not necessarily ACA compliant but the majority of what I see these scammy agents selling), should be patient enough to walk you through your options, take your concerns into consideration (providers you really need/want to have in network, medications you're currently taking, etc.) when finding you a policy. If you feel rushed or don't like the policies they are presenting, don't be afraid to go to the next broker. However, saying this AS a broker--- the ACA Marketplace is where I instruct my friends to look first as every single one of those plans is a legitimate ACA compliant, comprehensive coverage plan, no matter what you choose. We have a pinned post on walking you through how to pick a plan here: https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1fvniop/questions_answered_which_plan_should_i_choose/ (https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1fvniop/questions_answered_which_plan_should_i_choose/) I don't know that you can pre-pay the ENTIRE year, that's a question you'll have to ask the carrier. We typically see it billed by month-- though if you're not getting a subsidy, I supposed it's possible- in theory."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1qwmym/paying_for_aca_obamacare/o3qda4/

"Don't trust e-health with your bank information!. When filling out the information it asks me my birth date and my age and I filled it out correctly. It gave me a quote that was affordable for me so I gave them my bank information for it to be withdrawn. Then they claimed that the year of birth for me was 2026. Asked them to change it to the correct one. Then they told me the rate would be three times more and tried to take it out of my bank account immediately. I had to stop check on my bank account which caused me a fee. It was obvious that they are trying to meet quotas. Even after filling out a request to cancel the application, they tried to take it out of my bank account. They should ask if I can afford the new quote before taking it out of my bank account. It's obvious that this is some sort of a scam. I will report this to some sort of authority."

— TrustPilot · eHealth Insurance · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6aa416f26f6f32c34dfa7e4f>

"Disappointing process and premium results. Extremely long process. Poor planning for health evaluation. Misleading premium quotation."

— TrustPilot · SelectQuote · 2★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/699b1e3582b26675fbf5900d>